Homero · *Ilíada*

Texto en griego y traducción inglesa alineados por pasaje; cada sección de la traducción figura una sola vez, junto al primer pasaje que abarca.

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Disposición: el texto griego de cada grupo de pasajes va seguido de la sección correspondiente de la traducción inglesa.

1.1

1 μῆνιν ἄειδε θεὰ Πηληϊάδεω Ἀχιλῆος
2 οὐλομένην, ἣ μυρί’ Ἀχαιοῖς ἄλγε’ ἔθηκε,
3 πολλὰς δ’ ἰφθίμους ψυχὰς Ἄϊδι προΐαψεν
4 ἡρώων, αὐτοὺς δὲ ἑλώρια τεῦχε κύνεσσιν
5 οἰωνοῖσί τε πᾶσι, Διὸς δ’ ἐτελείετο βουλή,
6 ἐξ οὗ δὴ τὰ πρῶτα διαστήτην ἐρίσαντε
7 Ἀτρεΐδης τε ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν καὶ δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς.
8 τίς τ’ ἄρ σφωε θεῶν ἔριδι ξυνέηκε μάχεσθαι;
9 Λητοῦς καὶ Διὸς υἱός· ὃ γὰρ βασιλῆϊ χολωθεὶς
10 νοῦσον ἀνὰ στρατὸν ὄρσε κακήν, ὀλέκοντο δὲ λαοί,
11 οὕνεκα τὸν Χρύσην ἠτίμασεν ἀρητῆρα
12 Ἀτρεΐδης· ὃ γὰρ ἦλθε θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
13 λυσόμενός τε θύγατρα φέρων τ’ ἀπερείσι’ ἄποινα,
14 στέμματ’ ἔχων ἐν χερσὶν ἑκηβόλου Ἀπόλλωνος
15 χρυσέῳ ἀνὰ σκήπτρῳ, καὶ λίσσετο πάντας Ἀχαιούς,
16 Ἀτρεΐδα δὲ μάλιστα δύω, κοσμήτορε λαῶν·
17 Ἀτρεΐδαι τε καὶ ἄλλοι ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοί,
18 ὑμῖν μὲν θεοὶ δοῖεν Ὀλύμπια δώματ’ ἔχοντες
19 ἐκπέρσαι Πριάμοιο πόλιν, εὖ δ’ οἴκαδ’ ἱκέσθαι·
20 παῖδα δ’ ἐμοὶ λύσαιτε φίλην, τὰ δ’ ἄποινα δέχεσθαι,
21 ἁζόμενοι Διὸς υἱὸν ἑκηβόλον Ἀπόλλωνα.
22 ἔνθ’ ἄλλοι μὲν πάντες ἐπευφήμησαν Ἀχαιοὶ
23 αἰδεῖσθαί θ’ ἱερῆα καὶ ἀγλαὰ δέχθαι ἄποινα·
24 ἀλλ’ οὐκ Ἀτρεΐδῃ Ἀγαμέμνονι ἤνδανε θυμῷ,
25 ἀλλὰ κακῶς ἀφίει, κρατερὸν δ’ ἐπὶ μῦθον ἔτελλε·
26 μή σε γέρον κοίλῃσιν ἐγὼ παρὰ νηυσὶ κιχείω
27 ἢ νῦν δηθύνοντ’ ἢ ὕστερον αὖτις ἰόντα,
28 μή νύ τοι οὐ χραίσμῃ σκῆπτρον καὶ στέμμα θεοῖο·
29 τὴν δ’ ἐγὼ οὐ λύσω· πρίν μιν καὶ γῆρας ἔπεισιν
30 ἡμετέρῳ ἐνὶ οἴκῳ ἐν Ἄργεϊ τηλόθι πάτρης

Sing, O goddess, the anger [mênis] of Achilles son of Peleus, that brought countless ills upon the Achaeans. Many a brave soul [psukhê] did it send hurrying down to Hades, and many a hero did it yield a prey to dogs and vultures, for so was the will of Zeus fulfilled from the day on which the son of Atreus, king of men, and great Achilles, first fell out with one another. And which of the gods was it that set them on to quarrel? It was the son of Zeus and Leto; for he was angry with the king and sent a pestilence upon the host to plague the people, because the son of Atreus had dishonored Chryses his priest. Now Chryses had come to the ships of the Achaeans to free his daughter, and had brought with him a great

ransom: moreover he bore in his hand the scepter of Apollo wreathed with a suppliant's wreath and he besought the Achaeans, but most of all the two sons of Atreus, who were their chiefs. "Sons of Atreus," he cried, "and all other Achaeans, may the gods who dwell in Olympus grant you to sack the city of Priam, and to reach your homes in safety; but free my daughter, and accept a ransom for her, in reverence to Apollo, son of Zeus." On this the rest of the Achaeans with one voice were for respecting the priest and taking the ransom that he offered; but not so Agamemnon, who spoke fiercely to him and sent him roughly away. "Old man," said he, "let me not find you tarrying about our ships, nor yet coming hereafter. Your scepter of the god and your wreath shall profit you nothing. I will not free her. She shall grow old in my house at Argos far from her own home, busying herself with her loom and visiting my couch; so go, and do not provoke me or it shall be the worse for you." The old man feared him and obeyed. Not a word he spoke, but went by the shore of the sounding sea and prayed apart to King Apollo whom lovely Leto had borne. "Hear me," he cried, "O god of the silver bow, you who protect Chryse and holy Cilla and rule Tenedos with your might, hear me O god of Sminthe. If I have ever decked your temple with garlands,

1.31

31 ἱστὸν ἐποιχομένην καὶ ἐμὸν λέχος ἀντιόωσαν·
32 ἀλλ᾽ ἴθι μή μ᾽ ἐρέθιζε σαώτερος ὥς κε νέηαι.
33 ὣς ἔφατ᾽, ἔδεισεν δ᾽ ὃ γέρων καὶ ἐπείθετο μύθῳ·
34 βῆ δ᾽ ἀκέων παρὰ θῖνα πολυφλοίσβοιο θαλάσσης·
35 πολλὰ δ᾽ ἔπειτ᾽ ἀπάνευθε κιὼν ἠρᾶθ᾽ ὁ γεραιὸς
36 Ἀπόλλωνι ἄνακτι, τὸν ἠΰκομος τέκε Λητώ·
37 κλῦθί μευ ἀργυρότοξ᾽, ὃς Χρύσην ἀμφιβέβηκας
38 Κίλλαν τε ζαθέην Τενέδοιό τε ἶφι ἀνάσσεις,
39 Σμινθεῦ εἴ ποτέ τοι χαρίεντ᾽ ἐπὶ νηὸν ἔρεψα,
40 ἢ εἰ δή ποτέ τοι κατὰ πίονα μηρί᾽ ἔκηα
41 ταύρων ἠδ᾽ αἰγῶν, τὸ δέ μοι κρήηνον ἐέλδωρ·
42 τίσειαν Δαναοὶ ἐμὰ δάκρυα σοῖσι βέλεσσιν.
43 ὣς ἔφατ᾽ εὐχόμενος, τοῦ δ᾽ ἔκλυε Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων,
44 βῆ δὲ κατ᾽ Οὐλύμποιο καρήνων χωόμενος κῆρ,
45 τόξ᾽ ὤμοισιν ἔχων ἀμφηρεφέα τε φαρέτρην·
46 ἔκλαγξαν δ᾽ ἄρ᾽ ὀϊστοὶ ἐπ᾽ ὤμων χωομένοιο,
47 αὐτοῦ κινηθέντος· ὃ δ᾽ ἤϊε νυκτὶ ἐοικώς.
48 ἕζετ᾽ ἔπειτ᾽ ἀπάνευθε νεῶν, μετὰ δ᾽ ἰὸν ἔηκε·
49 δεινὴ δὲ κλαγγὴ γένετ᾽ ἀργυρέοιο βιοῖο·
50 οὐρῆας μὲν πρῶτον ἐπῴχετο καὶ κύνας ἀργούς,
51 αὐτὰρ ἔπειτ᾽ αὐτοῖσι βέλος ἐχεπευκὲς ἐφιεὶς
52 βάλλ᾽· αἰεὶ δὲ πυραὶ νεκύων καίοντο θαμειαί.
53 ἐννῆμαρ μὲν ἀνὰ στρατὸν ᾤχετο κῆλα θεοῖο,
54 τῇ δεκάτῃ δ᾽ ἀγορὴν δὲ καλέσσατο λαὸν Ἀχιλλεύς·
55 τῷ γὰρ ἐπὶ φρεσὶ θῆκε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη·
56 κήδετο γὰρ Δαναῶν, ὅτι ῥα θνήσκοντας ὁρᾶτο.
57 οἳ δ᾽ ἐπεὶ οὖν ἤγερθεν ὁμηγερέες τε γένοντο,
58 τοῖσι δ᾽ ἀνιστάμενος μετέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
59 Ἀτρεΐδη νῦν ἄμμε παλιμπλαγχθέντας οἴω
60 ἂψ ἀπονοστήσειν, εἴ κεν θάνατόν γε φύγοιμεν,

or burned for you thigh-bones in fat of bulls or goats, grant my prayer, and let your arrows avenge these my tears upon the Danaans." Thus did he pray, and Apollo heard his prayer. He came down furious from the summits of Olympus, with his bow and his quiver upon his shoulder, and the arrows rattled on his back with the rage that trembled within him. He sat

himself down away from the ships with a face as dark as night, and his silver bow rang death as he shot his arrow in the midst of them. First he smote their mules and their hounds, but presently he aimed his shafts at the people themselves, and all day long the pyres of the dead were burning. For nine whole days he shot his arrows among the people, but upon the tenth day Achilles called them in assembly - moved thereto by Hera, who saw the Achaeans in their death-throes and had compassion upon them. Then, when they were got together, he rose and spoke among them. "Son of Atreus," said he, "I deem that we should now turn roving home if we would escape destruction, for we are being cut down by war and pestilence at once. Let us ask some priest or seer [mantis], or some reader of dreams (for dreams, too, are of Zeus) who can tell us why Phoebus Apollo is so angry, and say whether it is for some vow that we have broken, or hecatomb that we have not offered, and whether he will accept the savor of lambs and goats without blemish, so as to take away the plague from us." With these words he sat down, and Kalkhas son of Thestor, wisest of augurs, who knew things past present and to come, rose to speak. He it was who had guided the Achaeans with their fleet to Ilion, through the prophesyings with which Phoebus Apollo had inspired him. With all sincerity and goodwill he addressed them thus: - "Achilles, loved of heaven, you bid me tell you about the anger [mênis] of King Apollo, I will therefore do so; but consider first and swear that you will stand by me heartily in word and deed, for I know that I shall offend one who rules the Argives with might, to whom all the Achaeans are in subjection.

1.61

61 εἰ δὴ ὁμοῦ πόλεμός τε δαμᾷ καὶ λοιμὸς Ἀχαιούς·
62 ἀλλ’ ἄγε δή τινα μάντιν ἐρείομεν ἢ ἱερῆα
63 ἢ καὶ ὀνειροπόλον, καὶ γάρ τ’ ὄναρ ἐκ Διός ἐστιν,
64 ὅς κ’ εἴποι ὅ τι τόσσον ἐχώσατο Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων,
65 εἴτ’ ἄρ’ ὅ γ’ εὐχωλῆς ἐπιμέμφεται ἠδ’ ἑκατόμβης,
66 αἴ κέν πως ἀρνῶν κνίσης αἰγῶν τε τελείων
67 βούλεται ἀντιάσας ἡμῖν ἀπὸ λοιγὸν ἀμῦναι.
68 ἤτοι ὅ γ’ ὣς εἰπὼν κατ’ ἄρ’ ἕζετο· τοῖσι δ’ ἀνέστη
69 Κάλχας Θεστορίδης οἰωνοπόλων ὄχ’ ἄριστος,
70 ὃς ᾔδη τά τ’ ἐόντα τά τ’ ἐσσόμενα πρό τ’ ἐόντα,
71 καὶ νήεσσ’ ἡγήσατ’ Ἀχαιῶν Ἴλιον εἴσω
72 ἣν διὰ μαντοσύνην, τήν οἱ πόρε Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων·
73 ὅ σφιν ἐὺ φρονέων ἀγορήσατο καὶ μετέειπεν·
74 ὦ Ἀχιλεῦ κέλεαί με Διῒ φίλε μυθήσασθαι
75 μῆνιν Ἀπόλλωνος ἑκατηβελέταο ἄνακτος·
76 τοὶ γὰρ ἐγὼν ἐρέω· σὺ δὲ σύνθεο καί μοι ὄμοσσον
77 ἦ μέν μοι πρόφρων ἔπεσιν καὶ χερσὶν ἀρήξειν·
78 ἦ γὰρ ὀΐομαι ἄνδρα χολωσέμεν, ὃς μέγα πάντων
79 Ἀργείων κρατέει καί οἱ πείθονται Ἀχαιοί·
80 κρείσσων γὰρ βασιλεὺς ὅτε χώσεται ἀνδρὶ χέρηϊ·
81 εἴ περ γάρ τε χόλον γε καὶ αὐτῆμαρ καταπέψῃ,
82 ἀλλά τε καὶ μετόπισθεν ἔχει κότον, ὄφρα τελέσσῃ,
83 ἐν στήθεσσιν ἑοῖσι· σὺ δὲ φράσαι εἴ με σαώσεις.
84 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
85 θαρσήσας μάλα εἰπὲ θεοπρόπιον ὅ τι οἶσθα·
86 οὐ μὰ γὰρ Ἀπόλλωνα Διῒ φίλον, ᾧ τε σὺ Κάλχαν
87 εὐχόμενος Δαναοῖσι θεοπροπίας ἀναφαίνεις,
88 οὔ τις ἐμεῦ ζῶντος καὶ ἐπὶ χθονὶ δερκομένοιο
89 σοὶ κοίλῃς παρὰ νηυσί βαρείας χεῖρας ἐποίσει

90 συμπάντων Δαναῶν, οὐδ’ ἢν Ἀγαμέμνονα εἴπῃς,
A plain man cannot stand against the anger of a king, who if he swallow his displeasure now, will yet nurse revenge till he has wreaked it. Consider, therefore, whether or no you will protect me." And Achilles answered, "Fear not, but speak as it is borne in upon you from heaven, for by Apollo, Kalkhas, to whom you pray, and whose oracles you reveal to us, not a Danaan at our ships shall lay his hand upon you, while I yet live to look upon the face of the earth - no, not though you name Agamemnon himself, who is by far the foremost of the Achaeans." Thereon the seer [mantis] spoke boldly. "The god," he said, "is angry neither about vow nor hecatomb, but for his priest's sake, whom Agamemnon has dishonored, in that he would not free his daughter nor take a ransom for her; therefore has he sent these evils upon us, and will yet send others. He will not deliver the Danaans from this pestilence till Agamemnon has restored the girl without fee or ransom to her father, and has sent a holy hecatomb to Chryse. Thus we may perhaps appease him." With these words he sat down, and Agamemnon rose in anger. His heart was black with rage, and his eyes flashed fire as he scowled on Kalkhas and said, "Seer [mantis] of evil, you never yet prophesied smooth things concerning me, but have ever loved to foretell that which was evil. You have brought me neither comfort nor performance; and now you come seeing among Danaans, and saying that Apollo has plagued us because I would not take a ransom for this girl, the daughter of Chryses. I have set my heart on keeping her in my own house, for I love her better even than my own wife Clytemnestra, whose peer she is alike in form and feature, in understanding and accomplishments. Still I will give her up if I must, for I would have the people live, not die; but you must find me a prize instead, or I alone among the Argives shall be without one. This is not well;

1.91

91 ὃς νῦν πολλὸν ἄριστος Ἀχαιῶν εὔχεται εἶναι.
92 καὶ τότε δὴ θάρσησε καὶ ηὔδα μάντις ἀμύμων·
93 οὔ τ’ ἄρ ὅ γ’ εὐχωλῆς ἐπιμέμφεται οὐδ’ ἑκατόμβης,
94 ἀλλ’ ἕνεκ’ ἀρητῆρος ὃν ἠτίμησ’ Ἀγαμέμνων,
95 οὐδ’ ἀπέλυσε θύγατρα καὶ οὐκ ἀπεδέξατ’ ἄποινα,
96 τοὔνεκ’ ἄρ’ ἄλγε’ ἔδωκεν ἑκηβόλος ἠδ’ ἔτι δώσει·
97 οὐδ’ ὅ γε πρὶν Δαναοῖσιν ἀεικέα λοιγὸν ἀπώσει
98 πρίν γ’ ἀπὸ πατρὶ φίλῳ δόμεναι ἑλικώπιδα κούρην
99 ἀπριάτην ἀνάποινον, ἄγειν θ’ ἱερὴν ἑκατόμβην
100 ἐς Χρύσην· τότε κέν μιν ἱλασσάμενοι πεπίθοιμεν.
101 ἤτοι ὅ γ’ ὣς εἰπὼν κατ’ ἄρ’ ἕζετο· τοῖσι δ’ ἀνέστη
102 ἥρως Ἀτρεΐδης εὐρὺ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
103 ἀχνύμενος· μένεος δὲ μέγα φρένες ἀμφιμέλαιναι
104 πίμπλαντ’, ὄσσε δέ οἱ πυρὶ λαμπετόωντι ἐΐκτην·
105 Κάλχαντα πρώτιστα κάκ’ ὀσσόμενος προσέειπε·
106 μάντι κακῶν οὐ πώ ποτέ μοι τὸ κρήγυον εἶπας·
107 αἰεί τοι τὰ κάκ’ ἐστὶ φίλα φρεσὶ μαντεύεσθαι,
108 ἐσθλὸν δ’ οὔτέ τί πω εἶπας ἔπος οὔτ’ ἐτέλεσσας·
109 καὶ νῦν ἐν Δαναοῖσι θεοπροπέων ἀγορεύεις
110 ὡς δὴ τοῦδ’ ἕνεκά σφιν ἑκηβόλος ἄλγεα τεύχει,
111 οὕνεκ’ ἐγὼ κούρης Χρυσηΐδος ἀγλά’ ἄποινα
112 οὐκ ἔθελον δέξασθαι, ἐπεὶ πολὺ βούλομαι αὐτὴν
113 οἴκοι ἔχειν· καὶ γάρ ῥα Κλυταιμνήστρης προβέβουλα
114 κουριδίης ἀλόχου, ἐπεὶ οὔ ἑθέν ἐστι χερείων,
115 οὐ δέμας οὐδὲ φυήν, οὔτ’ ἂρ φρένας οὔτέ τι ἔργα.
116 ἀλλὰ καὶ ὣς ἐθέλω δόμεναι πάλιν εἰ τό γ’ ἄμεινον·

117 βούλομ’ ἐγὼ λαὸν σῶν ἔμμεναι ἢ ἀπολέσθαι·
118 αὐτὰρ ἐμοὶ γέρας αὐτίχ’ ἑτοιμάσατ’ ὄφρα μὴ οἶος
119 Ἀργείων ἀγέραστος ἔω, ἐπεὶ οὐδὲ ἔοικε·
120 λεύσσετε γὰρ τό γε πάντες ὅ μοι γέρας ἔρχεται ἄλλῃ.
for you behold, all of you, that my prize is to go elsewhere." And Achilles answered, "Most noble son of Atreus, covetous beyond all humankind, how shall the Achaeans find you another prize? We have no common store from which to take one. Those we took from the cities have been awarded; we cannot disallow the awards that have been made already. Give this girl, therefore, to the god, and if ever Zeus grants us to sack the city of Troy we will requite you three and fourfold." Then Agamemnon said, "Achilles, valiant though you be, you shall not thus get the better of me in matters of the mind [noos]. You shall not overreach and you shall not persuade me. Are you to keep your own prize, while I sit tamely under my loss and give up the girl at your bidding? Let the Achaeans find me a prize in fair exchange to my liking, or I will come and take your own, or that of Ajax or of Odysseus; and he to whomsoever I may come shall rue my coming. But of this we will take thought hereafter; for the present, let us draw a ship into the sea, and find a crew for her expressly; let us put a hecatomb on board, and let us send Chryseis also; further, let some chief man among us be in command, either Ajax, or Idomeneus, or yourself, son of Peleus, mighty warrior that you are, that we may offer sacrifice and appease the anger of the god." Achilles scowled at him and answered, "You are steeped in insolence and lust of gain. With what heart can any of the Achaeans do your bidding, either on foray or in open fighting? I came to make war here not because the Trojans are responsible [aitioi] for any wrong committed against me. I have no quarrel with them. They have not raided my cattle nor my horses, nor cut down my harvests on the fertile plains of Phthia; for between me and them there is a great space, both mountain and sounding sea. We have followed you, Sir Insolence! for your pleasure, not ours - to gain satisfaction [timê] from the Trojans for your shameless self and for Menelaos.

1.121

121 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
122 Ἀτρεΐδη κύδιστε φιλοκτεανώτατε πάντων,
123 πῶς γάρ τοι δώσουσι γέρας μεγάθυμοι Ἀχαιοί;
124 οὐδέ τί που ἴδμεν ξυνήϊα κείμενα πολλά·
125 ἀλλὰ τὰ μὲν πολίων ἐξεπράθομεν, τὰ δέδασται,
126 λαοὺς δ’ οὐκ ἐπέοικε παλίλλογα ταῦτ’ ἐπαγείρειν.
127 ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν νῦν τήνδε θεῷ πρόες· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
128 τριπλῇ τετραπλῇ τ’ ἀποτείσομεν, αἴ κέ ποθι Ζεὺς
129 δῷσι πόλιν Τροίην εὐτείχεον ἐξαλαπάξαι.
130 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων·
131 μὴ δ’ οὕτως ἀγαθός περ ἐὼν θεοείκελ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ
132 κλέπτε νόῳ, ἐπεὶ οὐ παρελεύσεαι οὐδέ με πείσεις.
133 ἦ ἐθέλεις ὄφρ’ αὐτὸς ἔχῃς γέρας, αὐτὰρ ἔμ’ αὖτως
134 ἧσθαι δευόμενον, κέλεαι δέ με τήνδ’ ἀποδοῦναι;
135 ἀλλ’ εἰ μὲν δώσουσι γέρας μεγάθυμοι Ἀχαιοὶ
136 ἄρσαντες κατὰ θυμὸν ὅπως ἀντάξιον ἔσται·
137 εἰ δέ κε μὴ δώωσιν ἐγὼ δέ κεν αὐτὸς ἕλωμαι
138 ἢ τεὸν ἢ Αἴαντος ἰὼν γέρας, ἢ Ὀδυσῆος
139 ἄξω ἑλών· ὃ δέ κεν κεχολώσεται ὅν κεν ἵκωμαι.
140 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι μὲν ταῦτα μεταφρασόμεσθα καὶ αὖτις,
141 νῦν δ’ ἄγε νῆα μέλαιναν ἐρύσσομεν εἰς ἅλα δῖαν,
142 ἐν δ’ ἐρέτας ἐπιτηδὲς ἀγείρομεν, ἐς δ’ ἑκατόμβην

143 θείομεν, ἂν δ’ αὐτὴν Χρυσηΐδα καλλιπάρῃον
144 βήσομεν· εἷς δέ τις ἀρχὸς ἀνὴρ βουληφόρος ἔστω,
145 ἢ Αἴας ἢ Ἰδομενεὺς ἢ δῖος Ὀδυσσεὺς
146 ἠὲ σὺ Πηλεΐδη πάντων ἐκπαγλότατ’ ἀνδρῶν,
147 ὄφρ’ ἤμιν ἐκάεργον ἱλάσσεαι ἱερὰ ῥέξας.
148 τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
149 ὤ μοι ἀναιδείην ἐπιειμένε κερδαλεόφρον
150 πῶς τίς τοι πρόφρων ἔπεσιν πείθηται Ἀχαιῶν

1.151

151 ἢ ὁδὸν ἐλθέμεναι ἢ ἀνδράσιν ἶφι μάχεσθαι;
152 οὐ γὰρ ἐγὼ Τρώων ἕνεκ’ ἦλυθον αἰχμητάων
153 δεῦρο μαχησόμενος, ἐπεὶ οὔ τί μοι αἴτιοί εἰσιν·
154 οὐ γὰρ πώποτ’ ἐμὰς βοῦς ἤλασαν οὐδὲ μὲν ἵππους,
155 οὐδέ ποτ’ ἐν Φθίῃ ἐριβώλακι βωτιανείρῃ
156 καρπὸν ἐδηλήσαντ’, ἐπεὶ ἦ μάλα πολλὰ μεταξὺ
157 οὔρεά τε σκιόεντα θάλασσά τε ἠχήεσσα·
158 ἀλλὰ σοὶ ὦ μέγ’ ἀναιδὲς ἅμ’ ἑσπόμεθ’ ὄφρα σὺ χαίρῃς,
159 τιμὴν ἀρνύμενοι Μενελάῳ σοί τε κυνῶπα
160 πρὸς Τρώων· τῶν οὔ τι μετατρέπῃ οὐδ’ ἀλεγίζεις·
161 καὶ δή μοι γέρας αὐτὸς ἀφαιρήσεσθαι ἀπειλεῖς,
162 ᾧ ἔπι πολλὰ μόγησα, δόσαν δέ μοι υἷες Ἀχαιῶν.
163 οὐ μὲν σοί ποτε ἶσον ἔχω γέρας ὁππότ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
164 Τρώων ἐκπέρσωσ’ εὖ ναιόμενον πτολίεθρον·
165 ἀλλὰ τὸ μὲν πλεῖον πολυάϊκος πολέμοιο
166 χεῖρες ἐμαὶ διέπουσ’· ἀτὰρ ἤν ποτε δασμὸς ἵκηται,
167 σοὶ τὸ γέρας πολὺ μεῖζον, ἐγὼ δ’ ὀλίγον τε φίλον τε
168 ἔρχομ’ ἔχων ἐπὶ νῆας, ἐπεί κε κάμω πολεμίζων.
169 νῦν δ’ εἶμι Φθίην δ’, ἐπεὶ ἦ πολὺ φέρτερόν ἐστιν
170 οἴκαδ’ ἴμεν σὺν νηυσὶ κορωνίσιν, οὐδέ σ’ ὄΐω
171 ἐνθάδ’ ἄτιμος ἐὼν ἄφενος καὶ πλοῦτον ἀφύξειν.
172 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
173 φεῦγε μάλ’ εἴ τοι θυμὸς ἐπέσσυται, οὐδέ σ’ ἔγωγε
174 λίσσομαι εἵνεκ’ ἐμεῖο μένειν· πάρ’ ἔμοιγε καὶ ἄλλοι
175 οἵ κέ με τιμήσουσι, μάλιστα δὲ μητίετα Ζεύς.
176 ἔχθιστος δέ μοί ἐσσι διοτρεφέων βασιλήων·
177 αἰεὶ γάρ τοι ἔρις τε φίλη πόλεμοί τε μάχαι τε·
178 εἰ μάλα καρτερός ἐσσι, θεός που σοὶ τό γ’ ἔδωκεν·
179 οἴκαδ’ ἰὼν σὺν νηυσί τε σῇς καὶ σοῖς ἑτάροισι
180 Μυρμιδόνεσσιν ἄνασσε, σέθεν δ’ ἐγὼ οὐκ ἀλεγίζω,

You forget this, and threaten to rob me of the prize for which I have toiled, and which the sons of the Achaeans have given me. Never when the Achaeans sack any rich city of the Trojans do I receive so good a prize as you do, though it is my hands that do the better part of the fighting. When the sharing comes, your share is far the largest, and I, indeed, must go back to my ships, take what I can get and be thankful, when my labor of fighting is done. Now, therefore, I shall go back to Phthia; it will be much better for me to return home with my ships, for I will not stay here dishonored to gather gold and substance for you." And Agamemnon answered, "Flee if you will, I shall make you no prayers to stay you. I have others here who will do me honor, and above all Zeus, the lord of counsel. There is no king here so hateful to me as you are, for you are ever quarrelsome and ill affected. What though you be brave? Was it not heaven that made you so? Go home, then, with your ships and

comrades to lord it over the Myrmidons. I care neither for you nor for your anger; and thus will I do: since Phoebus Apollo is taking Chryseis from me, I shall send her with my ship and my followers, but I shall come to your tent and take your own prize Briseis, that you may learn how much more prestigious I am than you are, and that another may fear to set himself up as equal or comparable with me." The son of Peleus felt grief [akhos], and his heart within his shaggy breast was divided whether to draw his sword, push the others aside, and kill the son of Atreus, or to restrain himself and check his anger. While he was thus in two minds, and was drawing his mighty sword from its scabbard, Athena came down from heaven (for Hera had sent her in the love she bore to them both), and seized the son of Peleus by his yellow hair, visible to him alone, for of the others no man could see her. Achilles turned in amaze, and by the fire that flashed from her eyes at once knew that she was

1.181

181 οὐδ’ ὄθομαι κοτέοντος· ἀπειλήσω δέ τοι ὧδε·
182 ὡς ἔμ’ ἀφαιρεῖται Χρυσηΐδα Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων,
183 τὴν μὲν ἐγὼ σὺν νηΐ τ’ ἐμῇ καὶ ἐμοῖς ἑτάροισι
184 πέμψω, ἐγὼ δέ κ’ ἄγω Βρισηΐδα καλλιπάρῃον
185 αὐτὸς ἰὼν κλισίην δὲ τὸ σὸν γέρας ὄφρ’ ἐῢ εἰδῇς
186 ὅσσον φέρτερός εἰμι σέθεν, στυγέῃ δὲ καὶ ἄλλος
187 ἶσον ἐμοὶ φάσθαι καὶ ὁμοιωθήμεναι ἄντην.
188 ὣς φάτο· Πηλεΐωνι δ’ ἄχος γένετ’, ἐν δέ οἱ ἦτορ
189 στήθεσσιν λασίοισι διάνδιχα μερμήριξεν,
190 ἢ ὅ γε φάσγανον ὀξὺ ἐρυσσάμενος παρὰ μηροῦ
191 τοὺς μὲν ἀναστήσειεν, ὃ δ’ Ἀτρεΐδην ἐναρίζοι,
192 ἦε χόλον παύσειεν ἐρητύσειέ τε θυμόν.
193 ἦος ὃ ταῦθ’ ὥρμαινε κατὰ φρένα καὶ κατὰ θυμόν,
194 ἔλκετο δ’ ἐκ κολεοῖο μέγα ξίφος, ἦλθε δ’ Ἀθήνη
195 οὐρανόθεν· πρὸ γὰρ ἧκε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη
196 ἄμφω ὁμῶς θυμῷ φιλέουσά τε κηδομένη τε·
197 στῆ δ’ ὄπιθεν, ξανθῆς δὲ κόμης ἕλε Πηλεΐωνα
198 οἴῳ φαινομένη· τῶν δ’ ἄλλων οὔ τις ὁρᾶτο·
199 θάμβησεν δ’ Ἀχιλεύς, μετὰ δ’ ἐτράπετ’, αὐτίκα δ’ ἔγνω
200 Παλλάδ’ Ἀθηναίην· δεινὼ δέ οἱ ὄσσε φάανθεν·
201 καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
202 τίπτ’ αὖτ’ αἰγιόχοιο Διὸς τέκος εἰλήλουθας;
203 ἦ ἵνα ὕβριν ἴδῃ Ἀγαμέμνονος Ἀτρεΐδαο;
204 ἀλλ’ ἔκ τοι ἐρέω, τὸ δὲ καὶ τελέεσθαι ὀΐω·
205 ᾗς ὑπεροπλίῃσι τάχ’ ἄν ποτε θυμὸν ὀλέσσῃ.
206 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·
207 ἦλθον ἐγὼ παύσουσα τὸ σὸν μένος, αἴ κε πίθηαι,
208 οὐρανόθεν· πρὸ δέ μ’ ἧκε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη
209 ἄμφω ὁμῶς θυμῷ φιλέουσά τε κηδομένη τε·
210 ἀλλ’ ἄγε λῆγ’ ἔριδος, μηδὲ ξίφος ἕλκεο χειρί·

Athena. "Why are you here," said he, "daughter of aegis-bearing Zeus? To see the pride [hubris] of Agamemnon, son of Atreus? Let me tell you - and it shall surely be - he shall pay for this insolence with his life." And Athena said, "I come from heaven, if you will hear me, to bid you stay your anger. Hera has sent me, who cares for both of you alike. Cease, then, this brawling, and do not draw your sword; rail at him if you will, and your railing will not be vain, for I tell you - and it shall surely be - that you shall hereafter receive gifts three times as splendid by reason of this present insult [hubris]. Hold, therefore, and obey."

"Goddess," answered Achilles, "however angry a man may be, he must do as you two command him. This will be best, for the gods ever hear the prayers of him who has obeyed them." He stayed his hand on the silver hilt of his sword, and thrust it back into the scabbard as Athena bade him. Then she went back to Olympus among the other gods [daimones], and to the house of aegis-bearing Zeus. But the son of Peleus again began railing at the son of Atreus, for he was still in a rage. "Wine-bibber," he cried, "with the face of a dog and the heart of a hind, you never dare to go out with the host in fight, nor yet with our chosen men in ambuscade. You shun this as you do death itself. You had rather go round and rob his prizes from any man who contradicts you. You devour your people, for you are king over a feeble folk; otherwise, son of Atreus, henceforward you would insult no man. Therefore I say, and swear it with a great oath - nay, by this my scepter which shall sprout neither leaf nor shoot, nor bud anew from the day on which it left its parent stem upon the mountains - for the axe stripped it of leaf and bark, and now the sons of the Achaeans bear it as judges and guardians of the decrees [themistes] of heaven - so surely and solemnly do I swear

1.211

211 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι ἔπεσιν μὲν ὀνείδισον ὡς ἔσεταί περ·
212 ὧδε γὰρ ἐξερέω, τὸ δὲ καὶ τετελεσμένον ἔσται·
213 καί ποτέ τοι τρὶς τόσσα παρέσσεται ἀγλαὰ δῶρα
214 ὕβριος εἵνεκα τῆσδε· σὺ δ’ ἴσχεο, πείθεο δ’ ἡμῖν.
215 τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
216 χρὴ μὲν σφωΐτερόν γε θεὰ ἔπος εἰρύσσασθαι
217 καὶ μάλα περ θυμῷ κεχολωμένον· ὧς γὰρ ἄμεινον·
218 ὅς κε θεοῖς ἐπιπείθηται μάλα τ’ ἔκλυον αὐτοῦ.
219 ἦ καὶ ἐπ’ ἀργυρέῃ κώπῃ σχέθε χεῖρα βαρεῖαν,
220 ἂψ δ’ ἐς κουλεὸν ὦσε μέγα ξίφος, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε
221 μύθῳ Ἀθηναίης· ἣ δ’ Οὔλυμπον δὲ βεβήκει
222 δώματ’ ἐς αἰγιόχοιο Διὸς μετὰ δαίμονας ἄλλους.
223 Πηλεΐδης δ’ ἐξαῦτις ἀταρτηροῖς ἐπέεσσιν
224 Ἀτρεΐδην προσέειπε, καὶ οὔ πω λῆγε χόλοιο·
225 οἰνοβαρές, κυνὸς ὄμματ’ ἔχων, κραδίην δ’ ἐλάφοιο,
226 οὔτέ ποτ’ ἐς πόλεμον ἅμα λαῷ θωρηχθῆναι
227 οὔτε λόχον δ’ ἰέναι σὺν ἀριστήεσσιν Ἀχαιῶν
228 τέτληκας θυμῷ· τὸ δέ τοι κὴρ εἶδεται εἶναι.
229 ἦ πολὺ λώϊόν ἐστι κατὰ στρατὸν εὐρὺν Ἀχαιῶν
230 δῶρ’ ἀποαιρεῖσθαι ὅς τις σέθεν ἀντίον εἴπῃ·
231 δημοβόρος βασιλεὺς ἐπεὶ οὐτιδανοῖσιν ἀνάσσεις·
232 ἦ γὰρ ἂν Ἀτρεΐδη νῦν ὕστατα λωβήσαιο.
233 ἀλλ’ ἔκ τοι ἐρέω καὶ ἐπὶ μέγαν ὅρκον ὀμοῦμαι·
234 ναὶ μὰ τόδε σκῆπτρον, τὸ μὲν οὔ ποτε φύλλα καὶ ὄζους
235 φύσει, ἐπεὶ δὴ πρῶτα τομὴν ἐν ὄρεσσι λέλοιπεν,
236 οὐδ’ ἀναθηλήσει· περὶ γάρ ῥά ἑ χαλκὸς ἔλεψε
237 φύλλά τε καὶ φλοιόν· νῦν αὖτέ μιν υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
238 ἐν παλάμῃς φορέουσι δικασπόλοι, οἵ τε θέμιστας
239 πρὸς Διὸς εἰρύαται· ὃ δέ τοι μέγας ἔσσεται ὅρκος·
240 ἦ ποτ’ Ἀχιλλῆος ποθὴ ἵξεται υἷας Ἀχαιῶν
that hereafter they shall look fondly for Achilles and shall not find him. In the day of your distress, when your men fall dying by the murderous hand of Hektor, you shall not know how to help them, and shall rend your heart with rage for the hour when you offered insult to the best [aristos] of the Achaeans." With this the son of Peleus dashed his gold-bestudded

scepter on the ground and took his seat, while the son of Atreus was beginning fiercely from his place upon the other side. Then stood up smooth-tongued Nestor, the facile speaker of the Pylians, and the words fell from his lips sweeter than honey. Two generations of men born and bred in Pylos had passed away under his rule, and he was now reigning over the third. With all sincerity and goodwill, therefore, he addressed them thus: - "Of a truth," he said, "a great sorrow [penthos] has befallen the Achaean land. Surely Priam with his sons would rejoice, and the Trojans be glad at heart if they could hear this quarrel between you two, who are so excellent in fight and counsel. I am older than either of you; therefore be guided by me. Moreover I have been the familiar friend of men even greater than you are, and they did not disregard my counsels. Never again can I behold such men as Peirithoos and Dryas shepherd of his people, or as Kaineus, Exadios, godlike Polyphemus, and Theseus son of Aegeus, peer of the immortals. These were the mightiest men ever born upon this earth: mightiest were they, and when they fought the fiercest tribes of mountain savages they utterly overthrew them. I came from distant Pylos, and went about among them, for they would have me come, and I fought as it was in me to do. Not a man now living could withstand them, but they heard my words, and were persuaded by them. So be it also with yourselves, for this is the more excellent way. Therefore, Agamemnon, though you be prestigious, take not this girl away, for the sons of the Achaeans have already given her to Achilles; and you, Achilles, strive not further with the king, for no man who by the grace of Zeus wields a scepter has like honor [timê] with Agamemnon.

1.241

σύμπαντας· τότε δ’ οὔ τι δυνήσεαι ἀχνύμενός περ
χραισμεῖν, εὖτ’ ἂν πολλοὶ ὑφ’ Ἕκτορος ἀνδροφόνοιο
θνήσκοντες πίπτωσι· σὺ δ’ ἔνδοθι θυμὸν ἀμύξεις
χωόμενος ὅ τ’ ἄριστον Ἀχαιῶν οὐδὲν ἔτισας.
ὣς φάτο Πηλεΐδης, ποτὶ δὲ σκῆπτρον βάλε γαίῃ
χρυσείοις ἥλοισι πεπαρμένον, ἕζετο δ’ αὐτός·
Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ἐτέρωθεν ἐμήνιε· τοῖσι δὲ Νέστωρ
ἡδυεπὴς ἀνόρουσε λιγὺς Πυλίων ἀγορητής,
τοῦ καὶ ἀπὸ γλώσσης μέλιτος γλυκίων ῥέεν αὐδή·
τῷ δ’ ἤδη δύο μὲν γενεαὶ μερόπων ἀνθρώπων
ἐφθίαθ’, οἵ οἱ πρόσθεν ἅμα τράφεν ἠδ’ ἐγένοντο
ἐν Πύλῳ ἠγαθέῃ, μετὰ δὲ τριτάτοισιν ἄνασσεν·
ὅ σφιν ἐὺ φρονέων ἀγορήσατο καὶ μετέειπεν·
ὤ πόποι ἦ μέγα πένθος Ἀχαιΐδα γαῖαν ἱκάνει·
ἦ κεν γηθήσαι Πρίαμος Πριάμοιό τε παῖδες
ἄλλοι τε Τρῶες μέγα κεν κεχαροίατο θυμῷ
εἰ σφῶϊν τάδε πάντα πυθοίατο μαρναμένοιϊν,
οἳ περὶ μὲν βουλὴν Δαναῶν, περὶ δ’ ἐστὲ μάχεσθαι.
ἀλλὰ πίθεσθ’· ἄμφω δὲ νεωτέρω ἐστὸν ἐμεῖο·
ἤδη γάρ ποτ’ ἐγὼ καὶ ἀρείοσιν ἠέ περ ὑμῖν
ἀνδράσιν ὡμίλησα, καὶ οὔ ποτέ μ’ οἵ γ’ ἀθέριζον.
οὐ γάρ πω τοίους ἴδον ἀνέρας οὐδὲ ἴδωμαι,
οἷον Πειρίθοόν τε Δρύαντά τε ποιμένα λαῶν
Καινέα τ’ Ἐξάδιόν τε καὶ ἀντίθεον Πολύφημον
Θησέα τ’ Αἰγεΐδην, ἐπιείκελον ἀθανάτοισιν·
κάρτιστοι δὴ κεῖνοι ἐπιχθονίων τράφεν ἀνδρῶν·
κάρτιστοι μὲν ἔσαν καὶ καρτίστοις ἐμάχοντο
φηρσὶν ὀρεσκῴοισι καὶ ἐκπάγλως ἀπόλεσσαν.

καὶ μὲν τοῖσιν ἐγὼ μεθομίλεον ἐκ Πύλου ἐλθὼν
τηλόθεν ἐξ ἀπίης γαίης· καλέσαντο γὰρ αὐτοί·

1.271

καὶ μαχόμην κατ’ ἔμ’ αὐτὸν ἐγώ· κείνοισι δ’ ἂν οὔ τις
τῶν οἳ νῦν βροτοί εἰσιν ἐπιχθόνιοι μαχέοιτο·
καὶ μέν μευ βουλέων ξύνιεν πείθοντό τε μύθῳ·
ἀλλὰ πίθεσθε καὶ ὔμμες, ἐπεὶ πείθεσθαι ἄμεινον·
μήτε σὺ τόνδ’ ἀγαθός περ ἐὼν ἀποαίρεο κούρην,
ἀλλ’ ἔα ὥς οἱ πρῶτα δόσαν γέρας υἷες Ἀχαιῶν·
μήτε σὺ Πηλείδη ἔθελ’ ἐριζέμεναι βασιλῆϊ
ἀντιβίην, ἐπεὶ οὔ ποθ’ ὁμοίης ἔμμορε τιμῆς
σκηπτοῦχος βασιλεύς, ᾧ τε Ζεὺς κῦδος ἔδωκεν.
εἰ δὲ σὺ καρτερός ἐσσι θεὰ δέ σε γείνατο μήτηρ,
ἀλλ’ ὅ γε φέρτερός ἐστιν ἐπεὶ πλεόνεσσιν ἀνάσσει.
Ἀτρεΐδη σὺ δὲ παῦε τεὸν μένος· αὐτὰρ ἔγωγε
λίσσομ’ Ἀχιλλῆϊ μεθέμεν χόλον, ὃς μέγα πᾶσιν
ἕρκος Ἀχαιοῖσιν πέλεται πολέμοιο κακοῖο.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων·
ναὶ δὴ ταῦτά γε πάντα γέρον κατὰ μοῖραν ἔειπες·
ἀλλ’ ὅδ’ ἀνὴρ ἐθέλει περὶ πάντων ἔμμεναι ἄλλων,
πάντων μὲν κρατέειν ἐθέλει, πάντεσσι δ’ ἀνάσσειν,
πᾶσι δὲ σημαίνειν, ἅ τιν’ οὐ πείσεσθαι ὀΐω·
εἰ δέ μιν αἰχμητὴν ἔθεσαν θεοὶ αἰὲν ἐόντες
τοὔνεκά οἱ προθέουσιν ὀνείδεα μυθήσασθαι;
τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑποβλήδην ἠμείβετο δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
ἦ γάρ κεν δειλός τε καὶ οὐτιδανὸς καλεοίμην
εἰ δὴ σοὶ πᾶν ἔργον ὑπείξομαι ὅττί κεν εἴπῃς·
ἄλλοισιν δὴ ταῦτ’ ἐπιτέλλεο, μὴ γὰρ ἔμοιγε
σήμαιν’· οὐ γὰρ ἔγωγ’ ἔτι σοὶ πείσεσθαι ὀΐω.
ἄλλο δέ τοι ἐρέω, σὺ δ’ ἐνὶ φρεσὶ βάλλεο σῇσι·
χερσὶ μὲν οὔ τοι ἔγωγε μαχήσομαι εἵνεκα κούρης
οὔτε σοὶ οὔτέ τῳ ἄλλῳ, ἐπεί μ’ ἀφέλεσθέ γε δόντες·
τῶν δ’ ἄλλων ἅ μοί ἐστι θοῇ παρὰ νηῒ μελαίνῃ

You are strong, and have a goddess for your mother; but Agamemnon is more prestigious than you, for he has more people under him. Son of Atreus, check your anger, I implore you; end this quarrel with Achilles, who in the day of battle is a tower of strength to the Achaeans." And Agamemnon answered, "Old sir, all that you have said is true, but this man wants to become our lord and master: he must be lord of all, king of all, and leader of all, and this shall hardly be. Granted that the gods have made him a great warrior, have they also given him the right to speak with railing?" Achilles in turn said to him: "I should be a mean coward," he cried, "were I to give in to you in all things. Order other people about, not me, for I shall obey no longer. Furthermore I say - and lay my saying to your heart - I shall fight neither you nor any man about this girl, for those that take were those also that gave. But of all else that is at my ship you shall carry away nothing by force. Try, that others may see; if you do, my spear shall be reddened with your blood." When they had quarreled thus angrily, they rose, and broke up the assembly at the ships of the Achaeans. The son of Peleus went back to his tents and ships with the son of Menoitios and his company, while Agamemnon drew a vessel into the water and chose a crew of twenty oarsmen. He escorted Chryseis on board and sent moreover a hecatomb for the god. And Odysseus went as leader. These, then, went on board and sailed their ways over the sea.

But the son of Atreus bade the people purify themselves; so they purified themselves and cast their filth into the sea. Then they offered hecatombs of bulls and goats without blemish on the sea-shore, and the smoke with the savor of their sacrifice rose curling up towards heaven. Thus did they busy themselves throughout the host. But Agamemnon did not forget the threat that he had made Achilles,

1.301

301 τῶν οὐκ ἄν τι φέροις ἀνελὼν ἀέκοντος ἐμεῖο·
302 εἰ δ’ ἄγε μὴν πείρησαι ἵνα γνώωσι καὶ οἵδε·
303 αἶψά τοι αἷμα κελαινὸν ἐρωήσει περὶ δουρί.
304 ὣς τώ γ’ ἀντιβίοισι μαχεσσαμένω ἐπέεσσιν
305 ἀνστήτην, λῦσαν δ’ ἀγορὴν παρὰ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν·
306 Πηλεΐδης μὲν ἐπὶ κλισίας καὶ νῆας ἐΐσας
307 ἤϊε σύν τε Μενοιτιάδῃ καὶ οἷς ἑτάροισιν·
308 Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ἄρα νῆα θοὴν ἅλα δὲ προέρυσσεν,
309 ἐν δ’ ἐρέτας ἔκρινεν ἐείκοσιν, ἐς δ’ ἑκατόμβην
310 βῆσε θεῷ, ἀνὰ δὲ Χρυσηΐδα καλλιπάρῃον
311 εἶσεν ἄγων· ἐν δ’ ἀρχὸς ἔβη πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεύς.
312 οἳ μὲν ἔπειτ’ ἀναβάντες ἐπέπλεον ὑγρὰ κέλευθα,
313 λαοὺς δ’ Ἀτρεΐδης ἀπολυμαίνεσθαι ἄνωγεν·
314 οἳ δ’ ἀπελυμαίνοντο καὶ εἰς ἅλα λύματα βάλλον,
315 ἔρδον δ’ Ἀπόλλωνι τελήεσσας ἑκατόμβας
316 ταύρων ἠδ’ αἰγῶν παρὰ θῖν’ ἁλὸς ἀτρυγέτοιο·
317 κνίση δ’ οὐρανὸν ἶκεν ἑλισσομένη περὶ καπνῷ.
318 ὣς οἳ μὲν τὰ πένοντο κατὰ στρατόν· οὐδ’ Ἀγαμέμνων
319 λῆγ’ ἔριδος τὴν πρῶτον ἐπηπείλησ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ,
320 ἀλλ’ ὅ γε Ταλθύβιόν τε καὶ Εὐρυβάτην προσέειπε,
321 τώ οἱ ἔσαν κήρυκε καὶ ὀτρηρὼ θεράποντε·
322 ἔρχεσθον κλισίην Πηληϊάδεω Ἀχιλῆος·
323 χειρὸς ἑλόντ’ ἀγέμεν Βρισηΐδα καλλιπάρῃον·
324 εἰ δέ κε μὴ δώῃσιν ἐγὼ δέ κεν αὐτὸς ἕλωμαι
325 ἐλθὼν σὺν πλεόνεσσι· τό οἱ καὶ ῥίγιον ἔσται.
326 ὣς εἰπὼν προΐει, κρατερὸν δ’ ἐπὶ μῦθον ἔτελλε·
327 τὼ δ’ ἀέκοντε βάτην παρὰ θῖν’ ἁλὸς ἀτρυγέτοιο,
328 Μυρμιδόνων δ’ ἐπί τε κλισίας καὶ νῆας ἱκέσθην,
329 τὸν δ’ εὗρον παρά τε κλισίῃ καὶ νηῒ μελαίνῃ
330 ἥμενον· οὐδ’ ἄρα τώ γε ἰδὼν γήθησεν Ἀχιλλεύς.

and called his trusty messengers and squires [therapontes] Talthybios and Eurybates. "Go," said he, "to the tent of Achilles, son of Peleus; take Briseis by the hand and bring her hither; if he will not give her I shall come with others and take her - which will press him harder." He charged them straightly further and dismissed them, whereon they went their way sorrowfully by the seaside, till they came to the tents and ships of the Myrmidons. They found Achilles sitting by his tent and his ships, and ill-pleased he was when he beheld them. They stood fearfully and reverently before him, and never a word did they speak, but he knew them and said, "Welcome, heralds, messengers of gods and men; draw near; my quarrel is not with you but with Agamemnon who has sent you for the girl Briseis. Therefore, Patroklos, bring her and give her to them, but let them be witnesses by the blessed gods, by mortal men, and by the fierceness of Agamemnon's anger, that if ever again there be need of me to save the people from ruin, they shall seek and they shall not find. Agamemnon is mad with rage and knows not how to look before and after that the Achaeans may fight by their ships in safety." Patroklos did as his dear comrade had bidden

him. He brought Briseis from the tent and gave her over to the heralds, who took her with them to the ships of the Achaeans - and the woman was loath to go. Then Achilles went all alone by the side of the hoar sea [pontos], weeping and looking out upon the boundless waste of waters. He raised his hands in prayer to his immortal mother, "Mother," he cried, "you bore me doomed to live but for a brief season; surely Zeus, who thunders from Olympus, might have given honor [timê] in return. It is not so. Agamemnon, son of Atreus, has done me dishonor, and has robbed me of my prize by force." As he spoke he wept aloud, and his mother heard him where she was sitting in the depths of the sea hard by the Old One, her father. Forthwith she rose as it were a gray mist out of the waves,

1.331

331 τὼ μὲν ταρβήσαντε καὶ αἰδομένω βασιλῆα
332 στήτην, οὐδέ τί μιν προσεφώνεον οὐδ’ ἐρέοντο·
333 αὐτὰρ ὃ ἔγνω ᾗσιν ἐνὶ φρεσὶ φώνησέν τε·
334 χαίρετε κήρυκες Διὸς ἄγγελοι ἠδὲ καὶ ἀνδρῶν,
335 ἆσσον ἴτ’· οὔ τί μοι ὔμμες ἐπαίτιοι ἀλλ’ Ἀγαμέμνων,
336 ὃ σφῶϊ προΐει Βρισηΐδος εἵνεκα κούρης.
337 ἀλλ’ ἄγε διογενὲς Πατρόκλεες ἔξαγε κούρην
338 καί σφωϊν δὸς ἄγειν· τὼ δ’ αὐτὼ μάρτυροι ἔστων
339 πρός τε θεῶν μακάρων πρός τε θνητῶν ἀνθρώπων
340 καὶ πρὸς τοῦ βασιλῆος ἀπηνέος εἴ ποτε δ’ αὖτε
341 χρειὼ ἐμεῖο γένηται ἀεικέα λοιγὸν ἀμῦναι
342 τοῖς ἄλλοις· ἦ γὰρ ὅ γ’ ὀλοιῇσι φρεσὶ θύει,
343 οὐδέ τι οἶδε νοῆσαι ἅμα πρόσσω καὶ ὀπίσσω,
344 ὅππως οἱ παρὰ νηυσὶ σόοι μαχέοιντο Ἀχαιοί.
345 ὣς φάτο, Πάτροκλος δὲ φίλῳ ἐπεπείθεθ’ ἑταίρῳ,
346 ἐκ δ’ ἄγαγε κλισίης Βρισηΐδα καλλιπάρῃον,
347 δῶκε δ’ ἄγειν· τὼ δ’ αὖτις ἴτην παρὰ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν·
348 ἣ δ’ ἀέκουσ’ ἅμα τοῖσι γυνὴ κίεν· αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
349 δακρύσας ἑτάρων ἄφαρ ἕζετο νόσφι λιασθείς,
350 θῖν’ ἔφ’ ἁλὸς πολιῆς, ὁρόων ἐπ’ ἀπείρονα πόντον·
351 πολλὰ δὲ μητρὶ φίλῃ ἠρήσατο χεῖρας ὀρεγνύς·
352 μῆτερ ἐπεί μ’ ἔτεκές γε μινυνθάδιόν περ ἐόντα,
353 τιμήν πέρ μοι ὄφελλεν Ὀλύμπιος ἐγγυαλίξαι
354 Ζεὺς ὑψιβρεμέτης· νῦν δ’ οὐδέ με τυτθὸν ἔτισεν·
355 ἦ γάρ μ’ Ἀτρεΐδης εὐρὺ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
356 ἠτίμησεν· ἑλὼν γὰρ ἔχει γέρας αὐτὸς ἀπούρας.
357 ὣς φάτο δάκρυ χέων, τοῦ δ’ ἔκλυε πότνια μήτηρ
358 ἡμένη ἐν βένθεσσιν ἁλὸς παρὰ πατρὶ γέροντι·
359 καρπαλίμως δ’ ἀνέδυ πολιῆς ἁλὸς ἠΰτ’ ὀμίχλη,
360 καί ῥα πάροιθ’ αὐτοῖο καθέζετο δάκρυ χέοντος,

sat down before him as he stood weeping, caressed him with her hand, and said, "My son, why are you weeping? What is it that gives you grief [penthos]? Keep it not from my thinking [noos], but tell me, that we may know it together." Achilles drew a deep sigh and said, "You know it; why tell you what you know well already? We went to Thebe the strong city of Eetion, sacked it, and brought hither the spoil. The sons of the Achaeans shared it duly among themselves, and chose lovely Chryseis as the prize of Agamemnon; but Chryses, priest of Apollo, came to the ships of the Achaeans to free his daughter, and brought with him a great ransom: moreover he bore in his hand the scepter of Apollo, wreathed with a suppliant's wreath, and he besought the Achaeans, but most of all the two sons of Atreus who were their chiefs. On this the rest of the Achaeans with one voice were for respecting

the priest and taking the ransom that he offered; but not so Agamemnon, who spoke fiercely to him and sent him roughly away. So he went back in anger, and Apollo, who loved him dearly, heard his prayer. Then the god sent a deadly dart upon the Argives, and the people died thick on one another, for the arrows went everywhere among the wide host of the Achaeans. At last a seer [mantis] in the fullness of his knowledge declared to us the oracles of Apollo, and I was myself first to say that we should appease him. Whereon the son of Atreus rose in anger, and threatened that which he has since done. The Achaeans are now taking the girl in a ship to Chryse, and sending gifts of sacrifice to the god; but the heralds have just taken from my tent the daughter of Briseus, whom the Achaeans had awarded to myself. Help your brave son, therefore, if you are able. Go to Olympus, and if you have ever done him service in word or deed, implore the aid of Zeus. Ofttimes in my father's house have I heard you glory in that you alone of the immortals saved the son of Kronos from ruin, when the others,

1.361

361 χειρί τέ μιν κατέρεξεν ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζε·
362 τέκνον τί κλαίεις; τί δέ σε φρένας ἵκετο πένθος;
363 ἐξαύδα, μὴ κεῦθε νόῳ, ἵνα εἴδομεν ἄμφω.
364 τὴν δὲ βαρὺ στενάχων προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
365 οἶσθα· τί ἤ τοι ταῦτα ἰδυίῃ πάντ’ ἀγορεύω;
366 ᾠχόμεθ’ ἐς Θήβην ἱερὴν πόλιν Ἠετίωνος,
367 τὴν δὲ διεπράθομέν τε καὶ ἤγομεν ἐνθάδε πάντα·
368 καὶ τὰ μὲν εὖ δάσσαντο μετὰ σφίσιν υἷες Ἀχαιῶν,
369 ἐκ δ’ ἔλον Ἀτρεΐδῃ Χρυσηΐδα καλλιπάρῃον.
370 Χρύσης δ’ αὖθ’ ἱερεὺς ἑκατηβόλου Ἀπόλλωνος
371 ἦλθε θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων
372 λυσόμενός τε θύγατρα φέρων τ’ ἀπερείσι’ ἄποινα,
373 στέμματ’ ἔχων ἐν χερσὶν ἑκηβόλου Ἀπόλλωνος
374 χρυσέῳ ἀνὰ σκήπτρῳ, καὶ λίσσετο πάντας Ἀχαιούς,
375 Ἀτρεΐδα δὲ μάλιστα δύω κοσμήτορε λαῶν.
376 ἔνθ’ ἄλλοι μὲν πάντες ἐπευφήμησαν Ἀχαιοὶ
377 αἰδεῖσθαί θ’ ἱερῆα καὶ ἀγλαὰ δέχθαι ἄποινα·
378 ἀλλ’ οὐκ Ἀτρεΐδῃ Ἀγαμέμνονι ἤνδανε θυμῷ,
379 ἀλλὰ κακῶς ἀφίει, κρατερὸν δ’ ἐπὶ μῦθον ἔτελλε·
380 χωόμενος δ’ ὁ γέρων πάλιν ᾤχετο· τοῖο δ’ Ἀπόλλων
381 εὐξαμένου ἤκουσεν, ἐπεὶ μάλα οἱ φίλος ἦεν,
382 ἦκε δ’ ἐπ’ Ἀργείοισι κακὸν βέλος· οἳ δέ νυ λαοὶ
383 θνῄσκον ἐπασσύτεροι, τὰ δ’ ἐπώχετο κῆλα θεοῖο
384 πάντῃ ἀνὰ στρατὸν εὐρὺν Ἀχαιῶν· ἄμμι δὲ μάντις
385 εὖ εἰδὼς ἀγόρευε θεοπροπίας ἑκάτοιο.
386 αὐτίκ’ ἐγὼ πρῶτος κελόμην θεὸν ἱλάσκεσθαι·
387 Ἀτρεΐωνα δ’ ἔπειτα χόλος λάβεν, αἶψα δ’ ἀναστὰς
388 ἠπείλησεν μῦθον ὃ δὴ τετελεσμένος ἐστί·
389 τὴν μὲν γὰρ σὺν νηῒ θοῇ ἐλίκωπες Ἀχαιοὶ
390 ἐς Χρύσην πέμπουσιν, ἄγουσι δὲ δῶρα ἄνακτι·

1.391

391 τὴν δὲ νέον κλισίηθεν ἔβαν κήρυκες ἄγοντες
392 κούρην Βρισῆος τήν μοι δόσαν υἷες Ἀχαιῶν.
393 ἀλλὰ σὺ εἰ δύνασαί γε περίσχεο παιδὸς ἑῆος·

394 ἐλθοῦσ’ Οὔλυμπον δὲ Δία λίσαι, εἴ ποτε δή τι
395 ἢ ἔπει ὤνησας κραδίην Διὸς ἠὲ καὶ ἔργῳ.
396 πολλάκι γάρ σεο πατρὸς ἐνὶ μεγάροισιν ἄκουσα
397 εὐχομένης ὅτ’ ἔφησθα κελαινεφέϊ Κρονίωνι
398 οἴη ἐν ἀθανάτοισιν ἀεικέα λοιγὸν ἀμῦναι,
399 ὁππότε μιν ξυνδῆσαι Ὀλύμπιοι ἤθελον ἄλλοι
400 Ἥρη τ’ ἠδὲ Ποσειδάων καὶ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη·
401 ἀλλὰ σὺ τόν γ’ ἐλθοῦσα θεὰ ὑπελύσαο δεσμῶν,
402 ὦχ’ ἑκατόγχειρον καλέσασ’ ἐς μακρὸν Ὄλυμπον,
403 ὃν Βριάρεων καλέουσι θεοί, ἄνδρες δέ τε πάντες
404 Αἰγαίων’, ὃ γὰρ αὖτε βίην οὗ πατρὸς ἀμείνων·
405 ὅς ῥα παρὰ Κρονίωνι καθέζετο κύδεϊ γαίων·
406 τὸν καὶ ὑπέδεισαν μάκαρες θεοὶ οὐδ’ ἔτ’ ἔδησαν.
407 τῶν νῦν μιν μνήσασα παρέζεο καὶ λαβὲ γούνων
408 αἴ κέν πως ἐθέλῃσιν ἐπὶ Τρώεσσιν ἀρῆξαι,
409 τοὺς δὲ κατὰ πρύμνας τε καὶ ἀμφ’ ἅλα ἔλσαι Ἀχαιοὺς
410 κτεινομένους, ἵνα πάντες ἐπαύρωνται βασιλῆος,
411 γνῷ δὲ καὶ Ἀτρεΐδης εὐρὺ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
412 ἣν ἄτην ὅ τ’ ἄριστον Ἀχαιῶν οὐδὲν ἔτισεν.
413 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Θέτις κατὰ δάκρυ χέουσα·
414 ὤ μοι τέκνον ἐμόν, τί νύ σ’ ἔτρεφον αἰνὰ τεκοῦσα;
415 αἴθ’ ὄφελες παρὰ νηυσὶν ἀδάκρυτος καὶ ἀπήμων
416 ἧσθαι, ἐπεί νύ τοι αἶσα μίνυνθά περ οὔ τι μάλα δήν·
417 νῦν δ’ ἅμα τ’ ὠκύμορος καὶ ὀϊζυρὸς περὶ πάντων
418 ἔπλεο· τώ σε κακῇ αἴσῃ τέκον ἐν μεγάροισι.
419 τοῦτο δέ τοι ἐρέουσα ἔπος Διὶ τερπικεραύνῳ
420 εἶμ’ αὐτὴ πρὸς Ὄλυμπον ἀγάννιφον αἴ κε πίθηται.
with Hera, Poseidon, and Pallas Athena would have put him in bonds. It was you, goddess, who delivered him by calling to Olympus the hundred-handed one whom gods call Briareus, but men Aigaion, for he has more force [biê] even than his father; when therefore he took his seat all-glorious beside the son of Kronos, the other gods were afraid, and did not bind him. Go, then, to him, remind him of all this, clasp his knees, and bid him give succor to the Trojans. Let the Achaeans be hemmed in at the sterns of their ships, and perish on the sea-shore, that they may reap what joy they may of their king, and that Agamemnon may rue his derangement [atê] in offering insult to the best [aristos] of the Achaeans." Thetis wept and answered, "My son, woe is me that I should have borne or suckled you. Would indeed that you had lived your span free from all sorrow at your ships, for it is all too brief; alas, that you should be at once short of life and long of sorrow above your peers: woe, therefore, was the hour in which I bore you; nevertheless I will go to the snowy heights of Olympus, and tell this tale to Zeus, if he will hear our prayer: meanwhile stay where you are with your ships, nurse your anger [mênis] against the Achaeans, and hold aloof from fight. For Zeus went yesterday to Okeanos, to a feast among the Ethiopians, and the other gods went with him. He will return to Olympus twelve days hence; I will then go to his mansion paved with bronze and will beseech him; nor do I doubt that I shall be able to persuade him." On this she left him, still furious at the loss of her that had been taken by force [biê] from him. Meanwhile Odysseus reached Chryse with the hecatomb. When they had come inside the harbor they furled the sails and laid them in the ship's hold; they slackened the forestays, lowered the mast into its place, and rowed the ship to the place where they would have her lie; there they cast out their mooring-stones and made fast the hawsers. They then got out upon the sea-shore and landed the hecatomb for Apollo; Chryseis also left the ship,

1.421

421 ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν νῦν νηυσὶ παρήμενος ὠκυπόροισι
422 μήνι’ Ἀχαιοῖσιν, πολέμου δ’ ἀποπαύεο πάμπαν·
423 Ζεὺς γὰρ ἐς Ὠκεανὸν μετ’ ἀμύμονας Αἰθιοπῆας
424 χθιζὸς ἔβη κατὰ δαῖτα, θεοὶ δ’ ἅμα πάντες ἕποντο·
425 δωδεκάτῃ δέ τοι αὖτις ἐλεύσεται Οὔλυμπον δέ,
426 καὶ τότ’ ἔπειτά τοι εἶμι Διὸς ποτὶ χαλκοβατὲς δῶ,
427 καί μιν γουνάσομαι καί μιν πείσεσθαι ὀΐω.
428 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσασ’ ἀπεβήσετο, τὸν δὲ λίπ’ αὐτοῦ
429 χωόμενον κατὰ θυμὸν ἐϋζώνοιο γυναικὸς
430 τήν ῥα βίῃ ἀέκοντος ἀπηύρων· αὐτὰρ Ὀδυσσεὺς
431 ἐς Χρύσην ἵκανεν ἄγων ἱερὴν ἑκατόμβην.
432 οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ λιμένος πολυβενθέος ἐντὸς ἵκοντο
433 ἱστία μὲν στείλαντο, θέσαν δ’ ἐν νηῒ μελαίνῃ,
434 ἱστὸν δ’ ἱστοδόκῃ πέλασαν προτόνοισιν ὑφέντες
435 καρπαλίμως, τὴν δ’ εἰς ὅρμον προέρεσσαν ἐρετμοῖς.
436 ἐκ δ’ εὐνὰς ἔβαλον, κατὰ δὲ πρυμνήσι’ ἔδησαν·
437 ἐκ δὲ καὶ αὐτοὶ βαῖνον ἐπὶ ῥηγμῖνι θαλάσσης,
438 ἐκ δ’ ἑκατόμβην βῆσαν ἑκηβόλῳ Ἀπόλλωνι·
439 ἐκ δὲ Χρυσηῒς νηὸς βῆ ποντοπόροιο.
440 τὴν μὲν ἔπειτ’ ἐπὶ βωμὸν ἄγων πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεὺς
441 πατρὶ φίλῳ ἐν χερσὶ τίθει καί μιν προσέειπεν·
442 ὦ Χρύση, πρό μ’ ἔπεμψεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων
443 παῖδά τε σοὶ ἀγέμεν, Φοίβῳ θ’ ἱερὴν ἑκατόμβην
444 ῥέξαι ὑπὲρ Δαναῶν ὄφρ’ ἱλασόμεσθα ἄνακτα,
445 ὃς νῦν Ἀργείοισι πολύστονα κήδε’ ἐφῆκεν.
446 ὣς εἰπὼν ἐν χερσὶ τίθει, ὃ δὲ δέξατο χαίρων
447 παῖδα φίλην· τοὶ δ’ ὦκα θεῷ ἱερὴν ἑκατόμβην
448 ἑξείης ἔστησαν ἐΰδμητον περὶ βωμόν,
449 χερνίψαντο δ’ ἔπειτα καὶ οὐλοχύτας ἀνέλοντο.
450 τοῖσιν δὲ Χρύσης μεγάλ’ εὔχετο χεῖρας ἀνασχών·

and Odysseus led her to the altar to deliver her into the hands of her father. "Chryses," said he, "King Agamemnon has sent me to bring you back your child, and to offer sacrifice to Apollo on behalf of the Danaans, that we may propitiate the god, who has now brought sorrow upon the Argives." So saying he gave the girl over to her father, who received her gladly, and they ranged the holy hecatomb all orderly round the altar of the god. They washed their hands and took up the barley-meal to sprinkle over the victims, while Chryses lifted up his hands and prayed aloud on their behalf. "Hear me," he cried, "O god of the silver bow, you who protect Chryse and holy Cilla, and rule Tenedos with your might. Even as you did hear me aforetime when I prayed, and did press hard upon the Achaeans, so hear me yet again, and stay this fearful pestilence from the Danaans." Thus did he pray, and Apollo heard his prayer. When they had done praying and sprinkling the barley-meal, they drew back the heads of the victims and killed and flayed them. They cut out the thigh-bones, wrapped them round in two layers of fat, set some pieces of raw meat on the top of them, and then Chryses laid them on the wood fire and poured wine over them, while the young men stood near him with five-pronged spits in their hands. When the thigh-bones were burned and they had tasted the inward meats, they cut the rest up small, put the pieces upon the spits, roasted them till they were done, and drew them off: then, when they had finished their work [ponos] and the feast was ready, they ate it, and every man had his full share, so that all were satisfied. As soon as they had had enough to eat and drink, pages filled the mixing-bowl with wine and water and handed it round, after giving every man his

drink-offering. Thus all day long the young men worshipped the god with song, hymning him and chanting the joyous paean, and the god took pleasure in their voices; but when the sun went down, and it came on dark, they laid themselves down to sleep by the stern cables of the ship, and when the child of morning, rosy-fingered Dawn, appeared they again set sail for the host of the Achaeans. Apollo sent them a fair wind,

1.451

451 κλῦθί μευ ἀργυρότοξ’, ὃς Χρύσην ἀμφιβέβηκας
452 Κίλλαν τε ζαθέην Τενέδοιό τε ἶφι ἀνάσσεις·
453 ἦ μὲν δή ποτ’ ἐμεῦ πάρος ἔκλυες εὐξαμένοιο,
454 τίμησας μὲν ἐμέ, μέγα δ’ ἴψαο λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν·
455 ἠδ’ ἔτι καὶ νῦν μοι τόδ’ ἐπικρήηνον ἐέλδωρ·
456 ἤδη νῦν Δαναοῖσιν ἀεικέα λοιγὸν ἄμυνον.
457 ὣς ἔφατ’ εὐχόμενος, τοῦ δ’ ἔκλυε Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων.
458 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί ῥ’ εὔξαντο καὶ οὐλοχύτας προβάλοντο,
459 αὐέρυσαν μὲν πρῶτα καὶ ἔσφαξαν καὶ ἔδειραν,
460 μηρούς τ’ ἐξέταμον κατά τε κνίσῃ ἐκάλυψαν
461 δίπτυχα ποιήσαντες, ἐπ’ αὐτῶν δ’ ὠμοθέτησαν·
462 καῖε δ’ ἐπὶ σχίζῃς ὁ γέρων, ἐπὶ δ’ αἴθοπα οἶνον
463 λεῖβε· νέοι δὲ παρ’ αὐτὸν ἔχον πεμπώβολα χερσίν.
464 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ κατὰ μῆρε κάη καὶ σπλάγχνα πάσαντο,
465 μίστυλλόν τ’ ἄρα τἆλλα καὶ ἀμφ’ ὀβελοῖσιν ἔπειραν,
466 ὤπτησάν τε περιφραδέως, ἐρύσαντό τε πάντα.
467 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ παύσαντο πόνου τετύκοντό τε δαῖτα
468 δαίνυντ’, οὐδέ τι θυμὸς ἐδεύετο δαιτὸς ἐΐσης.
469 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ πόσιος καὶ ἐδητύος ἐξ ἔρον ἔντο,
470 κοῦροι μὲν κρητῆρας ἐπεστέψαντο ποτοῖο,
471 νώμησαν δ’ ἄρα πᾶσιν ἐπαρξάμενοι δεπάεσσιν·
472 οἳ δὲ πανημέριοι μολπῇ θεὸν ἱλάσκοντο
473 καλὸν ἀείδοντες παιήονα κοῦροι Ἀχαιῶν
474 μέλποντες ἑκάεργον· ὃ δὲ φρένα τέρπετ’ ἀκούων.
475 ἦμος δ’ ἠέλιος κατέδυ καὶ ἐπὶ κνέφας ἦλθε,
476 δὴ τότε κοιμήσαντο παρὰ πρυμνήσια νηός·
477 ἦμος δ’ ἠριγένεια φάνη ῥοδοδάκτυλος Ἠώς,
478 καὶ τότ’ ἔπειτ’ ἀνάγοντο μετὰ στρατὸν εὐρὺν Ἀχαιῶν·
479 τοῖσιν δ’ ἴκμενον οὖρον ἵει ἑκάεργος Ἀπόλλων·
480 οἳ δ’ ἱστὸν στήσαντ’ ἀνά θ’ ἱστία λευκὰ πέτασσαν,

so they raised their mast and hoisted their white sails aloft. As the sail bellied with the wind the ship flew through the seething deep water, and the foam hissed against her bows as she sped onward. When they reached the wide-stretching host of the Achaeans, they drew the vessel ashore, high and dry upon the sands, set her strong props beneath her, and went their ways to their own tents and ships. But Achilles stayed at his ships and nursed his anger [mênis]. He went not to the honorable assembly, and sallied not forth to fight, but gnawed at his own heart, pining for battle and the war-cry. Now after twelve days the immortal gods came back in a body to Olympus, and Zeus led the way. Thetis was not unmindful of the charge her son had laid upon her, so she rose from under the sea and went, enveloped in mist, through great heaven with early morning to Olympus, where she found the mighty son of Kronos sitting all alone upon its topmost ridges. She sat herself down before him, and with her left hand seized his knees, while with her right she caught him under the chin, and besought him, saying - "Father Zeus, if I ever did you service in word or deed among the immortals, hear my prayer, and do honor to my son, whose life is

to be cut short so early. King Agamemnon has dishonored him by taking his prize and keeping her. Honor him then yourself, Olympian lord of counsel, and grant victory to the Trojans, till the Achaeans give my son his due and load him with riches in requital [timê]." Zeus sat for a while silent, and without a word, but Thetis still kept firm hold of his knees, and besought him a second time. "Nod your head," said she, "and promise me surely, or else deny me - for you have nothing to fear - that I may learn how greatly you disdain me." At this Zeus was much troubled and answered, "I shall have trouble if you set me quarreling with Hera, for she will provoke me with her taunting speeches;

1.481

481 ἐν δ’ ἄνεμος πρῆσεν μέσον ἱστίον, ἀμφὶ δὲ κῦμα
482 στείρῃ πορφύρεον μεγάλ’ ἴαχε νηὸς ἰούσης·
483 ἣ δ’ ἔθεεν κατὰ κῦμα διαπρήσσουσα κέλευθον.
484 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί ῥ’ ἵκοντο κατὰ στρατὸν εὐρὺν Ἀχαιῶν,
485 νῆα μὲν οἵ γε μέλαιναν ἐπ’ ἠπείροιο ἔρυσσαν
486 ὑψοῦ ἐπὶ ψαμάθοις, ὑπὸ δ’ ἔρματα μακρὰ τάνυσσαν·
487 αὐτοὶ δ’ ἐσκίδναντο κατὰ κλισίας τε νέας τε.
488 αὐτὰρ ὃ μήνιε νηυσὶ παρήμενος ὠκυπόροισι
489 διογενὴς Πηλῆος υἱὸς πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
490 οὔτέ ποτ’ εἰς ἀγορὴν πωλέσκετο κυδιάνειραν
491 οὔτέ ποτ’ ἐς πόλεμον, ἀλλὰ φθινύθεσκε φίλον κῆρ
492 αὖθι μένων, ποθέεσκε δ’ ἀϋτήν τε πτόλεμόν τε.
493 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἐκ τοῖο δυωδεκάτη γένετ’ ἠώς,
494 καὶ τότε δὴ πρὸς Ὄλυμπον ἴσαν θεοὶ αἰὲν ἐόντες
495 πάντες ἅμα, Ζεὺς δ’ ἦρχε· Θέτις δ’ οὐ λήθετ’ ἐφετμέων
496 παιδὸς ἑοῦ, ἀλλ’ ἥ γ’ ἀνεδύσετο κῦμα θαλάσσης.
497 ἠερίη δ’ ἀνέβη μέγαν οὐρανὸν Οὔλυμπόν τε.
498 εὗρεν δ’ εὐρύοπα Κρονίδην ἄτερ ἥμενον ἄλλων
499 ἀκροτάτῃ κορυφῇ πολυδειράδος Οὐλύμποιο·
500 καί ῥα πάροιθ’ αὐτοῖο καθέζετο, καὶ λάβε γούνων
501 σκαιῇ, δεξιτερῇ δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπ’ ἀνθερεῶνος ἑλοῦσα
502 λισσομένη προσέειπε Δία Κρονίωνα ἄνακτα·
503 Ζεῦ πάτερ εἴ ποτε δή σε μετ’ ἀθανάτοισιν ὄνησα
504 ἢ ἔπει ἢ ἔργῳ, τόδε μοι κρήηνον ἐέλδωρ·
505 τίμησόν μοι υἱὸν ὃς ὠκυμορώτατος ἄλλων
506 ἔπλετ’· ἀτάρ μιν νῦν γε ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων
507 ἠτίμησεν· ἑλὼν γὰρ ἔχει γέρας αὐτὸς ἀπούρας.
508 ἀλλὰ σύ πέρ μιν τῖσον Ὀλύμπιε μητίετα Ζεῦ·
509 τόφρα δ’ ἐπὶ Τρώεσσι τίθει κράτος ὄφρ’ ἂν Ἀχαιοὶ
510 υἱὸν ἐμὸν τίσωσιν ὀφέλλωσίν τέ ἑ τιμῇ.

1.511

511 ὣς φάτο· τὴν δ’ οὔ τι προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς,
512 ἀλλ’ ἀκέων δὴν ἧστο· Θέτις δ’ ὡς ἥψατο γούνων
513 ὣς ἔχετ’ ἐμπεφυυῖα, καὶ εἴρετο δεύτερον αὖτις·
514 νημερτὲς μὲν δή μοι ὑπόσχεο καὶ κατάνευσον
515 ἢ ἀπόειπ’, ἐπεὶ οὔ τοι ἔπι δέος, ὄφρ’ ἐὺ εἰδέω
516 ὅσσον ἐγὼ μετὰ πᾶσιν ἀτιμοτάτη θεός εἰμι.
517 τὴν δὲ μέγ’ ὀχθήσας προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
518 ἦ δὴ λοίγια ἔργ’ ὅ τέ μ’ ἐχθοδοπῆσαι ἐφήσεις

519 Ἥρῃ ὅτ’ ἄν μ’ ἐρέθῃσιν ὀνειδείοις ἐπέεσσιν·
520 ἢ δὲ καὶ αὖτως μ’ αἰεὶ ἐν ἀθανάτοισι θεοῖσι
521 νεικεῖ, καί τέ μέ φησι μάχῃ Τρώεσσιν ἀρήγειν.
522 ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν νῦν αὖτις ἀπόστιχε μή τι νοήσῃ
523 Ἥρη· ἐμοὶ δέ κε ταῦτα μελήσεται ὄφρα τελέσσω·
524 εἰ δ’ ἄγε τοι κεφαλῇ κατανεύσομαι ὄφρα πεποίθῃς·
525 τοῦτο γὰρ ἐξ ἐμέθεν γε μετ’ ἀθανάτοισι μέγιστον
526 τέκμωρ· οὐ γὰρ ἐμὸν παλινάγρετον οὐδ’ ἀπατηλὸν
527 οὐδ’ ἀτελεύτητον ὅ τί κεν κεφαλῇ κατανεύσω.
528 ἦ καὶ κυανέῃσιν ἐπ’ ὀφρύσι νεῦσε Κρονίων·
529 ἀμβρόσιαι δ’ ἄρα χαῖται ἐπερρώσαντο ἄνακτος
530 κρατὸς ἀπ’ ἀθανάτοιο· μέγαν δ’ ἐλέλιξεν Ὄλυμπον.
531 τώ γ’ ὣς βουλεύσαντε διέτμαγεν· ἣ μὲν ἔπειτα
532 εἰς ἅλα ἆλτο βαθεῖαν ἀπ’ αἰγλήεντος Ὀλύμπου,
533 Ζεὺς δὲ ἑὸν πρὸς δῶμα· θεοὶ δ’ ἅμα πάντες ἀνέσταν
534 ἐξ ἑδέων σφοῦ πατρὸς ἐναντίον· οὐδέ τις ἔτλη
535 μεῖναι ἐπερχόμενον, ἀλλ’ ἀντίοι ἔσταν ἅπαντες.
536 ὣς ὃ μὲν ἔνθα καθέζετ’ ἐπὶ θρόνου· οὐδέ μιν Ἥρη
537 ἠγνοίησεν ἰδοῦσ’ ὅτι οἱ συμφράσσατο βουλὰς
538 ἀργυρόπεζα Θέτις θυγάτηρ ἁλίοιο γέροντος.
539 αὐτίκα κερτομίοισι Δία Κρονίωνα προσηύδα·
540 τίς δ’ αὖ τοι δολομῆτα θεῶν συμφράσσατο βουλάς;
even now she is always railing at me before the other gods and accusing me of giving aid to the Trojans. Go back now, lest she should find out. I will consider the matter, and will bring it about as wish. See, I nod my head that you believe me. This is the most solemn act that I can offer to any god. I never recall my word, or deceive, or fail to do what I say, when I have nodded my head." As he spoke the son of Kronos bowed his dark brows, and the ambrosial locks swayed on his immortal head, till vast Olympus reeled. When the pair had thus laid their plans, they parted - Zeus to his mansion, while the goddess left the splendor of Olympus, and plunged into the depths of the sea. The gods rose from their seats, before the coming of their sire. Not one of them dared to remain sitting, but all stood up as he came among them. There, then, he took his seat. But Hera, when she saw him, knew that he and silver-footed Thetis, the daughter of the Old One of the Sea, had been planning mischief, so she at once began to upbraid him. "Trickster," she cried, "which of the gods have you been taking into your counsels now? You are always settling matters in secret behind my back, and have never yet told me, if you could help it, one word of your intentions." "Hera," replied the sire of gods and men, "you must not expect to be informed of all my counsels. You are my wife, but you would find it hard to understand them. When it is proper for you to hear, there is no one, god or man, who will be told sooner, but when I mean to keep a matter to myself, you must not pry nor ask questions." "Dread son of Kronos," answered Hera, "what are you talking about? I? Pry and ask questions? Never. I let you have your own way in everything. Still, I have a strong misgiving that Thetis, daughter of the Old One of the Sea, has been talking you over, for she was with you and had hold of your knees this self-same morning. I believe, therefore, that you have been promising her to give glory to Achilles, and to kill many people at the ships of the Achaeans."

1.541

541 αἰεί τοι φίλον ἐστὶν ἐμεῦ ἀπὸ νόσφιν ἐόντα
542 κρυπτάδια φρονέοντα δικαζέμεν· οὐδέ τί πώ μοι
543 πρόφρων τέτληκας εἰπεῖν ἔπος ὅττι νοήσῃς.

544 τὴν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε·
545 Ἥρη μὴ δὴ πάντας ἐμοὺς ἐπιέλπεο μύθους
546 εἰδήσειν· χαλεποί τοι ἔσοντ’ ἀλόχῳ περ ἐούσῃ·
547 ἀλλ’ ὃν μέν κ’ ἐπιεικὲς ἀκουέμεν οὔ τις ἔπειτα
548 οὔτε θεῶν πρότερος τὸν εἴσεται οὔτ’ ἀνθρώπων·
549 ὃν δέ κ’ ἐγὼν ἀπάνευθε θεῶν ἐθέλωμι νοῆσαι
550 μή τι σὺ ταῦτα ἕκαστα διείρεο μηδὲ μετάλλα.
551 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη·
552 αἰνότατε Κρονίδη ποῖον τὸν μῦθον ἔειπες;
553 καὶ λίην σε πάρος γ’ οὔτ’ εἴρομαι οὔτε μεταλλῶ,
554 ἀλλὰ μάλ’ εὔκηλος τὰ φράζεαι ἅσσ’ ἐθέλῃσθα.
555 νῦν δ’ αἰνῶς δείδοικα κατὰ φρένα μή σε παρείπῃ
556 ἀργυρόπεζα Θέτις θυγάτηρ ἁλίοιο γέροντος·
557 ἠερίη γὰρ σοί γε παρέζετο καὶ λάβε γούνων·
558 τῇ σ’ ὀΐω κατανεῦσαι ἐτήτυμον ὡς Ἀχιλῆα
559 τιμήσῃς, ὀλέσῃς δὲ πολέας ἐπὶ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν.
560 τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
561 δαιμονίη αἰεὶ μὲν ὀΐεαι οὐδέ σε λήθω·
562 πρῆξαι δ’ ἔμπης οὔ τι δυνήσεαι, ἀλλ’ ἀπὸ θυμοῦ
563 μᾶλλον ἐμοὶ ἔσεαι· τὸ δέ τοι καὶ ῥίγιον ἔσται.
564 εἰ δ’ οὕτω τοῦτ’ ἐστὶν ἐμοὶ μέλλει φίλον εἶναι·
565 ἀλλ’ ἀκέουσα κάθησο, ἐμῷ δ’ ἐπιπείθεο μύθῳ,
566 μή νύ τοι οὐ χραίσμωσιν ὅσοι θεοί εἰσ’ ἐν Ὀλύμπῳ
567 ἆσσον ἰόντ’, ὅτε κέν τοι ἀάπτους χεῖρας ἐφείω.
568 ὣς ἔφατ’ ἔδεισεν δὲ βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη,
569 καί ῥ’ ἀκέουσα καθῆστο ἐπιγνάμψασα φίλον κῆρ·
570 ὄχθησαν δ’ ἀνὰ δῶμα Διὸς θεοὶ Οὐρανίωνες·
"Wife," said Zeus, "I can do nothing but you suspect me and find it out. You will take nothing by it, for I shall only dislike you the more, and it will go harder with you. Granted that it is as you say; I mean to have it so; sit down and hold your tongue as I bid you for if I once begin to lay my hands about you, though all heaven were on your side it would profit you nothing." On this Hera was frightened, so she curbed her stubborn will and sat down in silence. But the heavenly beings were disquieted throughout the house of Zeus, till the cunning workman Hephaistos began to try and pacify his mother Hera. "It will be intolerable," said he, "if you two fall to wrangling and setting heaven in an uproar about a pack of mortals. If such ill counsels are to prevail, we shall have no pleasure at our banquet. Let me then advise my mother - and she must herself know that it will be better - to make friends with my dear father Zeus, lest he again scold her and disturb our feast. If the Olympian Thunderer wants to hurl us all from our seats, he can do so, for he is far the strongest, so give him fair words, and he will then soon be in a good humor with us." As he spoke, he took a double cup of nectar, and placed it in his mother's hand. "Cheer up, my dear mother," said he, "and make the best of it. I love you dearly, and should be very sorry to see you get a thrashing; however grieved I might be, I could not help for there is no standing against Zeus. Once before when I was trying to help you, he caught me by the foot and flung me from the heavenly threshold. All day long from morn till eve, was I falling, till at sunset I came to ground in the island of Lemnos, and there I lay, with very little life left in me, till the Sintians came and tended me." Hera smiled at this, and as she smiled she took the cup from her son's hands. Then Hephaistos drew sweet nectar from the mixing-bowl, and served it round among the gods, going from left to right; and the blessed gods laughed out a loud approval

1.571

571 τοῖσιν δ’ Ἥφαιστος κλυτοτέχνης ἦρχ’ ἀγορεύειν
572 μητρὶ φίλῃ ἐπίηρα φέρων λευκωλένῳ Ἥρῃ·
573 ἦ δὴ λοίγια ἔργα τάδ’ ἔσσεται οὐδ’ ἔτ’ ἀνεκτά,
574 εἰ δὴ σφὼ ἕνεκα θνητῶν ἐριδαίνετον ὧδε,
575 ἐν δὲ θεοῖσι κολῳὸν ἐλαύνετον· οὐδέ τι δαιτὸς
576 ἐσθλῆς ἔσσεται ἦδος, ἐπεὶ τὰ χερείονα νικᾷ.
577 μητρὶ δ’ ἐγὼ παράφημι καὶ αὐτῇ περ νοεούσῃ
578 πατρὶ φίλῳ ἐπίηρα φέρειν Διί, ὄφρα μὴ αὖτε
579 νεικείῃσι πατήρ, σὺν δ’ ἡμῖν δαῖτα ταράξῃ.
580 εἴ περ γάρ κ’ ἐθέλῃσιν Ὀλύμπιος ἀστεροπητὴς
581 ἐξ ἑδέων στυφελίξαι· ὃ γὰρ πολὺ φέρτατός ἐστιν.
582 ἀλλὰ σὺ τὸν ἐπέεσσι καθάπτεσθαι μαλακοῖσιν·
583 αὐτίκ’ ἔπειθ’ ἵλαος Ὀλύμπιος ἔσσεται ἡμῖν.
584 ὣς ἄρ’ ἔφη καὶ ἀναΐξας δέπας ἀμφικύπελλον
585 μητρὶ φίλῃ ἐν χειρὶ τίθει καί μιν προσέειπε·
586 τέτλαθι μῆτερ ἐμή, καὶ ἀνάσχεο κηδομένη περ,
587 μή σε φίλην περ ἐοῦσαν ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ἴδωμαι
588 θεινομένην, τότε δ’ οὔ τι δυνήσομαι ἀχνύμενός περ
589 χραισμεῖν· ἀργαλέος γὰρ Ὀλύμπιος ἀντιφέρεσθαι·
590 ἤδη γάρ με καὶ ἄλλοτ’ ἀλεξέμεναι μεμαῶτα
591 ῥῖψε ποδὸς τεταγὼν ἀπὸ βηλοῦ θεσπεσίοιο,
592 πᾶν δ’ ἦμαρ φερόμην, ἅμα δ’ ἠελίῳ καταδύντι
593 κάππεσον ἐν Λήμνῳ, ὀλίγος δ’ ἔτι θυμὸς ἐνῆεν·
594 ἔνθά με Σίντιες ἄνδρες ἄφαρ κομίσαντο πεσόντα.
595 ὣς φάτο, μείδησεν δὲ θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη,
596 μειδήσασα δὲ παιδὸς ἐδέξατο χειρὶ κύπελλον·
597 αὐτὰρ ὃ τοῖς ἄλλοισι θεοῖς ἐνδέξια πᾶσιν
598 οἰνοχόει γλυκὺ νέκταρ ἀπὸ κρητῆρος ἀφύσσων·
599 ἄσβεστος δ’ ἄρ’ ἐνῶρτο γέλως μακάρεσσι θεοῖσιν
600 ὡς ἴδον Ἥφαιστον διὰ δώματα ποιπνύοντα.

as they saw him bustling about the heavenly mansion. Thus through the livelong day to the going down of the sun they feasted, and every one had his full share, so that all were satisfied. Apollo struck his lyre, and the Muses lifted up their sweet voices, taking turns. But when the sun's glorious light had faded, they went home to bed, each in his own abode, which lame Hephaistos with his consummate skill had fashioned for them. So Zeus, the Olympian Lord of Thunder, hied him to the bed in which he always slept; and when he had got on to it he went to sleep, with Hera of the golden throne by his side.

1.601

601 ὣς τότε μὲν πρόπαν ἦμαρ ἐς ἠέλιον καταδύντα
602 δαίνυντ’, οὐδέ τι θυμὸς ἐδεύετο δαιτὸς ἐΐσης,
603 οὐ μὲν φόρμιγγος περικαλλέος ἣν ἔχ’ Ἀπόλλων,
604 Μουσάων θ’ αἳ ἄειδον ἀμειβόμεναι ὀπὶ καλῇ.
605 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ κατέδυ λαμπρὸν φάος ἠελίοιο,
606 οἳ μὲν κακκείοντες ἔβαν οἶκον δὲ ἕκαστος,
607 ἦχι ἑκάστῳ δῶμα περικλυτὸς ἀμφιγυήεις
608 Ἥφαιστος ποίησεν ἰδυίῃσι πραπίδεσσι·
609 Ζεὺς δὲ πρὸς ὃν λέχος ἤϊ’ Ὀλύμπιος ἀστεροπητής,
610 ἔνθα πάρος κοιμᾶθ’ ὅτε μιν γλυκὺς ὕπνος ἱκάνοι·
611 ἔνθα καθεῦδ’ ἀναβάς, παρὰ δὲ χρυσόθρονος Ἥρη.

2.1

ἄλλοι μέν ῥα θεοί τε καὶ ἀνέρες ἱπποκορυσταὶ
εὗδον παννύχιοι, Δία δ’ οὐκ ἔχε νήδυμος ὕπνος,
ἀλλ’ ὅ γε μερμήριζε κατὰ φρένα ὡς Ἀχιλῆα
τιμήσῃ, ὀλέσῃ δὲ πολέας ἐπὶ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν.
ἥδε δέ οἱ κατὰ θυμὸν ἀρίστη φαίνετο βουλή,
πέμψαι ἐπ’ Ἀτρεΐδῃ Ἀγαμέμνονι οὖλον ὄνειρον·
καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
βάσκ’ ἴθι οὖλε ὄνειρε θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν·
ἐλθὼν ἐς κλισίην Ἀγαμέμνονος Ἀτρεΐδαο
πάντα μάλ’ ἀτρεκέως ἀγορευέμεν ὡς ἐπιτέλλω·
θωρῆξαί ἑ κέλευε κάρη κομόωντας Ἀχαιοὺς
πανσυδίῃ· νῦν γάρ κεν ἕλοι πόλιν εὐρυάγυιαν
Τρώων· οὐ γὰρ ἔτ’ ἀμφὶς Ὀλύμπια δώματ’ ἔχοντες
ἀθάνατοι φράζονται· ἐπέγναμψεν γὰρ ἅπαντας
Ἥρη λισσομένη, Τρώεσσι δὲ κήδε’ ἐφῆπται.
ὣς φάτο, βῆ δ’ ἄρ’ ὄνειρος ἐπεὶ τὸν μῦθον ἄκουσε·
καρπαλίμως δ’ ἵκανε θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν,
βῆ δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπ’ Ἀτρεΐδην Ἀγαμέμνονα· τὸν δὲ κίχανεν
εὕδοντ’ ἐν κλισίῃ, περὶ δ’ ἀμβρόσιος κέχυθ’ ὕπνος.
στῆ δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπὲρ κεφαλῆς Νηληΐῳ υἷι ἐοικώς
Νέστορι, τόν ῥα μάλιστα γερόντων τῖ’ Ἀγαμέμνων·
τῷ μιν ἐεισάμενος προσεφώνεε θεῖος ὄνειρος·
εὕδεις Ἀτρέος υἱὲ δαΐφρονος ἱπποδάμοιο·
οὐ χρὴ παννύχιον εὕδειν βουληφόρον ἄνδρα
ᾧ λαοί τ’ ἐπιτετράφαται καὶ τόσσα μέμηλε·
νῦν δ’ ἐμέθεν ξύνες ὦκα· Διὸς δέ τοι ἄγγελός εἰμι,
ὃς σεῦ ἄνευθεν ἐὼν μέγα κήδεται ἠδ’ ἐλεαίρει.
θωρῆξαί σε κέλευσε κάρη κομόωντας Ἀχαιοὺς
πανσυδίῃ· νῦν γάρ κεν ἕλοις πόλιν εὐρυάγυιαν
Τρώων· οὐ γὰρ ἔτ’ ἀμφὶς Ὀλύμπια δώματ’ ἔχοντες

Now the other gods and the armed warriors on the plain slept soundly, but Zeus was wakeful, for he was thinking how to do honor to Achilles, and destroy many people at the ships of the Achaeans. In the end he deemed it would be best to send a lying dream to King Agamemnon; so he called one to him and said to it, "Lying Dream, go to the ships of the Achaeans, into the tent of Agamemnon, and say to him word to word as I now bid you. Tell him to get the Achaeans instantly under arms, for he shall take Troy. There are no longer divided counsels among the gods; Hera has brought them to her own mind, and woe betides the Trojans." The dream went when it had heard its message, and soon reached the ships of the Achaeans. It sought Agamemnon son of Atreus and found him in his tent, wrapped in a profound slumber. It hovered over his head in the likeness of Nestor, son of Neleus, whom Agamemnon honored above all his councilors, and said: - "You are sleeping, son of Atreus; one who has the welfare of his host and so much other care upon his shoulders should dock his sleep. Hear me at once, for I come as a messenger from Zeus, who, though he be not near, yet takes thought for you and pities you. He bids you get the Achaeans instantly under arms, for you shall take Troy. There are no longer divided counsels among the gods; Hera has brought them over to her own mind, and woe betides the Trojans at the hands of Zeus. Remember this, and when you wake see that it does not escape you." The dream then left him, and he thought of things that were, surely not to be accomplished. He thought that on that same day he was to take the city of Priam, but he little knew what was in the mind of Zeus, who had many another

2.31

ἀθάνατοι φράζονται· ἐπέγναμψεν γὰρ ἅπαντας
Ἥρη λισσομένη, Τρώεσσι δὲ κήδε’ ἐφῆπται
ἐκ Διός· ἀλλὰ σὺ σῇσιν ἔχε φρεσί, μηδέ σε λήθη
αἱρείτω εὖτ’ ἄν σε μελίφρων ὕπνος ἀνήῃ.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἀπεβήσετο, τὸν δὲ λίπ’ αὐτοῦ
τὰ φρονέοντ’ ἀνὰ θυμὸν ἅ ῥ’ οὐ τελέεσθαι ἔμελλον·
φῆ γὰρ ὅ γ’ αἱρήσειν Πριάμου πόλιν ἤματι κείνῳ
νήπιος, οὐδὲ τὰ ᾔδη ἅ ῥα Ζεὺς μήδετο ἔργα·
θήσειν γὰρ ἔτ’ ἔμελλεν ἐπ’ ἄλγεά τε στοναχάς τε
Τρωσί τε καὶ Δαναοῖσι διὰ κρατερὰς ὑσμίνας.
ἔγρετο δ’ ἐξ ὕπνου, θείη δέ μιν ἀμφέχυτ’ ὀμφή·
ἕζετο δ’ ὀρθωθείς, μαλακὸν δ’ ἔνδυνε χιτῶνα
καλὸν νηγάτεον, περὶ δὲ μέγα βάλλετο φᾶρος·
ποσσὶ δ’ ὑπὸ λιπαροῖσιν ἐδήσατο καλὰ πέδιλα,
ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ ὤμοισιν βάλετο ξίφος ἀργυρόηλον·
εἵλετο δὲ σκῆπτρον πατρώϊον ἄφθιτον αἰεὶ
σὺν τῷ ἔβη κατὰ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων·
ἠὼς μέν ῥα θεὰ προσεβήσετο μακρὸν Ὄλυμπον
Ζηνὶ φόως ἐρέουσα καὶ ἄλλοις ἀθανάτοισιν·
αὐτὰρ ὃ κηρύκεσσι λιγυφθόγγοισι κέλευσε
κηρύσσειν ἀγορὴν δὲ κάρη κομόωντας Ἀχαιούς·
οἳ μὲν ἐκήρυσσον, τοὶ δ’ ἠγείροντο μάλ’ ὦκα·
βουλὴν δὲ πρῶτον μεγαθύμων ἷζε γερόντων
Νεστορέῃ παρὰ νηῒ Πυλοιγενέος βασιλῆος·
τοὺς ὅ γε συγκαλέσας πυκινὴν ἀρτύνετο βουλήν·
κλῦτε φίλοι· θεῖός μοι ἐνύπνιον ἦλθεν ὄνειρος
ἀμβροσίην διὰ νύκτα· μάλιστα δὲ Νέστορι δίῳ
εἶδός τε μέγεθός τε φυήν τ’ ἄγχιστα ἐῴκει·
στῆ δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπὲρ κεφαλῆς καί με πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν·
εὕδεις Ἀτρέος υἱὲ δαΐφρονος ἱπποδάμοιο·

hard-fought fight in store alike for Danaans and Trojans. Then presently he woke, with the divine message still ringing in his ears; so he sat upright, and put on his soft shirt so fair and new, and over this his heavy cloak. He bound his sandals on to his comely feet, and slung his silver-studded sword about his shoulders; then he took the imperishable staff of his father, and sallied forth to the ships of the Achaeans. The goddess Dawn now wended her way to vast Olympus that she might herald day to Zeus and to the other immortals, and Agamemnon sent the criers round to call the people in assembly; so they called them and the people gathered thereon. But first he summoned a meeting of the elders at the ship of Nestor king of Pylos, and when they were assembled he laid a cunning counsel before them. "My friends," said he, "I have had a dream from heaven in the dead of night, and its face and figure resembled none but Nestor's. It hovered over my head and said, ‘You are sleeping, son of Atreus; one who has the welfare of his host and so much other care upon his shoulders should dock his sleep. Hear me at once, for I am a messenger from Zeus, who, though he be not near, yet takes thought for you and pities you. He bids you get the Achaeans instantly under arms, for you shall take Troy. There are no longer divided counsels among the gods; Hera has brought them over to her own mind, and woe betides the Trojans at the hands of Zeus. Remember this.’ The dream then vanished and I awoke. Let us now, therefore, arm the sons of the Achaeans. But it will be the right thing [themis] that I should first sound them, and to this end I will tell them to flee with their ships; but do you others go about among the host and prevent their doing so." He then sat down, and

Nestor the king of Pylos with all sincerity and goodwill addressed them thus: "My friends," said he, "princes and councilors of the Argives,

2.61

οὐ χρὴ παννύχιον εὕδειν βουληφόρον ἄνδρα,
ᾧ λαοί τ’ ἐπιτετράφαται καὶ τόσσα μέμηλε·
νῦν δ’ ἐμέθεν ξύνες ὦκα· Διὸς δέ τοι ἄγγελός εἰμι,
ὃς σεῦ ἄνευθεν ἐὼν μέγα κήδεται ἠδ’ ἐλεαίρει·
θωρῆξαί σε κέλευσε κάρη κομόωντας Ἀχαιοὺς
πανσυδίῃ· νῦν γάρ κεν ἕλοις πόλιν εὐρυάγυιαν
Τρώων· οὐ γὰρ ἔτ’ ἀμφὶς Ὀλύμπια δώματ’ ἔχοντες
ἀθάνατοι φράζονται· ἐπέγναμψεν γὰρ ἅπαντας
Ἥρη λισσομένη, Τρώεσσι δὲ κήδε’ ἐφῆπται
ἐκ Διός· ἀλλὰ σὺ σῇσιν ἔχε φρεσίν· ὣς ὃ μὲν εἰπὼν
ὤχετ’ ἀποπτάμενος, ἐμὲ δὲ γλυκὺς ὕπνος ἀνῆκεν.
ἀλλ’ ἄγετ’ αἴ κέν πως θωρήξομεν υἷας Ἀχαιῶν·
πρῶτα δ’ ἐγὼν ἔπεσιν πειρήσομαι, ἣ θέμις ἐστί,
καὶ φεύγειν σὺν νηυσὶ πολυκλήϊσι κελεύσω·
ὑμεῖς δ’ ἄλλοθεν ἄλλος ἐρητύειν ἐπέεσσιν.
ἤτοι ὅ γ’ ὣς εἰπὼν κατ’ ἄρ’ ἕζετο, τοῖσι δ’ ἀνέστη
Νέστωρ, ὅς ῥα Πύλοιο ἄναξ ἦν ἠμαθόεντος,
ὅ σφιν ἐὺ φρονέων ἀγορήσατο καὶ μετέειπεν·
ὦ φίλοι Ἀργείων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες
εἰ μέν τις τὸν ὄνειρον Ἀχαιῶν ἄλλος ἔνισπε
ψεῦδός κεν φαῖμεν καὶ νοσφιζοίμεθα μᾶλλον·
νῦν δ’ ἴδεν ὃς μέγ’ ἄριστος Ἀχαιῶν εὔχεται εἶναι·
ἀλλ’ ἄγετ’ αἴ κέν πως θωρήξομεν υἷας Ἀχαιῶν.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας βουλῆς ἐξῆρχε νέεσθαι,
οἳ δ’ ἐπανέστησαν πείθοντό τε ποιμένι λαῶν
σκηπτοῦχοι βασιλῆες· ἐπεσσεύοντο δὲ λαοί.
ἠΰτε ἔθνεα εἶσι μελισσάων ἀδινάων
πέτρης ἐκ γλαφυρῆς αἰεὶ νέον ἐρχομενάων,
βοτρυδὸν δὲ πέτονται ἐπ’ ἄνθεσιν εἰαρινοῖσιν·
αἳ μέν τ’ ἔνθα ἅλις πεποτήαται, αἳ δέ τε ἔνθα·

if any other man of the Achaeans had told us of this dream we should have declared it false, and would have had nothing to do with it. But he who has seen it is the foremost man among us; we must therefore set about getting the people under arms." With this he led the way from the assembly, and the other sceptered kings rose with him in obedience to the word of Agamemnon; but the people pressed forward to hear. They swarmed like bees that sally from some hollow cave and flit in countless throng among the spring flowers, bunched in knots and clusters; even so did the mighty multitude pour from ships and tents to the assembly, and range themselves upon the wide-watered shore, while among them ran Wildfire Rumor, messenger of Zeus, urging them ever to the fore. Thus they gathered in a pell-mell of mad confusion, and the earth groaned under the tramp of men as the people sought their places. Nine heralds went crying about among them to stay their tumult and bid them listen to the kings, till at last they were got into their several places and ceased their clamor. Then King Agamemnon rose, holding his scepter. This was the work of Hephaistos, who gave it to Zeus the son of Kronos. Zeus gave it to Hermes, slayer of Argos, guide and guardian. King Hermes gave it to Pelops, the mighty charioteer, and Pelops to Atreus, shepherd of his people. Atreus, when he died, left it to Thyestes, rich in flocks, and Thyestes in his turn left it to be borne by Agamemnon, that he might be lord of all Argos

and of the isles. Leaning, then, on his scepter, he addressed the Argives. "My friends," he said, "heroes, squires [therapontes] of Ares, Zeus the son of Kronos has tied me down with atê. Cruel, he gave me his solemn promise that I should sack the city of Priam before returning, but he has played me false, and is now bidding me go ingloriously back to Argos with the loss of many people. Such is the will of Zeus, who has laid many a proud city in the dust, as he will yet lay others, for his power is above all. It will be a sorry tale hereafter that an

2.91

91 ὣς τῶν ἔθνεα πολλὰ νεῶν ἄπο καὶ κλισιάων
92 ἠϊόνος προπάροιθε βαθείης ἐστιχόωντο
93 ἰλαδὸν εἰς ἀγορήν· μετὰ δέ σφισιν ὄσσα δεδήει
94 ὀτρύνουσ’ ἰέναι Διὸς ἄγγελος· οἳ δ’ ἀγέροντο.
95 τετρήχει δ’ ἀγορή, ὑπὸ δὲ στεναχίζετο γαῖα
96 λαῶν ἱζόντων, ὅμαδος δ’ ἦν· ἐννέα δέ σφεας
97 κήρυκες βοόωντες ἐρήτυον, εἴ ποτ’ ἀϋτῆς
98 σχοίατ’, ἀκούσειαν δὲ διοτρεφέων βασιλήων.
99 σπουδῇ δ’ ἔζετο λαός, ἐρήτυθεν δὲ καθ’ ἕδρας
100 παυσάμενοι κλαγγῆς· ἀνὰ δὲ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
101 ἔστη σκῆπτρον ἔχων τὸ μὲν Ἥφαιστος κάμε τεύχων.
102 Ἥφαιστος μὲν δῶκε Διὶ Κρονίωνι ἄνακτι,
103 αὐτὰρ ἄρα Ζεὺς δῶκε διακτόρῳ ἀργεϊφόντῃ·
104 Ἑρμείας δὲ ἄναξ δῶκεν Πέλοπι πληξίππῳ,
105 αὐτὰρ ὃ αὖτε Πέλοψ δῶκ’ Ἀτρέϊ ποιμένι λαῶν,
106 Ἀτρεὺς δὲ θνήσκων ἔλιπεν πολύαρνι Θυέστῃ,
107 αὐτὰρ ὃ αὖτε Θυέστ’ Ἀγαμέμνονι λεῖπε φορῆναι,
108 πολλῇσιν νήσοισι καὶ Ἄργεϊ παντὶ ἀνάσσειν.
109 τῷ ὅ γ’ ἐρεισάμενος ἔπε’ Ἀργείοισι μετηύδα·
110 ὦ φίλοι ἥρωες Δαναοὶ θεράποντες Ἄρηος
111 Ζεύς με μέγα Κρονίδης ἄτῃ ἐνέδησε βαρείῃ,
112 σχέτλιος, ὃς πρὶν μέν μοι ὑπέσχετο καὶ κατένευσεν
113 Ἴλιον ἐκπέρσαντ’ εὐτείχεον ἀπονέεσθαι,
114 νῦν δὲ κακὴν ἀπάτην βουλεύσατο, καί με κελεύει
115 δυσκλέα Ἄργος ἱκέσθαι, ἐπεὶ πολὺν ὤλεσα λαόν.
116 οὕτω που Διὶ μέλλει ὑπερμενέϊ φίλον εἶναι,
117 ὃς δὴ πολλάων πολίων κατέλυσε κάρηνα
118 ἠδ’ ἔτι καὶ λύσει· τοῦ γὰρ κράτος ἐστὶ μέγιστον.
119 αἰσχρὸν γὰρ τόδε γ’ ἐστὶ καὶ ἐσσομένοισι πυθέσθαι
120 μὰψ οὕτω τοιόνδε τοσόνδε τε λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν

Achaean host, at once so great and valiant, battled in vain against men fewer in number than themselves; but as yet the end is not in sight. Think that the Achaeans and Trojans have sworn to a solemn covenant, and that they have each been numbered - the Trojans by the roll of their householders, and we by companies of ten; think further that each of our companies desired to have a Trojan householder to pour out their wine; we are so greatly more in number that full many a company would have to go without its cup-bearer. But they have in the town allies from other places, and it is these that hinder me from being able to sack the rich city of Ilion. Nine of Zeus years are gone; the timbers of our ships have rotted; their tackling is sound no longer. Our wives and little ones at home look anxiously for our coming, but the work that we came hither to do has not been done. Now, therefore, let us all do as I say: let us sail back to our own land, for we shall not take Troy." With these words he moved the hearts of the multitude, so many of them as knew not the cunning

counsel of Agamemnon. They surged to and fro like the waves of the Ikarian Sea [pontos], when the east and south winds break from heaven's clouds to lash them; or as when the west wind sweeps over a field of grain and the ears bow beneath the blast, even so were they swayed as they flew with loud cries towards the ships, and the dust from under their feet rose heavenward. They cheered each other on to draw the ships into the sea; they cleared the channels in front of them; they began taking away the stays from underneath them, and the welkin rang with their glad cries, so eager were they to return. Then surely the Argives would have had a return [nostos] after a fashion that was not fated. But Hera said to Athena, "Alas, daughter of aegis-bearing Zeus, unweariable, shall the Argives flee home to their own land over the broad sea,

2.121

ἄπρηκτον πόλεμον πολεμίζειν ἠδὲ μάχεσθαι
ἀνδράσι παυροτέροισι, τέλος δ’ οὔ πώ τι πέφανται·
εἴ περ γάρ κ’ ἐθέλοιμεν Ἀχαιοί τε Τρῶές τε
ὅρκια πιστὰ ταμόντες ἀριθμηθήμεναι ἄμφω,
Τρῶας μὲν λέξασθαι ἐφέστιοι ὅσσοι ἔασιν,
ἡμεῖς δ’ ἐς δεκάδας διακοσμηθεῖμεν Ἀχαιοί,
Τρώων δ’ ἄνδρα ἕκαστοι ἐλοίμεθα οἰνοχοεύειν,
πολλαί κεν δεκάδες δευοίατο οἰνοχόοιο.
τόσσον ἐγώ φημι πλέας ἔμμεναι υἷας Ἀχαιῶν
Τρώων, οἳ ναίουσι κατὰ πτόλιν· ἀλλ’ ἐπίκουροι
πολλέων ἐκ πολίων ἐγχέσπαλοι ἄνδρες ἔασιν,
οἵ με μέγα πλάζουσι καὶ οὐκ εἰῶσ’ ἐθέλοντα
Ἰλίου ἐκπέρσαι εὖ ναιόμενον πτολίεθρον.
ἐννέα δὴ βεβάασι Διὸς μεγάλου ἐνιαυτοί,
καὶ δὴ δοῦρα σέσηπε νεῶν καὶ σπάρτα λέλυνται·
αἳ δέ που ἡμέτεραί τ’ ἄλοχοι καὶ νήπια τέκνα
εἵατ’ ἐνὶ μεγάροις ποτιδέγμεναι· ἄμμι δὲ ἔργον
αὖτως ἀκράαντον οὗ εἵνεκα δεῦρ’ ἱκόμεσθα.
ἀλλ’ ἄγεθ’ ὡς ἂν ἐγὼ εἴπω πειθώμεθα πάντες·
φεύγωμεν σὺν νηυσὶ φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν·
οὐ γὰρ ἔτι Τροίην αἱρήσομεν εὐρυάγυιαν.
ὣς φάτο, τοῖσι δὲ θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ὄρινε
πᾶσι μετὰ πληθὺν ὅσοι οὐ βουλῆς ἐπάκουσαν·
κινήθη δ’ ἀγορὴ φὴ κύματα μακρὰ θαλάσσης
πόντου Ἰκαρίοιο, τὰ μέν τ’ Εὖρός τε Νότος τε
ὄρορ’ ἐπαΐξας πατρὸς Διὸς ἐκ νεφελάων.
ὡς δ’ ὅτε κινήσῃ Ζέφυρος βαθὺ λήϊον ἐλθὼν
λάβρος ἐπαιγίζων, ἐπί τ’ ἠμύει ἀσταχύεσσιν,
ὣς τῶν πᾶσ’ ἀγορὴ κινήθη· τοὶ δ’ ἀλαλητῷ
νῆας ἔπ’ ἐσσεύοντο, ποδῶν δ’ ὑπένερθε κονίη

2.151

ἵστατ’ ἀειρομένη· τοὶ δ’ ἀλλήλοισι κέλευον
ἅπτεσθαι νηῶν ἠδ’ ἐλκέμεν εἰς ἅλα δῖαν,
οὐρούς τ’ ἐξεκάθαιρον· ἀϋτὴ δ’ οὐρανὸν ἶκεν
οἴκαδε ἰεμένων· ὑπὸ δ’ ἤρεον ἔρματα νηῶν.
ἔνθά κεν Ἀργείοισιν ὑπέρμορα νόστος ἐτύχθη
εἰ μὴ Ἀθηναίην Ἥρη πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν·

157 ὢ πόποι αἰγιόχοιο Διὸς τέκος Ἀτρυτώνη,
158 οὕτω δὴ οἶκον δὲ φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν
159 Ἀργεῖοι φεύξονται ἐπ’ εὐρέα νῶτα θαλάσσης,
160 κὰδ δέ κεν εὐχωλὴν Πριάμῳ καὶ Τρωσὶ λίποιεν
161 Ἀργείην Ἑλένην, ἧς εἵνεκα πολλοὶ Ἀχαιῶν
162 ἐν Τροίῃ ἀπόλοντο φίλης ἀπὸ πατρίδος αἴης·
163 ἀλλ’ ἴθι νῦν κατὰ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων·
164 σοῖς ἀγανοῖς ἐπέεσσιν ἐρήτυε φῶτα ἕκαστον,
165 μηδὲ ἔα νῆας ἅλα δ’ ἑλκέμεν ἀμφιελίσσας.
166 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη,
167 βῆ δὲ κατ’ Οὐλύμποιο καρήνων ἀΐξασα·
168 καρπαλίμως δ’ ἵκανε θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν.
169 εὗρεν ἔπειτ’ Ὀδυσῆα Διὶ μῆτιν ἀτάλαντον
170 ἑσταότ’· οὐδ’ ὅ γε νηὸς ἐϋσσέλμοιο μελαίνης
171 ἅπτετ’, ἐπεί μιν ἄχος κραδίην καὶ θυμὸν ἵκανεν·
172 ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἰσταμένη προσέφη γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·
173 διογενὲς Λαερτιάδη πολυμήχαν’ Ὀδυσσεῦ,
174 οὕτω δὴ οἶκον δὲ φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν
175 φεύξεσθ’ ἐν νήεσσι πολυκλήϊσι πεσόντες,
176 κὰδ δέ κεν εὐχωλὴν Πριάμῳ καὶ Τρωσὶ λίποιτε
177 Ἀργείην Ἑλένην, ἧς εἵνεκα πολλοὶ Ἀχαιῶν
178 ἐν Τροίῃ ἀπόλοντο φίλης ἀπὸ πατρίδος αἴης;
179 ἀλλ’ ἴθι νῦν κατὰ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν, μηδ’ ἔτ’ ἐρώει,
180 σοῖς δ’ ἀγανοῖς ἐπέεσσιν ἐρήτυε φῶτα ἕκαστον,
and leave Priam and the Trojans the glory of still keeping Helen, for whose sake so many of the Achaeans have died at Troy, far from their homes? Go about at once among the host, and speak fairly to them, man by man, that they draw not their ships into the sea." Athena was not slack to do her bidding. Down she darted from the topmost summits of Olympus, and in a moment she was at the ships of the Achaeans. There she found Odysseus, peer of Zeus in counsel, standing alone. He had not as yet laid a hand upon his ship, for he felt grief [akhos] and was sorry; so she went close up to him and said, "Odysseus, noble son of Laertes, are you going to fling yourselves into your ships and be off home to your own land in this way? Will you leave Priam and the Trojans the glory of still keeping Helen, for whose sake so many of the Achaeans have died at Troy, far from their homes? Go about at once among the host, and speak fairly to them, man by man, that they draw not their ships into the sea." Odysseus knew the voice as that of the goddess: he flung his cloak from him and set off to run. His squire Eurybates, a man of Ithaca, who waited on him, took charge of the cloak, whereon Odysseus went straight up to Agamemnon and received from him his ancestral, imperishable staff. With this he went about among the ships of the Achaeans. Whenever he met a king or chieftain, he stood by him and spoke him fairly. "Sir," said he, "this flight is cowardly and unworthy. Stand to your post, and bid your people also keep their places. You do not yet know the full mind [noos] of Agamemnon; he was sounding us, and ere long will visit the Achaeans with his displeasure. We were not all of us at the council to hear what he then said; see to it lest he be angry and do us a mischief; for the timê of kings is great, and the hand of Zeus is with them." But when he came across some man from some locale [dêmos] who was making a noise, he struck him with his staff and rebuked him, saying,

2.181

181 μηδὲ ἔα νῆας ἅλα δ’ ἑλκέμεν ἀμφιελίσσας.
182 ὣς φάθ’, ὃ δὲ ξυνέηκε θεᾶς ὄπα φωνησάσης,

183 βῆ δὲ θέειν, ἀπὸ δὲ χλαῖναν βάλε· τὴν δὲ κόμισσε
184 κῆρυξ Εὐρυβάτης Ἰθακήσιος ὅς οἱ ὀπήδει·
185 αὐτὸς δ’ Ἀτρεΐδεω Ἀγαμέμνονος ἀντίος ἐλθὼν
186 δέξατό οἱ σκῆπτρον πατρώϊον ἄφθιτον αἰεί·
187 σὺν τῷ ἔβη κατὰ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων.
188 ὅν τινα μὲν βασιλῆα καὶ ἔξοχον ἄνδρα κιχείη
189 τὸν δ’ ἀγανοῖς ἐπέεσσιν ἐρητύσασκε παραστάς·
190 δαιμόνι’ οὔ σε ἔοικε κακὸν ὣς δειδίσσεσθαι,
191 ἀλλ’ αὐτός τε κάθησο καὶ ἄλλους ἵδρυε λαούς·
192 οὐ γάρ πω σάφα οἶσθ’ οἷος νόος Ἀτρεΐωνος·
193 νῦν μὲν πειρᾶται, τάχα δ’ ἴψεται υἷας Ἀχαιῶν.
194 ἐν βουλῇ δ’ οὐ πάντες ἀκούσαμεν οἷον ἔειπε.
195 μή τι χολωσάμενος ῥέξῃ κακὸν υἷας Ἀχαιῶν·
196 θυμὸς δὲ μέγας ἐστὶ διοτρεφέων βασιλήων,
197 τιμὴ δ’ ἐκ Διός ἐστι, φιλεῖ δέ ἑ μητίετα Ζεύς.
198 ὃν δ’ αὖ δήμου τ’ ἄνδρα ἴδοι βοόωντά τ’ ἐφεύροι,
199 τὸν σκήπτρῳ ἐλάσασκεν ὀμοκλήσασκέ τε μύθῳ·
200 δαιμόνι’ ἀτρέμας ἧσο καὶ ἄλλων μῦθον ἄκουε,
201 οἳ σέο φέρτεροί εἰσι, σὺ δ’ ἀπτόλεμος καὶ ἄναλκις
202 οὔτέ ποτ’ ἐν πολέμῳ ἐναρίθμιος οὔτ’ ἐνὶ βουλῇ·
203 οὐ μέν πως πάντες βασιλεύσομεν ἐνθάδ’ Ἀχαιοί·
204 οὐκ ἀγαθὸν πολυκοιρανίη· εἷς κοίρανος ἔστω,
205 εἷς βασιλεύς, ᾧ δῶκε Κρόνου πάϊς ἀγκυλομήτεω
206 σκῆπτρόν τ’ ἠδὲ θέμιστας, ἵνά σφισι βουλεύῃσι.
207 ὣς ὅ γε κοιρανέων δίεπε στρατόν· οἳ δ’ ἀγορὴν δὲ
208 αὖτις ἐπεσσεύοντο νεῶν ἄπο καὶ κλισιάων
209 ἠχῇ, ὡς ὅτε κῦμα πολυφλοίσβοιο θαλάσσης
210 αἰγιαλῷ μεγάλῳ βρέμεται, σμαραγεῖ δέ τε πόντος.

"What kind of daimôn has possessed you? Hold your peace, and listen to better men than yourself. You are a coward and no warrior; you are nobody either in fight or council; we cannot all be kings; it is not well that there should be many masters; one man must be supreme - one king to whom the son of scheming Kronos has given the scepter and divine laws to rule over you all." Thus masterfully did he go about among the host, and the people hurried back to the council from their tents and ships with a sound as the thunder of surf when it comes crashing down upon the shore, and all the sea [pontos] is in an uproar. The rest now took their seats and kept to their own several places, but Thersites still went on wagging his unbridled tongue - a man of many words, and those unseemly; a monger of sedition, a railer against all who were in authority [kosmos], who cared not what he said, so that he might set the Achaeans in a laugh. He was the ugliest man of all those that came before Troy - bandy-legged, lame of one foot, with his two shoulders rounded and hunched over his chest. His head ran up to a point, but there was little hair on the top of it. Achilles and Odysseus hated him worst of all, for it was with them that he was most wont to wrangle; now, however, with a shrill squeaky voice he began heaping his abuse on Agamemnon. The Achaeans were angry and disgusted, yet none the less he kept on brawling and bawling at the son of Atreus. "Agamemnon," he cried, "what ails you now, and what more do you want? Your tents are filled with bronze and with fair women, for whenever we take a town we give you the pick of them. Would you have yet more gold, which some Trojan is to give you as a ransom for his son, when I or another Achaean has taken him prisoner? or is it some young girl to hide and lie with? It is not well that you, the ruler of the Achaeans, should bring them into such misery. Weakling cowards, women rather than men, let us sail home, and leave this man here at Troy to stew in his own prizes

of honor, and discover whether we were of any service to him or no. Achilles is a much better man than he is, and see how he has treated him -

2.211

211 ἄλλοι μέν ῥ’ ἔζοντο, ἐρήτυθεν δὲ καθ’ ἕδρας·
212 Θερσίτης δ’ ἔτι μοῦνος ἀμετροεπὴς ἐκολῴα,
213 ὃς ἔπεα φρεσὶν ᾗσιν ἄκοσμά τε πολλά τε ᾖδη
214 μάψ, ἀτὰρ οὐ κατὰ κόσμον, ἐριζέμεναι βασιλεῦσιν,
215 ἀλλ’ ὅ τι οἱ εἴσαιτο γελοίϊον Ἀργείοισιν
216 ἔμμεναι· αἴσχιστος δὲ ἀνὴρ ὑπὸ Ἴλιον ἦλθε·
217 φολκὸς ἔην, χωλὸς δ’ ἕτερον πόδα· τὼ δέ οἱ ὤμω
218 κυρτὼ ἐπὶ στῆθος συνοχωκότε· αὐτὰρ ὕπερθε
219 φοξὸς ἔην κεφαλήν, ψεδνὴ δ’ ἐπενήνοθε λάχνη.
220 ἔχθιστος δ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ μάλιστ’ ἦν ἠδ’ Ὀδυσῆϊ·
221 τὼ γὰρ νεικείεσκε· τότ’ αὖτ’ Ἀγαμέμνονι δίῳ
222 ὀξέα κεκλήγων λέγ’ ὀνείδεα· τῷ δ’ ἄρ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
223 ἐκπάγλως κοτέοντο νεμέσσηθέν τ’ ἐνὶ θυμῷ.
224 αὐτὰρ ὃ μακρὰ βοῶν Ἀγαμέμνονα νείκεε μύθῳ·
225 Ἀτρεΐδη τέο δ’ αὖτ’ ἐπιμέμφεαι ἠδὲ χατίζεις;
226 πλεῖαί τοι χαλκοῦ κλισίαι, πολλαὶ δὲ γυναῖκες
227 εἰσὶν ἐνὶ κλισίῃς ἐξαίρετοι, ἄς τοι Ἀχαιοὶ
228 πρωτίστῳ δίδομεν εὖτ’ ἂν πτολίεθρον ἕλωμεν.
229 ἦ ἔτι καὶ χρυσοῦ ἐπιδεύεαι, ὅν κέ τις οἴσει
230 Τρώων ἱπποδάμων ἐξ Ἰλίου υἷος ἄποινα,
231 ὅν κεν ἐγὼ δήσας ἀγάγω ἢ ἄλλος Ἀχαιῶν,
232 ἠὲ γυναῖκα νέην, ἵνα μίσγεαι ἐν φιλότητι,
233 ἥν τ’ αὐτὸς ἀπονόσφι κατίσχεαι; οὐ μὲν ἔοικεν
234 ἀρχὸν ἐόντα κακῶν ἐπιβασκέμεν υἷας Ἀχαιῶν.
235 ὦ πέπονες κάκ’ ἐλέγχε’ Ἀχαιΐδες οὐκέτ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
236 οἴκαδέ περ σὺν νηυσὶ νεώμεθα, τόνδε δ’ ἐῶμεν
237 αὐτοῦ ἐνὶ Τροίῃ γέρα πεσσέμεν, ὄφρα ἴδηται
238 ἤ ῥά τί οἱ χἠμεῖς προσαμύνομεν ἦε καὶ οὐκί·
239 ὃς καὶ νῦν Ἀχιλῆα ἔο μέγ’ ἀμείνονα φῶτα
240 ἠτίμησεν· ἑλὼν γὰρ ἔχει γέρας αὐτὸς ἀπούρας.

robbing him of his prize and keeping it himself. Achilles takes it meekly and shows no fight; if he did, son of Atreus, you would never again insult him." Thus railed Thersites, but Odysseus at once went up to him and rebuked him sternly. "Check your glib tongue, Thersites," said be, "and babble not a word further. Chide not with princes when you have none to back you. There is no viler creature come before Troy with the sons of Atreus. Drop this chatter about kings, and neither revile them nor keep harping about homecoming [nostos]. We do not yet know how things are going to be, nor whether the Achaeans are to return with good success or evil. How dare you gibe at Agamemnon because the Danaans have awarded him so many prizes? I tell you, therefore - and it shall surely be - that if I again catch you talking such nonsense, I will either forfeit my own head and be no more called father of Telemakhos, or I will take you, strip away from you all respect [aidôs], and whip you out of the assembly till you go blubbering back to the ships." On this he beat him with his staff about the back and shoulders till he dropped and fell a-weeping. The golden scepter raised a bloody weal on his back, so he sat down frightened and in pain, looking foolish as he wiped the tears from his eyes. The people were sorry for him, yet they laughed heartily, and one would turn to his neighbor saying, "Odysseus has done many a good thing ere now in fight and council, but he never did the Argives a better turn than when he

stopped this man's mouth from prating further. He will give the kings no more of his insolence." Thus said the people. Then Odysseus rose, scepter in hand, and Athena

2.241

ἀλλὰ μάλ’ οὐκ Ἀχιλῆϊ χόλος φρεσίν, ἀλλὰ μεθήμων·
ἦ γὰρ ἂν Ἀτρεΐδη νῦν ὕστατα λωβήσαιο·
ὣς φάτο νεικείων Ἀγαμέμνονα ποιμένα λαῶν,
Θερσίτης· τῷ δ’ ὦκα παρίστατο δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς,
καί μιν ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν χαλεπῷ ἠνίπαπε μύθῳ·
Θερσῖτ’ ἀκριτόμυθε, λιγύς περ ἐὼν ἀγορητής,
ἴσχεο, μηδ’ ἔθελ’ οἷος ἐριζέμεναι βασιλεῦσιν·
οὐ γὰρ ἐγὼ σέο φημὶ χερειότερον βροτὸν ἄλλον
ἔμμεναι, ὅσσοι ἅμ’ Ἀτρεΐδῃς ὑπὸ Ἴλιον ἦλθον.
τὼ οὐκ ἂν βασιλῆας ἀνὰ στόμ’ ἔχων ἀγορεύοις,
καί σφιν ὀνείδεά τε προφέροις, νόστόν τε φυλάσσοις.
οὐδέ τί πω σάφα ἴδμεν ὅπως ἔσται τάδε ἔργα,
ἢ εὖ ἦε κακῶς νοστήσομεν υἷες Ἀχαιῶν.
τὼ νῦν Ἀτρεΐδῃ Ἀγαμέμνονι ποιμένι λαῶν
ἧσαι ὀνειδίζων, ὅτι οἱ μάλα πολλὰ διδοῦσιν
ἥρωες Δαναοί· σὺ δὲ κερτομέων ἀγορεύεις.
ἀλλ’ ἔκ τοι ἐρέω, τὸ δὲ καὶ τετελεσμένον ἔσται·
εἴ κ’ ἔτι σ’ ἀφραίνοντα κιχήσομαι ὥς νύ περ ὧδε,
μηκέτ’ ἔπειτ’ Ὀδυσῆϊ κάρη ὤμοισιν ἐπείη,
μηδ’ ἔτι Τηλεμάχοιο πατὴρ κεκλημένος εἴην,
εἰ μὴ ἐγώ σε λαβὼν ἀπὸ μὲν φίλα εἵματα δύσω,
χλαῖνάν τ’ ἠδὲ χιτῶνα, τά τ’ αἰδῶ ἀμφικαλύπτει,
αὐτὸν δὲ κλαίοντα θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας ἀφήσω
πεπλήγων ἀγορῆθεν ἀεικέσσι πληγῇσιν.
ὣς ἄρ’ ἔφη, σκήπτρῳ δὲ μετάφρενον ἠδὲ καὶ ὤμω
πλῆξεν· ὃ δ’ ἰδνώθη, θαλερὸν δέ οἱ ἔκπεσε δάκρυ·
σμῶδιξ δ’ αἱματόεσσα μεταφρένου ἐξυπανέστη
σκήπτρου ὕπο χρυσέου· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ἔζετο τάρβησέν τε,
ἀλγήσας δ’ ἀχρεῖον ἰδὼν ἀπομόρξατο δάκρυ.
οἳ δὲ καὶ ἀχνύμενοί περ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ ἡδὺ γέλασσαν·

2.271

ὧδε δέ τις εἶπεσκεν ἰδὼν ἐς πλησίον ἄλλον·
ὦ πόποι ἦ δὴ μυρί’ Ὀδυσσεὺς ἐσθλὰ ἔοργε
βουλάς τ’ ἐξάρχων ἀγαθὰς πόλεμόν τε κορύσσων·
νῦν δὲ τόδε μέγ’ ἄριστον ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἔρεξεν,
ὃς τὸν λωβητῆρα ἐπεσβόλον ἔσχ’ ἀγοράων.
οὔ θήν μιν πάλιν αὖτις ἀνήσει θυμὸς ἀγήνωρ
νεικείειν βασιλῆας ὀνειδείοις ἐπέεσσιν.
ὣς φάσαν ἠ πληθύς· ἀνὰ δ’ ὃ πτολίπορθος Ὀδυσσεὺς
ἔστη σκῆπτρον ἔχων· παρὰ δὲ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη
εἰδομένη κήρυκι σιωπᾶν λαὸν ἀνώγει,
ὡς ἅμα θ’ οἳ πρῶτοί τε καὶ ὕστατοι υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
μῦθον ἀκούσειαν καὶ ἐπιφρασσαίατο βουλήν·
ὅ σφιν ἐὺ φρονέων ἀγορήσατο καὶ μετέειπεν·
Ἀτρεΐδη νῦν δή σε ἄναξ ἐθέλουσιν Ἀχαιοὶ

285 πᾶσιν ἐλέγχιστον θέμεναι μερόπεσσι βροτοῖσιν,
286 οὐδέ τοι ἐκτελέουσιν ὑπόσχεσιν ἥν περ ὑπέσταν
287 ἐνθάδ’ ἔτι στείχοντες ἀπ’ Ἄργεος ἱπποβότοιο
288 Ἴλιον ἐκπέρσαντ’ εὐτείχεον ἀπονέεσθαι.
289 ὥς τε γὰρ ἢ παῖδες νεαροὶ χῆραί τε γυναῖκες
290 ἀλλήλοισιν ὀδύρονται οἶκον δὲ νέεσθαι.
291 ἦ μὴν καὶ πόνος ἐστὶν ἀνιηθέντα νέεσθαι·
292 καὶ γάρ τίς θ’ ἕνα μῆνα μένων ἀπὸ ἧς ἀλόχοιο
293 ἀσχαλάᾳ σὺν νηῒ πολυζύγῳ, ὅν περ ἄελλαι
294 χειμέριαι εἰλέωσιν ὀρινομένη τε θάλασσα·
295 ἡμῖν δ’ εἴνατός ἐστι περιτροπέων ἐνιαυτὸς
296 ἐνθάδε μιμνόντεσσι· τὼ οὐ νεμεσίζομ’ Ἀχαιοὺς
297 ἀσχαλάαν παρὰ νηυσὶ κορωνίσιν· ἀλλὰ καὶ ἔμπης
298 αἰσχρόν τοι δηρόν τε μένειν κενεόν τε νέεσθαι.
299 τλῆτε φίλοι, καὶ μείνατ’ ἐπὶ χρόνον ὄφρα δαῶμεν
300 ἢ ἐτεὸν Κάλχας μαντεύεται ἦε καὶ οὐκί.
in the likeness of a herald bade the people be still, that those who were far off might hear him and consider his council. He therefore with all sincerity and goodwill addressed them thus: - "King Agamemnon, the Achaeans are for making you a by-word among all humankind. They forget the promise they made you when they set out from Argos, that you should not return till you had sacked the town of Troy, and, like children or widowed women, they murmur and would set off homeward. True it is that they have had toil [ponos] enough to be disheartened. A man chafes at having to stay away from his wife even for a single month, when he is on shipboard, at the mercy of wind and sea, but it is now nine long years that we have been kept here; I cannot, therefore, blame the Achaeans if they turn restive; still we shall be shamed if we go home empty after so long a stay - therefore, my friends, be patient yet a little longer that we may learn whether the prophesyings of Kalkhas were false or true. "All who have not since perished must remember as though it were yesterday or the day before, how the ships of the Achaeans were detained in Aulis when we were on our way hither to make war on Priam and the Trojans. We were ranged round about a fountain offering hecatombs to the gods upon their holy altars, and there was a fine plane-tree from beneath which there welled a stream of pure water. Then we saw a sign [sêma]; for Zeus sent a fearful serpent out of the ground, with blood-red stains upon its back, and it darted from under the altar on to the plane-tree. Now there was a brood of young sparrows, quite small, upon the topmost bough, peeping out from under the leaves, eight in all, and their mother that hatched them made nine. The serpent ate the poor cheeping things, while the old bird flew about lamenting her little ones; but the serpent threw his coils about her and caught her by the wing as she was screaming. Then, when he had eaten both the sparrow and her young, the god who had sent him made him become a sign; for the son of scheming Kronos turned him into stone,

2.301

301 εὖ γὰρ δὴ τόδε ἴδμεν ἐνὶ φρεσίν, ἐστὲ δὲ πάντες
302 μάρτυροι, οὓς μὴ κῆρες ἔβαν θανάτοιο φέρουσαι·
303 χθιζά τε καὶ πρωΐζ’ ὅτ’ ἐς Αὐλίδα νῆες Ἀχαιῶν
304 ἠγερέθοντο κακὰ Πριάμῳ καὶ Τρωσὶ φέρουσαι,
305 ἡμεῖς δ’ ἀμφὶ περὶ κρήνην ἱεροὺς κατὰ βωμοὺς
306 ἕρδομεν ἀθανάτοισι τελησσας ἑκατόμβας
307 καλῇ ὑπὸ πλατανίστῳ ὅθεν ῥέεν ἀγλαὸν ὕδωρ·
308 ἔνθ’ ἐφάνη μέγα σῆμα· δράκων ἐπὶ νῶτα δαφοινὸς
309 σμερδαλέος, τόν ῥ’ αὐτὸς Ὀλύμπιος ἦκε φόως δέ,

310 βωμοῦ ὑπαΐξας πρός ῥα πλατάνιστον ὄρουσεν.
311 ἔνθα δ’ ἔσαν στρουθοῖο νεοσσοί, νήπια τέκνα,
312 ὄζῳ ἐπ’ ἀκροτάτῳ πετάλοις ὑποπεπτηῶτες
313 ὀκτώ, ἀτὰρ μήτηρ ἐνάτη ἦν ἢ τέκε τέκνα·
314 ἔνθ’ ὅ γε τοὺς ἐλεεινὰ κατήσθιε τετριγῶτας·
315 μήτηρ δ’ ἀμφεποτᾶτο ὀδυρομένη φίλα τέκνα·
316 τὴν δ’ ἐλελιξάμενος πτέρυγος λάβεν ἀμφιαχυῖαν.
317 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ κατὰ τέκνα φάγε στρουθοῖο καὶ αὐτήν,
318 τὸν μὲν ἀρίζηλον θῆκεν θεὸς ὅς περ ἔφηνε·
319 λᾶαν γάρ μιν ἔθηκε Κρόνου πάϊς ἀγκυλομήτεω·
320 ἡμεῖς δ’ ἐσταότες θαυμάζομεν οἷον ἐτύχθη.
321 ὡς οὖν δεινὰ πέλωρα θεῶν εἰσῆλθ’ ἑκατόμβας,
322 Κάλχας δ’ αὐτίκ’ ἔπειτα θεοπροπέων ἀγόρευε·
323 τίπτ’ ἄνεῳ ἐγένεσθε κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοί;
324 ἡμῖν μὲν τόδ’ ἔφηνε τέρας μέγα μητίετα Ζεὺς
325 ὄψιμον ὀψιτέλεστον, ὅου κλέος οὔ ποτ’ ὀλεῖται.
326 ὡς οὗτος κατὰ τέκνα φάγε στρουθοῖο καὶ αὐτὴν
327 ὀκτώ, ἀτὰρ μήτηρ ἐνάτη ἦν ἢ τέκε τέκνα,
328 ὣς ἡμεῖς τοσσαῦτ’ ἔτεα πτολεμίξομεν αὖθι,
329 τῷ δεκάτῳ δὲ πόλιν αἱρήσομεν εὐρυάγυιαν.
330 κεῖνος τὼς ἀγόρευε· τὰ δὴ νῦν πάντα τελεῖται.
and we stood there wondering at that which had come to pass. Seeing, then, that such a fearful portent had broken in upon our hecatombs, Kalkhas forthwith declared to us the oracles of heaven. ‘Why, Achaeans,’ said he, ‘are you thus speechless? Zeus has sent us this sign, long in coming, and long ere it be fulfilled, though its fame [kleos] shall last for ever. As the serpent ate the eight fledglings and the sparrow that hatched them, which makes nine, so shall we fight nine years at Troy, but in the tenth shall take the town.’ This was what he said, and now it is all coming true. Stay here, therefore, all of you, till we take the city of Priam." On this the Argives raised a shout, till the ships rang again with the uproar. Nestor, horseman of Gerene, then addressed them. "Shame on you," he cried, "to stay talking here like children, when you should fight like men. Where are our covenants now, and where the oaths that we have taken? Shall our counsels be flung into the fire, with our drink-offerings and the right hands of fellowship wherein we have put our trust? We waste our time in words, and for all our talking here shall be no further forward. Stand, therefore, son of Atreus, by your own steadfast purpose; lead the Argives on to battle, and leave this handful of men to rot, who scheme, and scheme in vain, to get back to Argos ere they have learned whether Zeus be true or a liar. For the mighty son of Kronos surely promised that we should succeed, when we Argives set sail to bring death and destruction upon the Trojans. He showed us favorable signs [sêmata] by flashing his lightning on our right hands; therefore let none make haste to go till he has first lain with the wife of some Trojan, and avenged the toil and sorrow that he has suffered for the sake of Helen. Nevertheless, if any man is in such haste to be at home again, let him lay his hand to his ship that he may meet his doom in the sight of all.

2.331

331 ἀλλ’ ἄγε μίμνετε πάντες ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
332 αὐτοῦ εἰς ὅ κεν ἄστυ μέγα Πριάμοιο ἕλωμεν.
333 ὣς ἔφατ’, Ἀργεῖοι δὲ μέγ’ ἴαχον, ἀμφὶ δὲ νῆες
334 σμερδαλέον κονάβησαν ἀϋσάντων ὑπ’ Ἀχαιῶν,
335 μῦθον ἐπαινήσαντες Ὀδυσσῆος θείοιο·
336 τοῖσι δὲ καὶ μετέειπε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·

337 ὦ πόποι ἦ δὴ παισὶν ἐοικότες ἀγοράασθε
338 νηπιάχοις οἷς οὔ τι μέλει πολεμήϊα ἔργα.
339 πῇ δὴ συνθεσίαι τε καὶ ὅρκια βήσεται ἥμιν;
340 ἐν πυρὶ δὴ βουλαί τε γενοίατο μήδεά τ’ ἀνδρῶν
341 σπονδαί τ’ ἄκρητοι καὶ δεξιαί, ᾗς ἐπέπιθμεν·
342 αὔτως γὰρ ἐπέεσσ’ ἐριδαίνομεν, οὐδέ τι μῆχος
343 εὑρέμεναι δυνάμεσθα, πολὺν χρόνον ἐνθάδ’ ἐόντες.
344 Ἀτρεΐδη σὺ δ’ ἔθ’ ὡς πρὶν ἔχων ἀστεμφέα βουλὴν
345 ἄρχευ’ Ἀργείοισι κατὰ κρατερὰς ὑσμίνας,
346 τούσδε δ’ ἔα φθινύθειν ἕνα καὶ δύο, τοί κεν Ἀχαιῶν
347 νόσφιν βουλεύωσ’· ἄνυσις δ’ οὐκ ἔσσεται αὐτῶν·
348 πρὶν Ἄργος δ’ ἰέναι πρὶν καὶ Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο
349 γνώμεναι εἴ τε ψεῦδος ὑπόσχεσις εἴ τε καὶ οὐκί.
350 φημὶ γὰρ οὖν κατανεῦσαι ὑπερμενέα Κρονίωνα
351 ἤματι τῷ ὅτε νηυσὶν ἐν ὠκυπόροισιν ἔβαινον
352 Ἀργεῖοι Τρώεσσι φόνον καὶ κῆρα φέροντες
353 ἀστράπτων ἐπιδέξι’ ἐναίσιμα σήματα φαίνων.
354 τὼ μή τις πρὶν ἐπειγέσθω οἶκον δὲ νέεσθαι
355 πρίν τινα πὰρ Τρώων ἁλόχῳ κατακοιμηθῆναι,
356 τίσασθαι δ’ Ἑλένης ὀρμήματά τε στοναχάς τε.
357 εἰ δέ τις ἐκπάγλως ἐθέλει οἶκον δὲ νέεσθαι
358 ἁπτέσθω ἧς νηὸς ἐϋσσέλμοιο μελαίνης,
359 ὅφρα πρόσθ’ ἄλλων θάνατον καὶ πότμον ἐπίσπῃ.
360 ἀλλὰ ἄναξ αὐτός τ’ εὖ μήδεο πείθεό τ’ ἄλλῳ·
But, O king, consider and give ear to my counsel, for the word that I say may not be neglected lightly. Divide [krinô] your men, Agamemnon, into their several tribes and clans, that clans and tribes may stand by and help one another. If you do this, and if the Achaeans obey you, you will find out who, both chiefs and peoples, are brave, and who are cowards; for they will vie against the other. Thus you shall also learn whether it is through the counsel of heaven or the cowardice of man that you shall fail to take the town." And Agamemnon answered, "Nestor, you have again outdone the sons of the Achaeans in counsel. Would, by Father Zeus, Athena, and Apollo, that I had among them ten more such councilors, for the city of King Priam would then soon fall beneath our hands, and we should sack it. But the son of Kronos afflicts me with bootless wranglings and strife. Achilles and I are quarreling about this girl, in which matter I was the first to offend; if we can be of one mind again, the Trojans will not stave off destruction for a day. Now, therefore, get your morning meal, that our hosts join in fight. Whet well your spears; see well to the ordering of your shields; give good feeds to your horses, and look your chariots carefully over, that we may do battle the livelong day; for we shall have no rest, not for a moment, till night falls to part us. The bands that bear your shields shall be wet with the sweat upon your shoulders, your hands shall weary upon your spears, your horses shall steam in front of your chariots, and if I see any man shirking the fight, or trying to keep out of it at the ships, there shall be no help for him, but he shall be a prey to dogs and vultures." Thus he spoke, and the Achaeans roared approval. As when the waves run high before the blast of the south wind and break on some lofty headland, dashing against it and buffeting it without ceasing, as the storms from every quarter drive them, even so did the Achaeans rise and hurry in all directions to their ships. There they lighted their fires at their tents and got dinner,

2.361

361 οὔ τοι ἀπόβλητον ἔπος ἔσσεται ὅττί κεν εἴπω·

κρῖν’ ἄνδρας κατὰ φῦλα κατὰ φρήτρας Ἀγάμεμνον,
ὡς φρήτρη φρήτρηφιν ἀρήγῃ, φῦλα δὲ φύλοις.
εἰ δέ κεν ὣς ἔρξῃς καί τοι πείθωνται Ἀχαιοί,
γνώσῃ ἔπειθ’ ὅς θ’ ἡγεμόνων κακὸς ὅς τέ νυ λαῶν
ἠδ’ ὅς κ’ ἐσθλὸς ἔῃσι· κατὰ σφέας γὰρ μαχέονται.
γνώσεαι δ’ εἰ καὶ θεσπεσίῃ πόλιν οὐκ ἀλαπάξεις,
ἦ ἀνδρῶν κακότητι καὶ ἀφραδίῃ πολέμοιο.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων·
ἦ μὰν αὖτ’ ἀγορῇ νικᾷς γέρον υἷας Ἀχαιῶν.
αἲ γὰρ Ζεῦ τε πάτερ καὶ Ἀθηναίη καὶ Ἄπολλον
τοιοῦτοι δέκα μοι συμφράδμονες εἶεν Ἀχαιῶν·
τώ κε τάχ’ ἠμύσειε πόλις Πριάμοιο ἄνακτος
χερσὶν ὑφ’ ἡμετέρῃσιν ἁλοῦσά τε περθομένη τε.
ἀλλά μοι αἰγίοχος Κρονίδης Ζεὺς ἄλγε’ ἔδωκεν,
ὅς με μετ’ ἀπρήκτους ἔριδας καὶ νείκεα βάλλει.
καὶ γὰρ ἐγὼν Ἀχιλεύς τε μαχεσσάμεθ’ εἵνεκα κούρης
ἀντιβίοις ἐπέεσσιν, ἐγὼ δ’ ἦρχον χαλεπαίνων·
εἰ δέ ποτ’ ἔς γε μίαν βουλεύσομεν, οὐκέτ’ ἔπειτα
Τρωσὶν ἀνάβλησις κακοῦ ἔσσεται οὐδ’ ἠβαιόν.
νῦν δ’ ἔρχεσθ’ ἐπὶ δεῖπνον ἵνα ξυνάγωμεν Ἄρηα.
εὖ μέν τις δόρυ θηξάσθω, εὖ δ’ ἀσπίδα θέσθω,
εὖ δέ τις ἵπποισιν δεῖπνον δότω ὠκυπόδεσσιν,
εὖ δέ τις ἅρματος ἀμφὶς ἰδὼν πολέμοιο μεδέσθω,
ὥς κε πανημέριοι στυγερῷ κρινώμεθ’ Ἀρῆϊ.
οὐ γὰρ παυσωλή γε μετέσσεται οὐδ’ ἠβαιὸν
εἰ μὴ νὺξ ἐλθοῦσα διακρινέει μένος ἀνδρῶν.
ἱδρώσει μέν τευ τελαμὼν ἀμφὶ στήθεσφιν
ἀσπίδος ἀμφιβρότης, περὶ δ’ ἔγχεϊ χεῖρα καμεῖται·
ἱδρώσει δέ τευ ἵππος ἐΰξοον ἅρμα τιταίνων.

2.391

ὃν δέ κ’ ἐγὼν ἀπάνευθε μάχης ἐθέλοντα νοήσω
μιμνάζειν παρὰ νηυσὶ κορωνίσιν, οὔ οἱ ἔπειτα
ἄρκιον ἐσσεῖται φυγέειν κύνας ἠδ’ οἰωνούς.
ὣς ἔφατ’, Ἀργεῖοι δὲ μέγ’ ἴαχον ὡς ὅτε κῦμα
ἀκτῇ ἐφ’ ὑψηλῇ, ὅτε κινήσῃ Νότος ἐλθών,
προβλῆτι σκοπέλῳ· τὸν δ’ οὔ ποτε κύματα λείπει
παντοίων ἀνέμων, ὅτ’ ἂν ἔνθ’ ἢ ἔνθα γένωνται.
ἀνστάντες δ’ ὀρέοντο κεδασθέντες κατὰ νῆας,
κάπνισσάν τε κατὰ κλισίας, καὶ δεῖπνον ἔλοντο.
ἄλλος δ’ ἄλλῳ ἔρεζε θεῶν αἰειγενετάων
εὐχόμενος θάνατόν τε φυγεῖν καὶ μῶλον Ἄρηος.
αὐτὰρ ὃ βοῦν ἱέρευσε ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων
πίονα πενταέτηρον ὑπερμενέϊ Κρονίωνι,
κίκλησκεν δὲ γέροντας ἀριστῆας Παναχαιῶν,
Νέστορα μὲν πρώτιστα καὶ Ἰδομενῆα ἄνακτα,
αὐτὰρ ἔπειτ’ Αἴαντε δύω καὶ Τυδέος υἱόν,
ἕκτον δ’ αὖτ’ Ὀδυσῆα Διὶ μῆτιν ἀτάλαντον.
αὐτόματος δέ οἱ ἦλθε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος·
ᾔδεε γὰρ κατὰ θυμὸν ἀδελφεὸν ὡς ἐπονεῖτο.
βοῦν δὲ περιστήσαντο καὶ οὐλοχύτας ἀνέλοντο·

411 τοῖσιν δ’ εὐχόμενος μετέφη κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων·
412 Ζεῦ κύδιστε μέγιστε κελαινεφὲς αἰθέρι ναίων
413 μὴ πρὶν ἐπ’ ἠέλιον δῦναι καὶ ἐπὶ κνέφας ἐλθεῖν
414 πρίν με κατὰ πρηνὲς βαλέειν Πριάμοιο μέλαθρον
415 αἰθαλόεν, πρῆσαι δὲ πυρὸς δηΐοιο θύρετρα,
416 Ἕκτόρεον δὲ χιτῶνα περὶ στήθεσσι δαΐξαι
417 χαλκῷ ῥωγαλέον· πολέες δ’ ἀμφ’ αὐτὸν ἑταῖροι
418 πρηνέες ἐν κονίῃσιν ὀδὰξ λαζοίατο γαῖαν.
419 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἄρα πώ οἱ ἐπεκραίαινε Κρονίων,
420 ἀλλ’ ὅ γε δέκτο μὲν ἱρά, πόνον δ’ ἀμέγαρτον ὄφελλεν.
offering sacrifice every man to one or other of the gods, and praying each one of them that he might live to come out of the fight. Agamemnon, king of men, sacrificed a fat five-year-old bull to the mighty son of Kronos, and invited the princes and elders of his host. First he asked Nestor and King Idomeneus, then the two Ajaxes and the son of Tydeus, and sixthly Odysseus, peer of gods in counsel; but Menelaos came of his own accord, for he knew how busy his brother then was. They stood round the bull with the barley-meal in their hands, and Agamemnon prayed, saying, "Zeus, most glorious, supreme, you who dwell in heaven, and ride upon the storm-cloud, grant that the sun may not go down, nor the night fall, till the palace of Priam is laid low, and its gates are consumed with fire. Grant that my sword may pierce the shirt of Hektor about his heart, and that full many of his comrades may bite the dust as they fall dying round him." Thus he prayed, but the son of Kronos would not fulfill his prayer. He accepted the sacrifice, yet none the less increased their toil [ponos] continually. When they had done praying and sprinkling the barley-meal upon the victim, they drew back its head, killed it, and then flayed it. They cut out the thigh-bones, wrapped them round in two layers of fat, and set pieces of raw meat on the top of them. These they burned upon the split logs of firewood, but they spitted the inward meats, and held them in the flames to cook. When the thigh-bones were burned, and they had tasted the inward meats, they cut the rest up small, put the pieces upon spits, roasted them till they were done, and drew them off; then, when they had finished their work [ponos] and the feast was ready, they ate it, and every man had his full share, so that all were satisfied. As soon as they had had enough to eat and drink, Nestor, horseman of Gerene, began to speak. "King Agamemnon," said he, "let us not stay talking here, nor be slack in the work that heaven has put into our hands. Let the heralds summon the people to gather at their several ships; we will then go about among the host,

2.421

421 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί ῥ’ εὔξαντο καὶ οὐλοχύτας προβάλοντο,
422 αὐέρυσαν μὲν πρῶτα καὶ ἔσφαξαν καὶ ἔδειραν,
423 μηρούς τ’ ἐξέταμον κατά τε κνίσῃ ἐκάλυψαν
424 δίπτυχα ποιήσαντες, ἐπ’ αὐτῶν δ’ ὠμοθέτησαν.
425 καὶ τὰ μὲν ἂρ σχίζῃσιν ἀφύλλοισιν κατέκαιον,
426 σπλάγχνα δ’ ἄρ’ ἀμπείραντες ὑπείρεχον Ἡφαίστοιο.
427 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ κατὰ μῆρε κάη καὶ σπλάγχνα πάσαντο,
428 μίστυλλόν τ’ ἄρα τἆλλα καὶ ἀμφ’ ὀβελοῖσιν ἔπειραν,
429 ὤπτησάν τε περιφραδέως, ἐρύσαντό τε πάντα.
430 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ παύσαντο πόνου τετύκοντό τε δαῖτα
431 δαίνυντ’, οὐδέ τι θυμὸς ἐδεύετο δαιτὸς ἐΐσης.
432 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ πόσιος καὶ ἐδητύος ἐξ ἔρον ἔντο,
433 τοῖς ἄρα μύθων ἦρχε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
434 Ἀτρεΐδη κύδιστε ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγάμεμνον,
435 μηκέτι νῦν δήθ’ αὖθι λεγώμεθα, μηδ’ ἔτι δηρὸν

436 ἀμβαλλώμεθα ἔργον ὃ δὴ θεὸς ἐγγυαλίζει.
437 ἀλλ’ ἄγε κήρυκες μὲν Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων
438 λαὸν κηρύσσοντες ἀγειρόντων κατὰ νῆας,
439 ἡμεῖς δ’ ἀθρόοι ὧδε κατὰ στρατὸν εὐρὺν Ἀχαιῶν
440 ἴομεν ὄφρα κε θᾶσσον ἐγείρομεν ὀξὺν Ἄρηα.
441 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων.
442 αὐτίκα κηρύκεσσι λιγυφθόγγοισι κέλευσε
443 κηρύσσειν πόλεμον δὲ κάρη κομόωντας Ἀχαιούς·
444 οἳ μὲν ἐκήρυσσον, τοὶ δ’ ἠγείροντο μάλ’ ὦκα.
445 οἳ δ’ ἀμφ’ Ἀτρεΐωνα διοτρεφέες βασιλῆες
446 θῦνον κρίνοντες, μετὰ δὲ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη
447 αἰγίδ’ ἔχουσ’ ἐρίτιμον ἀγήρων ἀθανάτην τε,
448 τῆς ἑκατὸν θύσανοι παγχρύσεοι ἠερέθονται,
449 πάντες ἐϋπλεκέες, ἑκατόμβοιος δὲ ἕκαστος·
450 σὺν τῇ παιφάσσουσα διέσσυτο λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν
that we may begin fighting at once." Thus did he speak, and Agamemnon heeded his words. He at once sent the criers round to call the people in assembly. So they called them, and the people gathered thereon. The chiefs about the son of Atreus chose their men and marshaled [krinô] them, while Athena went among them holding her priceless aegis that knows neither age nor death. From it there waved a hundred tassels of pure gold, all deftly woven, and each one of them worth a hundred oxen. With this she darted furiously everywhere among the hosts of the Achaeans, urging them forward, and putting courage into the heart of each, so that he might fight and do battle without ceasing. Thus war became sweeter in their eyes even than returning home in their ships. As when some great forest fire is raging upon a mountain top and its light is seen afar, even so as they marched the gleam of their armor flashed up into the firmament of heaven. They were like great flocks of geese, or cranes, or swans on the plain about the waters of Cayster, that wing their way hither and thither, glorying in the pride of flight, and crying as they settle till the fen is alive with their screaming. Even thus did their tribes pour from ships and tents on to the plain of the Skamandros, and the ground rang as brass under the feet of men and horses. They stood as thick upon the flower-bespangled field as leaves that bloom in season [hôra]. As countless swarms of flies buzz around a herdsman's homestead in the season [hôra] of spring when the pails are drenched with milk, even so did the Achaeans swarm on to the plain to charge the Trojans and destroy them. The chiefs disposed their men this way and that before the fight began, drafting them out as easily as goatherds draft their flocks when they have got mixed while feeding; and among them went King Agamemnon, with a head and face like Zeus the lord of thunder, a waist like Ares, and a chest like that of Poseidon.

2.451

451 ὀτρύνουσ’ ἰέναι· ἐν δὲ σθένος ὦρσεν ἑκάστῳ
452 καρδίῃ ἄλληκτον πολεμίζειν ἠδὲ μάχεσθαι.
453 τοῖσι δ’ ἄφαρ πόλεμος γλυκίων γένετ’ ἠὲ νέεσθαι
454 ἐν νηυσὶ γλαφυρῇσι φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν.
455 ἠΰτε πῦρ ἀΐδηλον ἐπιφλέγει ἄσπετον ὕλην
456 οὔρεος ἐν κορυφῇς, ἔκαθεν δέ τε φαίνεται αὐγή,
457 ὣς τῶν ἐρχομένων ἀπὸ χαλκοῦ θεσπεσίοιο
458 αἴγλη παμφανόωσα δι’ αἰθέρος οὐρανὸν ἷκε.
459 τῶν δ’ ὥς τ’ ὀρνίθων πετεηνῶν ἔθνεα πολλὰ
460 χηνῶν ἢ γεράνων ἢ κύκνων δουλιχοδείρων
461 Ἀσίῳ ἐν λειμῶνι Καϋστρίου ἀμφὶ ῥέεθρα

462 ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα ποτῶνται ἀγαλλόμενα πτερύγεσσι
463 κλαγγηδὸν προκαθιζόντων, σμαραγεῖ δέ τε λειμών,
464 ὣς τῶν ἔθνεα πολλὰ νεῶν ἄπο καὶ κλισιάων
465 ἐς πεδίον προχέοντο Σκαμάνδριον· αὐτὰρ ὑπὸ χθὼν
466 σμερδαλέον κονάβιζε ποδῶν αὐτῶν τε καὶ ἵππων.
467 ἔσταν δ’ ἐν λειμῶνι Σκαμανδρίῳ ἀνθεμόεντι
468 μυρίοι, ὅσσά τε φύλλα καὶ ἄνθεα γίγνεται ὥρῃ.
469 ἠΰτε μυιάων ἀδινάων ἔθνεα πολλὰ
470 αἵ τε κατὰ σταθμὸν ποιμνήϊον ἠλάσκουσιν
471 ὥρῃ ἐν εἰαρινῇ ὅτε τε γλάγος ἄγγεα δεύει,
472 τόσσοι ἐπὶ Τρώεσσι κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοὶ
473 ἐν πεδίῳ ἵσταντο διαρραῖσαι μεμαῶτες.
474 τοὺς δ’ ὥς τ’ αἰπόλια πλατέ’ αἰγῶν αἰπόλοι ἄνδρες
475 ῥεῖα διακρίνωσιν ἐπεί κε νομῷ μιγέωσιν,
476 ὣς τοὺς ἡγεμόνες διεκόσμεον ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα
477 ὑσμίνην δ’ ἰέναι, μετὰ δὲ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
478 ὄμματα καὶ κεφαλὴν ἴκελος Διὶ τερπικεραύνῳ,
479 Ἄρεϊ δὲ ζώνην, στέρνον δὲ Ποσειδάωνι.
480 ἠΰτε βοῦς ἀγέληφι μέγ’ ἔξοχος ἔπλετο πάντων
As some great bull that lords it over the herds upon the plain, even so did Zeus make the son of Atreus stand peerless among the multitude of heroes. And now, O Muses, dwellers in the mansions of Olympus, tell me - for you are goddesses and are in all places so that you see all things, while we know nothing but by report [kleos] - who were the chiefs and princes of the Danaans? As for the common warriors, they were so that I could not name every single one of them though I had ten tongues, and though my voice failed not and my heart were of bronze within me, unless you, O Olympian Muses, daughters of aegis-bearing Zeus, were to recount them to me. Nevertheless, I will tell the leaders of the ships and all the fleet together. Peneleos, Leitos, Arkesilaos, Prothoenor, and Klonios were leaders of the Boeotians. These were they that dwelt in Hyria and rocky Aulis, and who held Schoinos, Skolos, and the highlands of Eteonos, with Thespeia, Graia, and the fair city of Mykalessos. They also held Harma, Eilesium, and Erythrae; and they had Eleon, Hyle, and Peteon; Ocalea and the strong fortress of Medeon; Copae, Eutresis, and Thisbe the haunt of doves; Coronea, and the pastures of Haliartus; Plataea and Glisas; the fortress of Thebes the less; holy Onchestos with its famous grove of Poseidon; Arne rich in vineyards; Midea, sacred Nisa, and Anthedon upon the sea. From these there came fifty ships, and in each there were a hundred and twenty young men of the Boeotians. Askalaphos and Ialmenos, sons of Ares, led the people that dwelt in Aspledon and Orkhomenos the realm of Minyas. Astyoche a noble maiden bore them in the house of Aktor son of Azeus; for she had gone with Ares secretly into an upper chamber, and he had lain with her. With these there came thirty ships. The Phocaeans were led by Schedios and Epistrophos, sons of mighty Iphitos the son of Naubolos. These were they that held Cyparissus, rocky Pytho,

2.481

481 ταῦρος· ὃ γάρ τε βόεσσι μεταπρέπει ἀγρομένῃσι·
482 τοῖον ἄρ’ Ἀτρεΐδην θῆκε Ζεὺς ἤματι κείνῳ
483 ἐκπρεπέ’ ἐν πολλοῖσι καὶ ἔξοχον ἡρώεσσιν.
484 ἔσπετε νῦν μοι Μοῦσαι Ὀλύμπια δώματ’ ἔχουσαι·
485 ὑμεῖς γὰρ θεαί ἐστε πάρεστέ τε ἴστέ τε πάντα,
486 ἡμεῖς δὲ κλέος οἶον ἀκούομεν οὐδέ τι ἴδμεν·
487 οἵ τινες ἡγεμόνες Δαναῶν καὶ κοίρανοι ἦσαν·
488 πληθὺν δ’ οὐκ ἂν ἐγὼ μυθήσομαι οὐδ’ ὀνομήνω,

οὐδ’ εἴ μοι δέκα μὲν γλῶσσαι, δέκα δὲ στόματ’ εἶεν,
φωνὴ δ’ ἄρρηκτος, χάλκεον δέ μοι ἦτορ ἐνείη,
εἰ μὴ Ὀλυμπιάδες Μοῦσαι Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο
θυγατέρες μνησαίαθ’ ὅσοι ὑπὸ Ἴλιον ἦλθον·
ἀρχοὺς αὖ νηῶν ἐρέω νῆάς τε προπάσας.
Βοιωτῶν μὲν Πηνέλεως καὶ Λήϊτος ἦρχον
Ἀρκεσίλαός τε Προθοήνωρ τε Κλονίος τε,
οἵ θ’ Ὑρίην ἐνέμοντο καὶ Αὐλίδα πετρήεσσαν
Σχοῖνόν τε Σκῶλόν τε πολύκνημόν τ’ Ἐτεωνόν,
Θέσπειαν Γραῖάν τε καὶ εὐρύχορον Μυκαλησσόν,
οἵ τ’ ἀμφ’ Ἅρμ’ ἐνέμοντο καὶ Εἰλέσιον καὶ Ἐρυθράς,
οἵ τ’ Ἐλεῶν’ εἶχον ἠδ’ Ὕλην καὶ Πετεῶνα,
Ὠκαλέην Μεδεῶνά τ’ ἐϋκτίμενον πτολίεθρον,
Κώπας Εὔτρησίν τε πολυτρήρωνά τε Θίσβην,
οἵ τε Κορώνειαν καὶ ποιήενθ’ Ἁλίαρτον,
οἵ τε Πλάταιαν ἔχον ἠδ’ οἳ Γλισᾶντ’ ἐνέμοντο,
οἵ θ’ Ὑποθήβας εἶχον ἐϋκτίμενον πτολίεθρον,
Ὀγχηστόν θ’ ἱερὸν Ποσιδήϊον ἀγλαὸν ἄλσος,
οἵ τε πολυστάφυλον Ἄρνην ἔχον, οἵ τε Μίδειαν
Νῖσάν τε ζαθέην Ἀνθηδόνα τ’ ἐσχατόωσαν·
τῶν μὲν πεντήκοντα νέες κίον, ἐν δὲ ἑκάστῃ
κοῦροι Βοιωτῶν ἑκατὸν καὶ εἴκοσι βαῖνον.

2.511

οἳ δ’ Ἀσπληδόνα ναῖον ἰδ’ Ὀρχομενὸν Μινύειον,
τῶν ἦρχ’ Ἀσκάλαφος καὶ Ἰάλμενος υἷες Ἄρηος
οὓς τέκεν Ἀστυόχη δόμῳ Ἄκτορος Ἀζεΐδαο,
παρθένος αἰδοίη ὑπερώϊον εἰσαναβᾶσα
Ἄρηϊ κρατερῷ· ὃ δέ οἱ παρελέξατο λάθρῃ·
τοῖς δὲ τριήκοντα γλαφυραὶ νέες ἐστιχόωντο.
αὐτὰρ Φωκήων Σχεδίος καὶ Ἐπίστροφος ἦρχον
υἷες Ἰφίτου μεγαθύμου Ναυβολίδαο,
οἳ Κυπάρισσον ἔχον Πυθῶνά τε πετρήεσσαν
Κρῖσάν τε ζαθέην καὶ Δαυλίδα καὶ Πανοπῆα,
οἵ τ’ Ἀνεμώρειαν καὶ Ὑάμπολιν ἀμφενέμοντο,
οἵ τ’ ἄρα πὰρ ποταμὸν Κηφισὸν δῖον ἔναιον,
οἵ τε Λίλαιαν ἔχον πηγῇς ἔπι Κηφισοῖο·
τοῖς δ’ ἅμα τεσσαράκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἕποντο.
οἳ μὲν Φωκήων στίχας ἵστασαν ἀμφιέποντες,
Βοιωτῶν δ’ ἔμπλην ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ θωρήσσοντο.
Λοκρῶν δ’ ἡγεμόνευεν Ὀϊλῆος ταχὺς Αἴας
μείων, οὔ τι τόσος γε ὅσος Τελαμώνιος Αἴας
ἀλλὰ πολὺ μείων· ὀλίγος μὲν ἔην λινοθώρηξ,
ἐγχείῃ δ’ ἐκέκαστο Πανέλληνας καὶ Ἀχαιούς·
οἳ Κῦνόν τ’ ἐνέμοντ’ Ὀπόεντά τε Καλλίαρόν τε
Βῆσσάν τε Σκάρφην τε καὶ Αὐγειὰς ἐρατεινὰς
Τάρφην τε Θρόνιον τε Βοαγρίου ἀμφὶ ῥέεθρα·
τῷ δ’ ἅμα τεσσαράκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἕποντο
Λοκρῶν, οἳ ναίουσι πέρην ἱερῆς Εὐβοίης.
οἳ δ’ Εὔβοιαν ἔχον μένεα πνείοντες Ἄβαντες
Χαλκίδα τ’ Εἰρέτριάν τε πολυστάφυλόν θ’ Ἱστίαιαν

538 Κήρινθόν τ’ ἔφαλον Δίου τ’ αἰπὺ πτολίεθρον,
539 οἵ τε Κάρυστον ἔχον ἠδ’ οἳ Στύρα ναιετάασκον,
540 τῶν αὖθ’ ἡγεμόνευ’ Ἐλεφήνωρ ὄζος Ἄρηος
holy Crisa , Daulis, and Panopeus; they also that dwelt in Anemorea and Hyampolis, and about the waters of the river Kephissos, and Lilaea by the springs of the Kephissos; with their chieftains came forty ships, and they marshaled the forces of the Phocaeans, which were stationed next to the Boeotians, on their left. Ajax, the fleet son of Oileus, commanded the Locrians. He was not so great, nor nearly so great, as Ajax the son of Telamon. He was a little man, and his breastplate was made of linen, but in use of the spear he excelled all the Hellenes and the Achaeans. These dwelt in Cynus, Opous, Calliarus, Bessa, Scarphe, fair Augeae, Tarphe, and Thronium about the river Boagrios. With him there came forty ships of the Locrians who dwell beyond Euboea. The fierce Abantes held Euboea with its cities, Khalkis, Eretria, Histiaea rich in vines, Cerinthus upon the sea, and the rock-perched town of Dion; with them were also the men of Karystos and Styra; Elephenor of the race of Ares was in command of these; he was son of Khalkodon, and chief over all the Abantes. With him they came, fleet of foot and wearing their hair long behind, brave warriors, who would ever strive to tear open the corselets of their foes with their long ashen spears. Of these there came fifty ships. And they that held the strong city of Athens, the dêmos of great Erechtheus, who was born of the soil itself, but Zeus' daughter, Athena, fostered him, and established him at Athens in her own rich sanctuary. There, year by year, the Athenian youths worship him with sacrifices of bulls and rams. These were commanded by Menestheus, son of Peteos. No man living could equal him in the marshaling of chariots and foot soldiers. Nestor could alone rival him, for he was older. With him there came fifty ships. Ajax brought twelve ships from Salamis, and stationed them alongside those of the Athenians. The men of Argos, again, and those who held the walls of Tiryns ,

2.541

541 Χαλκωδοντιάδης μεγαθύμων ἀρχὸς Ἀβάντων.
542 τῷ δ’ ἅμ’ Ἄβαντες ἕποντο θοοὶ ὄπιθεν κομόωντες
543 αἰχμηταὶ μεμαῶτες ὀρεκτῇσιν μελίῃσι
544 θώρηκας ῥήξειν δηΐων ἀμφὶ στήθεσσι·
545 τῷ δ’ ἅμα τεσσαράκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἕποντο.
546 οἳ δ’ ἄρ’ Ἀθήνας εἶχον ἐϋκτίμενον πτολίεθρον
547 δῆμον Ἐρεχθῆος μεγαλήτορος, ὅν ποτ’ Ἀθήνη
548 θρέψε Διὸς θυγάτηρ, τέκε δὲ ζείδωρος ἄρουρα,
549 κὰδ δ’ ἐν Ἀθήνῃς εἷσεν ἑῷ ἐν πίονι νηῷ·
550 ἔνθα δέ μιν ταύροισι καὶ ἀρνειοῖς ἱλάονται
551 κοῦροι Ἀθηναίων περιτελλομένων ἐνιαυτῶν·
552 τῶν αὖθ’ ἡγεμόνευ’ υἱὸς Πετεῶο Μενεσθεύς.
553 τῷ δ’ οὔ πώ τις ὁμοῖος ἐπιχθόνιος γένετ’ ἀνὴρ
554 κοσμῆσαι ἵππους τε καὶ ἀνέρας ἀσπιδιώτας·
555 Νέστωρ οἷος ἔριζεν· ὃ γὰρ προγενέστερος ἦεν·
556 τῷ δ’ ἅμα πεντήκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἕποντο.
557 Αἴας δ’ ἐκ Σαλαμῖνος ἄγεν δυοκαίδεκα νῆας,
558 στῆσε δ’ ἄγων ἵν’ Ἀθηναίων ἵσταντο φάλαγγες.
559 οἳ δ’ Ἄργός τ’ εἶχον Τίρυνθά τε τειχιόεσσαν
560 Ἑρμιόνην Ἀσίνην τε, βαθὺν κατὰ κόλπον ἐχούσας,
561 Τροιζῆν’ Ἠιόνας τε καὶ ἀμπελόεντ’ Ἐπίδαυρον,
562 οἵ τ’ ἔχον Αἴγιναν Μάσητά τε κοῦροι Ἀχαιῶν,
563 τῶν αὖθ’ ἡγεμόνευε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης
564 καὶ Σθένελος, Καπανῆος ἀγακλειτοῦ φίλος υἱός·

565 τοῖσι δ’ ἅμ’ Εὐρύαλος τρίτατος κίεν ἰσόθεος φὼς
566 Μηκιστέος υἱὸς Ταλαϊονίδαο ἄνακτος·
567 συμπάντων δ’ ἡγεῖτο βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
568 τοῖσι δ’ ἅμ’ ὀγδώκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἕποντο.
569 οἳ δὲ Μυκήνας εἶχον ἐϋκτίμενον πτολίεθρον
570 ἀφνειόν τε Κόρινθον ἐϋκτιμένας τε Κλεωνάς,
with Hermione, and Asine upon the gulf; Trozen, Eionae, and the vineyard lands of Epidaurus; the Achaean youths, moreover, who came from Aegina and Mases; these were led by Diomedes of the loud battle-cry, and Sthenelos son of famed Kapaneus. With them in command was Euryalos, son of king Mekisteus, son of Talaos; but Diomedes was chief over them all. With these there came eighty ships. Those who held the strong city of Mycenae, rich Corinth and Cleonae; Orneae, Araethyrea, and Licyon, where Adrastos reigned of old; Hyperesia, high Gonoessa, and Pellene; Aegium and all the coast-land round about Helike; these sent a hundred ships under the command of King Agamemnon, son of Atreus. His force was far both finest and most numerous, and in their midst was the king himself, all glorious in his armor of gleaming bronze - foremost among the heroes, for he was the greatest king, and had most men under him. And those that dwelt in Lacedaemon, lying low among the hills, Pharis, Sparta, with Messe the haunt of doves; Bryseae, Augeae, Amyclae, and Helos upon the sea; Laas, moreover, and Oetylus; these were led by Menelaos of the loud battle-cry, brother to Agamemnon, and of them there were sixty ships, drawn up apart from the others. Among them went Menelaos himself, strong in zeal, urging his men to fight; for he longed to avenge the toil and sorrow that he had suffered for the sake of Helen. The men of Pylos and Arene, and Thryum where is the ford of the river Alpheus; strong Aipy, Cyparisseis, and Amphigenea; Pteleum, Helos, and Dorium, where the Muses met Thamyris, and stilled his minstrelsy for ever. He was returning from Oechalia, where Eurytos lived and reigned, and boasted that he would surpass even the Muses, daughters of aegis-bearing Zeus, if they should sing against him; whereon they were angry, and maimed him.

2.571

571 Ὀρνειάς τ’ ἐνέμοντο Ἀραιθυρέην τ’ ἐρατεινὴν
572 καὶ Σικυῶν’, ὅθ’ ἄρ’ Ἄδρηστος πρῶτ’ ἐμβασίλευεν,
573 οἵ θ’ Ὑπερησίην τε καὶ αἰπεινὴν Γονόεσσαν
574 Πελλήνην τ’ εἶχον ἠδ’ Αἴγιον ἀμφενέμοντο
575 Αἰγιαλόν τ’ ἀνὰ πάντα καὶ ἀμφ’ Ἑλίκην εὐρεῖαν,
576 τῶν ἑκατὸν νηῶν ἦρχε κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
577 Ἀτρεΐδης· ἅμα τῷ γε πολὺ πλεῖστοι καὶ ἄριστοι
578 λαοὶ ἕποντ’· ἐν δ’ αὐτὸς ἐδύσετο νώροπα χαλκὸν
579 κυδιόων, πᾶσιν δὲ μετέπρεπεν ἡρώεσσιν
580 οὕνεκ’ ἄριστος ἔην πολὺ δὲ πλείστους ἄγε λαούς.
581 οἳ δ’ εἶχον κοίλην Λακεδαίμονα κητώεσσαν,
582 Φᾶρίν τε Σπάρτην τε πολυτρήρωνά τε Μέσσην,
583 Βρυσειάς τ’ ἐνέμοντο καὶ Αὐγειὰς ἐρατεινάς,
584 οἵ τ’ ἄρ’ Ἀμύκλας εἶχον Ἕλος τ’ ἔφαλον πτολίεθρον,
585 οἵ τε Λάαν εἶχον ἠδ’ Οἴτυλον ἀμφενέμοντο,
586 τῶν οἱ ἀδελφεὸς ἦρχε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος
587 ἑξήκοντα νεῶν· ἀπάτερθε δὲ θωρήσσοντο·
588 ἐν δ’ αὐτὸς κίεν ᾗσι προθυμίῃσι πεποιθὼς
589 ὀτρύνων πόλεμον δέ· μάλιστα δὲ ἵετο θυμῷ
590 τίσασθαι Ἑλένης ὁρμήματά τε στοναχάς τε.
591 οἳ δὲ Πύλον τ’ ἐνέμοντο καὶ Ἀρήνην ἐρατεινὴν

592 καὶ Θρύον Ἀλφειοῖο πόρον καὶ ἐΰκτιτον Αἰπὺ
593 καὶ Κυπαρισσήεντα καὶ Ἀμφιγένειαν ἔναιον
594 καὶ Πτελεὸν καὶ Ἔλος καὶ Δώριον, ἔνθά τε Μοῦσαι
595 ἀντόμεναι Θάμυριν τὸν Θρήϊκα παῦσαν ἀοιδῆς
596 Οἰχαλίηθεν ἰόντα παρ’ Εὐρύτου Οἰχαλιῆος·
597 στεῦτο γὰρ εὐχόμενος νικησέμεν εἴ περ ἂν αὐταὶ
598 Μοῦσαι ἀείδοιεν κοῦραι Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο·
599 αἳ δὲ χολωσάμεναι πηρὸν θέσαν, αὐτὰρ ἀοιδὴν
600 θεσπεσίην ἀφέλοντο καὶ ἐκλέλαθον κιθαριστύν·
They robbed him of his divine power of song, and thenceforth he could strike the lyre no more. These were commanded by Nestor, horseman of Gerene, and with him there came ninety ships. And those that held Arcadia, under the high mountain of Cyllene, near the tomb of Aipytos, where the people fight hand to hand; the men of Pheneus also, and Orkhomenos rich in flocks; of Rhipae, Stratie, and bleak Enispe; of Tegea and fair Mantinea; of Stymphelus and Parrhasia; of these King Agapenor son of Ankaios was commander, and they had sixty ships. Many Arcadians, good warriors, came in each one of them, but Agamemnon found them the ships in which to cross the sea [pontos], for they were not a people that occupied their business upon the waters. The men, moreover, of Bouprasion and of Elis, so much of it as is enclosed between Hyrmine, Myrsinus upon the sea-shore, the rock Olene and Alesium. These had four leaders, and each of them had ten ships, with many Epeans on board. Their leaders were Amphimakhos and Thalpios - the one, son of Kteatos, and the other, of Eurytos - both of the race of Aktor. The two others were Diores, son of Amarynkes, and Polyxenos, son of King Agasthenes, son of Augeas. And those of Dulichium with the sacred Echinean islands, who dwelt beyond the sea off Elis; these were led by Meges, peer of Ares, and the son of valiant Phyleus, dear to Zeus, who quarreled with his father, and went to settle in Dulichium. With him there came forty ships. Odysseus led the brave Cephallenians, who held Ithaca, Neritum with its forests, Crocylea, rugged Aegilips, Samos and Zacynthus, with the mainland also that was over against the islands. These were led by Odysseus, peer of Zeus in counsel, and with him there came twelve ships. Thoas, son of Andraimon, commanded the Aetolians, who dwelt in Pleuron, Olenus, Pylene,

2.601

601 τῶν αὖθ’ ἡγεμόνευε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
602 τῷ δ’ ἐνενήκοντα γλαφυραὶ νέες ἐστιχόωντο.
603 οἳ δ’ ἔχον Ἀρκαδίην ὑπὸ Κυλλήνης ὄρος αἰπὺ
604 Αἰπύτιον παρὰ τύμβον ἴν’ ἀνέρες ἀγχιμαχηταί,
605 οἳ Φενεόν τ’ ἐνέμοντο καὶ Ὀρχομενὸν πολύμηλον
606 Ῥίπην τε Στρατίην τε καὶ ἠνεμόεσσαν Ἐνίσπην
607 καὶ Τεγέην εἶχον καὶ Μαντινέην ἐρατεινὴν
608 Στύμφηλόν τ’ εἶχον καὶ Παρρασίην ἐνέμοντο,
609 τῶν ἦρχ’ Ἀγκαίοιο πάϊς κρείων Ἀγαπήνωρ
610 ἑξήκοντα νεῶν· πολέες δ’ ἐν νηῒ ἑκάστῃ
611 Ἀρκάδες ἄνδρες ἔβαινον ἐπιστάμενοι πολεμίζειν.
612 αὐτὸς γάρ σφιν δῶκεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων
613 νῆας ἐϋσσέλμους περάαν ἐπὶ οἴνοπα πόντον
614 Ἀτρεΐδης, ἐπεὶ οὔ σφι θαλάσσια ἔργα μεμήλει.
615 οἳ δ’ ἄρα Βουπράσιόν τε καὶ Ἤλιδα δῖαν ἔναιον
616 ὅσσον ἐφ’ Ὑρμίνη καὶ Μύρσινος ἐσχατόωσα
617 πέτρη τ’ Ὠλενίη καὶ Ἀλήσιον ἐντὸς ἐέργει,
618 τῶν αὖ τέσσαρες ἀρχοὶ ἔσαν, δέκα δ’ ἀνδρὶ ἑκάστῳ

619 νῆες ἔποντο θοαί, πολέες δ’ ἔμβαινον Ἐπειοί.
620 τῶν μὲν ἄρ’ Ἀμφίμαχος καὶ Θάλπιος ἡγησάσθην
621 υἷες ὃ μὲν Κτεάτου, ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ Εὐρύτου, Ἀκτορίωνε·
622 τῶν δ’ Ἀμαρυγκεΐδης ἦρχε κρατερὸς Διώρης·
623 τῶν δὲ τετάρτων ἦρχε Πολύξεινος θεοειδὴς
624 υἱὸς Ἀγασθένεος Αὐγηϊάδαο ἄνακτος.
625 οἳ δ’ ἐκ Δουλιχίοιο Ἐχινάων θ’ ἱεράων
626 νήσων, αἳ ναίουσι πέρην ἁλὸς Ἤλιδος ἄντα,
627 τῶν αὖθ’ ἡγεμόνευε Μέγης ἀτάλαντος Ἀρηϊ
628 Φυλεΐδης, ὃν τίκτε Διῒ φίλος ἱππότα Φυλεύς,
629 ὅς ποτε Δουλίχιον δ’ ἀπενάσσατο πατρὶ χολωθείς·
630 τῷ δ’ ἅμα τεσσαράκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἔποντο.

2.631

631 αὐτὰρ Ὀδυσσεὺς ἦγε Κεφαλλῆνας μεγαθύμους,
632 οἵ ῥ’ Ἰθάκην εἶχον καὶ Νήριτον εἰνοσίφυλλον
633 καὶ Κροκύλει’ ἐνέμοντο καὶ Αἰγίλιπα τρηχεῖαν,
634 οἵ τε Ζάκυνθον ἔχον ἠδ’ οἳ Σάμον ἀμφενέμοντο,
635 οἵ τ’ ἤπειρον ἔχον ἠδ’ ἀντιπέραι’ ἐνέμοντο·
636 τῶν μὲν Ὀδυσσεὺς ἦρχε Διὶ μῆτιν ἀτάλαντος·
637 τῷ δ’ ἅμα νῆες ἔποντο δυώδεκα μιλτοπάρῃοι.
638 Αἰτωλῶν δ’ ἡγεῖτο Θόας Ἀνδραίμονος υἱός,
639 οἳ Πλευρῶν’ ἐνέμοντο καὶ Ὤλενον ἠδὲ Πυλήνην
640 Χαλκίδα τ’ ἀγχίαλον Καλυδῶνά τε πετρήεσσαν·
641 οὐ γὰρ ἔτ’ Οἰνῆος μεγαλήτορος υἱέες ἦσαν,
642 οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔτ’ αὐτὸς ἔην, θάνε δὲ ξανθὸς Μελέαγρος·
643 τῷ δ’ ἐπὶ πάντ’ ἐτέταλτο ἀνασσέμεν Αἰτωλοῖσι·
644 τῷ δ’ ἅμα τεσσαράκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἔποντο.
645 Κρητῶν δ’ Ἰδομενεὺς δουρὶ κλυτὸς ἡγεμόνευεν,
646 οἳ Κνωσόν τ’ εἶχον Γόρτυνά τε τειχιόεσσαν,
647 Λύκτον Μίλητόν τε καὶ ἀργινόεντα Λύκαστον
648 Φαιστόν τε Ῥύτιόν τε, πόλεις εὖ ναιετοώσας,
649 ἄλλοι θ’ οἳ Κρήτην ἑκατόμπολιν ἀμφενέμοντο.
650 τῶν μὲν ἄρ’ Ἰδομενεὺς δουρὶ κλυτὸς ἡγεμόνευε
651 Μηριόνης τ’ ἀτάλαντος Ἐνυαλίῳ ἀνδρειφόντῃ·
652 τοῖσι δ’ ἅμ’ ὀγδώκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἔποντο.
653 Τληπόλεμος δ’ Ἡρακλεΐδης ἠΰς τε μέγας τε
654 ἐκ Ῥόδου ἐννέα νῆας ἄγεν Ῥοδίων ἀγερώχων,
655 οἳ Ῥόδον ἀμφενέμοντο διὰ τρίχα κοσμηθέντες
656 Λίνδον Ἰηλυσόν τε καὶ ἀργινόεντα Κάμειρον.
657 τῶν μὲν Τληπόλεμος δουρὶ κλυτὸς ἡγεμόνευεν,
658 ὃν τέκεν Ἀστυόχεια βίῃ Ἡρακληείῃ,
659 τὴν ἄγετ’ ἐξ Ἐφύρης ποταμοῦ ἄπο Σελλήεντος
660 πέρσας ἄστεα πολλὰ διοτρεφέων αἰζηῶν.

Khalkis by the sea, and rocky Calydon, for the great king Oeneus had now no sons living, and was himself dead, as was also golden-haired Meleager, who had been set over the Aetolians to be their king. And with Thoas there came forty ships. The famous spearsman Idomeneus led the Cretans, who held Knossos, and the well-walled city of Gortys; Lyktos also, Miletus and Lykastos that lies upon the chalk; the populous towns of Phaistos and Rhytium, with the other peoples that dwelt in the hundred cities of Crete. All these were led by Idomeneus, and by Meriones, peer of murderous Ares. And with these there came eighty

ships. Tlepolemos, son of Herakles, a man both brave and large of stature, brought nine ships of lordly warriors from Rhodes . These dwelt in Rhodes which is divided among the three cities of Lindos, Ialysos, and Kameiros, that lies upon the chalk. These were commanded by Tlepolemos, son of mighty Herakles and born of Astyochea, whom he had carried off from Ephyra, on the river Selleis, after sacking many cities of valiant warriors. When Tlepolemos grew up, he killed his father's uncle Likymnios, who had been a famous warrior in his time, but was then grown old. On this he built himself a fleet, gathered a great following, and fled beyond the sea [pontos], for he was menaced by the other sons and grandsons of Herakles. After a voyage. during which he suffered great hardship, he came to Rhodes, where the people divided into three communities, according to their tribes, and were dearly loved by Zeus, the lord, of gods and men; wherefore the son of Kronos showered down great riches upon them. And Nireus brought three ships from Syme - Nireus, who was the handsomest man that came up under Ilion of all the Danaans after the son of Peleus - but he was a man of no substance, and had but a small following. And those that held Nisyrus, Carpathus, and Casus, with Cos, the city of Eurypylos, and the Calydnian islands, these were commanded by Pheidippos and Antiphos, two sons of King Thessalos the son of Herakles.

2.661

661 Τληπόλεμος δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν τράφ’ ἐνὶ μεγάρῳ εὐπήκτῳ,
662 αὐτίκα πατρὸς ἑοῖο φίλον μήτρωα κατέκτα
663 ἤδη γηράσκοντα Λικύμνιον ὄζον Ἄρηος·
664 αἶψα δὲ νῆας ἔπηξε, πολὺν δ’ ὅ γε λαὸν ἀγείρας
665 βῆ φεύγων ἐπὶ πόντον· ἀπείλησαν γάρ οἱ ἄλλοι
666 υἱέες υἱωνοί τε βίης Ἡρακληείης.
667 αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἐς Ῥόδον ἶξεν ἀλώμενος ἄλγεα πάσχων·
668 τριχθὰ δὲ ᾤκηθεν καταφυλαδόν, ἠδὲ φίληθεν
669 ἐκ Διός, ὅς τε θεοῖσι καὶ ἀνθρώποισιν ἀνάσσει,
670 καί σφιν θεσπέσιον πλοῦτον κατέχευε Κρονίων.
671 Νιρεὺς αὖ Σύμηθεν ἄγε τρεῖς νῆας ἐΐσας
672 Νιρεὺς Ἀγλαΐης υἱὸς Χαρόποιό τ’ ἄνακτος
673 Νιρεύς, ὃς κάλλιστος ἀνὴρ ὑπὸ Ἴλιον ἦλθε
674 τῶν ἄλλων Δαναῶν μετ’ ἀμύμονα Πηλεΐωνα·
675 ἀλλ’ ἀλαπαδνὸς ἔην, παῦρος δέ οἱ εἵπετο λαός.
676 οἳ δ’ ἄρα Νίσυρόν τ’ εἶχον Κράπαθόν τε Κάσον τε
677 καὶ Κῶν Εὐρυπύλοιο πόλιν νήσους τε Καλύδνας,
678 τῶν αὖ Φείδιππός τε καὶ Ἄντιφος ἡγησάσθην
679 Θεσσαλοῦ υἷε δύω Ἡρακλεΐδαο ἄνακτος·
680 τοῖς δὲ τριήκοντα γλαφυραὶ νέες ἐστιχόωντο.
681 νῦν αὖ τοὺς ὅσσοι τὸ Πελασγικὸν Ἄργος ἔναιον,
682 οἵ τ’ Ἄλον οἵ τ’ Ἀλόπην οἵ τε Τρηχῖνα νέμοντο,
683 οἵ τ’ εἶχον Φθίην ἠδ’ Ἑλλάδα καλλιγύναικα,
684 Μυρμιδόνες δὲ καλεῦντο καὶ Ἕλληνες καὶ Ἀχαιοί,
685 τῶν αὖ πεντήκοντα νεῶν ἦν ἀρχὸς Ἀχιλλεύς.
686 ἀλλ’ οἵ γ’ οὐ πολέμοιο δυσηχέος ἐμνώοντο·
687 οὐ γὰρ ἔην ὅς τίς σφιν ἐπὶ στίχας ἡγήσαιτο·
688 κεῖτο γὰρ ἐν νήεσσι ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
689 κούρης χωόμενος Βρισηΐδος ἠϋκόμοιο,
690 τὴν ἐκ Λυρνησσοῦ ἐξείλετο πολλὰ μογήσας

And with them there came thirty ships. Those again who held Pelasgian Argos, Alos, Alope, and Trachis; and those of Phthia and Hellas the land of fair women, who were called

Myrmidons, Hellenes, and Achaeans; these had fifty ships, over which Achilles was in command. But they now took no part in the war, inasmuch as there was no one to marshal them; for Achilles stayed by his ships, furious about the loss of the girl Briseis, whom he had taken from Lyrnessos at his own great peril, when he had sacked Lyrnessos and Thebe, and had overthrown Mynes and Epistrophos, sons of king Euenor, son of Selepus. For her sake Achilles was still in grief [akhos], but ere long he was again to join them. And those that held Phylake and the flowery meadows of Pyrasus, sanctuary of Demeter ; Iton, the mother of sheep; Antrum upon the sea, and Pteleum that lies upon the grass lands. Of these brave Protesilaos had been leader while he was yet alive, but he was now lying under the earth. He had left a wife behind him in Phylake to tear her cheeks in sorrow, and his house was only half finished, for he was slain by a Dardanian warrior while leaping foremost of the Achaeans upon the soil of Troy. Still, though his people mourned their chieftain, they were not without a leader, for Podarkes, of the race of Ares, marshaled them; he was son of Iphiklos, rich in sheep, who was the son of Phylakos, and he was own brother to Protesilaos, only younger, Protesilaos being at once the elder and the more valiant. So the people were not without a leader, though they mourned him whom they had lost. With him there came forty ships. And those that held Pherai by the Boebean lake, with Boebe, Glaphyrae, and the populous city of Iolkos, these with their eleven ships were led by Eumelos, son of Admetos, whom Alcestis bore to him, loveliest of the daughters of Pelias. And those that held Methone and Thaumacia, with Meliboia and rugged Olizon, these were led by the skillful archer Philoctetes, and they had seven ships, each with fifty oarsmen

2.691

691 Λυρνησσὸν διαπορθήσας καὶ τείχεα Θήβης,
692 κὰδ δὲ Μύνητ’ ἔβαλεν καὶ Ἐπίστροφον ἐγχεσιμώρους,
693 υἱέας Εὐηνοῖο Σεληπιάδαο ἄνακτος·
694 τῆς ὅ γε κεῖτ’ ἀχέων, τάχα δ’ ἀνστήσεσθαι ἔμελλεν.
695 οἳ δ’ εἶχον Φυλάκην καὶ Πύρασον ἀνθεμόεντα
696 Δήμητρος τέμενος, Ἴτωνά τε μητέρα μήλων,
697 ἀγχίαλόν τ’ Ἀντρῶνα ἰδὲ Πτελεὸν λεχεποίην,
698 τῶν αὖ Πρωτεσίλαος ἀρήϊος ἡγεμόνευε
699 ζωὸς ἐών· τότε δ’ ἤδη ἔχεν κάτα γαῖα μέλαινα.
700 τοῦ δὲ καὶ ἀμφιδρυφὴς ἄλοχος Φυλάκῃ ἐλέλειπτο
701 καὶ δόμος ἡμιτελής· τὸν δ’ ἔκτανε Δάρδανος ἀνὴρ
702 νηὸς ἀποθρῴσκοντα πολὺ πρώτιστον Ἀχαιῶν.
703 οὐδὲ μὲν οὐδ’ οἳ ἄναρχοι ἔσαν, πόθεόν γε μὲν ἀρχόν·
704 ἀλλά σφεας κόσμησε Ποδάρκης ὄζος Ἄρηος
705 Ἰφίκλου υἱὸς πολυμήλου Φυλακίδαο
706 αὐτοκασίγνητος μεγαθύμου Πρωτεσιλάου
707 ὁπλότερος γενεῇ· ὁ δ’ ἅμα πρότερος καὶ ἀρείων
708 ἥρως Πρωτεσίλαος ἀρήϊος· οὐδέ τι λαοὶ
709 δεύονθ’ ἡγεμόνος, πόθεόν γε μὲν ἐσθλὸν ἐόντα·
710 τῷ δ’ ἅμα τεσσαράκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἕποντο.
711 οἳ δὲ Φερὰς ἐνέμοντο παραὶ Βοιβηΐδα λίμνην
712 Βοίβην καὶ Γλαφύρας καὶ ἐϋκτιμένην Ἰαωλκόν,
713 τῶν ἦρχ’ Ἀδμήτοιο φίλος πάϊς ἕνδεκα νηῶν
714 Εὔμηλος, τὸν ὑπ’ Ἀδμήτῳ τέκε δῖα γυναικῶν
715 Ἄλκηστις Πελίαο θυγατρῶν εἶδος ἀρίστη.
716 οἳ δ’ ἄρα Μηθώνην καὶ Θαυμακίην ἐνέμοντο
717 καὶ Μελίβοιαν ἔχον καὶ Ὀλιζῶνα τρηχεῖαν,
718 τῶν δὲ Φιλοκτήτης ἦρχεν τόξων ἐὺ εἰδὼς

719 ἑπτὰ νεῶν· ἐρέται δ’ ἐν ἑκάστῃ πεντήκοντα
720 ἐμβέβασαν τόξων εὖ εἰδότες ἶφι μάχεσθαι.
all of them good archers; but Philoctetes was lying in great pain in the Island of Lemnos, where the sons of the Achaeans left him, for he had been bitten by a poisonous water snake. There he lay sick and in grief [akhos], and full soon did the Argives come to miss him. But his people, though they felt his loss were not leaderless, for Medon, the bastard son of Oileus by Rhene, set them in array. Those, again, of Tricca and the stony region of Ithome, and they that held Oechalia, the city of Oechalian Eurytos, these were commanded by the two sons of Asklepios, skilled in the art of healing, Podaleirios and Machaon. And with them there came thirty ships. The men, moreover, of Ormenios, and by the fountain of Hypereia, with those that held Asterios, and the white crests of Titanus, these were led by Eurypylos, the son of Euaemon, and with them there came forty ships. Those that held Argissa and Gyrtone, Orthe, Elone, and the white city of Oloosson, of these brave Polypoites was leader. He was son of Peirithoos, who was son of Zeus himself, for Hippodameia bore him to Peirithoos on the day when he took his revenge on the shaggy mountain savages and drove them from Mount Pelion to the Aithikes. But Polypoites was not sole in command, for with him was Leonteus, of the race of Ares, who was son of Koronos, the son of Kaineus. And with these there came forty ships. Guneus brought two and twenty ships from Cyphus, and he was followed by the Enienes and the valiant Peraebi, who dwelt about wintry Dodona, and held the lands round the lovely river Titaresios, which sends its waters into the Peneus. They do not mingle with the silver eddies of the Peneus, but flow on the top of them like oil; for the Titaresios is a branch of dread Orcus and of the river Styx. Of the Magnetes, Prothoos son of Tenthredon was commander. They were they that dwelt about the river Peneus and Mount Pelion. Prothoos, fleet of foot, was their leader, and with him there came forty ships.

2.721

721 ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν ἐν νήσῳ κεῖτο κρατέρ’ ἄλγεα πάσχων
722 Λήμνῳ ἐν ἠγαθέῃ, ὅθι μιν λίπον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
723 ἕλκεϊ μοχθίζοντα κακῷ ὀλοόφρονος ὕδρου·
724 ἔνθ’ ὅ γε κεῖτ’ ἀχέων· τάχα δὲ μνήσεσθαι ἔμελλον
725 Ἀργεῖοι παρὰ νηυσὶ Φιλοκτήταο ἄνακτος.
726 οὐδὲ μὲν οὐδ’ οἳ ἄναρχοι ἔσαν, πόθεόν γε μὲν ἀρχόν·
727 ἀλλὰ Μέδων κόσμησεν Ὀϊλῆος νόθος υἱός,
728 τόν ῥ’ ἔτεκεν Ῥήνη ὑπ’ Ὀϊλῆϊ πτολιπόρθῳ.
729 οἳ δ’ εἶχον Τρίκκην καὶ Ἰθώμην κλωμακόεσσαν,
730 οἵ τ’ ἔχον Οἰχαλίην πόλιν Εὐρύτου Οἰχαλιῆος,
731 τῶν αὖθ’ ἡγείσθην Ἀσκληπιοῦ δύο παῖδε
732 ἰητῆρ’ ἀγαθὼ Ποδαλείριος ἠδὲ Μαχάων·
733 τοῖς δὲ τριήκοντα γλαφυραὶ νέες ἑστιχόωντο.
734 οἳ δ’ ἔχον Ὀρμένιον, οἵ τε κρήνην Ὑπέρειαν,
735 οἵ τ’ ἔχον Ἀστέριον Τιτάνοιό τε λευκὰ κάρηνα,
736 τῶν ἦρχ’ Εὐρύπυλος Εὐαίμονος ἀγλαὸς υἱός·
737 τῷ δ’ ἅμα τεσσαράκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἕποντο.
738 οἳ δ’ Ἄργισσαν ἔχον καὶ Γυρτώνην ἐνέμοντο,
739 Ὄρθην Ἠλώνην τε πόλιν τ’ Ὀλοοσσόνα λευκήν,
740 τῶν αὖθ’ ἡγεμόνευε μενεπτόλεμος Πολυποίτης
741 υἱὸς Πειριθόοιο τὸν ἀθάνατος τέκετο Ζεύς·
742 τόν ῥ’ ὑπὸ Πειριθόῳ τέκετο κλυτὸς Ἱπποδάμεια
743 ἤματι τῷ ὅτε Φῆρας ἐτίσατο λαχνήεντας,
744 τοὺς δ’ ἐκ Πηλίου ὦσε καὶ Αἰθίκεσσι πέλασσεν·

745 οὐκ οἷος, ἅμα τῷ γε Λεοντεὺς ὄζος Ἄρηος
746 υἱὸς ὑπερθύμοιο Κορώνου Καινεΐδαο·
747 τοῖς δ’ ἅμα τεσσαράκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἕποντο.
748 Γουνεὺς δ’ ἐκ Κύφου ἦγε δύω καὶ εἴκοσι νῆας·
749 τῷ δ’ Ἐνιῆνες ἕποντο μενεπτόλεμοί τε Περαιβοὶ
750 οἳ περὶ Δωδώνην δυσχείμερον οἰκί’ ἔθεντο,

2.751

751 οἵ τ’ ἀμφ’ ἰμερτὸν Τιταρησσὸν ἔργα νέμοντο
752 ὅς ῥ’ ἐς Πηνειὸν προΐει καλλίρροον ὕδωρ,
753 οὐδ’ ὅ γε Πηνειῷ συμμίσγεται ἀργυροδίνῃ,
754 ἀλλά τέ μιν καθύπερθεν ἐπιρρέει ἠΰτ’ ἔλαιον·
755 ὅρκου γὰρ δεινοῦ Στυγὸς ὕδατός ἐστιν ἀπορρώξ.
756 Μαγνήτων δ’ ἦρχε Πρόθοος Τενθρηδόνος υἱός,
757 οἳ περὶ Πηνειὸν καὶ Πήλιον εἰνοσίφυλλον
758 ναίεσκον· τῶν μὲν Πρόθοος θοὸς ἡγεμόνευε,
759 τῷ δ’ ἅμα τεσσαράκοντα μέλαιναι νῆες ἕποντο.
760 οὗτοι ἄρ’ ἡγεμόνες Δαναῶν καὶ κοίρανοι ἦσαν·
761 τίς τὰρ τῶν ὄχ’ ἄριστος ἔην σύ μοι ἔννεπε Μοῦσα
762 αὐτῶν ἠδ’ ἵππων, οἳ ἅμ’ Ἀτρεΐδῃσιν ἕποντο.
763 ἵπποι μὲν μέγ’ ἄρισται ἔσαν Φηρητιάδαο,
764 τὰς Εὔμηλος ἔλαυνε ποδώκεας ὄρνιθας ὡς
765 ὄτριχας οἰέτεας σταφύλῃ ἐπὶ νῶτον ἐΐσας·
766 τὰς ἐν Πηρείῃ θρέψ’ ἀργυρότοξος Ἀπόλλων
767 ἄμφω θηλείας, φόβον Ἄρηος φορεούσας.
768 ἀνδρῶν αὖ μέγ’ ἄριστος ἔην Τελαμώνιος Αἴας
769 ὄφρ’ Ἀχιλεὺς μήνιεν· ὃ γὰρ πολὺ φέρτατος ἦεν,
770 ἵπποι θ’ οἳ φορέεσκον ἀμύμονα Πηλεΐωνα.
771 ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν ἐν νήεσσι κορωνίσι ποντοπόροισι
772 κεῖτ’ ἀπομηνίσας Ἀγαμέμνονι ποιμένι λαῶν
773 Ἀτρεΐδῃ· λαοὶ δὲ παρὰ ῥηγμῖνι θαλάσσης
774 δίσκοισιν τέρποντο καὶ αἰγανέῃσιν ἱέντες
775 τόξοισίν θ’· ἵπποι δὲ παρ’ ἅρμασιν οἷσιν ἕκαστος
776 λωτὸν ἐρεπτόμενοι ἐλεόθρεπτόν τε σέλινον
777 ἕστασαν· ἅρματα δ’ εὖ πεπυκασμένα κεῖτο ἀνάκτων
778 ἐν κλισίῃς· οἳ δ’ ἀρχὸν ἀρηΐφιλον ποθέοντες
779 φοίτων ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα κατὰ στρατὸν οὐδὲ μάχοντο.
780 οἳ δ’ ἄρ’ ἴσαν ὡς εἴ τε πυρὶ χθὼν πᾶσα νέμοιτο·

Such were the chiefs and princes of the Danaans. Who, then, O Muse, was the foremost, whether man or horse, among those that followed after the sons of Atreus? Of the horses, those of the son of Pheres were by far the finest. They were driven by Eumelos, and were as fleet as birds. They were of the same age and color, and perfectly matched in height. Apollo, of the silver bow, had bred them in Perea - both of them mares, and terrible as Ares in battle. Of the men, Ajax, son of Telamon, was much the foremost so long as Achilles' anger lasted, for Achilles excelled him greatly and he had also better horses; but Achilles was now holding aloof at his ships by reason of his quarrel with Agamemnon, and his people passed their time upon the sea shore, throwing discs or aiming with spears at a mark, and in archery. Their horses stood each by his own chariot, champing lotus and wild celery. The chariots were housed under cover, but their owners, for lack of leadership, wandered hither and thither about the host and went not forth to fight. Thus marched the host like a consuming fire, and the earth groaned beneath them when the lord of thunder is

angry and lashes the land about Typhoeus among the Arimi, where they say Typhoeus lies. Even so did the earth groan beneath them as they sped over the plain. And now Iris, fleet as the wind, was sent by Zeus to tell the bad news among the Trojans. They were gathered in assembly, old and young, at Priam's gates, and Iris came close up to Priam, speaking with the voice of Priam's son Polites, who, being fleet of foot, was stationed as watchman for the Trojans on the tomb of old Aisyetes, to look out for any sally of the Achaeans. In his likeness Iris spoke, saying, "Old man, you talk idly, as in time of peace, while war is at hand. I have been in many a battle, but never yet saw such a host as is now advancing. They are crossing the plain to attack the city as

2.781

781 γαῖα δ’ ὑπεστενάχιζε Διὶ ὣς τερπικεραύνῳ
782 χωομένῳ ὅτε τ’ ἀμφὶ Τυφωέϊ γαῖαν ἰμάσσῃ
783 εἰν Ἀρίμοις, ὅθι φασὶ Τυφωέος ἔμμεναι εὐνάς·
784 ὣς ἄρα τῶν ὑπὸ ποσσὶ μέγα στεναχίζετο γαῖα
785 ἐρχομένων· μάλα δ’ ὦκα διέπρησσον πεδίοιο.
786 Τρωσὶν δ’ ἄγγελος ἦλθε ποδήνεμος ὠκέα Ἶρις
787 πὰρ Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο σὺν ἀγγελίῃ ἀλεγεινῇ·
788 οἳ δ’ ἀγορὰς ἀγόρευον ἐπὶ Πριάμοιο θύρῃσι
789 πάντες ὁμηγερέες ἠμὲν νέοι ἠδὲ γέροντες·
790 ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱσταμένη προσέφη πόδας ὠκέα Ἶρις·
791 εἴσατο δὲ φθογγὴν υἷϊ Πριάμοιο Πολίτῃ,
792 ὃς Τρώων σκοπὸς ἷζε ποδωκείῃσι πεποιθὼς
793 τύμβῳ ἐπ’ ἀκροτάτῳ Αἰσυήταο γέροντος,
794 δέγμενος ὁππότε ναῦφιν ἀφορμηθεῖεν Ἀχαιοί·
795 τῷ μιν ἐεισαμένη προσέφη πόδας ὠκέα Ἶρις·
796 ὦ γέρον αἰεί τοι μῦθοι φίλοι ἄκριτοί εἰσιν,
797 ὥς ποτ’ ἐπ’ εἰρήνης· πόλεμος δ’ ἀλίαστος ὄρωρεν.
798 ἤδη μὲν μάλα πολλὰ μάχας εἰσήλυθον ἀνδρῶν,
799 ἀλλ’ οὔ πω τοιόνδε τοσόνδέ τε λαὸν ὄπωπα·
800 λίην γὰρ φύλλοισιν ἐοικότες ἢ ψαμάθοισιν
801 ἔρχονται πεδίοιο μαχησόμενοι προτὶ ἄστυ.
802 Ἕκτορ σοὶ δὲ μάλιστ’ ἐπιτέλλομαι, ὧδε δὲ ῥέξαι·
803 πολλοὶ γὰρ κατὰ ἄστυ μέγα Πριάμου ἐπίκουροι,
804 ἄλλη δ’ ἄλλων γλῶσσα πολυσπερέων ἀνθρώπων·
805 τοῖσιν ἕκαστος ἀνὴρ σημαινέτω οἵσί περ ἄρχει,
806 τῶν δ’ ἐξηγείσθω κοσμησάμενος πολιήτας.
807 ὣς ἔφαθ’, Ἕκτωρ δ’ οὔ τι θεᾶς ἔπος ἠγνοίησεν,
808 αἶψα δ’ ἔλυσ’ ἀγορήν· ἐπὶ τεύχεα δ’ ἐσσεύοντο·
809 πᾶσαι δ’ ὠΐγνυντο πύλαι, ἐκ δ’ ἔσσυτο λαὸς
810 πεζοί θ’ ἱππῆές τε· πολὺς δ’ ὀρυμαγδὸς ὀρώρει.

thick as leaves or as the sands of the sea. Hektor, I charge you above all others, do as I say. There are many allies dispersed about the city of Priam from distant places and speaking divers tongues. Therefore, let each chief give orders to his own people, setting them severally in array and leading them forth to battle." Thus she spoke, but Hektor knew that it was the goddess, and at once broke up the assembly. The men flew to arms; all the gates were opened, and the people thronged through them, horse and foot, with the tramp as of a great multitude. Now there is a high mound before the city, rising by itself upon the plain. Men call it Batieia, but the gods know that it is the tomb [sêma] of lithe Myrrhine. Here the Trojans and their allies divided their forces. Priam's son, great Hektor of the gleaming helmet, commanded the Trojans, and with him were arrayed by far the greater number and

most valiant of those who were longing for the fray. The Dardanians were led by brave Aeneas, whom Aphrodite bore to Anchises, when she, goddess though she was, had lain with him upon the mountain slopes of Ida. He was not alone, for with him were the two sons of Antenor, Archilokhos and Akamas, both skilled in all the arts of war. They that dwelt in Telea under the lowest spurs of Mount Ida, men of substance, who drink the limpid waters of the Aesepos, and are of Trojan blood - these were led by Pandaros son of Lykaon, whom Apollo had taught to use the bow. They that held Adrasteia and the district [dêmos] of Apaesus, with Pityeia, and the high mountain of Tereia - these were led by Adrastos and Amphios, whose breastplate was of linen. These were the sons of Merops of Perkote, who excelled in all kinds of divination. He told them not to take part in the war, but they gave him no heed, for fate lured them to destruction. They that dwelt about Perkote and Praktios, with Sestos, Abydos, and Arisbe - these were led by Asios, son of Hyrtakos, a brave commander - Asios, the son of Hyrtakos, whom his powerful dark bay steeds, of the breed that comes from the river Selleis, had brought from Arisbe.

2.811

811 ἔστι δέ τις προπάροιθε πόλιος αἰπεῖα κολώνη
812 ἐν πεδίῳ ἀπάνευθε περίδρομος ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα,
813 τὴν ἤτοι ἄνδρες Βατίειαν κικλήσκουσιν,
814 ἀθάνατοι δέ τε σῆμα πολυσκάρθμοιο Μυρίνης·
815 ἔνθα τότε Τρῶές τε διέκριθεν ἠδ’ ἐπίκουροι.
816 Τρωσὶ μὲν ἡγεμόνευε μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ
817 Πριαμίδης· ἅμα τῷ γε πολὺ πλεῖστοι καὶ ἄριστοι
818 λαοὶ θωρήσσοντο μεμαότες ἐγχείῃσι.
819 Δαρδανίων αὖτ’ ἦρχεν ἐΰς πάϊς Ἀγχίσαο
820 Αἰνείας, τὸν ὑπ’ Ἀγχίσῃ τέκε δῖ’ Ἀφροδίτη
821 Ἴδης ἐν κνημοῖσι θεὰ βροτῷ εὐνηθεῖσα,
822 οὐκ οἶος, ἅμα τῷ γε δύω Ἀντήνορος υἷε
823 Ἀρχέλοχός τ’ Ἀκάμας τε μάχης εὖ εἰδότε πάσης.
824 οἳ δὲ Ζέλειαν ἔναιον ὑπαὶ πόδα νείατον Ἴδης
825 ἀφνειοὶ πίνοντες ὕδωρ μέλαν Αἰσήποιο
826 Τρῶες, τῶν αὖτ’ ἦρχε Λυκάονος ἀγλαὸς υἱὸς
827 Πάνδαρος, ᾧ καὶ τόξον Ἀπόλλων αὐτὸς ἔδωκεν.
828 οἳ δ’ Ἀδρήστειάν τ’ εἶχον καὶ δῆμον Ἀπαισοῦ
829 καὶ Πιτύειαν ἔχον καὶ Τηρείης ὄρος αἰπύ,
830 τῶν ἦρχ’ Ἄδρηστός τε καὶ Ἄμφιος λινοθώρηξ
831 υἷε δύω Μέροπος Περκωσίου, ὃς περὶ πάντων
832 ᾔδεε μαντοσύνας, οὐδὲ οὓς παῖδας ἔασκε
833 στείχειν ἐς πόλεμον φθισήνορα· τὼ δέ οἱ οὔ τι
834 πειθέσθην· κῆρες γὰρ ἄγον μέλανος θανάτοιο.
835 οἳ δ’ ἄρα Περκώτην καὶ Πράκτιον ἀμφενέμοντο
836 καὶ Σηστὸν καὶ Ἄβυδον ἔχον καὶ δῖαν Ἀρίσβην,
837 τῶν αὖθ’ Ὑρτακίδης ἦρχ’ Ἄσιος ὄρχαμος ἀνδρῶν,
838 Ἄσιος Ὑρτακίδης ὃν Ἀρίσβηθεν φέρον ἵπποι
839 αἴθωνες μεγάλοι ποταμοῦ ἄπο Σελλήεντος.
840 Ἱππόθοος δ’ ἄγε φῦλα Πελασγῶν ἐγχεσιμώρων

Hippothoos led the tribes of Pelasgian spearsmen, who dwelt in fertile Larissa - Hippothoos, and Pylaios of the race of Ares, two sons of the Pelasgian Lethus, son of Teutamus. Akamas and the warrior Peirous commanded the Thracians and those that came from beyond the mighty stream of the Hellespont. Euphemos, son of Troizenos, the son of Ceos, was leader of the Ciconian spearsmen. Pyraikhmes led the Paeonian archers from distant Amydon, by

the broad waters of the river Axios, the fairest that flow upon the earth. The Paphlagonians were commanded by stout-hearted Pylaimenes from Enetae, where the mules run wild in herds. These were they that held Cytorus and the country round Sesamus, with the cities by the river Parthenios, Cromna, Aigialos, and lofty Erithinoi. Odios and Epistrophos were leaders over the Halizoni from distant Alybe, where there are mines of silver. Chromis, and Ennomos the augur, led the Mysians, but his skill in augury availed not to save him from destruction, for he fell by the hand of the fleet descendant of Aiakos in the river, where he slew others also of the Trojans. Phorkys, again, and noble Askanios led the Phrygians from the far country of Askania, and both were eager for the fray. Mesthles and Antiphos commanded the Meonians, sons of Talaimenes, born to him of the Gygaean lake. These led the Meonians, who dwelt under Mount Tmolos. Nastes led the Carians, men of a strange speech. These held Miletus and the wooded mountain of Phthires, with the water of the river Maeander and the lofty crests of Mount Mycale. These were commanded by Nastes and Amphimakhos, the brave sons of Nomion. He came into the fight with gold about him, like a girl; fool that he was, his gold was of no avail to save him, for he fell in the river by the hand of the fleet descendant of Aiakos, and Achilles bore away his gold. Sarpedon and Glaukos led the Lycians from their distant land, by the eddying waters of the Xanthos.

2.841

841 τῶν οἳ Λάρισαν ἐριβώλακα ναιετάασκον·
842 τῶν ἦρχ’ Ἱππόθοός τε Πύλαιός τ’ ὄζος Ἄρηος,
843 υἷε δύω Λήθοιο Πελασγοῦ Τευταμίδαο.
844 αὐτὰρ Θρήϊκας ἦγ’ Ἀκάμας καὶ Πείροος ἥρως
845 ὅσσους Ἑλλήσποντος ἀγάρροος ἐντὸς ἐέργει.
846 Εὔφημος δ’ ἀρχὸς Κικόνων ἦν αἰχμητάων
847 υἱὸς Τροιζήνοιο διοτρεφέος Κεάδαο.
848 αὐτὰρ Πυραίχμης ἄγε Παίονας ἀγκυλοτόξους
849 τηλόθεν ἐξ Ἀμυδῶνος ἀπ’ Ἀξιοῦ εὐρὺ ῥέοντος,
850 Ἀξιοῦ οὗ κάλλιστον ὕδωρ ἐπικίδναται αἶαν.
851 Παφλαγόνων δ’ ἡγεῖτο Πυλαιμένεος λάσιον κῆρ
852 ἐξ Ἐνετῶν, ὅθεν ἡμιόνων γένος ἀγροτεράων,
853 οἵ ῥα Κύτωρον ἔχον καὶ Σήσαμον ἀμφενέμοντο
854 ἀμφί τε Παρθένιον ποταμὸν κλυτὰ δώματ’ ἔναιον
855 Κρῶμνάν τ’ Αἰγιαλόν τε καὶ ὑψηλοὺς Ἐρυθίνους.
856 αὐτὰρ Ἁλιζώνων Ὀδίος καὶ Ἐπίστροφος ἦρχον
857 τηλόθεν ἐξ Ἀλύβης, ὅθεν ἀργύρου ἐστὶ γενέθλη.
858 Μυσῶν δὲ Χρόμις ἦρχε καὶ Ἔννομος οἰωνιστής·
859 ἀλλ’ οὐκ οἰωνοῖσιν ἐρύσατο κῆρα μέλαιναν,
860 ἀλλ’ ἐδάμη ὑπὸ χερσὶ ποδώκεος Αἰακίδαο
861 ἐν ποταμῷ, ὅθι περ Τρῶας κεράϊζε καὶ ἄλλους.
862 Φόρκυς αὖ Φρύγας ἦγε καὶ Ἀσκάνιος θεοειδὴς
863 τῆλ’ ἐξ Ἀσκανίης· μέμασαν δ’ ὑσμῖνι μάχεσθαι.
864 Μῄοσιν αὖ Μέσθλης τε καὶ Ἄντιφος ἡγησάσθην
865 υἷε Ταλαιμένεος τὼ Γυγαίη τέκε λίμνη,
866 οἳ καὶ Μῄονας ἦγον ὑπὸ Τμώλῳ γεγαῶτας.
867 Νάστης αὖ Καρῶν ἡγήσατο βαρβαροφώνων,
868 οἳ Μίλητον ἔχον Φθιρῶν τ’ ὄρος ἀκριτόφυλλον
869 Μαιάνδρου τε ῥοὰς Μυκάλης τ’ αἰπεινὰ κάρηνα·
870 τῶν μὲν ἄρ’ Ἀμφίμαχος καὶ Νάστης ἡγησάσθην,

2.871

871 Νάστης Ἀμφίμαχός τε Νομίονος ἀγλαὰ τέκνα,
872 ὃς καὶ χρυσὸν ἔχων πόλεμον δ’ ἴεν ἠΰτε κούρη
873 νήπιος, οὐδέ τί οἱ τό γ’ ἐπήρκεσε λυγρὸν ὄλεθρον,
874 ἀλλ’ ἐδάμη ὑπὸ χερσὶ ποδώκεος Αἰακίδαο
875 ἐν ποταμῷ, χρυσὸν δ’ Ἀχιλεὺς ἐκόμισσε δαΐφρων.
876 Σαρπηδὼν δ’ ἦρχεν Λυκίων καὶ Γλαῦκος ἀμύμων
877 τηλόθεν ἐκ Λυκίης, Ξάνθου ἄπο δινήεντος.

3.1

1 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ κόσμηθεν ἅμ’ ἡγεμόνεσσιν ἕκαστοι,
2 Τρῶες μὲν κλαγγῇ τ’ ἐνοπῇ τ’ ἴσαν ὄρνιθες ὣς
3 ἠΰτε περ κλαγγὴ γεράνων πέλει οὐρανόθι πρό·
4 αἵ τ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν χειμῶνα φύγον καὶ ἀθέσφατον ὄμβρον
5 κλαγγῇ ταί γε πέτονται ἐπ’ ὠκεανοῖο ῥοάων
6 ἀνδράσι Πυγμαίοισι φόνον καὶ κῆρα φέρουσαι·
7 ἠέριαι δ’ ἄρα ταί γε κακὴν ἔριδα προφέρονται.
8 οἳ δ’ ἄρ’ ἴσαν σιγῇ μένεα πνείοντες Ἀχαιοὶ
9 ἐν θυμῷ μεμαῶτες ἀλεξέμεν ἀλλήλοισιν.
10 εὖτ’ ὄρεος κορυφῇσι Νότος κατέχευεν ὀμίχλην
11 ποιμέσιν οὔ τι φίλην, κλέπτῃ δέ τε νυκτὸς ἀμείνω,
12 τόσσόν τίς τ’ ἐπιλεύσσει ὅσον τ’ ἐπὶ λᾶαν ἵησιν·
13 ὣς ἄρα τῶν ὑπὸ ποσσὶ κονίσαλος ὄρνυτ’ ἀελλὴς
14 ἐρχομένων· μάλα δ’ ὦκα διέπρησσον πεδίοιο.
15 οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντες,
16 Τρωσὶν μὲν προμάχιζεν Ἀλέξανδρος θεοειδὴς
17 παρδαλέην ὤμοισιν ἔχων καὶ καμπύλα τόξα
18 καὶ ξίφος· αὐτὰρ δοῦρε δύω κεκορυθμένα χαλκῷ
19 πάλλων Ἀργείων προκαλίζετο πάντας ἀρίστους
20 ἀντίβιον μαχέσασθαι ἐν αἰνῇ δηϊοτῆτι.
21 τὸν δ’ ὡς οὖν ἐνόησεν ἀρηΐφιλος Μενέλαος
22 ἐρχόμενον προπάροιθεν ὁμίλου μακρὰ βιβάντα,
23 ὥς τε λέων ἐχάρη μεγάλῳ ἐπὶ σώματι κύρσας
24 εὑρὼν ἢ ἔλαφον κεραὸν ἢ ἄγριον αἶγα
25 πεινάων· μάλα γάρ τε κατεσθίει, εἴ περ ἂν αὐτὸν
26 σεύωνται ταχέες τε κύνες θαλεροί τ’ αἰζηοί·
27 ὣς ἐχάρη Μενέλαος Ἀλέξανδρον θεοειδέα
28 ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ἰδών· φάτο γὰρ τίσεσθαι ἀλείτην·
29 αὐτίκα δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων σὺν τεύχεσιν ἆλτο χαμᾶζε.
30 τὸν δ’ ὡς οὖν ἐνόησεν Ἀλέξανδρος θεοειδὴς

When the companies were thus arrayed, each under its own leader, the Trojans advanced as a flight of wild fowl or cranes that scream overhead when rain and winter drive them over the flowing waters of Okeanos to bring death and destruction on the Pygmies, and they wrangle in the air as they fly; but the Achaeans marched silently, in high heart, and minded to stand by one another. As when the south wind spreads a curtain of mist upon the mountain tops, bad for shepherds but better than night for thieves, and a man can see no further than he can throw a stone, even so rose the dust from under their feet as they made all speed over the plain. When they were close up with one another, Alexander came forward as champion on the Trojan side. On his shoulders he bore the skin of a panther, his bow, and his sword, and he brandished two spears shod with bronze as a challenge to the bravest of the Achaeans to meet him in single fight. Menelaos saw him thus stride out

before the ranks, and was glad as a hungry lion that lights on the carcass of some goat or horned stag, and devours it there and then, though dogs and youths set upon him. Even thus was Menelaos glad when his eyes caught sight of Alexander, for he deemed that now he should be revenged. He sprang, therefore, from his chariot, clad in his suit of armor. Alexander quailed as he saw Menelaos come forward, and shrank in fear of his life under cover of his men. As one who starts back affrighted, trembling and pale, when he comes suddenly upon a serpent in some mountain glade, even so did Alexander plunge into the throng of Trojan warriors, terror-stricken at the sight of the son Atreus. Then Hektor upbraided him. "Paris," said he, "evil-hearted Paris, fair to see, but woman-mad, and false of tongue, would that you had never been born, or that you had died unwed. Better so, than live to be disgraced and looked askance at. Will not the Achaeans mock at us and say that we have sent one to champion us who is fair to see but who has neither wit nor force [biê]? Did you not, such as you are, get your following together and sail beyond the seas [pontos]? Did you not from your a far country carry off a lovely woman wedded among a people of warriors - to bring sorrow upon your father, your city, and your whole district [dêmos], but joy to your enemies, and hang-dog shamefacedness to yourself? And now can you not dare face Menelaos and learn what manner of man he is whose wife you have stolen? Where indeed would be your lyre and your love-tricks, your comely locks and your fair favor, when you were lying in the dust before him? The Trojans are a weak-kneed people, or ere this you would have had a shirt of stones for the wrongs you have done them." And Alexander answered, "Hektor, your rebuke is just. You are hard as the axe which a shipwright wields at his work, and cleaves the timber to his liking. As the axe in his hand, so keen is the edge of your mind [noos]. Still, taunt me not with the gifts that golden Aphrodite has given me; they are precious; let not a man disdain them, for the gods give them where they are minded, and none can have them for the asking. If you would have me do battle with Menelaos, bid the Trojans and Achaeans take their seats, while he and I fight in their midst for Helen and all her wealth. Let him who shall be victorious and prove to be the better man take the woman and all she has, to bear them to his home, but let the rest swear to a solemn covenant of peace whereby you Trojans shall stay here in Troy, while the others go home to Argos and the land of the Achaeans."

3.31

31 ἐν προμάχοισι φανέντα, κατεπλήγη φίλον ἦτορ,
32 ἂψ δ’ ἑτάρων εἰς ἔθνος ἐχάζετο κῆρ’ ἀλεείνων.
33 ὡς δ’ ὅτε τίς τε δράκοντα ἰδὼν παλίνορσος ἀπέστη
34 οὔρεος ἐν βήσσῃς, ὑπό τε τρόμος ἔλλαβε γυῖα,
35 ἂψ δ’ ἀνεχώρησεν, ὤχρός τέ μιν εἶλε παρειάς,
36 ὣς αὖτις καθ’ ὅμιλον ἔδυ Τρώων ἀγερώχων
37 δείσας Ἀτρέος υἱὸν Ἀλέξανδρος θεοειδής.
38 τὸν δ’ Ἕκτωρ νείκεσσεν ἰδὼν αἰσχροῖς ἐπέεσσιν·
39 Δύσπαρι εἶδος ἄριστε γυναιμανὲς ἠπεροπευτὰ
40 αἴθ’ ὄφελες ἄγονός τ’ ἔμεναι ἄγαμός τ’ ἀπολέσθαι·
41 καί κε τὸ βουλοίμην, καί κεν πολὺ κέρδιον ἦεν
42 ἢ οὕτω λώβην τ’ ἔμεναι καὶ ὑπόψιον ἄλλων.
43 ἦ που καγχαλόωσι κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοὶ
44 φάντες ἀριστῆα πρόμον ἔμμεναι, οὕνεκα καλὸν
45 εἶδος ἔπ’, ἀλλ’ οὐκ ἔστι βίη φρεσὶν οὐδέ τις ἀλκή.
46 ἦ τοιόσδε ἐὼν ἐν ποντοπόροισι νέεσσι
47 πόντον ἐπιπλώσας, ἑτάρους ἐρίηρας ἀγείρας,
48 μιχθεὶς ἀλλοδαποῖσι γυναῖκ’ εὐειδέ’ ἀνῆγες
49 ἐξ ἀπίης γαίης νυὸν ἀνδρῶν αἰχμητάων

50 πατρί τε σῷ μέγα πῆμα πόληΐ τε παντί τε δήμῳ,
51 δυσμενέσιν μὲν χάρμα, κατηφείην δὲ σοὶ αὐτῷ;
52 οὐκ ἂν δὴ μείνειας ἀρηΐφιλον Μενέλαον;
53 γνοίης χ’ οἵου φωτὸς ἔχεις θαλερὴν παράκοιτιν·
54 οὐκ ἄν τοι χραίσμῃ κίθαρις τά τε δῶρ’ Ἀφροδίτης
55 ἥ τε κόμη τό τε εἶδος ὅτ’ ἐν κονίῃσι μιγείης.
56 ἀλλὰ μάλα Τρῶες δειδήμονες· ἦ τέ κεν ἤδη
57 λάϊνον ἔσσο χιτῶνα κακῶν ἕνεχ’ ὅσσα ἔοργας.
58 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν Ἀλέξανδρος θεοειδής·
59 Ἕκτορ ἐπεί με κατ’ αἶσαν ἐνείκεσας οὐδ’ ὑπὲρ αἶσαν·
60 αἰεί τοι κραδίη πέλεκυς ὥς ἐστιν ἀτειρὴς

3.61

61 ὅς τ’ εἶσιν διὰ δουρὸς ὑπ’ ἀνέρος ὅς ῥά τε τέχνῃ
62 νήϊον ἐκτάμνῃσιν, ὀφέλλει δ’ ἀνδρὸς ἐρωήν·
63 ὣς σοὶ ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἀτάρβητος νόος ἐστί·
64 μή μοι δῶρ’ ἐρατὰ πρόφερε χρυσέης Ἀφροδίτης·
65 οὔ τοι ἀπόβλητ’ ἐστὶ θεῶν ἐρικυδέα δῶρα
66 ὅσσά κεν αὐτοὶ δῶσιν, ἑκὼν δ’ οὐκ ἄν τις ἕλοιτο·
67 νῦν αὖτ’ εἴ μ’ ἐθέλεις πολεμίζειν ἠδὲ μάχεσθαι,
68 ἄλλους μὲν κάθισον Τρῶας καὶ πάντας Ἀχαιούς,
69 αὐτὰρ ἔμ’ ἐν μέσσῳ καὶ ἀρηΐφιλον Μενέλαον
70 συμβάλετ’ ἀμφ’ Ἑλένῃ καὶ κτήμασι πᾶσι μάχεσθαι·
71 ὁππότερος δέ κε νικήσῃ κρείσσων τε γένηται,
72 κτήμαθ’ ἑλὼν εὖ πάντα γυναῖκά τε οἶκαδ’ ἀγέσθω·
73 οἳ δ’ ἄλλοι φιλότητα καὶ ὅρκια πιστὰ ταμόντες
74 ναίοιτε Τροίην ἐριβώλακα, τοὶ δὲ νεέσθων
75 Ἄργος ἐς ἱππόβοτον καὶ Ἀχαιΐδα καλλιγύναικα.
76 ὣς ἔφαθ’, Ἕκτωρ δ’ αὖτ’ ἐχάρη μέγα μῦθον ἀκούσας,
77 καί ῥ’ ἐς μέσσον ἰὼν Τρώων ἀνέεργε φάλαγγας
78 μέσσου δουρὸς ἑλών· τοὶ δ’ ἱδρύνθησαν ἅπαντες.
79 τῷ δ’ ἐπετοξάζοντο κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοὶ
80 ἰοῖσίν τε τιτυσκόμενοι λάεσσί τ’ ἔβαλλον·
81 αὐτὰρ ὃ μακρὸν ἄϋσεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
82 ἴσχεσθ’ Ἀργεῖοι, μὴ βάλλετε κοῦροι Ἀχαιῶν·
83 στεῦται γάρ τι ἔπος ἐρέειν κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ.
84 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἔσχοντο μάχης ἄνεώ τ’ ἐγένοντο
85 ἐσσυμένως· Ἕκτωρ δὲ μετ’ ἀμφοτέροισιν ἔειπε·
86 κέκλυτέ μευ Τρῶες καὶ ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
87 μῦθον Ἀλεξάνδροιο, τοῦ εἵνεκα νεῖκος ὄρωρεν.
88 ἄλλους μὲν κέλεται Τρῶας καὶ πάντας Ἀχαιοὺς
89 τεύχεα κάλ’ ἀποθέσθαι ἐπὶ χθονὶ πουλυβοτείρῃ,
90 αὐτὸν δ’ ἐν μέσσῳ καὶ ἀρηΐφιλον Μενέλαον

When Hektor heard this he was glad, and went about among the Trojan ranks holding his spear by the middle to keep them back, and they all sat down at his bidding: but the Achaeans still aimed at him with stones and arrows, till Agamemnon shouted to them saying, "Hold, Argives, shoot not, sons of the Achaeans; Hektor desires to speak." They ceased taking aim and were still, whereon Hektor spoke. "Hear from my mouth," said he, "Trojans and Achaeans, the saying of Alexander, through whom this quarrel has come about. He bids the Trojans and Achaeans lay their armor upon the ground, while he and Menelaos fight in the midst of you for Helen and all her wealth. Let him who shall be

victorious and prove to be the better man take the woman and all she has, to bear them to his own home, but let the rest swear to a solemn covenant of peace." Thus he spoke, and they all held their peace, till Menelaos of the loud battle-cry addressed them. "And now," he said, "hear me too, for it is I who am the most aggrieved. I deem that the parting of Achaeans and Trojans is at hand, as well it may be, seeing how much have suffered for my quarrel with Alexander and the wrong he did me. Let him who shall die, die, and let the others fight no more. Bring, then, two lambs, a white ram and a black ewe, for Earth and Sun, and we will bring a third for Zeus. Moreover, you shall bid mighty Priam come, that he may swear to the covenant himself; for his sons are high-handed and ill to trust, and the oaths of Zeus must not be transgressed or taken in vain. Young men's minds are light as air, but when an old man comes he looks before and after, deeming that which shall be fairest upon both sides." The Trojans and Achaeans were glad when they heard this, for they thought that they should now have rest. They backed their chariots toward the ranks, got out of them, and put off their armor, laying it down upon the ground; and the hosts were near to one another with a little space between them. Hektor sent two messengers to the city to bring the lambs and to bid Priam come, while Agamemnon told Talthybios to fetch the other lamb from the ships, and he did as Agamemnon had said. Meanwhile Iris went to Helen in the form of her sister-in-law, wife of the son of Antenor, for Helikaon, son of Antenor, had married Laodike, the fairest of Priam's daughters. She found her in her own room, working at a great web of purple linen, on which she was embroidering the struggles [athloi] between Trojans and Achaeans, that Ares had made them fight for her sake. Iris then came close up to her and said, "Come hither, child, and see the strange doings of the Trojans and Achaeans till now they have been warring upon the plain, mad with lust of battle, but now they have left off fighting, and are leaning upon their shields, sitting still with their spears planted beside them. Alexander and Menelaos are going to fight about yourself, and you are to the wife of him who is the victor." Thus spoke the goddess, and Helen's heart yearned after her former husband, her city, and her parents. She threw a white mantle over her head, and hurried from her room, weeping as she went, not alone, but attended by two of her handmaids, Aithra, daughter of Pittheus, and Klymene. And straightway they were at the Scaean gates. The two sages, Ucalegon and Antenor, elders of the people, were seated by the Scaean gates, with Priam, Panthoos, Thymoetes, Lampos, Klytios, and Hiketaon of the race of Ares. These were too old to fight, but they were fluent orators, and sat on the tower like cicadas that chirrup delicately from the boughs of some high tree in a wood. When they saw Helen coming towards the tower, they said softly to one another, "No wonder the Trojans and Achaeans endure so much and so long, for the sake of a woman so marvelously and divinely lovely. There is no sense of nemesis here. Still, fair though she be, let them take her and go, or she will breed sorrow for us and for our children after us."

3.91

91 οἵους ἀμφ’ Ἑλένῃ καὶ κτήμασι πᾶσι μάχεσθαι.
92 ὁππότερος δέ κε νικήσῃ κρείσσων τε γένηται
93 κτήμαθ’ ἑλὼν εὖ πάντα γυναῖκά τε οἶκαδ’ ἀγέσθω·
94 οἳ δ’ ἄλλοι φιλότητα καὶ ὅρκια πιστὰ τάμωμεν.
95 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἀκὴν ἐγένοντο σιωπῇ·
96 τοῖσι δὲ καὶ μετέειπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος·
97 κέκλυτε νῦν καὶ ἐμεῖο· μάλιστα γὰρ ἄλγος ἱκάνει
98 θυμὸν ἐμόν, φρονέω δὲ διακρινθήμεναι ἤδη
99 Ἀργείους καὶ Τρῶας, ἐπεὶ κακὰ πολλὰ πέπασθε
100 εἵνεκ’ ἐμῆς ἔριδος καὶ Ἀλεξάνδρου ἕνεκ’ ἀρχῆς·
101 ἡμέων δ’ ὁπποτέρῳ θάνατος καὶ μοῖρα τέτυκται

τεθναίη· ἄλλοι δὲ διακρινθεῖτε τάχιστα.
οἴσετε ἄρν’, ἕτερον λευκόν, ἑτέρην δὲ μέλαιναν,
Γῇ τε καὶ Ἠελίῳ· Διὶ δ’ ἡμεῖς οἴσομεν ἄλλον·
ἄξετε δὲ Πριάμοιο βίην, ὅφρ’ ὅρκια τάμνῃ
αὐτός, ἐπεί οἱ παῖδες ὑπερφίαλοι καὶ ἄπιστοι,
μή τις ὑπερβασίῃ Διὸς ὅρκια δηλήσηται.
αἰεὶ δ’ ὀπλοτέρων ἀνδρῶν φρένες ἠερέθονται·
οἷς δ’ ὁ γέρων μετέῃσιν ἅμα πρόσσω καὶ ὀπίσσω
λεύσσει, ὅπως ὄχ’ ἄριστα μετ’ ἀμφοτέροισι γένηται.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἐχάρησαν Ἀχαιοί τε Τρῶές τε
ἐλπόμενοι παύσασθαι ὀϊζυροῦ πολέμοιο.
καί ῥ’ ἵππους μὲν ἔρυξαν ἐπὶ στίχας, ἐκ δ’ ἔβαν αὐτοί,
τεύχεά τ’ ἐξεδύοντο· τὰ μὲν κατέθεντ’ ἐπὶ γαίῃ
πλησίον ἀλλήλων, ὀλίγη δ’ ἦν ἀμφὶς ἄρουρα·
Ἕκτωρ δὲ προτὶ ἄστυ δύω κήρυκας ἔπεμπε
καρπαλίμως ἄρνάς τε φέρειν Πρίαμόν τε καλέσσαι·
αὐτὰρ ὃ Ταλθύβιον προΐει κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
νῆας ἔπι γλαφυρὰς ἰέναι, ἠδ’ ἄρν’ ἐκέλευεν
οἰσέμεναι· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ οὐκ ἀπίθησ’ Ἀγαμέμνονι δίῳ.

3.121

Ἶρις δ’ αὖθ’ Ἑλένῃ λευκωλένῳ ἄγγελος ἦλθεν
εἰδομένη γαλόῳ Ἀντηνορίδαο δάμαρτι,
τὴν Ἀντηνορίδης εἶχε κρείων Ἑλικάων
Λαοδίκην Πριάμοιο θυγατρῶν εἶδος ἀρίστην.
τὴν δ’ εὗρ’ ἐν μεγάρῳ· ἣ δὲ μέγαν ἱστὸν ὕφαινε
δίπλακα πορφυρέην, πολέας δ’ ἐνέπασσεν ἀέθλους
Τρώων θ’ ἱπποδάμων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων,
οὕς ἑθεν εἵνεκ’ ἔπασχον ὑπ’ Ἄρηος παλαμάων·
ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱσταμένη προσέφη πόδας ὠκέα Ἶρις·
δεῦρ’ ἴθι νύμφα φίλη, ἵνα θέσκελα ἔργα ἴδηαι
Τρώων θ’ ἱπποδάμων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων,
οἳ πρὶν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισι φέρον πολύδακρυν Ἄρηα
ἐν πεδίῳ ὀλοοῖο λιλαιόμενοι πολέμοιο·
οἳ δὴ νῦν ἕαται σιγῇ, πόλεμος δὲ πέπαυται,
ἀσπίσι κεκλιμένοι, παρὰ δ’ ἔγχεα μακρὰ πέπηγεν.
αὐτὰρ Ἀλέξανδρος καὶ ἀρηΐφιλος Μενέλαος
μακρῇς ἐγχείῃσι μαχήσονται περὶ σεῖο·
τῷ δέ κε νικήσαντι φίλη κεκλήσῃ ἄκοιτις.
ὣς εἰποῦσα θεὰ γλυκὺν ἵμερον ἔμβαλε θυμῷ
ἀνδρός τε προτέρου καὶ ἄστεος ἠδὲ τοκήων·
αὐτίκα δ’ ἀργεννῇσι καλυψαμένη ὀθόνῃσιν
ὁρμᾶτ’ ἐκ θαλάμοιο τέρεν κατὰ δάκρυ χέουσα
οὐκ οἴη, ἅμα τῇ γε καὶ ἀμφίπολοι δύ’ ἕποντο,
Αἴθρη Πιτθῆος θυγάτηρ, Κλυμένη τε βοῶπις·
αἶψα δ’ ἔπειθ’ ἵκανον ὅθι Σκαιαὶ πύλαι ἦσαν.
οἳ δ’ ἀμφὶ Πρίαμον καὶ Πάνθοον ἠδὲ Θυμοίτην
Λάμπόν τε Κλυτίον θ’ Ἱκετάονά τ’ ὄζον Ἄρηος
Οὐκαλέγων τε καὶ Ἀντήνωρ πεπνυμένω ἄμφω
ἥατο δημογέροντες ἐπὶ Σκαιῇσι πύλῃσι,
γήραϊ δὴ πολέμοιο πεπαυμένοι, ἀλλ’ ἀγορηταὶ

3.151

151 ἐσθλοί, τεττίγεσσιν ἐοικότες οἵ τε καθ’ ὕλην
152 δενδρέῳ ἐφεζόμενοι ὄπα λειριόεσσαν ἱεῖσι·
153 τοῖοι ἄρα Τρώων ἡγήτορες ἦντ’ ἐπὶ πύργῳ.
154 οἳ δ’ ὡς οὖν εἶδονθ’ Ἑλένην ἐπὶ πύργον ἰοῦσαν,
155 ἦκα πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἔπεα πτερόεντ’ ἀγόρευον·
156 οὐ νέμεσις Τρῶας καὶ ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιοὺς
157 τοιῇδ’ ἀμφὶ γυναικὶ πολὺν χρόνον ἄλγεα πάσχειν·
158 αἰνῶς ἀθανάτῃσι θεῇς εἰς ὦπα ἔοικεν·
159 ἀλλὰ καὶ ὣς τοίη περ ἐοῦσ’ ἐν νηυσὶ νεέσθω,
160 μηδ’ ἡμῖν τεκέεσσί τ’ ὀπίσσω πῆμα λίποιτο.
161 ὣς ἄρ’ ἔφαν, Πρίαμος δ’ Ἑλένην ἐκαλέσσατο φωνῇ·
162 δεῦρο πάροιθ’ ἐλθοῦσα φίλον τέκος ἵζευ ἐμεῖο,
163 ὄφρα ἴδῃ πρότερόν τε πόσιν πηούς τε φίλους τε·
164 οὔ τί μοι αἰτίη ἐσσί, θεοί νύ μοι αἴτιοί εἰσιν
165 οἵ μοι ἐφώρμησαν πόλεμον πολύδακρυν Ἀχαιῶν·
166 ὥς μοι καὶ τόνδ’ ἄνδρα πελώριον ἐξονομήνῃς
167 ὅς τις ὅδ’ ἐστὶν Ἀχαιὸς ἀνὴρ ἠΰς τε μέγας τε.
168 ἄλλοι μὲν κεφαλῇ καὶ μείζονες ἄλλοι ἔασι,
169 καλὸν δ’ οὔτω ἐγὼν οὔ πω ἴδον ὀφθαλμοῖσιν,
170 οὐδ’ οὕτω γεραρόν· βασιλῆϊ γὰρ ἀνδρὶ ἔοικε.
171 τὸν δ’ Ἑλένη μύθοισιν ἀμείβετο δῖα γυναικῶν·
172 αἰδοῖός τέ μοί ἐσσι φίλε ἑκυρὲ δεινός τε·
173 ὡς ὄφελεν θάνατός μοι ἀδεῖν κακὸς ὁππότε δεῦρο
174 υἱέϊ σῷ ἑπόμην θάλαμον γνωτούς τε λιποῦσα
175 παῖδά τε τηλυγέτην καὶ ὁμηλικίην ἐρατεινήν.
176 ἀλλὰ τά γ’ οὐκ ἐγένοντο· τὸ καὶ κλαίουσα τέτηκα.
177 τοῦτο δέ τοι ἐρέω ὅ μ’ ἀνείρεαι ἠδὲ μεταλλᾷς·
178 οὗτός γ’ Ἀτρεΐδης εὐρὺ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων,
179 ἀμφότερον βασιλεύς τ’ ἀγαθὸς κρατερός τ’ αἰχμητής·
180 δαὴρ αὖτ’ ἐμὸς ἔσκε κυνώπιδος, εἴ ποτ’ ἔην γε.

But Priam bade her draw nigh. "My child," said he, "take your seat in front of me that you may see your former husband, your kinsmen and your friends. I lay no responsibility [aitia] upon you, it is the gods, not you who are responsible [aitioi]. It is they that have brought about this terrible war with the Achaeans. Tell me, then, who is yonder huge hero so great and goodly? I have seen men taller by a head, but none so comely and so royal. Surely he must be a king." "Sir," answered Helen, "father of my husband, dear and reverend in my eyes, would that I had chosen death rather than to have come here with your son, far from my bridal chamber, my friends, my darling daughter, and all the companions of my girlhood. But it was not to be, and my lot is one of tears and sorrow. As for your question, the hero of whom you ask is Agamemnon, son of Atreus, a good king and a brave warrior, brother-in-law as surely as that he lives, to my abhorred and miserable self." The old man marveled at him and said, "Happy son of Atreus, child of good fortune. I see that the Achaeans are subject to you in great multitudes. When I was in Phrygia I saw much horsemen, the people of Otreus and of Mygdon, who were camping upon the banks of the river Sangarios; I was their ally, and with them when the Amazons, peers of men, came up against them, but even they were not so many as the Achaeans." The old man next looked upon Odysseus; "Tell me," he said, "who is that other, shorter by a head than Agamemnon, but broader across the chest and shoulders? His armor is laid upon the ground, and he stalks in front of the ranks as it were some great woolly ram ordering his ewes." And Helen answered, "He is Odysseus, a man of great craft, son of Laertes. He was born in the district

[dêmos] of rugged Ithaca, and excels in all manner of stratagems and subtle cunning." On this Antenor said, "my lady, you have spoken truly. Odysseus once came here as envoy about yourself, and Menelaos with him. I received them in my own house, and therefore know both of them by sight and conversation. When they stood up in presence of the assembled Trojans, Menelaos was the broader shouldered, but when both were seated Odysseus had the more royal presence. After a time they delivered their message, and the speech of Menelaos ran trippingly on the tongue; he did not say much, for he was a man of few words, but he spoke very clearly and to the point, though he was the younger man of the two; Odysseus, on the other hand, when he rose to speak, was at first silent and kept his eyes fixed upon the ground. There was no play nor graceful movement of his scepter; he kept it straight and stiff like a man unpracticed in oratory - one might have taken him for a mere churl or simpleton; but when he raised his voice, and the words came driving from his deep chest like winter snow before the wind, then there was none to touch him, and no man thought further of what he looked like." Priam then caught sight of Ajax and asked, "Who is that great and goodly warrior whose head and broad shoulders tower above the rest of the Argives?" "That," answered Helen, "is huge Ajax, bulwark of the Achaeans, and on the other side of him, among the Cretans, stands Idomeneus looking like a god, and with the leaders of the Cretans round him. Often did Menelaos receive him as a guest in our house when he came visiting us from Crete. I see, moreover, many other Achaeans whose names I could tell you, but there are two whom I can nowhere find, Castor, breaker of horses, and Pollux the mighty boxer; they are children of my mother, and own brothers to myself. Either they have not left Lacedaemon, or else, though they have brought their ships, they will not show themselves in battle for the shame and disgrace that I have brought upon them."

3.181

181 ὣς φάτο, τὸν δ’ ὁ γέρων ἠγάσσατο φώνησέν τε·
182 ὦ μάκαρ Ἀτρεΐδη μοιρηγενὲς ὀλβιόδαιμον,
183 ἦ ῥά νύ τοι πολλοὶ δεδμήατο κοῦροι Ἀχαιῶν.
184 ἤδη καὶ Φρυγίην εἰσήλυθον ἀμπελόεσσαν,
185 ἔνθα ἴδον πλείστους Φρύγας ἀνέρας αἰολοπώλους
186 λαοὺς Ὀτρῆος καὶ Μυγδόνος ἀντιθέοιο,
187 οἵ ῥα τότ’ ἐστρατόωντο παρ’ ὄχθας Σαγγαρίοιο·
188 καὶ γὰρ ἐγὼν ἐπίκουρος ἐὼν μετὰ τοῖσιν ἐλέχθην
189 ἤματι τῷ ὅτε τ’ ἦλθον Ἀμαζόνες ἀντιάνειραι·
190 ἀλλ’ οὐδ’ οἳ τόσοι ἦσαν ὅσοι ἐλίκωπες Ἀχαιοί.
191 δεύτερον αὖτ’ Ὀδυσῆα ἰδὼν ἐρέειν’ ὁ γεραιός·
192 εἶπ’ ἄγε μοι καὶ τόνδε φίλον τέκος ὅς τις ὅδ’ ἐστί·
193 μείων μὲν κεφαλῇ Ἀγαμέμνονος Ἀτρεΐδαο,
194 εὐρύτερος δ’ ὤμοισιν ἰδὲ στέρνοισιν ἰδέσθαι.
195 τεύχεα μέν οἱ κεῖται ἐπὶ χθονὶ πουλυβοτείρῃ,
196 αὐτὸς δὲ κτίλος ὣς ἐπιπωλεῖται στίχας ἀνδρῶν·
197 ἀρνειῷ μιν ἔγωγε ἐΐσκω πηγεσιμάλλῳ,
198 ὅς τ’ οἰῶν μέγα πῶϋ διέρχεται ἀργεννάων.
199 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειθ’ Ἑλένη Διὸς ἐκγεγαυῖα·
200 οὗτος δ’ αὖ Λαερτιάδης πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεύς,
201 ὃς τράφη ἐν δήμῳ Ἰθάκης κραναῆς περ ἐούσης
202 εἰδὼς παντοίους τε δόλους καὶ μήδεα πυκνά.
203 τὴν δ’ αὖτ’ Ἀντήνωρ πεπνυμένος ἀντίον ηὔδα·
204 ὦ γύναι ἦ μάλα τοῦτο ἔπος νημερτὲς ἔειπες·
205 ἤδη γὰρ καὶ δεῦρό ποτ’ ἦλυθε δῖος Ὀδυσσεὺς
206 σεῦ ἕνεκ’ ἀγγελίης σὺν ἀρηϊφίλῳ Μενελάῳ·

τοὺς δ’ ἐγὼ ἐξείνισσα καὶ ἐν μεγάροισι φίλησα,
ἀμφοτέρων δὲ φυὴν ἐδάην καὶ μήδεα πυκνά.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ Τρώεσσιν ἐν ἀγρομένοισιν ἔμιχθεν
στάντων μὲν Μενέλαος ὑπείρεχεν εὐρέας ὤμους,

3.211

ἄμφω δ’ ἑζομένω γεραρώτερος ἦεν Ὀδυσσεύς·
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ μύθους καὶ μήδεα πᾶσιν ὕφαινον
ἤτοι μὲν Μενέλαος ἐπιτροχάδην ἀγόρευε,
παῦρα μὲν ἀλλὰ μάλα λιγέως, ἐπεὶ οὐ πολύμυθος
οὐδ’ ἀφαμαρτοεπής· ἦ καὶ γένει ὕστερος ἦεν.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ πολύμητις ἀναΐξειεν Ὀδυσσεὺς
στάσκεν, ὑπαὶ δὲ ἴδεσκε κατὰ χθονὸς ὄμματα πήξας,
σκῆπτρον δ’ οὔτ’ ὀπίσω οὔτε προπρηνὲς ἐνώμα,
ἀλλ’ ἀστεμφὲς ἔχεσκεν ἀΐδρεϊ φωτὶ ἐοικώς·
φαίης κε ζάκοτόν τέ τιν’ ἔμμεναι ἄφρονά τ’ αὖτως.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ ὄπα τε μεγάλην ἐκ στήθεος εἵη
καὶ ἔπεα νιφάδεσσιν ἐοικότα χειμερίῃσιν,
οὐκ ἂν ἔπειτ’ Ὀδυσῆΐ γ’ ἐρίσσειε βροτὸς ἄλλος·
οὐ τότε γ’ ὦδ’ Ὀδυσῆος ἀγασσάμεθ’ εἶδος ἰδόντες.
τὸ τρίτον αὖτ’ Αἴαντα ἰδὼν ἐρέειν’ ὃ γεραιός·
τίς τὰρ ὅδ’ ἄλλος Ἀχαιὸς ἀνὴρ ἠΰς τε μέγας τε
ἔξοχος Ἀργείων κεφαλήν τε καὶ εὐρέας ὤμους;
τὸν δ’ Ἑλένη τανύπεπλος ἀμείβετο δῖα γυναικῶν·
οὗτος δ’ Αἴας ἐστὶ πελώριος ἕρκος Ἀχαιῶν·
Ἰδομενεὺς δ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐνὶ Κρήτεσσι θεὸς ὡς
ἕστηκ’, ἀμφὶ δέ μιν Κρητῶν ἀγοὶ ἠγερέθονται.
πολλάκι μιν ξείνισσεν ἀρηΐφιλος Μενέλαος
οἴκῳ ἐν ἡμετέρῳ ὁπότε Κρήτηθεν ἵκοιτο.
νῦν δ’ ἄλλους μὲν πάντας ὁρῶ ἐλίκωπας Ἀχαιούς,
οὕς κεν ἐὺ γνοίην καί τ’ οὔνομα μυθησαίμην·
δοιὼ δ’ οὐ δύναμαι ἰδέειν κοσμήτορε λαῶν
Κάστορά θ’ ἱππόδαμον καὶ πὺξ ἀγαθὸν Πολυδεύκεα
αὐτοκασιγνήτω, τώ μοι μία γείνατο μήτηρ.
ἦ οὐχ ἑσπέσθην Λακεδαίμονος ἐξ ἐρατεινῆς,
ἦ δεύρω μὲν ἔποντο νέεσσ’ ἔνι ποντοπόροισι,

3.241

νῦν αὖτ’ οὐκ ἐθέλουσι μάχην καταδύμεναι ἀνδρῶν
αἴσχεα δειδιότες καὶ ὀνείδεα πόλλ’ ἅ μοί ἐστιν.
ὣς φάτο, τοὺς δ’ ἤδη κάτεχεν φυσίζοος αἶα
ἐν Λακεδαίμονι αὖθι φίλῃ ἐν πατρίδι γαίῃ.
κήρυκες δ’ ἀνὰ ἄστυ θεῶν φέρον ὅρκια πιστὰ
ἄρνε δύω καὶ οἶνον ἐΰφρονα καρπὸν ἀρούρης
ἀσκῷ ἐν αἰγείῳ· φέρε δὲ κρητῆρα φαεινὸν
κῆρυξ Ἰδαῖος ἠδὲ χρύσεια κύπελλα·
ὄτρυνεν δὲ γέροντα παριστάμενος ἐπέεσσιν·
ὄρσεο Λαομεδοντιάδη, καλέουσιν ἄριστοι
Τρώων θ’ ἱπποδάμων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων
ἐς πεδίον καταβῆναι ἵν’ ὅρκια πιστὰ τάμητε·

αὐτὰρ Ἀλέξανδρος καὶ ἀρηΐφιλος Μενέλαος
μακρῇς ἐγχείῃσι μαχήσοντ’ ἀμφὶ γυναικί·
τῷ δέ κε νικήσαντι γυνὴ καὶ κτήμαθ’ ἕποιτο·
οἳ δ’ ἄλλοι φιλότητα καὶ ὅρκια πιστὰ ταμόντες
ναίοιμεν Τροίην ἐριβώλακα, τοὶ δὲ νέονται
Ἄργος ἐς ἱππόβοτον καὶ Ἀχαιΐδα καλλιγύναικα.
ὣς φάτο ῥίγησεν δ’ ὃ γέρων, ἐκέλευσε δ’ ἑταίρους
ἵππους ζευγνύμεναι· τοὶ δ’ ὀτραλέως ἐπίθοντο.
ἂν δ’ ἄρ’ ἔβη Πρίαμος, κατὰ δ’ ἡνία τεῖνεν ὀπίσσω·
πὰρ δέ οἱ Ἀντήνωρ περικαλλέα βήσετο δίφρον·
τὼ δὲ διὰ Σκαιῶν πεδίον δ’ ἔχον ὠκέας ἵππους.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἵκοντο μετὰ Τρῶας καὶ Ἀχαιούς,
ἐξ ἵππων ἀποβάντες ἐπὶ χθόνα πουλυβότειραν
ἐς μέσσον Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν ἐστιχόωντο.
ὄρνυτο δ’ αὐτίκ’ ἔπειτα ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων,
ἂν δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς πολύμητις· ἀτὰρ κήρυκες ἀγαυοὶ
ὅρκια πιστὰ θεῶν σύναγον, κρητῆρι δὲ οἶνον
μίσγον, ἀτὰρ βασιλεῦσιν ὕδωρ ἐπὶ χεῖρας ἔχευαν.

She knew not that both these heroes were already lying under the earth in their own land of Lacedaemon. Meanwhile the heralds were bringing the holy oath-offerings through the city - two lambs and a goatskin of wine, the gift of earth; and Idaios brought the mixing bowl and the cups of gold. He went up to Priam and said, "Son of Laomedon, the princes of the Trojans and Achaeans bid you come down on to the plain and swear to a solemn covenant. Alexander and Menelaos are to fight for Helen in single combat, that she and all her wealth may go with him who is the victor. We are to swear to a solemn covenant of peace whereby we others shall dwell here in Troy, while the Achaeans return to Argos and the land of the Achaeans." The old man trembled as he heard, but bade his followers yoke the horses, and they made all haste to do so. He mounted the chariot, gathered the reins in his hand, and Antenor took his seat beside him; they then drove through the Scaean gates on to the plain. When they reached the ranks of the Trojans and Achaeans they left the chariot, and with measured pace advanced into the space between the hosts. Agamemnon and Odysseus both rose to meet them. The attendants brought on the oath-offerings and mixed the wine in the mixing-bowls; they poured water over the hands of the chieftains, and the son of Atreus drew the dagger that hung by his sword, and cut wool from the lambs' heads; this the men-servants gave about among the Trojan and Achaean princes, and the son of Atreus lifted up his hands in prayer. "Father Zeus," he cried, "you who rule in Ida, most glorious in power, and you O Sun, who see and give ear to all things, Earth and Rivers, and you who in the realms below chastise those mortals who have broken their oath, witness these rites and guard them, that they be not vain. If Alexander kills Menelaos, let him keep Helen and all her wealth, while we sail home with our ships; but if Menelaos kills Alexander, let the Trojans give back Helen and all that she has; let them moreover pay such fine [timê] to the Achaeans as shall be agreed upon, in testimony among those that shall be born hereafter. And if Priam and his sons refuse such fine [timê] when Alexander has fallen, then will I stay here and fight on till the war reaches its completion [telos]. " As he spoke he drew his knife across the throats of the victims, and laid them down gasping and dying upon the ground, for the knife had reft them of their strength. Then they poured wine from the mixing-bowl into the cups, and prayed to the everlasting gods, saying, Trojans and Achaeans among one another, "Zeus, most great and glorious, and you other everlasting gods, grant that the brains of them who shall first violate their oaths - of them and their children - may be shed upon the ground even as this wine, and let their wives become the slaves of strangers." Thus they prayed, but not as yet would Zeus grant them their prayer.

Then Priam, descendant of Dardanos, spoke, saying, "Hear me, Trojans and Achaeans, I will now go back to the wind-beaten city of Ilion: I dare not with my own eyes witness this fight between my son and Menelaos, for Zeus and the other immortals alone know which of the two is doomed to undergo the outcome of death." On this he laid the two lambs on his chariot and took his seat. He gathered the reins in his hand, and Antenor sat beside him; the two then went back to Ilion. Hektor and Odysseus measured the ground, and cast lots from a helmet of bronze to see which should take aim first. Meanwhile the two hosts lifted up their hands and prayed saying, "Father Zeus, you who rule from Ida, most glorious in power, grant that he who first brought about this war between us may die, and enter the house of Hades, while we others remain at peace and abide by our oaths."

3.271

271 Ἀτρεΐδης δὲ ἐρυσσάμενος χείρεσσι μάχαιραν,
272 ἥ οἱ πὰρ ξίφεος μέγα κουλεόν αἰὲν ἄωρτο,
273 ἀρνῶν ἐκ κεφαλέων τάμνε τρίχας· αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
274 κήρυκες Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν νεῖμαν ἀρίστοις.
275 τοῖσιν δ’ Ἀτρεΐδης μεγάλ’ εὔχετο χεῖρας ἀνασχών·
276 Ζεῦ πάτερ Ἴδηθεν μεδέων κύδιστε μέγιστε,
277 Ἠέλιός θ’, ὃς πάντ’ ἐφορᾷς καὶ πάντ’ ἐπακούεις,
278 καὶ ποταμοὶ καὶ γαῖα, καὶ οἳ ὑπένερθε καμόντας
279 ἀνθρώπους τίνυσθον ὅτις κ’ ἐπίορκον ὀμόσσῃ,
280 ὑμεῖς μάρτυροι ἔστε, φυλάσσετε δ’ ὅρκια πιστά·
281 εἰ μέν κεν Μενέλαον Ἀλέξανδρος καταπέφνῃ
282 αὐτὸς ἔπειθ’ Ἑλένην ἐχέτω καὶ κτήματα πάντα,
283 ἡμεῖς δ’ ἐν νήεσσι νεώμεθα ποντοπόροισιν·
284 εἰ δέ κ’ Ἀλέξανδρον κτείνῃ ξανθὸς Μενέλαος,
285 Τρῶας ἔπειθ’ Ἑλένην καὶ κτήματα πάντ’ ἀποδοῦναι,
286 τιμὴν δ’ Ἀργείοις ἀποτινέμεν ἥν τιν’ ἔοικεν,
287 ἥ τε καὶ ἐσσομένοισι μετ’ ἀνθρώποισι πέληται.
288 εἰ δ’ ἂν ἐμοὶ τιμὴν Πρίαμος Πριάμοιό τε παῖδες
289 τίνειν οὐκ ἐθέλωσιν Ἀλεξάνδροιο πεσόντος,
290 αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ καὶ ἔπειτα μαχήσομαι εἵνεκα ποινῆς
291 αὖθι μένων, ἧός κε τέλος πολέμοιο κιχείω.
292 ἦ, καὶ ἀπὸ στομάχους ἀρνῶν τάμε νηλέϊ χαλκῷ·
293 καὶ τοὺς μὲν κατέθηκεν ἐπὶ χθονὸς ἀσπαίροντας
294 θυμοῦ δευομένους· ἀπὸ γὰρ μένος εἵλετο χαλκός.
295 οἶνον δ’ ἐκ κρητῆρος ἀφυσσόμενοι δεπάεσσιν
296 ἔκχεον, ἠδ’ εὔχοντο θεοῖς αἰειγενέτῃσιν.
297 ὣδε δέ τις εἴπεσκεν Ἀχαιῶν τε Τρώων τε·
298 Ζεῦ κύδιστε μέγιστε καὶ ἀθάνατοι θεοὶ ἄλλοι
299 ὁππότεροι πρότεροι ὑπὲρ ὅρκια πημήνειαν
300 ὣδέ σφ’ ἐγκέφαλος χαμάδις ῥέοι ὡς ὅδε οἶνος

3.301

301 αὐτῶν καὶ τεκέων, ἄλοχοι δ’ ἄλλοισι δαμεῖεν.
302 ὣς ἔφαν, οὐδ’ ἄρα πώ σφιν ἐπεκραίαινε Κρονίων.
303 τοῖσι δὲ Δαρδανίδης Πρίαμος μετὰ μῦθον ἔειπε·
304 κέκλυτέ μευ Τρῶες καὶ ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοί·
305 ἤτοι ἐγὼν εἶμι προτὶ Ἴλιον ἠνεμόεσσαν
306 ἄψ, ἐπεὶ οὔ πω τλήσομ’ ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ὁρᾶσθαι

μαρνάμενον φίλον υἱὸν ἀρηϊφίλῳ Μενελάῳ·
Ζεὺς μέν που τό γε οἶδε καὶ ἀθάνατοι θεοὶ ἄλλοι
ὁπποτέρῳ θανάτοιο τέλος πεπρωμένον ἐστίν.
ἦ ῥα καὶ ἐς δίφρον ἄρνας θέτο ἰσόθεος φώς,
ἂν δ’ ἄρ’ ἔβαιν’ αὐτός, κατὰ δ’ ἡνία τεῖνεν ὀπίσσω·
πὰρ δέ οἱ Ἀντήνωρ περικαλλέα βήσετο δίφρον.
τὼ μὲν ἄρ’ ἄψορροι προτὶ Ἴλιον ἀπονέοντο·
Ἕκτωρ δὲ Πριάμοιο πάϊς καὶ δῖος Ὀδυσσεὺς
χῶρον μὲν πρῶτον διεμέτρεον, αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
κλήρους ἐν κυνέῃ χαλκήρεϊ πάλλον ἐλόντες,
ὁππότερος δὴ πρόσθεν ἀφείη χάλκεον ἔγχος.
λαοὶ δ’ ἠρήσαντο, θεοῖσι δὲ χεῖρας ἀνέσχον,
ὧδε δέ τις εἶπεσκεν Ἀχαιῶν τε Τρώων τε·
Ζεῦ πάτερ Ἴδηθεν μεδέων κύδιστε μέγιστε
ὁππότερος τάδε ἔργα μετ’ ἀμφοτέροισιν ἔθηκε,
τὸν δὸς ἀποφθίμενον δῦναι δόμον Ἄϊδος εἴσω,
ἡμῖν δ’ αὖ φιλότητα καὶ ὅρκια πιστὰ γενέσθαι.
ὣς ἄρ’ ἔφαν, πάλλεν δὲ μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ
ἂψ ὀρόων· Πάριος δὲ θοῶς ἐκ κλῆρος ὄρουσεν.
οἳ μὲν ἔπειθ’ ἵζοντο κατὰ στίχας, ἦχι ἑκάστῳ
ἵπποι ἀερσίποδες καὶ ποικίλα τεύχε’ ἔκειτο·
αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἀμφ’ ὤμοισιν ἐδύσετο τεύχεα καλὰ
δῖος Ἀλέξανδρος Ἑλένης πόσις ἠϋκόμοιο.
κνημῖδας μὲν πρῶτα περὶ κνήμῃσιν ἔθηκε
Great Hektor now turned his head aside while he shook the helmet, and the lot of Paris flew out first. The others took their several stations, each by his horses and the place where his arms were lying, while Alexander, husband of lovely Helen, put on his goodly armor. First he greaved his legs with greaves of good make and fitted with ankle-clasps of silver; after this he donned the cuirass of his brother Lykaon, and fitted it to his own body; he hung his silver-studded sword of bronze about his shoulders, and then his mighty shield. On his comely head he set his helmet, well-wrought, with a crest of horse-hair that nodded menacingly above it, and he grasped a redoubtable spear that suited his hands. In like fashion Menelaos also put on his armor. When they had thus armed, each amid his own people, they strode fierce of aspect into the open space, and both Trojans and Achaeans were struck with awe as they beheld them. They stood near one another on the measured ground, brandishing their spears, and each furious against the other. Alexander aimed first, and struck the round shield of the son of Atreus, but the spear did not pierce it, for the shield turned its point. Menelaos next took aim, praying to Father Zeus as he did so. "King Zeus," he said, "grant me revenge on Alexander who has wronged me; subdue him under my hand that in ages yet to come a man may shrink from doing ill deeds in the house of his host." He poised his spear as he spoke, and hurled it at the shield of Alexander. Through shield and cuirass it went, and tore the shirt by his flank, but Alexander swerved aside, and thus saved his life. Then the son of Atreus drew his sword, and drove at the projecting part of his helmet, but the sword fell shivered in three or four pieces from his hand, and he cried, looking towards Heaven, "Father Zeus, of all gods you are the most spiteful; I made sure of my revenge, but the sword has broken in my hand, my spear has been hurled in vain, and I have not killed him." With this he flew at Alexander, caught him by the horsehair plume of his helmet, and began dragging him towards the Achaeans. The strap of the helmet that went under his chin was choking him, and Menelaos would have dragged him off to his own great glory had not Zeus' daughter Aphrodite been quick to mark and to break the strap of oxhide, so that the empty helmet came away in his hand. This he flung to

his comrades among the Achaeans, and was again springing upon Alexander to run him through with a spear, but Aphrodite snatched him up in a moment (as a god can do), hid him under a cloud of darkness, and conveyed him to his own bedchamber. Then she went to call Helen, and found her on a high tower with the Trojan women crowding round her. She took the form of an old woman who used to dress wool for her when she was still in Lacedaemon, and of whom she was very fond. Thus disguised she plucked her by perfumed robe and said, "Come hither; Alexander says you are to go to the house; he is on his bed in his own room, radiant with beauty and dressed in gorgeous apparel. No one would think he had just come from fighting, but rather that he was going to a dance [khoros], or had done dancing [khoros] and was sitting down." With these words she moved the heart of Helen to anger. When she marked the beautiful neck of the goddess, her lovely bosom, and sparkling eyes, she marveled at her and said, "Goddess, why do you thus beguile me? Are you going to send me afield still further to some man whom you have taken up in Phrygia or fair Meonia? Menelaos has just vanquished Alexander, and is to take my hateful self back with him. You are come here to betray me. Go sit with Alexander yourself; henceforth be goddess no longer; never let your feet carry you back to Olympus; worry about him and look after him till he make you his wife, or, for the matter of that, his slave - but me? I shall not go; I can garnish his bed no longer; I should be a by-word among all the women of Troy. Besides, I have trouble [akhos] on my mind." Aphrodite was very angry, and said, "Bold hussy, do not provoke me; if you do, I shall leave you to your fate and hate you as much as I have loved you. I will stir up fierce hatred between Trojans and Achaeans, and you shall come to a bad end."

3.331

καλάς, ἀργυρέοισιν ἐπισφυρίοις ἀραρυίας·
δεύτερον αὖ θώρηκα περὶ στήθεσσιν ἔδυνεν
οἷο κασιγνήτοιο Λυκάονος· ἥρμοσε δ’ αὐτῷ.
ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ ὤμοισιν βάλετο ξίφος ἀργυρόηλον
χάλκεον, αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα σάκος μέγα τε στιβαρόν τε·
κρατὶ δ’ ἐπ’ ἰφθίμῳ κυνέην εὔτυκτον ἔθηκεν
ἵππουριν· δεινὸν δὲ λόφος καθύπερθεν ἔνευεν·
εἵλετο δ’ ἄλκιμον ἔγχος, ὅ οἱ παλάμηφιν ἀρήρει.
ὣς δ’ αὔτως Μενέλαος ἀρήϊος ἔντε’ ἔδυνεν.
οἳ δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν ἑκάτερθεν ὁμίλου θωρήχθησαν,
ἐς μέσσον Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν ἐστιχόωντο
δεινὸν δερκόμενοι· θάμβος δ’ ἔχεν εἰσορόωντας
Τρῶάς θ’ ἱπποδάμους καὶ ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιούς.
καί ῥ’ ἐγγὺς στήτην διαμετρητῷ ἐνὶ χώρῳ
σείοντ’ ἐγχείας ἀλλήλοισιν κοτέοντε.
πρόσθε δ’ Ἀλέξανδρος προΐει δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος,
καὶ βάλεν Ἀτρεΐδαο κατ’ ἀσπίδα πάντοσε ἴσην,
οὐδ’ ἔρρηξεν χαλκός, ἀνεγνάμφθη δέ οἱ αἰχμὴ
ἀσπίδ’ ἐνὶ κρατερῇ· ὃ δὲ δεύτερον ὄρνυτο χαλκῷ
Ἀτρεΐδης Μενέλαος ἐπευξάμενος Διὶ πατρί·
Ζεῦ ἄνα δὸς τίσασθαι ὅ με πρότερος κάκ’ ἔοργε
δῖον Ἀλέξανδρον, καὶ ἐμῇς ὑπὸ χερσὶ δάμασσον,
ὄφρα τις ἐρρίγῃσι καὶ ὀψιγόνων ἀνθρώπων
ξεινοδόκον κακὰ ῥέξαι, ὅ κεν φιλότητα παράσχῃ.
ἦ ῥα καὶ ἀμπεπαλὼν προΐει δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος,
καὶ βάλε Πριαμίδαο κατ’ ἀσπίδα πάντοσε ἴσην·
διὰ μὲν ἀσπίδος ἦλθε φαεινῆς ὄβριμον ἔγχος,

καὶ διὰ θώρηκος πολυδαιδάλου ἠρήρειστο·
ἀντικρὺ δὲ παραὶ λαπάρην διάμησε χιτῶνα
ἔγχος· ὃ δ’ ἐκλίνθη καὶ ἀλεύατο κῆρα μέλαιναν.

3.361

Ἀτρεΐδης δὲ ἐρυσσάμενος ξίφος ἀργυρόηλον
πλῆξεν ἀνασχόμενος κόρυθος φάλον· ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ αὐτῷ
τριχθά τε καὶ τετραχθὰ διατρυφὲν ἔκπεσε χειρός.
Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ὤμωξεν ἰδὼν εἰς οὐρανὸν εὐρύν·
Ζεῦ πάτερ οὔ τις σεῖο θεῶν ὀλοώτερος ἄλλος·
ἦ τ’ ἐφάμην τίσασθαι Ἀλέξανδρον κακότητος·
νῦν δέ μοι ἐν χείρεσσιν ἄγη ξίφος, ἐκ δέ μοι ἔγχος
ἠΐχθη παλάμηφιν ἐτώσιον, οὐδ’ ἔβαλόν μιν.
ἦ καὶ ἐπαΐξας κόρυθος λάβεν ἱπποδασείης,
ἕλκε δ’ ἐπιστρέψας μετ’ ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιούς·
ἄγχε δέ μιν πολύκεστος ἱμὰς ἀπαλὴν ὑπὸ δειρήν,
ὅς οἱ ὑπ’ ἀνθερεῶνος ὀχεὺς τέτατο τρυφαλείης.
καί νύ κεν εἴρυσσέν τε καὶ ἄσπετον ἤρατο κῦδος,
εἰ μὴ ἄρ’ ὀξὺ νόησε Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἀφροδίτη,
ἥ οἱ ῥῆξεν ἱμάντα βοὸς ἶφι κταμένοιο·
κεινὴ δὲ τρυφάλεια ἅμ’ ἕσπετο χειρὶ παχείῃ.
τὴν μὲν ἔπειθ’ ἥρως μετ’ ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιοὺς
ῥῖψ’ ἐπιδινήσας, κόμισαν δ’ ἐρίηρες ἑταῖροι·
αὐτὰρ ὃ ἂψ ἐπόρουσε κατακτάμεναι μενεαίνων
ἔγχεϊ χαλκείῳ· τὸν δ’ ἐξήρπαξ’ Ἀφροδίτη
ῥεῖα μάλ’ ὥς τε θεός, ἐκάλυψε δ’ ἄρ’ ἠέρι πολλῇ,
κὰδ δ’ εἶσ’ ἐν θαλάμῳ εὐώδεϊ κηώεντι.
αὐτὴ δ’ αὖ Ἑλένην καλέουσ’ ἴε· τὴν δὲ κίχανε
πύργῳ ἐφ’ ὑψηλῷ, περὶ δὲ Τρῳαὶ ἅλις ἦσαν·
χειρὶ δὲ νεκταρέου ἑανοῦ ἐτίναξε λαβοῦσα,
γρηῒ δέ μιν ἐϊκυῖα παλαιγενέϊ προσέειπεν
εἰροκόμῳ, ἥ οἱ Λακεδαίμονι ναιετοώσῃ
ἥσκειν εἴρια καλά, μάλιστα δέ μιν φιλέεσκε·
τῇ μιν ἐεισαμένη προσεφώνεε δῖ’ Ἀφροδίτη·
δεῦρ’ ἴθ’· Ἀλέξανδρός σε καλεῖ οἶκον δὲ νέεσθαι.

3.391

κεῖνος ὅ γ’ ἐν θαλάμῳ καὶ δινωτοῖσι λέχεσσι
κάλλεΐ τε στίλβων καὶ εἵμασιν· οὐδέ κε φαίης
ἀνδρὶ μαχεσσάμενον τόν γ’ ἐλθεῖν, ἀλλὰ χορὸν δὲ
ἔρχεσθ’, ἠὲ χοροῖο νέον λήγοντα καθίζειν.
ὣς φάτο, τῇ δ’ ἄρα θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ὄρινε·
καί ῥ’ ὡς οὖν ἐνόησε θεᾶς περικαλλέα δειρὴν
στήθεά θ’ ἱμερόεντα καὶ ὄμματα μαρμαίροντα,
θάμβησέν τ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζε·
δαιμονίη, τί με ταῦτα λιλαίεαι ἠπεροπεύειν;
ἦ πῄ με προτέρω πολίων εὖ ναιομενάων
ἄξεις, ἢ Φρυγίης ἢ Μῃονίης ἐρατεινῆς,
εἴ τίς τοι καὶ κεῖθι φίλος μερόπων ἀνθρώπων·
οὕνεκα δὴ νῦν δῖον Ἀλέξανδρον Μενέλαος

404 νικήσας ἐθέλει στυγερὴν ἐμὲ οἴκαδ’ ἄγεσθαι,
405 τοὔνεκα δὴ νῦν δεῦρο δολοφρονέουσα παρέστης;
406 ἦσο παρ’ αὐτὸν ἰοῦσα, θεῶν δ’ ἀπόεικε κελεύθου,
407 μηδ’ ἔτι σοῖσι πόδεσσιν ὑποστρέψειας Ὄλυμπον,
408 ἀλλ’ αἰεὶ περὶ κεῖνον ὀΐζυε καί ἑ φύλασσε,
409 εἰς ὅ κέ σ’ ἢ ἄλοχον ποιήσεται ἢ ὅ γε δούλην.
410 κεῖσε δ’ ἐγὼν οὐκ εἶμι· νεμεσσητὸν δέ κεν εἴη·
411 κείνου πορσανέουσα λέχος· Τρῳαὶ δέ μ’ ὀπίσσω
412 πᾶσαι μωμήσονται· ἔχω δ’ ἄχε’ ἄκριτα θυμῷ.
413 τὴν δὲ χολωσαμένη προσεφώνεε δῖ’ Ἀφροδίτη·
414 μή μ’ ἔρεθε σχετλίη, μὴ χωσαμένη σε μεθείω,
415 τὼς δέ σ’ ἀπεχθήρω ὡς νῦν ἔκπαγλ’ ἐφίλησα,
416 μέσσῳ δ’ ἀμφοτέρων μητίσομαι ἔχθεα λυγρὰ
417 Τρώων καὶ Δαναῶν, σὺ δέ κεν κακὸν οἶτον ὄληαι.
418 ὣς ἔφατ’, ἔδεισεν δ’ Ἑλένη Διὸς ἐκγεγαυῖα,
419 βῆ δὲ κατασχομένη ἐανῷ ἀργῆτι φαεινῷ
420 σιγῇ, πάσας δὲ Τρῳὰς λάθεν· ἦρχε δὲ δαίμων.
At this Helen was frightened. She wrapped her mantle about her and went in silence, following the divinity [daimôn] and unnoticed by the Trojan women. When they came to the house of Alexander the maid-servants set about their work, but Helen went into her own room, and the laughter-loving goddess took a seat and set it for her facing Alexander. On this Helen, daughter of aegis-bearing Zeus, sat down, and with eyes askance began to upbraid her husband. "So you are come from the fight," said she; "would that you had fallen rather by the hand of that brave man who was my husband. You used to brag that you were a better man with might [biê] of hands and spear than Menelaos. Go, then, and challenge him again - but I would advise you not to do so, for if you are foolish enough to meet him in single combat, you will soon fall by his spear." And Paris answered, "Woman, do not vex me with your reproaches. This time, with the help of Athena, Menelaos has vanquished me; another time I may myself be victor, for I too have gods that will stand by me. Come, let us lie down together and make friends. Never yet was I so passionately enamored of you as at this moment - not even when I first carried you off from Lacedaemon and sailed away with you - not even when I had converse with you upon the couch of love in the island of Cranae was I so enthralled by desire of you as now." On this he led her towards the bed, and his wife went with him. Thus they laid themselves on the bed together; but the son of Atreus strode among the throng, looking everywhere for Alexander, and no man, neither of the Trojans nor of the allies, could find him. If they had seen him they were in no mind to hide him, for they all of them hated him as they did death itself. Then Agamemnon, king of men, spoke, saying, "Hear me, Trojans, Dardanians, and allies. The victory has been with Menelaos; therefore give back Helen with all her wealth, and pay such fine [timê] as shall be agreed upon, in testimony among them that shall be born hereafter." Thus spoke the son of Atreus, and the Achaeans shouted in approval.

3.421

421 αἳ δ’ ὅτ’ Ἀλεξάνδροιο δόμον περικαλλέ’ ἵκοντο,
422 ἀμφίπολοι μὲν ἔπειτα θοῶς ἐπὶ ἔργα τράποντο,
423 ἣ δ’ εἰς ὑψόροφον θάλαμον κίε δῖα γυναικῶν.
424 τῇ δ’ ἄρα δίφρον ἐλοῦσα φιλομειδὴς Ἀφροδίτη
425 ἀντί’ Ἀλεξάνδροιο θεὰ κατέθηκε φέρουσα·
426 ἔνθα κάθιζ’ Ἑλένη κούρη Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο
427 ὄσσε πάλιν κλίνασα, πόσιν δ’ ἠνίπαπε μύθῳ·
428 ἦλυθες ἐκ πολέμου· ὡς ὤφελες αὐτόθ’ ὀλέσθαι

ἀνδρὶ δαμεὶς κρατερῷ, ὃς ἐμὸς πρότερος πόσις ἦεν.
ἦ μὲν δὴ πρίν γ’ εὔχε’ ἀρηϊφίλου Μενελάου
σῇ τε βίῃ καὶ χερσὶ καὶ ἔγχεϊ φέρτερος εἶναι·
ἀλλ’ ἴθι νῦν προκάλεσσαι ἀρηΐφιλον Μενέλαον
ἐξαῦτις μαχέσασθαι ἐναντίον· ἀλλά σ’ ἔγωγε
παύεσθαι κέλομαι, μηδὲ ξανθῷ Μενελάῳ
ἀντίβιον πόλεμον πολεμίζειν ἠδὲ μάχεσθαι
ἀφραδέως, μή πως τάχ’ ὑπ’ αὐτοῦ δουρὶ δαμήῃς.
τὴν δὲ Πάρις μύθοισιν ἀμειβόμενος προσέειπε·
μή με γύναι χαλεποῖσιν ὀνείδεσι θυμὸν ἔνιπτε·
νῦν μὲν γὰρ Μενέλαος ἐνίκησεν σὺν Ἀθήνῃ,
κεῖνον δ’ αὖτις ἐγώ· πάρα γὰρ θεοί εἰσι καὶ ἡμῖν.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ φιλότητι τραπείομεν εὐνηθέντε·
οὐ γάρ πώ ποτέ μ’ ὧδέ γ’ ἔρως φρένας ἀμφεκάλυψεν,
οὐδ’ ὅτε σε πρῶτον Λακεδαίμονος ἐξ ἐρατεινῆς
ἔπλεον ἁρπάξας ἐν ποντοπόροισι νέεσσι,
νήσῳ δ’ ἐν Κραναῇ ἐμίγην φιλότητι καὶ εὐνῇ,
ὥς σεο νῦν ἔραμαι καί με γλυκὺς ἵμερος αἱρεῖ.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἄρχε λέχος δὲ κιών· ἅμα δ’ εἵπετ’ ἄκοιτις.
τὼ μὲν ἄρ’ ἐν τρητοῖσι κατεύνασθεν λεχέεσσιν,
Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ἀν’ ὅμιλον ἐφοίτα θηρὶ ἐοικὼς
εἴ που ἐσαθρήσειεν Ἀλέξανδρον θεοειδέα.

3.451

ἀλλ’ οὔ τις δύνατο Τρώων κλειτῶν τ’ ἐπικούρων
δεῖξαι Ἀλέξανδρον τότ’ ἀρηϊφίλῳ Μενελάῳ·
οὐ μὲν γὰρ φιλότητί γ’ ἐκεύθανον εἴ τις ἴδοιτο·
ἶσον γάρ σφιν πᾶσιν ἀπήχθετο κηρὶ μελαίνῃ.
τοῖσι δὲ καὶ μετέειπεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
κέκλυτέ μευ Τρῶες καὶ Δάρδανοι ἠδ’ ἐπίκουροι·
νίκη μὲν δὴ φαίνετ’ ἀρηϊφίλου Μενελάου,
ὑμεῖς δ’ Ἀργείην Ἑλένην καὶ κτήματ’ ἄμ’ αὐτῇ
ἔκδοτε, καὶ τιμὴν ἀποτινέμεν ἥν τιν’ ἔοικεν,
ἥ τε καὶ ἐσσομένοισι μετ’ ἀνθρώποισι πέληται.
ὣς ἔφατ’ Ἀτρεΐδης, ἐπὶ δ’ ἤνεον ἄλλοι Ἀχαιοί.

4.1

οἳ δὲ θεοὶ πὰρ Ζηνὶ καθήμενοι ἠγορόωντο
χρυσέῳ ἐν δαπέδῳ, μετὰ δέ σφισι πότνια Ἥβη
νέκταρ ἐοινοχόει· τοὶ δὲ χρυσέοις δεπάεσσι
δειδέχατ’ ἀλλήλους, Τρώων πόλιν εἰσορόωντες·
αὐτίκ’ ἐπειρᾶτο Κρονίδης ἐρεθιζέμεν Ἥρην
κερτομίοις ἐπέεσσι παραβλήδην ἀγορεύων·
δοιαὶ μὲν Μενελάῳ ἀρηγόνες εἰσὶ θεάων
Ἥρη τ’ Ἀργείη καὶ Ἀλαλκομενηΐς Ἀθήνη.
ἀλλ’ ἤτοι ταὶ νόσφι καθήμεναι εἰσορόωσαι
τέρπεσθον· τῷ δ’ αὖτε φιλομειδὴς Ἀφροδίτη
αἰεὶ παρμέμβλωκε καὶ αὐτοῦ κῆρας ἀμύνει·
καὶ νῦν ἐξεσάωσεν ὀϊόμενον θανέεσθαι.
ἀλλ’ ἤτοι νίκη μὲν ἀρηϊφίλου Μενελάου·

14 ἡμεῖς δὲ φραζώμεθ’ ὅπως ἔσται τάδε ἔργα,
15 ἤ ῥ’ αὖτις πόλεμόν τε κακὸν καὶ φύλοπιν αἰνὴν
16 ὄρσομεν, ἦ φιλότητα μετ’ ἀμφοτέροισι βάλωμεν.
17 εἰ δ’ αὖ πως τόδε πᾶσι φίλον καὶ ἠδὺ γένοιτο,
18 ἤτοι μὲν οἰκέοιτο πόλις Πριάμοιο ἄνακτος,
19 αὖτις δ’ Ἀργείην Ἑλένην Μενέλαος ἄγοιτο.
20 ὣς ἔφαθ’, αἳ δ’ ἐπέμυξαν Ἀθηναίη τε καὶ Ἥρη·
21 πλησίαι αἵ γ’ ἧσθην, κακὰ δὲ Τρώεσσι μεδέσθην.
22 ἤτοι Ἀθηναίη ἀκέων ἦν οὐδέ τι εἶπε
23 σκυζομένη Διὶ πατρί, χόλος δέ μιν ἄγριος ἦρει·
24 Ἥρῃ δ’ οὐκ ἔχαδε στῆθος χόλον, ἀλλὰ προσηύδα·
25 αἰνότατε Κρονίδη ποῖον τὸν μῦθον ἔειπες·
26 πῶς ἐθέλεις ἄλιον θεῖναι πόνον ἠδ’ ἀτέλεστον,
27 ἱδρῶ θ’ ὃν ἵδρωσα μόγῳ, καμέτην δέ μοι ἵπποι
28 λαὸν ἀγειρούσῃ, Πριάμῳ κακὰ τοῖό τε παισίν.
29 ἔρδ’· ἀτὰρ οὔ τοι πάντες ἐπαινέομεν θεοὶ ἄλλοι.
30 τὴν δὲ μέγ’ ὀχθήσας προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
Now the gods were sitting with Zeus in council upon the golden floor while Hebe went round pouring out nectar for them to drink, and as they pledged one another in their cups of gold they looked down upon the town of Troy. The son of Kronos then began to tease Hera, talking at her so as to provoke her. "Menelaos," said he, "has two good friends among the goddesses, Hera of Argos, and Athena of Alalkomene, but they only sit still and look on, while Aphrodite keeps ever by Alexander's side to defend him in any danger; indeed she has just rescued him when he made sure that it was all over with him - for the victory really did lie with Menelaos. We must consider what we shall do about all this; shall we set them fighting anew or make peace between them? If you will agree to this last Menelaos can take back Helen and the city of Priam may remain still inhabited." Athena and Hera muttered their discontent as they sat side by side hatching mischief for the Trojans. Athena scowled at her father, for she was in a furious passion with him, and said nothing, but Hera could not contain herself. "Dread son of Kronos," said she, "what, pray, is the meaning of all this? Is my trouble [ponos], then, to go for nothing, and the sweat that I have sweated, to say nothing of my horses, while getting the people together against Priam and his children? Do as you will, but we other gods shall not all of us approve your counsel." Zeus was angry and answered, "My dear, what harm have Priam and his sons done you that you are so hotly bent on sacking the city of Ilion? Will nothing do for you but you must within their walls and eat Priam raw, with his sons and all the other Trojans to boot? Have it your own way then; for I would not have this matter become a bone of contention between us. I say further, and lay my saying to your heart, if ever I want to sack a city belonging to friends of yours, you must not try to stop me; you will have to let me do it, for I am giving in to you sorely against my will. Of all inhabited cities under the sun and stars of heaven, there was none that I so much respected as Ilion with Priam and his whole people. Equitable feasts were never wanting about my altar, nor the savor of burning fat, which is honor due to ourselves." "My own three favorite cities," answered Hera, "are Argos, Sparta, and Mycenae. Sack them whenever you may be displeased with them. I shall not defend them and I shall not care. Even if I did, and tried to stay you, I should take nothing by it, for you are much stronger than I am, but I will not have my own work wasted. I too am a god and of the same race with yourself. I am Kronos' eldest daughter, and am honorable not on this ground only, but also because I am your wife, and you are king over the gods. Let it be a case, then, of give-and-take between us, and the rest of the gods will follow our lead. Tell Athena to go and take part in the fight at once, and let her contrive that the Trojans shall be the first to break their oaths and set upon the Achaeans." The sire of gods and men heeded her words, and

said to Athena, "Go at once into the Trojan and Achaean hosts, and contrive that the Trojans shall be the first to break their oaths and set upon the Achaeans." This was what Athena was already eager to do, so down she darted from the topmost summits of Olympus. She shot through the sky as some brilliant meteor which the son of scheming Kronos has sent as a sign to mariners or to some great army, and a fiery train of light follows in its wake. The Trojans and Achaeans were struck with awe as they beheld, and one would turn to his neighbor, saying, "Either we shall again have war and din of combat, or Zeus the lord of battle will now make peace between us." Thus did they converse. Then Athena took the form of Laodokos, son of Antenor, and went through the ranks of the Trojans to find Pandaros, the redoubtable son of Lykaon. She found him standing among the stalwart heroes who had followed him from the banks of the Aesepos, so she went close up to him and said, "Brave son of Lykaon, will you do as I tell you? If you dare send an arrow at Menelaos you will win honor and thanks [kharis] from all the Trojans, and especially from prince Alexander - he would be the first to requite you very handsomely if he could see Menelaos mount his funeral pyre, slain by an arrow from your hand. Take your home aim then, and pray to Lycian Apollo, the famous archer; vow that when you get home to your strong city of Zelea you will offer a hecatomb of firstling lambs in his honor."

4.31

31 δαιμονίη τί νύ σε Πρίαμος Πριάμοιό τε παῖδες
32 τόσσα κακὰ ῥέζουσιν, ὅ τ’ ἀσπερχὲς μενεαίνεις
33 Ἰλίου ἐξαλαπάξαι ἐϋκτίμενον πτολίεθρον;
34 εἰ δὲ σύ γ’ εἰσελθοῦσα πύλας καὶ τείχεα μακρὰ
35 ὠμὸν βεβρώθοις Πρίαμον Πριάμοιό τε παῖδας
36 ἄλλους τε Τρῶας, τότε κεν χόλον ἐξακέσαιο.
37 ἔρξον ὅπως ἐθέλεις· μὴ τοῦτό γε νεῖκος ὀπίσσω
38 σοὶ καὶ ἐμοὶ μέγ’ ἔρισμα μετ’ ἀμφοτέροισι γένηται.
39 ἄλλο δέ τοι ἐρέω, σὺ δ’ ἐνὶ φρεσὶ βάλλεο σῇσιν·
40 ὁππότε κεν καὶ ἐγὼ μεμαὼς πόλιν ἐξαλαπάξαι
41 τὴν ἐθέλω ὄθι τοι φίλοι ἀνέρες ἐγγεγάασι,
42 μή τι διατρίβειν τὸν ἐμὸν χόλον, ἀλλά μ’ ἐᾶσαι·
43 καὶ γὰρ ἐγὼ σοὶ δῶκα ἑκὼν ἀέκοντί γε θυμῷ·
44 αἳ γὰρ ὑπ’ ἠελίῳ τε καὶ οὐρανῷ ἀστερόεντι
45 ναιετάουσι πόληες ἐπιχθονίων ἀνθρώπων,
46 τάων μοι περὶ κῆρι τιέσκετο Ἴλιος ἱρὴ
47 καὶ Πρίαμος καὶ λαὸς ἐϋμμελίω Πριάμοιο.
48 οὐ γάρ μοί ποτε βωμὸς ἐδεύετο δαιτὸς ἐΐσης
49 λοιβῆς τε κνίσης τε· τὸ γὰρ λάχομεν γέρας ἡμεῖς.
50 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη·
51 ἤτοι ἐμοὶ τρεῖς μὲν πολὺ φίλταταί εἰσι πόληες
52 Ἄργός τε Σπάρτη τε καὶ εὐρυάγυια Μυκήνη·
53 τὰς διαπέρσαι ὅτ’ ἄν τοι ἀπέχθωνται περὶ κῆρι·
54 τάων οὔ τοι ἐγὼ πρόσθ’ ἵσταμαι οὐδὲ μεγαίρω.
55 εἴ περ γὰρ φθονέω τε καὶ οὐκ εἰῶ διαπέρσαι,
56 οὐκ ἀνύω φθονέουσ’ ἐπεὶ ἦ πολὺ φέρτερός ἐσσι.
57 ἀλλὰ χρὴ καὶ ἐμὸν θέμεναι πόνον οὐκ ἀτέλεστον·
58 καὶ γὰρ ἐγὼ θεός εἰμι, γένος δέ μοι ἔνθεν ὅθεν σοί,
59 καί με πρεσβυτάτην τέκετο Κρόνος ἀγκυλομήτης,
60 ἀμφότερον γενεῇ τε καὶ οὕνεκα σὴ παράκοιτις

4.61

κέκλημαι, σὺ δὲ πᾶσι μετ’ ἀθανάτοισιν ἀνάσσεις.
ἀλλ’ ἤτοι μὲν ταῦθ’ ὑποείξομεν ἀλλήλοισι,
σοὶ μὲν ἐγώ, σὺ δ’ ἐμοί· ἐπὶ δ’ ἕψονται θεοὶ ἄλλοι
ἀθάνατοι· σὺ δὲ θᾶσσον Ἀθηναίῃ ἐπιτεῖλαι
ἐλθεῖν ἐς Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν φύλοπιν αἰνήν,
πειρᾶν δ’ ὥς κε Τρῶες ὑπερκύδαντας Ἀχαιοὺς
ἄρξωσι πρότεροι ὑπὲρ ὅρκια δηλήσασθαι.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε·
αὐτίκ’ Ἀθηναίην ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
αἶψα μάλ’ ἐς στρατὸν ἐλθὲ μετὰ Τρῶας καὶ Ἀχαιούς,
πειρᾶν δ’ ὥς κε Τρῶες ὑπερκύδαντας Ἀχαιοὺς
ἄρξωσι πρότεροι ὑπὲρ ὅρκια δηλήσασθαι.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε πάρος μεμαυῖαν Ἀθήνην,
βῆ δὲ κατ’ Οὐλύμποιο καρήνων ἀΐξασα.
οἷον δ’ ἀστέρα ἧκε Κρόνου πάϊς ἀγκυλομήτεω
ἢ ναύτῃσι τέρας ἠὲ στρατῷ εὐρέϊ λαῶν
λαμπρόν· τοῦ δέ τε πολλοὶ ἀπὸ σπινθῆρες ἵενται·
τῷ ἐϊκυῖ’ ἤϊξεν ἐπὶ χθόνα Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη,
κὰδ δ’ ἔθορ’ ἐς μέσσον· θάμβος δ’ ἔχεν εἰσορόωντας
Τρῶάς θ’ ἱπποδάμους καὶ ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιούς·
ὧδε δέ τις εἶπεσκεν ἰδὼν ἐς πλησίον ἄλλον·
ἦ ῥ’ αὖτις πόλεμός τε κακὸς καὶ φύλοπις αἰνὴ
ἔσσεται, ἢ φιλότητα μετ’ ἀμφοτέροισι τίθησι
Ζεύς, ὅς τ’ ἀνθρώπων ταμίης πολέμοιο τέτυκται.
ὣς ἄρα τις εἶπεσκεν Ἀχαιῶν τε Τρώων τε.
ἢ δ’ ἀνδρὶ ἰκέλη Τρώων κατεδύσεθ’ ὅμιλον
Λαοδόκῳ Ἀντηνορίδῃ κρατερῷ αἰχμητῇ,
Πάνδαρον ἀντίθεον διζημένη εἴ που ἐφεύροι.
εὗρε Λυκάονος υἱὸν ἀμύμονά τε κρατερόν τε
ἑσταότ’· ἀμφὶ δέ μιν κρατεραὶ στίχες ἀσπιστάων

4.91

λαῶν, οἵ οἱ ἕποντο ἀπ’ Αἰσήποιο ῥοάων·
ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱσταμένη ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
ἦ ῥά νύ μοί τι πίθοιο Λυκάονος υἱὲ δαΐφρον.
τλαίης κεν Μενελάῳ ἐπιπροέμεν ταχὺν ἰόν,
πᾶσι δέ κε Τρώεσσι χάριν καὶ κῦδος ἄροιο,
ἐκ πάντων δὲ μάλιστα Ἀλεξάνδρῳ βασιλῆϊ.
τοῦ κεν δὴ πάμπρωτα παρ’ ἀγλαὰ δῶρα φέροιο,
αἴ κεν ἴδῃ Μενέλαον ἀρήϊον Ἀτρέος υἱὸν
σῷ βέλεϊ δμηθέντα πυρῆς ἐπιβάντ’ ἀλεγεινῆς.
ἀλλ’ ἄγ’ ὀΐστευσον Μενελάου κυδαλίμοιο,
εὔχεο δ’ Ἀπόλλωνι Λυκηγενέϊ κλυτοτόξῳ
ἀρνῶν πρωτογόνων ῥέξειν κλειτὴν ἑκατόμβην
οἴκαδε νοστήσας ἱερῆς εἰς ἄστυ Ζελείης.
ὣς φάτ’ Ἀθηναίη, τῷ δὲ φρένας ἄφρονι πεῖθεν·
αὐτίκ’ ἐσύλα τόξον ἐΰξοον ἰξάλου αἰγὸς
ἀγρίου, ὅν ῥά ποτ’ αὐτὸς ὑπὸ στέρνοιο τυχήσας
πέτρης ἐκβαίνοντα δεδεγμένος ἐν προδοκῇσι
βεβλήκει πρὸς στῆθος· ὃ δ’ ὕπτιος ἔμπεσε πέτρῃ.

109 τοῦ κέρα ἐκ κεφαλῆς ἐκκαιδεκάδωρα πεφύκει·
110 καὶ τὰ μὲν ἀσκήσας κεραοξόος ἤραρε τέκτων,
111 πᾶν δ’ εὖ λειήνας χρυσέην ἐπέθηκε κορώνην.
112 καὶ τὸ μὲν εὖ κατέθηκε τανυσσάμενος ποτὶ γαίῃ
113 ἀγκλίνας· πρόσθεν δὲ σάκεα σχέθον ἐσθλοὶ ἑταῖροι
114 μὴ πρὶν ἀναΐξειαν ἀρήϊοι υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
115 πρὶν βλῆσθαι Μενέλαον ἀρήϊον Ἀτρέος υἱόν.
116 αὐτὰρ ὁ σύλα πῶμα φαρέτρης, ἐκ δ’ ἕλετ’ ἰὸν
117 ἀβλῆτα πτερόεντα μελαινέων ἔρμ’ ὀδυνάων·
118 αἶψα δ’ ἐπὶ νευρῇ κατεκόσμει πικρὸν ὀϊστόν,
119 εὔχετο δ’ Ἀπόλλωνι Λυκηγενέϊ κλυτοτόξῳ
120 ἀρνῶν πρωτογόνων ῥέξειν κλειτὴν ἑκατόμβην
His fool's heart was persuaded, and he took his bow from its case. This bow was made from the horns of a wild ibex which he had killed as it was bounding from a rock; he had stalked it, and it had fallen as the arrow struck it to the heart. Its horns were sixteen palms long, and a worker in horn had made them into a bow, smoothing them well down, and giving them tips of gold. When Pandaros had strung his bow he laid it carefully on the ground, and his brave followers held their shields before him lest the Achaeans should set upon him before he had shot Menelaos. Then he opened the lid of his quiver and took out a winged arrow that had yet been shot, fraught with the pangs of death. He laid the arrow on the string and prayed to Lycian Apollo, the famous archer, vowing that when he got home to his strong city of Zelea he would offer a hecatomb of firstling lambs in his honor. He laid the notch of the arrow on the oxhide bowstring, and drew both notch and string to his breast till the arrow-head was near the bow; then when the bow was arched into a half-circle he let fly, and the bow twanged, and the string sang as the arrow flew gladly on over the heads of the throng. But the blessed gods did not forget you, O Menelaos, and Zeus' daughter, driver of the spoil, was the first to stand before you and ward off the piercing arrow. She turned it from his skin as a mother whisks a fly from off her child when it is sleeping sweetly; she guided it to the part where the golden buckles of the belt that passed over his double cuirass were fastened, so the arrow struck the belt that went tightly round him. It went right through this and through the cuirass of cunning workmanship; it also pierced the belt beneath it, which he wore next his skin to keep out darts or arrows; it was this that served him in the best stead, nevertheless the arrow went through it and grazed the top of the skin, so that blood began flowing from the wound. As when some woman of Meonia or Caria strains purple dye on to a piece of ivory that is to be the cheek-piece of a horse, and is to be laid up in a treasure house - many a horseman is fain to bear it, but the king keeps it as an ornament [kosmos] of which both horse and driver may be proud - even so, O Menelaos, were your shapely thighs and your legs down to your fair ankles stained with blood. When King Agamemnon saw the blood flowing from the wound he was afraid, and so was brave Menelaos himself till he saw that the barbs of the arrow and the thread that bound the arrow-head to the shaft were still outside the wound. Then he took heart, but Agamemnon heaved a deep sigh as he held Menelaos' hand in his own, and his comrades made moan in concert. "Dear brother, "he cried, "I have been the death of you in pledging this covenant and letting you come forward as our champion. The Trojans have trampled on their oaths and have wounded you; nevertheless the oath, the blood of lambs, the drink-offerings and the right hands of fellowship in which have put our trust shall not be vain. If he that rules Olympus fulfill it not here and now, he. will yet fulfill it hereafter, and they shall pay dearly with their lives and with their wives and children. The day will surely come when mighty Ilion shall be laid low, with Priam and Priam's people, when the son of Kronos from his high throne shall overshadow them with his awful aegis in punishment of their present treachery. This shall surely be; but how, Menelaos, shall I feel grief [akhos] for you,

if it be your lot now to die? I should return to Argos as a by-word, for the Achaeans will at once go home. We shall leave Priam and the Trojans the glory of still keeping Helen, and the earth will rot your bones as you lie here at Troy with your purpose not fulfilled. Then shall some braggart Trojan leap upon your tomb and say, ‘Ever thus may Agamemnon wreak his vengeance; he brought his army in vain; he is gone home to his own land with empty ships, and has left Menelaos behind him.’ Thus will one of them say, and may the earth then swallow me." But Menelaos reassured him and said, "Take heart, and do not alarm the people; the arrow has not struck me in a mortal part, for my outer belt of burnished metal first stayed it, and under this my cuirass and the belt of mail which the bronze-smiths made me." And Agamemnon answered, "I trust, dear Menelaos, that it may be even so, but the surgeon shall examine your wound and lay herbs upon it to relieve your pain."

4.121

οἴκαδε νοστήσας ἱερῆς εἰς ἄστυ Ζελείης.
ἕλκε δ’ ὁμοῦ γλυφίδας τε λαβὼν καὶ νεῦρα βόεια·
νευρὴν μὲν μαζῷ πέλασεν, τόξῳ δὲ σίδηρον.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ κυκλοτερὲς μέγα τόξον ἔτεινε,
λίγξε βιός, νευρὴ δὲ μέγ’ ἴαχεν, ἆλτο δ’ ὀϊστὸς
ὀξυβελὴς καθ’ ὅμιλον ἐπιπτέσθαι μενεαίνων.
οὐδὲ σέθεν Μενέλαε θεοὶ μάκαρες λελάθοντο
ἀθάνατοι, πρώτη δὲ Διὸς θυγάτηρ ἀγελείη,
ἥ τοι πρόσθε στᾶσα βέλος ἐχεπευκὲς ἄμυνεν.
ἣ δὲ τόσον μὲν ἔεργεν ἀπὸ χροὸς ὡς ὅτε μήτηρ
παιδὸς ἐέργῃ μυῖαν ὅθ’ ἡδέϊ λέξεται ὕπνῳ,
αὐτὴ δ’ αὖτ’ ἴθυνεν ὅθι ζωστῆρος ὀχῆες
χρύσειοι σύνεχον καὶ διπλόος ἤντετο θώρηξ.
ἐν δ’ ἔπεσε ζωστῆρι ἀρηρότι πικρὸς ὀϊστός·
διὰ μὲν ἂρ ζωστῆρος ἐλήλατο δαιδαλέοιο,
καὶ διὰ θώρηκος πολυδαιδάλου ἠρήρειστο
μίτρης θ’, ἣν ἐφόρει ἔρυμα χροὸς ἔρκος ἀκόντων,
ἥ οἱ πλεῖστον ἔρυτο· διὰ πρὸ δὲ εἴσατο καὶ τῆς.
ἀκρότατον δ’ ἄρ’ ὀϊστὸς ἐπέγραψε χρόα φωτός·
αὐτίκα δ’ ἔρρεεν αἷμα κελαινεφὲς ἐξ ὠτειλῆς.
ὡς δ’ ὅτε τίς τ’ ἐλέφαντα γυνὴ φοίνικι μιήνῃ
Μῃονὶς ἠὲ Κάειρα παρήϊον ἔμμεναι ἵππων·
κεῖται δ’ ἐν θαλάμῳ, πολέες τέ μιν ἠρήσαντο
ἱππῆες φορέειν· βασιλῆϊ δὲ κεῖται ἄγαλμα,
ἀμφότερον κόσμός θ’ ἵππῳ ἐλατῆρί τε κῦδος·
τοῖοί τοι Μενέλαε μιάνθην αἵματι μηροὶ
εὐφυέες κνῆμαί τε ἰδὲ σφυρὰ κάλ’ ὑπένερθε.
ῥίγησεν δ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων
ὡς εἶδεν μέλαν αἷμα καταρρέον ἐξ ὠτειλῆς·
ῥίγησεν δὲ καὶ αὐτὸς ἀρηΐφιλος Μενέλαος.

4.151

ὡς δὲ ἴδεν νεῦρόν τε καὶ ὄγκους ἐκτὸς ἐόντας
ἄψορρόν οἱ θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἀγέρθη.
τοῖς δὲ βαρὺ στενάχων μετέφη κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
χειρὸς ἔχων Μενέλαον, ἐπεστενάχοντο δ’ ἑταῖροι·

φίλε κασίγνητε θάνατόν νύ τοι ὅρκι’ ἔταμνον
οἷον προστήσας πρὸ Ἀχαιῶν Τρωσὶ μάχεσθαι,
ὥς σ’ ἔβαλον Τρῶες, κατὰ δ’ ὅρκια πιστὰ πάτησαν.
οὐ μέν πως ἅλιον πέλει ὅρκιον αἷμά τε ἀρνῶν
σπονδαί τ’ ἄκρητοι καὶ δεξιαὶ ᾗς ἐπέπιθμεν.
εἴ περ γάρ τε καὶ αὐτίκ’ Ὀλύμπιος οὐκ ἐτέλεσσεν,
ἕκ τε καὶ ὀψὲ τελεῖ, σύν τε μεγάλῳ ἀπέτισαν
σὺν σφῇσιν κεφαλῇσι γυναιξί τε καὶ τεκέεσσιν.
εὖ γὰρ ἐγὼ τόδε οἶδα κατὰ φρένα καὶ κατὰ θυμόν·
ἔσσεται ἦμαρ ὅτ’ ἄν ποτ’ ὀλώλῃ Ἴλιος ἰρὴ
καὶ Πρίαμος καὶ λαὸς ἐϋμμελίω Πριάμοιο,
Ζεὺς δέ σφι Κρονίδης ὑψίζυγος αἰθέρι ναίων
αὐτὸς ἐπισσείῃσιν ἐρεμνὴν αἰγίδα πᾶσι
τῆσδ’ ἀπάτης κοτέων· τὰ μὲν ἔσσεται οὐκ ἀτέλεστα·
ἀλλά μοι αἰνὸν ἄχος σέθεν ἔσσεται ὦ Μενέλαε
αἴ κε θάνῃς καὶ πότμον ἀναπλήσῃς βιότοιο.
καί κεν ἐλέγχιστος πολυδίψιον Ἄργος ἱκοίμην·
αὐτίκα γὰρ μνήσονται Ἀχαιοὶ πατρίδος αἴης·
κὰδ δέ κεν εὐχωλὴν Πριάμῳ καὶ Τρωσὶ λίποιμεν
Ἀργείην Ἑλένην· σέο δ’ ὀστέα πύσει ἄρουρα
κειμένου ἐν Τροίῃ ἀτελευτήτῳ ἐπὶ ἔργῳ.
καί κέ τις ὧδ’ ἐρέει Τρώων ὑπερηνορεόντων
τύμβῳ ἐπιθρῴσκων Μενελάου κυδαλίμοιο·
αἴθ’ οὕτως ἐπὶ πᾶσι χόλον τελέσει’ Ἀγαμέμνων,
ὡς καὶ νῦν ἅλιον στρατὸν ἤγαγεν ἐνθάδ’ Ἀχαιῶν,
καὶ δὴ ἔβη οἶκον δὲ φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν

4.181

σὺν κεινῇσιν νηυσὶ λιπὼν ἀγαθὸν Μενέλαον.
ὥς ποτέ τις ἐρέει· τότε μοι χάνοι εὐρεῖα χθών.
τὸν δ’ ἐπιθαρσύνων προσέφη ξανθὸς Μενέλαος·
θάρσει, μηδέ τί πω δειδίσσεο λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν·
οὐκ ἐν καιρίῳ ὀξὺ πάγη βέλος, ἀλλὰ πάροιθεν
εἰρύσατο ζωστήρ τε παναίολος ἠδ’ ὑπένερθε
ζῶμά τε καὶ μίτρη, τὴν χαλκῆες κάμον ἄνδρες.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων·
αἴ γὰρ δὴ οὕτως εἴη φίλος ὦ Μενέλαε·
ἕλκος δ’ ἰητὴρ ἐπιμάσσεται ἠδ’ ἐπιθήσει
φάρμαχ’ ἅ κεν παύσῃσι μελαινάων ὀδυνάων.
ἦ καὶ Ταλθύβιον θεῖον κήρυκα προσηύδα·
Ταλθύβι’ ὅττι τάχιστα Μαχάονα δεῦρο κάλεσσον
φῶτ’ Ἀσκληπιοῦ υἱὸν ἀμύμονος ἰητῆρος,
ὄφρα ἴδῃ Μενέλαον ἀρήϊον Ἀτρέος υἱόν,
ὅν τις ὀϊστεύσας ἔβαλεν τόξων ἐὺ εἰδὼς
Τρώων ἢ Λυκίων, τῷ μὲν κλέος, ἄμμι δὲ πένθος.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἄρα οἱ κῆρυξ ἀπίθησεν ἀκούσας,
βῆ δ’ ἰέναι κατὰ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων
παπταίνων ἥρωα Μαχάονα· τὸν δὲ νόησεν
ἑσταότ’· ἀμφὶ δέ μιν κρατεραὶ στίχες ἀσπιστάων
λαῶν, οἵ οἱ ἕποντο Τρίκης ἐξ ἱπποβότοιο.
ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱστάμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·

204 ὄρσ’ Ἀσκληπιάδη, καλέει κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων,
205 ὄφρα ἴδῃς Μενέλαον ἀρήϊον ἀρχὸν Ἀχαιῶν,
206 ὅν τις ὀϊστεύσας ἔβαλεν τόξων ἐὺ εἰδὼς
207 Τρώων ἢ Λυκίων, τῷ μὲν κλέος, ἄμμι δὲ πένθος.
208 ὣς φάτο, τῷ δ’ ἄρα θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ὄρινε·
209 βὰν δ’ ἰέναι καθ’ ὅμιλον ἀνὰ στρατὸν εὐρὺν Ἀχαιῶν.
210 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἵκανον ὅθι ξανθὸς Μενέλαος
He then said to Talthybios, "Talthybios, tell Machaon, son to the great physician, Asklepios, to come and see Menelaos immediately. Some Trojan or Lycian archer has wounded him with an arrow to our dismay [penthos], and to his own great glory [kleos]." Talthybios did as he was told, and went about the host trying to find Machaon. Presently he found standing amid the brave warriors who had followed him from Tricca; thereon he went up to him and said, "Son of Asklepios, King Agamemnon says you are to come and see Menelaos immediately. Some Trojan or Lycian archer has wounded him with an arrow to our dismay [penthos] and to his own great glory [kleos]." Thus did he speak, and Machaon was moved to go. They passed through the spreading host of the Achaeans and went on till they came to the place where Menelaos had been wounded and was lying with the chieftains gathered in a circle round him. Machaon passed into the middle of the ring and at once drew the arrow from the belt, bending its barbs back through the force with which he pulled it out. He undid the burnished belt, and beneath this the cuirass and the belt of mail which the bronze-smiths had made; then, when he had seen the wound, he wiped away the blood and applied some soothing drugs which Chiron had given to Asklepios out of the good will he bore him. While they were thus busy about Menelaos, the Trojans came forward against them, for they had put on their armor, and now renewed the fight. You would not have then found Agamemnon asleep nor cowardly and unwilling to fight, but eager rather for the fray. He left his chariot rich with bronze and his panting steeds in charge of the squire [therapôn] Eurymedon, son of Ptolemaios the son of Peiraios, and bade him hold them in readiness against the time his limbs should weary of going about and giving orders to so many, for he went among the ranks on foot. When he saw men hastening to the front he stood by them and cheered them on. "Argives," said he, "slacken not one whit in your onset; father Zeus will be no helper of liars; the Trojans have been the first to break their oaths and to attack us; therefore they shall be devoured of vultures; we shall take their city and carry off their wives and children in our ships." But he angrily rebuked those whom he saw shirking and disinclined to fight. "Argives," he cried, "cowardly miserable creatures, have you no shame to stand here like frightened fawns who, when they can no longer scud over the plain, huddle together, but show no fight? You are as dazed and spiritless as deer. Would you wait till the Trojans reach the sterns of our ships as they lie on the shore, to see, whether the son of Kronos will hold his hand over you to protect you?" Thus did he go about giving his orders among the ranks. Passing through the crowd, he came presently on the Cretans, arming round Idomeneus, who was at their head, fierce as a wild boar, while Meriones was bringing up the battalions that were in the rear. Agamemnon was glad when he saw him, and spoke him fairly. "Idomeneus," said he, "I treat you with greater distinction than I do any others of the Achaeans, whether in war or in other things, or at table. When the princes are mixing my choicest wines in the mixing-bowls, they have each of them a fixed allowance, but your cup is kept always full like my own, that you may drink whenever you are minded. Go, therefore, into battle, and show yourself the man you have been always proud to be."

4.211

211 βλήμενος ἦν, περὶ δ’ αὐτὸν ἀγηγέραθ’ ὅσσοι ἄριστοι
212 κυκλόσ’, ὃ δ’ ἐν μέσσοισι παρίστατο ἰσόθεος φώς,

αὐτίκα δ’ ἐκ ζωστῆρος ἀρηρότος ἕλκεν ὀϊστόν·
τοῦ δ’ ἐξελκομένοιο πάλιν ἄγεν ὀξέες ὄγκοι.
λῦσε δέ οἱ ζωστῆρα παναίολον ἠδ’ ὑπένερθε
ζῶμά τε καὶ μίτρην, τὴν χαλκῆες κάμον ἄνδρες.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ ἴδεν ἕλκος ὅθ’ ἔμπεσε πικρὸς ὀϊστός,
αἷμ’ ἐκμυζήσας ἐπ’ ἄρ’ ἤπια φάρμακα εἰδὼς
πάσσε, τά οἵ ποτε πατρὶ φίλα φρονέων πόρε Χείρων.
ὄφρα τοὶ ἀμφεπένοντο βοὴν ἀγαθὸν Μενέλαον,
τόφρα δ’ ἐπὶ Τρώων στίχες ἤλυθον ἀσπιστάων·
οἳ δ’ αὖτις κατὰ τεύχε’ ἔδυν, μνήσαντο δὲ χάρμης.
ἔνθ’ οὐκ ἂν βρίζοντα ἴδοις Ἀγαμέμνονα δῖον
οὐδὲ καταπτώσσοντ’ οὐδ’ οὐκ ἐθέλοντα μάχεσθαι,
ἀλλὰ μάλα σπεύδοντα μάχην ἐς κυδιάνειραν.
ἵππους μὲν γὰρ ἔασε καὶ ἅρματα ποικίλα χαλκῷ·
καὶ τοὺς μὲν θεράπων ἀπάνευθ’ ἔχε φυσιόωντας
Εὐρυμέδων υἱὸς Πτολεμαίου Πειραΐδαο·
τῷ μάλα πόλλ’ ἐπέτελλε παρισχέμεν ὁππότε κέν μιν
γυῖα λάβῃ κάματος πολέας διὰ κοιρανέοντα·
αὐτὰρ ὃ πεζὸς ἐὼν ἐπεπωλεῖτο στίχας ἀνδρῶν·
καί ῥ’ οὓς μὲν σπεύδοντας ἴδοι Δαναῶν ταχυπώλων,
τοὺς μάλα θαρσύνεσκε παριστάμενος ἐπέεσσιν·
Ἀργεῖοι μή πώ τι μεθίετε θούριδος ἀλκῆς·
οὐ γὰρ ἐπὶ ψευδέσσι πατὴρ Ζεὺς ἔσσετ’ ἀρωγός,
ἀλλ’ οἵ περ πρότεροι ὑπὲρ ὅρκια δηλήσαντο
τῶν ἦτοι αὐτῶν τέρενα χρόα γῦπες ἔδονται,
ἡμεῖς αὖτ’ ἀλόχους τε φίλας καὶ νήπια τέκνα
ἄξομεν ἐν νήεσσιν, ἐπὴν πτολίεθρον ἕλωμεν.
οὔς τινας αὖ μεθιέντας ἴδοι στυγεροῦ πολέμοιο,

4.241

τοὺς μάλα νεικείεσκε χολωτοῖσιν ἐπέεσσιν·
Ἀργεῖοι ἰόμωροι ἐλεγχέες οὔ νυ σέβεσθε;
τίφθ’ οὕτως ἕστητε τεθηπότες ἠΰτε νεβροί,
αἵ τ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν ἔκαμον πολέος πεδίοιο θέουσαι
ἑστᾶσ’, οὐδ’ ἄρα τίς σφι μετὰ φρεσὶ γίγνεται ἀλκή·
ὣς ὑμεῖς ἕστητε τεθηπότες οὐδὲ μάχεσθε.
ἦ μένετε Τρῶας σχεδὸν ἐλθέμεν ἔνθά τε νῆες
εἰρύατ’ εὔπρυμνοι πολιῆς ἐπὶ θινὶ θαλάσσης,
ὄφρα ἴδητ’ αἴ κ’ ὔμμιν ὑπέρσχῃ χεῖρα Κρονίων;
ὣς ὅ γε κοιρανέων ἐπεπωλεῖτο στίχας ἀνδρῶν·
ἦλθε δ’ ἐπὶ Κρήτεσσι κιὼν ἀνὰ οὐλαμὸν ἀνδρῶν.
οἳ δ’ ἀμφ’ Ἰδομενῆα δαΐφρονα θωρήσσοντο·
Ἰδομενεὺς μὲν ἐνὶ προμάχοις συῒ εἴκελος ἀλκήν,
Μηριόνης δ’ ἄρα οἱ πυμάτας ὄτρυνε φάλαγγας.
τοὺς δὲ ἰδὼν γήθησεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων,
αὐτίκα δ’ Ἰδομενῆα προσηύδα μειλιχίοισιν·
Ἰδομενεῦ περὶ μέν σε τίω Δαναῶν ταχυπώλων
ἠμὲν ἐνὶ πτολέμῳ ἠδ’ ἀλλοίῳ ἐπὶ ἔργῳ
ἠδ’ ἐν δαίθ’, ὅτε πέρ τε γερούσιον αἴθοπα οἶνον
Ἀργείων οἳ ἄριστοι ἐνὶ κρητῆρι κέρωνται.
εἴ περ γάρ τ’ ἄλλοι γε κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοὶ

262 δαιτρὸν πίνωσιν, σὸν δὲ πλεῖον δέπας αἰεὶ
263 ἕστηχ’, ὥς περ ἐμοί, πιέειν ὅτε θυμὸς ἀνώγοι.
264 ἀλλ’ ὄρσευ πόλεμον δ’ οἷος πάρος εὔχεαι εἶναι.
265 τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ Ἰδομενεὺς Κρητῶν ἀγὸς ἀντίον ηὔδα·
266 Ἀτρεΐδη μάλα μέν τοι ἐγὼν ἑρίηρος ἑταῖρος
267 ἔσσομαι, ὡς τὸ πρῶτον ὑπέστην καὶ κατένευσα·
268 ἀλλ’ ἄλλους ὄτρυνε κάρη κομόωντας Ἀχαιοὺς
269 ὄφρα τάχιστα μαχώμεθ’, ἐπεὶ σύν γ’ ὅρκι’ ἔχευαν
270 Τρῶες· τοῖσιν δ’ αὖ θάνατος καὶ κήδε’ ὀπίσσω
Idomeneus answered, "I will be a trusty comrade, as I promised you from the first I would be. Urge on the other Achaeans, that we may join battle at once, for the Trojans have trampled upon their covenants. Death and destruction shall be theirs, seeing they have been the first to break their oaths and to attack us." The son of Atreus went on, glad at heart, till he came upon the two Ajaxes arming themselves amid a host of foot-soldiers. As when a goat-herd from some high post watches a storm drive over the deep [pontos] before the west wind - black as pitch is the offing and a mighty whirlwind draws towards him, so that he is afraid and drives his flock into a cave - even thus did the ranks of stalwart youths move in a dark mass to battle under the Ajaxes, horrid with shield and spear. Glad was King Agamemnon when he saw them. "No need," he cried, "to give orders to such leaders of the Argives as you are, for of your own selves you spur your men on to fight with might and main. Would, by father Zeus, Athena, and Apollo that all were so minded as you are, for the city of Priam would then soon fall beneath our hands, and we should sack it." With this he left them and went onward to Nestor, the facile speaker of the Pylians, who was marshaling his men and urging them on, in company with Pelagon, Alastor, Chromios, Haimon, and Bias shepherd of his people. He placed his horsemen with their chariots and horses in the front rank, while the foot-soldiers, brave men and many, whom he could trust, were in the rear. The cowards he drove into the middle, that they might fight whether they would or no. He gave his orders to the horsemen first, bidding them hold their horses well in hand, so as to avoid confusion. "Let no man," he said, "relying on his strength or horsemanship, get before the others and engage singly with the Trojans, nor yet let him lag behind or you will weaken your attack; but let each when he meets an enemy's chariot throw his spear from his own; this be much the best; this is how the men of old took towns and strongholds; in this wise was their thinking [noos]." Thus did the old man charge them, for he had been in many a fight, and King Agamemnon was glad. "I wish," he said to him, that your limbs were as supple and your strength [biê] as sure as your judgment is; but age, the common enemy of humankind, has laid his hand upon you; would that it had fallen upon some other, and that you were still young." And Nestor, horseman of Gerene, answered, "Son of Atreus, I too would gladly be the man I was when I slew mighty Ereuthalion; but the gods will not give us everything at one and the same time. I was then young, and now I am old; still I can go with my horsemen and give them that counsel which old men have a right to give. The wielding of the spear I leave to those who are younger and has more force [biê] than myself." Agamemnon went his way rejoicing, and presently found Menestheus, son of Peteos, tarrying in his place, and with him were the Athenians loud of tongue in battle. Near him also tarried cunning Odysseus, with his sturdy Cephallenians round him; they had not yet heard the battle-cry, for the ranks of Trojans and Achaeans had only just begun to move, so they were standing still, waiting for some other columns of the Achaeans to attack the Trojans and begin the fighting. When he saw this Agamemnon rebuked them and said, "Son of Peteos, and you other, steeped in cunning, heart of guile, why stand you here cowering and waiting on others? You two should be of all men foremost when there is hard fighting to be done, for you are ever foremost to accept my invitation when we councilors of the Achaeans are holding feast. You are glad enough then to take your fill of roast meats and to

drink wine as long as you please, whereas now you would not care though you saw ten columns of Achaeans engage the enemy in front of you."

4.271

ἔσσετ’ ἐπεὶ πρότεροι ὑπὲρ ὅρκια δηλήσαντο.
ὣς ἔφατ’, Ἀτρεΐδης δὲ παρῴχετο γηθόσυνος κῆρ·
ἦλθε δ’ ἐπ’ Αἰάντεσσι κιὼν ἀνὰ οὐλαμὸν ἀνδρῶν·
τὼ δὲ κορυσσέσθην, ἅμα δὲ νέφος εἵπετο πεζῶν.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἀπὸ σκοπιῆς εἶδεν νέφος αἰπόλος ἀνὴρ
ἐρχόμενον κατὰ πόντον ὑπὸ Ζεφύροιο ἰωῆς·
τῷ δέ τ’ ἄνευθεν ἐόντι μελάντερον ἠΰτε πίσσα
φαίνετ’ ἰὸν κατὰ πόντον, ἄγει δέ τε λαίλαπα πολλήν,
ῥίγησέν τε ἰδών, ὑπό τε σπέος ἤλασε μῆλα·
τοῖαι ἅμ’ Αἰάντεσσι διοτρεφέων αἰζηῶν
δήϊον ἐς πόλεμον πυκιναὶ κίνυντο φάλαγγες
κυάνεαι, σάκεσίν τε καὶ ἔγχεσι πεφρικυῖαι.
καὶ τοὺς μὲν γήθησεν ἰδὼν κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων,
καί σφεας φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Αἴαντ’ Ἀργείων ἠγήτορε χαλκοχιτώνων,
σφῶϊ μέν· οὐ γὰρ ἔοικ’ ὀτρυνέμεν· οὔ τι κελεύω·
αὐτὼ γὰρ μάλα λαὸν ἀνώγετον ἶφι μάχεσθαι.
αἲ γὰρ Ζεῦ τε πάτερ καὶ Ἀθηναίη καὶ Ἄπολλον
τοῖος πᾶσιν θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι γένοιτο·
τώ κε τάχ’ ἠμύσειε πόλις Πριάμοιο ἄνακτος
χερσὶν ὑφ’ ἡμετέρῃσιν ἁλοῦσά τε περθομένη τε.
ὣς εἰπὼν τοὺς μὲν λίπεν αὐτοῦ, βῆ δὲ μετ’ ἄλλους·
ἔνθ’ ὅ γε Νέστορ’ ἔτετμε λιγὺν Πυλίων ἀγορητὴν
οὓς ἑτάρους στέλλοντα καὶ ὀτρύνοντα μάχεσθαι
ἀμφὶ μέγαν Πελάγοντα Ἀλάστορά τε Χρομίον τε
Αἵμονά τε κρείοντα Βίαντά τε ποιμένα λαῶν·
ἱππῆας μὲν πρῶτα σὺν ἵπποισιν καὶ ὄχεσφι,
πεζοὺς δ’ ἐξόπιθε στῆσεν πολέας τε καὶ ἐσθλοὺς
ἔρκος ἔμεν πολέμοιο· κακοὺς δ’ ἐς μέσσον ἔλασσεν,
ὄφρα καὶ οὐκ ἐθέλων τις ἀναγκαίῃ πολεμίζοι.

4.301

ἱππεῦσιν μὲν πρῶτ’ ἐπετέλλετο· τοὺς γὰρ ἀνώγει
σφοὺς ἵππους ἐχέμεν μηδὲ κλονέεσθαι ὁμίλῳ·
μηδέ τις ἱπποσύνῃ τε καὶ ἠνορέηφι πεποιθὼς
οἷος πρόσθ’ ἄλλων μεμάτω Τρώεσσι μάχεσθαι,
μηδ’ ἀναχωρείτω· ἀλαπαδνότεροι γὰρ ἔσεσθε.
ὃς δέ κ’ ἀνὴρ ἀπὸ ὧν ὀχέων ἕτερ’ ἅρμαθ’ ἵκηται
ἔγχει ὀρεξάσθω, ἐπεὶ ἦ πολὺ φέρτερον οὕτω.
ὣδε καὶ οἱ πρότεροι πόλεας καὶ τείχε’ ἐπόρθεον
τόνδε νόον καὶ θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἔχοντες.
ὣς ὃ γέρων ὄτρυνε πάλαι πολέμων ἐὺ εἰδώς·
καὶ τὸν μὲν γήθησεν ἰδὼν κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων,
καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
ὦ γέρον εἴθ’ ὡς θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι φίλοισιν
ὥς τοι γούναθ’ ἕποιτο, βίη δέ τοι ἔμπεδος εἴη·

315 ἀλλά σε γῆρας τείρει ὁμοίϊον· ὡς ὄφελέν τις
316 ἀνδρῶν ἄλλος ἔχειν, σὺ δὲ κουροτέροισι μετεῖναι.
317 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
318 Ἀτρεΐδη μάλα μέν τοι ἐγὼν ἐθέλοιμι καὶ αὐτὸς
319 ὣς ἔμεν ὡς ὅτε δῖον Ἐρευθαλίωνα κατέκταν.
320 ἀλλ’ οὔ πως ἅμα πάντα θεοὶ δόσαν ἀνθρώποισιν·
321 εἰ τότε κοῦρος ἔα νῦν αὖτέ με γῆρας ὀπάζει.
322 ἀλλὰ καὶ ὧς ἱππεῦσι μετέσσομαι ἠδὲ κελεύσω
323 βουλῇ καὶ μύθοισι· τὸ γὰρ γέρας ἐστὶ γερόντων.
324 αἰχμὰς δ’ αἰχμάσσουσι νεώτεροι, οἵ περ ἐμεῖο
325 ὀπλότεροι γεγάασι πεποίθασίν τε βίηφιν.
326 ὣς ἔφατ’, Ἀτρεΐδης δὲ παρῴχετο γηθόσυνος κῆρ.
327 εὗρ’ υἱὸν Πετεῶο Μενεσθῆα πλήξιππον
328 ἑσταότ’· ἀμφὶ δ’ Ἀθηναῖοι μήστωρες ἀϋτῆς·
329 αὐτὰρ ὃ πλησίον ἑστήκει πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεύς,
330 πὰρ δὲ Κεφαλλήνων ἀμφὶ στίχες οὐκ ἀλαπαδναὶ

4.331

331 ἔστασαν· οὐ γάρ πώ σφιν ἀκούετο λαὸς ἀϋτῆς,
332 ἀλλὰ νέον συνορινόμεναι κίνυντο φάλαγγες
333 Τρώων ἰπποδάμων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν· οἳ δὲ μένοντες
334 ἔστασαν ὁππότε πύργος Ἀχαιῶν ἄλλος ἐπελθὼν
335 Τρώων ὁρμήσειε καὶ ἄρξειαν πολέμοιο.
336 τοὺς δὲ ἰδὼν νείκεσσεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων,
337 καί σφεας φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
338 ὦ υἱὲ Πετεῶο διοτρεφέος βασιλῆος,
339 καὶ σὺ κακοῖσι δόλοισι κεκασμένε κερδαλεόφρον
340 τίπτε καταπτώσσοντες ἀφέστατε, μίμνετε δ’ ἄλλους;
341 σφῶϊν μέν τ’ ἐπέοικε μετὰ πρώτοισιν ἐόντας
342 ἑστάμεν ἠδὲ μάχης καυστείρης ἀντιβολῆσαι·
343 πρώτω γὰρ καὶ δαιτὸς ἀκουάζεσθον ἐμεῖο,
344 ὁππότε δαῖτα γέρουσιν ἐφοπλίζωμεν Ἀχαιοί.
345 ἔνθα φίλ’ ὀπταλέα κρέα ἔδμεναι ἠδὲ κύπελλα
346 οἴνου πινέμεναι μελιηδέος ὄφρ’ ἐθέλητον·
347 νῦν δὲ φίλως χ’ ὁρόῳτε καὶ εἰ δέκα πύργοι Ἀχαιῶν
348 ὑμείων προπάροιθε μαχοίατο νηλέϊ χαλκῷ.
349 τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεύς·
350 Ἀτρεΐδη ποῖόν σε ἔπος φύγεν ἕρκος ὀδόντων;
351 πῶς δὴ φῄς πολέμοιο μεθιέμεν ὁππότ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
352 Τρωσὶν ἐφ’ ἱπποδάμοισιν ἐγείρομεν ὀξὺν Ἄρηα;
353 ὄψεαι αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσθα καὶ αἴ κέν τοι τὰ μεμήλῃ
354 Τηλεμάχοιο φίλον πατέρα προμάχοισι μιγέντα
355 Τρώων ἱπποδάμων· σὺ δὲ ταῦτ’ ἀνεμώλια βάζεις.
356 τὸν δ’ ἐπιμειδήσας προσέφη κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
357 ὡς γνῶ χωομένοιο· πάλιν δ’ ὅ γε λάζετο μῦθον·
358 διογενὲς Λαερτιάδη πολυμήχαν’ Ὀδυσσεῦ
359 οὔτέ σε νεικείω περιώσιον οὔτε κελεύω·
360 οἶδα γὰρ ὥς τοι θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι φίλοισιν
Odysseus glared at him and answered, "Son of Atreus, what are you talking about? How can you say that we are slack? When the Achaeans are in full fight with the Trojans, you shall see, if you care to do so, that the father of Telemakhos will join battle with the foremost of

them. You are talking idly." When Agamemnon saw that Odysseus was angry, he smiled pleasantly at him and withdrew his words. "Odysseus," said he, "noble son of Laertes, excellent in all good counsel, I have neither fault to find nor orders to give you, for I know your heart is right, and that you and I are of a mind. Enough; I will make you amends for what I have said, and if any ill has now been spoken may the gods bring it to nothing." He then left them and went on to others. Presently he saw the son of Tydeus, noble Diomedes, standing by his chariot and horses, with Sthenelos the son of Kapaneus beside him; whereon he began to upbraid him. "Son of Tydeus," he said, "why stand you cowering here upon the brink of battle? Tydeus did not shrink thus, but was ever ahead of his men when leading them on against the foe - so, at least, say they that saw him in battle, for I never set eyes upon him myself. They say that there was no man like him. He came once to Mycenae, not as an enemy but as a guest, in company with Polyneikes to recruit his forces, for they were levying war against the strong city of Thebes, and prayed our people for a body of picked men to help them. The men of Mycenae were willing to let them have one, but Zeus dissuaded them by showing them unfavorable omens [sêmata]. Tydeus, therefore, and Polyneikes went their way. When they had got as far the deep-meadowed and rush-grown banks of the Aesepos, the Achaeans sent Tydeus as their envoy, and he found the Cadmeans gathered in great numbers to a banquet in the house of Eteokles. Stranger though he was, he knew no fear on finding himself single-handed among so many, but challenged them to contests of all kinds, and in each one of them was at once victorious, so mightily did Athena help him. The Cadmeans were incensed at his success, and set a force of fifty youths with two leaders - the godlike hero Maion, son of Haimon, and Polyphontes, son of Autophonos - at their head, to lie in wait for him on his return journey; but Tydeus slew every man of them, save only Maion, whom he let go in obedience to heaven's omens. Such was Tydeus of Aetolia. His son can talk more glibly, but he cannot fight as his father did." Diomedes made no answer, for he was shamed by the rebuke of Agamemnon; but the son of Kapaneus took up his words and said, "Son of Atreus, tell no lies, for you can speak truth if you will. We boast ourselves as even better men than our fathers; we took seven-gated Thebes, though the wall was stronger and our men were fewer in number, for we trusted in the omens of the gods and in the help of Zeus, whereas they perished through their own sheer folly; hold not, then, our fathers in like honor [timê] with us." Diomedes looked sternly at him and said, "Hold your peace, my friend, as I bid you. It is not amiss that Agamemnon should urge the Achaeans forward, for the glory will be his if we take the city, and his the grief [penthos] if we are vanquished. Therefore let us acquit ourselves with valor." As he spoke he sprang from his chariot, and his armor rang so fiercely about his body that even a brave man might well have been scared to hear it. As when some mighty wave that thunders on the beach when the west wind has lashed it into fury at sea [pontos]- it has reared its head afar and now comes crashing down on the shore; it bows its arching crest high over the jagged rocks and spews its salt foam in all directions - even so did the serried phalanxes of the Danaans march steadfastly to battle. The chiefs gave orders each to his own people, but the men said never a word; no man would think it, for huge as the host was, it seemed as though there was not a tongue among them, so silent were they in their obedience; and as they marched the armor about their bodies glistened in the sun. But the clamor of the Trojan ranks was as that of many thousand ewes that stand waiting to be milked in the yards of some rich flockmaster, and bleat incessantly in answer to the bleating of their lambs; for they had not one speech nor language, but their tongues were diverse, and they came from many different places. These were inspired of Ares, but the others by Athena - and with them came Panic, Rout, and Strife whose fury never tires, sister and friend of murderous Ares, who, from being at first but low in stature, grows till she uprears her head to heaven, though her feet are still on earth. She it was that went about among them and flung down discord to the waxing of sorrow with even hand between them.

4.361

ἤπια δήνεα οἶδε· τὰ γὰρ φρονέεις ἅ τ’ ἐγώ περ.
ἀλλ’ ἴθι ταῦτα δ’ ὄπισθεν ἀρεσσόμεθ’ εἴ τι κακὸν νῦν
εἴρηται, τὰ δὲ πάντα θεοὶ μεταμώνια θεῖεν.
ὣς εἰπὼν τοὺς μὲν λίπεν αὐτοῦ, βῆ δὲ μετ’ ἄλλους.
εὗρε δὲ Τυδέος υἱὸν ὑπέρθυμον Διομήδεα
ἑσταότ’ ἔν θ’ ἵπποισι καὶ ἄρμασι κολλητοῖσι·
πὰρ δέ οἱ ἑστήκει Σθένελος Καπανήϊος υἱός.
καὶ τὸν μὲν νείκεσσεν ἰδὼν κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων,
καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
ὤ μοι Τυδέος υἱὲ δαΐφρονος ἱπποδάμοιο
τί πτώσσεις, τί δ’ ὀπιπεύεις πολέμοιο γεφύρας;
οὐ μὲν Τυδέϊ γ’ ὧδε φίλον πτωσκαζέμεν ἦεν,
ἀλλὰ πολὺ πρὸ φίλων ἑτάρων δηΐοισι μάχεσθαι,
ὡς φάσαν οἵ μιν ἴδοντο πονεύμενον· οὐ γὰρ ἔγωγε
ἤντησ’ οὐδὲ ἴδον· περὶ δ’ ἄλλων φασὶ γενέσθαι.
ἤτοι μὲν γὰρ ἄτερ πολέμου εἰσῆλθε Μυκήνας
ξεῖνος ἅμ’ ἀντιθέῳ Πολυνείκεϊ λαὸν ἀγείρων·
οἳ δὲ τότ’ ἐστρατόωνθ’ ἱερὰ πρὸς τείχεα Θήβης,
καί ῥα μάλα λίσσοντο δόμεν κλειτοὺς ἐπικούρους·
οἳ δ’ ἔθελον δόμεναι καὶ ἐπήνεον ὡς ἐκέλευον·
ἀλλὰ Ζεὺς ἔτρεψε παραίσια σήματα φαίνων.
οἳ δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν ᾤχοντο ἰδὲ πρὸ ὁδοῦ ἐγένοντο,
Ἀσωπὸν δ’ ἵκοντο βαθύσχοινον λεχεποίην,
ἔνθ’ αὖτ’ ἀγγελίην ἐπὶ Τυδῆ στεῖλαν Ἀχαιοί.
αὐτὰρ ὃ βῆ, πολέας δὲ κιχήσατο Καδμείωνας
δαινυμένους κατὰ δῶμα βίης Ἐτεοκληείης.
ἔνθ’ οὐδὲ ξεῖνός περ ἐὼν ἱππηλάτα Τυδεὺς
τάρβει, μοῦνος ἐὼν πολέσιν μετὰ Καδμείοισιν,
ἀλλ’ ὅ γ’ ἀεθλεύειν προκαλίζετο, πάντα δ’ ἐνίκα
ῥηϊδίως· τοίη οἱ ἐπίρροθος ἦεν Ἀθήνη.

4.391

οἳ δὲ χολωσάμενοι Καδμεῖοι κέντορες ἵππων
ἂψ ἄρ’ ἀνερχομένῳ πυκινὸν λόχον εἶσαν ἄγοντες
κούρους πεντήκοντα· δύω δ’ ἡγήτορες ἦσαν,
Μαίων Αἱμονίδης ἐπιείκελος ἀθανάτοισιν,
υἱός τ’ Αὐτοφόνοιο μενεπτόλεμος Πολυφόντης.
Τυδεὺς μὲν καὶ τοῖσιν ἀεικέα πότμον ἐφῆκε·
πάντας ἔπεφν’, ἕνα δ’ οἷον ἴει οἶκον δὲ νέεσθαι·
Μαίον’ ἄρα προέηκε θεῶν τεράεσσι πιθήσας.
τοῖος ἔην Τυδεὺς Αἰτώλιος· ἀλλὰ τὸν υἱὸν
γείνατο εἶο χέρεια μάχῃ, ἀγορῇ δέ τ’ ἀμείνω.
ὣς φάτο, τὸν δ’ οὔ τι προσέφη κρατερὸς Διομήδης
αἰδεσθεὶς βασιλῆος ἐνιπὴν αἰδοίοιο·
τὸν δ’ υἱὸς Καπανῆος ἀμείψατο κυδαλίμοιο·
Ἀτρεΐδη μὴ ψεύδε’ ἐπιστάμενος σάφα εἰπεῖν·
ἡμεῖς τοι πατέρων μέγ’ ἀμείνονες εὐχόμεθ’ εἶναι·
ἡμεῖς καὶ Θήβης ἔδος εἵλομεν ἑπταπύλοιο
παυρότερον λαὸν ἀγαγόνθ’ ὑπὸ τεῖχος ἄρειον,
πειθόμενοι τεράεσσι θεῶν καὶ Ζηνὸς ἀρωγῇ·

409 κεῖνοι δὲ σφετέρῃσιν ἀτασθαλίῃσιν ὄλοντο·
410 τὼ μή μοι πατέρας ποθ’ ὁμοίῃ ἔνθεο τιμῇ.
411 τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη κρατερὸς Διομήδης·
412 τέττα, σιωπῇ ἧσο, ἐμῷ δ’ ἐπιπείθεο μύθῳ·
413 οὐ γὰρ ἐγὼ νεμεσῶ Ἀγαμέμνονι ποιμένι λαῶν
414 ὀτρύνοντι μάχεσθαι ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιούς·
415 τούτῳ μὲν γὰρ κῦδος ἅμ’ ἕψεται εἴ κεν Ἀχαιοὶ
416 Τρῶας δηώσωσιν ἕλωσί τε Ἴλιον ἰρήν,
417 τούτῳ δ’ αὖ μέγα πένθος Ἀχαιῶν δῃωθέντων.
418 ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ καὶ νῶϊ μεδώμεθα θούριδος ἀλκῆς.
419 ἦ ῥα καὶ ἐξ ὀχέων σὺν τεύχεσιν ἆλτο χαμᾶζε·
420 δεινὸν δ’ ἔβραχε χαλκὸς ἐπὶ στήθεσσιν ἄνακτος

4.421

421 ὀρνυμένου· ὑπό κεν ταλασίφρονά περ δέος εἷλεν.
422 ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἐν αἰγιαλῷ πολυηχέϊ κῦμα θαλάσσης
423 ὄρνυτ’ ἐπασσύτερον Ζεφύρου ὕπο κινήσαντος·
424 πόντῳ μέν τε πρῶτα κορύσσεται, αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
425 χέρσῳ ῥηγνύμενον μεγάλα βρέμει, ἀμφὶ δέ τ’ ἄκρας
426 κυρτὸν ἐὸν κορυφοῦται, ἀποπτύει δ’ ἁλὸς ἄχνην·
427 ὣς τότ’ ἐπασσύτεραι Δαναῶν κίνυντο φάλαγγες
428 νωλεμέως πόλεμον δέ· κέλευε δὲ οἷσιν ἕκαστος
429 ἡγεμόνων· οἳ δ’ ἄλλοι ἀκὴν ἴσαν, οὐδέ κε φαίης
430 τόσσον λαὸν ἕπεσθαι ἔχοντ’ ἐν στήθεσιν αὐδήν,
431 σιγῇ δειδιότες σημάντορας· ἀμφὶ δὲ πᾶσι
432 τεύχεα ποικίλ’ ἔλαμπε, τὰ εἱμένοι ἐστιχόωντο.
433 Τρῶες δ’, ὥς τ’ ὄϊες πολυπάμονος ἀνδρὸς ἐν αὐλῇ
434 μυρίαι ἐστήκασιν ἀμελγόμεναι γάλα λευκὸν
435 ἀζηχὲς μεμακυῖαι ἀκούουσαι ὄπα ἀρνῶν,
436 ὣς Τρώων ἀλαλητὸς ἀνὰ στρατὸν εὐρὺν ὀρώρει·
437 οὐ γὰρ πάντων ἦεν ὁμὸς θρόος οὐδ’ ἴα γῆρυς,
438 ἀλλὰ γλῶσσα μέμικτο, πολύκλητοι δ’ ἔσαν ἄνδρες.
439 ὄρσε δὲ τοὺς μὲν Ἄρης, τοὺς δὲ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη
440 Δεῖμός τ’ ἠδὲ Φόβος καὶ Ἔρις ἄμοτον μεμαυῖα,
441 Ἄρεος ἀνδροφόνοιο κασιγνήτη ἑτάρη τε,
442 ἥ τ’ ὀλίγη μὲν πρῶτα κορύσσεται, αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
443 οὐρανῷ ἐστήριξε κάρη καὶ ἐπὶ χθονὶ βαίνει·
444 ἥ σφιν καὶ τότε νεῖκος ὁμοίϊον ἔμβαλε μέσσῳ
445 ἐρχομένη καθ’ ὅμιλον ὀφέλλουσα στόνον ἀνδρῶν.
446 οἳ δ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἐς χῶρον ἕνα ξυνιόντες ἵκοντο,
447 σύν ῥ’ ἔβαλον ῥινούς, σὺν δ’ ἔγχεα καὶ μένε’ ἀνδρῶν
448 χαλκεοθωρήκων· ἀτὰρ ἀσπίδες ὀμφαλόεσσαι
449 ἔπληντ’ ἀλλήλῃσι, πολὺς δ’ ὀρυμαγδὸς ὀρώρει.
450 ἔνθα δ’ ἅμ’ οἰμωγή τε καὶ εὐχωλὴ πέλεν ἀνδρῶν

When they were got together in one place shield clashed with shield and spear with spear in the rage of battle. The bossed shields beat one upon another, and there was a tramp as of a great multitude - death-cry and shout of triumph of slain and slayers, and the earth ran red with blood. As torrents swollen with rain course madly down their deep channels till the angry floods meet in some gorge, and the shepherd the hillside hears their roaring from afar - even such was the toil [ponos] and uproar of the hosts as they joined in battle. First Antilokhos slew an armed warrior of the Trojans, Ekhepolos, son of Thalysios, fighting in

the foremost ranks. He struck at the projecting part of his helmet and drove the spear into his brow; the point of bronze pierced the bone, and darkness veiled his eyes; headlong as a tower he fell amid the press of the fight, and as he dropped King Elephenor, son of Khalkodon and leader of the proud Abantes began dragging him out of reach of the darts that were falling around him, in haste to strip him of his armor. But his purpose was not for long; Agenor saw him haling the body away, and smote him in the side with his bronze-shod spear - for as he stooped his side was left unprotected by his shield - and thus he perished. Then the fight between Trojans and Achaeans grew furious over his body, and they flew upon each other like wolves, man and man crushing one upon the other. Forthwith Ajax, son of Telamon, slew the fair youth Simoeisios, son of Anthemion, whom his mother bore by the banks of the Simoeis, as she was coming down from Mount Ida, where she had been with her parents to see their flocks. Therefore he was named Simoeisios, but he did not live to pay his parents for his rearing, for he was cut off untimely by the spear of mighty Ajax, who struck him in the breast by the right nipple as he was coming on among the foremost fighters; the spear went right through his shoulder, and he fell as a poplar that has grown straight and tall in a meadow by some mere, and its top is thick with branches. Then the wheelwright lays his axe to its roots that he may fashion a felloe for the wheel of some goodly chariot, and it lies seasoning by the waterside. In such wise did Ajax fell to earth Simoeisios, son of Anthemion. Thereon Antiphos of the gleaming corselet, son of Priam, hurled a spear at Ajax from amid the crowd and missed him, but he hit Leukos, the brave comrade of Odysseus, in the groin, as he was dragging the body of Simoeisios over to the other side; so he fell upon the body and loosed his hold upon it. Odysseus was furious when he saw Leukos slain, and strode in full armor through the front ranks till he was quite close; then he glared round about him and took aim, and the Trojans fell back as he did so. His dart was not sped in vain, for it struck Demokoön, the bastard son of Priam, who had come to him from Abydos, where he had charge of his father's mares. Odysseus, infuriated by the death of his comrade, hit him with his spear on one temple, and the bronze point came through on the other side of his forehead. Thereon darkness veiled his eyes, and his armor rang rattling round him as he fell heavily to the ground. Hektor, and they that were in front, then gave round while the Argives raised a shout and drew off the dead, pressing further forward as they did so. But Apollo looked down from Pergamos and called aloud to the Trojans, for he was displeased. "Trojans," he cried, "rush on the foe, and do not let yourselves be thus beaten by the Argives. Their skins are not stone nor iron that when hit them you do them no harm. Moreover, Achilles, the son of lovely Thetis, is not fighting, but is nursing his anger at the ships." Thus spoke the mighty god, crying to them from the city, while Zeus' redoubtable daughter, the Trito-born, went about among the host of the Achaeans, and urged them forward whenever she beheld them slackening. Then fate fell upon Diores, son of Amarynkeus, for he was struck by a jagged stone near the ankle of his right leg. He that hurled it was Peirous, son of Imbrasos, leader of the Thracians, who had come from Ainos; the bones and both the tendons were crushed by the pitiless stone. He fell to the ground on his back, and in his death throes stretched out his hands towards his comrades. But Peirous, who had wounded him, sprang on him and thrust a spear into his belly, so that his bowels came gushing out upon the ground, and darkness veiled his eyes. As he was leaving the body, Thoas of Aetolia struck him in the chest near the nipple, and the point fixed itself in his lungs. Thoas came close up to him, pulled the spear out of his chest, and then drawing his sword, smote him in the middle of the belly so that he died; but he did not strip him of his armor, for his Thracian comrades, men who wear their hair in a tuft at the top of their heads, stood round the body and kept him off with their long spears for all his great stature and valor; so he was driven back. Thus the two corpses lay stretched on earth near to one another, the one leader of the Thracians and the other of the Epeans; and many another fell round them. And now no man would have made light of the

fighting if he could have gone about among it scatheless and unwounded, with Athena leading him by the hand, and protecting him from the storm of spears and arrows. For many Trojans and Achaeans on that day lay stretched side by side face downwards upon the earth.

4.451

ὀλλύντων τε καὶ ὀλλυμένων, ῥέε δ’ αἵματι γαῖα.
ὡς δ’ ὅτε χείμαρροι ποταμοὶ κατ’ ὄρεσφι ῥέοντες
ἐς μισγάγκειαν συμβάλλετον ὄβριμον ὕδωρ
κρουνῶν ἐκ μεγάλων κοίλης ἔντοσθε χαράδρης,
τῶν δέ τε τηλόσε δοῦπον ἐν οὔρεσιν ἔκλυε ποιμήν·
ὣς τῶν μισγομένων γένετο ἰαχή τε πόνος τε.
πρῶτος δ’ Ἀντίλοχος Τρώων ἕλεν ἄνδρα κορυστὴν
ἐσθλὸν ἐνὶ προμάχοισι Θαλυσιάδην Ἐχέπωλον·
τόν ῥ’ ἔβαλε πρῶτος κόρυθος φάλον ἱπποδασείης,
ἐν δὲ μετώπῳ πῆξε, πέρησε δ’ ἄρ’ ὀστέον εἴσω
αἰχμὴ χαλκείη· τὸν δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψεν,
ἤριπε δ’ ὡς ὅτε πύργος ἐνὶ κρατερῇ ὑσμίνῃ.
τὸν δὲ πεσόντα ποδῶν ἕλαβε κρείων Ἐλεφήνωρ
Χαλκωδοντιάδης μεγαθύμων ἀρχὸς Ἀβάντων,
ἕλκε δ’ ὑπ’ ἐκ βελέων, λελιημένος ὄφρα τάχιστα
τεύχεα συλήσειε· μίνυνθα δέ οἱ γένεθ’ ὁρμή.
νεκρὸν γὰρ ἐρύοντα ἰδὼν μεγάθυμος Ἀγήνωρ
πλευρά, τά οἱ κύψαντι παρ’ ἀσπίδος ἐξεφαάνθη,
οὔτησε ξυστῷ χαλκήρεϊ, λῦσε δὲ γυῖα.
ὣς τὸν μὲν λίπε θυμός, ἐπ’ αὐτῷ δ’ ἔργον ἐτύχθη
ἀργαλέον Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν· οἳ δὲ λύκοι ὣς
ἀλλήλοις ἐπόρουσαν, ἀνὴρ δ’ ἄνδρ’ ἐδνοπάλιζεν.
ἔνθ’ ἔβαλ’ Ἀνθεμίωνος υἱὸν Τελαμώνιος Αἴας
ἠΐθεον θαλερὸν Σιμοείσιον, ὅν ποτε μήτηρ
Ἴδηθεν κατιοῦσα παρ’ ὄχθῃσιν Σιμόεντος
γείνατ’, ἐπεί ῥα τοκεῦσιν ἄμ’ ἕσπετο μῆλα ἰδέσθαι·
τοὔνεκά μιν κάλεον Σιμοείσιον· οὐδὲ τοκεῦσι
θρέπτρα φίλοις ἀπέδωκε, μινυνθάδιος δέ οἱ αἰὼν
ἔπλεθ’ ὑπ’ Αἴαντος μεγαθύμου δουρὶ δαμέντι.
πρῶτον γάρ μιν ἰόντα βάλε στῆθος παρὰ μαζὸν

4.481

δεξιόν· ἀντικρὺ δὲ δι’ ὤμου χάλκεον ἔγχος
ἦλθεν· ὁ δ’ ἐν κονίῃσι χαμαὶ πέσεν αἴγειρος ὡς
ἥ ῥά τ’ ἐν εἰαμενῇ ἕλεος μεγάλοιο πεφύκει
λείη, ἀτάρ τέ οἱ ὄζοι ἐπ’ ἀκροτάτῃ πεφύασι·
τὴν μέν θ’ ἁρματοπηγὸς ἀνὴρ αἴθωνι σιδήρῳ
ἐξέταμ’, ὄφρα ἴτυν κάμψῃ περικαλλέϊ δίφρῳ·
ἣ μέν τ’ ἀζομένη κεῖται ποταμοῖο παρ’ ὄχθας.
τοῖον ἄρ’ Ἀνθεμίδην Σιμοείσιον ἐξενάριξεν
Αἴας διογενής· τοῦ δ’ Ἄντιφος αἰολοθώρηξ
Πριαμίδης καθ’ ὅμιλον ἀκόντισεν ὀξέϊ δουρί.
τοῦ μὲν ἅμαρθ’, ὃ δὲ Λεῦκον Ὀδυσσέος ἐσθλὸν ἑταῖρον
βεβλήκει βουβῶνα, νέκυν ἑτέρωσ’ ἐρύοντα·

493 ἤριπε δ’ ἀμφ’ αὐτῷ, νεκρὸς δέ οἱ ἔκπεσε χειρός.
494 τοῦ δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς μάλα θυμὸν ἀποκταμένοιο χολώθη,
495 βῆ δὲ διὰ προμάχων κεκορυθμένος αἴθοπι χαλκῷ,
496 στῆ δὲ μάλ’ ἐγγὺς ἰὼν καὶ ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ
497 ἀμφὶ ἒ παπτήνας· ὑπὸ δὲ Τρῶες κεκάδοντο
498 ἀνδρὸς ἀκοντίσσαντος· ὃ δ’ οὐχ ἅλιον βέλος ἦκεν,
499 ἀλλ’ υἱὸν Πριάμοιο νόθον βάλε Δημοκόωντα
500 ὅς οἱ Ἀβυδόθεν ἦλθε παρ’ ἵππων ὠκειάων.
501 τόν ῥ’ Ὀδυσεὺς ἑτάροιο χολωσάμενος βάλε δουρὶ
502 κόρσην· ἣ δ’ ἑτέροιο διὰ κροτάφοιο πέρησεν
503 αἰχμὴ χαλκείη· τὸν δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψε,
504 δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, ἀράβησε δὲ τεύχε’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ.
505 χώρησαν δ’ ὑπό τε πρόμαχοι καὶ φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ·
506 Ἀργεῖοι δὲ μέγα ἴαχον, ἐρύσαντο δὲ νεκρούς,
507 ἴθυσαν δὲ πολὺ προτέρω· νεμέσησε δ’ Ἀπόλλων
508 Περγάμου ἐκκατιδών, Τρώεσσι δὲ κέκλετ’ ἀΰσας·
509 ὄρνυσθ’ ἱππόδαμοι Τρῶες μηδ’ εἴκετε χάρμης
510 Ἀργείοις, ἐπεὶ οὔ σφι λίθος χρὼς οὐδὲ σίδηρος

4.511

511 χαλκὸν ἀνασχέσθαι ταμεσίχροα βαλλομένοισιν·
512 οὐ μὰν οὐδ’ Ἀχιλεὺς Θέτιδος πάϊς ἠϋκόμοιο
513 μάρναται, ἀλλ’ ἐπὶ νηυσὶ χόλον θυμαλγέα πέσσει.
514 ὣς φάτ’ ἀπὸ πτόλιος δεινὸς θεός· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὺς
515 ὦρσε Διὸς θυγάτηρ κυδίστη Τριτογένεια
516 ἐρχομένη καθ’ ὅμιλον, ὅθι μεθιέντας ἴδοιτο.
517 ἔνθ’ Ἀμαρυγκείδην Διώρεα μοῖρα πέδησε·
518 χερμαδίῳ γὰρ βλῆτο παρὰ σφυρὸν ὀκριόεντι
519 κνήμην δεξιτερήν· βάλε δὲ Θρῃκῶν ἀγὸς ἀνδρῶν
520 Πείρως Ἰμβρασίδης ὃς ἄρ’ Αἰνόθεν εἰληλούθει.
521 ἀμφοτέρῳ δὲ τένοντε καὶ ὀστέα λᾶας ἀναιδὴς
522 ἄχρις ἀπηλοίησεν· ὃ δ’ ὕπτιος ἐν κονίῃσι
523 κάππεσεν ἄμφω χεῖρε φίλοις ἑτάροισι πετάσσας
524 θυμὸν ἀποπνείων· ὃ δ’ ἐπέδραμεν ὅς ῥ’ ἔβαλέν περ
525 Πείροος, οὗτα δὲ δουρὶ παρ’ ὀμφαλόν· ἐκ δ’ ἄρα πᾶσαι
526 χύντο χαμαὶ χολάδες, τὸν δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψε.
527 τὸν δὲ Θόας Αἰτωλὸς ἀπεσσύμενον βάλε δουρὶ
528 στέρνον ὑπὲρ μαζοῖο, πάγη δ’ ἐν πνεύμονι χαλκός·
529 ἀγχίμολον δέ οἱ ἦλθε Θόας, ἐκ δ’ ὄβριμον ἔγχος
530 ἐσπάσατο στέρνοιο, ἐρύσσατο δὲ ξίφος ὀξύ,
531 τῷ ὅ γε γαστέρα τύψε μέσην, ἐκ δ’ αἶνυτο θυμόν.
532 τεύχεα δ’ οὐκ ἀπέδυσε· περίστησαν γὰρ ἑταῖροι
533 Θρῄϊκες ἀκρόκομοι δολίχ’ ἔγχεα χερσὶν ἔχοντες,
534 οἵ ἑ μέγαν περ ἐόντα καὶ ἴφθιμον καὶ ἀγαυὸν
535 ὦσαν ἀπὸ σφείων· ὃ δὲ χασσάμενος πελεμίχθη.
536 ὣς τώ γ’ ἐν κονίῃσι παρ’ ἀλλήλοισι τετάσθην,
537 ἤτοι ὃ μὲν Θρῃκῶν, ὃ δ’ Ἐπειῶν χαλκοχιτώνων
538 ἡγεμόνες· πολλοὶ δὲ περὶ κτείνοντο καὶ ἄλλοι.
539 ἔνθά κεν οὐκέτι ἔργον ἀνὴρ ὀνόσαιτο μετελθών,
540 ὅς τις ἔτ’ ἄβλητος καὶ ἀνούτατος ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ

4.541

541 δινεύοι κατὰ μέσσον, ἄγοι δέ ἑ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη
542 χειρὸς ἑλοῦσ’, αὐτὰρ βελέων ἀπερύκοι ἐρωήν·
543 πολλοὶ γὰρ Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν ἤματι κείνῳ
544 πρηνέες ἐν κονίῃσι παρ’ ἀλλήλοισι τέταντο.

5.1

1 ἔνθ’ αὖ Τυδεΐδῃ Διομήδεϊ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη
2 δῶκε μένος καὶ θάρσος, ἵν’ ἔκδηλος μετὰ πᾶσιν
3 Ἀργείοισι γένοιτο ἰδὲ κλέος ἐσθλὸν ἄροιτο·
4 δαΐέ οἱ ἐκ κόρυθός τε καὶ ἀσπίδος ἀκάματον πῦρ
5 ἀστέρ’ ὀπωρινῷ ἐναλίγκιον, ὅς τε μάλιστα
6 λαμπρὸν παμφαίνῃσι λελουμένος ὠκεανοῖο·
7 τοῖόν οἱ πῦρ δαΐεν ἀπὸ κρατός τε καὶ ὤμων,
8 ὦρσε δέ μιν κατὰ μέσσον ὅθι πλεῖστοι κλονέοντο.
9 ἦν δέ τις ἐν Τρώεσσι Δάρης ἀφνειὸς ἀμύμων
10 ἱρεὺς Ἡφαίστοιο· δύω δέ οἱ υἱέες ἦστην
11 Φηγεὺς Ἰδαῖός τε μάχης εὖ εἰδότε πάσης.
12 τώ οἱ ἀποκρινθέντε ἐναντίω ὁρμηθήτην·
13 τὼ μὲν ἀφ’ ἵπποιιν, ὃ δ’ ἀπὸ χθονὸς ὄρνυτο πεζός.
14 οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντες
15 Φηγεύς ῥα πρότερος προΐει δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος·
16 Τυδεΐδεω δ’ ὑπὲρ ὦμον ἀριστερὸν ἦλυθ’ ἀκωκὴ
17 ἔγχεος, οὐδ’ ἔβαλ’ αὐτόν· ὃ δ’ ὕστερος ὄρνυτο χαλκῷ
18 Τυδεΐδης· τοῦ δ’ οὐχ ἅλιον βέλος ἔκφυγε χειρός,
19 ἀλλ’ ἔβαλε στῆθος μεταμάζιον, ὦσε δ’ ἀφ’ ἵππων.
20 Ἰδαῖος δ’ ἀπόρουσε λιπὼν περικαλλέα δίφρον,
21 οὐδ’ ἔτλη περιβῆναι ἀδελφειοῦ κταμένοιο·
22 οὐδὲ γὰρ οὐδέ κεν αὐτὸς ὑπέκφυγε κῆρα μέλαιναν,
23 ἀλλ’ Ἥφαιστος ἔρυτο, σάωσε δὲ νυκτὶ καλύψας,
24 ὡς δή οἱ μὴ πάγχυ γέρων ἀκαχήμενος εἴη.
25 ἵππους δ’ ἐξελάσας μεγαθύμου Τυδέος υἱὸς
26 δῶκεν ἑταίροισιν κατάγειν κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας.
27 Τρῶες δὲ μεγάθυμοι ἐπεὶ ἴδον υἷε Δάρητος
28 τὸν μὲν ἀλευάμενον, τὸν δὲ κτάμενον παρ’ ὄχεσφι,
29 πᾶσιν ὀρίνθη θυμός· ἀτὰρ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη
30 χειρὸς ἑλοῦσ’ ἐπέεσσι προσηύδα θοῦρον Ἄρηα·

Then Pallas Athena put valor into the heart of Diomedes, son of Tydeus, that he might excel all the other Argives, and cover himself with glory [kleos]. She made a stream of fire flare from his shield and helmet like the star that shines most brilliantly in summer after its bath in the waters of Okeanos - even such a fire did she kindle upon his head and shoulders as she bade him speed into the thickest uproar of the fight. Now there was a certain rich and honorable man among the Trojans, priest of Hephaistos, and his name was Dares. He had two sons, Phegeus and Idaios, both of them skilled in all the arts of war. These two came forward from the main body of Trojans, and set upon Diomedes, he being on foot, while they fought from their chariot. When they were close up to one another, Phegeus took aim first, but his spear went over Diomedes ‘s left shoulder without hitting him. Diomedes then threw, and his spear sped not in vain, for it hit Phegeus on the breast near the nipple, and he fell from his chariot. Idaios did not dare to bestride his brother's body, but sprang from the chariot and took to flight, or he would have shared his brother's fate; whereon Hephaistos saved him by wrapping him in a cloud of darkness, that his old father might not

be utterly overwhelmed with grief; but the son of Tydeus drove off with the horses, and bade his followers take them to the ships. The Trojans were scared when they saw the two sons of Dares, one of them in fright and the other lying dead by his chariot. Athena, therefore, took Ares by the hand and said, "Ares, Ares, bane of men, bloodstained stormer of cities, may we not now leave the Trojans and Achaeans to fight it out, and see to which of the two Zeus will grant the victory? Let us go away, and thus avoid his anger [mênis]." So saying, she drew Ares out of the battle, and set him down upon the steep banks of the Skamandros. Upon this the Danaans drove the Trojans back, and each one of their chieftains killed his man. First King Agamemnon flung mighty Odios, leader of the Halizonoi, from his chariot. The spear of Agamemnon caught him on the broad of his back, just as he was turning in flight; it struck him between the shoulders and went right through his chest, and his armor rang rattling round him as he fell heavily to the ground. Then Idomeneus killed Phaesus, son of Boros the Meonian, who had come from Varne. Mighty Idomeneus speared him on the right shoulder as he was mounting his chariot, and the darkness of death enshrouded him as he fell heavily from the car. The squires [therapontes] of Idomeneus spoiled him of his armor, while Menelaos, son of Atreus, killed Skamandrios the son of Strophios, a mighty huntsman and keen lover of the chase. Artemis herself had taught him how to kill every kind of wild creature that is bred in mountain forests, but neither she nor his famed skill in archery could now save him, for the spear of Menelaos struck him in the back as he was fleeing; it struck him between the shoulders and went right through his chest, so that he fell headlong and his armor rang rattling round him. Meriones then killed Phereklos the son of Tekton, who was the son of Harmon, a man whose hand was skilled in all manner of cunning workmanship, for Pallas Athena had dearly loved him. He it was that made the ships for Alexander, which were the beginning of all mischief, and brought evil alike both on the Trojans and on Alexander himself; for he heeded not the decrees of heaven. Meriones overtook him as he was fleeing, and struck him on the right buttock. The point of the spear went through the bone into the bladder, and death came upon him as he cried aloud and fell forward on his knees. Meges, moreover, slew Pedaios, son of Antenor, who, though he was a bastard, had been brought up by Theano as one of her own children, for the love she bore her husband. The son of Phyleus got close up to him and drove a spear into the nape of his neck: it went under his tongue all among his teeth, so he bit the cold bronze, and fell dead in the dust. And Eurypylos, son of Euaemon, killed Hypsenor, the son of noble Dolopion, who had been made priest of the river Skamandros, and was honored in the dêmos as though he were a god. Eurypylos gave him chase as he was fleeing before him, smote him with his sword upon the arm, and lopped his strong hand from off it. The bloody hand fell to the ground, and the shades of death, with fate that no man can withstand, came over his eyes. Thus furiously did the battle rage between them. As for the son of Tydeus, you could not say whether he was more among the Achaeans or the Trojans. He rushed across the plain like a winter torrent that has burst its barrier in full flood; no dikes, no walls of fruitful vineyards can embank it when it is swollen with rain from heaven, but in a moment it comes tearing onward, and lays many a field waste that many a strong man hand has reclaimed - even so were the dense phalanxes of the Trojans driven in rout by the son of Tydeus, and many though they were, they dared not abide his onslaught. Now when the son of Lykaon saw him scouring the plain and driving the Trojans pell-mell before him, he aimed an arrow and hit the front part of his cuirass near the shoulder: the arrow went right through the metal and pierced the flesh, so that the cuirass was covered with blood. On this the son of Lykaon shouted in triumph, "Horsemen Trojans, come on; the bravest of the Achaeans is wounded, and he will not hold out much longer if King Apollo was indeed with me when I sped from Lycia hither."

5.31

Ἄρες Ἄρες βροτολοιγὲ μιαιφόνε τειχεσιπλῆτα
οὐκ ἂν δὴ Τρῶας μὲν ἐάσαιμεν καὶ Ἀχαιοὺς
μάρνασθ’, ὁπποτέροισι πατὴρ Ζεὺς κῦδος ὀρέξῃ,
νῶϊ δὲ χαζώμεσθα, Διὸς δ’ ἀλεώμεθα μῆνιν;
ὣς εἰποῦσα μάχης ἐξήγαγε θοῦρον Ἄρηα·
τὸν μὲν ἔπειτα καθεῖσεν ἐπ’ ἠϊόεντι Σκαμάνδρῳ,
Τρῶας δ’ ἔκλιναν Δαναοί· ἕλε δ’ ἄνδρα ἕκαστος
ἡγεμόνων· πρῶτος δὲ ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων
ἀρχὸν Ἀλιζώνων Ὀδίον μέγαν ἔκβαλε δίφρου·
πρώτῳ γὰρ στρεφθέντι μεταφρένῳ ἐν δόρυ πῆξεν
ὤμων μεσσηγύς, διὰ δὲ στήθεσφιν ἔλασσε,
δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, ἀράβησε δὲ τεύχε’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ.
Ἰδομενεὺς δ’ ἄρα Φαῖστον ἐνήρατο Μῄονος υἱὸν
Βώρου, ὃς ἐκ Τάρνης ἐριβώλακος εἰληλούθει.
τὸν μὲν ἄρ’ Ἰδομενεὺς δουρικλυτὸς ἔγχεϊ μακρῷ
νύξ’ ἴππων ἐπιβησόμενον κατὰ δεξιὸν ὦμον·
ἤριπε δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων, στυγερὸς δ’ ἄρα μιν σκότος εἷλε.
τὸν μὲν ἄρ’ Ἰδομενῆος ἐσύλευον θεράποντες·
υἱὸν δὲ Στροφίοιο Σκαμάνδριον αἴμονα θήρης
Ἀτρεΐδης Μενέλαος ἕλ’ ἔγχεϊ ὀξυόεντι
ἐσθλὸν θηρητῆρα· δίδαξε γὰρ Ἄρτεμις αὐτὴ
βάλλειν ἄγρια πάντα, τά τε τρέφει οὔρεσιν ὕλη·
ἀλλ’ οὔ οἱ τότε γε χραῖσμ’ Ἄρτεμις ἰοχέαιρα,
οὐδὲ ἑκηβολίαι ᾗσιν τὸ πρίν γε κέκαστο·
ἀλλά μιν Ἀτρεΐδης δουρικλειτὸς Μενέλαος
πρόσθεν ἔθεν φεύγοντα μετάφρενον οὔτασε δουρὶ
ὤμων μεσσηγύς, διὰ δὲ στήθεσφιν ἔλασσεν,
ἤριπε δὲ πρηνής, ἀράβησε δὲ τεύχε’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ.
Μηριόνης δὲ Φέρεκλον ἐνήρατο, τέκτονος υἱὸν
Ἁρμονίδεω, ὃς χερσὶν ἐπίστατο δαίδαλα πάντα

5.61

τεύχειν· ἔξοχα γάρ μιν ἐφίλατο Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη·
ὃς καὶ Ἀλεξάνδρῳ τεκτήνατο νῆας ἐΐσας
ἀρχεκάκους, αἳ πᾶσι κακὸν Τρώεσσι γένοντο
οἵ τ’ αὐτῷ, ἐπεὶ οὔ τι θεῶν ἐκ θέσφατα ᾔδη.
τὸν μὲν Μηριόνης ὅτε δὴ κατέμαρπτε διώκων
βεβλήκει γλουτὸν κατὰ δεξιόν· ἢ δὲ διαπρὸ
ἀντικρὺ κατὰ κύστιν ὑπ’ ὀστέον ἦλυθ’ ἀκωκή·
γνὺξ δ’ ἔριπ’ οἰμώξας, θάνατος δέ μιν ἀμφεκάλυψε.
Πήδαιον δ’ ἄρ’ ἔπεφνε Μέγης Ἀντήνορος υἱὸν
ὅς ῥα νόθος μὲν ἔην, πύκα δ’ ἔτρεφε δῖα Θεανὼ
ἶσα φίλοισι τέκεσσι χαριζομένη πόσεϊ ᾧ.
τὸν μὲν Φυλεΐδης δουρὶ κλυτὸς ἐγγύθεν ἐλθὼν
βεβλήκει κεφαλῆς κατὰ ἰνίον ὀξέϊ δουρί·
ἀντικρὺ δ’ ἀν’ ὀδόντας ὑπὸ γλῶσσαν τάμε χαλκός·
ἤριπε δ’ ἐν κονίῃ, ψυχρὸν δ’ ἔλε χαλκὸν ὀδοῦσιν.
Εὐρύπυλος δ’ Εὐαιμονίδης Ὑψήνορα δῖον
υἱὸν ὑπερθύμου Δολοπίονος, ὅς ῥα Σκαμάνδρου
ἀρητὴρ ἐτέτυκτο, θεὸς δ’ ὣς τίετο δήμῳ,

79 τὸν μὲν ἄρ’ Εὐρύπυλος, Εὐαίμονος ἀγλαὸς υἱός,
80 πρόσθεν ἔθεν φεύγοντα μεταδρομάδην ἔλασ’ ὦμον
81 φασγάνῳ ἀΐξας, ἀπὸ δ’ ἔξεσε χεῖρα βαρεῖαν·
82 αἱματόεσσα δὲ χεὶρ πεδίῳ πέσε· τὸν δὲ κατ’ ὄσσε
83 ἔλλαβε πορφύρεος θάνατος καὶ μοῖρα κραταιή.
84 ὣς οἳ μὲν πονέοντο κατὰ κρατερὴν ὑσμίνην·
85 Τυδεΐδην δ’ οὐκ ἂν γνοίης ποτέροισι μετείη
86 ἠὲ μετὰ Τρώεσσιν ὁμιλέοι ἦ μετ’ Ἀχαιοῖς.
87 θῦνε γὰρ ἂμ πεδίον ποταμῷ πλήθοντι ἐοικὼς
88 χειμάρρῳ, ὅς τ’ ὦκα ῥέων ἐκέδασσε γεφύρας·
89 τὸν δ’ οὔτ’ ἄρ τε γέφυραι ἐεργμέναι ἰσχανόωσιν,
90 οὔτ’ ἄρα ἕρκεα ἴσχει ἀλωάων ἐριθηλέων

5.91

91 ἐλθόντ’ ἐξαπίνης ὅτ’ ἐπιβρίσῃ Διὸς ὄμβρος·
92 πολλὰ δ’ ὑπ’ αὐτοῦ ἔργα κατήριπε κάλ’ αἰζηῶν·
93 ὣς ὑπὸ Τυδεΐδῃ πυκιναὶ κλονέοντο φάλαγγες
94 Τρώων, οὐδ’ ἄρα μιν μίμνον πολέες περ ἐόντες.
95 τὸν δ’ ὡς οὖν ἐνόησε Λυκάονος ἀγλαὸς υἱὸς
96 θύνοντ’ ἂμ πεδίον πρὸ ἔθεν κλονέοντα φάλαγγας,
97 αἶψ’ ἐπὶ Τυδεΐδῃ ἐτιταίνετο καμπύλα τόξα,
98 καὶ βάλ’ ἐπαΐσσοντα τυχὼν κατὰ δεξιὸν ὦμον
99 θώρηκος γύαλον· διὰ δ’ ἔπτατο πικρὸς ὀϊστός,
100 ἀντικρὺ δὲ διέσχε, παλάσσετο δ’ αἵματι θώρηξ.
101 τῷ δ’ ἐπὶ μακρὸν ἄϋσε Λυκάονος ἀγλαὸς υἱός·
102 ὄρνυσθε Τρῶες μεγάθυμοι κέντορες ἵππων·
103 βέβληται γὰρ ἄριστος Ἀχαιῶν, οὐδέ ἕ φημι
104 δήθ’ ἀνσχήσεσθαι κρατερὸν βέλος, εἰ ἐτεόν με
105 ὦρσεν ἄναξ Διὸς υἱὸς ἀπορνύμενον Λυκίηθεν.
106 ὣς ἔφατ’ εὐχόμενος· τὸν δ’ οὐ βέλος ὠκὺ δάμασσεν,
107 ἀλλ’ ἀναχωρήσας πρόσθ’ ἵπποιιν καὶ ὄχεσφιν
108 ἔστη, καὶ Σθένελον προσέφη Καπανήϊον υἱόν·
109 ὄρσο πέπον Καπανηϊάδη, καταβήσεο δίφρου,
110 ὄφρά μοι ἐξ ὤμοιο ἐρύσσῃς πικρὸν ὀϊστόν.
111 ὣς ἄρ’ ἔφη, Σθένελος δὲ καθ’ ἵππων ἆλτο χαμᾶζε,
112 πὰρ δὲ στὰς βέλος ὠκὺ διαμπερὲς ἐξέρυσ’ ὤμου·
113 αἷμα δ’ ἀνηκόντιζε διὰ στρεπτοῖο χιτῶνος.
114 δὴ τότ’ ἔπειτ’ ἠρᾶτο βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
115 κλῦθί μευ αἰγιόχοιο Διὸς τέκος Ἀτρυτώνη,
116 εἴ ποτέ μοι καὶ πατρὶ φίλα φρονέουσα παρέστης
117 δηΐῳ ἐν πολέμῳ, νῦν αὖτ’ ἐμὲ φῖλαι Ἀθήνη·
118 δὸς δέ τέ μ’ ἄνδρα ἑλεῖν καὶ ἐς ὁρμὴν ἔγχεος ἐλθεῖν
119 ὅς μ’ ἔβαλε φθάμενος καὶ ἐπεύχεται, οὐδέ μέ φησι
120 δηρὸν ἔτ’ ὄψεσθαι λαμπρὸν φάος ἠελίοιο.

Thus did he vaunt; but his arrow had not killed Diomedes, who withdrew and made for the chariot and horses of Sthenelos, the son of Kapaneus. "Dear son of Kapaneus," said he, "come down from your chariot, and draw the arrow out of my shoulder." Sthenelos sprang from his chariot, and drew the arrow from the wound, whereon the blood came spouting out through the hole that had been made in his shirt. Then Diomedes prayed, saying, "Hear me, daughter of aegis-bearing Zeus, unweariable, if ever you loved my father well and stood by him in the thick of a fight, do the like now by me; grant me to come within a spear's

throw of that man and kill him. He has been too quick for me and has wounded me; and now he is boasting that I shall not see the light of the sun much longer." Thus he prayed, and Pallas Athena heard him; she made his limbs supple and quickened his hands and his feet. Then she went up close to him and said, "Fear not, Diomedes, to do battle with the Trojans, for I have set in your heart the spirit of your father, the horseman Tydeus. Moreover, I have withdrawn the veil from your eyes, that you know gods and men apart. If, then, any other god comes here and offers you battle, do not fight him; but should Zeus' daughter Aphrodite come, strike her with your spear and wound her." When she had said this Athena went away, and the son of Tydeus again took his place among the foremost fighters, three times more fierce even than he had been before. He was like a lion that some mountain shepherd has wounded, but not killed, as he is springing over the wall of a sheep-yard to attack the sheep. The shepherd has roused the brute to fury but cannot defend his flock, so he takes shelter under cover of the buildings, while the sheep, panic-stricken on being deserted, are smothered in heaps one on top of the other, and the angry lion leaps out over the sheep-yard wall. Even thus did Diomedes go furiously about among the Trojans. He killed Astynoos, and shepherd of his people, the one with a thrust of his spear, which struck him above the nipple, the other with a sword - cut on the collar-bone, that severed his shoulder from his neck and back. He let both of them lie, and went in pursuit of Abas and Polyidos, sons of the old man who read [krinô] dreams, Eurydamas: they never came back for him to read them any more dreams, for mighty Diomedes made an end of them. He then gave chase to Xanthos and Thoon, the two sons of Phainops, both of them very dear to him, for he was now worn out with age, and begat no more sons to inherit his possessions. But Diomedes took both their lives and left their father sorrowing bitterly, for he nevermore saw them come home from battle alive, and his kinsmen divided his wealth among themselves. Then he came upon two sons of Priam, Echemmon and Chromios, as they were both in one chariot. He sprang upon them as a lion fastens on the neck of some cow or heifer when the herd is feeding in a coppice. For all their vain struggles he flung them both from their chariot and stripped the armor from their bodies. Then he gave their horses to his comrades to take them back to the ships. When Aeneas saw him thus making havoc among the ranks, he went through the fight amid the rain of spears to see if he could find Pandaros. When he had found the brave son of Lykaon he said, "Pandaros, where is now your bow, your winged arrows, and your renown [kleos] as an archer, in respect of which no man here can rival you nor is there any in Lycia that can beat you? Lift then your hands to Zeus and send an arrow at this man who is going so masterfully about,

5.121

121 ὣς ἔφατ’ εὐχόμενος· τοῦ δ’ ἔκλυε Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη,
122 γυῖα δ’ ἔθηκεν ἐλαφρά, πόδας καὶ χεῖρας ὕπερθεν·
123 ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱσταμένη ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
124 θαρσῶν νῦν Διόμηδες ἐπὶ Τρώεσσι μάχεσθαι·
125 ἐν γάρ τοι στήθεσσι μένος πατρώϊον ἧκα
126 ἄτρομον, οἷον ἔχεσκε σακέσπαλος ἱππότα Τυδεύς·
127 ἀχλὺν δ’ αὖ τοι ἀπ’ ὀφθαλμῶν ἕλον ἣ πρὶν ἐπῆεν,
128 ὄφρ’ εὖ γιγνώσκῃς ἠμὲν θεὸν ἠδὲ καὶ ἄνδρα.
129 τὼ νῦν αἴ κε θεὸς πειρώμενος ἐνθάδ’ ἵκηται
130 μή τι σύ γ’ ἀθανάτοισι θεοῖς ἀντικρὺ μάχεσθαι
131 τοῖς ἄλλοις· ἀτὰρ εἴ κε Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἀφροδίτη
132 ἔλθῃσ’ ἐς πόλεμον, τήν γ’ οὐτάμεν ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ.
133 ἣ μὲν ἄρ’ ὣς εἰποῦσ’ ἀπέβη γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη,
134 Τυδεΐδης δ’ ἐξαῦτις ἰὼν προμάχοισιν ἐμίχθη
135 καὶ πρίν περ θυμῷ μεμαὼς Τρώεσσι μάχεσθαι·

136 δὴ τότε μιν τρὶς τόσσον ἔλεν μένος ὥς τε λέοντα
137 ὅν ῥά τε ποιμὴν ἀγρῷ ἐπ’ εἰροπόκοις ὀΐεσσι
138 χραύσῃ μέν τ’ αὐλῆς ὑπεράλμενον οὐδὲ δαμάσσῃ·
139 τοῦ μέν τε σθένος ὦρσεν, ἔπειτα δέ τ’ οὐ προσαμύνει,
140 ἀλλὰ κατὰ σταθμοὺς δύεται, τὰ δ’ ἐρῆμα φοβεῖται·
141 αἳ μέν τ’ ἀγχιστῖναι ἐπ’ ἀλλήλῃσι κέχυνται,
142 αὐτὰρ ὃ ἐμμεμαὼς βαθέης ἐξάλλεται αὐλῆς·
143 ὣς μεμαὼς Τρώεσσι μίγη κρατερὸς Διομήδης.
144 ἔνθ’ ἔλεν Ἀστύνοον καὶ Ὑπείρονα ποιμένα λαῶν,
145 τὸν μὲν ὑπὲρ μαζοῖο βαλὼν χαλκήρεϊ δουρί,
146 τὸν δ’ ἕτερον ξίφεϊ μεγάλῳ κληῖδα παρ’ ὦμον
147 πλῆξ’, ἀπὸ δ’ αὐχένος ὦμον ἐέργαθεν ἠδ’ ἀπὸ νώτου.
148 τοὺς μὲν ἔασ’, ὃ δ’ Ἄβαντα μετῴχετο καὶ Πολύειδον
149 υἱέας Εὐρυδάμαντος ὀνειροπόλοιο γέροντος·
150 τοῖς οὐκ ἐρχομένοις ὃ γέρων ἐκρίνατ’ ὀνείρους,

5.151

151 ἀλλά σφεας κρατερὸς Διομήδης ἐξενάριξε·
152 βῆ δὲ μετὰ Ξάνθόν τε Θόωνά τε Φαίνοπος υἱε
153 ἄμφω τηλυγέτω· ὃ δὲ τείρετο γήραϊ λυγρῷ,
154 υἱὸν δ’ οὐ τέκετ’ ἄλλον ἐπὶ κτεάτεσσι λιπέσθαι.
155 ἔνθ’ ὅ γε τοὺς ἐνάριζε, φίλον δ’ ἐξαίνυτο θυμὸν
156 ἀμφοτέρω, πατέρι δὲ γόον καὶ κήδεα λυγρὰ
157 λεῖπ’, ἐπεὶ οὐ ζώοντε μάχης ἐκνοστήσαντε
158 δέξατο· χηρωσταὶ δὲ διὰ κτῆσιν δατέοντο.
159 ἔνθ’ υἷας Πριάμοιο δύω λάβε Δαρδανίδαο
160 εἰν ἑνὶ δίφρῳ ἑόντας Ἐχέμμονά τε Χρομίον τε.
161 ὡς δὲ λέων ἐν βουσὶ θορὼν ἐξ αὐχένα ἄξῃ
162 πόρτιος ἠὲ βοὸς ξύλοχον κάτα βοσκομενάων,
163 ὣς τοὺς ἀμφοτέρους ἐξ ἵππων Τυδέος υἱὸς
164 βῆσε κακῶς ἀέκοντας, ἔπειτα δὲ τεύχε’ ἐσύλα·
165 ἵππους δ’ οἷς ἑτάροισι δίδου μετὰ νῆας ἐλαύνειν.
166 τὸν δ’ ἴδεν Αἰνείας ἀλαπάζοντα στίχας ἀνδρῶν,
167 βῆ δ’ ἴμεν ἄν τε μάχην καὶ ἀνὰ κλόνον ἐγχειάων
168 Πάνδαρον ἀντίθεον διζήμενος εἴ που ἐφεύροι·
169 εὗρε Λυκάονος υἱὸν ἀμύμονά τε κρατερόν τε,
170 στῆ δὲ πρόσθ’ αὐτοῖο ἔπος τέ μιν ἀντίον ηὔδα·
171 Πάνδαρε ποῦ τοι τόξον ἰδὲ πτερόεντες ὀϊστοὶ
172 καὶ κλέος; ᾧ οὔ τίς τοι ἐρίζεται ἐνθάδε γ’ ἀνήρ,
173 οὐδέ τις ἐν Λυκίῃ σέο γ’ εὔχεται εἶναι ἀμείνων.
174 ἀλλ’ ἄγε τῷδ’ ἔφες ἀνδρὶ βέλος Διὶ χεῖρας ἀνασχὼν
175 ὅς τις ὅδε κρατέει καὶ δὴ κακὰ πολλὰ ἔοργε
176 Τρῶας, ἐπεὶ πολλῶν τε καὶ ἐσθλῶν γούνατ’ ἔλυσεν·
177 εἰ μή τις θεός ἐστι κοτεσσάμενος Τρώεσσιν
178 ἱρῶν μηνίσας· χαλεπὴ δὲ θεοῦ ἔπι μῆνις.
179 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε Λυκάονος ἀγλαὸς υἱός·
180 Αἰνεία Τρώων βουληφόρε χαλκοχιτώνων
and has done such deadly work among the Trojans. He has killed many a brave man - unless indeed he is some god who is angry with the Trojans about their sacrifices, and has set his hand against them in his anger [mênis]." And the son of Lykaon answered, "Aeneas, I take him for none other than the son of Tydeus. I know him by his shield, the visor of his helmet,

and by his horses. It is possible that he may be a god, but if he is the man I say he is, he is not making all this havoc without heaven's help, but has some god by his side who is shrouded in a cloud of darkness, and who turned my arrow aside when it had hit him. I have taken aim at him already and hit him on the right shoulder; my arrow went through the breastplate of his cuirass; and I made sure I should send him hurrying to the world below, but it seems that I have not killed him. There must be a god who is angry with me. Moreover I have neither horse nor chariot. In my father's stables there are eleven excellent chariots, fresh from the builder, quite new, with cloths spread over them; and by each of them there stand a pair of horses, champing barley and rye; my old father Lykaon urged me again and again when I was at home and on the point of starting, to take chariots and horses with me that I might lead the Trojans in battle, but I would not listen to him; it would have been much better if I had done so, but I was thinking about the horses, which had been used to eat their fill, and I was afraid that in such a great gathering of men they might be ill-fed, so I left them at home and came on foot to Ilion armed only with my bow and arrows. These it seems, are of no use, for I have already hit two chieftains, the sons of Atreus and of Tydeus, and though I drew blood surely enough, I have only made them still more furious. I did ill to take my bow down from its peg on the day I led my band of Trojans to Ilion as a favor [kharis] to Hektor, and if ever I get home again to set eyes on my native place, my wife, and the greatness of my house, may some one cut my head off then and there if I do not break the bow and set it on a hot fire - such pranks as it plays me." Aeneas answered, "Say no more. Things will not mend till we two go against this man with chariot and horses and bring him to a trial of arms. Mount my chariot, and note how cleverly the horses of Tros can speed hither and thither over the plain in pursuit or flight. If Zeus again grants glory to the son of Tydeus they will carry us safely back to the city. Take hold, then, of the whip and reins while I stand upon the car to fight, or else do you wait this man's onset while I look after the horses." "Aeneas." replied the son of Lykaon, "take the reins and drive; if we have to flee before the son of Tydeus the horses will go better for their own driver. If they miss the sound of your voice when they expect it they may be frightened, and refuse to take us out of the fight. The son of Tydeus will then kill both of us and take the horses. Therefore drive them yourself and I will be ready for him with my spear." They then mounted the chariot and drove full-speed towards the son of Tydeus. Sthenelos, son of Kapaneus, saw them coming and said to Diomedes, "Diomedes, son of Tydeus, man after my own heart, I see two heroes speeding towards you, both of them men of might the one a skillful archer, Pandaros son of Lykaon, the other, Aeneas, whose sire is Anchises, while his mother is Aphrodite. Mount the chariot and let us retreat. Do not, I pray you, press so furiously forward, or you may get killed." Diomedes looked angrily at him and answered: "Talk not of flight, for I shall not listen to you: I am of a race that knows neither flight nor fear, and my limbs are as yet unwearied. I am in no mind to mount, but will go against them even as I am; Pallas Athena bids me be afraid of no man, and even though one of them escape, their steeds shall not take both back again. I say further, and lay my saying to your heart - if Athena sees fit to grant me the glory of killing both, stay your horses here and make the reins fast to the rim of the chariot; then be sure you spring Aeneas' horses and drive them from the Trojan to the Achaean ranks. They are of the stock that great Zeus gave to Tros in payment for his son Ganymede, and are the finest that live and move under the sun. King Anchises stole the blood by putting his mares to them without Laomedon's knowledge, and they bore him six foals. Four are still in his stables, but he gave the other two to Aeneas. We shall win great glory [kleos] if we can take them."

5.181

181 Τυδεΐδῃ μιν ἔγωγε δαΐφρονι πάντα ἐΐσκω,
182 ἀσπίδι γιγνώσκων αὐλώπιδί τε τρυφαλείῃ,

ἵππους τ’ εἰσορόων· σάφα δ’ οὐκ οἶδ’ εἰ θεός ἐστιν.
εἰ δ’ ὅ γ’ ἀνὴρ ὃν φημι δαΐφρων Τυδέος υἱὸς
οὐχ ὅ γ’ ἄνευθε θεοῦ τάδε μαίνεται, ἀλλά τις ἄγχι
ἕστηκ’ ἀθανάτων νεφέλῃ εἰλυμένος ὤμους,
ὃς τούτου βέλος ὠκὺ κιχήμενον ἔτραπεν ἄλλῃ.
ἤδη γάρ οἱ ἐφῆκα βέλος, καί μιν βάλον ὦμον
δεξιὸν ἀντικρὺ διὰ θώρηκος γυάλοιο·
καί μιν ἔγωγ’ ἐφάμην Ἀϊδωνῆϊ προϊάψειν,
ἔμπης δ’ οὐκ ἐδάμασσα· θεός νύ τίς ἐστι κοτήεις.
ἵπποι δ’ οὐ παρέασι καὶ ἅρματα τῶν κ’ ἐπιβαίην·
ἀλλά που ἐν μεγάροισι Λυκάονος ἕνδεκα δίφροι
καλοὶ πρωτοπαγεῖς νεοτευχέες· ἀμφὶ δὲ πέπλοι
πέπτανται· παρὰ δέ σφιν ἑκάστῳ δίζυγες ἵπποι
ἑστᾶσι κρῖ λευκὸν ἐρεπτόμενοι καὶ ὀλύρας.
ἦ μέν μοι μάλα πολλὰ γέρων αἰχμητὰ Λυκάων
ἐρχομένῳ ἐπέτελλε δόμοις ἔνι ποιητοῖσιν·
ἵπποισίν μ’ ἐκέλευε καὶ ἅρμασιν ἐμβεβαῶτα
ἀρχεύειν Τρώεσσι κατὰ κρατερὰς ὑσμίνας·
ἀλλ’ ἐγὼ οὐ πιθόμην· ἦ τ’ ἂν πολὺ κέρδιον ἦεν·
ἵππων φειδόμενος, μή μοι δευοίατο φορβῆς
ἀνδρῶν εἰλομένων εἰωθότες ἔδμεναι ἄδην.
ὣς λίπον, αὐτὰρ πεζὸς ἐς Ἴλιον εἰλήλουθα
τόξοισιν πίσυνος· τὰ δέ μ’ οὐκ ἄρ’ ἔμελλον ὀνήσειν.
ἤδη γὰρ δοιοῖσιν ἀριστήεσσιν ἐφῆκα
Τυδεΐδῃ τε καὶ Ἀτρεΐδῃ, ἐκ δ’ ἀμφοτέροιιν
ἀτρεκὲς αἷμ’ ἔσσευα βαλών, ἤγειρα δὲ μᾶλλον.
τώ ῥα κακῇ αἴσῃ ἀπὸ πασσάλου ἀγκύλα τόξα
ἤματι τῷ ἐλόμην ὅτε Ἴλιον εἰς ἐρατεινὴν

5.211

ἠγεόμην Τρώεσσι φέρων χάριν Ἕκτορι δίῳ.
εἰ δέ κε νοστήσω καὶ ἐσόψομαι ὀφθαλμοῖσι
πατρίδ’ ἐμὴν ἄλοχόν τε καὶ ὑψερεφὲς μέγα δῶμα,
αὐτίκ’ ἔπειτ’ ἀπ’ ἐμεῖο κάρη τάμοι ἀλλότριος φὼς
εἰ μὴ ἐγὼ τάδε τόξα φαεινῷ ἐν πυρὶ θείην
χερσὶ διακλάσσας· ἀνεμώλια γάρ μοι ὀπηδεῖ.
τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ Αἰνείας Τρώων ἀγὸς ἀντίον ηὔδα·
μὴ δ’ οὕτως ἀγόρευε· πάρος δ’ οὐκ ἔσσεται ἄλλως,
πρίν γ’ ἐπὶ νὼ τῷδ’ ἀνδρὶ σὺν ἵπποισιν καὶ ὄχεσφιν
ἀντιβίην ἐλθόντε σὺν ἔντεσι πειρηθῆναι.
ἀλλ’ ἄγ’ ἐμῶν ὀχέων ἐπιβήσεο, ὄφρα ἴδηαι
οἷοι Τρῴοι ἵπποι ἐπιστάμενοι πεδίοιο
κραιπνὰ μάλ’ ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα διωκέμεν ἠδὲ φέβεσθαι·
τὼ καὶ νῶϊ πόλιν δὲ σαώσετον, εἴ περ ἂν αὖτε
Ζεὺς ἐπὶ Τυδεΐδῃ Διομήδεϊ κῦδος ὀρέξῃ.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε νῦν μάστιγα καὶ ἡνία σιγαλόεντα
δέξαι, ἐγὼ δ’ ἵππων ἀποβήσομαι ὄφρα μάχωμαι·
ἠὲ σὺ τόνδε δέδεξο, μελήσουσιν δ’ ἐμοὶ ἵπποι.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε Λυκάονος ἀγλαὸς υἱός·
Αἰνεία σὺ μὲν αὐτὸς ἔχ’ ἡνία καὶ τεὼ ἵππω·
μᾶλλον ὑφ’ ἡνιόχῳ εἰωθότι καμπύλον ἅρμα

οἴσετον, εἴ περ ἂν αὖτε φεβώμεθα Τυδέος υἱόν·
μὴ τὼ μὲν δείσαντε ματήσετον, οὐδ' ἐθέλητον
ἐκφερέμεν πολέμοιο τεὸν φθόγγον ποθέοντε,
νῶϊ δ' ἐπαΐξας μεγαθύμου Τυδέος υἱὸς
αὐτώ τε κτείνῃ καὶ ἐλάσσῃ μώνυχας ἵππους.
ἀλλὰ σύ γ' αὐτὸς ἔλαυνε τέ' ἅρματα καὶ τεὼ ἵππω,
τὸν δὲ δ' ἐγὼν ἐπιόντα δεδέξομαι ὀξέϊ δουρί.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσαντες ἐς ἅρματα ποικίλα βάντες
ἐμμεμαῶτ' ἐπὶ Τυδεΐδῃ ἔχον ὠκέας ἵππους.

5.241

τοὺς δὲ ἴδε Σθένελος Καπανήϊος ἀγλαὸς υἱός,
αἶψα δὲ Τυδεΐδην ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Τυδεΐδη Διόμηδες ἐμῷ κεχαρισμένε θυμῷ,
ἄνδρ' ὀρόω κρατερὼ ἐπὶ σοὶ μεμαῶτε μάχεσθαι
ἶν' ἀπέλεθρον ἔχοντας· ὃ μὲν τόξων ἐὺ εἰδὼς
Πάνδαρος, υἱὸς δ' αὖτε Λυκάονος εὔχεται εἶναι·
Αἰνείας δ' υἱὸς μὲν ἀμύμονος Ἀγχίσαο
εὔχεται ἐκγεγάμεν, μήτηρ δέ οἵ ἐστ' Ἀφροδίτη.
ἀλλ' ἄγε δὴ χαζώμεθ' ἐφ' ἵππων, μηδέ μοι οὕτω
θῦνε διὰ προμάχων, μή πως φίλον ἦτορ ὀλέσσῃς.
τὸν δ' ἄρ' ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη κρατερὸς Διομήδης·
μή τι φόβον δ' ἀγόρευ', ἐπεὶ οὐδὲ σὲ πεισέμεν οἴω.
οὐ γάρ μοι γενναῖον ἀλυσκάζοντι μάχεσθαι
οὐδὲ καταπτώσσειν· ἔτι μοι μένος ἔμπεδόν ἐστιν·
ὀκνείω δ' ἵππων ἐπιβαινέμεν, ἀλλὰ καὶ αὖτως
ἀντίον εἶμ' αὐτῶν· τρεῖν μ' οὐκ ἐᾷ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη.
τούτω δ' οὐ πάλιν αὖτις ἀποίσετον ὠκέες ἵπποι
ἄμφω ἀφ' ἡμείων, εἴ γ' οὖν ἕτερός γε φύγῃσιν.
ἄλλο δέ τοι ἐρέω, σὺ δ' ἐνὶ φρεσὶ βάλλεο σῇσιν·
αἴ κέν μοι πολύβουλος Ἀθήνη κῦδος ὀρέξῃ
ἀμφοτέρω κτεῖναι, σὺ δὲ τούσδε μὲν ὠκέας ἵππους
αὐτοῦ ἐρυκακέειν ἐξ ἄντυγος ἡνία τείνας,
Αἰνείαο δ' ἐπαΐξαι μεμνημένος ἵππων,
ἐκ δ' ἐλάσαι Τρώων μετ' ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιούς.
τῆς γάρ τοι γενεῆς ἧς Τρωΐ περ εὐρύοπα Ζεὺς
δῶχ' υἷος ποινὴν Γανυμήδεος, οὕνεκ' ἄριστοι
ἵππων ὅσσοι ἔασιν ὑπ' ἠῶ τ' ἠέλιόν τε,
τῆς γενεῆς ἔκλεψεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγχίσης
λάθρῃ Λαομέδοντος ὑποσχὼν θήλεας ἵππους·
τῶν οἱ ἓξ ἐγένοντο ἐνὶ μεγάροισι γενέθλη.

5.271

τοὺς μὲν τέσσαρας αὐτὸς ἔχων ἀτίταλλ' ἐπὶ φάτνῃ,
τὼ δὲ δύ' Αἰνείᾳ δῶκεν μήστωρε φόβοιο.
εἰ τούτω κε λάβοιμεν, ἀροίμεθά κε κλέος ἐσθλόν.
ὣς οἳ μὲν τοιαῦτα πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἀγόρευον,
τὼ δὲ τάχ' ἐγγύθεν ἦλθον ἐλαύνοντ' ὠκέας ἵππους.
τὸν πρότερος προσέειπε Λυκάονος ἀγλαὸς υἱός·
καρτερόθυμε δαΐφρον ἀγαυοῦ Τυδέος υἱὲ

278 ἦ μάλα σ’ οὐ βέλος ὠκὺ δαμάσσατο πικρὸς ὀϊστός·
279 νῦν αὖτ’ ἐγχείῃ πειρήσομαι αἴ κε τύχωμι.
280 ἦ ῥα καὶ ἀμπεπαλὼν προΐει δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος
281 καὶ βάλε Τυδεΐδαο κατ’ ἀσπίδα· τῆς δὲ διὰ πρὸ
282 αἰχμὴ χαλκείη πταμένη θώρηκι πελάσθη·
283 τῷ δ’ ἐπὶ μακρὸν ἄϋσε Λυκάονος ἀγλαὸς υἱός·
284 βέβληαι κενεῶνα διαμπερές, οὐδέ σ’ ὀΐω
285 δηρὸν ἔτ’ ἀνσχήσεσθαι· ἐμοὶ δὲ μέγ’ εὖχος ἔδωκας.
286 τὸν δ’ οὐ ταρβήσας προσέφη κρατερὸς Διομήδης·
287 ἤμβροτες οὐδ’ ἔτυχες· ἀτὰρ οὐ μὲν σφῶΐ γ’ ὀΐω
288 πρίν γ’ ἀποπαύσεσθαι πρίν γ’ ἢ ἕτερόν γε πεσόντα
289 αἵματος ἆσαι Ἄρηα, ταλαύρινον πολεμιστήν.
290 ὣς φάμενος προέηκε· βέλος δ’ ἴθυνεν Ἀθήνη
291 ῥῖνα παρ’ ὀφθαλμόν, λευκοὺς δ’ ἐπέρησεν ὀδόντας.
292 τοῦ δ’ ἀπὸ μὲν γλῶσσαν πρυμνὴν τάμε χαλκὸς ἀτειρής,
293 αἰχμὴ δ’ ἐξελύθη παρὰ νείατον ἀνθερεῶνα·
294 ἤριπε δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων, ἀράβησε δὲ τεύχε’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ
295 αἰόλα παμφανόωντα, παρέτρεσσαν δέ οἱ ἵπποι
296 ὠκύποδες· τοῦ δ’ αὖθι λύθη ψυχή τε μένος τε.
297 Αἰνείας δ’ ἀπόρουσε σὺν ἀσπίδι δουρί τε μακρῷ
298 δείσας μή πώς οἱ ἐρυσαίατο νεκρὸν Ἀχαιοί.
299 ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ αὐτῷ βαῖνε λέων ὣς ἀλκὶ πεποιθώς,
300 πρόσθε δέ οἱ δόρυ τ’ ἔσχε καὶ ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην,
Thus did they converse, but the other two had now driven close up to them, and the son of Lykaon spoke first. "Great and mighty son," said he, "of noble Tydeus, my arrow failed to lay you low, so I will now try with my spear." He poised his spear as he spoke and hurled it from him. It struck the shield of the son of Tydeus; the bronze point pierced it and passed on till it reached the breastplate. Thereon the son of Lykaon shouted out and said, "You are hit clean through the belly; you will not stand out for long, and the glory of the fight is mine." But Diomedes all undismayed made answer, "You have missed, not hit, and before you two see the end of this matter one or other of you shall glut tough-shielded Ares with his blood." With this he hurled his spear, and Athena guided it on to Pandaros' nose near the eye. It went crashing in among his white teeth; the bronze point cut through the root of his to tongue, coming out under his chin, and his glistening armor rang rattling round him as he fell heavily to the ground. The horses started aside for fear, and he was reft of life [psukhê] and strength [menos]. Aeneas sprang from his chariot armed with shield and spear, fearing lest the Achaeans should carry off the body. He bestrode it as a lion in the pride of strength, with shield and on spear before him and a cry of battle on his lips resolute to kill the first that should dare face him. But the son of Tydeus caught up a mighty stone, so huge and great that as men now are it would take two to lift it; nevertheless he bore it aloft with ease unaided, and with this he struck Aeneas on the groin where the hip turns in the joint that is called the "cup-bone." The stone crushed this joint, and broke both the sinews, while its jagged edges tore away all the flesh. The hero fell on his knees, and propped himself with his hand resting on the ground till the darkness of night fell upon his eyes. And now Aeneas, king of men, would have perished then and there, had not his mother, Zeus' daughter Aphrodite, who had conceived him by Anchises when he was herding cattle, been quick to mark, and thrown her two white arms about the body of her dear son. She protected him by covering him with a fold of her own fair garment, lest some Danaan should drive a spear into his breast and kill him. Thus, then, did she bear her dear son out of the fight. But the son of Kapaneus was not unmindful of the orders that Diomedes had given him. He made his own horses fast, away from the struggle, by binding the reins

to the rim of the chariot. Then he sprang upon Aeneas' horses and drove them from the Trojan to the Achaean ranks. When he had so done he gave them over to his chosen comrade Deipylos, whom he valued above all others as the one who was most like-minded with himself, to take them on to the ships. He then remounted his own chariot, seized the reins, and drove with all speed in search of the son of Tydeus. Now the son of Tydeus was in pursuit of the Cyprian goddess, spear in hand, for he knew her to be feeble and not one of those goddesses that can lord it among men in battle like Athena or Enyo the waster of cities, and when at last after a long chase he caught her up, he flew at her and thrust his spear into the flesh of her delicate hand. The point tore through the ambrosial robe which the Graces [kharites] had woven for her, and pierced the skin between her wrist and the palm of her hand, so that the immortal blood, or ichor, that flows in the veins of the blessed gods, came pouring from the wound; for the gods do not eat bread nor drink wine, hence they have no blood such as ours, and are immortal. Aphrodite screamed aloud, and let her son fall, but Phoebus Apollo caught him in his arms, and hid him in a cloud of darkness, lest some Danaan should drive a spear into his breast and kill him; and Diomedes shouted out as he left her, "Daughter of Zeus, leave war and battle alone, can you not be contented with beguiling silly women? If you meddle with fighting you will get what will make you shudder at the very name of war."

5.301

301 τὸν κτάμεναι μεμαὼς ὅς τις τοῦ γ’ ἀντίος ἔλθοι
302 σμερδαλέα ἰάχων· ὃ δὲ χερμάδιον λάβε χειρὶ
303 Τυδεΐδης μέγα ἔργον ὃ οὐ δύο γ’ ἄνδρε φέροιεν,
304 οἷοι νῦν βροτοί εἰσ’· ὃ δέ μιν ῥέα πάλλε καὶ οἶος.
305 τῷ βάλεν Αἰνείαο κατ’ ἰσχίον ἔνθά τε μηρὸς
306 ἰσχίῳ ἐνστρέφεται, κοτύλην δέ τέ μιν καλέουσι·
307 θλάσσε δέ οἱ κοτύλην, πρὸς δ’ ἄμφω ῥῆξε τένοντε·
308 ὤσε δ’ ἀπὸ ῥινὸν τρηχὺς λίθος· αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἥρως
309 ἔστη γνὺξ ἐριπὼν καὶ ἐρείσατο χειρὶ παχείῃ
310 γαίης· ἀμφὶ δὲ ὄσσε κελαινὴ νὺξ ἐκάλυψε.
311 καί νύ κεν ἔνθ’ ἀπόλοιτο ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Αἰνείας,
312 εἰ μὴ ἄρ’ ὀξὺ νόησε Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἀφροδίτη
313 μήτηρ, ἥ μιν ὑπ’ Ἀγχίσῃ τέκε βουκολέοντι·
314 ἀμφὶ δ’ ἑὸν φίλον υἱὸν ἐχεύατο πήχεε λευκώ,
315 πρόσθε δέ οἱ πέπλοιο φαεινοῦ πτύγμα κάλυψεν
316 ἔρκος ἔμεν βελέων, μή τις Δαναῶν ταχυπώλων
317 χαλκὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσι βαλὼν ἐκ θυμὸν ἕλοιτο.
318 ἣ μὲν ἑὸν φίλον υἱὸν ὑπεξέφερεν πολέμοιο·
319 οὐδ’ υἱὸς Καπανῆος ἐλήθετο συνθεσιάων
320 τάων ἃς ἐπέτελλε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης,
321 ἀλλ’ ὅ γε τοὺς μὲν ἑοὺς ἠρύκακε μώνυχας ἵππους
322 νόσφιν ἀπὸ φλοίσβου ἐξ ἄντυγος ἠνία τείνας,
323 Αἰνείαο δ’ ἐπαΐξας καλλίτριχας ἵππους
324 ἐξέλασε Τρώων μετ’ ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιούς.
325 δῶκε δὲ Δηϊπύλῳ ἑτάρῳ φίλῳ, ὃν περὶ πάσης
326 τῖεν ὁμηλικίης ὅτι οἱ φρεσὶν ἄρτια ᾔδη,
327 νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσιν ἐλαυνέμεν· αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἥρως
328 ὧν ἵππων ἐπιβὰς ἔλαβ’ ἡνία σιγαλόεντα,
329 αἶψα δὲ Τυδεΐδην μέθεπε κρατερώνυχας ἵππους
330 ἐμμεμαώς· ὃ δὲ Κύπριν ἐπώχετο νηλέϊ χαλκῷ

5.331

331 γιγνώσκων ὅ τ’ ἄναλκις ἔην θεός, οὐδὲ θεάων
332 τάων αἵ τ’ ἀνδρῶν πόλεμον κάτα κοιρανέουσιν,
333 οὔτ’ ἄρ’ Ἀθηναίη οὔτε πτολίπορθος Ἐνυώ.
334 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἐκίχανε πολὺν καθ’ ὅμιλον ὀπάζων,
335 ἔνθ’ ἐπορεξάμενος μεγαθύμου Τυδέος υἱὸς
336 ἄκρην οὐτασε χεῖρα μετάλμενος ὀξέϊ δουρὶ
337 ἀβληχρήν· εἶθαρ δὲ δόρυ χροὸς ἀντετόρησεν
338 ἀμβροσίου διὰ πέπλου, ὅν οἱ Χάριτες κάμον αὐταί,
339 πρυμνὸν ὕπερ θέναρος· ῥέε δ’ ἄμβροτον αἷμα θεοῖο
340 ἰχώρ, οἷός πέρ τε ῥέει μακάρεσσι θεοῖσιν·
341 οὐ γὰρ σῖτον ἔδουσ’, οὐ πίνουσ’ αἴθοπα οἶνον,
342 τοὔνεκ’ ἀναίμονές εἰσι καὶ ἀθάνατοι καλέονται.
343 ἣ δὲ μέγα ἰάχουσα ἀπὸ ἕο κάββαλεν υἱόν·
344 καὶ τὸν μὲν μετὰ χερσὶν ἐρύσατο Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων
345 κυανέῃ νεφέλῃ, μή τις Δαναῶν ταχυπώλων
346 χαλκὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσι βαλὼν ἐκ θυμὸν ἕλοιτο·
347 τῇ δ’ ἐπὶ μακρὸν ἄϋσε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
348 εἶκε Διὸς θύγατερ πολέμου καὶ δηϊοτῆτος·
349 ἦ οὐχ ἅλις ὅττι γυναῖκας ἀνάλκιδας ἠπεροπεύεις;
350 εἰ δὲ σύ γ’ ἐς πόλεμον πωλήσεαι, ἦ τέ σ’ ὀΐω
351 ῥιγήσειν πόλεμόν γε καὶ εἴ χ’ ἑτέρωθι πύθηαι.
352 ὣς ἔφαθ’, ἣ δ’ ἀλύουσ’ ἀπεβήσετο, τείρετο δ’ αἰνῶς·
353 τὴν μὲν ἄρ’ Ἶρις ἐλοῦσα ποδήνεμος ἔξαγ’ ὁμίλου
354 ἀχθομένην ὀδύνῃσι, μελαίνετο δὲ χρόα καλόν.
355 εὗρεν ἔπειτα μάχης ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ θοῦρον Ἄρηα
356 ἥμενον· ἠέρι δ’ ἔγχος ἐκέκλιτο καὶ ταχέ’ ἵππω·
357 ἣ δὲ γνὺξ ἐριποῦσα κασιγνήτοιο φίλοιο
358 πολλὰ λισσομένη χρυσάμπυκας ᾔτεεν ἵππους·
359 φίλε κασίγνητε κόμισαί τέ με δός τέ μοι ἵππους,
360 ὄφρ’ ἐς Ὄλυμπον ἵκωμαι ἵν’ ἀθανάτων ἕδος ἐστί.

The goddess went dazed and discomfited away, and Iris, fleet as the wind, drew her from the throng, in pain and with her fair skin all besmirched. She found fierce Ares waiting on the left of the battle, with his spear and his two fleet steeds resting on a cloud; whereon she fell on her knees before her brother and implored him to let her have his horses. "Dear brother," she cried, "save me, and give me your horses to take me to Olympus where the gods dwell. I am badly wounded by a mortal, the son of Tydeus, who would now fight even with father Zeus." Thus she spoke, and Ares gave her his gold-bedizened steeds. She mounted the chariot sick and sorry at heart, while Iris sat beside her and took the reins in her hand. She lashed her horses on and they flew forward nothing loath, till in a trice they were at high Olympus, where the gods have their dwelling. There she stayed them, unloosed them from the chariot, and gave them their ambrosial forage; but Aphrodite flung herself on to the lap of her mother Dione, who threw her arms about her and caressed her, saying, "Which of the heavenly beings has been treating you in this way, as though you had been doing something wrong in the face of day?" And laughter-loving Aphrodite answered, "Proud Diomedes, the son of Tydeus, wounded me because I was bearing my dear son Aeneas, whom I love best of all humankind, out of the fight. The war is no longer one between Trojans and Achaeans, for the Danaans have now taken to fighting with the immortals." "Bear it, my child," replied Dione, "and make the best of it. We dwellers in Olympus have to put up with much at the hands of men, and we lay much suffering on one another. Ares had to suffer when Otos and Ephialtes, children of Aloeus, bound him in cruel

bonds, so that he lay thirteen months imprisoned in a vessel of bronze. Ares would have then perished had not fair Eeriboia, stepmother to the sons of Aloeus, told Hermes, who stole him away when he was already well-nigh worn out by the severity of his bondage. Hera, again, suffered when the mighty son of Amphitryon wounded her on the right breast with a three-barbed arrow, and nothing could assuage her pain. So, also, did huge Hades, when this same man, the son of aegis-bearing Zeus, hit him with an arrow even at the gates of Hades, and hurt him badly. Thereon Hades went to the house of Zeus on great Olympus, angry and full of pain [akhos]; and the arrow in his brawny shoulder caused him great anguish till Paieon healed him by spreading soothing herbs on the wound, for Hades was not of mortal mold. Daring, head-strong, evildoer who recked not of his evil deed in shooting the gods that dwell in Olympus. And now Athena has egged this son of Tydeus on against yourself, fool that he is for not reflecting that no man who fights with gods will live long or hear his children prattling about his knees when he returns from battle. Let, then, the son of Tydeus see that he does not have to fight with one who is stronger than you are. Then shall his brave wife Aigialeia, daughter of Adrastos, rouse her whole house from sleep, wailing for the loss of her wedded lord, Diomedes the bravest of the Achaeans." So saying, she wiped the ichor from the wrist of her daughter with both hands, whereon the pain left her, and her hand was healed. But Athena and Hera, who were looking on, began to taunt Zeus with their mocking talk, and Athena was first to speak. "Father Zeus," said she, "do not be angry with me, but I think the Cyprian must have been persuading some one of the Achaean women to go with the Trojans of whom she is so very fond, and while caressing one or other of them she must have torn her delicate hand with the gold pin of the woman's brooch." The sire of gods and men smiled, and called golden Aphrodite to his side. "My child," said he, "it has not been given you to be a warrior. Attend, henceforth, to your own delightful matrimonial duties, and leave all this fighting to Ares and to Athena." Thus did they converse. But Diomedes sprang upon Aeneas, though he knew him to be in the very arms of Apollo. Not one whit did he fear the mighty god, so set was he on killing Aeneas and stripping him of his armor. Thrice did he spring forward with might and main to slay him, and thrice did Apollo beat back his gleaming shield. When he was coming on for the fourth time, equal to a daimôn, Apollo shouted to him with an awful voice and said, "Take heed, son of Tydeus, and draw off; think not to match yourself against gods, for men that walk the earth cannot hold their own with the immortals."

5.361

361 λίην ἄχθομαι ἕλκος ὅ με βροτὸς οὔτασεν ἀνὴρ
362 Τυδεΐδης, ὃς νῦν γε καὶ ἂν Διὶ πατρὶ μάχοιτο.
363 ὣς φάτο, τῇ δ’ ἄρ’ Ἄρης δῶκε χρυσάμπυκας ἵππους·
364 ἣ δ’ ἐς δίφρον ἔβαινεν ἀκηχεμένη φίλον ἦτορ,
365 πὰρ δέ οἱ Ἶρις ἔβαινε καὶ ἡνία λάζετο χερσί,
366 μάστιξεν δ’ ἐλάαν, τὼ δ’ οὐκ ἀέκοντε πετέσθην.
367 αἶψα δ’ ἔπειθ’ ἵκοντο θεῶν ἕδος αἰπὺν Ὄλυμπον·
368 ἔνθ’ ἵππους ἔστησε ποδήνεμος ὠκέα Ἶρις
369 λύσασ’ ἐξ ὀχέων, παρὰ δ’ ἀμβρόσιον βάλεν εἶδαρ·
370 ἣ δ’ ἐν γούνασι πῖπτε Διώνης δῖ’ Ἀφροδίτη
371 μητρὸς ἑῆς· ἣ δ’ ἀγκὰς ἐλάζετο θυγατέρα ἥν,
372 χειρί τέ μιν κατέρεξεν ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἐκ τ’ ὀνόμαζε·
373 τίς νύ σε τοιάδ’ ἔρεξε φίλον τέκος Οὐρανιώνων
374 μαψιδίως, ὡς εἴ τι κακὸν ῥέζουσαν ἐνωπῇ;
375 τὴν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα φιλομμειδὴς Ἀφροδίτη·
376 οὗτά με Τυδέος υἱὸς ὑπέρθυμος Διομήδης,
377 οὕνεκ’ ἐγὼ φίλον υἱὸν ὑπεξέφερον πολέμοιο

Αἰνείαν, ὃς ἐμοὶ πάντων πολὺ φίλτατός ἐστιν.
οὐ γὰρ ἔτι Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν φύλοπις αἰνή,
ἀλλ᾽ ἤδη Δαναοί γε καὶ ἀθανάτοισι μάχονται.
τὴν δ᾽ ἠμείβετ᾽ ἔπειτα Διώνη, δῖα θεάων·
τέτλαθι τέκνον ἐμόν, καὶ ἀνάσχεο κηδομένη περ·
πολλοὶ γὰρ δὴ τλῆμεν Ὀλύμπια δώματ᾽ ἔχοντες
ἐξ ἀνδρῶν χαλέπ᾽ ἄλγε᾽ ἐπ᾽ ἀλλήλοισι τιθέντες.
τλῆ μὲν Ἄρης ὅτε μιν Ὦτος κρατερός τ᾽ Ἐφιάλτης
παῖδες Ἀλωῆος, δῆσαν κρατερῷ ἐνὶ δεσμῷ·
χαλκέῳ δ᾽ ἐν κεράμῳ δέδετο τρισκαίδεκα μῆνας·
καί νύ κεν ἔνθ᾽ ἀπόλοιτο Ἄρης ἆτος πολέμοιο,
εἰ μὴ μητρυιὴ περικαλλὴς Ἠερίβοια
Ἑρμέᾳ ἐξήγγειλεν· ὃ δ᾽ ἐξέκλεψεν Ἄρηα

5.391

ἤδη τειρόμενον, χαλεπὸς δέ ἑ δεσμὸς ἐδάμνα.
τλῆ δ᾽ Ἥρη, ὅτε μιν κρατερὸς πάϊς Ἀμφιτρύωνος
δεξιτερὸν κατὰ μαζὸν ὀϊστῷ τριγλώχινι
βεβλήκει· τότε καί μιν ἀνήκεστον λάβεν ἄλγος.
τλῆ δ᾽ Ἀΐδης ἐν τοῖσι πελώριος ὠκὺν ὀϊστόν,
εὖτέ μιν ωὐτὸς ἀνὴρ υἱὸς Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο
ἐν Πύλῳ ἐν νεκύεσσι βαλὼν ὀδύνῃσιν ἔδωκεν·
αὐτὰρ ὃ βῆ πρὸς δῶμα Διὸς καὶ μακρὸν Ὄλυμπον
κῆρ ἀχέων ὀδύνῃσι πεπαρμένος· αὐτὰρ ὀϊστὸς
ὤμῳ ἔνι στιβαρῷ ἠλήλατο, κῆδε δὲ θυμόν.
τῷ δ᾽ ἐπὶ Παιήων ὀδυνήφατα φάρμακα πάσσων
ἠκέσατ᾽· οὐ μὲν γάρ τι καταθνητός γε τέτυκτο.
σχέτλιος ὀβριμοεργὸς ὃς οὐκ ὄθετ᾽ αἴσυλα ῥέζων,
ὃς τόξοισιν ἔκηδε θεοὺς οἳ Ὄλυμπον ἔχουσι.
σοὶ δ᾽ ἐπὶ τοῦτον ἀνῆκε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·
νήπιος, οὐδὲ τὸ οἶδε κατὰ φρένα Τυδέος υἱὸς
ὅττι μάλ᾽ οὐ δηναιὸς ὃς ἀθανάτοισι μάχηται,
οὐδέ τί μιν παῖδες ποτὶ γούνασι παππάζουσιν
ἐλθόντ᾽ ἐκ πολέμοιο καὶ αἰνῆς δηϊοτῆτος.
τὼ νῦν Τυδεΐδης, εἰ καὶ μάλα καρτερός ἐστι,
φραζέσθω μή τίς οἱ ἀμείνων σεῖο μάχηται,
μὴ δὴν Αἰγιάλεια περίφρων Ἀδρηστίνη
ἐξ ὕπνου γοόωσα φίλους οἰκῆας ἐγείρῃ
κουρίδιον ποθέουσα πόσιν τὸν ἄριστον Ἀχαιῶν
ἰφθίμη ἄλοχος Διομήδεος ἱπποδάμοιο.
ἦ ῥα καὶ ἀμφοτέρῃσιν ἀπ᾽ ἰχῶ χειρὸς ὀμόργνυ·
ἄλθετο χείρ, ὀδύναι δὲ κατηπιόωντο βαρεῖαι.
αἳ δ᾽ αὖτ᾽ εἰσορόωσαι Ἀθηναίη τε καὶ Ἥρη
κερτομίοις ἐπέεσσι Δία Κρονίδην ἐρέθιζον.
τοῖσι δὲ μύθων ἦρχε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·

5.421

Ζεῦ πάτερ ἦ ῥά τί μοι κεχολώσεαι ὅττι κεν εἴπω;
ἦ μάλα δή τινα Κύπρις Ἀχαιϊάδων ἀνιεῖσα
Τρωσὶν ἅμα σπέσθαι, τοὺς νῦν ἔκπαγλα φίλησε,

424 τῶν τινα καρρέζουσα Ἀχαιϊάδων ἐϋπέπλων
425 πρὸς χρυσῇ περόνῃ καταμύξατο χεῖρα ἀραιήν.
426 ὣς φάτο, μείδησεν δὲ πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε,
427 καί ῥα καλεσσάμενος προσέφη χρυσῆν Ἀφροδίτην·
428 οὔ τοι τέκνον ἐμὸν δέδοται πολεμήϊα ἔργα,
429 ἀλλὰ σύ γ’ ἱμερόεντα μετέρχεο ἔργα γάμοιο,
430 ταῦτα δ’ Ἄρηϊ θοῷ καὶ Ἀθήνῃ πάντα μελήσει.
431 ὣς οἳ μὲν τοιαῦτα πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἀγόρευον,
432 Αἰνείᾳ δ’ ἐπόρουσε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης,
433 γιγνώσκων ὅ οἱ αὐτὸς ὑπείρεχε χεῖρας Ἀπόλλων·
434 ἀλλ’ ὅ γ’ ἄρ’ οὐδὲ θεὸν μέγαν ἄζετο, ἵετο δ’ αἰεὶ
435 Αἰνείαν κτεῖναι καὶ ἀπὸ κλυτὰ τεύχεα δῦσαι.
436 τρὶς μὲν ἔπειτ’ ἐπόρουσε κατακτάμεναι μενεαίνων,
437 τρὶς δέ οἱ ἐστυφέλιξε φαεινὴν ἀσπίδ’ Ἀπόλλων·
438 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ τὸ τέταρτον ἐπέσσυτο δαίμονι ἶσος,
439 δεινὰ δ’ ὀμοκλήσας προσέφη ἑκάεργος Ἀπόλλων·
440 φράζεο Τυδεΐδη καὶ χάζεο, μηδὲ θεοῖσιν
441 ἶσ’ ἔθελε φρονέειν, ἐπεὶ οὔ ποτε φῦλον ὁμοῖον
442 ἀθανάτων τε θεῶν χαμαὶ ἐρχομένων τ’ ἀνθρώπων.
443 ὣς φάτο, Τυδεΐδης δ’ ἀνεχάζετο τυτθὸν ὀπίσσω
444 μῆνιν ἀλευάμενος ἑκατηβόλου Ἀπόλλωνος.
445 Αἰνείαν δ’ ἀπάτερθεν ὁμίλου θῆκεν Ἀπόλλων
446 Περγάμῳ εἰν ἱερῇ, ὅθι οἱ νηός γε τέτυκτο.
447 ἤτοι τὸν Λητώ τε καὶ Ἄρτεμις ἰοχέαιρα
448 ἐν μεγάλῳ ἀδύτῳ ἀκέοντό τε κύδαινόν τε·
449 αὐτὰρ ὃ εἴδωλον τεῦξ’ ἀργυρότοξος Ἀπόλλων
450 αὐτῷ τ’ Αἰνείᾳ ἴκελον καὶ τεύχεσι τοῖον,
The son of Tydeus then gave way for a little space, to avoid the anger [mênis] of the god, while Apollo took Aeneas out of the crowd and set him in sacred Pergamos, where his temple stood. There, within the mighty sanctuary, Leto and Artemis healed him and made him glorious to behold, while Apollo of the silver bow fashioned a wraith in the likeness of Aeneas, and armed as he was. Round this the Trojans and Achaeans hacked at the bucklers about one another's breasts, hewing each other's round shields and light hide-covered targets. Then Phoebus Apollo said to Ares, "Ares, Ares, bane of men, blood-stained stormer of cities, can you not go to this man, the son of Tydeus, who would now fight even with father Zeus, and draw him out of the battle? He first went up to the Cyprian and wounded her in the hand near her wrist, and afterwards sprang upon me too, equal to a daimôn ." He then took his seat on the top of Pergamos, while murderous Ares went about among the ranks of the Trojans, cheering them on, in the likeness of fleet Akamas chief of the Thracians. "Sons of Priam," said he, "how long will you let your people be thus slaughtered by the Achaeans? Would you wait till they are at the walls of Troy? Aeneas the son of Anchises has fallen, he whom we held in as high honor as Hektor himself. Help me, then, to rescue our brave comrade from the stress of the fight." With these words he put heart and soul into them all. Then Sarpedon rebuked Hektor very sternly. "Hektor," said he, "where is your prowess now? You used to say that though you had neither people nor allies you could hold the town alone with your brothers and brothers-in-law. I see not one of them here; they cower as hounds before a lion; it is we, your allies, who bear the brunt of the battle. I have come from afar, even from Lycia and the banks of the river Xanthos, where I have left my wife, my infant son, and much wealth to tempt whoever is needy; nevertheless, I head my Lycian warriors and stand my ground against any who would fight me though I have nothing here for the Achaeans to plunder, while you look on, without even bidding your

men stand firm in defense of their wives. See that you fall not into the hands of your foes as men caught in the meshes of a net, and they sack your fair city forthwith. Keep this before your mind night and day, and beseech the leaders of your allies to hold on without flinching, and thus put away their reproaches from you." So spoke Sarpedon, and Hektor smarted under his words. He sprang from his chariot clad in his suit of armor, and went about among the host brandishing his two spears, exhorting the men to fight and raising the terrible cry of battle. Then they rallied and again faced the Achaeans, but the Argives stood compact and firm, and were not driven back. As the breezes sport with the chaff upon some goodly threshing-floor, when men are winnowing - while yellow Demeter blows with the wind to sift [krinô] the chaff from the grain, and the chaff- heaps grow whiter and whiter - even so did the Achaeans whiten in the dust which the horses' hoofs raised to the firmament of heaven, as their drivers turned them back to battle, and they bore down with might upon the foe. Fierce Ares, to help the Trojans, covered them in a veil of darkness, and went about everywhere among them, inasmuch as Phoebus Apollo had told him that when he saw Pallas, Athena leave the fray he was to put courage into the hearts of the Trojans - for it was she who was helping the Danaans. Then Apollo sent Aeneas forth from his rich sanctuary, and filled his heart with valor, whereon he took his place among his comrades, who were overjoyed at seeing him alive, sound, and of a good courage; but they could not ask him how it had all happened, for they had too much pain [ponos] with the turmoil raised by Ares and by Strife, who raged insatiably in their midst. The two Ajaxes, Odysseus and Diomedes, cheered the Danaans on, fearless of the fury and onset of the Trojans. They stood as still as clouds which the son of Kronos has spread upon the mountain tops when there is no air and fierce Boreas sleeps with the other boisterous winds whose shrill blasts scatter the clouds in all directions - even so did the Danaans stand firm and unflinching against the Trojans. The son of Atreus went about among them and exhorted them. "My friends," said he, "quit yourselves like brave men, and shun dishonor in one another's eyes amid the stress of battle. They that shun dishonor more often live than get killed, but they that flee save neither life nor name [kleos]." As he spoke he hurled his spear and hit one of those who were in the front rank, the comrade of Aeneas, Deikoön son of Pergasus, whom the Trojans held in no less honor than the sons of Priam, for he was ever quick to place himself among the foremost. The spear of King Agamemnon struck his shield and went right through it, for the shield stayed it not. It drove through his belt into the lower part of his belly, and his armor rang rattling round him as he fell heavily to the ground. Then Aeneas killed two champions of the Danaans, Crethon and Orsilokhos. Their father was a rich man who lived in the strong city of Phere and was descended from the river Alpheus, whose broad stream flows through the land of the Pylians. The river begat Orsilokhos, who ruled over many people and was father to Diokles, who in his turn begat twin sons, Crethon and Orsilokhos, well skilled in all the arts of war. These, when they grew up, went to Ilion with the Argive fleet in honor [timê] of Menelaos and Agamemnon sons of Atreus, and there they both of them reached the final outcome [telos]. As two lions whom their dam has reared in the depths of some mountain forest to plunder homesteads and carry off sheep and cattle till they get killed by the hand of man, so were these two vanquished by Aeneas, and fell like high pine-trees to the ground. Brave Menelaos pitied them in their fall, and made his way to the front, clad in gleaming bronze and brandishing his spear, for Ares egged him on to do so with intent that he should be killed by Aeneas; but Antilokhos the son of Nestor saw him and sprang forward, fearing that the king might come to harm and thus bring all their labor [ponos] to nothing; when, therefore Aeneas and Menelaos were setting their hands and spears against one another eager to do battle, Antilokhos placed himself by the side of Menelaos.

5.451

ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ εἰδώλῳ Τρῶες καὶ δῖοι Ἀχαιοὶ
δῄουν ἀλλήλων ἀμφὶ στήθεσσι βοείας
ἀσπίδας εὐκύκλους λαισήϊά τε πτερόεντα.
δὴ τότε θοῦρον Ἄρηα προσηύδα Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων·
Ἄρες Ἄρες βροτολοιγὲ μιαιφόνε τειχεσιπλῆτα,
οὐκ ἂν δὴ τόνδ’ ἄνδρα μάχης ἐρύσαιο μετελθὼν
Τυδεΐδην, ὃς νῦν γε καὶ ἂν Διὶ πατρὶ μάχοιτο;
Κύπριδα μὲν πρῶτα σχεδὸν οὔτασε χεῖρ’ ἐπὶ καρπῷ,
αὐτὰρ ἔπειτ’ αὐτῷ μοι ἐπέσσυτο δαίμονι ἶσος.
ὣς εἰπὼν αὐτὸς μὲν ἐφέζετο Περγάμῳ ἄκρῃ,
Τρῳὰς δὲ στίχας οὖλος Ἄρης ὄτρυνε μετελθὼν
εἰδόμενος Ἀκάμαντι θοῷ ἡγήτορι Θρῃκῶν·
υἱάσι δὲ Πριάμοιο διοτρεφέεσσι κέλευεν·
ὦ υἷες Πριάμοιο διοτρεφέος βασιλῆος
ἐς τί ἔτι κτείνεσθαι ἐάσετε λαὸν Ἀχαιοῖς;
ἦ εἰς ὅ κεν ἀμφὶ πύλῃς εὖ ποιητῇσι μάχωνται;
κεῖται ἀνὴρ ὃν ἶσον ἐτίομεν Ἕκτορι δίῳ
Αἰνείας υἱὸς μεγαλήτορος Ἀγχίσαο·
ἀλλ’ ἄγετ’ ἐκ φλοίσβοιο σαώσομεν ἐσθλὸν ἑταῖρον.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε μένος καὶ θυμὸν ἑκάστου.
ἔνθ’ αὖ Σαρπηδὼν μάλα νείκεσεν Ἕκτορα δῖον·
Ἕκτορ πῇ δή τοι μένος οἴχεται ὃ πρὶν ἔχεσκες;
φῆς που ἄτερ λαῶν πόλιν ἐξέμεν ἠδ’ ἐπικούρων
οἷος σὺν γαμβροῖσι κασιγνήτοισί τε σοῖσι.
τῶν νῦν οὔ τιν’ ἐγὼ ἰδέειν δύναμ’ οὐδὲ νοῆσαι,
ἀλλὰ καταπτώσσουσι κύνες ὣς ἀμφὶ λέοντα·
ἡμεῖς δὲ μαχόμεσθ’ οἵ πέρ τ’ ἐπίκουροι ἔνειμεν.
καὶ γὰρ ἐγὼν ἐπίκουρος ἐὼν μάλα τηλόθεν ἥκω·
τηλοῦ γὰρ Λυκίη Ξάνθῳ ἔπι δινήεντι,
ἔνθ’ ἄλοχόν τε φίλην ἔλιπον καὶ νήπιον υἱόν,

5.481

κἀδ δὲ κτήματα πολλά, τὰ ἔλδεται ὅς κ’ ἐπιδευής.
ἀλλὰ καὶ ὧς Λυκίους ὀτρύνω καὶ μέμον’ αὐτὸς
ἀνδρὶ μαχήσασθαι· ἀτὰρ οὔ τί μοι ἐνθάδε τοῖον
οἷόν κ’ ἠὲ φέροιεν Ἀχαιοὶ ἦ κεν ἄγοιεν·
τύνη δ’ ἕστηκας, ἀτὰρ οὐδ’ ἄλλοισι κελεύεις
λαοῖσιν μενέμεν καὶ ἀμυνέμεναι ὥρεσσι.
μή πως ὡς ἀψῖσι λίνου ἁλόντε πανάγρου
ἀνδράσι δυσμενέεσσιν ἕλωρ καὶ κύρμα γένησθε·
οἳ δὲ τάχ’ ἐκπέρσουσ’ εὖ ναιομένην πόλιν ὑμήν.
σοὶ δὲ χρὴ τάδε πάντα μέλειν νύκτάς τε καὶ ἦμαρ
ἀρχοὺς λισσομένῳ τηλεκλειτῶν ἐπικούρων
νωλεμέως ἐχέμεν, κρατερὴν δ’ ἀποθέσθαι ἐνιπήν.
ὣς φάτο Σαρπηδών, δάκε δὲ φρένας Ἕκτορι μῦθος·
αὐτίκα δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων σὺν τεύχεσιν ἅλτο χαμᾶζε,
πάλλων δ’ ὀξέα δοῦρα κατὰ στρατὸν ᾤχετο πάντῃ
ὀτρύνων μαχέσασθαι, ἔγειρε δὲ φύλοπιν αἰνήν.
οἳ δ’ ἐλελίχθησαν καὶ ἐναντίοι ἔσταν Ἀχαιῶν·
Ἀργεῖοι δ’ ὑπέμειναν ἀολλέες οὐδὲ φόβηθεν.

ὡς δ’ ἄνεμος ἄχνας φορέει ἱερὰς κατ’ ἀλωὰς
ἀνδρῶν λικμώντων, ὅτε τε ξανθὴ Δημήτηρ
κρίνῃ ἐπειγομένων ἀνέμων καρπόν τε καὶ ἄχνας,
αἳ δ’ ὑπολευκαίνονται ἀχυρμιαί· ὣς τότ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
λευκοὶ ὕπερθε γένοντο κονισάλῳ, ὃν ῥα δι’ αὐτῶν
οὐρανὸν ἐς πολύχαλκον ἐπέπληγον πόδες ἵππων
ἂψ ἐπιμισγομένων· ὑπὸ δ’ ἔστρεφον ἡνιοχῆες.
οἳ δὲ μένος χειρῶν ἰθὺς φέρον· ἀμφὶ δὲ νύκτα
θοῦρος Ἄρης ἐκάλυψε μάχῃ Τρώεσσιν ἀρήγων
πάντοσ’ ἐποιχόμενος· τοῦ δ’ ἐκραίαινεν ἐφετμὰς
Φοίβου Ἀπόλλωνος χρυσαόρου, ὅς μιν ἀνώγει
Τρωσὶν θυμὸν ἐγεῖραι, ἐπεὶ ἴδε Παλλάδ’ Ἀθήνην

5.511

οἰχομένην· ἣ γάρ ῥα πέλεν Δαναοῖσιν ἀρηγών.
αὐτὸς δ’ Αἰνείαν μάλα πίονος ἐξ ἀδύτοιο
ἦκε, καὶ ἐν στήθεσσι μένος βάλε ποιμένι λαῶν.
Αἰνείας δ’ ἐτάροισι μεθίστατο· τοὶ δὲ χάρησαν,
ὡς εἶδον ζωόν τε καὶ ἀρτεμέα προσιόντα
καὶ μένος ἐσθλὸν ἔχοντα· μετάλλησάν γε μὲν οὔ τι.
οὐ γὰρ ἔα πόνος ἄλλος, ὃν ἀργυρότοξος ἔγειρεν
Ἄρης τε βροτολοιγὸς Ἔρις τ’ ἄμοτον μεμαυῖα.
τοὺς δ’ Αἴαντε δύω καὶ Ὀδυσσεὺς καὶ Διομήδης
ὄτρυνον Δαναοὺς πολεμιζέμεν· οἳ δὲ καὶ αὐτοὶ
οὔτε βίας Τρώων ὑπεδείδισαν οὔτε ἰωκάς,
ἀλλ’ ἔμενον νεφέλῃσιν ἐοικότες ἄς τε Κρονίων
νηνεμίης ἔστησεν ἐπ’ ἀκροπόλοισιν ὄρεσσιν
ἀτρέμας, ὄφρ’ εὔδῃσι μένος Βορέαο καὶ ἄλλων
ζαχρειῶν ἀνέμων, οἵ τε νέφεα σκιόεντα
πνοιῇσιν λιγυρῇσι διασκιδνᾶσιν ἀέντες·
ὣς Δαναοὶ Τρῶας μένον ἔμπεδον οὐδὲ φέβοντο.
Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ἀν’ ὅμιλον ἐφοίτα πολλὰ κελεύων·
ὦ φίλοι ἀνέρες ἔστε καὶ ἄλκιμον ἦτορ ἔλεσθε,
ἀλλήλους τ’ αἰδεῖσθε κατὰ κρατερὰς ὑσμίνας·
αἰδομένων ἀνδρῶν πλέονες σόοι ἠὲ πέφανται·
φευγόντων δ’ οὔτ’ ἂρ κλέος ὄρνυται οὔτε τις ἀλκή.
ἦ καὶ ἀκόντισε δουρὶ θοῶς, βάλε δὲ πρόμον ἄνδρα
Αἰνείω ἕταρον μεγαθύμου Δηϊκόωντα
Περγασίδην, ὃν Τρῶες ὁμῶς Πριάμοιο τέκεσσι
τῖον, ἐπεὶ θοὸς ἔσκε μετὰ πρώτοισι μάχεσθαι.
τόν ῥα κατ’ ἀσπίδα δουρὶ βάλε κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων·
ἣ δ’ οὐκ ἔγχος ἔρυτο, διὰ πρὸ δὲ εἴσατο χαλκός,
νειαίρῃ δ’ ἐν γαστρὶ διὰ ζωστῆρος ἔλασσε·
δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, ἀράβησε δὲ τεύχε’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ.

5.541

ἔνθ’ αὖτ’ Αἰνείας Δαναῶν ἕλεν ἄνδρας ἀρίστους
υἷε Διοκλῆος Κρήθωνά τε Ὀρσίλοχόν τε,
τῶν ῥα πατὴρ μὲν ἔναιεν ἐϋκτιμένῃ ἐνὶ Φηρῇ
ἀφνειὸς βιότοιο, γένος δ’ ἦν ἐκ ποταμοῖο

Ἀλφειοῦ, ὅς τ’ εὐρὺ ῥέει Πυλίων διὰ γαίης,
ὃς τέκετ’ Ὀρτίλοχον πολέεσσ’ ἄνδρεσσιν ἄνακτα·
Ὀρτίλοχος δ’ ἄρ’ ἔτικτε Διοκλῆα μεγάθυμον,
ἐκ δὲ Διοκλῆος διδυμάονε παῖδε γενέσθην,
Κρήθων Ὀρσίλοχός τε μάχης εὖ εἰδότε πάσης.
τὼ μὲν ἄρ’ ἡβήσαντε μελαινάων ἐπὶ νηῶν
Ἴλιον εἰς εὔπωλον ἅμ’ Ἀργείοισιν ἐπέσθην,
τιμὴν Ἀτρεΐδῃς Ἀγαμέμνονι καὶ Μενελάῳ
ἀρνυμένω· τὼ δ’ αὖθι τέλος θανάτοιο κάλυψεν.
οἵω τώ γε λέοντε δύω ὄρεος κορυφῇσιν
ἐτραφέτην ὑπὸ μητρὶ βαθείης τάρφεσιν ὕλης·
τὼ μὲν ἄρ’ ἁρπάζοντε βόας καὶ ἴφια μῆλα
σταθμοὺς ἀνθρώπων κεραΐζετον, ὄφρα καὶ αὐτὼ
ἀνδρῶν ἐν παλάμῃσι κατέκταθεν ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ·
τοίω τὼ χείρεσσιν ὑπ’ Αἰνείαο δαμέντε
καππεσέτην, ἐλάτῃσιν ἐοικότες ὑψηλῇσι.
τὼ δὲ πεσόντ’ ἐλέησεν ἀρηΐφιλος Μενέλαος,
βῆ δὲ διὰ προμάχων κεκορυθμένος αἴθοπι χαλκῷ
σείων ἐγχείην· τοῦ δ’ ὄτρυνεν μένος Ἄρης,
τὰ φρονέων ἵνα χερσὶν ὑπ’ Αἰνείαο δαμείη.
τὸν δ’ ἴδεν Ἀντίλοχος μεγαθύμου Νέστορος υἱός,
βῆ δὲ διὰ προμάχων· περὶ γὰρ δίε ποιμένι λαῶν
μή τι πάθοι, μέγα δέ σφας ἀποσφήλειε πόνοιο.
τὼ μὲν δὴ χεῖράς τε καὶ ἔγχεα ὀξυόεντα
ἀντίον ἀλλήλων ἐχέτην μεμαῶτε μάχεσθαι·
Ἀντίλοχος δὲ μάλ’ ἄγχι παρίστατο ποιμένι λαῶν.

5.571

Αἰνείας δ’ οὐ μεῖνε θοός περ ἐὼν πολεμιστὴς
ὡς εἶδεν δύο φῶτε παρ’ ἀλλήλοισι μένοντε.
οἳ δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν νεκροὺς ἔρυσαν μετὰ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν,
τὼ μὲν ἄρα δειλὼ βαλέτην ἐν χερσὶν ἑταίρων,
αὐτὼ δὲ στρεφθέντε μετὰ πρώτοισι μαχέσθην.
ἔνθα Πυλαιμένεα ἐλέτην ἀτάλαντον Ἄρηϊ
ἀρχὸν Παφλαγόνων μεγαθύμων ἀσπιστάων.
τὸν μὲν ἄρ’ Ἀτρεΐδης δουρικλειτὸς Μενέλαος
ἑσταότ’ ἔγχεϊ νύξε κατὰ κληῖδα τυχήσας·
Ἀντίλοχος δὲ Μύδωνα βάλ’ ἡνίοχον θεράποντα
ἐσθλὸν Ἀτυμνιάδην· ὃ δ’ ὑπέστρεφε μώνυχας ἵππους·
χερμαδίῳ ἀγκῶνα τυχὼν μέσον· ἐκ δ’ ἄρα χειρῶν
ἡνία λεύκ’ ἐλέφαντι χαμαὶ πέσον ἐν κονίῃσιν.
Ἀντίλοχος δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπαΐξας ξίφει ἤλασε κόρσην·
αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἀσθμαίνων εὐεργέος ἔκπεσε δίφρου
κύμβαχος ἐν κονίῃσιν ἐπὶ βρεχμόν τε καὶ ὤμους.
δηθὰ μάλ’ ἑστήκει· τύχε γάρ ῥ’ ἀμάθοιο βαθείης·
ὄφρ’ ἵππω πλήξαντε χαμαὶ βάλον ἐν κονίῃσι·
τοὺς ἵμασ’ Ἀντίλοχος, μετὰ δὲ στρατὸν ἤλασ’ Ἀχαιῶν.
τοὺς δ’ Ἕκτωρ ἐνόησε κατὰ στίχας, ὦρτο δ’ ἐπ’ αὐτοὺς
κεκλήγων· ἅμα δὲ Τρώων εἵποντο φάλαγγες
καρτεραί· ἦρχε δ’ ἄρα σφιν Ἄρης καὶ πότνι’ Ἐνυώ,
ἣ μὲν ἔχουσα Κυδοιμὸν ἀναιδέα δηϊοτῆτος,

594 Ἄρης δ’ ἐν παλάμῃσι πελώριον ἔγχος ἐνώμα,
595 φοίτα δ’ ἄλλοτε μὲν πρόσθ’ Ἕκτορος, ἄλλοτ’ ὄπισθε.
596 τὸν δὲ ἰδὼν ῥίγησε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
597 ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἀνὴρ ἀπάλαμνος ἰὼν πολέος πεδίοιο
598 στήῃ ἐπ’ ὠκυρόῳ ποταμῷ ἅλα δὲ προρέοντι
599 ἀφρῷ μορμύροντα ἰδών, ἀνά τ’ ἔδραμ’ ὀπίσσω,
600 ὣς τότε Τυδεΐδης ἀνεχάζετο, εἶπέ τε λαῷ·
Aeneas, bold though he was, drew back on seeing the two heroes side by side in front of him, so they drew the bodies of Crethon and Orsilokhos to the ranks of the Achaeans and committed the two poor men into the hands of their comrades. They then turned back and fought in the front ranks. They killed Pylaimenes peer of Ares, leader of the Paphlagonian warriors. Menelaos struck him on the collar-bone as he was standing on his chariot, while Antilokhos hit his charioteer and squire [therapôn] Mydon, the son of Atymnios, who was turning his horses in flight. He hit him with a stone upon the elbow, and the reins, enriched with white ivory, fell from his hands into the dust. Antilokhos rushed towards him and struck him on the temples with his sword, whereon he fell head first from the chariot to the ground. There he stood for a while with his head and shoulders buried deep in the dust - for he had fallen on sandy soil till his horses kicked him and laid him flat on the ground, as Antilokhos lashed them and drove them off to the host of the Achaeans. But Hektor marked them from across the ranks, and with a loud cry rushed towards them, followed by the strong battalions of the Trojans. Ares and dread Enyo led them on, she fraught with ruthless turmoil of battle, while Ares wielded a monstrous spear, and went about, now in front of Hektor and now behind him. Diomedes shook with passion as he saw them. As a man crossing a wide plain is dismayed to find himself on the brink of some great river rolling swiftly to the sea - he sees its boiling waters and starts back in fear - even so did the son of Tydeus give ground. Then he said to his men, "My friends, how can we wonder that Hektor wields the spear so well? Some god is ever by his side to protect him, and now Ares is with him in the likeness of mortal man. Keep your faces therefore towards the Trojans, but give ground backwards, for we dare not fight with gods." As he spoke the Trojans drew close up, and Hektor killed two men, both in one chariot, Menesthes and Anchialos, heroes well versed in war. Ajax son of Telamon pitied them in their fall; he came close up and hurled his spear, hitting Amphios the son of Selagus, a man of great wealth who lived in Paesus and owned much grain-growing land, but his lot had led him to come to the aid of Priam and his sons. Ajax struck him in the belt; the spear pierced the lower part of his belly, and he fell heavily to the ground. Then Ajax ran towards him to strip him of his armor, but the Trojans rained spears upon him, many of which fell upon his shield. He planted his heel upon the body and drew out his spear, but the darts pressed so heavily upon him that he could not strip the goodly armor from his shoulders. The Trojan chieftains, moreover, many and valiant, came about him with their spears, so that he dared not stay; great, brave and valiant though he was, they drove him from them and he was beaten back. Thus, then, did the battle rage between them. Presently the strong hand of fate impelled Tlepolemos, the son of Herakles, a man both brave and of great stature, to fight Sarpedon; so the two, son and grandson of great Zeus, drew near to one another, and Tlepolemos spoke first. "Sarpedon," said he, "councilor of the Lycians, why should you come skulking here you who are a man of peace? They lie who call you son of aegis-bearing Zeus, for you are little like those who were of old his children. Far other was Herakles, my own brave and lion-hearted father, who came here for the horses of Laomedon, and though he had six ships only, and few men to follow him, sacked the city of Ilion and made a wilderness of her highways. You are a coward, and your people are falling from you. For all your strength, and all your coming from Lycia, you will be no help to the Trojans but will pass the gates of Hades vanquished by my hand." And Sarpedon, leader of the Lycians, answered, "Tlepolemos, your

father overthrew Ilion by reason of Laomedon's folly in refusing payment to one who had served him well. He would not give your father the horses which he had come so far to fetch. As for yourself, you shall meet death by my spear. You shall yield glory to myself, and your soul [psukhê] to Hades of the noble steeds." Thus spoke Sarpedon, and Tlepolemos upraised his spear. They threw at the same moment, and Sarpedon struck his foe in the middle of his throat; the spear went right through, and the darkness of death fell upon his eyes. Tlepolemos' spear struck Sarpedon on the left thigh with such force that it tore through the flesh and grazed the bone, but his father as yet warded off destruction from him.

5.601

601 ὦ φίλοι οἷον δὴ θαυμάζομεν Ἕκτορα δῖον
602 αἰχμητήν τ’ ἔμεναι καὶ θαρσαλέον πολεμιστήν·
603 τῷ δ’ αἰεὶ πάρα εἷς γε θεῶν, ὃς λοιγὸν ἀμύνει·
604 καὶ νῦν οἱ πάρα κεῖνος Ἄρης βροτῷ ἀνδρὶ ἐοικώς.
605 ἀλλὰ πρὸς Τρῶας τετραμμένοι αἰὲν ὀπίσσω
606 εἴκετε, μηδὲ θεοῖς μενεαινέμεν ἶφι μάχεσθαι.
607 ὣς ἄρ’ ἔφη, Τρῶες δὲ μάλα σχεδὸν ἦλυθον αὐτῶν.
608 ἔνθ’ Ἕκτωρ δύο φῶτε κατέκτανεν εἰδότε χάρμης
609 εἰν ἑνὶ δίφρῳ ἑόντε, Μενέσθην Ἀγχίαλόν τε.
610 τὼ δὲ πεσόντ’ ἐλέησε μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας·
611 στῆ δὲ μάλ’ ἐγγὺς ἰών, καὶ ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ,
612 καὶ βάλεν Ἄμφιον Σελάγου υἱόν, ὅς ῥ’ ἐνὶ Παισῷ
613 ναῖε πολυκτήμων πολυλήϊος· ἀλλά ἑ μοῖρα
614 ἦγ’ ἐπικουρήσοντα μετὰ Πρίαμόν τε καὶ υἷας.
615 τόν ῥα κατὰ ζωστῆρα βάλεν Τελαμώνιος Αἴας,
616 νειαίρῃ δ’ ἐν γαστρὶ πάγη δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος,
617 δούπησεν δὲ πεσών· ὃ δ’ ἐπέδραμε φαίδιμος Αἴας
618 τεύχεα συλήσων· Τρῶες δ’ ἐπὶ δούρατ’ ἔχευαν
619 ὀξέα παμφανόωντα· σάκος δ’ ἀνεδέξατο πολλά.
620 αὐτὰρ ὃ λὰξ προσβὰς ἐκ νεκροῦ χάλκεον ἔγχος
621 ἐσπάσατ’· οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔτ’ ἄλλα δυνήσατο τεύχεα καλὰ
622 ὤμοιιν ἀφελέσθαι· ἐπείγετο γὰρ βελέεσσι.
623 δεῖσε δ’ ὅ γ’ ἀμφίβασιν κρατερὴν Τρώων ἀγερώχων,
624 οἳ πολλοί τε καὶ ἐσθλοὶ ἐφέστασαν ἔγχε’ ἔχοντες,
625 οἵ ἑ μέγαν περ ἑόντα καὶ ἴφθιμον καὶ ἀγαυὸν
626 ὦσαν ἀπὸ σφείων· ὃ δὲ χασσάμενος πελεμίχθη.
627 ὣς οἳ μὲν πονέοντο κατὰ κρατερὴν ὑσμίνην·
628 Τληπόλεμον δ’ Ἡρακλεΐδην ἠΰν τε μέγαν τε
629 ὦρσεν ἐπ’ ἀντιθέῳ Σαρπηδόνι μοῖρα κραταιή.
630 οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντες

5.631

631 υἱός θ’ υἱωνός τε Διὸς νεφεληγερέταο,
632 τὸν καὶ Τληπόλεμος πρότερος πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπε·
633 Σαρπῆδον Λυκίων βουληφόρε, τίς τοι ἀνάγκη
634 πτώσσειν ἐνθάδ’ ἐόντι μάχης ἀδαήμονι φωτί;
635 ψευδόμενοι δέ σέ φασι Διὸς γόνον αἰγιόχοιο
636 εἶναι, ἐπεὶ πολλὸν κείνων ἐπιδεύεαι ἀνδρῶν
637 οἳ Διὸς ἐξεγένοντο ἐπὶ προτέρων ἀνθρώπων·

ἀλλ’ οἷόν τινά φασι βίην Ἡρακληείην
εἶναι, ἐμὸν πατέρα θρασυμέμνονα θυμολέοντα·
ὅς ποτε δεῦρ’ ἐλθὼν ἔνεχ’ ἵππων Λαομέδοντος
ἓξ οἵῃς σὺν νηυσὶ καὶ ἀνδράσι παυροτέροισιν
Ἰλίου ἐξαλάπαξε πόλιν, χήρωσε δ’ ἀγυιάς·
σοὶ δὲ κακὸς μὲν θυμός, ἀποφθινύθουσι δὲ λαοί.
οὐδέ τί σε Τρώεσσιν ὀΐομαι ἄλκαρ ἔσεσθαι
ἐλθόντ’ ἐκ Λυκίης, οὐδ’ εἰ μάλα καρτερός ἐσσι,
ἀλλ’ ὑπ’ ἐμοὶ δμηθέντα πύλας Ἄϊδαο περήσειν.
τὸν δ’ αὖ Σαρπηδὼν Λυκίων ἀγὸς ἀντίον ηὔδα·
Τληπόλεμ’ ἦτοι κεῖνος ἀπώλεσεν Ἴλιον ἰρὴν
ἀνέρος ἀφραδίῃσιν ἀγαυοῦ Λαομέδοντος,
ὅς ῥά μιν εὖ ἔρξαντα κακῷ ἠνίπαπε μύθῳ,
οὐδ’ ἀπέδωχ’ ἵππους, ὧν εἵνεκα τηλόθεν ἦλθε.
σοὶ δ’ ἐγὼ ἐνθάδε φημὶ φόνον καὶ κῆρα μέλαιναν
ἐξ ἐμέθεν τεύξεσθαι, ἐμῷ δ’ ὑπὸ δουρὶ δαμέντα
εὖχος ἐμοὶ δώσειν, ψυχὴν δ’ Ἄϊδι κλυτοπώλῳ.
ὣς φάτο Σαρπηδών, ὃ δ’ ἀνέσχετο μείλινον ἔγχος
Τληπόλεμος· καὶ τῶν μὲν ἁμαρτῇ δούρατα μακρὰ
ἐκ χειρῶν ἤϊξαν· ὃ μὲν βάλεν αὐχένα μέσσον
Σαρπηδών, αἰχμὴ δὲ διαμπερὲς ἦλθ’ ἀλεγεινή·
τὸν δὲ κατ’ ὀφθαλμῶν ἐρεβεννὴ νὺξ ἐκάλυψε.
Τληπόλεμος δ’ ἄρα μηρὸν ἀριστερὸν ἔγχεϊ μακρῷ

5.661

βεβλήκειν, αἰχμὴ δὲ διέσσυτο μαιμώωσα
ὀστέῳ ἐγχριμφθεῖσα, πατὴρ δ’ ἔτι λοιγὸν ἄμυνεν.
οἳ μὲν ἄρ’ ἀντίθεον Σαρπηδόνα δῖοι ἑταῖροι
ἐξέφερον πολέμοιο· βάρυνε δέ μιν δόρυ μακρὸν
ἑλκόμενον· τὸ μὲν οὔ τις ἐπεφράσατ’ οὐδὲ νόησε
μηροῦ ἐξερύσαι δόρυ μείλινον ὄφρ’ ἐπιβαίη
σπευδόντων· τοῖον γὰρ ἔχον πόνον ἀμφιέποντες.
Τληπόλεμον δ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
ἐξέφερον πολέμοιο· νόησε δὲ δῖος Ὀδυσσεὺς
τλήμονα θυμὸν ἔχων, μαίμησε δέ οἱ φίλον ἦτορ·
μερμήριξε δ’ ἔπειτα κατὰ φρένα καὶ κατὰ θυμὸν
ἢ προτέρω Διὸς υἱὸν ἐριγδούποιο διώκοι,
ἦ ὅ γε τῶν πλεόνων Λυκίων ἀπὸ θυμὸν ἔλοιτο.
οὐδ’ ἄρ’ Ὀδυσσῆϊ μεγαλήτορι μόρσιμον ἦεν
ἴφθιμον Διὸς υἱὸν ἀποκτάμεν ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ·
τώ ῥα κατὰ πληθὺν Λυκίων τράπε θυμὸν Ἀθήνη.
ἔνθ’ ὅ γε Κοίρανον εἶλεν Ἀλάστορά τε Χρομίον τε
Ἄλκανδρόν θ’ Ἅλιόν τε Νοήμονά τε Πρύτανίν τε.
καί νύ κ’ ἔτι πλέονας Λυκίων κτάνε δῖος Ὀδυσσεὺς
εἰ μὴ ἄρ’ ὀξὺ νόησε μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
βῆ δὲ διὰ προμάχων κεκορυθμένος αἴθοπι χαλκῷ
δεῖμα φέρων Δαναοῖσι· χάρη δ’ ἄρα οἱ προσιόντι
Σαρπηδὼν Διὸς υἱός, ἔπος δ’ ὀλοφυδνὸν ἔειπε·
Πριαμίδη, μὴ δή με ἕλωρ Δαναοῖσιν ἐάσῃς
κεῖσθαι, ἀλλ’ ἐπάμυνον· ἔπειτά με καὶ λίποι αἰὼν
ἐν πόλει ὑμετέρῃ, ἐπεὶ οὐκ ἄρ’ ἔμελλον ἔγωγε

687 νοστήσας οἶκον δὲ φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν
688 εὐφρανέειν ἄλοχόν τε φίλην καὶ νήπιον υἱόν.
689 ὣς φάτο, τὸν δ’ οὔ τι προσέφη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ,
690 ἀλλὰ παρήϊξεν λελιημένος ὄφρα τάχιστα
His comrades bore Sarpedon out of the fight, in great pain by the weight of the spear that was dragging from his wound. They were in such haste and stress [ponos] as they bore him that no one thought of drawing the spear from his thigh so as to let him walk uprightly. Meanwhile the Achaeans carried off the body of Tlepolemos, whereon Odysseus was moved to pity, and panted for the fray as he beheld them. He doubted whether to pursue the son of Zeus, or to make slaughter of the Lycian rank and file; it was not decreed, however, that he should slay the son of Zeus; Athena, therefore, turned him against the main body of the Lycians. He killed Koiranos, Alastor, Chromios, Alkandros, Halios, Noemon, and Prytanis, and would have slain yet more, had not great Hektor marked him, and sped to the front of the fight clad in his suit of mail, filling the Danaans with terror. Sarpedon was glad when he saw him coming, and besought him, saying, "Son of Priam, let me not he here to fall into the hands of the Danaans. Help me, and since I may not return home to gladden the hearts of my wife and of my infant son, let me die within the walls of your city." Hektor made him no answer, but rushed onward to fall at once upon the Achaeans and. kill many among them. His comrades then bore Sarpedon away and laid him beneath Zeus' spreading oak tree. Pelagon, his friend and comrade drew the spear out of his thigh, but Sarpedon lost his life-breath [psukhê], and a mist came over his eyes. Presently he came to again, for the breath of the north wind as it played upon him gave him new life, and brought him out of the deep swoon into which he had fallen. Meanwhile the Argives were neither driven towards their ships by Ares and Hektor, nor yet did they attack them; when they knew that Ares was with the Trojans they retreated, but kept their faces still turned towards the foe. Who, then, was first and who last to be slain by Ares and Hektor? They were valiant Teuthras, and Orestes the renowned charioteer, Trechos the Aetolian warrior, Oinomaos, Helenos the son of Oinops, and Oresbios of the gleaming belt, who was possessed of great wealth, and dwelt by the Cephisian lake with the other Boeotians who lived near him, owners of a fertile district [dêmos]. Now when the goddess Hera saw the Argives thus falling, she said to Athena, "Alas, daughter of aegis-bearing Zeus, unweariable, the promise we made Menelaos that he should not return till he had sacked the city of Ilion will be of none effect if we let Ares rage thus furiously. Let us go into the fray at once." Athena did not gainsay her. Thereon the august goddess, daughter of great Kronos, began to harness her gold-bedizened steeds. Hebe with all speed fitted on the eight-spoked wheels of bronze that were on either side of the iron axle-tree. The felloes of the wheels were of gold, imperishable, and over these there was a tire of bronze, wondrous to behold. The naves of the wheels were silver, turning round the axle upon either side. The car itself was made with plaited bands of gold and silver, and it had a double top-rail running all round it. From the body of the car there went a pole of silver, on to the end of which she bound the golden yoke, with the bands of gold that were to go under the necks of the horses Then Hera put her steeds under the yoke, eager for battle and the war-cry. Meanwhile Athena flung her richly embroidered vesture, made with her own hands, on to her father's threshold, and donned the shirt of Zeus, arming herself for battle. She threw her tasseled aegis about. her shoulders, wreathed round with Rout as with a fringe, and on it were Strife, and Strength, and Panic whose blood runs cold; moreover there was the head of the dread monster Gorgon,, grim and awful to behold, portent of aegis-bearing Zeus. On her head she set her helmet of gold, with four plumes, and coming to a peak both in front and behind - decked with the emblems of a hundred cities; then she stepped into her flaming chariot and grasped the spear, so stout and sturdy and strong, with which she quells the ranks of heroes who have displeased her. Hera lashed the horses on, and the gates of heaven

bellowed as they flew open of their own accord -gates over which the flours preside, in whose hands are Heaven and Olympus, either to open the dense cloud that hides them, or to close it. Through these the goddesses drove their obedient steeds, and found the son of Kronos sitting all alone on the topmost ridges of Olympus. There Hera stayed her horses, and spoke to Zeus the son of Kronos, lord of all. "Father Zeus," said she, "are you not angry with Ares for these high doings? how great and goodly a host of the Achaeans he has destroyed to my great grief [akhos], in violation of the order [kosmos] of things, while the Cyprian and Apollo are enjoying it all at their ease and setting this unrighteous madman on to keep on doing things that are not right [themis]. I hope, Father Zeus, that you will not be angry if I hit Ares hard, and chase him out of the battle." And Zeus answered, "Set Athena on to him, for she punishes him more often than any one else does." Hera did as he had said. She lashed her horses, and they flew forward nothing loath midway betwixt earth and sky. As far as a man can see when he looks out upon the sea [pontos] from some high beacon, so far can the loud-neighing horses of the gods spring at a single bound. When they reached Troy and the place where its two flowing streams Simoeis and Skamandros meet, there Hera stayed them and took them from the chariot. She hid them in a thick cloud, and Simoeis made ambrosia spring up for them to eat; the two goddesses then went on, flying like turtledoves in their eagerness to help the Argives. When they came to the part where the bravest and most in number were gathered about mighty Diomedes, fighting like lions or wild boars of great strength and endurance, there Hera stood still and raised a shout like that of brazen-voiced Stentor, whose cry was as loud as that of fifty men together. "Argives," she cried; "shame [aidôs] on cowardly creatures, brave in semblance only; as long as Achilles was fighting, his spear was so deadly that the Trojans dared not show themselves outside the Dardanian gates, but now they sally far from the city and fight even at your ships."

5.691

691 ὥσαιτ’ Ἀργείους, πολέων δ’ ἀπὸ θυμὸν ἔλοιτο.
692 οἳ μὲν ἄρ’ ἀντίθεον Σαρπηδόνα δῖοι ἑταῖροι
693 εἶσαν ὑπ’ αἰγιόχοιο Διὸς περικαλλέϊ φηγῷ·
694 ἐκ δ’ ἄρα οἱ μηροῦ δόρυ μείλινον ὦσε θύραζε
695 ἴφθιμος Πελάγων, ὅς οἱ φίλος ἦεν ἑταῖρος.
696 τὸν δ’ ἔλιπε ψυχή, κατὰ δ’ ὀφθαλμῶν κέχυτ’ ἀχλύς·
697 αὖτις δ’ ἐμπνύνθη, περὶ δὲ πνοιὴ Βορέαο
698 ζώγρει ἐπιπνείουσα κακῶς κεκαφηότα θυμόν.
699 Ἀργεῖοι δ’ ὑπ’ Ἄρηϊ καὶ Ἕκτορι χαλκοκορυστῇ
700 οὔτε ποτὲ προτρέποντο μελαινάων ἐπὶ νηῶν
701 οὔτε ποτ’ ἀντεφέροντο μάχῃ, ἀλλ’ αἰὲν ὀπίσσω
702 χάζονθ’, ὡς ἐπύθοντο μετὰ Τρώεσσιν Ἄρηα.
703 ἔνθα τίνα πρῶτον τίνα δ’ ὕστατον ἐξενάριξαν
704 Ἕκτωρ τε Πριάμοιο πάϊς καὶ χάλκεος Ἄρης;
705 ἀντίθεον Τεύθραντ’, ἐπὶ δὲ πλήξιππον Ὀρέστην,
706 Τρῆχόν τ’ αἰχμητὴν Αἰτώλιον Οἰνόμαόν τε,
707 Οἰνοπίδην θ’ Ἕλενον καὶ Ὀρέσβιον αἰολομίτρην,
708 ὅς ῥ’ ἐν Ὕλῃ ναίεσκε μέγα πλούτοιο μεμηλώς,
709 λίμνῃ κεκλιμένος Κηφισίδι· πὰρ δέ οἱ ἄλλοι
710 ναῖον Βοιωτοὶ μάλα πίονα δῆμον ἔχοντες.
711 τοὺς δ’ ὡς οὖν ἐνόησε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη
712 Ἀργείους ὀλέκοντας ἐνὶ κρατερῇ ὑσμίνῃ,
713 αὐτίκ’ Ἀθηναίην ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
714 ὢ πόποι αἰγιόχοιο Διὸς τέκος Ἀτρυτώνη,

ἦ ῥ’ ἅλιον τὸν μῦθον ὑπέστημεν Μενελάῳ
Ἴλιον ἐκπέρσαντ’ εὐτείχεον ἀπονέεσθαι,
εἰ οὕτω μαίνεσθαι ἐάσομεν οὖλον Ἄρηα.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ καὶ νῶϊ μεδώμεθα θούριδος ἀλκῆς.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη.
ἣ μὲν ἐποιχομένη χρυσάμπυκας ἔντυεν ἵππους

5.721

Ἥρη πρέσβα θεὰ θυγάτηρ μεγάλοιο Κρόνοιο·
Ἥβη δ’ ἀμφ’ ὀχέεσσι θοῶς βάλε καμπύλα κύκλα
χάλκεα ὀκτάκνημα σιδηρέῳ ἄξονι ἀμφίς.
τῶν ἧτοι χρυσέη ἴτυς ἄφθιτος, αὐτὰρ ὕπερθε
χάλκε’ ἐπίσσωτρα προσαρηρότα, θαῦμα ἰδέσθαι·
πλῆμναι δ’ ἀργύρου εἰσὶ περίδρομοι ἀμφοτέρωθεν·
δίφρος δὲ χρυσέοισι καὶ ἀργυρέοισιν ἱμᾶσιν
ἐντέταται, δοιαὶ δὲ περίδρομοι ἄντυγές εἰσι.
τοῦ δ’ ἐξ ἀργύρεος ῥυμὸς πέλεν· αὐτὰρ ἐπ’ ἄκρῳ
δῆσε χρύσειον καλὸν ζυγόν, ἐν δὲ λέπαδνα
κάλ’ ἔβαλε χρύσει’· ὑπὸ δὲ ζυγὸν ἤγαγεν Ἥρη
ἵππους ὠκύποδας, μεμαυῖ’ ἔριδος καὶ ἀϋτῆς.
αὐτὰρ Ἀθηναίη κούρη Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο
πέπλον μὲν κατέχευεν ἑανὸν πατρὸς ἐπ’ οὔδει
ποικίλον, ὅν ῥ’ αὐτὴ ποιήσατο καὶ κάμε χερσίν·
ἣ δὲ χιτῶν’ ἐνδῦσα Διὸς νεφεληγερέταο
τεύχεσιν ἐς πόλεμον θωρήσσετο δακρυόεντα.
ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ ὤμοισιν βάλετ’ αἰγίδα θυσσανόεσσαν
δεινήν, ἣν περὶ μὲν πάντῃ Φόβος ἐστεφάνωται,
ἐν δ’ Ἔρις, ἐν δ’ Ἀλκή, ἐν δὲ κρυόεσσα Ἰωκή,
ἐν δέ τε Γοργείη κεφαλὴ δεινοῖο πελώρου
δεινή τε σμερδνή τε, Διὸς τέρας αἰγιόχοιο.
κρατὶ δ’ ἐπ’ ἀμφίφαλον κυνέην θέτο τετραφάληρον
χρυσείην, ἑκατὸν πολίων πρυλέεσσ’ ἀραρυῖαν·
ἐς δ’ ὄχεα φλόγεα ποσὶ βήσετο, λάζετο δ’ ἔγχος
βριθὺ μέγα στιβαρόν, τῷ δάμνησι στίχας ἀνδρῶν
ἡρώων, οἷσίν τε κοτέσσεται ὀβριμοπάτρη.
Ἥρη δὲ μάστιγι θοῶς ἐπεμαίετ’ ἄρ’ ἵππους·
αὐτόμαται δὲ πύλαι μύκον οὐρανοῦ ἂς ἔχον Ὧραι,
τῇς ἐπιτέτραπται μέγας οὐρανὸς Οὔλυμπός τε

5.751

ἠμὲν ἀνακλῖναι πυκινὸν νέφος ἠδ’ ἐπιθεῖναι.
τῇ ῥα δι’ αὐτάων κεντρηνεκέας ἔχον ἵππους·
εὗρον δὲ Κρονίωνα θεῶν ἄτερ ἥμενον ἄλλων
ἀκροτάτῃ κορυφῇ πολυδειράδος Οὐλύμποιο.
ἔνθ’ ἵππους στήσασα θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη
Ζῆν’ ὕπατον Κρονίδην ἐξείρετο καὶ προσέειπε·
Ζεῦ πάτερ οὐ νεμεσίζῃ Ἄρῃ τάδε καρτερὰ ἔργα
ὁσσάτιόν τε καὶ οἷον ἀπώλεσε λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν
μὰψ ἀτὰρ οὐ κατὰ κόσμον ἐμοὶ δ’ ἄχος, οἳ δὲ ἔκηλοι
τέρπονται Κύπρίς τε καὶ ἀργυρότοξος Ἀπόλλων

761 ἄφρονα τοῦτον ἀνέντες, ὃς οὔ τινα οἶδε θέμιστα;
762 Ζεῦ πάτερ ἦ ῥά τί μοι κεχολώσεαι, αἴ κεν Ἄρηα
763 λυγρῶς πεπληγυῖα μάχης ἐξαποδίωμαι;
764 τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
765 ἄγρει μάν οἱ ἔπορσον Ἀθηναίην ἀγελείην,
766 ἥ ἐ μάλιστ’ εἴωθε κακῇς ὀδύνῃσι πελάζειν.
767 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη,
768 μάστιξεν δ’ ἵππους· τὼ δ’ οὐκ ἀέκοντε πετέσθην
769 μεσσηγὺς γαίης τε καὶ οὐρανοῦ ἀστερόεντος.
770 ὅσσον δ’ ἠεροειδὲς ἀνὴρ ἴδεν ὀφθαλμοῖσιν
771 ἥμενος ἐν σκοπιῇ, λεύσσων ἐπὶ οἰνοπα πόντον,
772 τόσσον ἐπιθρῴσκουσι θεῶν ὑψηχέες ἵπποι.
773 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ Τροίην ἶξον ποταμώ τε ῥέοντε,
774 ἧχι ῥοὰς Σιμόεις συμβάλλετον ἠδὲ Σκάμανδρος,
775 ἔνθ’ ἵππους ἔστησε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη
776 λύσασ’ ἐξ ὀχέων, περὶ δ’ ἠέρα πουλὺν ἔχευε·
777 τοῖσιν δ’ ἀμβροσίην Σιμόεις ἀνέτειλε νέμεσθαι.
778 αἳ δὲ βάτην τρήρωσι πελειάσιν ἴθμαθ’ ὁμοῖαι
779 ἀνδράσιν Ἀργείοισιν ἀλεξέμεναι μεμαυῖαι·
780 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἵκανον ὅθι πλεῖστοι καὶ ἄριστοι

5.781

781 ἔστασαν ἀμφὶ βίην Διομήδεος ἱπποδάμοιο
782 εἰλόμενοι λείουσιν ἐοικότες ὠμοφάγοισιν
783 ἢ συσὶ κάπροισιν, τῶν τε σθένος οὐκ ἀλαπαδνόν,
784 ἔνθα στᾶσ’ ἤϋσε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη
785 Στέντορι εἰσαμένη μεγαλήτορι χαλκεοφώνῳ,
786 ὃς τόσον αὐδήσασχ’ ὅσον ἄλλοι πεντήκοντα·
787 αἰδὼς Ἀργεῖοι κάκ’ ἐλέγχεα εἶδος ἀγητοί·
788 ὄφρα μὲν ἐς πόλεμον πωλέσκετο δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
789 οὐδέ ποτε Τρῶες πρὸ πυλάων Δαρδανιάων
790 οἴχνεσκον· κείνου γὰρ ἐδείδισαν ὄβριμον ἔγχος·
791 νῦν δὲ ἑκὰς πόλιος κοίλῃς ἐπὶ νηυσὶ μάχονται.
792 ὣς εἰποῦσ’ ὄτρυνε μένος καὶ θυμὸν ἑκάστου.
793 Τυδεΐδῃ δ’ ἐπόρουσε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·
794 εὗρε δὲ τόν γε ἄνακτα παρ’ ἵπποισιν καὶ ὄχεσφιν
795 ἕλκος ἀναψύχοντα τό μιν βάλε Πάνδαρος ἰῷ.
796 ἰδρὼς γάρ μιν ἔτειρεν ὑπὸ πλατέος τελαμῶνος
797 ἀσπίδος εὐκύκλου· τῷ τείρετο, κάμνε δὲ χεῖρα,
798 ἂν δ’ ἴσχων τελαμῶνα κελαινεφὲς αἷμ’ ἀπομόργνυ.
799 ἱππείου δὲ θεὰ ζυγοῦ ἅψατο φώνησέν τε·
800 ἦ ὀλίγον οἷ παῖδα ἐοικότα γείνατο Τυδεύς.
801 Τυδεύς τοι μικρὸς μὲν ἔην δέμας, ἀλλὰ μαχητής·
802 καί ῥ’ ὅτε πέρ μιν ἐγὼ πολεμίζειν οὐκ εἴασκον
803 οὐδ’ ἐκπαιφάσσειν, ὅτε τ’ ἦλυθε νόσφιν Ἀχαιῶν
804 ἄγγελος ἐς Θήβας πολέας μετὰ Καδμείωνας·
805 δαίνυσθαί μιν ἄνωγον ἐνὶ μεγάροισιν ἔκηλον·
806 αὐτὰρ ὃ θυμὸν ἔχων ὃν καρτερὸν ὡς τὸ πάρος περ
807 κούρους Καδμείων προκαλίζετο, πάντα δ’ ἐνίκα
808 ῥηϊδίως· τοίη οἱ ἐγὼν ἐπιτάρροθος ἦα.
809 σοὶ δ’ ἤτοι μὲν ἐγὼ παρά θ’ ἵσταμαι ἠδὲ φυλάσσω,

810 καί σε προφρονέως κέλομαι Τρώεσσι μάχεσθαι·
With these words she put heart and soul into them all, while Athena sprang to the side of the son of Tydeus, whom she found near his chariot and horses, cooling the wound that Pandaros had given him. For the sweat caused by the hand that bore the weight of his shield irritated the hurt: his arm was weary with pain, and he was lifting up the strap to wipe away the blood. The goddess laid her hand on the yoke of his horses and said, "The son of Tydeus is not such another as his father. Tydeus was a little man, but he could fight, and rushed madly into the fray even when I told him not to do so. When he went all unattended as envoy to the city of Thebes among the Cadmeans, I bade him feast in their houses and be at peace; but with that high spirit which was ever present with him, he challenged the youth of the Cadmeans, and at once beat them in all that he attempted, so mightily did I help him. I stand by you too to protect you, and I bid you be instant in fighting the Trojans; but either you are tired out, or you are afraid and out of heart, and in that case I say that you are no true son of Tydeus the son of Oeneus." Diomedes answered, "I know you, goddess, daughter of aegis-bearing Zeus, and will hide nothing from you. I am not afraid nor out of heart, nor is there any slackness in me. I am only following your own instructions; you told me not to fight any of the blessed gods; but if Zeus' daughter Aphrodite came into battle I was to wound her with my spear. Therefore I am retreating, and bidding the other Argives gather in this place, for I know that Ares is now lording it in the field." "Diomedes, son of Tydeus," replied Athena, "man after my own heart, fear neither Ares nor any other of the immortals, for I will befriend you. Nay, drive straight at Ares, and smite him in close combat; fear not this raging madman, villain incarnate, first on one side and then on the other. But now he was holding talk with Hera and myself, saying he would help the Argives and attack the Trojans; nevertheless he is with the Trojans, and has forgotten the Argives." With this she caught hold of Sthenelos and lifted him off the chariot on to the ground. In a second he was on the ground, whereupon the goddess mounted the car and placed herself by the side of Diomedes. The oaken axle groaned aloud under the burden of the awful goddess and the hero; Pallas Athena took the whip and reins, and drove straight at Ares. He was in the act of stripping huge Periphas, son of Ochesios and bravest of the Aetolians. Bloody Ares was stripping him of his armor, and Athena donned the helmet of Hades, that he might not see her; when, therefore, he saw Diomedes, he made straight for him and let Periphas lie where he had fallen. As soon as they were at close quarters he let fly with his bronze spear over the reins and yoke, thinking to take the life of Diomedes, but Athena caught the spear in her hand and made it fly harmlessly over the chariot. Diomedes then threw, and Pallas Athena drove the spear into the pit of Ares' stomach where his under-belt went round him. There Diomedes wounded him, tearing his fair flesh and then drawing his spear out again. Ares roared as loudly as nine or ten thousand men in the thick of a fight, and the Achaeans and Trojans were struck with panic, so terrible was the cry he raised. As a dark cloud in the sky when it comes on to blow after heat, even so did Diomedes son of Tydeus see Ares ascend into the broad heavens. With all speed he reached high Olympus, home of the gods, and in great pain sat down beside Zeus the son of Kronos. He showed Zeus the immortal blood that was flowing from his wound, and spoke piteously, saying, "Father Zeus, are you not angered by such doings? We gods are continually suffering in the most cruel manner at one another's hands while doing a favor [kharis] for mortals; and we all owe you a grudge for having begotten that mad termagant of a daughter, who is always committing outrage of some kind. We other gods must all do as you bid us, but her you neither scold nor punish; you encourage her because the pestilent creature is your daughter. See how she has been inciting proud Diomedes to vent his rage on the immortal gods. First he went up to the Cyprian and wounded her in the hand near her wrist, and then he sprang upon me too, equal to a daimôn. Had I not run for it I must either have lain there for long enough in torments among the ghastly corpses, or

have been eaten alive with spears till I had no more strength left in me." Zeus looked angrily at him and said, "Do not come whining here, Sir Facing-bothways. I hate you worst of all the gods in Olympus, for you are ever fighting and making mischief. You have the intolerable and stubborn spirit of your mother Hera: it is all I can do to manage her, and it is her doing that you are now in this plight: still, I cannot let you remain longer in such great pain; you are my own off-spring, and it was by me that your mother conceived you; if, however, you had been the son of any other god, you are so destructive that by this time you should have been lying lower than the Titans." He then bade Paieon heal him, whereon Paieon spread pain-killing herbs upon his wound and cured him, for he was not of mortal mold. As the juice of the fig-tree curdles milk, and thickens it in a moment though it is liquid, even so instantly did Paieon cure fierce Ares. Then Hebe washed him, and clothed him in goodly raiment, and he took his seat by his father Zeus all glorious to behold. But Hera of Argos and Athena of Alalkomene, now that they had put a stop to the murderous doings of Ares, went back again to the house of Zeus.

5.811

ἀλλά σευ ἢ κάματος πολυᾶϊξ γυῖα δέδυκεν
ἤ νύ σέ που δέος ἴσχει ἀκήριον· οὐ σύ γ’ ἔπειτα
Τυδέος ἔκγονός ἐσσι δαΐφρονος Οἰνεΐδαο.
τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη κρατερὸς Διομήδης·
γιγνώσκω σε θεὰ θύγατερ Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο·
τώ τοι προφρονέως ἐρέω ἔπος οὐδ’ ἐπικεύσω.
οὔτέ τί με δέος ἴσχει ἀκήριον οὔτέ τις ὄκνος,
ἀλλ’ ἔτι σέων μέμνημαι ἐφετμέων ἃς ἐπέτειλας·
οὔ μ’ εἴας μακάρεσσι θεοῖς ἀντικρὺ μάχεσθαι
τοῖς ἄλλοις· ἀτὰρ εἴ κε Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἀφροδίτη
ἔλθῃσ’ ἐς πόλεμον, τήν γ’ οὐτάμεν ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ.
τοὔνεκα νῦν αὐτός τ’ ἀναχάζομαι ἠδὲ καὶ ἄλλους
Ἀργείους ἐκέλευσα ἀλήμεναι ἐνθάδε πάντας·
γιγνώσκω γὰρ Ἄρηα μάχην ἀνὰ κοιρανέοντα.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·
Τυδεΐδη Διόμηδες ἐμῷ κεχαρισμένε θυμῷ
μήτε σύ γ’ Ἄρηα τό γε δείδιθι μήτε τιν’ ἄλλον
ἀθανάτων, τοίη τοι ἐγὼν ἐπιτάρροθός εἰμι·
ἀλλ’ ἄγ’ ἐπ’ Ἄρηϊ πρώτῳ ἔχε μώνυχας ἵππους,
τύψον δὲ σχεδίην μηδ’ ἄζεο θοῦρον Ἄρηα
τοῦτον μαινόμενον, τυκτὸν κακόν, ἀλλοπρόσαλλον,
ὃς πρώην μὲν ἐμοί τε καὶ Ἥρῃ στεῦτ’ ἀγορεύων
Τρωσὶ μαχήσεσθαι, ἀτὰρ Ἀργείοισιν ἀρήξειν,
νῦν δὲ μετὰ Τρώεσσιν ὁμιλεῖ, τῶν δὲ λέλασται.
ὣς φαμένη Σθένελον μὲν ἀφ’ ἵππων ὦσε χαμᾶζε,
χειρὶ πάλιν ἐρύσασ’, ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ἐμμαπέως ἀπόρουσεν·
ἣ δ’ ἐς δίφρον ἔβαινε παραὶ Διομήδεα δῖον
ἐμμεμαυῖα θεά· μέγα δ’ ἔβραχε φήγινος ἄξων
βριθοσύνῃ· δεινὴν γὰρ ἄγεν θεὸν ἄνδρά τ’ ἄριστον.
λάζετο δὲ μάστιγα καὶ ἡνία Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη·

5.841

αὐτίκ’ ἐπ’ Ἄρηϊ πρώτῳ ἔχε μώνυχας ἵππους.
ἤτοι ὃ μὲν Περίφαντα πελώριον ἐξενάριζεν

Αἰτωλῶν ὄχ᾽ ἄριστον Ὀχησίου ἀγλαὸν υἱόν·
τὸν μὲν Ἄρης ἐνάριζε μιαιφόνος· αὐτὰρ Ἀθήνη
δῦν᾽ Ἄϊδος κυνέην, μή μιν ἴδοι ὄβριμος Ἄρης.
ὡς δὲ ἴδε βροτολοιγὸς Ἄρης Διομήδεα δῖον,
ἤτοι ὃ μὲν Περίφαντα πελώριον αὐτόθ᾽ ἔασε
κεῖσθαι ὅθι πρῶτον κτείνων ἐξαίνυτο θυμόν,
αὐτὰρ ὃ βῆ ῥ᾽ ἰθὺς Διομήδεος ἱπποδάμοιο.
οἳ δ᾽ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ᾽ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντες,
πρόσθεν Ἄρης ὠρέξαθ᾽ ὑπὲρ ζυγὸν ἡνία θ᾽ ἵππων
ἔγχεϊ χαλκείῳ μεμαὼς ἀπὸ θυμὸν ἑλέσθαι·
καὶ τό γε χειρὶ λαβοῦσα θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη
ὤσεν ὑπὲκ δίφροιο ἐτώσιον ἀϊχθῆναι.
δεύτερος αὖθ᾽ ὡρμᾶτο βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης
ἔγχεϊ χαλκείῳ· ἐπέρεισε δὲ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη
νείατον ἐς κενεῶνα ὅθι ζωννύσκετο μίτρῃ·
τῇ ῥά μιν οὖτα τυχών, διὰ δὲ χρόα καλὸν ἔδαψεν,
ἐκ δὲ δόρυ σπάσεν αὖτις· ὃ δ᾽ ἔβραχε χάλκεος Ἄρης
ὅσσόν τ᾽ ἐννεάχιλοι ἐπίαχον ἢ δεκάχιλοι
ἀνέρες ἐν πολέμῳ ἔριδα ξυνάγοντες Ἄρηος.
τοὺς δ᾽ ἄρ᾽ ὑπὸ τρόμος εἷλεν Ἀχαιούς τε Τρῶάς τε
δείσαντας· τόσον ἔβραχ᾽ Ἄρης ἅτος πολέμοιο.
οἵη δ᾽ ἐκ νεφέων ἐρεβεννὴ φαίνεται ἀὴρ
καύματος ἐξ ἀνέμοιο δυσαέος ὀρνυμένοιο,
τοῖος Τυδεΐδῃ Διομήδεϊ χάλκεος Ἄρης
φαίνεθ᾽ ὁμοῦ νεφέεσσιν ἰὼν εἰς οὐρανὸν εὐρύν.
καρπαλίμως δ᾽ ἵκανε θεῶν ἕδος αἰπὺν Ὄλυμπον,
πὰρ δὲ Διὶ Κρονίωνι καθέζετο θυμὸν ἀχεύων,
δεῖξεν δ᾽ ἄμβροτον αἷμα καταρρέον ἐξ ὠτειλῆς,

5.871

καί ῥ᾽ ὀλοφυρόμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Ζεῦ πάτερ οὐ νεμεσίζῃ ὁρῶν τάδε καρτερὰ ἔργα;
αἰεί τοι ῥίγιστα θεοὶ τετληότες εἰμὲν
ἀλλήλων ἰότητι, χάριν ἄνδρεσσι φέροντες.
σοὶ πάντες μαχόμεσθα· σὺ γὰρ τέκες ἄφρονα κούρην
οὐλομένην, ᾗ τ᾽ αἰὲν ἀήσυλα ἔργα μέμηλεν.
ἄλλοι μὲν γὰρ πάντες ὅσοι θεοί εἰσ᾽ ἐν Ὀλύμπῳ
σοί τ᾽ ἐπιπείθονται καὶ δεδμήμεσθα ἕκαστος·
ταύτην δ᾽ οὔτ᾽ ἔπεϊ προτιβάλλεαι οὔτέ τι ἔργῳ,
ἀλλ᾽ ἀνιεῖς, ἐπεὶ αὐτὸς ἐγείναο παῖδ᾽ ἀΐδηλον·
ἣ νῦν Τυδέος υἱὸν ὑπερφίαλον Διομήδεα
μαργαίνειν ἀνέηκεν ἐπ᾽ ἀθανάτοισι θεοῖσι.
Κύπριδα μὲν πρῶτον σχεδὸν οὔτασε χεῖρ᾽ ἐπὶ καρπῷ,
αὐτὰρ ἔπειτ᾽ αὐτῷ μοι ἐπέσσυτο δαίμονι ἶσος·
ἀλλά μ᾽ ὑπήνεικαν ταχέες πόδες· ἦ τέ κε δηρὸν
αὐτοῦ πήματ᾽ ἔπασχον ἐν αἰνῇσιν νεκάδεσσιν,
ἤ κε ζὼς ἀμενηνὸς ἔα χαλκοῖο τυπῇσι.
τὸν δ᾽ ἄρ᾽ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς.
μή τί μοι ἀλλοπρόσαλλε παρεζόμενος μινύριζε.
ἔχθιστος δέ μοί ἐσσι θεῶν οἳ Ὄλυμπον ἔχουσιν·
αἰεὶ γάρ τοι ἔρις τε φίλη πόλεμοί τε μάχαι τε.

μητρός τοι μένος ἐστὶν ἀάσχετον οὐκ ἐπιεικτὸν
Ἥρης· τὴν μὲν ἐγὼ σπουδῇ δάμνημ’ ἐπέεσσι·
τώ σ’ οἵῳ κείνης τάδε πάσχειν ἐννεσίῃσιν.
ἀλλ’ οὐ μάν σ’ ἔτι δηρὸν ἀνέξομαι ἄλγε’ ἔχοντα·
ἐκ γὰρ ἐμεῦ γένος ἐσσί, ἐμοὶ δέ σε γείνατο μήτηρ·
εἰ δέ τευ ἐξ ἄλλου γε θεῶν γένευ ὤδ’ ἀΐδηλος
καί κεν δὴ πάλαι ἦσθα ἐνέρτερος Οὐρανιώνων.
ὣς φάτο, καὶ Παιήον’ ἀνώγειν ἰήσασθαι.
τῷ δ’ ἐπὶ Παιήων ὀδυνήφατα φάρμακα πάσσων

5.901

ἠκέσατ’· οὐ μὲν γάρ τι καταθνητός γ’ ἐτέτυκτο.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ὀπὸς γάλα λευκὸν ἐπειγόμενος συνέπηξεν
ὑγρὸν ἐόν, μάλα δ’ ὦκα περιτρέφεται κυκόωντι,
ὣς ἄρα καρπαλίμως ἰήσατο θοῦρον Ἄρηα.
τὸν δ’ Ἥβη λοῦσεν, χαρίεντα δὲ εἵματα ἔσσε·
πὰρ δὲ Διὶ Κρονίωνι καθέζετο κύδεϊ γαίων.
αἳ δ’ αὖτις πρὸς δῶμα Διὸς μεγάλοιο νέοντο
Ἥρη τ’ Ἀργείη καὶ Ἀλαλκομενηὶς Ἀθήνη
παύσασαι βροτολοιγὸν Ἄρη’ ἀνδροκτασιάων.

6.1

Τρώων δ’ οἰώθη καὶ Ἀχαιῶν φύλοπις αἰνή·
πολλὰ δ’ ἄρ’ ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθ’ ἴθυσε μάχη πεδίοιο
ἀλλήλων ἰθυνομένων χαλκήρεα δοῦρα
μεσσηγὺς Σιμόεντος ἰδὲ Ξάνθοιο ῥοάων.
Αἴας δὲ πρῶτος Τελαμώνιος ἔρκος Ἀχαιῶν
Τρώων ῥῆξε φάλαγγα, φόως δ’ ἑτάροισιν ἔθηκεν,
ἄνδρα βαλὼν ὃς ἄριστος ἐνὶ Θρῄκεσσι τέτυκτο
υἱὸν Ἠϋσσώρου Ἀκάμαντ’ ἠΰν τε μέγαν τε.
τόν ῥ’ ἔβαλε πρῶτος κόρυθος φάλον ἱπποδασείης,
ἐν δὲ μετώπῳ πῆξε, πέρησε δ’ ἄρ’ ὀστέον εἴσω
αἰχμὴ χαλκείη· τὸν δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψεν.
Ἄξυλον δ’ ἄρ’ ἔπεφνε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης
Τευθρανίδην, ὃς ἔναιεν ἐϋκτιμένῃ ἐν Ἀρίσβῃ
ἀφνειὸς βιότοιο, φίλος δ’ ἦν ἀνθρώποισι.
πάντας γὰρ φιλέεσκεν ὁδῷ ἔπι οἰκία ναίων.
ἀλλά οἱ οὔ τις τῶν γε τότ’ ἤρκεσε λυγρὸν ὄλεθρον
πρόσθεν ὑπαντιάσας, ἀλλ’ ἄμφω θυμὸν ἀπηύρα
αὐτὸν καὶ θεράποντα Καλήσιον, ὅς ῥα τόθ’ ἵππων
ἔσκεν ὑφηνίοχος· τὼ δ’ ἄμφω γαῖαν ἐδύτην.
Δρῆσον δ’ Εὐρύαλος καὶ Ὀφέλτιον ἐξενάριξε·
βῆ δὲ μετ’ Αἴσηπον καὶ Πήδασον, οὕς ποτε νύμφη
νηὶς Ἀβαρβαρέη τέκ’ ἀμύμονι Βουκολίωνι.
Βουκολίων δ’ ἦν υἱὸς ἀγαυοῦ Λαομέδοντος
πρεσβύτατος γενεῇ, σκότιον δέ ἑ γείνατο μήτηρ·
ποιμαίνων δ’ ἐπ’ ὄεσσι μίγη φιλότητι καὶ εὐνῇ,
ἣ δ’ ὑποκυσαμένη διδυμάονε γείνατο παῖδε.
καὶ μὲν τῶν ὑπέλυσε μένος καὶ φαίδιμα γυῖα
Μηκιστηϊάδης καὶ ἀπ’ ὤμων τεύχε’ ἐσύλα.

29 Ἀστύαλον δ’ ἄρ’ ἔπεφνε μενεπτόλεμος Πολυποίτης·
30 Πιδύτην δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς Περκώσιον ἐξενάριξεν
The fight between Trojans and Achaeans was now left to rage as it would, and the tide of war surged hither and thither over the plain as they aimed their bronze-shod spears at one another between the streams of Simoeis and Xanthos. First, Ajax son of Telamon, tower of strength to the Achaeans, broke a phalanx of the Trojans, and came to the assistance of his comrades by killing Akamas son of Eussoros, the best man among the Thracians, being both brave and of great stature. The spear struck the projecting peak of his helmet: its bronze point then went through his forehead into the brain, and darkness veiled his eyes. Then Diomedes killed Axylos son of Teuthranos, a rich man who lived in the strong city of Arisbe, and was beloved by all men; for he had a house by the roadside, and entertained every one who passed; howbeit not one of his guests stood before him to save his life, and Diomedes killed both him and his squire [therapôn] Kalesios, who was then his charioteer - so the pair passed beneath the earth. Euryalos killed Dresus and Opheltios, and then went in pursuit of Aesepos and Pedasos, whom the naiad nymph Abarbarea had borne to noble Bucolion. Bucolion was eldest son to Laomedon, but he was a bastard. While tending his sheep he had converse with the nymph, and she conceived twin sons; these the son of Mekisteus now slew, and he stripped the armor from their shoulders. Polypoites then killed Astyalos, Odysseus Pidytes of Perkote, and Teucer Aretaon. Ablerus fell by the spear of Nestor's son Antilokhos, and Agamemnon, king of men, killed Elatus who dwelt in Pedasos by the banks of the river Satnioeis. Leitos killed Phylakos as he was fleeing, and Eurypylos slew Melanthos. Then Menelaos of the loud war-cry took Adrastos alive, for his horses ran into a tamarisk bush, as they were flying wildly over the plain, and broke the pole from the car; they went on towards the city along with the others in full flight, but Adrastos rolled out, and fell in the dust flat on his face by the wheel of his chariot; Menelaos came up to him spear in hand, but Adrastos caught him by the knees begging for his life. "Take me alive," he cried, "son of Atreus, and you shall have a full ransom for me: my father is rich and has much treasure of gold, bronze, and wrought iron laid by in his house. From this store he will give you a large ransom should he hear of my being alive and at the ships of the Achaeans." Thus did he plead, and Menelaos was for yielding and giving him to a squire [therapôn] to take to the ships of the Achaeans, but Agamemnon came running up to him and rebuked him. "My good Menelaos," said he, "this is no time for giving quarter. Has, then, your house fared so well at the hands of the Trojans? Let us not spare a single one of them - not even the child unborn and in its mother's womb; let not a man of them be left alive, but let all in Ilion perish, unheeded and forgotten." Thus did he speak, and his brother was persuaded by him, for his words were just. Menelaos, therefore, thrust Adrastos from him, whereon King Agamemnon struck him in the flank, and he fell: then the son of Atreus planted his foot upon his breast to draw his spear from the body. Meanwhile Nestor shouted to the Argives, saying, "My friends, Danaan warriors, squires [therapontes] of Ares, let no man lag that he may spoil the dead, and bring back much booty to the ships. Let us kill as many as we can; the bodies will lie upon the plain, and you can despoil them later at your leisure." With these words he put heart and soul into them all. And now the Trojans would have been routed and driven back into Ilion, had not Priam's son Helenos, wisest of augurs, said to Hektor and Aeneas, "Hektor and Aeneas, the labors of you two make you the mainstays of the Trojans and Lycians, for you are foremost at all times, alike in fight and counsel; hold your ground here, and go about among the host to rally them in front of the gates, or they will fling themselves into the arms of their wives, to the great joy of our foes. Then, when you have put heart into all our companies, we will stand firm here and fight the Danaans however hard they press us, for there is nothing else to be done. Meanwhile do you, Hektor, go to the city and tell our mother what is happening. Tell her to bid the matrons gather at the temple of Athena in the acropolis; let her then take her key and open

the doors of the sacred building; there, upon the knees of Athena, let her lay the largest, fairest robe she has in her house - the one she sets most store by; let her, moreover, promise to sacrifice twelve yearling heifers that have never yet felt the goad, in the temple of the goddess, if she will take pity on the town, with the wives and little ones of the Trojans, and keep the son of Tydeus from falling on the goodly city of Ilion; for he fights with fury and fills men's souls with panic. I hold him mightiest of them all; we did not fear even their great champion Achilles, son of a goddess though he be, as we do this man: his rage is beyond all bounds, and there is none can vie with him in prowess"

6.31

ἔγχεϊ χαλκείῳ, Τεῦκρος δ’ Ἀρετάονα δῖον.
Ἀντίλοχος δ’ Ἄβληρον ἐνήρατο δουρὶ φαεινῷ
Νεστορίδης, Ἔλατον δὲ ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
ναῖε δὲ Σατνιόεντος ἐϋρρείταο παρ’ ὄχθας
Πήδασον αἰπεινήν. Φύλακον δ’ ἕλε Λήϊτος ἥρως
φεύγοντ’· Εὐρύπυλος δὲ Μελάνθιον ἐξενάριξεν.
Ἄδρηστον δ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος
ζωὸν ἕλ’· ἵππω γάρ οἱ ἀτυζομένω πεδίοιο
ὄζῳ ἔνι βλαφθέντε μυρικίνῳ ἀγκύλον ἅρμα
ἄξαντ’ ἐν πρώτῳ ῥυμῷ αὐτὼ μὲν ἐβήτην
πρὸς πόλιν, ᾗ περ οἱ ἄλλοι ἀτυζόμενοι φοβέοντο,
αὐτὸς δ’ ἐκ δίφροιο παρὰ τροχὸν ἐξεκυλίσθη
πρηνὴς ἐν κονίῃσιν ἐπὶ στόμα· πὰρ δέ οἱ ἔστη
Ἀτρεΐδης Μενέλαος ἔχων δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος.
Ἄδρηστος δ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα λαβὼν ἐλίσσετο γούνων·
ζώγρει Ἀτρέος υἱέ, σὺ δ’ ἄξια δέξαι ἄποινα·
πολλὰ δ’ ἐν ἀφνειοῦ πατρὸς κειμήλια κεῖται
χαλκός τε χρυσός τε πολύκμητός τε σίδηρος,
τῶν κέν τοι χαρίσαιτο πατὴρ ἀπερείσι’ ἄποινα
εἴ κεν ἐμὲ ζωὸν πεπύθοιτ’ ἐπὶ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν.
ὣς φάτο, τῷ δ’ ἄρα θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἔπειθε·
καὶ δή μιν τάχ’ ἔμελλε θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
δώσειν ᾧ θεράποντι καταξέμεν· ἀλλ’ Ἀγαμέμνων
ἀντίος ἦλθε θέων, καὶ ὁμοκλήσας ἔπος ηὔδα·
ὦ πέπον ὦ Μενέλαε, τί ἢ δὲ σὺ κήδεαι οὕτως
ἀνδρῶν; ἦ σοὶ ἄριστα πεποίηται κατὰ οἶκον
πρὸς Τρώων; τῶν μή τις ὑπεκφύγοι αἰπὺν ὄλεθρον
χεῖράς θ’ ἡμετέρας, μηδ’ ὅν τινα γαστέρι μήτηρ
κοῦρον ἐόντα φέροι, μηδ’ ὃς φύγοι, ἀλλ’ ἅμα πάντες
Ἰλίου ἐξαπολοίατ’ ἀκήδεστοι καὶ ἄφαντοι.

6.61

ὣς εἰπὼν ἔτρεψεν ἀδελφειοῦ φρένας ἥρως
αἴσιμα παρειπών· ὃ δ’ ἀπὸ ἕθεν ὤσατο χειρὶ
ἥρω’ Ἄδρηστον· τὸν δὲ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
οὖτα κατὰ λαπάρην· ὃ δ’ ἀνετράπετ’, Ἀτρεΐδης δὲ
λὰξ ἐν στήθεσι βὰς ἐξέσπασε μείλινον ἔγχος.
Νέστωρ δ’ Ἀργείοισιν ἐκέκλετο μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
ὦ φίλοι ἥρωες Δαναοὶ θεράποντες Ἄρηος
μή τις νῦν ἐνάρων ἐπιβαλλόμενος μετόπισθε

μιμνέτω ὥς κε πλεῖστα φέρων ἐπὶ νῆας ἵκηται,
ἀλλ’ ἄνδρας κτείνωμεν· ἔπειτα δὲ καὶ τὰ ἔκηλοι
νεκροὺς ἂμ πεδίον συλήσετε τεθνηῶτας.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε μένος καὶ θυμὸν ἑκάστου.
ἔνθά κεν αὖτε Τρῶες ἀρηϊφίλων ὑπ’ Ἀχαιῶν
Ἴλιον εἰσανέβησαν ἀναλκείῃσι δαμέντες,
εἰ μὴ ἄρ’ Αἰνείᾳ τε καὶ Ἕκτορι εἶπε παραστὰς
Πριαμίδης Ἕλενος οἰωνοπόλων ὄχ’ ἄριστος·
Αἰνεία τε καὶ Ἕκτορ, ἐπεὶ πόνος ὔμμι μάλιστα
Τρώων καὶ Λυκίων ἐγκέκλιται, οὕνεκ’ ἄριστοι
πᾶσαν ἐπ’ ἰθύν ἐστε μάχεσθαί τε φρονέειν τε,
στῆτ’ αὐτοῦ, καὶ λαὸν ἐρυκάκετε πρὸ πυλάων
πάντῃ ἐποιχόμενοι πρὶν αὖτ’ ἐν χερσὶ γυναικῶν
φεύγοντας πεσέειν, δηΐοισι δὲ χάρμα γενέσθαι.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεί κε φάλαγγας ἐποτρύνητον ἁπάσας,
ἡμεῖς μὲν Δαναοῖσι μαχησόμεθ’ αὖθι μένοντες,
καὶ μάλα τειρόμενοί περ· ἀναγκαίη γὰρ ἐπείγει·
Ἕκτορ ἀτὰρ σὺ πόλιν δὲ μετέρχεο, εἰπὲ δ’ ἔπειτα
μητέρι σῇ καὶ ἐμῇ· ἣ δὲ ξυνάγουσα γεραιὰς
νηὸν Ἀθηναίης γλαυκώπιδος ἐν πόλει ἄκρῃ
οἴξασα κληῖδι θύρας ἱεροῖο δόμοιο
πέπλον, ὅς οἱ δοκέει χαριέστατος ἠδὲ μέγιστος

6.91

εἶναι ἐνὶ μεγάρῳ καί οἱ πολὺ φίλτατος αὐτῇ,
θεῖναι Ἀθηναίης ἐπὶ γούνασιν ἠϋκόμοιο,
καί οἱ ὑποσχέσθαι δυοκαίδεκα βοῦς ἐνὶ νηῷ
ἥνις ἠκέστας ἱερευσέμεν, αἴ κ’ ἐλεήσῃ
ἄστύ τε καὶ Τρώων ἀλόχους καὶ νήπια τέκνα,
ὥς κεν Τυδέος υἱὸν ἀπόσχῃ Ἰλίου ἱρῆς
ἄγριον αἰχμητὴν κρατερὸν μήστωρα φόβοιο,
ὃν δὴ ἐγὼ κάρτιστον Ἀχαιῶν φημι γενέσθαι.
οὐδ’ Ἀχιλῆά ποθ’ ὧδέ γ’ ἐδείδιμεν ὄρχαμον ἀνδρῶν,
ὅν πέρ φασι θεᾶς ἐξέμμεναι· ἀλλ’ ὅδε λίην
μαίνεται, οὐδέ τίς οἱ δύναται μένος ἰσοφαρίζειν.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, Ἕκτωρ δ’ οὔ τι κασιγνήτῳ ἀπίθησεν.
αὐτίκα δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων σὺν τεύχεσιν ἅλτο χαμᾶζε,
πάλλων δ’ ὀξέα δοῦρα κατὰ στρατὸν ᾤχετο πάντῃ
ὀτρύνων μαχέσασθαι, ἔγειρε δὲ φύλοπιν αἰνήν.
οἳ δ’ ἐλελίχθησαν καὶ ἐναντίοι ἔσταν Ἀχαιῶν·
Ἀργεῖοι δ’ ὑπεχώρησαν, λῆξαν δὲ φόνοιο,
φὰν δέ τιν’ ἀθανάτων ἐξ οὐρανοῦ ἀστερόεντος
Τρωσὶν ἀλεξήσοντα κατελθέμεν, ὡς ἐλέλιχθεν.
Ἕκτωρ δὲ Τρώεσσιν ἐκέκλετο μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
Τρῶες ὑπέρθυμοι τηλεκλειτοί τ’ ἐπίκουροι
ἀνέρες ἔστε φίλοι, μνήσασθε δὲ θούριδος ἀλκῆς,
ὄφρ’ ἂν ἐγὼ βείω προτὶ Ἴλιον, ἠδὲ γέρουσιν
εἴπω βουλευτῆσι καὶ ἡμετέρῃς ἀλόχοισι
δαίμοσιν ἀρήσασθαι, ὑποσχέσθαι δ’ ἑκατόμβας.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἀπέβη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
ἀμφὶ δέ μιν σφυρὰ τύπτε καὶ αὐχένα δέρμα κελαινὸν

118 ἄντυξ ἢ πυμάτη θέεν ἀσπίδος ὀμφαλοέσσης.
119 Γλαῦκος δ’ Ἱππολόχοιο πάϊς καὶ Τυδέος υἱὸς
120 ἐς μέσον ἀμφοτέρων συνίτην μεμαῶτε μάχεσθαι.
Hektor did as his brother bade him. He sprang from his chariot, and went about everywhere among the host, brandishing his spears, urging the men on to fight, and raising the dread cry of battle. Thereon they rallied and again faced the Achaeans, who gave ground and ceased their murderous onset, for they deemed that some one of the immortals had come down from starry heaven to help the Trojans, so strangely had they rallied. And Hektor shouted to the Trojans, "Trojans and allies, be men, my friends, and fight with might and main, while I go to Ilion and tell the old men of our council and our wives to pray to the gods [daimones] and vow hecatombs in their honor." With this he went his way, and the black rim of hide that went round his shield beat against his neck and his ankles. Then Glaukos son of Hippolokhos, and the son of Tydeus went into the open space between the hosts to fight in single combat. When they were close up to one another Diomedes of the loud war-cry was the first to speak. "Who, my good sir," said he, "who are you among men? I have never seen you in battle until now, but you are daring beyond all others if you abide my onset. Woe to those fathers whose sons face my might. If, however, you are one of the immortals and have come down from heaven, I will not fight you; for even valiant Lycurgus, son of Dryas, did not live long when he took to fighting with the gods. He it was that drove the nursing women who were in charge of frenzied Bacchus through the land of Nysa, and they flung their thyrsi on the ground as murderous Lycurgus beat them with his oxgoad. Bacchus himself plunged terror-stricken into the sea, and Thetis took him to her bosom to comfort him, for he was scared by the fury with which the man reviled him. Thereon the gods who live at ease were angry with Lycurgus and the son of Kronos struck him blind, nor did he live much longer after he had become hateful to the immortals. Therefore I will not fight with the blessed gods; but if you are of them that eat the fruit of the ground, draw near and meet your doom." And the son of Hippolokhos answered, son of Tydeus, why ask me of my lineage? Men come and go as leaves year by year upon the trees. Those of autumn the wind sheds upon the ground, but when the season [hôra] of spring returns the forest buds forth with fresh vines. Even so is it with the generations of humankind, the new spring up as the old are passing away. If, then, you would learn my descent, it is one that is well known to many. There is a city in the heart of Argos, pasture land of horses, called Ephyra, where Sisyphus lived, who was the craftiest of all humankind. He was the son of Aeolus, and had a son named Glaukos, who was father to Bellerophon, whom heaven endowed with the most surpassing comeliness and beauty. But Proetus devised his ruin, and being stronger than he, drove him from the district [dêmos] of the Argives, over which Zeus had made him ruler. For Antaea, wife of Proetus, lusted after him, and would have had him lie with her in secret; but Bellerophon was an honorable man and would not, so she told lies about him to Proetus. ‘Proetus,’ said she, ‘kill Bellerophon or die, for he would have had converse with me against my will.’ The king was angered, but shrank from killing Bellerophon, so he sent him to Lycia bearing baneful signs [sêmata], written inside a folded tablet and containing much ill against the bearer. He bade Bellerophon show these written signs to his father-in-law, to the end that he might thus perish; Bellerophon therefore went to Lycia, and the gods convoyed him safely. "When he reached the river Xanthos, which is in Lycia, the king received him with all goodwill, feasted him nine days, and killed nine heifers in his honor, but when rosy-fingered morning appeared upon the tenth day, he questioned him and desired to see the written signs [sêmata] from his son-in-law Proetus. When he had received the wicked written signs [sêmata] he first commanded Bellerophon to kill that savage monster, the Chimaera, who was not a human being, but a goddess, for she had the head of a lion and the tail of a serpent, while her body was that of a goat, and she breathed forth flames of fire; but Bellerophon slew her, for he was guided by signs from

heaven. He next fought the far-famed Solymoi, and this, he said, was the hardest of all his battles. Thirdly, he killed the Amazons, women who were the peers of men, and as he was returning thence the king devised yet another plan for his destruction; he picked [krinô] the bravest warriors in all Lycia, and placed them in ambuscade, but not a man ever came back, for Bellerophon killed every one of them. Then the king knew that he must be the valiant offspring of a god, so he kept him in Lycia, gave him his daughter in marriage, and made him of equal honor [timê] in the kingdom with himself; and the Lycians gave him a piece of land, the best in all the country, fair with vineyards and tilled fields, to have and to hold. "The king's daughter bore Bellerophon three children, Isandros, Hippolokhos, and Laodameia. Zeus, the lord of counsel, lay with Laodameia, and she bore him noble Sarpedon; but when Bellerophon came to be hated by all the gods, he wandered all desolate and dismayed upon the Alean plain, gnawing at his own heart, and shunning the path of man. Ares, insatiate of battle, killed his son Isandros while he was fighting the Solymi; his daughter was killed by Artemis of the golden reins, for she was angered with her; but Hippolokhos was father to myself, and when he sent me to Troy he urged me again and again to fight ever among the foremost and outvie my peers, so as not to shame the blood of my fathers who were the noblest in Ephyra and in all Lycia. This, then, is the descent I claim."

6.121

121 οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντε,
122 τὸν πρότερος προσέειπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
123 τίς δὲ σύ ἐσσι φέριστε καταθνητῶν ἀνθρώπων;
124 οὐ μὲν γάρ ποτ’ ὄπωπα μάχῃ ἔνι κυδιανείρῃ
125 τὸ πρίν· ἀτὰρ μὲν νῦν γε πολὺ προβέβηκας ἁπάντων
126 σῷ θάρσει, ὅ τ’ ἐμὸν δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος ἔμεινας·
127 δυστήνων δέ τε παῖδες ἐμῷ μένει ἀντιόωσιν.
128 εἰ δέ τις ἀθανάτων γε κατ’ οὐρανοῦ εἰλήλουθας,
129 οὐκ ἂν ἔγωγε θεοῖσιν ἐπουρανίοισι μαχοίμην.
130 οὐδὲ γὰρ οὐδὲ Δρύαντος υἱὸς κρατερὸς Λυκόοργος
131 δὴν ἦν, ὅς ῥα θεοῖσιν ἐπουρανίοισιν ἔριζεν·
132 ὅς ποτε μαινομένοιο Διωνύσοιο τιθήνας
133 σεῦε κατ’ ἠγάθεον Νυσήϊον· αἳ δ’ ἅμα πᾶσαι
134 θύσθλα χαμαὶ κατέχευαν ὑπ’ ἀνδροφόνοιο Λυκούργου
135 θεινόμεναι βουπλῆγι· Διώνυσος δὲ φοβηθεὶς
136 δύσεθ’ ἁλὸς κατὰ κῦμα, Θέτις δ’ ὑπεδέξατο κόλπῳ
137 δειδιότα· κρατερὸς γὰρ ἔχε τρόμος ἀνδρὸς ὁμοκλῇ.
138 τῷ μὲν ἔπειτ’ ὀδύσαντο θεοὶ ῥεῖα ζώοντες,
139 καί μιν τυφλὸν ἔθηκε Κρόνου πάϊς· οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔτι δὴν
140 ἦν, ἐπεὶ ἀθανάτοισιν ἀπήχθετο πᾶσι θεοῖσιν·
141 οὐδ’ ἂν ἐγὼ μακάρεσσι θεοῖς ἐθέλοιμι μάχεσθαι.
142 εἰ δέ τίς ἐσσι βροτῶν οἳ ἀρούρης καρπὸν ἔδουσιν,
143 ἆσσον ἴθ’ ὥς κεν θᾶσσον ὀλέθρου πείραθ’ ἵκηαι.
144 τὸν δ’ αὖθ’ Ἱππολόχοιο προσηύδα φαίδιμος υἱός·
145 Τυδεΐδη μεγάθυμε τί ἢ γενεὴν ἐρεείνεις;
146 οἵη περ φύλλων γενεὴ τοίη δὲ καὶ ἀνδρῶν.
147 φύλλα τὰ μέν τ’ ἄνεμος χαμάδις χέει, ἄλλα δέ θ’ ὕλη
148 τηλεθόωσα φύει, ἔαρος δ’ ἐπιγίγνεται ὥρη·
149 ὣς ἀνδρῶν γενεὴ ἣ μὲν φύει ἣ δ’ ἀπολήγει.
150 εἰ δ’ ἐθέλεις καὶ ταῦτα δαήμεναι ὄφρ’ ἐὺ εἰδῇς

6.151

ἡμετέρην γενεήν, πολλοὶ δέ μιν ἄνδρες ἴσασιν·
ἔστι πόλις Ἐφύρη μυχῷ Ἄργεος ἱπποβότοιο,
ἔνθα δὲ Σίσυφος ἔσκεν, ὃ κέρδιστος γένετ’ ἀνδρῶν,
Σίσυφος Αἰολίδης· ὃ δ’ ἄρα Γλαῦκον τέκεθ’ υἱόν,
αὐτὰρ Γλαῦκος τίκτεν ἀμύμονα Βελλεροφόντην·
τῷ δὲ θεοὶ κάλλός τε καὶ ἠνορέην ἐρατεινὴν
ὤπασαν· αὐτάρ οἱ Προῖτος κακὰ μήσατο θυμῷ,
ὅς ῥ’ ἐκ δήμου ἔλασσεν, ἐπεὶ πολὺ φέρτερος ἦεν,
Ἀργείων· Ζεὺς γάρ οἱ ὑπὸ σκήπτρῳ ἐδάμασσε.
τῷ δὲ γυνὴ Προίτου ἐπεμήνατο δῖ’ Ἀντεια
κρυπταδίῃ φιλότητι μιγήμεναι· ἀλλὰ τὸν οὔ τι
πεῖθ’ ἀγαθὰ φρονέοντα δαΐφρονα Βελλεροφόντην.
ἣ δὲ ψευσαμένη Προῖτον βασιλῆα προσηύδα·
τεθναίης ὦ Προῖτ’, ἢ κάκτανε Βελλεροφόντην,
ὅς μ’ ἔθελεν φιλότητι μιγήμεναι οὐκ ἐθελούσῃ.
ὣς φάτο, τὸν δὲ ἄνακτα χόλος λάβεν οἷον ἄκουσε·
κτεῖναι μέν ῥ’ ἀλέεινε, σεβάσσατο γὰρ τό γε θυμῷ,
πέμπε δέ μιν Λυκίην δέ, πόρεν δ’ ὅ γε σήματα λυγρὰ
γράψας ἐν πίνακι πτυκτῷ θυμοφθόρα πολλά,
δεῖξαι δ’ ἠνώγειν ᾧ πενθερῷ ὄφρ’ ἀπόλοιτο.
αὐτὰρ ὁ βῆ Λυκίην δὲ θεῶν ὑπ’ ἀμύμονι πομπῇ.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ Λυκίην ἶξε Ξάνθόν τε ῥέοντα,
προφρονέως μιν τῖεν ἄναξ Λυκίης εὐρείης·
ἐννῆμαρ ξείνισσε καὶ ἐννέα βοῦς ἱέρευσεν.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ δεκάτη ἐφάνη ῥοδοδάκτυλος Ἠὼς
καὶ τότε μιν ἐρέεινε καὶ ᾔτεε σῆμα ἰδέσθαι
ὅττί ῥά οἱ γαμβροῖο πάρα Προίτοιο φέροιτο.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ σῆμα κακὸν παρεδέξατο γαμβροῦ,
πρῶτον μέν ῥα Χίμαιραν ἀμαιμακέτην ἐκέλευσε
πεφνέμεν· ἣ δ’ ἄρ’ ἔην θεῖον γένος οὐδ’ ἀνθρώπων,

6.181

πρόσθε λέων, ὄπιθεν δὲ δράκων, μέσση δὲ χίμαιρα,
δεινὸν ἀποπνείουσα πυρὸς μένος αἰθομένοιο,
καὶ τὴν μὲν κατέπεφνε θεῶν τεράεσσι πιθήσας.
δεύτερον αὖ Σολύμοισι μαχέσσατο κυδαλίμοισι·
καρτίστην δὴ τήν γε μάχην φάτο δύμεναι ἀνδρῶν.
τὸ τρίτον αὖ κατέπεφνεν Ἀμαζόνας ἀντιανείρας.
τῷ δ’ ἄρ’ ἀνερχομένῳ πυκινὸν δόλον ἄλλον ὕφαινε·
κρίνας ἐκ Λυκίης εὐρείης φῶτας ἀρίστους
εἶσε λόχον· τοὶ δ’ οὔ τι πάλιν οἶκον δὲ νέοντο·
πάντας γὰρ κατέπεφνεν ἀμύμων Βελλεροφόντης.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ γίγνωσκε θεοῦ γόνον ἠὺν ἐόντα
αὐτοῦ μιν κατέρυκε, δίδου δ’ ὅ γε θυγατέρα ἣν,
δῶκε δέ οἱ τιμῆς βασιληΐδος ἥμισυ πάσης·
καὶ μέν οἱ Λύκιοι τέμενος τάμον ἔξοχον ἄλλων
καλὸν φυταλιῆς καὶ ἀρούρης, ὄφρα νέμοιτο.
ἣ δ’ ἔτεκε τρία τέκνα δαΐφρονι Βελλεροφόντῃ
Ἴσανδρόν τε καὶ Ἱππόλοχον καὶ Λαοδάμειαν.
Λαοδαμείῃ μὲν παρελέξατο μητίετα Ζεύς,

199 ἣ δ’ ἔτεκ’ ἀντίθεον Σαρπηδόνα χαλκοκορυστήν.
200 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ καὶ κεῖνος ἀπήχθετο πᾶσι θεοῖσιν,
201 ἤτοι ὃ κὰπ πεδίον τὸ Ἀλήϊον οἶος ἀλᾶτο
202 ὃν θυμὸν κατέδων, πάτον ἀνθρώπων ἀλεείνων·
203 Ἴσανδρον δέ οἱ υἱὸν Ἄρης ἆτος πολέμοιο
204 μαρνάμενον Σολύμοισι κατέκτανε κυδαλίμοισι·
205 τὴν δὲ χολωσαμένη χρυσήνιος Ἄρτεμις ἔκτα.
206 Ἱππόλοχος δέ μ’ ἔτικτε, καὶ ἐκ τοῦ φημι γενέσθαι·
207 πέμπε δέ μ’ ἐς Τροίην, καί μοι μάλα πόλλ’ ἐπέτελλεν
208 αἰὲν ἀριστεύειν καὶ ὑπείροχον ἔμμεναι ἄλλων,
209 μηδὲ γένος πατέρων αἰσχυνέμεν, οἳ μέγ’ ἄριστοι
210 ἔν τ’ Ἐφύρῃ ἐγένοντο καὶ ἐν Λυκίῃ εὐρείῃ.

6.211

211 ταύτης τοι γενεῆς τε καὶ αἵματος εὔχομαι εἶναι.
212 ὣς φάτο, γήθησεν δὲ βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
213 ἔγχος μὲν κατέπηξεν ἐπὶ χθονὶ πουλυβοτείρῃ,
214 αὐτὰρ ὃ μειλιχίοισι προσηύδα ποιμένα λαῶν·
215 ἦ ῥά νύ μοι ξεῖνος πατρώϊός ἐσσι παλαιός·
216 Οἰνεὺς γάρ ποτε δῖος ἀμύμονα Βελλεροφόντην
217 ξείνισ’ ἐνὶ μεγάροισιν ἐείκοσιν ἤματ’ ἐρύξας·
218 οἳ δὲ καὶ ἀλλήλοισι πόρον ξεινήϊα καλά·
219 Οἰνεὺς μὲν ζωστῆρα δίδου φοίνικι φαεινόν,
220 Βελλεροφόντης δὲ χρύσεον δέπας ἀμφικύπελλον
221 καί μιν ἐγὼ κατέλειπον ἰὼν ἐν δώμασ’ ἐμοῖσι.
222 Τυδέα δ’ οὐ μέμνημαι, ἐπεί μ’ ἔτι τυτθὸν ἐόντα
223 κάλλιφ’, ὅτ’ ἐν Θήβῃσιν ἀπώλετο λαὸς Ἀχαιῶν.
224 τὼ νῦν σοὶ μὲν ἐγὼ ξεῖνος φίλος Ἄργεϊ μέσσῳ
225 εἰμί, σὺ δ’ ἐν Λυκίῃ ὅτε κεν τῶν δῆμον ἵκωμαι.
226 ἔγχεα δ’ ἀλλήλων ἀλεώμεθα καὶ δι’ ὁμίλου·
227 πολλοὶ μὲν γὰρ ἐμοὶ Τρῶες κλειτοί τ’ ἐπίκουροι
228 κτείνειν ὅν κε θεός γε πόρῃ καὶ ποσσὶ κιχείω,
229 πολλοὶ δ’ αὖ σοὶ Ἀχαιοὶ ἐναιρέμεν ὅν κε δύνηαι.
230 τεύχεα δ’ ἀλλήλοις ἐπαμείψομεν, ὄφρα καὶ οἵδε
231 γνῶσιν ὅτι ξεῖνοι πατρώϊοι εὐχόμεθ’ εἶναι.
232 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσαντε καθ’ ἵππων ἀΐξαντε
233 χεῖράς τ’ ἀλλήλων λαβέτην καὶ πιστώσαντο·
234 ἔνθ’ αὖτε Γλαύκῳ Κρονίδης φρένας ἐξέλετο Ζεύς,
235 ὃς πρὸς Τυδεΐδην Διομήδεα τεύχε’ ἄμειβε
236 χρύσεα χαλκείων, ἑκατόμβοι’ ἐννεαβοίων.
237 Ἕκτωρ δ’ ὡς Σκαιάς τε πύλας καὶ φηγὸν ἵκανεν,
238 ἀμφ’ ἄρα μιν Τρώων ἄλοχοι θέον ἠδὲ θύγατρες
239 εἰρόμεναι παῖδάς τε κασιγνήτους τε ἔτας τε
240 καὶ πόσιας· ὃ δ’ ἔπειτα θεοῖς εὔχεσθαι ἀνώγει

Thus did he speak, and the heart of Diomedes was glad. He planted his spear in the ground, and spoke to him with friendly words. "Then," he said, you are an old friend of my father's house. Great Oeneus once entertained Bellerophon for twenty days, and the two exchanged presents. Oeneus gave a belt rich with purple, and Bellerophon a double cup, which I left at home when I set out for Troy. I do not remember Tydeus, for he was taken from us while I was yet a child, when the army of the Achaeans was cut to pieces before Thebes. Henceforth, however, I must be your host in middle Argos, and you mine in Lycia, if I

should ever go to that district [dêmos]; let us avoid one another's spears even during a general engagement; there are many noble Trojans and allies whom I can kill, if I overtake them and heaven delivers them into my hand; so again with yourself, there are many Achaeans whose lives you may take if you can; we two, then, will exchange armor, that all present may know of the old ties that subsist between us." With these words they sprang from their chariots, grasped one another's hands, and plighted friendship. But the son of Kronos made Glaukos take leave of his wits, for he exchanged golden armor for bronze, the worth of a hundred head of cattle for the worth of nine. Now when Hektor reached the Scaean gates and the oak tree, the wives and daughters of the Trojans came running towards him to ask after their sons, brothers, kinsmen, and husbands: he told them to set about praying to the gods, and many were made sorrowful as they heard him. Presently he reached the splendid palace of King Priam, adorned with colonnades of hewn stone. In it there were fifty bedchambers - all of hewn stone - built near one another, where the sons of Priam slept, each with his wedded wife. Opposite these, on the other side the courtyard, there were twelve upper rooms also of hewn stone for Priam's daughters, built near one another, where his sons-in-law slept with their wives. When Hektor got there, his fond mother came up to him with Laodike the fairest of her daughters. She took his hand within her own and said, "My son, why have you left the battle to come hither? Are the Achaeans, woe betide them, pressing you hard about the city that you have thought fit to come and uplift your hands to Zeus from the citadel? Wait till I can bring you wine that you may make offering to Zeus and to the other immortals, and may then drink and be refreshed. Wine gives a man fresh strength when he is wearied, as you now are with fighting on behalf of your kinsmen." And Hektor answered, "Honored mother, bring no wine, lest you unman me and I forget my strength. I dare not make a drink-offering to Zeus with unwashed hands; one who is bespattered with blood and filth may not pray to the son of Kronos. Get the matrons together, and go with offerings to the temple of Athena driver of the spoil; there, upon the knees of Athena, lay the largest and fairest robe you have in your house - the one you set most store by; promise, moreover, to sacrifice twelve yearling heifers that have never yet felt the goad, in the temple of the goddess if she will take pity on the town, with the wives and little ones of the Trojans, and keep the son of Tydeus from off the goodly city of Ilion, for he fights with fury, and fills men's souls with panic. Go, then, to the temple of Athena, while I seek Paris and exhort him, if he will hear my words. Would that the earth might open her jaws and swallow him, for Zeus bred him to be the bane of the Trojans, and of Priam and Priam's sons. Could I but see him go down into the house of Hades, my heart would forget its heaviness." His mother went into the house and called her waiting-women who gathered the matrons throughout the city. She then went down into her fragrant store-room, where her embroidered robes were kept, the work of Sidonian women, whom Alexander had brought over from Sidon when he sailed the seas [pontos] upon that voyage during which he carried off Helen. Hecuba took out the largest robe, and the one that was most beautifully enriched with embroidery, as an offering to Athena: it glittered like a star, and lay at the very bottom of the chest. With this she went on her way and many matrons with her. When they reached the temple of Athena, lovely Theano, daughter of Kisseus and wife of Antenor, opened the doors, for the Trojans had made her priestess of Athena. The women lifted up their hands to the goddess with a loud cry, and Theano took the robe to lay it upon the knees of Athena, praying the while to the daughter of great Zeus.

6.241

241 πάσας ἐξείης· πολλῇσι δὲ κήδε’ ἐφῆπτο.
242 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ Πριάμοιο δόμον περικαλλέ’ ἵκανε
243 ξεστῇς αἰθούσῃσι τετυγμένον· αὐτὰρ ἐν αὐτῷ
244 πεντήκοντ’ ἔνεσαν θάλαμοι ξεστοῖο λίθοιο

πλησίον ἀλλήλων δεδμημένοι, ἔνθα δὲ παῖδες
κοιμῶντο Πριάμοιο παρὰ μνηστῇς ἀλόχοισι,
κουράων δ’ ἐτέρωθεν ἐναντίοι ἔνδοθεν αὐλῆς
δώδεκ’ ἔσαν τέγεοι θάλαμοι ξεστοῖο λίθοιο
πλησίον ἀλλήλων δεδμημένοι, ἔνθα δὲ γαμβροὶ
κοιμῶντο Πριάμοιο παρ’ αἰδοίῃς ἀλόχοισιν·
ἔνθά οἱ ἠπιόδωρος ἐναντίη ἤλυθε μήτηρ
Λαοδίκην ἐσάγουσα θυγατρῶν εἶδος ἀρίστην·
ἔν τ’ ἄρα οἱ φῦ χειρὶ ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζε·
τέκνον τίπτε λιπὼν πόλεμον θρασὺν εἰλήλουθας;
ἦ μάλα δὴ τείρουσι δυσώνυμοι υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
μαρνάμενοι περὶ ἄστυ· σὲ δ’ ἐνθάδε θυμὸς ἀνῆκεν
ἐλθόντ’ ἐξ ἄκρης πόλιος Διὶ χεῖρας ἀνασχεῖν.
ἀλλὰ μέν’ ὄφρά κέ τοι μελιηδέα οἶνον ἐνείκω,
ὡς σπείσῃς Διὶ πατρὶ καὶ ἄλλοις ἀθανάτοισι
πρῶτον, ἔπειτα δὲ καὐτὸς ὀνήσεαι αἴ κε πίῃσθα.
ἀνδρὶ δὲ κεκμηῶτι μένος μέγα οἶνος ἀέξει,
ὡς τύνη κέκμηκας ἀμύνων σοῖσιν ἔτῃσι.
τὴν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
μή μοι οἶνον ἄειρε μελίφρονα πότνια μῆτερ,
μή μ’ ἀπογυιώσῃς μένεος, ἀλκῆς τε λάθωμαι·
χερσὶ δ’ ἀνίπτοισιν Διὶ λείβειν αἴθοπα οἶνον
ἄζομαι· οὐδέ πῃ ἔστι κελαινεφέϊ Κρονίωνι
αἵματι καὶ λύθρῳ πεπαλαγμένον εὐχετάασθαι.
ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν πρὸς νηὸν Ἀθηναίης ἀγελείης
ἔρχεο σὺν θυέεσσιν ἀολλίσσασα γεραιάς·

6.271

πέπλον δ’, ὅς τίς τοι χαριέστατος ἠδὲ μέγιστος
ἔστιν ἐνὶ μεγάρῳ καί τοι πολὺ φίλτατος αὐτῇ,
τὸν θὲς Ἀθηναίης ἐπὶ γούνασιν ἠϋκόμοιο,
καί οἱ ὑποσχέσθαι δυοκαίδεκα βοῦς ἐνὶ νηῷ
ἥνις ἠκέστας ἱερευσέμεν, αἴ κ’ ἐλεήσῃ
ἄστύ τε καὶ Τρώων ἀλόχους καὶ νήπια τέκνα,
αἴ κεν Τυδέος υἱὸν ἀπόσχῃ Ἰλίου ἱρῆς
ἄγριον αἰχμητὴν κρατερὸν μήστωρα φόβοιο.
ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν πρὸς νηὸν Ἀθηναίης ἀγελείης
ἔρχευ, ἐγὼ δὲ Πάριν μετελεύσομαι ὄφρα καλέσσω
αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσ’ εἰπόντος ἀκουέμεν· ὥς κέ οἱ αὖθι
γαῖα χάνοι· μέγα γάρ μιν Ὀλύμπιος ἔτρεφε πῆμα
Τρωσί τε καὶ Πριάμῳ μεγαλήτορι τοῖό τε παισίν.
εἰ κεῖνόν γε ἴδοιμι κατελθόντ’ Ἄϊδος εἴσω
φαίην κε φρέν’ ἀτέρπου ὀϊζύος ἐκλελαθέσθαι.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, ἡ δὲ μολοῦσα ποτὶ μέγαρ’ ἀμφιπόλοισι
κέκλετο· ταὶ δ’ ἄρ’ ἀόλλισσαν κατὰ ἄστυ γεραιάς.
αὐτὴ δ’ ἐς θάλαμον κατεβήσετο κηώεντα,
ἔνθ’ ἔσάν οἱ πέπλοι παμποίκιλα ἔργα γυναικῶν
Σιδονίων, τὰς αὐτὸς Ἀλέξανδρος θεοειδὴς
ἤγαγε Σιδονίηθεν ἐπιπλὼς εὐρέα πόντον,
τὴν ὁδὸν ἣν Ἑλένην περ ἀνήγαγεν εὐπατέρειαν·
τῶν ἔν’ ἀειραμένη Ἑκάβη φέρε δῶρον Ἀθήνῃ,

294 ὃς κάλλιστος ἔην ποικίλμασιν ἠδὲ μέγιστος,
295 ἀστὴρ δ’ ὡς ἀπέλαμπεν· ἔκειτο δὲ νείατος ἄλλων.
296 βῆ δ’ ἰέναι, πολλαὶ δὲ μετεσσεύοντο γεραιαί.
297 αἱ δ’ ὅτε νηὸν ἵκανον Ἀθήνης ἐν πόλει ἄκρῃ,
298 τῇσι θύρας ὤϊξε Θεανὼ καλλιπάρῃος
299 Κισσηΐς ἄλοχος Ἀντήνορος ἱπποδάμοιο·
300 τὴν γὰρ Τρῶες ἔθηκαν Ἀθηναίης ἱέρειαν.

6.301

301 αἳ δ’ ὀλολυγῇ πᾶσαι Ἀθήνῃ χεῖρας ἀνέσχον·
302 ἣ δ’ ἄρα πέπλον ἑλοῦσα Θεανὼ καλλιπάρῃος
303 θῆκεν Ἀθηναίης ἐπὶ γούνασιν ἠϋκόμοιο,
304 εὐχομένη δ’ ἠρᾶτο Διὸς κούρῃ μεγάλοιο·
305 πότνι’ Ἀθηναίη ἐρυσίπτολι δῖα θεάων
306 ἆξον δὴ ἔγχος Διομήδεος, ἠδὲ καὶ αὐτὸν
307 πρηνέα δὸς πεσέειν Σκαιῶν προπάροιθε πυλάων,
308 ὄφρά τοι αὐτίκα νῦν δυοκαίδεκα βοῦς ἐνὶ νηῷ
309 ἤνις ἠκέστας ἱερεύσομεν, αἴ κ’ ἐλεήσῃς
310 ἄστύ τε καὶ Τρώων ἀλόχους καὶ νήπια τέκνα.
311 ὣς ἔφατ’ εὐχομένη, ἀνένευε δὲ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη.
312 ὣς αἳ μέν ῥ’ εὔχοντο Διὸς κούρῃ μεγάλοιο,
313 Ἕκτωρ δὲ πρὸς δώματ’ Ἀλεξάνδροιο βεβήκει
314 καλά, τά ῥ’ αὐτὸς ἔτευξε σὺν ἀνδράσιν οἳ τότ’ ἄριστοι
315 ἦσαν ἐνὶ Τροίῃ ἐριβώλακι τέκτονες ἄνδρες,
316 οἵ οἱ ἐποίησαν θάλαμον καὶ δῶμα καὶ αὐλὴν
317 ἐγγύθι τε Πριάμοιο καὶ Ἕκτορος ἐν πόλει ἄκρῃ.
318 ἔνθ’ Ἕκτωρ εἰσῆλθε Διῒ φίλος, ἐν δ’ ἄρα χειρὶ
319 ἔγχος ἔχ’ ἐνδεκάπηχυ· πάροιθε δὲ λάμπετο δουρὸς
320 αἰχμὴ χαλκείη, περὶ δὲ χρύσεος θέε πόρκης.
321 τὸν δ’ εὗρ’ ἐν θαλάμῳ περικαλλέα τεύχε’ ἕποντα
322 ἀσπίδα καὶ θώρηκα, καὶ ἀγκύλα τόξ’ ἀφόωντα·
323 Ἀργείη δ’ Ἑλένη μετ’ ἄρα δμῳῇσι γυναιξὶν
324 ἧστο καὶ ἀμφιπόλοισι περικλυτὰ ἔργα κέλευε.
325 τὸν δ’ Ἕκτωρ νείκεσσεν ἰδὼν αἰσχροῖς ἐπέεσσι·
326 δαιμόνι’ οὐ μὲν καλὰ χόλον τόνδ’ ἔνθεο θυμῷ,
327 λαοὶ μὲν φθινύθουσι περὶ πτόλιν αἰπύ τε τεῖχος
328 μαρνάμενοι· σέο δ’ εἵνεκ’ ἀϋτή τε πτόλεμός τε
329 ἄστυ τόδ’ ἀμφιδέδηε· σὺ δ’ ἂν μαχέσαιο καὶ ἄλλῳ,
330 ὅν τινά που μεθιέντα ἴδοις στυγεροῦ πολέμοιο.
"Holy Athena," she cried, "protectress of our city, mighty goddess, break the spear of Diomedes and lay him low before the Scaean gates. Do this, and we will sacrifice twelve heifers that have never yet known the goad, in your temple, if you will have pity upon the town, with the wives and little ones If the Trojans." Thus she prayed, but Pallas Athena granted not her prayer. While they were thus praying to the daughter of great Zeus, Hektor went to the fair house of Alexander, which he had built for him by the foremost builders in the land. They had built him his house, storehouse, and courtyard near those of Priam and Hektor on the acropolis. Here Hektor entered, with a spear eleven cubits long in his hand; the bronze point gleamed in front of him, and was fastened to the shaft of the spear by a ring of gold. He found Alexander within the house, busied about his armor, his shield and cuirass, and handling his curved bow; there, too, sat Argive Helen with her women, setting them their several tasks; and as Hektor saw him he rebuked him with words of scorn. "Sir,"

said he, "you do ill to nurse this rancor; the people perish fighting round this our town; you would yourself chide one whom you saw shirking his part in the combat. Up then, or ere long the city will be in a blaze." And Alexander answered, "Hektor, your rebuke is just; listen therefore, and believe me when I tell you that I am not here so much through rancor or ill-will [nemesis] towards the Trojans, as from a desire to indulge my grief. My wife was even now gently urging me to battle, and I hold it better that I should go, for victory is ever fickle. Wait, then, while I put on my armor, or go first and I will follow. I shall be sure to overtake you." Hektor made no answer, but Helen tried to soothe him. "Brother," said she, "to my abhorred and sinful self, would that a whirlwind had caught me up on the day my mother brought me forth, and had borne me to some mountain or to the waves of the roaring sea that should have swept me away ere this mischief had come about. But, since the gods have devised these evils, would, at any rate, that I had been wife to a better man - to one who could smart under dishonor [nemesis] and men's evil speeches. This man was never yet to be depended upon, nor never will be, and he will surely reap what he has sown. Still, brother, come in and rest upon this seat, for it is you who bear the brunt of that toil [ponos] that has been caused by my hateful self and by the veering [atê] of Alexander - both of whom Zeus has doomed to be a theme of song among those that shall be born hereafter." And Hektor answered, "Bid me not be seated, Helen, for all the goodwill you bear me. I cannot stay. I am in haste to help the Trojans, who miss me greatly when I am not among them; but urge your husband, and of his own self also let him make haste to overtake me before I am out of the city. I must go home to see my household, my wife and my little son, for I know not whether I shall ever again return to them, or whether the gods will cause me to fill by the hands of the Achaeans." Then Hektor left her, and forthwith was at his own house. He did not find Andromache, for she was on the wall with her child and one of her maids, weeping bitterly. Seeing, then, that she was not within, he stood on the threshold of the women's rooms and said, "Women, tell me, and tell me true, where did Andromache go when she left the house? Was it to my sisters, or to my brothers' wives? or is she at the temple of Athena where the other women are propitiating the awful goddess?" His good housekeeper answered, "Hektor, since you bid me tell you truly [alêthea], she did not go to your sisters nor to your brothers' wives, nor yet to the temple of Athena, where the other women are propitiating the awful goddess, but she is on the high wall of Ilion, for she had heard the Trojans were being hard pressed, and that the Achaeans were in great force: she went to the wall in frenzied haste, and the nurse went with her carrying the child."

6.331

ἀλλ᾽ ἄνα μὴ τάχα ἄστυ πυρὸς δηΐοιο θέρηται.
τὸν δ᾽ αὖτε προσέειπεν Ἀλέξανδρος θεοειδής·
Ἕκτορ ἐπεί με κατ᾽ αἶσαν ἐνείκεσας οὐδ᾽ ὑπὲρ αἶσαν,
τοὔνεκά τοι ἐρέω· σὺ δὲ σύνθεο καί μευ ἄκουσον·
οὔ τοι ἐγὼ Τρώων τόσσον χόλῳ οὐδὲ νεμέσσι
ἤμην ἐν θαλάμῳ, ἔθελον δ᾽ ἄχεϊ προτραπέσθαι.
νῦν δέ με παρειποῦσ᾽ ἄλοχος μαλακοῖς ἐπέεσσιν
ὄρμησ᾽ ἐς πόλεμον· δοκέει δέ μοι ὧδε καὶ αὐτῷ
λώϊον ἔσσεσθαι· νίκη δ᾽ ἐπαμείβεται ἄνδρας.
ἀλλ᾽ ἄγε νῦν ἐπίμεινον, Ἀρήϊα τεύχεα δύω·
ἢ ἴθ᾽, ἐγὼ δὲ μέτειμι· κιχήσεσθαι δέ σ᾽ ὀΐω.
ὣς φάτο, τὸν δ᾽ οὔ τι προσέφη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
τὸν δ᾽ Ἑλένη μύθοισι προσηύδα μειλιχίοισι·
δᾶερ ἐμεῖο κυνὸς κακομηχάνου ὀκρυοέσσης,
ὥς μ᾽ ὄφελ᾽ ἤματι τῷ ὅτε με πρῶτον τέκε μήτηρ
οἴχεσθαι προφέρουσα κακὴ ἀνέμοιο θύελλα

347 εἰς ὄρος ἢ εἰς κῦμα πολυφλοίσβοιο θαλάσσης,
348 ἔνθά με κῦμ’ ἀπόερσε πάρος τάδε ἔργα γενέσθαι.
349 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ τάδε γ’ ὧδε θεοὶ κακὰ τεκμήραντο,
350 ἀνδρὸς ἔπειτ’ ὤφελλον ἀμείνονος εἶναι ἄκοιτις,
351 ὃς ἤδη νέμεσίν τε καὶ αἴσχεα πόλλ’ ἀνθρώπων.
352 τούτῳ δ’ οὔτ’ ἂρ νῦν φρένες ἔμπεδοι οὔτ’ ἄρ’ ὀπίσσω
353 ἔσσονται· τὼ καί μιν ἐπαυρήσεσθαι ὀΐω.
354 ἀλλ’ ἄγε νῦν εἴσελθε καὶ ἕζεο τῷδ’ ἐπὶ δίφρῳ
355 δᾶερ, ἐπεί σε μάλιστα πόνος φρένας ἀμφιβέβηκεν
356 εἵνεκ’ ἐμεῖο κυνὸς καὶ Ἀλεξάνδρου ἕνεκ’ ἄτης,
357 οἵσιν ἐπὶ Ζεὺς θῆκε κακὸν μόρον, ὡς καὶ ὀπίσσω
358 ἀνθρώποισι πελώμεθ’ ἀοίδιμοι ἐσσομένοισι.
359 τὴν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ
360 μή με κάθιζ’ Ἑλένη φιλέουσά περ· οὐδέ με πείσεις·

6.361

361 ἤδη γάρ μοι θυμὸς ἐπέσσυται ὄφρ’ ἐπαμύνω
362 Τρώεσσ’, οἳ μέγ’ ἐμεῖο ποθὴν ἀπεόντος ἔχουσιν.
363 ἀλλὰ σύ γ’ ὄρνυθι τοῦτον, ἐπειγέσθω δὲ καὶ αὐτός,
364 ὥς κεν ἔμ’ ἔντοσθεν πόλιος καταμάρψῃ ἐόντα.
365 καὶ γὰρ ἐγὼν οἶκον δὲ ἐλεύσομαι ὄφρα ἴδωμαι
366 οἰκῆας ἄλοχόν τε φίλην καὶ νήπιον υἱόν.
367 οὐ γὰρ οἶδ’ εἰ ἔτι σφιν ὑπότροπος ἵξομαι αὖτις,
368 ἦ ἤδη μ’ ὑπὸ χερσὶ θεοὶ δαμόωσιν Ἀχαιῶν.
369 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἀπέβη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
370 αἶψα δ’ ἔπειθ’ ἵκανε δόμους εὖ ναιετάοντας,
371 οὐδ’ εὗρ’ Ἀνδρομάχην λευκώλενον ἐν μεγάροισιν,
372 ἀλλ’ ἥ γε ξὺν παιδὶ καὶ ἀμφιπόλῳ ἐϋπέπλῳ
373 πύργῳ ἐφεστήκει γοόωσά τε μυρομένη τε.
374 Ἕκτωρ δ’ ὡς οὐκ ἔνδον ἀμύμονα τέτμεν ἄκοιτιν
375 ἔστη ἐπ’ οὐδὸν ἰών, μετὰ δὲ δμῳῇσιν ἔειπεν·
376 εἰ δ’ ἄγε μοι δμῳαὶ νημερτέα μυθήσασθε·
377 πῇ ἔβη Ἀνδρομάχη λευκώλενος ἐκ μεγάροιο;
378 ἠέ πῃ ἐς γαλόων ἢ εἰνατέρων ἐϋπέπλων
379 ἢ ἐς Ἀθηναίης ἐξοίχεται, ἔνθά περ ἄλλαι
380 Τρῳαὶ ἐϋπλόκαμοι δεινὴν θεὸν ἱλάσκονται;
381 τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ ὀτρηρὴ ταμίη πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν·
382 Ἕκτορ ἐπεὶ μάλ’ ἄνωγας ἀληθέα μυθήσασθαι,
383 οὔτέ πῃ ἐς γαλόων οὔτ’ εἰνατέρων ἐϋπέπλων
384 οὔτ’ ἐς Ἀθηναίης ἐξοίχεται, ἔνθά περ ἄλλαι
385 Τρῳαὶ ἐϋπλόκαμοι δεινὴν θεὸν ἱλάσκονται,
386 ἀλλ’ ἐπὶ πύργον ἔβη μέγαν Ἰλίου, οὕνεκ’ ἄκουσε
387 τείρεσθαι Τρῶας, μέγα δὲ κράτος εἶναι Ἀχαιῶν.
388 ἣ μὲν δὴ πρὸς τεῖχος ἐπειγομένη ἀφικάνει
389 μαινομένῃ ἐϊκυῖα· φέρει δ’ ἅμα παῖδα τιθήνη.
390 ἦ ῥα γυνὴ ταμίη, ὃ δ’ ἀπέσσυτο δώματος Ἕκτωρ

Hektor hurried from the house when she had done speaking, and went down the streets by the same way that he had come. When he had gone through the city and had reached the Scaean gates through which he would go out on to the plain, his wife came running towards him, Andromache, daughter of great Eetion who ruled in Thebe under the wooded slopes of Mount Plakos, and was king of the Cilicians. His daughter had married Hektor, and now

came to meet him with a nurse who carried his little child in her bosom - a mere babe. Hektor's darling son, and lovely as a star. Hektor had named him Skamandrios, but the people called him Astyanax, for his father stood alone as chief guardian of Ilion. Hektor smiled as he looked upon the boy, but he did not speak, and Andromache stood by him weeping and taking his hand in her own. "Dear husband," said she, "your valor will bring you to destruction; think on your infant son, and on my hapless self who ere long shall be your widow - for the Achaeans will set upon you in a body and kill you. It would be better for me, should I lose you, to lie dead and buried, for I shall have nothing left to comfort me when you are gone, save only sorrow [akhos]. I have neither father nor mother now. Achilles slew my father when he sacked Thebe the goodly city of the Cilicians. He slew him, but did not for very shame despoil him; when he had burned him in his wondrous armor, he raised a barrow over his ashes and the mountain nymphs, daughters of aegis-bearing Zeus, planted a grove of elms about his tomb [sêma]. I had seven brothers in my father's house, but on the same day they all went within the house of Hades. Achilles killed them as they were with their sheep and cattle. My mother - her who had been queen of all the land under Mount Plakos - he brought hither with the spoil, and freed her for a great sum, but the archer - queen Artemis took her in the house of your father. Nay - Hektor - you who to me are father, mother, brother, and dear husband - have mercy upon me; stay here upon this wall; make not your child fatherless, and your wife a widow; as for the host, place them near the fig-tree, where the city can be best scaled, and the wall is weakest. Thrice have the bravest of them come thither and assailed it, under the two Ajaxes, Idomeneus, the sons of Atreus, and the brave son of Tydeus, either of their own bidding, or because some soothsayer had told them." And Hektor answered, "Wife, I too have thought upon all this, but with what face should I look upon the Trojans, men or women, if I shirked battle like a coward? I cannot do so: I know nothing save to fight bravely in the forefront of the Trojan host and win renown [kleos] alike for my father and myself. Well do I know that the day will surely come when mighty Ilion shall be destroyed with Priam and Priam's people, but I grieve for none of these - not even for Hecuba, nor King Priam, nor for my brothers many and brave who may fall in the dust before their foes - for none of these do I grieve as for yourself when the day shall come on which some one of the Achaeans shall rob you for ever of your freedom, and bear you weeping away. It may be that you will have to ply the loom in Argos at the bidding of a mistress, or to fetch water from the springs Messeis or Hypereia, treated brutally by some cruel task-master; then will one say who sees you weeping, ‘She was wife to Hektor, the bravest warrior among the Trojans during the war before Ilion.’ On this your tears will break forth anew for him who would have put away the day of captivity from you. May I lie dead under the barrow that is heaped over my body ere I hear your cry as they carry you into bondage." He stretched his arms towards his child, but the boy cried and nestled in his nurse's bosom, scared at the sight of his father's armor, and at the horse-hair plume that nodded fiercely from his helmet. His father and mother laughed to see him, but Hektor took the helmet from his head and laid it all gleaming upon the ground. Then he took his darling child, kissed him, and dandled him in his arms, praying over him the while to Zeus and to all the gods. "Zeus," he cried, "grant that this my child may be even as myself, chief among the Trojans; let him be not less excellent in strength, and let him rule Ilion with his might. Then may one say of him as he comes from battle, ‘The son is far better than the father.’ May he bring back the blood-stained spoils of him whom he has laid low, and let his mother's heart be glad.’" With this he laid the child again in the arms of his wife, who took him to her own soft bosom, smiling through her tears. As her husband watched her his heart yearned towards her and he caressed her fondly, saying, "My own wife, do not take these things too bitterly to heart. No one can hurry me down to Hades before my time, but if a man's hour is come, be he brave or be he coward, there is no escape for him when he has once been born. Go, then, within the house, and busy yourself with your daily duties,

your loom, your distaff, and the ordering of your servants; for war is man's matter, and mine above all others of them that have been born in Ilion." He took his plumed helmet from the ground, and his wife went back again to her house, weeping bitterly and often looking back towards him. When she reached her home she found her maidens within, and bade them all join in her lament; so they mourned Hektor in his own house though he was yet alive, for they deemed that they should never see him return safe from battle, and from the furious hands of the Achaeans. Paris did not remain long in his house. He donned his goodly armor overlaid with bronze, and hastened through the city as fast as his feet could take him. As a horse, stabled and fed, breaks loose and gallops gloriously over the plain to the place where he is wont to bathe in the fair-flowing river - he holds his head high, and his mane streams upon his shoulders as he exults in his strength and flies like the wind to the haunts and feeding ground of the mares -

6.391

391 τὴν αὐτὴν ὁδὸν αὖτις ἐϋκτιμένας κατ’ ἀγυιάς.
392 εὖτε πύλας ἵκανε διερχόμενος μέγα ἄστυ
393 Σκαιάς, τῇ ἄρ’ ἔμελλε διεξίμεναι πεδίον δέ,
394 ἔνθ’ ἄλοχος πολύδωρος ἐναντίη ἦλθε θέουσα
395 Ἀνδρομάχη θυγάτηρ μεγαλήτορος Ἠετίωνος
396 Ἠετίων ὃς ἔναιεν ὑπὸ Πλάκῳ ὑληέσσῃ
397 Θήβῃ Ὑποπλακίῃ Κιλίκεσσ’ ἄνδρεσσιν ἀνάσσων·
398 τοῦ περ δὴ θυγάτηρ ἔχεθ’ Ἕκτορι χαλκοκορυστῇ.
399 ἥ οἱ ἔπειτ’ ἤντησ’, ἅμα δ’ ἀμφίπολος κίεν αὐτῇ
400 παῖδ’ ἐπὶ κόλπῳ ἔχουσ’ ἀταλάφρονα νήπιον αὖτως
401 Ἕκτορίδην ἀγαπητὸν ἀλίγκιον ἀστέρι καλῷ,
402 τόν ῥ’ Ἕκτωρ καλέεσκε Σκαμάνδριον, αὐτὰρ οἱ ἄλλοι
403 Ἀστυάνακτ’· οἶος γὰρ ἐρύετο Ἴλιον Ἕκτωρ.
404 ἤτοι ὃ μὲν μείδησεν ἰδὼν ἐς παῖδα σιωπῇ·
405 Ἀνδρομάχη δέ οἱ ἄγχι παρίστατο δάκρυ χέουσα,
406 ἔν τ’ ἄρα οἱ φῦ χειρὶ ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζε·
407 δαιμόνιε φθίσει σε τὸ σὸν μένος, οὐδ’ ἐλεαίρεις
408 παῖδά τε νηπίαχον καὶ ἔμ’ ἄμμορον, ἢ τάχα χήρη
409 σεῦ ἔσομαι· τάχα γάρ σε κατακτανέουσιν Ἀχαιοὶ
410 πάντες ἐφορμηθέντες· ἐμοὶ δέ κε κέρδιον εἴη
411 σεῦ ἀφαμαρτούσῃ χθόνα δύμεναι· οὐ γὰρ ἔτ’ ἄλλη
412 ἔσται θαλπωρὴ ἐπεὶ ἂν σύ γε πότμον ἐπίσπῃς
413 ἀλλ’ ἄχε’· οὐδέ μοι ἔστι πατὴρ καὶ πότνια μήτηρ.
414 ἤτοι γὰρ πατέρ’ ἀμὸν ἀπέκτανε δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
415 ἐκ δὲ πόλιν πέρσεν Κιλίκων εὖ ναιετάουσαν
416 Θήβην ὑψίπυλον· κατὰ δ’ ἔκτανεν Ἠετίωνα,
417 οὐδέ μιν ἐξενάριξε, σεβάσσατο γὰρ τό γε θυμῷ,
418 ἀλλ’ ἄρα μιν κατέκηε σὺν ἔντεσι δαιδαλέοισιν
419 ἠδ’ ἐπὶ σῆμ’ ἔχεεν· περὶ δὲ πτελέας ἐφύτευσαν
420 νύμφαι ὀρεστιάδες κοῦραι Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο.

6.421

421 οἳ δέ μοι ἑπτὰ κασίγνητοι ἔσαν ἐν μεγάροισιν
422 οἳ μὲν πάντες ἰῷ κίον ἤματι Ἄϊδος εἴσω·
423 πάντας γὰρ κατέπεφνε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
424 βουσὶν ἐπ’ εἰλιπόδεσσι καὶ ἀργεννῇς οἰέσσι.

μητέρα δ’, ἣ βασίλευεν ὑπὸ Πλάκῳ ὑληέσσῃ,
τὴν ἐπεὶ ἂρ δεῦρ’ ἤγαγ’ ἅμ’ ἄλλοισι κτεάτεσσιν,
ἂψ ὅ γε τὴν ἀπέλυσε λαβὼν ἀπερείσι’ ἄποινα,
πατρὸς δ’ ἐν μεγάροισι βάλ’ Ἄρτεμις ἰοχέαιρα.
Ἕκτορ ἀτὰρ σύ μοί ἐσσι πατὴρ καὶ πότνια μήτηρ
ἠδὲ κασίγνητος, σὺ δέ μοι θαλερὸς παρακοίτης·
ἀλλ’ ἄγε νῦν ἐλέαιρε καὶ αὐτοῦ μίμν’ ἐπὶ πύργῳ,
μὴ παῖδ’ ὀρφανικὸν θήῃς χήρην τε γυναῖκα·
λαὸν δὲ στῆσον παρ’ ἐρινεόν, ἔνθα μάλιστα
ἀμβατός ἐστι πόλις καὶ ἐπίδρομον ἔπλετο τεῖχος.
τρὶς γὰρ τῇ γ’ ἐλθόντες ἐπειρήσανθ’ οἱ ἄριστοι
ἀμφ’ Αἴαντε δύω καὶ ἀγακλυτὸν Ἰδομενῆα
ἠδ’ ἀμφ’ Ἀτρεΐδας καὶ Τυδέος ἄλκιμον υἱόν·
ἤ πού τίς σφιν ἔνισπε θεοπροπίων ἐὺ εἰδώς,
ἤ νυ καὶ αὐτῶν θυμὸς ἐποτρύνει καὶ ἀνώγει.
τὴν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
ἦ καὶ ἐμοὶ τάδε πάντα μέλει γύναι· ἀλλὰ μάλ’ αἰνῶς
αἰδέομαι Τρῶας καὶ Τρῳάδας ἑλκεσιπέπλους,
αἴ κε κακὸς ὣς νόσφιν ἀλυσκάζω πολέμοιο·
οὐδέ με θυμὸς ἄνωγεν, ἐπεὶ μάθον ἔμμεναι ἐσθλὸς
αἰεὶ καὶ πρώτοισι μετὰ Τρώεσσι μάχεσθαι
ἀρνύμενος πατρός τε μέγα κλέος ἠδ’ ἐμὸν αὐτοῦ.
εὖ γὰρ ἐγὼ τόδε οἶδα κατὰ φρένα καὶ κατὰ θυμόν·
ἔσσεται ἦμαρ ὅτ’ ἄν ποτ’ ὀλώλῃ Ἴλιος ἰρὴ
καὶ Πρίαμος καὶ λαὸς ἐϋμμελίω Πριάμοιο.
ἀλλ’ οὔ μοι Τρώων τόσσον μέλει ἄλγος ὀπίσσω,

6.451

οὔτ’ αὐτῆς Ἑκάβης οὔτε Πριάμοιο ἄνακτος
οὔτε κασιγνήτων, οἵ κεν πολέες τε καὶ ἐσθλοὶ
ἐν κονίῃσι πέσοιεν ὑπ’ ἀνδράσι δυσμενέεσσιν,
ὅσσον σεῦ, ὅτε κέν τις Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων
δακρυόεσσαν ἄγηται ἐλεύθερον ἦμαρ ἀπούρας·
καί κεν ἐν Ἄργει ἐοῦσα πρὸς ἄλλης ἱστὸν ὑφαίνοις,
καί κεν ὕδωρ φορέοις Μεσσηΐδος ἢ Ὑπερείης
πόλλ’ ἀεκαζομένη, κρατερὴ δ’ ἐπικείσετ’ ἀνάγκη·
καί ποτέ τις εἴπῃσιν ἰδὼν κατὰ δάκρυ χέουσαν·
Ἕκτορος ἥδε γυνὴ ὃς ἀριστεύεσκε μάχεσθαι
Τρώων ἱπποδάμων ὅτε Ἴλιον ἀμφεμάχοντο.
ὥς ποτέ τις ἐρέει· σοὶ δ’ αὖ νέον ἔσσεται ἄλγος
χήτεϊ τοιοῦδ’ ἀνδρὸς ἀμύνειν δούλιον ἦμαρ.
ἀλλά με τεθνηῶτα χυτὴ κατὰ γαῖα καλύπτοι
πρίν γέ τι σῆς τε βοῆς σοῦ θ’ ἑλκηθμοῖο πυθέσθαι.
ὣς εἰπὼν οὗ παιδὸς ὀρέξατο φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ·
ἂψ δ’ ὃ πάϊς πρὸς κόλπον ἐϋζώνοιο τιθήνης
ἐκλίνθη ἰάχων πατρὸς φίλου ὄψιν ἀτυχθεὶς
ταρβήσας χαλκόν τε ἰδὲ λόφον ἱππιοχαίτην,
δεινὸν ἀπ’ ἀκροτάτης κόρυθος νεύοντα νοήσας.
ἐκ δ’ ἐγέλασσε πατήρ τε φίλος καὶ πότνια μήτηρ·
αὐτίκ’ ἀπὸ κρατὸς κόρυθ’ εἵλετο φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ,
καὶ τὴν μὲν κατέθηκεν ἐπὶ χθονὶ παμφανόωσαν·

αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ὃν φίλον υἱὸν ἐπεὶ κύσε πῆλέ τε χερσὶν
εἶπε δ’ ἐπευξάμενος Διί τ’ ἄλλοισίν τε θεοῖσι·
Ζεῦ ἄλλοι τε θεοὶ δότε δὴ καὶ τόνδε γενέσθαι
παῖδ’ ἐμὸν ὡς καὶ ἐγώ περ ἀριπρεπέα Τρώεσσιν,
ὧδε βίην τ’ ἀγαθόν, καὶ Ἰλίου ἶφι ἀνάσσειν·
καί ποτέ τις εἴποι πατρός γ’ ὅδε πολλὸν ἀμείνων
ἐκ πολέμου ἀνιόντα· φέροι δ’ ἔναρα βροτόεντα

6.481

κτείνας δήϊον ἄνδρα, χαρείη δὲ φρένα μήτηρ.
ὣς εἰπὼν ἀλόχοιο φίλης ἐν χερσὶν ἔθηκε
παῖδ’ ἑόν· ἣ δ’ ἄρα μιν κηώδεϊ δέξατο κόλπῳ
δακρυόεν γελάσασα· πόσις δ’ ἐλέησε νοήσας,
χειρί τέ μιν κατέρεξεν ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζε·
δαιμονίη μή μοί τι λίην ἀκαχίζεο θυμῷ·
οὐ γάρ τίς μ’ ὑπὲρ αἶσαν ἀνὴρ Ἄϊδι προϊάψει·
μοῖραν δ’ οὔ τινά φημι πεφυγμένον ἔμμεναι ἀνδρῶν,
οὐ κακὸν οὐδὲ μὲν ἐσθλόν, ἐπὴν τὰ πρῶτα γένηται.
ἀλλ’ εἰς οἶκον ἰοῦσα τὰ σ’ αὐτῆς ἔργα κόμιζε
ἱστόν τ’ ἠλακάτην τε, καὶ ἀμφιπόλοισι κέλευε
ἔργον ἐποίχεσθαι· πόλεμος δ’ ἄνδρεσσι μελήσει
πᾶσι, μάλιστα δ’ ἐμοί, τοὶ Ἰλίῳ ἐγγεγάασιν.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας κόρυθ’ εἵλετο φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
ἵππουριν· ἄλοχος δὲ φίλη οἶκον δὲ βεβήκει
ἐντροπαλιζομένη, θαλερὸν κατὰ δάκρυ χέουσα.
αἶψα δ’ ἔπειθ’ ἵκανε δόμους εὖ ναιετάοντας
Ἕκτορος ἀνδροφόνοιο, κιχήσατο δ’ ἔνδοθι πολλὰς
ἀμφιπόλους, τῇσιν δὲ γόον πάσῃσιν ἐνῶρσεν.
αἳ μὲν ἔτι ζωὸν γόον Ἕκτορα ᾧ ἐνὶ οἴκῳ·
οὐ γάρ μιν ἔτ’ ἔφαντο ὑπότροπον ἐκ πολέμοιο
ἴξεσθαι προφυγόντα μένος καὶ χεῖρας Ἀχαιῶν.
οὐδὲ Πάρις δήθυνεν ἐν ὑψηλοῖσι δόμοισιν,
ἀλλ’ ὅ γ’, ἐπεὶ κατέδυ κλυτὰ τεύχεα ποικίλα χαλκῷ,
σεύατ’ ἔπειτ’ ἀνὰ ἄστυ ποσὶ κραιπνοῖσι πεποιθώς.
ὡς δ’ ὅτε τις στατὸς ἵππος ἀκοστήσας ἐπὶ φάτνῃ
δεσμὸν ἀπορρήξας θείῃ πεδίοιο κροαίνων
εἰωθὼς λούεσθαι ἐϋρρεῖος ποταμοῖο
κυδιόων· ὑψοῦ δὲ κάρη ἔχει, ἀμφὶ δὲ χαῖται
ὤμοις ἀΐσσονται· ὃ δ’ ἀγλαΐηφι πεποιθὼς

6.511

ῥίμφά ἑ γοῦνα φέρει μετά τ’ ἤθεα καὶ νομὸν ἵππων·
ὣς υἱὸς Πριάμοιο Πάρις κατὰ Περγάμου ἄκρης
τεύχεσι παμφαίνων ὥς τ’ ἠλέκτωρ ἐβεβήκει
καγχαλόων, ταχέες δὲ πόδες φέρον· αἶψα δ’ ἔπειτα
Ἕκτορα δῖον ἔτετμεν ἀδελφεὸν εὖτ’ ἄρ’ ἔμελλε
στρέψεσθ’ ἐκ χώρης ὅθι ᾗ ὁάριζε γυναικί.
τὸν πρότερος προσέειπεν Ἀλέξανδρος θεοειδής·
ἠθεῖ’ ἦ μάλα δή σε καὶ ἐσσύμενον κατερύκω
δηθύνων, οὐδ’ ἦλθον ἐναίσιμον ὡς ἐκέλευες;

520 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
521 δαιμόνι’ οὐκ ἄν τίς τοι ἀνὴρ ὃς ἐναίσιμος εἴη
522 ἔργον ἀτιμήσειε μάχης, ἐπεὶ ἄλκιμός ἐσσι·
523 ἀλλὰ ἑκὼν μεθιεῖς τε καὶ οὐκ ἐθέλεις· τὸ δ’ ἐμὸν κῆρ
524 ἄχνυται ἐν θυμῷ, ὅθ’ ὑπὲρ σέθεν αἴσχε’ ἀκούω
525 πρὸς Τρώων, οἳ ἔχουσι πολὺν πόνον εἵνεκα σεῖο.
526 ἀλλ’ ἴομεν· τὰ δ’ ὄπισθεν ἀρεσσόμεθ’, αἴ κέ ποθι Ζεὺς
527 δώῃ ἐπουρανίοισι θεοῖς αἰειγενέτῃσι
528 κρητῆρα στήσασθαι ἐλεύθερον ἐν μεγάροισιν
529 ἐκ Τροίης ἐλάσαντας ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιούς.
even so went forth Paris from high Pergamos, gleaming like sunlight in his armor, and he laughed aloud as he sped swiftly on his way. Forthwith he came upon his brother Hektor, who was then turning away from the place where he had held converse with his wife, and he was himself the first to speak. "Sir," said he, "I fear that I have kept you waiting when you are in haste, and have not come as quickly as you bade me." "My good brother," answered Hektor, you fight bravely, and no man with any justice can make light of your doings in battle. But you are careless and willfully remiss. It grieves me to the heart to hear the ill that the Trojans speak about you, for they have suffered much toil [ponos] on your account. Let us be going, and we will make things right hereafter, should Zeus grant us to set the cup of our deliverance before ever-living gods of heaven in our own homes, when we have chased the Achaeans from Troy."

7.1

1 Ὣς εἰπὼν πυλέων ἐξέσσυτο φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ,
2 τῷ δ’ ἅμ’ Ἀλέξανδρος κί’ ἀδελφεός· ἐν δ’ ἄρα θυμῷ
3 ἀμφότεροι μέμασαν πολεμίζειν ἠδὲ μάχεσθαι.
4 ὡς δὲ θεὸς ναύτῃσιν ἐελδομένοισιν ἔδωκεν
5 οὖρον, ἐπεί κε κάμωσιν ἐϋξέστῃς ἐλάτῃσι
6 πόντον ἐλαύνοντες, καμάτῳ δ’ ὑπὸ γυῖα λέλυνται,
7 ὣς ἄρα τὼ Τρώεσσιν ἐελδομένοισι φανήτην.
8 ἔνθ’ ἑλέτην ὃ μὲν υἱὸν Ἀρηϊθόοιο ἄνακτος
9 Ἄρνῃ ναιετάοντα Μενέσθιον, ὃν κορυνήτης
10 γείνατ’ Ἀρηΐθοος καὶ Φυλομέδουσα βοῶπις·
11 Ἕκτωρ δ’ Ἠϊονῆα βάλ’ ἔγχεϊ ὀξυόεντι
12 αὐχέν’ ὑπὸ στεφάνης εὐχάλκου, λύντο δὲ γυῖα.
13 Γλαῦκος δ’ Ἱππολόχοιο πάϊς Λυκίων ἀγὸς ἀνδρῶν
14 Ἰφίνοον βάλε δουρὶ κατὰ κρατερὴν ὑσμίνην
15 Δεξιάδην ἵππων ἐπιάλμενον ὠκειάων
16 ὦμον· ὃ δ’ ἐξ ἵππων χαμάδις πέσε, λύντο δὲ γυῖα.
17 τοὺς δ’ ὡς οὖν ἐνόησε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη
18 Ἀργείους ὀλέκοντας ἐνὶ κρατερῇ ὑσμίνῃ,
19 βῆ ῥα κατ’ Οὐλύμποιο καρήνων ἀΐξασα
20 Ἴλιον εἰς ἱερήν· τῇ δ’ ἀντίος ὄρνυτ’ Ἀπόλλων
21 Περγάμου ἐκκατιδών, Τρώεσσι δὲ βούλετο νίκην·
22 ἀλλήλοισι δὲ τώ γε συναντέσθην παρὰ φηγῷ.
23 τὴν πρότερος προσέειπεν ἄναξ Διὸς υἱὸς Ἀπόλλων·
24 τίπτε σὺ δ’ αὖ μεμαυῖα Διὸς θύγατερ μεγάλοιο
25 ἦλθες ἀπ’ Οὐλύμποιο, μέγας δέ σε θυμὸς ἀνῆκεν;
26 ἦ ἵνα δὴ Δαναοῖσι μάχης ἐτεραλκέα νίκην
27 δῷς; ἐπεὶ οὔ τι Τρῶας ἀπολλυμένους ἐλεαίρεις.
28 ἀλλ’ εἴ μοί τι πίθοιο τό κεν πολὺ κέρδιον εἴη·

29 νῦν μὲν παύσωμεν πόλεμον καὶ δηϊοτῆτα
30 σήμερον· ὕστερον αὖτε μαχήσοντ’ εἰς ὅ κε τέκμωρ
With these words Hektor passed through the gates, and his brother Alexander with him, both eager for the fray. As when heaven sends a breeze to sailors who have long looked for one in vain, and have labored at their oars at sea [pontos] till they are faint with toil, even so welcome was the sight of these two heroes to the Trojans. Thereon Alexander killed Menesthios the son of Areithoos; he lived in Ame, and was son of Areithoos the Mace-man, and of Phylomedousa. Hektor threw a spear at Eioneus and struck him dead with a wound in the neck under the bronze rim of his helmet. Glaukos, moreover, son of Hippolokhos, leader of the Lycians, in hard hand-to-hand fight smote Iphinoos son of Dexios on the shoulder, as he was springing on to his chariot behind his fleet mares; so he fell to earth from the car, and there was no life left in him. When, therefore, Athena saw these men making havoc of the Argives, she darted down to Ilion from the summits of Olympus, and Apollo, who was looking on from Pergamos, went out to meet her; for he wanted the Trojans to be victorious. The pair met by the oak tree, and King Apollo son of Zeus was first to speak. "What would you have said he, "daughter of great Zeus, that your proud spirit has sent you hither from Olympus? Have you no pity upon the Trojans, and would you incline the scales of victory in favor of the Danaans? Let me persuade you - for it will be better thus - stay the combat for to-day, but let them renew the fight hereafter till they compass the doom of Ilion, since you goddesses have made up your minds to destroy the city." And Athena answered, "So be it, Far-Darter; it was in this mind that I came down from Olympus to the Trojans and Achaeans. Tell me, then, how do you propose to end this present fighting?" Apollo, son of Zeus, replied, "Let us incite great Hektor to challenge some one of the Danaans in single combat; on this the Achaeans will be shamed into finding a man who will fight him." Athena assented, and Helenos son of Priam divined the counsel of the gods; he therefore went up to Hektor and said, "Hektor son of Priam, peer of gods in counsel, I am your brother, let me then persuade you. Bid the other Trojans and Achaeans all of them take their seats, and challenge the best man among the Achaeans to meet you in single combat. I have heard the voice of the ever-living gods, and the hour of your doom is not yet come." Hektor was glad when he heard this saying, and went in among the Trojans, grasping his spear by the middle to hold them back, and they all sat down. Agamemnon also bade the Achaeans be seated. But Athena and Apollo, in the likeness of vultures, perched on father Zeus' high oak tree, proud of their men; and the ranks sat close ranged together, bristling with shield and helmet and spear. As when the rising west wind furs the face of the sea [pontos] and the waters grow dark beneath it, so sat the companies of Trojans and Achaeans upon the plain. And Hektor spoke thus:- "Hear me, Trojans and Achaeans, that I may speak even as I am minded; Zeus on his high throne has brought our oaths and covenants to nothing, and foreshadows ill for both of us, till you either take the towers of Troy, or are yourselves vanquished at your ships. The princes of the Achaeans are here present in the midst of you;

7.31

31 Ἰλίου εὔρωσιν, ἐπεὶ ὣς φίλον ἔπλετο θυμῷ
32 ὑμῖν ἀθανάτῃσι, διαπραθέειν τόδε ἄστυ.
33 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·
34 ὦδ’ ἔστω ἐκάεργε· τὰ γὰρ φρονέουσα καὶ αὐτὴ
35 ἦλθον ἀπ’ Οὐλύμποιο μετὰ Τρῶας καὶ Ἀχαιούς.
36 ἀλλ’ ἄγε πῶς μέμονας πόλεμον καταπαυσέμεν ἀνδρῶν;
37 τὴν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν ἄναξ Διὸς υἱὸς Ἀπόλλων·
38 Ἕκτορος ὄρσωμεν κρατερὸν μένος ἱπποδάμοιο,
39 ἤν τινά που Δαναῶν προκαλέσσεται οἰόθεν οἷος

ἀντίβιον μαχέσασθαι ἐν αἰνῇ δηϊοτῆτι,
οἳ δέ κ’ ἀγασσάμενοι χαλκοκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
οἷον ἐπόρσειαν πολεμίζειν Ἕκτορι δίῳ.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη.
τῶν δ’ Ἕλενος Πριάμοιο φίλος παῖς σύνθετο θυμῷ
βουλήν, ἥ ῥα θεοῖσιν ἐφήνδανε μητιόωσι·
στῆ δὲ παρ’ Ἕκτορ’ ἰὼν καί μιν πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν·
Ἕκτορ υἱὲ Πριάμοιο Διὶ μῆτιν ἀτάλαντε
ἦ ῥά νύ μοί τι πίθοιο, κασίγνητος δέ τοί εἰμι·
ἄλλους μὲν κάθισον Τρῶας καὶ πάντας Ἀχαιούς,
αὐτὸς δὲ προκάλεσσαι Ἀχαιῶν ὅς τις ἄριστος
ἀντίβιον μαχέσασθαι ἐν αἰνῇ δηϊοτῆτι·
οὐ γάρ πώ τοι μοῖρα θανεῖν καὶ πότμον ἐπισπεῖν·
ὣς γὰρ ἐγὼ ὄπ’ ἄκουσα θεῶν αἰειγενετάων.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, Ἕκτωρ δ’ αὖτε χάρη μέγα μῦθον ἀκούσας,
καί ῥ’ ἐς μέσσον ἰὼν Τρώων ἀνέεργε φάλαγγας,
μέσσου δουρὸς ἑλών· οἳ δ’ ἱδρύνθησαν ἅπαντες.
κὰδ δ’ Ἀγαμέμνων εἶσεν ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιούς·
κὰδ δ’ ἄρ’ Ἀθηναίη τε καὶ ἀργυρότοξος Ἀπόλλων
ἑζέσθην ὄρνισιν ἐοικότες αἰγυπιοῖσι
φηγῷ ἐφ’ ὑψηλῇ πατρὸς Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο

7.61

ἀνδράσι τερπόμενοι· τῶν δὲ στίχες εἵατο πυκναὶ
ἀσπίσι καὶ κορύθεσσι καὶ ἔγχεσι πεφρικυῖαι.
οἵη δὲ Ζεφύροιο ἐχεύατο πόντον ἔπι φρὶξ
ὀρνυμένοιο νέον, μελάνει δέ τε πόντος ὑπ’ αὐτῆς,
τοῖαι ἄρα στίχες εἵατ’ Ἀχαιῶν τε Τρώων τε
ἐν πεδίῳ· Ἕκτωρ δὲ μετ’ ἀμφοτέροισιν ἔειπε·
κέκλυτέ μευ Τρῶες καὶ ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
ὅφρ’ εἴπω τά με θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι κελεύει.
ὅρκια μὲν Κρονίδης ὑψίζυγος οὐκ ἐτέλεσσεν,
ἀλλὰ κακὰ φρονέων τεκμαίρεται ἀμφοτέροισιν
εἰς ὅ κεν ἢ ὑμεῖς Τροίην εὔπυργον ἕλητε
ἢ αὐτοὶ παρὰ νηυσὶ δαμείετε ποντοπόροισιν.
ὑμῖν δ’ ἐν γὰρ ἔασιν ἀριστῆες Παναχαιῶν·
τῶν νῦν ὅν τινα θυμὸς ἐμοὶ μαχέσασθαι ἀνώγει
δεῦρ’ ἴτω ἐκ πάντων πρόμος ἔμμεναι Ἕκτορι δίῳ.
ὧδε δὲ μυθέομαι, Ζεὺς δ’ ἄμμ’ ἐπιμάρτυρος ἔστω·
εἰ μέν κεν ἐμὲ κεῖνος ἕλῃ ταναήκεϊ χαλκῷ,
τεύχεα συλήσας φερέτω κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας,
σῶμα δὲ οἴκαδ’ ἐμὸν δόμεναι πάλιν, ὄφρα πυρός με
Τρῶες καὶ Τρώων ἄλοχοι λελάχωσι θανόντα.
εἰ δέ κ’ ἐγὼ τὸν ἕλω, δώῃ δέ μοι εὖχος Ἀπόλλων,
τεύχεα σύλησας οἴσω προτὶ Ἴλιον ἱρήν,
καὶ κρεμόω προτὶ νηὸν Ἀπόλλωνος ἑκάτοιο,
τὸν δὲ νέκυν ἐπὶ νῆας ἐϋσσέλμους ἀποδώσω,
ὄφρά ἑ ταρχύσωσι κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοί,
σῆμά τέ οἱ χεύωσιν ἐπὶ πλατεῖ Ἑλλησπόντῳ.
καί ποτέ τις εἴπῃσι καὶ ὀψιγόνων ἀνθρώπων
νηῒ πολυκλήϊδι πλέων ἐπὶ οἴνοπα πόντον·

89 ἀνδρὸς μὲν τόδε σῆμα πάλαι κατατεθνηῶτος,
90 ὅν ποτ’ ἀριστεύοντα κατέκτανε φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ.
let him, then, that will fight me stand forward as your champion against Hektor. Thus I say, and may Zeus be witness between us. If your champion slay me, let him strip me of my armor and take it to your ships, but let him send my body home that the Trojans and their wives may give me my dues of fire when I am dead. In like manner, if Apollo grant me glory and I slay your champion, I will strip him of his armor and take it to the city of Ilion, where I will hang it in the temple of Apollo, but I will give up his body, that the Achaeans may bury him at their ships, and the build him a tomb [sêma] by the wide waters of the Hellespont. Then will one say hereafter as he sails his ship over the sea [pontos], ‘This is the marker [sêma] of one who died long since a champion who was slain by mighty Hektor.’ Thus will one say, and my fame [kleos] shall not be lost." Thus did he speak, but they all held their peace, ashamed to decline the challenge, yet fearing to accept it, till at last Menelaos rose and rebuked them, for he was angry. "Alas," he cried, "vain braggarts, women indeed not men, double-dyed indeed will be the stain upon us if no man of the Danaans will now face Hektor. May you be turned every man of you into earth and water as you sit spiritless and inglorious in your places. I will myself go out against this man, but the upshot of the fight will be from on high in the hands of the immortal gods." With these words he put on his armor; and then, O Menelaos, your life would have come to an end at the hands of hands of Hektor, for he was far better the man, had not the princes of the Achaeans sprung upon you and checked you. King Agamemnon caught him by the right hand and said, "Menelaos, you are mad; a truce to this folly. Be patient in spite of passion, do not think of fighting a man so much stronger than yourself as Hektor son of Priam, who is feared by many another as well as you. Even Achilles, who is far more doughty than you are, shrank from meeting him in battle. Sit down your own people, and the Achaeans will send some other champion to fight Hektor; fearless and fond of battle though he be, I ween his knees will bend gladly under him if he comes out alive from the struggle of this fight." With these words of reasonable counsel he persuaded his brother, whereon his squires [therapontes] gladly stripped the armor from off his shoulders. Then Nestor rose and spoke, "For sure," said he, "grief [penthos] has befallen the Achaean land. The old horseman Peleus, counselor and orator among the Myrmidons, loved when I was in his house to question me concerning the race and lineage of all the Argives. How would it not grieve him could he hear of them as now quailing before Hektor? Many a time would he lift his hands in prayer that his soul might leave his body and go down within the house of Hades. Would, by father Zeus, Athena, and Apollo, that I were still young and strong as when the Pylians and Arcadians were gathered in fight by the rapid river Keladon under the walls of Pheia, and round about the waters of the river Iardanos. The godlike hero Ereuthalion stood forward as their champion, with the armor of King Areithoos upon his shoulders - Areithoos whom men and women had surnamed ‘the Mace-man,’ because he fought neither with bow nor spear, but broke the battalions of the foe with his iron mace. Lycurgus killed him, not in fair fight, but by entrapping him in a narrow way where his mace served him in no stead; for Lycurgus was too quick for him and speared him through the middle, so he fell to earth on his back. Lycurgus then spoiled him of the armor which Ares had given him, and bore it in battle thenceforward; but when he grew old and stayed at home, he gave it to his faithful squire [therapôn] Ereuthalion, who in this same armor challenged the foremost men among us. The others quaked and quailed, but my high spirit bade me fight him though none other would venture; I was the youngest man of them all; but when I fought him Athena granted me victory. He was the biggest and strongest man that ever I killed, and covered much ground as he lay sprawling upon the earth. Would that I were still young and strong as I then was, for the son of Priam would then soon find one who would face him. But you, foremost among the whole host though you be, have none of you any stomach for fighting

Hektor." Thus did the old man rebuke them, and forthwith nine men started to their feet. Foremost of all stood up King Agamemnon, and after him brave Diomedes the son of Tydeus. Next were the two Ajaxes, men clothed in valor as with a garment, and then Idomeneus, and Meriones his brother in arms. After these Eurypylos son of Euaemon, Thoas the son of Andraimon, and Odysseus also rose. Then Nestor horseman of Gerene again spoke, saying: "Cast lots among you to see who shall be chosen. If he come alive out of this fight he will have done good service alike to his own soul and to the Achaeans." Thus he spoke, and when each of them had marked his lot, and had thrown it into the helmet of Agamemnon son of Atreus, the people lifted their hands in prayer, and thus would one of them say as he looked into the vault of heaven, "Father Zeus, grant that the lot fall on Ajax, or on the son of Tydeus, or upon the king of rich Mycenae himself."

7.91

ὣς ποτέ τις ἐρέει· τὸ δ’ ἐμὸν κλέος οὔ ποτ’ ὀλεῖται.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἱ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἀκὴν ἐγένοντο σιωπῇ·
αἴδεσθεν μὲν ἀνήνασθαι, δεῖσαν δ’ ὑποδέχθαι·
ὀψὲ δὲ δὴ Μενέλαος ἀνίστατο καὶ μετέειπε
νείκει ὀνειδίζων, μέγα δὲ στεναχίζετο θυμῷ·
ὤ μοι ἀπειλητῆρες Ἀχαιΐδες οὐκέτ’ Ἀχαιοί·
ἦ μὲν δὴ λώβη τάδε γ’ ἔσσεται αἰνόθεν αἰνῶς
εἰ μή τις Δαναῶν νῦν Ἕκτορος ἀντίος εἶσιν.
ἀλλ’ ὑμεῖς μὲν πάντες ὕδωρ καὶ γαῖα γένοισθε
ἥμενοι αὖθι ἕκαστοι ἀκήριοι ἀκλεὲς αὔτως·
τῷδε δ’ ἐγὼν αὐτὸς θωρήξομαι· αὐτὰρ ὕπερθε
νίκης πείρατ’ ἔχονται ἐν ἀθανάτοισι θεοῖσιν.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας κατεδύσετο τεύχεα καλά.
ἔνθά κέ τοι Μενέλαε φάνη βιότοιο τελευτὴ
Ἕκτορος ἐν παλάμῃσιν, ἐπεὶ πολὺ φέρτερος ἦεν,
εἰ μὴ ἀναΐξαντες ἕλον βασιλῆες Ἀχαιῶν,
αὐτός τ’ Ἀτρεΐδης εὐρὺ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
δεξιτερῆς ἕλε χειρὸς ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζεν·
ἀφραίνεις Μενέλαε διοτρεφές, οὐδέ τί σε χρὴ
ταύτης ἀφροσύνης· ἀνὰ δὲ σχέο κηδόμενός περ,
μηδ’ ἔθελ’ ἐξ ἔριδος σεῦ ἀμείνονι φωτὶ μάχεσθαι
Ἕκτορι Πριαμίδῃ, τόν τε στυγέουσι καὶ ἄλλοι.
καὶ δ’ Ἀχιλεὺς τούτῳ γε μάχῃ ἔνι κυδιανείρῃ
ἔρριγ’ ἀντιβολῆσαι, ὅ περ σέο πολλὸν ἀμείνων.
ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν νῦν ἴζευ ἰὼν μετὰ ἕθνος ἑταίρων,
τούτῳ δὲ πρόμον ἄλλον ἀναστήσουσιν Ἀχαιοί.
εἴ περ ἀδειής τ’ ἐστὶ καὶ εἰ μόθου ἔστ’ ἀκόρητος,
φημί μιν ἀσπασίως γόνυ κάμψειν, αἴ κε φύγῃσι
δηΐου ἐκ πολέμοιο καὶ αἰνῆς δηϊοτῆτος.
ὣς εἰπὼν παρέπεισεν ἀδελφειοῦ φρένας ἥρως

7.121

αἴσιμα παρειπών, ὃ δ’ ἐπείθετο· τοῦ μὲν ἔπειτα
γηθόσυνοι θεράποντες ἀπ’ ὤμων τεύχε’ ἔλοντο·
Νέστωρ δ’ Ἀργείοισιν ἀνίστατο καὶ μετέειπεν·
ὦ πόποι ἦ μέγα πένθος Ἀχαιΐδα γαῖαν ἱκάνει.
ἦ κε μέγ’ οἰμώξειε γέρων ἱππηλάτα Πηλεὺς

ἐσθλὸς Μυρμιδόνων βουληφόρος ἠδ’ ἀγορητής,
ὅς ποτέ μ’ εἰρόμενος μέγ’ ἐγήθεεν ᾧ ἐνὶ οἴκῳ
πάντων Ἀργείων ἐρέων γενεήν τε τόκον τε.
τοὺς νῦν εἰ πτώσσοντας ὑφ’ Ἕκτορι πάντας ἀκούσαι,
πολλά κεν ἀθανάτοισι φίλας ἀνὰ χεῖρας ἀείραι
θυμὸν ἀπὸ μελέων δῦναι δόμον Ἄϊδος εἴσω.
αἰ γὰρ Ζεῦ τε πάτερ καὶ Ἀθηναίη καὶ Ἄπολλον
ἠβῷμ’ ὡς ὅτ’ ἐπ’ ὠκυρόῳ Κελάδοντι μάχοντο
ἀγρόμενοι Πύλιοί τε καὶ Ἀρκάδες ἐγχεσίμωροι
Φειᾶς πὰρ τείχεσσιν Ἰαρδάνου ἀμφὶ ῥέεθρα.
τοῖσι δ’ Ἐρευθαλίων πρόμος ἵστατο ἰσόθεος φὼς
τεύχε’ ἔχων ὤμοισιν Ἀρηϊθόοιο ἄνακτος
δίου Ἀρηϊθόου, τὸν ἐπίκλησιν κορυνήτην
ἄνδρες κίκλησκον καλλίζωνοί τε γυναῖκες
οὔνεκ’ ἄρ’ οὐ τόξοισι μαχέσκετο δουρί τε μακρῷ,
ἀλλὰ σιδηρείῃ κορύνῃ ῥήγνυσκε φάλαγγας.
τὸν Λυκόοργος ἔπεφνε δόλῳ, οὔ τι κράτεΐ γε,
στεινωπῷ ἐν ὁδῷ ὅθ’ ἄρ’ οὐ κορύνη οἱ ὄλεθρον
χραῖσμε σιδηρείη· πρὶν γὰρ Λυκόοργος ὑποφθὰς
δουρὶ μέσον περόνησεν, ὃ δ’ ὕπτιος οὔδει ἐρείσθη·
τεύχεα δ’ ἐξενάριξε, τά οἱ πόρε χάλκεος Ἄρης.
καὶ τὰ μὲν αὐτὸς ἔπειτα φόρει μετὰ μῶλον Ἄρηος·
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ Λυκόοργος ἐνὶ μεγάροισιν ἐγήρα,
δῶκε δ’ Ἐρευθαλίωνι φίλῳ θεράποντι φορῆναι·
τοῦ ὅ γε τεύχε’ ἔχων προκαλίζετο πάντας ἀρίστους.

7.151

οἳ δὲ μάλ’ ἐτρόμεον καὶ ἐδείδισαν, οὐδέ τις ἔτλη·
ἀλλ’ ἐμὲ θυμὸς ἀνῆκε πολυτλήμων πολεμίζειν
θάρσεϊ ᾧ· γενεῇ δὲ νεώτατος ἔσκον ἁπάντων·
καὶ μαχόμην οἰ ἐγώ, δῶκεν δέ μοι εὖχος Ἀθήνη.
τὸν δὴ μήκιστον καὶ κάρτιστον κτάνον ἄνδρα·
πολλὸς γάρ τις ἔκειτο παρήορος ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα.
εἴθ’ ὡς ἠβώοιμι, βίη δέ μοι ἔμπεδος εἴη·
τώ κε τάχ’ ἀντήσειε μάχης κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ.
ὑμέων δ’ οἵ περ ἔασιν ἀριστῆες Παναχαιῶν
οὐδ’ οἳ προφρονέως μέμαθ’ Ἕκτορος ἀντίον ἐλθεῖν.
ὣς νείκεσσ’ ὃ γέρων, οἳ δ’ ἐννέα πάντες ἀνέσταν.
ὦρτο πολὺ πρῶτος μὲν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων,
τῷ δ’ ἐπὶ Τυδεΐδης ὦρτο κρατερὸς Διομήδης,
τοῖσι δ’ ἐπ’ Αἴαντες θοῦριν ἐπιειμένοι ἀλκήν,
τοῖσι δ’ ἐπ’ Ἰδομενεὺς καὶ ὀπάων Ἰδομενῆος
Μηριόνης ἀτάλαντος Ἐνυαλίῳ ἀνδρειφόντῃ,
τοῖσι δ’ ἐπ’ Εὐρύπυλος Εὐαίμονος ἀγλαὸς υἱός,
ἂν δὲ Θόας Ἀνδραιμονίδης καὶ δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς·
πάντες ἄρ’ οἵ γ’ ἔθελον πολεμίζειν Ἕκτορι δίῳ.
τοῖς δ’ αὖτις μετέειπε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
κλήρῳ νῦν πεπάλασθε διαμπερὲς ὅς κε λάχῃσιν·
οὗτος γὰρ δὴ ὀνήσει ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιούς,
καὶ δ’ αὐτὸς ὃν θυμὸν ὀνήσεται αἴ κε φύγῃσι
δηΐου ἐκ πολέμοιο καὶ αἰνῆς δηϊοτῆτος.

175 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δὲ κλῆρον ἐσημήναντο ἕκαστος,
176 ἐν δ’ ἔβαλον κυνέῃ Ἀγαμέμνονος Ἀτρεΐδαο.
177 λαοὶ δ’ ἠρήσαντο, θεοῖσι δὲ χεῖρας ἀνέσχον·
178 ὧδε δέ τις εἶπεσκεν ἰδὼν εἰς οὐρανὸν εὐρύν·
179 Ζεῦ πάτερ ἢ Αἴαντα λαχεῖν, ἢ Τυδέος υἱόν,
180 ἢ αὐτὸν βασιλῆα πολυχρύσοιο Μυκήνης.

7.181

181 ὣς ἄρ’ ἔφαν, πάλλεν δὲ Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ,
182 ἐκ δ’ ἔθορε κλῆρος κυνέης ὃν ἄρ’ ἤθελον αὐτοὶ
183 Αἴαντος· κῆρυξ δὲ φέρων ἀν’ ὅμιλον ἁπάντῃ
184 δεῖξ’ ἐνδέξια πᾶσιν ἀριστήεσσιν Ἀχαιῶν.
185 οἳ δ’ οὐ γιγνώσκοντες ἀπηνήναντο ἕκαστος.
186 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ τὸν ἵκανε φέρων ἀν’ ὅμιλον ἁπάντῃ
187 ὅς μιν ἐπιγράψας κυνέῃ βάλε φαίδιμος Αἴας,
188 ἤτοι ὑπέσχεθε χεῖρ’, ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ἔμβαλεν ἄγχι παραστάς,
189 γνῶ δὲ κλήρου σῆμα ἰδών, γήθησε δὲ θυμῷ.
190 τὸν μὲν πὰρ πόδ’ ἐὸν χαμάδις βάλε φώνησέν τε·
191 ὦ φίλοι ἦτοι κλῆρος ἐμός, χαίρω δὲ καὶ αὐτὸς
192 θυμῷ, ἐπεὶ δοκέω νικησέμεν Ἕκτορα δῖον.
193 ἀλλ’ ἄγετ’ ὄφρ’ ἂν ἐγὼ πολεμήϊα τεύχεα δύω,
194 τόφρ’ ὑμεῖς εὔχεσθε Διὶ Κρονίωνι ἄνακτι
195 σιγῇ ἐφ’ ὑμείων ἵνα μὴ Τρῶές γε πύθωνται,
196 ἠὲ καὶ ἀμφαδίην, ἐπεὶ οὔ τινα δείδιμεν ἔμπης·
197 οὐ γάρ τίς με βίῃ γε ἑκὼν ἀέκοντα δίηται
198 οὐδέ τι ἰδρείῃ, ἐπεὶ οὐδ’ ἐμὲ νήϊδά γ’ οὕτως
199 ἔλπομαι ἐν Σαλαμῖνι γενέσθαι τε τραφέμεν τε.
200 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ εὔχοντο Διὶ Κρονίωνι ἄνακτι·
201 ὧδε δέ τις εἶπεσκεν ἰδὼν εἰς οὐρανὸν εὐρύν·
202 Ζεῦ πάτερ Ἴδηθεν μεδέων κύδιστε μέγιστε
203 δὸς νίκην Αἴαντι καὶ ἀγλαὸν εὖχος ἀρέσθαι·
204 εἰ δὲ καὶ Ἕκτορά περ φιλέεις καὶ κήδεαι αὐτοῦ,
205 ἴσην ἀμφοτέροισι βίην καὶ κῦδος ὄπασσον.
206 ὣς ἄρ’ ἔφαν, Αἴας δὲ κορύσσετο νώροπι χαλκῷ.
207 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ πάντα περὶ χροῒ ἔσσατο τεύχεα,
208 σεύατ’ ἔπειθ’ οἷός τε πελώριος ἔρχεται Ἄρης,
209 ὅς τ’ εἶσιν πόλεμον δὲ μετ’ ἀνέρας οὓς τε Κρονίων
210 θυμοβόρου ἔριδος μένεϊ ξυνέηκε μάχεσθαι.
As they were speaking, Nestor horseman of Gerene shook the helmet, and from it there fell the very lot which they wanted - the lot of Ajax. The herald bore it about and showed it to all the chieftains of the Achaeans, going from left to right; but they none of them owned it. When, however, in due course he reached the man who had written upon it and had put it into the helmet, brave Ajax held out his hand, and the herald gave him the lot. When Ajax saw his mark [sêma] he knew it and was glad; he threw it to the ground and said, "My friends, the lot is mine, and I rejoice, for I shall vanquish Hektor. I will put on my armor; meanwhile, pray to King Zeus in silence among yourselves that the Trojans may not hear you - or aloud if you will, for we fear no man. None shall overcome me, neither by force nor cunning, for I was born and bred in Salamis, and can hold my own in all things." With this they fell praying to King Zeus the son of Kronos, and thus would one of them say as he looked into the vault of heaven, "Father Zeus, you who rule from Ida, most glorious in power, grant victory to Ajax, and let him win great glory: but if you wish well to Hektor also

and would protect him, grant to each of them equal fame and prowess. Thus they prayed, and Ajax armed himself in his suit of gleaming bronze. When he was in full array he sprang forward as monstrous Ares when he takes part among men whom Zeus has set fighting with one another - even so did huge Ajax, bulwark of the Achaeans, spring forward with a grim smile on his face as he brandished his long spear and strode onward. The Argives were elated as they beheld him, but the Trojans trembled in every limb, and the heart even of Hektor beat quickly, but he could not now retreat and withdraw into the ranks behind him, for he had been the challenger. Ajax came up bearing his shield in front of him like a wall - a shield of bronze with seven folds of oxhide - the work of Tychios, who lived in Hyle and was by far the best worker in leather. He had made it with the hides of seven full-fed bulls, and over these he had set an eighth layer of bronze. Holding this shield before him, Ajax son of Telamon came close up to Hektor, and menaced him saying, "Hektor, you shall now learn, man to man, what kind of champions the Danaans have among them even besides lion-hearted Achilles cleaver of the ranks of men. He now abides at the ships in anger with Agamemnon shepherd of his people, but there are many of us who are well able to face you; therefore begin the fight." And Hektor answered, "Noble Ajax, son of Telamon, leader of the host, treat me not as though I were some puny boy or woman that cannot fight. I have been long used to the blood and butcheries of battle. I am quick to turn my leathern shield either to right or left, for this I deem the main thing in battle. I can charge among the chariots and horsemen, and in hand to hand fighting can delight the heart of Ares; howbeit I would not take such a man as you are off his guard - but I will smite you openly if I can." He poised his spear as he spoke, and hurled it from him. It struck the sevenfold shield in its outermost layer - the eighth, which was of bronze - and went through six of the layers but in the seventh hide it stayed. Then Ajax threw in his turn, and struck the round shield of the son of Priam. The terrible spear went through his gleaming shield, and pressed onward through his cuirass of cunning workmanship; it pierced the shirt against his side, but he swerved and thus saved his life. They then each of them drew out the spear from his shield, and fell on one another like savage lions or wild boars of great strength and endurance: the son of Priam struck the middle of Ajax's shield, but the bronze did not break, and the point of his dart was turned. Ajax then sprang forward and pierced the shield of Hektor; the spear went through it and staggered him as he was springing forward to attack; it gashed his neck and the blood came pouring from the wound, but even so Hektor did not cease fighting; he gave ground, and with his brawny hand seized a stone, rugged and huge, that was lying upon the plain; with this he struck the shield of Ajax on the boss that was in its middle, so that the bronze rang again. But Ajax in turn caught up a far larger stone, swung it aloft, and hurled it with prodigious force. This millstone of a rock broke Hektor's shield inwards and threw him down on his back with the shield crushing him under it, but Apollo raised him at once. Thereon they would have hacked at one another in close combat with their swords, had not heralds, messengers of gods and men, come forward, one from the Trojans and the other from the Achaeans - Talthybios and Idaios both of them honorable men; these parted them with their staves, and the good herald Idaios said, "My sons, fight no longer, you are both of you valiant, and both are dear to Zeus; we know this; but night is now falling, and the behests of night may not be well gainsaid." Ajax son of Telamon answered, "Idaios, bid Hektor say so, for it was he that challenged our princes. Let him speak first and I will accept his saying."

7.211

211 τοῖος ἄρ’ Αἴας ὦρτο πελώριος ἔρκος Ἀχαιῶν
212 μειδιόων βλοσυροῖσι προσώπασι· νέρθε δὲ ποσσὶν
213 ἤϊε μακρὰ βιβάς, κραδάων δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος.
214 τὸν δὲ καὶ Ἀργεῖοι μὲν ἐγήθεον εἰσορόωντες,

Τρῶας δὲ τρόμος αἰνὸς ὑπήλυθε γυῖα ἕκαστον,
Ἕκτορί τ’ αὐτῷ θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι πάτασσεν·
ἀλλ’ οὔ πως ἔτι εἶχεν ὑποτρέσαι οὐδ’ ἀναδῦναι
ἂψ λαῶν ἐς ὅμιλον, ἐπεὶ προκαλέσσατο χάρμῃ.
Αἴας δ’ ἐγγύθεν ἦλθε φέρων σάκος ἠΰτε πύργον
χάλκεον ἑπταβόειον, ὅ οἱ Τυχίος κάμε τεύχων
σκυτοτόμων ὄχ’ ἄριστος Ὕλῃ ἔνι οἰκία ναίων,
ὅς οἱ ἐποίησεν σάκος αἰόλον ἑπταβόειον
ταύρων ζατρεφέων, ἐπὶ δ’ ὄγδοον ἤλασε χαλκόν.
τὸ πρόσθε στέρνοιο φέρων Τελαμώνιος Αἴας
στῆ ῥα μάλ’ Ἕκτορος ἐγγύς, ἀπειλήσας δὲ προσηύδα·
Ἕκτορ νῦν μὲν δὴ σάφα εἴσεαι οἰόθεν οἷος
οἷοι καὶ Δαναοῖσιν ἀριστῆες μετέασι
καὶ μετ’ Ἀχιλλῆα ῥηξήνορα θυμολέοντα.
ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν ἐν νήεσσι κορωνίσι ποντοπόροισι
κεῖτ’ ἀπομηνίσας Ἀγαμέμνονι ποιμένι λαῶν·
ἡμεῖς δ’ εἰμὲν τοῖοι οἳ ἂν σέθεν ἀντιάσαιμεν
καὶ πολέες· ἀλλ’ ἄρχε μάχης ἠδὲ πτολέμοιο.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
Αἶαν διογενὲς Τελαμώνιε κοίρανε λαῶν
μή τί μευ ἠΰτε παιδὸς ἀφαυροῦ πειρήτιζε
ἠὲ γυναικός, ἣ οὐκ οἶδεν πολεμήϊα ἔργα.
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼν εὖ οἶδα μάχας τ’ ἀνδροκτασίας τε·
οἶδ’ ἐπὶ δεξιά, οἶδ’ ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ νωμῆσαι βῶν
ἀζαλέην, τό μοι ἔστι ταλαύρινον πολεμίζειν·
οἶδα δ’ ἐπαΐξαι μόθον ἵππων ὠκειάων·

7.241

οἶδα δ’ ἐνὶ σταδίῃ δηΐῳ μέλπεσθαι Ἄρηϊ.
ἀλλ’ οὐ γάρ σ’ ἐθέλω βαλέειν τοιοῦτον ἐόντα
λάθρῃ ὀπιπεύσας, ἀλλ’ ἀμφαδόν, αἴ κε τύχωμι.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἀμπεπαλὼν προΐει δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος,
καὶ βάλεν Αἴαντος δεινὸν σάκος ἑπταβόειον
ἀκρότατον κατὰ χαλκόν, ὃς ὄγδοος ἦεν ἐπ’ αὐτῷ.
ἓξ δὲ διὰ πτύχας ἦλθε δαΐζων χαλκὸς ἀτειρής,
ἐν τῇ δ’ ἑβδομάτῃ ῥινῷ σχέτο· δεύτερος αὖτε
Αἴας διογενὴς προΐει δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος,
καὶ βάλε Πριαμίδαο κατ’ ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην.
διὰ μὲν ἀσπίδος ἦλθε φαεινῆς ὄβριμον ἔγχος,
καὶ διὰ θώρηκος πολυδαιδάλου ἠρήρειστο·
ἀντικρὺ δὲ παραὶ λαπάρην διάμησε χιτῶνα
ἔγχος· ὃ δ’ ἐκλίνθη καὶ ἀλεύατο κῆρα μέλαιναν.
τὼ δ’ ἐκσπασσαμένω δολίχ’ ἔγχεα χερσὶν ἄμ’ ἄμφω
σύν ῥ’ ἔπεσον λείουσιν ἐοικότες ὠμοφάγοισιν
ἢ συσὶ κάπροισιν, τῶν τε σθένος οὐκ ἀλαπαδνόν.
Πριαμίδης μὲν ἔπειτα μέσον σάκος οὔτασε δουρί,
οὐδ’ ἔρρηξεν χαλκός, ἀνεγνάμφθη δέ οἱ αἰχμή.
Αἴας δ’ ἀσπίδα νύξεν ἐπάλμενος· ἣ δὲ διαπρὸ
ἤλυθεν ἐγχείη, στυφέλιξε δέ μιν μεμαῶτα,
τμήδην δ’ αὐχέν’ ἐπῆλθε, μέλαν δ’ ἀνεκήκιεν αἷμα,
ἀλλ’ οὐδ’ ὣς ἀπέληγε μάχης κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ,

264 ἀλλ’ ἀναχασσάμενος λίθον εἴλετο χειρὶ παχείῃ
265 κείμενον ἐν πεδίῳ μέλανα τρηχύν τε μέγαν τε·
266 τῷ βάλεν Αἴαντος δεινὸν σάκος ἐπταβόειον
267 μέσσον ἐπομφάλιον· περιήχησεν δ’ ἄρα χαλκός.
268 δεύτερος αὖτ’ Αἴας πολὺ μείζονα λᾶαν ἀείρας
269 ἧκ’ ἐπιδινήσας, ἐπέρεισε δὲ ἶν’ ἀπέλεθρον,
270 εἴσω δ’ ἀσπίδ’ ἔαξε βαλὼν μυλοειδέϊ πέτρῳ,

7.271

271 βλάψε δέ οἱ φίλα γούναθ’· ὃ δ’ ὕπτιος ἐξετανύσθη
272 ἀσπίδι ἐγχριμφθείς· τὸν δ’ αἶψ’ ὤρθωσεν Ἀπόλλων.
273 καί νύ κε δὴ ξιφέεσσ’ αὐτοσχεδὸν οὐτάζοντο,
274 εἰ μὴ κήρυκες Διὸς ἄγγελοι ἠδὲ καὶ ἀνδρῶν
275 ἦλθον, ὃ μὲν Τρώων, ὃ δ’ Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων,
276 Ταλθύβιός τε καὶ Ἰδαῖος πεπνυμένω ἄμφω·
277 μέσσῳ δ’ ἀμφοτέρων σκῆπτρα σχέθον, εἶπέ τε μῦθον
278 κῆρυξ Ἰδαῖος πεπνυμένα μήδεα εἰδώς·
279 μηκέτι παῖδε φίλω πολεμίζετε μηδὲ μάχεσθον·
280 ἀμφοτέρω γὰρ σφῶϊ φιλεῖ νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς,
281 ἄμφω δ’ αἰχμητά· τό γε δὴ καὶ ἴδμεν ἅπαντες.
282 νὺξ δ’ ἤδη τελέθει· ἀγαθὸν καὶ νυκτὶ πιθέσθαι.
283 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη Τελαμώνιος Αἴας·
284 Ἰδαῖ’ Ἕκτορα ταῦτα κελεύετε μυθήσασθαι·
285 αὐτὸς γὰρ χάρμῃ προκαλέσσατο πάντας ἀρίστους.
286 ἀρχέτω· αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ μάλα πείσομαι ᾗ περ ἂν οὗτος.
287 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
288 Αἶαν ἐπεί τοι δῶκε θεὸς μέγεθός τε βίην τε
289 καὶ πινυτήν, περὶ δ’ ἔγχει Ἀχαιῶν φέρτατός ἐσσι,
290 νῦν μὲν παυσώμεσθα μάχης καὶ δηϊοτῆτος
291 σήμερον· ὕστερον αὖτε μαχησόμεθ’ εἰς ὅ κε δαίμων
292 ἄμμε διακρίνῃ, δώῃ δ’ ἑτέροισί γε νίκην.
293 νὺξ δ’ ἤδη τελέθει· ἀγαθὸν καὶ νυκτὶ πιθέσθαι,
294 ὡς σύ τ’ ἐϋφρήνῃς πάντας παρὰ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιούς,
295 σούς τε μάλιστα ἕτας καὶ ἑταίρους, οἵ τοι ἔασιν·
296 αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ κατὰ ἄστυ μέγα Πριάμοιο ἄνακτος
297 Τρῶας ἐϋφρανέω καὶ Τρῳάδας ἑλκεσιπέπλους,
298 αἵ τέ μοι εὐχόμεναι θεῖον δύσονται ἀγῶνα.
299 δῶρα δ’ ἄγ’ ἀλλήλοισι περικλυτὰ δώομεν ἄμφω,
300 ὄφρά τις ὧδ’ εἴπῃσιν Ἀχαιῶν τε Τρώων τε·

Then Hektor said, "Ajax, heaven has granted you stature and strength, and judgment; and in wielding the spear you excel all others of the Achaeans. Let us for this day cease fighting; hereafter we will fight anew till a daimôn decides between us, and give victory to one or to the other; night is now falling, and the behests of night may not be well gainsaid. Gladden, then, the hearts of the Achaeans at your ships, and more especially those of your own followers and clansmen, while I, in the great city of King Priam, bring comfort to the Trojans and their women, who vie with one another in their prayers directed at me. Let us, moreover, exchange presents that it may be said among the Achaeans and Trojans, ‘They fought with might and main, but were reconciled and parted in friendship.’ On this he gave Ajax a silver-studded sword with its sheath and leathern Balearic, and in return Ajax gave him a belt dyed with purple. Thus they parted, the one going to the host of the Achaeans, and the other to that of the Trojans, who rejoiced when they saw their hero come to them

safe and unharmed from the strong hands of mighty Ajax. They led him, therefore, to the city as one that had been saved beyond their hopes. On the other side the Achaeans brought Ajax elated with victory to Agamemnon. When they reached the quarters of the son of Atreus, Agamemnon sacrificed for them a five-year-old bull in honor of Zeus the son of Kronos. They flayed the carcass, made it ready, and divided it into joints; these they cut carefully up into smaller pieces, putting them on the spits, roasting them sufficiently, and then drawing them off. When they had done all this and had prepared the feast, they ate it, and every man had his full and equal share, so that all were satisfied, and King Agamemnon gave Ajax some slices cut lengthwise down the loin, as a mark of special honor. As soon as they had had enough to eat and drink, old Nestor whose counsel was ever truest began to speak; with all sincerity and goodwill, therefore, he addressed them thus: "Son of Atreus, and other chieftains, inasmuch as many of the Achaeans are now dead, whose blood Ares has shed by the banks of the Skamandros, and their psukhai have gone down to the house of Hades, it will be well when morning comes that we should cease fighting; we will then wheel our dead together with oxen and mules and burn them not far from the ships, that when we sail hence we may take the bones of our comrades home to their children. Hard by the funeral pyre we will build a barrow that shall be raised from the plain for all in common; near this let us set about building a high wall, to shelter ourselves and our ships, and let it have well-made gates that there may be a way through them for our chariots. Close outside we will dig a deep trench all round it to keep off both horse and foot, that the Trojan chieftains may not bear hard upon us." Thus he spoke, and the princes shouted in approval. Meanwhile the Trojans held a council, angry and full of discord, on the acropolis by the gates of King Priam's palace; and wise Antenor spoke. "Hear me he said, "Trojans, Dardanians, and allies, that I may speak even as I am minded. Let us give up Argive Helen and her wealth to the sons of Atreus, for we are now fighting in violation of our solemn covenants, and shall not prosper till we have done as I say." He then sat down and Alexander husband of lovely Helen rose to speak. "Antenor," said he, "your words are not to my liking; you can find a better saying than this if you will; if, however, you have spoken in good earnest, then indeed has heaven robbed you of your reason. I will speak plainly, and hereby notify to the Trojans that I will not give up the woman; but the wealth that I brought home with her from Argos I will restore, and will add yet further of my own." On this, when Paris had spoken and taken his seat, Priam of the race of Dardanos, peer of gods in council, rose and with all sincerity and goodwill addressed them thus: "Hear me, Trojans, Dardanians, and allies, that I may speak even as I am minded. Get your suppers now as hitherto throughout the city, but keep your watches and be wakeful. At daybreak let Idaios go to the ships, and tell Agamemnon and Menelaos sons of Atreus the saying of Alexander through whom this quarrel has come about; and let him also be instant with them that they now cease fighting till we burn our dead; hereafter we will fight anew, till a daimôn decides between us and give victory to one or to the other." Thus did he speak, and they did even as he had said. They took supper in their companies and at daybreak Idaios went his way to the ships. He found the Danaans, squires [therapontes] of Ares, in council at the stern of Agamemnon's ship, and took his place in the midst of them. "Son of Atreus," he said, "and princes of the Achaean host, Priam and the other noble Trojans have sent me to tell you the saying of Alexander through whom this quarrel has come about, if so be that you may find it acceptable. All the treasure he took with him in his ships to Troy - would that he had sooner perished - he will restore, and will add yet further of his own, but he will not give up the wedded wife of Menelaos, though the Trojans would have him do so. Priam bade me inquire further if you will cease fighting till we burn our dead;

7.301

301 ἠμὲν ἐμαρνάσθην ἔριδος πέρι θυμοβόροιο,

ἠδ’ αὖτ’ ἐν φιλότητι διέτμαγεν ἀρθμήσαντε.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας δῶκε ξίφος ἀργυρόηλον
σὺν κολεῷ τε φέρων καὶ ἐϋτμήτῳ τελαμῶνι·
Αἴας δὲ ζωστῆρα δίδου φοίνικι φαεινόν.
τὼ δὲ διακρινθέντε ὃ μὲν μετὰ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν
ἤϊ’, ὃ δ’ ἐς Τρώων ὅμαδον κίε· τοὶ δὲ χάρησαν,
ὡς εἶδον ζωόν τε καὶ ἀρτεμέα προσιόντα,
Αἴαντος προφυγόντα μένος καὶ χεῖρας ἀάπτους·
καί ῥ’ ἦγον προτὶ ἄστυ ἀελπτέοντες σόον εἶναι.
Αἴαντ’ αὖθ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
εἰς Ἀγαμέμνονα δῖον ἄγον κεχαρηότα νίκῃ.
οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ κλισίῃσιν ἐν Ἀτρεΐδαο γένοντο,
τοῖσι δὲ βοῦν ἱέρευσεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων
ἄρσενα πενταέτηρον ὑπερμενέϊ Κρονίωνι.
τὸν δέρον ἀμφί θ’ ἔπον, καί μιν διέχευαν ἅπαντα,
μίστυλλόν τ’ ἄρ’ ἐπισταμένως πεῖράν τ’ ὀβελοῖσιν,
ὄπτησάν τε περιφραδέως, ἐρύσαντό τε πάντα.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ παύσαντο πόνου τετύκοντό τε δαῖτα,
δαίνυντ’, οὐδέ τι θυμὸς ἐδεύετο δαιτὸς ἐΐσης·
νώτοισιν δ’ Αἴαντα διηνεκέεσσι γέραιρεν
ἥρως Ἀτρεΐδης εὐρὺ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ πόσιος καὶ ἐδητύος ἐξ ἔρον ἔντο,
τοῖς ὁ γέρων πάμπρωτος ὑφαίνειν ἤρχετο μῆτιν
Νέστωρ, οὗ καὶ πρόσθεν ἀρίστη φαίνετο βουλή·
ὅ σφιν ἐϋφρονέων ἀγορήσατο καὶ μετέειπεν·
Ἀτρεΐδη τε καὶ ἄλλοι ἀριστῆες Παναχαιῶν,
πολλοὶ γὰρ τεθνᾶσι κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοί,
τῶν νῦν αἶμα κελαινὸν ἐΰρροον ἀμφὶ Σκάμανδρον
ἐσκέδασ’ ὀξὺς Ἄρης, ψυχαὶ δ’ Ἄϊδος δὲ κατῆλθον·

7.331

τώ σε χρὴ πόλεμον μὲν ἅμ’ ἠοῖ παῦσαι Ἀχαιῶν,
αὐτοὶ δ’ ἀγρόμενοι κυκλήσομεν ἐνθάδε νεκροὺς
βουσὶ καὶ ἡμιόνοισιν· ἀτὰρ κατακήομεν αὐτοὺς
τυτθὸν ἀπὸ πρὸ νεῶν, ὥς κ’ ὀστέα παισὶν ἕκαστος
οἴκαδ’ ἄγῃ ὅτ’ ἂν αὖτε νεώμεθα πατρίδα γαῖαν.
τύμβον δ’ ἀμφὶ πυρὴν ἕνα χεύομεν ἐξαγαγόντες
ἄκριτον ἐκ πεδίου· ποτὶ δ’ αὐτὸν δείμομεν ὦκα
πύργους ὑψηλοὺς εἴλαρ νηῶν τε καὶ αὐτῶν.
ἐν δ’ αὐτοῖσι πύλας ποιήσομεν εὖ ἀραρυίας,
ὄφρα δι’ αὐτάων ἱππηλασίη ὁδὸς εἴη·
ἔκτοσθεν δὲ βαθεῖαν ὀρύξομεν ἐγγύθι τάφρον,
ἥ χ’ ἵππον καὶ λαὸν ἐρυκάκοι ἀμφὶς ἐοῦσα,
μή ποτ’ ἐπιβρίσῃ πόλεμος Τρώων ἀγερώχων.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἐπῄνησαν βασιλῆες.
Τρώων αὖτ’ ἀγορὴ γένετ’ Ἰλίου ἐν πόλει ἄκρῃ
δεινὴ τετρηχυῖα, παρὰ Πριάμοιο θύρῃσι·
τοῖσιν δ’ Ἀντήνωρ πεπνυμένος ἦρχ’ ἀγορεύειν·
κέκλυτέ μευ Τρῶες καὶ Δάρδανοι ἠδ’ ἐπίκουροι,
ὄφρ’ εἴπω τά με θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι κελεύει.
δεῦτ’ ἄγετ’ Ἀργείην Ἑλένην καὶ κτήματ’ ἄμ’ αὐτῇ

δώομεν Ἀτρεΐδῃσιν ἄγειν· νῦν δ’ ὅρκια πιστὰ
ψευσάμενοι μαχόμεσθα· τὼ οὔ νύ τι κέρδιον ἡμῖν
ἔλπομαι ἐκτελέεσθαι, ἵνα μὴ ῥέξομεν ὧδε.
ἤτοι ὅ γ’ ὣς εἰπὼν κατ’ ἄρ’ ἕζετο· τοῖσι δ’ ἀνέστη
δῖος Ἀλέξανδρος Ἑλένης πόσις ἠϋκόμοιο,
ὅς μιν ἀμειβόμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Ἀντῆνορ σὺ μὲν οὐκέτ’ ἐμοὶ φίλα ταῦτ’ ἀγορεύεις·
οἶσθα καὶ ἄλλον μῦθον ἀμείνονα τοῦδε νοῆσαι.
εἰ δ’ ἐτεὸν δὴ τοῦτον ἀπὸ σπουδῆς ἀγορεύεις,
ἐξ ἄρα δή τοι ἔπειτα θεοὶ φρένας ὤλεσαν αὐτοί.

7.361

αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ Τρώεσσι μεθ’ ἱπποδάμοις ἀγορεύσω·
ἀντικρὺ δ’ ἀπόφημι γυναῖκα μὲν οὐκ ἀποδώσω·
κτήματα δ’ ὅσσ’ ἀγόμην ἐξ Ἄργεος ἠμέτερον δῶ
πάντ’ ἐθέλω δόμεναι καὶ οἴκοθεν ἄλλ’ ἐπιθεῖναι.
ἤτοι ὅ γ’ ὣς εἰπὼν κατ’ ἄρ’ ἕζετο· τοῖσι δ’ ἀνέστη
Δαρδανίδης Πρίαμος, θεόφιν μήστωρ ἀτάλαντος,
ὅ σφιν ἐϋφρονέων ἀγορήσατο καὶ μετέειπε·
κέκλυτέ μευ Τρῶες καὶ Δάρδανοι ἠδ’ ἐπίκουροι,
ὄφρ’ εἴπω τά με θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι κελεύει.
νῦν μὲν δόρπον ἕλεσθε κατὰ πτόλιν ὡς τὸ πάρος περ,
καὶ φυλακῆς μνήσασθε καὶ ἐγρήγορθε ἕκαστος·
ἠῶθεν δ’ Ἰδαῖος ἴτω κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας
εἰπέμεν Ἀτρεΐδῃς Ἀγαμέμνονι καὶ Μενελάῳ
μῦθον Ἀλεξάνδροιο, τοῦ εἵνεκα νεῖκος ὄρωρε·
καὶ δὲ τόδ’ εἰπέμεναι πυκινὸν ἔπος, αἴ κ’ ἐθέλωσι
παύσασθαι πολέμοιο δυσηχέος, εἰς ὅ κε νεκροὺς
κήομεν· ὕστερον αὖτε μαχησόμεθ’ εἰς ὅ κε δαίμων
ἄμμε διακρίνῃ, δώῃ δ’ ἑτέροισί γε νίκην.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα τοῦ μάλα μὲν κλύον ἠδ’ ἐπίθοντο·
δόρπον ἔπειθ’ εἵλοντο κατὰ στρατὸν ἐν τελέεσσιν·
ἠῶθεν δ’ Ἰδαῖος ἔβη κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας·
τοὺς δ’ εὗρ’ εἰν ἀγορῇ Δαναοὺς θεράποντας Ἄρηος
νηὶ πάρα πρύμνῃ Ἀγαμέμνονος· αὐτὰρ ὃ τοῖσι
στὰς ἐν μέσσοισιν μετεφώνεεν ἠπύτα κῆρυξ·
Ἀτρεΐδη τε καὶ ἄλλοι ἀριστῆες Παναχαιῶν
ἠνώγει Πρίαμός τε καὶ ἄλλοι Τρῶες ἀγαυοὶ
εἰπεῖν, αἴ κέ περ ὔμμι φίλον καὶ ἠδὺ γένοιτο,
μῦθον Ἀλεξάνδροιο, τοῦ εἵνεκα νεῖκος ὄρωρε·
κτήματα μὲν ὅσ’ Ἀλέξανδρος κοίλῃς ἐνὶ νηυσὶν
ἠγάγετο Τροίηνδ’· ὡς πρὶν ὤφελλ’ ἀπολέσθαι·

7.391

πάντ’ ἐθέλει δόμεναι καὶ οἴκοθεν ἄλλ’ ἐπιθεῖναι·
κουριδίην δ’ ἄλοχον Μενελάου κυδαλίμοιο
οὔ φησιν δώσειν· ἦ μὴν Τρῶές γε κέλονται.
καὶ δὲ τόδ’ ἠνώγεον εἰπεῖν ἔπος αἴ κ’ ἐθέλητε
παύσασθαι πολέμοιο δυσηχέος εἰς ὅ κε νεκροὺς
κήομεν· ὕστερον αὖτε μαχησόμεθ’ εἰς ὅ κε δαίμων

397 ἄμμε διακρίνῃ, δώῃ δ’ ἑτέροισί γε νίκην.
398 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἀκὴν ἐγένοντο σιωπῇ·
399 ὀψὲ δὲ δὴ μετέειπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
400 μήτ’ ἄρ τις νῦν κτήματ’ Ἀλεξάνδροιο δεχέσθω
401 μήθ’ Ἑλένην· γνωτὸν δὲ καὶ ὃς μάλα νήπιός ἐστιν
402 ὡς ἤδη Τρώεσσιν ὀλέθρου πείρατ’ ἐφῆπται.
403 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἐπίαχον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
404 μῦθον ἀγασσάμενοι Διομήδεος ἱπποδάμοιο·
405 καὶ τότ’ ἄρ’ Ἰδαῖον προσέφη κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων·
406 Ἰδαῖ’ ἦτοι μῦθον Ἀχαιῶν αὐτὸς ἀκούεις
407 ὥς τοι ὑποκρίνονται· ἐμοὶ δ’ ἐπιανδάνει οὕτως
408 ἀμφὶ δὲ νεκροῖσιν κατακαιέμεν οὔ τι μεγαίρω·
409 οὐ γάρ τις φειδὼ νεκύων κατατεθνηώτων
410 γίγνετ’ ἐπεί κε θάνωσι πυρὸς μειλισσέμεν ὦκα.
411 ὅρκια δὲ Ζεὺς ἴστω ἐρίγδουπος πόσις Ἥρης.
412 ὣς εἰπὼν τὸ σκῆπτρον ἀνέσχεθε πᾶσι θεοῖσιν,
413 ἄψορρον δ’ Ἰδαῖος ἔβη προτὶ Ἴλιον ἱρήν.
414 οἳ δ’ ἔατ’ εἰν ἀγορῇ Τρῶες καὶ Δαρδανίωνες
415 πάντες ὁμηγερέες, ποτιδέγμενοι ὁππότ’ ἄρ’ ἔλθοι
416 Ἰδαῖος· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ἦλθε καὶ ἀγγελίην ἀπέειπε
417 στὰς ἐν μέσσοισιν· τοὶ δ’ ὁπλίζοντο μάλ’ ὦκα,
418 ἀμφότερον νέκυάς τ’ ἀγέμεν ἔτεροι δὲ μεθ’ ὕλην·
419 Ἀργεῖοι δ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐϋσσέλμων ἀπὸ νηῶν
420 ὀτρύνοντο νέκυς τ’ ἀγέμεν, ἕτεροι δὲ μεθ’ ὕλην.
hereafter we will fight anew, till a daimôn decides between us and gives victory to one or to the other." They all held their peace, but presently Diomedes of the loud war-cry spoke, saying, "Let there be no taking, neither treasure, nor yet Helen, for even a child may see that the doom of the Trojans is at hand." The sons of the Achaeans shouted approval at the words that Diomedes had spoken, and thereon King Agamemnon said to Idaios, "Idaios, you have heard the answer the Achaeans make you-and I with them. But as concerning the dead, I give you leave to burn them, for when men are once dead there should be no grudging them the rites of fire. Let Zeus the mighty husband of Hera be witness to this covenant." As he spoke he upheld his scepter in the sight of all the gods, and Idaios went back to the strong city of Ilion. The Trojans and Dardanians were gathered in council waiting his return; when he came, he stood in their midst and delivered his message. As soon as they heard it they set about their twofold labor, some to gather the corpses, and others to bring in wood. The Argives on their part also hastened from their ships, some to gather the corpses, and others to bring in wood. The sun was beginning to beat upon the fields, fresh risen into the vault of heaven from the slow still currents of deep Okeanos, when the two armies met. They could hardly recognize their dead, but they washed the clotted gore from off them, shed tears over them, and lifted them upon their wagons. Priam had forbidden the Trojans to wail aloud, so they heaped their dead sadly and silently upon the pyre, and having burned them went back to the city of Ilion. The Achaeans in like manner heaped their dead sadly and silently on the pyre, and having burned them went back to their ships. Now in the twilight when it was not yet dawn, chosen bands of the Achaeans were gathered round the pyre and built one barrow that was raised in common for all, and hard by this they built a high wall to shelter themselves and their ships; they gave it strong gates that there might be a way through them for their chariots, and close outside it they dug a trench deep and wide, and they planted it within with stakes. Thus did the Achaeans toil, and the gods, seated by the side of Zeus the lord of lightning, marveled at their great work; but Poseidon, lord of the earthquake, spoke, saying, "Father Zeus, what

mortal in the whole world will again take the gods into his counsel [noos]? See you not how the Achaeans have built a wall about their ships and driven a trench all round it, without offering hecatombs to the gods? The fame [kleos] of this wall will reach as far as dawn itself, and men will no longer think anything of the one which Phoebus Apollo and myself built with so much labor for Laomedon." Zeus was displeased and answered, "What, O shaker of the earth, are you talking about? A god less powerful than yourself might be alarmed at what they are doing, but your fame [kleos] reaches as far as dawn itself. Surely when the Achaeans have gone home with their ships, you can shatter their wall and Ring it into the sea; you can cover the beach with sand again, and the great wall of the Achaeans will then be utterly effaced."

7.421

421 Ἠέλιος μὲν ἔπειτα νέον προσέβαλλεν ἀρούρας
422 ἐξ ἀκαλαρρείταο βαθυρρόου Ὠκεανοῖο
423 οὐρανὸν εἰσανιών· οἳ δ’ ἤντεον ἀλλήλοισιν.
424 ἔνθα διαγνῶναι χαλεπῶς ἦν ἄνδρα ἕκαστον·
425 ἀλλ’ ὕδατι νίζοντες ἄπο βρότον αἱματόεντα
426 δάκρυα θερμὰ χέοντες ἀμαξάων ἐπάειραν.
427 οὐδ’ εἴα κλαίειν Πρίαμος μέγας· οἳ δὲ σιωπῇ
428 νεκροὺς πυρκαϊῆς ἐπινήνεον ἀχνύμενοι κῆρ,
429 ἐν δὲ πυρὶ πρήσαντες ἔβαν προτὶ Ἴλιον ἱρήν.
430 ὣς δ’ αὖτως ἑτέρωθεν ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
431 νεκροὺς πυρκαϊῆς ἐπινήνεον ἀχνύμενοι κῆρ,
432 ἐν δὲ πυρὶ πρήσαντες ἔβαν κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας.
433 ἦμος δ’ οὔτ’ ἄρ πω ἠώς, ἔτι δ’ ἀμφιλύκη νύξ,
434 τῆμος ἄρ’ ἀμφὶ πυρὴν κριτὸς ἔγρετο λαὸς Ἀχαιῶν,
435 τύμβον δ’ ἀμφ’ αὐτὴν ἕνα ποίεον ἐξαγαγόντες
436 ἄκριτον ἐκ πεδίου, ποτὶ δ’ αὐτὸν τεῖχος ἔδειμαν
437 πύργους θ’ ὑψηλούς, εἶλαρ νηῶν τε καὶ αὐτῶν.
438 ἐν δ’ αὐτοῖσι πύλας ἐνεποίεον εὖ ἀραρυίας,
439 ὄφρα δι’ αὐτάων ἱππηλασίη ὁδὸς εἴη·
440 ἔκτοσθεν δὲ βαθεῖαν ἐπ’ αὐτῷ τάφρον ὄρυξαν
441 εὐρεῖαν μεγάλην, ἐν δὲ σκόλοπας κατέπηξαν.
442 ὣς οἳ μὲν πονέοντο κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοί·
443 οἳ δὲ θεοὶ πὰρ Ζηνὶ καθήμενοι ἀστεροπητῇ
444 θηεῦντο μέγα ἔργον Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων.
445 τοῖσι δὲ μύθων ἦρχε Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων·
446 Ζεῦ πάτερ, ἦ ῥά τίς ἐστι βροτῶν ἐπ’ ἀπείρονα γαῖαν
447 ὅς τις ἔτ’ ἀθανάτοισι νόον καὶ μῆτιν ἐνίψει;
448 οὐχ ὁράᾳς ὅτι δ’ αὖτε κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοὶ
449 τεῖχος ἐτειχίσσαντο νεῶν ὕπερ, ἀμφὶ δὲ τάφρον
450 ἤλασαν, οὐδὲ θεοῖσι δόσαν κλειτὰς ἑκατόμβας;

7.451

451 τοῦ δ’ ἤτοι κλέος ἔσται ὅσον τ’ ἐπικίδναται ἠώς·
452 τοῦ δ’ ἐπιλήσονται τὸ ἐγὼ καὶ Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων
453 ἤρῳ Λαομέδοντι πολίσσαμεν ἀθλήσαντε.
454 τὸν δὲ μέγ’ ὀχθήσας προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
455 ὢ πόποι ἐννοσίγαι’ εὐρυσθενές, οἷον ἔειπες.
456 ἄλλός κέν τις τοῦτο θεῶν δείσειε νόημα,

457 ὃς σέο πολλὸν ἀφαυρότερος χεῖράς τε μένος τε·
458 σὸν δ’ ἤτοι κλέος ἔσται ὅσον τ’ ἐπικίδναται ἠώς.
459 ἄγρει μὰν ὅτ’ ἂν αὖτε κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοὶ
460 οἴχωνται σὺν νηυσὶ φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν
461 τεῖχος ἀναρρήξας τὸ μὲν εἰς ἅλα πᾶν καταχεῦαι,
462 αὖτις δ’ ἠϊόνα μεγάλην ψαμάθοισι καλύψαι,
463 ὥς κέν τοι μέγα τεῖχος ἀμαλδύνηται Ἀχαιῶν.
464 ὣς οἳ μὲν τοιαῦτα πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἀγόρευον,
465 δύσετο δ’ ἠέλιος, τετέλεστο δὲ ἔργον Ἀχαιῶν,
466 βουφόνεον δὲ κατὰ κλισίας καὶ δόρπον ἕλοντο.
467 νῆες δ’ ἐκ Λήμνοιο παρέσταν οἶνον ἄγουσαι
468 πολλαί, τὰς προέηκεν Ἰησονίδης Εὔνηος,
469 τόν ῥ’ ἔτεχ’ Ὑψιπύλη ὑπ’ Ἰήσονι ποιμένι λαῶν.
470 χωρὶς δ’ Ἀτρεΐδῃς Ἀγαμέμνονι καὶ Μενελάῳ
471 δῶκεν Ἰησονίδης ἀγέμεν μέθυ χίλια μέτρα.
472 ἔνθεν οἰνίζοντο κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοί,
473 ἄλλοι μὲν χαλκῷ, ἄλλοι δ’ αἴθωνι σιδήρῳ,
474 ἄλλοι δὲ ῥινοῖς, ἄλλοι δ’ αὐτῇσι βόεσσιν,
475 ἄλλοι δ’ ἀνδραπόδεσσι· τίθεντο δὲ δαῖτα θάλειαν.
476 παννύχιοι μὲν ἔπειτα κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοὶ
477 δαίνυντο, Τρῶες δὲ κατὰ πτόλιν ἠδ’ ἐπίκουροι·
478 παννύχιος δέ σφιν κακὰ μήδετο μητίετα Ζεὺς
479 σμερδαλέα κτυπέων· τοὺς δὲ χλωρὸν δέος ᾕρει·
480 οἶνον δ’ ἐκ δεπάων χαμάδις χέον, οὐδέ τις ἔτλη
Thus did they converse, and by sunset the work of the Achaeans was completed; they then slaughtered oxen at their tents and got their supper. Many ships had come with wine from Lemnos, sent by Euneus the son of Jason, born to him by Hypsipyle. The son of Jason freighted them with ten thousand measures of wine, which he sent specially to the sons of Atreus, Agamemnon and Menelaos. From this supply the Achaeans bought their wine, some with bronze, some with iron, some with hides, some with whole heifers, and some again with captives. They spread a goodly banquet and feasted the whole night through, as also did the Trojans and their allies in the city. But all the time Zeus boded them ill and roared with his portentous thunder. Pale fear got hold upon them, and they spilled the wine from their cups on to the ground, nor did any dare drink till he had made offerings to the most mighty son of Kronos. Then they laid themselves down to rest and enjoyed the boon of sleep.

7.481

481 πρὶν πιέειν πρὶν λεῖψαι ὑπερμενέϊ Κρονίωνι.
482 κοιμήσαντ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα καὶ ὕπνου δῶρον ἕλοντο.

8.1

1 Ἠὼς μὲν κροκόπεπλος ἐκίδνατο πᾶσαν ἐπ’ αἶαν,
2 Ζεὺς δὲ θεῶν ἀγορὴν ποιήσατο τερπικέραυνος
3 ἀκροτάτῃ κορυφῇ πολυδειράδος Οὐλύμποιο·
4 αὐτὸς δέ σφ’ ἀγόρευε, θεοὶ δ’ ὑπὸ πάντες ἄκουον·
5 κέκλυτέ μευ πάντές τε θεοὶ πᾶσαί τε θέαιναι,
6 ὄφρ’ εἴπω τά με θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι κελεύει.
7 μήτέ τις οὖν θήλεια θεὸς τό γε μήτέ τις ἄρσην
8 πειράτω διακέρσαι ἐμὸν ἔπος, ἀλλ’ ἅμα πάντες

9 αἰνεῖτ’, ὄφρα τάχιστα τελευτήσω τάδε ἔργα.
10 ὃν δ’ ἂν ἐγὼν ἀπάνευθε θεῶν ἐθέλοντα νοήσω
11 ἐλθόντ’ ἢ Τρώεσσιν ἀρηγέμεν ἢ Δαναοῖσι
12 πληγεὶς οὐ κατὰ κόσμον ἐλεύσεται Οὔλυμπον δέ·
13 ἥ μιν ἑλὼν ῥίψω ἐς Τάρταρον ἠερόεντα
14 τῆλε μάλ’, ἧχι βάθιστον ὑπὸ χθονός ἐστι βέρεθρον,
15 ἔνθα σιδήρειαί τε πύλαι καὶ χάλκεος οὐδός,
16 τόσσον ἔνερθ’ Ἄΐδεω ὅσον οὐρανός ἐστ’ ἀπὸ γαίης·
17 γνώσετ’ ἔπειθ’ ὅσον εἰμὶ θεῶν κάρτιστος ἁπάντων.
18 εἰ δ’ ἄγε πειρήσασθε θεοὶ ἵνα εἴδετε πάντες·
19 σειρὴν χρυσείην ἐξ οὐρανόθεν κρεμάσαντες
20 πάντές τ’ ἐξάπτεσθε θεοὶ πᾶσαί τε θέαιναι·
21 ἀλλ’ οὐκ ἂν ἐρύσαιτ’ ἐξ οὐρανόθεν πεδίον δὲ
22 Ζῆν’ ὕπατον μήστωρ’, οὐδ’ εἰ μάλα πολλὰ κάμοιτε.
23 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ καὶ ἐγὼ πρόφρων ἐθέλοιμι ἐρύσσαι,
24 αὐτῇ κεν γαίῃ ἐρύσαιμ’ αὐτῇ τε θαλάσσῃ·
25 σειρὴν μέν κεν ἔπειτα περὶ ῥίον Οὐλύμποιο
26 δησαίμην, τὰ δέ κ’ αὖτε μετήορα πάντα γένοιτο.
27 τόσσον ἐγὼ περί τ’ εἰμὶ θεῶν περί τ’ εἴμ’ ἀνθρώπων.
28 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἱ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἀκὴν ἐγένοντο σιωπῇ
29 μῦθον ἀγασσάμενοι· μάλα γὰρ κρατερῶς ἀγόρευσεν.
30 ὀψὲ δὲ δὴ μετέειπε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·
Now when Morning, clad in her robe of saffron, had begun to suffuse light over the earth, Zeus called the gods in council on the topmost crest of serrated Olympus. Then he spoke and all the other gods gave ear. "Hear me," said he, "gods and goddesses, that I may speak even as I am minded. Let none of you neither goddess nor god try to cross me, but obey me every one of you that I may bring this matter to an end. If I see anyone acting apart and helping either Trojans or Danaans, he shall be beaten beyond the limits of universal order [kosmos] ere he come back again to Olympus; or I will hurl him down into dark Tartaros far into the deepest pit under the earth, where the gates are iron and the floor bronze, as far beneath Hades as heaven is high above the earth, that you may learn how much the mightiest I am among you. Try me and find out for yourselves. Hang me a golden chain from heaven, and lay hold of it all of you, gods and goddesses together - tug as you will, you will not drag Zeus the supreme counselor from heaven to earth; but were I to pull at it myself I should draw you up with earth and sea into the bargain, then would I bind the chain about some pinnacle of Olympus and leave you all dangling in the mid firmament. So far am I above all others either of gods or men." They were frightened and all of them of held their peace, for he had spoken masterfully; but at last Athena answered, "Father, son of Kronos, king of kings, we all know that your might is not to be gainsaid, but we are also sorry for the Danaan warriors, who are perishing and coming to a bad end. We will, however, since you so bid us, refrain from actual fighting, but we will make serviceable suggestions to the Argives that they may not all of them perish in your displeasure." Zeus smiled at her and answered, "Take heart, my child, Trito-born; I am not really in earnest, and I wish to be kind to you." With this he yoked his fleet horses, with hoofs of bronze and manes of glittering gold. He girded himself also with gold about the body, seized his gold whip and took his seat in his chariot. Thereon he lashed his horses and they flew forward nothing loath midway twixt earth and starry heaven. After a while he reached many-fountained Ida, mother of wild beasts, and Gargaros, where are his grove and fragrant altar. There the father of gods and men stayed his horses, took them from the chariot, and hid them in a thick cloud; then he took his seat all glorious upon the topmost crests, looking down upon the city of Troy and the ships of the Achaeans. The Achaeans took their morning

meal hastily at the ships, and afterwards put on their armor. The Trojans on the other hand likewise armed themselves throughout the city, fewer in numbers but nevertheless eager perforce to do battle for their wives and children. All the gates were flung wide open, and horse and foot sallied forth with the tramp as of a great multitude. When they were got together in one place, shield clashed with shield, and spear with spear, in the conflict of mail-clad men. Mighty was the din as the bossed shields pressed hard on one another- death - cry and shout of triumph of slain and slayers, and the earth ran red with blood. Now so long as the day waxed and it was still morning their weapons beat against one another, and the people fell, but when the sun had reached mid-heaven, the sire of all balanced his golden scales, and put two fates of death within them, one for the Trojans and the other for the Achaeans. He took the balance by the middle, and when he lifted it up the day of the Achaeans sank; the death-fraught scale of the Achaeans settled down upon the ground, while that of the Trojans rose heavenwards. Then he thundered aloud from Ida, and sent the glare of his lightning upon the Achaeans; when they saw this, pale fear fell upon them and they were sore afraid. Idomeneus dared not stay nor yet Agamemnon, nor did the two Ajaxes, squires [therapontes] of Ares, hold their ground. Nestor horseman of Gerene alone stood firm, bulwark of the Achaeans, not of his own will, but one of his horses was disabled. Alexander husband of lovely Helen had hit it with an arrow just on the top of its head where the mane begins to grow away from the skull, a very deadly place. The horse bounded in his anguish as the arrow pierced his brain, and his struggles threw others into confusion. The old man instantly began cutting the traces with his sword, but Hektor's fleet horses bore down upon him through the rout with their bold charioteer, even Hektor himself, and the old man would have perished there and then had not Diomedes been quick to mark, and with a loud cry called Odysseus to help him.

8.31

31 ὦ πάτερ ἡμέτερε Κρονίδη ὔπατε κρειόντων
32 εὖ νυ καὶ ἡμεῖς ἴδμεν ὅ τοι σθένος οὐκ ἐπιεικτόν·
33 ἀλλ᾽ ἔμπης Δαναῶν ὀλοφυρόμεθ᾽ αἰχμητάων,
34 οἵ κεν δὴ κακὸν οἶτον ἀναπλήσαντες ὄλωνται.
35 ἀλλ᾽ ἤτοι πολέμου μὲν ἀφεξόμεθ᾽ ὡς σὺ κελεύεις·
36 βουλὴν δ᾽ Ἀργείοις ὑποθησόμεθ᾽ ἥ τις ὀνήσει,
37 ὡς μὴ πάντες ὄλωνται ὀδυσσαμένοιο τεοῖο.
38 τὴν δ᾽ ἐπιμειδήσας προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
39 θάρσει Τριτογένεια φίλον τέκος· οὔ νύ τι θυμῷ
40 πρόφρονι μυθέομαι, ἐθέλω δέ τοι ἤπιος εἶναι.
41 ὣς εἰπὼν ὑπ᾽ ὄχεσφι τιτύσκετο χαλκόποδ᾽ ἵππω
42 ὠκυπέτα χρυσέῃσιν ἐθείρῃσιν κομόωντε,
43 χρυσὸν δ᾽ αὐτὸς ἔδυνε περὶ χροΐ, γέντο δ᾽ ἰμάσθλην
44 χρυσείην εὔτυκτον, ἐοῦ δ᾽ ἐπεβήσετο δίφρου,
45 μάστιξεν δ᾽ ἐλάαν· τὼ δ᾽ οὐκ ἀέκοντε πετέσθην
46 μεσσηγὺς γαίης τε καὶ οὐρανοῦ ἀστερόεντος.
47 Ἴδην δ᾽ ἵκανεν πολυπίδακα μητέρα θηρῶν
48 Γάργαρον, ἔνθά τέ οἱ τέμενος βωμός τε θυήεις.
49 ἔνθ᾽ ἵππους ἔστησε πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε
50 λύσας ἐξ ὀχέων, κατὰ δ᾽ ἠέρα πουλὺν ἔχευεν.
51 αὐτὸς δ᾽ ἐν κορυφῇσι καθέζετο κύδεϊ γαίων
52 εἰσορόων Τρώων τε πόλιν καὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν.
53 οἳ δ᾽ ἄρα δεῖπνον ἕλοντο κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοὶ
54 ῥίμφα κατὰ κλισίας, ἀπὸ δ᾽ αὐτοῦ θωρήσσοντο.
55 Τρῶες δ᾽ αὖθ᾽ ἑτέρωθεν ἀνὰ πτόλιν ὁπλίζοντο

παυρότεροι· μέμασαν δὲ καὶ ὣς ὑσμῖνι μάχεσθαι
χρειοῖ ἀναγκαίῃ, πρό τε παίδων καὶ πρὸ γυναικῶν.
πᾶσαι δ’ ὠΐγνυντο πύλαι, ἐκ δ’ ἔσσυτο λαός,
πεζοί θ’ ἱππῆές τε· πολὺς δ’ ὀρυμαγδὸς ὀρώρει.
οἳ δ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἐς χῶρον ἔνα ξυνιόντες ἵκοντο

8.61

σύν ῥ’ ἔβαλον ῥινούς, σὺν δ’ ἔγχεα καὶ μένε’ ἀνδρῶν
χαλκεοθωρήκων· ἀτὰρ ἀσπίδες ὀμφαλόεσσαι
ἔπληντ’ ἀλλήλῃσι, πολὺς δ’ ὀρυμαγδὸς ὀρώρει.
ἔνθα δ’ ἅμ’ οἰμωγή τε καὶ εὐχωλὴ πέλεν ἀνδρῶν
ὀλλύντων τε καὶ ὀλλυμένων, ῥέε δ’ αἵματι γαῖα.
ὄφρα μὲν ἠὼς ἦν καὶ ἀέξετο ἱερὸν ἦμαρ,
τόφρα μάλ’ ἀμφοτέρων βέλε’ ἤπτετο, πῖπτε δὲ λαός.
ἦμος δ’ Ἠέλιος μέσον οὐρανὸν ἀμφιβεβήκει,
καὶ τότε δὴ χρύσεια πατὴρ ἐτίταινε τάλαντα·
ἐν δ’ ἐτίθει δύο κῆρε τανηλεγέος θανάτοιο
Τρώων θ’ ἱπποδάμων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων,
ἕλκε δὲ μέσσα λαβών· ῥέπε δ’ αἶσιμον ἦμαρ Ἀχαιῶν.
αἳ μὲν Ἀχαιῶν κῆρες ἐπὶ χθονὶ πουλυβοτείρῃ
ἐζέσθην, Τρώων δὲ πρὸς οὐρανὸν εὐρὺν ἄερθεν·
αὐτὸς δ’ ἐξ Ἴδης μεγάλ’ ἔκτυπε, δαιόμενον δὲ
ἧκε σέλας μετὰ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν· οἳ δὲ ἰδόντες
θάμβησαν, καὶ πάντας ὑπὸ χλωρὸν δέος εἷλεν.
ἔνθ’ οὔτ’ Ἰδομενεὺς τλῆ μίμνειν οὔτ’ Ἀγαμέμνων,
οὔτε δύ’ Αἴαντες μενέτην θεράποντες Ἄρηος·
Νέστωρ οἷος ἔμιμνε Γερήνιος οὖρος Ἀχαιῶν
οὔ τι ἑκών, ἀλλ’ ἵππος ἐτείρετο, τὸν βάλεν ἰῷ
δῖος Ἀλέξανδρος Ἑλένης πόσις ἠϋκόμοιο
ἄκρην κὰκ κορυφήν, ὅθι τε πρῶται τρίχες ἵππων
κρανίῳ ἐμπεφύασι, μάλιστα δὲ καίριόν ἐστιν.
ἀλγήσας δ’ ἀνέπαλτο, βέλος δ’ εἰς ἐγκέφαλον δῦ,
σὺν δ’ ἵππους ἐτάραξε κυλινδόμενος περὶ χαλκῷ.
ὄφρ’ ὁ γέρων ἵπποιο παρηορίας ἀπέταμνε
φασγάνῳ ἀΐσσων, τόφρ’ Ἕκτορος ὠκέες ἵπποι
ἦλθον ἀν’ ἰωχμὸν θρασὺν ἡνίοχον φορέοντες
Ἕκτορα· καί νύ κεν ἔνθ’ ὁ γέρων ἀπὸ θυμὸν ὄλεσσεν

8.91

εἰ μὴ ἄρ’ ὀξὺ νόησε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
σμερδαλέον δ’ ἐβόησεν ἐποτρύνων Ὀδυσῆα·
διογενὲς Λαερτιάδη πολυμήχαν’ Ὀδυσσεῦ
πῇ φεύγεις μετὰ νῶτα βαλὼν κακὸς ὡς ἐν ὁμίλῳ;
μή τίς τοι φεύγοντι μεταφρένῳ ἐν δόρυ πήξῃ·
ἀλλὰ μέν’ ὄφρα γέροντος ἀπώσομεν ἄγριον ἄνδρα.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἐσάκουσε πολύτλας δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς,
ἀλλὰ παρήϊξεν κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν.
Τυδεΐδης δ’ αὐτός περ ἐὼν προμάχοισιν ἐμίχθη,
στῆ δὲ πρόσθ’ ἵππων Νηληϊάδαο γέροντος,
καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·

102 ὦ γέρον ἦ μάλα δή σε νέοι τείρουσι μαχηταί,
103 σὴ δὲ βίη λέλυται, χαλεπὸν δέ σε γῆρας ὀπάζει,
104 ἠπεδανὸς δέ νύ τοι θεράπων, βραδέες δέ τοι ἵπποι.
105 ἀλλ’ ἄγ’ ἐμῶν ὀχέων ἐπιβήσεο, ὄφρα ἴδηαι
106 οἷοι Τρώϊοι ἵπποι ἐπιστάμενοι πεδίοιο
107 κραιπνὰ μάλ’ ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα διωκέμεν ἠδὲ φέβεσθαι,
108 οὔς ποτ’ ἀπ’ Αἰνείαν ἐλόμην μήστωρε φόβοιο.
109 τούτω μὲν θεράποντε κομείτων, τώδε δὲ νῶϊ
110 Τρωσὶν ἐφ’ ἱπποδάμοις ἰθύνομεν, ὄφρα καὶ Ἕκτωρ
111 εἴσεται εἰ καὶ ἐμὸν δόρυ μαίνεται ἐν παλάμῃσιν.
112 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ.
113 Νεστορέας μὲν ἔπειθ’ ἵππους θεράποντε κομείτην
114 ἴφθιμοι Σθένελός τε καὶ Εὐρυμέδων ἀγαπήνωρ.
115 τὼ δ’ εἰς ἀμφοτέρω Διομήδεος ἅρματα βήτην·
116 Νέστωρ δ’ ἐν χείρεσσι λάβ’ ἡνία σιγαλόεντα,
117 μάστιξεν δ’ ἵππους· τάχα δ’ Ἕκτορος ἄγχι γένοντο.
118 τοῦ δ’ ἰθὺς μεμαῶτος ἀκόντισε Τυδέος υἱός·
119 καὶ τοῦ μέν ῥ’ ἀφάμαρτεν, ὃ δ’ ἡνίοχον θεράποντα
120 υἱὸν ὑπερθύμου Θηβαίου Ἠνιοπῆα
"Odysseus," he cried, "noble son of Laertes where are you fleeing to, with your back turned like a coward? See that you are not struck with a spear between the shoulders. Stay here and help me to defend Nestor from this man's furious onset." Odysseus would not give ear, but sped onward to the ships of the Achaeans, and the son of Tydeus flinging himself alone into the thick of the fight took his stand before the horses of the son of Neleus. "Sir," said he, "these young warriors are pressing you hard, your force is spent, and age is heavy upon you, your squire [therapôn] is naught, and your horses are slow to move. Mount my chariot and see what the horses of Tros can do- how cleverly they can scud hither and thither over the plain either in flight or in pursuit. I took them from the hero Aeneas. Let our squires [theraponte] attend to your own steeds, but let us drive mine straight at the Trojans, that Hektor may learn how furiously I too can wield my spear." Nestor horseman of Gerene hearkened to his words. Thereon the doughty squires [therapontes], Sthenelos and kind-hearted Eurymedon, saw to Nestor's horses, while the two both mounted Diomedes' chariot. Nestor took the reins in his hands and lashed the horses on; they were soon close up with Hektor, and the son of Tydeus aimed a spear at him as he was charging full speed towards them. He missed him, but struck his charioteer and squire [therapôn] Eniopeus son of noble Thebaios in the breast by the nipple while the reins were in his hands, so that he lost his life-breath [psukhê] there and then, and the horses swerved as he fell headlong from the chariot. Hektor was greatly grieved at the loss of his charioteer, but let him lie, despite his sorrow [akhos], while he went in quest of another driver; nor did his steeds have to go long without one, for he presently found brave Arkheptolemos the son of Iphitos, and made him get up behind the horses, giving the reins into his hand. All had then been lost and no help for it, for they would have been penned up in Ilion like sheep, had not the sire of gods and men been quick to mark, and hurled a fiery flaming thunderbolt which fell just in front of Diomedes' horses with a flare of burning brimstone. The horses were frightened and tried to back beneath the car, while the reins dropped from Nestor's hands. Then he was afraid and said to Diomedes, "Son of Tydeus, turn your horses in flight; see you not that the hand of Zeus is against you? To-day he grants victory to Hektor; tomorrow, if it so please him, he will again grant it to ourselves; no man, however brave, may thwart the purpose [noon] of Zeus, for he is far stronger than any." Diomedes answered, "All that you have said is true; there is a grief [akhos], however, which pierces me to the very heart, for Hektor will talk among the Trojans and say, ‘The son of Tydeus fled before me to the ships.’

This is the vaunt he will make, and may earth then swallow me." "Son of Tydeus," replied Nestor, "what mean you? Though Hektor say that you are a coward the Trojans and Dardanians will not believe him, nor yet the wives of the mighty warriors whom you have laid low." So saying he turned the horses back through the thick of the battle, and with a cry that rent the air the Trojans and Hektor rained their darts after them. Hektor shouted to him and said, "Son of Tydeus, the Danaans have done you honor hitherto as regards your place at table, the meals they give you, and the filling of your cup with wine. Henceforth they will despise you, for you are become no better than a woman. Be off, girl and coward that you are, you shall not try to scale our towers without my stopping you; neither shall you carry off our wives in your ships, for I shall give you, with my own hand, a fate [daimôn] that will doom you."

8.121

ἵππων ἠνί’ ἔχοντα βάλε στῆθος παρὰ μαζόν.
ἤριπε δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων, ὑπερώησαν δέ οἱ ἵπποι
ὠκύποδες· τοῦ δ’ αὖθι λύθη ψυχή τε μένος τε.
Ἕκτορα δ’ αἰνὸν ἄχος πύκασε φρένας ἠνιόχοιο·
τὸν μὲν ἔπειτ’ εἴασε καὶ ἀχνύμενός περ ἑταίρου
κεῖσθαι, ὃ δ’ ἡνίοχον μέθεπε θρασύν· οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔτι δὴν
ἵππω δευέσθην σημάντορος· αἶψα γὰρ εὗρεν
Ἰφιτίδην Ἀρχεπτόλεμον θρασύν, ὅν ῥα τόθ’ ἵππων
ὠκυπόδων ἐπέβησε, δίδου δέ οἱ ἡνία χερσίν.
ἔνθά κε λοιγὸς ἔην καὶ ἀμήχανα ἔργα γένοντο,
καί νύ κε σήκασθεν κατὰ Ἴλιον ἠΰτε ἄρνες,
εἰ μὴ ἄρ’ ὀξὺ νόησε πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε·
βροντήσας δ’ ἄρα δεινὸν ἀφῆκ’ ἀργῆτα κεραυνόν,
κὰδ δὲ πρόσθ’ ἵππων Διομήδεος ἧκε χαμᾶζε·
δεινὴ δὲ φλὸξ ὦρτο θεείου καιομένοιο,
τὼ δ’ ἵππω δείσαντε καταπτήτην ὑπ’ ὄχεσφι·
Νέστορα δ’ ἐκ χειρῶν φύγον ἡνία σιγαλόεντα,
δεῖσε δ’ ὅ γ’ ἐν θυμῷ, Διομήδεα δὲ προσέειπε·
Τυδεΐδη ἄγε δ’ αὖτε φόβον δ’ ἔχε μώνυχας ἵππους.
ἦ οὐ γιγνώσκεις ὅ τοι ἐκ Διὸς οὐχ ἕπετ’ ἀλκή;
νῦν μὲν γὰρ τούτῳ Κρονίδης Ζεὺς κῦδος ὀπάζει
σήμερον· ὕστερον αὖτε καὶ ἡμῖν, αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσι,
δώσει· ἀνὴρ δέ κεν οὔ τι Διὸς νόον εἰρύσσαιτο
οὐδὲ μάλ’ ἴφθιμος, ἐπεὶ ἦ πολὺ φέρτερός ἐστι.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
ναὶ δὴ ταῦτά γε πάντα γέρον κατὰ μοῖραν ἔειπες·
ἀλλὰ τόδ’ αἰνὸν ἄχος κραδίην καὶ θυμὸν ἱκάνει·
Ἕκτωρ γάρ ποτε φήσει ἐνὶ Τρώεσσ’ ἀγορεύων·
Τυδεΐδης ὑπ’ ἐμεῖο φοβεύμενος ἴκετο νῆας.
ὥς ποτ’ ἀπειλήσει· τότε μοι χάνοι εὐρεῖα χθών.

8.151

τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
ὤ μοι Τυδέος υἱὲ δαΐφρονος, οἷον ἔειπες.
εἴ περ γάρ σ’ Ἕκτωρ γε κακὸν καὶ ἀνάλκιδα φήσει,
ἀλλ’ οὐ πείσονται Τρῶες καὶ Δαρδανίωνες
καὶ Τρώων ἄλοχοι μεγαθύμων ἀσπιστάων,

156 τάων ἐν κονίῃσι βάλες θαλεροὺς παρακοίτας.
157 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας φύγαδε τράπε μώνυχας ἵππους
158 αὖτις ἀν’ ἰωχμόν· ἐπὶ δὲ Τρῶές τε καὶ Ἕκτωρ
159 ἠχῇ θεσπεσίῃ βέλεα στονόεντα χέοντο.
160 τῷ δ’ ἐπὶ μακρὸν ἄϋσε μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
161 Τυδεΐδη περὶ μέν σε τίον Δαναοὶ ταχύπωλοι
162 ἕδρῃ τε κρέασίν τε ἰδὲ πλείοις δεπάεσσι·
163 νῦν δέ σ’ ἀτιμήσουσι· γυναικὸς ἄρ’ ἀντὶ τέτυξο.
164 ἔρρε κακὴ γλήνη, ἐπεὶ οὐκ εἴξαντος ἐμεῖο
165 πύργων ἠμετέρων ἐπιβήσεαι, οὐδὲ γυναῖκας
166 ἄξεις ἐν νήεσσι· πάρος τοι δαίμονα δώσω.
167 ὣς φάτο, Τυδεΐδης δὲ διάνδιχα μερμήριξεν
168 ἵππους τε στρέψαι καὶ ἐναντίβιον μαχέσασθαι.
169 τρὶς μὲν μερμήριξε κατὰ φρένα καὶ κατὰ θυμόν,
170 τρὶς δ’ ἄρ’ ἀπ’ Ἰδαίων ὀρέων κτύπε μητίετα Ζεὺς
171 σῆμα τιθεὶς Τρώεσσι μάχης ἑτεραλκέα νίκην.
172 Ἕκτωρ δὲ Τρώεσσιν ἐκέκλετο μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
173 Τρῶες καὶ Λύκιοι καὶ Δάρδανοι ἀγχιμαχηταὶ
174 ἀνέρες ἔστε φίλοι, μνήσασθε δὲ θούριδος ἀλκῆς.
175 γιγνώσκω δ’ ὅτι μοι πρόφρων κατένευσε Κρονίων
176 νίκην καὶ μέγα κῦδος, ἀτὰρ Δαναοῖσί γε πῆμα·
177 νήπιοι οἳ ἄρα δὴ τάδε τείχεα μηχανόωντο
178 ἀβλήχρ’ οὐδενόσωρα· τὰ δ’ οὐ μένος ἀμὸν ἐρύξει·
179 ἵπποι δὲ ῥέα τάφρον ὑπερθορέονται ὀρυκτήν.
180 ἀλλ’ ὅτε κεν δὴ νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσι γένωμαι,

The son of Tydeus was in two minds whether or no to turn his horses round again and fight him. Thrice did he doubt, and thrice did Zeus thunder from the heights of Ida in token [sêma] to the Trojans that he would turn the battle in their favor. Hektor then shouted to them and said, "Trojans, Lycians, and Dardanians, lovers of close fighting, be men, my friends, and fight with might and with main; I see that Zeus is minded to grant victory and great glory to myself, while he will deal destruction upon the Danaans. Fools, for having thought of building this weak and worthless wall. It shall not stay my fury; my horses will spring lightly over their trench, and when I am at their ships forget not to bring me fire that I may burn them, while I slaughter the Argives who will be all dazed and bewildered by the smoke." Then he cried to his horses, "Xanthos and Podagros, and you Aithon and goodly Lampos, pay me for your keep now and for all the honey-sweet grain with which Andromache daughter of great Eetion has fed you, and for she has mixed wine and water for you to drink whenever you would, before doing so even for me who am her own husband. Haste in pursuit, that we may take the shield of Nestor, the fame [kleos] of which ascends to heaven, for it is of solid gold, arm-rods and all, and that we may strip from the shoulders of Diomedes. the cuirass which Hephaistos made him. Could we take these two things, the Achaeans would set sail in their ships this self-same night." Thus did he vaunt, but Queen Hera made high Olympus quake as she shook with rage upon her throne. Then said she to the mighty god of Poseidon, "What now, wide ruling lord of the earthquake? Can you find no compassion in your heart for the dying Danaans, who bring you many a welcome offering to Helike and to Aigai? Wish them well then. If all of us who are with the Danaans were to drive the Trojans back and keep Zeus from helping them, he would have to sit there sulking alone on Ida." King Poseidon was greatly troubled and answered, "Hera, rash of tongue, what are you talking about? We other gods must not set ourselves against Zeus, for he is far stronger than we are." Thus did they converse; but the whole space enclosed by the ditch, from the ships even to the wall, was filled with horses and warriors,

who were pent up there by Hektor son of Priam, now that the hand of Zeus was with him. He would even have set fire to the ships and burned them, had not Queen Hera put it into the mind of Agamemnon, to bestir himself and to encourage the Achaeans. To this end he went round the ships and tents carrying a great purple cloak, and took his stand by the huge black hull of Odysseus' ship, which was middlemost of all; it was from this place that his voice would carry farthest, on the one hand towards the tents of Ajax son of Telamon, and on the other towards those of Achilles- for these two heroes, well assured of their own strength, had valorously drawn up their ships at the two ends of the line. From this spot then, with a voice that could be heard afar, he shouted to the Danaans, saying, "Argives, shame on you cowardly creatures, brave in semblance only; where are now our vaunts that we should prove victorious - the vaunts we made so vaingloriously in Lemnos, when we ate the flesh of horned cattle and filled our mixing-bowls to the brim? You vowed that you would each of you stand against a hundred or two hundred men, and now you prove no match even for one- for Hektor, who will be ere long setting our ships in a blaze. Father Zeus, did you ever before cause the ruin [atê] of a great king to such an extent and rob him so utterly of his greatness? yet, when to my sorrow I was coming hither, I never let my ship pass your altars without offering the fat and thigh-bones of heifers upon every one of them, so eager was I to sack the city of Troy. Vouchsafe me then this prayer- suffer us to escape at any rate with our lives, and let not the Achaeans be so utterly vanquished by the Trojans." Thus did he pray, and father Zeus pitying his tears granted him that his people should live, not die; forthwith he sent them an eagle, most unfailingly portentous of all birds, with a young fawn in its talons; the eagle dropped the fawn by the altar on which the Achaeans sacrificed to Zeus the lord of omens; When, therefore, the people saw that the bird had come from Zeus, they sprang more fiercely upon the Trojans and fought more boldly.

8.181

181 μνημοσύνη τις ἔπειτα πυρὸς δηΐοιο γενέσθω,
182 ὡς πυρὶ νῆας ἐνιπρήσω, κτείνω δὲ καὶ αὐτοὺς
183 Ἀργείους παρὰ νηυσὶν ἀτυζομένους ὑπὸ καπνοῦ.
184 ὣς εἰπὼν ἵπποισιν ἐκέκλετο φώνησέν τε·
185 Ξάνθέ τε καὶ σὺ Πόδαργε καὶ Αἴθων Λάμπέ τε δῖε
186 νῦν μοι τὴν κομιδὴν ἀποτίνετον, ἣν μάλα πολλὴν
187 Ἀνδρομάχη θυγάτηρ μεγαλήτορος Ἠετίωνος
188 ὑμῖν πὰρ προτέροισι μελίφρονα πυρὸν ἔθηκεν
189 οἶνόν τ’ ἐγκεράσασα πιεῖν, ὅτε θυμὸς ἀνώγοι,
190 ἠ ἐμοί, ὅς πέρ οἱ θαλερὸς πόσις εὔχομαι εἶναι.
191 ἀλλ’ ἐφομαρτεῖτον καὶ σπεύδετον ὄφρα λάβωμεν
192 ἀσπίδα Νεστορέην, τῆς νῦν κλέος οὐρανὸν ἵκει
193 πᾶσαν χρυσείην ἔμεναι, κανόνας τε καὶ αὐτήν,
194 αὐτὰρ ἀπ’ ὤμοιιν Διομήδεος ἱπποδάμοιο
195 δαιδάλεον θώρηκα, τὸν Ἥφαιστος κάμε τεύχων.
196 εἰ τούτω κε λάβοιμεν, ἐελποίμην κεν Ἀχαιοὺς
197 αὐτονυχὶ νηῶν ἐπιβησέμεν ὠκειάων.
198 ὣς ἔφατ’ εὐχόμενος, νεμέσησε δὲ πότνια Ἥρη,
199 σείσατο δ’ εἰνὶ θρόνῳ, ἐλέλιξε δὲ μακρὸν Ὄλυμπον,
200 καί ῥα Ποσειδάωνα μέγαν θεὸν ἀντίον ηὔδα·
201 ὢ πόποι ἐννοσίγαι’ εὐρυσθενές, οὐδέ νυ σοί περ
202 ὀλλυμένων Δαναῶν ὀλοφύρεται ἐν φρεσὶ θυμός.
203 οἳ δέ τοι εἰς Ἑλίκην τε καὶ Αἰγὰς δῶρ’ ἀνάγουσι
204 πολλά τε καὶ χαρίεντα· σὺ δέ σφισι βούλεο νίκην.

εἴ περ γάρ κ’ ἐθέλοιμεν, ὅσοι Δαναοῖσιν ἀρωγοί,
Τρῶας ἀπώσασθαι καὶ ἐρυκέμεν εὐρύοπα Ζῆν,
αὐτοῦ κ’ ἔνθ’ ἀκάχοιτο καθήμενος οἷος ἐν Ἴδῃ.
τὴν δὲ μέγ’ ὀχθήσας προσέφη κρείων ἐνοσίχθων·
Ἥρη ἀπτοεπὲς ποῖον τὸν μῦθον ἔειπες.
οὐκ ἂν ἔγωγ’ ἐθέλοιμι Διὶ Κρονίωνι μάχεσθαι

8.211

ἠμέας τοὺς ἄλλους, ἐπεὶ ἦ πολὺ φέρτερός ἐστιν.
ὣς οἳ μὲν τοιαῦτα πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἀγόρευον·
τῶν δ’ ὅσον ἐκ νηῶν ἀπὸ πύργου τάφρος ἔεργε
πλῆθεν ὁμῶς ἵππων τε καὶ ἀνδρῶν ἀσπιστάων
εἰλομένων· εἴλει δὲ θοῷ ἀτάλαντος Ἀρηϊ
Ἕκτωρ Πριαμίδης, ὅτε οἱ Ζεὺς κῦδος ἔδωκε.
καί νύ κ’ ἐνέπρησεν πυρὶ κηλέῳ νῆας ἐΐσας,
εἰ μὴ ἐπὶ φρεσὶ θῆκ’ Ἀγαμέμνονι πότνια Ἥρη
αὐτῷ ποιπνύσαντι θοῶς ὀτρῦναι Ἀχαιούς.
βῆ δ’ ἰέναι παρά τε κλισίας καὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
πορφύρεον μέγα φᾶρος ἔχων ἐν χειρὶ παχείῃ,
στῆ δ’ ἐπ’ Ὀδυσσῆος μεγακήτεϊ νηῒ μελαίνῃ,
ἥ ῥ’ ἐν μεσσάτῳ ἔσκε γεγωνέμεν ἀμφοτέρωσε,
ἠμὲν ἐπ’ Αἴαντος κλισίας Τελαμωνιάδαο
ἠδ’ ἐπ’ Ἀχιλλῆος, τοί ῥ’ ἔσχατα νῆας ἐΐσας
εἴρυσαν, ἠνορέῃ πίσυνοι καὶ κάρτεϊ χειρῶν·
ἤϋσεν δὲ διαπρύσιον Δαναοῖσι γεγωνώς·
αἰδὼς Ἀργεῖοι, κάκ’ ἐλέγχεα, εἶδος ἀγητοί·
πῇ ἔβαν εὐχωλαί, ὅτε δὴ φάμεν εἶναι ἄριστοι,
ἃς ὀπότ’ ἐν Λήμνῳ κενεαυχέες ἠγοράασθε,
ἔσθοντες κρέα πολλὰ βοῶν ὀρθοκραιράων
πίνοντες κρητῆρας ἐπιστεφέας οἴνοιο,
Τρώων ἄνθ’ ἑκατόν τε διηκοσίων τε ἕκαστος
στήσεσθ’ ἐν πολέμῳ· νῦν δ’ οὐδ’ ἑνὸς ἄξιοί εἰμεν
Ἕκτορος, ὃς τάχα νῆας ἐνιπρήσει πυρὶ κηλέῳ.
Ζεῦ πάτερ, ἦ ῥά τιν’ ἤδη ὑπερμενέων βασιλήων
τῇδ’ ἄτῃ ἄασας καί μιν μέγα κῦδος ἀπηύρας;
οὐ μὲν δή ποτέ φημι τεὸν περικαλλέα βωμὸν
νηῒ πολυκλήϊδι παρελθέμεν ἐνθάδε ἔρρων,
ἀλλ’ ἐπὶ πᾶσι βοῶν δημὸν καὶ μηρί’ ἔκηα

8.241

ἱέμενος Τροίην εὐτείχεον ἐξαλαπάξαι.
ἀλλὰ Ζεῦ τόδε πέρ μοι ἐπικρήηνον ἐέλδωρ·
αὐτοὺς δή περ ἔασον ὑπεκφυγέειν καὶ ἀλύξαι,
μηδ’ οὕτω Τρώεσσιν ἔα δάμνασθαι Ἀχαιούς.
ὣς φάτο, τὸν δὲ πατὴρ ὀλοφύρατο δάκρυ χέοντα,
νεῦσε δέ οἱ λαὸν σόον ἔμμεναι οὐδ’ ἀπολέσθαι.
αὐτίκα δ’ αἰετὸν ἧκε τελειότατον πετεηνῶν,
νεβρὸν ἔχοντ’ ὀνύχεσσι τέκος ἐλάφοιο ταχείης·
πὰρ δὲ Διὸς βωμῷ περικαλλέϊ κάββαλε νεβρόν,
ἔνθα πανομφαίῳ Ζηνὶ ῥέζεσκον Ἀχαιοί.

οἳ δ’ ὡς οὖν εἴδονθ’ ὅ τ’ ἄρ’ ἐκ Διὸς ἤλυθεν ὄρνις,
μᾶλλον ἐπὶ Τρώεσσι θόρον, μνήσαντο δὲ χάρμης.
ἔνθ’ οὔ τις πρότερος Δαναῶν πολλῶν περ ἐόντων
εὔξατο Τυδεΐδαο πάρος σχέμεν ὠκέας ἵππους
τάφρου τ’ ἐξελάσαι καὶ ἐναντίβιον μαχέσασθαι,
ἀλλὰ πολὺ πρῶτος Τρώων ἕλεν ἄνδρα κορυστὴν
Φραδμονίδην Ἀγέλαον· ὃ μὲν φύγαδ’ ἔτραπεν ἵππους·
τῷ δὲ μεταστρεφθέντι μεταφρένῳ ἐν δόρυ πῆξεν
ὤμων μεσσηγύς, διὰ δὲ στήθεσφιν ἔλασσεν·
ἤριπε δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων, ἀράβησε δὲ τεύχε’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ.
τὸν δὲ μετ’ Ἀτρεΐδαι Ἀγαμέμνων καὶ Μενέλαος,
τοῖσι δ’ ἐπ’ Αἴαντες θοῦριν ἐπιειμένοι ἀλκήν,
τοῖσι δ’ ἐπ’ Ἰδομενεὺς καὶ ὀπάων Ἰδομενῆος
Μηριόνης ἀτάλαντος Ἐνυαλίῳ ἀνδρειφόντῃ,
τοῖσι δ’ ἐπ’ Εὐρύπυλος Εὐαίμονος ἀγλαὸς υἱός·
Τεῦκρος δ’ εἶνατος ἦλθε παλίντονα τόξα τιταίνων,
στῆ δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπ’ Αἴαντος σάκεϊ Τελαμωνιάδαο.
ἔνθ’ Αἴας μὲν ὑπεξέφερεν σάκος· αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἥρως
παπτήνας, ἐπεὶ ἄρ τιν’ ὀϊστεύσας ἐν ὁμίλῳ
βεβλήκοι, ὃ μὲν αὖθι πεσὼν ἀπὸ θυμὸν ὄλεσσεν,
There was no man of all the many Danaans who could then boast that he had driven his horses over the trench and gone forth to fight sooner than the son of Tydeus; long before any one else could do so he slew an armed warrior of the Trojans, Agelaos the son of Phradmon. He had turned his horses in flight, but the spear struck him in the back midway between his shoulders and went right through his chest, and his armor rang rattling round him as he fell forward from his chariot. After him came Agamemnon and Menelaos, sons of Atreus, the two Ajaxes clothed in valor as with a garment, Idomeneus and his companion in arms Meriones, peer of murderous Ares, and Eurypylos the brave son of Euaemon. Ninth came Teucer with his bow, and took his place under cover of the shield of Ajax son of Telamon. When Ajax lifted his shield Teucer would peer round, and when he had hit any one in the throng, the man would fall dead; then Teucer would hie back to Ajax as a child to its mother, and again duck down under his shield. Which of the Trojans did brave Teucer first kill? Orsilokhos, and then Ormenos and Ophelestes, Daitor, Chromios, and godlike Lykophontes, Amopaon son of Polyaimon, and Melanippos. these in turn did he lay low upon the earth, and King Agamemnon was glad when he saw him making havoc of the Trojans with his mighty bow. He went up to him and said, "Teucer, man after my own heart, son of Telamon, leader among the host, shoot on, and be at once the saving of the Danaans and the glory of your father Telamon, who brought you up and took care of you in his own house when you were a child, bastard though you were. Cover him with glory though he is far off; I will promise and I will assuredly perform; if aegis-bearing Zeus and Athena grant me to sack the city of Ilion, you shall have the next best prize of honor after my own - a tripod, or two horses with their chariot, or a woman who shall go up into your bed." And Teucer answered, "Most noble son of Atreus, you need not urge me; from the moment we began to drive them back to Ilion, I have never ceased so far as in me lies to look out for men whom I can shoot and kill; I have shot eight barbed shafts, and all of them have been buried in the flesh of warlike youths, but this mad dog I cannot hit." As he spoke he aimed another arrow straight at Hektor, for he was bent on hitting him; nevertheless he missed him, and the arrow hit Priam's brave son Gorgythion in the breast. His mother, fair Kastianeira, lovely as a goddess, had been married from Aisyme, and now he bowed his head as a garden poppy in full bloom when it is weighed down by showers in spring- even thus heavy bowed his head beneath the weight of his helmet. Again he aimed at Hektor, for he was longing to hit

him, and again his arrow missed, for Apollo turned it aside; but he hit Hektor's brave charioteer Arkheptolemos in the breast, by the nipple, as he was driving furiously into the fight. The horses swerved aside as he fell headlong from the chariot, and there was no life-breath [psukhê] left in him. Hektor was greatly grieved at the loss of his charioteer, but for all his sorrow [akhos] he let him lie where he fell, and bade his brother Kebriones, who was hard by, take the reins. Kebriones did as he had said. Hektor thereon with a loud cry sprang from his chariot to the ground, and seizing a great stone made straight for Teucer with intent kill him. Teucer had just taken an arrow from his quiver and had laid it upon the bow-string, but Hektor struck him with the jagged stone as he was taking aim and drawing the string to his shoulder; he hit him just where the collar-bone divides the neck from the chest, a very deadly place, and broke the sinew of his arm so that his wrist was less, and the bow dropped from his hand as he fell forward on his knees. Ajax saw that his brother had fallen, and running towards him bestrode him and sheltered him with his shield. Meanwhile his two trusty squires, Mekisteus son of Echios, and Alastor, came up and bore him to the ships groaning in his great pain. glad when he saw Zeus now again put heart into the Trojans, and they drove the Achaeans to their deep trench with Hektor in all his glory at their head. As a hound grips a wild boar or lion in flank or buttock when he gives him chase, and watches warily for his wheeling, even so did Hektor follow close upon the Achaeans, ever killing the hindmost as they rushed panic-stricken onwards. When they had fled through the set stakes and trench and many Achaeans had been laid low at the hands of the Trojans,

8.271

271 αὐτὰρ ὃ αὖτις ἰὼν πάϊς ὣς ὑπὸ μητέρα δύσκεν
272 εἰς Αἴανθ’· ὃ δέ μιν σάκεϊ κρύπτασκε φαεινῷ.
273 ἔνθα τίνα πρῶτον Τρώων ἔλε Τεῦκρος ἀμύμων;
274 Ὀρσίλοχον μὲν πρῶτα καὶ Ὄρμενον ἠδ’ Ὀφελέστην
275 Δαίτορά τε Χρομίον τε καὶ ἀντίθεον Λυκοφόντην
276 καὶ Πολυαιμονίδην Ἀμοπάονα καὶ Μελάνιππον,
277 πάντας ἐπασσυτέρους πέλασε χθονὶ πουλυβοτείρῃ.
278 τὸν δὲ ἰδὼν γήθησεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων
279 τόξου ἄπο κρατεροῦ Τρώων ὀλέκοντα φάλαγγας·
280 στῆ δὲ παρ’ αὐτὸν ἰὼν καί μιν πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπε·
281 Τεῦκρε φίλη κεφαλή, Τελαμώνιε κοίρανε λαῶν
282 βάλλ’ οὕτως, αἴ κέν τι φόως Δαναοῖσι γένηαι
283 πατρί τε σῷ Τελαμῶνι, ὅ σ’ ἔτρεφε τυτθὸν ἐόντα,
284 καί σε νόθον περ ἐόντα κομίσσατο ᾧ ἐνὶ οἴκῳ·
285 τὸν καὶ τηλόθ’ ἐόντα ἐϋκλείης ἐπίβησον.
286 σοὶ δ’ ἐγὼ ἐξερέω ὡς καὶ τετελεσμένον ἔσται·
287 αἴ κέν μοι δώῃ Ζεύς τ’ αἰγίοχος καὶ Ἀθήνη
288 Ἰλίου ἐξαλαπάξαι ἐϋκτίμενον πτολίεθρον,
289 πρώτῳ τοι μετ’ ἐμὲ πρεσβήϊον ἐν χερὶ θήσω,
290 ἢ τρίποδ’ ἠὲ δύω ἵππους αὐτοῖσιν ὄχεσφιν
291 ἠὲ γυναῖχ’, ἥ κέν τοι ὁμὸν λέχος εἰσαναβαίνοι.
292 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσεφώνεε Τεῦκρος ἀμύμων·
293 Ἀτρεΐδη κύδιστε τί με σπεύδοντα καὶ αὐτὸν
294 ὀτρύνεις; οὐ μέν τοι ὅση δύναμίς γε πάρεστι
295 παύομαι, ἀλλ’ ἐξ οὗ προτὶ Ἴλιον ὡσάμεθ’ αὐτοὺς
296 ἐκ τοῦ δὴ τόξοισι δεδεγμένος ἄνδρας ἐναίρω.
297 ὀκτὼ δὴ προέηκα τανυγλώχινας ὀϊστούς,
298 πάντες δ’ ἐν χροῒ πῆχθεν ἀρηϊθόων αἰζηῶν·
299 τοῦτον δ’ οὐ δύναμαι βαλέειν κύνα λυσσητῆρα.

ἦ ῥα καὶ ἄλλον ὀϊστὸν ἀπὸ νευρῆφιν ἴαλλεν

8.301

Ἕκτορος ἀντικρύ, βαλέειν δέ ἑ ἴετο θυμός·
καὶ τοῦ μέν ῥ’ ἀφάμαρθ’, ὃ δ’ ἀμύμονα Γοργυθίωνα
υἱὸν ἐὺν Πριάμοιο κατὰ στῆθος βάλεν ἰῷ,
τόν ῥ’ ἐξ Αἰσύμηθεν ὀπυιομένη τέκε μήτηρ
καλὴ Καστιάνειρα δέμας ἐϊκυῖα θεῇσι.
μήκων δ’ ὡς ἑτέρωσε κάρη βάλεν, ἤ τ’ ἐνὶ κήπῳ
καρπῷ βριθομένη νοτίῃσί τε εἰαρινῇσιν,
ὣς ἑτέρωσ’ ἤμυσε κάρη πήληκι βαρυνθέν.
Τεῦκρος δ’ ἄλλον ὀϊστὸν ἀπὸ νευρῆφιν ἴαλλεν
Ἕκτορος ἀντικρύ, βαλέειν δέ ἑ ἴετο θυμός.
ἀλλ’ ὅ γε καὶ τόθ’ ἅμαρτε· παρέσφηλεν γὰρ Ἀπόλλων·
ἀλλ’ Ἀρχεπτόλεμον θρασὺν Ἕκτορος ἡνιοχῆα
ἱέμενον πόλεμον δὲ βάλε στῆθος παρὰ μαζόν·
ἤριπε δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων, ὑπερώησαν δέ οἱ ἵπποι
ὠκύποδες· τοῦ δ’ αὖθι λύθη ψυχή τε μένος τε.
Ἕκτορα δ’ αἰνὸν ἄχος πύκασε φρένας ἡνιόχοιο·
τὸν μὲν ἔπειτ’ εἴασε καὶ ἀχνύμενός περ ἑταίρου,
Κεβριόνην δ’ ἐκέλευσεν ἀδελφεὸν ἐγγὺς ἐόντα
ἵππων ἡνί’ ἐλεῖν· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ οὐκ ἀπίθησεν ἀκούσας.
αὐτὸς δ’ ἐκ δίφροιο χαμαὶ θόρε παμφανόωντος
σμερδαλέα ἰάχων· ὃ δὲ χερμάδιον λάβε χειρί,
βῆ δ’ ἰθὺς Τεύκρου, βαλέειν δέ ἑ θυμὸς ἀνώγει.
ἤτοι ὃ μὲν φαρέτρης ἐξείλετο πικρὸν ὀϊστόν,
θῆκε δ’ ἐπὶ νευρῇ· τὸν δ’ αὖ κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ
αὐερύοντα παρ’ ὦμον, ὅθι κληῖς ἀποέργει
αὐχένα τε στῆθός τε, μάλιστα δὲ καίριόν ἐστι,
τῇ ῥ’ ἐπὶ οἱ μεμαῶτα βάλεν λίθῳ ὀκριόεντι,
ῥῆξε δέ οἱ νευρήν· νάρκησε δὲ χεὶρ ἐπὶ καρπῷ,
στῆ δὲ γνὺξ ἐριπών, τόξον δέ οἱ ἔκπεσε χειρός.
Αἴας δ’ οὐκ ἀμέλησε κασιγνήτοιο πεσόντος,

8.331

ἀλλὰ θέων περίβη καί οἱ σάκος ἀμφεκάλυψε.
τὸν μὲν ἔπειθ’ ὑποδύντε δύω ἐρίηρες ἑταῖροι
Μηκιστεὺς Ἐχίοιο πάϊς καὶ δῖος Ἀλάστωρ
νῆας ἔπι γλαφυρὰς φερέτην βαρέα στενάχοντα.
ἂψ δ’ αὖτις Τρώεσσιν Ὀλύμπιος ἐν μένος ὦρσεν·
οἳ δ’ ἰθὺς τάφροιο βαθείης ὦσαν Ἀχαιούς·
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ἐν πρώτοισι κίε σθένεϊ βλεμεαίνων.
ὡς δ’ ὅτε τίς τε κύων συὸς ἀγρίου ἠὲ λέοντος
ἅπτηται κατόπισθε ποσὶν ταχέεσσι διώκων
ἰσχία τε γλουτούς τε, ἑλισσόμενόν τε δοκεύει,
ὣς Ἕκτωρ ὤπαζε κάρη κομόωντας Ἀχαιούς,
αἰὲν ἀποκτείνων τὸν ὀπίστατον· οἳ δὲ φέβοντο.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ διά τε σκόλοπας καὶ τάφρον ἔβησαν
φεύγοντες, πολλοὶ δὲ δάμεν Τρώων ὑπὸ χερσίν,
οἳ μὲν δὴ παρὰ νηυσὶν ἐρητύοντο μένοντες,

346 ἀλλήλοισί τε κεκλόμενοι καὶ πᾶσι θεοῖσι
347 χεῖρας ἀνίσχοντες μεγάλ’ εὐχετόωντο ἕκαστος·
348 Ἕκτωρ δ’ ἀμφιπεριστρώφα καλλίτριχας ἵππους
349 Γοργοῦς ὄμματ’ ἔχων ἠδὲ βροτολοιγοῦ Ἄρηος.
350 τοὺς δὲ ἰδοῦσ’ ἐλέησε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη,
351 αἶψα δ’ Ἀθηναίην ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
352 ὢ πόποι αἰγιόχοιο Διὸς τέκος οὐκέτι νῶϊ
353 ὀλλυμένων Δαναῶν κεκαδησόμεθ’ ὑστάτιόν περ;
354 οἵ κεν δὴ κακὸν οἶτον ἀναπλήσαντες ὄλωνται
355 ἀνδρὸς ἑνὸς ῥιπῇ, ὃ δὲ μαίνεται οὐκέτ’ ἀνεκτῶς
356 Ἕκτωρ Πριαμίδης, καὶ δὴ κακὰ πολλὰ ἔοργε.
357 τὴν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·
358 καὶ λίην οὗτός γε μένος θυμόν τ’ ὀλέσειε
359 χερσὶν ὑπ’ Ἀργείων φθίμενος ἐν πατρίδι γαίῃ·
360 ἀλλὰ πατὴρ οὐμὸς φρεσὶ μαίνεται οὐκ ἀγαθῇσι
they halted at their ships, calling upon one another and praying every man instantly as they lifted up their hands to the gods; but Hektor wheeled his horses this way and that, his eyes glaring like those of Gorgo or murderous Ares. Hera when she saw them had pity upon them, and at once said to Athena, "Alas, child of aegis-bearing Zeus, shall you and I take no more thought for the dying Danaans, though it be the last time we ever do so? See how they perish and come to a bad end before the onset of but a single man. Hektor the son of Priam rages with intolerable fury, and has already done great mischief." Athena answered, "Would, indeed, this man might die in his own land, and fall by the hands of the Achaeans; but my father Zeus is mad with spleen, ever foiling me, ever headstrong and unjust. He forgets how often I saved his son when he was worn out by the labors [athloi] Eurystheus had laid on him. He would weep till his cry came up to heaven, and then Zeus would send me down to help him; if I had had the sense to foresee all this, when Eurystheus sent him to the house of Hades, to fetch the hell-hound from Erebos, he would never have come back alive out of the deep waters of the river Styx. And now Zeus hates me, while he lets Thetis have her way because she kissed his knees and took hold of his beard, when she was begging him to do honor to Achilles. I shall know what to do next time he begins calling me his gray-eyed darling. Get our horses ready, while I go within the house of aegis-bearing Zeus and put on my armor; we shall then find out whether Priam's son Hektor will be glad to meet us in the highways of battle, or whether the Trojans will glut hounds and vultures with the fat of their flesh as they he dead by the ships of the Achaeans." Thus did she speak and white-armed Hera, daughter of great Kronos, obeyed her words; she set about harnessing her gold-bedizened steeds, while Athena daughter of aegis-bearing Zeus flung her richly vesture, made with her own hands, on to the threshold of her father, and donned the shirt of Zeus, arming herself for battle. Then she stepped into her flaming chariot, and grasped the spear so stout and sturdy and strong with which she quells the ranks of heroes who have displeased her. Hera lashed her horses, and the gates of heaven bellowed as they flew open of their own accord- gates over which the Hours preside, in whose hands are heaven and Olympus, either to open the dense cloud that hides them or to close it. Through these the goddesses drove their obedient steeds. But father Zeus when he saw them from Ida was very angry, and sent winged Iris with a message to them. "Go," said he, "fleet Iris, turn them back, and see that they do not come near me, for if we come to fighting there will be mischief. This is what I say, and this is what I mean to do. I will lame their horses for them; I will hurl them from their chariot, and will break it in pieces. It will take them all ten years to heal the wounds my lightning shall inflict upon them; my gray-eyed daughter will then learn what quarreling with her father means. I am less surprised and angry with Hera, for whatever I say she always contradicts me." With this Iris went her way, fleet as the

wind, from the heights of Ida to the lofty summits of Olympus. She met the goddesses at the outer gates of its many valleys and gave them her message. "What," said she, "are you about? Are you mad? The son of Kronos forbids going. This is what he says, and this is he means to do, he will lame your horses for you, he will hurl you from your chariot, and will break it in pieces. It will take you all ten years to heal the wounds his lightning will inflict upon you, that you may learn, gray-eyed goddess, what quarreling with your father means. He is less hurt and angry with Hera, for whatever he says she always contradicts him but you, bold hussy, will you really dare to raise your huge spear in defiance of Zeus?" With this she left them, and Hera said to Athena, "Of a truth, child of aegis-bearing Zeus, I am not for fighting men's battles further in defiance of Zeus. Let them live or die as luck will have it, and let Zeus mete out his judgments upon the Trojans and Danaans according to his own pleasure."

8.361

361 σχέτλιος, αἰὲν ἀλιτρός, ἐμῶν μενέων ἀπερωεύς·
362 οὐδέ τι τῶν μέμνηται, ὅ οἱ μάλα πολλάκις υἱὸν
363 τειρόμενον σώεσκον ὑπ’ Εὐρυσθῆος ἀέθλων.
364 ἤτοι ὃ μὲν κλαίεσκε πρὸς οὐρανόν, αὐτὰρ ἐμὲ Ζεὺς
365 τῷ ἐπαλεξήσουσαν ἀπ’ οὐρανόθεν προΐαλλεν.
366 εἰ γὰρ ἐγὼ τάδε ᾔδε’ ἐνὶ φρεσὶ πευκαλίμῃσιν
367 εὖτέ μιν εἰς Ἀΐδαο πυλάρταο προὔπεμψεν
368 ἐξ Ἐρέβευς ἄξοντα κύνα στυγεροῦ Ἀΐδαο,
369 οὐκ ἂν ὑπεξέφυγε Στυγὸς ὕδατος αἰπὰ ῥέεθρα.
370 νῦν δ’ ἐμὲ μὲν στυγέει, Θέτιδος δ’ ἐξήνυσε βουλάς,
371 ἥ οἱ γούνατ’ ἔκυσσε καὶ ἔλλαβε χειρὶ γενείου,
372 λισσομένη τιμῆσαι Ἀχιλλῆα πτολίπορθον.
373 ἔσται μὰν ὅτ’ ἂν αὖτε φίλην γλαυκώπιδα εἴπῃ.
374 ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν νῦν νῶϊν ἐπέντυε μώνυχας ἵππους,
375 ὄφρ’ ἂν ἐγὼ καταδῦσα Διὸς δόμον αἰγιόχοιο
376 τεύχεσιν ἐς πόλεμον θωρήξομαι, ὄφρα ἴδωμαι
377 ἢ νῶϊ Πριάμοιο πάϊς κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ
378 γηθήσει προφανέντε ἀνὰ πτολέμοιο γεφύρας,
379 ἦ τις καὶ Τρώων κορέει κύνας ἠδ’ οἰωνοὺς
380 δημῷ καὶ σάρκεσσι, πεσὼν ἐπὶ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν.
381 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη.
382 ἣ μὲν ἐποιχομένη χρυσάμπυκας ἔντυεν ἵππους
383 Ἥρη πρέσβα θεὰ θυγάτηρ μεγάλοιο Κρόνοιο·
384 αὐτὰρ Ἀθηναίη κούρη Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο
385 πέπλον μὲν κατέχευεν ἐανὸν πατρὸς ἐπ’ οὔδει
386 ποικίλον, ὅν ῥ’ αὐτὴ ποιήσατο καὶ κάμε χερσίν,
387 ἣ δὲ χιτῶν’ ἐνδῦσα Διὸς νεφεληγερέταο
388 τεύχεσιν ἐς πόλεμον θωρήσσετο δακρυόεντα.
389 ἐς δ’ ὄχεα φλόγεα ποσὶ βήσετο, λάζετο δ’ ἔγχος
390 βριθὺ μέγα στιβαρόν, τῷ δάμνησι στίχας ἀνδρῶν

8.391

391 ἡρώων, τοῖσίν τε κοτέσσεται ὀβριμοπάτρη.
392 Ἥρη δὲ μάστιγι θοῶς ἐπεμαίετ’ ἄρ’ ἵππους·
393 αὐτόμαται δὲ πύλαι μύκον οὐρανοῦ ἂς ἔχον Ὧραι,
394 τῇς ἐπιτέτραπται μέγας οὐρανὸς Οὔλυμπός τε

ἡμὲν ἀνακλῖναι πυκινὸν νέφος ἠδ’ ἐπιθεῖναι.
τῇ ῥα δι’ αὐτάων κεντρηνεκέας ἔχον ἵππους.
Ζεὺς δὲ πατὴρ Ἴδηθεν ἐπεὶ ἴδε χώσατ’ ἄρ’ αἰνῶς,
Ἶριν δ’ ὄτρυνε χρυσόπτερον ἀγγελέουσαν·
βάσκ’ ἴθι Ἶρι ταχεῖα, πάλιν τρέπε μηδ’ ἔα ἄντην
ἔρχεσθ’· οὐ γὰρ καλὰ συνοισόμεθα πτόλεμον δέ.
ὧδε γὰρ ἐξερέω, τὸ δὲ καὶ τετελεσμένον ἔσται·
γυιώσω μέν σφωϊν ὑφ’ ἅρμασιν ὠκέας ἵππους,
αὐτὰς δ’ ἐκ δίφρου βαλέω κατά θ’ ἅρματα ἄξω·
οὐδέ κεν ἐς δεκάτους περιτελλομένους ἐνιαυτοὺς
ἕλκε’ ἀπαλθήσεσθον, ἅ κεν μάρπτῃσι κεραυνός·
ὄφρα ἰδῇ γλαυκῶπις ὅτ’ ἂν ᾧ πατρὶ μάχηται.
Ἥρῃ δ’ οὔ τι τόσον νεμεσίζομαι οὐδὲ χολοῦμαι·
αἰεὶ γάρ μοι ἔωθεν ἐνικλᾶν ὅττί κεν εἴπω.
ὣς ἔφατ’, ὦρτο δὲ Ἶρις ἀελλόπος ἀγγελέουσα,
βῆ δ’ ἐξ Ἰδαίων ὀρέων ἐς μακρὸν Ὄλυμπον.
πρώτῃσιν δὲ πύλῃσι πολυπτύχου Οὐλύμποιο
ἀντομένη κατέρυκε, Διὸς δέ σφ’ ἔννεπε μῦθον·
πῇ μέματον; τί σφῶϊν ἐνὶ φρεσὶ μαίνεται ἦτορ;
οὐκ ἐάᾳ Κρονίδης ἐπαμυνέμεν Ἀργείοισιν.
ὧδε γὰρ ἠπείλησε Κρόνου πάϊς, ᾗ τελέει περ,
γυιώσειν μὲν σφῶϊν ὑφ’ ἅρμασιν ὠκέας ἵππους,
αὐτὰς δ’ ἐκ δίφρου βαλέειν κατά θ’ ἅρματα ἄξειν·
οὐδέ κεν ἐς δεκάτους περιτελλομένους ἐνιαυτοὺς
ἕλκε’ ἀπαλθήσεσθον, ἅ κεν μάρπτῃσι κεραυνός·
ὄφρα ἰδῇς γλαυκῶπι ὅτ’ ἂν σῷ πατρὶ μάχηαι.

8.421

Ἥρῃ δ’ οὔ τι τόσον νεμεσίζεται οὐδὲ χολοῦται·
αἰεὶ γάρ οἱ ἔωθεν ἐνικλᾶν ὅττι κεν εἴπῃ·
ἀλλὰ σύ γ’ αἰνοτάτη κύον ἀδεὲς εἰ ἐτεόν γε
τολμήσεις Διὸς ἄντα πελώριον ἔγχος ἀεῖραι.
ἦ μὲν ἄρ’ ὣς εἰποῦσ’ ἀπέβη πόδας ὠκέα Ἶρις,
αὐτὰρ Ἀθηναίην Ἥρη πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν·
ὢ πόποι αἰγιόχοιο Διὸς τέκος, οὐκέτ’ ἔγωγε
νῶϊ ἐῶ Διὸς ἄντα βροτῶν ἕνεκα πτολεμίζειν·
τῶν ἄλλος μὲν ἀποφθίσθω, ἄλλος δὲ βιώτω,
ὅς κε τύχῃ· κεῖνος δὲ τὰ ἃ φρονέων ἐνὶ θυμῷ
Τρωσί τε καὶ Δαναοῖσι δικαζέτω, ὡς ἐπιεικές.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσασα πάλιν τρέπε μώνυχας ἵππους·
τῇσιν δ’ Ὧραι μὲν λῦσαν καλλίτριχας ἵππους,
καὶ τοὺς μὲν κατέδησαν ἐπ’ ἀμβροσίῃσι κάπῃσιν,
ἅρματα δ’ ἔκλιναν πρὸς ἐνώπια παμφανόωντα·
αὐταὶ δὲ χρυσέοισιν ἐπὶ κλισμοῖσι κάθιζον
μίγδ’ ἄλλοισι θεοῖσι, φίλον τετιημέναι ἦτορ.
Ζεὺς δὲ πατὴρ Ἴδηθεν ἐΰτροχον ἅρμα καὶ ἵππους
Οὔλυμπον δὲ δίωκε, θεῶν δ’ ἐξίκετο θώκους.
τῷ δὲ καὶ ἵππους μὲν λῦσε κλυτὸς ἐννοσίγαιος,
ἅρματα δ’ ἂμ βωμοῖσι τίθει κατὰ λῖτα πετάσσας·
αὐτὸς δὲ χρύσειον ἐπὶ θρόνον εὐρύοπα Ζεὺς
ἕζετο, τῷ δ’ ὑπὸ ποσσὶ μέγας πελεμίζετ’ Ὄλυμπος.

444 αἳ δ’ οἷαι Διὸς ἀμφὶς Ἀθηναίη τε καὶ Ἥρη
445 ἧσθην, οὐδέ τί μιν προσεφώνεον οὐδ’ ἐρέοντο·
446 αὐτὰρ ὃ ἔγνω ᾗσιν ἐνὶ φρεσὶ φώνησέν τε·
447 τίφθ’ οὕτω τετίησθον Ἀθηναίη τε καὶ Ἥρη;
448 οὐ μέν θην κάμετόν γε μάχῃ ἔνι κυδιανείρῃ
449 ὀλλῦσαι Τρῶας, τοῖσιν κότον αἰνὸν ἔθεσθε.
450 πάντως, οἷον ἐμόν γε μένος καὶ χεῖρες ἄαπτοι,
She turned her steeds; the Hours presently unyoked them, made them fast to their ambrosial mangers, and leaned the chariot against the end wall of the courtyard. The two goddesses then sat down upon their golden thrones, amid the company of the other gods; but they were very angry. Presently father Zeus drove his chariot to Olympus, and entered the assembly of gods. The mighty lord of the earthquake unyoked his horses for him, set the car upon its stand, and threw a cloth over it. Zeus then sat down upon his golden throne and Olympus reeled beneath him. Athena and Hera sat alone, apart from Zeus, and neither spoke nor asked him questions, but Zeus knew what they meant, and said, "Athena and Hera, why are you so angry? Are you fatigued with killing so many of your dear friends the Trojans? Be this as it may, such is the might of my hands that all the gods in Olympus cannot turn me; you were both of you trembling all over ere ever you saw the fight and its terrible doings. I tell you therefore-and it would have surely been - I should have struck you with lighting, and your chariots would never have brought you back again to Olympus." Athena and Hera groaned in spirit as they sat side by side and brooded mischief for the Trojans. Athena sat silent without a word, for she was in a furious passion and bitterly incensed against her father; but Hera could not contain herself and said, "What, dread son of Kronos, are you talking about? We know how great your power is, nevertheless we have compassion upon the Danaan warriors who are perishing and coming to a bad end. We will, however, since you so bid us, refrain from actual fighting, but we will make serviceable suggestions to the Argives, that they may not all of them perish in your displeasure." And Zeus answered, "Tomorrow morning, Hera, if you choose to do so, you will see the son of Kronos destroying large numbers of the Argives, for fierce Hektor shall not cease fighting till he has roused the son of Peleus when they are fighting in dire straits at their ships' sterns about the body of Patroklos. Like it or no, this is how it is decreed; for I don't care, you may go to the lowest depths beneath earth and sea [pontos], where Iapetos and Kronos dwell in lone Tartaros with neither ray of light nor breath of wind to cheer them. You may go on and on till you get there, and I shall not care one whit for your displeasure; you are the greatest vixen living." Hera made him no answer. The sun's glorious orb now sank into Okeanos and drew down night over the land. Sorry indeed were the Trojans when light failed them, but welcome and thrice prayed for did darkness fall upon the Achaeans. Then Hektor led the Trojans back from the ships, and held a council on the open space near the river, where there was a spot ear corpses. They left their chariots and sat down on the ground to hear the speech he made them. He grasped a spear eleven cubits long, the bronze point of which gleamed in front of it, while the ring round the spear-head was of gold Spear in hand he spoke. "Hear me," said he, "Trojans, Dardanians, and allies. I deemed but now that I should destroy the ships and all the Achaeans with them ere I went back to Ilion, but darkness came on too soon. It was this alone that saved them and their ships upon the seashore. Now, therefore, let us obey the behests of night, and prepare our suppers. Take your horses out of their chariots and give them their feeds of grain; then make speed to bring sheep and cattle from the city; bring wine also and grain for your horses and gather much wood, that from dark till dawn we may burn watchfires whose flare may reach to heaven. For the Achaeans may try to flee beyond the sea by night, and they must not embark scatheless and unmolested; many a man among them must take a dart with him to nurse at home, hit with spear or arrow as he is leaping on board his ship, that others may

fear to bring war and weeping upon the Trojans. Moreover let the heralds tell it about the city that the growing youths and gray-bearded men are to camp upon its heaven-built walls. Let the women each of them light a great fire in her house, and let watch be safely kept lest the town be entered by surprise while the host is outside. See to it, brave Trojans, as I have said, and let this suffice for the moment; at daybreak I will instruct you further. I pray in hope to Zeus and to the gods that we may then drive those fate-sped hounds from our land, for ‘tis the fates that have borne them and their ships hither. This night, therefore, let us keep watch, but with early morning let us put on our armor and rouse fierce war at the ships of the Achaeans; I shall then know whether brave Diomedes the son of Tydeus will drive me back from the ships to the wall, or whether I shall myself slay him and carry off his bloodstained spoils. Tomorrow let him show his mettle [aretê], abide my spear if he dare. I ween that at break of day, he shall be among the first to fall and many another of his comrades round him. Would that I were as sure of being immortal and never growing old, and of being worshipped like Athena and Apollo, as I am that this day will bring evil to the Argives."

8.451

451 οὐκ ἄν με τρέψειαν ὅσοι θεοί εἰσ’ ἐν Ὀλύμπῳ.
452 σφῶϊν δὲ πρίν περ τρόμος ἔλλαβε φαίδιμα γυῖα
453 πρὶν πόλεμόν τε ἰδεῖν πολέμοιό τε μέρμερα ἔργα.
454 ὧδε γὰρ ἐξερέω, τὸ δέ κεν τετελεσμένον ἦεν·
455 οὐκ ἂν ἐφ’ ὑμετέρων ὀχέων πληγέντε κεραυνῷ
456 ἂψ ἐς Ὄλυμπον ἵκεσθον, ἵν’ ἀθανάτων ἕδος ἐστίν.
457 ὣς ἔφαθ’, αἳ δ’ ἐπέμυξαν Ἀθηναίη τε καὶ Ἥρη·
458 πλησίαι αἵ γ’ ἥσθην, κακὰ δὲ Τρώεσσι μεδέσθην.
459 ἤτοι Ἀθηναίη ἀκέων ἦν οὐδέ τι εἶπε
460 σκυζομένη Διὶ πατρί, χόλος δέ μιν ἄγριος ᾕρει·
461 Ἥρῃ δ’ οὐκ ἔχαδε στῆθος χόλον, ἀλλὰ προσηύδα·
462 αἰνότατε Κρονίδη ποῖον τὸν μῦθον ἔειπες.
463 εὖ νυ καὶ ἡμεῖς ἴδμεν ὅ τοι σθένος οὐκ ἀλαπαδνόν·
464 ἀλλ’ ἔμπης Δαναῶν ὀλοφυρόμεθ’ αἰχμητάων,
465 οἵ κεν δὴ κακὸν οἶτον ἀναπλήσαντες ὄλωνται.
466 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι πολέμου μὲν ἀφεξόμεθ’, εἰ σὺ κελεύεις·
467 βουλὴν δ’ Ἀργείοις ὑποθησόμεθ’ ἥ τις ὀνήσει,
468 ὡς μὴ πάντες ὄλωνται ὀδυσσαμένοιο τεοῖο.
469 τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
470 ἠοῦς δὴ καὶ μᾶλλον ὑπερμενέα Κρονίωνα
471 ὄψεαι, αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσθα, βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη
472 ὀλλύντ’ Ἀργείων πουλὺν στρατὸν αἰχμητάων·
473 οὐ γὰρ πρὶν πολέμου ἀποπαύσεται ὄβριμος Ἕκτωρ
474 πρὶν ὄρθαι παρὰ ναῦφι ποδώκεα Πηλεΐωνα,
475 ἤματι τῷ ὅτ’ ἂν οἳ μὲν ἐπὶ πρύμνῃσι μάχωνται
476 στείνει ἐν αἰνοτάτῳ περὶ Πατρόκλοιο θανόντος·
477 ὣς γὰρ θέσφατόν ἐστι· σέθεν δ’ ἐγὼ οὐκ ἀλεγίζω
478 χωομένης, οὐδ’ εἴ κε τὰ νείατα πείραθ’ ἵκηαι
479 γαίης καὶ πόντοιο, ἵν’ Ἰάπετός τε Κρόνος τε
480 ἥμενοι οὔτ’ αὐγῇς Ὑπερίονος Ἠελίοιο

8.481

481 τέρποντ’ οὔτ’ ἀνέμοισι, βαθὺς δέ τε Τάρταρος ἀμφίς·

οὐδ’ ἦν ἔνθ’ ἀφίκηαι ἀλωμένη, οὔ σευ ἔγωγε
σκυζομένης ἀλέγω, ἐπεὶ οὐ σέο κύντερον ἄλλο.
ὣς φάτο, τὸν δ’ οὔ τι προσέφη λευκώλενος Ἥρη.
ἐν δ’ ἔπεσ’ Ὠκεανῷ λαμπρὸν φάος ἠελίοιο
ἕλκον νύκτα μέλαιναν ἐπὶ ζείδωρον ἄρουραν.
Τρωσὶν μέν ῥ’ ἀέκουσιν ἔδυ φάος, αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοῖς
ἀσπασίη τρίλλιστος ἐπήλυθε νὺξ ἐρεβεννή.
Τρώων αὖτ’ ἀγορὴν ποιήσατο φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
νόσφι νεῶν ἀγαγὼν ποταμῷ ἔπι δινήεντι,
ἐν καθαρῷ ὅθι δὴ νεκύων διεφαίνετο χῶρος.
ἐξ ἵππων δ’ ἀποβάντες ἐπὶ χθόνα μῦθον ἄκουον
τόν ῥ’ Ἕκτωρ ἀγόρευε Διῒ φίλος· ἐν δ’ ἄρα χειρὶ
ἔγχος ἔχ’ ἐνδεκάπηχυ· πάροιθε δὲ λάμπετο δουρὸς
αἰχμὴ χαλκείη, περὶ δὲ χρύσεος θέε πόρκης,
τῷ ὅ γ’ ἐρεισάμενος ἔπεα Τρώεσσι μετηύδα·
κέκλυτέ μευ Τρῶες καὶ Δάρδανοι ἠδ’ ἐπίκουροι·
νῦν ἐφάμην νῆάς τ’ ὀλέσας καὶ πάντας Ἀχαιοὺς
ἂψ ἀπονοστήσειν προτὶ Ἴλιον ἠνεμόεσσαν·
ἀλλὰ πρὶν κνέφας ἦλθε, τὸ νῦν ἐσάωσε μάλιστα
Ἀργείους καὶ νῆας ἐπὶ ῥηγμῖνι θαλάσσης.
ἀλλ’ ἤτοι νῦν μὲν πειθώμεθα νυκτὶ μελαίνῃ
δόρπά τ’ ἐφοπλισόμεσθα· ἀτὰρ καλλίτριχας ἵππους
λύσαθ’ ὑπὲξ ὀχέων, παρὰ δέ σφισι βάλλετ’ ἐδωδήν·
ἐκ πόλιος δ’ ἄξεσθε βόας καὶ ἴφια μῆλα
καρπαλίμως, οἶνον δὲ μελίφρονα οἰνίζεσθε
σῖτόν τ’ ἐκ μεγάρων, ἐπὶ δὲ ξύλα πολλὰ λέγεσθε,
ὥς κεν παννύχιοι μέσφ’ ἠοῦς ἠριγενείης
καίωμεν πυρὰ πολλά, σέλας δ’ εἰς οὐρανὸν ἴκῃ,
μή πως καὶ διὰ νύκτα κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοὶ

8.511

φεύγειν ὁρμήσωνται ἐπ’ εὐρέα νῶτα θαλάσσης.
μὴ μὰν ἀσπουδί γε νεῶν ἐπιβαῖεν ἕκηλοι,
ἀλλ’ ὥς τις τούτων γε βέλος καὶ οἴκοθι πέσσῃ
βλήμενος ἢ ἰῷ ἢ ἔγχεϊ ὀξυόεντι
νηὸς ἐπιθρῴσκων, ἵνα τις στυγέῃσι καὶ ἄλλος
Τρωσὶν ἐφ’ ἱπποδάμοισι φέρειν πολύδακρυν Ἄρηα.
κήρυκες δ’ ἀνὰ ἄστυ Διῒ φίλοι ἀγγελλόντων
παῖδας πρωθήβας πολιοκροτάφους τε γέροντας
λέξασθαι περὶ ἄστυ θεοδμήτων ἐπὶ πύργων·
θηλύτεραι δὲ γυναῖκες ἐνὶ μεγάροισιν ἑκάστη
πῦρ μέγα καιόντων· φυλακὴ δέ τις ἔμπεδος ἔστω
μὴ λόχος εἰσέλθῃσι πόλιν λαῶν ἀπεόντων.
ὧδ’ ἔστω Τρῶες μεγαλήτορες ὡς ἀγορεύω·
μῦθος δ’ ὃς μὲν νῦν ὑγιὴς εἰρημένος ἔστω,
τὸν δ’ ἠοῦς Τρώεσσι μεθ’ ἱπποδάμοις ἀγορεύσω.
ἔλπομαι εὐχόμενος Διί τ’ ἄλλοισίν τε θεοῖσιν
ἐξελάαν ἐνθένδε κύνας κηρεσσιφορήτους,
οὓς κῆρες φορέουσι μελαινάων ἐπὶ νηῶν.
ἀλλ’ ἤτοι ἐπὶ νυκτὶ φυλάξομεν ἡμέας αὐτούς,
πρῶϊ δ’ ὑπηοῖοι σὺν τεύχεσι θωρηχθέντες

νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσιν ἐγείρομεν ὀξὺν Ἄρηα.
εἴσομαι εἴ κέ μ’ ὁ Τυδεΐδης κρατερὸς Διομήδης
πὰρ νηῶν πρὸς τεῖχος ἀπώσεται, ἦ κεν ἐγὼ τὸν
χαλκῷ δηώσας ἔναρα βροτόεντα φέρωμαι.
αὔριον ἢν ἀρετὴν διαείσεται, εἴ κ’ ἐμὸν ἔγχος
μείνῃ ἐπερχόμενον· ἀλλ’ ἐν πρώτοισιν ὀΐω
κείσεται οὐτηθείς, πολέες δ’ ἀμφ’ αὐτὸν ἑταῖροι
ἠελίου ἀνιόντος ἐς αὔριον· εἰ γὰρ ἐγὼν ὣς
εἴην ἀθάνατος καὶ ἀγήρως ἤματα πάντα,
τιοίμην δ’ ὡς τίετ’ Ἀθηναίη καὶ Ἀπόλλων,

8.541

ὡς νῦν ἡμέρη ἥδε κακὸν φέρει Ἀργείοισιν.
ὣς Ἕκτωρ ἀγόρευ’, ἐπὶ δὲ Τρῶες κελάδησαν.
οἳ δ’ ἵππους μὲν λῦσαν ὑπὸ ζυγοῦ ἱδρώοντας,
δῆσαν δ’ ἱμάντεσσι παρ’ ἅρμασιν οἷσιν ἕκαστος·
ἐκ πόλιος δ’ ἄξοντο βόας καὶ ἴφια μῆλα
καρπαλίμως, οἶνον δὲ μελίφρονα οἰνίζοντο,
σῖτόν τ’ ἐκ μεγάρων, ἐπὶ δὲ ξύλα πολλὰ λέγοντο.

κνίσην δ’ ἐκ πεδίου ἄνεμοι φέρον οὐρανὸν εἴσω.

οἳ δὲ μέγα φρονέοντες ἐπὶ πτολέμοιο γεφύρας
εἵατο παννύχιοι, πυρὰ δέ σφισι καίετο πολλά.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἐν οὐρανῷ ἄστρα φαεινὴν ἀμφὶ σελήνην
φαίνετ’ ἀριπρεπέα, ὅτε τ’ ἔπλετο νήνεμος αἰθήρ·
ἔκ τ’ ἔφανεν πᾶσαι σκοπιαὶ καὶ πρώονες ἄκροι
καὶ νάπαι· οὐρανόθεν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπερράγη ἄσπετος αἰθήρ,
πάντα δὲ εἴδεται ἄστρα, γέγηθε δέ τε φρένα ποιμήν·
τόσσα μεσηγὺ νεῶν ἠδὲ Ξάνθοιο ῥοάων
Τρώων καιόντων πυρὰ φαίνετο Ἰλιόθι πρό.
χίλι’ ἄρ’ ἐν πεδίῳ πυρὰ καίετο, πὰρ δὲ ἑκάστῳ
εἵατο πεντήκοντα σέλᾳ πυρὸς αἰθομένοιο.
ἵπποι δὲ κρῖ λευκὸν ἐρεπτόμενοι καὶ ὀλύρας
ἑσταότες παρ’ ὄχεσφιν ἐΰθρονον Ἠῶ μίμνον.

Thus spoke Hektor and the Trojans shouted approval. They took their sweating steeds from under the yoke, and made them fast each by his own chariot. They made haste to bring sheep and cattle from the city, they brought wine also and grain from their houses and gathered much wood. They then offered unblemished hecatombs to the immortals, and the wind carried the sweet savor of sacrifice to heaven - but the blessed gods partook not thereof, for they bitterly hated Ilion with Priam and Priam's people. Thus high in hope they sat through the livelong night by the highways of war, and many a watchfire did they kindle. As when the stars shine clear, and the moon is bright- there is not a breath of air, not a peak nor glade nor jutting headland but it stands out in the ineffable radiance that breaks from the serene of heaven; the stars can all of them be told and the heart of the shepherd is glad - even thus shone the watchfires of the Trojans before Ilion midway between the ships and the river Xanthos. A thousand camp-fires gleamed upon the plain, and in the glow of each there sat fifty men, while the horses, champing oats and wheat beside their chariots, waited till dawn should come.

9.1

ὣς οἱ μὲν Τρῶες φυλακὰς ἔχον· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὺς
θεσπεσίη ἔχε φύζα φόβου κρυόεντος ἑταίρη,
πένθεϊ δ’ ἀτλήτῳ βεβολήατο πάντες ἄριστοι.
ὡς δ’ ἄνεμοι δύο πόντον ὀρίνετον ἰχθυόεντα
Βορέης καὶ Ζέφυρος, τώ τε Θρῄκηθεν ἄητον
ἐλθόντ’ ἐξαπίνης· ἄμυδις δέ τε κῦμα κελαινὸν
κορθύεται, πολλὸν δὲ παρὲξ ἅλα φῦκος ἔχευεν·
ὣς ἐδαΐζετο θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν Ἀχαιῶν.
Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ἄχεϊ μεγάλῳ βεβολημένος ἦτορ
φοίτα κηρύκεσσι λιγυφθόγγοισι κελεύων
κλήδην εἰς ἀγορὴν κικλήσκειν ἄνδρα ἕκαστον,
μὴ δὲ βοᾶν· αὐτὸς δὲ μετὰ πρώτοισι πονεῖτο.
ἵζον δ’ εἰν ἀγορῇ τετιηότες· ἂν δ’ Ἀγαμέμνων
ἵστατο δάκρυ χέων ὥς τε κρήνη μελάνυδρος
ἥ τε κατ’ αἰγίλιπος πέτρης δνοφερὸν χέει ὕδωρ·
ὣς ὃ βαρὺ στενάχων ἔπε’ Ἀργείοισι μετηύδα·
ὦ φίλοι Ἀργείων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες
Ζεύς με μέγα Κρονίδης ἄτῃ ἐνέδησε βαρείῃ
σχέτλιος, ὃς τότε μέν μοι ὑπέσχετο καὶ κατένευσεν
Ἴλιον ἐκπέρσαντ’ εὐτείχεον ἀπονέεσθαι,
νῦν δὲ κακὴν ἀπάτην βουλεύσατο, καί με κελεύει
δυσκλέα Ἄργος ἱκέσθαι, ἐπεὶ πολὺν ὤλεσα λαόν.
οὕτω που Διὶ μέλλει ὑπερμενέϊ φίλον εἶναι,
ὃς δὴ πολλάων πολίων κατέλυσε κάρηνα
ἠδ’ ἔτι καὶ λύσει· τοῦ γὰρ κράτος ἐστὶ μέγιστον.
ἀλλ’ ἄγεθ’ ὡς ἂν ἐγὼ εἴπω πειθώμεθα πάντες·
φεύγωμεν σὺν νηυσὶ φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν·
οὐ γὰρ ἔτι Τροίην αἱρήσομεν εὐρυάγυιαν.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἀκὴν ἐγένοντο σιωπῇ.
δὴν δ’ ἄνεῳ ἦσαν τετιηότες υἷες Ἀχαιῶν·

Thus did the Trojans watch. But Panic, comrade of blood-stained Rout, had taken fast hold of the Achaeans and their princes were all of them in despair. As when the two winds that blow from Thrace - the north and the northwest - spring up of a sudden and rouse the fury of the main [pontos] - in a moment the dark waves uprear their heads and scatter their sea-wrack in all directions - even thus troubled were the hearts of the Achaeans. The son of Atreus in dismay bade the heralds call the people to a council man by man, but not to cry the matter aloud; he made haste also himself to call them, and they sat sorry at heart in their assembly. Agamemnon shed tears as it were a running stream or cataract on the side of some sheer cliff; and thus, with many a heavy sigh he spoke to the Achaeans. "My friends," said he, "princes and councilors, Zeus has tied down with ruin [atê] more than any other Argive. The cruel god gave me his solemn promise that I should sack the city of Troy before returning, but he has played me false, and is now bidding me go back to Argos with bad kleos and with the loss of many people. Such is the will of Zeus, who has laid many a proud city in the dust as he will yet lay others, for his power is above all. Now, therefore, let us all do as I say and sail back to our own country, for we shall not take Troy." Thus he spoke, and the sons of the Achaeans for a long while sat sorrowful there, but they all held their peace, till at last Diomedes of the loud battle-cry made answer saying, "Son of Atreus, I will chide your folly, as is my right [themis] in council. Be not then aggrieved that I should do so. In the first place you attacked me before all the Danaans and said that I was a coward and no warrior. The Argives young and old know that you did so. But the son of

scheming Kronos endowed you by halves only. He gave you honor as the chief ruler over us, but valor, which is the highest both right and might he did not give you. Sir, think you that the sons of the Achaeans are indeed as unwarlike and cowardly as you say they are? If your own mind is set upon going home - go - the way is open to you; the many ships that followed you from Mycenae stand ranged upon the seashore; but the rest of us stay here till we have sacked Troy. Nay though these too should turn homeward with their ships, Sthenelos and myself will still fight on till we reach the goal of Ilion, for heaven was with us when we came." The sons of the Achaeans shouted approval at the words of Diomedes, and presently Nestor rose to speak. "Son of Tydeus," said he, "in war your prowess is beyond question, and in council you excel all who are of your own years; no one of the Achaeans can make light of what you say nor gainsay it, but you have not yet come to the end [telos] of the whole matter. You are still young - you might be the youngest of my own children - still you have spoken wisely and have counseled the chief of the Achaeans not without discretion; nevertheless I am older than you and I will tell you every" thing; therefore let no man, not even King Agamemnon, disregard my saying, for he that foments civil discord is a clanless, hearthless outlaw. "Now, however, let us obey the behests of night and get our suppers, but let the sentinels every man of them camp by the trench that is without the wall. I am giving these instructions to the young men; when they have been attended to, do you, son of Atreus, give your orders, for you are the most royal among us all. Prepare a feast for your councilors; it is right and reasonable that you should do so; there is abundance of wine in your tents, which the ships of the Achaeans bring from Thrace daily over the sea [pontos]. You have everything at your disposal wherewith to entertain guests, and you have many subjects. When many are got together, you can be guided by him whose counsel is wisest - and sorely do we need shrewd and prudent counsel, for the foe has lit his watchfires hard by our ships. Who can be other than dismayed? This night will either be the ruin of our host, or save it." Thus did he speak, and they did even as he had said. The sentinels went out in their armor under command of Nestor's son Thrasymedes, a leader of the host, and of the bold warriors Askalaphos and Ialmenos: there were also Meriones, Aphareus and Deipyros, and the son of Kreion, noble Lykomedes. There were seven leaders of the sentinels, and with each there went a hundred youths armed with long spears: they took their places midway between the trench and the wall, and when they had done so they lit their fires and got every man his supper.

9.31

31 ὀψὲ δὲ δὴ μετέειπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
32 Ἀτρεΐδη σοὶ πρῶτα μαχήσομαι ἀφραδέοντι,
33 ἢ θέμις ἐστὶν ἄναξ ἀγορῇ· σὺ δὲ μή τι χολωθῇς.
34 ἀλκὴν μέν μοι πρῶτον ὀνείδισας ἐν Δαναοῖσι
35 φὰς ἔμεν ἀπτόλεμον καὶ ἀνάλκιδα· ταῦτα δὲ πάντα
36 ἴσασ’ Ἀργείων ἠμὲν νέοι ἠδὲ γέροντες.
37 σοὶ δὲ διάνδιχα δῶκε Κρόνου πάϊς ἀγκυλομήτεω·
38 σκήπτρῳ μέν τοι δῶκε τετιμῆσθαι περὶ πάντων,
39 ἀλκὴν δ’ οὔ τοι δῶκεν, ὅ τε κράτος ἐστὶ μέγιστον.
40 δαιμόνι’ οὕτω που μάλα ἔλπεαι υἷας Ἀχαιῶν
41 ἀπτολέμους τ’ ἔμεναι καὶ ἀνάλκιδας ὡς ἀγορεύεις;
42 εἰ δέ τοι αὐτῷ θυμὸς ἐπέσσυται ὥς τε νέεσθαι
43 ἔρχεο· πάρ τοι ὁδός, νῆες δέ τοι ἄγχι θαλάσσης
44 ἑστᾶσ’, αἵ τοι ἔποντο Μυκήνηθεν μάλα πολλαί.
45 ἀλλ’ ἄλλοι μενέουσι κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοὶ
46 εἰς ὅ κέ περ Τροίην διαπέρσομεν. εἰ δὲ καὶ αὐτοὶ
47 φευγόντων σὺν νηυσὶ φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν·

48 νῶϊ δ’ ἐγὼ Σθένελός τε μαχησόμεθ’ εἰς ὅ κε τέκμωρ
49 Ἰλίου εὔρωμεν· σὺν γὰρ θεῷ εἰλήλουθμεν.
50 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἐπίαχον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
51 μῦθον ἀγασσάμενοι Διομήδεος ἱπποδάμοιο.
52 τοῖσι δ’ ἀνιστάμενος μετεφώνεεν ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
53 Τυδεΐδη περὶ μὲν πολέμῳ ἔνι καρτερός ἐσσι,
54 καὶ βουλῇ μετὰ πάντας ὁμήλικας ἔπλευ ἄριστος.
55 οὔ τίς τοι τὸν μῦθον ὀνόσσεται ὅσσοι Ἀχαιοί,
56 οὐδὲ πάλιν ἐρέει· ἀτὰρ οὐ τέλος ἵκεο μύθων.
57 ἦ μὲν καὶ νέος ἐσσί, ἐμὸς δέ κε καὶ πάϊς εἴης
58 ὀπλότατος γενεῇφιν· ἀτὰρ πεπνυμένα βάζεις
59 Ἀργείων βασιλῆας, ἐπεὶ κατὰ μοῖραν ἔειπες.
60 ἀλλ’ ἄγ’ ἐγών, ὃς σεῖο γεραίτερος εὔχομαι εἶναι,

9.61

61 ἐξείπω καὶ πάντα διίξομαι· οὐδέ κέ τίς μοι
62 μῦθον ἀτιμήσει’, οὐδὲ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων.
63 ἀφρήτωρ ἀθέμιστος ἀνέστιός ἐστιν ἐκεῖνος
64 ὃς πολέμου ἔραται ἐπιδημίου ὀκρυόεντος.
65 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι νῦν μὲν πειθώμεθα νυκτὶ μελαίνῃ
66 δόρπά τ’ ἐφοπλισόμεσθα· φυλακτῆρες δὲ ἕκαστοι
67 λεξάσθων παρὰ τάφρον ὀρυκτὴν τείχεος ἐκτός.
68 κούροισιν μὲν ταῦτ’ ἐπιτέλλομαι· αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
69 Ἀτρεΐδη σὺ μὲν ἄρχε· σὺ γὰρ βασιλεύτατός ἐσσι.
70 δαίνυ δαῖτα γέρουσιν· ἔοικέ τοι, οὔ τοι ἀεικές.
71 πλεῖαί τοι οἴνου κλισίαι, τὸν νῆες Ἀχαιῶν
72 ἠμάτιαι Θρῄκηθεν ἐπ’ εὐρέα πόντον ἄγουσι·
73 πᾶσά τοί ἐσθ’ ὑποδεξίη, πολέεσσι δ’ ἀνάσσεις.
74 πολλῶν δ’ ἀγρομένων τῷ πείσεαι ὅς κεν ἀρίστην
75 βουλὴν βουλεύσῃ· μάλα δὲ χρεὼ πάντας Ἀχαιοὺς
76 ἐσθλῆς καὶ πυκινῆς, ὅτι δήϊοι ἐγγύθι νηῶν
77 καίουσιν πυρὰ πολλά· τίς ἂν τάδε γηθήσειε;
78 νὺξ δ’ ἦδ’ ἠὲ διαρραίσει στρατὸν ἠὲ σαώσει.
79 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα τοῦ μάλα μὲν κλύον ἠδὲ πίθοντο.
80 ἐκ δὲ φυλακτῆρες σὺν τεύχεσιν ἐσσεύοντο
81 ἀμφί τε Νεστορίδην Θρασυμήδεα ποιμένα λαῶν,
82 ἠδ’ ἀμφ’ Ἀσκάλαφον καὶ Ἰάλμενον υἷας Ἄρηος
83 ἀμφί τε Μηριόνην Ἀφαρῆά τε Δηΐπυρόν τε,
84 ἠδ’ ἀμφὶ Κρείοντος υἱὸν Λυκομήδεα δῖον.
85 ἕπτ’ ἔσαν ἡγεμόνες φυλάκων, ἑκατὸν δὲ ἑκάστῳ
86 κοῦροι ἅμα στεῖχον δολίχ’ ἔγχεα χερσὶν ἔχοντες·
87 κὰδ δὲ μέσον τάφρου καὶ τείχεος ἷζον ἰόντες·
88 ἔνθα δὲ πῦρ κήαντο, τίθεντο δὲ δόρπα ἕκαστος.
89 Ἀτρεΐδης δὲ γέροντας ἀολλέας ἦγεν Ἀχαιῶν
90 ἐς κλισίην, παρὰ δέ σφι τίθει μενοεικέα δαῖτα.

The son of Atreus then bade many councilors of the Achaeans to his quarters prepared a great feast in their honor. They laid their hands on the good things that were before them, and as soon as they had enough to eat and drink, old Nestor, whose counsel was ever truest, was the first to lay his mind before them. He, therefore, with all sincerity and goodwill addressed them thus. "With yourself, most noble son of Atreus, king of men, Agamemnon, will I both begin my speech and end it, for you are king over many people.

Zeus, moreover, has granted you to wield the scepter and to uphold what is right [themis] that you may take thought for your people under you; therefore it behooves you above all others both to speak and to give ear, and to out the counsel of another who shall have been minded to speak wisely. All turns on you and on your commands, therefore I will say what I think will be best. No man will be of a truer mind [noos] than that which has been mine from the hour when you, sir, angered Achilles by taking the girl Briseis from his tent against my judgment [noos]. I urged you not to do so, but you yielded to your own pride, and dishonored a hero whom heaven itself had honored - for you still hold the prize that had been awarded to him. Now, however, let us think how we may appease him, both with presents and fair speeches that may conciliate him." And King Agamemnon answered, "Sir, you have reproved my folly [atê] justly. I was wrong. I own it. One whom heaven befriends is in himself a host, and Zeus has shown that he befriends this man by destroying many people of the Achaeans. I was blinded with passion and yielded to my worser mind; therefore I will make amends, and will give him great gifts by way of atonement. I will tell them in the presence of you all. I will give him seven tripods that have never yet been on the fire, and ten talents of gold. I will give him twenty iron cauldrons and twelve strong horses that have won races and carried off prizes. Rich, indeed, both in land and gold is he that has as many prizes as my horses have won me. I will give him seven excellent workwomen, from Lesbos, whom I chose for myself when he took Lesbos - all of surpassing beauty. I will give him these, and with them her whom I erewhile took from him, the daughter of Briseus; and I swear a great oath that I never went up into her couch, nor did I lie down with her, even though it is right [themis] for humans, both men and women, to do this. "All these things will I give him now down, and if hereafter the gods grant me to sack the city of Priam, let him come when we Achaeans are dividing the spoil, and load his ship with gold and bronze to his liking; furthermore let him take twenty Trojan women, the loveliest after Helen herself. Then, when we reach Achaean Argos, wealthiest of all lands, he shall be my son-in-law and I will show him like honor with my own dear son Orestes, who is being nurtured in all abundance. I have three daughters, Chrysothemis, Laodike, and Iphianassa, let him take the one of his choice, freely and without gifts of wooing, to the house of Peleus; I will add such dower to boot as no man ever yet gave his daughter, and will give him seven well established cities, Kardamyle, Enope, and Hire, where there is grass; holy Pherai and the fertile meadows of Anthea; Aipeia also, and the vine-clad slopes of Pedasos, all near the sea, and on the borders of sandy Pylos. The men that dwell there are rich in cattle and sheep; they will honor him with gifts as though he were a god, and be obedient to his comfortable ordinances [themistes]. All this will I do if he will now forgo his anger. Let him then yield: it is only Hades who is utterly ruthless and unyielding - and hence he is of all gods the one most hateful to humankind. Moreover I am older and more royal than himself. Therefore, let him now obey me." Then Nestor answered, "Most noble son of Atreus, king of men, Agamemnon. The gifts you offer are no small ones, let us then send chosen messengers, who may go to the tent of Achilles son of Peleus without delay. Let those go whom I shall name. Let Phoenix, dear to Zeus, lead the way; let Ajax and Odysseus follow, and let the heralds Odios and Eurybates go with them. Now bring water for our hands, and bid all keep silence while we pray to Zeus the son of Kronos, if so be that he may have mercy upon us." Thus did he speak, and his saying pleased them well. Men-servants poured water over the hands of the guests, while pages filled the mixing-bowls with wine and water, and handed it round after giving every man his drink-offering; then, when they had made their offerings, and had drunk each as much as he was minded, the envoys set out from the tent of Agamemnon son of Atreus; and Nestor, looking first to one and then to another, but most especially at Odysseus, was instant with them that they should prevail with the noble son of Peleus.

9.91

οἳ δ’ ἐπ’ ὀνείαθ’ ἑτοῖμα προκείμενα χεῖρας ἴαλλον.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ πόσιος καὶ ἐδητύος ἐξ ἔρον ἔντο,
τοῖς ὁ γέρων πάμπρωτος ὑφαίνειν ἤρχετο μῆτιν
Νέστωρ, οὗ καὶ πρόσθεν ἀρίστη φαίνετο βουλή·
ὅ σφιν ἐϋφρονέων ἀγορήσατο καὶ μετέειπεν·
Ἀτρεΐδη κύδιστε ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγάμεμνον
ἐν σοὶ μὲν λήξω, σέο δ’ ἄρξομαι, οὕνεκα πολλῶν
λαῶν ἐσσι ἄναξ καί τοι Ζεὺς ἐγγυάλιξε
σκῆπτρόν τ’ ἠδὲ θέμιστας, ἵνά σφισι βουλεύῃσθα.
τώ σε χρὴ περὶ μὲν φάσθαι ἔπος ἠδ’ ἐπακοῦσαι,
κρηῆναι δὲ καὶ ἄλλῳ, ὅτ’ ἄν τινα θυμὸς ἀνώγῃ
εἰπεῖν εἰς ἀγαθόν· σέο δ’ ἔξεται ὅττί κεν ἄρχῃ.
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼν ἐρέω ὥς μοι δοκεῖ εἶναι ἄριστα.
οὐ γάρ τις νόον ἄλλος ἀμείνονα τοῦδε νοήσει
οἷον ἐγὼ νοέω ἠμὲν πάλαι ἠδ’ ἔτι καὶ νῦν
ἐξ ἔτι τοῦ ὅτε διογενὲς Βρισηΐδα κούρην
χωομένου Ἀχιλῆος ἔβης κλισίηθεν ἀπούρας
οὔ τι καθ’ ἡμέτερόν γε νόον· μάλα γάρ τοι ἔγωγε
πόλλ’ ἀπεμυθεόμην· σὺ δὲ σῷ μεγαλήτορι θυμῷ
εἴξας ἄνδρα φέριστον, ὃν ἀθάνατοί περ ἔτισαν,
ἠτίμησας, ἑλὼν γὰρ ἔχεις γέρας· ἀλλ’ ἔτι καὶ νῦν
φραζώμεσθ’ ὥς κέν μιν ἀρεσσάμενοι πεπίθωμεν
δώροισίν τ’ ἀγανοῖσιν ἔπεσσί τε μειλιχίοισι.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
ὦ γέρον οὔ τι ψεῦδος ἐμὰς ἄτας κατέλεξας·
ἀασάμην, οὐδ’ αὐτὸς ἀναίνομαι. ἀντί νυ πολλῶν
λαῶν ἐστὶν ἀνὴρ ὅν τε Ζεὺς κῆρι φιλήσῃ,
ὡς νῦν τοῦτον ἔτισε, δάμασσε δὲ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν.
ἀλλ’ ἐπεὶ ἀασάμην φρεσὶ λευγαλέῃσι πιθήσας,
ἂψ ἐθέλω ἀρέσαι δόμεναί τ’ ἀπερείσι’ ἄποινα.

9.121

ὑμῖν δ’ ἐν πάντεσσι περικλυτὰ δῶρ’ ὀνομήνω
ἕπτ’ ἀπύρους τρίποδας, δέκα δὲ χρυσοῖο τάλαντα,
αἴθωνας δὲ λέβητας ἐείκοσι, δώδεκα δ’ ἵππους
πηγοὺς ἀθλοφόρους, οἳ ἀέθλια ποσσὶν ἄροντο.
οὔ κεν ἀλήϊος εἴη ἀνὴρ ᾧ τόσσα γένοιτο,
οὐδέ κεν ἀκτήμων ἐριτίμοιο χρυσοῖο,
ὅσσά μοι ἠνείκαντο ἀέθλια μώνυχες ἵπποι.
δώσω δ’ ἑπτὰ γυναῖκας ἀμύμονα ἔργα ἰδυίας
Λεσβίδας, ἃς ὅτε Λέσβον ἐϋκτιμένην ἕλεν αὐτὸς
ἐξελόμην, αἳ κάλλει ἐνίκων φῦλα γυναικῶν.
τὰς μέν οἱ δώσω, μετὰ δ’ ἔσσεται ἣν τότ’ ἀπηύρων
κούρη Βρισῆος· ἐπὶ δὲ μέγαν ὅρκον ὀμοῦμαι
μή ποτε τῆς εὐνῆς ἐπιβήμεναι ἠδὲ μιγῆναι,
ἣ θέμις ἀνθρώπων πέλει ἀνδρῶν ἠδὲ γυναικῶν.
ταῦτα μὲν αὐτίκα πάντα παρέσσεται· εἰ δέ κεν αὖτε
ἄστυ μέγα Πριάμοιο θεοὶ δώωσ’ ἁλαπάξαι,
νῆα ἅλις χρυσοῦ καὶ χαλκοῦ νηησάσθω
εἰσελθών, ὅτε κεν δατεώμεθα λῆϊδ’ Ἀχαιοί,

Τρωϊάδας δὲ γυναῖκας ἐείκοσιν αὐτὸς ἑλέσθω,
αἵ κε μετ’ Ἀργείην Ἑλένην κάλλισται ἔωσιν.
εἰ δέ κεν Ἄργος ἰκοίμεθ’ Ἀχαιϊκὸν οὖθαρ ἀρούρης
γαμβρός κέν μοι ἔοι· τίσω δέ μιν ἶσον Ὀρέστῃ,
ὅς μοι τηλύγετος τρέφεται θαλίῃ ἔνι πολλῇ.
τρεῖς δέ μοί εἰσι θύγατρες ἐνὶ μεγάρῳ εὐπήκτῳ
Χρυσόθεμις καὶ Λαοδίκη καὶ Ἰφιάνασσα,
τάων ἥν κ’ ἐθέλῃσι φίλην ἀνάεδνον ἀγέσθω
πρὸς οἶκον Πηλῆος· ἐγὼ δ’ ἐπὶ μείλια δώσω
πολλὰ μάλ’, ὅσσ’ οὔ πώ τις ἐῇ ἐπέδωκε θυγατρί·
ἑπτὰ δέ οἱ δώσω εὖ ναιόμενα πτολίεθρα
Καρδαμύλην Ἐνόπην τε καὶ Ἱρὴν ποιήεσσαν

9.151

Φηράς τε ζαθέας ἠδ’ Ἄνθειαν βαθύλειμον
καλήν τ’ Αἴπειαν καὶ Πήδασον ἀμπελόεσσαν.
πᾶσαι δ’ ἐγγὺς ἁλός, νέαται Πύλου ἠμαθόεντος·
ἐν δ’ ἄνδρες ναίουσι πολύρρηνες πολυβοῦται,
οἵ κέ ἑ δωτίνῃσι θεὸν ὣς τιμήσουσι
καί οἱ ὑπὸ σκήπτρῳ λιπαρὰς τελέουσι θέμιστας.
ταῦτά κέ οἱ τελέσαιμι μεταλήξαντι χόλοιο.
δμηθήτω· Ἀΐδης τοι ἀμείλιχος ἠδ’ ἀδάμαστος,
τοὔνεκα καί τε βροτοῖσι θεῶν ἔχθιστος ἁπάντων·
καί μοι ὑποστήτω ὅσσον βασιλεύτερός εἰμι
ἠδ’ ὅσσον γενεῇ προγενέστερος εὔχομαι εἶναι.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
Ἀτρεΐδη κύδιστε ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγάμεμνον
δῶρα μὲν οὐκέτ’ ὀνοστὰ διδοῖς Ἀχιλῆϊ ἄνακτι·
ἀλλ’ ἄγετε κλητοὺς ὀτρύνομεν, οἵ κε τάχιστα
ἔλθωσ’ ἐς κλισίην Πηληϊάδεω Ἀχιλῆος.
εἰ δ’ ἄγε τοὺς ἂν ἐγὼ ἐπιόψομαι οἳ δὲ πιθέσθων.
Φοῖνιξ μὲν πρώτιστα Διῒ φίλος ἡγησάσθω,
αὐτὰρ ἔπειτ’ Αἴας τε μέγας καὶ δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς·
κηρύκων δ’ Ὀδίος τε καὶ Εὐρυβάτης ἅμ’ ἑπέσθων.
φέρτε δὲ χερσὶν ὕδωρ, εὐφημῆσαί τε κέλεσθε,
ὄφρα Διὶ Κρονίδῃ ἀρησόμεθ’, αἴ κ’ ἐλεήσῃ.
ὣς φάτο, τοῖσι δὲ πᾶσιν ἐαδότα μῦθον ἔειπεν.
αὐτίκα κήρυκες μὲν ὕδωρ ἐπὶ χεῖρας ἔχευαν,
κοῦροι δὲ κρητῆρας ἐπεστέψαντο ποτοῖο,
νώμησαν δ’ ἄρα πᾶσιν ἐπαρξάμενοι δεπάεσσιν.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ σπεῖσάν τ’ ἔπιόν θ’ ὅσον ἤθελε θυμός,
ὁρμῶντ’ ἐκ κλισίης Ἀγαμέμνονος Ἀτρεΐδαο.
τοῖσι δὲ πόλλ’ ἐπέτελλε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ
δενδίλλων ἐς ἕκαστον, Ὀδυσσῆϊ δὲ μάλιστα,

9.181

πειρᾶν ὡς πεπίθοιεν ἀμύμονα Πηλεΐωνα.
τὼ δὲ βάτην παρὰ θῖνα πολυφλοίσβοιο θαλάσσης
πολλὰ μάλ’ εὐχομένω γαιήοχῳ ἐννοσιγαίῳ
ῥηϊδίως πεπιθεῖν μεγάλας φρένας Αἰακίδαο.

185 Μυρμιδόνων δ’ ἐπί τε κλισίας καὶ νῆας ἱκέσθην,
186 τὸν δ’ εὗρον φρένα τερπόμενον φόρμιγγι λιγείῃ
187 καλῇ δαιδαλέῃ, ἐπὶ δ’ ἀργύρεον ζυγὸν ἦεν,
188 τὴν ἄρετ’ ἐξ ἐνάρων πόλιν Ἠετίωνος ὀλέσσας·
189 τῇ ὅ γε θυμὸν ἔτερπεν, ἄειδε δ’ ἄρα κλέα ἀνδρῶν.
190 Πάτροκλος δέ οἱ οἶος ἐναντίος ἧστο σιωπῇ,
191 δέγμενος Αἰακίδην ὁπότε λήξειεν ἀείδων,
192 τὼ δὲ βάτην προτέρω, ἡγεῖτο δὲ δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς,
193 στὰν δὲ πρόσθ’ αὐτοῖο· ταφὼν δ’ ἀνόρουσεν Ἀχιλλεὺς
194 αὐτῇ σὺν φόρμιγγι λιπὼν ἕδος ἔνθα θάασσεν.
195 ὣς δ’ αὔτως Πάτροκλος, ἐπεὶ ἴδε φῶτας, ἀνέστη.
196 τὼ καὶ δεικνύμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
197 χαίρετον· ἦ φίλοι ἄνδρες ἱκάνετον ἦ τι μάλα χρεώ,
198 οἵ μοι σκυζομένῳ περ Ἀχαιῶν φίλτατοί ἐστον.
199 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας προτέρω ἄγε δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
200 εἶσεν δ’ ἐν κλισμοῖσι τάπησί τε πορφυρέοισιν.
201 αἶψα δὲ Πάτροκλον προσεφώνεεν ἐγγὺς ἐόντα·
202 μείζονα δὴ κρητῆρα Μενοιτίου υἱὲ καθίστα,
203 ζωρότερον δὲ κέραιε, δέπας δ’ ἔντυνον ἑκάστῳ·
204 οἳ γὰρ φίλτατοι ἄνδρες ἐμῷ ὑπέασι μελάθρῳ.
205 ὣς φάτο, Πάτροκλος δὲ φίλῳ ἐπεπείθεθ’ ἑταίρῳ.
206 αὐτὰρ ὅ γε κρεῖον μέγα κάββαλεν ἐν πυρὸς αὐγῇ,
207 ἐν δ’ ἄρα νῶτον ἔθηκ’ ὄϊος καὶ πίονος αἰγός,
208 ἐν δὲ συὸς σιάλοιο ῥάχιν τεθαλυῖαν ἀλοιφῇ.
209 τῷ δ’ ἔχεν Αὐτομέδων, τάμνεν δ’ ἄρα δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς.
210 καὶ τὰ μὲν εὖ μίστυλλε καὶ ἀμφ’ ὀβελοῖσιν ἔπειρε,
They went their way by the shore of the sounding sea, and prayed earnestly to earth-encircling Poseidon that the high spirit of the son of Aiakos might incline favorably towards them. When they reached the ships and tents of the Myrmidons, they found Achilles playing on a lyre, fair, of cunning workmanship, and its cross-bar was of silver. It was part of the spoils which he had taken when he sacked the city of Eetion, and he was now diverting himself with it and singing the glories [klea] of heroes. Patroklos alone sat facing him, in silence, waiting till he should cease singing. Odysseus and Ajax now came in - Odysseus leading the way -and stood before him. Achilles sprang from his seat with the lyre still in his hand, and Patroklos, when he saw the strangers, rose also. Achilles then greeted them saying, "All hail and welcome - you must come upon some great matter, you, who for all my anger are still dearest to me of the Achaeans." With this he led them forward, and bade them sit on seats covered with purple rugs; then he said to Patroklos who was close by him, "Son of Menoitios, set a larger bowl upon the table, mix less water with the wine, and give every man his cup, for these are very dear friends, who are now under my roof." Patroklos did as his comrade bade him; he set the chopping-block in front of the fire, and on it he laid the loin of a sheep, the loin also of a goat, and the chine of a fat hog. Automedon held the meat while Achilles chopped it; he then sliced the pieces and put them on spits while the son of Menoitios made the fire burn high. When the flame had died down, he spread the embers, laid the spits on top of them, lifting them up and setting them upon the spit-racks; and he sprinkled them with salt. When the meat was roasted, he set it on platters, and handed bread round the table in fair baskets, while Achilles dealt them their portions. Then Achilles took his seat facing Odysseus against the opposite wall, and bade his comrade Patroklos offer sacrifice to the gods; so he cast the offerings into the fire, and they laid their hands upon the good things that were before them. As soon as they had had enough to eat and drink, Ajax made a sign to Phoenix, and when he saw this, Odysseus filled his cup with

wine and pledged Achilles. "Hail," said he, "Achilles, we have had no scant of good cheer, neither in the tent of Agamemnon, nor yet here; there has been plenty to eat and drink, but our thought turns upon no such matter. Sir, we are in the face of great disaster, and without your help know not whether we shall save our fleet or lose it. The Trojans and their allies have camped hard by our ships and by the wall; they have lit watchfires throughout their host and deem that nothing can now prevent them from falling on our fleet. Zeus, moreover, has sent his lightnings on the right side, as signs [sêmata]; Hektor, in all his glory, rages like a maniac; confident that Zeus is with him he fears neither god nor man, but is gone raving mad, and prays for the approach of day. He vows that he will hew the high sterns of our ships in pieces, set fire to their hulls, and make havoc of the Achaeans while they are dazed and smothered in smoke; I much fear that heaven will make good his boasting, and it will prove our lot to perish at Troy far from our home in Argos. Up, then, and late though it be, save the sons of the Achaeans who faint before the fury of the Trojans. You will have grief [akhos] hereafter for all time to come if you do not, for when the harm is done there will be no cure for it; consider ere it be too late, and save the Danaans from destruction. "My good friend, when your father Peleus sent you from Phthia to Agamemnon, did he not charge you saying, ‘Son, Athena and Hera will make you strong if they choose, but check your high temper, for the better part is in goodwill. Eschew vain quarreling, and the Achaeans old and young will respect you more for doing so.’ These were his words, but you have forgotten them. Even now, however, be appeased, and put away your anger from you. Agamemnon will make you great amends if you will forgive him; listen, and I will tell you what he has said in his tent that he will give you. He will give you seven tripods that have never yet been on the fire, and ten talents of gold; twenty iron cauldrons, and twelve strong horses that have won races and carried off prizes. Rich indeed both in land and gold is he who has as many prizes as these horses have won for Agamemnon. Moreover he will give you seven excellent workers, women of Lesbos, whom he chose for himself, when you took Lesbos - all of surpassing beauty. He will give you these, and with them her whom he erewhile took from you, the daughter of Briseus, and he will swear a great oath, he has never gone up into her couch nor lain down with her, though it is right [themis] for men and women to do so. All these things will he give you now down, and if hereafter the gods grant him to sack the city of Priam, you can come when we Achaeans are dividing the spoil, and load your ship with gold and bronze to your liking. You can take twenty Trojan women, the loveliest after Helen herself. Then, when we reach Achaean Argos, wealthiest of all lands, you shall be his son-in-law, and he will show you like honor with his own dear son Orestes, who is being nurtured in all abundance. Agamemnon has three daughters, Chrysothemis, Laodike, and Iphianassa; you may take the one of your choice, freely and without gifts of wooing, to the house of Peleus; he will add such dower to boot as no man ever yet gave his daughter, and will give you seven well-established cities, Kardamyle, Enope, and Hire where there is grass; holy Pheras and the fertile meadows of Anthea; Aipeia also, and the vine-clad slopes of Pedasos, all near the sea, and on the borders of sandy Pylos. The men that dwell there are rich in cattle and sheep; they will honor you with gifts as though were a god, and be obedient to your comfortable ordinances [themistes]. All this will he do if you will now forgo your anger. Moreover, though you hate both him and his gifts with all your heart, yet pity the rest of the Achaeans who are being harassed in all their host; they will honor you as a god, and you will earn great glory at their hands. You might even kill Hektor; he will come within your reach, for he is infatuated, and declares that not a Danaan whom the ships have brought can hold his own against him." Achilles answered, "Odysseus, noble son of Laertes, I should give you formal notice plainly and in all fixity of purpose that there be no more of this cajoling, from whatsoever quarter it may come. Hateful [ekhthros] to me like the gates of Hades is the man who says one thing while he hides another thing in his mind [phrenes]; therefore I will

say what I mean. I will be appeased neither by Agamemnon son of Atreus nor by any other of the Danaans, for I see that I have no thanks [kharis] for all my fighting. He that fights fares no better than he that does not; coward and hero are held in equal honor [timê], and death deals like measure to him who works and him who is idle. I have taken nothing by all my hardships - with my life [psukhê] ever at risk; as a bird when she has found a morsel takes it to her nestlings, and herself fares hardly, even so many a long night have I been wakeful, and many a bloody battle have I waged by day against those who were fighting for their women. With my ships I have taken twelve cities, and eleven round about Troy have I stormed with my men by land; I took great store of wealth from every one of them, but I gave all up to Agamemnon son of Atreus. He stayed where he was by his ships, yet of what came to him he gave little, and kept much himself.

9.211

211 πῦρ δὲ Μενοιτιάδης δαῖεν μέγα ἰσόθεος φώς.
212 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ κατὰ πῦρ ἑκάη καὶ φλὸξ ἐμαράνθη,
213 ἀνθρακιὴν στορέσας ὀβελοὺς ἐφύπερθε τάνυσσε,
214 πάσσε δ’ ἁλὸς θείοιο κρατευτάων ἐπαείρας.
215 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί ῥ’ ὤπτησε καὶ εἰν ἐλεοῖσιν ἔχευε,
216 Πάτροκλος μὲν σῖτον ἐλὼν ἐπένειμε τραπέζῃ
217 καλοῖς ἐν κανέοισιν, ἀτὰρ κρέα νεῖμεν Ἀχιλλεύς.
218 αὐτὸς δ’ ἀντίον ἷζεν Ὀδυσσῆος θείοιο
219 τοίχου τοῦ ἑτέροιο, θεοῖσι δὲ θῦσαι ἀνώγει
220 Πάτροκλον ὃν ἑταῖρον· ὃ δ’ ἐν πυρὶ βάλλε θυηλάς.
221 οἳ δ’ ἐπ’ ὀνείαθ’ ἑτοῖμα προκείμενα χεῖρας ἴαλλον.
222 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ πόσιος καὶ ἐδητύος ἐξ ἔρον ἔντο,
223 νεῦσ’ Αἴας Φοίνικι· νόησε δὲ δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς,
224 πλησάμενος δ’ οἴνοιο δέπας δείδεκτ’ Ἀχιλῆα·
225 χαῖρ’ Ἀχιλεῦ· δαιτὸς μὲν ἐΐσης οὐκ ἐπιδευεῖς
226 ἠμὲν ἐνὶ κλισίῃ Ἀγαμέμνονος Ἀτρεΐδαο
227 ἠδὲ καὶ ἐνθάδε νῦν, πάρα γὰρ μενοεικέα πολλὰ
228 δαίνυσθ’· ἀλλ’ οὐ δαιτὸς ἐπηράτου ἔργα μέμηλεν,
229 ἀλλὰ λίην μέγα πῆμα διοτρεφὲς εἰσορόωντες
230 δείδιμεν· ἐν δοιῇ δὲ σαωσέμεν ἢ ἀπολέσθαι
231 νῆας ἐϋσσέλμους, εἰ μὴ σύ γε δύσεαι ἀλκήν.
232 ἐγγὺς γὰρ νηῶν καὶ τείχεος αὖλιν ἔθεντο
233 Τρῶες ὑπέρθυμοι τηλεκλειτοί τ’ ἐπίκουροι
234 κηάμενοι πυρὰ πολλὰ κατὰ στρατόν, οὐδ’ ἔτι φασὶ
235 σχήσεσθ’, ἀλλ’ ἐν νηυσὶ μελαίνῃσιν πεσέεσθαι.
236 Ζεὺς δέ σφι Κρονίδης ἐνδέξια σήματα φαίνων
237 ἀστράπτει· Ἕκτωρ δὲ μέγα σθένεϊ βλεμεαίνων
238 μαίνεται ἐκπάγλως πίσυνος Διί, οὐδέ τι τίει
239 ἀνέρας οὐδὲ θεούς· κρατερὴ δέ ἑ λύσσα δέδυκεν.
240 ἀρᾶται δὲ τάχιστα φανήμεναι Ἠῶ δῖαν·

9.241

241 στεῦται γὰρ νηῶν ἀποκόψειν ἄκρα κόρυμβα
242 αὐτάς τ’ ἐμπρήσειν μαλεροῦ πυρός, αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὺς
243 δῃώσειν παρὰ τῇσιν ὀρινομένους ὑπὸ καπνοῦ.
244 ταῦτ’ αἰνῶς δείδοικα κατὰ φρένα, μή οἱ ἀπειλὰς
245 ἐκτελέσωσι θεοί, ἡμῖν δὲ δὴ αἶσιμον εἴη

φθίσθαι ἐνὶ Τροίῃ ἑκὰς Ἄργεος ἱπποβότοιο.
ἀλλ’ ἄνα εἰ μέμονάς γε καὶ ὀψέ περ υἷας Ἀχαιῶν
τειρομένους ἐρύεσθαι ὑπὸ Τρώων ὀρυμαγδοῦ.
αὐτῷ τοι μετόπισθ’ ἄχος ἔσσεται, οὐδέ τι μῆχος
ῥεχθέντος κακοῦ ἔστ’ ἄκος εὑρεῖν· ἀλλὰ πολὺ πρὶν
φράζευ ὅπως Δαναοῖσιν ἀλεξήσεις κακὸν ἦμαρ.
ὦ πέπον ἦ μὲν σοί γε πατὴρ ἐπετέλλετο Πηλεὺς
ἤματι τῷ ὅτε σ’ ἐκ Φθίης Ἀγαμέμνονι πέμπε·
τέκνον ἐμὸν κάρτος μὲν Ἀθηναίη τε καὶ Ἥρη
δώσουσ’ αἴ κ’ ἐθέλωσι, σὺ δὲ μεγαλήτορα θυμὸν
ἴσχειν ἐν στήθεσσι· φιλοφροσύνη γὰρ ἀμείνων·
ληγέμεναι δ’ ἔριδος κακομηχάνου, ὄφρά σε μᾶλλον
τίωσ’ Ἀργείων ἠμὲν νέοι ἠδὲ γέροντες.
ὣς ἐπέτελλ’ ὁ γέρων, σὺ δὲ λήθεαι· ἀλλ’ ἔτι καὶ νῦν
παύε’, ἔα δὲ χόλον θυμαλγέα· σοὶ δ’ Ἀγαμέμνων
ἄξια δῶρα δίδωσι μεταλήξαντι χόλοιο.
εἰ δὲ σὺ μέν μευ ἄκουσον, ἐγὼ δέ κέ τοι καταλέξω
ὅσσά τοι ἐν κλισίῃσιν ὑπέσχετο δῶρ’ Ἀγαμέμνων·
ἕπτ’ ἀπύρους τρίποδας, δέκα δὲ χρυσοῖο τάλαντα,
αἴθωνας δὲ λέβητας ἐείκοσι, δώδεκα δ’ ἵππους
πηγοὺς ἀθλοφόρους, οἳ ἀέθλια ποσσὶν ἄροντο.
οὔ κεν ἀλήϊος εἴη ἀνὴρ ᾧ τόσσα γένοιτο
οὐδέ κεν ἀκτήμων ἐριτίμοιο χρυσοῖο,
ὅσσ’ Ἀγαμέμνονος ἵπποι ἀέθλια ποσσὶν ἄροντο.
δώσει δ’ ἑπτὰ γυναῖκας ἀμύμονα ἔργα ἰδυίας

9.271

Λεσβίδας, ἃς ὅτε Λέσβον ἐϋκτιμένην ἕλες αὐτὸς
ἐξέλεθ’, αἳ τότε κάλλει ἐνίκων φῦλα γυναικῶν.
τὰς μέν τοι δώσει, μετὰ δ’ ἔσσεται ἣν τότ’ ἀπηύρα
κούρη Βρισῆος· ἐπὶ δὲ μέγαν ὅρκον ὀμεῖται
μή ποτε τῆς εὐνῆς ἐπιβήμεναι ἠδὲ μιγῆναι
ἢ θέμις ἐστὶν ἄναξ ἦτ’ ἀνδρῶν ἦτε γυναικῶν.
ταῦτα μὲν αὐτίκα πάντα παρέσσεται· εἰ δέ κεν αὖτε
ἄστυ μέγα Πριάμοιο θεοὶ δώωσ’ ἁλαπάξαι,
νῆα ἅλις χρυσοῦ καὶ χαλκοῦ νηήσασθαι
εἰσελθών, ὅτε κεν δατεώμεθα λῃΐδ’ Ἀχαιοί,
Τρωϊάδας δὲ γυναῖκας ἐείκοσιν αὐτὸς ἑλέσθαι,
αἵ κε μετ’ Ἀργείην Ἑλένην κάλλισται ἔωσιν.
εἰ δέ κεν Ἄργος ἱκοίμεθ’ Ἀχαιϊκὸν οὖθαρ ἀρούρης
γαμβρός κέν οἱ ἔοις· τίσει δέ σε ἶσον Ὀρέστῃ,
ὅς οἱ τηλύγετος τρέφεται θαλίῃ ἔνι πολλῇ.
τρεῖς δέ οἵ εἰσι θύγατρες ἐνὶ μεγάρῳ εὐπήκτῳ
Χρυσόθεμις καὶ Λαοδίκη καὶ Ἰφιάνασσα,
τάων ἥν κ’ ἐθέλῃσθα φίλην ἀνάεδνον ἄγεσθαι
πρὸς οἶκον Πηλῆος· ὃ δ’ αὖτ’ ἐπὶ μείλια δώσει
πολλὰ μάλ’, ὅσσ’ οὔ πώ τις ἐῇ ἐπέδωκε θυγατρί·
ἑπτὰ δέ τοι δώσει εὖ ναιόμενα πτολίεθρα
Καρδαμύλην Ἐνόπην τε καὶ Ἱρὴν ποιήεσσαν
Φηράς τε ζαθέας ἠδ’ Ἄνθειαν βαθύλειμον
καλήν τ’ Αἴπειαν καὶ Πήδασον ἀμπελόεσσαν.

πᾶσαι δ’ ἐγγὺς ἁλός, νέαται Πύλου ἡμαθόεντος·
ἐν δ’ ἄνδρες ναίουσι πολύρρηνες πολυβοῦται,
οἵ κέ σε δωτίνῃσι θεὸν ὣς τιμήσουσι
καί τοι ὑπὸ σκήπτρῳ λιπαρὰς τελέουσι θέμιστας.
ταῦτά κέ τοι τελέσειε μεταλήξαντι χόλοιο.
εἰ δέ τοι Ἀτρεΐδης μὲν ἀπήχθετο κηρόθι μᾶλλον

9.301

αὐτὸς καὶ τοῦ δῶρα, σὺ δ’ ἄλλους περ Παναχαιοὺς
τειρομένους ἐλέαιρε κατὰ στρατόν, οἵ σε θεὸν ὣς
τίσουσ’· ἦ γάρ κέ σφι μάλα μέγα κῦδος ἄροιο·
νῦν γάρ χ’ Ἕκτορ’ ἔλοις, ἐπεὶ ἂν μάλα τοι σχεδὸν ἔλθοι
λύσσαν ἔχων ὀλοήν, ἐπεὶ οὔ τινά φησιν ὁμοῖον
οἷ ἔμεναι Δαναῶν οὓς ἐνθάδε νῆες ἔνεικαν.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
διογενὲς Λαερτιάδη πολυμήχαν’ Ὀδυσσεῦ
χρὴ μὲν δὴ τὸν μῦθον ἀπηλεγέως ἀποειπεῖν,
ᾗ περ δὴ φρονέω τε καὶ ὡς τετελεσμένον ἔσται,
ὡς μή μοι τρύζητε παρήμενοι ἄλλοθεν ἄλλος.
ἐχθρὸς γάρ μοι κεῖνος ὁμῶς Ἀΐδαο πύλῃσιν
ὅς χ’ ἕτερον μὲν κεύθῃ ἐνὶ φρεσίν, ἄλλο δὲ εἴπῃ.
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼν ἐρέω ὥς μοι δοκεῖ εἶναι ἄριστα·
οὔτ’ ἔμεγ’ Ἀτρεΐδην Ἀγαμέμνονα πεισέμεν οἴω
οὔτ’ ἄλλους Δαναούς, ἐπεὶ οὐκ ἄρα τις χάρις ἦεν
μάρνασθαι δηΐοισιν ἐπ’ ἀνδράσι νωλεμὲς αἰεί.
ἴση μοῖρα μένοντι καὶ εἰ μάλα τις πολεμίζοι·
ἐν δὲ ἰῇ τιμῇ ἠμὲν κακὸς ἠδὲ καὶ ἐσθλός·
κάτθαν’ ὁμῶς ὅ τ’ ἀεργὸς ἀνὴρ ὅ τε πολλὰ ἐοργώς.
οὐδέ τί μοι περίκειται, ἐπεὶ πάθον ἄλγεα θυμῷ
αἰεὶ ἐμὴν ψυχὴν παραβαλλόμενος πολεμίζειν.
ὡς δ’ ὄρνις ἀπτῆσι νεοσσοῖσι προφέρῃσι
μάστακ’ ἐπεί κε λάβῃσι, κακῶς δ’ ἄρα οἱ πέλει αὐτῇ,
ὣς καὶ ἐγὼ πολλὰς μὲν ἀΰπνους νύκτας ἴαυον,
ἤματα δ’ αἱματόεντα διέπρησσον πολεμίζων
ἀνδράσι μαρνάμενος ὀάρων ἕνεκα σφετεράων.
δώδεκα δὴ σὺν νηυσὶ πόλεις ἀλάπαξ’ ἀνθρώπων,
πεζὸς δ’ ἔνδεκά φημι κατὰ Τροίην ἐρίβωλον·
τάων ἐκ πασέων κειμήλια πολλὰ καὶ ἐσθλὰ

9.331

ἐξελόμην, καὶ πάντα φέρων Ἀγαμέμνονι δόσκον
Ἀτρεΐδῃ· ὃ δ’ ὄπισθε μένων παρὰ νηυσὶ θοῇσι
δεξάμενος διὰ παῦρα δασάσκετο, πολλὰ δ’ ἔχεσκεν.
ἄλλα δ’ ἀριστήεσσι δίδου γέρα καὶ βασιλεῦσι·
τοῖσι μὲν ἔμπεδα κεῖται, ἐμεῦ δ’ ἀπὸ μούνου Ἀχαιῶν
εἵλετ’, ἔχει δ’ ἄλοχον θυμαρέα· τῇ παριαύων
τερπέσθω. τί δὲ δεῖ πολεμιζέμεναι Τρώεσσιν
Ἀργείους; τί δὲ λαὸν ἀνήγαγεν ἐνθάδ’ ἀγείρας
Ἀτρεΐδης; ἦ οὐχ Ἑλένης ἕνεκ’ ἠϋκόμοιο;
ἦ μοῦνοι φιλέουσ’ ἀλόχους μερόπων ἀνθρώπων

341 Ἀτρεΐδαι; ἐπεὶ ὅς τις ἀνὴρ ἀγαθὸς καὶ ἐχέφρων
342 τὴν αὐτοῦ φιλέει καὶ κήδεται, ὡς καὶ ἐγὼ τὴν
343 ἐκ θυμοῦ φίλεον δουρικτητήν περ ἐοῦσαν.
344 νῦν δ’ ἐπεὶ ἐκ χειρῶν γέρας εἵλετο καί μ’ ἀπάτησε
345 μή μευ πειράτω εὖ εἰδότος· οὐδέ με πείσει.
346 ἀλλ’ Ὀδυσεῦ σὺν σοί τε καὶ ἄλλοισιν βασιλεῦσι
347 φραζέσθω νήεσσιν ἀλεξέμεναι δήϊον πῦρ.
348 ἦ μὲν δὴ μάλα πολλὰ πονήσατο νόσφιν ἐμεῖο,
349 καὶ δὴ τεῖχος ἔδειμε, καὶ ἤλασε τάφρον ἐπ’ αὐτῷ
350 εὐρεῖαν μεγάλην, ἐν δὲ σκόλοπας κατέπηξεν·
351 ἀλλ’ οὐδ’ ὣς δύναται σθένος Ἕκτορος ἀνδροφόνοιο
352 ἴσχειν· ὅφρα δ’ ἐγὼ μετ’ Ἀχαιοῖσιν πολέμιζον
353 οὐκ ἐθέλεσκε μάχην ἀπὸ τείχεος ὀρνύμεν Ἕκτωρ,
354 ἀλλ’ ὅσον ἐς Σκαιάς τε πύλας καὶ φηγὸν ἵκανεν·
355 ἔνθά ποτ’ οἶον ἔμιμνε, μόγις δέ μευ ἔκφυγεν ὁρμήν.
356 νῦν δ’ ἐπεὶ οὐκ ἐθέλω πολεμιζέμεν Ἕκτορι δίῳ
357 αὔριον ἱρὰ Διὶ ῥέξας καὶ πᾶσι θεοῖσι
358 νηήσας εὖ νῆας, ἐπὴν ἅλα δὲ προερύσσω,
359 ὄψεαι, αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσθα καὶ αἴ κέν τοι τὰ μεμήλῃ,
360 ἦρι μάλ’ Ἑλλήσποντον ἐπ’ ἰχθυόεντα πλεούσας

"Nevertheless he did distribute some prizes of honor among the chieftains and kings, and these have them still; from me alone of the Achaeans did he take the woman in whom I delighted - let him keep her and sleep with her. Why, pray, must the Argives needs fight the Trojans? What made the son of Atreus gather the host and bring them? Was it not for the sake of Helen? Are the sons of Atreus the only men in the world who love their wives? Any man of common right feeling will love and cherish her who is his own, as I this woman, with my whole heart, though she was but a fruitling of my spear. Agamemnon has taken her from me; he has played me false; I know him; let him tempt me no further, for he shall not move me. Let him look to you, Odysseus, and to the other princes to save his ships from burning. He has done much without me already. He has built a wall; he has dug a trench deep and wide all round it, and he has planted it within with stakes; but even so he stays not the murderous might of Hektor. So long as I fought the Achaeans Hektor suffered not the battle range far from the city walls; he would come to the Scaean gates and to the oak tree, but no further. Once he stayed to meet me and hardly did he escape my onset: now, however, since I am in no mood to fight him, I will tomorrow offer sacrifice to Zeus and to all the gods; I will draw my ships into the water and then victual them duly; tomorrow morning, if you care to look, you will see my ships on the Hellespont, and my men rowing out to sea with might and main. If great Poseidon grants me a fair passage, in three days I shall be in Phthia. I have much there that I left behind me when I came here to my sorrow, and I shall bring back still further store of gold, of red copper, of fair women, and of iron, my share of the spoils that we have taken; but one prize, he who gave has insolently taken away. Tell him all as I now bid you, and tell him in public that the Achaeans may hate him and beware of him should he think that he can yet dupe others for his effrontery never fails him. "As for me, hound that he is, he dares not look me in the face. I will take no counsel with him, and will undertake nothing in common with him. He has wronged me and deceived me enough, he shall not cozen me further; let him go his own way, for Zeus has robbed him of his reason. Hateful [ekhthra] to me are his presents, and for himself care not one straw. He may offer me ten or even twenty times what he has now done, nay- not though it be all that he has in the world, both now or ever shall have; he may promise me the wealth of Orkhomenos or of Egyptian Thebes, which is the richest city in the whole world, for it has a hundred gates through each of which two hundred men may drive at

once with their chariots and horses; he may offer me gifts as the sands of the sea or the dust of the plain in multitude, but even so he shall not move me till I have been revenged in full for the bitter wrong he has done me. I will not marry his daughter; she may be fair as Aphrodite, and skillful as Athena, but I will have none of her: let another take her, who may be a good match for her and who rules a larger kingdom. If the gods spare me to return home, Peleus will find me a wife; there are Achaean women in Hellas and Phthia, daughters of kings that have cities under them; of these I can take whom I will and marry her. Many a time was I minded when at home in Phthia to woo and wed a woman who would make me a suitable wife, and to enjoy the riches of my old father Peleus. My life [psukhê] means more to me than all the wealth of Ilion while it was yet at peace before the Achaeans went there, or than all the treasure that lies on the stone floor of Apollo's temple beneath the cliffs of Pytho. Cattle and sheep are to be had for harrying, and a man buy both tripods and horses if he wants them, but when his life has once left him it can neither be bought nor harried back again. "My mother Thetis tells me that there are two ways in which I may meet my end [telos]. If I stay here and fight, I shall lose my safe homecoming [nostos] but I will have a glory [kleos] that is unwilting: whereas if I go home my glory [kleos] will die, but it will be a long time before the outcome [telos] of death shall take me. To the rest of you, then, I say, ‘Go home, for you will not take Ilion.’ Zeus has held his hand over her to protect her, and her people have taken heart. Go, therefore, as in duty bound, and tell the princes of the Achaeans the message that I have sent them; tell them to find some other plan for the saving of their ships and people, for so long as my displeasure lasts the one that they have now hit upon may not be. As for Phoenix, let him sleep here that he may sail with me in the morning if he so will. But I will not take him by force." They all held their peace, dismayed at the sternness with which he had denied them, till presently the old horseman Phoenix in his great fear for the ships of the Achaeans, burst into tears and said, "Noble Achilles, if you are now minded to have your homecoming [nostos], and in the fierceness of your anger will do nothing to save the ships from burning, how, my son, can I remain here without you? Your father Peleus bade me go with you when he sent you as a mere lad from Phthia to Agamemnon. You knew nothing neither of war nor of the arts whereby men make their mark in council, and he sent me with you to train you in all excellence of speech and action. Therefore, my son, I will not stay here without you - no, not though heaven itself grant to strip my years from off me, and make me young as I was when I first left Hellas the land of fair women. I was then fleeing the anger of father Amyntor, son of Ormenus, who was furious with me in the matter of his concubine, of whom he was enamored to the wronging of his wife my mother. My mother, therefore, prayed me without ceasing to lie with the woman myself, that so she hate my father, and in the course of time I yielded. But my father soon came to know, and cursed me bitterly, calling the dread Erinyes to witness. He prayed that no son of mine might ever sit upon knees - and the gods, Zeus of the world below and awful Persephone, fulfilled his curse. I took counsel to kill him, but some god stayed my rashness and bade me think on men's evil tongues and how I should be branded as the murderer of my father: nevertheless I could not bear to stay in my father's house with him so bitter a against me. My cousins and clansmen came about me, and pressed me sorely to remain; many a sheep and many an ox did they slaughter, and many a fat hog did they set down to roast before the fire; many a jar, too, did they broach of my father's wine. Nine whole nights did they set a guard over me taking it in turns to watch, and they kept a fire always burning, both in the room of the outer court and in the inner court at the doors of the room wherein I lay; but when the darkness of the tenth night came, I broke through the closed doors of my room, and climbed the wall of the outer court after passing quickly and unperceived through the men on guard and the women servants. I then fled through Hellas till I came to fertile Phthia, mother of sheep, and to King Peleus, who made me welcome and treated me as a father treats an only son who will be heir to all his wealth. He made me

rich and set me over many people, establishing me on the borders of Phthia where I was chief ruler over the Dolopians. "It was I, Achilles, who had the making of you; I loved you with all my heart: for you would eat neither at home nor when you had gone out elsewhere, till I had first set you upon my knees, cut up the dainty morsel that you were to eat, and held the wine-cup to your lips. Many a time have you slobbered your wine in baby helplessness over my shirt; I had infinite trouble with you, but I knew that heaven had granted me no offspring of my own, and I made a son of you, Achilles, that in my hour of need you might protect me. Now, therefore, I say battle with your pride and beat it; cherish not your anger for ever; the excellence [aretê] and might [biê] and honor [timê] of the gods are more than ours, but even gods may be appeased; and if a man has erred he prays the gods, and reconciles them to himself by his piteous cries and by frankincense, with drink-offerings and the savor of burnt sacrifice. For prayers are as daughters to great Zeus; halt, wrinkled, with eyes askance, they follow in the footsteps of Derangement [Atê], who, being fierce and fleet of foot, leaves them far behind him, and ever baneful to humankind outstrips them even to the ends of the world; but nevertheless the prayers come hobbling and healing after. If a man has pity upon these daughters of Zeus when they draw near him, they will bless him and hear him too when he is praying; but if he deny them and will not listen to them, they go to Zeus the son of Kronos and pray that he may presently fall into derangement [atê] - to his ruing bitterly hereafter.

9.361

361 νῆας ἐμάς, ἐν δ’ ἄνδρας ἐρεσσέμεναι μεμαῶτας·
362 εἰ δέ κεν εὐπλοίην δώῃ κλυτὸς ἐννοσίγαιος
363 ἥματί κε τριτάτῳ Φθίην ἐρίβωλον ἱκοίμην.
364 ἔστι δέ μοι μάλα πολλά, τὰ κάλλιπον ἐνθάδε ἔρρων·
365 ἄλλον δ’ ἐνθένδε χρυσὸν καὶ χαλκὸν ἐρυθρὸν
366 ἠδὲ γυναῖκας ἐϋζώνους πολιόν τε σίδηρον
367 ἄξομαι, ἄσσ’ ἔλαχόν γε· γέρας δέ μοι, ὅς περ ἔδωκεν,
368 αὖτις ἐφυβρίζων ἕλετο κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
369 Ἀτρεΐδης· τῷ πάντ’ ἀγορευέμεν ὡς ἐπιτέλλω
370 ἀμφαδόν, ὄφρα καὶ ἄλλοι ἐπισκύζωνται Ἀχαιοὶ
371 εἴ τινά που Δαναῶν ἔτι ἔλπεται ἐξαπατήσειν
372 αἰὲν ἀναιδείην ἐπιειμένος· οὐδ’ ἂν ἔμοιγε
373 τετληίη κύνεός περ ἐὼν εἰς ὦπα ἰδέσθαι·
374 οὐδέ τί οἱ βουλὰς συμφράσσομαι, οὐδὲ μὲν ἔργον·
375 ἐκ γὰρ δή μ’ ἀπάτησε καὶ ἤλιτεν· οὐδ’ ἂν ἔτ’ αὖτις
376 ἐξαπάφοιτ’ ἐπέεσσιν· ἄλις δέ οἱ· ἀλλὰ ἔκηλος
377 ἐρρέτω· ἐκ γάρ εὐ φρένας εἵλετο μητίετα Ζεύς.
378 ἐχθρὰ δέ μοι τοῦ δῶρα, τίω δέ μιν ἐν καρὸς αἴσῃ.
379 οὐδ’ εἴ μοι δεκάκις τε καὶ εἰκοσάκις τόσα δοίη
380 ὅσσά τέ οἱ νῦν ἔστι, καὶ εἴ ποθεν ἄλλα γένοιτο,
381 οὐδ’ ὅσ’ ἐς Ὀρχομενὸν ποτινίσεται, οὐδ’ ὅσα Θήβας
382 Αἰγυπτίας, ὅθι πλεῖστα δόμοις ἐν κτήματα κεῖται,
383 αἵ θ’ ἑκατόμπυλοί εἰσι, διηκόσιοι δ’ ἀν’ ἑκάστας
384 ἀνέρες ἐξοιχνεῦσι σὺν ἵπποισιν καὶ ὄχεσφιν·
385 οὐδ’ εἴ μοι τόσα δοίη ὅσα ψάμαθός τε κόνις τε,
386 οὐδέ κεν ὣς ἔτι θυμὸν ἐμὸν πείσει’ Ἀγαμέμνων
387 πρίν γ’ ἀπὸ πᾶσαν ἐμοὶ δόμεναι θυμαλγέα λώβην.
388 κούρην δ’ οὐ γαμέω Ἀγαμέμνονος Ἀτρεΐδαο,
389 οὐδ’ εἰ χρυσείῃ Ἀφροδίτῃ κάλλος ἐρίζοι,
390 ἔργα δ’ Ἀθηναίῃ γλαυκώπιδι ἰσοφαρίζοι·

9.391

391 οὐδέ μιν ὥς γαμέω· ὃ δ’ Ἀχαιῶν ἄλλον ἐλέσθω,
392 ὅς τις οἶ τ’ ἐπέοικε καὶ ὃς βασιλεύτερός ἐστιν.
393 ἦν γὰρ δή με σαῶσι θεοὶ καὶ οἴκαδ’ ἵκωμαι,
394 Πηλεύς θήν μοι ἔπειτα γυναῖκά γε μάσσεται αὐτός.
395 πολλαὶ Ἀχαιΐδες εἰσὶν ἀν’ Ἑλλάδα τε Φθίην τε
396 κοῦραι ἀριστήων, οἵ τε πτολίεθρα ῥύονται,
397 τάων ἥν κ’ ἐθέλωμι φίλην ποιήσομ’ ἄκοιτιν.
398 ἔνθα δέ μοι μάλα πολλὸν ἐπέσσυτο θυμὸς ἀγήνωρ
399 γήμαντα μνηστὴν ἄλοχον ἐϊκυῖαν ἄκοιτιν
400 κτήμασι τέρπεσθαι τὰ γέρων ἐκτήσατο Πηλεύς·
401 οὐ γὰρ ἐμοὶ ψυχῆς ἀντάξιον οὐδ’ ὅσα φασὶν
402 Ἴλιον ἐκτῆσθαι εὖ ναιόμενον πτολίεθρον
403 τὸ πρὶν ἐπ’ εἰρήνης, πρὶν ἐλθεῖν υἷας Ἀχαιῶν,
404 οὐδ’ ὅσα λάϊνος οὐδὸς ἀφήτορος ἐντὸς ἐέργει
405 Φοίβου Ἀπόλλωνος Πυθοῖ ἔνι πετρηέσσῃ.
406 ληϊστοὶ μὲν γάρ τε βόες καὶ ἴφια μῆλα,
407 κτητοὶ δὲ τρίποδές τε καὶ ἵππων ξανθὰ κάρηνα,
408 ἀνδρὸς δὲ ψυχὴ πάλιν ἐλθεῖν οὔτε λεϊστὴ
409 οὔθ’ ἑλετή, ἐπεὶ ἄρ κεν ἀμείψεται ἕρκος ὀδόντων.
410 μήτηρ γάρ τέ μέ φησι θεὰ Θέτις ἀργυρόπεζα
411 διχθαδίας κῆρας φερέμεν θανάτοιο τέλος δέ.
412 εἰ μέν κ’ αὖθι μένων Τρώων πόλιν ἀμφιμάχωμαι,
413 ὤλετο μέν μοι νόστος, ἀτὰρ κλέος ἄφθιτον ἔσται·
414 εἰ δέ κεν οἴκαδ’ ἵκωμι φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν,
415 ὤλετό μοι κλέος ἐσθλόν, ἐπὶ δηρὸν δέ μοι αἰὼν
416 ἔσσεται, οὐδέ κέ μ’ ὦκα τέλος θανάτοιο κιχείη.
417 καὶ δ’ ἂν τοῖς ἄλλοισιν ἐγὼ παραμυθησαίμην
418 οἴκαδ’ ἀποπλείειν, ἐπεὶ οὐκέτι δήετε τέκμωρ
419 Ἰλίου αἰπεινῆς· μάλα γάρ ἐθεν εὐρύοπα Ζεὺς
420 χεῖρα ἐὴν ὑπερέσχε, τεθαρσήκασι δὲ λαοί.

9.421

421 ἀλλ’ ὑμεῖς μὲν ἰόντες ἀριστήεσσιν Ἀχαιῶν
422 ἀγγελίην ἀπόφασθε· τὸ γὰρ γέρας ἐστὶ γερόντων·
423 ὄφρ’ ἄλλην φράζωνται ἐνὶ φρεσὶ μῆτιν ἀμείνω,
424 ἥ κέ σφιν νῆάς τε σαῷ καὶ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν
425 νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇς, ἐπεὶ οὔ σφισιν ἥδέ γ’ ἑτοίμη
426 ἣν νῦν ἐφράσσαντο ἐμεῦ ἀπομηνίσαντος·
427 Φοῖνιξ δ’ αὖθι παρ’ ἄμμι μένων κατακοιμηθήτω,
428 ὄφρά μοι ἐν νήεσσι φίλην ἐς πατρίδ’ ἕπηται
429 αὔριον ἢν ἐθέλῃσιν· ἀνάγκῃ δ’ οὔ τί μιν ἄξω.
430 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἀκὴν ἐγένοντο σιωπῇ
431 μῦθον ἀγασσάμενοι· μάλα γὰρ κρατερῶς ἀπέειπεν·
432 ὀψὲ δὲ δὴ μετέειπε γέρων ἱππηλάτα Φοῖνιξ
433 δάκρυ’ ἀναπρήσας· περὶ γὰρ δίε νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν·
434 εἰ μὲν δὴ νόστόν γε μετὰ φρεσὶ φαίδιμ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ
435 βάλλεαι, οὐδέ τι πάμπαν ἀμύνειν νηυσὶ θοῇσι
436 πῦρ ἐθέλεις ἀΐδηλον, ἐπεὶ χόλος ἔμπεσε θυμῷ,
437 πῶς ἂν ἔπειτ’ ἀπὸ σεῖο φίλον τέκος αὖθι λιποίμην
438 οἷος; σοὶ δέ μ’ ἔπεμπε γέρων ἱππηλάτα Πηλεὺς

ἤματι τῷ ὅτε σ’ ἐκ Φθίης Ἀγαμέμνονι πέμπε
νήπιον οὔ πω εἰδόθ’ ὁμοιΐου πολέμοιο
οὐδ’ ἀγορέων, ἵνα τ’ ἄνδρες ἀριπρεπέες τελέθουσι.
τοὔνεκά με προέηκε διδασκέμεναι τάδε πάντα,
μύθων τε ῥητῆρ’ ἔμεναι πρηκτῆρά τε ἔργων.
ὡς ἂν ἔπειτ’ ἀπὸ σεῖο φίλον τέκος οὐκ ἐθέλοιμι
λείπεσθ’, οὐδ’ εἴ κέν μοι ὑποσταίη θεὸς αὐτὸς
γῆρας ἀποξύσας θήσειν νέον ἠβώοντα,
οἷον ὅτε πρῶτον λίπον Ἑλλάδα καλλιγύναικα
φεύγων νείκεα πατρὸς Ἀμύντορος Ὀρμενίδαο,
ὅς μοι παλλακίδος περιχώσατο καλλικόμοιο,
τὴν αὐτὸς φιλέεσκεν, ἀτιμάζεσκε δ’ ἄκοιτιν

9.451

μητέρ’ ἐμήν· ἣ δ’ αἰὲν ἐμὲ λισσέσκετο γούνων
παλλακίδι προμιγῆναι, ἵν’ ἐχθήρειε γέροντα.
τῇ πιθόμην καὶ ἔρεξα· πατὴρ δ’ ἐμὸς αὐτίκ’ ὀϊσθεὶς
πολλὰ κατηρᾶτο, στυγερὰς δ’ ἐπεκέκλετ’ Ἐρινῦς,
μή ποτε γούνασιν οἷσιν ἐφέσσεσθαι φίλον υἱὸν
ἐξ ἐμέθεν γεγαῶτα· θεοὶ δ’ ἐτέλειον ἐπαρὰς
Ζεύς τε καταχθόνιος καὶ ἐπαινὴ Περσεφόνεια.
ἔνθ’ ἐμοὶ οὐκέτι πάμπαν ἐρητύετ’ ἐν φρεσὶ θυμὸς
πατρὸς χωομένοιο κατὰ μέγαρα στρωφᾶσθαι.
ἦ μὲν πολλὰ ἔται καὶ ἀνεψιοὶ ἀμφὶς ἐόντες
αὐτοῦ λισσόμενοι κατερήτυον ἐν μεγάροισι,
πολλὰ δὲ ἴφια μῆλα καὶ εἰλίποδας ἕλικας βοῦς
ἔσφαζον, πολλοὶ δὲ σύες θαλέθοντες ἀλοιφῇ
εὐόμενοι τανύοντο διὰ φλογὸς Ἡφαίστοιο,
πολλὸν δ’ ἐκ κεράμων μέθυ πίνετο τοῖο γέροντος.
εἰνάνυχες δέ μοι ἀμφ’ αὐτῷ παρὰ νύκτας ἴαυον·
οἳ μὲν ἀμειβόμενοι φυλακὰς ἔχον, οὐδέ ποτ’ ἔσβη
πῦρ, ἕτερον μὲν ὑπ’ αἰθούσῃ εὐερκέος αὐλῆς,
ἄλλο δ’ ἐνὶ προδόμῳ, πρόσθεν θαλάμοιο θυράων.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ δεκάτη μοι ἐπήλυθε νὺξ ἐρεβεννή,
καὶ τότ’ ἐγὼ θαλάμοιο θύρας πυκινῶς ἀραρυίας
ῥήξας ἐξῆλθον, καὶ ὑπέρθορον ἑρκίον αὐλῆς
ῥεῖα, λαθὼν φύλακάς τ’ ἄνδρας δμῳάς τε γυναῖκας.
φεῦγον ἔπειτ’ ἀπάνευθε δι’ Ἑλλάδος εὐρυχόροιο,
Φθίην δ’ ἐξικόμην ἐριβώλακα μητέρα μήλων
ἐς Πηλῆα ἄναχθ’· ὃ δέ με πρόφρων ὑπέδεκτο,
καί μ’ ἐφίλησ’ ὡς εἴ τε πατὴρ ὃν παῖδα φιλήσῃ
μοῦνον τηλύγετον πολλοῖσιν ἐπὶ κτεάτεσσι,
καί μ’ ἀφνειὸν ἔθηκε, πολὺν δέ μοι ὤπασε λαόν·
ναῖον δ’ ἐσχατιὴν Φθίης Δολόπεσσιν ἀνάσσων.

9.485

καί σε τοσοῦτον ἔθηκα θεοῖς ἐπιείκελ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ,
ἐκ θυμοῦ φιλέων, ἐπεὶ οὐκ ἐθέλεσκες ἅμ’ ἄλλῳ
οὔτ’ ἐς δαῖτ’ ἰέναι οὔτ’ ἐν μεγάροισι πάσασθαι,
πρίν γ’ ὅτε δή σ’ ἐπ’ ἐμοῖσιν ἐγὼ γούνεσσι καθίσσας

489 ὄψου τ’ ἄσαιμι προταμὼν καὶ οἶνον ἐπισχών.
490 πολλάκι μοι κατέδευσας ἐπὶ στήθεσσι χιτῶνα
491 οἴνου ἀποβλύζων ἐν νηπιέῃ ἀλεγεινῇ.
492 ὣς ἐπὶ σοὶ μάλα πολλὰ πάθον καὶ πολλὰ μόγησα,
493 τὰ φρονέων ὅ μοι οὔ τι θεοὶ γόνον ἐξετέλειον
494 ἐξ ἐμεῦ· ἀλλὰ σὲ παῖδα θεοῖς ἐπιείκελ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ
495 ποιεύμην, ἵνα μοί ποτ’ ἀεικέα λοιγὸν ἀμύνῃς.
496 ἀλλ’ Ἀχιλεῦ δάμασον θυμὸν μέγαν· οὐδέ τί σε χρὴ
497 νηλεὲς ἦτορ ἔχειν· στρεπτοὶ δέ τε καὶ θεοὶ αὐτοί,
498 τῶν περ καὶ μείζων ἀρετὴ τιμή τε βίη τε.
499 καὶ μὲν τοὺς θυέεσσι καὶ εὐχωλῇς ἀγανῇσι
500 λοιβῇ τε κνίσῃ τε παρατρωπῶσ’ ἄνθρωποι
501 λισσόμενοι, ὅτε κέν τις ὑπερβήῃ καὶ ἁμάρτῃ.
502 καὶ γάρ τε λιταί εἰσι Διὸς κοῦραι μεγάλοιο
503 χωλαί τε ῥυσαί τε παραβλῶπές τ’ ὀφθαλμώ,
504 αἵ ῥά τε καὶ μετόπισθ’ ἄτης ἀλέγουσι κιοῦσαι.
505 ἢ δ’ ἄτη σθεναρή τε καὶ ἀρτίπος, οὕνεκα πάσας
506 πολλὸν ὑπεκπροθέει, φθάνει δέ τε πᾶσαν ἐπ’ αἶαν
507 βλάπτουσ’ ἀνθρώπους· αἳ δ’ ἐξακέονται ὀπίσσω.
508 ὃς μέν τ’ αἰδέσεται κούρας Διὸς ἆσσον ἰούσας,
509 τὸν δὲ μέγ’ ὤνησαν καί τ’ ἔκλυον εὐχομένοιο·
510 ὃς δέ κ’ ἀνήνηται καί τε στερεῶς ἀποείπῃ,
511 λίσσονται δ’ ἄρα ταί γε Δία Κρονίωνα κιοῦσαι
512 τῷ ἄτην ἅμ’ ἕπεσθαι, ἵνα βλαφθεὶς ἀποτίσῃ.
513 ἀλλ’ Ἀχιλεῦ πόρε καὶ σὺ Διὸς κούρῃσιν ἕπεσθαι
514 τιμήν, ἥ τ’ ἄλλων περ ἐπιγνάμπτει νόον ἐσθλῶν.

Therefore, Achilles, give these daughters of Zeus due reverence [timê], just as every other person does whose mind [noos] they change. Were not the son of Atreus offering you gifts and promising others later - if he were still furious and implacable - I am not he that would bid you throw off your anger [mênis] and help the Achaeans, no matter how great their need; but he is giving much now, and more hereafter; he has sent his leading men to urge his suit, and has chosen [krinô] those who of all the Argives are most near-and-dear [philoi] to you; make not then their words and their coming to be of no effect. Your anger has been righteous so far. We have heard in song the glories [klea] of heroes of old time: how they quarreled when they were roused to fury, but still they could be won by gifts, and fair words could soothe them. "I totally recall [memnêmai] this event of the past - it is not a new thing - and how it happened. You are all near and dear [philoi], and I will tell it in your presence. The Curetes and the Aetolians were fighting and killing one another round Calydon - the Aetolians defending the city and the Curetes trying to destroy it. For Artemis of the golden throne was angry and did them hurt because Oeneus had not offered her his harvest first-fruits. The other gods had all been feasted with hecatombs, but to the daughter of great Zeus alone he had made no sacrifice. He had forgotten her, or somehow or other it had escaped him, and this was a grievous derangement. Thereon the archer goddess in her displeasure sent a prodigious creature against him - a savage wild boar with great white tusks that did much harm to his orchard lands, uprooting apple-trees in full bloom and throwing them to the ground. But Meleager son of Oeneus got huntsmen and hounds from many cities and killed it - for it was so monstrous that not a few were needed, and many a man did it stretch upon his funeral pyre. On this the goddess set the Curetes and the Aetolians fighting furiously about the head and skin of the boar. "So long as Meleager was in the field things went badly with the Curetes, and for all their numbers they could not hold their ground under the city walls; but in the course of time the anger

weighed heavy on the thinking [noos] of Meleager : this can sometimes happen even to a sensible man. He was incensed with his mother Althaia, and therefore stayed at home with his wedded wife fair Cleopatra, who was daughter of Marpessa daughter of Euenos, and of Ides the man then living. He it was who took his bow and faced King Apollo himself for fair Marpessa's sake; her father and mother then named her Halcyone, because her mother had mourned with the strains of the halcyon, bird of much grief [penthos], when Phoebus Apollo had carried her off. Meleager, then, stayed at home with Cleopatra, nursing the anger which he felt by reason of his mother's curses. His mother, grieving for the death of her brother, prayed the gods, and beat the earth with her hands, calling upon Hades and on awful Persephone; she went down upon her knees and her bosom was wet with tears as she prayed that they would kill her son - and Erinys that walks in darkness and knows no ruth heard her from Erebos. "Then was heard the din of battle about the gates of Calydon, and the dull thump of the battering against their walls. Thereon the elders of the Aetolians besought Meleager; they sent the chiefest of their priests, and begged him to come out and help them, promising him a great reward. They bade him choose fifty plough-gates, the most fertile in the plain of Calydon, the one-half vineyard and the other open plough-land. The old warrior Oeneus implored him, standing at the threshold of his room and beating the doors in supplication. His sisters and his mother herself besought him sore, but he the more refused them; those of his comrades who were nearest and dearest to him also prayed him, but they could not move him till the foe was battering at the very doors of his chamber, and the Curetes had scaled the walls and were setting fire to the city. Then at last his sorrowing wife detailed the horrors that befall those whose city is taken; she reminded him how the men are slain, and the city is given over to the flames, while the women and children are carried into captivity; when he heard all this, his heart was touched, and he donned his armor to go forth. Thus of his own inward motion he saved the city of the Aetolians; but they now gave him nothing of those rich rewards that they had offered earlier, and though he saved the city he took nothing by it. Be not then, my son, thus minded; let not heaven lure you into any such course. When the ships are burning it will be a harder matter to save them. Take the gifts, and go, for the Achaeans will then honor you as a god [daimôn]; whereas if you fight without taking them, you may beat the battle back, but you will not be held in like honor [timê]." And Achilles answered, "Phoenix, old friend and foster-father, I have no need of such honor. I have honor [timê] from Zeus himself, which will abide with me at my ships while I have breath in my body, and my limbs are strong. I say further - and lay my saying to your heart - vex me no more with this weeping and lamentation, all to do a favor [kharis] for the son of Atreus. Love him so well, and you may lose the love I bear you. You ought to help me rather in troubling those that trouble me; be king as much as I am, and share like honor [timê] with myself; the others shall take my answer; stay here yourself and sleep comfortably in your bed; at daybreak we will consider whether to remain or go." On this he nodded quietly to Patroklos as a sign that he was to prepare a bed for Phoenix, and that the others should take their leave [nostos]. Ajax son of Telamon then said, "Odysseus, noble son of Laertes, let us be gone, for I see that our journey is vain. We must now take our answer, unwelcome though it be, to the Danaans who are waiting to receive it. Achilles is savage and remorseless; he is cruel, and cares nothing for the affection [philotês] that his comrades lavished upon him more than on all the others. He is implacable - and yet if a man's brother or son has been slain he will accept a fine by way of amends from him that killed him, and the wrong-doer having paid in full remains in peace in his own district [dêmos]; but as for you, Achilles, the gods have put a wicked unforgiving spirit [thumos] in your breast, and this, all about one single girl, whereas we now offer you the seven best we have, and much else into the bargain. Be then of a more gracious mind, respect the hospitality of your own roof. We are with you as messengers from the host of the Danaans, and would fain he held nearest and dearest to yourself of all the Achaeans."

9.515

εἰ μὲν γὰρ μὴ δῶρα φέροι τὰ δ’ ὄπισθ’ ὀνομάζοι
Ἀτρεΐδης, ἀλλ’ αἰὲν ἐπιζαφελῶς χαλεπαίνοι,
οὐκ ἂν ἔγωγέ σε μῆνιν ἀπορρίψαντα κελοίμην
Ἀργείοισιν ἀμυνέμεναι χατέουσί περ ἔμπης·
νῦν δ’ ἅμα τ’ αὐτίκα πολλὰ διδοῖ τὰ δ’ ὄπισθεν ὑπέστη,
ἄνδρας δὲ λίσσεσθαι ἐπιπροέηκεν ἀρίστους
κρινάμενος κατὰ λαὸν Ἀχαιϊκόν, οἵ τε σοὶ αὐτῷ
φίλτατοι Ἀργείων· τῶν μὴ σύ γε μῦθον ἐλέγξῃς
μηδὲ πόδας· πρὶν δ’ οὔ τι νεμεσσητὸν κεχολῶσθαι.
οὕτω καὶ τῶν πρόσθεν ἐπευθόμεθα κλέα ἀνδρῶν
ἡρώων, ὅτε κέν τιν’ ἐπιζάφελος χόλος ἵκοι·
δωρητοί τε πέλοντο παράρρητοί τ’ ἐπέεσσι.
μέμνημαι τόδε ἔργον ἐγὼ πάλαι οὔ τι νέον γε
ὡς ἦν· ἐν δ’ ὑμῖν ἐρέω πάντεσσι φίλοισι.
Κουρῆτές τ’ ἐμάχοντο καὶ Αἰτωλοὶ μενεχάρμαι
ἀμφὶ πόλιν Καλυδῶνα καὶ ἀλλήλους ἐνάριζον,
Αἰτωλοὶ μὲν ἀμυνόμενοι Καλυδῶνος ἐραννῆς,
Κουρῆτες δὲ διαπραθέειν μεμαῶτες Ἀρηϊ.
καὶ γὰρ τοῖσι κακὸν χρυσόθρονος Ἄρτεμις ὦρσε
χωσαμένη ὅ οἱ οὔ τι θαλύσια γουνῷ ἀλωῆς
Οἰνεὺς ῥέξ’· ἄλλοι δὲ θεοὶ δαίνυνθ’ ἑκατόμβας,
οἶῃ δ’ οὐκ ἔρρεξε Διὸς κούρῃ μεγάλοιο.
ἢ λάθετ’ ἢ οὐκ ἐνόησεν· ἀάσατο δὲ μέγα θυμῷ.
ἣ δὲ χολωσαμένη δῖον γένος ἰοχέαιρα
ὦρσεν ἔπι χλούνην σῦν ἄγριον ἀργιόδοντα,
ὃς κακὰ πόλλ’ ἔρδεσκεν ἔθων Οἰνῆος ἀλωήν·
πολλὰ δ’ ὅ γε προθέλυμνα χαμαὶ βάλε δένδρεα μακρὰ
αὐτῇσιν ῥίζῃσι καὶ αὐτοῖς ἄνθεσι μήλων.
τὸν δ’ υἱὸς Οἰνῆος ἀπέκτεινεν Μελέαγρος
πολλέων ἐκ πολίων θηρήτορας ἄνδρας ἀγείρας

9.545

καὶ κύνας· οὐ μὲν γάρ κε δάμη παύροισι βροτοῖσι·
τόσσος ἔην, πολλοὺς δὲ πυρῆς ἐπέβησ’ ἀλεγεινῆς.
ἣ δ’ ἀμφ’ αὐτῷ θῆκε πολὺν κέλαδον καὶ ἀϋτὴν
ἀμφὶ συὸς κεφαλῇ καὶ δέρματι λαχνήεντι,
Κουρήτων τε μεσηγὺ καὶ Αἰτωλῶν μεγαθύμων.
ὄφρα μὲν οὖν Μελέαγρος ἄρηι φίλος πολέμιζε,
τόφρα δὲ Κουρήτεσσι κακῶς ἦν, οὐδὲ δύναντο
τείχεος ἔκτοσθεν μίμνειν πολέες περ ἐόντες·
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ Μελέαγρον ἔδυ χόλος, ὅς τε καὶ ἄλλων
οἰδάνει ἐν στήθεσσι νόον πύκα περ φρονεόντων,
ἤτοι ὃ μητρὶ φίλῃ Ἀλθαίῃ χωόμενος κῆρ
κεῖτο παρὰ μνηστῇ ἀλόχῳ καλῇ Κλεοπάτρῃ
κούρῃ Μαρπήσσης καλλισφύρου Εὐηνίνης
Ἴδεώ θ’, ὃς κάρτιστος ἐπιχθονίων γένετ’ ἀνδρῶν
τῶν τότε· καί ῥα ἄνακτος ἐναντίον εἵλετο τόξον
Φοίβου Ἀπόλλωνος καλλισφύρου εἵνεκα νύμφης,
τὴν δὲ τότ’ ἐν μεγάροισι πατὴρ καὶ πότνια μήτηρ
Ἀλκυόνην καλέεσκον ἐπώνυμον, οὕνεκ’ ἄρ’ αὐτῆς

563 μήτηρ ἀλκυόνος πολυπενθέος οἶτον ἔχουσα
564 κλαῖεν ὅ μιν ἐκάεργος ἀνήρπασε Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων·
565 τῇ ὅ γε παρκατέλεκτο χόλον θυμαλγέα πέσσων
566 ἐξ ἀρέων μητρὸς κεχολωμένος, ἥ ῥα θεοῖσι
567 πόλλ’ ἀχέουσ’ ἠρᾶτο κασιγνήτοιο φόνοιο,
568 πολλὰ δὲ καὶ γαῖαν πολυφόρβην χερσὶν ἀλοία
569 κικλήσκουσ’ Ἀΐδην καὶ ἐπαινὴν Περσεφόνειαν
570 πρόχνυ καθεζομένη, δεύοντο δὲ δάκρυσι κόλποι,
571 παιδὶ δόμεν θάνατον· τῆς δ’ ἠεροφοῖτις Ἐρινὺς
572 ἔκλυεν ἐξ Ἐρέβεσφιν ἀμείλιχον ἦτορ ἔχουσα.
573 τῶν δὲ τάχ’ ἀμφὶ πύλας ὅμαδος καὶ δοῦπος ὀρώρει
574 πύργων βαλλομένων· τὸν δὲ λίσσοντο γέροντες

9.575

575 Αἰτωλῶν, πέμπον δὲ θεῶν ἱερῆας ἀρίστους,
576 ἐξελθεῖν καὶ ἀμῦναι ὑποσχόμενοι μέγα δῶρον·
577 ὀππόθι πιότατον πεδίον Καλυδῶνος ἐραννῆς,
578 ἔνθά μιν ἤνωγον τέμενος περικαλλὲς ἑλέσθαι
579 πεντηκοντόγυον, τὸ μὲν ἥμισυ οἰνοπέδοιο,
580 ἥμισυ δὲ ψιλὴν ἄροσιν πεδίοιο ταμέσθαι.
581 πολλὰ δέ μιν λιτάνευε γέρων ἱππηλάτα Οἰνεὺς
582 οὐδοῦ ἐπεμβεβαὼς ὑψηρεφέος θαλάμοιο
583 σείων κολλητὰς σανίδας γουνούμενος υἱόν·
584 πολλὰ δὲ τόν γε κασίγνηται καὶ πότνια μήτηρ
585 ἐλλίσσονθ’· ὃ δὲ μᾶλλον ἀναίνετο· πολλὰ δ’ ἑταῖροι,
586 οἵ οἱ κεδνότατοι καὶ φίλτατοι ἦσαν ἁπάντων·
587 ἀλλ’ οὐδ’ ὣς τοῦ θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἔπειθον,
588 πρίν γ’ ὅτε δὴ θάλαμος πύκ’ ἐβάλλετο, τοὶ δ’ ἐπὶ πύργων
589 βαῖνον Κουρῆτες καὶ ἐνέπρηθον μέγα ἄστυ.
590 καὶ τότε δὴ Μελέαγρον ἐΰζωνος παράκοιτις
591 λίσσετ’ ὀδυρομένη, καί οἱ κατέλεξεν ἅπαντα
592 κήδε’, ὅσ’ ἀνθρώποισι πέλει τῶν ἄστυ ἁλώῃ·
593 ἄνδρας μὲν κτείνουσι, πόλιν δέ τε πῦρ ἀμαθύνει,
594 τέκνα δέ τ’ ἄλλοι ἄγουσι βαθυζώνους τε γυναῖκας.
595 τοῦ δ’ ὠρίνετο θυμὸς ἀκούοντος κακὰ ἔργα,
596 βῆ δ’ ἰέναι, χροῒ δ’ ἔντε’ ἐδύσετο παμφανόωντα.
597 ὣς ὃ μὲν Αἰτωλοῖσιν ἀπήμυνεν κακὸν ἦμαρ
598 εἴξας ᾧ θυμῷ· τῷ δ’ οὐκέτι δῶρα τέλεσσαν
599 πολλά τε καὶ χαρίεντα, κακὸν δ’ ἤμυνε καὶ αὖτως.
600 ἀλλὰ σὺ μή μοι ταῦτα νόει φρεσί, μὴ δέ σε δαίμων
601 ἐνταῦθα τρέψειε φίλος· κάκιον δέ κεν εἴη
602 νηυσὶν καιομένῃσιν ἀμυνέμεν· ἀλλ’ ἐπὶ δώρων
603 ἔρχεο· ἶσον γάρ σε θεῷ τίσουσιν Ἀχαιοί.
604 εἰ δέ κ’ ἄτερ δώρων πόλεμον φθισήνορα δύῃς

9.605

605 οὐκέθ’ ὁμῶς τιμῆς ἔσεαι πόλεμόν περ ἀλαλκών.
606 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
607 Φοῖνιξ ἄττα γεραιὲ διοτρεφὲς οὔ τί με ταύτης
608 χρεὼ τιμῆς· φρονέω δὲ τετιμῆσθαι Διὸς αἴσῃ,

ἥ μ’ ἔξει παρὰ νηυσὶ κορωνίσιν εἰς ὅ κ’ ἀϋτμὴ
ἐν στήθεσσι μένῃ καί μοι φίλα γούνατ’ ὀρώρῃ.
ἄλλο δέ τοι ἐρέω, σὺ δ’ ἐνὶ φρεσὶ βάλλεο σῇσι·
μή μοι σύγχει θυμὸν ὀδυρόμενος καὶ ἀχεύων
Ἀτρεΐδῃ ἥρωϊ φέρων χάριν· οὐδέ τί σε χρὴ
τὸν φιλέειν, ἵνα μή μοι ἀπέχθηαι φιλέοντι.
καλόν τοι σὺν ἐμοὶ τὸν κήδειν ὅς κ’ ἐμὲ κήδῃ·
ἶσον ἐμοὶ βασίλευε καὶ ἥμισυ μείρεο τιμῆς.
οὗτοι δ’ ἀγγελέουσι, σὺ δ’ αὐτόθι λέξεο μίμνων
εὐνῇ ἔνι μαλακῇ· ἅμα δ’ ἠοῖ φαινομένηφι
φρασσόμεθ’ ἤ κε νεώμεθ’ ἐφ’ ἡμέτερ’ ἦ κε μένωμεν.
ἦ καὶ Πατρόκλῳ ὅ γ’ ἐπ’ ὀφρύσι νεῦσε σιωπῇ
Φοίνικι στορέσαι πυκινὸν λέχος, ὄφρα τάχιστα
ἐκ κλισίης νόστοιο μεδοίατο· τοῖσι δ’ ἄρ’ Αἴας
ἀντίθεος Τελαμωνιάδης μετὰ μῦθον ἔειπε·
διογενὲς Λαερτιάδη πολυμήχαν’ Ὀδυσσεῦ
ἴομεν· οὐ γάρ μοι δοκέει μύθοιο τελευτὴ
τῇδέ γ’ ὁδῷ κρανέεσθαι· ἀπαγγεῖλαι δὲ τάχιστα
χρὴ μῦθον Δαναοῖσι καὶ οὐκ ἀγαθόν περ ἐόντα
οἵ που νῦν ἔαται ποτιδέγμενοι. αὐτάρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
ἄγριον ἐν στήθεσσι θέτο μεγαλήτορα θυμὸν
σχέτλιος, οὐδὲ μετατρέπεται φιλότητος ἑταίρων
τῆς ᾗ μιν παρὰ νηυσὶν ἐτίομεν ἔξοχον ἄλλων
νηλής· καὶ μέν τίς τε κασιγνήτοιο φονῆος
ποινὴν ἢ οὖ παιδὸς ἐδέξατο τεθνηῶτος·
καί ῥ’ ὃ μὲν ἐν δήμῳ μένει αὐτοῦ πόλλ’ ἀποτίσας,

9.635

τοῦ δέ τ’ ἐρητύεται κραδίη καὶ θυμὸς ἀγήνωρ
ποινὴν δεξαμένῳ· σοὶ δ’ ἄληκτόν τε κακόν τε
θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσι θεοὶ θέσαν εἵνεκα κούρης
οἵης· νῦν δέ τοι ἑπτὰ παρίσχομεν ἔξοχ’ ἀρίστας,
ἄλλά τε πόλλ’ ἐπὶ τῇσι· σὺ δ’ ἵλαον ἔνθεο θυμόν,
αἴδεσσαι δὲ μέλαθρον· ὑπωρόφιοι δέ τοί εἰμεν
πληθύος ἐκ Δαναῶν, μέμαμεν δέ τοι ἔξοχον ἄλλων
κήδιστοί τ’ ἔμεναι καὶ φίλτατοι ὅσσοι Ἀχαιοί.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
Αἶαν διογενὲς Τελαμώνιε κοίρανε λαῶν
πάντά τί μοι κατὰ θυμὸν ἐείσαο μυθήσασθαι·
ἀλλά μοι οἰδάνεται κραδίη χόλῳ ὁππότε κείνων
μνήσομαι ὥς μ’ ἀσύφηλον ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἔρεξεν
Ἀτρεΐδης ὡς εἴ τιν’ ἀτίμητον μετανάστην.
ἀλλ’ ὑμεῖς ἔρχεσθε καὶ ἀγγελίην ἀπόφασθε·
οὐ γὰρ πρὶν πολέμοιο μεδήσομαι αἱματόεντος
πρίν γ’ υἱὸν Πριάμοιο δαΐφρονος Ἕκτορα δῖον
Μυρμιδόνων ἐπί τε κλισίας καὶ νῆας ἰκέσθαι
κτείνοντ’ Ἀργείους, κατά τε σμῦξαι πυρὶ νῆας.
ἀμφὶ δέ τοι τῇ ἐμῇ κλισίῃ καὶ νηῒ μελαίνῃ
Ἕκτορα καὶ μεμαῶτα μάχης σχήσεσθαι οἴω.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δὲ ἕκαστος ἐλὼν δέπας ἀμφικύπελλον
σπείσαντες παρὰ νῆας ἴσαν πάλιν· ἦρχε δ’ Ὀδυσσεύς.

658 Πάτροκλος δ’ ἑτάροισιν ἰδὲ δμωῇσι κέλευσε
659 Φοίνικι στορέσαι πυκινὸν λέχος ὅττι τάχιστα.
660 αἳ δ’ ἐπιπειθόμεναι στόρεσαν λέχος ὡς ἐκέλευσε
661 κώεά τε ῥῆγός τε λίνοιό τε λεπτὸν ἄωτον.
662 ἔνθ’ ὃ γέρων κατέλεκτο καὶ ἠῶ δῖαν ἔμιμνεν.
663 αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς εὖδε μυχῷ κλισίης εὐπήκτου·
664 τῷ δ’ ἄρα παρκατέλεκτο γυνή, τὴν Λεσβόθεν ἦγε,

"Ajax," replied Achilles, "noble son of Telamon, you have spoken much to my liking, but my blood boils when I think it all over, and remember how the son of Atreus treated me with contumely as though I were some vile tramp, and that too in the presence of the Argives. Go, then, and deliver your message; say that I will have no concern with fighting till Hektor, son of noble Priam, reaches the tents of the Myrmidons in his murderous course, and flings fire upon their ships. For all his lust of battle, I take it he will be held in check when he is at my own tent and ship." On this they took every man his double cup, made their drink-offerings, and went back to the ships, Odysseus leading the way. But Patroklos told his men and the maid-servants to make ready a comfortable bed for Phoenix; they therefore did so with sheepskins, a rug, and a sheet of fine linen. The old man then laid himself down and waited till morning came. But Achilles slept in an inner room, and beside him the daughter of Phorbas lovely Diomede, whom he had carried off from Lesbos. Patroklos lay on the other side of the room, and with him fair Iphis whom Achilles had given him when he took Skyros the city of Enyeus. When the envoys reached the tents of the son of Atreus, the Achaeans rose, pledged them in cups of gold, and began to question them. King Agamemnon was the first to do so. Tell me, Odysseus," said he, "will he save the ships from burning, or did be refuse, and is he still furious?" Odysseus answered, "Most noble son of Atreus, king of men, Agamemnon, Achilles will not be calmed, but is more fiercely angry than ever, and spurns both you and your gifts. He bids you take counsel with the Achaeans to save the ships and host as you best may; as for himself, he said that at daybreak he should draw his ships into the water. He said further that he should advise every one to sail home likewise, for that you will not reach the goal of Ilion. ‘Zeus,’ he said, ‘has laid his hand over the city to protect it, and the people have taken heart.’ This is what he said, and the others who were with me can tell you the same story - Ajax and the two heralds, men, both of them, who may be trusted. The old man Phoenix stayed where he was to sleep, for so Achilles would have it, that he might go home with him in the morning if he so would; but he will not take him by force." They all held their peace, sitting for a long time silent and dejected, by reason of the sternness with which Achilles had refused them, till presently Diomedes said, "Most noble son of Atreus, king of men, Agamemnon, you ought not to have sued the son of Peleus nor offered him gifts. He is proud enough as it is, and you have encouraged him in his pride am further. Let him stay or go as he will. He will fight later when he is in the humor, and heaven puts it in his mind to do so. Now, therefore, let us all do as I say; we have eaten and drunk our fill, let us then take our rest, for in rest there is both strength and stay. But when fair rosy-fingered morn appears, forthwith bring out your host and your horsemen in front of the ships, urging them on, and yourself fighting among the foremost." Thus he spoke, and the other chieftains approved his words. They then made their drink-offerings and went every man to his own tent, where they laid down to rest and enjoyed the boon of sleep.

9.665

665 Φόρβαντος θυγάτηρ Διομήδη καλλιπάρῃος.
666 Πάτροκλος δ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐλέξατο· πὰρ δ’ ἄρα καὶ τῷ
667 Ἴφις ἐΰζωνος, τήν οἱ πόρε δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
668 Σκῦρον ἑλὼν αἰπεῖαν Ἐνυῆος πτολίεθρον.
669 οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ κλισίῃσιν ἐν Ἀτρεΐδαο γένοντο.

τοὺς μὲν ἄρα χρυσέοισι κυπέλλοις υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
δειδέχατ’ ἄλλοθεν ἄλλος ἀνασταδόν, ἔκ τ’ ἐρέοντο·
πρῶτος δ’ ἐξερέεινεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
εἶπ’ ἄγε μ’ ὦ πολύαιν’ Ὀδυσεῦ μέγα κῦδος Ἀχαιῶν
ἦ ῥ’ ἐθέλει νήεσσιν ἀλεξέμεναι δήϊον πῦρ,
ἦ ἀπέειπε, χόλος δ’ ἔτ’ ἔχει μεγαλήτορα θυμόν;
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε πολύτλας δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς·
Ἀτρεΐδη κύδιστε ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγάμεμνον
κεῖνός γ’ οὐκ ἐθέλει σβέσσαι χόλον, ἀλλ’ ἔτι μᾶλλον
πιμπλάνεται μένεος, σὲ δ’ ἀναίνεται ἠδὲ σὰ δῶρα.
αὐτόν σε φράζεσθαι ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἄνωγεν
ὅππως κεν νῆάς τε σαῷς καὶ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν·
αὐτὸς δ’ ἠπείλησεν ἅμ’ ἠοῖ φαινομένηφι
νῆας ἐϋσσέλμους ἅλαδ’ ἑλκέμεν ἀμφιελίσσας.
καὶ δ’ ἂν τοῖς ἄλλοισιν ἔφη παραμυθήσασθαι
οἴκαδ’ ἀποπλείειν, ἐπεὶ οὐκέτι δήετε τέκμωρ
Ἰλίου αἰπεινῆς· μάλα γάρ ἐθεν εὐρύοπα Ζεὺς
χεῖρα ἐὴν ὑπερέσχε, τεθαρσήκασι δὲ λαοί.
ὣς ἔφατ’· εἰσὶ καὶ οἵδε τάδ’ εἰπέμεν, οἵ μοι ἕποντο,
Αἴας καὶ κήρυκε δύω πεπνυμένω ἄμφω.
Φοῖνιξ δ’ αὖθ’ ὃ γέρων κατελέξατο, ὡς γὰρ ἀνώγει,
ὄφρά οἱ ἐν νήεσσι φίλην ἐς πατρίδ’ ἔπηται
αὔριον, ἢν ἐθέλῃσιν· ἀνάγκῃ δ’ οὔ τί μιν ἄξει.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἀκὴν ἐγένοντο σιωπῇ
μῦθον ἀγασσάμενοι· μάλα γὰρ κρατερῶς ἀγόρευσε.

9.695

δὴν δ’ ἄνεῳ ἦσαν τετιηότες υἷες Ἀχαιῶν·
ὀψὲ δὲ δὴ μετέειπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
Ἀτρεΐδη κύδιστε ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγάμεμνον
μὴ ὄφελες λίσσεσθαι ἀμύμονα Πηλεΐωνα
μυρία δῶρα διδούς· ὃ δ’ ἀγήνωρ ἐστὶ καὶ ἄλλως·
νῦν αὖ μιν πολὺ μᾶλλον ἀγηνορίῃσιν ἐνῆκας.
ἀλλ’ ἤτοι κεῖνον μὲν ἐάσομεν ἤ κεν ἴῃσιν
ἦ κε μένῃ· τότε δ’ αὖτε μαχήσεται ὁππότε κέν μιν
θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἀνώγῃ καὶ θεὸς ὄρσῃ.
ἀλλ’ ἄγεθ’ ὡς ἂν ἐγὼ εἴπω πειθώμεθα πάντες·
νῦν μὲν κοιμήσασθε τεταρπόμενοι φίλον ἦτορ
σίτου καὶ οἴνοιο· τὸ γὰρ μένος ἐστὶ καὶ ἀλκή·
αὐτὰρ ἐπεί κε φανῇ καλὴ ῥοδοδάκτυλος Ἠώς,
καρπαλίμως πρὸ νεῶν ἐχέμεν λαόν τε καὶ ἵππους
ὀτρύνων, καὶ δ’ αὐτὸς ἐνὶ πρώτοισι μάχεσθαι.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἐπῄνησαν βασιλῆες
μῦθον ἀγασσάμενοι Διομήδεος ἱπποδάμοιο.
καὶ τότε δὴ σπείσαντες ἔβαν κλισίην δὲ ἕκαστος,
ἔνθα δὲ κοιμήσαντο καὶ ὕπνου δῶρον ἔλοντο.

10.1

ἄλλοι μὲν παρὰ νηυσὶν ἀριστῆες Παναχαιῶν
εὗδον παννύχιοι μαλακῷ δεδμημένοι ὕπνῳ·

3 ἀλλ’ οὐκ Ἀτρεΐδην Ἀγαμέμνονα ποιμένα λαῶν
4 ὕπνος ἔχε γλυκερὸς πολλὰ φρεσὶν ὀρμαίνοντα.
5 ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἂν ἀστράπτῃ πόσις Ἥρης ἠϋκόμοιο
6 τεύχων ἢ πολὺν ὄμβρον ἀθέσφατον ἠὲ χάλαζαν
7 ἢ νιφετόν, ὅτε πέρ τε χιὼν ἐπάλυνεν ἀρούρας,
8 ἠέ ποθι πτολέμοιο μέγα στόμα πευκεδανοῖο,
9 ὣς πυκίν’ ἐν στήθεσσιν ἀνεστενάχιζ’ Ἀγαμέμνων
10 νειόθεν ἐκ κραδίης, τρομέοντο δέ οἱ φρένες ἐντός.
11 ἤτοι ὅτ’ ἐς πεδίον τὸ Τρωϊκὸν ἀθρήσειε,
12 θαύμαζεν πυρὰ πολλὰ τὰ καίετο Ἰλιόθι πρὸ
13 αὐλῶν συρίγγων τ’ ἐνοπὴν ὅμαδόν τ’ ἀνθρώπων.
14 αὐτὰρ ὅτ’ ἐς νῆάς τε ἴδοι καὶ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν,
15 πολλὰς ἐκ κεφαλῆς προθελύμνους ἔλκετο χαίτας
16 ὑψόθ’ ἐόντι Διί, μέγα δ’ ἔστενε κυδάλιμον κῆρ.
17 ἤδε δέ οἱ κατὰ θυμὸν ἀρίστη φαίνετο βουλὴ
18 Νέστορ’ ἔπι πρῶτον Νηλήϊον ἐλθέμεν ἀνδρῶν,
19 εἴ τινά οἱ σὺν μῆτιν ἀμύμονα τεκτήναιτο,
20 ἤ τις ἀλεξίκακος πᾶσιν Δαναοῖσι γένοιτο.
21 ὀρθωθεὶς δ’ ἔνδυνε περὶ στήθεσσι χιτῶνα,
22 ποσσὶ δ’ ὑπὸ λιπαροῖσιν ἐδήσατο καλὰ πέδιλα,
23 ἀμφὶ δ’ ἔπειτα δαφοινὸν ἑέσσατο δέρμα λέοντος
24 αἴθωνος μεγάλοιο ποδηνεκές, εἵλετο δ’ ἔγχος.
25 ὣς δ’ αὔτως Μενέλαον ἔχε τρόμος· οὐδὲ γὰρ αὐτῷ
26 ὕπνος ἐπὶ βλεφάροισιν ἐφίζανε· μή τι πάθοιεν
27 Ἀργεῖοι, τοὶ δὴ ἕθεν εἵνεκα πουλὺν ἐφ’ ὑγρὴν
28 ἤλυθον ἐς Τροίην πόλεμον θρασὺν ὀρμαίνοντες.
29 παρδαλέῃ μὲν πρῶτα μετάφρενον εὐρὺ κάλυψε
30 ποικίλῃ, αὐτὰρ ἐπὶ στεφάνην κεφαλῆφιν ἀείρας

Now the other princes of the Achaeans slept soundly the whole night through, but Agamemnon son of Atreus was troubled, so that he could get no rest. As when fair Hera's lord flashes his lightning in token of great rain or hail or snow when the snow-flakes whiten the ground, or again as a sign that he will open the wide jaws of hungry war, even so did Agamemnon heave many a heavy sigh, for his soul trembled within him. When he looked upon the plain of Troy he marveled at the many watchfires burning in front of Ilion, and at the sound of pipes and flutes and of the hum of men, but when presently he turned towards the ships and hosts of the Achaeans, he tore his hair by handfuls before Zeus on high, and groaned aloud for the very disquietness of his soul. In the end he deemed it best to go at once to Nestor son of Neleus, and see if between them they could find any way of the Achaeans from destruction. He therefore rose, put on his shirt, bound his sandals about his comely feet, flung the skin of a huge tawny lion over his shoulders - a skin that reached his feet- and took his spear in his hand. Neither could Menelaos sleep, for he, too, boded ill for the Argives who for his sake had sailed from far over the seas to fight the Trojans. He covered his broad back with the skin of a spotted panther, put a casque of bronze upon his head, and took his spear in his brawny hand. Then he went to rouse his brother, who was by far the most powerful of the Achaeans, and was honored in his district [dêmos] as though he were a god. He found him by the stern of his ship already putting his goodly array about his shoulders, and right glad was he that his brother had come. Menelaos spoke first. "Why," said he, "my dear brother, are you thus arming? Are you going to send any of our comrades to exploit the Trojans? I greatly fear that no one will do you this service, and spy upon the enemy alone in the dead of night. It will be a deed of great daring." And King Agamemnon answered, "Menelaos, we both of us need shrewd counsel to save the Argives

and our ships, for Zeus has changed his mind, and inclines towards Hektor's sacrifices rather than ours. I never saw nor heard tell of any man as having wrought such ruin in one day as Hektor has now wrought against the sons of the Achaeans - and that too of his own unaided self, for he is son neither to god nor goddess. The Argives will rue it long and deeply. Run, therefore, with all speed by the line of the ships, and call Ajax and Idomeneus. Meanwhile I will go to Nestor, and bid him rise and go about among the companies of our sentinels to give them their instructions; they will listen to him sooner than to any man, for his own son, and Meriones brother in arms to Idomeneus, are leaders over them. It was to them more particularly that we gave this charge." Menelaos replied, "How do I take your meaning? Am I to stay with them and wait your coming, or shall I return here as soon as I have given your orders?" "Wait," answered King Agamemnon, "for there are so many paths about the camp that we might miss one another. Call every man on your way, and bid him be stirring; name him by his lineage and by his father's name, give each all titular observance, and stand not too much upon your own dignity; we must take our full share of toil, for at our birth Zeus laid this heavy burden upon us." With these instructions he sent his brother on his way, and went on to Nestor shepherd of his people. He found him sleeping in his tent hard by his own ship; his goodly armor lay beside him - his shield, his two spears and his helmet; beside him also lay the gleaming belt with which the old man girded himself when he armed to lead his people into battle - for his age stayed him not. He raised himself on his elbow and looked up at Agamemnon. "Who is it," said he, "that goes thus about the host and the ships alone and in the dead of night, when men are sleeping? Are you looking for one of your mules or for some comrade? Do not stand there and say nothing, but speak. What is your business?" And Agamemnon answered, "Nestor, son of Neleus, honor to the Achaean name, it is I, Agamemnon son of Atreus, on whom Zeus has laid labor [ponoi] and sorrow so long as there is breath in my body and my limbs carry me. I am thus abroad because sleep sits not upon my eyelids, but my heart is big with war and with the jeopardy of the Achaeans. I am in great fear for the Danaans. I am at sea, and without sure counsel; my heart beats as though it would leap out of my body, and my limbs fail me. If then you can do anything - for you too cannot sleep - let us go the round of the watch, and see whether they are drowsy with toil and sleeping to the neglect of their duty. The enemy is encamped hard and we know not but he may attack us by night." Nestor replied, "Most noble son of Atreus, king of men, Agamemnon, Zeus will not do all for Hektor that Hektor thinks he will; he will have troubles yet in plenty if Achilles will lay aside his anger. I will go with you, and we will rouse others, either the son of Tydeus, or Odysseus, or fleet Ajax and the valiant son of Phyleus. Some one had also better go and call Ajax and King Idomeneus, for their ships are not near at hand but the farthest of all. I cannot however refrain from blaming Menelaos, much as I love him and respect him -

10.31

31 θήκατο χαλκείην, δόρυ δ’ εἴλετο χειρὶ παχείῃ.
32 βῆ δ’ ἴμεν ἀνστήσων ὃν ἀδελφεόν, ὃς μέγα πάντων
33 Ἀργείων ἤνασσε, θεὸς δ’ ὡς τίετο δήμῳ.
34 τὸν δ’ εὗρ’ ἀμφ’ ὤμοισι τιθήμενον ἔντεα καλὰ
35 νηῒ πάρα πρύμνῃ· τῷ δ’ ἀσπάσιος γένετ’ ἐλθών.
36 τὸν πρότερος προσέειπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος·
37 τίφθ’ οὕτως ἠθεῖε κορύσσεαι; ἦ τιν’ ἑταίρων
38 ὀτρυνέεις Τρώεσσιν ἐπίσκοπον; ἀλλὰ μάλ’ αἰνῶς
39 δείδω μὴ οὔ τίς τοι ὑπόσχηται τόδε ἔργον
40 ἄνδρας δυσμενέας σκοπιαζέμεν οἷος ἐπελθὼν
41 νύκτα δι’ ἀμβροσίην· μάλα τις θρασυκάρδιος ἔσται.
42 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων·

χρεὼ βουλῆς ἐμὲ καὶ σὲ διοτρεφὲς ὦ Μενέλαε
κερδαλέης, ἥ τίς κεν ἐρύσσεται ἠδὲ σαώσει
Ἀργείους καὶ νῆας, ἐπεὶ Διὸς ἐτράπετο φρήν.
Ἕκτορέοις ἄρα μᾶλλον ἐπὶ φρένα θῆχ’ ἱεροῖσιν·
οὐ γάρ πω ἰδόμην, οὐδ’ ἔκλυον αὐδήσαντος
ἄνδρ’ ἕνα τοσσάδε μέρμερ’ ἐπ’ ἤματι μητίσασθαι,
ὅσσ’ Ἕκτωρ ἔρρεξε Διῒ φίλος υἱὰς Ἀχαιῶν
αὖτως, οὔτε θεᾶς υἱὸς φίλος οὔτε θεοῖο.
ἔργα δ’ ἔρεξ’ ὅσα φημὶ μελησέμεν Ἀργείοισι
δηθά τε καὶ δολιχόν· τόσα γὰρ κακὰ μήσατ’ Ἀχαιούς.
ἀλλ’ ἴθι νῦν Αἴαντα καὶ Ἰδομενῆα κάλεσσον
ῥίμφα θέων παρὰ νῆας· ἐγὼ δ’ ἐπὶ Νέστορα δῖον
εἶμι, καὶ ὀτρυνέω ἀνστήμεναι, αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσιν
ἐλθεῖν ἐς φυλάκων ἱερὸν τέλος ἠδ’ ἐπιτεῖλαι.
κείνῳ γάρ κε μάλιστα πιθοίατο· τοῖο γὰρ υἱὸς
σημαίνει φυλάκεσσι καὶ Ἰδομενῆος ὀπάων
Μηριόνης· τοῖσιν γὰρ ἐπετράπομέν γε μάλιστα.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος·

10.61

πῶς γάρ μοι μύθῳ ἐπιτέλλεαι ἠδὲ κελεύεις;
αὖθι μένω μετὰ τοῖσι δεδεγμένος εἰς ὅ κεν ἔλθῃς,
ἦε θέω μετὰ σ’ αὖτις, ἐπὴν εὖ τοῖς ἐπιτείλω;
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων,
αὖθι μένειν, μή πως ἀβροτάξομεν ἀλλήλοιιν
ἐρχομένω· πολλαὶ γὰρ ἀνὰ στρατόν εἰσι κέλευθοι.
φθέγγεο δ’ ᾗ κεν ἴῃσθα καὶ ἐγρήγορθαι ἄνωχθι
πατρόθεν ἐκ γενεῆς ὀνομάζων ἄνδρα ἕκαστον
πάντας κυδαίνων· μηδὲ μεγαλίζεο θυμῷ,
ἀλλὰ καὶ αὐτοί περ πονεώμεθα· ὧδέ που ἄμμι
Ζεὺς ἐπὶ γιγνομένοισιν ἴει κακότητα βαρεῖαν.
ὣς εἰπὼν ἀπέπεμπεν ἀδελφεὸν εὖ ἐπιτείλας·
αὐτὰρ ὃ βῆ ῥ’ ἰέναι μετὰ Νέστορα ποιμένα λαῶν·
τὸν δ’ εὗρεν παρά τε κλισίῃ καὶ νηῒ μελαίνῃ
εὐνῇ ἔνι μαλακῇ· παρὰ δ’ ἔντεα ποικίλ’ ἔκειτο
ἀσπὶς καὶ δύο δοῦρε φαεινή τε τρυφάλεια.
πὰρ δὲ ζωστὴρ κεῖτο παναίολος, ᾧ ῥ’ ὁ γεραιὸς
ζώννυθ’ ὅτ’ ἐς πόλεμον φθισήνορα θωρήσσοιτο
λαὸν ἄγων, ἐπεὶ οὐ μὲν ἐπέτρεπε γήραϊ λυγρῷ.
ὀρθωθεὶς δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπ’ ἀγκῶνος κεφαλὴν ἐπαείρας
Ἀτρεΐδην προσέειπε καὶ ἐξερεείνετο μύθῳ·
τίς δ’ οὗτος κατὰ νῆας ἀνὰ στρατὸν ἔρχεαι οἷος
νύκτα δι’ ὀρφναίην, ὅτε θ’ εὕδουσι βροτοὶ ἄλλοι,
ἠέ τιν’ οὐρήων διζήμενος, ἤ τιν’ ἑταίρων;
φθέγγεο, μηδ’ ἀκέων ἐπ’ ἔμ’ ἔρχεο· τίπτε δέ σε χρεώ;
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
ὦ Νέστορ Νηληϊάδη μέγα κῦδος Ἀχαιῶν
γνώσεαι Ἀτρεΐδην Ἀγαμέμνονα, τὸν περὶ πάντων
Ζεὺς ἐνέηκε πόνοισι διαμπερὲς εἰς ὅ κ’ ἀϋτμὴ
ἐν στήθεσσι μένῃ καί μοι φίλα γούνατ’ ὀρώρῃ.

10.91

91 πλάζομαι ὦδ’ ἐπεὶ οὔ μοι ἐπ’ ὄμμασι νήδυμος ὕπνος
92 ἰζάνει, ἀλλὰ μέλει πόλεμος καὶ κήδε’ Ἀχαιῶν.
93 αἰνῶς γὰρ Δαναῶν περιδείδια, οὐδέ μοι ἦτορ
94 ἔμπεδον, ἀλλ’ ἀλαλύκτημαι, κραδίη δέ μοι ἔξω
95 στηθέων ἐκθρῴσκει, τρομέει δ’ ὑπὸ φαίδιμα γυῖα.
96 ἀλλ’ εἴ τι δραίνεις, ἐπεὶ οὐδὲ σέ γ’ ὕπνος ἱκάνει,
97 δεῦρ’ ἐς τοὺς φύλακας καταβήομεν, ὄφρα ἴδωμεν
98 μὴ τοὶ μὲν καμάτῳ ἀδηκότες ἠδὲ καὶ ὕπνῳ
99 κοιμήσωνται, ἀτὰρ φυλακῆς ἐπὶ πάγχυ λάθωνται.
100 δυσμενέες δ’ ἄνδρες σχεδὸν εἴαται· οὐδέ τι ἴδμεν
101 μή πως καὶ διὰ νύκτα μενοινήσωσι μάχεσθαι.
102 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
103 Ἀτρεΐδη κύδιστε ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγάμεμνον
104 οὔ θην Ἕκτορι πάντα νοήματα μητίετα Ζεὺς
105 ἐκτελέει, ὅσα πού νυν ἐέλπεται· ἀλλά μιν οἴω
106 κήδεσι μοχθήσειν καὶ πλείοσιν, εἴ κεν Ἀχιλλεὺς
107 ἐκ χόλου ἀργαλέοιο μεταστρέψῃ φίλον ἦτορ.
108 σοὶ δὲ μάλ’ ἔψομ’ ἐγώ· ποτὶ δ’ αὖ καὶ ἐγείρομεν ἄλλους
109 ἡμὲν Τυδεΐδην δουρὶ κλυτὸν ἠδ’ Ὀδυσῆα
110 ἠδ’ Αἴαντα ταχὺν καὶ Φυλέος ἄλκιμον υἱόν.
111 ἀλλ’ εἴ τις καὶ τούσδε μετοιχόμενος καλέσειεν
112 ἀντίθεόν τ’ Αἴαντα καὶ Ἰδομενῆα ἄνακτα·
113 τῶν γὰρ νῆες ἔασιν ἑκαστάτω, οὐδὲ μάλ’ ἐγγύς.
114 ἀλλὰ φίλον περ ἐόντα καὶ αἰδοῖον Μενέλαον
115 νεικέσω, εἴ πέρ μοι νεμεσήσεαι, οὐδ’ ἐπικεύσω
116 ὡς εὖδει, σοὶ δ’ οἵῳ ἐπέτρεψεν πονέεσθαι.
117 νῦν ὄφελεν κατὰ πάντας ἀριστῆας πονέεσθαι
118 λισσόμενος· χρειὼ γὰρ ἱκάνεται οὐκέτ’ ἀνεκτός.
119 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
120 ὦ γέρον ἄλλοτε μέν σε καὶ αἰτιάασθαι ἄνωγα·

and I will say so plainly, even at the risk of offending you - for sleeping and leaving all this trouble to yourself. He ought to be going about imploring aid from all the princes of the Achaeans, for we are in extreme danger." And Agamemnon answered, "Sir, you may sometimes blame him justly, for he is often remiss and unwilling to exert himself - not indeed from sloth, nor yet lack of thought [noos], but because he looks to me and expects me to take the lead. On this occasion, however, he was awake before I was, and came to me of his own accord. I have already sent him to call the very men whom you have named. And now let us be going. We shall find them with the watch outside the gates, for it was there I said that we would meet them." "In that case," answered Nestor, "the Argives will not blame him nor disobey his orders when he urges them to fight or gives them instructions." With this he put on his shirt, and bound his sandals about his comely feet. He buckled on his purple coat, of two thicknesses, large, and of a rough shaggy texture, grasped his redoubtable bronze-shod spear, and wended his way along the line of the Achaean ships. First he called loudly to Odysseus peer of gods in counsel and woke him, for he was soon roused by the sound of the battle-cry. He came outside his tent and said, "Why do you go thus alone about the host, and along the line of the ships in the stillness of the night? What is it that you find so urgent?" And Nestor horseman of Gerene answered, "Odysseus, noble son of Laertes, take it not amiss, for the Achaeans are in great sorrow [akhos]. Come with me and let us wake some other, who may advise well with us whether we shall fight or flee." On this Odysseus went at once into his tent, put his shield about his shoulders and came out

with them. First they went to Diomedes son of Tydeus, and found him outside his tent clad in his armor with his comrades sleeping round him and using their shields as pillows; as for their spears, they stood upright on the spikes of their butts that were driven into the ground, and the burnished bronze flashed afar like the lightning of father Zeus. The hero was sleeping upon the skin of an ox, with a piece of fine carpet under his head; Nestor went up to him and stirred him with his heel to rouse him, upbraiding him and urging him to bestir himself. "Wake up," he exclaimed, "son of Tydeus. How can you sleep on in this way? Can you not see that the Trojans are encamped on the brow of the plain hard by our ships, with but a little space between us and them?" On these words Diomedes leaped up instantly and said, "Old man, your heart is of iron; you rest not one moment from your labors [ponos]. Are there no younger men among the Achaeans who could go about to rouse the princes? There is no tiring you." And Nestor horseman of Gerene made answer, "My son, all that you have said is true. I have good sons, and also many people who might call the chieftains, but the Achaeans are in the gravest danger; life and death are balanced as it were on the edge of a razor. Go then, for you are younger than I, and of your courtesy rouse Ajax and the fleet son of Phyleus."

10.121

121 πολλάκι γὰρ μεθιεῖ τε καὶ οὐκ ἐθέλει πονέεσθαι
122 οὔτ’ ὄκνῳ εἴκων οὔτ’ ἀφραδίῃσι νόοιο,
123 ἀλλ’ ἐμέ τ’ εἰσορόων καὶ ἐμὴν ποτιδέγμενος ὁρμήν.
124 νῦν δ’ ἐμέο πρότερος μάλ’ ἐπέγρετο καί μοι ἐπέστη·
125 τὸν μὲν ἐγὼ προέηκα καλήμεναι οὓς σὺ μεταλλᾷς.
126 ἀλλ’ ἴομεν· κείνους δὲ κιχησόμεθα πρὸ πυλάων
127 ἐν φυλάκεσσ’, ἵνα γάρ σφιν ἐπέφραδον ἠγερέθεσθαι.
128 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
129 οὕτως οὔ τίς οἱ νεμεσήσεται οὐδ’ ἀπιθήσει
130 Ἀργείων, ὅτε κέν τιν’ ἐποτρύνῃ καὶ ἀνώγῃ.
131 ὣς εἰπὼν ἔνδυνε περὶ στήθεσσι χιτῶνα,
132 ποσσὶ δ’ ὑπὸ λιπαροῖσιν ἐδήσατο καλὰ πέδιλα,
133 ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρα χλαῖναν περονήσατο φοινικόεσσαν
134 διπλῆν ἐκταδίην, οὔλη δ’ ἐπενήνοθε λάχνη.
135 εἵλετο δ’ ἄλκιμον ἔγχος ἀκαχμένον ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ,
136 βῆ δ’ ἰέναι κατὰ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων.
137 πρῶτον ἔπειτ’ Ὀδυσῆα Διὶ μῆτιν ἀτάλαντον
138 ἐξ ὕπνου ἀνέγειρε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ
139 φθεγξάμενος· τὸν δ’ αἶψα περὶ φρένας ἦλυθ’ ἰωή,
140 ἐκ δ’ ἦλθε κλισίης καί σφεας πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπε·
141 τίφθ’ οὕτω κατὰ νῆας ἀνὰ στρατὸν οἶοι ἀλᾶσθε
142 νύκτα δι’ ἀμβροσίην, ὅ τι δὴ χρειὼ τόσον ἵκει;
143 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
144 διογενὲς Λαερτιάδη πολυμήχαν’ Ὀδυσσεῦ
145 μὴ νεμέσα· τοῖον γὰρ ἄχος βεβίηκεν Ἀχαιούς.
146 ἀλλ’ ἔπε’, ὄφρα καὶ ἄλλον ἐγείρομεν ὅν τ’ ἐπέοικε
147 βουλὰς βουλεύειν, ἢ φευγέμεν ἠὲ μάχεσθαι.
148 ὣς φάθ’, ὃ δὲ κλισίην δὲ κιὼν πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεὺς
149 ποικίλον ἀμφ’ ὤμοισι σάκος θέτο, βῆ δὲ μετ’ αὐτούς.
150 βὰν δ’ ἐπὶ Τυδεΐδην Διομήδεα· τὸν δὲ κίχανον

10.151

ἐκτὸς ἀπὸ κλισίης σὺν τεύχεσιν· ἀμφὶ δ’ ἑταῖροι
εὖδον, ὑπὸ κρασὶν δ’ ἔχον ἀσπίδας· ἔγχεα δέ σφιν
ὄρθ’ ἐπὶ σαυρωτῆρος ἐλήλατο, τῆλε δὲ χαλκὸς
λάμφ’ ὥς τε στεροπὴ πατρὸς Διός· αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἥρως
εὖδ’, ὑπὸ δ’ ἔστρωτο ῥινὸν βοὸς ἀγραύλοιο,
αὐτὰρ ὑπὸ κράτεσφι τάπης τετάνυστο φαεινός.
τὸν παρστὰς ἀνέγειρε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ,
λὰξ ποδὶ κινήσας, ὄτρυνέ τε νείκεσέ τ’ ἄντην·
ἔγρεο Τυδέος υἱέ· τί πάννυχον ὕπνον ἀωτεῖς;
οὐκ ἀΐεις ὡς Τρῶες ἐπὶ θρωσμῷ πεδίοιο
εἵαται ἄγχι νεῶν, ὀλίγος δ’ ἔτι χῶρος ἐρύκει;
ὣς φάθ’, ὃ δ’ ἐξ ὕπνοιο μάλα κραιπνῶς ἀνόρουσε,
καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
σχέτλιός ἐσσι γεραιέ· σὺ μὲν πόνου οὔ ποτε λήγεις.
οὔ νυ καὶ ἄλλοι ἔασι νεώτεροι υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
οἵ κεν ἔπειτα ἕκαστον ἐγείρειαν βασιλήων
πάντῃ ἐποιχόμενοι; σὺ δ’ ἀμήχανός ἐσσι γεραιέ.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
ναὶ δὴ ταῦτά γε πάντα φίλος κατὰ μοῖραν ἔειπες.
εἰσὶν μέν μοι παῖδες ἀμύμονες, εἰσὶ δὲ λαοὶ
καὶ πολέες, τῶν κέν τις ἐποιχόμενος καλέσειεν·
ἀλλὰ μάλα μεγάλη χρειὼ βεβίηκεν Ἀχαιούς.
νῦν γὰρ δὴ πάντεσσιν ἐπὶ ξυροῦ ἵσταται ἀκμῆς
ἢ μάλα λυγρὸς ὄλεθρος Ἀχαιοῖς ἠὲ βιῶναι.
ἀλλ’ ἴθι νῦν Αἴαντα ταχὺν καὶ Φυλέος υἱὸν
ἄνστησον· σὺ γάρ ἐσσι νεώτερος· εἴ μ’ ἐλεαίρεις.
ὣς φάθ’, ὃ δ’ ἀμφ’ ὤμοισιν ἑέσσατο δέρμα λέοντος
αἴθωνος μεγάλοιο ποδηνεκές, εἵλετο δ’ ἔγχος.
βῆ δ’ ἰέναι, τοὺς δ’ ἔνθεν ἀναστήσας ἄγεν ἥρως.
οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ φυλάκεσσιν ἐν ἀγρομένοισιν ἔμιχθεν,

Diomedes threw the skin of a great tawny lion about his shoulders - a skin that reached his feet - and grasped his spear. When he had roused the heroes, he brought them back with him; they then went the round of those who were on guard, and found the leaders not sleeping at their posts but wakeful and sitting with their arms about them. As sheep dogs that watch their flocks when they are yarded, and hear a wild beast coming through the mountain forest towards them - forthwith there is a hue and cry of dogs and men, and slumber is broken - even so was sleep chased from the eyes of the Achaeans as they kept the watches of the wicked night, for they turned constantly towards the plain whenever they heard any stir among the Trojans. The old man was glad bade them be of good cheer. "Watch on, my children," said he, "and let not sleep get hold upon you, lest our enemies triumph over us." With this he passed the trench, and with him the other chiefs of the Achaeans who had been called to the council. Meriones and the brave son of Nestor went also, for the princes bade them. When they were beyond the trench that was dug round the wall they held their meeting on the open ground where there was a space clear of corpses, for it was here that when night fell Hektor had turned back from his onslaught on the Argives. They sat down, therefore, and held debate with one another. Nestor spoke first. "My friends," said he, "is there any man bold enough to venture the Trojans, and cut off some straggler, or us news of what the enemy mean to do whether they will stay here by the ships away from the city, or whether, now that they have worsted the Achaeans, they will retire within their walls. If he could learn all this and come back safely here, his fame

[kleos] would be high as heaven in the mouths of all men, and he would be rewarded richly; for the chiefs from all our ships would each of them give him a black ewe with her lamb - which is a present of surpassing value - and he would be asked as a guest to all feasts and clan-gatherings." They all held their peace, but Diomedes of the loud war-cry spoke saying, "Nestor, gladly will I visit the host of the Trojans over against us, but if another will go with me I shall do so in greater confidence and comfort. When two men are together, one of them may see some opportunity [kerdos] which the other has not caught sight of; if a man is alone he is less full of resource, and his wit [noos] is weaker." On this several offered to go with Diomedes. The two Ajaxes, squires [therapontes] of Ares, Meriones, and the son of Nestor all wanted to go, so did Menelaos son of Atreus; Odysseus also wished to go among the host of the Trojans, for he was ever full of daring, and thereon Agamemnon king of men spoke thus: "Diomedes," said he, "son of Tydeus, man after my own heart, choose your comrade for yourself - take the best man of those that have offered, for many would now go with you. Do not through delicacy reject the better man, and take the worst out of respect [aidôs] for his lineage, because he is of more royal blood." He said this because he feared for Menelaos. Diomedes answered, "If you bid me take the man of my own choice, how in that case can I fail to think of Odysseus, than whom there is no man more eager to face all kinds of danger [ponoi] - and Pallas Athena loves him well? If he were to go with me we should pass safely through fire itself, for he is quick to see and understand." "Son of Tydeus," replied Odysseus, "say neither good nor ill about me, for you are among Argives who know me well. Let us be going, for the night wanes and dawn is at hand. The stars have gone forward, two-thirds of the night are already spent, and the third is alone left us." They then put on their armor. Brave Thrasymedes provided the son of Tydeus with a sword and a shield (for he had left his own at his ship) and on his head he set a helmet of bull's hide without either peak or crest; it is called a skull-cap and is a common headgear. Meriones found a bow and quiver for Odysseus, and on his head he set a leathern helmet that was lined with a strong plaiting of leathern thongs, while on the outside it was thickly studded with boar's teeth, well and skillfully set into it; next the head there was an inner lining of felt. This helmet had been stolen by Autolykos out of Eleon when he broke into the house of Amyntor son of Ormenus. He gave it to Amphidamas of Cythera to take to Scandea, and Amphidamas gave it as a guest-gift to Molos, who gave it to his son Meriones; and now it was set upon the head of Odysseus.

10.181

οὐδὲ μὲν εὖδοντας φυλάκων ἡγήτορας εὗρον,
ἀλλ’ ἐγρηγορτὶ σὺν τεύχεσιν εἵατο πάντες.
ὡς δὲ κύνες περὶ μῆλα δυσωρήσωνται ἐν αὐλῇ
θηρὸς ἀκούσαντες κρατερόφρονος, ὅς τε καθ’ ὕλην
ἔρχηται δι’ ὄρεσφι· πολὺς δ’ ὀρυμαγδὸς ἐπ’ αὐτῷ
ἀνδρῶν ἠδὲ κυνῶν, ἀπό τέ σφισιν ὕπνος ὄλωλεν·
ὣς τῶν νήδυμος ὕπνος ἀπὸ βλεφάροιιν ὀλώλει
νύκτα φυλασσομένοισι κακήν· πεδίον δὲ γὰρ αἰεὶ
τετράφαθ’, ὁππότ’ ἐπὶ Τρώων ἀΐοιεν ἰόντων.
τοὺς δ’ ὃ γέρων γήθησεν ἰδὼν θάρσυνέ τε μύθῳ
καί σφεας φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
οὕτω νῦν φίλα τέκνα φυλάσσετε· μηδέ τιν’ ὕπνος
αἱρείτω, μὴ χάρμα γενώμεθα δυσμενέεσσιν.
ὣς εἰπὼν τάφροιο διέσσυτο· τοὶ δ’ ἅμ’ ἕποντο
Ἀργείων βασιλῆες ὅσοι κεκλήατο βουλήν.
τοῖς δ’ ἅμα Μηριόνης καὶ Νέστορος ἀγλαὸς υἱὸς
ἧϊσαν· αὐτοὶ γὰρ κάλεον συμμητιάασθαι.

τάφρον δ’ ἐκδιαβάντες ὀρυκτὴν ἐδριόωντο
ἐν καθαρῷ, ὅθι δὴ νεκύων διεφαίνετο χῶρος
πιπτόντων· ὅθεν αὖτις ἀπετράπετ’ ὄβριμος Ἕκτωρ
ὀλλὺς Ἀργείους, ὅτε δὴ περὶ νὺξ ἐκάλυψεν.
ἔνθα καθεζόμενοι ἔπε’ ἀλλήλοισι πίφαυσκον·
τοῖσι δὲ μύθων ἦρχε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
ὦ φίλοι οὐκ ἂν δή τις ἀνὴρ πεπίθοιθ’ ἑῷ αὐτοῦ
θυμῷ τολμήεντι μετὰ Τρῶας μεγαθύμους
ἐλθεῖν, εἴ τινά που δηΐων ἔλοι ἐσχατόωντα,
ἤ τινά που καὶ φῆμιν ἐνὶ Τρώεσσι πύθοιτο,
ἅσσά τε μητιόωσι μετὰ σφίσιν, ἠ μεμάασιν
αὖθι μένειν παρὰ νηυσὶν ἀπόπροθεν, ἦε πόλιν δὲ
ἂψ ἀναχωρήσουσιν, ἐπεὶ δαμάσαντό γ’ Ἀχαιούς.

10.211

ταῦτά κε πάντα πύθοιτο, καὶ ἂψ εἰς ἡμέας ἔλθοι
ἀσκηθής· μέγα κέν οἱ ὑπουράνιον κλέος εἴη
πάντας ἐπ’ ἀνθρώπους, καί οἱ δόσις ἔσσεται ἐσθλή·
ὅσσοι γὰρ νήεσσιν ἐπικρατέουσιν ἄριστοι
τῶν πάντων οἱ ἕκαστος ὄϊν δώσουσι μέλαιναν
θῆλυν ὑπόρρηνον· τῇ μὲν κτέρας οὐδὲν ὁμοῖον,
αἰεὶ δ’ ἐν δαίτῃσι καὶ εἰλαπίνῃσι παρέσται.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἀκὴν ἐγένοντο σιωπῇ.
τοῖσι δὲ καὶ μετέειπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
Νέστορ ἔμ’ ὀτρύνει κραδίη καὶ θυμὸς ἀγήνωρ
ἀνδρῶν δυσμενέων δῦναι στρατὸν ἐγγὺς ἐόντων
Τρώων· ἀλλ’ εἴ τίς μοι ἀνὴρ ἅμ’ ἕποιτο καὶ ἄλλος
μᾶλλον θαλπωρὴ καὶ θαρσαλεώτερον ἔσται.
σύν τε δύ’ ἐρχομένω καί τε πρὸ ὃ τοῦ ἐνόησεν
ὅππως κέρδος ἔῃ· μοῦνος δ’ εἴ πέρ τε νοήσῃ
ἀλλά τέ οἱ βράσσων τε νόος, λεπτὴ δέ τε μῆτις.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἔθελον Διομήδεϊ πολλοὶ ἕπεσθαι.
ἠθελέτην Αἴαντε δύω θεράποντες Ἄρηος,
ἤθελε Μηριόνης, μάλα δ’ ἤθελε Νέστορος υἱός,
ἤθελε δ’ Ἀτρεΐδης δουρικλειτὸς Μενέλαος,
ἤθελε δ’ ὁ τλήμων Ὀδυσεὺς καταδῦναι ὅμιλον
Τρώων· αἰεὶ γάρ οἱ ἐνὶ φρεσὶ θυμὸς ἐτόλμα.
τοῖσι δὲ καὶ μετέειπεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
Τυδεΐδη Διόμηδες ἐμῷ κεχαρισμένε θυμῷ
τὸν μὲν δὴ ἕταρόν γ’ αἱρήσεαι ὅν κ’ ἐθέλῃσθα,
φαινομένων τὸν ἄριστον, ἐπεὶ μεμάασί γε πολλοί.
μηδὲ σύ γ’ αἰδόμενος σῇσι φρεσὶ τὸν μὲν ἀρείω
καλλείπειν, σὺ δὲ χείρον’ ὀπάσσεαι αἰδοῖ εἴκων
ἐς γενεὴν ὀρόων, μηδ’ εἰ βασιλεύτερός ἐστιν.
ὣς ἔφατ’, ἔδεισεν δὲ περὶ ξανθῷ Μενελάῳ.

10.241

τοῖς δ’ αὖτις μετέειπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
εἰ μὲν δὴ ἕταρόν γε κελεύετέ μ’ αὐτὸν ἑλέσθαι,
πῶς ἂν ἔπειτ’ Ὀδυσῆος ἐγὼ θείοιο λαθοίμην,

οὗ πέρι μὲν πρόφρων κραδίη καὶ θυμὸς ἀγήνωρ
ἐν πάντεσσι πόνοισι, φιλεῖ δέ ἑ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη.
τούτου γ’ ἑσπομένοιο καὶ ἐκ πυρὸς αἰθομένοιο
ἄμφω νοστήσαιμεν, ἐπεὶ περίοιδε νοῆσαι.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε πολύτλας δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς·
Τυδεΐδη μήτ’ ἄρ με μάλ’ αἴνεε μήτέ τι νείκει·
εἰδόσι γάρ τοι ταῦτα μετ’ Ἀργείοις ἀγορεύεις.
ἀλλ’ ἴομεν· μάλα γὰρ νὺξ ἄνεται, ἐγγύθι δ’ ἠώς,
ἄστρα δὲ δὴ προβέβηκε, παροίχωκεν δὲ πλέων νὺξ
τῶν δύο μοιράων, τριτάτη δ’ ἔτι μοῖρα λέλειπται.
ὣς εἰπόνθ’ ὅπλοισιν ἔνι δεινοῖσιν ἐδύτην.
Τυδεΐδῃ μὲν δῶκε μενεπτόλεμος Θρασυμήδης
φάσγανον ἄμφηκες· τὸ δ’ ἐὸν παρὰ νηὶ λέλειπτο·
καὶ σάκος· ἀμφὶ δέ οἱ κυνέην κεφαλῇφιν ἔθηκε
ταυρείην, ἄφαλόν τε καὶ ἄλλοφον, ἥ τε καταῖτυξ
κέκληται, ῥύεται δὲ κάρη θαλερῶν αἰζηῶν.
Μηριόνης δ’ Ὀδυσῆϊ δίδου βιὸν ἠδὲ φαρέτρην
καὶ ξίφος, ἀμφὶ δέ οἱ κυνέην κεφαλῇφιν ἔθηκε
ῥινοῦ ποιητήν· πολέσιν δ’ ἔντοσθεν ἱμᾶσιν
ἐντέτατο στερεῶς· ἔκτοσθε δὲ λευκοὶ ὀδόντες
ἀργιόδοντος ὑὸς θαμέες ἔχον ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα
εὖ καὶ ἐπισταμένως· μέσσῃ δ’ ἐνὶ πῖλος ἀρήρει.
τήν ῥά ποτ’ ἐξ Ἐλεῶνος Ἀμύντορος Ὀρμενίδαο
ἐξέλετ’ Αὐτόλυκος πυκινὸν δόμον ἀντιτορήσας,
Σκάνδειαν δ’ ἄρα δῶκε Κυθηρίῳ Ἀμφιδάμαντι·
Ἀμφιδάμας δὲ Μόλῳ δῶκε ξεινήϊον εἶναι,
αὐτὰρ ὃ Μηριόνῃ δῶκεν ᾧ παιδὶ φορῆναι·

10.271

δὴ τότ’ Ὀδυσσῆος πύκασεν κάρη ἀμφιτεθεῖσα.
τὼ δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν ὅπλοισιν ἔνι δεινοῖσιν ἐδύτην,
βάν ῥ’ ἰέναι, λιπέτην δὲ κατ’ αὐτόθι πάντας ἀρίστους.
τοῖσι δὲ δεξιὸν ἦκεν ἐρῳδιὸν ἐγγὺς ὁδοῖο
Παλλὰς Ἀθηναίη· τοὶ δ’ οὐκ ἴδον ὀφθαλμοῖσι
νύκτα δι’ ὀρφναίην, ἀλλὰ κλάγξαντος ἄκουσαν.
χαῖρε δὲ τῷ ὄρνιθ’ Ὀδυσεύς, ἠρᾶτο δ’ Ἀθήνῃ·
κλῦθί μευ αἰγιόχοιο Διὸς τέκος, ἥ τέ μοι αἰεὶ
ἐν πάντεσσι πόνοισι παρίστασαι, οὐδέ σε λήθω
κινύμενος· νῦν αὖτε μάλιστά με φῖλαι Ἀθήνη,
δὸς δὲ πάλιν ἐπὶ νῆας ἐϋκλεῖας ἀφικέσθαι
ῥέξαντας μέγα ἔργον, ὅ κε Τρώεσσι μελήσῃ.
δεύτερος αὖτ’ ἠρᾶτο βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
κέκλυθι νῦν καὶ ἐμεῖο Διὸς τέκος Ἀτρυτώνη·
σπεῖό μοι ὡς ὅτε πατρὶ ἄμ’ ἕσπεο Τυδέϊ δίῳ
ἐς Θήβας, ὅτε τε πρὸ Ἀχαιῶν ἄγγελος ἦει.
τοὺς δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπ’ Ἀσωπῷ λίπε χαλκοχίτωνας Ἀχαιούς,
αὐτὰρ ὃ μειλίχιον μῦθον φέρε Καδμείοισι
κεῖσ’· ἀτὰρ ἂψ ἀπιὼν μάλα μέρμερα μήσατο ἔργα
σὺν σοὶ δῖα θεά, ὅτε οἱ πρόφρασσα παρέστης.
ὣς νῦν μοι ἐθέλουσα παρίσταο καί με φύλασσε.
σοὶ δ’ αὖ ἐγὼ ῥέξω βοῦν ἦνιν εὐρυμέτωπον

293 ἀδμήτην, ἣν οὔ πω ὑπὸ ζυγὸν ἤγαγεν ἀνήρ·
294 τήν τοι ἐγὼ ῥέξω χρυσὸν κέρασιν περιχεύας.
295 ὣς ἔφαν εὐχόμενοι, τῶν δ’ ἔκλυε Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη.
296 οἳ δ’ ἐπεὶ ἠρήσαντο Διὸς κούρῃ μεγάλοιο,
297 βάν ῥ’ ἴμεν ὥς τε λέοντε δύω διὰ νύκτα μέλαιναν
298 ἂμ φόνον, ἂν νέκυας, διά τ’ ἔντεα καὶ μέλαν αἷμα.
299 οὐδὲ μὲν οὐδὲ Τρῶας ἀγήνορας εἴασεν Ἕκτωρ
300 εὕδειν, ἀλλ’ ἄμυδις κικλήσκετο πάντας ἀρίστους,
When the pair had armed, they set out, and left the other chieftains behind them. Pallas Athena sent them a heron by the wayside upon their right hands; they could not see it for the darkness, but they heard its cry. Odysseus was glad when he heard it and prayed to Athena: "Hear me," he cried, "daughter of aegis-bearing Zeus, you who spy out all my ways and who are with me in all my hardships [ponoi]; befriend me in this mine hour, and grant that we may return to the ships covered with glory after having achieved some mighty exploit that shall bring sorrow to the Trojans." Then Diomedes of the loud war-cry also prayed: "Hear me too," said he, "daughter of Zeus, unweariable; be with me even as you were with my noble father Tydeus when he went to Thebes as envoy sent by the Achaeans. He left the Achaeans by the banks of the river Aesopos, and went to the city bearing a message of peace to the Cadmeans; on his return thence, with your help, goddess, he did great deeds of daring, for you were his ready helper. Even so guide me and guard me now, and in return I will offer you in sacrifice a broad-browed heifer of a year old, unbroken, and never yet brought by man under the yoke. I will gild her horns and will offer her up to you in sacrifice." Thus they prayed, and Pallas Athena heard their prayer. When they had done praying to the daughter of great Zeus, they went their way like two lions prowling by night amid the armor and blood-stained bodies of them that had fallen. Neither again did Hektor let the Trojans sleep; for he too called the princes and councilors of the Trojans that he might set his counsel before them. "Is there one," said he, "who for a great reward will do me the service of which I will tell you? He shall be well paid if he will. I will give him a chariot and a couple of horses, the fleetest that can be found at the ships of the Achaeans, if he will dare this thing; and he will win infinite honor to boot; he must go to the ships and find out whether they are still guarded as heretofore, or whether now that we have beaten them the Achaeans design to flee, and through sheer exhaustion are neglecting to keep their watches." They all held their peace; but there was among the Trojans a certain man named Dolon, son of Eumedes, the famous herald - a man rich in gold and bronze. He was ill-favored, but a good runner, and was an only son among five sisters. He it was that now addressed the Trojans. "I, Hektor," said he, "Will to the ships and will exploit them. But first hold up your scepter and swear that you will give me the chariot, equipped with bronze, and the horses that now carry the noble son of Peleus. I will make you a good scout, and will not fail you. I will go through the host from one end to the other till I come to the ship of Agamemnon, where I take it the princes of the Achaeans are now consulting whether they shall fight or flee." When he had done speaking Hektor held up his scepter, and swore him his oath saying, "May Zeus the thundering husband of Hera bear witness that no other Trojan but yourself shall mount those steeds, and that you shall have your will with them for ever." The oath he swore was bootless, but it made Dolon more keen on going. He hung his bow over his shoulder, and as an overall he wore the skin of a gray wolf, while on his head he set a cap of ferret skin. Then he took a pointed javelin, and left the camp for the ships, but he was not to return with any news for Hektor. When he had left the horses and the troops behind him, he made all speed on his way, but Odysseus perceived his coming and said to Diomedes, "Diomedes, here is some one from the camp; I am not sure whether he is a spy, or whether it is some thief who would plunder the bodies of the dead; let him get a little past us, we can then spring upon him and take him. If, however, he is too quick

for us, go after him with your spear and hem him in towards the ships away from the Trojan camp, to prevent his getting back to the town."

10.301

ὅσσοι ἔσαν Τρώων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες·
τοὺς ὅ γε συγκαλέσας πυκινὴν ἀρτύνετο βουλήν·
τίς κέν μοι τόδε ἔργον ὑποσχόμενος τελέσειε
δώρῳ ἔπι μεγάλῳ; μισθὸς δέ οἱ ἄρκιος ἔσται.
δώσω γὰρ δίφρόν τε δύω τ’ ἐριαύχενας ἵππους
οἵ κεν ἄριστοι ἔωσι θοῇς ἐπὶ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν
ὅς τίς κε τλαίη, οἵ τ’ αὐτῷ κῦδος ἄροιτο,
νηῶν ὠκυπόρων σχεδὸν ἐλθέμεν, ἔκ τε πυθέσθαι
ἠέ φυλάσσονται νῆες θοαὶ ὡς τὸ πάρος περ,
ἦ ἤδη χείρεσσιν ὑφ’ ἡμετέρῃσι δαμέντες
φύξιν βουλεύουσι μετὰ σφίσιν, οὐδ’ ἐθέλουσι
νύκτα φυλασσέμεναι, καμάτῳ ἀδηκότες αἰνῷ.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἀκὴν ἐγένοντο σιωπῇ.
ἦν δέ τις ἐν Τρώεσσι Δόλων Εὐμήδεος υἱὸς
κήρυκος θείοιο πολύχρυσος πολύχαλκος,
ὃς δή τοι εἶδος μὲν ἔην κακός, ἀλλὰ ποδώκης·
αὐτὰρ ὃ μοῦνος ἔην μετὰ πέντε κασιγνήτῃσιν.
ὅς ῥα τότε Τρωσίν τε καὶ Ἕκτορι μῦθον ἔειπεν·
Ἕκτορ ἔμ’ ὀτρύνει κραδίη καὶ θυμὸς ἀγήνωρ
νηῶν ὠκυπόρων σχεδὸν ἐλθέμεν ἔκ τε πυθέσθαι.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε μοι τὸ σκῆπτρον ἀνάσχεο, καί μοι ὄμοσσον
ἦ μὲν τοὺς ἵππους τε καὶ ἅρματα ποικίλα χαλκῷ
δωσέμεν, οἳ φορέουσιν ἀμύμονα Πηλεΐωνα,
σοὶ δ’ ἐγὼ οὐχ ἅλιος σκοπὸς ἔσσομαι οὐδ’ ἀπὸ δόξης·
τόφρα γὰρ ἐς στρατὸν εἶμι διαμπερὲς ὄφρ’ ἂν ἵκωμαι
νῆ’ Ἀγαμεμνονέην, ὅθι που μέλλουσιν ἄριστοι
βουλὰς βουλεύειν ἢ φευγέμεν ἠὲ μάχεσθαι.
ὣς φάθ’, ὃ δ’ ἐν χερσὶ σκῆπτρον λάβε καί οἱ ὄμοσσεν·
ἴστω νῦν Ζεὺς αὐτὸς ἐρίγδουπος πόσις Ἥρης
μὴ μὲν τοῖς ἵπποισιν ἀνὴρ ἐποχήσεται ἄλλος

10.331

Τρώων, ἀλλά σέ φημι διαμπερὲς ἀγλαϊεῖσθαι.
ὣς φάτο καί ῥ’ ἐπίορκον ἐπώμοσε, τὸν δ’ ὀρόθυνεν·
αὐτίκα δ’ ἀμφ’ ὤμοισιν ἐβάλλετο καμπύλα τόξα,
ἔσσατο δ’ ἔκτοσθεν ῥινὸν πολιοῖο λύκοιο,
κρατὶ δ’ ἐπὶ κτιδέην κυνέην, ἔλε δ’ ὀξὺν ἄκοντα,
βῆ δ’ ἰέναι προτὶ νῆας ἀπὸ στρατοῦ· οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔμελλεν
ἐλθὼν ἐκ νηῶν ἂψ Ἕκτορι μῦθον ἀποίσειν.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἵππων τε καὶ ἀνδρῶν κάλλιφ’ ὅμιλον,
βῆ ῥ’ ἀν’ ὁδὸν μεμαώς· τὸν δὲ φράσατο προσιόντα
διογενὴς Ὀδυσεύς, Διομήδεα δὲ προσέειπεν·
οὗτός τις Διόμηδες ἀπὸ στρατοῦ ἔρχεται ἀνήρ,
οὐκ οἶδ’ ἢ νήεσσιν ἐπίσκοπος ἡμετέρῃσιν,
ἦ τινα συλήσων νεκύων κατατεθνηώτων.
ἀλλ’ ἐῶμέν μιν πρῶτα παρεξελθεῖν πεδίοιο

345 τυτθόν· ἔπειτα δέ κ’ αὐτὸν ἐπαΐξαντες ἕλοιμεν
346 καρπαλίμως· εἰ δ’ ἄμμε παραφθαίησι πόδεσσιν,
347 αἰεί μιν ἐπὶ νῆας ἀπὸ στρατόφι προτιειλεῖν
348 ἔγχει ἐπαΐσσων, μή πως προτὶ ἄστυ ἀλύξῃ.
349 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσαντε παρὲξ ὁδοῦ ἐν νεκύεσσι
350 κλινθήτην· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ὦκα παρέδραμεν ἀφραδίῃσιν.
351 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἀπέην ὅσσόν τ’ ἐπὶ οὖρα πέλονται
352 ἡμιόνων· αἱ γάρ τε βοῶν προφερέστεραί εἰσιν
353 ἑλκέμεναι νειοῖο βαθείης πηκτὸν ἄροτρον·
354 τὼ μὲν ἐπεδραμέτην, ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ἔστη δοῦπον ἀκούσας.
355 ἔλπετο γὰρ κατὰ θυμὸν ἀποστρέψοντας ἑταίρους
356 ἐκ Τρώων ἰέναι πάλιν Ἕκτορος ὀτρύναντος.
357 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἄπεσαν δουρηνεκὲς ἢ καὶ ἔλασσον,
358 γνῶ ῥ’ ἄνδρας δηΐους, λαιψηρὰ δὲ γούνατ’ ἐνώμα
359 φευγέμεναι· τοὶ δ’ αἶψα διώκειν ὁρμήθησαν.
360 ὡς δ’ ὅτε καρχαρόδοντε δύω κύνε εἰδότε θήρης

With this they turned out of their way and lay down among the corpses. Dolon suspected nothing and soon passed them, but when he had got about as far as the distance by which a mule-plowed furrow exceeds one that has been ploughed by oxen (for mules can plow fallow land quicker than oxen) they ran after him, and when he heard their footsteps he stood still, for he made sure they were friends from the Trojan camp come by Hektor's orders to bid him return; when, however, they were only a spear's cast, or less away form him, he saw that they were enemies as fast as his legs could take him. The others gave chase at once, and as a couple of well-trained hounds press forward after a doe or hare that runs screaming in front of them, even so did the son of Tydeus and Odysseus pursue Dolon and cut him off from his own people. But when he had fled so far towards the ships that he would soon have fallen in with the outposts, Athena infused fresh strength into the son of Tydeus for fear some other of the Achaeans might have the glory of being first to hit him, and he might himself be only second; he therefore sprang forward with his spear and said, "Stand, or I shall throw my spear, and in that case I shall soon make an end of you." He threw as he spoke, but missed his aim on purpose. The dart flew over the man's right shoulder, and then stuck in the ground. He stood stock still, trembling and in great fear; his teeth chattered, and he turned pale with fear. The two came breathless up to him and seized his hands, whereon he began to weep and said, "Take me alive; I will ransom myself; we have great store of gold, bronze, and wrought iron, and from this my father will satisfy you with a very large ransom, should he hear of my being alive at the ships of the Achaeans." "Fear not," replied Odysseus, "let no thought of death be in your mind; but tell me, and tell me true, why are you thus going about alone in the dead of night away from your camp and towards the ships, while other men are sleeping? Is it to plunder the bodies of the slain, or did Hektor send you to spy out what was going on at the ships? Or did you come here of your own mere notion [noon]?" Dolon answered, his limbs trembling beneath him: "Hektor, with his vain flattering promises, lured me into derangement [atê]. He said he would give me the horses of the noble son of Peleus and his bronze-bedizened chariot; he bade me go through the darkness of the fleeing night, get close to the enemy, and find out whether the ships are still guarded as heretofore, or whether, now that we have beaten them, the Achaeans design to flee, and through sheer exhaustion are neglecting to keep their watches." Odysseus smiled at him and answered, "You had indeed set your heart upon a great reward, but the horses of the descendant of Aiakos are hardly to be kept in hand or driven by any other mortal man than Achilles himself, whose mother was an immortal. But tell me, and tell me true, where did you leave Hektor when you started? Where lies his armor and his horses? How, too, are the watches and sleeping-ground of the Trojans

ordered? What are their plans? Will they stay here by the ships and away from the city, or now that they have worsted the Achaeans, will they retire within their walls?" And Dolon answered, "I will tell you truly all. Hektor and the other councilors are now holding conference by the monument [sêma] of great Ilos, away from the general tumult; as for the guards about which you ask me, there is no chosen watch to keep guard over the host. The Trojans have their watchfires, for they are bound to have them; they, therefore, are awake and keep each other to their duty as sentinels; but the allies who have come from other places are asleep and leave it to the Trojans to keep guard, for their wives and children are not here." Odysseus then said, "Now tell me; are they sleeping among the Trojan troops, or do they lie apart? Explain this that I may understand it." "I will tell you truly all," replied Dolon. "To the seaward lie the Carians, the Paeonian bowmen, the Leleges, the Cauconians, and the noble Pelasgi. The Lysians and proud Mysians,

10.361

ἢ κεμάδ’ ἠὲ λαγωὸν ἐπείγετον ἐμμενὲς αἰεὶ
χῶρον ἀν’ ὑλήενθ’, ὃ δέ τε προθέῃσι μεμηκώς,
ὣς τὸν Τυδεΐδης ἠδ’ ὃ πτολίπορθος Ὀδυσσεὺς
λαοῦ ἀποτμήξαντε διώκετον ἐμμενὲς αἰεί.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ τάχ’ ἔμελλε μιγήσεσθαι φυλάκεσσι
φεύγων ἐς νῆας, τότε δὴ μένος ἔμβαλ’ Ἀθήνη
Τυδεΐδῃ, ἵνα μή τις Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων
φθαίη ἐπευξάμενος βαλέειν, ὃ δὲ δεύτερος ἔλθοι.
δουρὶ δ’ ἐπαΐσσων προσέφη κρατερὸς Διομήδης·
ἠὲ μέν’ ἠέ σε δουρὶ κιχήσομαι, οὐδέ σέ φημι
δηρὸν ἐμῆς ἀπὸ χειρὸς ἀλύξειν αἰπὺν ὄλεθρον.
ἦ ῥα καὶ ἔγχος ἀφῆκεν, ἐκὼν δ’ ἡμάρτανε φωτός·
δεξιτερὸν δ’ ὑπὲρ ὦμον ἐΰξου δουρὸς ἀκωκὴ
ἐν γαίῃ ἐπάγη· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ἔστη τάρβησέν τε
βαμβαίνων· ἄραβος δὲ διὰ στόμα γίγνετ’ ὀδόντων·
χλωρὸς ὑπαὶ δείους· τὼ δ’ ἀσθμαίνοντε κιχήτην,
χειρῶν δ’ ἀψάσθην· ὃ δὲ δακρύσας ἔπος ηὔδα·
ζωγρεῖτ’, αὐτὰρ ἐγὼν ἐμὲ λύσομαι· ἔστι γὰρ ἔνδον
χαλκός τε χρυσός τε πολύκμητός τε σίδηρος,
τῶν κ’ ὔμμιν χαρίσαιτο πατὴρ ἀπερείσι’ ἄποινα
εἴ κεν ἐμὲ ζωὸν πεπύθοιτ’ ἐπὶ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεύς·
θάρσει, μηδέ τί τοι θάνατος καταθύμιος ἔστω.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε μοι τόδε εἰπὲ καὶ ἀτρεκέως κατάλεξον·
πῇ δὴ οὕτως ἐπὶ νῆας ἀπὸ στρατοῦ ἔρχεαι οἶος
νύκτα δι’ ὀρφναίην, ὅτε θ’ εὕδουσι βροτοὶ ἄλλοι;
ἦ τινα συλήσων νεκύων κατατεθνηώτων;
ἦ σ’ Ἕκτωρ προέηκε διασκοπιᾶσθαι ἕκαστα
νῆας ἔπι γλαφυράς; ἦ σ’ αὐτὸν θυμὸς ἀνῆκε;
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Δόλων, ὑπὸ δ’ ἔτρεμε γυῖα·

10.391

πολλῇσίν μ’ ἄτῃσι παρὲκ νόον ἤγαγεν Ἕκτωρ,
ὅς μοι Πηλεΐωνος ἀγαυοῦ μώνυχας ἵππους
δωσέμεναι κατένευσε καὶ ἅρματα ποικίλα χαλκῷ,
ἠνώγει δέ μ’ ἰόντα θοὴν διὰ νύκτα μέλαιναν

ἀνδρῶν δυσμενέων σχεδὸν ἐλθέμεν, ἔκ τε πυθέσθαι
ἠὲ φυλάσσονται νῆες θοαὶ ὡς τὸ πάρος περ,
ἦ ἤδη χείρεσσιν ὑφ’ ἡμετέρῃσι δαμέντες
φύξιν βουλεύουσι μετὰ σφίσιν, οὐδ’ ἐθέλουσι
νύκτα φυλασσέμεναι, καμάτῳ ἀδηκότες αἰνῷ.
τὸν δ’ ἐπιμειδήσας προσέφη πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεύς·
ἦ ῥά νύ τοι μεγάλων δώρων ἐπεμαίετο θυμὸς
ἵππων Αἰακίδαο δαΐφρονος· οἳ δ’ ἀλεγεινοὶ
ἀνδράσι γε θνητοῖσι δαμήμεναι ἠδ’ ὀχέεσθαι
ἄλλῳ γ’ ἢ Ἀχιλῆϊ, τὸν ἀθανάτη τέκε μήτηρ.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε μοι τόδε εἰπὲ καὶ ἀτρεκέως κατάλεξον·
ποῦ νῦν δεῦρο κιὼν λίπες Ἕκτορα ποιμένα λαῶν;
ποῦ δέ οἱ ἔντεα κεῖται ἀρήϊα, ποῦ δέ οἱ ἵπποι;
πῶς δαὶ τῶν ἄλλων Τρώων φυλακαί τε καὶ εὐναί;
ἄσσά τε μητιόωσι μετὰ σφίσιν, ἢ μεμάασιν
αὖθι μένειν παρὰ νηυσὶν ἀπόπροθεν, ἦε πόλιν δὲ
ἂψ ἀναχωρήσουσιν, ἐπεὶ δαμάσαντό γ’ Ἀχαιούς.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε Δόλων Εὐμήδεος υἱός·
τοὶ γὰρ ἐγώ τοι ταῦτα μάλ’ ἀτρεκέως καταλέξω.
Ἕκτωρ μὲν μετὰ τοῖσιν, ὅσοι βουληφόροι εἰσί,
βουλὰς βουλεύει θείου παρὰ σήματι Ἴλου
νόσφιν ἀπὸ φλοίσβου· φυλακὰς δ’ ἂς εἴρεαι ἥρως
οὔ τις κεκριμένη ῥύεται στρατὸν οὐδὲ φυλάσσει.
ὅσσαι μὲν Τρώων πυρὸς ἐσχάραι, οἷσιν ἀνάγκη
οἳ δ’ ἐγρηγόρθασι φυλασσέμεναί τε κέλονται
ἀλλήλοις· ἀτὰρ αὖτε πολύκλητοι ἐπίκουροι

10.421

εὕδουσι· Τρωσὶν γὰρ ἐπιτραπέουσι φυλάσσειν·
οὐ γάρ σφιν παῖδες σχεδὸν εἴαται οὐδὲ γυναῖκες.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεύς·
πῶς γὰρ νῦν Τρώεσσι μεμιγμένοι ἱπποδάμοισιν
εὕδουσ’ ἦ ἀπάνευθε; δίειπέ μοι ὄφρα δαείω.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Δόλων Εὐμήδεος υἱός·
τοὶ γὰρ ἐγὼ καὶ ταῦτα μάλ’ ἀτρεκέως καταλέξω.
πρὸς μὲν ἀλὸς Κᾶρες καὶ Παίονες ἀγκυλότοξοι
καὶ Λέλεγες καὶ Καύκωνες δῖοί τε Πελασγοί,
πρὸς Θύμβρης δ’ ἔλαχον Λύκιοι Μυσοί τ’ ἀγέρωχοι
καὶ Φρύγες ἱππόμαχοι καὶ Μῄονες ἱπποκορυσταί.
ἀλλὰ τί ἦ ἐμὲ ταῦτα διεξερέεσθε ἕκαστα;
εἰ γὰρ δὴ μέματον Τρώων καταδῦναι ὅμιλον
Θρῄϊκες οἶδ’ ἀπάνευθε νεήλυδες ἔσχατοι ἄλλων·
ἐν δέ σφιν Ῥῆσος βασιλεὺς πάϊς Ἠϊονῆος.
τοῦ δὴ καλλίστους ἵππους ἴδον ἠδὲ μεγίστους·
λευκότεροι χιόνος, θείειν δ’ ἀνέμοισιν ὁμοῖοι·
ἅρμα δέ οἱ χρυσῷ τε καὶ ἀργύρῳ εὖ ἤσκηται·
τεύχεα δὲ χρύσεια πελώρια θαῦμα ἰδέσθαι
ἤλυθ’ ἔχων· τὰ μὲν οὔ τι καταθνητοῖσιν ἔοικεν
ἄνδρεσσιν φορέειν, ἀλλ’ ἀθανάτοισι θεοῖσιν.
ἀλλ’ ἐμὲ μὲν νῦν νηυσὶ πελάσσετον ὠκυπόροισιν,
ἠέ με δήσαντες λίπετ’ αὐτόθι νηλέϊ δεσμῷ,

444 ὄφρά κεν ἔλθητον καὶ πειρηθῆτον ἐμεῖο
445 ἠὲ κατ’ αἶσαν ἔειπον ἐν ὑμῖν, ἦε καὶ οὐκί.
446 τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη κρατερὸς Διομήδης·
447 μὴ δή μοι φύξίν γε Δόλων ἐμβάλλεο θυμῷ·
448 ἐσθλά περ ἀγγείλας, ἐπεὶ ἵκεο χεῖρας ἐς ἁμάς.
449 εἰ μὲν γάρ κέ σε νῦν ἀπολύσομεν ἠὲ μεθῶμεν,
450 ἦ τε καὶ ὕστερον εἶσθα θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
with the Phrygians and Meonians, have their place on the side towards Thymbra; but why ask about an this? If you want to find your way into the host of the Trojans, there are the Thracians, who have lately come here and lie apart from the others at the far end of the camp; and they have Rhesus son of Eioneus for their king. His horses are the finest and strongest that I have ever seen, they are whiter than snow and fleeter than any wind that blows. His chariot is equipped with silver and gold, and he has brought his marvelous golden armor, of the rarest workmanship - too splendid for any mortal man to carry, and meet only for the gods. Now, therefore, take me to the ships or bind me securely here, until you come back and have proved my words whether they be false or true." Diomedes looked sternly at him and answered, "Think not, Dolon, for all the good information you have given us, that you shall escape now you are in our hands, for if we ransom you or let you go, you will come some second time to the ships of the Achaeans either as a spy or as an open enemy, but if I kill you and an end of you, you will give no more trouble." On this Dolon would have caught him by the beard to beseech him further, but Diomedes struck him in the middle of his neck with his sword and cut through both sinews so that his head fell rolling in the dust while he was yet speaking. They took the ferret-skin cap from his head, and also the wolf-skin, the bow, and his long spear. Odysseus hung them up aloft in honor of Athena the goddess of plunder, and prayed saying, "Accept these, goddess, for we give them to you in preference to all the gods in Olympus: therefore speed us still further towards the horses and sleeping-ground of the Thracians." With these words he took the spoils and set them upon a tamarisk tree, and they made a mark [sêma] at the place by pulling up reeds and gathering boughs of tamarisk that they might not miss it as they came back through the fleeing hours of darkness. The two then went onwards amid the fallen armor and the blood, and came presently to the company of Thracian warriors, who were sleeping, tired out with their day's toil; their goodly armor was lying on the ground beside them all in order [kosmos], in three rows, and each man had his yoke of horses beside him. Rhesus was sleeping in the middle, and hard by him his horses were made fast to the topmost rim of his chariot. Odysseus from some way off saw him and said, "This, Diomedes, is the man, and these are the horses about which Dolon whom we killed told us. Do your very utmost; dally not about your armor, but loose the horses at once - or else kill the men yourself, while I see to the horses." Thereon Athena put courage into the heart of Diomedes, and he smote them right and left. They made a hideous groaning as they were being hacked about, and the earth was red with their blood. As a lion springs furiously upon a flock of sheep or goats when he finds without their shepherd, so did the son of Tydeus set upon the Thracian warriors till he had killed twelve. As he killed them Odysseus came and drew them aside by their feet one by one, that the horses might go forward freely without being frightened as they passed over the dead bodies, for they were not yet used to them. When the son of Tydeus came to the king, he killed him too (which made thirteen), as he was breathing hard, for by the counsel of Athena an evil dream, the seed of Oeneus, hovered that night over his head. Meanwhile Odysseus untied the horses, made them fast one to another and drove them off, striking them with his bow, for he had forgotten to take the whip from the chariot. Then he whistled as a sign to Diomedes. But Diomedes stayed where he was, thinking what other daring deed he might accomplish. He was doubting whether to take the chariot in which the king's armor was lying, and draw it out by the

pole, or to lift the armor out and carry it off; or whether again, he should not kill some more Thracians. While he was thus hesitating Athena came up to him and said, "Make your homecoming [nostos], Diomedes, to the ships or you may be driven thither, should some other god rouse the Trojans." Diomedes knew that it was the goddess, and at once sprang upon the horses. Odysseus beat them with his bow and they flew onward to the ships of the Achaeans. But Apollo kept no blind look-out when he saw Athena with the son of Tydeus. He was angry with her, and coming to the host of the Trojans he roused Hippokoön, a counselor of the Thracians and a noble kinsman of Rhesus. He started up out of his sleep and saw that the horses were no longer in their place, and that the men were gasping in their death-agony; on this he groaned aloud, and called upon his friend by name. Then the whole Trojan camp was in an uproar as the people kept hurrying together, and they marveled at the deeds of the heroes who had now got away towards the ships.

10.451

ἠὲ διοπτεύσων ἢ ἐναντίβιον πολεμίξων·
εἰ δέ κ’ ἐμῇς ὑπὸ χερσὶ δαμεὶς ἀπὸ θυμὸν ὀλέσσῃς,
οὐκέτ’ ἔπειτα σὺ πῆμά ποτ’ ἔσσεαι Ἀργείοισιν.
ἦ, καὶ ὃ μέν μιν ἔμελλε γενείου χειρὶ παχείῃ
ἁψάμενος λίσσεσθαι, ὃ δ’ αὐχένα μέσσον ἔλασσε
φασγάνῳ ἀΐξας, ἀπὸ δ’ ἄμφω κέρσε τένοντε·
φθεγγομένου δ’ ἄρα τοῦ γε κάρη κονίῃσιν ἐμίχθη.
τοῦ δ’ ἀπὸ μὲν κτιδέην κυνέην κεφαλῆφιν ἕλοντο
καὶ λυκέην καὶ τόξα παλίντονα καὶ δόρυ μακρόν·
καὶ τά γ’ Ἀθηναίῃ ληΐτιδι δῖος Ὀδυσσεὺς
ὑψόσ’ ἀνέσχεθε χειρὶ καὶ εὐχόμενος ἔπος ηὔδα·
χαῖρε θεὰ τοῖσδεσσι· σὲ γὰρ πρώτην ἐν Ὀλύμπῳ
πάντων ἀθανάτων ἐπιδωσόμεθ’· ἀλλὰ καὶ αὖτις
πέμψον ἐπὶ Θρῃκῶν ἀνδρῶν ἵππους τε καὶ εὐνάς.
ὣς ἄρ’ ἐφώνησεν, καὶ ἀπὸ ἕθεν ὑψόσ’ ἀείρας
θῆκεν ἀνὰ μυρίκην· δέελον δ’ ἐπὶ σῆμά τ’ ἔθηκε
συμμάρψας δόνακας μυρίκης τ’ ἐριθηλέας ὄζους,
μὴ λάθοι αὖτις ἰόντε θοὴν διὰ νύκτα μέλαιναν.
τὼ δὲ βάτην προτέρω διά τ’ ἔντεα καὶ μέλαν αἷμα,
αἶψα δ’ ἐπὶ Θρῃκῶν ἀνδρῶν τέλος ἶξον ἰόντες.
οἳ δ’ εὗδον καμάτῳ ἀδηκότες, ἔντεα δέ σφιν
καλὰ παρ’ αὐτοῖσι χθονὶ κέκλιτο εὖ κατὰ κόσμον
τριστοιχί· παρὰ δέ σφιν ἑκάστῳ δίζυγες ἵπποι.
Ῥῆσος δ’ ἐν μέσῳ εὗδε, παρ’ αὐτῷ δ’ ὠκέες ἵπποι
ἐξ ἐπιδιφριάδος πυμάτης ἱμᾶσι δέδεντο.
τὸν δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς προπάροιθεν ἰδὼν Διομήδεϊ δεῖξεν·
οὗτός τοι Διόμηδες ἀνήρ, οὗτοι δέ τοι ἵπποι,
οὓς νῶϊν πίφαυσκε Δόλων ὃν ἐπέφνομεν ἡμεῖς.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ πρόφερε κρατερὸν μένος· οὐδέ τί σε χρὴ
ἑστάμεναι μέλεον σὺν τεύχεσιν, ἀλλὰ λύ’ ἵππους·

10.481

ἠὲ σύ γ’ ἄνδρας ἔναιρε, μελήσουσιν δ’ ἐμοὶ ἵπποι.
ὣς φάτο, τῷ δ’ ἔμπνευσε μένος γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη,
κτεῖνε δ’ ἐπιστροφάδην· τῶν δὲ στόνος ὄρνυτ’ ἀεικὴς
ἄορι θεινομένων, ἐρυθαίνετο δ’ αἵματι γαῖα.

ὡς δὲ λέων μήλοισιν ἀσημάντοισιν ἐπελθὼν
αἴγεσιν ἢ οἰέσσι κακὰ φρονέων ἐνορούσῃ,
ὣς μὲν Θρήϊκας ἄνδρας ἐπῴχετο Τυδέος υἱὸς
ὄφρα δυώδεκ’ ἔπεφνεν· ἀτὰρ πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεὺς
ὅν τινα Τυδεΐδης ἄορι πλήξειε παραστὰς
τὸν δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς μετόπισθε λαβὼν ποδὸς ἐξερύσασκε,
τὰ φρονέων κατὰ θυμὸν ὅπως καλλίτριχες ἵπποι
ῥεῖα διέλθοιεν μηδὲ τρομεοίατο θυμῷ
νεκροῖς ἀμβαίνοντες· ἀήθεσσον γὰρ ἔτ’ αὐτῶν.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ βασιλῆα κιχήσατο Τυδέος υἱός,
τὸν τρισκαιδέκατον μελιηδέα θυμὸν ἀπηύρα
ἀσθμαίνοντα· κακὸν γὰρ ὄναρ κεφαλῇφιν ἐπέστη
τὴν νύκτ’ Οἰνεΐδαο πάϊς διὰ μῆτιν Ἀθήνης.
τόφρα δ’ ἄρ’ ὃ τλήμων Ὀδυσεὺς λύε μώνυχας ἵππους,
σὺν δ’ ἤειρεν ἰμᾶσι καὶ ἐξήλαυνεν ὁμίλου
τόξῳ ἐπιπλήσσων, ἐπεὶ οὐ μάστιγα φαεινὴν
ποικίλου ἐκ δίφροιο νοήσατο χερσὶν ἐλέσθαι·
ῥοίζησεν δ’ ἄρα πιφαύσκων Διομήδεϊ δίῳ.
αὐτὰρ ὃ μερμήριζε μένων ὅ τι κύντατον ἔρδοι,
ἢ ὅ γε δίφρον ἑλών, ὅθι ποικίλα τεύχε’ ἔκειτο,
ῥυμοῦ ἐξερύοι ἢ ἐκφέροι ὑψόσ’ ἀείρας,
ἦ ἔτι τῶν πλεόνων Θρῃκῶν ἀπὸ θυμὸν ἕλοιτο.
εἶος ὃ ταῦθ’ ὥρμαινε κατὰ φρένα, τόφρα δ’ Ἀθήνη
ἐγγύθεν ἱσταμένη προσέφη Διομήδεα δῖον·
νόστου δὴ μνῆσαι μεγαθύμου Τυδέος υἱὲ
νῆας ἔπι γλαφυράς, μὴ καὶ πεφοβημένος ἔλθῃς,

10.511

μή πού τις καὶ Τρῶας ἐγείρῃσιν θεὸς ἄλλος.
ὣς φάθ’, ὃ δὲ ξυνέηκε θεᾶς ὄπα φωνησάσης,
καρπαλίμως δ’ ἵππων ἐπεβήσετο· κόψε δ’ Ὀδυσσεὺς
τόξῳ· τοὶ δ’ ἐπέτοντο θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν.
οὐδ’ ἀλαοσκοπιὴν εἶχ’ ἀργυρότοξος Ἀπόλλων
ὡς ἴδ’ Ἀθηναίην μετὰ Τυδέος υἱὸν ἔπουσαν·
τῇ κοτέων Τρώων κατεδύσετο πουλὺν ὅμιλον,
ὦρσεν δὲ Θρῃκῶν βουληφόρον Ἱπποκόωντα
Ῥήσου ἀνεψιὸν ἐσθλόν· ὃ δ’ ἐξ ὕπνου ἀνορούσας
ὡς ἴδε χῶρον ἐρῆμον, ὅθ’ ἔστασαν ὠκέες ἵπποι,
ἄνδράς τ’ ἀσπαίροντας ἐν ἀργαλέῃσι φονῇσιν,
ὤμωξέν τ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα φίλον τ’ ὀνόμηνεν ἑταῖρον.
Τρώων δὲ κλαγγή τε καὶ ἄσπετος ὦρτο κυδοιμὸς
θυνόντων ἄμυδις· θηεῦντο δὲ μέρμερα ἔργα
ὅσσ’ ἄνδρες ῥέξαντες ἔβαν κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας.
οἳ δ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἵκανον ὅθι σκοπὸν Ἕκτορος ἔκταν,
ἔνθ’ Ὀδυσεὺς μὲν ἔρυξε Διῒ φίλος ὠκέας ἵππους,
Τυδεΐδης δὲ χαμᾶζε θορὼν ἔναρα βροτόεντα
ἐν χείρεσσ’ Ὀδυσῆϊ τίθει, ἐπεβήσετο δ’ ἵππων·
μάστιξεν δ’ ἵππους, τὼ δ’ οὐκ ἀέκοντε πετέσθην
νῆας ἔπι γλαφυράς· τῇ γὰρ φίλον ἔπλετο θυμῷ.
Νέστωρ δὲ πρῶτος κτύπον ἄϊε φώνησέν τε·
ὦ φίλοι Ἀργείων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες

534 ψεύσομαι, ἦ ἔτυμον ἐρέω; κέλεται δέ με θυμός.
535 ἵππων μ’ ὠκυπόδων ἀμφὶ κτύπος οὔατα βάλλει.
536 αἰ γὰρ δὴ Ὀδυσεύς τε καὶ ὃ κρατερὸς Διομήδης
537 ὧδ’ ἄφαρ ἐκ Τρώων ἐλασαίατο μώνυχας ἵππους·
538 ἀλλ’ αἰνῶς δείδοικα κατὰ φρένα μή τι πάθωσιν
539 Ἀργείων οἳ ἄριστοι ὑπὸ Τρώων ὀρυμαγδοῦ.
540 οὔ πω πᾶν εἴρητο ἔπος ὅτ’ ἄρ’ ἦλυθον αὐτοί.
When they reached the place where they had killed Hektor's scout, Odysseus stayed his horses, and the son of Tydeus, leaping to the ground, placed the blood-stained spoils in the hands of Odysseus and remounted: then he lashed the horses onwards, and they flew forward nothing loath towards the ships as though of their own free will. Nestor was first to hear the tramp of their feet. "My friends," said he, "princes and counselors of the Argives, shall I guess right or wrong? - but I must say what I think: there is a sound in my ears as of the tramp of horses. I hope it may Diomedes and Odysseus driving in horses from the Trojans, but I much fear that the bravest of the Argives may have come to some harm at their hands." He had hardly done speaking when the two men came in and dismounted, whereon the others shook hands right gladly with them and congratulated them. Nestor horseman of Gerene was first to question them. "Tell me," said he, "renowned Odysseus, how did you two come by these horses? Did you steal in among the Trojan forces, or did some god meet you and give them to you? They are like sunbeams. I am well conversant with the Trojans, for old warrior though I am I never hold back by the ships, but I never yet saw or heard of such horses as these are. Surely some god must have met you and given them to you, for you are both of dear to Zeus, and to Zeus' daughter Athena." And Odysseus answered, "Nestor son of Neleus, honor to the Achaean name, heaven, if it so will, can give us even better horses than these, for the gods are far mightier than we are. These horses, however, about which you ask me, are freshly come from Thrace. Diomedes killed their king with the twelve bravest of his companions. Hard by the ships we took a thirteenth man - a scout whom Hektor and the other Trojans had sent as a spy upon our ships." He laughed as he spoke and drove the horses over the ditch, while the other Achaeans followed him gladly. When they reached the strongly built quarters of the son of Tydeus, they tied the horses with thongs of leather to the manger, where the steeds of Diomedes stood eating their sweet grain, but Odysseus hung the blood-stained spoils of Dolon at the stern of his ship, that they might prepare a sacred offering to Athena. As for themselves, they went into the sea and washed the sweat from their bodies, and from their necks and thighs. When the sea-water had taken all the sweat from off them, and had refreshed them, they went into the baths and washed themselves. After they had so done and had anointed themselves with oil, they sat down to table, and drawing from a full mixing-bowl, made a drink-offering of wine to Athena.

10.541

541 καί ῥ’ οἳ μὲν κατέβησαν ἐπὶ χθόνα, τοὶ δὲ χαρέντες
542 δεξιῇ ἡσπάζοντο ἔπεσσί τε μειλιχίοισι·
543 πρῶτος δ’ ἐξερέεινε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
544 εἶπ’ ἄγε μ’ ὦ πολύαιν’ Ὀδυσεῦ μέγα κῦδος Ἀχαιῶν
545 ὅππως τοῦσδ’ ἵππους λάβετον καταδύντες ὅμιλον
546 Τρώων, ἦ τίς σφωε πόρεν θεὸς ἀντιβολήσας.
547 αἰνῶς ἀκτίνεσσιν ἐοικότες ἠελίοιο.
548 αἰεὶ μὲν Τρώεσσ’ ἐπιμίσγομαι, οὐδέ τί φημι
549 μιμνάζειν παρὰ νηυσὶ γέρων περ ἐὼν πολεμιστής·
550 ἀλλ’ οὔ πω τοίους ἵππους ἴδον οὐδὲ νόησα.
551 ἀλλά τιν’ ὔμμ’ ὀΐω δόμεναι θεὸν ἀντιάσαντα·

552 ἀμφοτέρω γὰρ σφῶϊ φιλεῖ νεφεληγερέτα Ζεὺς
553 κούρη τ’ αἰγιόχοιο Διὸς γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη.
554 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεύς·
555 ὦ Νέστορ Νηληϊάδη μέγα κῦδος Ἀχαιῶν
556 ῥεῖα θεός γ’ ἐθέλων καὶ ἀμείνονας ἠέ περ οἵδε
557 ἵππους δωρήσαιτ’, ἐπεὶ ἢ πολὺ φέρτεροί εἰσιν.
558 ἵπποι δ’ οἵδε γεραιὲ νεήλυδες οὓς ἐρεείνεις
559 Θρηΐκιοι· τὸν δέ σφιν ἄνακτ’ ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης
560 ἔκτανε, πὰρ δ’ ἑτάρους δυοκαίδεκα πάντας ἀρίστους.
561 τὸν τρισκαιδέκατον σκοπὸν εἴλομεν ἐγγύθι νηῶν,
562 τόν ῥα διοπτῆρα στρατοῦ ἔμμεναι ἡμετέροιο
563 Ἕκτωρ τε προέηκε καὶ ἄλλοι Τρῶες ἀγαυοί.
564 ὣς εἰπὼν τάφροιο διήλασε μώνυχας ἵππους
565 καγχαλόων· ἅμα δ’ ἄλλοι ἴσαν χαίροντες Ἀχαιοί.
566 οἳ δ’ ὅτε Τυδεΐδεω κλισίην εὔτυκτον ἵκοντο,
567 ἵππους μὲν κατέδησαν ἐϋτμήτοισιν ἱμᾶσι
568 φάτνῃ ἐφ’ ἱππείῃ, ὅθι περ Διομήδεος ἵπποι
569 ἕστασαν ὠκύποδες μελιηδέα πυρὸν ἔδοντες·
570 νηὶ δ’ ἐνὶ πρυμνῇ ἔναρα βροτόεντα Δόλωνος

10.571

571 θῆκ’ Ὀδυσεύς, ὄφρ’ ἱρὸν ἑτοιμασσαίατ’ Ἀθήνῃ.
572 αὐτοὶ δ’ ἱδρῶ πολλὸν ἀπενίζοντο θαλάσσῃ
573 ἐσβάντες κνήμας τε ἰδὲ λόφον ἀμφί τε μηρούς.
574 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί σφιν κῦμα θαλάσσης ἱδρῶ πολλὸν
575 νίψεν ἀπὸ χρωτὸς καὶ ἀνέψυχθεν φίλον ἦτορ,
576 ἔς ῥ’ ἀσαμίνθους βάντες ἐϋξέστας λούσαντο.
577 τὼ δὲ λοεσσαμένω καὶ ἀλειψαμένω λίπ’ ἐλαίῳ
578 δείπνῳ ἐφιζανέτην, ἀπὸ δὲ κρητῆρος Ἀθήνῃ
579 πλείου ἀφυσσόμενοι λεῖβον μελιηδέα οἶνον.

11.1

1 Ἠὼς δ’ ἐκ λεχέων παρ’ ἀγαυοῦ Τιθωνοῖο
2 ὄρνυθ’, ἵν’ ἀθανάτοισι φόως φέροι ἠδὲ βροτοῖσι·
3 Ζεὺς δ’ Ἔριδα προΐαλλε θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
4 ἀργαλέην, πολέμοιο τέρας μετὰ χερσὶν ἔχουσαν.
5 στῆ δ’ ἐπ’ Ὀδυσσῆος μεγακήτεϊ νηὶ μελαίνῃ,
6 ἥ ῥ’ ἐν μεσσάτῳ ἔσκε γεγωνέμεν ἀμφοτέρωσε,
7 ἠμὲν ἐπ’ Αἴαντος κλισίας Τελαμωνιάδαο
8 ἠδ’ ἐπ’ Ἀχιλλῆος, τοί ῥ’ ἔσχατα νῆας ἐΐσας
9 εἴρυσαν ἠνορέῃ πίσυνοι καὶ κάρτεϊ χειρῶν
10 ἔνθα στᾶσ’ ἤϋσε θεὰ μέγα τε δεινόν τε
11 ὄρθι’, Ἀχαιοῖσιν δὲ μέγα σθένος ἔμβαλ’ ἑκάστῳ
12 καρδίῃ ἄληκτον πολεμίζειν ἠδὲ μάχεσθαι.
13 τοῖσι δ’ ἄφαρ πόλεμος γλυκίων γένετ’ ἠὲ νέεσθαι
14 ἐν νηυσὶ γλαφυρῇσι φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν.
15 Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ἐβόησεν ἰδὲ ζώννυσθαι ἄνωγεν
16 Ἀργείους· ἐν δ’ αὐτὸς ἐδύσετο νώροπα χαλκόν.
17 κνημῖδας μὲν πρῶτα περὶ κνήμῃσιν ἔθηκε
18 καλὰς ἀργυρέοισιν ἐπισφυρίοις ἀραρυίας·

19 δεύτερον αὖ θώρηκα περὶ στήθεσσιν ἔδυνε,
20 τόν ποτέ οἱ Κινύρης δῶκε ξεινήϊον εἶναι.
21 πεύθετο γὰρ Κύπρον δὲ μέγα κλέος οὕνεκ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
22 ἐς Τροίην νήεσσιν ἀναπλεύσεσθαι ἔμελλον·
23 τοὔνεκά οἱ τὸν δῶκε χαριζόμενος βασιλῆϊ.
24 τοῦ δ’ ἤτοι δέκα οἶμοι ἔσαν μέλανος κυάνοιο,
25 δώδεκα δὲ χρυσοῖο καὶ εἴκοσι κασσιτέροιο·
26 κυάνεοι δὲ δράκοντες ὀρωρέχατο προτὶ δειρὴν
27 τρεῖς ἑκάτερθ’ ἴρισσιν ἐοικότες, ἅς τε Κρονίων
28 ἐν νέφεϊ στήριξε, τέρας μερόπων ἀνθρώπων.
29 ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ ὤμοισιν βάλετο ξίφος· ἐν δέ οἱ ἦλοι
30 χρύσειοι πάμφαινον, ἀτὰρ περὶ κουλεὸν ἦεν

And now as Dawn rose from her couch beside Tithonos, harbinger of light alike to mortals and immortals, Zeus sent fierce Discord with the ensign of war in her hands to the ships of the Achaeans. She took her stand by the huge black hull of Odysseus' ship which was middlemost of all, so that her voice might carry farthest on either side, on the one hand towards the tents of Ajax son of Telamon, and on the other towards those of Achilles - for these two heroes, well-assured of their own strength, had valorously drawn up their ships at the two ends of the line. There she took her stand, and raised a cry both loud and shrill that filled the Achaeans with courage, giving them heart to fight resolutely and with all their might, so that they had rather stay there and do battle than go home in their ships. The son of Atreus shouted aloud and bade the Argives gird themselves for battle while he put on his armor. First he girded his goodly greaves about his legs, making them fast with ankle clasps of silver; and about his chest he set the breastplate which Cinyras had once given him as a guest-gift. There had been a report [kleos] abroad, reaching as far as Cyprus, that the Achaeans were about to sail for Troy, and therefore he gave it to the king. It had ten courses of dark lapis lazuli, twelve of gold, and ten of tin. There were serpents of lapis lazuli that reared themselves up towards the neck, three upon either side, like the rainbows which the son of Kronos has set in heaven as a sign to mortal men. About his shoulders he threw his sword, studded with bosses of gold; and the scabbard was of silver with a chain of gold wherewith to hang it. He took moreover the richly-equipped shield that covered his body when he was in battle - fair to see, with ten circles of bronze running all round see, wit it. On the body of the shield there were twenty bosses of white tin, with another of dark lapis lazuli in the middle: this last was made to show a Gorgon's head, fierce and grim, with Rout and Panic on either side. The band for the arm to go through was of silver, on which there was a writhing snake of lapis lazuli with three heads that sprang from a single neck, and went in and out among one another. On his head Agamemnon set a helmet, with a peak before and behind, and four plumes of horse-hair that nodded menacingly above it; then he grasped two redoubtable bronze-shod spears, and the gleam of his armor shot from him as a flame into the firmament, while Hera and Athena thundered in honor of the king of rich Mycenae. Every man now left his horses in charge of his charioteer to hold them in proper order [kosmos] by the trench, while he went into battle on foot clad in full armor, and a mighty uproar rose on high into the dawning. The chiefs were armed and at the trench before the horses got there, but these came up presently. The son of Kronos sent a portent of evil sound about their host, and the dew fell red with blood, for he was about to send many a brave man hurrying down to Hades. The Trojans, on the other side upon the rising slope of the plain, were gathered round great Hektor, noble Polydamas, Aeneas who was honored in the district [dêmos] of the Trojans like an immortal, and the three sons of Antenor - Polybos, Agenor, and young Akamas, beauteous as a god. Hektor's round shield showed in the front rank, and as some baneful star that shines for a moment through a rent in the clouds and is again hidden beneath them; even so was Hektor

now seen in the front ranks and now again in the hindermost, and his bronze armor gleamed like the lightning of aegis-bearing Zeus. And now as a band of reapers mow swathes of wheat or barley upon a rich man's land, and the sheaves fall thick before them, even so did the Trojans and Achaeans fall upon one another; they were in no mood for yielding but fought like wolves, and neither side got the better of the other. Discord was glad as she beheld them, for she was the only god that went among them; the others were not there, but stayed quietly each in his own home among the dells and valleys of Olympus. All of them blamed the son of Kronos for wanting to Live victory to the Trojans, but father Zeus heeded them not: he held aloof from all, and sat apart in his all-glorious majesty, looking down upon the city of the Trojans, the ships of the Achaeans, the gleam of bronze, and alike upon the slayers and on the slain. Now so long as the day waxed and it was still morning, their darts rained thick on one another and the people perished, but as the hour drew nigh when a woodsman working in some mountain forest will get his midday meal - for he has felled till his hands are weary; he is tired out, and must now have food - then the Danaans, by force of their striving [aretê], broke the battalions of the enemy with a cry that rang through all their ranks. Agamemnon led them on, and slew first Bienor, a leader of his people, and afterwards his comrade and charioteer Oileus, who sprang from his chariot and was coming full towards him; but Agamemnon struck him on the forehead with his spear; his bronze visor was of no avail against the weapon, which pierced both bronze and bone, so that his brains were battered in and he was killed in full fight.

11.31

ἀργύρεον χρυσέοισιν ἀορτήρεσσιν ἀρηρός.
ἂν δ’ ἔλετ’ ἀμφιβρότην πολυδαίδαλον ἀσπίδα θοῦριν
καλήν, ἣν πέρι μὲν κύκλοι δέκα χάλκεοι ἦσαν,
ἐν δέ οἱ ὀμφαλοὶ ἦσαν ἐείκοσι κασσιτέροιο
λευκοί, ἐν δὲ μέσοισιν ἔην μέλανος κυάνοιο.
τῇ δ’ ἐπὶ μὲν Γοργὼ βλοσυρῶπις ἐστεφάνωτο
δεινὸν δερκομένη, περὶ δὲ Δεῖμός τε Φόβος τε.
τῆς δ’ ἐξ ἀργύρεος τελαμὼν ἦν· αὐτὰρ ἐπ’ αὐτοῦ
κυάνεος ἐλέλικτο δράκων, κεφαλαὶ δέ οἱ ἦσαν
τρεῖς ἀμφιστρεφέες ἑνὸς αὐχένος ἐκπεφυυῖαι.
κρατὶ δ’ ἐπ’ ἀμφίφαλον κυνέην θέτο τετραφάληρον
ἵππουριν· δεινὸν δὲ λόφος καθύπερθεν ἔνευεν.
εἵλετο δ’ ἄλκιμα δοῦρε δύω κεκορυθμένα χαλκῷ
ὀξέα· τῆλε δὲ χαλκὸς ἀπ’ αὐτόφιν οὐρανὸν εἴσω
λάμπ’· ἐπὶ δ’ ἐγδούπησαν Ἀθηναίη τε καὶ Ἥρη
τιμῶσαι βασιλῆα πολυχρύσοιο Μυκήνης.
ἡνιόχῳ μὲν ἔπειτα ἑῷ ἐπέτελλεν ἕκαστος
ἵππους εὖ κατὰ κόσμον ἐρυκέμεν αὖθ’ ἐπὶ τάφρῳ,
αὐτοὶ δὲ πρυλέες σὺν τεύχεσι θωρηχθέντες
ῥώοντ’· ἄσβεστος δὲ βοὴ γένετ’ ἠῶθι πρό.
φθὰν δὲ μέγ’ ἰππήων ἐπὶ τάφρῳ κοσμηθέντες,
ἱππῆες δ’ ὀλίγον μετεκίαθον· ἐν δὲ κυδοιμὸν
ὦρσε κακὸν Κρονίδης, κατὰ δ’ ὑψόθεν ἦκεν ἐέρσας
αἵματι μυδαλέας ἐξ αἰθέρος, οὔνεκ’ ἔμελλε
πολλὰς ἰφθίμους κεφαλὰς Ἄϊδι προϊάψειν.
Τρῶες δ’ αὖθ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐπὶ θρωσμῷ πεδίοιο
Ἕκτορά τ’ ἀμφὶ μέγαν καὶ ἀμύμονα Πουλυδάμαντα
Αἰνείαν θ’, ὃς Τρωσὶ θεὸς ὣς τίετο δήμῳ,
τρεῖς τ’ Ἀντηνορίδας Πόλυβον καὶ Ἀγήνορα δῖον

60 ἠΐθεόν τ’ Ἀκάμαντ’ ἐπιείκελον ἀθανάτοισιν.

11.61

61 Ἕκτωρ δ’ ἐν πρώτοισι φέρ’ ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην,
62 οἷος δ’ ἐκ νεφέων ἀναφαίνεται οὔλιος ἀστὴρ
63 παμφαίνων, τοτὲ δ’ αὖτις ἔδυ νέφεα σκιόεντα,
64 ὣς Ἕκτωρ ὁτὲ μέν τε μετὰ πρώτοισι φάνεσκεν,
65 ἄλλοτε δ’ ἐν πυμάτοισι κελεύων· πᾶς δ’ ἄρα χαλκῷ
66 λάμφ’ ὥς τε στεροπὴ πατρὸς Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο.
67 οἳ δ’, ὥς τ’ ἀμητῆρες ἐναντίοι ἀλλήλοισιν
68 ὄγμον ἐλαύνωσιν ἀνδρὸς μάκαρος κατ’ ἄρουραν
69 πυρῶν ἢ κριθῶν· τὰ δὲ δράγματα ταρφέα πίπτει·
70 ὣς Τρῶες καὶ Ἀχαιοὶ ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισι θορόντες
71 δῄουν, οὐδ’ ἔτεροι μνώοντ’ ὀλοοῖο φόβοιο.
72 ἵσας δ’ ὑσμίνη κεφαλὰς ἔχεν, οἳ δὲ λύκοι ὣς
73 θῦνον· Ἔρις δ’ ἄρ’ ἔχαιρε πολύστονος εἰσορόωσα·
74 οἴη γάρ ῥα θεῶν παρετύγχανε μαρναμένοισιν,
75 οἳ δ’ ἄλλοι οὔ σφιν πάρεσαν θεοί, ἀλλὰ ἔκηλοι
76 σφοῖσιν ἐνὶ μεγάροισι καθήατο, ἦχι ἑκάστῳ
77 δώματα καλὰ τέτυκτο κατὰ πτύχας Οὐλύμποιο.
78 πάντες δ’ ἠτιόωντο κελαινεφέα Κρονίωνα
79 οὕνεκ’ ἄρα Τρώεσσιν ἐβούλετο κῦδος ὀρέξαι.
80 τῶν μὲν ἄρ’ οὐκ ἀλέγιζε πατήρ· ὃ δὲ νόσφι λιασθεὶς
81 τῶν ἄλλων ἀπάνευθε καθέζετο κύδεϊ γαίων
82 εἰσορόων Τρώων τε πόλιν καὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
83 χαλκοῦ τε στεροπήν, ὀλλύντάς τ’ ὀλλυμένους τε.
84 ὄφρα μὲν ἠὼς ἦν καὶ ἀέξετο ἱερὸν ἦμαρ,
85 τόφρα μάλ’ ἀμφοτέρων βέλε’ ἵπτετο, πῖπτε δὲ λαός·
86 ἦμος δὲ δρυτόμος περ ἀνὴρ ὀπλίσσατο δεῖπνον
87 οὔρεος ἐν βήσσῃσιν, ἐπεί τ’ ἐκορέσσατο χεῖρας
88 τάμνων δένδρεα μακρά, ἄδος τέ μιν ἵκετο θυμόν,
89 σίτου τε γλυκεροῖο περὶ φρένας ἵμερος αἱρεῖ,
90 τῇμος σφῇ ἀρετῇ Δαναοὶ ῥήξαντο φάλαγγας

11.91

91 κεκλόμενοι ἑτάροισι κατὰ στίχας· ἐν δ’ Ἀγαμέμνων
92 πρῶτος ὄρουσ’, ἔλε δ’ ἄνδρα Βιάνορα ποιμένα λαῶν
93 αὐτόν, ἔπειτα δ’ ἑταῖρον Ὀϊλῆα πλήξιππον.
94 ἤτοι ὅ γ’ ἐξ ἵππων κατεπάλμενος ἀντίος ἔστη·
95 τὸν δ’ ἰθὺς μεμαῶτα μετώπιον ὀξέϊ δουρὶ
96 νύξ’, οὐδὲ στεφάνη δόρυ οἱ σχέθε χαλκοβάρεια,
97 ἀλλὰ δι’ αὐτῆς ἦλθε καὶ ὀστέου, ἐγκέφαλος δὲ
98 ἔνδον ἅπας πεπάλακτο· δάμασσε δέ μιν μεμαῶτα.
99 καὶ τοὺς μὲν λίπεν αὖθι ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων
100 στήθεσι παμφαίνοντας, ἐπεὶ περίδυσε χιτῶνας·
101 αὐτὰρ ὃ βῆ Ἴσόν τε καὶ Ἀντιφον ἐξεναρίξων
102 υἷε δύω Πριάμοιο νόθον καὶ γνήσιον ἄμφω
103 εἰν ἑνὶ δίφρῳ ἐόντας· ὃ μὲν νόθος ἡνιόχευεν,
104 Ἀντιφος αὖ παρέβασκε περικλυτός· ὥ ποτ’ Ἀχιλλεὺς
105 Ἴδης ἐν κνημοῖσι δίδη μόσχοισι λύγοισι,

106 ποιμαίνοντ’ ἐπ’ ὄεσσι λαβών, καὶ ἔλυσεν ἀποίνων.
107 δὴ τότε γ’ Ἀτρεΐδης εὐρὺ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
108 τὸν μὲν ὑπὲρ μαζοῖο κατὰ στῆθος βάλε δουρί,
109 Ἄντιφον αὖ παρὰ οὖς ἔλασε ξίφει, ἐκ δ’ ἔβαλ’ ἵππων.
110 σπερχόμενος δ’ ἀπὸ τοῖιν ἐσύλα τεύχεα καλὰ
111 γιγνώσκων· καὶ γάρ σφε πάρος παρὰ νηυσὶ θοῇσιν
112 εἶδεν, ὅτ’ ἐξ Ἴδης ἄγαγεν πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς.
113 ὡς δὲ λέων ἐλάφοιο ταχείης νήπια τέκνα
114 ῥηϊδίως συνέαξε λαβὼν κρατεροῖσιν ὀδοῦσιν
115 ἐλθὼν εἰς εὐνήν, ἁπαλόν τέ σφ’ ἦτορ ἀπηύρα·
116 ἣ δ’ εἴ πέρ τε τύχῃσι μάλα σχεδόν, οὐ δύναταί σφι
117 χραισμεῖν· αὐτὴν γάρ μιν ὑπὸ τρόμος αἰνὸς ἱκάνει·
118 καρπαλίμως δ’ ἤϊξε διὰ δρυμὰ πυκνὰ καὶ ὕλην
119 σπεύδουσ’ ἱδρώουσα κραταιοῦ θηρὸς ὑφ’ ὁρμῆς·
120 ὣς ἄρα τοῖς οὔ τις δύνατο χραισμῆσαι ὄλεθρον
Agamemnon stripped their shirts from off them and left them with their breasts all bare to lie where they had fallen. He then went on to kill Isos and Antiphos two sons of Priam, the one a bastard, the other born in wedlock; they were in the same chariot - the bastard driving, while noble Antiphos fought beside him. Achilles had once taken both of them prisoners in the glades of Ida, and had bound them with fresh withies as they were shepherding, but he had taken a ransom for them; now, however, Agamemnon son of Atreus smote Isos in the chest above the nipple with his spear, while he struck Antiphos hard by the ear and threw him from his chariot. Forthwith he stripped their goodly armor from off them and recognized them, for he had already seen them at ships when Achilles brought them in from Ida. As a lion fastens on the fawns of a hind and crushes them in his great jaws, robbing them of their tender life while he on his way back to his lair - the hind can do nothing for them even though she be close by, for she is in an agony of fear, and flies through the thick forest, sweating, and at her utmost speed before the mighty monster - so, no man of the Trojans could help Isos and Antiphos, for they were themselves fleeing panic before the Argives. Then King Agamemnon took the two sons of Antimakhos, Peisandros and brave Hippolokhos. It was Antimakhos who had been foremost in preventing Helen's being restored to Menelaos, for he was largely bribed by Alexander; and now Agamemnon took his two sons, both in the same chariot, trying to bring their horses to a stand - for they had lost hold of the reins and the horses were mad with fear. The son of Atreus sprang upon them like a lion, and the pair besought him from their chariot. "Take us alive," they cried, "son of Atreus, and you shall receive a great ransom for us. Our father Antimakhos has great store of gold, bronze, and wrought iron, and from this he will satisfy you with a very large ransom should he hear of our being alive at the ships of the Achaeans." With such piteous words and tears did they beseech the king, but they heard no pitiful answer in return. "If," said Agamemnon, "you are sons of Antimakhos, who once at a council of Trojans proposed that Menelaos and Odysseus, who had come to you as envoys, should be killed and not suffered to return, you shall now pay for the foul iniquity of your father." As he spoke he felled Peisandros from his chariot to the earth, smiting him on the chest with his spear, so that he lay face uppermost upon the ground. Hippolokhos fled, but him too did Agamemnon smite; he cut off his hands and his head - which he sent rolling in among the crowd as though it were a ball. There he let them both lie, and wherever the ranks were thickest thither he flew, while the other Achaeans followed. Foot soldiers drove the foot soldiers of the foe in rout before them, and slew them; horsemen did the like by horsemen, and the thundering tramp of the horses raised a cloud of dust from off the plain. King Agamemnon followed after, ever slaying them and cheering on the Achaeans. As when some mighty forest is all ablaze- the eddying gusts whirl fire in all directions till the thickets

shrivel and are consumed before the blast of the flame - even so fell the heads of the fleeing Trojans before Agamemnon son of Atreus, and many a noble pair of steeds drew an empty chariot along the highways of war, for lack of drivers who were lying on the plain, more useful now to vultures than to their wives. Zeus drew Hektor away from the darts and dust, with the carnage and din of battle; but the son of Atreus sped onwards, calling out lustily to the Danaans. They flew on by the tomb [sêma] of old Ilos, son of Dardanos, in the middle of the plain, and past the place of the wild fig-tree making always for the city - the son of Atreus still shouting, and with hands all bedrabbled in gore; but when they had reached the Scaean gates and the oak tree, there they halted and waited for the others to come up. Meanwhile the Trojans kept on fleeing over the middle of the plain like a herd cows maddened with fright when a lion has attacked them in the dead of night - he springs on one of them, seizes her neck in the grip of his strong teeth and then laps up her blood and gorges himself upon her entrails - even so did King Agamemnon son of Atreus pursue the foe, ever slaughtering the hindmost as they fled pell-mell before him. Many a man was flung headlong from his chariot by the hand of the son of Atreus, for he wielded his spear with fury. But when he was just about to reach the high wall and the city, the father of gods and men came down from heaven and took his seat, thunderbolt in hand, upon the crest of many-fountained Ida. He then told Iris of the golden wings to carry a message for him. "Go," said he, "fleet Iris, and speak thus to Hektor - say that so long as he sees Agamemnon heading his men and making havoc of the Trojan ranks, he is to keep aloof and bid the others bear the brunt of the battle, but when Agamemnon is wounded either by spear or arrow, and takes to his chariot, then will I grant him strength to slay till he reach the ships and night falls at the going down of the sun." Iris hearkened and obeyed. Down she went to strong Ilion from the crests of Ida, and found Hektor son of Priam standing by his chariot and horses. Then she said, "Hektor son of Priam, peer of gods in counsel, father Zeus has sent me to bear you this message - so long as you see Agamemnon heading his men and making havoc of the Trojan ranks, you are to keep aloof and bid the others bear the brunt of the battle, but when Agamemnon is wounded either by spear or arrow, and takes to his chariot, then will Zeus grant you strength to slay till you reach the ships, and till night falls at the going down of the sun."

11.121

121 Τρώων, ἀλλὰ καὶ αὐτοὶ ὑπ’ Ἀργείοισι φέβοντο.
122 αὐτὰρ ὃ Πείσανδρόν τε καὶ Ἱππόλοχον μενεχάρμην
123 υἱέας Ἀντιμάχοιο δαΐφρονος, ὅς ῥα μάλιστα
124 χρυσὸν Ἀλεξάνδροιο δεδεγμένος ἀγλαὰ δῶρα
125 οὐκ εἴασχ’ Ἑλένην δόμεναι ξανθῷ Μενελάῳ,
126 τοῦ περ δὴ δύο παῖδε λάβε κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
127 εἰν ἑνὶ δίφρῳ ἐόντας, ὁμοῦ δ’ ἔχον ὠκέας ἵππους·
128 ἐκ γάρ σφεας χειρῶν φύγον ἡνία σιγαλόεντα,
129 τὼ δὲ κυκηθήτην· ὃ δ’ ἐναντίον ὦρτο λέων ὡς
130 Ἀτρεΐδης· τὼ δ’ αὖτ’ ἐκ δίφρου γουναζέσθην·
131 ζώγρει Ἀτρέος υἱέ, σὺ δ’ ἄξια δέξαι ἄποινα·
132 πολλὰ δ’ ἐν Ἀντιμάχοιο δόμοις κειμήλια κεῖται
133 χαλκός τε χρυσός τε πολύκμητός τε σίδηρος,
134 τῶν κέν τοι χαρίσαιτο πατὴρ ἀπερείσι’ ἄποινα,
135 εἰ νῶϊ ζωοὺς πεπύθοιτ’ ἐπὶ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν.
136 ὣς τώ γε κλαίοντε προσαυδήτην βασιλῆα
137 μειλιχίοις ἐπέεσσιν· ἀμείλικτον δ’ ὄπ’ ἄκουσαν·
138 εἰ μὲν δὴ Ἀντιμάχοιο δαΐφρονος υἱέες ἐστόν,
139 ὅς ποτ’ ἐνὶ Τρώων ἀγορῇ Μενέλαον ἄνωγεν

ἀγγελίην ἐλθόντα σὺν ἀντιθέῳ Ὀδυσῆϊ
αὖθι κατακτεῖναι μηδ’ ἐξέμεν ἂψ ἐς Ἀχαιούς,
νῦν μὲν δὴ τοῦ πατρὸς ἀεικέα τίσετε λώβην.
ἦ, καὶ Πείσανδρον μὲν ἀφ’ ἵππων ὦσε χαμᾶζε
δουρὶ βαλὼν πρὸς στῆθος· ὃ δ’ ὕπτιος οὔδει ἐρείσθη.
Ἱππόλοχος δ’ ἀπόρουσε, τὸν αὖ χαμαὶ ἐξενάριξε
χεῖρας ἀπὸ ξίφεϊ τμήξας ἀπό τ’ αὐχένα κόψας,
ὅλμον δ’ ὡς ἔσσευε κυλίνδεσθαι δι’ ὁμίλου.
τοὺς μὲν ἔασ’· ὃ δ’ ὅθι πλεῖσται κλονέοντο φάλαγγες,
τῇ ῥ’ ἐνόρουσ’, ἅμα δ’ ἄλλοι ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοί.
πεζοὶ μὲν πεζοὺς ὄλεκον φεύγοντας ἀνάγκῃ,

11.151

ἱππεῖς δ’ ἱππῆας· ὑπὸ δέ σφισιν ὦρτο κονίη
ἐκ πεδίου, τὴν ὦρσαν ἐρίγδουποι πόδες ἵππων
χαλκῷ δηϊόωντες· ἀτὰρ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
αἰὲν ἀποκτείνων ἔπετ’ Ἀργείοισι κελεύων.
ὡς δ’ ὅτε πῦρ ἀΐδηλον ἐν ἀξύλῳ ἐμπέσῃ ὕλῃ,
πάντῃ τ’ εἰλυφόων ἄνεμος φέρει, οἱ δέ τε θάμνοι
πρόρριζοι πίπτουσιν ἐπειγόμενοι πυρὸς ὁρμῇ·
ὣς ἄρ’ ὑπ’ Ἀτρεΐδῃ Ἀγαμέμνονι πῖπτε κάρηνα
Τρώων φευγόντων, πολλοὶ δ’ ἐριαύχενες ἵπποι
κείν’ ὄχεα κροτάλιζον ἀνὰ πτολέμοιο γεφύρας
ἠνιόχους ποθέοντες ἀμύμονας· οἳ δ’ ἐπὶ γαίῃ
κείατο, γύπεσσιν πολὺ φίλτεροι ἢ ἀλόχοισιν.
Ἕκτορα δ’ ἐκ βελέων ὕπαγε Ζεὺς ἔκ τε κονίης
ἔκ τ’ ἀνδροκτασίης ἔκ θ’ αἵματος ἔκ τε κυδοιμοῦ·
Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ἔπετο σφεδανὸν Δαναοῖσι κελεύων.
οἳ δὲ παρ’ Ἴλου σῆμα παλαιοῦ Δαρδανίδαο
μέσσον κὰπ πεδίον παρ’ ἐρινεὸν ἐσσεύοντο
ἱέμενοι πόλιος· ὃ δὲ κεκλήγων ἔπετ’ αἰεὶ
Ἀτρεΐδης, λύθρῳ δὲ παλάσσετο χεῖρας ἀάπτους.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ Σκαιάς τε πύλας καὶ φηγὸν ἵκοντο,
ἔνθ’ ἄρα δὴ ἵσταντο καὶ ἀλλήλους ἀνέμιμνον.
οἳ δ’ ἔτι κὰμ μέσσον πεδίον φοβέοντο βόες ὥς,
ἅς τε λέων ἐφόβησε μολὼν ἐν νυκτὸς ἀμολγῷ
πάσας· τῇ δέ τ’ ἰῇ ἀναφαίνεται αἰπὺς ὄλεθρος·
τῆς δ’ ἐξ αὐχέν’ ἔαξε λαβὼν κρατεροῖσιν ὀδοῦσι
πρῶτον, ἔπειτα δέ θ’ αἷμα καὶ ἔγκατα πάντα λαφύσσει·
ὣς τοὺς Ἀτρεΐδης ἕφεπε κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
αἰὲν ἀποκτείνων τὸν ὀπίστατον· οἳ δ’ ἐφέβοντο.
πολλοὶ δὲ πρηνεῖς τε καὶ ὕπτιοι ἔκπεσον ἵππων
Ἀτρεΐδεω ὑπὸ χερσί· περὶ πρὸ γὰρ ἔγχεϊ θῦεν.

11.181

ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ τάχ’ ἔμελλεν ὑπὸ πτόλιν αἰπύ τε τεῖχος
ἵξεσθαι, τότε δή ῥα πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε
Ἴδης ἐν κορυφῇσι καθέζετο πιδηέσσης
οὐρανόθεν καταβάς· ἔχε δ’ ἀστεροπὴν μετὰ χερσίν.
Ἶριν δ’ ὄτρυνε χρυσόπτερον ἀγγελέουσαν·

186 βάσκ’ ἴθι Ἶρι ταχεῖα, τὸν Ἕκτορι μῦθον ἐνίσπες·
187 ὅφρ’ ἂν μέν κεν ὁρᾷ Ἀγαμέμνονα ποιμένα λαῶν
188 θύνοντ’ ἐν προμάχοισιν ἐναίροντα στίχας ἀνδρῶν,
189 τόφρ’ ἀναχωρείτω, τὸν δ’ ἄλλον λαὸν ἀνώχθω
190 μάρνασθαι δηΐοισι κατὰ κρατερὴν ὑσμίνην.
191 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί κ’ ἢ δουρὶ τυπεὶς ἢ βλήμενος ἰῷ
192 εἰς ἵππους ἅλεται, τότε οἱ κράτος ἐγγυαλίξω
193 κτείνειν εἰς ὅ κε νῆας ἐϋσσέλμους ἀφίκηται
194 δύῃ τ’ ἠέλιος καὶ ἐπὶ κνέφας ἱερὸν ἔλθῃ.
195 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε ποδήνεμος ὠκέα Ἶρις,
196 βῆ δὲ κατ’ Ἰδαίων ὀρέων εἰς Ἴλιον ἱρήν.
197 εὗρ’ υἱὸν Πριάμοιο δαΐφρονος Ἕκτορα δῖον
198 ἑσταότ’ ἔν θ’ ἵπποισι καὶ ἄρμασι κολλητοῖσιν·
199 ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱσταμένη προσέφη πόδας ὠκέα Ἶρις·
200 Ἕκτορ υἱὲ Πριάμοιο Διὶ μῆτιν ἀτάλαντε
201 Ζεύς με πατὴρ προέηκε τεὴν τάδε μυθήσασθαι.
202 ὅφρ’ ἂν μέν κεν ὁρᾷς Ἀγαμέμνονα ποιμένα λαῶν
203 θύνοντ’ ἐν προμάχοισιν, ἐναίροντα στίχας ἀνδρῶν,
204 τόφρ’ ὑπόεικε μάχης, τὸν δ’ ἄλλον λαὸν ἄνωχθι
205 μάρνασθαι δηΐοισι κατὰ κρατερὴν ὑσμίνην.
206 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί κ’ ἢ δουρὶ τυπεὶς ἢ βλήμενος ἰῷ
207 εἰς ἵππους ἅλεται, τότε τοι κράτος ἐγγυαλίξει
208 κτείνειν, εἰς ὅ κε νῆας ἐϋσσέλμους ἀφίκηαι
209 δύῃ τ’ ἠέλιος καὶ ἐπὶ κνέφας ἱερὸν ἔλθῃ.
210 ἣ μὲν ἄρ’ ὣς εἰποῦσ’ ἀπέβη πόδας ὠκέα Ἶρις,

When she had thus spoken Iris left him, and Hektor sprang full armed from his chariot to the ground, brandishing his spear as he went about everywhere among the host, cheering his men on to fight, and stirring the dread strife of battle. The Trojans then wheeled round, and again met the Achaeans, while the Argives on their part strengthened their battalions. The battle was now in array and they stood face to face with one another, Agamemnon ever pressing forward in his eagerness to be ahead of all others. Tell me now you Muses that dwell in the mansions of Olympus, who, whether of the Trojans or of their allies, was first to face Agamemnon? It was Iphidamas son of Antenor, a man both brave and of great stature, who was brought up in fertile Thrace the mother of sheep. Kissês, his mother's father, brought him up in his own house when he was a child - Kissês, father to fair Theano. When he reached manhood, Kissês would have kept him there, and was for giving him his daughter in marriage, but as soon as he had married, he went away from the bride chamber, looking for glory [kleos] from the Achaeans. He came with twelve ships: these he had left at Perkote and had come on by land to Ilion. He it was that now met Agamemnon son of Atreus. When they were close up with one another, the son of Atreus missed his aim, and Iphidamas hit him on the belt below the cuirass and then flung himself upon him, trusting to his strength of arm; the belt, however, was not pierced, nor nearly so, for the point of the spear struck against the silver and was turned aside as though it had been lead: King Agamemnon caught it from his hand, and drew it towards him with the fury of a lion; he then drew his sword, and killed Iphidamas by striking him on the neck. So there the poor young man lay, sleeping a sleep as it were of bronze, killed in the defense of his fellow-citizens, far from his wedded wife, of whom he had had no joy [kharis] though he had given much for her: he had given a hundred-head of cattle down, and had promised later on to give a thousand sheep and goats mixed, from the countless flocks of which he was possessed. Agamemnon son of Atreus then despoiled him, and carried off his armor into the host of the Achaeans. When noble Koön, Antenor's eldest son, saw this, the grief [penthos]

made his eyes sore at the sight of his fallen brother. Unseen by Agamemnon he got beside him, spear in hand, and wounded him in the middle of his arm below the elbow, the point of the spear going right through the arm. Agamemnon was convulsed with pain, but still not even for this did he leave off struggling and fighting, but grasped his spear that flew as fleet as the wind, and sprang upon Koön who was trying to drag off the body of his brother - his father's son - by the foot, and was crying for help to all the bravest of his comrades; but Agamemnon struck him with a bronze-shod spear and killed him as he was dragging the dead body through the press of men under cover of his shield: he then cut off his head, standing over the body of Iphidamas. Thus did the sons of Antenor meet their fate at the hands of the son of Atreus, and go down into the house of Hades. As long as the blood still welled warm from his wound Agamemnon went about attacking the ranks of the enemy with spear and sword and with great handfuls of stone, but when the blood had ceased to flow and the wound grew dry, the pain became great. As the sharp pangs which the Eileithuiai, goddesses of childbirth, daughters of Hera and dispensers of cruel pain, send upon a woman when she is in labor- even so sharp were the pangs of the son of Atreus. He sprang on to his chariot, and bade his charioteer drive to the ships, for he was in great agony. With a loud clear voice he shouted to the Danaans, "My friends, princes and counselors of the Argives, defend the ships yourselves, for Zeus has not suffered me to fight the whole day through against the Trojans." With this the charioteer turned his horses towards the ships, and they flew forward nothing loath. Their chests were white with foam and their bellies with dust, as they drew the wounded king out of the battle. When Hektor saw Agamemnon quit the field, he shouted to the Trojans and Lycians saying, "Trojans, Lycians, and Dardanian warriors, be men, my friends, and acquit yourselves in battle bravely; their best man has left them, and Zeus has granted me a great triumph; charge the foe with your chariots that. you may win still greater glory." With these words he put heart and soul into them all, and as a huntsman hounds his dogs on against a lion or wild boar, even so did Hektor, peer of Ares, hound the proud Trojans on against the Achaeans. Full of hope he plunged in among the foremost, and fell on the fight like some fierce tempest that swoops down upon the sea, and lashes its deep violet waters [pontos] into fury. What, then is the full tale of those whom Hektor son of Priam killed in the hour of triumph which Zeus then granted him? First Asaios, Autonoos, and Opites; Dolops son of Klytios, Opheltios and Agelaos; Aisymnos, Orus and Hipponoos steadfast in battle; these chieftains of the Achaeans did Hektor slay, and then he fell upon the rank and file. As when the west wind hustles the clouds of the white south and beats them down with the fierceness of its fury - the waves of the sea roll high, and the spray is flung aloft in the rage of the wandering wind - even so thick were the heads of them that fell by the hand of Hektor.

11.211

211 Ἕκτωρ δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων σὺν τεύχεσιν ἅλτο χαμᾶζε,
212 πάλλων δ’ ὀξέα δοῦρα κατὰ στρατὸν ὤχετο πάντῃ
213 ὀτρύνων μαχέσασθαι, ἔγειρε δὲ φύλοπιν αἰνήν.
214 οἳ δ’ ἐλελίχθησαν καὶ ἐναντίοι ἔσταν Ἀχαιῶν,
215 Ἀργεῖοι δ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐκαρτύναντο φάλαγγας.
216 ἀρτύνθη δὲ μάχη, στὰν δ’ ἀντίοι· ἐν δ’ Ἀγαμέμνων
217 πρῶτος ὄρουσ’, ἔθελεν δὲ πολὺ προμάχεσθαι ἁπάντων.
218 ἔσπετε νῦν μοι Μοῦσαι Ὀλύμπια δώματ’ ἔχουσαι
219 ὅς τις δὴ πρῶτος Ἀγαμέμνονος ἀντίον ἦλθεν
220 ἢ αὐτῶν Τρώων ἠὲ κλειτῶν ἐπικούρων.
221 Ἰφιδάμας Ἀντηνορίδης ἠΰς τε μέγας τε
222 ὃς τράφη ἐν Θρήκῃ ἐριβώλακι μητέρι μήλων·
223 Κισσῆς τόν γ’ ἔθρεψε δόμοις ἔνι τυτθὸν ἐόντα

μητροπάτωρ, ὃς τίκτε Θεανὼ καλλιπάρῃον·
αὐτὰρ ἐπεί ῥ’ ἤβης ἐρικυδέος ἵκετο μέτρον,
αὐτοῦ μιν κατέρυκε, δίδου δ’ ὅ γε θυγατέρα ἣν·
γήμας δ’ ἐκ θαλάμοιο μετὰ κλέος ἵκετ’ Ἀχαιῶν
σὺν δυοκαίδεκα νηυσὶ κορωνίσιν, αἵ οἱ ἕποντο.
τὰς μὲν ἔπειτ’ ἐν Περκώτῃ λίπε νῆας ἐΐσας,
αὐτὰρ ὃ πεζὸς ἐὼν ἐς Ἴλιον εἰληλούθει·
ὅς ῥα τότ’ Ἀτρεΐδεω Ἀγαμέμνονος ἀντίον ἦλθεν.
οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντες,
Ἀτρεΐδης μὲν ἄμαρτε, παραὶ δέ οἱ ἐτράπετ’ ἔγχος,
Ἰφιδάμας δὲ κατὰ ζώνην θώρηκος ἔνερθε
νύξ’, ἐπὶ δ’ αὐτὸς ἔρεισε βαρείῃ χειρὶ πιθήσας·
οὐδ’ ἔτορε ζωστῆρα παναίολον, ἀλλὰ πολὺ πρὶν
ἀργύρῳ ἀντομένη μόλιβος ὣς ἐτράπετ’ αἰχμή.
καὶ τό γε χειρὶ λαβὼν εὐρὺ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
ἕλκ’ ἐπὶ οἷ μεμαὼς ὥς τε λίς, ἐκ δ’ ἄρα χειρὸς
σπάσσατο· τὸν δ’ ἄορι πλῆξ’ αὐχένα, λῦσε δὲ γυῖα.

11.241

ὣς ὃ μὲν αὖθι πεσὼν κοιμήσατο χάλκεον ὕπνον
οἰκτρὸς ἀπὸ μνηστῆς ἀλόχου, ἀστοῖσιν ἀρήγων,
κουριδίης, ἧς οὔ τι χάριν ἴδε, πολλὰ δ’ ἔδωκε·
πρῶθ’ ἑκατὸν βοῦς δῶκεν, ἔπειτα δὲ χίλι’ ὑπέστη
αἶγας ὁμοῦ καὶ ὄϊς, τά οἱ ἄσπετα ποιμαίνοντο.
δὴ τότε γ’ Ἀτρεΐδης Ἀγαμέμνων ἐξενάριξε,
βῆ δὲ φέρων ἀν’ ὅμιλον Ἀχαιῶν τεύχεα καλά.
τὸν δ’ ὡς οὖν ἐνόησε Κόων ἀριδείκετος ἀνδρῶν
πρεσβυγενὴς Ἀντηνορίδης, κρατερόν ῥά ἑ πένθος
ὀφθαλμοὺς ἐκάλυψε κασιγνήτοιο πεσόντος.
στῆ δ’ εὐρὰξ σὺν δουρὶ λαθὼν Ἀγαμέμνονα δῖον,
νύξε δέ μιν κατὰ χεῖρα μέσην ἀγκῶνος ἔνερθε,
ἀντικρὺ δὲ διέσχε φαεινοῦ δουρὸς ἀκωκή.
ῥίγησέν τ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
ἀλλ’ οὐδ’ ὣς ἀπέληγε μάχης ἠδὲ πτολέμοιο,
ἀλλ’ ἐπόρουσε Κόωνι ἔχων ἀνεμοτρεφὲς ἔγχος.
ἤτοι ὃ Ἰφιδάμαντα κασίγνητον καὶ ὄπατρον
ἕλκε ποδὸς μεμαώς, καὶ ἀΰτει πάντας ἀρίστους·
τὸν δ’ ἔλκοντ’ ἀν’ ὅμιλον ὑπ’ ἀσπίδος ὀμφαλοέσσης
οὔτησε ξυστῷ χαλκήρεϊ, λῦσε δὲ γυῖα·
τοῖο δ’ ἐπ’ Ἰφιδάμαντι κάρη ἀπέκοψε παραστάς.
ἔνθ’ Ἀντήνορος υἷες ὑπ’ Ἀτρεΐδῃ βασιλῆϊ
πότμον ἀναπλήσαντες ἔδυν δόμον Ἄϊδος εἴσω.
αὐτὰρ ὃ τῶν ἄλλων ἐπεπωλεῖτο στίχας ἀνδρῶν
ἔγχεΐ τ’ ἄορί τε μεγάλοισί τε χερμαδίοισιν,
ὄφρά οἱ αἷμ’ ἔτι θερμὸν ἀνήνοθεν ἐξ ὠτειλῆς.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ τὸ μὲν ἕλκος ἐτέρσετο, παύσατο δ’ αἷμα,
ὀξεῖαι δ’ ὀδύναι δῦνον μένος Ἀτρεΐδαο.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἂν ὠδίνουσαν ἔχῃ βέλος ὀξὺ γυναῖκα
δριμύ, τό τε προϊεῖσι μογοστόκοι Εἰλείθυιαι

11.271

271 Ἥρης θυγατέρες πικρὰς ὠδῖνας ἔχουσαι,
272 ὣς ὀξεῖ᾽ ὀδύναι δῦνον μένος Ἀτρεΐδαο.
273 ἐς δίφρον δ᾽ ἀνόρουσε, καὶ ἡνιόχῳ ἐπέτελλε
274 νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσιν ἐλαυνέμεν· ἤχθετο γὰρ κῆρ.
275 ἤϋσεν δὲ διαπρύσιον Δαναοῖσι γεγωνώς·
276 ὦ φίλοι Ἀργείων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες
277 ὑμεῖς μὲν νῦν νηυσὶν ἀμύνετε ποντοπόροισι
278 φύλοπιν ἀργαλέην, ἐπεὶ οὐκ ἐμὲ μητίετα Ζεὺς
279 εἴασε Τρώεσσι πανημέριον πολεμίζειν.
280 ὣς ἔφαθ᾽, ἡνίοχος δ᾽ ἵμασεν καλλίτριχας ἵππους
281 νῆας ἔπι γλαφυράς· τὼ δ᾽ οὐκ ἀέκοντε πετέσθην·
282 ἄφρεον δὲ στήθεα, ῥαίνοντο δὲ νέρθε κονίῃ
283 τειρόμενον βασιλῆα μάχης ἀπάνευθε φέροντες.
284 Ἕκτωρ δ᾽ ὡς ἐνόησ᾽ Ἀγαμέμνονα νόσφι κιόντα
285 Τρωσί τε καὶ Λυκίοισιν ἐκέκλετο μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
286 Τρῶες καὶ Λύκιοι καὶ Δάρδανοι ἀγχιμαχηταὶ
287 ἀνέρες ἔστε φίλοι, μνήσασθε δὲ θούριδος ἀλκῆς.
288 οἴχετ᾽ ἀνὴρ ὥριστος, ἐμοὶ δὲ μέγ᾽ εὖχος ἔδωκε
289 Ζεὺς Κρονίδης· ἀλλ᾽ ἰθὺς ἐλαύνετε μώνυχας ἵππους
290 ἰφθίμων Δαναῶν, ἵν᾽ ὑπέρτερον εὖχος ἄρησθε.
291 ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε μένος καὶ θυμὸν ἑκάστου.
292 ὡς δ᾽ ὅτε πού τις θηρητὴρ κύνας ἀργιόδοντας
293 σεύῃ ἐπ᾽ ἀγροτέρῳ συῒ καπρίῳ ἠὲ λέοντι,
294 ὣς ἐπ᾽ Ἀχαιοῖσιν σεῦε Τρῶας μεγαθύμους
295 Ἕκτωρ Πριαμίδης βροτολοιγῷ ἶσος Ἄρηϊ.
296 αὐτὸς δ᾽ ἐν πρώτοισι μέγα φρονέων ἐβεβήκει,
297 ἐν δ᾽ ἔπεσ᾽ ὑσμίνῃ ὑπεραΐῃ ἶσος ἀέλλῃ,
298 ἥ τε καθαλλομένη ἰοειδέα πόντον ὀρίνει.
299 ἔνθα τίνα πρῶτον, τίνα δ᾽ ὕστατον ἐξενάριξεν
300 Ἕκτωρ Πριαμίδης, ὅτε οἱ Ζεὺς κῦδος ἔδωκεν;

11.301

301 Ἀσαῖον μὲν πρῶτα καὶ Αὐτόνοον καὶ Ὀπίτην
302 καὶ Δόλοπα Κλυτίδην καὶ Ὀφέλτιον ἠδ᾽ Ἀγέλαον
303 Αἴσυμνόν τ᾽ Ὄρόν τε καὶ Ἱππόνοον μενεχάρμην.
304 τοὺς ἄρ᾽ ὅ γ᾽ ἡγεμόνας Δαναῶν ἕλεν, αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
305 πληθύν, ὡς ὁπότε νέφεα Ζέφυρος στυφελίξῃ
306 ἀργεστᾶο Νότοιο βαθείῃ λαίλαπι τύπτων·
307 πολλὸν δὲ τρόφι κῦμα κυλίνδεται, ὑψόσε δ᾽ ἄχνη
308 σκίδναται ἐξ ἀνέμοιο πολυπλάγκτοιο ἰωῆς·
309 ὣς ἄρα πυκνὰ καρήαθ᾽ ὑφ᾽ Ἕκτορι δάμνατο λαῶν.
310 ἔνθά κε λοιγὸς ἔην καὶ ἀμήχανα ἔργα γένοντο,
311 καί νύ κεν ἐν νήεσσι πέσον φεύγοντες Ἀχαιοί,
312 εἰ μὴ Τυδεΐδῃ Διομήδεϊ κέκλετ᾽ Ὀδυσσεύς·
313 Τυδεΐδη τί παθόντε λελάσμεθα θούριδος ἀλκῆς;
314 ἀλλ᾽ ἄγε δεῦρο πέπον, παρ᾽ ἔμ᾽ ἵσταο· δὴ γὰρ ἔλεγχος
315 ἔσσεται εἴ κεν νῆας ἕλῃ κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ.
316 τὸν δ᾽ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη κρατερὸς Διομήδης·
317 ἤτοι ἐγὼ μενέω καὶ τλήσομαι· ἀλλὰ μίνυνθα
318 ἡμέων ἔσσεται ἦδος, ἐπεὶ νεφεληγερέτα Ζεὺς

319 Τρωσὶν δὴ βόλεται δοῦναι κράτος ἠέ περ ἡμῖν.
320 ἦ καὶ Θυμβραῖον μὲν ἀφ’ ἵππων ὦσε χαμᾶζε
321 δουρὶ βαλὼν κατὰ μαζὸν ἀριστερόν· αὐτὰρ Ὀδυσσεὺς
322 ἀντίθεον θεράποντα Μολίονα τοῖο ἄνακτος.
323 τοὺς μὲν ἔπειτ’ εἴασαν, ἐπεὶ πολέμου ἀπέπαυσαν·
324 τὼ δ’ ἀν’ ὅμιλον ἰόντε κυδοίμεον, ὡς ὅτε κάπρω
325 ἐν κυσὶ θηρευτῇσι μέγα φρονέοντε πέσητον·
326 ὣς ὄλεκον Τρῶας πάλιν ὀρμένω· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
327 ἀσπασίως φεύγοντες ἀνέπνεον Ἕκτορα δῖον.
328 ἔνθ’ ἐλέτην δίφρόν τε καὶ ἀνέρε δήμου ἀρίστω
329 υἷε δύω Μέροπος Περκωσίου, ὃς περὶ πάντων
330 ᾔδεε μαντοσύνας, οὐδὲ οὓς παῖδας ἔασκε
All had then been lost and no help for it, and the Achaeans would have fled pell-mell to their ships, had not Odysseus cried out to Diomedes, "Son of Tydeus, what has happened to us that we thus forget our prowess? Come, my good man, stand by my side and help me, we shall be shamed for ever if Hektor takes the ships." And Diomedes answered, "Come what may, I will stand firm; but we shall have scant joy of it, for Zeus is minded to give victory to the Trojans rather than to us." With these words he struck Thymbraios from his chariot to the ground, smiting him in the left breast with his spear, while Odysseus killed Molion who was his squire [therapôn]. These they let lie, now that they had stopped their fighting; the two heroes then went on playing havoc with the foe, like two wild boars that turn in fury and rend the hounds that hunt them. Thus did they turn upon the Trojans and slay them, and the Achaeans were thankful to have breathing time in their flight from Hektor. They then took two princes with their chariot, the two sons of Merops of Perkote, who excelled in the arts of divination all others from the district [dêmos]. He had forbidden his sons to go to the war, but they would not obey him, for fate lured them to their fall. Diomedes son of Tydeus deprived them both of their life-breath [psukhê] and stripped them of their armor, while Odysseus killed Hippodamos and Hypeirochos. And now the son of Kronos as he looked down from Ida ordained that neither side should have the advantage, and they kept on killing one another. The son of Tydeus speared Agastrophos son of Paeon in the hip-joint with his spear. His chariot was not at hand for him to fly with, so blindly confident had he been. His squire [therapôn] was in charge of it at some distance and he was fighting on foot among the foremost until he lost his life. Hektor soon marked the havoc Diomedes and Odysseus were making, and bore down upon them with a loud cry, followed by the Trojan ranks; brave Diomedes was dismayed when he saw them, and said to Odysseus who was beside him, "Great Hektor is bearing down upon us and we shall be undone; let us stand firm and wait his onset." He poised his spear as he spoke and hurled it, nor did he miss his mark. He had aimed at Hektor's head near the top of his helmet, but bronze was turned by bronze, and Hektor was untouched, for the spear was stayed by the visored helm made with three plates of metal, which Phoebus Apollo had given him. Hektor sprang back with a great bound under cover of the ranks; he fell on his knees and propped himself with his brawny hand leaning on the ground, for darkness had fallen on his eyes. The son of Tydeus having thrown his spear dashed in among the foremost fighters, to the place where he had seen it strike the ground; meanwhile Hektor recovered himself and springing back into his chariot mingled with the crowd, by which means he saved his life. But Diomedes made at him with his spear and said, "Dog, you have again got away though death was close on your heels. Phoebus Apollo, to whom I ween you pray ere you go into battle, has again saved you, nevertheless I will meet you and make and end of you hereafter, if there is any god who will stand by me too and be my helper. For the present I must pursue those I can lay hands on." As he spoke he began stripping the spoils from the son of Paeon, but Alexander husband of lovely Helen aimed an arrow at him, leaning against a pillar of the monument which men

had raised to Ilos son of Dardanos, a ruler in days of old. Diomedes had taken the cuirass from off the breast of Agastrophos, his heavy helmet also, and the shield from off his shoulders, when Paris drew his bow and let fly an arrow that sped not from his hand in vain, but pierced the flat of Diomedes' right foot, going right through it and fixing itself in the ground. Thereon Paris with a hearty laugh sprang forward from his hiding-place, and taunted him saying, "You are wounded - my arrow has not been shot in vain; would that it had hit you in the belly and killed you, for thus the Trojans, who fear you as goats fear a lion, would have had a truce from evil."

11.331

στείχειν ἐς πόλεμον φθισήνορα· τὼ δέ οἱ οὔ τι
πειθέσθην· κῆρες γὰρ ἄγον μέλανος θανάτοιο.
τοὺς μὲν Τυδεΐδης δουρικλειτὸς Διομήδης
θυμοῦ καὶ ψυχῆς κεκαδὼν κλυτὰ τεύχε’ ἀπηύρα·
Ἱππόδαμον δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς καὶ Ὑπείροχον ἐξενάριξεν.
ἔνθά σφιν κατὰ ἶσα μάχην ἐτάνυσσε Κρονίων
ἐξ Ἴδης καθορῶν· τοὶ δ’ ἀλλήλους ἐνάριζον.
ἤτοι Τυδέος υἱὸς Ἀγάστροφον οὔτασε δουρὶ
Παιονίδην ἥρωα κατ’ ἰσχίον· οὐ δέ οἱ ἵπποι
ἐγγὺς ἔσαν προφυγεῖν, ἀάσατο δὲ μέγα θυμῷ.
τοὺς μὲν γὰρ θεράπων ἀπάνευθ’ ἔχεν, αὐτὰρ ὃ πεζὸς
θῦνε διὰ προμάχων, εἷος φίλον ὤλεσε θυμόν.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ὀξὺ νόησε κατὰ στίχας, ὦρτο δ’ ἐπ’ αὐτοὺς
κεκλήγων· ἅμα δὲ Τρώων εἵποντο φάλαγγες.
τὸν δὲ ἰδὼν ῥίγησε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης,
αἶψα δ’ Ὀδυσσῆα προσεφώνεεν ἐγγὺς ἐόντα·
νῶϊν δὴ τόδε πῆμα κυλίνδεται ὄβριμος Ἕκτωρ·
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ στέωμεν καὶ ἀλεξώμεσθα μένοντες.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἀμπεπαλὼν προΐει δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος
καὶ βάλεν, οὐδ’ ἀφάμαρτε τιτυσκόμενος κεφαλῆφιν,
ἄκρην κὰκ κόρυθα· πλάγχθη δ’ ἀπὸ χαλκόφι χαλκός,
οὐδ’ ἵκετο χρόα καλόν· ἐρύκακε γὰρ τρυφάλεια
τρίπτυχος αὐλῶπις, τήν οἱ πόρε Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ὦκ’ ἀπέλεθρον ἀνέδραμε, μίκτο δ’ ὁμίλῳ,
στῆ δὲ γνὺξ ἐριπὼν καὶ ἐρείσατο χειρὶ παχείῃ
γαίης· ἀμφὶ δὲ ὄσσε κελαινὴ νὺξ ἐκάλυψεν.
ὄφρα δὲ Τυδεΐδης μετὰ δούρατος ὤχετ’ ἐρωὴν
τῆλε διὰ προμάχων, ὅθι οἱ καταείσατο γαίης
τόφρ’ Ἕκτωρ ἔμπνυτο, καὶ ἂψ ἐς δίφρον ὀρούσας
ἐξέλασ’ ἐς πληθύν, καὶ ἀλεύατο κῆρα μέλαιναν.

11.361

δουρὶ δ’ ἐπαΐσσων προσέφη κρατερὸς Διομήδης·
ἐξ αὖ νῦν ἔφυγες θάνατον κύον· ἦ τέ τοι ἄγχι
ἦλθε κακόν· νῦν αὖτέ σ’ ἐρύσατο Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων
ᾧ μέλλεις εὔχεσθαι ἰὼν ἐς δοῦπον ἀκόντων.
ἦ θήν σ’ ἐξανύω γε καὶ ὕστερον ἀντιβολήσας,
εἴ πού τις καὶ ἔμοιγε θεῶν ἐπιτάρροθός ἐστι.
νῦν αὖ τοὺς ἄλλους ἐπιείσομαι, ὅν κε κιχείω.
ἦ, καὶ Παιονίδην δουρὶ κλυτὸν ἐξενάριζεν.

369 αὐτὰρ Ἀλέξανδρος Ἑλένης πόσις ἠϋκόμοιο
370 Τυδεΐδῃ ἔπι τόξα τιταίνετο ποιμένι λαῶν,
371 στήλῃ κεκλιμένος ἀνδροκμήτῳ ἐπὶ τύμβῳ
372 Ἴλου Δαρδανίδαο, παλαιοῦ δημογέροντος.
373 ἤτοι ὃ μὲν θώρηκα Ἀγαστρόφου ἰφθίμοιο
374 αἴνυτ’ ἀπὸ στήθεσφι παναίολον ἀσπίδα τ’ ὤμων
375 καὶ κόρυθα βριαρήν· ὃ δὲ τόξου πῆχυν ἄνελκε
376 καὶ βάλεν, οὐδ’ ἄρα μιν ἅλιον βέλος ἔκφυγε χειρός,
377 ταρσὸν δεξιτεροῖο ποδός· διὰ δ’ ἀμπερὲς ἰὸς
378 ἐν γαίῃ κατέπηκτο· ὃ δὲ μάλα ἡδὺ γελάσσας
379 ἐκ λόχου ἀμπήδησε καὶ εὐχόμενος ἔπος ηὔδα·
380 βέβληαι οὐδ’ ἅλιον βέλος ἔκφυγεν· ὡς ὄφελόν τοι
381 νείατον ἐς κενεῶνα βαλὼν ἐκ θυμὸν ἑλέσθαι.
382 οὕτω κεν καὶ Τρῶες ἀνέπνευσαν κακότητος,
383 οἵ τέ σε πεφρίκασι λέονθ’ ὡς μηκάδες αἶγες.
384 τὸν δ’ οὐ ταρβήσας προσέφη κρατερὸς Διομήδης·
385 τοξότα λωβητὴρ κέρᾳ ἀγλαὲ παρθενοπῖπα
386 εἰ μὲν δὴ ἀντίβιον σὺν τεύχεσι πειρηθείης,
387 οὐκ ἄν τοι χραίσμῃσι βιὸς καὶ ταρφέες ἰοί·
388 νῦν δέ μ’ ἐπιγράψας ταρσὸν ποδὸς εὔχεαι αὔτως.
389 οὐκ ἀλέγω, ὡς εἴ με γυνὴ βάλοι ἢ πάϊς ἄφρων·
390 κωφὸν γὰρ βέλος ἀνδρὸς ἀνάλκιδος οὐτιδανοῖο.
Diomedes all undaunted answered, "Archer, you who without your bow are nothing, slanderer and seducer, if you were to be tried in single combat fighting in full armor, your bow and your arrows would serve you in little stead. Vain is your boast in that you have scratched the sole of my foot. I care no more than if a girl or some silly boy had hit me. A worthless coward can inflict but a light wound; when I wound a man though I but graze his skin it is another matter, for my weapon will lay him low. His wife will tear her cheeks for grief and his children will be fatherless: there will he rot, reddening the earth with his blood, and vultures, not women, will gather round him." Thus he spoke, but Odysseus came up and stood over him. Under this cover he sat down to draw the arrow from his foot, and sharp was the pain he suffered as he did so. Then he sprang on to his chariot and bade the charioteer drive him to the ships, for he was sick at heart. Odysseus was now alone; not one of the Argives stood by him, for they were all panic-stricken. "Alas," said he to himself in his dismay, "what will become of me? It is ill if I turn and flee before these odds, but it will be worse if I am left alone and taken prisoner, for the son of Kronos has struck the rest of the Danaans with panic. But why talk to myself in this way? Well do I know that though cowards quit the field, a hero, whether he wound or be wounded, must stand firm and hold his own." While he was thus in two minds, the ranks of the Trojans advanced and hemmed him in, and bitterly did they come to me it. As hounds and lusty youths set upon a wild boar that sallies from his lair whetting his white tusks - they attack him from every side and can hear the gnashing of his jaws, but for all his fierceness they still hold their ground - even so furiously did the Trojans attack Odysseus. First he sprang spear in hand upon Deiopites and wounded him on the shoulder with a downward blow; then he killed Thoon and Ennomos. After these he struck Chersidamas in the loins under his shield as he had just sprung down from his chariot; so he fell in the dust and clutched the earth in the hollow of his hand. These he let lie, and went on to wound Charops son of Hippasus, brother to noble Sokos. Sokos, hero that he was, made all speed to help him, and when he was close to Odysseus he said, "Far-famed Odysseus, insatiable of craft and toil [ponos], this day you shall either boast of having killed both the sons of Hippasus and stripped them of their armor, or you shall fall before my spear." With these words he struck the shield of Odysseus. The spear

went through the shield and passed on through his richly wrought cuirass, tearing the flesh from his side, but Pallas Athena did not suffer it to pierce the entrails of the hero. Odysseus knew that his hour [telos] was not yet come, but he gave ground and said to Sokos, "Wretch, you shall now surely die. You have stayed me from fighting further with the Trojans, but you shall now fall by my spear, yielding glory to myself, and your life-breath [psukhê] to Hades of the noble steeds." Sokos had turned in flight, but as he did so, the spear struck him in the back midway between the shoulders, and went right through his chest. He fell heavily to the ground and Odysseus vaunted over him saying, "O Sokos, son of Hippasus tamer of horses, the outcome [telos] of death has been too quick for you and you have not escaped him: poor wretch, not even in death shall your father and mother close your eyes, but the ravening vultures shall enshroud you with the flapping of their dark wings and devour you. Whereas even though I fall the Achaeans will give me my due rites of burial." So saying he drew Sokos' heavy spear out of his flesh and from his shield, and the blood welled forth when the spear was withdrawn so that he was much dismayed. When the Trojans saw that Odysseus was bleeding they raised a great shout and came on in a body towards him; he therefore gave ground, and called his comrades to come and help him. Thrice did he cry as loudly as man can cry, and thrice did brave Menelaos hear him; he turned, therefore, to Ajax who was close beside him and said, "Ajax, noble son of Telamon, leader of your people, the cry of Odysseus rings in my ears, as though the Trojans had cut him off and were worsting him while he is single-handed. Let us make our way through the throng; it will be well that we defend him; I fear he may come to harm for all his valor if he be left without support, and the Danaans would miss him sorely."

11.391

391 ἦ τ’ ἄλλως ὑπ’ ἐμεῖο, καὶ εἴ κ’ ὀλίγον περ ἐπαύρῃ,
392 ὀξὺ βέλος πέλεται, καὶ ἀκήριον αἶψα τίθησι.
393 τοῦ δὲ γυναικὸς μέν τ’ ἀμφίδρυφοί εἰσι παρειαί,
394 παῖδες δ’ ὀρφανικοί· ὃ δέ θ’ αἵματι γαῖαν ἐρεύθων
395 πύθεται, οἰωνοὶ δὲ περὶ πλέες ἠὲ γυναῖκες.
396 ὣς φάτο, τοῦ δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς δουρικλυτὸς ἐγγύθεν ἐλθὼν
397 ἔστη πρόσθ’· ὃ δ’ ὄπισθε καθεζόμενος βέλος ὠκὺ
398 ἐκ ποδὸς ἕλκ’, ὀδύνη δὲ διὰ χροὸς ἦλθ’ ἀλεγεινή.
399 ἐς δίφρον δ’ ἀνόρουσε, καὶ ἡνιόχῳ ἐπέτελλε
400 νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσιν ἐλαυνέμεν· ἤχθετο γὰρ κῆρ.
401 οἰώθη δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς δουρὶ κλυτός, οὐδέ τις αὐτῷ
402 Ἀργείων παρέμεινεν, ἐπεὶ φόβος ἔλλαβε πάντας·
403 ὀχθήσας δ’ ἄρα εἶπε πρὸς ὃν μεγαλήτορα θυμόν·
404 ὤ μοι ἐγὼ τί πάθω; μέγα μὲν κακὸν αἴ κε φέβωμαι
405 πληθὺν ταρβήσας· τὸ δὲ ῥίγιον αἴ κεν ἁλώω
406 μοῦνος· τοὺς δ’ ἄλλους Δαναοὺς ἐφόβησε Κρονίων.
407 ἀλλὰ τί ἦ μοι ταῦτα φίλος διελέξατο θυμός;
408 οἶδα γὰρ ὅττι κακοὶ μὲν ἀποίχονται πολέμοιο,
409 ὃς δέ κ’ ἀριστεύῃσι μάχῃ ἔνι τὸν δὲ μάλα χρεὼ
410 ἑστάμεναι κρατερῶς, ἤ τ’ ἔβλητ’ ἤ τ’ ἔβαλ’ ἄλλον.
411 εἶος ὃ ταῦθ’ ὥρμαινε κατὰ φρένα καὶ κατὰ θυμόν,
412 τόφρα δ’ ἐπὶ Τρώων στίχες ἤλυθον ἀσπιστάων,
413 ἔλσαν δ’ ἐν μέσσοισι, μετὰ σφίσι πῆμα τιθέντες.
414 ὡς δ’ ὅτε κάπριον ἀμφὶ κύνες θαλεροί τ’ αἰζηοὶ
415 σεύωνται, ὃ δέ τ’ εἶσι βαθείης ἐκ ξυλόχοιο
416 θήγων λευκὸν ὀδόντα μετὰ γναμπτῇσι γένυσσιν,
417 ἀμφὶ δέ τ’ ἀΐσσονται, ὑπαὶ δέ τε κόμπος ὀδόντων

γίγνεται, οἳ δὲ μένουσιν ἄφαρ δεινόν περ ἐόντα,
ὥς ῥα τότ’ ἀμφ’ Ὀδυσῆα Διῒ φίλον ἐσσεύοντο
Τρῶες· ὃ δὲ πρῶτον μὲν ἀμύμονα Δηϊοπίτην

11.421

οὔτασεν ὦμον ὕπερθεν ἐπάλμενος ὀξέϊ δουρί,
αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα Θόωνα καὶ Ἔννομον ἐξενάριξε.
Χερσιδάμαντα δ’ ἔπειτα καθ’ ἵππων ἀΐξαντα
δουρὶ κατὰ πρότμησιν ὑπ’ ἀσπίδος ὀμφαλοέσσης
νύξεν· ὃ δ’ ἐν κονίῃσι πεσὼν ἕλε γαῖαν ἀγοστῷ.
τοὺς μὲν ἔασ’, ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ Ἱππασίδην Χάροπ’ οὔτασε δουρὶ
αὐτοκασίγνητον εὐηφενέος Σώκοιο.
τῷ δ’ ἐπαλεξήσων Σῶκος κίεν ἰσόθεος φώς,
στῆ δὲ μάλ’ ἐγγὺς ἰὼν καί μιν πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν
ὦ Ὀδυσεῦ πολύαινε δόλων ἆτ’ ἠδὲ πόνοιο
σήμερον ἢ δοιοῖσιν ἐπεύξεαι Ἱππασίδῃσι
τοιώδ’ ἄνδρε κατακτείνας καὶ τεύχε’ ἀπούρας,
ἤ κεν ἐμῷ ὑπὸ δουρὶ τυπεὶς ἀπὸ θυμὸν ὀλέσσῃς.
ὣς εἰπὼν οὔτησε κατ’ ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην.
διὰ μὲν ἀσπίδος ἦλθε φαεινῆς ὄβριμον ἔγχος,
καὶ διὰ θώρηκος πολυδαιδάλου ἠρήρειστο,
πάντα δ’ ἀπὸ πλευρῶν χρόα ἔργαθεν, οὐδ’ ἔτ’ ἔασε
Παλλὰς Ἀθηναίη μιχθήμεναι ἔγκασι φωτός.
γνῶ δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς ὅ οἱ οὔ τι τέλος κατακαίριον ἦλθεν,
ἂψ δ’ ἀναχωρήσας Σῶκον πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν·
ἆ δείλ’ ἦ μάλα δή σε κιχάνεται αἰπὺς ὄλεθρος.
ἤτοι μέν ῥ’ ἔμ’ ἔπαυσας ἐπὶ Τρώεσσι μάχεσθαι·
σοὶ δ’ ἐγὼ ἐνθάδε φημὶ φόνον καὶ κῆρα μέλαιναν
ἤματι τῷδ’ ἔσσεσθαι, ἐμῷ δ’ ὑπὸ δουρὶ δαμέντα
εὖχος ἐμοὶ δώσειν, ψυχὴν δ’ Ἄϊδι κλυτοπώλῳ.
ἦ, καὶ ὃ μὲν φύγαδ’ αὖτις ὑποστρέψας ἐβεβήκει,
τῷ δὲ μεταστρεφθέντι μεταφρένῳ ἐν δόρυ πῆξεν
ὤμων μεσσηγύς, διὰ δὲ στήθεσφιν ἔλασσε,
δούπησεν δὲ πεσών· ὃ δ’ ἐπεύξατο δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς·
ὦ Σῶχ’ Ἱππάσου υἱὲ δαΐφρονος ἱπποδάμοιο

11.451

φθῆ σε τέλος θανάτοιο κιχήμενον, οὐδ’ ὑπάλυξας.
ἆ δείλ’ οὐ μὲν σοί γε πατὴρ καὶ πότνια μήτηρ
ὄσσε καθαιρήσουσι θανόντι περ, ἀλλ’ οἰωνοὶ
ὠμησταὶ ἐρύουσι, περὶ πτερὰ πυκνὰ βαλόντες.
αὐτὰρ ἔμ’, εἴ κε θάνω, κτεριοῦσί γε δῖοι Ἀχαιοί.
ὣς εἰπὼν Σώκοιο δαΐφρονος ὄβριμον ἔγχος
ἔξω τε χροὸς ἕλκε καὶ ἀσπίδος ὀμφαλοέσσης·
αἷμα δέ οἱ σπασθέντος ἀνέσσυτο, κῆδε δὲ θυμόν.
Τρῶες δὲ μεγάθυμοι ὅπως ἴδον αἷμ’ Ὀδυσῆος
κεκλόμενοι καθ’ ὅμιλον ἐπ’ αὐτῷ πάντες ἔβησαν.
αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἐξοπίσω ἀνεχάζετο, αὖε δ’ ἑταίρους.
τρὶς μὲν ἔπειτ’ ἤϋσεν ὅσον κεφαλὴ χάδε φωτός,
τρὶς δ’ ἄϊεν ἰάχοντος ἄρηι φίλος Μενέλαος.

464 αἶψα δ’ ἄρ’ Αἴαντα προσεφώνεεν ἐγγὺς ἐόντα·
465 Αἶαν διογενὲς Τελαμώνιε κοίρανε λαῶν
466 ἀμφί μ’ Ὀδυσσῆος ταλασίφρονος ἵκετ’ ἀϋτὴ
467 τῷ ἰκέλη ὡς εἴ ἐ βιᾠατο μοῦνον ἐόντα
468 Τρῶες ἀποτμήξαντες ἐνὶ κρατερῇ ὑσμίνῃ.
469 ἀλλ’ ἴομεν καθ’ ὅμιλον· ἀλεξέμεναι γὰρ ἄμεινον.
470 δείδω μή τι πάθῃσιν ἐνὶ Τρώεσσι μονωθεὶς
471 ἐσθλὸς ἐών, μεγάλη δὲ ποθὴ Δαναοῖσι γένηται.
472 ὣς εἰπὼν ὃ μὲν ἦρχ’, ὃ δ’ ἅμ’ ἕσπετο ἰσόθεος φώς.
473 εὗρον ἔπειτ’ Ὀδυσῆα Διῒ φίλον· ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ αὐτὸν
474 Τρῶες ἔπονθ’ ὡς εἴ τε δαφοινοὶ θῶες ὄρεσφιν
475 ἀμφ’ ἔλαφον κεραὸν βεβλημένον, ὅν τ’ ἔβαλ’ ἀνὴρ
476 ἰῷ ἀπὸ νευρῆς· τὸν μέν τ’ ἤλυξε πόδεσσι
477 φεύγων, ὄφρ’ αἷμα λιαρὸν καὶ γούνατ’ ὀρώρῃ·
478 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ τόν γε δαμάσσεται ὠκὺς ὀϊστός,
479 ὠμοφάγοι μιν θῶες ἐν οὔρεσι δαρδάπτουσιν
480 ἐν νέμεϊ σκιερῷ· ἐπί τε λῖν ἤγαγε δαίμων
He led the way and mighty Ajax went with him. The Trojans had gathered round Odysseus like ravenous mountain jackals round the carcass of some horned stag that has been hit with an arrow - the stag has fled at full speed so long as his blood was warm and his strength has lasted, but when the arrow has overcome him, the savage jackals devour him in the shady glades of the forest. Then some daimôn sends a fierce lion thither, whereon the jackals flee in terror and the lion robs them of their prey - even so did Trojans many and brave gather round crafty Odysseus, but the hero stood at bay and kept them off with his spear. Ajax then came up with his shield before him like a wall, and stood hard by, whereon the Trojans fled in all directions. Menelaos took Odysseus by the hand, and led him out of the press while his squire [therapôn] brought up his chariot, but Ajax rushed furiously on the Trojans and killed Doryklos, a bastard son of Priam; then he wounded Pandokos, Lysandros, Pyrasus, and Pylartes; as some swollen torrent comes rushing in full flood from the mountains on to the plain, big with the rain of heaven - many a dry oak and many a pine does it engulf, and much mud does it bring down and cast into the sea - even so did brave Ajax chase the foe furiously over the plain, slaying both men and horses. Hektor did not yet know what Ajax was doing, for he was fighting on the extreme left of the battle by the banks of the river Skamandros, where the carnage was thickest and the war-cry loudest round Nestor and brave Idomeneus. Among these Hektor was making great slaughter with his spear and furious driving, and was destroying the ranks that were opposed to him; still the Achaeans would have given no ground, had not Alexander husband of lovely Helen stayed the prowess of Machaon shepherd of his people, by wounding him in the right shoulder with a triple-barbed arrow. The Achaeans were in great fear that as the fight had turned against them the Trojans might take him prisoner, and Idomeneus said to Nestor, "Nestor son of Neleus, honor to the Achaean name, mount your chariot at once; take Machaon with you and drive your horses to the ships as fast as you can. A physician is worth more than several other men put together, for he can cut out arrows and spread healing herbs." Nestor horseman of Gerene did as Idomeneus had counseled; he at once mounted his chariot, and Machaon son of the famed physician Asklepios went with him. He lashed his horses and they flew onward nothing loath towards the ships, as though of their own free will. Then Kebriones seeing the Trojans in confusion said to Hektor from his place beside him, "Hektor, here are we two fighting on the extreme wing of the battle, while the other Trojans are in pell-mell rout, they and their horses. Ajax son of Telamon is driving them before him; I know him by the breadth of his shield: let us turn our chariot and horses thither, where horse and foot are fighting most desperately, and where the cry of battle is

loudest." With this he lashed his goodly steeds, and when they felt the whip they drew the chariot full speed among the Achaeans and Trojans, over the bodies and shields of those that had fallen: the axle was bespattered with blood, and the rail round the car was covered with splashes both from the horses' hoofs and from the tires of the wheels. Hektor tore his way through and flung himself into the thick of the fight, and his presence threw the Danaans into confusion, for his spear was not long idle; nevertheless though he went among the ranks with sword and spear, and throwing great stones, he avoided Ajax son of Telamon, for Zeus would have been angry with him if he had fought a better man than himself. Then father Zeus from his high throne struck fear into the heart of Ajax, so that he stood there dazed and threw his shield behind him- looking fearfully at the throng of his foes as though he were some wild beast, and turning hither and thither but crouching slowly backwards. As peasants with their hounds chase a lion from their stockyard, and watch by night to prevent his carrying off the pick of their herd - he makes his greedy spring, but in vain, for the darts from many a strong hand fall thick around him, with burning brands that scare him for all his fury, and when morning comes he slinks foiled and angry away - even so did Ajax, sorely against his will, retreat angrily before the Trojans, fearing for the ships of the Achaeans. Or as some lazy ass that has had many a cudgel broken about his back, when he into a field begins eating the grain - boys beat him but he is too many for them, and though they lay about with their sticks they cannot hurt him; still when he has had his fill they at last drive him from the field - even so did the Trojans and their allies pursue great Ajax, ever smiting the middle of his shield with their darts. Now and again he would turn and show fight, keeping back the battalions of the Trojans, and then he would again retreat; but he prevented any of them from making his way to the ships. Single-handed he stood midway between the Trojans and Achaeans: the spears that sped from their hands stuck some of them in his mighty shield, while many, though thirsting for his blood, fell to the ground ere they could reach him to the wounding of his fair flesh.

11.481

σίντην· θῶες μέν τε διέτρεσαν, αὐτὰρ ὃ δάπτει·
ὣς ῥα τότ’ ἀμφ’ Ὀδυσῆα δαΐφρονα ποικιλομήτην
Τρῶες ἔπον πολλοί τε καὶ ἄλκιμοι, αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἥρως
ἀΐσσων ᾧ ἔγχει ἀμύνετο νηλεὲς ἦμαρ.
Αἴας δ’ ἐγγύθεν ἦλθε φέρων σάκος ἠΰτε πύργον,
στῆ δὲ παρέξ· Τρῶες δὲ διέτρεσαν ἄλλυδις ἄλλος.
ἤτοι τὸν Μενέλαος ἀρήϊος ἔξαγ’ ὁμίλου
χειρὸς ἔχων, εἶος θεράπων σχεδὸν ἤλασεν ἵππους.
Αἴας δὲ Τρώεσσιν ἐπάλμενος εἶλε Δόρυκλον
Πριαμίδην νόθον υἱόν, ἔπειτα δὲ Πάνδοκον οὖτα,
οὖτα δὲ Λύσανδρον καὶ Πύρασον ἠδὲ Πυλάρτην.
ὡς δ’ ὁπότε πλήθων ποταμὸς πεδίον δὲ κάτεισι
χειμάρρους κατ’ ὄρεσφιν ὀπαζόμενος Διὸς ὄμβρῳ,
πολλὰς δὲ δρῦς ἀζαλέας, πολλὰς δέ τε πεύκας
ἐσφέρεται, πολλὸν δέ τ’ ἀφυσγετὸν εἰς ἅλα βάλλει,
ὣς ἔφεπε κλονέων πεδίον τότε φαίδιμος Αἴας,
δαΐζων ἵππους τε καὶ ἀνέρας· οὐδέ πω Ἕκτωρ
πεύθετ’, ἐπεί ῥα μάχης ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ μάρνατο πάσης
ὄχθας πὰρ ποταμοῖο Σκαμάνδρου, τῇ ῥα μάλιστα
ἀνδρῶν πῖπτε κάρηνα, βοὴ δ’ ἄσβεστος ὀρώρει
Νέστορά τ’ ἀμφὶ μέγαν καὶ ἀρήϊον Ἰδομενῆα.
Ἕκτωρ μὲν μετὰ τοῖσιν ὁμίλει μέρμερα ῥέζων

503 ἔγχεΐ θ’ ἱπποσύνῃ τε, νέων δ’ ἀλάπαζε φάλαγγας·
504 οὐδ’ ἄν πω χάζοντο κελεύθου δῖοι Ἀχαιοὶ
505 εἰ μὴ Ἀλέξανδρος Ἑλένης πόσις ἠϋκόμοιο
506 παῦσεν ἀριστεύοντα Μαχάονα ποιμένα λαῶν,
507 ἰῷ τριγλώχινι βαλὼν κατὰ δεξιὸν ὦμον.
508 τῷ ῥα περίδεισαν μένεα πνείοντες Ἀχαιοὶ
509 μή πώς μιν πολέμοιο μετακλινθέντος ἕλοιεν.
510 αὐτίκα δ’ Ἰδομενεὺς προσεφώνεε Νέστορα δῖον·

11.511

511 ὦ Νέστορ Νηληϊάδη μέγα κῦδος Ἀχαιῶν
512 ἄγρει σῶν ὀχέων ἐπιβήσεο, πὰρ δὲ Μαχάων
513 βαινέτω, ἐς νῆας δὲ τάχιστ’ ἔχε μώνυχας ἵππους·
514 ἰητρὸς γὰρ ἀνὴρ πολλῶν ἀντάξιος ἄλλων
515 ἰούς τ’ ἐκτάμνειν ἐπί τ’ ἤπια φάρμακα πάσσειν.
516 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ.
517 αὐτίκα δ’ ὧν ὀχέων ἐπεβήσετο, πὰρ δὲ Μαχάων
518 βαῖν’ Ἀσκληπιοῦ υἱὸς ἀμύμονος ἰητῆρος·
519 μάστιξεν δ’ ἵππους, τὼ δ’ οὐκ ἀέκοντε πετέσθην
520 νῆας ἔπι γλαφυράς· τῇ γὰρ φίλον ἔπλετο θυμῷ.
521 Κεβριόνης δὲ Τρῶας ὀρινομένους ἐνόησεν
522 Ἕκτορι παρβεβαώς, καί μιν πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν·
523 Ἕκτορ νῶϊ μὲν ἐνθάδ’ ὁμιλέομεν Δαναοῖσιν
524 ἐσχατιῇ πολέμοιο δυσηχέος· οἳ δὲ δὴ ἄλλοι
525 Τρῶες ὀρίνονται ἐπιμὶξ ἵπποι τε καὶ αὐτοί.
526 Αἴας δὲ κλονέει Τελαμώνιος· εὖ δέ μιν ἔγνων·
527 εὐρὺ γὰρ ἀμφ’ ὤμοισιν ἔχει σάκος· ἀλλὰ καὶ ἡμεῖς
528 κεῖσ’ ἵππους τε καὶ ἅρμ’ ἰθύνομεν, ἔνθα μάλιστα
529 ἱππῆες πεζοί τε κακὴν ἔριδα προβαλόντες
530 ἀλλήλους ὀλέκουσι, βοὴ δ’ ἄσβεστος ὄρωρεν.
531 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἵμασεν καλλίτριχας ἵππους
532 μάστιγι λιγυρῇ· τοὶ δὲ πληγῆς ἀΐοντες
533 ῥίμφ’ ἔφερον θοὸν ἅρμα μετὰ Τρῶας καὶ Ἀχαιοὺς
534 στείβοντες νέκυάς τε καὶ ἀσπίδας· αἵματι δ’ ἄξων
535 νέρθεν ἅπας πεπάλακτο καὶ ἄντυγες αἳ περὶ δίφρον,
536 ἃς ἄρ’ ἀφ’ ἱππείων ὁπλέων ῥαθάμιγγες ἔβαλλον
537 αἵ τ’ ἀπ’ ἐπισσώτρων. ὃ δὲ ἵετο δῦναι ὅμιλον
538 ἀνδρόμεον ῥῆξαί τε μετάλμενος· ἐν δὲ κυδοιμὸν
539 ἦκε κακὸν Δαναοῖσι, μίνυνθα δὲ χάζετο δουρός.
540 αὐτὰρ ὃ τῶν ἄλλων ἐπεπωλεῖτο στίχας ἀνδρῶν

11.541

541 ἔγχεΐ τ’ ἄορί τε μεγάλοισί τε χερμαδίοισιν,
542 Αἴαντος δ’ ἀλέεινε μάχην Τελαμωνιάδαο.
544 Ζεὺς δὲ πατὴρ Αἴανθ’ ὑψίζυγος ἐν φόβον ὦρσε·
545 στῆ δὲ ταφών, ὄπιθεν δὲ σάκος βάλεν ἑπταβόειον,
546 τρέσσε δὲ παπτήνας ἐφ’ ὁμίλου θηρὶ ἐοικὼς
547 ἐντροπαλιζόμενος ὀλίγον γόνυ γουνὸς ἀμείβων.
548 ὡς δ’ αἴθωνα λέοντα βοῶν ἀπὸ μεσσαύλοιο
549 ἐσσεύαντο κύνες τε καὶ ἀνέρες ἀγροιῶται,

οἵ τέ μιν οὐκ εἰῶσι βοῶν ἐκ πῖαρ ἐλέσθαι
πάννυχοι ἐγρήσσοντες· ὃ δὲ κρειῶν ἐρατίζων
ἰθύει, ἀλλ’ οὔ τι πρήσσει· θαμέες γὰρ ἄκοντες
ἀντίον ἀΐσσουσι θρασειάων ἀπὸ χειρῶν
καιόμεναί τε δεταί, τάς τε τρεῖ ἐσσύμενός περ·
ἠῶθεν δ’ ἀπὸ νόσφιν ἔβη τετιηότι θυμῷ·
ὣς Αἴας τότ’ ἀπὸ Τρώων τετιημένος ἦτορ
ἤϊε πόλλ’ ἀέκων· περὶ γὰρ δίε νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ὄνος παρ’ ἄρουραν ἰὼν ἐβιήσατο παῖδας
νωθής, ᾧ δὴ πολλὰ περὶ ῥόπαλ’ ἀμφὶς ἐάγῃ,
κείρει τ’ εἰσελθὼν βαθὺ λήϊον· οἱ δέ τε παῖδες
τύπτουσιν ῥοπάλοισι· βίη δέ τε νηπίη αὐτῶν·
σπουδῇ τ’ ἐξήλασσαν, ἐπεί τ’ ἐκορέσσατο φορβῆς·
ὣς τότ’ ἔπειτ’ Αἴαντα μέγαν Τελαμώνιον υἱὸν
Τρῶες ὑπέρθυμοι πολυηγερέες τ’ ἐπίκουροι
νύσσοντες ξυστοῖσι μέσον σάκος αἰὲν ἔποντο.
Αἴας δ’ ἄλλοτε μὲν μνησάσκετο θούριδος ἀλκῆς
αὖτις ὑποστρεφθείς, καὶ ἐρητύσασκε φάλαγγας
Τρώων ἱπποδάμων· ὀτὲ δὲ τρωπάσκετο φεύγειν.
πάντας δὲ προέεργε θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας ὀδεύειν,
αὐτὸς δὲ Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν θῦνε μεσηγὺ
ἱστάμενος· τὰ δὲ δοῦρα θρασειάων ἀπὸ χειρῶν

11.572

ἄλλα μὲν ἐν σάκεϊ μεγάλῳ πάγεν ὄρμενα πρόσσω,
πολλὰ δὲ καὶ μεσσηγύ, πάρος χρόα λευκὸν ἐπαυρεῖν,
ἐν γαίῃ ἵσταντο λιλαιόμενα χροὸς ἆσαι.
τὸν δ’ ὡς οὖν ἐνόησ’ Εὐαίμονος ἀγλαὸς υἱὸς
Εὐρύπυλος πυκινοῖσι βιαζόμενον βελέεσσι,
στῆ ῥα παρ’ αὐτὸν ἰών, καὶ ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ,
καὶ βάλε Φαυσιάδην Ἀπισάονα ποιμένα λαῶν
ἦπαρ ὑπὸ πραπίδων, εἶθαρ δ’ ὑπὸ γούνατ’ ἔλυσεν·
Εὐρύπυλος δ’ ἐπόρουσε καὶ αἴνυτο τεύχε’ ἀπ’ ὤμων.
τὸν δ’ ὡς οὖν ἐνόησεν Ἀλέξανδρος θεοειδὴς
τεύχε’ ἀπαινύμενον Ἀπισάονος, αὐτίκα τόξον
ἕλκετ’ ἐπ’ Εὐρυπύλῳ, καί μιν βάλε μηρὸν ὀϊστῷ
δεξιόν· ἐκλάσθη δὲ δόναξ, ἐβάρυνε δὲ μηρόν.
ἂψ δ’ ἐτάρων εἰς ἔθνος ἐχάζετο κῆρ’ ἀλεείνων,
ἤϋσεν δὲ διαπρύσιον Δαναοῖσι γεγωνώς·
ὦ φίλοι Ἀργείων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες
στῆτ’ ἐλελιχθέντες καὶ ἀμύνετε νηλεὲς ἦμαρ
Αἴανθ’, ὃς βελέεσσι βιάζεται, οὐδέ ἕ φημι
φεύξεσθ’ ἐκ πολέμοιο δυσηχέος· ἀλλὰ μάλ’ ἄντην
ἵστασθ’ ἀμφ’ Αἴαντα μέγαν Τελαμώνιον υἱόν.
ὣς ἔφατ’ Εὐρύπυλος βεβλημένος· οἱ δὲ παρ’ αὐτὸν
πλησίοι ἔστησαν σάκε’ ὤμοισι κλίναντες
δούρατ’ ἀνασχόμενοι· τῶν δ’ ἀντίος ἦλυθεν Αἴας.
στῆ δὲ μεταστρεφθείς, ἐπεὶ ἵκετο ἕθνος ἑταίρων.
ὣς οἳ μὲν μάρναντο δέμας πυρὸς αἰθομένοιο·
Νέστορα δ’ ἐκ πολέμοιο φέρον Νηλήϊαι ἵπποι
ἰδρῶσαι, ἦγον δὲ Μαχάονα ποιμένα λαῶν.

599 τὸν δὲ ἰδὼν ἐνόησε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
600 ἑστήκει γὰρ ἐπὶ πρυμνῇ μεγακήτεϊ νηῒ
601 εἰσορόων πόνον αἰπὺν ἰῶκά τε δακρυόεσσαν.
Now when Eurypylos the brave son of Euaemon saw that Ajax was being overpowered by the rain of arrows, he went up to him and hurled his spear. He struck Apisaon son of Phausios in the liver below the midriff, and laid him low. Eurypylos sprang upon him, and stripped the armor from his shoulders; but when Alexander saw him, he aimed an arrow at him which struck him in the right thigh; the arrow broke, but the point that was left in the wound dragged on the thigh; he drew back, therefore, under cover of his comrades to save his life, shouting as he did so to the Danaans, "My friends, princes and counselors of the Argives, rally to the defense of Ajax who is being overpowered, and I doubt whether he will come out of the fight alive. Hither, then, to the rescue of great Ajax son of Telamon." Even so did he cry when he was wounded; thereon the others came near, and gathered round him, holding their shields upwards from their shoulders so as to give him cover. Ajax then made towards them, and turned round to stand at bay as soon as he had reached his men. Thus then did they fight as it were a flaming fire. Meanwhile the mares of Neleus, all in a lather with sweat, were bearing Nestor out of the fight, and with him Machaon shepherd of his people. Achilles saw and took note, for he was standing on the stern of his ship watching the hard stress [ponos] and struggle of the fight. He called from the ship to his comrade Patroklos, who heard him in the tent and came out looking like Ares himself - here indeed was the beginning of the ill that presently befell him. "Why," said he, "Achilles do you call me? what do you what do you want with me?" And Achilles answered, "Noble son of Menoitios, man after my own heart, I take it that I shall now have the Achaeans praying at my knees, for they are in great straits; go, Patroklos, and ask Nestor who is that he is bearing away wounded from the field; from his back I should say it was Machaon son of Asklepios, but I could not see his face for the horses went by me at full speed." Patroklos did as his dear comrade had bidden him, and set off running by the ships and tents of the Achaeans. When Nestor and Machaon had reached the tents of the son of Neleus, they dismounted, and an esquire [therapôn], Eurymedon, took the horses from the chariot. The pair then stood in the breeze by the seaside to dry the sweat from their shirts, and when they had so done they came inside and took their seats. Fair Hekamede, whom Nestor had had awarded to him from Tenedos when Achilles took it, mixed them a mess; she was daughter of wise Arsinoos, and the Achaeans had given her to Nestor because he excelled all of them in counsel. First she set for them a fair and well-made table that had feet of lapis lazuli; on it there was a vessel of bronze and an onion to give relish to the drink, with honey and cakes of barley-meal. There was also a cup of rare workmanship which the old man had brought with him from home, studded with bosses of gold; it had four handles, on each of which there were two golden doves feeding, and it had two feet to stand on. Any one else would hardly have been able to lift it from the table when it was full, but Nestor could do so quite easily. In this the woman, as fair as a goddess, mixed them a mess with Pramnian wine; she grated goat's milk cheese into it with a bronze grater, threw in a handful of white barley-meal, and having thus prepared the mess she bade them drink it. When they had done so and had thus quenched their thirst, they fell talking with one another, and at this moment Patroklos appeared at the door. When the old man saw him he sprang from his seat, seized his hand, led him into the tent, and bade him take his place among them; but Patroklos stood where he was and said, "Noble sir, I may not stay, you cannot persuade me to come in; he that sent me is not one to be trifled with, and he bade me ask who the wounded man was whom you were bearing away from the field. I can now see for myself that he is Machaon shepherd of his people. I must go back and tell Achilles. You, sir, know what a terrible man he is, and how ready to blame even where no blame should lie." And Nestor answered, "Why should Achilles care to know how many of the Achaeans may be

wounded? He recks not of the grief [penthos] that reigns in our host; our most valiant chieftains lie disabled, brave Diomedes son of Tydeus is wounded; so are Odysseus and Agamemnon; Eurypylos has been hit with an arrow in the thigh, and I have just been bringing this man from the field - he too wounded - with an arrow; nevertheless Achilles, so valiant though he be, cares not and knows no ruth. Will he wait till the ships, do what we may, are in a blaze, and we perish one upon the other?

11.602

602 αἶψα δ’ ἑταῖρον ἑὸν Πατροκλῆα προσέειπε
603 φθεγξάμενος παρὰ νηός· ὃ δὲ κλισίηθεν ἀκούσας
604 ἔκμολεν ἶσος Ἄρηϊ, κακοῦ δ’ ἄρα οἱ πέλεν ἀρχή.
605 τὸν πρότερος προσέειπε Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμος υἱός·
606 τίπτέ με κικλήσκεις Ἀχιλεῦ; τί δέ σε χρεὼ ἐμεῖο;
607 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
608 δῖε Μενοιτιάδη τῷ ἐμῷ κεχαρισμένε θυμῷ
609 νῦν ὀΐω περὶ γούνατ’ ἐμὰ στήσεσθαι Ἀχαιοὺς
610 λισσομένους· χρειὼ γὰρ ἱκάνεται οὐκέτ’ ἀνεκτός.
611 ἀλλ’ ἴθι νῦν Πάτροκλε Διῒ φίλε Νέστορ’ ἔρειο
612 ὅν τινα τοῦτον ἄγει βεβλημένον ἐκ πολέμοιο·
613 ἤτοι μὲν τά γ’ ὄπισθε Μαχάονι πάντα ἔοικε
614 τῷ Ἀσκληπιάδῃ, ἀτὰρ οὐκ ἴδον ὄμματα φωτός·
615 ἵπποι γάρ με παρήϊξαν πρόσσω μεμαυῖαι.
616 ὣς φάτο, Πάτροκλος δὲ φίλῳ ἐπεπείθεθ’ ἑταίρῳ,
617 βῆ δὲ θέειν παρά τε κλισίας καὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν.
618 οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ κλισίην Νηληϊάδεω ἀφίκοντο,
619 αὐτοὶ μέν ῥ’ ἀπέβησαν ἐπὶ χθόνα πουλυβότειραν,
620 ἵππους δ’ Εὐρυμέδων θεράπων λύε τοῖο γέροντος
621 ἐξ ὀχέων· τοὶ δ’ ἱδρῶ ἀπεψύχοντο χιτώνων
622 στάντε ποτὶ πνοιὴν παρὰ θῖν’ ἁλός· αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
623 ἐς κλισίην ἐλθόντες ἐπὶ κλισμοῖσι κάθιζον.
624 τοῖσι δὲ τεῦχε κυκειῶ ἐϋπλόκαμος Ἑκαμήδη,
625 τὴν ἄρετ’ ἐκ Τενέδοιο γέρων, ὅτε πέρσεν Ἀχιλλεύς,
626 θυγατέρ’ Ἀρσινόου μεγαλήτορος, ἣν οἱ Ἀχαιοὶ
627 ἔξελον οὕνεκα βουλῇ ἀριστεύεσκεν ἁπάντων.
628 ἥ σφωϊν πρῶτον μὲν ἐπιπροΐηλε τράπεζαν
629 καλὴν κυανόπεζαν ἐΰξοον, αὐτὰρ ἐπ’ αὐτῆς
630 χάλκειον κάνεον, ἐπὶ δὲ κρόμυον ποτῷ ὄψον,
631 ἠδὲ μέλι χλωρόν, παρὰ δ’ ἀλφίτου ἱεροῦ ἀκτήν,

11.632

632 πὰρ δὲ δέπας περικαλλές, ὃ οἴκοθεν ἦγ’ ὁ γεραιός,
633 χρυσείοις ἥλοισι πεπαρμένον· οὔατα δ’ αὐτοῦ
634 τέσσαρ’ ἔσαν, δοιαὶ δὲ πελειάδες ἀμφὶς ἕκαστον
635 χρύσειαι νεμέθοντο, δύω δ’ ὑπὸ πυθμένες ἦσαν.
636 ἄλλος μὲν μογέων ἀποκινήσασκε τραπέζης
637 πλεῖον ἐόν, Νέστωρ δ’ ὁ γέρων ἀμογητὶ ἄειρεν.
638 ἐν τῷ ῥά σφι κύκησε γυνὴ εἰκυῖα θεῇσιν
639 οἴνῳ Πραμνείῳ, ἐπὶ δ’ αἴγειον κνῆ τυρὸν
640 κνήστι χαλκείῃ, ἐπὶ δ’ ἄλφιτα λευκὰ πάλυνε,
641 πινέμεναι δ’ ἐκέλευσεν, ἐπεί ῥ’ ὤπλισσε κυκειῶ.

642 τὼ δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν πίνοντ’ ἀφέτην πολυκαγκέα δίψαν
643 μύθοισιν τέρποντο πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἐνέποντες,
644 Πάτροκλος δὲ θύρῃσιν ἐφίστατο ἰσόθεος φώς.
645 τὸν δὲ ἰδὼν ὁ γεραιὸς ἀπὸ θρόνου ὦρτο φαεινοῦ,
646 ἐς δ’ ἄγε χειρὸς ἑλών, κατὰ δ’ ἑδριάασθαι ἄνωγε.
647 Πάτροκλος δ’ ἐτέρωθεν ἀναίνετο εἶπέ τε μῦθον·
648 οὐχ ἕδος ἐστὶ γεραιὲ διοτρεφές, οὐδέ με πείσεις.
649 αἰδοῖος νεμεσητὸς ὅ με προέηκε πυθέσθαι
650 ὅν τινα τοῦτον ἄγεις βεβλημένον· ἀλλὰ καὶ αὐτὸς
651 γιγνώσκω, ὁρόω δὲ Μαχάονα ποιμένα λαῶν.
652 νῦν δὲ ἔπος ἐρέων πάλιν ἄγγελος εἶμ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ.
653 εὖ δὲ σὺ οἶσθα γεραιὲ διοτρεφές, οἷος ἐκεῖνος
654 δεινὸς ἀνήρ· τάχα κεν καὶ ἀναίτιον αἰτιόωτο.
655 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
656 τίπτε τὰρ ὧδ’ Ἀχιλεὺς ὀλοφύρεται υἷας Ἀχαιῶν,
657 ὅσσοι δὴ βέλεσιν βεβλήαται; οὐδέ τι οἶδε
658 πένθεος, ὅσσον ὄρωρε κατὰ στρατόν· οἳ γὰρ ἄριστοι
659 ἐν νηυσὶν κέαται βεβλημένοι οὐτάμενοί τε.
660 βέβληται μὲν ὃ Τυδεΐδης κρατερὸς Διομήδης,
661 οὔτασται δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς δουρὶ κλυτὸς ἠδ’ Ἀγαμέμνων·

11.662

662 βέβληται δὲ καὶ Εὐρύπυλος κατὰ μηρὸν ὀϊστῷ·
663 τοῦτον δ’ ἄλλον ἐγὼ νέον ἤγαγον ἐκ πολέμοιο
664 ἰῷ ἀπὸ νευρῆς βεβλημένον. αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
665 ἐσθλὸς ἐὼν Δαναῶν οὐ κήδεται οὐδ’ ἐλεαίρει.
666 ἦ μένει εἰς ὅ κε δὴ νῆες θοαὶ ἄγχι θαλάσσης
667 Ἀργείων ἀέκητι πυρὸς δηΐοιο θέρωνται,
668 αὐτοί τε κτεινώμεθ’ ἐπισχερώ; οὐ γὰρ ἐμὴ ἶς
669 ἔσθ’ οἵη πάρος ἔσκεν ἐνὶ γναμπτοῖσι μέλεσσιν.
670 εἴθ’ ὡς ἠβώοιμι βίη δέ μοι ἔμπεδος εἴη
671 ὡς ὁπότ’ Ἠλείοισι καὶ ἡμῖν νεῖκος ἐτύχθη
672 ἀμφὶ βοηλασίῃ, ὅτ’ ἐγὼ κτάνον Ἰτυμονῆα
673 ἐσθλὸν Ὑπειροχίδην, ὃς ἐν Ἤλιδι ναιετάασκε,
674 ῥύσι’ ἐλαυνόμενος· ὃ δ’ ἀμύνων ᾗσι βόεσσιν
675 ἔβλητ’ ἐν πρώτοισιν ἐμῆς ἀπὸ χειρὸς ἄκοντι,
676 κὰδ δ’ ἔπεσεν, λαοὶ δὲ περίτρεσαν ἀγροιῶται.
677 ληΐδα δ’ ἐκ πεδίου συνελάσσαμεν ἤλιθα πολλὴν
678 πεντήκοντα βοῶν ἀγέλας, τόσα πώεα οἰῶν,
679 τόσσα συῶν συβόσια, τόσ’ αἰπόλια πλατέ’ αἰγῶν,
680 ἵππους δὲ ξανθὰς ἑκατὸν καὶ πεντήκοντα
681 πάσας θηλείας, πολλῇσι δὲ πῶλοι ὑπῆσαν.
682 καὶ τὰ μὲν ἠλασάμεσθα Πύλον Νηλήϊον εἴσω
683 ἐννύχιοι προτὶ ἄστυ· γεγήθει δὲ φρένα Νηλεύς,
684 οὕνεκά μοι τύχε πολλὰ νέῳ πόλεμον δὲ κιόντι.
685 κήρυκες δ’ ἐλίγαινον ἅμ’ ἠοῖ φαινομένηφι
686 τοὺς ἴμεν οἷσι χρεῖος ὀφείλετ’ ἐν Ἤλιδι δίῃ·
687 οἳ δὲ συναγρόμενοι Πυλίων ἡγήτορες ἄνδρες
688 δαίτρευον· πολέσιν γὰρ Ἐπειοὶ χρεῖος ὄφειλον,
689 ὡς ἡμεῖς παῦροι κεκακωμένοι ἐν Πύλῳ ἦμεν·
690 ἐλθὼν γάρ ῥ’ ἐκάκωσε βίη Ἡρακληείη

691 τῶν προτέρων ἐτέων, κατὰ δ’ ἔκταθεν ὅσσοι ἄριστοι·
As for me, I have no strength nor stay in me any longer; would that I were still young and strong as in the days when there was a fight between us and the men of Elis about some cattle-raiding. I then killed Itymoneus the valiant son of Hypeirochos a dweller in Elis, as I was driving in the spoil; he was hit by a dart thrown my hand while fighting in the front rank in defense of his cows, so he fell and the country people around him were in great fear. We drove off a vast quantity of booty from the plain, fifty herds of cattle and as many flocks of sheep; fifty droves also of pigs, and as many wide-spreading flocks of goats. Of horses moreover we seized a hundred and fifty, all of them mares, and many had foals running with them. All these did we drive by night to Pylos the city of Neleus, taking them within the city; and the heart of Neleus was glad in that I had taken so much, though it was the first time I had ever been in the field. At daybreak the heralds went round crying that all in Elis to whom there was a debt owing should come; and the leading Pylians assembled to divide the spoils. There were many to whom the Epeans owed chattels, for we men of Pylos were few and had been oppressed with wrong; in former years Herakles had come, and had laid his hand heavy upon us, so that all our best men had perished. Neleus had had twelve sons, but I alone was left; the others had all been killed. The Epeans presuming upon all this had looked down upon us and had done us much evil. My father chose [krinô] a herd of cattle and a great flock of sheep - three hundred in all - and he took their shepherds with him, for there was a great debt due to him in Elis, to wit four horses, winners of prizes. They and their chariots with them had gone to the games and were to run for a tripod, but King Augeas took them, and sent back their driver grieving for the loss of his horses. Neleus was angered by what he had both said and done, and took great value in return, but he gave the rest to the people of the district [dêmos] to divide among themselves, so that no man might have less than his full share. "Thus did we order all things, and offer sacrifices to the gods throughout the city; but three days afterwards the Epeans came in a body, many in number, they and their chariots, in full array, and with them the two Moliones in their armor, though they were still lads and unused to fighting. Now there is a certain town, Thryoessa, perched upon a rock on the river Alpheus, the border city Pylos; this they would destroy, and pitched their camp about it, but when they had crossed their whole plain, Athena darted down by night from Olympus and bade us set ourselves in array; and she found willing warriors in Pylos, for the men meant fighting. Neleus would not let me arm, and hid my horses, for he said that as yet I could know nothing about war; nevertheless Athena so ordered the fight that, all on foot as I was, I fought among our mounted forces and vied with the foremost of them. There is a river Minyeios that falls into the sea near Arene, and there they that were mounted (and I with them) waited till morning, when the companies of foot soldiers came up with us in force. Thence in full panoply and equipment we came towards noon to the sacred waters of the Alpheus, and there we offered victims to almighty Zeus, with a bull to Alpheus, another to Poseidon, and a herd-heifer to Athena. After this we took supper in our companies, and laid us down to rest each in his armor by the river. "The Epeans were beleaguering the city and were determined to take it, but ere this might be there was a desperate fight in store for them. When the sun's rays began to fall upon the earth we joined battle, praying to Zeus and to Athena, and when the fight had begun, I was the first to kill my man and take his horses - to wit the warrior Moulios. He was son-in-law to Augeas, having married his eldest daughter, golden-haired Agamede, who knew the virtues of every herb which grows upon the face of the earth. I speared him as he was coming towards me, and when he fell headlong in the dust, I sprang upon his chariot and took my place in the front ranks. The Epeans fled in all directions when they saw the leader of their horsemen (the best man they had) laid low, and I swept down on them like a whirlwind, taking fifty chariots - and in each of them two men bit the dust, slain by my spear. I should have even killed the two Moliones sons of Aktor, unless their real father,

Poseidon lord of the earthquake, had hidden them in a thick mist and borne them out of the fight. Thereon Zeus granted the Pylians a great victory, for we chased them far over the plain, killing the men and bringing in their armor, till we had brought our horses to Bouprasion rich in wheat and to the Olenian rock, with the hill that is called Alision, at which point Athena turned the people back. There I slew the last man and left him; then the Achaeans drove their horses back from Bouprasion to Pylos and gave thanks to Zeus among the gods, and among mortal men to Nestor. "Such was I among my peers, as surely as ever was, but Achilles is for keeping all his valor [aretê] for himself; bitterly will he rue it hereafter when the host is being cut to pieces. My good friend, did not Menoitios charge you thus, on the day when he sent you from Phthia to Agamemnon? Odysseus and I were in the house, inside, and heard all that he said to you; for we came to the fair house of Peleus while beating up recruits throughout all Achaea, and when we got there we found Menoitios and yourself, and Achilles with you. The old horseman Peleus was in the outer court, roasting the fat thigh-bones of a heifer to Zeus the lord of thunder; and he held a gold chalice in his hand from which he poured drink-offerings of wine over the burning sacrifice. You two were busy cutting up the heifer, and at that moment we stood at the gates, whereon Achilles sprang to his feet, led us by the hand into the house, placed us at table, and set before us such hospitable entertainment as is right [themis] for guests to expect. When we had satisfied ourselves with meat and drink, I said my say and urged both of you to join us. You were ready enough to do so, and the two old men charged you much and straitly. Old Peleus bade his son Achilles fight ever among the foremost and outvie his peers, while Menoitios the son of Aktor spoke thus to you: ‘My son,’ said he, ‘Achilles is of nobler birth than you are, but you are older than he, though he is far the better man of the two. Counsel him wisely, guide him in the right way, and he will follow you to his own profit.’ Thus did your father charge you, but you have forgotten; nevertheless, even now, say all this to Achilles if he will listen to you. Who knows but with the help of a daimôn you may talk him over, for it is good to take a friend's advice. If, however, he is fearful about some oracle, or if his mother has told him something from Zeus, then let him send you, and let the rest of the Myrmidons follow with you, if perchance you may bring light and saving to the Danaans. And let him send you into battle clad in his own armor, that the Trojans may mistake you for him and leave off fighting; the sons of the Achaeans may thus have time to get their breath, for they are hard pressed and there is little breathing time in battle. You, who are fresh, might easily drive a tired enemy back to his walls and away from the tents and ships." With these words he moved the heart of Patroklos, who set off running by the line of the ships to Achilles, descendant of Aiakos. When he had got as far as the ships of Odysseus, where was their place of assembly and rendering of judgment [themis], with their altars dedicated to the gods, Eurypylos son of Euaemon met him, wounded in the thigh with an arrow, and limping out of the fight. Sweat rained from his head and shoulders, and black blood welled from his cruel wound, but his mind [noos] did not wander. The son of Menoitios when he saw him had compassion upon him and spoke piteously saying, "O unhappy princes and counselors of the Danaans, are you then doomed to feed the hounds of Troy with your fat, far from your friends and your native land? say, noble Eurypylos, will the Achaeans be able to hold great Hektor in check, or will they fall now before his spear?"

11.692

692 δώδεκα γὰρ Νηλῆος ἀμύμονος υἱέες ἦμεν·
693 τῶν οἶος λιπόμην, οἳ δ’ ἄλλοι πάντες ὄλοντο.
694 ταῦθ’ ὑπερηφανέοντες Ἐπειοὶ χαλκοχίτωνες
695 ἡμέας ὑβρίζοντες ἀτάσθαλα μηχανόωντο.
696 ἐκ δ’ ὃ γέρων ἀγέλην τε βοῶν καὶ πῶϋ μέγ’ οἰῶν

εἵλετο κρινάμενος τριηκόσι’ ἠδὲ νομῆας.
καὶ γὰρ τῷ χρεῖος μέγ’ ὀφείλετ’ ἐν Ἤλιδι δίῃ
τέσσαρες ἀθλοφόροι ἵπποι αὐτοῖσιν ὄχεσφιν
ἐλθόντες μετ’ ἄεθλα· περὶ τρίποδος γὰρ ἔμελλον
θεύσεσθαι· τοὺς δ’ αὖθι ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Αὐγείας
κάσχεθε, τὸν δ’ ἐλατῆρ’ ἀφίει ἀκαχήμενον ἵππων.
τῶν ὃ γέρων ἐπέων κεχολωμένος ἠδὲ καὶ ἔργων
ἐξέλετ’ ἄσπετα πολλά· τὰ δ’ ἄλλ’ ἐς δῆμον ἔδωκε
δαιτρεύειν, μή τίς οἱ ἀτεμβόμενος κίοι ἴσης.
ἡμεῖς μὲν τὰ ἕκαστα διείπομεν, ἀμφί τε ἄστυ
ἕρδομεν ἱρὰ θεοῖς· οἳ δὲ τρίτῳ ἤματι πάντες
ἦλθον ὁμῶς αὐτοί τε πολεῖς καὶ μώνυχες ἵπποι
πανσυδίῃ· μετὰ δέ σφι Μολίονε θωρήσσοντο
παῖδ’ ἔτ’ ἐόντ’, οὔ πω μάλα εἰδότε θούριδος ἀλκῆς.
ἔστι δέ τις Θρυόεσσα πόλις αἰπεῖα κολώνη
τηλοῦ ἐπ’ Ἀλφειῷ, νεάτη Πύλου ἠμαθόεντος·
τὴν ἀμφεστρατόωντο διαρραῖσαι μεμαῶτες.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε πᾶν πεδίον μετεκίαθον, ἄμμι δ’ Ἀθήνη
ἄγγελος ἦλθε θέουσ’ ἀπ’ Ὀλύμπου θωρήσσεσθαι
ἔννυχος, οὐδ’ ἀέκοντα Πύλον κάτα λαὸν ἄγειρεν
ἀλλὰ μάλ’ ἐσσυμένους πολεμίζειν. οὐδέ με Νηλεὺς
εἴα θωρήσσεσθαι, ἀπέκρυψεν δέ μοι ἵππους·
οὐ γάρ πώ τί μ’ ἔφη ἴδμεν πολεμήϊα ἔργα.
ἀλλὰ καὶ ὣς ἱππεῦσι μετέπρεπον ἡμετέροισι
καὶ πεζός περ ἐών, ἐπεὶ ὣς ἄγε νεῖκος Ἀθήνη.

11.722

ἔστι δέ τις ποταμὸς Μινυήϊος εἰς ἅλα βάλλων
ἐγγύθεν Ἀρήνης, ὅθι μείναμεν Ἠῶ δῖαν
ἱππῆες Πυλίων, τὰ δ’ ἐπέρρεον ἔθνεα πεζῶν.
ἔνθεν πανσυδίῃ σὺν τεύχεσι θωρηχθέντες
ἔνδιοι ἱκόμεσθ’ ἱερὸν ῥόον Ἀλφειοῖο.
ἔνθα Διὶ ῥέξαντες ὑπερμενεῖ ἱερὰ καλά,
ταῦρον δ’ Ἀλφειῷ, ταῦρον δὲ Ποσειδάωνι,
αὐτὰρ Ἀθηναίῃ γλαυκώπιδι βοῦν ἀγελαίην,
δόρπον ἔπειθ’ ἑλόμεσθα κατὰ στρατὸν ἐν τελέεσσι,
καὶ κατεκοιμήθημεν ἐν ἔντεσιν οἷσιν ἕκαστος
ἀμφὶ ῥοὰς ποταμοῖο. ἀτὰρ μεγάθυμοι Ἐπειοὶ
ἀμφέσταν δὴ ἄστυ διαρραῖσαι μεμαῶτες·
ἀλλά σφι προπάροιθε φάνη μέγα ἔργον Ἄρηος·
εὖτε γὰρ ἠέλιος φαέθων ὑπερέσχεθε γαίης,
συμφερόμεσθα μάχῃ Διί τ’ εὐχόμενοι καὶ Ἀθήνῃ.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ Πυλίων καὶ Ἐπειῶν ἔπλετο νεῖκος,
πρῶτος ἐγὼν ἕλον ἄνδρα, κόμισσα δὲ μώνυχας ἵππους,
Μούλιον αἰχμητήν· γαμβρὸς δ’ ἦν Αὐγείαο,
πρεσβυτάτην δὲ θύγατρ’ εἶχε ξανθὴν Ἀγαμήδην,
ἣ τόσα φάρμακα ᾔδη ὅσα τρέφει εὐρεῖα χθών.
τὸν μὲν ἐγὼ προσιόντα βάλον χαλκήρεϊ δουρί,
ἤριπε δ’ ἐν κονίῃσιν· ἐγὼ δ’ ἐς δίφρον ὀρούσας
στῆν ῥα μετὰ προμάχοισιν· ἀτὰρ μεγάθυμοι Ἐπειοὶ
ἔτρεσαν ἄλλυδις ἄλλος, ἐπεὶ ἴδον ἄνδρα πεσόντα

ἡγεμόν’ ἱππήων, ὃς ἀριστεύεσκε μάχεσθαι.
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼν ἐπόρουσα κελαινῇ λαίλαπι ἶσος,
πεντήκοντα δ’ ἕλον δίφρους, δύο δ’ ἀμφὶς ἕκαστον
φῶτες ὀδὰξ ἕλον οὖδας ἐμῷ ὑπὸ δουρὶ δαμέντες.
καί νύ κεν Ἀκτορίωνε Μολίονε παῖδ’ ἀλάπαξα,
εἰ μή σφωε πατὴρ εὐρὺ κρείων ἐνοσίχθων

11.752

ἐκ πολέμου ἐσάωσε καλύψας ἠέρι πολλῇ.
ἔνθα Ζεὺς Πυλίοισι μέγα κράτος ἐγγυάλιξε·
τόφρα γὰρ οὖν ἐπόμεσθα διὰ σπιδέος πεδίοιο
κτείνοντές τ’ αὐτοὺς ἀνά τ’ ἔντεα καλὰ λέγοντες,
ὄφρ’ ἐπὶ Βουπρασίου πολυπύρου βήσαμεν ἵππους
πέτρης τ’ Ὠλενίης, καὶ Ἀλησίου ἔνθα κολώνη
κέκληται· ὅθεν αὖτις ἀπέτραπε λαὸν Ἀθήνη.
ἔνθ’ ἄνδρα κτείνας πύματον λίπον· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
ἂψ ἀπὸ Βουπρασίοιο Πύλονδ’ ἔχον ὠκέας ἵππους,
πάντες δ’ εὐχετόωντο θεῶν Διὶ Νέστορί τ’ ἀνδρῶν.
ὣς ἔον, εἴ ποτ’ ἔον γε, μετ’ ἀνδράσιν. αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
οἷος τῆς ἀρετῆς ἀπονήσεται· ἦ τέ μιν οἴω
πολλὰ μετακλαύσεσθαι ἐπεί κ’ ἀπὸ λαὸς ὄληται.
ὦ πέπον ἦ μὲν σοί γε Μενοίτιος ὧδ’ ἐπέτελλεν
ἤματι τῷ ὅτε σ’ ἐκ Φθίης Ἀγαμέμνονι πέμπε,
νῶϊ δέ τ’ ἔνδον ἐόντες ἐγὼ καὶ δῖος Ὀδυσσεὺς
πάντα μάλ’ ἐν μεγάροις ἠκούομεν ὡς ἐπέτελλε.
Πηλῆος δ’ ἱκόμεσθα δόμους εὖ ναιετάοντας
λαὸν ἀγείροντες κατ’ Ἀχαιΐδα πουλυβότειραν.
ἔνθα δ’ ἔπειθ’ ἥρωα Μενοίτιον εὕρομεν ἔνδον
ἠδὲ σέ, πὰρ δ’ Ἀχιλῆα· γέρων δ’ ἱππηλάτα Πηλεὺς
πίονα μηρία καῖε βοὸς Διὶ τερπικεραύνῳ
αὐλῆς ἐν χόρτῳ· ἔχε δὲ χρύσειον ἄλεισον
σπένδων αἴθοπα οἶνον ἐπ’ αἰθομένοις ἱεροῖσι.
σφῶϊ μὲν ἀμφὶ βοὸς ἔπετον κρέα, νῶϊ δ’ ἔπειτα
στῆμεν ἐνὶ προθύροισι· ταφὼν δ’ ἀνόρουσεν Ἀχιλλεύς,
ἐς δ’ ἄγε χειρὸς ἑλών, κατὰ δ’ ἑδριάασθαι ἄνωγε,
ξείνιά τ’ εὖ παρέθηκεν, ἅ τε ξείνοις θέμις ἐστίν.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ τάρπημεν ἐδητύος ἠδὲ ποτῆτος,
ἦρχον ἐγὼ μύθοιο κελεύων ὔμμ’ ἄμ’ ἕπεσθαι·

11.782

σφὼ δὲ μάλ’ ἠθέλετον, τὼ δ’ ἄμφω πόλλ’ ἐπέτελλον.
Πηλεὺς μὲν ᾧ παιδὶ γέρων ἐπέτελλ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ
αἰὲν ἀριστεύειν καὶ ὑπείροχον ἔμμεναι ἄλλων·
σοὶ δ’ αὖθ’ ὧδ’ ἐπέτελλε Μενοίτιος Ἄκτορος υἱός·
τέκνον ἐμὸν γενεῇ μὲν ὑπέρτερός ἐστιν Ἀχιλλεύς,
πρεσβύτερος δὲ σύ ἐσσι· βίῃ δ’ ὅ γε πολλὸν ἀμείνων.
ἀλλ’ εὖ οἱ φάσθαι πυκινὸν ἔπος ἠδ’ ὑποθέσθαι
καί οἱ σημαίνειν· ὃ δὲ πείσεται εἰς ἀγαθόν περ.
ὣς ἐπέτελλ’ ὃ γέρων, σὺ δὲ λήθεαι· ἀλλ’ ἔτι καὶ νῦν
ταῦτ’ εἴποις Ἀχιλῆϊ δαΐφρονι αἴ κε πίθηται.

τίς δ’ οἶδ’ εἴ κέν οἱ σὺν δαίμονι θυμὸν ὀρίναις
παρειπών; ἀγαθὴ δὲ παραίφασίς ἐστιν ἑταίρου.
εἰ δέ τινα φρεσὶν ᾗσι θεοπροπίην ἀλεείνει
καί τινά οἱ πὰρ Ζηνὸς ἐπέφραδε πότνια μήτηρ,
ἀλλὰ σέ περ προέτω, ἅμα δ’ ἄλλος λαὸς ἑπέσθω
Μυρμιδόνων, αἴ κέν τι φόως Δαναοῖσι γένηαι·
καί τοι τεύχεα καλὰ δότω πόλεμον δὲ φέρεσθαι,
αἴ κέ σε τῷ εἴσκοντες ἀπόσχωνται πολέμοιο
Τρῶες, ἀναπνεύσωσι δ’ ἀρήϊοι υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
τειρόμενοι· ὀλίγη δέ τ’ ἀνάπνευσις πολέμοιο.
ῥεῖα δέ κ’ ἀκμῆτες κεκμηότας ἄνδρας ἀϋτῇ
ὤσαισθε προτὶ ἄστυ νεῶν ἄπο καὶ κλισιάων.
ὣς φάτο, τῷ δ’ ἄρα θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ὄρινε,
βῆ δὲ θέειν παρὰ νῆας ἐπ’ Αἰακίδην Ἀχιλῆα.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ κατὰ νῆας Ὀδυσσῆος θείοιο
ἵξε θέων Πάτροκλος, ἵνά σφ’ ἀγορή τε θέμις τε
ἦην, τῇ δὴ καί σφι θεῶν ἐτετεύχατο βωμοί,
ἔνθά οἱ Εὐρύπυλος βεβλημένος ἀντεβόλησε
διογενὴς Εὐαιμονίδης κατὰ μηρὸν ὀϊστῷ
σκάζων ἐκ πολέμου· κατὰ δὲ νότιος ῥέεν ἱδρὼς

11.812

ὤμων καὶ κεφαλῆς, ἀπὸ δ’ ἕλκεος ἀργαλέοιο
αἷμα μέλαν κελάρυζε· νόος γε μὲν ἔμπεδος ἦεν.
τὸν δὲ ἰδὼν ᾤκτειρε Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμος υἱός,
καί ῥ’ ὀλοφυρόμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
ἆ δειλοὶ Δαναῶν ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες
ὣς ἄρ’ ἐμέλλετε τῆλε φίλων καὶ πατρίδος αἴης
ἄσειν ἐν Τροίῃ ταχέας κύνας ἀργέτι δημῷ.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε μοι τόδε εἰπὲ διοτρεφὲς Εὐρύπυλ’ ἥρως,
ἦ ῥ’ ἔτι που σχήσουσι πελώριον Ἕκτορ’ Ἀχαιοί,
ἦ ἤδη φθίσονται ὑπ’ αὐτοῦ δουρὶ δαμέντες;
τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ Εὐρύπυλος βεβλημένος ἀντίον ηὔδα·
οὐκέτι διογενὲς Πατρόκλεες ἄλκαρ Ἀχαιῶν
ἔσσεται, ἀλλ’ ἐν νηυσὶ μελαίνῃσιν πεσέονται.
οἳ μὲν γὰρ δὴ πάντες, ὅσοι πάρος ἦσαν ἄριστοι,
ἐν νηυσὶν κέαται βεβλημένοι οὐτάμενοί τε
χερσὶν ὕπο Τρώων· τῶν δὲ σθένος ὄρνυται αἰέν.
ἀλλ’ ἐμὲ μὲν σὺ σάωσον ἄγων ἐπὶ νῆα μέλαιναν,
μηροῦ δ’ ἔκταμ’ ὀϊστόν, ἀπ’ αὐτοῦ δ’ αἷμα κελαινὸν
νίζ’ ὕδατι λιαρῷ, ἐπὶ δ’ ἤπια φάρμακα πάσσε
ἐσθλά, τά σε προτί φασιν Ἀχιλλῆος δεδιδάχθαι,
ὃν Χείρων ἐδίδαξε δικαιότατος Κενταύρων.
ἰητροὶ μὲν γὰρ Ποδαλείριος ἠδὲ Μαχάων
τὸν μὲν ἐνὶ κλισίῃσιν ὀΐομαι ἕλκος ἔχοντα
χρῄΐζοντα καὶ αὐτὸν ἀμύμονος ἰητῆρος
κεῖσθαι· ὃ δ’ ἐν πεδίῳ Τρώων μένει ὀξὺν Ἄρηα.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμος υἱός·
πῶς τὰρ ἔοι τάδε ἔργα; τί ῥέξομεν Εὐρύπυλ’ ἥρως;
ἔρχομαι ὄφρ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ δαΐφρονι μῦθον ἐνίσπω
ὃν Νέστωρ ἐπέτελλε Γερήνιος οὖρος Ἀχαιῶν·

841 ἀλλ’ οὐδ’ ὣς περ σεῖο μεθήσω τειρομένοιο.
Wounded Eurypylos made answer, "Noble Patroklos, there is no hope left for the Achaeans but they will perish at their ships. All they that were princes among us are lying struck down and wounded at the hands of the Trojans, who are waxing stronger and stronger. But save me and take me to your ship; cut out the arrow from my thigh; wash the black blood from off it with warm water, and lay upon it those gracious herbs which, so they say, have been shown you by Achilles, who was himself shown them by Chiron, most righteous of all the centaurs. For of the physicians Podaleirios and Machaon, I hear that the one is lying wounded in his tent and is himself in need of healing, while the other is fighting the Trojans upon the plain." "Hero Eurypylos," replied the brave son of Menoitios, "how may these things be? What can I do? I am on my way to bear a message to noble Achilles from Nestor of Gerene, bulwark of the Achaeans, but even so I will not be unmindful your distress." With this he clasped him round the middle and led him into the tent, and a squire [therapôn], when he saw him, spread bullock-skins on the ground for him to lie on. He laid him at full length and cut out the sharp arrow from his thigh; he washed the black blood from the wound with warm water; he then crushed a bitter herb, rubbing it between his hands, and spread it upon the wound; this was a virtuous herb which killed all pain; so the wound presently dried and the blood left off flowing.

11.842

842 ἦ, καὶ ὑπὸ στέρνοιο λαβὼν ἄγε ποιμένα λαῶν
843 ἐς κλισίην· θεράπων δὲ ἰδὼν ὑπέχευε βοείας.
844 ἔνθά μιν ἐκτανύσας ἐκ μηροῦ τάμνε μαχαίρῃ
845 ὀξὺ βέλος περιπευκές, ἀπ’ αὐτοῦ δ’ αἷμα κελαινὸν
846 νίζ’ ὕδατι λιαρῷ, ἐπὶ δὲ ῥίζαν βάλε πικρὴν
847 χερσὶ διατρίψας ὀδυνήφατον, ἥ οἱ ἁπάσας
848 ἔσχ’ ὀδύνας· τὸ μὲν ἕλκος ἐτέρσετο, παύσατο δ’ αἷμα.

12.1

1 ὣς ὃ μὲν ἐν κλισίῃσι Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμος υἱὸς
2 ἰᾶτ’ Εὐρύπυλον βεβλημένον· οἳ δὲ μάχοντο
3 Ἀργεῖοι καὶ Τρῶες ὁμιλαδόν· οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔμελλε
4 τάφρος ἔτι σχήσειν Δαναῶν καὶ τεῖχος ὕπερθεν
5 εὐρύ, τὸ ποιήσαντο νεῶν ὕπερ, ἀμφὶ δὲ τάφρον
6 ἤλασαν· οὐδὲ θεοῖσι δόσαν κλειτὰς ἑκατόμβας·
7 ὅφρά σφιν νῆάς τε θοὰς καὶ λῃΐδα πολλὴν
8 ἐντὸς ἔχον ῥύοιτο· θεῶν δ’ ἀέκητι τέτυκτο
9 ἀθανάτων· τὸ καὶ οὔ τι πολὺν χρόνον ἔμπεδον ἦεν.
10 ὄφρα μὲν Ἕκτωρ ζωὸς ἔην καὶ μήνι’ Ἀχιλλεὺς
11 καὶ Πριάμοιο ἄνακτος ἀπόρθητος πόλις ἔπλεν,
12 τόφρα δὲ καὶ μέγα τεῖχος Ἀχαιῶν ἔμπεδον ἦεν.
13 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ κατὰ μὲν Τρώων θάνον ὅσσοι ἄριστοι,
14 πολλοὶ δ’ Ἀργείων οἳ μὲν δάμεν, οἳ δὲ λίποντο,
15 πέρθετο δὲ Πριάμοιο πόλις δεκάτῳ ἐνιαυτῷ,
16 Ἀργεῖοι δ’ ἐν νηυσὶ φίλην ἐς πατρίδ’ ἔβησαν,
17 δὴ τότε μητιόωντο Ποσειδάων καὶ Ἀπόλλων
18 τεῖχος ἀμαλδῦναι ποταμῶν μένος εἰσαγαγόντες.
19 ὅσσοι ἀπ’ Ἰδαίων ὀρέων ἅλα δὲ προρέουσι,
20 Ῥῆσός θ’ Ἑπτάπορός τε Κάρησός τε Ῥοδίος τε
21 Γρήνικός τε καὶ Αἴσηπος δῖός τε Σκάμανδρος

22 καὶ Σιμόεις, ὅθι πολλὰ βοάγρια καὶ τρυφάλειαι
23 κάππεσον ἐν κονίῃσι καὶ ἡμιθέων γένος ἀνδρῶν·
24 τῶν πάντων ὁμόσε στόματ’ ἔτραπε Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων,
25 ἐννῆμαρ δ’ ἐς τεῖχος ἴει ῥόον· ὗε δ’ ἄρα Ζεὺς
26 συνεχές, ὄφρά κε θᾶσσον ἁλίπλοα τείχεα θείη.
27 αὐτὸς δ’ ἐννοσίγαιος ἔχων χείρεσσι τρίαιναν
28 ἡγεῖτ’, ἐκ δ’ ἄρα πάντα θεμείλια κύμασι πέμπε
29 φιτρῶν καὶ λάων, τὰ θέσαν μογέοντες Ἀχαιοί,
30 λεῖα δ’ ἐποίησεν παρ’ ἀγάρροον Ἑλλήσποντον,
So the son of Menoitios was attending to the hurt of Eurypylos within the tent, but the Argives and Trojans still fought desperately, nor were the trench and the high wall above it, to keep the Trojans in check longer. They had built it to protect their ships, and had dug the trench all round it that it might safeguard both the ships and the rich spoils which they had taken, but they had not offered hecatombs to the gods. It had been built without the consent of the immortals, and therefore it did not last. So long as Hektor lived and Achilles continued his anger [mênis], and so long as the city of Priam remained untaken, the great wall of the Achaeans stood firm; but when the bravest of the Trojans were no more, and many also of the Argives, though some were yet left alive when, moreover, the city was sacked in the tenth year, and the Argives had gone back with their ships to their own country - then Poseidon and Apollo took counsel to destroy the wall, and they turned on to it the streams of all the rivers from Mount Ida into the sea, Rhesus, Heptaporos, Caresus, Rhodios, Grenicus, Aesopos, and goodly Skamandros, with Simoeis, where many a shield and helm had fallen, and many a hero of the race of demigods had bitten the dust. Phoebus Apollo turned the mouths of all these rivers together and made them flow for nine days against the wall, while Zeus rained the whole time that he might wash it sooner into the sea. Poseidon himself, trident in hand, surveyed the work and threw into the sea all the foundations of beams and stones which the Achaeans had laid with so much toil; he made all level by the mighty stream of the Hellespont, and then when he had swept the wall away he spread a great beach of sand over the place where it had been. This done he turned the rivers back into their old courses. This was what Poseidon and Apollo were to do in after time; but as yet battle and turmoil were still raging round the wall till its timbers rang under the blows that rained upon them. The Argives, cowed by the scourge of Zeus, were hemmed in at their ships in fear of Hektor the mighty minister of Rout, who as heretofore fought with the force and fury of a whirlwind. As a lion or wild boar turns fiercely on the dogs and men that attack him, while these form solid wall and shower their javelins as they face him - his courage is all undaunted, but his high spirit will be the death of him; many a time does he charge at his pursuers to scatter them, and they fall back as often as he does so - even so did Hektor go about among the host exhorting his men, and cheering them on to cross the trench. But the horses dared not do so, and stood neighing upon its brink, for the width frightened them. They could neither jump it nor cross it, for it had overhanging banks all round upon either side, above which there were the sharp stakes that the sons of the Achaeans had planted so close and strong as a defense against all who would assail it; a horse, therefore, could not get into it and draw his chariot after him, but those who were on foot kept trying their very utmost. Then Polydamas went up to Hektor and said, "Hektor, and you other leaders of the Trojans and allies, it is madness for us to try and drive our horses across the trench; it will be very hard to cross, for it is full of sharp stakes, and beyond these there is the wall. Our horses therefore cannot get down into it, and would be of no use if they did; moreover it is a narrow place and we should come to harm. If, indeed, great Zeus is minded to help the Trojans, and in his anger will utterly destroy the Achaeans, I would myself gladly see them perish now and here far from Argos; but if they should rally and we are driven back from the ships pell-mell into the trench there will be not so much as

a man get back to the city to tell the tale. Now, therefore, let us all do as I say; let our squires [therapontes] hold our horses by the trench, but let us follow Hektor in a body on foot, clad in full armor, and if the day of their doom is at hand the Achaeans will not be able to withstand us." Thus spoke Polydamas and his saying pleased Hektor, who sprang in full armor to the ground, and all the other Trojans, when they saw him do so, also left their chariots. Each man then gave his horses over to his charioteer in charge to hold them ready, in proper order [kosmos], for him at the trench. Then they formed themselves into companies, made themselves ready, and in five bodies followed their leaders. Those that went with Hektor and Polydamas were the bravest and most in number, and the most determined to break through the wall and fight at the ships. Kebriones was also joined with them as third in command, for Hektor had left his chariot in charge of a less valiant warrior. The next company was led by Paris, Alkathoos, and Agenor; the third by Helenos and Deiphobos, two sons of Priam, and with them was the hero Asios - Asios the son of Hyrtakos, whose great black horses of the breed that comes from the river Selleis had brought him from Arisbe. Aeneas the valiant son of Anchises led the fourth; he and the two sons of Antenor, Arkhelokhos and Akamas, men well versed in all the arts of war. Sarpedon was leader over the allies, and took with him Glaukos and Asteropaios whom he deemed most valiant after himself - for he was far the best man of them all. These helped to array one another in their ox-hide shields, and then charged straight at the Danaans, for they felt sure that they would not hold out longer and that they should themselves now fall upon the ships. The rest of the Trojans and their allies now followed the counsel of Polydamas but Asios son of Hyrtakos would not leave his horses and his esquire [therapôn] behind him; in his foolhardiness he took them on with him towards the ships, nor did he fail to come by his end in consequence. Nevermore was he to return to wind-beaten Ilion, exulting in his chariot and his horses; ere he could do so, death of ill-omened name had overshadowed him and he had fallen by the spear of Idomeneus the noble son of Deukalion. He had driven towards the left wing of the ships, by which way the Achaeans used to return with their chariots and horses from the plain. Hither he drove and found the gates with their doors opened wide, and the great bar down - for the gatemen kept them open so as to let those of their comrades enter who might be fleeing towards the ships. Hither of set purpose did he direct his horses, and his men followed him with a loud cry, for they felt sure that the Achaeans would not hold out longer, and that they should now fall upon the ships. Little did they know that at the gates they should find two of the bravest chieftains, proud sons of the fighting Lapiths - the one, Polypoites, mighty son of Peirithoos, and the other Leonteus, peer of murderous Ares. These stood before the gates like two high oak trees upon the mountains, that tower from their wide-spreading roots, and year after year battle with wind and rain - even so did these two men await the onset of great Asios confidently and without flinching. The Trojans led by him and by Iamenos, Orestes, Adamas the son of Asios, Thoon and Oinomaos, raised a loud cry of battle and made straight for the wall, holding their shields of dry ox-hide above their heads; for a while the two defenders remained inside and cheered the Achaeans on to stand firm in the defense of their ships; when, however, they saw that the Trojans were attacking the wall, while the Danaans were crying out for help and being routed, they rushed outside and fought in front of the gates like two wild boars upon the mountains that abide the attack of men and dogs, and charging on either side break down the wood all round them tearing it up by the roots, and one can hear the clattering of their tusks, till some one hits them and makes an end of them - even so did the gleaming bronze rattle about their breasts, as the weapons fell upon them; for they fought with great fury, trusting to their own prowess and to those who were on the wall above them. These threw great stones at their assailants in defense of themselves their tents and their ships. The stones fell thick as the flakes of snow which some fierce blast drives from the dark clouds and showers down in sheets upon the earth - even so fell the weapons from

the hands alike of Trojans and Achaeans. Helmet and shield rang out as the great stones rained upon them, and Asios the son of Hyrtakos in his dismay cried aloud and smote his two thighs. "Father Zeus," he cried, "of a truth you too are altogether given to lying. I made sure the Argive heroes could not withstand us, whereas like slim-waisted wasps, or bees that have their nests in the rocks by the wayside - they leave not the holes wherein they have built undefended, but fight for their little ones against all who would take them - even so these men, though they be but two, will not be driven from the gates, but stand firm either to slay or be slain."

12.31

31 αὖτις δ’ ἠϊόνα μεγάλην ψαμάθοισι κάλυψε
32 τεῖχος ἀμαλδύνας· ποταμοὺς δ’ ἔτρεψε νέεσθαι
33 κὰρ ῥόον, ᾗ περ πρόσθεν ἴεν καλλίρροον ὕδωρ.
34 ὣς ἄρ’ ἔμελλον ὄπισθε Ποσειδάων καὶ Ἀπόλλων
35 θησέμεναι· τότε δ’ ἀμφὶ μάχη ἐνοπή τε δεδήει
36 τεῖχος ἐΰδμητον, κανάχιζε δὲ δούρατα πύργων
37 βαλλόμεν’· Ἀργεῖοι δὲ Διὸς μάστιγι δαμέντες
38 νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσιν ἐελμένοι ἰσχανόωντο
39 Ἕκτορα δειδιότες, κρατερὸν μήστωρα φόβοιο·
40 αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ὡς τὸ πρόσθεν ἐμάρνατο ἶσος ἀέλλῃ·
41 ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἂν ἔν τε κύνεσσι καὶ ἀνδράσι θηρευτῇσι
42 κάπριος ἠὲ λέων στρέφεται σθένεϊ βλεμεαίνων·
43 οἳ δέ τε πυργηδὸν σφέας αὐτοὺς ἀρτύναντες
44 ἀντίον ἵστανται καὶ ἀκοντίζουσι θαμειὰς
45 αἰχμὰς ἐκ χειρῶν· τοῦ δ’ οὔ ποτε κυδάλιμον κῆρ
46 ταρβεῖ οὐδὲ φοβεῖται, ἀγηνορίη δέ μιν ἔκτα·
47 ταρφέα τε στρέφεται στίχας ἀνδρῶν πειρητίζων·
48 ὅππῃ τ’ ἰθύσῃ τῇ εἴκουσι στίχες ἀνδρῶν·
49 ὣς Ἕκτωρ ἀν’ ὅμιλον ἰὼν ἐλλίσσεθ’ ἑταίρους
50 τάφρον ἐποτρύνων διαβαινέμεν· οὐδέ οἱ ἵπποι
51 τόλμων ὠκύποδες, μάλα δὲ χρεμέτιζον ἐπ’ ἄκρῳ
52 χείλει ἐφεσταότες· ἀπὸ γὰρ δειδίσσετο τάφρος
53 εὐρεῖ’, οὔτ’ ἄρ’ ὑπερθορέειν σχεδὸν οὔτε περῆσαι
54 ῥηϊδίη· κρημνοὶ γὰρ ἐπηρεφέες περὶ πᾶσαν
55 ἔστασαν ἀμφοτέρωθεν, ὕπερθεν δὲ σκολόπεσσιν
56 ὀξέσιν ἠρήρει, τοὺς ἵστασαν υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
57 πυκνοὺς καὶ μεγάλους δηΐων ἀνδρῶν ἀλεωρήν.
58 ἔνθ’ οὔ κεν ῥέα ἵππος ἐΰτροχον ἅρμα τιταίνων
59 ἐσβαίη, πεζοὶ δὲ μενοίνεον εἰ τελέουσι.
60 δὴ τότε Πουλυδάμας θρασὺν Ἕκτορα εἶπε παραστάς·

12.61

61 Ἕκτορ τ’ ἠδ’ ἄλλοι Τρώων ἀγοὶ ἠδ’ ἐπικούρων
62 ἀφραδέως διὰ τάφρον ἐλαύνομεν ὠκέας ἵππους·
63 ἣ δὲ μάλ’ ἀργαλέη περάαν· σκόλοπες γὰρ ἐν αὐτῇ
64 ὀξέες ἑστᾶσιν, ποτὶ δ’ αὐτοὺς τεῖχος Ἀχαιῶν,
65 ἔνθ’ οὔ πως ἔστιν καταβήμεναι οὐδὲ μάχεσθαι
66 ἱππεῦσι· στεῖνος γάρ, ὅθι τρώσεσθαι ὀΐω.
67 εἰ μὲν γὰρ τοὺς πάγχυ κακὰ φρονέων ἀλαπάζει
68 Ζεὺς ὑψιβρεμέτης, Τρώεσσι δὲ ἴετ’ ἀρήγειν,

ἦ τ’ ἂν ἔγωγ’ ἐθέλοιμι καὶ αὐτίκα τοῦτο γενέσθαι,
νωνύμνους ἀπολέσθαι ἀπ’ Ἄργεος ἐνθάδ’ Ἀχαιούς·
εἰ δέ χ’ ὑποστρέψωσι, παλίωξις δὲ γένηται
ἐκ νηῶν καὶ τάφρῳ ἐνιπλήξωμεν ὀρυκτῇ,
οὐκέτ’ ἔπειτ’ ὀΐω οὐδ’ ἄγγελον ἀπονέεσθαι
ἄψορρον προτὶ ἄστυ ἑλιχθέντων ὑπ’ Ἀχαιῶν.
ἀλλ’ ἄγεθ’ ὡς ἂν ἐγὼ εἴπω πειθώμεθα πάντες·
ἵππους μὲν θεράποντες ἐρυκόντων ἐπὶ τάφρῳ,
αὐτοὶ δὲ πρυλέες σὺν τεύχεσι θωρηχθέντες
Ἕκτορι πάντες ἑπώμεθ’ ἀολλέες· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
οὐ μενέουσ’ εἰ δή σφιν ὀλέθρου πείρατ’ ἐφῆπται.
ὣς φάτο Πουλυδάμας, ἄδε δ’ Ἕκτορι μῦθος ἀπήμων,
αὐτίκα δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων σὺν τεύχεσιν ἆλτο χαμᾶζε.
οὐδὲ μὲν ἄλλοι Τρῶες ἐφ’ ἵππων ἠγερέθοντο,
ἀλλ’ ἀπὸ πάντες ὄρουσαν, ἐπεὶ ἴδον Ἕκτορα δῖον.
ἡνιόχῳ μὲν ἔπειτα ἐῷ ἐπέτελλεν ἕκαστος
ἵππους εὖ κατὰ κόσμον ἐρυκέμεν αὖθ’ ἐπὶ τάφρῳ·
οἳ δὲ διαστάντες σφέας αὐτοὺς ἀρτύναντες
πένταχα κοσμηθέντες ἅμ’ ἡγεμόνεσσιν ἕποντο.
οἳ μὲν ἅμ’ Ἕκτορ’ ἴσαν καὶ ἀμύμονι Πουλυδάμαντι,
οἳ πλεῖστοι καὶ ἄριστοι ἔσαν, μέμασαν δὲ μάλιστα
τεῖχος ῥηξάμενοι κοίλῃς ἐπὶ νηυσὶ μάχεσθαι.

12.91

καί σφιν Κεβριόνης τρίτος εἴπετο· πὰρ δ’ ἄρ’ ὄχεσφιν
ἄλλον Κεβριόναο χερείονα κάλλιπεν Ἕκτωρ.
τῶν δ’ ἑτέρων Πάρις ἦρχε καὶ Ἀλκάθοος καὶ Ἀγήνωρ,
τῶν δὲ τρίτων Ἕλενος καὶ Δηΐφοβος θεοειδὴς
υἷε δύω Πριάμοιο· τρίτος δ’ ἦν Ἄσιος ἥρως
Ἄσιος Ὑρτακίδης, ὃν Ἀρίσβηθεν φέρον ἵπποι
αἴθωνες μεγάλοι ποταμοῦ ἄπο Σελλήεντος.
τῶν δὲ τετάρτων ἦρχεν ἐΰς πάϊς Ἀγχίσαο
Αἰνείας, ἅμα τῷ γε δύω Ἀντήνορος υἷε
Ἀρχέλοχός τ’ Ἀκάμας τε μάχης εὖ εἰδότε πάσης.
Σαρπηδὼν δ’ ἡγήσατ’ ἀγακλειτῶν ἐπικούρων,
πρὸς δ’ ἔλετο Γλαῦκον καὶ ἀρήϊον Ἀστεροπαῖον·
οἳ γάρ οἱ εἴσαντο διακριδὸν εἶναι ἄριστοι
τῶν ἄλλων μετά γ’ αὐτόν· ὃ δ’ ἔπρεπε καὶ διὰ πάντων.
οἳ δ’ ἐπεὶ ἀλλήλους ἄραρον τυκτῇσι βόεσσι
βάν ῥ’ ἰθὺς Δαναῶν λελιημένοι, οὐδ’ ἔτ’ ἔφαντο
σχήσεσθ’, ἀλλ’ ἐν νηυσὶ μελαίνῃσιν πεσέεσθαι.
ἔνθ’ ἄλλοι Τρῶες τηλεκλειτοί τ’ ἐπίκουροι
βουλῇ Πουλυδάμαντος ἀμωμήτοιο πίθοντο·
ἀλλ’ οὐχ Ὑρτακίδης ἔθελ’ Ἄσιος ὄρχαμος ἀνδρῶν
αὖθι λιπεῖν ἵππους τε καὶ ἡνίοχον θεράποντα,
ἀλλὰ σὺν αὐτοῖσιν πέλασεν νήεσσι θοῇσι
νήπιος, οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔμελλε κακὰς ὑπὸ κῆρας ἀλύξας
ἵπποισιν καὶ ὄχεσφιν ἀγαλλόμενος παρὰ νηῶν
ἂψ ἀπονοστήσειν προτὶ Ἴλιον ἠνεμόεσσαν·
πρόσθεν γάρ μιν μοῖρα δυσώνυμος ἀμφεκάλυψεν
ἔγχεϊ Ἰδομενῆος ἀγαυοῦ Δευκαλίδαο.

εἴσατο γὰρ νηῶν ἐπ’ ἀριστερά, τῇ περ Ἀχαιοὶ
ἐκ πεδίου νίσοντο σὺν ἵπποισιν καὶ ὄχεσφι·
τῇ ῥ’ ἵππους τε καὶ ἅρμα διήλασεν, οὐδὲ πύλῃσιν

12.121

εὗρ’ ἐπικεκλιμένας σανίδας καὶ μακρὸν ὀχῆα,
ἀλλ’ ἀναπεπταμένας ἔχον ἀνέρες, εἴ τιν’ ἑταίρων
ἐκ πολέμου φεύγοντα σαώσειαν μετὰ νῆας.
τῇ ῥ’ ἰθὺς φρονέων ἵππους ἔχε, τοὶ δ’ ἅμ’ ἕποντο
ὀξέα κεκλήγοντες· ἔφαντο γὰρ οὐκ ἔτ’ Ἀχαιοὺς
σχήσεσθ’, ἀλλ’ ἐν νηυσὶ μελαίνῃσιν πεσέεσθαι
νήπιοι, ἐν δὲ πύλῃσι δύ’ ἀνέρας εὗρον ἀρίστους
υἷας ὑπερθύμους Λαπιθάων αἰχμητάων,
τὸν μὲν Πειριθόου υἱὰ κρατερὸν Πολυποίτην,
τὸν δὲ Λεοντῆα βροτολοιγῷ ἶσον Ἀρηϊ.
τὼ μὲν ἄρα προπάροιθε πυλάων ὑψηλάων
ἕστασαν ὡς ὅτε τε δρύες οὔρεσιν ὑψικάρηνοι,
αἵ τ’ ἄνεμον μίμνουσι καὶ ὑετὸν ἤματα πάντα
ῥίζῃσιν μεγάλῃσι διηνεκέεσσ’ ἀραρυῖαι·
ὣς ἄρα τὼ χείρεσσι πεποιθότες ἠδὲ βίηφι
μίμνον ἐπερχόμενον μέγαν Ἄσιον οὐδὲ φέβοντο.
οἳ δ’ ἰθὺς πρὸς τεῖχος ἐΰδμητον βόας αὖας
ὑψόσ’ ἀνασχόμενοι ἔκιον μεγάλῳ ἀλαλητῷ
Ἄσιον ἀμφὶ ἄνακτα καὶ Ἰαμενὸν καὶ Ὀρέστην
Ἀσιάδην τ’ Ἀδάμαντα Θόωνά τε Οἰνόμαόν τε.
οἳ δ’ ἤτοι εἶος μὲν ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιοὺς
ὄρνυον ἔνδον ἐόντες ἀμύνεσθαι περὶ νηῶν·
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ τεῖχος ἐπεσσυμένους ἐνόησαν
Τρῶας, ἀτὰρ Δαναῶν γένετο ἰαχή τε φόβος τε,
ἐκ δὲ τὼ ἀΐξαντε πυλάων πρόσθε μαχέσθην
ἀγροτέροισι σύεσσιν ἐοικότε, τώ τ’ ἐν ὄρεσσιν
ἀνδρῶν ἠδὲ κυνῶν δέχαται κολοσυρτὸν ἰόντα,
δοχμώ τ’ ἀΐσσοντε περὶ σφίσιν ἄγνυτον ὕλην
πρυμνὴν ἐκτάμνοντες, ὑπαὶ δέ τε κόμπος ὀδόντων
γίγνεται εἰς ὅ κέ τίς τε βαλὼν ἐκ θυμὸν ἕληται·

12.151

ὣς τῶν κόμπει χαλκὸς ἐπὶ στήθεσσι φαεινὸς
ἄντην βαλλομένων· μάλα γὰρ κρατερῶς ἐμάχοντο
λαοῖσιν καθύπερθε πεποιθότες ἠδὲ βίηφιν.
οἳ δ’ ἄρα χερμαδίοισιν ἐϋδμήτων ἀπὸ πύργων
βάλλον ἀμυνόμενοι σφῶν τ’ αὐτῶν καὶ κλισιάων
νηῶν τ’ ὠκυπόρων· νιφάδες δ’ ὡς πῖπτον ἔραζε,
ἅς τ’ ἄνεμος ζαὴς νέφεα σκιόεντα δονήσας
ταρφειὰς κατέχευεν ἐπὶ χθονὶ πουλυβοτείρῃ·
ὣς τῶν ἐκ χειρῶν βέλεα ῥέον ἠμὲν Ἀχαιῶν
ἠδὲ καὶ ἐκ Τρώων· κόρυθες δ’ ἀμφ’ αὖον ἀΰτευν
βαλλομένων μυλάκεσσι καὶ ἀσπίδες ὀμφαλόεσσαι.
δή ῥα τότ’ ὤμωξεν καὶ ὃ πεπλήγετο μηρὸ
Ἄσιος Ὑρτακίδης, καὶ ἀλαστήσας ἔπος ηὔδα·

164 Ζεῦ πάτερ ἦ ῥά νυ καὶ σὺ φιλοψευδὴς ἐτέτυξο
165 πάγχυ μάλ’· οὐ γὰρ ἔγωγ’ ἐφάμην ἥρωας Ἀχαιοὺς
166 σχήσειν ἡμέτερόν γε μένος καὶ χεῖρας ἀάπτους.
167 οἳ δ’, ὥς τε σφῆκες μέσον αἰόλοι ἠὲ μέλισσαι
168 οἰκία ποιήσωνται ὁδῷ ἔπι παιπαλοέσσῃ,
169 οὐδ’ ἀπολείπουσιν κοῖλον δόμον, ἀλλὰ μένοντες
170 ἄνδρας θηρητῆρας ἀμύνονται περὶ τέκνων,
171 ὣς οἵ γ’ οὐκ ἐθέλουσι πυλάων καὶ δύ’ ἐόντε
172 χάσσασθαι πρίν γ’ ἠὲ κατακτάμεν ἠὲ ἁλῶναι.
173 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδὲ Διὸς πεῖθε φρένα ταῦτ’ ἀγορεύων·
174 Ἕκτορι γάρ οἱ θυμὸς ἐβούλετο κῦδος ὀρέξαι.
175 ἄλλοι δ’ ἀμφ’ ἄλλῃσι μάχην ἐμάχοντο πύλῃσιν·
176 ἀργαλέον δέ με ταῦτα θεὸν ὣς πάντ’ ἀγορεῦσαι·
177 πάντῃ γὰρ περὶ τεῖχος ὀρώρει θεσπιδαὲς πῦρ
178 λάϊνον· Ἀργεῖοι δὲ καὶ ἀχνύμενοί περ ἀνάγκῃ
179 νηῶν ἠμύνοντο· θεοὶ δ’ ἀκαχήατο θυμὸν
180 πάντες ὅσοι Δαναοῖσι μάχης ἐπιτάρροθοι ἦσαν.
He spoke, but moved not the mind of Zeus, whose counsel it then was to give glory to Hektor. Meanwhile the rest of the Trojans were fighting about the other gates; I, however, am no god to be able to tell about all these things, for the battle raged everywhere about the stone wall as it were a fiery furnace. The Argives, discomfited though they were, were forced to defend their ships, and all the gods who were defending the Achaeans were vexed in spirit; but the Lapiths kept on fighting with might and main. Thereon Polypoites, mighty son of Peirithoos, hit Damasos with a spear upon his cheek-pierced helmet. The helmet did not protect him, for the point of the spear went through it, and broke the bone, so that the brain inside was scattered about, and he died fighting. He then slew Pylon and Ormenus. Leonteus, of the race of Ares, killed Hippomakhos the son of Antimakhos by striking him with his spear upon the belt. He then drew his sword and sprang first upon Antiphates whom he killed in combat, and who fell face upwards on the earth. After him he killed Menon, Iamenos, and Orestes, and laid them low one after the other. While they were busy stripping the armor from these heroes, the youths who were led on by Polydamas and Hektor (and these were the greater part and the most valiant of those that were trying to break through the wall and fire the ships) were still standing by the trench, uncertain what they should do; for they had seen a sign from heaven when they had essayed to cross it - a soaring eagle that flew skirting the left wing of their host, with a monstrous blood-red snake in its talons still alive and struggling to escape. The snake was still bent on revenge, wriggling and twisting itself backwards till it struck the bird that held it, on the neck and breast; whereon the bird being in pain, let it fall, dropping it into the middle of the host, and then flew down the wind with a sharp cry. The Trojans were struck with terror when they saw the snake, portent of aegis-bearing Zeus, writhing in the midst of them, and Polydamas went up to Hektor and said, "Hektor, at our councils of war you are ever given to rebuke me, even when I speak wisely, as though it were not well, indeed, that one of the people of the local district [dêmos] should cross your will either in the field or at the council board; you would have them support you always: nevertheless I will say what I think will be best; let us not now go on to fight the Danaans at their ships, for I know what will happen if this soaring eagle which skirted the left wing of our with a monstrous blood-red snake in its talons (the snake being still alive) was really sent as an omen to the Trojans on their essaying to cross the trench. The eagle let go her hold; she did not succeed in taking it home to her little ones, and so will it be - with ourselves; even though by a mighty effort we break through the gates and wall of the Achaeans, and they give way before us, still we shall not return in good order [kosmos] by the way we came, but shall leave many a man

behind us whom the Achaeans will do to death in defense of their ships. Thus would any seer who was expert in these matters, and was trusted by the people, read the portent." Hektor looked fiercely at him and said, "Polydamas, I like not of your reading. You can find a better saying than this if you will. If, however, you have spoken in good earnest, then indeed has heaven robbed you of your reason. You would have me pay no heed to the counsels of Zeus, nor to the promises he made me - and he bowed his head in confirmation; you bid me be ruled rather by the flight of wild-fowl. What care I whether they flee towards dawn or dark, and whether they be on my right hand or on my left? Let us put our trust rather in the counsel of great Zeus, king of mortals and immortals. There is one omen, and one only - that a man should fight for his country. Why are you so fearful? Though we be all of us slain at the ships of the Argives you are not likely to be killed yourself, for you are not steadfast nor courageous. If you will. not fight, or would talk others over from doing so, you shall fall forthwith before my spear." With these words he led the way, and the others followed after with a cry that rent the air. Then Zeus the lord of thunder sent the blast of a mighty wind from the mountains of Ida, that bore the dust down towards the ships; he thus lulled the thinking [noos] of the Achaeans into security, and gave victory to Hektor and to the Trojans, who, trusting to their own might and to the signs he had shown them, essayed to break through the great wall of the Achaeans. They tore down the breastworks from the walls, and overthrew the battlements; they upheaved the buttresses, which the Achaeans had set in front of the wall in order to support it; when they had pulled these down they made sure of breaking through the wall, but the Danaans still showed no sign of giving ground; they still fenced the battlements with their shields of ox-hide, and hurled their missiles down upon the foe as soon as any came below the wall. The two Ajaxes went about everywhere on the walls cheering on the Achaeans, giving fair words to some while they spoke sharply to any one whom they saw to be remiss. "My friends," they cried, "Argives one and all - good bad and indifferent, for there was never fight yet, in which all were of equal prowess - there is now work enough, as you very well know, for all of you. See that you none of you turn in flight towards the ships, daunted by the shouting of the foe, but press forward and keep one another in heart, if it may so be that Olympian Zeus the lord of lightning will grant us to repel our foes, and drive them back towards the city." Thus did the two go about shouting and cheering the Achaeans on. As the flakes that fall thick upon a winter's day, when Zeus is minded to snow and to display these his arrows to humankind - he lulls the wind to rest, and snows hour after hour till he has buried the tops of the high mountains, the headlands that jut into the sea, the grassy plains, and the tilled fields of men; the snow lies deep upon the forelands, and havens of the gray sea, but the waves as they come rolling in stay it that it can come no further, though all else is wrapped as with a mantle so heavy are the heavens with snow - even thus thickly did the stones fall on one side and on the other, some thrown at the Trojans, and some by the Trojans at the Achaeans; and the whole wall was in an uproar.

12.181

181 σὺν δ’ ἔβαλον Λαπίθαι πόλεμον καὶ δηϊοτῆτα.
182 ἔνθ’ αὖ Πειριθόου υἱὸς κρατερὸς Πολυποίτης
183 δουρὶ βάλεν Δάμασον κυνέης διὰ χαλκοπαρῄου·
184 οὐδ’ ἄρα χαλκείη κόρυς ἔσχεθεν, ἀλλὰ διὰ πρὸ
185 αἰχμὴ χαλκείη ῥῆξ’ ὀστέον, ἐγκέφαλος δὲ
186 ἔνδον ἅπας πεπάλακτο· δάμασσε δέ μιν μεμαῶτα·
187 αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα Πύλωνα καὶ Ὄρμενον ἐξενάριξεν.
188 υἱὸν δ’ Ἀντιμάχοιο Λεοντεὺς ὄζος Ἄρηος
189 Ἱππόμαχον βάλε δουρὶ κατὰ ζωστῆρα τυχήσας.
190 αὖτις δ’ ἐκ κολεοῖο ἐρυσσάμενος ξίφος ὀξὺ

191 Ἀντιφάτην μὲν πρῶτον ἐπαΐξας δι’ ὁμίλου
192 πλῆξ’ αὐτοσχεδίην· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ὕπτιος οὔδει ἐρείσθη·
193 αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα Μένωνα καὶ Ἰαμενὸν καὶ Ὀρέστην
194 πάντας ἐπασσυτέρους πέλασε χθονὶ πουλυβοτείρῃ.
195 ὄφρ’ οἳ τοὺς ἐνάριζον ἀπ’ ἔντεα μαρμαίροντα,
196 τόφρ’ οἳ Πουλυδάμαντι καὶ Ἕκτορι κοῦροι ἕποντο,
197 οἳ πλεῖστοι καὶ ἄριστοι ἔσαν, μέμασαν δὲ μάλιστα
198 τεῖχός τε ῥῆξειν καὶ ἐνιπρήσειν πυρὶ νῆας,
199 οἵ ῥ’ ἔτι μερμήριζον ἐφεσταότες παρὰ τάφρῳ.
200 ὄρνις γάρ σφιν ἐπῆλθε περησέμεναι μεμαῶσιν
201 αἰετὸς ὑψιπέτης ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ λαὸν ἐέργων
202 φοινήεντα δράκοντα φέρων ὀνύχεσσι πέλωρον
203 ζωὸν ἔτ’ ἀσπαίροντα, καὶ οὔ πω λήθετο χάρμης,
204 κόψε γὰρ αὐτὸν ἔχοντα κατὰ στῆθος παρὰ δειρὴν
205 ἰδνωθεὶς ὀπίσω· ὃ δ’ ἀπὸ ἕθεν ἧκε χαμᾶζε
206 ἀλγήσας ὀδύνῃσι, μέσῳ δ’ ἐνὶ κάββαλ’ ὁμίλῳ,
207 αὐτὸς δὲ κλάγξας πέτετο πνοιῇς ἀνέμοιο.
208 Τρῶες δ’ ἐρρίγησαν ὅπως ἴδον αἰόλον ὄφιν
209 κείμενον ἐν μέσσοισι Διὸς τέρας αἰγιόχοιο.
210 δὴ τότε Πουλυδάμας θρασὺν Ἕκτορα εἶπε παραστάς·

12.211

211 Ἕκτορ ἀεὶ μέν πώς μοι ἐπιπλήσσεις ἀγορῇσιν
212 ἐσθλὰ φραζομένῳ, ἐπεὶ οὐδὲ μὲν οὐδὲ ἔοικε
213 δῆμον ἐόντα παρὲξ ἀγορευέμεν, οὔτ’ ἐνὶ βουλῇ
214 οὔτέ ποτ’ ἐν πολέμῳ, σὸν δὲ κράτος αἰὲν ἀέξειν·
215 νῦν αὖτ’ ἐξερέω ὥς μοι δοκεῖ εἶναι ἄριστα.
216 μὴ ἴομεν Δαναοῖσι μαχησόμενοι περὶ νηῶν.
217 ὧδε γὰρ ἐκτελέεσθαι ὀΐομαι, εἰ ἐτεόν γε
218 Τρωσὶν ὅδ’ ὄρνις ἦλθε περησέμεναι μεμαῶσιν
219 αἰετὸς ὑψιπέτης ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ λαὸν ἐέργων
220 φοινήεντα δράκοντα φέρων ὀνύχεσσι πέλωρον
221 ζωόν· ἄφαρ δ’ ἀφέηκε πάρος φίλα οἰκί’ ἱκέσθαι,
222 οὐδ’ ἐτέλεσσε φέρων δόμεναι τεκέεσσιν ἑοῖσιν.
223 ὣς ἡμεῖς, εἴ πέρ τε πύλας καὶ τεῖχος Ἀχαιῶν
224 ῥηξόμεθα σθένεϊ μεγάλῳ, εἴξωσι δ’ Ἀχαιοί,
225 οὐ κόσμῳ παρὰ ναῦφιν ἐλευσόμεθ’ αὐτὰ κέλευθα·
226 πολλοὺς γὰρ Τρώων καταλείψομεν, οὕς κεν Ἀχαιοὶ
227 χαλκῷ δηώσωσιν ἀμυνόμενοι περὶ νηῶν.
228 ὧδέ χ’ ὑποκρίναιτο θεοπρόπος, ὃς σάφα θυμῷ
229 εἰδείη τεράων καί οἱ πειθοίατο λαοί.
230 τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
231 Πουλυδάμα, σὺ μὲν οὐκ ἔτ’ ἐμοὶ φίλα ταῦτ’ ἀγορεύεις·
232 οἶσθα καὶ ἄλλον μῦθον ἀμείνονα τοῦδε νοῆσαι.
233 εἰ δ’ ἐτεὸν δὴ τοῦτον ἀπὸ σπουδῆς ἀγορεύεις,
234 ἐξ ἄρα δή τοι ἔπειτα θεοὶ φρένας ὤλεσαν αὐτοί,
235 ὃς κέλεαι Ζηνὸς μὲν ἐριγδούποιο λαθέσθαι
236 βουλέων, ἅς τέ μοι αὐτὸς ὑπέσχετο καὶ κατένευσε·
237 τύνη δ’ οἰωνοῖσι τανυπτερύγεσσι κελεύεις
238 πείθεσθαι, τῶν οὔ τι μετατρέπομ’ οὐδ’ ἀλεγίζω
239 εἴτ’ ἐπὶ δεξί’ ἴωσι πρὸς ἠῶ τ’ ἠέλιόν τε,

εἴτ’ ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ τοί γε ποτὶ ζόφον ἠερόεντα.

12.241

ἡμεῖς δὲ μεγάλοιο Διὸς πειθώμεθα βουλῇ,
ὃς πᾶσι θνητοῖσι καὶ ἀθανάτοισιν ἀνάσσει.
εἷς οἰωνὸς ἄριστος ἀμύνεσθαι περὶ πάτρης.
τίπτε σὺ δείδοικας πόλεμον καὶ δηϊοτῆτα;
εἴ περ γάρ τ’ ἄλλοι γε περὶ κτεινώμεθα πάντες
νηυσὶν ἐπ’ Ἀργείων, σοὶ δ’ οὐ δέος ἔστ’ ἀπολέσθαι·
οὐ γάρ τοι κραδίη μενεδήϊος οὐδὲ μαχήμων.
εἰ δὲ σὺ δηϊοτῆτος ἀφέξεαι, ἠέ τιν’ ἄλλον
παρφάμενος ἐπέεσσιν ἀποτρέψεις πολέμοιο,
αὐτίκ’ ἐμῷ ὑπὸ δουρὶ τυπεὶς ἀπὸ θυμὸν ὀλέσσεις.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἡγήσατο, τοὶ δ’ ἅμ’ ἕποντο
ἠχῇ θεσπεσίῃ· ἐπὶ δὲ Ζεὺς τερπικέραυνος
ὦρσεν ἀπ’ Ἰδαίων ὀρέων ἀνέμοιο θύελλαν,
ἥ ῥ’ ἰθὺς νηῶν κονίην φέρεν· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιῶν
θέλγε νόον, Τρωσὶν δὲ καὶ Ἕκτορι κῦδος ὄπαζε.
τοῦ περ δὴ τεράεσσι πεποιθότες ἠδὲ βίηφι
ῥήγνυσθαι μέγα τεῖχος Ἀχαιῶν πειρήτιζον.
κρόσσας μὲν πύργων ἔρυον, καὶ ἔρειπον ἐπάλξεις,
στήλας τε προβλῆτας ἐμόχλεον, ἃς ἄρ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
πρώτας ἐν γαίῃ θέσαν ἔμμεναι ἔχματα πύργων.
τὰς οἵ γ’ αὐέρυον, ἔλποντο δὲ τεῖχος Ἀχαιῶν
ῥήξειν· οὐδέ νύ πω Δαναοὶ χάζοντο κελεύθου,
ἀλλ’ οἵ γε ῥινοῖσι βοῶν φράξαντες ἐπάλξεις
βάλλον ἀπ’ αὐτάων δηΐους ὑπὸ τεῖχος ἰόντας.
ἀμφοτέρω δ’ Αἴαντε κελευτιόωντ’ ἐπὶ πύργων
πάντοσε φοιτήτην μένος ὀτρύνοντες Ἀχαιῶν.
ἄλλον μειλιχίοις, ἄλλον στερεοῖς ἐπέεσσι
νείκεον, ὄν τινα πάγχυ μάχης μεθιέντα ἴδοιεν·
ὦ φίλοι Ἀργείων ὅς τ’ ἔξοχος ὅς τε μεσήεις
ὅς τε χερειότερος, ἐπεὶ οὔ πω πάντες ὁμοῖοι

12.271

ἀνέρες ἐν πολέμῳ, νῦν ἔπλετο ἔργον ἅπασι·
καὶ δ’ αὐτοὶ τόδε που γιγνώσκετε. μή τις ὀπίσσω
τετράφθω ποτὶ νῆας ὁμοκλητῆρος ἀκούσας,
ἀλλὰ πρόσω ἴεσθε καὶ ἀλλήλοισι κέλεσθε,
αἴ κε Ζεὺς δώῃσιν Ὀλύμπιος ἀστεροπητὴς
νεῖκος ἀπωσαμένους δηΐους προτὶ ἄστυ δίεσθαι.
ὣς τώ γε προβοῶντε μάχην ὄτρυνον Ἀχαιῶν.
τῶν δ’, ὥς τε νιφάδες χιόνος πίπτωσι θαμειαὶ
ἤματι χειμερίῳ, ὅτε τ’ ὦρετο μητίετα Ζεὺς
νιφέμεν ἀνθρώποισι πιφαυσκόμενος τὰ ἃ κῆλα·
κοιμήσας δ’ ἀνέμους χέει ἔμπεδον, ὄφρα καλύψῃ
ὑψηλῶν ὀρέων κορυφὰς καὶ πρώονας ἄκρους
καὶ πεδία λωτοῦντα καὶ ἀνδρῶν πίονα ἔργα,
καί τ’ ἐφ’ ἁλὸς πολιῆς κέχυται λιμέσιν τε καὶ ἀκταῖς,
κῦμα δέ μιν προσπλάζον ἐρύκεται· ἄλλά τε πάντα

286 εἴλυται καθύπερθ’, ὅτ’ ἐπιβρίσῃ Διὸς ὄμβρος·
287 ὣς τῶν ἀμφοτέρωσε λίθοι πωτῶντο θαμειαί,
288 αἱ μὲν ἄρ’ ἐς Τρῶας, αἱ δ’ ἐκ Τρώων ἐς Ἀχαιούς,
289 βαλλομένων· τὸ δὲ τεῖχος ὕπερ πᾶν δοῦπος ὀρώρει.
290 οὐδ’ ἄν πω τότε γε Τρῶες καὶ φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
291 τείχεος ἐρρήξαντο πύλας καὶ μακρὸν ὀχῆα,
292 εἰ μὴ ἄρ’ υἱὸν ἐὸν Σαρπηδόνα μητίετα Ζεὺς
293 ὦρσεν ἐπ’ Ἀργείοισι λέονθ’ ὡς βουσὶν ἕλιξιν.
294 αὐτίκα δ’ ἀσπίδα μὲν πρόσθ’ ἔσχετο πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην
295 καλὴν χαλκείην ἐξήλατον, ἣν ἄρα χαλκεὺς
296 ἤλασεν, ἔντοσθεν δὲ βοείας ῥάψε θαμειὰς
297 χρυσείῃς ῥάβδοισι διηνεκέσιν περὶ κύκλον.
298 τὴν ἄρ’ ὅ γε πρόσθε σχόμενος δύο δοῦρε τινάσσων
299 βῆ ῥ’ ἴμεν ὥς τε λέων ὀρεσίτροφος, ὅς τ’ ἐπιδευὴς
300 δηρὸν ἔῃ κρειῶν, κέλεται δέ ἑ θυμὸς ἀγήνωρ
Still the Trojans and brave Hektor would not yet have broken down the gates and the great bar, had not Zeus turned his son Sarpedon against the Argives as a lion against a herd of horned cattle. Before him he held his shield of hammered bronze, that the smith had beaten so fair and round, and had lined with ox hides which he had made fast with rivets of gold all round the shield; this he held in front of him, and brandishing his two spears came on like some lion of the wilderness, who has been long famished for want of meat and will dare break even into a well-fenced homestead to try and get at the sheep. He may find the shepherds keeping watch over their flocks with dogs and spears, but he is in no mind to be driven from the fold till he has had a try for it; he will either spring on a sheep and carry it off, or be hit by a spear from strong hand - even so was Sarpedon fain to attack the wall and break down its battlements. Then he said to Glaukos son of Hippolokhos, "Glaukos, why in Lycia do we receive especial honor as regards our place at table? Why are the choicest portions served us and our cups kept brimming, and why do men look up to us as though we were gods? Moreover we hold a large estate by the banks of the river Xanthos, fair with orchard lawns and wheat-growing land; it becomes us, therefore, to take our stand at the head of all the Lycians and bear the brunt of the fight, that one may say to another, Our princes in Lycia eat the fat of the land and drink best of wine, but they are fine men; they fight well and are ever at the front in battle.’ My good friend, if, when we were once out of this fight, we could escape old age and death thenceforward and for ever, I should neither press forward myself nor bid you do so, but death in ten thousand shapes hangs ever over our heads, and no man can elude him; therefore let us go forward and either win glory for ourselves, or yield it to another." Glaukos heeded his saying, and the pair forthwith led on the host of Lycians. Menestheus son of Peteos was dismayed when he saw them, for it was against his part of the wall that they came - bringing destruction with them; he looked along the wall for some chieftain to support his comrades and saw the two Ajaxes, men ever eager for the fray, and Teucer, who had just come from his tent, standing near them; but he could not make his voice heard by shouting to them, so great an uproar was there from crashing shields and helmets and the battering of gates with a din which reached the skies. For all the gates had been closed, and the Trojans were hammering at them to try and break their way through them. Menestheus, therefore, sent Thoötes with a message to Ajax. "Run, good Thoötes," said and call Ajax, or better still bid both come, for it will be all over with us here directly; the leaders of the Lycians are upon us, men who have ever fought desperately heretofore. But if the have too much trouble [ponos] on their hands to let them come, at any rate let Ajax son of Telamon do so, and let Teucer the famous bowman come with him." The messenger did as he was told, and set off running along the wall of the Achaeans. When he reached the Ajaxes he said to them, "Sirs, princes of the Argives, the

son of noble Peteos bids you come to him for a while and help him. You had better both come if you can, or it will be all over with him directly; the leaders of the Lycians are upon him, men who have ever fought desperately heretofore; if you have too much on your hands to let both come, at any rate let Ajax son of Telamon do so, and let Teucer the famous bowman come with him." Great Ajax, son of Telamon, heeded the message, and at once spoke to the son of Oileus. "Ajax," said he, "do you two, yourself and brave Lykomedes, stay here and keep the Danaans in heart to fight their hardest. I will go over yonder, and bear my part in the fray, but I will come back here at once as soon as I have given them the help they need." With this, Ajax son of Telamon set off, and Teucer his brother by the same father went also, with Pandion to carry Teucer's bow. They went along inside the wall, and when they came to the tower where Menestheus was (and hard pressed indeed did they find him) the brave leaders and leaders of the Lycians were storming the battlements as it were a thick dark cloud, fighting in close quarters, and raising the battle-cry aloud. First, Ajax son of Telamon killed brave Epikles, a comrade of Sarpedon, hitting him with a jagged stone that lay by the battlements at the very top of the wall. As men now are, even one who is in the bloom of youth could hardly lift it with his two hands, but Ajax raised it high aloft and flung it down, smashing Epikles' four-crested helmet so that the bones of his head were crushed to pieces, and he fell from the high wall as though he were diving, with no more life left in him. Then Teucer wounded Glaukos the brave son of Hippolokhos as he was coming on to attack the wall. He saw his shoulder bare and aimed an arrow at it, which made Glaukos leave off fighting. Thereon he sprang covertly down for fear some of the Achaeans might see that he was wounded and taunt him. Sarpedon was stung with grief [akhos] when he saw Glaukos leave him, still he did not leave off fighting, but aimed his spear at Alkmaon the son of Thestor and hit him. He drew his spear back again Alkmaon came down headlong after it with his bronzed armor rattling round him. Then Sarpedon seized the battlement in his strong hands, and tugged at it till it an gave way together, and a breach was made through which many might pass. Ajax and Teucer then both of them attacked him. Teucer hit him with an arrow on the band that bore the shield which covered his body, but Zeus saved his son from destruction that he might not fall by the ships' sterns. Meanwhile Ajax sprang on him and pierced his shield, but the spear did not go clean through, though it hustled him back that he could come on no further. He therefore retired a little space from the battlement, yet without losing all his ground, for he still thought to cover himself with glory. Then he turned round and shouted to the brave Lycians saying, "Lycians, why do you thus fail me? For all my prowess I cannot break through the wall and open a way to the ships single-handed. Come close on behind me, for the more there are of us the better."

12.301

μήλων πειρήσοντα καὶ ἐς πυκινὸν δόμον ἐλθεῖν·
εἴ περ γάρ χ’ εὕρῃσι παρ’ αὐτόφι βώτορας ἄνδρας
σὺν κυσὶ καὶ δούρεσσι φυλάσσοντας περὶ μῆλα,
οὔ ῥά τ’ ἀπείρητος μέμονε σταθμοῖο δίεσθαι,
ἀλλ’ ὅ γ’ ἄρ’ ἢ ἥρπαξε μετάλμενος, ἠὲ καὶ αὐτὸς
ἔβλητ’ ἐν πρώτοισι θοῆς ἀπὸ χειρὸς ἄκοντι·
ὣς ῥα τότ’ ἀντίθεον Σαρπηδόνα θυμὸς ἀνῆκε
τεῖχος ἐπαΐξαι διά τε ῥῆξασθαι ἐπάλξεις.
αὐτίκα δὲ Γλαῦκον προσέφη παῖδ’ Ἱππολόχοιο·
Γλαῦκε τί ἢ δὴ νῶϊ τετιμήμεσθα μάλιστα
ἕδρῃ τε κρέασίν τε ἰδὲ πλείοις δεπάεσσιν
ἐν Λυκίῃ, πάντες δὲ θεοὺς ὣς εἰσορόωσι,
καὶ τέμενος νεμόμεσθα μέγα Ξάνθοιο παρ’ ὄχθας

καλὸν φυταλιῆς καὶ ἀρούρης πυροφόροιο;
τὼ νῦν χρὴ Λυκίοισι μέτα πρώτοισιν ἐόντας
ἐστάμεν ἠδὲ μάχης καυστείρης ἀντιβολῆσαι,
ὄφρά τις ὧδ’ εἴπῃ Λυκίων πύκα θωρηκτάων·
οὐ μὰν ἀκλεέες Λυκίην κάτα κοιρανέουσιν
ἡμέτεροι βασιλῆες, ἔδουσί τε πίονα μῆλα
οἶνόν τ’ ἔξαιτον μελιηδέα· ἀλλ’ ἄρα καὶ ἶς
ἐσθλή, ἐπεὶ Λυκίοισι μέτα πρώτοισι μάχονται.
ὦ πέπον εἰ μὲν γὰρ πόλεμον περὶ τόνδε φυγόντε
αἰεὶ δὴ μέλλοιμεν ἀγήρω τ’ ἀθανάτω τε
ἔσσεσθ’, οὔτέ κεν αὐτὸς ἐνὶ πρώτοισι μαχοίμην
οὔτέ κε σὲ στέλλοιμι μάχην ἐς κυδιάνειραν·
νῦν δ’ ἔμπης γὰρ κῆρες ἐφεστᾶσιν θανάτοιο
μυρίαι, ἃς οὐκ ἔστι φυγεῖν βροτὸν οὐδ’ ὑπαλύξαι,
ἴομεν ἠέ τῳ εὖχος ὀρέξομεν ἠέ τις ἡμῖν.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδὲ Γλαῦκος ἀπετράπετ’ οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε·
τὼ δ’ ἰθὺς βήτην Λυκίων μέγα ἔθνος ἄγοντε.

12.331

τοὺς δὲ ἰδὼν ῥίγησ’ υἱὸς Πετεῶο Μενεσθεύς·
τοῦ γὰρ δὴ πρὸς πύργον ἴσαν κακότητα φέροντες.
πάπτηνεν δ’ ἀνὰ πύργον Ἀχαιῶν εἴ τιν’ ἴδοιτο
ἡγεμόνων, ὅς τίς οἱ ἀρὴν ἑτάροισιν ἀμύναι·
ἐς δ’ ἐνόησ’ Αἴαντε δύω πολέμου ἀκορήτω
ἑσταότας, Τεῦκρόν τε νέον κλισίηθεν ἰόντα
ἐγγύθεν· ἀλλ’ οὔ πώς οἱ ἔην βώσαντι γεγωνεῖν·
τόσσος γὰρ κτύπος ἦεν, ἀϋτὴ δ’ οὐρανὸν ἶκε,
βαλλομένων σακέων τε καὶ ἱπποκόμων τρυφαλειῶν
καὶ πυλέων· πᾶσαι γὰρ ἐπώχατο, τοὶ δὲ κατ’ αὐτὰς
ἱστάμενοι πειρῶντο βίῃ ῥήξαντες ἐσελθεῖν.
αἶψα δ’ ἐπ’ Αἴαντα προΐει κήρυκα Θοώτην·
ἔρχεο δῖε Θοῶτα, θέων Αἴαντα κάλεσσον,
ἀμφοτέρω μὲν μᾶλλον· ὃ γάρ κ’ ὄχ’ ἄριστον ἁπάντων
εἴη, ἐπεὶ τάχα τῇδε τετεύξεται αἰπὺς ὄλεθρος.
ὧδε γὰρ ἔβρισαν Λυκίων ἀγοί, οἳ τὸ πάρος περ
ζαχρηεῖς τελέθουσι κατὰ κρατερὰς ὑσμίνας.
εἰ δέ σφιν καὶ κεῖθι πόνος καὶ νεῖκος ὄρωρεν,
ἀλλά περ οἷος ἴτω Τελαμώνιος ἄλκιμος Αἴας,
καί οἱ Τεῦκρος ἅμα σπέσθω τόξων ἐὺ εἰδώς.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἄρα οἱ κῆρυξ ἀπίθησεν ἀκούσας,
βῆ δὲ θέειν παρὰ τεῖχος Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων,
στῆ δὲ παρ’ Αἰάντεσσι κιών, εἶθαρ δὲ προσηύδα·
Αἴαντ’ Ἀργείων ἡγήτορε χαλκοχιτώνων
ἠνώγει Πετεῶο διοτρεφέος φίλος υἱὸς
κεῖσ’ ἴμεν, ὄφρα πόνοιο μίνυνθά περ ἀντιάσητον
ἀμφοτέρω μὲν μᾶλλον· ὃ γάρ κ’ ὄχ’ ἄριστον ἁπάντων
εἴη, ἐπεὶ τάχα κεῖθι τετεύξεται αἰπὺς ὄλεθρος·
ὧδε γὰρ ἔβρισαν Λυκίων ἀγοί, οἳ τὸ πάρος περ
ζαχρηεῖς τελέθουσι κατὰ κρατερὰς ὑσμίνας.

12.361

εἰ δὲ καὶ ἐνθάδε περ πόλεμος καὶ νεῖκος ὄρωρεν,
ἀλλά περ οἷος ἴτω Τελαμώνιος ἄλκιμος Αἴας,
καί οἱ Τεῦκρος ἅμα σπέσθω τόξων ἐὺ εἰδώς.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας.
αὐτίκ’ Ὀϊλιάδην ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Αἶαν σφῶϊ μὲν αὖθι, σὺ καὶ κρατερὸς Λυκομήδης,
ἑσταότες Δαναοὺς ὀτρύνετον ἶφι μάχεσθαι·
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ κεῖσ’ εἶμι καὶ ἀντιόω πολέμοιο·
αἶψα δ’ ἐλεύσομαι αὖτις, ἐπὴν εὖ τοῖς ἐπαμύνω.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἀπέβη Τελαμώνιος Αἴας,
καί οἱ Τεῦκρος ἅμ’ ἦε κασίγνητος καὶ ὄπατρος·
τοῖς δ’ ἅμα Πανδίων Τεύκρου φέρε καμπύλα τόξα.
εὖτε Μενεσθῆος μεγαθύμου πύργον ἵκοντο
τείχεος ἐντὸς ἰόντες, ἐπειγομένοισι δ’ ἵκοντο,
οἳ δ’ ἐπ’ ἐπάλξεις βαῖνον ἐρεμνῇ λαίλαπι ἶσοι
ἴφθιμοι Λυκίων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες·
σὺν δ’ ἐβάλοντο μάχεσθαι ἐναντίον, ὦρτο δ’ ἀϋτή.
Αἴας δὲ πρῶτος Τελαμώνιος ἄνδρα κατέκτα
Σαρπήδοντος ἑταῖρον Ἐπικλῆα μεγάθυμον
μαρμάρῳ ὀκριόεντι βαλών, ὅ ῥα τείχεος ἐντὸς
κεῖτο μέγας παρ’ ἔπαλξιν ὑπέρτατος· οὐδέ κέ μιν ῥέα
χείρεσσ’ ἀμφοτέρῃς ἔχοι ἀνὴρ οὐδὲ μάλ’ ἡβῶν,
οἷοι νῦν βροτοί εἰσ’· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ὑψόθεν ἔμβαλ’ ἀείρας,
θλάσσε δὲ τετράφαλον κυνέην, σὺν δ’ ὀστέ’ ἄραξε
πάντ’ ἄμυδις κεφαλῆς· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ἀρνευτῆρι ἐοικὼς
κάππεσ’ ἀφ’ ὑψηλοῦ πύργου, λίπε δ’ ὀστέα θυμός.
Τεῦκρος δὲ Γλαῦκον κρατερὸν παῖδ’ Ἱππολόχοιο
ἰῷ ἐπεσσύμενον βάλε τείχεος ὑψηλοῖο,
ᾗ ῥ’ ἴδε γυμνωθέντα βραχίονα, παῦσε δὲ χάρμης.
ἂψ δ’ ἀπὸ τείχεος ἆλτο λαθών, ἵνα μή τις Ἀχαιῶν

12.391

βλήμενον ἀθρήσειε καὶ εὐχετόῳτ’ ἐπέεσσι.
Σαρπήδοντι δ’ ἄχος γένετο Γλαύκου ἀπιόντος
αὐτίκ’ ἐπεί τ’ ἐνόησεν· ὅμως δ’ οὐ λήθετο χάρμης,
ἀλλ’ ὅ γε Θεστορίδην Ἀλκμάονα δουρὶ τυχήσας
νύξ’, ἐκ δ’ ἔσπασεν ἔγχος· ὃ δ’ ἐσπόμενος πέσε δουρὶ
πρηνής, ἀμφὶ δέ οἱ βράχε τεύχεα ποικίλα χαλκῷ,
Σαρπηδὼν δ’ ἄρ’ ἔπαλξιν ἐλὼν χερσὶ στιβαρῇσιν
ἕλχ’, ἣ δ’ ἔσπετο πᾶσα διαμπερές, αὐτὰρ ὕπερθε
τεῖχος ἐγυμνώθη, πολέεσσι δὲ θῆκε κέλευθον.
τὸν δ’ Αἴας καὶ Τεῦκρος ὁμαρτήσανθ’ ὃ μὲν ἰῷ
βεβλήκει τελαμῶνα περὶ στήθεσσι φαεινὸν
ἀσπίδος ἀμφιβρότης· ἀλλὰ Ζεὺς κῆρας ἄμυνε
παιδὸς ἑοῦ, μὴ νηυσὶν ἔπι πρύμνῃσι δαμείη·
Αἴας δ’ ἀσπίδα νύξεν ἐπάλμενος, οὐδὲ διὰ πρὸ
ἤλυθεν ἐγχείη, στυφέλιξε δέ μιν μεμαῶτα.
χώρησεν δ’ ἄρα τυτθὸν ἐπάλξιος· οὐδ’ ὅ γε πάμπαν
χάζετ’, ἐπεί οἱ θυμὸς ἐέλπετο κῦδος ἀρέσθαι.
κέκλετο δ’ ἀντιθέοισιν ἑλιξάμενος Λυκίοισιν·

409 ὦ Λύκιοι τί τ’ ἄρ’ ὦδε μεθίετε θούριδος ἀλκῆς;
410 ἀργαλέον δέ μοί ἐστι καὶ ἰφθίμῳ περ ἐόντι
411 μούνῳ ῥηξαμένῳ θέσθαι παρὰ νηυσὶ κέλευθον·
412 ἀλλ’ ἐφομαρτεῖτε· πλεόνων δέ τι ἔργον ἄμεινον.
413 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δὲ ἄνακτος ὑποδείσαντες ὁμοκλὴν
414 μᾶλλον ἐπέβρισαν βουληφόρον ἀμφὶ ἄνακτα.
415 Ἀργεῖοι δ’ ἐτέρωθεν ἐκαρτύναντο φάλαγγας
416 τείχεος ἔντοσθεν, μέγα δέ σφισι φαίνετο ἔργον·
417 οὔτε γὰρ ἴφθιμοι Λύκιοι Δαναῶν ἐδύναντο
418 τεῖχος ῥηξάμενοι θέσθαι παρὰ νηυσὶ κέλευθον,
419 οὔτέ ποτ’ αἰχμηταὶ Δαναοὶ Λυκίους ἐδύναντο
420 τείχεος ἂψ ὤσασθαι, ἐπεὶ τὰ πρῶτα πέλασθεν.
The Lycians, shamed by his rebuke, pressed closer round him who was their counselor their king. The Argives on their part got their men in fighting order within the wall, and there was a deadly struggle between them. The Lycians could not break through the wall and force their way to the ships, nor could the Danaans drive the Lycians from the wall now that they had once reached it. As two men, measuring-rods in hand, quarrel about their boundaries in a field that they own in common, and stickle for their rights though they be but in a mere strip, even so did the battlements now serve as a bone of contention, and they beat one another's round shields for their possession. Many a man's body was wounded with the pitiless bronze, as he turned round and bared his back to the foe, and many were struck clean through their shields; the wall and battlements were everywhere deluged with the blood alike of Trojans and of Achaeans. But even so the Trojans could not rout the Achaeans, who still held on; and as some honest hard-working woman weighs wool in her balance and sees that the scales be true [alêthês], for she would gain some pitiful earnings for her little ones, even so was the fight balanced evenly between them till the time came when Zeus gave the greater glory to Hektor son of Priam, who was first to spring towards the wall of the Achaeans. As he did so, he cried aloud to the Trojans, "Up, Trojans, break the wall of the Argives, and fling fire upon their ships." Thus did he hound them on, and in one body they rushed straight at the wall as he had bidden them, and scaled the battlements with sharp spears in their hands. Hektor laid hold of a stone that lay just outside the gates and was thick at one end but pointed at the other; two of the best men in a district [dêmos], as men now are, could hardly raise it from the ground and put it on to a wagon, but Hektor lifted it quite easily by himself, for the son of scheming Kronos made it light for him. As a shepherd picks up a ram's fleece with one hand and finds it no burden, so easily did Hektor lift the great stone and drive it right at the doors that closed the gates so strong and so firmly set. These doors were double and high, and were kept closed by two cross-bars to which there was but one key. When he had got close up to them, Hektor strode towards them that his blow might gain in force and struck them in the middle, leaning his whole weight against them. He broke both hinges, and the stone fell inside by reason of its great weight. The portals re-echoed with the sound, the bars held no longer, and the doors flew open, one one way, and the other the other, through the force of the blow. Then brave Hektor leaped inside with a face as dark as that of fleeing night. The gleaming bronze flashed fiercely about his body and he had tow spears in his hand. None but a god could have withstood him as he flung himself into the gateway, and his eyes glared like fire. Then he turned round towards the Trojans and called on them to scale the wall, and they did as he bade them - some of them at once climbing over the wall, while others passed through the gates. The Danaans then fled panic-stricken towards their ships, and all was uproar and confusion.

12.421

ἀλλ’ ὥς τ’ ἀμφ’ οὔροισι δύ’ ἀνέρε δηριάασθον
μέτρ’ ἐν χερσὶν ἔχοντες ἐπιξύνῳ ἐν ἀρούρῃ,
ὥ τ’ ὀλίγῳ ἐνὶ χώρῳ ἐρίζητον περὶ ἴσης,
ὣς ἄρα τοὺς διέεργον ἐπάλξιες· οἳ δ’ ὑπὲρ αὐτέων
δῄουν ἀλλήλων ἀμφὶ στήθεσσι βοείας
ἀσπίδας εὐκύκλους λαισήϊά τε πτερόεντα.
πολλοὶ δ’ οὐτάζοντο κατὰ χρόα νηλέϊ χαλκῷ,
ἠμὲν ὅτεῳ στρεφθέντι μετάφρενα γυμνωθείη
μαρναμένων, πολλοὶ δὲ διαμπερὲς ἀσπίδος αὐτῆς.
πάντῃ δὴ πύργοι καὶ ἐπάλξιες αἵματι φωτῶν
ἐρράδατ’ ἀμφοτέρωθεν ἀπὸ Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν.
ἀλλ’ οὐδ’ ὣς ἐδύναντο φόβον ποιῆσαι Ἀχαιῶν,
ἀλλ’ ἔχον ὥς τε τάλαντα γυνὴ χερνῆτις ἀληθής,
ἥ τε σταθμὸν ἔχουσα καὶ εἴριον ἀμφὶς ἀνέλκει
ἰσάζουσ’, ἵνα παισὶν ἀεικέα μισθὸν ἄρηται·
ὣς μὲν τῶν ἐπὶ ἶσα μάχη τέτατο πτόλεμός τε,
πρίν γ’ ὅτε δὴ Ζεὺς κῦδος ὑπέρτερον Ἕκτορι δῶκε
Πριαμίδῃ, ὃς πρῶτος ἐσήλατο τεῖχος Ἀχαιῶν.
ἤϋσεν δὲ διαπρύσιον Τρώεσσι γεγωνώς·
ὄρνυσθ’ ἱππόδαμοι Τρῶες, ῥήγνυσθε δὲ τεῖχος
Ἀργείων καὶ νηυσὶν ἐνίετε θεσπιδαὲς πῦρ.
ὣς φάτ’ ἐποτρύνων, οἳ δ’ οὔασι πάντες ἄκουον,
ἴθυσαν δ’ ἐπὶ τεῖχος ἀολλέες· οἳ μὲν ἔπειτα
κροσσάων ἐπέβαινον ἀκαχμένα δούρατ’ ἔχοντες,
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ἁρπάξας λᾶαν φέρεν, ὅς ῥα πυλάων
ἑστήκει πρόσθε πρυμνὸς παχύς, αὐτὰρ ὕπερθεν
ὀξὺς ἦεν· τὸν δ’ οὔ κε δύ’ ἀνέρε δήμου ἀρίστω
ῥηϊδίως ἐπ’ ἄμαξαν ἀπ’ οὔδεος ὀχλίσσειαν,
οἷοι νῦν βροτοί εἰσ’· ὃ δέ μιν ῥέα πάλλε καὶ οἷος.
τόν οἱ ἐλαφρὸν ἔθηκε Κρόνου πάϊς ἀγκυλομήτεω.

12.451

ὡς δ’ ὅτε ποιμὴν ῥεῖα φέρει πόκον ἄρσενος οἰὸς
χειρὶ λαβὼν ἑτέρῃ, ὀλίγον τέ μιν ἄχθος ἐπείγει,
ὣς Ἕκτωρ ἰθὺς σανίδων φέρε λᾶαν ἀείρας,
αἳ ῥα πύλας εἴρυντο πύκα στιβαρῶς ἀραρυίας
δικλίδας ὑψηλάς· δοιοὶ δ’ ἔντοσθεν ὀχῆες
εἶχον ἐπημοιβοί, μία δὲ κληὶς ἐπαρήρει.
στῆ δὲ μάλ’ ἐγγὺς ἰών, καὶ ἐρεισάμενος βάλε μέσσας
εὖ διαβάς, ἵνα μή οἱ ἀφαυρότερον βέλος εἴη,
ῥῆξε δ’ ἀπ’ ἀμφοτέρους θαιρούς· πέσε δὲ λίθος εἴσω
βριθοσύνῃ, μέγα δ’ ἀμφὶ πύλαι μύκον, οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ὀχῆες
ἐσχεθέτην, σανίδες δὲ διέτμαγεν ἄλλυδις ἄλλη
λᾶος ὑπὸ ῥιπῆς· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ἔσθορε φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
νυκτὶ θοῇ ἀτάλαντος ὑπώπια· λάμπε δὲ χαλκῷ
σμερδαλέῳ, τὸν ἕεστο περὶ χροΐ, δοιὰ δὲ χερσὶ
δοῦρ’ ἔχεν· οὔ κέν τίς μιν ἐρύκακεν ἀντιβολήσας
νόσφι θεῶν ὅτ’ ἐσᾶλτο πύλας· πυρὶ δ’ ὄσσε δεδήει.
κέκλετο δὲ Τρώεσσιν ἐλιξάμενος καθ’ ὅμιλον
τεῖχος ὑπερβαίνειν· τοὶ δ’ ὀτρύνοντι πίθοντο.

469 αὐτίκα δ’ οἳ μὲν τεῖχος ὑπέρβασαν, οἳ δὲ κατ’ αὐτὰς
470 ποιητὰς ἐσέχυντο πύλας· Δαναοὶ δὲ φόβηθεν
471 νῆας ἀνὰ γλαφυράς, ὅμαδος δ’ ἀλίαστος ἐτύχθη.

13.1

1 Ζεὺς δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν Τρῶάς τε καὶ Ἕκτορα νηυσὶ πέλασσε,
2 τοὺς μὲν ἔα παρὰ τῇσι πόνον τ’ ἐχέμεν καὶ ὀϊζὺν
3 νωλεμέως, αὐτὸς δὲ πάλιν τρέπεν ὄσσε φαεινὼ
4 νόσφιν ἐφ’ ἱπποπόλων Θρῃκῶν καθορώμενος αἶαν
5 Μυσῶν τ’ ἀγχεμάχων καὶ ἀγαυῶν ἱππημολγῶν
6 γλακτοφάγων Ἀβίων τε δικαιοτάτων ἀνθρώπων.
7 ἐς Τροίην δ’ οὐ πάμπαν ἔτι τρέπεν ὄσσε φαεινώ·
8 οὐ γὰρ ὅ γ’ ἀθανάτων τινα ἔλπετο ὃν κατὰ θυμὸν
9 ἐλθόντ’ ἢ Τρώεσσιν ἀρηξέμεν ἢ Δαναοῖσιν.
10 οὐδ’ ἀλαοσκοπιὴν εἶχε κρείων ἐνοσίχθων·
11 καὶ γὰρ ὃ θαυμάζων ἧστο πτόλεμόν τε μάχην τε
12 ὑψοῦ ἐπ’ ἀκροτάτης κορυφῆς Σάμου ὑλήεσσης
13 Θρῃϊκίης· ἔνθεν γὰρ ἐφαίνετο πᾶσα μὲν Ἴδη,
14 φαίνετο δὲ Πριάμοιο πόλις καὶ νῆες Ἀχαιῶν.
15 ἔνθ’ ἄρ’ ὅ γ’ ἐξ ἁλὸς ἔζετ’ ἰών, ἐλέαιρε δ’ Ἀχαιοὺς
16 Τρωσὶν δαμναμένους, Διὶ δὲ κρατερῶς ἐνεμέσσα.
17 αὐτίκα δ’ ἐξ ὄρεος κατεβήσετο παιπαλόεντος
18 κραιπνὰ ποσὶ προβιβάς· τρέμε δ’ οὔρεα μακρὰ καὶ ὕλη
19 ποσσὶν ὑπ’ ἀθανάτοισι Ποσειδάωνος ἰόντος.
20 τρὶς μὲν ὀρέξατ’ ἰών, τὸ δὲ τέτρατον ἵκετο τέκμωρ
21 Αἰγάς, ἔνθα δέ οἱ κλυτὰ δώματα βένθεσι λίμνης
22 χρύσεα μαρμαίροντα τετεύχαται ἄφθιτα αἰεί.
23 ἔνθ’ ἐλθὼν ὑπ’ ὄχεσφι τιτύσκετο χαλκόποδ’ ἵππω
24 ὠκυπέτα χρυσέῃσιν ἐθείρῃσιν κομόωντε,
25 χρυσὸν δ’ αὐτὸς ἔδυνε περὶ χροΐ, γέντο δ’ ἱμάσθλην
26 χρυσείην εὔτυκτον, ἐοῦ δ’ ἐπεβήσετο δίφρου,
27 βῆ δ’ ἐλάαν ἐπὶ κύματ’· ἄταλλε δὲ κήτε’ ὑπ’ αὐτοῦ
28 πάντοθεν ἐκ κευθμῶν, οὐδ’ ἠγνοίησεν ἄνακτα·
29 γηθοσύνῃ δὲ θάλασσα διίστατο· τοὶ δὲ πέτοντο
30 ῥίμφα μάλ’, οὐδ’ ὑπένερθε διαίνετο χάλκεος ἄξων·

Now when Zeus had thus brought Hektor and the Trojans to the ships, he left them to their never-ending toil [ponos], and turned his keen eyes away, looking elsewhere towards the horse-breeders of Thrace, the Mysians, fighters at close quarters, the noble Hippemolgoi, who live on milk, and the Abians, the most just [dikaioi] of humankind. He no longer turned so much as a glance towards Troy, for he did not think that any of the immortals would go and help either Trojans or Danaans. But King Poseidon had kept no blind look-out; he had been looking admiringly on the battle from his seat on the topmost crests of wooded Samothrace, whence he could see all Ida, with the city of Priam and the ships of the Achaeans. He had come from under the sea and taken his place here, for he pitied the Achaeans who were being overcome by the Trojans; and he was furiously angry with Zeus. Presently he came down from his post on the mountain top, and as he strode swiftly onwards the high hills and the forest quaked beneath the tread of his immortal feet. Three strides he took, and with the fourth he reached his goal - Aigai, where is his glittering golden palace, imperishable, in the depths of the sea. When he got there, he yoked his fleet brazen-footed steeds with their manes of gold all flying in the wind; he clothed himself in raiment of gold, grasped his gold whip, and took his stand upon his chariot. As he went his

way over the waves the sea-monsters left their lairs, for they knew their lord, and came gamboling round him from every quarter of the deep, while the sea in her gladness opened a path before his chariot. So lightly did the horses fly that the bronze axle of the car was not even wet beneath it; and thus his bounding steeds took him to the ships of the Achaeans. Now there is a certain huge cavern in the depths of the sea midway between Tenedos and rocky Imbros; here Poseidon lord of the earthquake stayed his horses, unyoked them, and set before them their ambrosial forage. He hobbled their feet with hobbles of gold which none could either unloose or break, so that they might stay there in that place until their lord should return. This done he went his way to the host of the Achaeans. Now the Trojans followed Hektor son of Priam in close array like a storm-cloud or flame of fire, fighting with might and main and raising the cry battle; for they deemed that they should take the ships of the Achaeans and kill all their chiefest heroes then and there. Meanwhile earth-encircling Poseidon lord of the earthquake cheered on the Argives, for he had come up out of the sea and had assumed the form and voice of Kalkhas. First he spoke to the two Ajaxes, who were doing their best already, and said, "Ajaxes, you two can be the saving of the Achaeans if you will put out all your strength and not let yourselves be daunted. I am not afraid that the Trojans, who have got over the wall in force, will be victorious in any other part, for the Achaeans can hold all of them in check, but I much fear that some evil will befall us here where furious Hektor, who boasts himself the son of great Zeus himself, is leading them on like a pillar of flame. May some god, then, put it into your hearts to make a firm stand here, and to incite others to do the like. In this case you will drive him from the ships even though he be inspired by Zeus himself." As he spoke the earth-encircling lord of the earthquake struck both of them with his scepter and filled their hearts with daring. He made their legs light and active, as also their hands and their feet. Then, as the soaring falcon poises on the wing high above some sheer rock, and presently swoops down to chase some bird over the plain, even so did Poseidon lord of the earthquake wing his flight into the air and leave them. Of the two, swift Ajax son of Oileus was the first to know who it was that had been speaking with them, and said to Ajax son of Telamon, "Ajax, this is one of the gods that dwell on Olympus, who in the likeness of the seer is bidding us fight hard by our ships. It was not Kalkhas the seer and diviner of omens; I knew him at once by his feet and knees as he turned away, for the gods are soon recognized. Moreover I feel the lust of battle burn more fiercely within me, while my hands and my feet under me are more eager for the fray."

13.31

31 τὸν δ’ ἐς Ἀχαιῶν νῆας ἐΰσκαρθμοι φέρον ἵπποι.
32 ἔστι δέ τι σπέος εὐρὺ βαθείης βένθεσι λίμνης
33 μεσσηγὺς Τενέδοιο καὶ Ἴμβρου παιπαλοέσσης·
34 ἔνθ’ ἵππους ἔστησε Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων
35 λύσας ἐξ ὀχέων, παρὰ δ’ ἀμβρόσιον βάλεν εἶδαρ
36 ἔδμεναι· ἀμφὶ δὲ ποσσὶ πέδας ἔβαλε χρυσείας
37 ἀρρήκτους ἀλύτους, ὄφρ’ ἔμπεδον αὖθι μένοιεν
38 νοστήσαντα ἄνακτα· ὃ δ’ ἐς στρατὸν ᾤχετ’ Ἀχαιῶν.
39 Τρῶες δὲ φλογὶ ἶσοι ἀολλέες ἠὲ θυέλλῃ
40 Ἕκτορι Πριαμίδῃ ἄμοτον μεμαῶτες ἕποντο
41 ἄβρομοι αὐΐαχοι· ἔλποντο δὲ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
42 αἱρήσειν, κτενέειν δὲ παρ’ αὐτόθι πάντας ἀρίστους.
43 ἀλλὰ Ποσειδάων γαιήοχος ἐννοσίγαιος
44 Ἀργείους ὄτρυνε βαθείης ἐξ ἁλὸς ἐλθὼν
45 εἰσάμενος Κάλχαντι δέμας καὶ ἀτειρέα φωνήν·
46 Αἴαντε πρώτω προσέφη μεμαῶτε καὶ αὐτώ·

47 Αἴαντε σφὼ μέν τε σαώσετε λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν
48 ἀλκῆς μνησαμένω, μὴ δὲ κρυεροῖο φόβοιο.
49 ἄλλῃ μὲν γὰρ ἔγωγ’ οὐ δείδια χεῖρας ἀάπτους
50 Τρώων, οἳ μέγα τεῖχος ὑπερκατέβησαν ὁμίλῳ·
51 ἔξουσιν γὰρ πάντας ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοί·
52 τῇ δὲ δὴ αἰνότατον περιδείδια μή τι πάθωμεν,
53 ᾗ ῥ’ ὅ γ’ ὁ λυσσώδης φλογὶ εἴκελος ἡγεμονεύει
54 Ἕκτωρ, ὃς Διὸς εὔχετ’ ἐρισθενέος πάϊς εἶναι.
55 σφῶϊν δ’ ὧδε θεῶν τις ἐνὶ φρεσὶ ποιήσειεν
56 αὐτώ θ’ ἑστάμεναι κρατερῶς καὶ ἀνωγέμεν ἄλλους·
57 τώ κε καὶ ἐσσύμενόν περ ἐρωήσαιτ’ ἀπὸ νηῶν
58 ὠκυπόρων, εἰ καί μιν Ὀλύμπιος αὐτὸς ἐγείρει.
59 ἦ καὶ σκηπανίῳ γαιήοχος ἐννοσίγαιος
60 ἀμφοτέρω κεκοπὼς πλῆσεν μένεος κρατεροῖο,

13.61

61 γυῖα δ’ ἔθηκεν ἐλαφρὰ πόδας καὶ χεῖρας ὕπερθεν.
62 αὐτὸς δ’ ὥς τ’ ἴρηξ ὠκύπτερος ὦρτο πέτεσθαι,
63 ὅς ῥά τ’ ἀπ’ αἰγίλιπος πέτρης περιμήκεος ἀρθεὶς
64 ὀρμήσῃ πεδίοιο διώκειν ὄρνεον ἄλλο,
65 ὣς ἀπὸ τῶν ἇϊξε Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων.
66 τοῖιν δ’ ἔγνω πρόσθεν Ὀϊλῆος ταχὺς Αἴας,
67 αἶψα δ’ ἄρ’ Αἴαντα προσέφη Τελαμώνιον υἱόν·
68 Αἶαν ἐπεί τις νῶϊ θεῶν οἳ Ὄλυμπον ἔχουσι
69 μάντεϊ εἰδόμενος κέλεται παρὰ νηυσὶ μάχεσθαι,
70 οὐδ’ ὅ γε Κάλχας ἐστὶ θεοπρόπος οἰωνιστής·
71 ἴχνια γὰρ μετόπισθε ποδῶν ἠδὲ κνημάων
72 ῥεῖ’ ἔγνων ἀπιόντος· ἀρίγνωτοι δὲ θεοί περ·
73 καὶ δ’ ἐμοὶ αὐτῷ θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι φίλοισι
74 μᾶλλον ἐφορμᾶται πολεμίζειν ἠδὲ μάχεσθαι,
75 μαιμώωσι δ’ ἔνερθε πόδες καὶ χεῖρες ὕπερθε.
76 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη Τελαμώνιος Αἴας·
77 οὕτω νῦν καὶ ἐμοὶ περὶ δούρατι χεῖρες ἄαπτοι
78 μαιμῶσιν, καί μοι μένος ὥρορε, νέρθε δὲ ποσσὶν
79 ἔσσυμαι ἀμφοτέροισι· μενοινώω δὲ καὶ οἷος
80 Ἕκτορι Πριαμίδῃ ἄμοτον μεμαῶτι μάχεσθαι.
81 ὣς οἳ μὲν τοιαῦτα πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἀγόρευον
82 χάρμῃ γηθόσυνοι, τήν σφιν θεὸς ἔμβαλε θυμῷ·
83 τόφρα δὲ τοὺς ὄπιθεν γαιήοχος ὦρσεν Ἀχαιούς,
84 οἳ παρὰ νηυσὶ θοῇσιν ἀνέψυχον φίλον ἦτορ.
85 τῶν ῥ’ ἅμα τ’ ἀργαλέῳ καμάτῳ φίλα γυῖα λέλυντο,
86 καί σφιν ἄχος κατὰ θυμὸν ἐγίγνετο δερκομένοισι
87 Τρῶας, τοὶ μέγα τεῖχος ὑπερκατέβησαν ὁμίλῳ.
88 τοὺς οἵ γ’ εἰσορόωντες ὑπ’ ὀφρύσι δάκρυα λεῖβον·
89 οὐ γὰρ ἔφαν φεύξεσθαι ὑπ’ ἐκ κακοῦ· ἀλλ’ ἐνοσίχθων
90 ῥεῖα μετεισάμενος κρατεὰς ὄτρυνε φάλαγγας.
And Ajax son of Telamon answered, "I too feel my hands grasp my spear more firmly; my strength is greater, and my feet more nimble; I long, moreover, to meet furious Hektor son of Priam, even in single combat." Thus did they converse, exulting in the hunger after battle with which the god had filled them. Meanwhile the earth-encircler roused the Achaeans, who were resting in the rear by the ships overcome at once by hard fighting and by grief

[akhos] at seeing that the Trojans had got over the wall in force. Tears began falling from their eyes as they beheld them, for they made sure that they should not escape destruction; but the lord of the earthquake passed lightly about among them and urged their battalions to the front. First he went up to Teucer and Leitos, the hero Peneleos, and Thoas and Deipyros; Meriones also and Antilokhos, valiant warriors; all did he exhort. "Shame [aidôs] on you young Argives," he cried, "it was on your prowess I relied for the saving of our ships; if you fight not with might and main, this very day will see us overcome by the Trojans. Of a truth my eyes behold a great and terrible portent which I had never thought to see - the Trojans at our ships - they, who were heretofore like panic-stricken hinds, the prey of jackals and wolves in a forest, with no strength but in flight for they cannot defend themselves. Hitherto the Trojans dared not for one moment face the attack of the Achaeans, but now they have sallied far from their city and are fighting at our very ships through the cowardice of our leader and the disaffection of the people themselves, who in their discontent care not to fight in defense of the ships but are being slaughtered near them. True, King Agamemnon son of Atreus is responsible [aitios] for our disaster by having insulted the son of Peleus, still this is no reason why we should leave off fighting. Let us be quick to heal, for the hearts of the brave heal quickly. You do ill to be thus remiss, you, who are the finest warriors in our whole army. I blame no man for keeping out of battle if he is a weakling, but I am indignant with such men as you are. My good friends, matters will soon become even worse through this slackness; think, each one of you, of his own respect [aidôs] and sense of nemesis, for the hazard of the fight is extreme. Great Hektor is now fighting at our ships; he has broken through the gates and the strong bolt that held them." Thus did the earth-encircler address the Achaeans and urge them on. Thereon round the two Ajaxes there gathered strong bands of men, of whom not even Ares nor Athena, marshaler of hosts could make light if they went among them, for they were the picked [krinô] men of all those who were now awaiting the onset of Hektor and the Trojans. They made a living fence, spear to spear, shield to shield, buckler to buckler, helmet to helmet, and man to man. The horse-hair crests on their gleaming helmets touched one another as they nodded forward, so closely locked in battle were they; the spears they brandished in their strong hands were interlaced, and their hearts were set on battle. The Trojans advanced in a dense body, with Hektor at their head pressing right on as a rock that comes thundering down the side of some mountain from whose brow the winter torrents have torn it; the foundations of the dull thing have been loosened by floods of rain, and as it bounds headlong on its way it sets the whole forest in an uproar; it swerves neither to right nor left till it reaches level ground, but then for all its fury it can go no further - even so easily did Hektor for a while seem as though he would career through the tents and ships of the Achaeans till he had reached the sea in his murderous course; but the closely serried battalions stayed him when he reached them, for the sons of the Achaeans thrust at him with swords and spears pointed at both ends, and drove him from them so that he staggered and gave ground; thereon he shouted to the Trojans, "Trojans, Lycians, and Dardanians, fighters in close combat, stand firm: the Achaeans have set themselves as a wall against me, but they will not check me for long; they will give ground before me if the mightiest of the gods, the thundering spouse of Hera, has indeed inspired my onset." With these words he put heart and soul into them all. Deiphobos son of Priam went about among them intent on deeds of daring with his round shield before him, under cover of which he strode quickly forward. Meriones took aim at him with a spear, nor did he fail to hit the broad orb of ox-hide; but he was far from piercing it for the spear broke in two pieces long ere he could do so; moreover Deiphobos had seen it coming and had held his shield well away from him. Meriones drew back under cover of his comrades, angry alike at having failed to vanquish Deiphobos, and having broken his spear. He turned therefore towards the ships and tents to fetch a spear which he had left behind in his tent. The others

continued fighting, and the cry of battle rose up into the heavens. Teucer son of Telamon was the first to kill his man, to wit, the warrior Imbrios son of Mentor rich in horses. Until the Achaeans came he had lived in Pedaeum, and had married Medesikaste a bastard daughter of Priam; but on the arrival of the Danaan fleet he had gone back to Ilion, and was a great man among the Trojans, dwelling near Priam himself, who gave him like honor with his own sons. The son of Telamon now struck him under the ear with a spear which he then drew back again, and Imbrios fell headlong as an ash-tree when it is felled on the crest of some high mountain beacon, and its delicate green foliage comes toppling down to the ground. Thus did he fall with his bronze-equipped armor ringing harshly round him, and Teucer sprang forward with intent to strip him of his armor; but as he was doing so, Hektor took aim at him with a spear. Teucer saw the spear coming and swerved aside, whereon it hit Amphimakhos, son of Kteatos son of Aktor, in the chest as he was coming into battle, and his armor rang rattling round him as he fell heavily to the ground. Hektor sprang forward to take Amphimakhos' helmet from off his temples, and in a moment Ajax threw a spear at him, but did not wound him, for he was encased all over in his terrible armor; nevertheless the spear struck the boss of his shield with such force as to drive him back from the two corpses, which the Achaeans then drew off. Stichios and Menestheus, leaders of the Athenians, bore away Amphimakhos to the host of the Achaeans, while the two brave and impetuous Ajaxes did the like by Imbrios. As two lions snatch a goat from the hounds that have it in their fangs, and bear it through thick brushwood high above the ground in their jaws, thus did the Ajaxes bear aloft the body of Imbrios, and strip it of its armor. Then the son of Oileus severed the head from the neck in revenge for the death of Amphimakhos, and sent it whirling over the crowd as though it had been a ball, till fell in the dust at Hektor's feet.

13.91

91 Τεῦκρον ἔπι πρῶτον καὶ Λήϊτον ἦλθε κελεύων
92 Πηνέλεών θ’ ἥρωα Θόαντά τε Δηΐπυρόν τε
93 Μηριόνην τε καὶ Ἀντίλοχον μήστωρας ἀϋτῆς·
94 τοὺς ὅ γ’ ἐποτρύνων ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
95 αἰδὼς Ἀργεῖοι, κοῦροι νέοι· ὔμμιν ἔγωγε
96 μαρναμένοισι πέποιθα σαωσέμεναι νέας ἀμάς·
97 εἰ δ’ ὑμεῖς πολέμοιο μεθήσετε λευγαλέοιο,
98 νῦν δὴ εἴδεται ἦμαρ ὑπὸ Τρώεσσι δαμῆναι.
99 ὢ πόποι ἦ μέγα θαῦμα τόδ’ ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ὁρῶμαι
100 δεινόν, ὃ οὔ ποτ’ ἔγωγε τελευτήσεσθαι ἔφασκον,
101 Τρῶας ἐφ’ ἡμετέρας ἰέναι νέας, οἳ τὸ πάρος περ
102 φυζακινῇς ἐλάφοισιν ἐοίκεσαν, αἵ τε καθ’ ὕλην
103 θώων παρδαλίων τε λύκων τ’ ἤϊα πέλονται
104 αὔτως ἠλάσκουσαι ἀνάλκιδες, οὐδ’ ἔπι χάρμη·
105 ὣς Τρῶες τὸ πρίν γε μένος καὶ χεῖρας Ἀχαιῶν
106 μίμνειν οὐκ ἐθέλεσκον ἐναντίον, οὐδ’ ἠβαιόν·
107 νῦν δὲ ἑκὰς πόλιος κοίλῃς ἐπὶ νηυσὶ μάχονται
108 ἠγεμόνος κακότητι μεθημοσύνῃσί τε λαῶν,
109 οἳ κείνῳ ἐρίσαντες ἀμυνέμεν οὐκ ἐθέλουσι
110 νηῶν ὠκυπόρων, ἀλλὰ κτείνονται ἀν’ αὐτάς.
111 ἀλλ’ εἰ δὴ καὶ πάμπαν ἐτήτυμον αἴτιός ἐστιν
112 ἥρως Ἀτρεΐδης εὐρὺ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
113 οὕνεκ’ ἀπητίμησε ποδώκεα Πηλεΐωνα,
114 ἡμέας γ’ οὔ πως ἔστι μεθιέμεναι πολέμοιο.
115 ἀλλ’ ἀκεώμεθα θᾶσσον· ἀκεσταί τοι φρένες ἐσθλῶν.

ὑμεῖς δ’ οὐκ ἔτι καλὰ μεθίετε θούριδος ἀλκῆς
πάντες ἄριστοι ἐόντες ἀνὰ στρατόν. οὐδ’ ἂν ἔγωγε
ἀνδρὶ μαχεσσαίμην ὅς τις πολέμοιο μεθείη
λυγρὸς ἐών· ὑμῖν δὲ νεμεσσῶμαι περὶ κῆρι.
ὦ πέπονες τάχα δή τι κακὸν ποιήσετε μεῖζον

13.121

τῇδε μεθημοσύνῃ· ἀλλ’ ἐν φρεσὶ θέσθε ἕκαστος
αἰδῶ καὶ νέμεσιν· δὴ γὰρ μέγα νεῖκος ὄρωρεν.
Ἕκτωρ δὴ παρὰ νηυσὶ βοὴν ἀγαθὸς πολεμίζει
καρτερός, ἔρρηξεν δὲ πύλας καὶ μακρὸν ὀχῆα.
ὣς ῥα κελευτιόων γαιήοχος ὦρσεν Ἀχαιούς.
ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ Αἴαντας δοιοὺς ἵσταντο φάλαγγες
καρτεραί, ἃς οὔτ’ ἄν κεν Ἄρης ὀνόσαιτο μετελθὼν
οὔτε κ’ Ἀθηναίη λαοσσόος· οἳ γὰρ ἄριστοι
κρινθέντες Τρῶάς τε καὶ Ἕκτορα δῖον ἔμιμνον,
φράξαντες δόρυ δουρί, σάκος σάκεϊ προθελύμνῳ·
ἀσπὶς ἄρ’ ἀσπίδ’ ἔρειδε, κόρυς κόρυν, ἀνέρα δ’ ἀνήρ·
ψαῦον δ’ ἱππόκομοι κόρυθες λαμπροῖσι φάλοισι
νευόντων, ὡς πυκνοὶ ἐφέστασαν ἀλλήλοισιν·
ἔγχεα δ’ ἐπτύσσοντο θρασειάων ἀπὸ χειρῶν
σειόμεν’· οἳ δ’ ἰθὺς φρόνεον, μέμασαν δὲ μάχεσθαι.
Τρῶες δὲ προὔτυψαν ἀολλέες, ἦρχε δ’ ἄρ’ Ἕκτωρ
ἀντικρὺ μεμαώς, ὀλοοίτροχος ὡς ἀπὸ πέτρης,
ὅν τε κατὰ στεφάνης ποταμὸς χειμάρροος ὤσῃ
ῥήξας ἀσπέτῳ ὄμβρῳ ἀναιδέος ἔχματα πέτρης·
ὕψι δ’ ἀναθρῴσκων πέτεται, κτυπέει δέ θ’ ὑπ’ αὐτοῦ
ὕλη· ὃ δ’ ἀσφαλέως θέει ἔμπεδον, εἷος ἵκηται
ἰσόπεδον, τότε δ’ οὔ τι κυλίνδεται ἐσσύμενός περ·
ὣς Ἕκτωρ εἷος μὲν ἀπείλει μέχρι θαλάσσης
ῥέα διελεύσεσθαι κλισίας καὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
κτείνων· ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ πυκινῇς ἐνέκυρσε φάλαγξι
στῆ ῥα μάλ’ ἐγχριμφθείς· οἳ δ’ ἀντίοι υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
νύσσοντες ξίφεσίν τε καὶ ἔγχεσιν ἀμφιγύοισιν
ὦσαν ἀπὸ σφείων· ὃ δὲ χασσάμενος πελεμίχθη.
ἤϋσεν δὲ διαπρύσιον Τρώεσσι γεγωνώς·
Τρῶες καὶ Λύκιοι καὶ Δάρδανοι ἀγχιμαχηταὶ

13.151

παρμένετ’· οὔ τοι δηρὸν ἐμὲ σχήσουσιν Ἀχαιοὶ
καὶ μάλα πυργηδὸν σφέας αὐτοὺς ἀρτύναντες,
ἀλλ’ οἵῳ χάσσονται ὑπ’ ἔγχεος, εἰ ἐτεόν με
ὦρσε θεῶν ὥριστος, ἐρίγδουπος πόσις Ἥρης.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε μένος καὶ θυμὸν ἑκάστου.
Δηΐφοβος δ’ ἐν τοῖσι μέγα φρονέων ἐβεβήκει
Πριαμίδης, πρόσθεν δ’ ἔχεν ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην
κοῦφα ποσὶ προβιβὰς καὶ ὑπασπίδια προποδίζων.
Μηριόνης δ’ αὐτοῖο τιτύσκετο δουρὶ φαεινῷ
καὶ βάλεν, οὐδ’ ἀφάμαρτε, κατ’ ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην
ταυρείην· τῆς δ’ οὔ τι διήλασεν, ἀλλὰ πολὺ πρὶν

ἐν καυλῷ ἐάγη δολιχὸν δόρυ· Δηΐφοβος δὲ
ἀσπίδα ταυρείην σχέθ’ ἀπὸ ἕο, δεῖσε δὲ θυμῷ
ἔγχος Μηριόναο δαΐφρονος· αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἥρως
ἂψ ἑτάρων εἰς ἔθνος ἐχάζετο, χώσατο δ’ αἰνῶς
ἀμφότερον, νίκης τε καὶ ἔγχεος ὃ ξυνέαξε.
βῆ δ’ ἰέναι παρά τε κλισίας καὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
οἰσόμενος δόρυ μακρόν, ὅ οἱ κλισίηφι λέλειπτο.
οἳ δ’ ἄλλοι μάρναντο, βοὴ δ’ ἄσβεστος ὀρώρει.
Τεῦκρος δὲ πρῶτος Τελαμώνιος ἄνδρα κατέκτα
Ἴμβριον αἰχμητὴν πολυΐππου Μέντορος υἱόν·
ναῖε δὲ Πήδαιον πρὶν ἐλθεῖν υἷας Ἀχαιῶν,
κούρην δὲ Πριάμοιο νόθην ἔχε, Μηδεσικάστην·
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ Δαναῶν νέες ἦλυθον ἀμφιέλισσαι,
ἂψ ἐς Ἴλιον ἦλθε, μετέπρεπε δὲ Τρώεσσι,
ναῖε δὲ πὰρ Πριάμῳ· ὃ δέ μιν τίεν ἶσα τέκεσσι.
τόν ῥ’ υἱὸς Τελαμῶνος ὑπ’ οὔατος ἔγχεϊ μακρῷ
νύξ’, ἐκ δ’ ἔσπασεν ἔγχος· ὃ δ’ αὖτ’ ἔπεσεν μελίη ὣς
ἤ τ’ ὄρεος κορυφῇ ἔκαθεν περιφαινομένοιο
χαλκῷ ταμνομένη τέρενα χθονὶ φύλλα πελάσσῃ·

13.181

ὣς πέσεν, ἀμφὶ δέ οἱ βράχε τεύχεα ποικίλα χαλκῷ.
Τεῦκρος δ’ ὁρμήθη μεμαὼς ἀπὸ τεύχεα δῦσαι·
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ὁρμηθέντος ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ.
ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν ἄντα ἰδὼν ἠλεύατο χάλκεον ἔγχος
τυτθόν· ὃ δ’ Ἀμφίμαχον Κτεάτου υἷ’ Ἀκτορίωνος
νισόμενον πόλεμον δὲ κατὰ στῆθος βάλε δουρί·
δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, ἀράβησε δὲ τεύχε’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ὁρμήθη κόρυθα κροτάφοις ἀραρυῖαν
κρατὸς ἁφαρπάξαι μεγαλήτορος Ἀμφιμάχοιο·
Αἴας δ’ ὁρμηθέντος ὀρέξατο δουρὶ φαεινῷ
Ἕκτορος· ἀλλ’ οὔ πῃ χροὸς εἴσατο, πᾶς δ’ ἄρα χαλκῷ
σμερδαλέῳ κεκάλυφθ’· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ἀσπίδος ὀμφαλὸν οὗτα,
ὦσε δέ μιν σθένεϊ μεγάλῳ· ὃ δὲ χάσσατ’ ὀπίσσω
νεκρῶν ἀμφοτέρων, τοὺς δ’ ἐξείρυσσαν Ἀχαιοί.
Ἀμφίμαχον μὲν ἄρα Στιχίος δῖός τε Μενεσθεὺς
ἀρχοὶ Ἀθηναίων κόμισαν μετὰ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν·
Ἴμβριον αὖτ’ Αἴαντε μεμαότε θούριδος ἀλκῆς
ὥς τε δύ’ αἶγα λέοντε κυνῶν ὕπο καρχαροδόντων
ἁρπάξαντε φέρητον ἀνὰ ῥωπήϊα πυκνὰ
ὑψοῦ ὑπὲρ γαίης μετὰ γαμφηλῇσιν ἔχοντε,
ὣς ῥα τὸν ὑψοῦ ἔχοντε δύω Αἴαντε κορυστὰ
τεύχεα συλήτην· κεφαλὴν δ’ ἀπαλῆς ἀπὸ δειρῆς
κόψεν Ὀϊλιάδης κεχολωμένος Ἀμφιμάχοιο,
ἦκε δέ μιν σφαιρηδὸν ἑλιξάμενος δι’ ὁμίλου·
Ἕκτορι δὲ προπάροιθε ποδῶν πέσεν ἐν κονίῃσι.
καὶ τότε δὴ περὶ κῆρι Ποσειδάων ἐχολώθη
υἱωνοῖο πεσόντος ἐν αἰνῇ δηϊοτῆτι,
βῆ δ’ ἰέναι παρά τε κλισίας καὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
ὀτρυνέων Δαναούς, Τρώεσσι δὲ κήδεα τεῦχεν.
Ἰδομενεὺς δ’ ἄρα οἱ δουρικλυτὸς ἀντεβόλησεν

Poseidon was exceedingly angry that his grandson Amphimakhos should have fallen; he therefore went to the tents and ships of the Achaeans to urge the Danaans still further, and to devise evil for the Trojans. Idomeneus met him, as he was taking leave of a comrade, who had just come to him from the fight, wounded in the knee. His fellow-warriors bore him off the field, and Idomeneus having given orders to the physicians went on to his tent, for he was still thirsting for battle. Poseidon spoke in the likeness and with the voice of Thoas son of Andraimon who ruled the Aetolians of all Pleuron and high Calydon, and was honored in his district [dêmos] as though he were a god. "Idomeneus," said he, "lawgiver to the Cretans, what has now become of the threats with which the sons of the Achaeans used to threaten the Trojans?" And Idomeneus chief among the Cretans answered, "Thoas, no one, so far as I know, is responsible [aitios], for we can all fight. None are held back neither by fear nor slackness, but it seems to be the of almighty Zeus that the Achaeans should perish ingloriously here far from Argos: you, Thoas, have been always staunch, and you keep others in heart if you see any fail in duty; be not then remiss now, but exhort all to do their utmost." To this Poseidon lord of the earthquake made answer, "Idomeneus, may he never return from Troy, but remain here for dogs to batten upon, who is this day willfully slack in fighting. Get your armor and go, we must make all haste together if we may be of any use, though we are only two. Even cowards gain a sense of striving [aretê] from companionship, and we two can hold our own with the bravest." Therewith the god went back into the thick of the fight [ponos], and Idomeneus when he had reached his tent donned his armor, grasped his two spears, and sallied forth. As the lightning which the son of Kronos brandishes from bright Olympus when he would show a sign [sêma] to mortals, and its gleam flashes far and wide - even so did his armor gleam about him as he ran. Meriones his sturdy squire [therapôn] met him while he was still near his tent (for he was going to fetch his spear) and Idomeneus said "Meriones, fleet son of Molos, best of comrades, why have you left the field? Are you wounded, and is the point of the weapon hurting you? or have you been sent to fetch me? I want no fetching; I had far rather fight than stay in my tent." "Idomeneus," answered Meriones, "I come for a spear, if I can find one in my tent; I have broken the one I had, in throwing it at the shield of Deiphobos." And Idomeneus leader of the Cretans answered, "You will find one spear, or twenty if you so please, standing up against the end wall of my tent. I have taken them from Trojans whom I have killed, for I am not one to keep my enemy at arm's length; therefore I have spears, bossed shields, helmets, and burnished corselets."

13.211

211 ἐρχόμενος παρ’ ἑταίρου, ὅ οἱ νέον ἐκ πολέμοιο
212 ἦλθε κατ’ ἰγνύην βεβλημένος ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ.
213 τὸν μὲν ἑταῖροι ἔνεικαν, ὃ δ’ ἰητροῖς ἐπιτείλας
214 ἤϊεν ἐς κλισίην· ἔτι γὰρ πολέμοιο μενοίνα
215 ἀντιάαν· τὸν δὲ προσέφη κρείων ἐνοσίχθων
216 εἰσάμενος φθογγὴν Ἀνδραίμονος υἷϊ Θόαντι
217 ὃς πάσῃ Πλευρῶνι καὶ αἰπεινῇ Καλυδῶνι
218 Αἰτωλοῖσιν ἄνασσε, θεὸς δ’ ὡς τίετο δήμῳ·
219 Ἰδομενεῦ Κρητῶν βουληφόρε ποῦ τοι ἀπειλαὶ
220 οἴχονται, τὰς Τρωσὶν ἀπείλεον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν;
221 τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ Ἰδομενεὺς Κρητῶν ἀγὸς ἀντίον ηὔδα·
222 ὦ Θόαν οὔ τις ἀνὴρ νῦν γ’ αἴτιος, ὅσσον ἔγωγε
223 γιγνώσκω· πάντες γὰρ ἐπιστάμεθα πτολεμίζειν.
224 οὔτέ τινα δέος ἴσχει ἀκήριον οὔτέ τις ὄκνῳ
225 εἴκων ἀνδύεται πόλεμον κακόν· ἀλλά που οὕτω
226 μέλλει δὴ φίλον εἶναι ὑπερμενέϊ Κρονίωνι

νωνύμνους ἀπολέσθαι ἀπ’ Ἄργεος ἐνθάδ’ Ἀχαιούς.
ἀλλὰ Θόαν, καὶ γὰρ τὸ πάρος μενεδήϊος ἦσθα,
ὀτρύνεις δὲ καὶ ἄλλον ὅθι μεθιέντα ἴδηαι·
τὼ νῦν μήτ’ ἀπόληγε κέλευέ τε φωτὶ ἑκάστῳ.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων·
Ἰδομενεῦ μὴ κεῖνος ἀνὴρ ἔτι νοστήσειεν
ἐκ Τροίης, ἀλλ’ αὖθι κυνῶν μέλπηθρα γένοιτο,
ὅς τις ἐπ’ ἤματι τῷδε ἑκὼν μεθίῃσι μάχεσθαι.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε τεύχεα δεῦρο λαβὼν ἴθι· ταῦτα δ’ ἅμα χρὴ
σπεύδειν, αἴ κ’ ὄφελός τι γενώμεθα καὶ δύ’ ἐόντε.
συμφερτὴ δ’ ἀρετὴ πέλει ἀνδρῶν καὶ μάλα λυγρῶν,
νῶϊ δὲ καί κ’ ἀγαθοῖσιν ἐπισταίμεσθα μάχεσθαι.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὃ μὲν αὖτις ἔβη θεὸς ἂμ πόνον ἀνδρῶν·
Ἰδομενεὺς δ’ ὅτε δὴ κλισίην εὖτυκτον ἵκανε

13.241

δύσετο τεύχεα καλὰ περὶ χροΐ, γέντο δὲ δοῦρε,
βῆ δ’ ἴμεν ἀστεροπῇ ἐναλίγκιος, ἥν τε Κρονίων
χειρὶ λαβὼν ἐτίναξεν ἀπ’ αἰγλήεντος Ὀλύμπου
δεικνὺς σῆμα βροτοῖσιν· ἀρίζηλοι δέ οἱ αὐγαί·
ὣς τοῦ χαλκὸς ἔλαμπε περὶ στήθεσσι θέοντος.
Μηριόνης δ’ ἄρα οἱ θεράπων ἐὺς ἀντεβόλησεν
ἐγγὺς ἔτι κλισίης· μετὰ γὰρ δόρυ χάλκεον ᾔει
οἰσόμενος· τὸν δὲ προσέφη σθένος Ἰδομενῆος·
Μηριόνη Μόλου υἱὲ πόδας ταχὺ φίλταθ’ ἑταίρων
τίπτ’ ἦλθες πόλεμόν τε λιπὼν καὶ δηϊοτῆτα;
ἦέ τι βέβληαι, βέλεος δέ σε τείρει ἀκωκή,
ἦέ τευ ἀγγελίης μετ’ ἔμ’ ἦλυθες; οὐδέ τοι αὐτὸς
ἧσθαι ἐνὶ κλισίῃσι λιλαίομαι, ἀλλὰ μάχεσθαι.
τὸν δ’ αὖ Μηριόνης πεπνυμένος ἀντίον ηὔδα·
Ἰδομενεῦ, Κρητῶν βουληφόρε χαλκοχιτώνων,
ἔρχομαι εἴ τί τοι ἔγχος ἐνὶ κλισίῃσι λέλειπται
οἰσόμενος· τό νυ γὰρ κατεάξαμεν ὃ πρὶν ἔχεσκον
ἀσπίδα Δηϊφόβοιο βαλὼν ὑπερηνορέοντος.
τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ Ἰδομενεὺς Κρητῶν ἀγὸς ἀντίον ηὔδα·
δούρατα δ’ αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσθα καὶ ἓν καὶ εἴκοσι δήεις
ἑσταότ’ ἐν κλισίῃ πρὸς ἐνώπια παμφανόωντα
Τρώϊα, τὰ κταμένων ἀποαίνυμαι· οὐ γὰρ ὀΐω
ἀνδρῶν δυσμενέων ἐκὰς ἱστάμενος πολεμίζειν.
τώ μοι δούρατά τ’ ἔστι καὶ ἀσπίδες ὀμφαλόεσσαι
καὶ κόρυθες καὶ θώρηκες λαμπρὸν γανόωντες.
τὸν δ’ αὖ Μηριόνης πεπνυμένος ἀντίον ηὔδα·
καί τοι ἐμοὶ παρά τε κλισίῃ καὶ νηῒ μελαίνῃ
πόλλ’ ἔναρα Τρώων· ἀλλ’ οὐ σχεδόν ἐστιν ἑλέσθαι.
οὐδὲ γὰρ οὐδ’ ἐμέ φημι λελασμένον ἔμμεναι ἀλκῆς,
ἀλλὰ μετὰ πρώτοισι μάχην ἀνὰ κυδιάνειραν

Then Meriones said, "I too in my tent and at my ship have spoils taken from the Trojans, but they are not at hand. I have been at all times valorous, and wherever there has been hard fighting have held my own among the foremost. There may be those among the Achaeans who do not know how I fight, but you know it well enough yourself." Idomeneus answered, "I know you for a man of excellence [aretê]: you need not tell me. If the best men at the

ships were being chosen to go on an ambush- and there is nothing like this for showing what a man is made of; it comes out then who is cowardly and who has a sense of striving [aretê]; the coward will change color at every touch and turn; he is full of fears, and keeps shifting his weight first on one knee and then on the other; his heart beats fast as he thinks of death, and one can hear the chattering of his teeth; whereas the brave man will not change color nor be on finding himself in ambush, but is all the time longing to go into action - if the best men were being chosen for such a service, no one could make light of your courage nor feats of arms. If you were struck by a dart or smitten in close combat, it would not be from behind, in your neck nor back, but the weapon would hit you in the chest or belly as you were pressing forward to a place in the front ranks. But let us no longer stay here talking like children, lest we be ill spoken of; go, fetch your spear from the tent at once." On this Meriones, peer of Ares, went to the tent and got himself a spear of bronze. He then followed after Idomeneus, big with great deeds of valor. As when baneful Ares sallies forth to battle, and his son Panic so strong and dauntless goes with him, to strike terror even into the heart of a hero - the pair have gone from Thrace to arm themselves among the Ephyroi or the brave Phlegyans, but they will not listen to both the contending hosts, and will give victory to one side or to the other - even so did Meriones and Idomeneus, leaders of men, go out to battle clad in their bronze armor. Meriones was first to speak. "Son of Deukalion," said he, "where would you have us begin fighting? On the right wing of the host, in the center, or on the left wing, where I take it the Achaeans will be weakest?" Idomeneus answered, "There are others to defend the center - the two Ajaxes and Teucer, who is the finest archer of all the Achaeans, and is good also in a hand-to-hand fight. These will give Hektor son of Priam enough to do; fight as he may, he will find it hard to vanquish their indomitable fury, and fire the ships, unless the son of Kronos fling a firebrand upon them with his own hand. Great Ajax son of Telamon will yield to no man who is in mortal mold and eats the grain of Demeter , if bronze and great stones can overthrow him. He would not yield even to Achilles in hand-to-hand fight, and in fleetness of foot there is none to beat him; let us turn therefore towards the left wing, that we may know forthwith whether we are to give glory to some other, or he to us." Meriones, peer of fleet Ares, then led the way till they came to the part of the host which Idomeneus had named. Now when the Trojans saw Idomeneus coming on like a flame of fire, him and his squire [therapôn] clad in their richly wrought armor, they shouted and made towards him all in a body, and a furious hand-to-hand fight raged under the ships' sterns. Fierce as the shrill winds that whistle upon a day when dust lies deep on the roads, and the gusts raise it into a thick cloud - even such was the fury of the combat, and might and main did they hack at each other with spear and sword throughout the host. The field bristled with the long and deadly spears which they bore. Dazzling was the sheen of their gleaming helmets, their fresh-burnished breastplates, and glittering shields as they joined battle with one another. Iron indeed must be his courage who could take pleasure in the sight of such a turmoil [ponos], and look on it without being dismayed. Thus did the two mighty sons of Kronos devise evil for mortal heroes. Zeus was minded to give victory to the Trojans and to Hektor, so as to do honor to fleet Achilles, nevertheless he did not mean to utterly overthrow the Achaean host before Ilion, and only wanted to glorify Thetis and her valiant son. Poseidon on the other hand went about among the Argives to incite them, having come up from the gray sea in secret, for he was grieved at seeing them vanquished by the Trojans, and was furiously angry with Zeus. Both were of the same race and country, but Zeus was elder born and knew more, therefore Poseidon feared to defend the Argives openly, but in the likeness of man, he kept on encouraging them throughout their host. Thus, then, did these two devise a knot of war and battle, that none could unloose or break, and set both sides tugging at it, to the failing of men's knees beneath them.

13.271

ἵσταμαι, ὁππότε νεῖκος ὀρώρηται πολέμοιο.
ἄλλόν πού τινα μᾶλλον Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων
λήθω μαρνάμενος, σὲ δὲ ἴδμεναι αὐτὸν ὀΐω.
τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ Ἰδομενεὺς Κρητῶν ἀγὸς ἀντίον ηὔδα·
οἶδ’ ἀρετὴν οἷός ἐσσι· τί σε χρὴ ταῦτα λέγεσθαι;
εἰ γὰρ νῦν παρὰ νηυσὶ λεγοίμεθα πάντες ἄριστοι
ἐς λόχον, ἔνθα μάλιστ’ ἀρετὴ διαείδεται ἀνδρῶν,
ἔνθ’ ὅ τε δειλὸς ἀνὴρ ὅς τ’ ἄλκιμος ἐξεφαάνθη·
τοῦ μὲν γάρ τε κακοῦ τρέπεται χρὼς ἄλλυδις ἄλλῃ,
οὐδέ οἱ ἀτρέμας ἧσθαι ἐρητύετ’ ἐν φρεσὶ θυμός,
ἀλλὰ μετοκλάζει καὶ ἐπ’ ἀμφοτέρους πόδας ἵζει,
ἐν δέ τέ οἱ κραδίη μεγάλα στέρνοισι πατάσσει
κῆρας ὀϊομένῳ, πάταγος δέ τε γίγνετ’ ὀδόντων·
τοῦ δ’ ἀγαθοῦ οὔτ’ ἂρ τρέπεται χρὼς οὔτέ τι λίην
ταρβεῖ, ἐπειδὰν πρῶτον ἐσίζηται λόχον ἀνδρῶν,
ἀρᾶται δὲ τάχιστα μιγήμεναι ἐν δαὶ λυγρῇ·
οὐδέ κεν ἔνθα τεόν γε μένος καὶ χεῖρας ὄνοιτο.
εἴ περ γάρ κε βλεῖο πονεύμενος ἠὲ τυπείης
οὐκ ἂν ἐν αὐχέν’ ὄπισθε πέσοι βέλος οὐδ’ ἐνὶ νώτῳ,
ἀλλά κεν ἢ στέρνων ἢ νηδύος ἀντιάσειε
πρόσσω ἰεμένοιο μετὰ προμάχων ὀαριστύν.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε μηκέτι ταῦτα λεγώμεθα νηπύτιοι ὣς
ἐσταότες, μή πού τις ὑπερφιάλως νεμεσήσῃ·
ἀλλὰ σύ γε κλισίην δὲ κιὼν ἕλευ ὄβριμον ἔγχος.
ὣς φάτο, Μηριόνης δὲ θοῷ ἀτάλαντος Ἀρηϊ
καρπαλίμως κλισίηθεν ἀνείλετο χάλκεον ἔγχος,
βῆ δὲ μετ’ Ἰδομενῆα μέγα πτολέμοιο μεμηλώς.
οἷος δὲ βροτολοιγὸς Ἄρης πόλεμον δὲ μέτεισι,
τῷ δὲ Φόβος φίλος υἱὸς ἅμα κρατερὸς καὶ ἀταρβὴς
ἕσπετο, ὅς τ’ ἐφόβησε ταλάφρονά περ πολεμιστήν·

13.301

τὼ μὲν ἄρ’ ἐκ Θρῄκης Ἐφύρους μέτα θωρήσσεσθον,
ἠὲ μετὰ Φλεγύας μεγαλήτορας· οὐδ’ ἄρα τώ γε
ἔκλυον ἀμφοτέρων, ἑτέροισι δὲ κῦδος ἔδωκαν·
τοῖοι Μηριόνης τε καὶ Ἰδομενεὺς ἀγοὶ ἀνδρῶν
ἤϊσαν ἐς πόλεμον κεκορυθμένοι αἴθοπι χαλκῷ.
τὸν καὶ Μηριόνης πρότερος πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπε·
Δευκαλίδη πῇ τὰρ μέμονας καταδῦναι ὅμιλον;
ἢ ἐπὶ δεξιόφιν παντὸς στρατοῦ, ἦ ἀνὰ μέσσους,
ἦ ἐπ’ ἀριστερόφιν; ἐπεὶ οὔ ποθι ἔλπομαι οὕτω
δεύεσθαι πολέμοιο κάρη κομόωντας Ἀχαιούς.
τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ Ἰδομενεὺς Κρητῶν ἀγὸς ἀντίον ηὔδα·
νηυσὶ μὲν ἐν μέσσῃσιν ἀμύνειν εἰσὶ καὶ ἄλλοι
Αἴαντές τε δύω Τεῦκρός θ’, ὃς ἄριστος Ἀχαιῶν
τοξοσύνῃ, ἀγαθὸς δὲ καὶ ἐν σταδίῃ ὑσμίνῃ·
οἵ μιν ἄδην ἐλόωσι καὶ ἐσσύμενον πολέμοιο
Ἕκτορα Πριαμίδην, καὶ εἰ μάλα καρτερός ἐστιν.
αἰπύ οἱ ἐσσεῖται μάλα περ μεμαῶτι μάχεσθαι
κείνων νικήσαντι μένος καὶ χεῖρας ἀάπτους

νῆας ἐνιπρῆσαι, ὅτε μὴ αὐτός γε Κρονίων
ἐμβάλοι αἰθόμενον δαλὸν νήεσσι θοῇσιν.
ἀνδρὶ δέ κ’ οὐκ εἴξειε μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας,
ὃς θνητός τ’ εἴη καὶ ἔδοι Δημήτερος ἀκτὴν
χαλκῷ τε ῥηκτὸς μεγάλοισί τε χερμαδίοισιν.
οὐδ’ ἂν Ἀχιλλῆϊ ῥηξήνορι χωρήσειεν
ἔν γ’ αὐτοσταδίῃ· ποσὶ δ’ οὔ πως ἔστιν ἐρίζειν.
νῶϊν δ’ ὧδ’ ἐπ’ ἀριστέρ’ ἔχε στρατοῦ, ὄφρα τάχιστα
εἴδομεν ἠέ τῳ εὖχος ὀρέξομεν, ἦέ τις ἡμῖν.
ὣς φάτο, Μηριόνης δὲ θοῷ ἀτάλαντος Ἄρηϊ
ἦρχ’ ἴμεν, ὄφρ’ ἀφίκοντο κατὰ στρατὸν ᾗ μιν ἀνώγει,
οἳ δ’ ὡς Ἰδομενῆα ἴδον φλογὶ εἴκελον ἀλκὴν

13.331

αὐτὸν καὶ θεράποντα σὺν ἔντεσι δαιδαλέοισι,
κεκλόμενοι καθ’ ὅμιλον ἐπ’ αὐτῷ πάντες ἔβησαν·
τῶν δ’ ὁμὸν ἵστατο νεῖκος ἐπὶ πρυμνῇσι νέεσσιν.
ὡς δ’ ὅθ’ ὑπὸ λιγέων ἀνέμων σπέρχωσιν ἄελλαι
ἤματι τῷ ὅτε τε πλείστη κόνις ἀμφὶ κελεύθους,
οἵ τ’ ἄμυδις κονίης μεγάλην ἱστᾶσιν ὀμίχλην,
ὣς ἄρα τῶν ὁμόσ’ ἦλθε μάχη, μέμασαν δ’ ἐνὶ θυμῷ
ἀλλήλους καθ’ ὅμιλον ἐναιρέμεν ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ.
ἔφριξεν δὲ μάχη φθισίμβροτος ἐγχείῃσι
μακρῇς, ἃς εἶχον ταμεσίχροας· ὄσσε δ’ ἄμερδεν
αὐγὴ χαλκείη κορύθων ἄπο λαμπομενάων
θωρήκων τε νεοσμήκτων σακέων τε φαεινῶν
ἐρχομένων ἄμυδις· μάλα κεν θρασυκάρδιος εἴη
ὃς τότε γηθήσειεν ἰδὼν πόνον οὐδ’ ἀκάχοιτο.
τὼ δ’ ἀμφὶς φρονέοντε δύω Κρόνου υἷε κραταιὼ
ἀνδράσιν ἠρώεσσιν ἐτεύχετον ἄλγεα λυγρά.
Ζεὺς μέν ῥα Τρώεσσι καὶ Ἕκτορι βούλετο νίκην
κυδαίνων Ἀχιλῆα πόδας ταχύν· οὐδέ τι πάμπαν
ἤθελε λαὸν ὀλέσθαι Ἀχαιϊκὸν Ἰλιόθι πρό,
ἀλλὰ Θέτιν κύδαινε καὶ υἱέα καρτερόθυμον.
Ἀργείους δὲ Ποσειδάων ὀρόθυνε μετελθὼν
λάθρῃ ὑπεξαναδὺς πολιῆς ἁλός· ἤχθετο γάρ ῥα
Τρωσὶν δαμναμένους, Διὶ δὲ κρατερῶς ἐνεμέσσα.
ἦ μὰν ἀμφοτέροισιν ὁμὸν γένος ἠδ’ ἴα πάτρη,
ἀλλὰ Ζεὺς πρότερος γεγόνει καὶ πλείονα ᾔδη.
τώ ῥα καὶ ἀμφαδίην μὲν ἀλεξέμεναι ἀλέεινε,
λάθρῃ δ’ αἰὲν ἔγειρε κατὰ στρατὸν ἀνδρὶ ἐοικώς.
τοὶ δ’ ἔριδος κρατερῆς καὶ ὁμοιΐου πτολέμοιο
πεῖραρ ἐπαλλάξαντες ἐπ’ ἀμφοτέροισι τάνυσσαν
ἄρρηκτόν τ’ ἄλυτόν τε, τὸ πολλῶν γούνατ’ ἔλυσεν.

13.361

ἔνθα μεσαιπόλιός περ ἐὼν Δαναοῖσι κελεύσας
Ἰδομενεὺς Τρώεσσι μετάλμενος ἐν φόβον ὦρσε.
πέφνε γὰρ Ὀθρυονῆα Καβησόθεν ἔνδον ἐόντα,
ὅς ῥα νέον πολέμοιο μετὰ κλέος εἰληλούθει,

365 ᾗτεε δὲ Πριάμοιο θυγατρῶν εἶδος ἀρίστην
366 Κασσάνδρην ἀνάεδνον, ὑπέσχετο δὲ μέγα ἔργον,
367 ἐκ Τροίης ἀέκοντας ἀπωσέμεν υἷας Ἀχαιῶν.
368 τῷ δ’ ὁ γέρων Πρίαμος ὑπό τ’ ἔσχετο καὶ κατένευσε
369 δωσέμεναι· ὃ δὲ μάρναθ’ ὑποσχεσίῃσι πιθήσας.
370 Ἰδομενεὺς δ’ αὐτοῖο τιτύσκετο δουρὶ φαεινῷ,
371 καὶ βάλεν ὕψι βιβάντα τυχών· οὐδ’ ἄρκεσε θώρηξ
372 χάλκεος, ὃν φορέεσκε, μέσῃ δ’ ἐν γαστέρι πῆξε.
373 δούπησεν δὲ πεσών· ὃ δ’ ἐπεύξατο φώνησέν τε·
374 Ὀθρυονεῦ περὶ δή σε βροτῶν αἰνίζομ’ ἁπάντων
375 εἰ ἐτεὸν δὴ πάντα τελευτήσεις ὅσ’ ὑπέστης
376 Δαρδανίδῃ Πριάμῳ· ὃ δ’ ὑπέσχετο θυγατέρα ἧν.
377 καί κέ τοι ἡμεῖς ταῦτά γ’ ὑποσχόμενοι τελέσαιμεν,
378 δοῖμεν δ’ Ἀτρεΐδαο θυγατρῶν εἶδος ἀρίστην
379 Ἄργεος ἐξαγαγόντες ὀπυιέμεν, εἴ κε σὺν ἄμμιν
380 Ἰλίου ἐκπέρσῃς εὖ ναιόμενον πτολίεθρον.
381 ἀλλ’ ἔπε’, ὄφρ’ ἐπὶ νηυσὶ συνώμεθα ποντοπόροισιν
382 ἀμφὶ γάμῳ, ἐπεὶ οὔ τοι ἐεδνωταὶ κακοί εἰμεν.
383 ὣς εἰπὼν ποδὸς ἕλκε κατὰ κρατερὴν ὑσμίνην
384 ἥρως Ἰδομενεύς· τῷ δ’ Ἄσιος ἦλθ’ ἐπαμύντωρ
385 πεζὸς πρόσθ’ ἵππων· τὼ δὲ πνείοντε κατ’ ὤμων
386 αἰὲν ἔχ’ ἡνίοχος θεράπων· ὃ δὲ ἵετο θυμῷ
387 Ἰδομενῆα βαλεῖν· ὃ δέ μιν φθάμενος βάλε δουρὶ
388 λαιμὸν ὑπ’ ἀνθερεῶνα, διὰ πρὸ δὲ χαλκὸν ἔλασσεν.
389 ἤριπε δ’ ὡς ὅτε τις δρῦς ἤριπεν ἢ ἀχερωΐς
390 ἠὲ πίτυς βλωθρή, τήν τ’ οὔρεσι τέκτονες ἄνδρες

And now Idomeneus, though his hair was already flecked with gray, called loud on the Danaans and spread panic among the Trojans as he leaped in among them. He slew Othryoneus from Cabesus, a sojourner, who had but lately come to take part in the kleos of the war. He sought Cassandra the fairest of Priam's daughters in marriage, but offered no gifts of wooing, for he promised a great thing, to wit, that he would drive the sons of the Achaeans, like it or not, from Troy; old King Priam had given his consent and promised her to him, whereon he fought on the strength of the promises thus made to him. Idomeneus aimed a spear, and hit him as he came striding on. His cuirass of bronze did not protect him, and the spear stuck in his belly, so that he fell heavily to the ground. Then Idomeneus vaunted over him saying, "Othryoneus, there is no one in the world whom I shall admire more than I do you, if you indeed perform what you have promised Priam son of Dardanos in return for his daughter. We too will make you an offer; we will give you the loveliest daughter of the son of Atreus, and will bring her from Argos for you to marry, if you will sack the goodly city of Ilion in company with ourselves; so come along with me, that we may make a covenant at the ships about the marriage, and we will not be hard upon you about gifts of wooing." With this Idomeneus began dragging him by the foot through the thick of the fight, but Asios came up to protect the body, on foot, in front of his horses which his esquire [therapôn] drove so close behind him that he could feel their ‘breath upon his shoulder. He was longing to strike down Idomeneus, but ere he could do so Idomeneus smote him with his spear in the throat under the chin, and the bronze point went clean through it. He fell as an oak, or poplar, or pine which shipwrights have felled for ship's timber upon the mountains with whetted axes- even thus did he lie full length in front of his chariot and horses, grinding his teeth and clutching at the bloodstained just. His charioteer was struck with panic and did not dare turn his horses round and escape: thereupon Antilokhos hit him in the middle of his body with a spear; his cuirass of bronze did not

protect him, and the spear stuck in his belly. He fell gasping from his chariot and Antilokhos great Nestor's son, drove his horses from the Trojans to the Achaeans. Deiphobos then came close up to Idomeneus to avenge Asios, and took aim at him with a spear, but Idomeneus was on the look-out and avoided it, for he was covered by the round shield he always bore - a shield of oxhide and bronze with two arm-rods on the inside. He crouched under cover of this, and the spear flew over him, but the shield rang out as the spear grazed it, and the weapon sped not in vain from the strong hand of Deiphobos, for it struck Hypsenor son of Hippasus, shepherd of his people, in the liver under the midriff, and his limbs failed beneath him. Deiphobos vaunted over him and cried with a loud voice saying, "Of a truth Asios has not fallen unavenged; he will be glad even while passing into the house of Hades, strong warden of the gate, that I have sent some one to escort him." Thus did he vaunt, and the Argives were stung with grief [akhos] over what he said. Noble Antilokhos was more angry than any one, but grief did not make him forget his friend and comrade. He ran up to him, bestrode him, and covered him with his shield; then two of his staunch comrades, Mekisteus son of Echios, and Alastor stooped down, and bore him away groaning heavily to the ships. But Idomeneus ceased not his fury. He kept on striving continually either to enshroud some Trojan in the darkness of death, or himself to fall while warding off the evil day from the Achaeans. Then fell Alkathoos son of noble Aisyetes: he was son-in-law to Anchises, having married his eldest daughter Hippodameia who was the darling of her father and mother, and excelled all her generation in beauty, accomplishments, and understanding, wherefore the bravest man in all Troy had taken her to wife - him did Poseidon lay low by the hand of Idomeneus, blinding his bright eyes and binding his strong limbs in fetters so that he could neither go back nor to one side, but stood stock still like pillar or lofty tree when Idomeneus struck him with a spear in the middle of his chest. The coat of mail that had hitherto protected his body was now broken, and rang harshly as the spear tore through it. He fell heavily to the ground, and the spear stuck in his heart, which still beat, and made the butt-end of the spear quiver till dread Ares put an end to his life. Idomeneus vaunted over him and cried with a loud voice saying, "Deiphobos, since you are in a mood to vaunt, shall we cry quits now that we have killed three men to your one? Nay, sir, stand in fight with me yourself, that you may learn what manner of Zeus-begotten man am I that have come hither. Zeus first begot Minos chief ruler in Crete, and Minos in his turn begot a son, noble Deukalion; Deukalion begot me to be a ruler over many men in Crete, and my ships have now brought me hither, to be the bane of yourself, your father, and the Trojans." Thus did he speak, and Deiphobos was in two minds, whether to go back and fetch some other Trojan to help him, or to take up the challenge single-handed. In the end, he deemed it best to go and fetch Aeneas, whom he found standing in the rear, for he had long been aggrieved with Priam because in spite his brave deeds he did not give him his due share of honor. Deiphobos went up to him and said, "Aeneas, prince among the Trojans, if you know any ties of kinship, help me now to defend the body of your sister's husband; come with me to the rescue of Alkathoos, who being husband to your sister brought you up when you were a child in his house, and now Idomeneus has slain him." With these words he moved the heart of Aeneas, and he went in pursuit of Idomeneus, big with great deeds of valor; but Idomeneus was not to be thus daunted as though he were a mere child; he held his ground as a wild boar at bay upon the mountains, who abides the coming of a great crowd of men in some lonely place - the bristles stand upright on his back, his eyes flash fire, and he whets his tusks in his eagerness to defend himself against hounds and men - even so did famed Idomeneus hold his ground and budge not at the coming of Aeneas. He cried aloud to his comrades looking towards Askalaphos, Aphareus, Deipyros, Meriones, and Antilokhos, all of them brave warriors- "Hither my friends," he cried, "and leave me not single-handed - I go in great fear by fleet Aeneas, who is coming against me, and is a redoubtable dispenser of death battle.

Moreover he is in the flower of youth when a man's strength is greatest; if I was of the same age as he is and in my present mind, either he or I should soon bear away the prize of victory

13.391

ἐξέταμον πελέκεσσι νεήκεσι νήϊον εἶναι·
ὣς ὃ πρόσθ’ ἵππων καὶ δίφρου κεῖτο τανυσθεὶς
βεβρυχὼς κόνιος δεδραγμένος αἱματοέσσης.
ἐκ δέ οἱ ἡνίοχος πλήγη φρένας ἂς πάρος εἶχεν,
οὐδ’ ὅ γ’ ἐτόλμησεν δηΐων ὑπὸ χεῖρας ἀλύξας
ἂψ ἵππους στρέψαι, τὸν δ’ Ἀντίλοχος μενεχάρμης
δουρὶ μέσον περόνησε τυχών· οὐδ’ ἤρκεσε θώρηξ
χάλκεος ὃν φορέεσκε, μέσῃ δ’ ἐν γαστέρι πῆξεν.
αὐτὰρ ὃ ἀσθμαίνων εὐεργέος ἔκπεσε δίφρου,
ἵππους δ’ Ἀντίλοχος μεγαθύμου Νέστορος υἱὸς
ἐξέλασε Τρώων μετ’ ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιούς.
Δηΐφοβος δὲ μάλα σχεδὸν ἦλυθεν Ἰδομενῆος
Ἀσίου ἀχνύμενος, καὶ ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ.
ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν ἄντα ἰδὼν ἠλεύατο χάλκεον ἔγχος
Ἰδομενεύς· κρύφθη γὰρ ὑπ’ ἀσπίδι πάντοσ’ ἐΐσῃ,
τὴν ἄρ’ ὅ γε ῥινοῖσι βοῶν καὶ νώροπι χαλκῷ
δινωτὴν φορέεσκε, δύω κανόνεσσ’ ἀραρυῖαν·
τῇ ὕπο πᾶς ἐάλη, τὸ δ’ ὑπέρπτατο χάλκεον ἔγχος,
καρφαλέον δέ οἱ ἀσπὶς ἐπιθρέξαντος ἄϋσεν
ἔγχεος· οὐδ’ ἄλιόν ῥα βαρείης χειρὸς ἀφῆκεν,
ἀλλ’ ἔβαλ’ Ἱππασίδην Ὑψήνορα ποιμένα λαῶν
ἦπαρ ὑπὸ πραπίδων, εἶθαρ δ’ ὑπὸ γούνατ’ ἔλυσε.
Δηΐφοβος δ’ ἔκπαγλον ἐπεύξατο μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
οὐ μὰν αὖτ’ ἄτιτος κεῖτ’ Ἄσιος, ἀλλά ἑ φημι
εἰς Ἄϊδός περ ἰόντα πυλάρταο κρατεροῖο
γηθήσειν κατὰ θυμόν, ἐπεί ῥά οἱ ὤπασα πομπόν.
ὣς ἔφατ’, Ἀργείοισι δ’ ἄχος γένετ’ εὐξαμένοιο,
Ἀντιλόχῳ δὲ μάλιστα δαΐφρονι θυμὸν ὄρινεν·
ἀλλ’ οὐδ’ ἀχνύμενός περ ἑοῦ ἀμέλησεν ἑταίρου,
ἀλλὰ θέων περίβη καί οἱ σάκος ἀμφεκάλυψε.

13.421

τὸν μὲν ἔπειθ’ ὑποδύντε δύω ἐρίηρες ἑταῖροι
Μηκιστεὺς Ἐχίοιο πάϊς καὶ δῖος Ἀλάστωρ,
νῆας ἔπι γλαφυρὰς φερέτην βαρέα στενάχοντα.
Ἰδομενεὺς δ’ οὐ λῆγε μένος μέγα, ἴετο δ’ αἰεὶ
ἠέ τινα Τρώων ἐρεβεννῇ νυκτὶ καλύψαι
ἢ αὐτὸς δουπῆσαι ἀμύνων λοιγὸν Ἀχαιοῖς.
ἔνθ’ Αἰσυήταο διοτρεφέος φίλον υἱὸν
ἥρω’ Ἀλκάθοον, γαμβρὸς δ’ ἦν Ἀγχίσαο,
πρεσβυτάτην δ’ ὤπυιε θυγατρῶν Ἱπποδάμειαν
τὴν περὶ κῆρι φίλησε πατὴρ καὶ πότνια μήτηρ
ἐν μεγάρῳ· πᾶσαν γὰρ ὁμηλικίην ἐκέκαστο
κάλλεϊ καὶ ἔργοισιν ἰδὲ φρεσί· τοὔνεκα καί μιν
γῆμεν ἀνὴρ ὥριστος ἐνὶ Τροίῃ εὐρείῃ·

434 τὸν τόθ’ ὑπ’ Ἰδομενῆϊ Ποσειδάων ἐδάμασσε
435 θέλξας ὅσσε φαεινά, πέδησε δὲ φαίδιμα γυῖα·
436 οὔτε γὰρ ἐξοπίσω φυγέειν δύνατ’ οὔτ’ ἀλέασθαι,
437 ἀλλ’ ὥς τε στήλην ἢ δένδρεον ὑψιπέτηλον
438 ἀτρέμας ἑσταότα στῆθος μέσον οὔτασε δουρὶ
439 ἥρως Ἰδομενεύς, ῥῆξεν δέ οἱ ἀμφὶ χιτῶνα
440 χάλκεον, ὅς οἱ πρόσθεν ἀπὸ χροὸς ἤρκει ὄλεθρον·
441 δὴ τότε γ’ αὖον ἄϋσεν ἐρεικόμενος περὶ δουρί.
442 δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, δόρυ δ’ ἐν κραδίῃ ἐπεπήγει,
443 ἥ ῥά οἱ ἀσπαίρουσα καὶ οὐρίαχον πελέμιζεν
444 ἔγχεος· ἔνθα δ’ ἔπειτ’ ἀφίει μένος ὄβριμος Ἄρης·
445 Ἰδομενεὺς δ’ ἔκπαγλον ἐπεύξατο μακρὸν ἀΰσας
446 Δηΐφοβ’ ἦ ἄρα δή τι ἐΐσκομεν ἄξιον εἶναι
447 τρεῖς ἑνὸς ἀντὶ πεφάσθαι; ἐπεὶ σύ περ εὔχεαι οὕτω.
448 δαιμόνι’ ἀλλὰ καὶ αὐτὸς ἐναντίον ἵστασ’ ἐμεῖο,
449 ὄφρα ἴδῃ οἷος Ζηνὸς γόνος ἐνθάδ’ ἱκάνω,
450 ὃς πρῶτον Μίνωα τέκε Κρήτῃ ἐπίουρον·

13.451

451 Μίνως δ’ αὖ τέκεθ’ υἱὸν ἀμύμονα Δευκαλίωνα,
452 Δευκαλίων δ’ ἐμὲ τίκτε πολέσσ’ ἄνδρεσσιν ἄνακτα
453 Κρήτῃ ἐν εὐρείῃ· νῦν δ’ ἐνθάδε νῆες ἔνεικαν
454 σοί τε κακὸν καὶ πατρὶ καὶ ἄλλοισι Τρώεσσιν.
455 ὣς φάτο, Δηΐφοβος δὲ διάνδιχα μερμήριξεν
456 ἤ τινά που Τρώων ἑταρίσσαιτο μεγαθύμων
457 ἂψ ἀναχωρήσας, ἦ πειρήσαιτο καὶ οἷος.
458 ὧδε δέ οἱ φρονέοντι δοάσσατο κέρδιον εἶναι
459 βῆναι ἐπ’ Αἰνείαν· τὸν δ’ ὕστατον εὗρεν ὁμίλου
460 ἑσταότ’· αἰεὶ γὰρ Πριάμῳ ἐπεμήνιε δίῳ
461 οὕνεκ’ ἄρ’ ἐσθλὸν ἐόντα μετ’ ἀνδράσιν οὔ τι τίεσκεν.
462 ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱστάμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
463 Αἰνεία Τρώων βουληφόρε νῦν σε μάλα χρὴ
464 γαμβρῷ ἀμυνέμεναι, εἴ πέρ τί σε κῆδος ἱκάνει.
465 ἀλλ’ ἕπευ Ἀλκαθόῳ ἐπαμύνομεν, ὅς σε πάρος γε
466 γαμβρὸς ἐὼν ἔθρεψε δόμοις ἔνι τυτθὸν ἐόντα·
467 τὸν δέ τοι Ἰδομενεὺς δουρικλυτὸς ἐξενάριξεν.
468 ὣς φάτο, τῷ δ’ ἄρα θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ὄρινε,
469 βῆ δὲ μετ’ Ἰδομενῆα μέγα πτολέμοιο μεμηλώς.
470 ἀλλ’ οὐκ Ἰδομενῆα φόβος λάβε τηλύγετον ὥς,
471 ἀλλ’ ἔμεν’ ὡς ὅτε τις σῦς οὔρεσιν ἀλκὶ πεποιθώς,
472 ὅς τε μένει κολοσυρτὸν ἐπερχόμενον πολὺν ἀνδρῶν
473 χώρῳ ἐν οἰοπόλῳ, φρίσσει δέ τε νῶτον ὕπερθεν·
474 ὀφθαλμὼ δ’ ἄρα οἱ πυρὶ λάμπετον· αὐτὰρ ὀδόντας
475 θήγει, ἀλέξασθαι μεμαὼς κύνας ἠδὲ καὶ ἄνδρας·
476 ὣς μένεν Ἰδομενεὺς δουρικλυτός, οὐδ’ ὑπεχώρει,
477 Αἰνείαν ἐπιόντα βοηθόον· αὖε δ’ ἑταίρους
478 Ἀσκάλαφόν τ’ ἐσορῶν Ἀφαρῆά τε Δηΐπυρόν τε
479 Μηριόνην τε καὶ Ἀντίλοχον μήστωρας ἀϋτῆς·
480 τοὺς ὅ γ’ ἐποτρύνων ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·

13.481

481 δεῦτε φίλοι, καί μ’ οἴῳ ἀμύνετε· δείδια δ’ αἰνῶς
482 Αἰνείαν ἐπιόντα πόδας ταχύν, ὅς μοι ἔπεισιν,
483 ὃς μάλα καρτερός ἐστι μάχῃ ἔνι φῶτας ἐναίρειν·
484 καὶ δ’ ἔχει ἥβης ἄνθος, ὅ τε κράτος ἐστὶ μέγιστον.
485 εἰ γὰρ ὁμηλικίη γε γενοίμεθα τῷδ’ ἐπὶ θυμῷ
486 αἶψά κεν ἠὲ φέροιτο μέγα κράτος, ἠὲ φεροίμην.
487 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἕνα φρεσὶ θυμὸν ἔχοντες
488 πλησίοι ἔστησαν, σάκε’ ὤμοισι κλίναντες.
489 Αἰνείας δ’ ἐτέρωθεν ἐκέκλετο οἷς ἑτάροισι
490 Δηΐφοβόν τε Πάριν τ’ ἐσορῶν καὶ Ἀγήνορα δῖον,
491 οἵ οἱ ἅμ’ ἡγεμόνες Τρώων ἔσαν· αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
492 λαοὶ ἕπονθ’, ὡς εἴ τε μετὰ κτίλον ἕσπετο μῆλα
493 πιόμεν’ ἐκ βοτάνης· γάνυται δ’ ἄρα τε φρένα ποιμήν·
494 ὣς Αἰνείᾳ θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι γεγήθει
495 ὡς ἴδε λαῶν ἔθνος ἐπισπόμενον ἑοῖ αὐτῷ.
496 οἳ δ’ ἀμφ’ Ἀλκαθόῳ αὐτοσχεδὸν ὁρμήθησαν
497 μακροῖσι ξυστοῖσι· περὶ στήθεσσι δὲ χαλκὸς
498 σμερδαλέον κονάβιζε τιτυσκομένων καθ’ ὅμιλον
499 ἀλλήλων· δύο δ’ ἄνδρες ἀρήϊοι ἔξοχον ἄλλων
500 Αἰνείας τε καὶ Ἰδομενεὺς ἀτάλαντοι Ἄρηϊ
501 ἵεντ’ ἀλλήλων ταμέειν χρόα νηλέϊ χαλκῷ.
502 Αἰνείας δὲ πρῶτος ἀκόντισεν Ἰδομενῆος·
503 ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν ἄντα ἰδὼν ἠλεύατο χάλκεον ἔγχος,
504 αἰχμὴ δ’ Αἰνείαο κραδαινομένη κατὰ γαίης
505 ᾤχετ’, ἐπεί ῥ’ ἄλιον στιβαρῆς ἀπὸ χειρὸς ὄρουσεν.
506 Ἰδομενεὺς δ’ ἄρα Οἰνόμαον βάλε γαστέρα μέσσην,
507 ῥῆξε δὲ θώρηκος γύαλον, διὰ δ’ ἔντερα χαλκὸς
508 ἤφυσ’· ὃ δ’ ἐν κονίῃσι πεσὼν ἔλε γαῖαν ἀγοστῷ.
509 Ἰδομενεὺς δ’ ἐκ μὲν νέκυος δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος
510 ἐσπάσατ’, οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔτ’ ἄλλα δυνήσατο τεύχεα καλὰ

On this, all of them as one man stood near him, shield on shoulder. Aeneas on the other side called to his comrades, looking towards Deiphobos, Paris, and Agenor, who were leaders of the Trojans along with himself, and the people followed them as sheep follow the ram when they go down to drink after they have been feeding, and the heart of the shepherd is glad - even so was the heart of Aeneas gladdened when he saw his people follow him. Then they fought furiously in close combat about the body of Alkathoos, wielding their long spears; and the bronze armor about their bodies rang fearfully as they took aim at one another in the press of the fight, while the two heroes Aeneas and Idomeneus, peers of Ares, outdid every one in their desire to hack at each other with sword and spear. Aeneas took aim first, but Idomeneus was on the lookout and avoided the spear, so that it sped from Aeneas' strong hand in vain, and fell quivering in the ground. Idomeneus meanwhile smote Oinomaos in the middle of his belly, and broke the plate of his corselet, whereon his bowels came gushing out and he clutched the earth in the palms of his hands as he fell sprawling in the dust. Idomeneus drew his spear out of the body, but could not strip him of the rest of his armor for the rain of darts that were showered upon him: moreover his strength was now beginning to fail him so that he could no longer charge, and could neither spring forward to recover his own weapon nor swerve aside to avoid one that was aimed at him; therefore, though he still defended himself in hand-to-hand fight, his heavy feet could not bear him swiftly out of the battle. Deiphobos aimed a spear at him as he was retreating slowly from the field, for his bitterness against him was as fierce as ever, but again he

missed him, and hit Askalaphos, the son of Ares; the spear went through his shoulder, and he clutched the earth in the palms of his hands as he fell sprawling in the dust. Grim Ares of awful voice did not yet know that his son had fallen, for he was sitting on the summits of Olympus under the golden clouds, by command of Zeus, where the other gods were also sitting, forbidden to take part in the battle. Meanwhile men fought furiously about the body. Deiphobos tore the helmet from off his head, but Meriones sprang upon him, and struck him on the arm with a spear so that the visored helmet fell from his hand and came ringing down upon the ground. Thereon Meriones sprang upon him like a vulture, drew the spear from his shoulder, and fell back under cover of his men. Then Polites, brother of Deiphobos, passed his arms around his waist, and bore him away from the battle till he got to his horses that were standing in the rear of the fight with the chariot and their driver. These took him towards the city groaning and in great pain, with the blood flowing from his arm. The others still fought on, and the battle-cry rose to heaven without ceasing. Aeneas sprang on Aphareus son of Kaletor, and struck him with a spear in his throat which was turned towards him; his head fell on one side, his helmet and shield came down along with him, and death, life's foe, was shed around him. Antilokhos spied his chance, flew forward towards Thoon, and wounded him as he was turning round. He laid open the vein that runs all the way up the back to the neck; he cut this vein clean away throughout its whole course, and Thoon fell in the dust face upwards, stretching out his hands imploringly towards his comrades. Antilokhos sprang upon him and stripped the armor from his shoulders, glaring round him fearfully as he did so. The Trojans came about him on every side and struck his broad and gleaming shield, but could not wound his body, for Poseidon stood guard over the son of Nestor, though the darts fell thickly round him. He was never clear of the foe, but was always in the thick of the fight; his spear was never idle; he poised and aimed it in every direction, so eager was he to hit some one from a distance or to fight him hand to hand. As he was thus aiming among the crowd, he was seen by Adamas son of Asios, who rushed towards him and struck him with a spear in the middle of his shield, but Poseidon made its point without effect, for he grudged him the life of Antilokhos. One half, therefore, of the spear stuck fast like a charred stake in Antilokhos' shield, while the other lay on the ground. Adamas then sought shelter under cover of his men, but Meriones followed after and hit him with a spear midway between the private parts and the navel, where a wound is particularly painful to wretched mortals. There did Meriones transfix him, and he writhed convulsively about the spear as some bull whom mountain herdsmen have bound with ropes of withies and are taking away perforce. Even so did he move convulsively for a while, but not for very long, till Meriones came up and drew the spear out of his body, and his eyes were veiled in darkness. Helenos then struck Deipyros with a great Thracian sword, hitting him on the temple in close combat and tearing the helmet from his head; the helmet fell to the ground, and one of those who were fighting on the Achaean side took charge of it as it rolled at his feet, but the eyes of Deipyros were closed in the darkness of death.

13.511

ὥμοιιν ἀφελέσθαι· ἐπείγετο γὰρ βελέεσσιν.
οὐ γὰρ ἔτ’ ἔμπεδα γυῖα ποδῶν ἦν ὁρμηθέντι,
οὔτ’ ἄρ’ ἐπαΐξαι μεθ’ ἑὸν· βέλος οὔτ’ ἀλέασθαι.
τώ ῥα καὶ ἐν σταδίῃ μὲν ἀμύνετο νηλεὲς ἦμαρ,
τρέσσαι δ’ οὐκ ἔτι ῥίμφα πόδες φέρον ἐκ πολέμοιο.
τοῦ δὲ βάδην ἀπιόντος ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ
Δηΐφοβος· δὴ γάρ οἱ ἔχεν κότον ἐμμενὲς αἰεί.
ἀλλ’ ὅ γε καὶ τόθ’ ἅμαρτεν, ὃ δ’ Ἀσκάλαφον βάλε δουρὶ
υἱὸν Ἐνυαλίοιο· δι’ ὤμου δ’ ὄβριμον ἔγχος

ἔσχεν· ὃ δ’ ἐν κονίῃσι πεσὼν ἔλε γαῖαν ἀγοστῷ.
οὐδ’ ἄρα πώ τι πέπυστο βριήπυος ὄβριμος Ἄρης
υἷος ἑοῖο πεσόντος ἐνὶ κρατερῇ ὑσμίνῃ,
ἀλλ’ ὅ γ’ ἄρ’ ἄκρῳ Ὀλύμπῳ ὑπὸ χρυσέοισι νέφεσσιν
ἧστο Διὸς βουλῇσιν ἐελμένος, ἔνθά περ ἄλλοι
ἀθάνατοι θεοὶ ἦσαν ἐεργόμενοι πολέμοιο.
οἳ δ’ ἀμφ’ Ἀσκαλάφῳ αὐτοσχεδὸν ὁρμήθησαν·
Δηΐφοβος μὲν ἀπ’ Ἀσκαλάφου πήληκα φαεινὴν
ἥρπασε, Μηριόνης δὲ θοῷ ἀτάλαντος Ἄρηϊ
δουρὶ βραχίονα τύψεν ἐπάλμενος, ἐκ δ’ ἄρα χειρὸς
αὐλῶπις τρυφάλεια χαμαὶ βόμβησε πεσοῦσα.
Μηριόνης δ’ ἐξ αὖτις ἐπάλμενος αἰγυπιὸς ὡς
ἐξέρυσε πρυμνοῖο βραχίονος ὄβριμον ἔγχος,
ἂψ δ’ ἐτάρων εἰς ἔθνος ἐχάζετο. τὸν δὲ Πολίτης
αὐτοκασίγνητος περὶ μέσσῳ χεῖρε τιτήνας
ἐξῆγεν πολέμοιο δυσηχέος, ὄφρ’ ἵκεθ’ ἵππους
ὠκέας, οἵ οἱ ὄπισθε μάχης ἠδὲ πτολέμοιο
ἕστασαν ἡνίοχόν τε καὶ ἅρματα ποικίλ’ ἔχοντες·
οἳ τόν γε προτὶ ἄστυ φέρον βαρέα στενάχοντα
τειρόμενον· κατὰ δ’ αἷμα νεουτάτου ἔρρεε χειρός.
οἳ δ’ ἄλλοι μάρναντο, βοὴ δ’ ἄσβεστος ὀρώρει.

13.541

ἔνθ’ Αἰνέας Ἀφαρῆα Καλητορίδην ἐπορούσας
λαιμὸν τύψ’ ἐπὶ οἷ τετραμμένον ὀξέϊ δουρί·
ἐκλίνθη δ’ ἐτέρωσε κάρη, ἐπὶ δ’ ἀσπὶς ἐάφθη
καὶ κόρυς, ἀμφὶ δέ οἱ θάνατος χύτο θυμοραϊστής.
Ἀντίλοχος δὲ Θόωνα μεταστρεφθέντα δοκεύσας
οὔτασ’ ἐπαΐξας, ἀπὸ δὲ φλέβα πᾶσαν ἔκερσεν,
ἥ τ’ ἀνὰ νῶτα θέουσα διαμπερὲς αὐχέν’ ἱκάνει·
τὴν ἀπὸ πᾶσαν ἔκερσεν· ὃ δ’ ὕπτιος ἐν κονίῃσι
κάππεσεν, ἄμφω χεῖρε φίλοις ἑτάροισι πετάσσας.
Ἀντίλοχος δ’ ἐπόρουσε, καὶ αἴνυτο τεύχε’ ἀπ’ ὤμων
παπταίνων· Τρῶες δὲ περισταδὸν ἄλλοθεν ἄλλος
οὔταζον σάκος εὐρὺ παναίολον, οὐδὲ δύναντο
εἴσω ἐπιγράψαι τέρενα χρόα νηλέϊ χαλκῷ
Ἀντιλόχου· πέρι γάρ ῥα Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων
Νέστορος υἱὸν ἔρυτο καὶ ἐν πολλοῖσι βέλεσσιν.
οὐ μὲν γάρ ποτ’ ἄνευ δηΐων ἦν, ἀλλὰ κατ’ αὐτοὺς
στρωφᾶτ’· οὐδέ οἱ ἔγχος ἔχ’ ἀτρέμας, ἀλλὰ μάλ’ αἰεὶ
σειόμενον ἐλέλικτο· τιτύσκετο δὲ φρεσὶν ᾗσιν
ἤ τευ ἀκοντίσσαι, ἠὲ σχεδὸν ὁρμηθῆναι.
ἀλλ’ οὐ λῆθ’ Ἀδάμαντα τιτυσκόμενος καθ’ ὅμιλον
Ἀσιάδην, ὅ οἱ οὖτα μέσον σάκος ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ
ἐγγύθεν ὁρμηθείς· ἀμενήνωσεν δέ οἱ αἰχμὴν
κυανοχαῖτα Ποσειδάων βιότοιο μεγήρας.
καὶ τὸ μὲν αὐτοῦ μεῖν’ ὥς τε σκῶλος πυρίκαυστος
ἐν σάκει Ἀντιλόχοιο, τὸ δ’ ἥμισυ κεῖτ’ ἐπὶ γαίης·
ἂψ δ’ ἐτάρων εἰς ἔθνος ἐχάζετο κῆρ’ ἀλεείνων·
Μηριόνης δ’ ἀπιόντα μετασπόμενος βάλε δουρὶ
αἰδοίων τε μεσηγὺ καὶ ὀμφαλοῦ, ἔνθα μάλιστα

569 γίγνετ’ Ἄρης ἀλεγεινὸς ὀϊζυροῖσι βροτοῖσιν.
570 ἔνθά οἱ ἔγχος ἔπηξεν· ὃ δ’ ἐσπόμενος περὶ δουρὶ

13.571

571 ἤσπαιρ’ ὡς ὅτε βοῦς τόν τ’ οὔρεσι βουκόλοι ἄνδρες
572 ἰλλάσιν οὐκ ἐθέλοντα βίῃ δήσαντες ἄγουσιν·
573 ὣς ὃ τυπεὶς ἤσπαιρε μίνυνθά περ, οὔ τι μάλα δήν,
574 ὄφρά οἱ ἐκ χροὸς ἔγχος ἀνεσπάσατ’ ἐγγύθεν ἐλθὼν
575 ἥρως Μηριόνης· τὸν δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψε.
576 Δηΐπυρον δ’ Ἕλενος ξίφεϊ σχεδὸν ἤλασε κόρσην
577 Θρηϊκίῳ μεγάλῳ, ἀπὸ δὲ τρυφάλειαν ἄραξεν.
578 ἣ μὲν ἀποπλαγχθεῖσα χαμαὶ πέσε, καί τις Ἀχαιῶν
579 μαρναμένων μετὰ ποσσὶ κυλινδομένην ἐκόμισσε·
580 τὸν δὲ κατ’ ὀφθαλμῶν ἐρεβεννὴ νὺξ ἐκάλυψεν.
581 Ἀτρεΐδην δ’ ἄχος εἶλε βοὴν ἀγαθὸν Μενέλαον·
582 βῆ δ’ ἐπαπειλήσας Ἑλένῳ ἥρωϊ ἄνακτι
583 ὀξὺ δόρυ κραδάων· ὃ δὲ τόξου πῆχυν ἄνελκε.
584 τὼ δ’ ἄρ’ ὁμαρτήδην ὃ μὲν ἔγχεϊ ὀξυόεντι
585 ἵετ’ ἀκοντίσσαι, ὃ δ’ ἀπὸ νευρῆφιν ὀϊστῷ.
586 Πριαμίδης μὲν ἔπειτα κατὰ στῆθος βάλεν ἰῷ
587 θώρηκος γύαλον, ἀπὸ δ’ ἔπτατο πικρὸς ὀϊστός.
588 ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἀπὸ πλατέος πτυόφιν μεγάλην κατ’ ἀλωὴν
589 θρῴσκωσιν κύαμοι μελανόχροες ἢ ἐρέβινθοι
590 πνοιῇ ὕπο λιγυρῇ καὶ λικμητῆρος ἐρωῇ,
591 ὣς ἀπὸ θώρηκος Μενελάου κυδαλίμοιο
592 πολλὸν ἀποπλαγχθεὶς ἐκὰς ἔπτατο πικρὸς ὀϊστός.
593 Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ἄρα χεῖρα βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος
594 τὴν βάλεν ᾗ ῥ’ ἔχε τόξον ἐΰξοον· ἐν δ’ ἄρα τόξῳ
595 ἀντικρὺ διὰ χειρὸς ἐλήλατο χάλκεον ἔγχος.
596 ἂψ δ’ ἑτάρων εἰς ἔθνος ἐχάζετο κῆρ’ ἀλεείνων
597 χεῖρα παρακρεμάσας· τὸ δ’ ἐφέλκετο μείλινον ἔγχος.
598 καὶ τὸ μὲν ἐκ χειρὸς ἔρυσεν μεγάθυμος Ἀγήνωρ,
599 αὐτὴν δὲ ξυνέδησεν ἐϋστρεφεῖ οἰὸς ἀώτῳ
600 σφενδόνῃ, ἣν ἄρα οἱ θεράπων ἔχε ποιμένι λαῶν.
On this Menelaos was stung by grief [akhos], and made menacingly towards Helenos, brandishing his spear; but Helenos drew his bow, and the two attacked one another at one and the same moment, the one with his spear, and the other with his bow and arrow. The son of Priam hit the breastplate of Menelaos' corselet, but the arrow glanced from off it. As black beans or pulse come pattering down on to a threshing-floor from the broad winnowing-shovel, blown by shrill winds and shaken by the shovel - even so did the arrow glance off and recoil from the shield of Menelaos, who in his turn wounded the hand with which Helenos carried his bow; the spear went right through his hand and stuck in the bow itself, so that to his life he retreated under cover of his men, with his hand dragging by his side - for the spear weighed it down till Agenor drew it out and bound the hand carefully up in a woolen sling which his esquire [therapôn] had with him. Peisandros then made straight at Menelaos - his evil destiny luring him on to his doom [telos], for he was to fall in fight with you, O Menelaos. When the two were hard by one another the spear of the son of Atreus turned aside and he missed his aim; Peisandros then struck the shield of brave Menelaos but could not pierce it, for the shield stayed the spear and broke the shaft; nevertheless he was glad and made sure of victory; forthwith, however, the son of Atreus drew his sword and sprang upon him. Peisandros then seized the bronze battle-axe, with its

long and polished handle of olive wood that hung by his side under his shield, and the two made at one another. Peisandros struck the peak of Menelaos' crested helmet just under the crest itself, and Menelaos hit Peisandros as he was coming towards him, on the forehead, just at the rise of his nose; the bones cracked and his two gore-bedrabbled eyes fell by his feet in the dust. He fell backwards to the ground, and Menelaos set his heel upon him, stripped him of his armor, and vaunted over him saying, "Even thus shall you Trojans leave the ships of the Achaeans, proud and insatiate of battle though you be: nor shall you lack any of the disgrace and shame which you have heaped upon myself. Cowardly she-wolves that you are, you feared not the anger [mênis] of dread Zeus, avenger of violated hospitality, who will one day destroy your city; you stole my wedded wife and wickedly carried off much treasure when you were her guest, and now you would fling fire upon our ships, and kill our heroes. A day will come when, rage as you may, you shall be stayed. O father Zeus, you, who they say art above all both gods and men in wisdom, and from whom all things that befall us do proceed, how can you thus favor the Trojans - men so proud and overweening, that they are never tired of fighting? All things pall after a while - sleep, love, sweet song, and stately dance - still these are things of which a man would surely have his fill rather than of battle, whereas it is of battle that the Trojans are insatiate." So saying Menelaos stripped the blood-stained armor from the body of Peisandros, and handed it over to his men; then he again ranged himself among those who were in the front of the fight. Harpalion son of King Pylaimenes then sprang upon him; he had come to fight at Troy along with his father, but he did not go home again. He struck the middle of Menelaos' shield with his spear but could not pierce it, and to save his life drew back under cover of his men, looking round him on every side lest he should be wounded. But Meriones aimed a bronze-tipped arrow at him as he was leaving the field, and hit him on the right buttock; the arrow pierced the bone through and through, and penetrated the bladder, so he sat down where he was and breathed his last in the arms of his comrades, stretched like a worm upon the ground and watering the earth with the blood that flowed from his wound. The brave Paphlagonians tended him with all due care; they raised him into his chariot, and bore him sadly off to the city of Troy; his father went also with him weeping bitterly, but there was no ransom that could bring his dead son to life again. Paris was deeply grieved by the death of Harpalion, who was his host when he went among the Paphlagonians; he aimed an arrow, therefore, in order to avenge him. Now there was a certain man named Euchenor, son of Polyidos the seer [mantis], a brave man and wealthy, whose home was in Corinth. This Euchenor had set sail for Troy well knowing that it would be the death of him, for his good old father Polyidos had often told him that he must either stay at home and die of a terrible disease, or go with the Achaeans and perish at the hands of the Trojans; he chose, therefore, to avoid incurring the heavy fine the Achaeans would have laid upon him, and at the same time to escape the pain and suffering of disease. Paris now smote him on the jaw under his ear, whereon the life went out of him and he was enshrouded in the darkness of death. Thus then did they fight as it were a flaming fire. But Hektor had not yet heard, and did not know that the Argives were making havoc of his men on the left wing of the battle, where the Achaeans ere long would have triumphed over them, so vigorously did Poseidon cheer them on and help them. He therefore held on at the point where he had first forced his way through the gates and the wall, after breaking through the serried ranks of Danaan warriors. It was here that the ships of Ajax and Protesilaos were drawn up by the sea-shore; here the wall was at its lowest, and the fight both of man and horse raged most fiercely. The Boeotians and the Ionians with their long tunics, the Locrians, the men of Phthia, and the famous force of the Epeans could hardly stay Hektor as he rushed on towards the ships, nor could they drive him from them, for he was as a wall of fire. The chosen men of the Athenians were in the van, led by Menestheus son of Peteos, with whom were also Pheidas, Stichios, and stalwart Bias: Meges son of Phyleus, Amphion, and Drakios commanded the

Epeans, while Medon and staunch Podarkes led the men of Phthia. Of these, Medon was bastard son to Oileus and brother of Ajax, but he lived in Phylake away from his own country, for he had killed the brother of his stepmother Eriopis, the wife of Oileus; the other, Podarkes, was the son of Iphiklos son of Phylakos. These two stood in the van of the Phthians, and defended the ships along with the Boeotians.

13.601

601 Πείσανδρος δ’ ἰθὺς Μενελάου κυδαλίμοιο
602 ἤϊε· τὸν δ’ ἄγε μοῖρα κακὴ θανάτοιο τέλος δὲ
603 σοὶ Μενέλαε δαμῆναι ἐν αἰνῇ δηϊοτῆτι.
604 οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντες
605 Ἀτρεΐδης μὲν ἅμαρτε, παραὶ δέ οἱ ἐτράπετ’ ἔγχος,
606 Πείσανδρος δὲ σάκος Μενελάου κυδαλίμοιο
607 οὔτασεν, οὐδὲ διὰ πρὸ δυνήσατο χαλκὸν ἐλάσσαι·
608 ἔσχεθε γὰρ σάκος εὐρύ, κατεκλάσθη δ’ ἐνὶ καυλῷ
609 ἔγχος· ὃ δὲ φρεσὶν ᾗσι χάρη καὶ ἐέλπετο νίκην.
610 Ἀτρεΐδης δὲ ἐρυσσάμενος ξίφος ἀργυρόηλον
611 ἆλτ’ ἐπὶ Πεισάνδρῳ· ὃ δ’ ὑπ’ ἀσπίδος εἴλετο καλὴν
612 ἀξίνην εὔχαλκον ἐλαΐνῳ ἀμφὶ πελέκκῳ
613 μακρῷ ἐϋξέστῳ· ἅμα δ’ ἀλλήλων ἐφίκοντο.
614 ἤτοι ὃ μὲν κόρυθος φάλον ἤλασεν ἱπποδασείης
615 ἄκρον ὑπὸ λόφον αὐτόν, ὃ δὲ προσιόντα μέτωπον
616 ῥινὸς ὕπερ πυμάτης· λάκε δ’ ὀστέα, τὼ δέ οἱ ὄσσε
617 πὰρ ποσὶν αἱματόεντα χαμαὶ πέσον ἐν κονίῃσιν,
618 ἰδνώθη δὲ πεσών· ὃ δὲ λὰξ ἐν στήθεσι βαίνων
619 τεύχεά τ’ ἐξενάριξε καὶ εὐχόμενος ἔπος ηὔδα·
620 λείψετέ θην οὕτω γε νέας Δαναῶν ταχυπώλων
621 Τρῶες ὑπερφίαλοι δεινῆς ἀκόρητοι ἀϋτῆς,
622 ἄλλης μὲν λώβης τε καὶ αἴσχεος οὐκ ἐπιδευεῖς
623 ἣν ἐμὲ λωβήσασθε κακαὶ κύνες, οὐδέ τι θυμῷ
624 Ζηνὸς ἐριβρεμέτεω χαλεπὴν ἐδείσατε μῆνιν
625 ξεινίου, ὅς τέ ποτ’ ὔμμι διαφθέρσει πόλιν αἰπήν·
626 οἵ μευ κουριδίην ἄλοχον καὶ κτήματα πολλὰ
627 μὰψ οἴχεσθ’ ἀνάγοντες, ἐπεὶ φιλέεσθε παρ’ αὐτῇ·
628 νῦν αὖτ’ ἐν νηυσὶν μενεαίνετε ποντοπόροισι
629 πῦρ ὀλοὸν βαλέειν, κτεῖναι δ’ ἥρωας Ἀχαιούς.
630 ἀλλά ποθι σχήσεσθε καὶ ἐσσύμενοί περ Ἄρηος.

13.631

631 Ζεῦ πάτερ ἦ τέ σέ φασι περὶ φρένας ἔμμεναι ἄλλων
632 ἀνδρῶν ἠδὲ θεῶν· σέο δ’ ἐκ τάδε πάντα πέλονται·
633 οἷον δὴ ἄνδρεσσι χαρίζεαι ὑβριστῇσι
634 Τρωσίν, τῶν μένος αἰὲν ἀτάσθαλον, οὐδὲ δύνανται
635 φυλόπιδος κορέσασθαι ὁμοιΐου πτολέμοιο.
636 πάντων μὲν κόρος ἐστὶ καὶ ὕπνου καὶ φιλότητος
637 μολπῆς τε γλυκερῆς καὶ ἀμύμονος ὀρχηθμοῖο,
638 τῶν πέρ τις καὶ μᾶλλον ἐέλδεται ἐξ ἔρον εἶναι
639 ἢ πολέμου· Τρῶες δὲ μάχης ἀκόρητοι ἔασιν.
640 ὣς εἰπὼν τὰ μὲν ἔντε’ ἀπὸ χροὸς αἱματόεντα
641 συλήσας ἑτάροισι δίδου Μενέλαος ἀμύμων,

αὐτὸς δ’ αὖτ’ ἐξ αὖτις ἰὼν προμάχοισιν ἐμίχθη.
ἔνθά οἱ υἱὸς ἐπᾶλτο Πυλαιμένεος βασιλῆος
Ἀρπαλίων, ὅ ῥα πατρὶ φίλῳ ἔπετο πτολεμίξων
ἐς τροίην, οὐδ’ αὖτις ἀφίκετο πατρίδα γαῖαν·
ὅς ῥα τότ’ Ἀτρεΐδαο μέσον σάκος οὔτασε δουρὶ
ἐγγύθεν, οὐδὲ διὰ πρὸ δυνήσατο χαλκὸν ἐλάσσαι
ἂψ δ’ ἑτάρων εἰς ἔθνος ἐχάζετο κῆρ’ ἀλεείνων
πάντοσε παπταίνων μή τις χρόα χαλκῷ ἐπαύρῃ.
Μηριόνης δ’ ἀπιόντος ἴει χαλκήρε’ ὀϊστόν,
καί ῥ’ ἔβαλε γλουτὸν κάτα δεξιόν· αὐτὰρ ὀϊστὸς
ἀντικρὺ κατὰ κύστιν ὑπ’ ὀστέον ἐξεπέρησεν.
ἐζόμενος δὲ κατ’ αὖθι φίλων ἐν χερσὶν ἑταίρων
θυμὸν ἀποπνείων, ὥς τε σκώληξ ἐπὶ γαίῃ
κεῖτο ταθείς· ἐκ δ’ αἷμα μέλαν ῥέε, δεῦε δὲ γαῖαν.
τὸν μὲν Παφλαγόνες μεγαλήτορες ἀμφεπένοντο,
ἐς δίφρον δ’ ἀνέσαντες ἄγον προτὶ Ἴλιον ἱρὴν
ἀχνύμενοι· μετὰ δέ σφι πατὴρ κίε δάκρυα λείβων,
ποινὴ δ’ οὔ τις παιδὸς ἐγίγνετο τεθνηῶτος.
τοῦ δὲ Πάρις μάλα θυμὸν ἀποκταμένοιο χολώθη·

13.661

ξεῖνος γάρ οἱ ἔην πολέσιν μετὰ Παφλαγόνεσσι·
τοῦ ὅ γε χωόμενος προΐει χαλκήρε’ ὀϊστόν.
ἦν δέ τις Εὐχήνωρ Πολυΐδου μάντιος υἱὸς
ἀφνειός τ’ ἀγαθός τε Κορινθόθι οἰκία ναίων,
ὅς ῥ’ εὖ εἰδὼς κῆρ’ ὀλοὴν ἐπὶ νηὸς ἔβαινε·
πολλάκι γάρ οἱ ἔειπε γέρων ἀγαθὸς Πολύϊδος
νούσῳ ὑπ’ ἀργαλέῃ φθίσθαι οἷς ἐν μεγάροισιν,
ἢ μετ’ Ἀχαιῶν νηυσὶν ὑπὸ Τρώεσσι δαμῆναι·
τώ ῥ’ ἅμα τ’ ἀργαλέην θωὴν ἀλέεινεν Ἀχαιῶν
νοῦσόν τε στυγερήν, ἵνα μὴ πάθοι ἄλγεα θυμῷ.
τὸν βάλ’ ὑπὸ γναθμοῖο. καὶ οὔατος· ὦκα δὲ θυμὸς
ᾧχετ’ ἀπὸ μελέων, στυγερὸς δ’ ἄρα μιν σκότος εἶλεν.
ὣς οἳ μὲν μάρναντο δέμας πυρὸς αἰθομένοιο·
Ἕκτωρ δ’ οὐκ ἐπέπυστο Διῒ φίλος, οὐδέ τι ᾔδη
ὅττί ῥά οἱ νηῶν ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ δηϊόωντο
λαοὶ ὑπ’ Ἀργείων. τάχα δ’ ἂν καὶ κῦδος Ἀχαιῶν
ἔπλετο· τοῖος γὰρ γαιήοχος ἐννοσίγαιος
ὄτρυν’ Ἀργείους, πρὸς δὲ σθένει αὐτὸς ἄμυνεν·
ἀλλ’ ἔχεν ᾗ τὰ πρῶτα πύλας καὶ τεῖχος ἐσᾶλτο
ῥηξάμενος Δαναῶν πυκινὰς στίχας ἀσπιστάων,
ἔνθ’ ἔσαν Αἴαντός τε νέες καὶ Πρωτεσιλάου
θῖν’ ἔφ’ ἁλὸς πολιῆς εἰρυμέναι· αὐτὰρ ὕπερθε
τεῖχος ἐδέδμητο χθαμαλώτατον, ἔνθα μάλιστα
ζαχρηεῖς γίγνοντο μάχῃ αὐτοί τε καὶ ἵπποι.
ἔνθα δὲ Βοιωτοὶ καὶ Ἰάονες ἑλκεχίτωνες
Λοκροὶ καὶ Φθῖοι καὶ φαιδιμόεντες Ἐπειοὶ
σπουδῇ ἐπαΐσσοντα νεῶν ἔχον, οὐδὲ δύναντο
ὦσαι ἀπὸ σφείων φλογὶ εἴκελον Ἕκτορα δῖον
οἳ μὲν Ἀθηναίων προλελεγμένοι· ἐν δ’ ἄρα τοῖσιν
ἦρχ’ υἱὸς Πετεῶο Μενεσθεύς, οἳ δ’ ἅμ’ ἕποντο

13.691

691 Φείδας τε Στιχίος τε Βίας τ’ ἐΰς· αὐτὰρ Ἐπειῶν
692 Φυλεΐδης τε Μέγης Ἀμφίων τε Δρακίος τε,
693 πρὸ Φθίων δὲ Μέδων τε μενεπτόλεμός τε Ποδάρκης.
694 ἤτοι ὃ μὲν νόθος υἱὸς Ὀϊλῆος θείοιο
695 ἔσκε Μέδων Αἴαντος ἀδελφεός· αὐτὰρ ἔναιεν
696 ἐν Φυλάκῃ γαίης ἄπο πατρίδος ἄνδρα κατακτὰς
697 γνωτὸν μητρυιῆς Ἐριώπιδος, ἣν ἔχ’ Ὀϊλεύς·
698 αὐτὰρ ὃ Ἰφίκλοιο πάϊς τοῦ Φυλακίδαο.
699 οἳ μὲν πρὸ Φθίων μεγαθύμων θωρηχθέντες
700 ναῦφιν ἀμυνόμενοι μετὰ Βοιωτῶν ἐμάχοντο·
701 Αἴας δ’ οὐκέτι πάμπαν Ὀϊλῆος ταχὺς υἱὸς
702 ἵστατ’ ἀπ’ Αἴαντος Τελαμωνίου οὐδ’ ἠβαιόν,
703 ἀλλ’ ὥς τ’ ἐν νειῷ βόε οἰνοπε πηκτὸν ἄροτρον
704 ἶσον θυμὸν ἔχοντε τιταίνετον· ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρά σφι
705 πρυμνοῖσιν κεράεσσι πολὺς ἀνακηκίει ἱδρώς·
706 τὼ μέν τε ζυγὸν οἷον ἐΰξοον ἀμφὶς ἐέργει
707 ἰεμένω κατὰ ὦλκα· τέμει δέ τε τέλσον ἀρούρης·
708 ὣς τὼ παρβεβαῶτε μάλ’ ἔστασαν ἀλλήλοιιν.
709 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι Τελαμωνιάδῃ πολλοί τε καὶ ἐσθλοὶ
710 λαοὶ ἕπονθ’ ἕταροι, οἵ οἱ σάκος ἐξεδέχοντο
711 ὁππότε μιν κάματός τε καὶ ἱδρὼς γούναθ’ ἵκοιτο.
712 οὐδ’ ἄρ’ Ὀϊλιάδῃ μεγαλήτορι Λοκροὶ ἕποντο·
713 οὐ γάρ σφι σταδίῃ ὑσμίνῃ μίμνε φίλον κῆρ·
714 οὐ γὰρ ἔχον κόρυθας χαλκήρεας ἱπποδασείας,
715 οὐδ’ ἔχον ἀσπίδας εὐκύκλους καὶ μείλινα δοῦρα,
716 ἀλλ’ ἄρα τόξοισιν καὶ ἐϋστρεφεῖ οἴῃσιν ἀώτῳ
717 Ἴλιον εἰς ἅμ’ ἕποντο πεποιθότες, οἷσιν ἔπειτα
718 ταρφέα βάλλοντες Τρώων ῥήγνυντο φάλαγγας·
719 δή ῥα τόθ’ οἳ μὲν πρόσθε σὺν ἔντεσι δαιδαλέοισι
720 μάρναντο Τρωσίν τε καὶ Ἕκτορι χαλκοκορυστῇ,

Ajax son of Oileus never for a moment left the side of Ajax son of Telamon, but as two swart oxen both strain their utmost at the plough which they are drawing in a fallow field, and the sweat steams upwards from about the roots of their horns - nothing but the yoke divides them as they break up the ground till they reach the end of the field - even so did the two Ajaxes stand shoulder to shoulder by one another. Many and brave comrades followed the son of Telamon, to relieve him of his shield when he was overcome with sweat and toil, but the Locrians did not follow so close after the son of Oileus, for they could not hold their own in a hand-to-hand fight. They had no bronze helmets with plumes of horse-hair, neither had they shields nor ashen spears, but they had come to Troy armed with bows, and with slings of twisted wool from which they showered their missiles to break the ranks of the Trojans. The others, therefore, with their heavy armor bore the brunt of the fight with the Trojans and with Hektor, while the Locrians shot from behind, under their cover; and thus the Trojans began to lose heart, for the arrows threw them into confusion. The Trojans would now have been driven in sorry plight from the ships and tents back to windy Ilion, had not Polydamas presently said to Hektor, "Hektor, there is no persuading you to take advice. Because heaven has so richly endowed you with the arts of war, you think that you must therefore excel others in counsel; but you cannot thus claim preeminence in all things. Heaven has made one man an excellent warrior; of another it has made a dancer or a singer and player on the lyre; while yet in another Zeus has implanted a wise understanding [noos] of which men reap fruit to the saving of many, and he himself knows more about it than any

one; therefore I will say what I think will be best. The fight has hemmed you in as with a circle of fire, and even now that the Trojans are within the wall some of them stand aloof in full armor, while others are fighting scattered and outnumbered near the ships. Draw back, therefore, and call your chieftains round you, that we may advise together whether to fall now upon the ships in the hope that heaven may grant us victory, or to beat a retreat while we can yet safely do so. I greatly fear that the Achaeans will pay us their debt of yesterday in full, for there is one abiding at their ships who is never weary of battle, and who will not hold aloof much longer." Thus spoke Polydamas, and his words pleased Hektor well. He sprang in full armor from his chariot and said, "Polydamas, gather the chieftains here; I will go yonder into the fight, but will return at once when I have given them their orders." He then sped onward, towering like a snowy mountain, and with a loud cry flew through the ranks of the Trojans and their allies. When they heard his voice they all hastened to gather round Polydamas the excellent son of Panthoos, but Hektor kept on among the foremost, looking everywhere to find Deiphobos and prince Helenos, Adamas son of Asios, and Asios son of Hyrtakos; living, indeed, and scatheless he could no longer find them, for the two last were lying by the sterns of the Achaean ships, having lost their lives [psukhai] at the hands of the Argives, while the others had been also stricken and wounded by them; but upon the left wing of the dread battle he found Alexander, husband of lovely Helen, cheering his men and urging them on to fight. He went up to him and upbraided him. "Paris," said he, "evil-hearted Paris, fair to see but woman-mad and false of tongue, where are Deiphobos and King Helenos? Where are Adamas son of Asios, and Asios son of Hyrtakos? Where too is Othryoneus? Ilion is undone and will now surely fall!" Alexander answered, "Hektor, why find fault when there is no one to find fault with? I should hold aloof from battle on any day rather than this, for my mother bore me with nothing of the coward about me. From the moment when you set our men fighting about the ships we have been staying here and doing battle with the Danaans. Our comrades about whom you ask me are dead; Deiphobos and King Helenos alone have left the field, wounded both of them in the hand, but the son of Kronos saved them alive. Now, therefore, lead on where you would have us go, and we will follow with right goodwill; you shall not find us fail you in so far as our strength holds out, but no man can do more than in him lies, no matter how willing he may be." With these words he satisfied his brother, and the two went towards the part of the battle where the fight was thickest, about Kebriones, brave Polydamas, Phalces, Orthaios, godlike Polyphetes, Palmys, Askanios, and Morys son of Hippotion, who had come from fertile Askania on the preceding day to relieve other troops. Then Zeus urged them on to fight. They flew forth like the blasts of some fierce wind that strike earth in the van of a thunderstorm - they buffet the salt sea into an uproar; many and mighty are the great waves that come crashing in one after the other upon the shore with their arching heads all crested with foam - even so did rank behind rank of Trojans arrayed in gleaming armor follow their leaders onward. The way was led by Hektor son of Priam, peer of murderous Ares, with his round shield before him - his shield of ox-hides covered with plates of bronze - and his gleaming helmet upon his temples. He kept stepping forward under cover of his shield in every direction, making trial of the ranks to see if they would give way be him, but he could not daunt the courage of the Achaeans. Ajax was the first to stride out and challenge him. "Sir," he cried, "draw near; why do you think thus vainly to dismay the Argives? We Achaeans are excellent warriors, but the scourge of Zeus has fallen heavily upon us. Your heart, indeed, is set on destroying our ships, but we too have bands that can keep you at bay, and your own fair town shall be sooner taken and sacked by ourselves. The time is near when you shall pray Zeus and all the gods in your flight, that your steeds may be swifter than hawks as they raise the dust on the plain and bear you back to your city."

13.721

οἳ δ’ ὄπιθεν βάλλοντες ἐλάνθανον· οὐδέ τι χάρμης
Τρῶες μιμνήσκοντο· συνεκλόνεον γὰρ ὀϊστοί.
ἔνθά κε λευγαλέως νηῶν ἄπο καὶ κλισιάων
Τρῶες ἐχώρησαν προτὶ Ἴλιον ἠνεμόεσσαν,
εἰ μὴ Πουλυδάμας θρασὺν Ἕκτορα εἶπε παραστάς·
Ἕκτορ ἀμήχανός ἐσσι παραρρητοῖσι πιθέσθαι.
οὕνεκά τοι περὶ δῶκε θεὸς πολεμήϊα ἔργα
τοὔνεκα καὶ βουλῇ ἐθέλεις περιίδμεναι ἄλλων·
ἀλλ’ οὔ πως ἅμα πάντα δυνήσεαι αὐτὸς ἑλέσθαι.
ἄλλῳ μὲν γὰρ ἔδωκε θεὸς πολεμήϊα ἔργα,
ἄλλῳ δ’ ὀρχηστύν, ἑτέρῳ κίθαριν καὶ ἀοιδήν,
ἄλλῳ δ’ ἐν στήθεσσι τιθεῖ νόον εὐρύοπα Ζεὺς
ἐσθλόν, τοῦ δέ τε πολλοὶ ἐπαυρίσκοντ’ ἄνθρωποι,
καί τε πολέας ἐσάωσε, μάλιστα δὲ καὐτὸς ἀνέγνω.
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼν ἐρέω ὥς μοι δοκεῖ εἶναι ἄριστα·
πάντῃ γάρ σε περὶ στέφανος πολέμοιο δέδηε·
Τρῶες δὲ μεγάθυμοι ἐπεὶ κατὰ τεῖχος ἔβησαν
οἳ μὲν ἀφεστᾶσιν σὺν τεύχεσιν, οἳ δὲ μάχονται
παυρότεροι πλεόνεσσι κεδασθέντες κατὰ νῆας.
ἀλλ’ ἀναχασσάμενος κάλει ἐνθάδε πάντας ἀρίστους·
ἔνθεν δ’ ἂν μάλα πᾶσαν ἐπιφρασσαίμεθα βουλὴν
ἤ κεν ἐνὶ νήεσσι πολυκλήϊσι πέσωμεν
αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσι θεὸς δόμεναι κράτος, ἦ κεν ἔπειτα
πὰρ νηῶν ἔλθωμεν ἀπήμονες. ἦ γὰρ ἔγωγε
δείδω μὴ τὸ χθιζὸν ἀποστήσωνται Ἀχαιοὶ
χρεῖος, ἐπεὶ παρὰ νηυσὶν ἀνὴρ ἅτος πολέμοιο
μίμνει, ὃν οὐκέτι πάγχυ μάχης σχήσεσθαι ὀΐω.
ὣς φάτο Πουλυδάμας, ἄδε δ’ Ἕκτορι μῦθος ἀπήμων,
αὐτίκα δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων σὺν τεύχεσιν ἅλτο χαμᾶζε
καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·

13.751

Πουλυδάμα σὺ μὲν αὐτοῦ ἐρύκακε πάντας ἀρίστους,
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ κεῖσ’ εἶμι καὶ ἀντιόω πολέμοιο·
αἶψα δ’ ἐλεύσομαι αὖτις ἐπὴν εὖ τοῖς ἐπιτείλω.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ὁρμήθη ὄρεϊ νιφόεντι ἐοικὼς
κεκλήγων, διὰ δὲ Τρώων πέτετ’ ἠδ’ ἐπικούρων.
οἳ δ’ ἐς Πανθοΐδην ἀγαπήνορα Πουλυδάμαντα
πάντες ἐπεσσεύοντ’, ἐπεὶ Ἕκτορος ἔκλυον αὐδήν.
αὐτὰρ ὃ Δηΐφοβόν τε βίην θ’ Ἑλένοιο ἄνακτος
Ἀσιάδην τ’ Ἀδάμαντα καὶ Ἄσιον Ὑρτάκου υἱὸν
φοίτα ἀνὰ προμάχους διζήμενος, εἴ που ἐφεύροι.
τοὺς δ’ εὗρ’ οὐκέτι πάμπαν ἀπήμονας οὐδ’ ἀνολέθρους·
ἀλλ’ οἳ μὲν δὴ νηυσὶν ἔπι πρυμνῇσιν Ἀχαιῶν
χερσὶν ὑπ’ Ἀργείων κέατο ψυχὰς ὀλέσαντες,
οἳ δ’ ἐν τείχει ἔσαν βεβλημένοι οὐτάμενοί τε.
τὸν δὲ τάχ’ εὗρε μάχης ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ δακρυοέσσης
δῖον Ἀλέξανδρον Ἑλένης πόσιν ἠϋκόμοιο
θαρσύνονθ’ ἑτάρους καὶ ἐποτρύνοντα μάχεσθαι,
ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱστάμενος προσέφη αἰσχροῖς ἐπέεσσι·

769 Δύσπαρι εἶδος ἄριστε γυναιμανὲς ἠπεροπευτὰ
770 ποῦ τοι Δηΐφοβός τε βίη θ’ Ἑλένοιο ἄνακτος
771 Ἀσιάδης τ’ Ἀδάμας ἠδ’ Ἄσιος Ὑρτάκου υἱός;
772 ποῦ δέ τοι Ὀθρυονεύς; νῦν ὤλετο πᾶσα κατ’ ἄκρης
773 Ἴλιος αἰπεινή· νῦν τοι σῶς αἰπὺς ὄλεθρος.
774 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν Ἀλέξανδρος θεοειδής·
775 Ἕκτορ ἐπεί τοι θυμὸς ἀναίτιον αἰτιάασθαι,
776 ἄλλοτε δή ποτε μᾶλλον ἐρωῆσαι πολέμοιο
777 μέλλω, ἐπεὶ οὐδ’ ἐμὲ πάμπαν ἀνάλκιδα γείνατο μήτηρ·
778 ἐξ οὗ γὰρ παρὰ νηυσὶ μάχην ἤγειρας ἑταίρων,
779 ἐκ τοῦ δ’ ἐνθάδ’ ἐόντες ὁμιλέομεν Δαναοῖσι
780 νωλεμέως· ἔταροι δὲ κατέκταθεν οὓς σὺ μεταλλᾷς.

13.781

781 οἵω Δηΐφοβός τε βίη θ’ Ἑλένοιο ἄνακτος
782 οἴχεσθον, μακρῇσι τετυμμένω ἐγχείῃσιν
783 ἀμφοτέρω κατὰ χεῖρα· φόνον δ’ ἤμυνε Κρονίων.
784 νῦν δ’ ἄρχ’ ὅππῃ σε κραδίη θυμός τε κελεύει·
785 ἡμεῖς δ’ ἐμμεμαῶτες ἅμ’ ἑψόμεθ’, οὐδέ τί φημι
786 ἀλκῆς δευήσεσθαι, ὅση δύναμίς γε πάρεστι.
787 πὰρ δύναμιν δ’ οὐκ ἔστι καὶ ἐσσύμενον πολεμίζειν.
788 ὣς εἰπὼν παρέπεισεν ἀδελφειοῦ φρένας ἥρως·
789 βὰν δ’ ἴμεν ἔνθα μάλιστα μάχη καὶ φύλοπις ἦεν
790 ἀμφί τε Κεβριόνην καὶ ἀμύμονα Πουλυδάμαντα
791 Φάλκην Ὀρθαῖόν τε καὶ ἀντίθεον Πολυφήτην
792 Πάλμύν τ’ Ἀσκάνιόν τε Μόρυν θ’ υἷ’ Ἱπποτίωνος,
793 οἵ ῥ’ ἐξ Ἀσκανίης ἐριβώλακος ἦλθον ἀμοιβοὶ
794 ἠοῖ τῇ προτέρῃ· τότε δὲ Ζεὺς ὦρσε μάχεσθαι.
795 οἳ δ’ ἴσαν ἀργαλέων ἀνέμων ἀτάλαντοι ἀέλλῃ,
796 ἥ ῥά θ’ ὑπὸ βροντῆς πατρὸς Διὸς εἶσι πέδον δέ,
797 θεσπεσίῳ δ’ ὁμάδῳ ἁλὶ μίσγεται, ἐν δέ τε πολλὰ
798 κύματα παφλάζοντα πολυφλοίσβοιο θαλάσσης
799 κυρτὰ φαληριόωντα, πρὸ μέν τ’ ἄλλ’, αὐτὰρ ἐπ’ ἄλλα·
800 ὣς Τρῶες πρὸ μὲν ἄλλοι ἀρηρότες, αὐτὰρ ἐπ’ ἄλλοι,
801 χαλκῷ μαρμαίροντες ἅμ’ ἡγεμόνεσσιν ἕποντο.
802 Ἕκτωρ δ’ ἡγεῖτο βροτολοιγῷ ἶσος Ἄρηϊ
803 Πριαμίδης· πρόσθεν δ’ ἔχεν ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην
804 ῥινοῖσιν πυκινήν, πολλὸς δ’ ἐπελήλατο χαλκός·
805 ἀμφὶ δέ οἱ κροτάφοισι φαεινὴ σείετο πήληξ.
806 πάντῃ δ’ ἀμφὶ φάλαγγας ἐπειρᾶτο προποδίζων,
807 εἴ πώς οἱ εἴξειαν ὑπασπίδια προβιβῶντι·
808 ἀλλ’ οὐ σύγχει θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν Ἀχαιῶν.
809 Αἴας δὲ πρῶτος προκαλέσσατο μακρὰ βιβάσθων·
810 δαιμόνιε σχεδὸν ἐλθέ· τί ἢ δειδίσσεαι αὖτως

13.811

811 Ἀργείους; οὔ τοί τι μάχης ἀδαήμονές εἰμεν,
812 ἀλλὰ Διὸς μάστιγι κακῇ ἐδάμημεν Ἀχαιοί.
813 ἦ θήν πού τοι θυμὸς ἐέλπεται ἐξαλαπάξειν
814 νῆας· ἄφαρ δέ τε χεῖρες ἀμύνειν εἰσὶ καὶ ἡμῖν.

815 ἦ κε πολὺ φθαίη εὖ ναιομένη πόλις ὑμὴ
816 χερσὶν ὑφ’ ἡμετέρῃσιν ἁλοῦσά τε περθομένη τε.
817 σοὶ δ’ αὐτῷ φημὶ σχεδὸν ἔμμεναι ὀππότε φεύγων
818 ἀρήσῃ Διὶ πατρὶ καὶ ἄλλοις ἀθανάτοισι
819 θάσσονας ἰρήκων ἔμεναι καλλίτριχας ἵππους,
820 οἵ σε πόλιν δ’ οἴσουσι κονίοντες πεδίοιο.
821 ὣς ἄρα οἱ εἰπόντι ἐπέπτατο δεξιὸς ὄρνις
822 αἰετὸς ὑψιπέτης· ἐπὶ δ’ ἴαχε λαὸς Ἀχαιῶν
823 θάρσυνος οἰωνῷ· ὃ δ’ ἀμείβετο φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ·
824 Αἶαν ἀμαρτοεπὲς βουγάϊε ποῖον ἔειπες·
825 εἰ γὰρ ἐγὼν οὕτω γε Διὸς πάϊς αἰγιόχοιο
826 εἴην ἤματα πάντα, τέκοι δέ με πότνια Ἥρη,
827 τιοίμην δ’ ὡς τίετ’ Ἀθηναίη καὶ Ἀπόλλων,
828 ὡς νῦν ἡμέρη ἥδε κακὸν φέρει Ἀργείοισι
829 πᾶσι μάλ’, ἐν δὲ σὺ τοῖσι πεφήσεαι, αἴ κε ταλάσσῃς
830 μεῖναι ἐμὸν δόρυ μακρόν, ὅ τοι χρόα λειριόεντα
831 δάψει· ἀτὰρ Τρώων κορέεις κύνας ἠδ’ οἰωνοὺς
832 δημῷ καὶ σάρκεσσι πεσὼν ἐπὶ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν.
833 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἡγήσατο· τοὶ δ’ ἅμ’ ἕποντο
834 ἠχῇ θεσπεσίῃ, ἐπὶ δ’ ἴαχε λαὸς ὄπισθεν.
835 Ἀργεῖοι δ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐπίαχον, οὐδὲ λάθοντο
836 ἀλκῆς, ἀλλ’ ἔμενον Τρώων ἐπιόντας ἀρίστους.
837 ἠχὴ δ’ ἀμφοτέρων ἵκετ’ αἰθέρα καὶ Διὸς αὐγάς.
As he was thus speaking a bird flew by upon his right hand, and the host of the Achaeans shouted, for they took heart at the omen. But Hektor answered, "Ajax, braggart and false of tongue, would that I were as sure of being son for evermore to aegis-bearing Zeus, with Queen Hera for my mother, and of being held in like honor with Athena and Apollo, as I am that this day is big with the destruction of the Achaeans; and you shall fall among them if you dare abide my spear; it shall rend your fair body and bid you glut our hounds and birds of prey with your fat and your flesh, as you fall by the ships of the Achaeans." With these words he led the way and the others followed after with a cry that rent the air, while the host shouted behind them. The Argives on their part raised a shout likewise, nor did they forget their prowess, but stood firm against the onslaught of the Trojan chieftains, and the cry from both the hosts rose up to heaven and to the brightness of Zeus' presence.

14.1

1 Νέστορα δ’ οὐκ ἔλαθεν ἰαχὴ πίνοντά περ ἔμπης,
2 ἀλλ’ Ἀσκληπιάδην ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
3 φράζεο δῖε Μαχᾶον ὅπως ἔσται τάδε ἔργα·
4 μείζων δὴ παρὰ νηυσὶ βοὴ θαλερῶν αἰζηῶν.
5 ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν νῦν πῖνε καθήμενος αἴθοπα οἶνον
6 εἰς ὅ κε θερμὰ λοετρὰ ἐϋπλόκαμος Ἑκαμήδη
7 θερμήνῃ καὶ λούσῃ ἄπο βρότον αἱματόεντα·
8 αὐτὰρ ἐγὼν ἐλθὼν τάχα εἴσομαι ἐς περιωπήν.
9 ὣς εἰπὼν σάκος εἶλε τετυγμένον υἱὸς ἐοῖο
10 κείμενον ἐν κλισίῃ Θρασυμήδεος ἱπποδάμοιο
11 χαλκῷ παμφαῖνον· ὃ δ’ ἔχ’ ἀσπίδα πατρὸς ἑοῖο.
12 εἵλετο δ’ ἄλκιμον ἔγχος ἀκαχμένον ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ,
13 στῆ δ’ ἐκτὸς κλισίης, τάχα δ’ εἴσιδεν ἔργον ἀεικὲς
14 τοὺς μὲν ὀρινομένους, τοὺς δὲ κλονέοντας ὄπισθε
15 Τρῶας ὑπερθύμους· ἐρέριπτο δὲ τεῖχος Ἀχαιῶν.

16 ὡς δ’ ὅτε πορφύρῃ πέλαγος μέγα κύματι κωφῷ
17 ὀσσόμενον λιγέων ἀνέμων λαιψηρὰ κέλευθα
18 αὔτως, οὐδ’ ἄρα τε προκυλίνδεται οὐδετέρωσε,
19 πρίν τινα κεκριμένον καταβήμεναι ἐκ Διὸς οὖρον,
20 ὣς ὃ γέρων ὅρμαινε δαϊζόμενος κατὰ θυμὸν
21 διχθάδι’, ἢ μεθ’ ὅμιλον ἴοι Δαναῶν ταχυπώλων,
22 ἦε μετ’ Ἀτρεΐδην Ἀγαμέμνονα ποιμένα λαῶν.
23 ὣδε δέ οἱ φρονέοντι δοάσσατο κέρδιον εἶναι
24 βῆναι ἐπ’ Ἀτρεΐδην. οἳ δ’ ἀλλήλους ἐνάριζον
25 μαρνάμενοι· λάκε δέ σφι περὶ χροῒ χαλκὸς ἀτειρὴς
26 νυσσομένων ξίφεσίν τε καὶ ἔγχεσιν ἀμφιγύοισι.
27 Νέστορι δὲ ξύμβληντο διοτρεφέες βασιλῆες
28 πὰρ νηῶν ἀνιόντες ὅσοι βεβλήατο χαλκῷ
29 Τυδεΐδης Ὀδυσεύς τε καὶ Ἀτρεΐδης Ἀγαμέμνων.
30 πολλὸν γάρ ῥ’ ἀπάνευθε μάχης εἰρύατο νῆες
Nestor was sitting over his wine, but the cry of battle did not escape him, and he said to the son of Asklepios, "What, noble Machaon, is the meaning of all this? The shouts of men fighting by our ships grow stronger and stronger; stay here, therefore, and sit over your wine, while fair Hekamede heats you a bath and washes the clotted blood from off you. I will go at once to the look-out station and see what it is all about." As he spoke he took up the shield of his son Thrasymedes that was lying in his tent, all gleaming with bronze, for Thrasymedes had taken his father's shield; he grasped his redoubtable bronze-shod spear, and as soon as he was outside saw the disastrous rout of the Achaeans who, now that their wall was overthrown, were fleeing pell-mell before the Trojans. As when there is a heavy swell upon the sea, but the waves are dumb - they keep their eyes on the watch for the quarter whence the fierce winds may spring upon them, but they stay where they are and set neither this way nor that, till some particular wind sweeps down from heaven to determine [krinô] them - even so did the old man ponder whether to make for the crowd of Danaans, or go in search of Agamemnon. In the end he deemed it best to go to the son of Atreus; but meanwhile the hosts were fighting and killing one another, and the hard bronze rattled on their bodies, as they thrust at one another with their swords and spears. The wounded kings, the son of Tydeus, Odysseus, and Agamemnon son of Atreus, fell in Nestor as they were coming up from their ships - for theirs were drawn up some way from where the fighting was going on, being on the shore itself inasmuch as they had been beached first, while the wall had been built behind the hindermost. The stretch of the shore, wide though it was, did not afford room for all the ships, and the host was cramped for space, therefore they had placed the ships in rows one behind the other, and had filled the whole opening of the bay between the two points that formed it. The kings, leaning on their spears, were coming out to survey the fight, being in great anxiety, and when old Nestor met them they were filled with dismay. Then King Agamemnon said to him, "Nestor son of Neleus, honor to the Achaean name, why have you left the battle to come hither? I fear that what dread Hektor said will come true, when he vaunted among the Trojans saying that he would not return to Ilion till he had fired our ships and killed us; this is what he said, and now it is all coming true. Alas! others of the Achaeans, like Achilles, are in anger with me that they refuse to fight by the sterns of our ships." Then Nestor horseman of Gerene answered, "It is indeed as you say; it is all coming true at this moment, and even Zeus who thunders from on high cannot prevent it. Fallen is the wall on which we relied as an impregnable bulwark both for us and our fleet. The Trojans are fighting stubbornly and without ceasing at the ships; look where you may you cannot see from what quarter the rout of the Achaeans is coming; they are being killed in a confused mass and the battle-cry ascends to heaven; let us think, if counsel [noos] can be of any use, what we had better do;

but I do not advise our going into battle ourselves, for a man cannot fight when he is wounded." And King Agamemnon answered, "Nestor, if the Trojans are indeed fighting at the rear of our ships, and neither the wall nor the trench has served us - over which the Danaans toiled so hard, and which they deemed would be an impregnable bulwark both for us and our fleet - I see it must be the will of Zeus that the Achaeans should perish ingloriously here, far from Argos. I knew when Zeus was willing to defend us, and I know now that he is raising the Trojans to like honor with the gods, while us, on the other hand, he bas bound hand and foot. Now, therefore, let us all do as I say; let us bring down the ships that are on the beach and draw them into the water; let us make them fast to their mooring-stones a little way out, against the fall of night - if even by night the Trojans will desist from fighting; we may then draw down the rest of the fleet. There is no sense of nemesis in fleeing ruin even by night. It is better for a man that he should flee and be saved than be caught and killed." Odysseus looked fiercely at him and said, "Son of Atreus, what are you talking about? Wretch, you should have commanded some other and baser army, and not been ruler over us to whom Zeus has allotted a life of hard fighting from youth to old age, till we every one of us perish. Is it thus that you would quit the city of Troy, to win which we have suffered so much hardship? Hold your peace, lest some other of the Achaeans hear you say what no man who knows how to give good counsel, no king over so great a host as that of the Argives should ever have let fall from his lips. I despise your judgment utterly for what you have been saying. Would you, then, have us draw down our ships into the water while the battle is raging, and thus play further into the hands of the conquering Trojans? It would be ruin; the Achaeans will not go on fighting when they see the ships being drawn into the water, but will cease attacking and keep turning their eyes towards them; your counsel, therefore, Sir leader, would be our destruction." Agamemnon answered, "Odysseus, your rebuke has stung me to the heart. I am not, however, ordering the Achaeans to draw their ships into the sea whether they will or no. Some one, it may be, old or young, can offer us better counsel which I shall rejoice to hear." Then said Diomedes, "Such an one is at hand; he is not far to seek, if you will listen to me and not resent my speaking though I am younger than any of you. I am by lineage son to a noble sire, Tydeus, who lies buried at Thebes. For Portheus had three noble sons, two of whom, Agrios and Melas, abode in Pleuron and rocky Calydon. The third was the horseman Oeneus, my father's father, and he was the most valor [aretê] of them all. Oeneus remained in his own country, but my father (as Zeus and the other gods ordained it) migrated to Argos. He married into the family of Adrastos, and his house was one of great abundance, for he had large estates of fertile grain-growing land, with much orchard ground as well, and he had many sheep; moreover he excelled all the Argives in the use of the spear. You must yourselves have heard whether these things are true or no; therefore when I say well despise not my words as though I were a coward or of ignoble birth. I say, then, let us go to the fight as we needs must, wounded though we be. When there, we may keep out of the battle and beyond the range of the spears lest we get fresh wounds in addition to what we have already, but we can spur on others, who have been indulging their spleen and holding aloof from battle hitherto."

14.31

31 θῖν’ ἔφ’ ἁλὸς πολιῆς· τὰς γὰρ πρώτας πεδίον δὲ
32 εἵρυσαν, αὐτὰρ τεῖχος ἐπὶ πρύμνῃσιν ἔδειμαν.
33 οὐδὲ γὰρ οὐδ’ εὐρύς περ ἐὼν ἐδυνήσατο πάσας
34 αἰγιαλὸς νῆας χαδέειν, στείνοντο δὲ λαοί·
35 τώ ῥα προκρόσσας ἔρυσαν, καὶ πλῆσαν ἀπάσης
36 ἠϊόνος στόμα μακρόν, ὅσον συνεέργαθον ἄκραι.
37 τώ ῥ’ οἵ γ’ ὀψείοντες ἀϋτῆς καὶ πολέμοιο

ἔγχει ἐρειδόμενοι κίον ἀθρόοι· ἄχνυτο δέ σφι
θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν. ὃ δὲ ξύμβλητο γεραιὸς
Νέστωρ, πτῆξε δὲ θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν Ἀχαιῶν.
τὸν καὶ φωνήσας προσέφη κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων·
ὦ Νέστορ Νηληϊάδη μέγα κῦδος Ἀχαιῶν
τίπτε λιπὼν πόλεμον φθισήνορα δεῦρ’ ἀφικάνεις;
δείδω μὴ δή μοι τελέσῃ ἔπος ὄβριμος Ἕκτωρ,
ὥς ποτ’ ἐπηπείλησεν ἐνὶ Τρώεσσ’ ἀγορεύων
μὴ πρὶν πὰρ νηῶν προτὶ Ἴλιον ἀπονέεσθαι
πρὶν πυρὶ νῆας ἐνιπρῆσαι, κτεῖναι δὲ καὶ αὐτούς.
κεῖνος τὼς ἀγόρευε· τὰ δὴ νῦν πάντα τελεῖται.
ὢ πόποι ἦ ῥα καὶ ἄλλοι ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
ἐν θυμῷ βάλλονται ἐμοὶ χόλον ὥς περ Ἀχιλλεὺς
οὐδ’ ἐθέλουσι μάχεσθαι ἐπὶ πρυμνῇσι νέεσσι.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Γερήνιος ἱππότα Νέστωρ·
ἦ δὴ ταῦτά γ’ ἐτοῖμα τετεύχαται, οὐδέ κεν ἄλλως
Ζεὺς ὑψιβρεμέτης αὐτὸς παρατεκτήναιτο.
τεῖχος μὲν γὰρ δὴ κατερήριπεν, ᾧ ἐπέπιθμεν
ἄρρηκτον νηῶν τε καὶ αὐτῶν εἶλαρ ἔσεσθαι·
οἳ δ’ ἐπὶ νηυσὶ θοῇσι μάχην ἀλίαστον ἔχουσι
νωλεμές· οὐδ’ ἂν ἔτι γνοίης μάλα περ σκοπιάζων
ὁπποτέρωθεν Ἀχαιοὶ ὁρινόμενοι κλονέονται,
ὡς ἐπιμὶξ κτείνονται, ἀϋτὴ δ’ οὐρανὸν ἵκει.

14.61

ἡμεῖς δὲ φραζώμεθ’ ὅπως ἔσται τάδε ἔργα
εἴ τι νόος ῥέξει· πόλεμον δ’ οὐκ ἄμμε κελεύω
δύμεναι· οὐ γάρ πως βεβλημένον ἐστὶ μάχεσθαι.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
Νέστορ ἐπεὶ δὴ νηυσὶν ἔπι πρυμνῇσι μάχονται,
τεῖχος δ’ οὐκ ἔχραισμε τετυγμένον, οὐδέ τι τάφρος,
ᾗ ἔπι πολλὰ πάθον Δαναοί, ἔλποντο δὲ θυμῷ
ἄρρηκτον νηῶν τε καὶ αὐτῶν εἶλαρ ἔσεσθαι·
οὕτω που Διὶ μέλλει ὑπερμενέϊ φίλον εἶναι
νωνύμνους ἀπολέσθαι ἀπ’ Ἄργεος ἐνθάδ’ Ἀχαιούς.
ᾔδεα μὲν γὰρ ὅτε πρόφρων Δαναοῖσιν ἄμυνεν,
οἶδα δὲ νῦν ὅτε τοὺς μὲν ὁμῶς μακάρεσσι θεοῖσι
κυδάνει, ἡμέτερον δὲ μένος καὶ χεῖρας ἔδησεν.
ἀλλ’ ἄγεθ’ ὡς ἂν ἐγὼν εἴπω πειθώμεθα πάντες.
νῆες ὅσαι πρῶται εἰρύαται ἄγχι θαλάσσης
ἕλκωμεν, πάσας δὲ ἐρύσσομεν εἰς ἅλα δῖαν,
ὕψι δ’ ἐπ’ εὐνάων ὁρμίσσομεν, εἰς ὅ κεν ἔλθῃ
νὺξ ἀβρότη, ἣν καὶ τῇ ἀπόσχωνται πολέμοιο
Τρῶες· ἔπειτα δέ κεν ἐρυσαίμεθα νῆας ἁπάσας.
οὐ γάρ τις νέμεσις φυγέειν κακόν, οὐδ’ ἀνὰ νύκτα.
βέλτερον ὃς φεύγων προφύγῃ κακὸν ἠὲ ἁλώῃ.
τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεύς·
Ἀτρεΐδη ποῖόν σε ἔπος φύγεν ἕρκος ὀδόντων·
οὐλόμεν’ αἴθ’ ὤφελλες ἀεικελίου στρατοῦ ἄλλου
σημαίνειν, μὴ δ’ ἄμμιν ἀνασσέμεν, οἷσιν ἄρα Ζεὺς
ἐκ νεότητος ἔδωκε καὶ ἐς γῆρας τολυπεύειν

ἀργαλέους πολέμους, ὄφρα φθιόμεσθα ἕκαστος.
οὕτω δὴ μέμονας Τρώων πόλιν εὐρυάγυιαν
καλλείψειν, ἧς εἵνεκ’ ὀϊζύομεν κακὰ πολλά;
σίγα, μή τίς τ’ ἄλλος Ἀχαιῶν τοῦτον ἀκούσῃ

14.91

μῦθον, ὃν οὔ κεν ἀνήρ γε διὰ στόμα πάμπαν ἄγοιτο
ὅς τις ἐπίσταιτο ᾗσι φρεσὶν ἄρτια βάζειν
σκηπτοῦχός τ’ εἴη, καί οἱ πειθοίατο λαοὶ
τοσσοίδ’ ὅσσοισιν σὺ μετ’ Ἀργείοισιν ἀνάσσεις·
νῦν δέ σευ ὠνοσάμην πάγχυ φρένας, οἷον ἔειπες·
ὃς κέλεαι πολέμοιο συνεσταότος καὶ ἀϋτῆς
νῆας ἐϋσσέλμους ἅλαδ’ ἑλκέμεν, ὄφρ’ ἔτι μᾶλλον
Τρωσὶ μὲν εὐκτὰ γένηται ἐπικρατέουσί περ ἔμπης,
ἡμῖν δ’ αἰπὺς ὄλεθρος ἐπιρρέπῃ. οὐ γὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
σχήσουσιν πόλεμον νηῶν ἅλα δ’ ἑλκομενάων,
ἀλλ’ ἀποπαπτανέουσιν, ἐρωήσουσι δὲ χάρμης.
ἔνθά κε σὴ βουλὴ δηλήσεται ὄρχαμε λαῶν.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
ὦ Ὀδυσεῦ μάλα πώς με καθίκεο θυμὸν ἐνιπῇ
ἀργαλέῃ· ἀτὰρ οὐ μὲν ἐγὼν ἀέκοντας ἄνωγα
νῆας ἐϋσσέλμους ἅλα δ’ ἑλκέμεν υἷας Ἀχαιῶν.
νῦν δ’ εἴη ὃς τῆσδέ γ’ ἀμείνονα μῆτιν ἐνίσποι
ἢ νέος ἠὲ παλαιός· ἐμοὶ δέ κεν ἀσμένῳ εἴη.
τοῖσι δὲ καὶ μετέειπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Διομήδης·
ἐγγὺς ἀνήρ· οὐ δηθὰ ματεύσομεν· αἴ κ’ ἐθέλητε
πείθεσθαι, καὶ μή τι κότῳ ἀγάσησθε ἕκαστος
οὕνεκα δὴ γενεῇφι νεώτατός εἰμι μεθ’ ὑμῖν·
πατρὸς δ’ ἐξ ἀγαθοῦ καὶ ἐγὼ γένος εὔχομαι εἶναι
Τυδέος, ὃν Θήβῃσι χυτὴ κατὰ γαῖα καλύπτει.
πορθεῖ γὰρ τρεῖς παῖδες ἀμύμονες ἐξεγένοντο,
οἴκεον δ’ ἐν Πλευρῶνι καὶ αἰπεινῇ Καλυδῶνι
Ἄγριος ἠδὲ Μέλας, τρίτατος δ’ ἦν ἱππότα Οἰνεὺς
πατρὸς ἐμοῖο πατήρ· ἀρετῇ δ’ ἦν ἔξοχος αὐτῶν.
ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν αὐτόθι μεῖνε, πατὴρ δ’ ἐμὸς Ἄργεϊ νάσθη
πλαγχθείς· ὡς γάρ που Ζεὺς ἤθελε καὶ θεοὶ ἄλλοι.

14.121

Ἀδρήστοιο δ’ ἔγημε θυγατρῶν, ναῖε δὲ δῶμα
ἀφνειὸν βιότοιο, ἅλις δέ οἱ ἦσαν ἄρουραι
πυροφόροι, πολλοὶ δὲ φυτῶν ἔσαν ὄρχατοι ἀμφίς,
πολλὰ δέ οἱ πρόβατ’ ἔσκε· κέκαστο δὲ πάντας Ἀχαιοὺς
ἐγχείῃ· τὰ δὲ μέλλετ’ ἀκουέμεν, εἰ ἐτεόν περ.
τὼ οὐκ ἄν με γένος γε κακὸν καὶ ἀνάλκιδα φάντες
μῦθον ἀτιμήσαιτε πεφασμένον ὅν κ’ ἐὺ εἴπω.
δεῦτ’ ἴομεν πόλεμον δὲ καὶ οὐτάμενοί περ ἀνάγκῃ.
ἔνθα δ’ ἔπειτ’ αὐτοὶ μὲν ἐχώμεθα δηϊοτῆτος
ἐκ βελέων, μή πού τις ἐφ’ ἕλκεϊ ἕλκος ἄρηται·
ἄλλους δ’ ὀτρύνοντες ἐνήσομεν, οἳ τὸ πάρος περ
θυμῷ ἦρα φέροντες ἀφεστᾶσ’ οὐδὲ μάχονται.

133 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα τοῦ μάλα μὲν κλύον ἠδὲ πίθοντο·
134 βὰν δ’ ἴμεν, ἦρχε δ’ ἄρά σφιν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων.
135 οὐδ’ ἀλαοσκοπιὴν εἶχε κλυτὸς ἐννοσίγαιος,
136 ἀλλὰ μετ’ αὐτοὺς ἦλθε παλαιῷ φωτὶ ἐοικώς,
137 δεξιτερὴν δ’ ἕλε χεῖρ’ Ἀγαμέμνονος Ἀτρεΐδαο,
138 καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
139 Ἀτρεΐδη νῦν δή που Ἀχιλλῆος ὀλοὸν κῆρ
140 γηθεῖ ἐνὶ στήθεσσι φόνον καὶ φύζαν Ἀχαιῶν
141 δερκομένῳ, ἐπεὶ οὔ οἱ ἔνι φρένες οὐδ’ ἠβαιαί.
142 ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν ὣς ἀπόλοιτο, θεὸς δέ ἑ σιφλώσειε·
143 σοὶ δ’ οὔ πω μάλα πάγχυ θεοὶ μάκαρες κοτέουσιν,
144 ἀλλ’ ἔτι που Τρώων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες
145 εὐρὺ κονίσουσιν πεδίον, σὺ δ’ ἐπόψεαι αὐτὸς
146 φεύγοντας προτὶ ἄστυ νεῶν ἄπο καὶ κλισιάων.
147 ὣς εἰπὼν μέγ’ ἄϋσεν ἐπεσσύμενος πεδίοιο.
148 ὅσσόν τ’ ἐννεάχιλοι ἐπίαχον ἢ δεκάχιλοι
149 ἀνέρες ἐν πολέμῳ ἔριδα ξυνάγοντες Ἄρηος,
150 τόσσην ἐκ στήθεσφιν ὄπα κρείων ἐνοσίχθων
Thus did he speak; whereon they did even as he had said and set out, King Agamemnon leading the way. Meanwhile Poseidon had kept no blind look-out, and came up to them in the semblance of an old man. He took Agamemnon's right hand in his own and said, "Son of Atreus, I take it Achilles is glad now that he sees the Achaeans routed and slain, for he is utterly without remorse - may he come to a bad end and heaven confound him. As for yourself, the blessed gods are not yet so bitterly angry with you but that the princes and counselors of the Trojans shall again raise the dust upon the plain, and you shall see them fleeing from the ships and tents towards their city." With this he raised a mighty cry of battle, and sped forward to the plain. The voice that came from his deep chest was as that of nine or ten thousand men when they are shouting in the thick of a fight, and it put fresh courage into the hearts of the Achaeans to wage war and do battle without ceasing. Hera of the golden throne looked down as she stood upon a peak of Olympus and her heart was gladdened at the sight of him who was at once her brother and her brother-in-law, hurrying hither and thither amid the fighting. Then she turned her eyes to Zeus as he sat on the topmost crests of many-fountained Ida, and loathed him. She set herself to think how she might trick his thinking [noos], and in the end she deemed that it would be best for her to go to Ida and array herself in rich attire, in the hope that Zeus might become enamored of her, and wish to embrace her. While he was thus engaged a sweet and careless sleep might be made to steal over his eyes and senses. She went, therefore, to the room which her son Hephaistos had made her, and the doors of which he had cunningly fastened by means of a secret key so that no other god could open them. Here she entered and closed the doors behind her. She cleansed all the dirt from her fair body with ambrosia, then she anointed herself with olive oil, ambrosial, very soft, and scented specially for herself - if it were so much as shaken in the bronze-floored house of Zeus, the scent pervaded the universe of heaven and earth. With this she anointed her delicate skin, and then she plaited the fair ambrosial locks that flowed in a stream of golden tresses from her immortal head. She put on the wondrous robe which Athena had worked for her with consummate art, and had embroidered with manifold devices; she fastened it about her bosom with golden clasps, and she girded herself with a girdle that had a hundred tassels: then she fastened her earrings, three brilliant pendants with much charm radiating from them, through the pierced lobes of her ears, and threw a lovely new veil over her head. She bound her sandals on to her feet, and when she had finished making herself up in perfect order [kosmos], she left her room and called Aphrodite to come aside and speak to her. "My dear child," said

she, "will you do what I am going to ask of you, or will refuse me because you are angry at my being on the Danaan side, while you are on the Trojan?" Zeus' daughter Aphrodite answered, "Hera, august queen of goddesses, daughter of mighty Kronos, say what you want, and I will do it for at once, if I can, and if it can be done at all." Then Hera told her a lying tale and said, "I want you to endow me with some of those fascinating charms, the spells of which bring all things mortal and immortal to your feet. I am going to the world's end to visit Okeanos (from whom all we gods proceed) and mother Tethys: they received me in their house, took care of me, and brought me up, having taken me over from Rhaea when Zeus imprisoned great Kronos in the depths that are under earth and sea. I must go and see them that I may make peace between them; they have been quarreling, and are so angry that they have not slept with one another this long while; if I can bring them round and restore them to one another's embraces, they will be grateful to me and love me for ever afterwards."

14.151

ἦκεν· Ἀχαιοῖσιν δὲ μέγα σθένος ἔμβαλ’ ἑκάστῳ
καρδίῃ, ἄληκτον πολεμίζειν ἠδὲ μάχεσθαι.
Ἥρη δ’ εἰσεῖδε χρυσόθρονος ὀφθαλμοῖσι
στᾶσ’ ἐξ Οὐλύμποιο ἀπὸ ῥίου· αὐτίκα δ’ ἔγνω
τὸν μὲν ποιπνύοντα μάχην ἀνὰ κυδιάνειραν
αὐτοκασίγνητον καὶ δαέρα, χαῖρε δὲ θυμῷ·
Ζῆνα δ’ ἐπ’ ἀκροτάτης κορυφῆς πολυπίδακος Ἴδης
ἥμενον εἰσεῖδε, στυγερὸς δέ οἱ ἔπλετο θυμῷ.
μερμήριξε δ’ ἔπειτα βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη
ὅππως ἐξαπάφοιτο Διὸς νόον αἰγιόχοιο·
ἥδε δέ οἱ κατὰ θυμὸν ἀρίστη φαίνετο βουλὴ
ἐλθεῖν εἰς Ἴδην εὖ ἐντύνασαν ἣ αὐτήν,
εἴ πως ἱμείραιτο παραδραθέειν φιλότητι
ᾗ χροιῇ, τῷ δ’ ὕπνον ἀπήμονά τε λιαρόν τε
χεύῃ ἐπὶ βλεφάροισιν ἰδὲ φρεσὶ πευκαλίμῃσι.
βῆ δ’ ἴμεν ἐς θάλαμον, τόν οἱ φίλος υἱὸς ἔτευξεν
Ἥφαιστος, πυκινὰς δὲ θύρας σταθμοῖσιν ἐπῆρσε
κληῗδι κρυπτῇ, τὴν δ’ οὐ θεὸς ἄλλος ἀνῷγεν·
ἔνθ’ ἥ γ’ εἰσελθοῦσα θύρας ἐπέθηκε φαεινάς.
ἀμβροσίῃ μὲν πρῶτον ἀπὸ χροὸς ἱμερόεντος
λύματα πάντα κάθηρεν, ἀλείψατο δὲ λίπ’ ἐλαίῳ
ἀμβροσίῳ ἑδανῷ, τό ῥά οἱ τεθυωμένον ἦεν·
τοῦ καὶ κινυμένοιο Διὸς κατὰ χαλκοβατὲς δῶ
ἔμπης ἐς γαῖάν τε καὶ οὐρανὸν ἵκετ’ ἀϋτμή.
τῷ ῥ’ ἥ γε χρόα καλὸν ἀλειψαμένη ἰδὲ χαίτας
πεξαμένη χερσὶ πλοκάμους ἔπλεξε φαεινοὺς
καλοὺς ἀμβροσίους ἐκ κράατος ἀθανάτοιο.
ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ ἀμβρόσιον ἑανὸν ἕσαθ’, ὅν οἱ Ἀθήνη
ἔξυσ’ ἀσκήσασα, τίθει δ’ ἐνὶ δαίδαλα πολλά·
χρυσείῃς δ’ ἐνετῇσι κατὰ στῆθος περονᾶτο.

14.181

ζώσατο δὲ ζώνῃ ἑκατὸν θυσάνοις ἀραρυίῃ,
ἐν δ’ ἄρα ἕρματα ἦκεν ἐϋτρήτοισι λοβοῖσι
τρίγληνα μορόεντα· χάρις δ’ ἀπελάμπετο πολλή.

κρηδέμνῳ δ’ ἐφύπερθε καλύψατο δῖα θεάων
καλῷ νηγατέῳ· λευκὸν δ’ ἦν ἠέλιος ὥς·
ποσσὶ δ’ ὑπὸ λιπαροῖσιν ἐδήσατο καλὰ πέδιλα.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ πάντα περὶ χροῒ θήκατο κόσμον
βῆ ῥ’ ἴμεν ἐκ θαλάμοιο, καλεσσαμένη δ’ Ἀφροδίτην
τῶν ἄλλων ἀπάνευθε θεῶν πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπε·
ἦ ῥά νύ μοί τι πίθοιο φίλον τέκος ὅττί κεν εἴπω,
ἦέ κεν ἀρνήσαιο κοτεσσαμένη τό γε θυμῷ,
οὕνεκ’ ἐγὼ Δαναοῖσι, σὺ δὲ Τρώεσσιν ἀρήγεις;
τὴν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἀφροδίτη·
Ἥρη πρέσβα θεὰ θύγατερ μεγάλοιο Κρόνοιο
αὔδα ὅ τι φρονέεις· τελέσαι δέ με θυμὸς ἄνωγεν,
εἰ δύναμαι τελέσαι γε καὶ εἰ τετελεσμένον ἐστίν.
τὴν δὲ δολοφρονέουσα προσηύδα πότνια Ἥρη·
δὸς νῦν μοι φιλότητα καὶ ἵμερον, ᾧ τε σὺ πάντας
δαμνᾷ ἀθανάτους ἠδὲ θνητοὺς ἀνθρώπους.
εἶμι γὰρ ὀψομένη πολυφόρβου πείρατα γαίης,
Ὠκεανόν τε θεῶν γένεσιν καὶ μητέρα Τηθύν,
οἵ μ’ ἐν σφοῖσι δόμοισιν ἐὺ τρέφον ἠδ’ ἀτίταλλον
δεξάμενοι Ῥείας, ὅτε τε Κρόνον εὐρύοπα Ζεὺς
γαίης νέρθε καθεῖσε καὶ ἀτρυγέτοιο θαλάσσης·
τοὺς εἶμ’ ὀψομένη, καί σφ’ ἄκριτα νείκεα λύσω·
ἤδη γὰρ δηρὸν χρόνον ἀλλήλων ἀπέχονται
εὐνῆς καὶ φιλότητος, ἐπεὶ χόλος ἔμπεσε θυμῷ.
εἰ κείνω ἐπέεσσι παραιπεπιθοῦσα φίλον κῆρ
εἰς εὐνὴν ἀνέσαιμι ὁμωθῆναι φιλότητι,
αἰεί κέ σφι φίλη τε καὶ αἰδοίη καλεοίμην.

14.211

τὴν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε φιλομειδὴς Ἀφροδίτη·
οὐκ ἔστ’ οὐδὲ ἔοικε τεὸν ἔπος ἀρνήσασθαι·
Ζηνὸς γὰρ τοῦ ἀρίστου ἐν ἀγκοίνῃσιν ἰαύεις.
ἦ, καὶ ἀπὸ στήθεσφιν ἐλύσατο κεστὸν ἱμάντα
ποικίλον, ἔνθα δέ οἱ θελκτήρια πάντα τέτυκτο·
ἔνθ’ ἔνι μὲν φιλότης, ἐν δ’ ἵμερος, ἐν δ’ ὀαριστὺς
πάρφασις, ἥ τ’ ἔκλεψε νόον πύκα περ φρονεόντων.
τόν ῥά οἱ ἔμβαλε χερσὶν ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζε·
τῇ νῦν τοῦτον ἱμάντα τεῷ ἐγκάθεο κόλπῳ
ποικίλον, ᾧ ἔνι πάντα τετεύχαται· οὐδέ σέ φημι
ἄπρηκτόν γε νέεσθαι, ὅ τι φρεσὶ σῇσι μενοινᾷς.
ὣς φάτο, μείδησεν δὲ βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη,
μειδήσασα δ’ ἔπειτα ἐῷ ἐγκάθετο κόλπῳ.
ἣ μὲν ἔβη πρὸς δῶμα Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἀφροδίτη,
Ἥρη δ’ ἀΐξασα λίπεν ῥίον Οὐλύμποιο,
Πιερίην δ’ ἐπιβᾶσα καὶ Ἠμαθίην ἐρατεινὴν
σεύατ’ ἐφ’ ἱπποπόλων Θρῃκῶν ὄρεα νιφόεντα
ἀκροτάτας κορυφάς· οὐδὲ χθόνα μάρπτε ποδοῖιν·
ἐξ Ἄθόω δ’ ἐπὶ πόντον ἐβήσετο κυμαίνοντα,
Λῆμνον δ’ εἰσαφίκανε πόλιν θείοιο Θόαντος.
ἔνθ’ Ὕπνῳ ξύμβλητο κασιγνήτῳ Θανάτοιο,
ἔν τ’ ἄρα οἱ φῦ χειρὶ ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζεν·

233 Ὕπνε ἄναξ πάντων τε θεῶν πάντων τ’ ἀνθρώπων,
234 ἠμὲν δή ποτ’ ἐμὸν ἔπος ἔκλυες, ἠδ’ ἔτι καὶ νῦν
235 πείθευ· ἐγὼ δέ κέ τοι ἰδέω χάριν ἤματα πάντα.
236 κοίμησόν μοι Ζηνὸς ὑπ’ ὀφρύσιν ὅσσε φαεινὼ
237 αὐτίκ’ ἐπεί κεν ἐγὼ παραλέξομαι ἐν φιλότητι.
238 δῶρα δέ τοι δώσω καλὸν θρόνον ἄφθιτον αἰεὶ
239 χρύσεον· Ἥφαιστος δέ κ’ ἐμὸς πάϊς ἀμφιγυήεις
240 τεύξει’ ἀσκήσας, ὑπὸ δὲ θρῆνυν ποσὶν ἧσει,
Thereon laughter-loving Aphrodite said, "I cannot and must not refuse you, for you sleep in the arms of Zeus who is our king." As she spoke she loosed from her bosom the curiously embroidered girdle into which all her charms had been wrought - love, desire, and that sweet flattery which steals the judgment [noos] even of the most prudent. She gave the girdle to Hera and said, "Take this girdle wherein all my charms reside and lay it in your bosom. If you will wear it I promise you that your errand, be it what it may, will not be bootless." When she heard this Hera smiled, and still smiling she laid the girdle in her bosom. Aphrodite now went back into the house of Zeus, while Hera darted down from the summits of Olympus. She passed over Pieria and fair Emathia, and went on and on till she came to the snowy ranges of the Thracian horsemen, over whose topmost crests she sped without ever setting foot to ground. When she came to Athos she went on over the, waves of the sea [pontos] till she reached Lemnos, the city of noble Thoas. There she met Sleep, own brother to Death, and caught him by the hand, saying, "Sleep, you who lord it alike over mortals and immortals, if you ever did me a service in times past, do one for me now, and I shall show gratitude [kharis] to you ever after. Close Zeus' keen eyes for me in slumber while I hold him clasped in my embrace, and I will give you a beautiful golden seat, that can never fall to pieces; my clubfooted son Hephaistos shall make it for you, and he shall give it a footstool for you to rest your fair feet upon when you are at table." Then Sleep answered, "Hera, great queen of goddesses, daughter of mighty Kronos, I would lull any other of the gods to sleep without compunction, not even excepting the waters of Okeanos from whom all of them proceed, but I dare not go near Zeus, nor send him to sleep unless he bids me. I have had one lesson already through doing what you asked me, on the day when Zeus' mighty son Herakles set sail from Ilion after having sacked the city of the Trojans. At your bidding I suffused my sweet self over the mind [noos] of aegis-bearing Zeus, and laid him to rest; meanwhile you hatched a plot against Herakles, and set the blasts of the angry winds beating upon the sea [pontos], till you took him to the goodly city of Cos away from all his friends. Zeus was furious when he awoke, and began hurling the gods about all over the house; he was looking more particularly for myself, and would have flung me down through space into the sea [pontos] where I should never have been heard of any more, had not Night who cows both men and gods protected me. I fled to her and Zeus left off looking for me in spite of his being so angry, for he did not dare do anything to displease Night. And now you are again asking me to do something on which I cannot venture." And Hera said, "Sleep, why do you take such notions as those into your head? Do you think Zeus will be as anxious to help the Trojans, as he was about his own son? Come, I will marry you to one of the youngest of the Graces [kharites], and she shall be your own - Pasithea, whom you have always wanted to marry." Sleep was pleased when he heard this, and answered, "Then swear it to me by the dread waters of the river Styx; lay one hand on the bounteous earth, and the other on the sheen of the sea, so that all the gods who dwell down below with Kronos may be our witnesses, and see that you really do give me one of the youngest of the Graces [kharites] - Pasithea, whom I have always wanted to marry." Hera did as he had said. She swore, and invoked all the gods of the nether world, who are called Titans, to witness. When she had completed her oath, the two enshrouded themselves in a thick mist and sped lightly forward, leaving Lemnos and Imbros behind them. Presently they reached

many-fountained Ida, mother of wild beasts, and Lectum where they left the sea to go on by land, and the tops of the trees of the forest soughed under the going of their feet. Here Sleep halted, and ere Zeus caught sight of him he climbed a lofty pine-tree - the tallest that reared its head towards heaven on all Ida. He hid himself behind the branches and sat there in the semblance of the sweet-singing bird that haunts the mountains and is called Khalkis by the gods, but men call it Kymindis. Hera then went to Gargaros, the topmost peak of Ida, and Zeus, driver of the clouds, set eyes upon her. As soon as he did so he became inflamed with the same passionate desire for her that he had felt when they had first enjoyed each other's embraces, and slept with one another without their dear parents knowing anything about it.

14.241

241 τῷ κεν ἐπισχοίης λιπαροὺς πόδας εἰλαπινάζων.
242 τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσεφώνεε νήδυμος Ὕπνος·
243 Ἥρη πρέσβα θεὰ θύγατερ μεγάλοιο Κρόνοιο
244 ἄλλον μέν κεν ἔγωγε θεῶν αἰειγενετάων
245 ῥεῖα κατευνήσαιμι, καὶ ἂν ποταμοῖο ῥέεθρα
246 Ὠκεανοῦ, ὅς περ γένεσις πάντεσσι τέτυκται·
247 Ζηνὸς δ’ οὐκ ἂν ἔγωγε Κρονίονος ἅσσον ἰκοίμην
248 οὐδὲ κατευνήσαιμ’, ὅτε μὴ αὐτός γε κελεύοι.
249 ἤδη γάρ με καὶ ἄλλο τεὴ ἐπίνυσσεν ἐφετμὴ
250 ἤματι τῷ ὅτε κεῖνος ὑπέρθυμος Διὸς υἱὸς
251 ἔπλεεν Ἰλιόθεν Τρώων πόλιν ἐξαλαπάξας.
252 ἤτοι ἐγὼ μὲν ἔλεξα Διὸς νόον αἰγιόχοιο
253 νήδυμος ἀμφιχυθείς· σὺ δέ οἱ κακὰ μήσαο θυμῷ
254 ὄρσασ’ ἀργαλέων ἀνέμων ἐπὶ πόντον ἀήτας,
255 καί μιν ἔπειτα Κόων δ’ εὖ ναιομένην ἀπένεικας
256 νόσφι φίλων πάντων. ὃ δ’ ἐπεγρόμενος χαλέπαινε
257 ῥιπτάζων κατὰ δῶμα θεούς, ἐμὲ δ’ ἔξοχα πάντων
258 ζήτει· καί κέ μ’ ἄϊστον ἀπ’ αἰθέρος ἔμβαλε πόντῳ,
259 εἰ μὴ Νὺξ δμήτειρα θεῶν ἐσάωσε καὶ ἀνδρῶν·
260 τὴν ἰκόμην φεύγων, ὃ δ’ ἐπαύσατο χωόμενός περ.
261 ἄζετο γὰρ μὴ Νυκτὶ θοῇ ἀποθύμια ἔρδοι.
262 νῦν αὖ τοῦτό μ’ ἄνωγας ἀμήχανον ἄλλο τελέσσαι.
263 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη·
264 Ὕπνε τί ἢ δὲ σὺ ταῦτα μετὰ φρεσὶ σῇσι μενοινᾷς;
265 ἦ φῂς ὡς Τρώεσσιν ἀρηξέμεν εὐρύοπα Ζῆν
266 ὡς Ἡρακλῆος περιχώσατο παῖδος ἑοῖο;
267 ἀλλ’ ἴθ’, ἐγὼ δέ κέ τοι Χαρίτων μίαν ὁπλοτεράων
268 δώσω ὀπυιέμεναι καὶ σὴν κεκλῆσθαι ἄκοιτιν.
270 ὣς φάτο, χήρατο δ’ Ὕπνος, ἀμειβόμενος δὲ προσηύδα·
271 ἄγρει νῦν μοι ὅμοσσον ἀάατον Στυγὸς ὕδωρ,

14.272

272 χειρὶ δὲ τῇ ἑτέρῃ μὲν ἕλε χθόνα πουλυβότειραν,
273 τῇ δ’ ἑτέρῃ ἅλα μαρμαρέην, ἵνα νῶϊν ἅπαντες
274 μάρτυροι ὦσ’ οἳ ἔνερθε θεοὶ Κρόνον ἀμφὶς ἑόντες,
275 ἦ μὲν ἐμοὶ δώσειν Χαρίτων μίαν ὁπλοτεράων
276 Πασιθέην, ἧς τ’ αὐτὸς ἐέλδομαι ἤματα πάντα.
277 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη,

278 ὄμνυε δ’ ὡς ἐκέλευε, θεοὺς δ’ ὀνόμηνεν ἅπαντας
279 τοὺς ὑποταρταρίους οἳ Τιτῆνες καλέονται.
280 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί ῥ’ ὅμοσέν τε τελεύτησέν τε τὸν ὅρκον,
281 τὼ βήτην Λήμνου τε καὶ Ἴμβρου ἄστυ λιπόντε
282 ἠέρα ἐσσαμένω ῥίμφα πρήσσοντε κέλευθον.
283 Ἴδην δ’ ἱκέσθην πολυπίδακα μητέρα θηρῶν
284 Λεκτόν, ὅθι πρῶτον λιπέτην ἅλα· τὼ δ’ ἐπὶ χέρσου
285 βήτην, ἀκροτάτη δὲ ποδῶν ὕπο σείετο ὕλη.
286 ἔνθ’ Ὕπνος μὲν ἔμεινε πάρος Διὸς ὄσσε ἰδέσθαι
287 εἰς ἐλάτην ἀναβὰς περιμήκετον, ἣ τότ’ ἐν Ἴδῃ
288 μακροτάτη πεφυυῖα δι’ ἠέρος αἰθέρ’ ἵκανεν·
289 ἔνθ’ ἧστ’ ὄζοισιν πεπυκασμένος εἰλατίνοισιν
290 ὄρνιθι λιγυρῇ ἐναλίγκιος, ἥν τ’ ἐν ὄρεσσι
291 χαλκίδα κικλήσκουσι θεοί, ἄνδρες δὲ κύμινδιν.
292 Ἥρη δὲ κραιπνῶς προσεβήσετο Γάργαρον ἄκρον
293 Ἴδης ὑψηλῆς· ἴδε δὲ νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς.
294 ὡς δ’ ἴδεν, ὥς μιν ἔρως πυκινὰς φρένας ἀμφεκάλυψεν,
295 οἷον ὅτε πρῶτόν περ ἐμισγέσθην φιλότητι
296 εἰς εὐνὴν φοιτῶντε, φίλους λήθοντε τοκῆας.
297 στῆ δ’ αὐτῆς προπάροιθεν ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζεν·
298 Ἥρη πῇ μεμαυῖα κατ’ Οὐλύμπου τόδ’ ἱκάνεις;
299 ἵπποι δ’ οὐ παρέασι καὶ ἅρματα τῶν κ’ ἐπιβαίης.
300 τὸν δὲ δολοφρονέουσα προσηύδα πότνια Ἥρη·
301 ἔρχομαι ὀψομένη πολυφόρβου πείρατα γαίης,

He went up to her and said, "What do you want that you have come hither from Olympus - and that too with neither chariot nor horses to convey you?" Then Hera told him a lying tale and said, "I am going to the world's end, to visit Okeanos, from whom all we gods proceed, and mother Tethys; they received me into their house, took care of me, and brought me up. I must go and see them that I may make peace between them: they have been quarreling, and are so angry that they have not slept with one another this long time. The horses that will take me over land and sea are stationed on the lowermost spurs of many-fountained Ida, and I have come here from Olympus on purpose to consult you. I was afraid you might be angry with me later on, if I went to the house of Okeanos without letting you know." And Zeus said, "Hera, you can choose some other time for paying your visit to Okeanos - for the present let us devote ourselves to love and to the enjoyment of one another. Never yet have I been so overpowered by passion neither for goddess nor mortal woman as I am at this moment for yourself - not even when I was in love with the wife of Ixion who bore me Peirithoos, peer of gods in counsel, nor yet with Danae the daintily-ankled daughter of Acrisius, who bore me the famed hero Perseus. Then there was the daughter of Phoenix, who bore me Minos and Rhadamanthus: there was Semele, and Alkmene in Thebes by whom I begot my lion-hearted son Herakles, while Semele became mother to Bacchus the comforter of humankind. There was queen Demeter again, and lovely Leto, and yourself - but with none of these was I ever so much enamored as I now am with you." Hera again answered him with a lying tale. "Most dread son of Kronos," she exclaimed, "what are you talking about? Would you have us enjoy one another here on the top of Mount Ida, where everything can be seen? What if one of the ever-living gods should see us sleeping together, and tell the others? It would be such a scandal that when I had risen from your embraces I could never show myself inside your house again; but if you are so minded, there is a room which your son Hephaistos has made me, and he has given it good strong doors; if you would so have it, let us go thither and lie down." And Zeus answered, "Hera, you need not be afraid that either god or man will see you, for I will enshroud both of us in such a dense

golden cloud, that the very sun for all his bright piercing beams shall not see through it." With this the son of Kronos caught his wife in his embrace; whereon the earth sprouted them a cushion of young grass, with dew-bespangled lotus, crocus, and hyacinth, so soft and thick that it raised them well above the ground. Here they laid themselves down and overhead they were covered by a fair cloud of gold, from which there fell glittering dew-drops. Thus, then, did the sire of all things repose peacefully on the crest of Ida, overcome at once by sleep and love, and he held his spouse in his arms. Meanwhile Sleep made off to the ships of the Achaeans, to tell earth-encircling Poseidon, lord of the earthquake. When he had found him he said, "Now, Poseidon, you can help the Danaans with a will, and give them victory though it be only for a short time while Zeus is still sleeping. I have sent him into a sweet slumber, and Hera has beguiled him into going to bed with her." Sleep now departed and went his ways to and fro among humankind, leaving Poseidon more eager than ever to help the Danaans. He darted forward among the first ranks and shouted saying, "Argives, shall we let Hektor son of Priam have the triumph of taking our ships and covering himself with glory? This is what he says that he shall now do, seeing that Achilles is still in dudgeon at his ship; We shall get on very well without him if we keep each other in heart and stand by one another. Now, therefore, let us all do as I say. Let us each take the best and largest shield we can lay hold of, put on our helmets, and sally forth with our longest spears in our hands; will lead you on, and Hektor son of Priam, rage as he may, will not dare to hold out against us. If any good staunch warrior has only a small shield, let him hand it over to a worse man, and take a larger one for himself."

14.302

302 Ὠκεανόν τε θεῶν γένεσιν καὶ μητέρα Τηθύν,
303 οἵ με σφοῖσι δόμοισιν ἐὺ τρέφον ἠδ’ ἀτίταλλον·
304 τοὺς εἶμ’ ὀψομένη, καί σφ’ ἄκριτα νείκεα λύσω·
305 ἤδη γὰρ δηρὸν χρόνον ἀλλήλων ἀπέχονται
306 εὐνῆς καὶ φιλότητος, ἐπεὶ χόλος ἔμπεσε θυμῷ.
307 ἵπποι δ’ ἐν πρυμνωρείῃ πολυπίδακος Ἴδης
308 ἑστᾶσ’, οἵ μ’ οἴσουσιν ἐπὶ τραφερήν τε καὶ ὑγρήν.
309 νῦν δὲ σεῦ εἵνεκα δεῦρο κατ’ Οὐλύμπου τόδ’ ἱκάνω,
310 μή πώς μοι μετέπειτα χολώσεαι, αἴ κε σιωπῇ
311 οἴχωμαι πρὸς δῶμα βαθυρρόου Ὠκεανοῖο.
312 τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
313 Ἥρη κεῖσε μὲν ἔστι καὶ ὕστερον ὁρμηθῆναι,
314 νῶϊ δ’ ἄγ’ ἐν φιλότητι τραπείομεν εὐνηθέντε.
315 οὐ γάρ πώ ποτέ μ’ ὧδε θεᾶς ἔρος οὐδὲ γυναικὸς
316 θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσι περιπροχυθεὶς ἐδάμασσεν,
317 οὐδ’ ὁπότ’ ἠρασάμην Ἰξιονίης ἀλόχοιο,
318 ἣ τέκε Πειρίθοον θεόφιν μήστωρ’ ἀτάλαντον·
319 οὐδ’ ὅτε περ Δανάης καλλισφύρου Ἀκρισιώνης,
320 ἣ τέκε Περσῆα πάντων ἀριδείκετον ἀνδρῶν·
321 οὐδ’ ὅτε Φοίνικος κούρης τηλεκλειτοῖο,
322 ἣ τέκε μοι Μίνων τε καὶ ἀντίθεον Ῥαδάμανθυν·
323 οὐδ’ ὅτε περ Σεμέλης οὐδ’ Ἀλκμήνης ἐνὶ Θήβῃ,
324 ἥ ῥ’ Ἡρακλῆα κρατερόφρονα γείνατο παῖδα·
325 ἣ δὲ Διώνυσον Σεμέλη τέκε χάρμα βροτοῖσιν·
326 οὐδ’ ὅτε Δήμητρος καλλιπλοκάμοιο ἀνάσσης,
327 οὐδ’ ὁπότε Λητοῦς ἐρικυδέος, οὐδὲ σεῦ αὐτῆς,
328 ὡς σέο νῦν ἔραμαι καί με γλυκὺς ἵμερος αἱρεῖ.
329 τὸν δὲ δολοφρονέουσα προσηύδα πότνια Ἥρη·

αἰνότατε Κρονίδη ποῖον τὸν μῦθον ἔειπες.
εἰ νῦν ἐν φιλότητι λιλαίεαι εὐνηθῆναι

14.332

Ἴδης ἐν κορυφῇσι, τὰ δὲ προπέφανται ἅπαντα·
πῶς κ’ ἔοι εἴ τις νῶϊ θεῶν αἰειγενετάων
εὕδοντ’ ἀθρήσειε, θεοῖσι δὲ πᾶσι μετελθὼν
πεφράδοι; οὐκ ἂν ἔγωγε τεὸν πρὸς δῶμα νεοίμην
ἐξ εὐνῆς ἀνστᾶσα, νεμεσσητὸν δέ κεν εἴη.
ἀλλ’ εἰ δή ῥ’ ἐθέλεις καί τοι φίλον ἔπλετο θυμῷ,
ἔστιν τοι θάλαμος, τόν τοι φίλος υἱὸς ἔτευξεν
Ἥφαιστος, πυκινὰς δὲ θύρας σταθμοῖσιν ἐπῆρσεν·
ἔνθ’ ἴομεν κείοντες, ἐπεί νύ τοι εὖαδεν εὐνή.
τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
Ἥρη μήτε θεῶν τό γε δείδιθι μήτέ τιν’ ἀνδρῶν
ὄψεσθαι· τοῖόν τοι ἐγὼ νέφος ἀμφικαλύψω
χρύσεον· οὐδ’ ἂν νῶϊ διαδράκοι Ἠέλιός περ,
οὔ τε καὶ ὀξύτατον πέλεται φάος εἰσοράασθαι.
ἦ ῥα καὶ ἀγκὰς ἔμαρπτε Κρόνου παῖς ἣν παράκοιτιν·
τοῖσι δ’ ὑπὸ χθὼν δῖα φύεν νεοθηλέα ποίην,
λωτόν θ’ ἑρσήεντα ἰδὲ κρόκον ἠδ’ ὑάκινθον
πυκνὸν καὶ μαλακόν, ὃς ἀπὸ χθονὸς ὑψόσ’ ἔεργε.
τῷ ἔνι λεξάσθην, ἐπὶ δὲ νεφέλην ἔσσαντο
καλὴν χρυσείην· στιλπναὶ δ’ ἀπέπιπτον ἔερσαι.
ὣς ὃ μὲν ἀτρέμας εὗδε πατὴρ ἀνὰ Γαργάρῳ ἄκρῳ,
ὕπνῳ καὶ φιλότητι δαμείς, ἔχε δ’ ἀγκὰς ἄκοιτιν·
βῆ δὲ θέειν ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν νήδυμος Ὕπνος
ἀγγελίην ἐρέων γαιήοχῳ ἐννοσιγαίῳ·
ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱστάμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
πρόφρων νῦν Δαναοῖσι Ποσείδαον ἐπάμυνε,
καί σφιν κῦδος ὄπαζε μίνυνθά περ, ὄφρ’ ἔτι εὕδει
Ζεύς, ἐπεὶ αὐτῷ ἐγὼ μαλακὸν περὶ κῶμ’ ἐκάλυψα·
Ἥρη δ’ ἐν φιλότητι παρήπαφεν εὐνηθῆναι.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὃ μὲν ὤχετ’ ἐπὶ κλυτὰ φῦλ’ ἀνθρώπων,

14.362

τὸν δ’ ἔτι μᾶλλον ἀνῆκεν ἀμυνέμεναι Δαναοῖσιν.
αὐτίκα δ’ ἐν πρώτοισι μέγα προθορὼν ἐκέλευσεν·
Ἀργεῖοι καὶ δ’ αὖτε μεθίεμεν Ἕκτορι νίκην
Πριαμίδῃ, ἵνα νῆας ἕλῃ καὶ κῦδος ἄρηται;
ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν οὕτω φησὶ καὶ εὔχεται οὔνεκ’ Ἀχιλλεὺς
νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσι μένει κεχολωμένος ἦτορ·
κείνου δ’ οὔ τι λίην ποθὴ ἔσσεται, εἴ κεν οἳ ἄλλοι
ἡμεῖς ὀτρυνώμεθ’ ἀμυνέμεν ἀλλήλοισιν.
ἀλλ’ ἄγεθ’ ὡς ἂν ἐγὼ εἴπω πειθώμεθα πάντες·
ἀσπίδες ὅσσαι ἄρισται ἐνὶ στρατῷ ἠδὲ μέγισται
ἐσσάμενοι, κεφαλὰς δὲ παναίθησιν κορύθεσσι
κρύψαντες, χερσίν τε τὰ μακρότατ’ ἔγχε’ ἑλόντες
ἴομεν· αὐτὰρ ἐγὼν ἡγήσομαι, οὐδ’ ἔτι φημὶ
Ἕκτορα Πριαμίδην μενέειν μάλα περ μεμαῶτα.

376 ὃς δέ κ’ ἀνὴρ μενέχαρμος, ἔχει δ’ ὀλίγον σάκος ὤμῳ,
377 χείρονι φωτὶ δότω, ὃ δ’ ἐν ἀσπίδι μείζονι δύτω.
378 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα τοῦ μάλα μὲν κλύον ἠδὲ πίθοντο·
379 τοὺς δ’ αὐτοὶ βασιλῆες ἐκόσμεον οὐτάμενοί περ
380 Τυδεΐδης Ὀδυσεύς τε καὶ Ἀτρεΐδης Ἀγαμέμνων·
381 οἰχόμενοι δ’ ἐπὶ πάντας ἀρήϊα τεύχε’ ἄμειβον·
382 ἐσθλὰ μὲν ἐσθλὸς ἔδυνε, χέρεια δὲ χείρονι δόσκεν.
383 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί ῥ’ ἔσσαντο περὶ χροῒ νώροπα χαλκὸν
384 βάν ῥ’ ἴμεν· ἦρχε δ’ ἄρά σφι Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων
385 δεινὸν ἄορ τανύηκες ἔχων ἐν χειρὶ παχείῃ
386 εἴκελον ἀστεροπῇ· τῷ δ’ οὐ θέμις ἐστὶ μιγῆναι
387 ἐν δαὶ λευγαλέῃ, ἀλλὰ δέος ἰσχάνει ἄνδρας.
388 Τρῶας δ’ αὖθ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐκόσμει φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ.
389 δή ῥα τότ’ αἰνοτάτην ἔριδα πτολέμοιο τάνυσσαν
390 κυανοχαῖτα Ποσειδάων καὶ φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ,
391 ἤτοι ὃ μὲν Τρώεσσιν, ὃ δ’ Ἀργείοισιν ἀρήγων.
Thus did he speak, and they did even as he had said. The son of Tydeus, Odysseus, and Agamemnon, wounded though they were, set the others in array, and went about everywhere effecting the exchanges of armor; the most valiant took the best armor, and gave the worse to the worse man. When they had donned their bronze armor they marched on with Poseidon at their head. In his strong hand he grasped his terrible sword, keen of edge and flashing like lightning; it is not the right thing [themis] to do, to come across it in the day of battle; all men quake for fear and keep away from it. Hektor on the other side set the Trojans in array. Thereon Poseidon and Hektor waged fierce war on one another - Hektor on the Trojan and Poseidon on the Argive side. Mighty was the uproar as the two forces met; the sea came rolling in towards the ships and tents of the Achaeans, but waves do not thunder on the shore more loudly when driven before the blast of Boreas, nor do the flames of a forest fire roar more fiercely when it is well alight upon the mountains, nor does the wind bellow with ruder music as it tears on through the tops of when it is blowing its hardest, than the terrible shout which the Trojans and Achaeans raised as they sprang upon one another. Hektor first aimed his spear at Ajax, who was turned full towards him, nor did he miss his aim. The spear struck him where two bands passed over his chest - the band of his shield and that of his silver-studded sword - and these protected his body. Hektor was angry that his spear should have been hurled in vain, and withdrew under cover of his men. As he was thus retreating, Ajax son of Telamon struck him with a stone, of which there were many lying about under the men's feet as they fought - brought there to give support to the ships' sides as they lay on the shore. Ajax caught up one of them and struck Hektor above the rim of his shield close to his neck; the blow made him spin round like a top and reel in all directions. As an oak falls headlong when uprooted by the lightning flash of father Zeus, and there is a terrible smell of brimstone - no man can help being dismayed if he is standing near it, for a thunderbolt is a very awful thing - even so did Hektor fall to earth and bite the dust. His spear fell from his hand, but his shield and helmet were made fast about his body, and his bronze armor rang about him. The sons of the Achaeans came running with a loud cry towards him, hoping to drag him away, and they showered their darts on the Trojans, but none of them could wound him before he was surrounded and covered by the princes Polydamas, Aeneas, Agenor, Sarpedon leader of the Lycians, and noble Glaukos: of the others, too, there was not one who was unmindful of him, and they held their round shields over him to cover him. His comrades then lifted him off the ground and bore him away from the battle [ponos] to the place where his horses stood waiting for him at the rear of the fight with their driver and the chariot; these then took him towards the city groaning and in great pain. When they reached the ford of the air stream of

Xanthos, begotten of Immortal Zeus, they took him from off his chariot and laid him down on the ground; they poured water over him, and as they did so he breathed again and opened his eyes. Then kneeling on his knees he vomited blood, but soon fell back on to the ground, and his eyes were again closed in darkness for he was still stunned by the blow. When the Argives saw Hektor leaving the field, they took heart and set upon the Trojans yet more furiously. Ajax fleet son of Oileus began by springing on Satnios son of Enops and wounding him with his spear: a fair naiad nymph had borne him to Enops as he was herding cattle by the banks of the river Satnioeis. The son of Oileus came up to him and struck him in the flank so that he fell, and a fierce fight between Trojans and Danaans raged round his body. Polydamas son of Panthoos drew near to avenge him, and wounded Prothoenor son of Areilykos on the right shoulder; the terrible spear went right through his shoulder, and he clutched the earth as he fell in the dust. Polydamas vaunted loudly over him saying, "Again I take it that the spear has not sped in vain from the strong hand of the son of Panthoos; an Argive has caught it in his body, and it will serve him for a staff as he goes down into the house of Hades." The Argives were stung by grief [akhos] on account of this boasting. Ajax son of Telamon was more angry than any, for the man had fallen close be, him; so he aimed at Polydamas as he was retreating, but Polydamas saved himself by swerving aside and the spear struck Arkhelokhos son of Antenor, for heaven counseled his destruction; it struck him where the head springs from the neck at the top joint of the spine, and severed both the tendons at the back of the head. His head, mouth, and nostrils reached the ground long before his legs and knees could do so, and Ajax shouted to Polydamas saying, "Think, Polydamas, and tell me truly whether this man is not as well worth killing as Prothoenor was: he seems rich, and of rich family, a brother, it may be, or son of the horseman Antenor, for he is very like him."

14.392

ἐκλύσθη δὲ θάλασσα ποτὶ κλισίας τε νέας τε
Ἀργείων· οἳ δὲ ξύνισαν μεγάλῳ ἀλαλητῷ.
οὔτε θαλάσσης κῦμα τόσον βοάᾳ ποτὶ χέρσον
ποντόθεν ὀρνύμενον πνοιῇ Βορέω ἀλεγεινῇ·
οὔτε πυρὸς τόσσός γε ποτὶ βρόμος αἰθομένοιο
οὔρεος ἐν βήσσῃς, ὅτε τ’ ὤρετο καιέμεν ὕλην·
οὔτ’ ἄνεμος τόσσόν γε περὶ δρυσὶν ὑψικόμοισι
ἠπύει, ὅς τε μάλιστα μέγα βρέμεται χαλεπαίνων,
ὅσση ἄρα Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν ἔπλετο φωνὴ
δεινὸν ἀϋσάντων, ὅτ’ ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ὄρουσαν.
Αἴαντος δὲ πρῶτος ἀκόντισε φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
ἔγχει, ἐπεὶ τέτραπτο πρὸς ἰθύ οἱ, οὐδ’ ἀφάμαρτε,
τῇ ῥα δύω τελαμῶνε περὶ στήθεσσι τετάσθην,
ἥτοι ὃ μὲν σάκεος, ὃ δὲ φασγάνου ἀργυροήλου·
τώ οἱ ῥυσάσθην τέρενα χρόα. χώσατο δ’ Ἕκτωρ,
ὅττί ῥά οἱ βέλος ὠκὺ ἐτώσιον ἔκφυγε χειρός,
ἂψ δ’ ἐτάρων εἰς ἔθνος ἐχάζετο κῆρ’ ἀλεείνων.
τὸν μὲν ἔπειτ’ ἀπιόντα μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας
χερμαδίῳ, τά ῥα πολλὰ θοάων ἕχματα νηῶν
πὰρ ποσὶ μαρναμένων ἐκυλίνδετο, τῶν ἓν ἀείρας
στῆθος βεβλήκει ὑπὲρ ἄντυγος ἀγχόθι δειρῆς,
στρόμβον δ’ ὣς ἔσσευε βαλών, περὶ δ’ ἔδραμε πάντῃ.
ὡς δ’ ὅθ’ ὑπὸ πληγῆς πατρὸς Διὸς ἐξερίπῃ δρῦς
πρόρριζος, δεινὴ δὲ θεείου γίγνεται ὀδμὴ
ἐξ αὐτῆς, τὸν δ’ οὔ περ ἔχει θράσος ὅς κεν ἴδηται

ἐγγὺς ἐών, χαλεπὸς δὲ Διὸς μεγάλοιο κεραυνός,
ὣς ἔπεσ᾽ Ἕκτορος ὦκα χαμαὶ μένος ἐν κονίῃσι·
χειρὸς δ᾽ ἔκβαλεν ἔγχος, ἐπ᾽ αὐτῷ δ᾽ ἀσπὶς ἐάφθη
καὶ κόρυς, ἀμφὶ δέ οἱ βράχε τεύχεα ποικίλα χαλκῷ.
οἳ δὲ μέγα ἰάχοντες ἐπέδραμον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν

14.422

ἐλπόμενοι ἐρύεσθαι, ἀκόντιζον δὲ θαμειὰς
αἰχμάς· ἀλλ᾽ οὔ τις ἐδυνήσατο ποιμένα λαῶν
οὐτάσαι οὐδὲ βαλεῖν· πρὶν γὰρ περίβησαν ἄριστοι
Πουλυδάμας τε καὶ Αἰνείας καὶ δῖος Ἀγήνωρ
Σαρπηδών τ᾽ ἀρχὸς Λυκίων καὶ Γλαῦκος ἀμύμων.
τῶν δ᾽ ἄλλων οὔ τίς εὐ ἀκήδεσεν, ἀλλὰ πάροιθεν
ἀσπίδας εὐκύκλους σχέθον αὐτοῦ. τὸν δ᾽ ἄρ᾽ ἑταῖροι
χερσὶν ἀείραντες φέρον ἐκ πόνου, ὄφρ᾽ ἵκεθ᾽ ἵππους
ὠκέας, οἵ οἱ ὄπισθε μάχης ἠδὲ πτολέμοιο
ἕστασαν ἡνίοχόν τε καὶ ἅρματα ποικίλ᾽ ἔχοντες·
οἳ τόν γε προτὶ ἄστυ φέρον βαρέα στενάχοντα.
ἀλλ᾽ ὅτε δὴ πόρον ἶξον ἐϋρρεῖος ποταμοῖο
Ξάνθου δινήεντος, ὃν ἀθάνατος τέκετο Ζεύς,
ἔνθά μιν ἐξ ἵππων πέλασαν χθονί, κὰδ δέ οἱ ὕδωρ
χεῦαν· ὃ δ᾽ ἀμπνύνθη καὶ ἀνέδρακεν ὀφθαλμοῖσιν,
ἑζόμενος δ᾽ ἐπὶ γοῦνα κελαινεφὲς αἷμ᾽ ἀπέμεσσεν·
αὖτις δ᾽ ἐξοπίσω πλῆτο χθονί, τὼ δέ οἱ ὄσσε
νὺξ ἐκάλυψε μέλαινα· βέλος δ᾽ ἔτι θυμὸν ἐδάμνα.
Ἀργεῖοι δ᾽ ὡς οὖν ἴδον Ἕκτορα νόσφι κιόντα
μᾶλλον ἐπὶ Τρώεσσι θόρον, μνήσαντο δὲ χάρμης.
ἔνθα πολὺ πρώτιστος Ὀϊλῆος ταχὺς Αἴας
Σάτνιον οὔτασε δουρὶ μετάλμενος ὀξυόεντι
Ἠνοπίδην, ὃν ἄρα νύμφη τέκε νηΐς ἀμύμων
Ἤνοπι βουκολέοντι παρ᾽ ὄχθας Σατνιόεντος.
τὸν μὲν Ὀϊλιάδης δουρὶ κλυτὸς ἐγγύθεν ἐλθὼν
οὖτα κατὰ λαπάρην· ὃ δ᾽ ἀνετράπετ᾽, ἀμφὶ δ᾽ ἄρ᾽ αὐτῷ
Τρῶες καὶ Δαναοὶ σύναγον κρατερὴν ὑσμίνην.
τῷ δ᾽ ἐπὶ Πουλυδάμας ἐγχέσπαλος ἦλθεν ἀμύντωρ
Πανθοΐδης, βάλε δὲ Προθοήνορα δεξιὸν ὦμον
υἱὸν Ἀρηϊλύκοιο, δι᾽ ὤμου δ᾽ ὄβριμον ἔγχος

14.452

ἔσχεν, ὃ δ᾽ ἐν κονίῃσι πεσὼν ἕλε γαῖαν ἀγοστῷ.
Πουλυδάμας δ᾽ ἔκπαγλον ἐπεύξατο μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
οὐ μὰν αὖτ᾽ οἴῳ μεγαθύμου Πανθοΐδαο
χειρὸς ἄπο στιβαρῆς ἅλιον πηδῆσαι ἄκοντα,
ἀλλά τις Ἀργείων κόμισε χροΐ, καί μιν οἴῳ
αὐτῷ σκηπτόμενον κατίμεν δόμον Ἄϊδος εἴσω.
ὣς ἔφατ᾽, Ἀργείοισι δ᾽ ἄχος γένετ᾽ εὐξαμένοιο·
Αἴαντι δὲ μάλιστα δαΐφρονι θυμὸν ὄρινε
τῷ Τελαμωνιάδῃ· τοῦ γὰρ πέσεν ἄγχι μάλιστα.
καρπαλίμως δ᾽ ἀπιόντος ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ.
Πουλυδάμας δ᾽ αὐτὸς μὲν ἀλεύατο κῆρα μέλαιναν

463 λικριφὶς ἀΐξας, κόμισεν δ’ Ἀντήνορος υἱὸς
464 Ἀρχέλοχος· τῷ γάρ ῥα θεοὶ βούλευσαν ὄλεθρον.
465 τόν ῥ’ ἔβαλεν κεφαλῆς τε καὶ αὐχένος ἐν συνεοχμῷ,
466 νείατον ἀστράγαλον, ἀπὸ δ’ ἄμφω κέρσε τένοντε·
467 τοῦ δὲ πολὺ προτέρη κεφαλὴ στόμα τε ῥῖνές τε
468 οὔδεϊ πλῆντ’ ἤ περ κνῆμαι καὶ γοῦνα πεσόντος.
469 Αἴας δ’ αὖτ’ ἐγέγωνεν ἀμύμονι Πουλυδάμαντι·
470 φράζεο Πουλυδάμα καί μοι νημερτὲς ἐνίσπες
471 ἦ ῥ’ οὐχ οὗτος ἀνὴρ Προθοήνορος ἀντὶ πεφάσθαι
472 ἄξιος; οὐ μέν μοι κακὸς εἴδεται οὐδὲ κακῶν ἔξ,
473 ἀλλὰ κασίγνητος Ἀντήνορος ἱπποδάμοιο
474 ἢ πάϊς· αὐτῷ γὰρ γενεὴν ἄγχιστα ἐώκει.
475 ἦ ῥ’ εὖ γιγνώσκων, Τρῶας δ’ ἄχος ἔλλαβε θυμόν.
476 ἔνθ’ Ἀκάμας Πρόμαχον Βοιώτιον οὔτασε δουρὶ
477 ἀμφὶ κασιγνήτῳ βεβαώς· ὃ δ’ ὕφελκε ποδοῖιν.
478 τῷ δ’ Ἀκάμας ἔκπαγλον ἐπεύξατο μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
479 Ἀργεῖοι ἰόμωροι ἀπειλάων ἀκόρητοι
480 οὔ θην οἵοισίν γε πόνος τ’ ἔσεται καὶ ὀϊζὺς
481 ἡμῖν, ἀλλά ποθ’ ὧδε κατακτενέεσθε καὶ ὔμμες.
But he knew well who it was, and the Trojans were greatly vexed with grief [akhos]. Akamas then bestrode his brother's body and wounded Promakhos the Boeotian with his spear, for he was trying to drag his brother's body away. Akamas vaunted loudly over him saying, "Argive archers, braggarts that you are, toil [ponos] and suffering shall not be for us only, but some of you too shall fall here as well as ourselves. See how Promakhos now sleeps, vanquished by my spear; payment for my brother's blood has not long delayed; a man, therefore, may well be thankful if he leaves a kinsman in his house behind him to avenge his fall." His taunts gave grief [akhos] to the Argives, and Peneleos was more enraged than any of them. He sprang towards Akamas, but Akamas did not stand his ground, and he killed Ilioneus son of the rich flock-master Phorbas, whom Hermes had favored and endowed with greater wealth than any other of the Trojans. Ilioneus was his only son, and Peneleos now wounded him in the eye under his eyebrows, tearing the eye-ball from its socket: the spear went right through the eye into the nape of the neck, and he fell, stretching out both hands before him. Peneleos then drew his sword and smote him on the neck, so that both head and helmet came tumbling down to the ground with the spear still sticking in the eye; he then held up the head, as though it had been a poppy-head, and showed it to the Trojans, vaunting over them as he did so. "Trojans," he cried, "bid the father and mother of noble Ilioneus make moan for him in their house, for the wife also of Promakhos son of Alegenor will never be gladdened by the coming of her dear husband - when we Argives return with our ships from Troy." As he spoke fear fell upon them, and every man looked round about to see whither he might flee for safety. Tell me now, O Muses that dwell on Olympus, who was the first of the Argives to bear away blood-stained spoils after Poseidon lord of the earthquake had turned the fortune of war. Ajax son of Telamon was first to wound Hyrtios son of Gyrtios, leader of the staunch Mysians. Antilokhos killed Phalces and Mermerus, while Meriones slew Morys and Hippotion, Teucer also killed Prothoon and Periphetes. The son of Atreus then wounded Hyperenor shepherd of his people, in the flank, and the bronze point made his entrails gush out as it tore in among them; on this his life-breath [psukhê] came hurrying out of him at the place where he had been wounded, and his eyes were closed in darkness. Ajax son of Oileus killed more than any other, for there was no man so fleet as he to pursue fleeing foes when Zeus had spread panic among them.

14.482

φράζεσθ’ ὡς ὑμῖν Πρόμαχος δεδμημένος εὕδει
ἔγχει ἐμῷ, ἵνα μή τι κασιγνήτοιό γε ποινὴ
δηρὸν ἄτιτος ἔῃ· τὼ καί κέ τις εὔχεται ἀνὴρ
γνωτὸν ἐνὶ μεγάροισιν ἀρῆς ἀλκτῆρα λιπέσθαι.
ὣς ἔφατ’, Ἀργείοισι δ’ ἄχος γένετ’ εὐξαμένοιο·
Πηνέλεῳ δὲ μάλιστα δαΐφρονι θυμὸν ὄρινεν·
ὀρμήθη δ’ Ἀκάμαντος· ὃ δ’ οὐχ ὑπέμεινεν ἐρωὴν
Πηνελέωο ἄνακτος· ὃ δ’ οὔτασεν Ἰλιονῆα
υἱὸν Φόρβαντος πολυμήλου, τόν ῥα μάλιστα
Ἑρμείας Τρώων ἐφίλει καὶ κτῆσιν ὄπασσε·
τῷ δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπὸ μήτηρ μοῦνον τέκεν Ἰλιονῆα.
τὸν τόθ’ ὑπ’ ὀφρύος οὖτα κατ’ ὀφθαλμοῖο θέμεθλα,
ἐκ δ’ ὦσε γλήνην· δόρυ δ’ ὀφθαλμοῖο διὰ πρὸ
καὶ διὰ ἰνίου ἦλθεν, ὃ δ’ ἔζετο χεῖρε πετάσσας
ἄμφω· Πηνέλεως δὲ ἐρυσσάμενος ξίφος ὀξὺ
αὐχένα μέσσον ἔλασσεν, ἀπήραξεν δὲ χαμᾶζε
αὐτῇ σὺν πήληκι κάρη· ἔτι δ’ ὄβριμον ἔγχος
ἦεν ἐν ὀφθαλμῷ· ὃ δὲ φὴ κώδειαν ἀνασχὼν
πέφραδέ τε Τρώεσσι καὶ εὐχόμενος ἔπος ηὔδα·
εἰπέμεναί μοι Τρῶες ἀγαυοῦ Ἰλιονῆος
πατρὶ φίλῳ καὶ μητρὶ γοήμεναι ἐν μεγάροισιν·
οὐδὲ γὰρ ἣ Προμάχοιο δάμαρ Ἀλεγηνορίδαο
ἀνδρὶ φίλῳ ἐλθόντι γανύσσεται, ὁππότε κεν δὴ
ἐκ Τροίης σὺν νηυσὶ νεώμεθα κοῦροι Ἀχαιῶν.
ὣς φάτο, τοὺς δ’ ἄρα πάντας ὑπὸ τρόμος ἔλλαβε γυῖα,
πάπτηνεν δὲ ἕκαστος ὅπῃ φύγοι αἰπὺν ὄλεθρον.
ἔσπετε νῦν μοι Μοῦσαι Ὀλύμπια δώματ’ ἔχουσαι
ὅς τις δὴ πρῶτος βροτόεντ’ ἀνδράγρι’ Ἀχαιῶν
ἤρατ’, ἐπεί ῥ’ ἔκλινε μάχην κλυτὸς ἐννοσίγαιος.
Αἴας ῥα πρῶτος Τελαμώνιος Ὕρτιον οὖτα

14.512

Γυρτιάδην Μυσῶν ἡγήτορα καρτεροθύμων·
Φάλκην δ’ Ἀντίλοχος καὶ Μέρμερον ἐξενάριξε·
Μηριόνης δὲ Μόρυν τε καὶ Ἱπποτίωνα κατέκτα,
Τεῦκρος δὲ Προθόωνά τ’ ἐνήρατο καὶ Περιφήτην·
Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειθ’ Ὑπερήνορα ποιμένα λαῶν
οὖτα κατὰ λαπάρην, διὰ δ’ ἔντερα χαλκὸς ἄφυσσε
δῃώσας· ψυχὴ δὲ κατ’ οὐταμένην ὠτειλὴν
ἔσσυτ’ ἐπειγομένη, τὸν δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψε.
πλείστους δ’ Αἴας εἶλεν Ὀϊλῆος ταχὺς υἱός·
οὐ γάρ οἵ τις ὁμοῖος ἐπισπέσθαι ποσὶν ἦεν
ἀνδρῶν τρεσσάντων, ὅτε τε Ζεὺς ἐν φόβον ὄρσῃ.

15.1

αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ διά τε σκόλοπας καὶ τάφρον ἔβησαν
φεύγοντες, πολλοὶ δὲ δάμεν Δαναῶν ὑπὸ χερσίν,
οἳ μὲν δὴ παρ’ ὄχεσφιν ἐρητύοντο μένοντες
χλωροὶ ὑπαὶ δείους πεφοβημένοι· ἔγρετο δὲ Ζεὺς

5 Ἴδης ἐν κορυφῇσι παρὰ χρυσοθρόνου Ἥρης,
6 στῆ δ’ ἄρ’ ἀναΐξας, ἴδε δὲ Τρῶας καὶ Ἀχαιοὺς
7 τοὺς μὲν ὀρινομένους, τοὺς δὲ κλονέοντας ὄπισθεν
8 Ἀργείους, μετὰ δέ σφι Ποσειδάωνα ἄνακτα·
9 Ἕκτορα δ’ ἐν πεδίῳ ἴδε κείμενον, ἀμφὶ δ’ ἑταῖροι
10 εἵαθ’, ὃ δ’ ἀργαλέῳ ἔχετ’ ἄσθματι κῆρ ἀπινύσσων
11 αἷμ’ ἐμέων, ἐπεὶ οὔ μιν ἀφαυρότατος βάλ’ Ἀχαιῶν.
12 τὸν δὲ ἰδὼν ἐλέησε πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε,
13 δεινὰ δ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν Ἥρην πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν·
14 ἦ μάλα δὴ κακότεχνος ἀμήχανε σὸς δόλος Ἥρη
15 Ἕκτορα δῖον ἔπαυσε μάχης, ἐφόβησε δὲ λαούς.
16 οὐ μὰν οἶδ’ εἰ αὖτε κακορραφίης ἀλεγεινῆς
17 πρώτη ἐπαύρηαι καί σε πληγῇσιν ἰμάσσω.
18 ἦ οὐ μέμνῃ ὅτε τ’ ἐκρέμω ὑψόθεν, ἐκ δὲ ποδοῖιν
19 ἄκμονας ἦκα δύω, περὶ χερσὶ δὲ δεσμὸν ἧλα
20 χρύσεον ἄρρηκτον; σὺ δ’ ἐν αἰθέρι καὶ νεφέλῃσιν
21 ἐκρέμω· ἠλάστεον δὲ θεοὶ κατὰ μακρὸν Ὄλυμπον,
22 λῦσαι δ’ οὐκ ἐδύναντο παρασταδόν· ὃν δὲ λάβοιμι
23 ῥίπτασκον τεταγὼν ἀπὸ βηλοῦ ὄφρ’ ἂν ἵκηται
24 γῆν ὀλιγηπελέων· ἐμὲ δ’ οὐδ’ ὣς θυμὸν ἀνίει
25 ἀζηχὴς ὀδύνη Ἡρακλῆος θείοιο,
26 τὸν σὺ ξὺν Βορέῃ ἀνέμῳ πεπιθοῦσα θυέλλας
27 πέμψας ἐπ’ ἀτρύγετον πόντον κακὰ μητιόωσα,
28 καί μιν ἔπειτα Κόων δ’ εὖ ναιομένην ἀπένεικας.
29 τὸν μὲν ἐγὼν ἔνθεν ῥυσάμην καὶ ἀνήγαγον αὖτις
30 Ἄργος ἐς ἱππόβοτον καὶ πολλά περ ἀθλήσαντα.

But when their flight had taken them past the trench and the set stakes, and many had fallen by the hands of the Danaans, the Trojans made a halt on reaching their chariots, routed and pale with fear. Zeus now woke on the crests of Ida, where he was lying with golden-throned Hera by his side, and starting to his feet he saw the Trojans and Achaeans, the one thrown into confusion, and the others driving them pell-mell before them with King Poseidon in their midst. He saw Hektor lying on the ground with his comrades gathered round him, gasping for breath, wandering in mind and vomiting blood, for it was not the feeblest of the Achaeans who struck him. The sire of gods and men had pity on him, and looked fiercely on Hera. "I see, Hera," said he, "you mischief-making trickster, that your cunning has stayed Hektor from fighting and has caused the rout of his host. I am in half a mind to thrash you, in which case you will be the first to reap the fruits of your scurvy knavery. Do you not remember how once upon a time I had you hanged? I fastened two anvils on to your feet, and bound your hands in a chain of gold which none might break, and you hung in mid-air among the clouds. All the gods in Olympus were in a fury, but they could not reach you to set you free; when I caught any one of them I gripped him and hurled him from the heavenly threshold till he came fainting down to earth; yet even this did not relieve my mind from the incessant anxiety which I felt about noble Herakles whom you and Boreas had spitefully conveyed beyond the seas [pontos] to Cos, after suborning the tempests; but I rescued him, and notwithstanding all his mighty labors I brought him back again to Argos. I would remind you of this that you may learn to leave off being so deceitful, and discover how much you are likely to gain by the embraces out of which you have come here to trick me." Hera trembled as he spoke, and said, "May heaven above and earth below be my witnesses, with the waters of the river Styx - and this is the most solemn oath that a blessed god can take - nay, I swear also by your own almighty head and by our bridal bed - things over which I could never possibly perjure myself - that Poseidon is not

punishing Hektor and the Trojans and helping the Achaeans through any doing of mine; it is all of his own mere motion because he was sorry to see the Achaeans hard pressed at their ships: if I were advising him, I should tell him to do as you bid him." The sire of gods and men smiled and answered, "If you, Hera, were always to support me when we sit in council of the gods, Poseidon, like it or no, would soon come round to your and my way of thinking [noon]. If, then, you are speaking the truth and mean what you say, go among the rank and file of the gods, and tell Iris and Apollo lord of the bow, that I want them - Iris, that she may go to the Achaean host and tell Poseidon to leave off fighting and go home, and Apollo, that he may send Hektor again into battle and give him fresh strength; he will thus forget his present sufferings, and drive the Achaeans back in confusion till they fall among the ships of Achilles son of Peleus. Achilles will then send his comrade Patroklos into battle, and Hektor will kill him in front of Ilion after he has slain many warriors, and among them my own noble son Sarpedon. Achilles will kill Hektor to avenge Patroklos, and from that time I will bring it about that the Achaeans shall persistently drive the Trojans back till they fulfill the counsels of Athena and take Ilion. But I will not stay my anger, nor permit any god to help the Danaans till I have accomplished the desire of the son of Peleus, according to the promise I made by bowing my head on the day when Thetis touched my knees and besought me to give him honor." Hera heeded his words and went from the heights of Ida to great Olympus. Swift as the thought [noos] of one whose fancy carries him over vast continents, and he says to himself, "Now I will be here, or there," and he would have all manner of things - even so swiftly did Hera wing her way till she came to high Olympus and went in among the gods who were gathered in the house of Zeus. When they saw her they all of them came up to her, and held out their cups to her by way of greeting. She let the others be, but took the cup offered her by lovely Themis, who was first to come running up to her. "Hera," said she, "why are you here? And you seem troubled - has your husband the son of Kronos been frightening you?" And Hera answered, "Themis, do not ask me about it. You know what a proud and cruel disposition my husband has. Lead the gods to table, where you and all the immortals can hear the wicked designs which he has avowed. Many a one, mortal and immortal, will be angered by them, however peaceably he may be feasting now." On this Hera sat down, and the gods were troubled throughout the house of Zeus. Laughter sat on her lips but her brow was furrowed with care, and she spoke up in a rage. "Fools that we are," she cried, "to be thus madly angry with Zeus; we keep on wanting to go up to him and stay him by force or by persuasion, but he sits aloof and cares for nobody, for he knows that he is much stronger than any other of the immortals. Make the best, therefore, of whatever ills he may choose to send each one of you; Ares, I take it, has had a taste of them already, for his son Askalaphos has fallen in battle - the man whom of all others he loved most dearly and whose father he owns himself to be."

15.31

31 τῶν σ’ αὖτις μνήσω ἴν’ ἀπολλήξῃς ἀπατάων,
32 ὄφρα ἴδῃ ἦν τοι χραίσμῃ φιλότης τε καὶ εὐνή,
33 ἣν ἐμίγης ἐλθοῦσα θεῶν ἄπο καί μ’ ἀπάτησας.
34 ὣς φάτο, ῥίγησεν δὲ βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη,
35 καί μιν φωνήσασ’ ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
36 ἴστω νῦν τόδε Γαῖα καὶ Οὐρανὸς εὐρὺς ὕπερθε
37 καὶ τὸ κατειβόμενον Στυγὸς ὕδωρ, ὅς τε μέγιστος
38 ὅρκος δεινότατός τε πέλει μακάρεσσι θεοῖσι,
39 σή θ’ ἱερὴ κεφαλὴ καὶ νωΐτερον λέχος αὐτῶν
40 κουρίδιον, τὸ μὲν οὐκ ἂν ἐγώ ποτε μὰψ ὀμόσαιμι·
41 μὴ δι’ ἐμὴν ἰότητα Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων
42 πημαίνει Τρῶάς τε καὶ Ἕκτορα, τοῖσι δ’ ἀρήγει,

ἀλλά που αὐτὸν θυμὸς ἐποτρύνει καὶ ἀνώγει,
τειρομένους δ’ ἐπὶ νηυσὶν ἰδὼν ἐλέησεν Ἀχαιούς.
αὐτάρ τοι καὶ κείνῳ ἐγὼ παραμυθησαίμην
τῇ ἴμεν ᾗ κεν δὴ σὺ κελαινεφὲς ἡγεμονεύῃς.
ὣς φάτο, μείδησεν δὲ πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε,
καί μιν ἀμειβόμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
εἰ μὲν δὴ σύ γ’ ἔπειτα βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη
ἶσον ἐμοὶ φρονέουσα μετ’ ἀθανάτοισι καθίζοις,
τώ κε Ποσειδάων γε, καὶ εἰ μάλα βούλεται ἄλλῃ,
αἶψα μεταστρέψειε νόον μετὰ σὸν καὶ ἐμὸν κῆρ.
ἀλλ’ εἰ δή ῥ’ ἐτεόν γε καὶ ἀτρεκέως ἀγορεύεις,
ἔρχεο νῦν μετὰ φῦλα θεῶν, καὶ δεῦρο κάλεσσον
Ἶρίν τ’ ἐλθέμεναι καὶ Ἀπόλλωνα κλυτότοξον,
ὄφρ’ ἣ μὲν μετὰ λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων
ἔλθῃ, καὶ εἴπῃσι Ποσειδάωνι ἄνακτι
παυσάμενον πολέμοιο τὰ ἃ πρὸς δώμαθ’ ἱκέσθαι,
Ἕκτορα δ’ ὀτρύνῃσι μάχην ἐς Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων,
αὖτις δ’ ἐμπνεύσῃσι μένος, λελάθῃ δ’ ὀδυνάων

15.61

αἳ νῦν μιν τείρουσι κατὰ φρένας, αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὺς
αὖτις ἀποστρέψῃσιν ἀνάλκιδα φύζαν ἐνόρσας,
φεύγοντες δ’ ἐν νηυσὶ πολυκλήϊσι πέσωσι
Πηλεΐδεω Ἀχιλῆος· ὃ δ’ ἀνστήσει ὃν ἑταῖρον
Πάτροκλον· τὸν δὲ κτενεῖ ἔγχεϊ φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
Ἰλίου προπάροιθε πολέας ὀλέσαντ’ αἰζηοὺς
τοὺς ἄλλους, μετὰ δ’ υἱὸν ἐμὸν Σαρπηδόνα δῖον.
τοῦ δὲ χολωσάμενος κτενεῖ Ἕκτορα δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς.
ἐκ τοῦ δ’ ἄν τοι ἔπειτα παλίωξιν παρὰ νηῶν
αἰὲν ἐγὼ τεύχοιμι διαμπερὲς εἰς ὅ κ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
Ἴλιον αἰπὺ ἕλοιεν Ἀθηναίης διὰ βουλάς.
τὸ πρὶν δ’ οὔτ’ ἄρ’ ἐγὼ παύω χόλον οὔτέ τιν’ ἄλλον
ἀθανάτων Δαναοῖσιν ἀμυνέμεν ἐνθάδ’ ἐάσω
πρίν γε τὸ Πηλεΐδαο τελευτηθῆναι ἐέλδωρ,
ὥς οἱ ὑπέστην πρῶτον, ἐμῷ δ’ ἐπένευσα κάρητι,
ἤματι τῷ ὅτ’ ἐμεῖο θεὰ Θέτις ἥψατο γούνων,
λισσομένη τιμῆσαι Ἀχιλλῆα πτολίπορθον.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη,
βῆ δ’ ἐξ Ἰδαίων ὀρέων ἐς μακρὸν Ὄλυμπον.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἂν ἀΐξῃ νόος ἀνέρος, ὅς τ’ ἐπὶ πολλὴν
γαῖαν ἐληλουθὼς φρεσὶ πευκαλίμῃσι νοήσῃ
ἔνθ’ εἶην ἢ ἔνθα, μενοινήῃσί τε πολλά,
ὣς κραιπνῶς μεμαυῖα διέπτατο πότνια Ἥρη·
ἵκετο δ’ αἰπὺν Ὄλυμπον, ὁμηγερέεσσι δ’ ἐπῆλθεν
ἀθανάτοισι θεοῖσι Διὸς δόμῳ· οἳ δὲ ἰδόντες
πάντες ἀνήϊξαν καὶ δεικανόωντο δέπασσιν.
ἣ δ’ ἄλλους μὲν ἔασε, Θέμιστι δὲ καλλιπαρῄῳ
δέκτο δέπας· πρώτη γὰρ ἐναντίη ἦλθε θέουσα,
καί μιν φωνήσασ’ ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Ἥρη τίπτε βέβηκας; ἀτυζομένη δὲ ἔοικας·

15.91

91 ἦ μάλα δή σ’ ἐφόβησε Κρόνου πάϊς, ὅς τοι ἀκοίτης.
92 τὴν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη·
93 μή με θεὰ Θέμι ταῦτα διείρεο· οἶσθα καὶ αὐτὴ
94 οἷος κείνου θυμὸς ὑπερφίαλος καὶ ἀπηνής.
95 ἀλλὰ σύ γ’ ἄρχε θεοῖσι δόμοις ἔνι δαιτὸς ἐΐσης·
96 ταῦτα δὲ καὶ μετὰ πᾶσιν ἀκούσεαι ἀθανάτοισιν
97 οἷα Ζεὺς κακὰ ἔργα πιφαύσκεται· οὐδέ τί φημι
98 πᾶσιν ὁμῶς θυμὸν κεχαρησέμεν, οὔτε βροτοῖσιν
99 οὔτε θεοῖς, εἴ πέρ τις ἔτι νῦν δαίνυται εὔφρων.
100 ἢ μὲν ἄρ’ ὣς εἰποῦσα καθέζετο πότνια Ἥρη,
101 ὄχθησαν δ’ ἀνὰ δῶμα Διὸς θεοί· ἢ δ’ ἐγέλασσε
102 χείλεσιν, οὐδὲ μέτωπον ἐπ’ ὀφρύσι κυανέῃσιν
103 ἰάνθη· πᾶσιν δὲ νεμεσσηθεῖσα μετηύδα·
104 νήπιοι οἳ Ζηνὶ μενεαίνομεν ἀφρονέοντες·
105 ἦ ἔτι μιν μέμαμεν καταπαυσέμεν ἄσσον ἰόντες
106 ἢ ἔπει ἠὲ βίῃ· ὃ δ’ ἀφήμενος οὐκ ἀλεγίζει
107 οὐδ’ ὄθεται· φησὶν γὰρ ἐν ἀθανάτοισι θεοῖσι
108 κάρτεΐ τε σθένεΐ τε διακριδὸν εἶναι ἄριστος.
109 τὼ ἔχεθ’ ὅττί κεν ὔμμι κακὸν πέμπῃσιν ἑκάστῳ.
110 ἤδη γὰρ νῦν ἔλπομ’ Ἄρηΐ γε πῆμα τετύχθαι·
111 υἱὸς γάρ οἱ ὄλωλε μάχῃ ἔνι φίλτατος ἀνδρῶν
112 Ἀσκάλαφος, τόν φησιν ὃν ἔμμεναι ὄβριμος Ἄρης.
113 ὣς ἔφατ’, αὐτὰρ Ἄρης θαλερὼ πεπλήγετο μηρὼ
114 χερσὶ καταπρηνέσσ’, ὀλοφυρόμενος δ’ ἔπος ηὔδα·
115 μὴ νῦν μοι νεμεσήσετ’ Ὀλύμπια δώματ’ ἔχοντες
116 τίσασθαι φόνον υἷος ἰόντ’ ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν,
117 εἴ πέρ μοι καὶ μοῖρα Διὸς πληγέντι κεραυνῷ
118 κεῖσθαι ὁμοῦ νεκύεσσι μεθ’ αἵματι καὶ κονίῃσιν.
119 ὣς φάτο, καί ῥ’ ἵππους κέλετο Δεῖμόν τε Φόβον τε
120 ζευγνύμεν, αὐτὸς δ’ ἔντε’ ἐδύσετο παμφανόωντα.

When he heard this Ares smote his two sturdy thighs with the flat of his hands, and said in anger, "Do not blame me, you gods that dwell in heaven, if I go to the ships of the Achaeans and avenge the death of my son, even though it end in my being struck by Zeus' lightning and lying in blood and dust among the corpses." As he spoke he gave orders to yoke his horses Panic and Rout, while he put on his armor. On this, Zeus would have been roused to still more fierce and implacable anger [mênis] against the other immortals, had not Athena, alarmed for the safety of the gods, sprung from her seat and hurried outside. She tore the helmet from his head and the shield from his shoulders, and she took the bronze spear from his strong hand and set it on one side; then she said to Ares, "Mad one, you are undone; you have ears that hear not, or you have lost all sense of respect [aidôs] and understanding [noos]; have you not heard what Hera has said on coming straight from the presence of Olympian Zeus? Do you wish to go through all kinds of suffering before you are brought back sick and sorry to Olympus, after having caused infinite mischief to all us others? Zeus would instantly leave the Trojans and Achaeans to themselves; he would come to Olympus to punish us, and would grip us up one after another, guilty [aitios] or not guilty. Therefore lay aside your anger for the death of your son; better men than he have either been killed already or will fall hereafter, and one cannot protect every one's whole family." With these words she took Ares back to his seat. Meanwhile Hera called Apollo outside, with Iris the messenger of the gods. "Zeus," she said to them, "desires you to go to him at once on Mount Ida; when you have seen him you are to do as he may then bid you." Thereon Hera

left them and resumed her seat inside, while Iris and Apollo made all haste on their way. When they reached many-fountained Ida, mother of wild beasts, they found Zeus seated on topmost Gargaros with a fragrant cloud encircling his head as with a diadem. They stood before his presence, and he was pleased with them for having been so quick in obeying the orders his wife had given them. He spoke to Iris first. "Go," said he, "fleet Iris, tell King Poseidon what I now bid you - and tell him true. Bid him leave off fighting, and either join the company of the gods, or go down into the sea. If he takes no heed and disobeys me, let him consider well whether he is strong enough to hold his own against me if I attack him. I am older and much stronger than he is; yet he is not afraid to set himself up as on a level with myself, of whom all the other gods stand in awe." Iris, fleet as the wind, obeyed him, and as the cold hail or snowflakes that fly from out the clouds before the blast of Boreas, even so did she wing her way till she came close up to the great shaker of the earth. Then she said, "I have come, O dark-haired king that holds the world in his embrace, to bring you a message from Zeus. He bids you leave off fighting, and either join the company of the gods or go down into the sea; if, however, you take no heed and disobey him, he says he will come down here and fight you. He would have you keep out of his reach, for he is older and much stronger than you are, and yet you are not afraid to set yourself up as on a level with himself, of whom all the other gods stand in awe." Poseidon was very angry and said, "Great heavens! strong as Zeus may be, he has said more than he can do if he has threatened violence against me, who am of like honor with himself. We were three brothers whom Rhea bore to Kronos - Zeus, myself, and Hades who rules the world below. Heaven and earth were divided into three parts, and each of us was to have an equal share. When we cast lots, it fell to me to have my dwelling in the sea for evermore; Hades took the darkness of the realms under the earth, while air and sky and clouds were the portion that fell to Zeus; but earth and great Olympus are the common property of all. Therefore I will not walk as Zeus would have me. For all his strength, let him keep to his own third share and be contented without threatening to lay hands upon me as though I were nobody. Let him keep his bragging talk for his own sons and daughters, who must perforce obey him.

15.121

121 ἔνθά κ’ ἔτι μείζων τε καὶ ἀργαλεώτερος ἄλλος
122 πὰρ Διὸς ἀθανάτοισι χόλος καὶ μῆνις ἐτύχθη,
123 εἰ μὴ Ἀθήνη πᾶσι περιδείσασα θεοῖσιν
124 ὦρτο διὲκ προθύρου, λίπε δὲ θρόνον ἔνθα θάασσε,
125 τοῦ δ’ ἀπὸ μὲν κεφαλῆς κόρυθ’ εἵλετο καὶ σάκος ὤμων,
126 ἔγχος δ’ ἔστησε στιβαρῆς ἀπὸ χειρὸς ἑλοῦσα
127 χάλκεον· ἢ δ’ ἐπέεσσι καθάπτετο θοῦρον Ἄρηα·
128 μαινόμενε φρένας ἠλὲ διέφθορας· ἦ νύ τοι αὖτως
129 οὔατ’ ἀκουέμεν ἐστί, νόος δ’ ἀπόλωλε καὶ αἰδώς.
130 οὐκ ἀΐεις ἄ τέ φησι θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη
131 ἠ δὴ νῦν πὰρ Ζηνὸς Ὀλυμπίου εἰλήλουθεν;
132 ἦ ἐθέλεις αὐτὸς μὲν ἀναπλήσας κακὰ πολλὰ
133 ἂψ ἴμεν Οὔλυμπον δὲ καὶ ἀχνύμενός περ ἀνάγκῃ,
134 αὐτὰρ τοῖς ἄλλοισι κακὸν μέγα πᾶσι φυτεῦσαι;
135 αὐτίκα γὰρ Τρῶας μὲν ὑπερθύμους καὶ Ἀχαιοὺς
136 λείψει, ὃ δ’ ἡμέας εἶσι κυδοιμήσων ἐς Ὄλυμπον,
137 μάρψει δ’ ἐξείης ὅς τ’ αἴτιος ὅς τε καὶ οὐκί.
138 τώ σ’ αὖ νῦν κέλομαι μεθέμεν χόλον υἷος ἐῆος·
139 ἤδη γάρ τις τοῦ γε βίην καὶ χεῖρας ἀμείνων
140 ἠ πέφατ’, ἠ καὶ ἔπειτα πεφήσεται· ἀργαλέον δὲ
141 πάντων ἀνθρώπων ῥῦσθαι γενεήν τε τόκον τε.

ὣς εἰποῦσ’ ἵδρυσε θρόνῳ ἔνι θοῦρον Ἄρηα.
Ἥρη δ’ Ἀπόλλωνα καλέσσατο δώματος ἐκτὸς
Ἶρίν θ’, ἥ τε θεοῖσι μετάγγελος ἀθανάτοισι,
καί σφεας φωνήσασ’ ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Ζεὺς σφὼ εἰς Ἴδην κέλετ’ ἐλθέμεν ὅττι τάχιστα·
αὐτὰρ ἐπὴν ἔλθητε, Διός τ’ εἰς ὦπα ἴδησθε,
ἔρδειν ὅττί κε κεῖνος ἐποτρύνῃ καὶ ἀνώγῃ.
ἢ μὲν ἄρ’ ὣς εἰποῦσα πάλιν κίε πότνια Ἥρη,
ἔζετο δ’ εἰνὶ θρόνῳ· τὼ δ’ ἀΐξαντε πετέσθην.

15.151

Ἴδην δ’ ἵκανον πολυπίδακα μητέρα θηρῶν,
εὗρον δ’ εὐρύοπα Κρονίδην ἀνὰ Γαργάρῳ ἄκρῳ
ἥμενον· ἀμφὶ δέ μιν θυόεν νέφος ἐστεφάνωτο.
τὼ δὲ πάροιθ’ ἐλθόντε Διὸς νεφεληγερέταο
στήτην· οὐδέ σφωϊν ἰδὼν ἐχολώσατο θυμῷ,
ὅττί οἱ ὦκ’ ἐπέεσσι φίλης ἀλόχοιο πιθέσθην.
Ἶριν δὲ προτέρην ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
βάσκ’ ἴθι Ἶρι ταχεῖα, Ποσειδάωνι ἄνακτι
πάντα τάδ’ ἀγγεῖλαι, μὴ δὲ ψευδάγγελος εἶναι.
παυσάμενόν μιν ἄνωχθι μάχης ἠδὲ πτολέμοιο
ἔρχεσθαι μετὰ φῦλα θεῶν ἢ εἰς ἅλα δῖαν.
εἰ δέ μοι οὐκ ἐπέεσσ’ ἐπιπείσεται, ἀλλ’ ἀλογήσει,
φραζέσθω δὴ ἔπειτα κατὰ φρένα καὶ κατὰ θυμὸν
μή μ’ οὐδὲ κρατερός περ ἐὼν ἐπιόντα ταλάσσῃ
μεῖναι, ἐπεί εὐ φημὶ βίῃ πολὺ φέρτερος εἶναι
καὶ γενεῇ πρότερος· τοῦ δ’ οὐκ ὄθεται φίλον ἦτορ
ἶσον ἐμοὶ φάσθαι, τόν τε στυγέουσι καὶ ἄλλοι.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε ποδήνεμος ὠκέα Ἶρις,
βῆ δὲ κατ’ Ἰδαίων ὀρέων εἰς Ἴλιον ἱρήν.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἂν ἐκ νεφέων πτῆται νιφὰς ἠὲ χάλαζα
ψυχρὴ ὑπὸ ῥιπῆς αἰθρηγενέος Βορέαο,
ὣς κραιπνῶς μεμαυῖα διέπτατο ὠκέα Ἶρις,
ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱσταμένη προσέφη κλυτὸν ἐννοσίγαιον·
ἀγγελίην τινά τοι γαιήοχε κυανοχαῖτα
ἦλθον δεῦρο φέρουσα παραὶ Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο.
παυσάμενόν σ’ ἐκέλευσε μάχης ἠδὲ πτολέμοιο
ἔρχεσθαι μετὰ φῦλα θεῶν ἢ εἰς ἅλα δῖαν.
εἰ δέ οἱ οὐκ ἐπέεσσ’ ἐπιπείσεαι, ἀλλ’ ἀλογήσεις,
ἠπείλει καὶ κεῖνος ἐναντίβιον πολεμίξων
ἐνθάδ’ ἐλεύσεσθαι· σὲ δ’ ὑπεξαλέασθαι ἄνωγε

15.181

χεῖρας, ἐπεὶ σέο φησὶ βίῃ πολὺ φέρτερος εἶναι
καὶ γενεῇ πρότερος· σὸν δ’ οὐκ ὄθεται φίλον ἦτορ
ἶσόν οἱ φάσθαι, τόν τε στυγέουσι καὶ ἄλλοι.
τὴν δὲ μέγ’ ὀχθήσας προσέφη κλυτὸς ἐννοσίγαιος·
ὢ πόποι ἦ ῥ’ ἀγαθός περ ἐὼν ὑπέροπλον ἔειπεν
εἴ μ’ ὁμότιμον ἐόντα βίῃ ἀέκοντα καθέξει.
τρεῖς γάρ τ’ ἐκ Κρόνου εἰμὲν ἀδελφεοὶ οὓς τέκετο Ῥέα

188 Ζεὺς καὶ ἐγώ, τρίτατος δ’ Ἀΐδης ἐνέροισιν ἀνάσσων.
189 τριχθὰ δὲ πάντα δέδασται, ἕκαστος δ’ ἔμμορε τιμῆς·
190 ἤτοι ἐγὼν ἔλαχον πολιὴν ἅλα ναιέμεν αἰεὶ
191 παλλομένων, Ἀΐδης δ’ ἔλαχε ζόφον ἠερόεντα,
192 Ζεὺς δ’ ἔλαχ’ οὐρανὸν εὐρὺν ἐν αἰθέρι καὶ νεφέλῃσι·
193 γαῖα δ’ ἔτι ξυνὴ πάντων καὶ μακρὸς Ὄλυμπος.
194 τώ ῥα καὶ οὔ τι Διὸς βέομαι φρεσίν, ἀλλὰ ἕκηλος
195 καὶ κρατερός περ ἐὼν μενέτω τριτάτῃ ἐνὶ μοίρῃ.
196 χερσὶ δὲ μή τί με πάγχυ κακὸν ὣς δειδισσέσθω·
197 θυγατέρεσσιν γάρ τε καὶ υἱάσι βέλτερον εἴη
198 ἐκπάγλοις ἐπέεσσιν ἐνισσέμεν οὓς τέκεν αὐτός,
199 οἵ ἑθεν ὀτρύνοντος ἀκούσονται καὶ ἀνάγκῃ.
200 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα ποδήνεμος ὠκέα Ἶρις·
201 οὕτω γὰρ δή τοι γαιήοχε κυανοχαῖτα
202 τόνδε φέρω Διὶ μῦθον ἀπηνέα τε κρατερόν τε,
203 ἦ τι μεταστρέψεις; στρεπταὶ μέν τε φρένες ἐσθλῶν.
204 οἶσθ’ ὡς πρεσβυτέροισιν Ἐρινύες αἰὲν ἕπονται.
205 τὴν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων·
206 Ἶρι θεὰ μάλα τοῦτο ἔπος κατὰ μοῖραν ἔειπες·
207 ἐσθλὸν καὶ τὸ τέτυκται ὅτ’ ἄγγελος αἴσιμα εἰδῇ.
208 ἀλλὰ τόδ’ αἰνὸν ἄχος κραδίην καὶ θυμὸν ἱκάνει
209 ὁππότ’ ἂν ἰσόμορον καὶ ὁμῇ πεπρωμένον αἴσῃ
210 νεικείειν ἐθέλῃσι χολωτοῖσιν ἐπέεσσιν.
Iris fleet as the wind then answered, "Am I really, Poseidon, to take this daring and unyielding message to Zeus, or will you reconsider your answer? Sensible people are open to argument, and you know that the Erinyes always range themselves on the side of the older person." Poseidon answered, "Goddess Iris, your words have been spoken in season. It is well when a messenger shows so much discretion. Nevertheless it cuts me to the very heart with grief [akhos] that any one should rebuke so angrily another who is his own peer, and of like empire with himself. Now, however, I will give way in spite of my displeasure; furthermore let me tell you, and I mean what I say - if contrary to the desire of myself, Athena driver of the spoil, Hera, Hermes, and King Hephaistos, Zeus spares steep Ilion, and will not let the Achaeans have the great triumph of sacking it, let him understand that he will incur our implacable resentment." Poseidon now left the field to go down under the sea [pontos], and sorely did the Achaeans miss him. Then Zeus said to Apollo, "Go, dear Phoebus, to Hektor, for Poseidon who holds the earth in his embrace has now gone down under the sea to avoid the severity of my displeasure. Had he not done so those gods who are below with Kronos would have come to hear of the fight between us. It is better for both of us that he should have curbed his anger and kept out of my reach, for I should have had much trouble with him. Take, then, your tasseled aegis, and shake it furiously, so as to set the Achaean heroes in a panic; take, moreover, brave Hektor, O Far-Darter, into your own care, and rouse him to deeds of daring, till the Achaeans are sent fleeing back to their ships and to the Hellespont. From that point I will think it well over, how the Achaeans may have a respite from their troubles [ponos]." Apollo obeyed his father's saying, and left the crests of Ida, flying like a falcon, bane of doves and swiftest of all birds. He found Hektor no longer lying upon the ground, but sitting up, for he had just come to himself again. He knew those who were about him, and the sweat and hard breathing had left him from the moment when the will [noos] of aegis-bearing Zeus had revived him. Apollo stood beside him and said, "Hektor, son of Priam, why are you so faint, and why are you here away from the others? Has any mishap befallen you?" Hektor in a weak voice answered, "And which, kind sir, of the gods are you, who now ask me thus? Do you not know that Ajax struck me on the

chest with a stone as I was killing his comrades at the ships of the Achaeans, and compelled me to leave off fighting? I made sure that this very day I should breathe my last and go down into the house of Hades." Then King Apollo said to him, "Take heart; the son of Kronos has sent you a mighty helper from Ida to stand by you and defend you, even me, Phoebus Apollo of the golden sword, who have been guardian hitherto not only of yourself but of your city. Now, therefore, order your horsemen to drive their chariots to the ships in great multitudes. I will go before your horses to smooth the way for them, and will turn the Achaeans in flight." As he spoke he infused great strength into the shepherd of his people. And as a horse, stabled and full-fed, breaks loose and gallops gloriously over the plain to the place where he is wont to take his bath in the river - he tosses his head, and his mane streams over his shoulders as in all the pride of his strength he flies full speed to the pastures where the mares are feeding - even so Hektor, when he heard what the god said, urged his horsemen on, and sped forward as fast as his limbs could take him. As country peasants set their hounds on to a horned stag or wild goat - he has taken shelter under rock or thicket, and they cannot find him, but, lo, a bearded lion whom their shouts have roused stands in their path, and they are in no further humor for the chase - even so the Achaeans were still charging on in a body, using their swords and spears pointed at both ends, but when they saw Hektor going about among his men they were afraid, and their hearts fell down into their feet.

15.211

211 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι νῦν μέν κε νεμεσσηθεὶς ὑποείξω·
212 ἄλλο δέ τοι ἐρέω, καὶ ἀπειλήσω τό γε θυμῷ·
213 αἴ κεν ἄνευ ἐμέθεν καὶ Ἀθηναίης ἀγελείης
214 Ἥρης Ἑρμείω τε καὶ Ἡφαίστοιο ἄνακτος
215 Ἰλίου αἰπεινῆς πεφιδήσεται, οὐδ’ ἐθελήσει
216 ἐκπέρσαι, δοῦναι δὲ μέγα κράτος Ἀργείοισιν,
217 ἴστω τοῦθ’ ὅτι νῶϊν ἀνήκεστος χόλος ἔσται.
218 ὣς εἰπὼν λίπε λαὸν Ἀχαιϊκὸν ἐννοσίγαιος,
219 δῦνε δὲ πόντον ἰών, πόθεσαν δ’ ἥρωες Ἀχαιοί.
220 καὶ τότ’ Ἀπόλλωνα προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
221 ἔρχεο νῦν φίλε Φοῖβε μεθ’ Ἕκτορα χαλκοκορυστήν·
222 ἤδη μὲν γάρ τοι γαιήοχος ἐννοσίγαιος
223 οἴχεται εἰς ἅλα δῖαν ἀλευάμενος χόλον αἰπὺν
224 ἡμέτερον· μάλα γάρ κε μάχης ἐπύθοντο καὶ ἄλλοι,
225 οἵ περ ἐνέρτεροί εἰσι θεοὶ Κρόνον ἀμφὶς ἐόντες.
226 ἀλλὰ τόδ’ ἡμὲν ἐμοὶ πολὺ κέρδιον ἠδέ οἱ αὐτῷ
227 ἔπλετο, ὅττι πάροιθε νεμεσσηθεὶς ὑπόειξε
228 χεῖρας ἐμάς, ἐπεὶ οὔ κεν ἀνιδρωτί γ’ ἐτελέσθη.
229 ἀλλὰ σύ γ’ ἐν χείρεσσι λάβ’ αἰγίδα θυσσανόεσσαν,
230 τῇ μάλ’ ἐπισσείων φοβέειν ἥρωας Ἀχαιούς·
231 σοὶ δ’ αὐτῷ μελέτω ἑκατηβόλε φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ·
232 τόφρα γὰρ οὗν οἱ ἔγειρε μένος μέγα, ὄφρ’ ἂν Ἀχαιοὶ
233 φεύγοντες νῆάς τε καὶ Ἑλλήσποντον ἵκωνται.
234 κεῖθεν δ’ αὐτὸς ἐγὼ φράσομαι ἔργον τε ἔπος τε,
235 ὥς κε καὶ αὖτις Ἀχαιοὶ ἀναπνεύσωσι πόνοιο.
236 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἄρα πατρὸς ἀνηκούστησεν Ἀπόλλων,
237 βῆ δὲ κατ’ Ἰδαίων ὀρέων ἴρηκι ἐοικὼς
238 ὠκέϊ φασσοφόνῳ, ὅς τ’ ὤκιστος πετεηνῶν.
239 εὗρ’ υἱὸν Πριάμοιο δαΐφρονος Ἕκτορα δῖον
240 ἥμενον, οὐδ’ ἔτι κεῖτο, νέον δ’ ἐσαγείρετο θυμόν,

15.241

ἀμφὶ ἓ γιγνώσκων ἑτάρους· ἀτὰρ ἆσθμα καὶ ἱδρὼς
παύετ’, ἐπεί μιν ἔγειρε Διὸς νόος αἰγιόχοιο.
ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱστάμενος προσέφη ἑκάεργος Ἀπόλλων·
Ἕκτορ υἱὲ Πριάμοιο, τί ἢ δὲ σὺ νόσφιν ἀπ’ ἄλλων
ἧσ’ ὀλιγηπελέων; ἦ πού τί σε κῆδος ἱκάνει;
τὸν δ’ ὀλιγοδρανέων προσέφη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
τίς δὲ σύ ἐσσι φέριστε θεῶν ὅς μ’ εἴρεαι ἄντην;
οὐκ ἀΐεις ὅ με νηυσὶν ἔπι πρυμνῇσιν Ἀχαιῶν
οὓς ἑτάρους ὀλέκοντα βοὴν ἀγαθὸς βάλεν Αἴας
χερμαδίῳ πρὸς στῆθος, ἔπαυσε δὲ θούριδος ἀλκῆς;
καὶ δὴ ἔγωγ’ ἐφάμην νέκυας καὶ δῶμ’ Ἀΐδαο
ἤματι τῷδ’ ἴξεσθαι, ἐπεὶ φίλον ἄϊον ἦτορ.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν ἄναξ ἑκάεργος Ἀπόλλων·
θάρσει νῦν· τοῖόν τοι ἀοσσητῆρα Κρονίων
ἐξ Ἴδης προέηκε παρεστάμεναι καὶ ἀμύνειν
Φοῖβον Ἀπόλλωνα χρυσάορον, ὅς σε πάρος περ
ῥύομ’, ὁμῶς αὐτόν τε καὶ αἰπεινὸν πτολίεθρον.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε νῦν ἱππεῦσιν ἐπότρυνον πολέεσσι
νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσιν ἐλαυνέμεν ὠκέας ἵππους·
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ προπάροιθε κιὼν ἵπποισι κέλευθον
πᾶσαν λειανέω, τρέψω δ’ ἥρωας Ἀχαιούς.
ὣς εἰπὼν ἔμπνευσε μένος μέγα ποιμένι λαῶν.
ὡς δ’ ὅτε τις στατὸς ἵππος ἀκοστήσας ἐπὶ φάτνῃ
δεσμὸν ἀπορρήξας θείῃ πεδίοιο κροαίνων
εἰωθὼς λούεσθαι ἐϋρρεῖος ποταμοῖο
κυδιόων· ὑψοῦ δὲ κάρη ἔχει, ἀμφὶ δὲ χαῖται
ὤμοις ἀΐσσονται· ὃ δ’ ἀγλαΐηφι πεποιθὼς
ῥίμφά ἑ γοῦνα φέρει μετά τ’ ἤθεα καὶ νομὸν ἵππων·
ὣς Ἕκτωρ λαιψηρὰ πόδας καὶ γούνατ’ ἐνώμα
ὀτρύνων ἱππῆας, ἐπεὶ θεοῦ ἔκλυεν αὐδήν.

15.271

οἳ δ’ ὥς τ’ ἢ ἔλαφον κεραὸν ἢ ἄγριον αἶγα
ἐσσεύαντο κύνες τε καὶ ἀνέρες ἀγροιῶται·
τὸν μέν τ’ ἠλίβατος πέτρη καὶ δάσκιος ὕλη
εἰρύσατ’, οὐδ’ ἄρα τέ σφι κιχήμεναι αἴσιμον ἦεν·
τῶν δέ θ’ ὑπὸ ἰαχῆς ἐφάνη λὶς ἠϋγένειος
εἰς ὁδόν, αἶψα δὲ πάντας ἀπέτραπε καὶ μεμαῶτας·
ὣς Δαναοὶ εἶος μὲν ὁμιλαδὸν αἰὲν ἔποντο
νύσσοντες ξίφεσίν τε καὶ ἔγχεσιν ἀμφιγύοισιν·
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ ἴδον Ἕκτορ’ ἐποιχόμενον στίχας ἀνδρῶν
τάρβησαν, πᾶσιν δὲ παραὶ ποσὶ κάππεσε θυμός.
τοῖσι δ’ ἔπειτ’ ἀγόρευε Θόας Ἀνδραίμονος υἱός,
Αἰτωλῶν ὄχ’ ἄριστος ἐπιστάμενος μὲν ἄκοντι
ἐσθλὸς δ’ ἐν σταδίῃ· ἀγορῇ δέ ἑ παῦροι Ἀχαιῶν
νίκων, ὁππότε κοῦροι ἐρίσσειαν περὶ μύθων·
ὅ σφιν ἐϋφρονέων ἀγορήσατο καὶ μετέειπεν·
ὢ πόποι ἦ μέγα θαῦμα τόδ’ ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ὁρῶμαι,
οἷον δ’ αὖτ’ ἐξαῦτις ἀνέστη κῆρας ἀλύξας
Ἕκτωρ· ἦ θήν μιν μάλα ἔλπετο θυμὸς ἑκάστου

289 χερσὶν ὑπ’ Αἴαντος θανέειν Τελαμωνιάδαο.
290 ἀλλά τις αὖτε θεῶν ἐρρύσατο καὶ ἐσάωσεν
291 Ἕκτορ’, ὃ δὴ πολλῶν Δαναῶν ὑπὸ γούνατ’ ἔλυσεν,
292 ὡς καὶ νῦν ἔσσεσθαι ὀΐομαι· οὐ γὰρ ἄτερ γε
293 Ζηνὸς ἐριγδούπου πρόμος ἵσταται ὧδε μενοινῶν.
294 ἀλλ’ ἄγεθ’ ὡς ἂν ἐγὼν εἴπω πειθώμεθα πάντες.
295 πληθὺν μὲν ποτὶ νῆας ἀνώξομεν ἀπονέεσθαι·
296 αὐτοὶ δ’, ὅσσοι ἄριστοι ἐνὶ στρατῷ εὐχόμεθ’ εἶναι,
297 στήομεν, εἴ κεν πρῶτον ἐρύξομεν ἀντιάσαντες
298 δούρατ’ ἀνασχόμενοι· τὸν δ’ οἴω καὶ μεμαῶτα
299 θυμῷ δείσεσθαι Δαναῶν καταδῦναι ὅμιλον.
300 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα τοῦ μάλα μὲν κλύον ἠδὲ πίθοντο·
Then spoke Thoas son of Andraimon, leader of the Aetolians, a man who could throw a good throw, and who was staunch also in close fight, while few could surpass him in debate when opinions were divided. He then with all sincerity and goodwill addressed them thus: "What, in heaven's name, do I now see? Is it not Hektor come to life again? Every one made sure he had been killed by Ajax son of Telamon, but it seems that one of the gods has again rescued him. He has killed many of us Danaans already, and I take it will yet do so, for the hand of Zeus must be with him or he would never dare show himself so masterful in the forefront of the battle. Now, therefore, let us all do as I say; let us order the main body of our forces to fall back upon the ships, but let those of us who profess to be the flower of the army stand firm, and see whether we cannot hold Hektor back at the point of our spears as soon as he comes near us; I conceive that he will then think better of it before he tries to charge into the press of the Danaans." Thus did he speak, and they did even as he had said. Those who were about Ajax and King Idomeneus, the followers moreover of Teucer, Meriones, and Meges peer of Ares called all their best men about them and sustained the fight against Hektor and the Trojans, but the main body fell back upon the ships of the Achaeans. The Trojans pressed forward in a dense body, with Hektor striding on at their head. Before him went Phoebus Apollo shrouded in cloud about his shoulders. He bore aloft the terrible aegis with its shaggy fringe, which Hephaistos the smith had given Zeus to strike terror into the hearts of men. With this in his hand he led on the Trojans. The Argives held together and stood their ground. The cry of battle rose high from either side, and the arrows flew from the bowstrings. Many a spear sped from strong hands and fastened in the bodies of many a valiant warrior, while others fell to earth midway, before they could taste of man's fair flesh and glut themselves with blood. So long as Phoebus Apollo held his aegis quietly and without shaking it, the weapons on either side took effect and the people fell, but when he shook it straight in the face of the Danaans and raised his mighty battle-cry their hearts fainted within them and they forgot their former prowess. As when two wild beasts spring in the dead of night on a herd of cattle or a large flock of sheep when the herdsman is not there - even so were the Danaans struck helpless, for Apollo filled them with panic and gave victory to Hektor and the Trojans. The fight then became more scattered and they killed one another where they best could. Hektor killed Stichios and Arkesilaos, the one, leader of the Boeotians, and the other, friend and comrade of Menestheus. Aeneas killed Medon and Iasos. The first was bastard son to Oileus, and brother to Ajax, but he lived in Phylake away from his own country, for he had killed a man, a kinsman of his stepmother Eriopis whom Oileus had married. Iasos had become a leader of the Athenians, and was son of Sphelus the son of Boukolos. Polydamas killed Mekisteus, and Polites Echios, in the front of the battle, while Agenor slew Klonios. Paris struck Deiochus from behind in the lower part of the shoulder, as he was fleeing among the foremost, and the point of the spear went clean through him. While they were spoiling these heroes of their armor, the Achaeans were fleeing pellmell to the trench and the set stakes, and were forced back within their wall.

Hektor then cried out to the Trojans, "Forward to the ships, and let the spoils be. If I see any man keeping back on the other side the wall away from the ships I will have him killed: his kinsmen and kinswomen shall not give him his dues of fire, but dogs shall tear him in pieces in front of our city." As he spoke he laid his whip about his horses' shoulders and called to the Trojans throughout their ranks; the Trojans shouted with a cry that rent the air, and kept their horses neck and neck with his own. Phoebus Apollo went before, and kicked down the banks of the deep trench into its middle so as to make a great broad bridge, as broad as the throw of a spear when a man is trying his strength. The Trojan battalions poured over the bridge, and Apollo with his redoubtable aegis led the way. He kicked down the wall of the Achaeans as easily as a child who playing on the sea-shore has built a house of sand and then kicks it down again and destroys it - even so did you, O Apollo, shed toil and trouble upon the Argives, filling them with panic and confusion. Thus then were the Achaeans hemmed in at their ships, calling out to one another and raising their hands with loud cries every man to heaven. Nestor of Gerene, tower of strength to the Achaeans, lifted up his hands to the starry firmament of heaven, and prayed more fervently than any of them. "Father Zeus," said he, "if ever any one in wheat-growing Argos burned you fat thigh-bones of sheep or heifer and prayed that he might return safely home, whereon you bowed your head to him in assent, bear it in mind now, and suffer not the Trojans to triumph thus over the Achaeans."

15.301

οἳ μὲν ἄρ’ ἀμφ’ Αἴαντα καὶ Ἰδομενῆα ἄνακτα
Τεῦκρον Μηριόνην τε Μέγην τ’ ἀτάλαντον Ἄρηϊ
ὑσμίνην ἤρτυνον ἀριστῆας καλέσαντες
Ἕκτορι καὶ Τρώεσσιν ἐναντίον· αὐτὰρ ὀπίσσω
ἢ πληθὺς ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν ἀπονέοντο.
Τρῶες δὲ προΰτυψαν ἀολλέες, ἦρχε δ’ ἄρ’ Ἕκτωρ
μακρὰ βιβάς· πρόσθεν δὲ κί’ αὐτοῦ Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων
εἰμένος ὤμοιιν νεφέλην, ἔχε δ’ αἰγίδα θοῦριν
δεινὴν ἀμφιδάσειαν ἀριπρεπέ’, ἣν ἄρα χαλκεὺς
Ἥφαιστος Διὶ δῶκε φορήμεναι ἐς φόβον ἀνδρῶν·
τὴν ἄρ’ ὅ γ’ ἐν χείρεσσιν ἔχων ἰγήσατο λαῶν.
Ἀργεῖοι δ’ ὑπέμειναν ἀολλέες, ὦρτο δ’ ἀϋτὴ
ὀξεῖ’ ἀμφοτέρωθεν, ἀπὸ νευρῆφι δ’ ὀϊστοὶ
θρῷσκον· πολλὰ δὲ δοῦρα θρασειάων ἀπὸ χειρῶν
ἄλλα μὲν ἐν χροὶ πήγνυτ’ ἀρηϊθόων αἰζηῶν,
πολλὰ δὲ καὶ μεσσηγὺ πάρος χρόα λευκὸν ἐπαυρεῖν
ἐν γαίῃ ἵσταντο λιλαιόμενα χροὸς ἆσαι.
ὄφρα μὲν αἰγίδα χερσὶν ἔχ’ ἀτρέμα Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων,
τόφρα μάλ’ ἀμφοτέρων βέλε’ ἥπτετο, πῖπτε δὲ λαός.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ κατ’ ἐνῶπα ἰδὼν Δαναῶν ταχυπώλων
σεῖσ’, ἐπὶ δ’ αὐτὸς ἄϋσε μάλα μέγα, τοῖσι δὲ θυμὸν
ἐν στήθεσσιν ἔθελξε, λάθοντο δὲ θούριδος ἀλκῆς.
οἳ δ’ ὥς τ’ ἠὲ βοῶν ἀγέλην ἢ πῶϋ μέγ’ οἰῶν
θῆρε δύω κλονέωσι μελαίνης νυκτὸς ἀμολγῷ
ἐλθόντ’ ἐξαπίνης σημάντορος οὐ παρεόντος,
ὣς ἐφόβηθεν Ἀχαιοὶ ἀνάλκιδες· ἐν γὰρ Ἀπόλλων
ἧκε φόβον, Τρωσὶν δὲ καὶ Ἕκτορι κῦδος ὄπαζεν.
ἔνθα δ’ ἀνὴρ ἔλεν ἄνδρα κεδασθείσης ὑσμίνης.
Ἕκτωρ μὲν Στιχίον τε καὶ Ἀρκεσίλαον ἔπεφνε,
τὸν μὲν Βοιωτῶν ἡγήτορα χαλκοχιτώνων,

15.331

τὸν δὲ Μενεσθῆος μεγαθύμου πιστὸν ἑταῖρον·
Αἰνείας δὲ Μέδοντα καὶ Ἴασον ἐξενάριξεν.
ἤτοι ὃ μὲν νόθος υἱὸς Ὀϊλῆος θείοιο
ἔσκε Μέδων Αἴαντος ἀδελφεός· αὐτὰρ ἔναιεν
ἐν Φυλάκῃ γαίης ἄπο πατρίδος ἄνδρα κατακτὰς
γνωτὸν μητρυιῆς Ἐριώπιδος, ἣν ἔχ’ Ὀϊλεύς·
Ἴασος αὖτ’ ἀρχὸς μὲν Ἀθηναίων ἐτέτυκτο,
υἱὸς δὲ Σφήλοιο καλέσκετο Βουκολίδαο.
Μηκιστῆ δ’ ἔλε Πουλυδάμας, Ἐχίον δὲ Πολίτης
πρώτῃ ἐν ὑσμίνῃ, Κλονίον δ’ ἔλε δῖος Ἀγήνωρ.
Δηΐοχον δὲ Πάρις βάλε νείατον ὦμον ὄπισθε
φεύγοντ’ ἐν προμάχοισι, διὰ πρὸ δὲ χαλκὸν ἔλασσεν.
ὄφρ’ οἳ τοὺς ἐνάριζον ἀπ’ ἔντεα, τόφρα δ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
τάφρῳ καὶ σκολόπεσσιν ἐνιπλήξαντες ὀρυκτῇ
ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα φέβοντο, δύοντο δὲ τεῖχος ἀνάγκῃ.
Ἕκτωρ δὲ Τρώεσσιν ἐκέκλετο μακρὸν ἀΰσας
νηυσὶν ἐπισσεύεσθαι, ἐᾶν δ’ ἔναρα βροτόεντα·
ὃν δ’ ἂν ἐγὼν ἀπάνευθε νεῶν ἐτέρωθι νοήσω,
αὐτοῦ οἱ θάνατον μητίσομαι, οὐδέ νυ τόν γε
γνωτοί τε γνωταί τε πυρὸς λελάχωσι θανόντα,
ἀλλὰ κύνες ἐρύουσι πρὸ ἄστεος ἠμετέροιο.
ὣς εἰπὼν μάστιγι κατωμαδὸν ἤλασεν ἵππους
κεκλόμενος Τρώεσσι κατὰ στίχας· οἳ δὲ σὺν αὐτῷ
πάντες ὁμοκλήσαντες ἔχον ἐρυσάρματας ἵππους
ἠχῇ θεσπεσίῃ· προπάροιθε δὲ Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων
ῥεῖ’ ὄχθας καπέτοιο βαθείης ποσσὶν ἐρείπων
ἐς μέσσον κατέβαλλε, γεφύρωσεν δὲ κέλευθον
μακρὴν ἠδ’ εὐρεῖαν, ὅσον τ’ ἐπὶ δουρὸς ἐρωὴ
γίγνεται, ὁππότ’ ἀνὴρ σθένεος πειρώμενος ᾖσι.
τῇ ῥ’ οἵ γε προχέοντο φαλαγγηδόν, πρὸ δ’ Ἀπόλλων

15.361

αἰγίδ’ ἔχων ἐρίτιμον· ἔρειπε δὲ τεῖχος Ἀχαιῶν
ῥεῖα μάλ’, ὡς ὅτε τις ψάμαθον πάϊς ἄγχι θαλάσσης,
ὅς τ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν ποιήσῃ ἀθύρματα νηπιέῃσιν
ἂψ αὖτις συνέχευε ποσὶν καὶ χερσὶν ἀθύρων.
ὥς ῥα σὺ ἤϊε Φοῖβε πολὺν κάματον καὶ ὀϊζὺν
σύγχεας Ἀργείων, αὐτοῖσι δὲ φύζαν ἐνῶρσας.
ὣς οἳ μὲν παρὰ νηυσὶν ἐρητύοντο μένοντες,
ἀλλήλοισί τε κεκλόμενοι καὶ πᾶσι θεοῖσι
χεῖρας ἀνίσχοντες μεγάλ’ εὐχετόωντο ἕκαστος·
Νέστωρ αὖτε μάλιστα Γερήνιος οὖρος Ἀχαιῶν
εὔχετο χεῖρ’ ὀρέγων εἰς οὐρανὸν ἀστερόεντα·
Ζεῦ πάτερ εἴ ποτέ τίς τοι ἐν Ἄργεΐ περ πολυπύρῳ
ἢ βοὸς ἢ οἰὸς κατὰ πίονα μηρία καίων
εὔχετο νοστῆσαι, σὺ δ’ ὑπέσχεο καὶ κατένευσας,
τῶν μνῆσαι καὶ ἄμυνον Ὀλύμπιε νηλεὲς ἦμαρ,
μηδ’ οὕτω Τρώεσσιν ἔα δάμνασθαι Ἀχαιούς.
ὣς ἔφατ’ εὐχόμενος, μέγα δ’ ἔκτυπε μητίετα Ζεύς,
ἀράων ἀΐων Νηληϊάδαο γέροντος.

379 Τρῶες δ’ ὡς ἐπύθοντο Διὸς κτύπον αἰγιόχοιο,
380 μᾶλλον ἐπ’ Ἀργείοισι θόρον, μνήσαντο δὲ χάρμης.
381 οἳ δ’ ὥς τε μέγα κῦμα θαλάσσης εὐρυπόροιο
382 νηὸς ὑπὲρ τοίχων καταβήσεται, ὀππότ’ ἐπείγῃ
383 ἴς ἀνέμου· ἦ γάρ τε μάλιστά γε κύματ’ ὀφέλλει·
384 ὣς Τρῶες μεγάλῃ ἰαχῇ κατὰ τεῖχος ἔβαινον,
385 ἵππους δ’ εἰσελάσαντες ἐπὶ πρύμνῃσι μάχοντο
386 ἔγχεσιν ἀμφιγύοις αὐτοσχεδόν, οἳ μὲν ἀφ’ ἵππων,
387 οἳ δ’ ἀπὸ νηῶν ὕψι μελαινάων ἐπιβάντες
388 μακροῖσι ξυστοῖσι, τά ῥά σφ’ ἐπὶ νηυσὶν ἔκειτο
389 ναύμαχα κολλήεντα, κατὰ στόμα εἰμένα χαλκῷ.
390 Πάτροκλος δ’ εἷος μὲν Ἀχαιοί τε Τρῶές τε
All counseling Zeus thundered loudly in answer to die prayer of the aged son of Neleus. When the heard Zeus thunder they flung themselves yet more fiercely on the Achaeans. As a wave breaking over the bulwarks of a ship when the sea runs high before a gale- for it is the force of the wind that makes the waves so great - even so did the Trojans spring over the wall with a shout, and drive their chariots onwards. The two sides fought with their double-pointed spears in hand-to-hand encounter-the Trojans from their chariots, and the Achaeans climbing up into their ships and wielding the long pikes that were lying on the decks ready for use in a sea-fight, jointed and shod with bronze. Now Patroklos, so long as the Achaeans and Trojans were fighting about the wall, but were not yet within it and at the ships, remained sitting in the tent of good Eurypylos, entertaining him with his conversation and spreading herbs over his wound to ease his pain. When, however, he saw the Trojans swarming through the breach in the wall, while the Achaeans were clamoring and struck with panic, he cried aloud, and smote his two thighs with the flat of his hands. "Eurypylos," said he in his dismay, "I know you want me badly, but I cannot stay with you any longer, for there is hard fighting going on; a squire [therapôn] shall take care of you now, for I must make all speed to Achilles, and induce him to fight if I can; who knows but with the help of a daimôn I may persuade him. A man does well to listen to the advice of a friend." When he had thus spoken he went his way. The Achaeans stood firm and resisted the attack of the Trojans, yet though these were fewer in number, they could not drive them back from the ships, neither could the Trojans break the Achaean ranks and make their way in among the tents and ships. As a carpenter's line gives a true edge to a piece of ship's timber, in the hand of some skilled workman whom Athena has instructed in all kinds of useful arts - even so level was the issue of the fight between the two sides, as they fought some round one and some round another. Hektor made straight for Ajax, and the put up fierce struggle [ponos] over the same ship. Hektor could not force Ajax back and fire the ship, nor yet could Ajax drive Hektor from the spot to which a daimôn had brought him. Then Ajax struck Kaletor son of Klytios in the chest with a spear as he was bringing fire towards the ship. He fell heavily to the ground and the torch dropped from his hand. When Hektor saw his cousin fallen in front of the ship he shouted to the Trojans and Lycians saying, "Trojans, Lycians, and Dardanians good in close fight, bate not a jot, but rescue the son of Klytios lest the Achaeans strip him of his armor now that he has fallen in the struggle [agôn]." He then aimed a spear at Ajax, and missed him, but he hit Lykophron a follower [therapôn] of Ajax, who came from Cythera, but was living with Ajax inasmuch as he had killed a man among the Cythereans. Hektor's spear struck him on the head below the ear, and he fell headlong from the ship's prow on to the ground with no life left in him. Ajax shook with rage and said to his brother, "Teucer, my good man, our trusty comrade the son of Mastor has fallen, he came to live with us from Cythera and whom we honored as much as our own parents. Hektor has just killed him; fetch your deadly arrows at once and the bow which Phoebus Apollo gave you." Teucer heard him and hastened towards him with his

bow and quiver in his hands. Forthwith he showered his arrows on the Trojans, and hit Kleitos the son of Pisenor, comrade of Polydamas the noble son of Panthoos, with the reins in his hands as he was attending to his horses; he was in the middle of the very thickest part of the fight, doing good service to Hektor and the Trojans, but evil had now come upon him, and not one of those who were fain to do so could avert it, for the arrow struck him on the back of the neck. He fell from his chariot and his horses shook the empty car as they swerved aside. King Polydamas saw what had happened, and was the first to come up to the horses; he gave them in charge to Astynoos son of Protiaon, and ordered him to look on, and to keep the horses near at hand. He then went back and took his place in the front ranks. Teucer then aimed another arrow at Hektor, and there would have been no more fighting at the ships if he had hit him and killed him then and there: but Teucer did not escape the notice [noos] of Zeus, who kept watch over Hektor and deprived him of his triumph, by breaking his bowstring for him just as he was drawing it and about to take his aim; on this the arrow went astray and the bow fell from his hands. Teucer shook with anger and said to his brother, "Alas, see how a daimôn thwarts us in all we do; he has broken my bowstring and snatched the bow from my hand, though I strung it this selfsame morning that it might serve me for many an arrow."

15.391

391 τείχεος ἀμφεμάχοντο θοάων ἔκτοθι νηῶν,
392 τόφρ’ ὅ γ’ ἐνὶ κλισίῃ ἀγαπήνορος Εὐρυπύλοιο
393 ἧστό τε καὶ τὸν ἔτερπε λόγοις, ἐπὶ δ’ ἕλκεϊ λυγρῷ
394 φάρμακ’ ἀκέσματ’ ἔπασσε μελαινάων ὀδυνάων.
395 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ τεῖχος ἐπεσσυμένους ἐνόησε
396 Τρῶας, ἀτὰρ Δαναῶν γένετο ἰαχή τε φόβος τε,
397 ὤμωξέν τ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα καὶ ὣ πεπλήγετο μηρὼ
398 χερσὶ καταπρηνέσσ’, ὀλοφυρόμενος δ’ ἔπος ηὔδα·
399 Εὐρύπυλ’ οὐκ ἔτι τοι δύναμαι χατέοντί περ’ ἔμπης
400 ἐνθάδε παρμενέμεν· δὴ γὰρ μέγα νεῖκος ὄρωρεν·
401 ἀλλὰ σὲ μὲν θεράπων ποτιτερπέτω, αὐτὰρ ἔγωγε
402 σπεύσομαι εἰς Ἀχιλῆα, ἵν’ ὀτρύνω πολεμίζειν.
403 τίς δ’ οἶδ’ εἴ κέν οἱ σὺν δαίμονι θυμὸν ὀρίνω
404 παρειπών; ἀγαθὴ δὲ παραίφασίς ἐστιν ἑταίρου.
405 τὸν μὲν ἄρ’ ὣς εἰπόντα πόδες φέρον· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
406 Τρῶας ἐπερχομένους μένον ἔμπεδον, οὐδ’ ἐδύναντο
407 παυροτέρους περ ἐόντας ἀπώσασθαι παρὰ νηῶν·
408 οὐδέ ποτε Τρῶες Δαναῶν ἐδύναντο φάλαγγας
409 ῥηξάμενοι κλισίῃσι μιγήμεναι ἠδὲ νέεσσιν.
410 ἀλλ’ ὥς τε στάθμη δόρυ νήϊον ἐξιθύνει
411 τέκτονος ἐν παλάμῃσι δαήμονος, ὅς ῥά τε πάσης
412 εὖ εἰδῇ σοφίης ὑποθημοσύνῃσιν Ἀθήνης,
413 ὣς μὲν τῶν ἐπὶ ἶσα μάχη τέτατο πτόλεμός τε·
414 ἄλλοι δ’ ἀμφ’ ἄλλῃσι μάχην ἐμάχοντο νέεσσιν,
415 Ἕκτωρ δ’ ἄντ’ Αἴαντος ἐείσατο κυδαλίμοιο.
416 τὼ δὲ μιῆς περὶ νηὸς ἔχον πόνον, οὐδὲ δύναντο
417 οὔθ’ ὃ τὸν ἐξελάσαι καὶ ἐνιπρῆσαι πυρὶ νῆα
418 οὔθ’ ὃ τὸν ἂψ ὤσασθαι, ἐπεί ῥ’ ἐπέλασσέ γε δαίμων.
419 ἔνθ’ υἷα Κλυτίοιο Καλήτορα φαίδιμος Αἴας
420 πῦρ ἐς νῆα φέροντα κατὰ στῆθος βάλε δουρί.

15.421

δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, δαλὸς δέ οἱ ἔκπεσε χειρός.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ὡς ἐνόησεν ἀνεψιὸν ὀφθαλμοῖσιν
ἐν κονίῃσι πεσόντα νεὸς προπάροιθε μελαίνης,
Τρωσί τε καὶ Λυκίοισιν ἐκέκλετο μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
Τρῶες καὶ Λύκιοι καὶ Δάρδανοι ἀγχιμαχηταὶ
μὴ δή πω χάζεσθε μάχης ἐν στείνεϊ τῷδε,
ἀλλ’ υἷα Κλυτίοιο σαώσατε, μή μιν Ἀχαιοὶ
τεύχεα συλήσωσι νεῶν ἐν ἀγῶνι πεσόντα.
ὣς εἰπὼν Αἴαντος ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ.
τοῦ μὲν ἄμαρθ’, ὃ δ’ ἔπειτα Λυκόφρονα Μάστορος υἱὸν
Αἴαντος θεράποντα Κυθήριον, ὅς ῥα παρ’ αὐτῷ
ναῖ’, ἐπεὶ ἄνδρα κατέκτα Κυθήροισι ζαθέοισι,
τόν ῥ’ ἔβαλεν κεφαλὴν ὑπὲρ οὔατος ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ
ἐσταότ’ ἄγχ’ Αἴαντος· ὃ δ’ ὕπτιος ἐν κονίῃσι
νηὸς ἄπο πρυμνῆς χαμάδις πέσε, λύντο δὲ γυῖα.
Αἴας δ’ ἐρρίγησε, κασίγνητον δὲ προσηύδα·
Τεῦκρε πέπον δὴ νῶϊν ἀπέκτατο πιστὸς ἑταῖρος
Μαστορίδης, ὃν νῶϊ Κυθηρόθεν ἔνδον ἐόντα
ἶσα φίλοισι τοκεῦσιν ἐτίομεν ἐν μεγάροισι·
τὸν δ’ Ἕκτωρ μεγάθυμος ἀπέκτανε. ποῦ νύ τοι ἰοὶ
ὠκύμοροι καὶ τόξον ὅ τοι πόρε Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων;
ὣς φάθ’, ὃ δὲ ξυνέηκε, θέων δέ οἱ ἄγχι παρέστη,
τόξον ἔχων ἐν χειρὶ παλίντονον ἠδὲ φαρέτρην
ἰοδόκον· μάλα δ’ ὦκα βέλεα Τρώεσσιν ἐφίει.
καί ῥ’ ἔβαλε Κλεῖτον Πεισήνορος ἀγλαὸν υἱὸν
Πουλυδάμαντος ἑταῖρον ἀγαυοῦ Πανθοΐδαο
ἡνία χερσὶν ἔχοντα· ὃ μὲν πεπόνητο καθ’ ἵππους·
τῇ γὰρ ἔχ’ ᾗ ῥα πολὺ πλεῖσται κλονέοντο φάλαγγες
Ἕκτορι καὶ Τρώεσσι χαριζόμενος· τάχα δ’ αὐτῷ
ἦλθε κακόν, τό οἱ οὔ τις ἐρύκακεν ἱεμένων περ.

15.451

αὐχένι γάρ οἱ ὄπισθε πολύστονος ἔμπεσεν ἰός·
ἤριπε δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων, ὑπερώησαν δέ οἱ ἵπποι
κείν’ ὄχεα κροτέοντες. ἄναξ δ’ ἐνόησε τάχιστα
Πουλυδάμας, καὶ πρῶτος ἐναντίος ἦλυθεν ἵππων.
τοὺς μὲν ὅ γ’ Ἀστυνόῳ Προτιάονος υἱέϊ δῶκε,
πολλὰ δ’ ἐπότρυνε σχεδὸν ἴσχειν εἰσορόωντα
ἵππους· αὐτὸς δ’ αὖτις ἰὼν promάχοισιν ἐμίχθη.
Τεῦκρος δ’ ἄλλον ὀϊστὸν ἐφ’ Ἕκτορι χαλκοκορυστῇ
αἴνυτο, καί κεν ἔπαυσε μάχης ἐπὶ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν,
εἴ μιν ἀριστεύοντα βαλὼν ἐξείλετο θυμόν.
ἀλλ’ οὐ λῆθε Διὸς πυκινὸν νόον, ὅς ῥ’ ἐφύλασσεν
Ἕκτορ’, ἀτὰρ Τεῦκρον Τελαμώνιον εὖχος ἀπηύρα,
ὅς οἱ ἐϋστρεφέα νευρὴν ἐν ἀμύμονι τόξῳ
ῥῆξ’ ἐπὶ τῷ ἐρύοντι· παρεπλάγχθη δέ οἱ ἄλλῃ
ἰὸς χαλκοβαρής, τόξον δέ οἱ ἔκπεσε χειρός.
Τεῦκρος δ’ ἐρρίγησε, κασίγνητον δὲ προσηύδα·
ὦ πόποι ἦ δὴ πάγχυ μάχης ἐπὶ μήδεα κείρει
δαίμων ἡμετέρης, ὅ τέ μοι βιὸν ἔκβαλε χειρός,

469 νευρὴν δ’ ἐξέρρηξε νεόστροφον, ἣν ἐνέδησα
470 πρώϊον, ὄφρ’ ἀνέχοιτο θαμὰ θρῴσκοντας ὀϊστούς.
471 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας·
472 ὦ πέπον ἀλλὰ βιὸν μὲν ἔα καὶ ταρφέας ἰοὺς
473 κεῖσθαι, ἐπεὶ συνέχευε θεὸς Δαναοῖσι μεγήρας·
474 αὐτὰρ χερσὶν ἑλὼν δολιχὸν δόρυ καὶ σάκος ὤμῳ
475 μάρναό τε Τρώεσσι καὶ ἄλλους ὄρνυθι λαούς.
476 μὴ μὰν ἀσπουδί γε δαμασσάμενοί περ ἕλοιεν
477 νῆας ἐϋσσέλμους, ἀλλὰ μνησώμεθα χάρμης.
478 ὣς φάθ’, ὁ δὲ τόξον μὲν ἐνὶ κλισίῃσιν ἔθηκεν,
479 αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἀμφ’ ὤμοισι σάκος θέτο τετραθέλυμνον,
480 κρατὶ δ’ ἐπ’ ἰφθίμῳ κυνέην εὔτυκτον ἔθηκεν
Ajax son of Telamon answered, "My good man, let your bow and your arrows be, for Zeus has made them useless in order to spite the Danaans. Take your spear, lay your shield upon your shoulder, and both fight the Trojans yourself and urge others to do so. They may be successful for the moment but if we fight as we ought they will find it a hard matter to take the ships." Teucer then took his bow and put it by in his tent. He hung a shield four hides thick about his shoulders, and on his comely head he set his helmet well wrought with a crest of horse-hair that nodded menacingly above it; he grasped his redoubtable bronze-shod spear, and forthwith he was by the side of Ajax. When Hektor saw that Teucer's bow was of no more use to him, he shouted out to the Trojans and Lycians, "Trojans, Lycians, and Dardanians good in close fight, be men, my friends, and show your mettle here at the ships, for I see the weapon of one of their chieftains made useless by the hand of Zeus. It is easy to see when Zeus is helping people and means to help them still further, or again when he is bringing them down and will do nothing for them; he is now on our side, and is going against the Argives. Therefore swarm round the ships and fight. If any of you is struck by spear or sword and loses his life, let him die; he dies with honor who dies fighting for his country; and he will leave his wife and children safe behind him, with his house and allotment unplundered if only the Achaeans can be driven back to their own land, they and their ships." With these words he put heart and soul into them all. Ajax on the other side exhorted his comrades saying, "Shame [aidôs] on you Argives, we are now utterly undone, unless we can save ourselves by driving the enemy from our ships. Do you think, if Hektor takes them, that you will be able to get home by land? Can you not hear him cheering on his whole host to fire our fleet, and bidding them remember that they are not at a dance [khoros] but in battle? Our only thought [noos] and plan [mêtis] is to fight them with might and main; we had better chance it, life or death, once for all, than fight long and without issue hemmed in at our ships by worse men than ourselves." With these words he put life [menos] and spirit [thumos] into them all. Hektor then killed Schedios son of Perimedes, leader of the Phoceans, and Ajax killed Laodamas leader of foot soldiers and son to Antenor. Polydamas killed Otos of Cyllene a comrade of the son of Phyleus and chief of the proud Epeans. When Meges saw this he sprang upon him, but Polydamas crouched down, and he missed him, for Apollo would not suffer the son of Panthoos to fall in battle; but the spear hit Croesmus in the middle of his chest, whereon he fell heavily to the ground, and Meges stripped him of his armor. At that moment the valiant warrior Dolops son of Lampos sprang upon Lampos was son of Laomedon and for his valor, while his son Dolops was versed in all the ways of war. He then struck the middle of the son of Phyleus' shield with his spear, setting on him at close quarters, but his good corselet made with plates of metal saved him; Phyleus had brought it from Ephyra and the river Selleis, where his host, King Euphetes, had given it him to wear in battle and protect him. It now served to save the life of his son. Then Meges struck the topmost crest of Dolops' bronze helmet with his spear and tore away its plume of horse-hair, so that all newly dyed with scarlet as it was it tumbled down into

the dust. While he was still fighting and confident of victory, Menelaos came up to help Meges, and got by the side of Dolops unperceived; he then speared him in the shoulder, from behind, and the point, driven so furiously, went through into his chest, whereon he fell headlong. The two then made towards him to strip him of his armor, but Hektor called on all his brothers for help, and he especially upbraided brave Melanippos son of Hiketaon, who erewhile used to pasture his herds of cattle in Perkote before the war broke out; but when the ships of the Danaans came, he went back to Ilion, where he was eminent among the Trojans, and lived near Priam who treated him as one of his own sons. Hektor now rebuked him and said, "Why, Melanippos, are we thus remiss? do you take no note of the death of your kinsman, and do you not see how they are trying to take Dolops' armor? Follow me; there must be no fighting the Argives from a distance now, but we must do so in close combat till either we kill them or they take the high wall of Ilion and slay her people." He led on as he spoke, and the hero Melanippos followed after. Meanwhile Ajax son of Telamon was cheering on the Argives. "My friends," he cried, "be men, and fear the loss of respect [aidôs]; quit yourselves in battle so as to win respect from one another. Men who respect each other's good opinion are less likely to be killed than those who do not, but in flight there is neither gain nor glory [kleos]." Thus did he exhort men who were already bent upon driving back the Trojans. They laid his words to heart and hedged the ships as with a wall of bronze, while Zeus urged on the Trojans. Menelaos of the loud battle-cry urged Antilokhos on. "Antilokhos," said he, "you are young and there is none of the Achaeans more fleet of foot or more valiant than you are. See if you cannot spring upon some Trojan and kill him." He hurried away when he had thus spurred Antilokhos, who at once darted out from the front ranks and aimed a spear, after looking carefully round him. The Trojans fell back as he threw, and the dart did not speed from his hand without effect, for it struck Melanippos the proud son of Hiketaon in the breast by the nipple as he was coming forward, and his armor rang rattling round him as he fell heavily to the ground. Antilokhos sprang upon him as a dog springs on a fawn which a hunter has hit as it was breaking away from its covert, and killed it. Even so, O Melanippos, did stalwart Antilokhos spring upon you to strip you of your armor; but noble Hektor marked him, and came running up to him through the thick of the battle. Antilokhos, brave warrior though he was, would not stay to face him, but fled like some savage creature which knows it has done wrong, and flies, when it has killed a dog or a man who is herding his cattle, before a body of men can be gathered to attack it. Even so did the son of Nestor flee, and the Trojans and Hektor with a cry that rent the air showered their weapons after him; nor did he turn round and stay his flight till he had reached his comrades.

15.481

ἵππουριν, δεινὸν δὲ λόφος καθύπερθεν ἔνευεν·
εἵλετο δ’ ἄλκιμον ἔγχος ἀκαχμένον ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ,
βῆ δ’ ἰέναι, μάλα δ’ ὦκα θέων Αἴαντι παρέστη.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ὡς εἶδεν Τεύκρου βλαφθέντα βέλεμνα,
Τρωσί τε καὶ Λυκίοισιν ἐκέκλετο μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
Τρῶες καὶ Λύκιοι καὶ Δάρδανοι ἀγχιμαχηταὶ
ἀνέρες ἔστε φίλοι, μνήσασθε δὲ θούριδος ἀλκῆς
νῆας ἀνὰ γλαφυράς· δὴ γὰρ ἴδον ὀφθαλμοῖσιν
ἀνδρὸς ἀριστῆος Διόθεν βλαφθέντα βέλεμνα.
ῥεῖα δ’ ἀρίγνωτος Διὸς ἀνδράσι γίγνεται ἀλκή,
ἠμὲν ὁτέοισιν κῦδος ὑπέρτερον ἐγγυαλίξῃ,
ἠδ’ ὅτινας μινύθῃ τε καὶ οὐκ ἐθέλῃσιν ἀμύνειν,
ὡς νῦν Ἀργείων μινύθει μένος, ἄμμι δ’ ἀρήγει.
ἀλλὰ μάχεσθ’ ἐπὶ νηυσὶν ἀολλέες· ὃς δέ κεν ὑμέων

βλήμενος ἠὲ τυπεὶς θάνατον καὶ πότμον ἐπίσπῃ
τεθνάτω· οὔ οἱ ἀεικὲς ἀμυνομένῳ περὶ πάτρης
τεθνάμεν· ἀλλ’ ἄλοχός τε σόη καὶ παῖδες ὀπίσσω,
καὶ οἶκος καὶ κλῆρος ἀκήρατος, εἴ κεν Ἀχαιοὶ
οἴχωνται σὺν νηυσὶ φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε μένος καὶ θυμὸν ἑκάστου.
Αἴας δ’ αὖθ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐκέκλετο οἷς ἑτάροισιν·
αἰδὼς Ἀργεῖοι· νῦν ἄρκιον ἢ ἀπολέσθαι
ἠὲ σαωθῆναι καὶ ἀπώσασθαι κακὰ νηῶν.
ἦ ἔλπεσθ’ ἢν νῆας ἕλῃ κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ
ἐμβαδὸν ἴξεσθαι ἢν πατρίδα γαῖαν ἕκαστος;
ἦ οὐκ ὀτρύνοντος ἀκούετε λαὸν ἅπαντα
Ἕκτορος, ὃς δὴ νῆας ἐνιπρῆσαι μενεαίνει;
οὐ μὰν ἔς γε χορὸν κέλετ’ ἐλθέμεν, ἀλλὰ μάχεσθαι.
ἡμῖν δ’ οὔ τις τοῦδε νόος καὶ μῆτις ἀμείνων
ἢ αὐτοσχεδίῃ μῖξαι χεῖράς τε μένος τε.

15.511

βέλτερον ἢ ἀπολέσθαι ἕνα χρόνον ἠὲ βιῶναι
ἢ δηθὰ στρεύγεσθαι ἐν αἰνῇ δηϊοτῆτι
ὧδ’ αὔτως παρὰ νηυσὶν ὑπ’ ἀνδράσι χειροτέροισιν.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε μένος καὶ θυμὸν ἑκάστου.
ἔνθ’ Ἕκτωρ μὲν ἔλε Σχεδίον Περιμήδεος υἱὸν
ἀρχὸν Φωκήων, Αἴας δ’ ἕλε Λαοδάμαντα
ἡγεμόνα πρυλέων Ἀντήνορος ἀγλαὸν υἱόν·
Πουλυδάμας δ’ Ὦτον Κυλλήνιον ἐξενάριξε
Φυλεΐδεω ἕταρον, μεγαθύμων ἀρχὸν Ἐπειῶν.
τῷ δὲ Μέγης ἐπόρουσεν ἰδών· ὃ δ’ ὕπαιθα λιάσθη
Πουλυδάμας· καὶ τοῦ μὲν ἀπήμβροτεν· οὐ γὰρ Ἀπόλλων
εἴα Πάνθου υἱὸν ἐνὶ προμάχοισι δαμῆναι·
αὐτὰρ ὅ γε Κροίσμου στῆθος μέσον οὔτασε δουρί.
δούπησεν δὲ πεσών· ὃ δ’ ἀπ’ ὤμων τεύχε’ ἐσύλα.
τόφρα δὲ τῷ ἐπόρουσε Δόλοψ αἰχμῆς ἐὺ εἰδὼς
Λαμπετίδης, ὃν Λάμπος ἐγείνατο φέρτατον υἱὸν
Λαομεδοντιάδης εὖ εἰδότα θούριδος ἀλκῆς,
ὃς τότε Φυλεΐδαο μέσον σάκος οὔτασε δουρὶ
ἐγγύθεν ὀρμηθείς· πυκινὸς δέ οἱ ἤρκεσε θώρηξ,
τόν ῥ’ ἐφόρει γυάλοισιν ἀρηρότα· τόν ποτε Φυλεὺς
ἤγαγεν ἐξ Ἐφύρης, ποταμοῦ ἄπο Σελλήεντος.
ξεῖνος γάρ οἱ ἔδωκεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Εὐφήτης
ἐς πόλεμον φορέειν δηΐων ἀνδρῶν ἀλεωρήν·
ὅς οἱ καὶ τότε παιδὸς ἀπὸ χροὸς ἤρκεσ’ ὄλεθρον.
τοῦ δὲ Μέγης κόρυθος χαλκήρεος ἱπποδασείης
κύμβαχον ἀκρότατον νύξ’ ἔγχεϊ ὀξυόεντι,
ῥῆξε δ’ ἀφ’ ἵππειον λόφον αὐτοῦ· πᾶς δὲ χαμᾶζε
κάππεσεν ἐν κονίῃσι νέον φοίνικι φαεινός.
εἶος ὃ τῷ πολέμιζε μένων, ἔτι δ’ ἔλπετο νίκην,
τόφρα δέ οἱ Μενέλαος ἀρήϊος ἦλθεν ἀμύντωρ,

15.541

στῆ δ’ εὐρὰξ σὺν δουρὶ λαθών, βάλε δ’ ὦμον ὄπισθεν·
αἰχμὴ δὲ στέρνοιο διέσσυτο μαιμώωσα
πρόσσω ἰεμένη· ὃ δ’ ἄρα πρηνὴς ἐλιάσθη.
τὼ μὲν ἐεισάσθην χαλκήρεα τεύχε’ ἀπ’ ὤμων
συλήσειν· Ἕκτωρ δὲ κασιγνήτοισι κέλευσε
πᾶσι μάλα, πρῶτον δ’ Ἰκεταονίδην ἐνένιπεν
ἴφθιμον Μελάνιππον. ὃ δ’ ὄφρα μὲν εἰλίποδας βοῦς
βόσκ’ ἐν Περκώτῃ δηΐων ἀπὸ νόσφιν ἐόντων·
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ Δαναῶν νέες ἤλυθον ἀμφιέλισσαι,
ἂψ εἰς Ἴλιον ἦλθε, μετέπρεπε δὲ Τρώεσσι,
ναῖε δὲ πὰρ Πριάμῳ, ὃ δέ μιν τίεν ἶσα τέκεσσι·
τόν ῥ’ Ἕκτωρ ἐνένιπεν ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζεν·
οὕτω δὴ Μελάνιππε μεθήσομεν; οὐδέ νυ σοί περ
ἐντρέπεται φίλον ἦτορ ἀνεψιοῦ κταμένοιο;
οὐχ ὁράᾳς οἷον Δόλοπος περὶ τεύχε’ ἔπουσιν;
ἀλλ’ ἔπευ· οὐ γὰρ ἔτ’ ἔστιν ἀποσταδὸν Ἀργείοισι
μάρνασθαι, πρίν γ’ ἠὲ κατακτάμεν ἠὲ κατ’ ἄκρης
Ἴλιον αἰπεινὴν ἑλέειν κτάσθαι τε πολίτας.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὃ μὲν ἦρχ’, ὃ δ’ ἅμ’ ἕσπετο ἰσόθεος φώς·
Ἀργείους δ’ ὄτρυνε μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας·
ὦ φίλοι ἀνέρες ἔστε, καὶ αἰδῶ θέσθ’ ἐνὶ θυμῷ,
ἀλλήλους τ’ αἰδεῖσθε κατὰ κρατερὰς ὑσμίνας.
αἰδομένων δ’ ἀνδρῶν πλέονες σόοι ἠὲ πέφανται·
φευγόντων δ’ οὔτ’ ἂρ κλέος ὄρνυται οὔτέ τις ἀλκή.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δὲ καὶ αὐτοὶ ἀλέξασθαι μενέαινον,
ἐν θυμῷ δ’ ἐβάλοντο ἔπος, φράξαντο δὲ νῆας
ἔρκεϊ χαλκείῳ· ἐπὶ δὲ Ζεὺς Τρῶας ἔγειρεν.
Ἀντίλοχον δ’ ὄτρυνε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος·
Ἀντίλοχ’ οὔ τις σεῖο νεώτερος ἄλλος Ἀχαιῶν,
οὔτε ποσὶν θάσσων οὔτ’ ἄλκιμος ὡς σὺ μάχεσθαι·

15.571

εἴ τινά που Τρώων ἐξάλμενος ἄνδρα βάλοισθα.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὃ μὲν αὖτις ἀπέσσυτο, τὸν δ’ ὀρόθυνεν·
ἐκ δ’ ἔθορε προμάχων, καὶ ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ
ἀμφὶ ἓ παπτήνας· ὑπὸ δὲ Τρῶες κεκάδοντο
ἀνδρὸς ἀκοντίσσαντος· ὃ δ’ οὐχ ἅλιον βέλος ἦκεν,
ἀλλ’ Ἰκετάονος υἱὸν ὑπέρθυμον Μελάνιππον
νισόμενον πόλεμον δὲ βάλε στῆθος παρὰ μαζόν.
δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, τὸν δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψεν.
Ἀντίλοχος δ’ ἐπόρουσε κύων ὥς, ὅς τ’ ἐπὶ νεβρῷ
βλημένῳ ἀΐξῃ, τόν τ’ ἐξ εὐνῆφι θορόντα
θηρητὴρ ἐτύχησε βαλών, ὑπέλυσε δὲ γυῖα·
ὣς ἐπὶ σοὶ Μελάνιππε θόρ’ Ἀντίλοχος μενεχάρμης
τεύχεα συλήσων· ἀλλ’ οὐ λάθεν Ἕκτορα δῖον,
ὅς ῥά οἱ ἀντίος ἦλθε θέων ἀνὰ δηϊοτῆτα.
Ἀντίλοχος δ’ οὐ μεῖνε θοός περ ἐὼν πολεμιστής,
ἀλλ’ ὅ γ’ ἄρ’ ἔτρεσε θηρὶ κακὸν ῥέξαντι ἐοικώς,
ὅς τε κύνα κτείνας ἢ βουκόλον ἀμφὶ βόεσσι
φεύγει πρίν περ ὅμιλον ἀολλισθήμεναι ἀνδρῶν·

589 ὣς τρέσε Νεστορίδης, ἐπὶ δὲ Τρῶές τε καὶ Ἕκτωρ
590 ἠχῇ θεσπεσίῃ βέλεα στονόεντα χέοντο·
591 στῆ δὲ μεταστρεφθείς, ἐπεὶ ἵκετο ἔθνος ἑταίρων.
592 Τρῶες δὲ λείουσιν ἐοικότες ὠμοφάγοισι
593 νηυσὶν ἐπεσσεύοντο, Διὸς δ’ ἐτέλειον ἐφετμάς,
594 ὅ σφισιν αἰὲν ἔγειρε μένος μέγα, θέλγε δὲ θυμὸν
595 Ἀργείων καὶ κῦδος ἀπαίνυτο, τοὺς δ’ ὀρόθυνεν.
596 Ἕκτορι γάρ οἱ θυμὸς ἐβούλετο κῦδος ὀρέξαι
597 Πριαμίδῃ, ἵνα νηυσὶ κορωνίσι θεσπιδαὲς πῦρ
598 ἐμβάλοι ἀκάματον, Θέτιδος δ’ ἐξαίσιον ἀρὴν
599 πᾶσαν ἐπικρήνειε· τὸ γὰρ μένε μητίετα Ζεὺς
600 νηὸς καιομένης σέλας ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ἰδέσθαι.
The Trojans, fierce as lions, were still rushing on towards the ships in fulfillment of the behests of Zeus who kept spurring them on to new deeds of daring, while he deadened the courage of the Argives and defeated them by encouraging the Trojans. For he meant giving glory to Hektor son of Priam, and letting him throw fire upon the ships, till he had fulfilled the unrighteous prayer that Thetis had made him; Zeus, therefore, bided his time till he should see the glare of a blazing ship. From that hour he was about so to order that the Trojans should be driven back from the ships and to grant glory to the Achaeans. With this purpose he inspired Hektor son of Priam, who was eager enough already, to assail the ships. His fury was as that of Ares, or as when a fire is raging in the glades of some dense forest upon the mountains; he foamed at the mouth, his eyes glared under his terrible eye-brows, and his helmet quivered on his temples by reason of the fury with which he fought. Zeus from heaven was with him, and though he was but one against many, granted him victory and glory; for he was doomed to an early death, and already Pallas Athena was hurrying on the hour of his destruction at the hands of the son of Peleus. Now, however, he kept trying to break the ranks of the enemy wherever he could see them thickest, and in the goodliest armor; but do what he might he could not break through them, for they stood as a tower foursquare, or as some high cliff rising from the gray sea that braves the anger of the gale, and of the waves that thunder up against it. He fell upon them like flames of fire from every quarter. As when a wave, raised mountain high by wind and storm, breaks over a ship and covers it deep in foam, the fierce winds roar against the mast, the hearts of the sailors fail them for fear, and they are saved but by a very little from destruction - even so were the hearts of the Achaeans fainting within them. Or as a savage lion attacking a herd of cows while they are feeding by thousands in the low-lying meadows by some wide-watered shore - the herdsman is at his wit's end how to protect his herd and keeps going about now in the van and now in the rear of his cattle, while the lion springs into the thick of them and fastens on a cow so that they all tremble for fear - even so were the Achaeans utterly panic-stricken by Hektor and father Zeus. Nevertheless Hektor only killed Periphetes of Mycenae; he was son of Kopreus who was wont to take the orders of King Eurystheus to mighty Herakles, but the son was far better in excellence [aretê] than the father in every way; he was fleet of foot, a valiant warrior, and in understanding [noos] ranked among the foremost men of Mycenae. He it was who then afforded Hektor a triumph, for as he was turning back he stumbled against the rim of his shield which reached his feet, and served to keep the javelins off him. He tripped against this and fell face upward, his helmet ringing loudly about his head as he did so. Hektor saw him fall and ran up to him; he then thrust a spear into his chest, and killed him close to his own comrades. These, for all their sorrow, could not help him for they were themselves terribly afraid of Hektor. They had now reached the ships and the prows of those that had been drawn up first were on every side of them, but the Trojans came pouring after them. The Argives were driven back from the first row of ships, but they made a stand by their tents without being broken up and scattered; shame

[aidôs] and fear restrained them. They kept shouting incessantly to one another, and Nestor of Gerene, tower of strength to the Achaeans, was loudest in imploring every man by his parents, and beseeching him to stand firm. "Be men, my friends," he cried, "and give respect [aidôs] to one another's good opinion. Think, all of you, on your children, your wives, your property, and your parents whether these be alive or dead. On their behalf though they are not here, I implore you to stand firm, and not to turn in flight." With these words he put heart and soul into them all. Athena lifted the thick veil of darkness from their eyes, and much light fell upon them, alike on the side of the ships and on that where the fight was raging. They could see Hektor and all his men, both those in the rear who were taking no part in the battle, and those who were fighting by the ships. Ajax could not bring himself to retreat along with the rest, but strode from deck to deck with a great sea-pike in his hands twelve cubits long and jointed with rings. As a man skilled in feats of horsemanship couples four horses together and comes tearing full speed along the public way from the country into some large town - many both men and women marvel as they see him for he keeps all the time changing his horse, springing from one to another without ever missing his feet while the horses are at a gallop - even so did Ajax go striding from one ship's deck to another, and his voice went up into the heavens. He kept on shouting his orders to the Danaans and exhorting them to defend their ships and tents; neither did Hektor remain within the main body of the Trojan warriors, but as a dun eagle swoops down upon a flock of wild-fowl feeding near a river-geese, it may be, or cranes, or long-necked swans - even so did Hektor make straight for a dark-prowed ship, rushing right towards it; for Zeus with his mighty hand impelled him forward, and roused his people to follow him. And now the battle again raged furiously at the ships. You would have thought the men were coming on fresh and unwearied, so fiercely did they fight; and this was the mind [noos] in which they were - the Achaeans did not believe they should escape destruction but thought themselves doomed, while there was not a Trojan but his heart beat high with the hope of firing the ships and putting the Achaean heroes to the sword.

15.601

601 ἐκ γὰρ δὴ τοῦ μέλλε παλίωξιν παρὰ νηῶν
602 θησέμεναι Τρώων, Δαναοῖσι δὲ κῦδος ὀρέξειν.
603 τὰ φρονέων νήεσσιν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσιν ἔγειρεν
604 Ἕκτορα Πριαμίδην μάλα περ μεμαῶτα καὶ αὐτόν.
605 μαίνετο δ’ ὡς ὅτ’ Ἄρης ἐγχέσπαλος ἢ ὁλοὸν πῦρ
606 οὔρεσι μαίνηται βαθέης ἐν τάρφεσιν ὕλης·
607 ἀφλοισμὸς δὲ περὶ στόμα γίγνετο, τὼ δέ οἱ ὄσσε
608 λαμπέσθην βλοσυρῇσιν ὑπ’ ὀφρύσιν, ἀμφὶ δὲ πήληξ
609 σμερδαλέον κροτάφοισι τινάσσετο μαρναμένοιο
610 Ἕκτορος· αὐτὸς γάρ οἱ ἀπ’ αἰθέρος ἦεν ἀμύντωρ
611 Ζεύς, ὅς μιν πλεόνεσσι μετ’ ἀνδράσι μοῦνον ἐόντα
612 τίμα καὶ κύδαινε. μινυνθάδιος γὰρ ἔμελλεν
613 ἔσσεσθ’· ἤδη γάρ οἱ ἐπόρνυε μόρσιμον ἦμαρ
614 Παλλὰς Ἀθηναίη ὑπὸ Πηλεΐδαο βίηφιν.
615 καί ῥ’ ἔθελεν ῥῆξαι στίχας ἀνδρῶν πειρητίζων,
616 ᾗ δὴ πλεῖστον ὅμιλον ὅρα καὶ τεύχε’ ἄριστα·
617 ἀλλ’ οὐδ’ ὣς δύνατο ῥῆξαι μάλα περ μενεαίνων·
618 ἴσχον γὰρ πυργηδὸν ἀρηρότες, ἠΰτε πέτρη
619 ἠλίβατος μεγάλη πολιῆς ἁλὸς ἐγγὺς ἐοῦσα,
620 ἥ τε μένει λιγέων ἀνέμων λαιψηρὰ κέλευθα
621 κύματά τε τροφόεντα, τά τε προσερεύγεται αὐτήν·
622 ὣς Δαναοὶ Τρῶας μένον ἔμπεδον οὐδὲ φέβοντο.

αὐτὰρ ὃ λαμπόμενος πυρὶ πάντοθεν ἔνθορ’ ὁμίλῳ,
ἐν δ’ ἔπεσ’ ὡς ὅτε κῦμα θοῇ ἐν νηῒ πέσῃσι
λάβρον ὑπαὶ νεφέων ἀνεμοτρεφές· ἣ δέ τε πᾶσα
ἄχνῃ ὑπεκρύφθη, ἀνέμοιο δὲ δεινὸς ἀήτη
ἱστίῳ ἐμβρέμεται, τρομέουσι δέ τε φρένα ναῦται
δειδιότες· τυτθὸν γὰρ ὑπ’ ἐκ θανάτοιο φέρονται·
ὣς ἐδαΐζετο θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν Ἀχαιῶν.
αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ὥς τε λέων ὀλοόφρων βουσὶν ἐπελθών,

15.631

αἵ ῥά τ’ ἐν εἰαμενῇ ἕλεος μεγάλοιο νέμονται
μυρίαι, ἐν δέ τε τῇσι νομεὺς οὔ πω σάφα εἰδὼς
θηρὶ μαχέσσασθαι ἕλικος βοὸς ἀμφὶ φονῇσιν·
ἤτοι ὃ μὲν πρώτῃσι καὶ ὑστατίῃσι βόεσσιν
αἰὲν ὁμοστιχάει, ὃ δέ τ’ ἐν μέσσῃσιν ὀρούσας
βοῦν ἔδει, αἳ δέ τε πᾶσαι ὑπέτρεσαν· ὣς τότ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
θεσπεσίως ἐφόβηθεν ὑφ’ Ἕκτορι καὶ Διὶ πατρὶ
πάντες, ὃ δ’ οἷον ἔπεφνε Μυκηναῖον Περιφήτην,
Κοπρῆος φίλον υἱόν, ὃς Εὐρυσθῆος ἄνακτος
ἀγγελίης οἴχνεσκε βίῃ Ἡρακληείῃ.
τοῦ γένετ’ ἐκ πατρὸς πολὺ χείρονος υἱὸς ἀμείνων
παντοίας ἀρετάς, ἠμὲν πόδας ἠδὲ μάχεσθαι,
καὶ νόον ἐν πρώτοισι Μυκηναίων ἐτέτυκτο·
ὅς ῥα τόθ’ Ἕκτορι κῦδος ὑπέρτερον ἐγγυάλιξε.
στρεφθεὶς γὰρ μετόπισθεν ἐν ἀσπίδος ἄντυγι πάλτο,
τὴν αὐτὸς φορέεσκε ποδηνεκέ’ ἔρκος ἀκόντων·
τῇ ὅ γ’ ἐνὶ βλαφθεὶς πέσεν ὕπτιος, ἀμφὶ δὲ πήληξ
σμερδαλέον κονάβησε περὶ κροτάφοισι πεσόντος.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ὀξὺ νόησε, θέων δέ οἱ ἄγχι παρέστη,
στήθεϊ δ’ ἐν δόρυ πῆξε, φίλων δέ μιν ἐγγὺς ἑταίρων
κτεῖν’· οἳ δ’ οὐκ ἐδύναντο καὶ ἀχνύμενοί περ ἑταίρου
χραισμεῖν· αὐτοὶ γὰρ μάλα δείδισαν Ἕκτορα δῖον.
εἰσωποὶ δ’ ἐγένοντο νεῶν, περὶ δ’ ἔσχεθον ἄκραι
νῆες ὅσαι πρῶται εἰρύατο· τοὶ δ’ ἐπέχυντο.
Ἀργεῖοι δὲ νεῶν μὲν ἐχώρησαν καὶ ἀνάγκῃ
τῶν πρωτέων, αὐτοῦ δὲ παρὰ κλισίῃσιν ἔμειναν
ἀθρόοι, οὐδὲ κέδασθεν ἀνὰ στρατόν· ἴσχε γὰρ αἰδὼς
καὶ δέος· ἀζηχὲς γὰρ ὀμόκλεον ἀλλήλοισι.
Νέστωρ αὖτε μάλιστα Γερήνιος οὖρος Ἀχαιῶν
λίσσεθ’ ὑπὲρ τοκέων γουνούμενος ἄνδρα ἕκαστον·

15.661

ὦ φίλοι ἀνέρες ἔστε καὶ αἰδῶ θέσθ’ ἐνὶ θυμῷ
ἄλλων ἀνθρώπων, ἐπὶ δὲ μνήσασθε ἕκαστος
παίδων ἠδ’ ἀλόχων καὶ κτήσιος ἠδὲ τοκήων,
ἠμὲν ὅτεῳ ζώουσι καὶ ᾧ κατατεθνήκασι·
τῶν ὕπερ ἐνθάδ’ ἐγὼ γουνάζομαι οὐ παρεόντων
ἑστάμεναι κρατερῶς, μὴ δὲ τρωπᾶσθε φόβον δέ.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε μένος καὶ θυμὸν ἑκάστου.
τοῖσι δ’ ἀπ’ ὀφθαλμῶν νέφος ἀχλύος ὦσεν Ἀθήνη

θεσπέσιον· μάλα δέ σφι φόως γένετ’ ἀμφοτέρωθεν
ἠμὲν πρὸς νηῶν καὶ ὁμοιΐου πολέμοιο.
Ἕκτορα δὲ φράσσαντο βοὴν ἀγαθὸν καὶ ἑταίρους,
ἠμὲν ὅσοι μετόπισθεν ἀφέστασαν οὐδὲ μάχοντο,
ἠδ’ ὅσσοι παρὰ νηυσὶ μάχην ἐμάχοντο θοῇσιν.
οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔτ’ Αἴαντι μεγαλήτορι ἤνδανε θυμῷ
ἑστάμεν ἔνθά περ ἄλλοι ἀφέστασαν υἷες Ἀχαιῶν·
ἀλλ’ ὅ γε νηῶν ἴκρι’ ἐπῴχετο μακρὰ βιβάσθων,
νώμα δὲ ξυστὸν μέγα ναύμαχον ἐν παλάμῃσι
κολλητὸν βλήτροισι δυωκαιεικοσίπηχυ.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἀνὴρ ἵπποισι κελητίζειν ἐὺ εἰδώς,
ὅς τ’ ἐπεὶ ἐκ πολέων πίσυρας συναείρεται ἵππους,
σεύας ἐκ πεδίοιο μέγα προτὶ ἄστυ δίηται
λαοφόρον καθ’ ὁδόν· πολέες τέ ἑ θηήσαντο
ἀνέρες ἠδὲ γυναῖκες· ὃ δ’ ἔμπεδον ἀσφαλὲς αἰεὶ
θρῴσκων ἄλλοτ’ ἐπ’ ἄλλον ἀμείβεται, οἳ δὲ πέτονται·
ὣς Αἴας ἐπὶ πολλὰ θοάων ἴκρια νηῶν
φοίτα μακρὰ βιβάς, φωνὴ δέ οἱ αἰθέρ’ ἵκανεν,
αἰεὶ δὲ σμερδνὸν βοόων Δαναοῖσι κέλευε
νηυσί τε καὶ κλισίῃσιν ἀμυνέμεν. οὐδὲ μὲν Ἕκτωρ
μίμνεν ἐνὶ Τρώων ὁμάδῳ πύκα θωρηκτάων·
ἀλλ’ ὥς τ’ ὀρνίθων πετεηνῶν αἰετὸς αἴθων

15.691

ἔθνος ἐφορμᾶται ποταμὸν πάρα βοσκομενάων
χηνῶν ἢ γεράνων ἢ κύκνων δουλιχοδείρων,
ὣς Ἕκτωρ ἴθυσε νεὸς κυανοπρῴροιο
ἀντίος ἀΐξας· τὸν δὲ Ζεὺς ὦσεν ὄπισθε
χειρὶ μάλα μεγάλῃ, ὄτρυνε δὲ λαὸν ἅμ’ αὐτῷ.
αὖτις δὲ δριμεῖα μάχη παρὰ νηυσὶν ἐτύχθη·
φαίης κ’ ἀκμῆτας καὶ ἀτειρέας ἀλλήλοισιν
ἄντεσθ’ ἐν πολέμῳ, ὡς ἐσσυμένως ἐμάχοντο.
τοῖσι δὲ μαρναμένοισιν ὅδ’ ἦν νόος· ἤτοι Ἀχαιοὶ
οὐκ ἔφασαν φεύξεσθαι ὑπ’ ἐκ κακοῦ, ἀλλ’ ὀλέεσθαι,
Τρωσὶν δ’ ἔλπετο θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἑκάστου
νῆας ἐνιπρήσειν κτενέειν θ’ ἥρωας Ἀχαιούς.
οἳ μὲν τὰ φρονέοντες ἐφέστασαν ἀλλήλοισιν·
Ἕκτωρ δὲ πρυμνῆς νεὸς ἥψατο ποντοπόροιο
καλῆς ὠκυάλου, ἣ Πρωτεσίλαον ἔνεικεν
ἐς Τροίην, οὐδ’ αὖτις ἀπήγαγε πατρίδα γαῖαν.
τοῦ περ δὴ περὶ νηὸς Ἀχαιοί τε Τρῶές τε
δῄουν ἀλλήλους αὐτοσχεδόν· οὐδ’ ἄρα τοί γε
τόξων ἀϊκὰς ἀμφὶς μένον οὐδ’ ἔτ’ ἀκόντων,
ἀλλ’ οἵ γ’ ἐγγύθεν ἱστάμενοι ἔνα θυμὸν ἔχοντες
ὀξέσι δὴ πελέκεσσι καὶ ἀξίνῃσι μάχοντο
καὶ ξίφεσιν μεγάλοισι καὶ ἔγχεσιν ἀμφιγύοισι.
πολλὰ δὲ φάσγανα καλὰ μελάνδετα κωπήεντα
ἄλλα μὲν ἐκ χειρῶν χαμάδις πέσον, ἄλλα δ’ ἀπ’ ὤμων
ἀνδρῶν μαρναμένων· ῥέε δ’ αἵματι γαῖα μέλαινα.
Ἕκτωρ δὲ πρύμνηθεν ἐπεὶ λάβεν οὐχὶ μεθίει
ἄφλαστον μετὰ χερσὶν ἔχων, Τρωσὶν δὲ κέλευεν·

718 οἴσετε πῦρ, ἅμα δ’ αὐτοὶ ἀολλέες ὄρνυτ’ ἀϋτήν·
719 νῦν ἡμῖν πάντων Ζεὺς ἄξιον ἦμαρ ἔδωκε
720 νῆας ἑλεῖν, αἳ δεῦρο θεῶν ἀέκητι μολοῦσαι
Thus were the two sides minded. Then Hektor seized the stern of the good ship that had brought Protesilaos to Troy, but never bore him back to his native land. Round this ship there raged a close hand-to-hand fight between Danaans and Trojans. They did not fight at a distance with bows and javelins, but with one mind hacked at one another in close combat with their mighty swords and spears pointed at both ends; they fought moreover with keen battle-axes and with hatchets. Many a good stout blade hilted and scabbarded with iron, fell from hand or shoulder as they fought, and the earth ran red with blood. Hektor, when he had seized the ship, would not loose his hold but held on to its curved stern and shouted to the Trojans, "Bring fire, and raise the battle-cry all of you with a single voice. Now has Zeus granted us a day that will pay us for all the rest; this day we shall take the ships which came hither against heaven's will, and which have caused us such infinite suffering through the cowardice of our councilors, who when I would have done battle at the ships held me back and forbade the host to follow me; if Zeus did then indeed warp our judgments, himself now commands me and cheers me on." As he spoke thus the Trojans sprang yet more fiercely on the Achaeans, and Ajax no longer held his ground, for he was overcome by the darts that were flung at him, and made sure that he was doomed. Therefore he left the raised deck at the stern, and stepped back on to the seven-foot bench of the oarsmen. Here he stood on the look-out, and with his spear held back Trojan whom he saw bringing fire to the ships. All the time he kept on shouting at the top of his voice and exhorting the Danaans. "My friends," he cried, "Danaan heroes, squires [therapontes] of Ares, be men my friends, and fight with might and with main. Can we hope to find helpers hereafter, or a wall to shield us more surely than the one we have? There is no strong city within reach, whence we may draw fresh population [dêmos] to turn the scales in our favor. We are on the plain of the armed Trojans with the sea [pontos] behind us, and far from our own country. Our salvation, therefore, is in the might of our hands and in hard fighting." As he spoke he wielded his spear with still greater fury, and when any Trojan made towards the ships with fire to win favor [kharis] with Hektor, he would be on the look-out for him, and drive at him with his long spear. Twelve men did he thus kill in hand-to-hand fight before the ships.

15.721

721 ἡμῖν πήματα πολλὰ θέσαν, κακότητι γερόντων,
722 οἵ μ’ ἐθέλοντα μάχεσθαι ἐπὶ πρυμνῇσι νέεσσιν
723 αὐτόν τ’ ἰσχανάασκον ἐρητύοντό τε λαόν·
724 ἀλλ’ εἰ δή ῥα τότε βλάπτε φρένας εὐρύοπα Ζεὺς
725 ἡμετέρας, νῦν αὐτὸς ἐποτρύνει καὶ ἀνώγει.
726 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα μᾶλλον ἐπ’ Ἀργείοισιν ὄρουσαν.
727 Αἴας δ’ οὐκέτ’ ἔμιμνε· βιάζετο γὰρ βελέεσσιν·
728 ἀλλ’ ἀνεχάζετο τυτθόν, ὀϊόμενος θανέεσθαι
729 θρῆνυν ἐφ’ ἑπταπόδην, λίπε δ’ ἴκρια νηὸς ἐΐσης.
730 ἔνθ’ ἄρ’ ὅ γ’ ἐστήκει δεδοκημένος, ἔγχεϊ δ’ αἰεὶ
731 Τρῶας ἄμυνε νεῶν, ὅς τις φέροι ἀκάματον πῦρ·
732 αἰεὶ δὲ σμερδνὸν βοόων Δαναοῖσι κέλευε·
733 ὦ φίλοι ἥρωες Δαναοὶ θεράποντες Ἄρηος
734 ἀνέρες ἔστε φίλοι, μνήσασθε δὲ θούριδος ἀλκῆς.
735 ἠέ τινάς φαμεν εἶναι ἀοσσητῆρας ὀπίσσω,
736 ἦέ τι τεῖχος ἄρειον, ὅ κ’ ἀνδράσι λοιγὸν ἀμύναι;
737 οὐ μέν τι σχεδόν ἐστι πόλις πύργοις ἀραρυῖα,

738 ᾗ κ’ ἀπαμυναίμεσθ’ ἐτεραλκέα δῆμον ἔχοντες·
739 ἀλλ’ ἐν γὰρ Τρώων πεδίῳ πύκα θωρηκτάων
740 πόντῳ κεκλιμένοι ἐκὰς ἤμεθα πατρίδος αἴης·
741 τὼ ἐν χερσὶ φόως, οὐ μειλιχίῃ πολέμοιο.
742 ἦ, καὶ μαιμώων ἔφεπ’ ἔγχεϊ ὀξυόεντι.
743 ὅς τις δὲ Τρώων κοίλῃς ἐπὶ νηυσὶ φέροιτο
744 σὺν πυρὶ κηλείῳ, χάριν Ἕκτορος ὀτρύναντος,
745 τὸν δ’ Αἴας οὔτασκε δεδεγμένος ἔγχεϊ μακρῷ·
746 δώδεκα δὲ προπάροιθε νεῶν αὐτοσχεδὸν οὗτα.

16.1

1 ὣς οἳ μὲν περὶ νηὸς ἐϋσσέλμοιο μάχοντο·
2 Πάτροκλος δ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ παρίστατο ποιμένι λαῶν
3 δάκρυα θερμὰ χέων ὥς τε κρήνη μελάνυδρος,
4 ἥ τε κατ’ αἰγίλιπος πέτρης δνοφερὸν χέει ὕδωρ.
5 τὸν δὲ ἰδὼν ὤκτιρε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
6 καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
7 τίπτε δεδάκρυσαι Πατρόκλεες, ἠΰτε κούρη
8 νηπίη, ἥ θ’ ἅμα μητρὶ θέουσ’ ἀνελέσθαι ἀνώγει
9 εἰανοῦ ἁπτομένη, καί τ’ ἐσσυμένην κατερύκει,
10 δακρυόεσσα δέ μιν ποτιδέρκεται, ὄφρ’ ἀνέληται·
11 τῇ ἴκελος Πάτροκλε τέρεν κατὰ δάκρυον εἴβεις.
12 ἠέ τι Μυρμιδόνεσσι πιφαύσκεαι, ἢ ἐμοὶ αὐτῷ,
13 ἦέ τιν’ ἀγγελίην Φθίης ἐξέκλυες οἶος;
14 ζώειν μὰν ἔτι φασὶ Μενοίτιον Ἀκτορος υἱόν,
15 ζώει δ’ Αἰακίδης Πηλεὺς μετὰ Μυρμιδόνεσσι;
16 τῶν κε μάλ’ ἀμφοτέρων ἀκαχοίμεθα τεθνηώτων.
17 ἦε σύ γ’ Ἀργείων ὀλοφύρεαι, ὡς ὀλέκονται
18 νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσιν ὑπερβασίης ἕνεκα σφῆς;
19 ἐξαύδα, μὴ κεῦθε νόῳ, ἵνα εἴδομεν ἄμφω.
20 τὸν δὲ βαρὺ στενάχων προσέφης Πατρόκλεες ἱππεῦ·
21 ὦ Ἀχιλεῦ Πηλῆος υἱὲ μέγα φέρτατ’ Ἀχαιῶν
22 μὴ νεμέσα· τοῖον γὰρ ἄχος βεβίηκεν Ἀχαιούς.
23 οἳ μὲν γὰρ δὴ πάντες, ὅσοι πάρος ἦσαν ἄριστοι,
24 ἐν νηυσὶν κέαται βεβλημένοι οὐτάμενοί τε.
25 βέβληται μὲν ὃ Τυδεΐδης κρατερὸς Διομήδης,
26 οὔτασται δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς δουρικλυτὸς ἠδ’ Ἀγαμέμνων,
27 βέβληται δὲ καὶ Εὐρύπυλος κατὰ μηρὸν ὀϊστῷ.
28 τοὺς μέν τ’ ἰητροὶ πολυφάρμακοι ἀμφιπένονται
29 ἕλκε’ ἀκειόμενοι· σὺ δ’ ἀμήχανος ἔπλευ Ἀχιλλεῦ.
30 μὴ ἐμέ γ’ οὖν οὗτός γε λάβοι χόλος, ὃν σὺ φυλάσσεις
Thus did they fight about the ship of Protesilaos. Then Patroklos drew near to Achilles with tears welling from his eyes, as from some spring whose crystal stream falls over the ledges of a high precipice. When Achilles saw him thus weeping he was sorry for him and said, "Why, Patroklos, do you stand there weeping like some silly child that comes running to her mother, and begs to be taken up and carried- she catches hold of her mother's dress to stay her though she is in a hurry, and looks tearfully up until her mother carries her - even such tears, Patroklos, are you now shedding. Have you anything to say to the Myrmidons or to myself? or have you had news from Phthia which you alone know? They tell me Menoitios son of Aktor is still alive, as also Peleus son of Aiakos, among the Myrmidons - men whose loss we two should bitterly deplore; or are you grieving about the Argives and the way in

which they are being killed at the ships, through their own high-handed doings? Do not hide in your mind [noos] anything from me but tell me that both of us may know about it." Then, O horseman Patroklos, with a deep sigh you answered, "Achilles, son of Peleus, foremost champion of the Achaeans, do not be angry, but I feel grief [akhos] for the disaster that has now befallen the Argives. All those who have been their champions so far are lying at the ships, wounded by sword or spear. Brave Diomedes son of Tydeus has been hit with a spear, while famed Odysseus and Agamemnon have received sword-wounds; Eurypylos again has been struck with an arrow in the thigh; skilled apothecaries are attending to these heroes, and healing them of their wounds; are you still, O Achilles, so inexorable? May it never be my lot to nurse such a passion as you have done, to the baning of your own good name. Who in future story will speak well of you unless you now save the Argives from ruin? You know no pity; horseman Peleus was not your father nor Thetis your mother, but the gray sea bore you and the sheer cliffs begot you, so cruel and remorseless are you in your thinking [noos]. If however you are kept back through knowledge of some oracle, or if your mother Thetis has told you something from the mouth of Zeus, at least send me and the Myrmidons with me, if I may bring deliverance to the Danaans. Let me moreover wear your armor; the Trojans may thus mistake me for you and quit the field, so that the hard-pressed sons of the Achaeans may have breathing time- which while they are fighting may hardly be. We who are fresh might soon drive tired men back from our ships and tents to their own city." He knew not what he was asking, nor that he was suing for his own destruction. Achilles was deeply moved and answered, "What, noble Patroklos, are you saying? I know no prophesyings which I am heeding, nor has my mother told me anything from the mouth of Zeus, but I am cut to the very heart with grief [akhos] that one of my own rank should dare to rob me because he is more powerful than I am. This grief [akhos], after all that I have gone through, is more than I can endure. The girl whom the sons of the Achaeans chose for me, whom I won as the fruit of my spear on having sacked a city - her has King Agamemnon taken from me as though I were some common vagrant. Still, let bygones be bygones: no man may keep his anger for ever; I said I would not relent till battle and the cry of war had reached my own ships; nevertheless, now gird my armor about your shoulders, and lead the Myrmidons to battle, for the dark cloud of Trojans has burst furiously over our fleet; the Argives are driven back on to the beach, cooped within a narrow space, and the whole people of Troy has taken heart to sally out against them, because they see not the visor of my helmet gleaming near them. Had they seen this, there would not have been a creek nor grip that had not been filled with their dead as they fled back again. And so it would have been, if only King Agamemnon had dealt fairly by me. As it is the Trojans have beset our host. Diomedes son of Tydeus no longer wields his spear to defend the Danaans, neither have I heard the voice of the son of Atreus coming from his hated [ekhthrê] head, whereas that of murderous Hektor rings in my cars as he gives orders to the Trojans, who triumph over the Achaeans and fill the whole plain with their cry of battle. But even so, Patroklos, fall upon them and save the fleet, lest the Trojans fire it and deprive us of our safe homecoming [nostos]. Bring to fulfillment [telos] what I now order you to do, so that you may win me great honor [timê] from all the Danaans, and that they may restore the girl to me again and give me rich gifts into the bargain. When you have driven the Trojans from the ships, come back again. Though Hera's thundering husband should put triumph within your reach, do not fight the Trojans further in my absence, or you will rob me of glory that should be mine. And do not for lust of battle go on killing the Trojans nor lead the Achaeans on to Ilion, lest one of the ever-living gods from Olympus attack you - for Phoebus Apollo loves them well: return when you have freed the ships from peril, and let others wage war upon the plain. Would, by father Zeus, Athena, and Apollo, that not a single man of all the Trojans might be left alive, nor yet of the Argives, but that we two might be alone left to tear aside the mantle that veils the brow of

Troy." Thus did they converse. But Ajax could no longer hold his ground for the shower of darts that rained upon him; the will [noos] of Zeus and the javelins of the Trojans were too much for him; the helmet that gleamed about his temples rang with the continuous clatter of the missiles that kept pouring on to it and on to the cheek-pieces that protected his face. Moreover his left shoulder was tired with having held his shield so long, yet for all this, let fly at him as they would, they could not make him give ground. He could hardly draw his breath, the sweat rained from every pore of his body, he had not a moment's respite, and on all sides he was beset by danger upon danger. And now, tell me, O Muses that hold your mansions on Olympus, how fire was thrown upon the ships of the Achaeans. Hektor came close up and let drive with his great sword at the ashen spear of Ajax. He cut it clean in two just behind where the point was fastened on to the shaft of the spear. Ajax, therefore, had now nothing but a headless spear, while the bronze point flew some way off and came ringing down on to the ground. Ajax knew the hand of heaven in this, and was dismayed at seeing that Zeus had now left him utterly defenseless and was willing victory for the Trojans. Therefore he drew back, and the Trojans flung fire upon the ship which was at once wrapped in flame. The fire was now flaring about the ship's stern, whereon Achilles smote his two thighs and said to Patroklos, "Up, noble horseman, for I see the glare of hostile fire at our fleet; up, lest they destroy our ships, and there be no way by which we may retreat. Gird on your armor at once while I call our people together."

16.31

31 αἰναρέτη· τί σευ ἄλλος ὀνήσεται ὀψίγονός περ
32 αἴ κε μὴ Ἀργείοισιν ἀεικέα λοιγὸν ἀμύνῃς;
33 νηλεές, οὐκ ἄρα σοί γε πατὴρ ἦν ἱππότα Πηλεύς,
34 οὐδὲ Θέτις μήτηρ· γλαυκὴ δέ σε τίκτε θάλασσα
35 πέτραι τ’ ἠλίβατοι, ὅτι τοι νόος ἐστὶν ἀπηνής.
36 εἰ δέ τινα φρεσὶ σῇσι θεοπροπίην ἀλεείνεις
37 καί τινά τοι πὰρ Ζηνὸς ἐπέφραδε πότνια μήτηρ,
38 ἀλλ’ ἐμέ περ πρόες ὦχ’, ἅμα δ’ ἄλλον λαὸν ὄπασσον
39 Μυρμιδόνων, ἵν πού τι φόως Δαναοῖσι γένωμαι.
40 δὸς δέ μοι ὤμοιιν τὰ σὰ τεύχεα θωρηχθῆναι,
41 αἴ κ’ ἐμὲ σοὶ ἴσκοντες ἀπόσχωνται πολέμοιο
42 Τρῶες, ἀναπνεύσωσι δ’ Ἀρήϊοι υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
43 τειρόμενοι· ὀλίγη δέ τ’ ἀνάπνευσις πολέμοιο.
44 ῥεῖα δέ κ’ ἀκμῆτες κεκμηότας ἄνδρας ἀϋτῇ
45 ὤσαιμεν προτὶ ἄστυ νεῶν ἄπο καὶ κλισιάων.
46 ὣς φάτο λισσόμενος μέγα νήπιος· ἦ γὰρ ἔμελλεν
47 οἷ αὐτῷ θάνατόν τε κακὸν καὶ κῆρα λιτέσθαι.
48 τὸν δὲ μέγ’ ὀχθήσας προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
49 ὤ μοι διογενὲς Πατρόκλεες οἷον ἔειπες·
50 οὔτε θεοπροπίης ἐμπάζομαι ἥν τινα οἶδα,
51 οὔτέ τί μοι πὰρ Ζηνὸς ἐπέφραδε πότνια μήτηρ·
52 ἀλλὰ τόδ’ αἰνὸν ἄχος κραδίην καὶ θυμὸν ἱκάνει,
53 ὁππότε δὴ τὸν ὁμοῖον ἀνὴρ ἐθέλῃσιν ἀμέρσαι
54 καὶ γέρας ἂψ ἀφελέσθαι, ὅ τε κράτεϊ προβεβήκῃ·
55 αἰνὸν ἄχος τό μοί ἐστιν, ἐπεὶ πάθον ἄλγεα θυμῷ.
56 κούρην ἣν ἄρα μοι γέρας ἔξελον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν,
57 δουρὶ δ’ ἐμῷ κτεάτισσα πόλιν εὐτείχεα πέρσας,
58 τὴν ἂψ ἐκ χειρῶν ἕλετο κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
59 Ἀτρεΐδης ὡς εἴ τιν’ ἀτίμητον μετανάστην.
60 ἀλλὰ τὰ μὲν προτετύχθαι ἐάσομεν· οὐδ’ ἄρα πως ἦν

16.61

ἀσπερχὲς κεχολῶσθαι ἐνὶ φρεσίν· ἤτοι ἔφην γε
οὐ πρὶν μηνιθμὸν καταπαυσέμεν, ἀλλ’ ὁπότ’ ἂν δὴ
νῆας ἐμὰς ἀφίκηται ἀϋτή τε πτόλεμός τε.
τύνη δ’ ὤμοιιν μὲν ἐμὰ κλυτὰ τεύχεα δῦθι,
ἄρχε δὲ Μυρμιδόνεσσι φιλοπτολέμοισι μάχεσθαι,
εἰ δὴ κυάνεον Τρώων νέφος ἀμφιβέβηκε
νηυσὶν ἐπικρατέως, οἳ δὲ ῥηγμῖνι θαλάσσης
κεκλίαται, χώρης ὀλίγην ἔτι μοῖραν ἔχοντες
Ἀργεῖοι, Τρώων δὲ πόλις ἐπὶ πᾶσα βέβηκε
θάρσυνος· οὐ γὰρ ἐμῆς κόρυθος λεύσσουσι μέτωπον
ἐγγύθι λαμπομένης· τάχα κεν φεύγοντες ἐναύλους
πλήσειαν νεκύων, εἴ μοι κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
ἤπια εἰδείη· νῦν δὲ στρατὸν ἀμφιμάχονται.
οὐ γὰρ Τυδεΐδεω Διομήδεος ἐν παλάμῃσι
μαίνεται ἐγχείη Δαναῶν ἀπὸ λοιγὸν ἀμῦναι·
οὐδέ πω Ἀτρεΐδεω ὀπὸς ἔκλυον αὐδήσαντος
ἐχθρῆς ἐκ κεφαλῆς· ἀλλ’ Ἕκτορος ἀνδροφόνοιο
Τρωσὶ κελεύοντος περιάγνυται, οἳ δ’ ἀλαλητῷ
πᾶν πεδίον κατέχουσι μάχῃ νικῶντες Ἀχαιούς.
ἀλλὰ καὶ ὣς Πάτροκλε νεῶν ἄπο λοιγὸν ἀμύνων
ἔμπεσ’ ἐπικρατέως, μὴ δὴ πυρὸς αἰθομένοιο
νῆας ἐνιπρήσωσι, φίλον δ’ ἀπὸ νόστον ἕλωνται.
πείθεο δ’ ὥς τοι ἐγὼ μύθου τέλος ἐν φρεσὶ θείω,
ὡς ἄν μοι τιμὴν μεγάλην καὶ κῦδος ἄρηαι
πρὸς πάντων Δαναῶν, ἀτὰρ οἳ περικαλλέα κούρην
ἂψ ἀπονάσσωσιν, ποτὶ δ’ ἀγλαὰ δῶρα πόρωσιν.
ἐκ νηῶν ἐλάσας ἰέναι πάλιν· εἰ δέ κεν αὖ τοι
δώῃ κῦδος ἀρέσθαι ἐρίγδουπος πόσις Ἥρης,
μὴ σύ γ’ ἄνευθεν ἐμεῖο λιλαίεσθαι πολεμίζειν
Τρωσὶ φιλοπτολέμοισιν· ἀτιμότερον δέ με θήσεις·

16.91

μὴ δ’ ἐπαγαλλόμενος πολέμῳ καὶ δηϊοτῆτι
Τρῶας ἐναιρόμενος προτὶ Ἴλιον ἡγεμονεύειν,
μή τις ἀπ’ Οὐλύμποιο θεῶν αἰειγενετάων
ἐμβήῃ· μάλα τούς γε φιλεῖ ἑκάεργος Ἀπόλλων·
ἀλλὰ πάλιν τρωπᾶσθαι, ἐπὴν φάος ἐν νήεσσι
θήῃς, τοὺς δ’ ἔτ’ ἐᾶν πεδίον κάτα δηριάασθαι.
αἳ γὰρ Ζεῦ τε πάτερ καὶ Ἀθηναίη καὶ Ἄπολλον
μήτέ τις οὖν Τρώων θάνατον φύγοι ὅσσοι ἔασι,
μήτέ τις Ἀργείων, νῶϊν δ’ ἐκδῦμεν ὄλεθρον,
ὄφρ’ οἷοι Τροίης ἱερὰ κρήδεμνα λύωμεν.
ὣς οἳ μὲν τοιαῦτα πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἀγόρευον,
Αἴας δ’ οὐκ ἔτ’ ἔμιμνε· βιάζετο γὰρ βελέεσσι·
δάμνα μιν Ζηνός τε νόος καὶ Τρῶες ἀγαυοὶ
βάλλοντες· δεινὴν δὲ περὶ κροτάφοισι φαεινὴ
πήληξ βαλλομένη καναχὴν ἔχε, βάλλετο δ’ αἰεὶ
κὰπ φάλαρ’ εὐποίηθ’· ὃ δ’ ἀριστερὸν ὦμον ἔκαμνεν
ἔμπεδον αἰὲν ἔχων σάκος αἰόλον· οὐδὲ δύναντο
ἀμφ’ αὐτῷ πελεμίξαι ἐρείδοντες βελέεσσιν.

αἰεὶ δ’ ἀργαλέῳ ἔχετ’ ἄσθματι, κὰδ δέ οἱ ἱδρὼς
πάντοθεν ἐκ μελέων πολὺς ἔρρεεν, οὐδέ πῃ εἶχεν
ἀμπνεῦσαι· πάντῃ δὲ κακὸν κακῷ ἐστήρικτο.
ἔσπετε νῦν μοι Μοῦσαι Ὀλύμπια δώματ’ ἔχουσαι,
ὅππως δὴ πρῶτον πῦρ ἔμπεσε νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν.
Ἕκτωρ Αἴαντος δόρυ μείλινον ἄγχι παραστὰς
πλῆξ’ ἄορι μεγάλῳ αἰχμῆς παρὰ καυλὸν ὄπισθεν,
ἀντικρὺ δ’ ἀπάραξε· τὸ μὲν Τελαμώνιος Αἴας
πῆλ’ αὖτως ἐν χειρὶ κόλον δόρυ, τῆλε δ’ ἀπ’ αὐτοῦ
αἰχμὴ χαλκείη χαμάδις βόμβησε πεσοῦσα.
γνῶ δ’ Αἴας κατὰ θυμὸν ἀμύμονα ῥίγησέν τε
ἔργα θεῶν, ὅ ῥα πάγχυ μάχης ἐπὶ μήδεα κεῖρε

16.121

Ζεὺς ὑψιβρεμέτης, Τρώεσσι δὲ βούλετο νίκην·
χάζετο δ’ ἐκ βελέων. τοὶ δ’ ἔμβαλον ἀκάματον πῦρ
νηῒ θοῇ· τῆς δ’ αἶψα κατ’ ἀσβέστη κέχυτο φλόξ.
ὣς τὴν μὲν πρυμνὴν πῦρ ἄμφεπεν· αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
μηρὼ πληξάμενος Πατροκλῆα προσέειπεν·
ὄρσεο διογενὲς Πατρόκλεες ἱπποκέλευθε·
λεύσσω δὴ παρὰ νηυσὶ πυρὸς δηΐοιο ἰωήν·
μὴ δὴ νῆας ἔλωσι καὶ οὐκέτι φυκτὰ πέλωνται·
δύσεο τεύχεα θᾶσσον, ἐγὼ δέ κε λαὸν ἀγείρω.
ὣς φάτο, Πάτροκλος δὲ κορύσσετο νώροπι χαλκῷ.
κνημῖδας μὲν πρῶτα περὶ κνήμῃσιν ἔθηκε
καλάς, ἀργυρέοισιν ἐπισφυρίοις ἀραρυίας·
δεύτερον αὖ θώρηκα περὶ στήθεσσιν ἔδυνε
ποικίλον ἀστερόεντα ποδώκεος Αἰακίδαο.
ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ ὤμοισιν βάλετο ξίφος ἀργυρόηλον
χάλκεον, αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα σάκος μέγα τε στιβαρόν τε·
κρατὶ δ’ ἐπ’ ἰφθίμῳ κυνέην εὔτυκτον ἔθηκεν
ἵππουριν· δεινὸν δὲ λόφος καθύπερθεν ἔνευεν.
εἵλετο δ’ ἄλκιμα δοῦρε, τά οἱ παλάμηφιν ἀρήρει.
ἔγχος δ’ οὐχ ἕλετ’ οἷον ἀμύμονος Αἰακίδαο
βριθὺ μέγα στιβαρόν· τὸ μὲν οὐ δύνατ’ ἄλλος Ἀχαιῶν
πάλλειν, ἀλλά μιν οἷος ἐπίστατο πῆλαι Ἀχιλλεὺς
Πηλιάδα μελίην, τὴν πατρὶ φίλῳ πόρε Χείρων
Πηλίου ἐκ κορυφῆς, φόνον ἔμμεναι ἡρώεσσιν.
ἵππους δ’ Αὐτομέδοντα θοῶς ζευγνῦμεν ἄνωγε,
τὸν μετ’ Ἀχιλλῆα ῥηξήνορα τῖε μάλιστα,
πιστότατος δέ οἱ ἔσκε μάχῃ ἔνι μεῖναι ὁμοκλήν.
τῷ δὲ καὶ Αὐτομέδων ὕπαγε ζυγὸν ὠκέας ἵππους
Ξάνθον καὶ Βαλίον, τὼ ἅμα πνοιῇσι πετέσθην,
τοὺς ἔτεκε Ζεφύρῳ ἀνέμῳ Ἅρπυια Ποδάργη

As he spoke Patroklos put on his armor. First he greaved his legs with greaves of good make, and fitted with ankle-clasps of silver; after this he donned the cuirass of the son of Aiakos, richly inlaid and studded. He hung his silver-studded sword of bronze about his shoulders, and then his mighty shield. On his comely head he set his helmet, well wrought, with a crest of horse-hair that nodded menacingly above it. He grasped two redoubtable spears that suited his hands, but he did not take the spear of noble Achilles, so stout and strong, for none other of the Achaeans could wield it, though Achilles could do so easily.

This was the ashen spear from Mount Pelion, which Chiron had cut upon a mountain top and had given to Peleus, wherewith to deal out death among heroes. He bade Automedon yoke his horses with all speed, for he was the man whom he held in honor next after Achilles, and on whose support in battle he could rely most firmly. Automedon therefore yoked the fleet horses Xanthos and Balios, steeds that could fly like the wind: these were they whom the harpy Podarge bore to the west wind, as she was grazing in a meadow by the waters of the river Okeanos. In the side traces he set the noble horse Pedasos, whom Achilles had brought away with him when he sacked the city of Eetion, and who, mortal steed though he was, could take his place along with those that were immortal. Meanwhile Achilles went about everywhere among the tents, and bade his Myrmidons put on their armor. Even as fierce ravening wolves that are feasting upon a horned stag which they have killed upon the mountains, and their jaws are red with blood - they go in a pack to lap water from the clear spring with their long thin tongues; and they reek of blood and slaughter; they know not what fear is, for it is hunger drives them - even so did the leaders and counselors of the Myrmidons gather round the good squire [therapôn] of the fleet descendant of Aiakos, and among them stood Achilles himself cheering on both men and horses. Fifty ships had noble Achilles brought to Troy, and in each there was a crew of fifty oarsmen. Over these he set five leaders whom he could trust, while he was himself commander over them all. Menesthios of the gleaming corselet, son to the river Spercheios that streams from heaven, was leader of the first company. Fair Polydora daughter of Peleus bore him to ever-flowing Spercheios - a woman mated with a god - but he was called son of Boros son of Perieres, with whom his mother was living as his wedded wife, and who gave great wealth to gain her. The second company was led by noble Eudoros, son to an unwedded woman. Polymele, daughter of Phylas, graceful in dancing [khoros], bore him; the mighty slayer of Argos was enamored of her as he saw her among the singing women at a dance [khoros] held in honor of Artemis the rushing huntress of the golden arrows; he therefore - Hermes, giver of all good - went with her into an upper chamber, and lay with her in secret, whereon she bore him a noble son Eudoros, singularly fleet of foot and in fight valiant. When Eileithuia goddess of the pains of child-birth brought him to the light of day, and he saw the face of the sun, mighty Echekles son of Aktor took the mother to wife, and gave great wealth to gain her, but her father Phylas brought the child up, and took care of him, doting as fondly upon him as though he were his own son. The third company was led by Peisandros son of Maimalos, the finest spearman among all the Myrmidons next to Achilles' own comrade Patroklos. The old horseman Phoenix was leader of the fourth company, and Alkimedon, noble son of Laerceus of the fifth. When Achilles had chosen [krinô] his men and had stationed them all with their leaders, he charged them straitly saying, "Myrmidons, remember your threats against the Trojans while you were at the ships in the time of my anger, and you were all complaining of me. ‘Cruel son of Peleus,’ you would say, ‘your mother must have suckled you on gall, so ruthless are you. You keep us here at the ships against our will; if you are so relentless it were better we went home over the sea.’ Often have you gathered and thus chided with me. The hour is now come for those high feats of arms that you have so long been pining for, therefore keep high hearts each one of you to do battle with the Trojans." With these words he put heart and soul into them all, and they serried their companies yet more closely when they heard the of their king. As the stones which a builder sets in the wall of some high house which is to give shelter from the winds - even so closely were the helmets and bossed shields set against one another. Shield pressed on shield, helm on helm, and man on man; so close were they that the horse-hair plumes on the gleaming ridges of their helmets touched each other as they bent their heads. In front of them all two men put on their armor - Patroklos and Automedon - two men, with but one mind to lead the Myrmidons. Then Achilles went inside his tent and opened the lid of the strong chest which silver-footed Thetis had given him to take on board

ship, and which she had filled with shirts, cloaks to keep out the cold, and good thick rugs. In this chest he had a cup of rare workmanship, from which no man but himself might drink, nor would he make offering from it to any other god save only to father Zeus. He took the cup from the chest and cleansed it with sulfur; this done he rinsed it clean water, and after he had washed his hands he drew wine. Then he stood in the middle of the court and prayed, looking towards heaven, and making his drink-offering of wine; nor was he unseen of Zeus whose joy is in thunder. "King Zeus," he cried, "lord of Dodona, god of the Pelasgi, you who dwell afar, you who hold wintry Dodona in your sway, where your seers the Selloi dwell around you with their feet unwashed and their couches made upon the ground - if you heard me when I prayed to you aforetime, and did me honor while you sent disaster on the Achaeans, grant me now the fulfillment of yet this further prayer. I shall stay here where my assembly [agôn] of ships are lying, but I shall send my comrade into battle at the head of many Myrmidons. Grant, O all-seeing Zeus, that victory may go with him; put your courage into his heart that Hektor may learn whether my squire [therapôn] is man enough to fight alone, or whether his might is only then so indomitable when I myself enter the turmoil of war. Afterwards when he has chased the fight and the cry of battle from the ships, grant that he may return unharmed, with his armor and his comrades, fighters in close combat."

16.151

151 βοσκομένη λειμῶνι παρὰ ῥόον Ὠκεανοῖο.
152 ἐν δὲ παρηορίῃσιν ἀμύμονα Πήδασον ἵει,
153 τόν ῥά ποτ’ Ἠετίωνος ἑλὼν πόλιν ἤγαγ’ Ἀχιλλεύς,
154 ὃς καὶ θνητὸς ἐὼν ἔπεθ’ ἵπποις ἀθανάτοισι.
155 Μυρμιδόνας δ’ ἄρ’ ἐποιχόμενος θώρηξεν Ἀχιλλεὺς
156 πάντας ἀνὰ κλισίας σὺν τεύχεσιν· οἳ δὲ λύκοι ὣς
157 ὠμοφάγοι, τοῖσίν τε περὶ φρεσὶν ἄσπετος ἀλκή,
158 οἵ τ’ ἔλαφον κεραὸν μέγαν οὔρεσι δηώσαντες
159 δάπτουσιν· πᾶσιν δὲ παρήϊον αἵματι φοινόν·
160 καί τ’ ἀγεληδὸν ἴασιν ἀπὸ κρήνης μελανύδρου
161 λάψοντες γλώσσῃσιν ἀραιῇσιν μέλαν ὕδωρ
162 ἄκρον ἐρευγόμενοι φόνον αἵματος· ἐν δέ τε θυμὸς
163 στήθεσιν ἄτρομός ἐστι, περιστένεται δέ τε γαστήρ·
164 τοῖοι Μυρμιδόνων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες
165 ἀμφ’ ἀγαθὸν θεράποντα ποδώκεος Αἰακίδαο
166 ῥώοντ’· ἐν δ’ ἄρα τοῖσιν ἀρήϊος ἵστατ’ Ἀχιλλεύς,
167 ὀτρύνων ἵππους τε καὶ ἀνέρας ἀσπιδιώτας.
168 πεντήκοντ’ ἦσαν νῆες θοαί, ᾗσιν Ἀχιλλεὺς
169 ἐς Τροίην ἡγεῖτο Διὶ φίλος· ἐν δὲ ἑκάστῃ
170 πεντήκοντ’ ἔσαν ἄνδρες ἐπὶ κληῖσιν ἑταῖροι·
171 πέντε δ’ ἄρ’ ἡγεμόνας ποιήσατο τοῖς ἐπεποίθει
172 σημαίνειν· αὐτὸς δὲ μέγα κρατέων ἤνασσε.
173 τῆς μὲν ἰῆς στιχὸς ἦρχε Μενέσθιος αἰολοθώρηξ
174 υἱὸς Σπερχειοῖο διιπετέος ποταμοῖο·
175 ὃν τέκε Πηλῆος θυγάτηρ καλὴ Πολυδώρη
176 Σπερχειῷ ἀκάμαντι γυνὴ θεῷ εὐνηθεῖσα,
177 αὐτὰρ ἐπίκλησιν Βώρῳ Περιήρεος υἷι,
178 ὅς ῥ’ ἀναφανδὸν ὄπυιε πορὼν ἀπερείσια ἕδνα.
179 τῆς δ’ ἑτέρης Εὔδωρος ἀρήϊος ἡγεμόνευε
180 παρθένιος, τὸν ἔτικτε χορῷ καλὴ Πολυμήλη

16.181

Φύλαντος θυγάτηρ· τῆς δὲ κρατὺς ἀργεϊφόντης
ἡράσατ’, ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ἰδὼν μετὰ μελπομένῃσιν
ἐν χορῷ Ἀρτέμιδος χρυσηλακάτου κελαδεινῆς.
αὐτίκα δ’ εἰς ὑπερῷ’ ἀναβὰς παρελέξατο λάθρῃ
Ἑρμείας ἀκάκητα, πόρεν δέ οἱ ἀγλαὸν υἱὸν
Εὔδωρον πέρι μὲν θείειν ταχὺν ἠδὲ μαχητήν.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ τόν γε μογοστόκος Εἰλείθυια
ἐξάγαγε πρὸ φόως δὲ καὶ ἠελίου ἴδεν αὐγάς,
τὴν μὲν Ἐχεκλῆος κρατερὸν μένος Ἀκτορίδαο
ἠγάγετο πρὸς δώματ’, ἐπεὶ πόρε μυρία ἕδνα,
τὸν δ’ ὃ γέρων Φύλας εὖ ἔτρεφεν ἠδ’ ἀτίταλλεν
ἀμφαγαπαζόμενος ὡς εἴ θ’ ἑὸν υἱὸν ἐόντα.
τῆς δὲ τρίτης Πείσανδρος ἀρήϊος ἡγεμόνευε
Μαιμαλίδης, ὃς πᾶσι μετέπρεπε Μυρμιδόνεσσιν
ἔγχεϊ μάρνασθαι μετὰ Πηλεΐωνος ἑταῖρον.
τῆς δὲ τετάρτης ἦρχε γέρων ἱππηλάτα Φοῖνιξ,
πέμπτης δ’ Ἀλκιμέδων Λαέρκεος υἱὸς ἀμύμων.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ πάντας ἅμ’ ἡγεμόνεσσιν Ἀχιλλεὺς
στῆσεν ἐὺ κρίνας, κρατερὸν δ’ ἐπὶ μῦθον ἔτελλε·
Μυρμιδόνες μή τίς μοι ἀπειλάων λελαθέσθω,
ἃς ἐπὶ νηυσὶ θοῇσιν ἀπειλεῖτε Τρώεσσι
πάνθ’ ὑπὸ μηνιθμόν, καί μ’ ᾐτιάασθε ἕκαστος·
σχέτλιε Πηλέος υἱὲ χόλῳ ἄρα σ’ ἔτρεφε μήτηρ,
νηλεές, ὃς παρὰ νηυσὶν ἔχεις ἀέκοντας ἑταίρους·
οἴκαδέ περ σὺν νηυσὶ νεώμεθα ποντοπόροισιν
αὖτις, ἐπεί ῥά τοι ὧδε κακὸς χόλος ἔμπεσε θυμῷ.
ταῦτά μ’ ἀγειρόμενοι θάμ’ ἐβάζετε· νῦν δὲ πέφανται
φυλόπιδος μέγα ἔργον, ἔης τὸ πρίν γ’ ἐράασθε.
ἔνθά τις ἄλκιμον ἦτορ ἔχων Τρώεσσι μαχέσθω.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε μένος καὶ θυμὸν ἑκάστου.

16.211

μᾶλλον δὲ στίχες ἄρθεν, ἐπεὶ βασιλῆος ἄκουσαν.
ὡς δ’ ὅτε τοῖχον ἀνὴρ ἀράρῃ πυκινοῖσι λίθοισι
δώματος ὑψηλοῖο βίας ἀνέμων ἀλεείνων,
ὣς ἄραρον κόρυθές τε καὶ ἀσπίδες ὀμφαλόεσσαι.
ἀσπὶς ἄρ’ ἀσπίδ’ ἔρειδε, κόρυς κόρυν, ἀνέρα δ’ ἀνήρ·
ψαῦον δ’ ἱππόκομοι κόρυθες λαμπροῖσι φάλοισι
νευόντων, ὡς πυκνοὶ ἐφέστασαν ἀλλήλοισι.
πάντων δὲ προπάροιθε δύ’ ἀνέρε θωρήσσοντο
Πάτροκλός τε καὶ Αὐτομέδων ἕνα θυμὸν ἔχοντες
πρόσθεν Μυρμιδόνων πολεμιζέμεν. αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
βῆ ῥ’ ἴμεν ἐς κλισίην, χηλοῦ δ’ ἀπὸ πῶμ’ ἀνέῳγε
καλῆς δαιδαλέης, τήν οἱ Θέτις ἀργυρόπεζα
θῆκ’ ἐπὶ νηὸς ἄγεσθαι ἐὺ πλήσασα χιτώνων
χλαινάων τ’ ἀνεμοσκεπέων οὔλων τε ταπήτων.
ἔνθα δέ οἱ δέπας ἔσκε τετυγμένον, οὐδέ τις ἄλλος
οὔτ’ ἀνδρῶν πίνεσκεν ἀπ’ αὐτοῦ αἴθοπα οἶνον,
οὔτέ τεῳ σπένδεσκε θεῶν, ὅτε μὴ Διὶ πατρί.
τό ῥα τότ’ ἐκ χηλοῖο λαβὼν ἐκάθηρε θείῳ

229 πρῶτον, ἔπειτα δ’ ἔνιψ’ ὕδατος καλῇσι ῥοῇσι,
230 νίψατο δ’ αὐτὸς χεῖρας, ἀφύσσατο δ’ αἴθοπα οἶνον.
231 εὔχετ’ ἔπειτα στὰς μέσῳ ἕρκεϊ, λεῖβε δὲ οἶνον
232 οὐρανὸν εἰσανιδών· Δία δ’ οὐ λάθε τερπικέραυνον·
233 Ζεῦ ἄνα Δωδωναῖε Πελασγικὲ τηλόθι ναίων
234 Δωδώνης μεδέων δυσχειμέρου, ἀμφὶ δὲ Σελλοὶ
235 σοὶ ναίουσ’ ὑποφῆται ἀνιπτόποδες χαμαιεῦναι,
236 ἠμὲν δή ποτ’ ἐμὸν ἔπος ἔκλυες εὐξαμένοιο,
237 τίμησας μὲν ἐμέ, μέγα δ’ ἴψαο λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν,
238 ἠδ’ ἔτι καὶ νῦν μοι τόδ’ ἐπικρήηνον ἐέλδωρ·
239 αὐτὸς μὲν γὰρ ἐγὼ μενέω νηῶν ἐν ἀγῶνι,
240 ἀλλ’ ἕταρον πέμπω πολέσιν μετὰ Μυρμιδόνεσσι

16.241

241 μάρνασθαι· τῷ κῦδος ἅμα πρόες εὐρύοπα Ζεῦ,
242 θάρσυνον δέ οἱ ἦτορ ἐνὶ φρεσίν, ὄφρα καὶ Ἕκτωρ
243 εἴσεται ἦ ῥα καὶ οἷος ἐπίστηται πολεμίζειν
244 ἠμέτερος θεράπων, ἦ οἱ τότε χεῖρες ἄαπτοι
245 μαίνονθ’, ὁππότ’ ἐγώ περ ἴω μετὰ μῶλον Ἄρηος.
246 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί κ’ ἀπὸ ναῦφι μάχην ἐνοπήν τε δίηται,
247 ἀσκηθής μοι ἔπειτα θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας ἵκοιτο
248 τεύχεσί τε ξὺν πᾶσι καὶ ἀγχεμάχοις ἑτάροισιν.
249 ὣς ἔφατ’ εὐχόμενος, τοῦ δ’ ἔκλυε μητίετα Ζεύς.
250 τῷ δ’ ἕτερον μὲν ἔδωκε πατήρ, ἕτερον δ’ ἀνένευσε·
251 νηῶν μέν οἱ ἀπώσασθαι πόλεμόν τε μάχην τε
252 δῶκε, σόον δ’ ἀνένευσε μάχης ἐξαπονέεσθαι.
253 ἤτοι ὃ μὲν σπείσας τε καὶ εὐξάμενος Διὶ πατρὶ
254 ἂψ κλισίην εἰσῆλθε, δέπας δ’ ἀπέθηκ’ ἐνὶ χηλῷ,
255 στῆ δὲ πάροιθ’ ἐλθὼν κλισίης, ἔτι δ’ ἤθελε θυμῷ
256 εἰσιδέειν Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν φύλοπιν αἰνήν.
257 οἳ δ’ ἅμα Πατρόκλῳ μεγαλήτορι θωρηχθέντες
258 ἔστιχον, ὄφρ’ ἐν Τρωσὶ μέγα φρονέοντες ὄρουσαν.
259 αὐτίκα δὲ σφήκεσσιν ἐοικότες ἐξεχέοντο
260 εἰνοδίοις, οὓς παῖδες ἐριδμαίνωσιν ἔθοντες
261 αἰεὶ κερτομέοντες ὁδῷ ἔπι οἰκί’ ἔχοντας
262 νηπίαχοι· ξυνὸν δὲ κακὸν πολέεσσι τιθεῖσι.
263 τοὺς δ’ εἴ περ παρά τίς τε κιὼν ἄνθρωπος ὁδίτης
264 κινήσῃ ἀέκων, οἳ δ’ ἄλκιμον ἦτορ ἔχοντες
265 πρόσσω πᾶς πέτεται καὶ ἀμύνει οἷσι τέκεσσι.
266 τῶν τότε Μυρμιδόνες κραδίην καὶ θυμὸν ἔχοντες
267 ἐκ νηῶν ἐχέοντο· βοὴ δ’ ἄσβεστος ὀρώρει.
268 Πάτροκλος δ’ ἑτάροισιν ἐκέκλετο μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
269 Μυρμιδόνες ἕταροι Πηληϊάδεω Ἀχιλῆος
270 ἀνέρες ἔστε φίλοι, μνήσασθε δὲ θούριδος ἀλκῆς,

Thus did he pray, and all-counseling Zeus heard his prayer. Part of it he did indeed grant him - but not the whole. He granted that Patroklos should thrust back war and battle from the ships, but refused to let him come safely out of the fight. When he had made his drink-offering and had thus prayed, Achilles went inside his tent and put back the cup into his chest. Then he again came out, for he still loved to look upon the fierce fight that raged between the Trojans and Achaeans. Meanwhile the armed band that was about Patroklos marched on till they sprang high in hope upon the Trojans. They came swarming out like

wasps whose nests are by the roadside, and whom silly children love to tease, whereon any one who happens to be passing may get stung - or again, if a wayfarer going along the road vexes them by accident, every wasp will come flying out in a fury to defend his little ones- even with such rage and courage did the Myrmidons swarm from their ships, and their cry of battle rose heavenwards. Patroklos called out to his men at the top of his voice, "Myrmidons, followers of Achilles son of Peleus, be men my friends, fight with might and with main, that we may win glory for the son of Peleus, who is far the foremost man at the ships of the Argives - he, and his close fighting followers [therapontes]. The son of Atreus King Agamemnon will thus recognize his derangement [atê] in showing no respect to the bravest of the Achaeans." With these words he put heart and soul into them all, and they fell in a body upon the Trojans. The ships rang again with the cry which the Achaeans raised, and when the Trojans saw the brave son of Menoitios and his squire [therapôn] all gleaming in their armor, they were daunted and their battalions were thrown into confusion, for they thought the fleet son of Peleus must now have put aside his anger, and have been reconciled to Agamemnon; every one, therefore, looked round about to see whither he might flee for safety. Patroklos first aimed a spear into the middle of the press where men were packed most closely, by the stern of the ship of Protesilaos. He hit Pyraikhmes who had led his Paeonian horsemen from the Amydon and the broad waters of the river Axios; the spear struck him on the right shoulder, and with a groan he fell backwards in the dust; on this his men were thrown into confusion, for by killing their leader, who was the finest warrior among them, Patroklos struck panic into them all. He thus drove them from the ship and quenched the fire that was then blazing - leaving the half-burnt ship to lie where it was. The Trojans were now driven back with a shout that rent the skies, while the Danaans poured after them from their ships, shouting also without ceasing. As when Zeus, gatherer of the thunder-cloud, spreads a dense canopy on the top of some lofty mountain, and all the peaks, the jutting headlands, and forest glades show out in the great light that flashes from the bursting heavens, even so when the Danaans had now driven back the fire from their ships, they took breath for a little while; but the fury of the fight was not yet over, for the Trojans were not driven back in utter rout, but still gave battle, and were ousted from their ground only by sheer fighting. The fight then became more scattered, and the chieftains killed one another when and how they could. The valiant son of Menoitios first drove his spear into the thigh of Areilykos just as he was turning round; the point went clean through, and broke the bone so that he fell forward. Meanwhile Menelaos struck Thoas in the chest, where it was exposed near the rim of his shield, and he fell dead. The son of Phyleus saw Amphiklos about to attack him, and ere he could do so took aim at the upper part of his thigh, where the muscles are thicker than in any other part; the spear tore through all the sinews of the leg, and his eyes were closed in darkness. Of the sons of Nestor one, Antilokhos, speared Atymnios, driving the point of the spear through his throat, and down he fell. Maris then sprang on Antilokhos in hand-to-hand fight to avenge his brother, and bestrode the body spear in hand; but valiant Thrasymedes was too quick for him, and in a moment had struck him in the shoulder ere he could deal his blow; his aim was true, and the spear severed all the muscles at the root of his arm, and tore them right down to the bone, so he fell heavily to the ground and his eyes were closed in darkness. Thus did these two noble comrades of Sarpedon go down to Erebos slain by the two sons of Nestor; they were the warrior sons of Amisodoros, who had reared the invincible Chimaera, to the bane of many. Ajax son of Oileus sprang on Kleoboulos and took him alive as he was entangled in the crush; but he killed him then and there by a sword-blow on the neck. The sword reeked with his blood, while dark death and the strong hand of fate gripped him and closed his eyes.

16.271

ὡς ἂν Πηλεΐδην τιμήσομεν, ὃς μέγ’ ἄριστος
Ἀργείων παρὰ νηυσὶ καὶ ἀγχέμαχοι θεράποντες,
γνῷ δὲ καὶ Ἀτρεΐδης εὐρὺ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
ἣν ἄτην, ὅ τ’ ἄριστον Ἀχαιῶν οὐδὲν ἔτισεν.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε μένος καὶ θυμὸν ἑκάστου,
ἐν δ’ ἔπεσον Τρώεσσιν ἀολλέες· ἀμφὶ δὲ νῆες
σμερδαλέον κονάβησαν ἀϋσάντων ὑπ’ Ἀχαιῶν.
Τρῶες δ’ ὡς εἴδοντο Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμον υἱὸν
αὐτὸν καὶ θεράποντα σὺν ἔντεσι μαρμαίροντας,
πᾶσιν ὀρίνθη θυμός, ἐκίνηθεν δὲ φάλαγγες
ἐλπόμενοι παρὰ ναῦφι ποδώκεα Πηλεΐωνα
μηνιθμὸν μὲν ἀπορρῖψαι, φιλότητα δ’ ἐλέσθαι·
πάπτηνεν δὲ ἕκαστος ὅπῃ φύγοι αἰπὺν ὄλεθρον.
Πάτροκλος δὲ πρῶτος ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ
ἀντικρὺ κατὰ μέσσον, ὅθι πλεῖστοι κλονέοντο,
νηῒ πάρα πρυμνῇ μεγαθύμου Πρωτεσιλάου,
καὶ βάλε Πυραίχμην, ὃς Παίονας ἱπποκορυστὰς
ἦγαγεν ἐξ Ἀμυδῶνος ἀπ’ Ἀξιοῦ εὐρὺ ῥέοντος·
τὸν βάλε δεξιὸν ὦμον· ὃ δ’ ὕπτιος ἐν κονίῃσι
κάππεσεν οἰμώξας, ἕταροι δέ μιν ἀμφεφόβηθεν
Παίονες· ἐν γὰρ Πάτροκλος φόβον ἧκεν ἅπασιν
ἡγεμόνα κτείνας, ὃς ἀριστεύεσκε μάχεσθαι.
ἐκ νηῶν δ’ ἔλασεν, κατὰ δ’ ἔσβεσεν αἰθόμενον πῦρ.
ἡμιδαὴς δ’ ἄρα νηῦς λίπετ’ αὐτόθι· τοὶ δὲ φόβηθεν
Τρῶες θεσπεσίῳ ὁμάδῳ· Δαναοὶ δ’ ἐπέχυντο
νῆας ἀνὰ γλαφυράς· ὅμαδος δ’ ἀλίαστος ἐτύχθη.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἀφ’ ὑψηλῆς κορυφῆς ὄρεος μεγάλοιο
κινήσῃ πυκινὴν νεφέλην στεροπηγερέτα Ζεύς,
ἔκ τ’ ἔφανεν πᾶσαι σκοπιαὶ καὶ πρώονες ἄκροι
καὶ νάπαι, οὐρανόθεν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπερράγη ἄσπετος αἰθήρ,

16.301

ὡς Δαναοὶ νηῶν μὲν ἀπωσάμενοι δήϊον πῦρ
τυτθὸν ἀνέπνευσαν, πολέμου δ’ οὐ γίγνετ’ ἐρωή·
οὐ γάρ πώ τι Τρῶες ἀρηϊφίλων ὑπ’ Ἀχαιῶν
προτροπάδην φοβέοντο μελαινάων ἀπὸ νηῶν,
ἀλλ’ ἔτ’ ἄρ’ ἀνθίσταντο, νεῶν δ’ ὑπόεικον ἀνάγκῃ.
ἔνθα δ’ ἀνὴρ ἕλεν ἄνδρα κεδασθείσης ὑσμίνης
ἡγεμόνων. πρῶτος δὲ Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμος υἱὸς
αὐτίκ’ ἄρα στρεφθέντος Ἀρηϊλύκου βάλε μηρὸν
ἔγχεϊ ὀξυόεντι, διὰ πρὸ δὲ χαλκὸν ἔλασσε·
ῥῆξεν δ’ ὀστέον ἔγχος, ὃ δὲ πρηνὴς ἐπὶ γαίῃ
κάππεσ’· ἀτὰρ Μενέλαος ἀρήϊος οὗτα Θόαντα
στέρνον γυμνωθέντα παρ’ ἀσπίδα, λῦσε δὲ γυῖα.
Φυλεΐδης δ’ Ἄμφικλον ἐφορμηθέντα δοκεύσας
ἔφθη ὀρεξάμενος πρυμνὸν σκέλος, ἔνθα πάχιστος
μυὼν ἀνθρώπου πέλεται· περὶ δ’ ἔγχεος αἰχμῇ
νεῦρα διεσχίσθη· τὸν δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψε.
Νεστορίδαι δ’ ὃ μὲν οὗτασ’ Ἀτύμνιον ὀξέϊ δουρὶ
Ἀντίλοχος, λαπάρης δὲ διήλασε χάλκεον ἔγχος·

319 ἤριπε δὲ προπάροιθε. Μάρις δ’ αὐτοσχεδὰ δουρὶ
320 Ἀντιλόχῳ ἐπόρουσε κασιγνήτοιο χολωθεὶς
321 στὰς πρόσθεν νέκυος· τοῦ δ’ ἀντίθεος Θρασυμήδης
322 ἔφθη ὀρεξάμενος πρὶν οὐτάσαι, οὐδ’ ἀφάμαρτεν,
323 ὦμον ἄφαρ· πρυμνὸν δὲ βραχίονα δουρὸς ἀκωκὴ
324 δρύψ’ ἀπὸ μυώνων, ἀπὸ δ’ ὀστέον ἄχρις ἄραξε·
325 δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, κατὰ δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψεν.
326 ὣς τὼ μὲν δοιοῖσι κασιγνήτοισι δαμέντε
327 βήτην εἰς Ἔρεβος Σαρπηδόνος ἐσθλοὶ ἑταῖροι
328 υἷες ἀκοντισταὶ Ἀμισωδάρου, ὅς ῥα Χίμαιραν
329 θρέψεν ἀμαιμακέτην πολέσιν κακὸν ἀνθρώποισιν.
330 Αἴας δὲ Κλεόβουλον Ὀϊλιάδης ἐπορούσας

16.331

331 ζωὸν ἔλε βλαφθέντα κατὰ κλόνον· ἀλλά οἱ αὖθι
332 λῦσε μένος πλήξας ξίφει αὐχένα κωπήεντι.
333 πᾶν δ’ ὑπεθερμάνθη ξίφος αἵματι· τὸν δὲ κατ’ ὄσσε
334 ἔλλαβε πορφύρεος θάνατος καὶ μοῖρα κραταιή.
335 Πηνέλεως δὲ Λύκων τε συνέδραμον· ἔγχεσι μὲν γὰρ
336 ἤμβροτον ἀλλήλων, μέλεον δ’ ἠκόντισαν ἄμφω·
337 τὼ δ’ αὖτις ξιφέεσσι συνέδραμον. ἔνθα Λύκων μὲν
338 ἱπποκόμου κόρυθος φάλον ἤλασεν, ἀμφὶ δὲ καυλὸν
339 φάσγανον ἐρραίσθη· ὃ δ’ ὑπ’ οὔατος αὐχένα θεῖνε
340 Πηνέλεως, πᾶν δ’ εἴσω ἔδυ ξίφος, ἔσχεθε δ’ οἷον
341 δέρμα, παρηέρθη δὲ κάρη, ὑπέλυντο δὲ γυῖα.
342 Μηριόνης δ’ Ἀκάμαντα κιχεὶς ποσὶ καρπαλίμοισι
343 νύξ’ ἵππων ἐπιβησόμενον κατὰ δεξιὸν ὦμον·
344 ἤριπε δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων, κατὰ δ’ ὀφθαλμῶν κέχυτ’ ἀχλύς.
345 Ἰδομενεὺς δ’ Ἐρύμαντα κατὰ στόμα νηλέϊ χαλκῷ
346 νύξε· τὸ δ’ ἀντικρὺ δόρυ χάλκεον ἐξεπέρησε
347 νέρθεν ὑπ’ ἐγκεφάλοιο, κέασσε δ’ ἄρ’ ὀστέα λευκά·
348 ἐκ δ’ ἐτίναχθεν ὀδόντες, ἐνέπλησθεν δέ οἱ ἄμφω
349 αἵματος ὀφθαλμοί· τὸ δ’ ἀνὰ στόμα καὶ κατὰ ῥῖνας
350 πρῆσε χανών· θανάτου δὲ μέλαν νέφος ἀμφεκάλυψεν.
351 οὗτοι ἄρ’ ἡγεμόνες Δαναῶν ἕλον ἄνδρα ἕκαστος.
352 ὡς δὲ λύκοι ἄρνεσσιν ἐπέχραον ἢ ἐρίφοισι
353 σίνται ὑπ’ ἐκ μήλων αἰρεύμενοι, αἵ τ’ ἐν ὄρεσσι
354 ποιμένος ἀφραδίῃσι διέτμαγεν· οἳ δὲ ἰδόντες
355 αἶψα διαρπάζουσιν ἀνάλκιδα θυμὸν ἐχούσας·
356 ὣς Δαναοὶ Τρώεσσιν ἐπέχραον· οἳ δὲ φόβοιο
357 δυσκελάδου μνήσαντο, λάθοντο δὲ θούριδος ἀλκῆς.
358 Αἴας δ’ ὃ μέγας αἰὲν ἐφ’ Ἕκτορι χαλκοκορυστῇ
359 ἴετ’ ἀκοντίσσαι· ὃ δὲ ἰδρείῃ πολέμοιο
360 ἀσπίδι ταυρείῃ κεκαλυμμένος εὐρέας ὤμους

Peneleos and Lykon now met in close fight, for they had missed each other with their spears. They had both thrown without effect, so now they drew their swords. Lykon struck the plumed crest of Peneleos' helmet but his sword broke at the hilt, while Peneleos smote Lykon on the neck under the ear. The blade sank so deep that the head was held on by nothing but the skin, and there was no more life left in him. Meriones gave chase to Akamas on foot and caught him up just as he was about to mount his chariot; he drove a spear through his right shoulder so that he fell headlong from the car, and his eyes were closed in

darkness. Idomeneus speared Erymas in the mouth; the bronze point of the spear went clean through it beneath the brain, crashing in among the white bones and smashing them up. His teeth were all of them knocked out and the blood came gushing in a stream from both his eyes; it also came gurgling up from his mouth and nostrils, and the darkness of death enfolded him round about. Thus did these chieftains of the Danaans each of them kill his man. As ravening wolves seize on kids or lambs, fastening on them when they are alone on the hillsides and have strayed from the main flock through the carelessness of the shepherd - and when the wolves see this they pounce upon them at once because they cannot defend themselves- even so did the Danaans now fall on the Trojans, who fled with ill-omened cries in their panic and had no more fight left in them. Meanwhile great Ajax kept on trying to drive a spear into Hektor, but Hektor was so skillful that he held his broad shoulders well under cover of his ox-hide shield, ever on the look-out for the whizzing of the arrows and the heavy thud of the spears. He well knew that the fortunes of the day had changed, but still stood his ground and tried to protect his comrades. As when a cloud goes up into heaven from Olympus, rising out of a clear sky when Zeus is brewing a gale - even with such panic stricken rout did the Trojans now flee, and there was no order in their going. Hektor's fleet horses bore him and his armor out of the fight, and he left the Trojan host penned in by the deep trench against their will. Many a yoke of horses snapped the pole of their chariots in the trench and left their master's car behind them. Patroklos gave chase, calling impetuously on the Danaans and full of fury against the Trojans, who, being now no longer in a body, filled all the ways with their cries of panic and rout; the air was darkened with the clouds of dust they raised, and the horses strained every nerve in their flight from the tents and ships towards the city. Patroklos kept on heading his horses wherever he saw most men fleeing in confusion, cheering on his men the while. Chariots were being smashed in all directions, and many a man came tumbling down from his own car to fall beneath the wheels of that of Patroklos, whose immortal steeds, given by the gods to Peleus, sprang over the trench at a bound as they sped onward. He was intent on trying to get near Hektor, for he had set his heart on spearing him, but Hektor's horses were now hurrying him away. As the whole dark earth bows before some tempest on an autumn day when Zeus rains his hardest to punish men for judging [krinô] crookedly in their courts, and arriving justice there from without heed to the decrees [themistes] of heaven - all the rivers run full and the torrents tear many a new channel as they roar headlong from the mountains to the dark sea, and it fares ill with the works of men - even such was the stress and strain of the Trojan horses in their flight. Patroklos now cut off the battalions that were nearest to him and drove them back to the ships. They were doing their best to reach the city, but he would not let them, and bore down on them between the river and the ships and wall. Many a fallen comrade did he then avenge. First he hit Pronoos with a spear on the chest where it was exposed near the rim of his shield, and he fell heavily to the ground. Next he sprang on Thestor son of Enops, who was sitting all huddled up in his chariot, for he had lost his head and the reins had been torn out of his hands. Patroklos went up to him and drove a spear into his right jaw; he thus hooked him by the teeth and the spear pulled him over the rim of his car, as one who sits at the end of some jutting rock and draws a strong fish out of the sea [pontos] with a hook and a line - even so with his spear did he pull Thestor all gaping from his chariot; he then threw him down on his face and he died while falling. On this, as Erylaos was on to attack him, he struck him full on the head with a stone, and his brains were all battered inside his helmet, whereon he fell headlong to the ground and the pangs of death took hold upon him. Then he laid low, one after the other, Erymas, Amphoteros, Epaltes, Tlepolemos, Echios son of Damastor, Pyris, Ipheus, Euippos and Polymelos son of Argeas. Now when Sarpedon saw his comrades, men who wore unbelted tunics, being overcome by Patroklos son of Menoitios, he rebuked the Lycians saying. "Shame [aidôs] on you, where are you fleeing to?

Show your mettle; I will myself meet this man in fight and learn who it is that is so masterful; he has done us much hurt, and has stretched many a brave man upon the ground." He sprang from his chariot as he spoke, and Patroklos, when he saw this, leaped on to the ground also. The two then rushed at one another with loud cries like eagle-beaked crook-taloned vultures that scream and tear at one another in some high mountain fastness.

16.361

361 σκέπτετ’ ὀϊστῶν τε ῥοῖζον καὶ δοῦπον ἀκόντων.
362 ἦ μὲν δὴ γίγνωσκε μάχης ἐτεραλκέα νίκην·
363 ἀλλὰ καὶ ὣς ἀνέμιμνε, σάω δ’ ἑρίηρας ἑταίρους.
364 ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἀπ’ Οὐλύμπου νέφος ἔρχεται οὐρανὸν εἴσω
365 αἰθέρος ἐκ δίης, ὅτε τε Ζεὺς λαίλαπα τείνῃ,
366 ὣς τῶν ἐκ νηῶν γένετο ἰαχή τε φόβος τε,
367 οὐδὲ κατὰ μοῖραν πέραον πάλιν. Ἕκτορα δ’ ἵπποι
368 ἔκφερον ὠκύποδες σὺν τεύχεσι, λεῖπε δὲ λαὸν
369 Τρωϊκόν, οὓς ἀέκοντας ὀρυκτὴ τάφρος ἔρυκε.
370 πολλοὶ δ’ ἐν τάφρῳ ἐρυσάρματες ὠκέες ἵπποι
371 ἄξαντ’ ἐν πρώτῳ ῥυμῷ λίπον ἅρματ’ ἀνάκτων,
372 Πάτροκλος δ’ ἔπετο σφεδανὸν Δαναοῖσι κελεύων
373 Τρωσὶ κακὰ φρονέων· οἱ δὲ ἰαχῇ τε φόβῳ τε
374 πάσας πλῆσαν ὁδούς, ἐπεὶ ἂρ τμάγεν· ὕψι δ’ ἀέλλη
375 σκίδναθ’ ὑπὸ νεφέων, τανύοντο δὲ μώνυχες ἵπποι
376 ἄψορρον προτὶ ἄστυ νεῶν ἄπο καὶ κλισιάων.
377 Πάτροκλος δ’ ᾗ πλεῖστον ὀρινόμενον ἴδε λαόν,
378 τῇ ῥ’ ἔχ’ ὁμοκλήσας· ὑπὸ δ’ ἄξοσι φῶτες ἔπιπτον
379 πρηνέες ἐξ ὀχέων, δίφροι δ’ ἀνακυμβαλίαζον.
380 ἀντικρὺ δ’ ἄρα τάφρον ὑπέρθορον ὠκέες ἵπποι
381 ἄμβροτοι, οὓς Πηλῆϊ θεοὶ δόσαν ἀγλαὰ δῶρα,
382 πρόσσω ἰέμενοι, ἐπὶ δ’ Ἕκτορι κέκλετο θυμός·
383 ἵετο γὰρ βαλέειν· τὸν δ’ ἔκφερον ὠκέες ἵπποι.
384 ὡς δ’ ὑπὸ λαίλαπι πᾶσα κελαινὴ βέβριθε χθὼν
385 ἤματ’ ὀπωρινῷ, ὅτε λαβρότατον χέει ὕδωρ
386 Ζεύς, ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἄνδρεσσι κοτεσσάμενος χαλεπήνῃ,
387 οἳ βίῃ εἰν ἀγορῇ σκολιὰς κρίνωσι θέμιστας,
388 ἐκ δὲ δίκην ἐλάσωσι θεῶν ὄπιν οὐκ ἀλέγοντες·
389 τῶν δέ τε πάντες μὲν ποταμοὶ πλήθουσι ῥέοντες,
390 πολλὰς δὲ κλιτῦς τότ’ ἀποτμήγουσι χαράδραι,

16.391

391 ἐς δ’ ἅλα πορφυρέην μεγάλα στενάχουσι ῥέουσαι
392 ἐξ ὀρέων ἐπικάρ, μινύθει δέ τε ἔργ’ ἀνθρώπων·
393 ὣς ἵπποι Τρῳαὶ μεγάλα στενάχοντο θέουσαι.
394 Πάτροκλος δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν πρώτας ἐπέκερσε φάλαγγας,
395 ἂψ ἐπὶ νῆας ἔεργε παλιμπετές, οὐδὲ πόληος
396 εἴα ἰεμένους ἐπιβαινέμεν, ἀλλὰ μεσηγὺ
397 νηῶν καὶ ποταμοῦ καὶ τείχεος ὑψηλοῖο
398 κτεῖνε μεταΐσσων, πολέων δ’ ἀπετίνυτο ποινήν.
399 ἔνθ’ ἤτοι Πρόνοον πρῶτον βάλε δουρὶ φαεινῷ
400 στέρνον γυμνωθέντα παρ’ ἀσπίδα, λῦσε δὲ γυῖα·
401 δούπησεν δὲ πεσών· ὃ δὲ Θέστορα Ἤνοπος υἱὸν

δεύτερον ὁρμηθείς· ὃ μὲν εὐξέστῳ ἐνὶ δίφρῳ
ἧστο ἀλείς· ἐκ γὰρ πλήγη φρένας, ἐκ δ’ ἄρα χειρῶν
ἡνία ᾔχθησαν· ὃ δ’ ἔγχεϊ νύξε παραστὰς
γναθμὸν δεξιτερόν, διὰ δ’ αὐτοῦ πεῖρεν ὀδόντων,
ἕλκε δὲ δουρὸς ἐλὼν ὑπὲρ ἄντυγος, ὡς ὅτε τις φὼς
πέτρῃ ἔπι προβλῆτι καθήμενος ἰερὸν ἰχθὺν
ἐκ πόντοιο θύραζε λίνῳ καὶ ἤνοπι χαλκῷ·
ὣς ἕλκ’ ἐκ δίφροιο κεχηνότα δουρὶ φαεινῷ,
κὰδ δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπὶ στόμ’ ἔωσε· πεσόντα δέ μιν λίπε θυμός.
αὐτὰρ ἔπειτ’ Ἐρύλαον ἐπεσσύμενον βάλε πέτρῳ
μέσσην κὰκ κεφαλήν· ἣ δ’ ἄνδιχα πᾶσα κεάσθη
ἐν κόρυθι βριαρῇ· ὃ δ’ ἄρα πρηνὴς ἐπὶ γαίῃ
κάππεσεν, ἀμφὶ δέ μιν θάνατος χύτο θυμοραϊστής.
αὐτὰρ ἔπειτ’ Ἐρύμαντα καὶ Ἀμφοτερὸν καὶ Ἐπάλτην
Τληπόλεμόν τε Δαμαστορίδην Ἐχίον τε Πύριν τε
Ἰφέα τ’ Εὐιππόν τε καὶ Ἀργεάδην Πολύμηλον
πάντας ἐπασσυτέρους πέλασε χθονὶ πουλυβοτείρῃ.
Σαρπηδὼν δ’ ὡς οὖν ἴδ’ ἀμιτροχίτωνας ἑταίρους
χέρσ’ ὕπο Πατρόκλοιο Μενοιτιάδαο δαμέντας,

16.421

κέκλετ’ ἄρ’ ἀντιθέοισι καθαπτόμενος Λυκίοισιν·
αἰδὼς ὦ Λύκιοι· πόσε φεύγετε; νῦν θοοὶ ἔστε.
ἀντήσω γὰρ ἐγὼ τοῦδ’ ἀνέρος, ὄφρα δαείω
ὅς τις ὅδε κρατέει καὶ δὴ κακὰ πολλὰ ἔοργε
Τρῶας, ἐπεὶ πολλῶν τε καὶ ἐσθλῶν γούνατ’ ἔλυσεν.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἐξ ὀχέων σὺν τεύχεσιν ἅλτο χαμᾶζε.
Πάτροκλος δ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐπεὶ ἴδεν ἔκθορε δίφρου.
οἳ δ’ ὥς τ’ αἰγυπιοὶ γαμψώνυχες ἀγκυλοχεῖλαι
πέτρῃ ἐφ’ ὑψηλῇ μεγάλα κλάζοντε μάχωνται,
ὣς οἳ κεκλήγοντες ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ὄρουσαν.
τοὺς δὲ ἰδὼν ἐλέησε Κρόνου πάϊς ἀγκυλομήτεω,
Ἥρην δὲ προσέειπε κασιγνήτην ἄλοχόν τε·
ὤ μοι ἐγώ, ὅ τέ μοι Σαρπηδόνα φίλτατον ἀνδρῶν
μοῖρ’ ὑπὸ Πατρόκλοιο Μενοιτιάδαο δαμῆναι.
διχθὰ δέ μοι κραδίη μέμονε φρεσὶν ὁρμαίνοντι,
ἤ μιν ζωὸν ἐόντα μάχης ἄπο δακρυοέσσης
θείω ἀναρπάξας Λυκίης ἐν πίονι δήμῳ,
ἦ ἤδη ὑπὸ χερσὶ Μενοιτιάδαο δαμάσσω.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη·
αἰνότατε Κρονίδη ποῖον τὸν μῦθον ἔειπες.
ἄνδρα θνητὸν ἐόντα πάλαι πεπρωμένον αἴσῃ
ἂψ ἐθέλεις θανάτοιο δυσηχέος ἐξαναλῦσαι;
ἔρδ’· ἀτὰρ οὔ τοι πάντες ἐπαινέομεν θεοὶ ἄλλοι.
ἄλλο δέ τοι ἐρέω, σὺ δ’ ἐνὶ φρεσὶ βάλλεο σῇσιν·
αἴ κε ζὸν πέμψῃς Σαρπηδόνα ὃν δὲ δόμον δέ,
φράζεο μή τις ἔπειτα θεῶν ἐθέλῃσι καὶ ἄλλος
πέμπειν ὃν φίλον υἱὸν ἀπὸ κρατερῆς ὑσμίνης·
πολλοὶ γὰρ περὶ ἄστυ μέγα Πριάμοιο μάχονται
υἱέες ἀθανάτων, τοῖσιν κότον αἰνὸν ἐνήσεις.
ἀλλ’ εἴ τοι φίλος ἐστί, τεὸν δ’ ὀλοφύρεται ἦτορ,

The son of scheming Kronos looked down upon them in pity and said to Hera who was his wife and sister, "Alas, that it should be the lot of Sarpedon whom I love so dearly to perish by the hand of Patroklos. I am in two minds whether to catch him up out of the fight and set him down safe and sound in the fertile district [dêmos] of Lycia, or to let him now fall by the hand of the son of Menoitios." And Hera answered, "Most dread son of Kronos, what is this that you are saying? Would you snatch a mortal man, whose doom has long been fated, out of the jaws of death? Do as you will, but we shall not all of us be of your mind. I say further, and lay my saying to your heart, that if you send Sarpedon safely to his own home, some other of the gods will be also wanting to escort his son out of battle, for there are many sons of gods fighting round the city of Troy, and you will make every one jealous. If, however, you are fond of him and pity him, let him indeed fall by the hand of Patroklos, but as soon as the life [psukhê] is gone out of him, send Death and sweet Sleep to bear him off the field and take him to the broad district [dêmos] of Lycia, where his brothers and his kinsmen will bury him with mound and pillar, in due honor to the dead." The sire of gods and men assented, but he shed a rain of blood upon the earth in honor [timê] of his son whom Patroklos was about to kill on the fertile plain of Troy far from his home. When they were now come close to one another Patroklos struck Thrasydemos, the brave squire [therapôn] of Sarpedon, in the lower part of the belly, and killed him. Sarpedon then aimed a spear at Patroklos and missed him, but he struck the horse Pedasos in the right shoulder, and it screamed aloud as it lay, groaning in the dust until the life went out of it. The other two horses began to plunge; the pole of the chariot cracked and they got entangled in the reins through the fall of the horse that was yoked along with them; but Automedon knew what to do; without the loss of a moment he drew the keen blade that hung by his sturdy thigh and cut the third horse adrift; whereon the other two righted themselves, and pulling hard at the reins again went together into battle. Sarpedon now took a second aim at Patroklos, and again missed him, the point of the spear passed over his left shoulder without hitting him. Patroklos then aimed in his turn, and the spear sped not from his hand in vain, for he hit Sarpedon just where the midriff surrounds the ever-beating heart. He fell like some oak or silver poplar or tall pine to which woodmen have laid their axes upon the mountains to make timber for ship-building - even so did he lie stretched at full length in front of his chariot and horses, moaning and clutching at the blood-stained dust. As when a lion springs with a bound upon a herd of cattle and fastens on a great black bull which dies bellowing in its clutches - even so did the leader of the Lycian warriors struggle in death as he fell by the hand of Patroklos. He called on his trusty comrade and said, "Glaukos, my brother, hero among heroes, put forth all your strength, fight with might and main, now if ever quit yourself like a valiant warrior. First go about among the Lycian leaders and bid them fight for Sarpedon; then yourself also do battle to save my armor from being taken. My name will haunt you henceforth and for ever if the Achaeans rob me of my armor now that I have fallen near the assembly [agôn] of their ships. Do your very utmost and call all my people together." The outcome [telos] of death closed his eyes as he spoke. Patroklos planted his heel on his breast and drew the spear from his body, whereon his diaphragm came out along with it, and he drew out both spear-point and Sarpedon's life-breath [psukhê] at the same time. Hard by the Myrmidons held his snorting steeds, who were wild with panic at finding themselves deserted by their lords. Glaukos was overcome with grief [akhos] when he heard what Sarpedon said, for he could not help him. He had to support his arm with his other hand, being in great pain through the wound which Teucer's arrow had given him when Teucer was defending the wall as he, Glaukos, was assailing it. Therefore he prayed to far-darting Apollo saying, "Hear me O king from your seat, may be in the fertile district [dêmos] of Lycia, or may be in Troy, for in all places you can hear the prayer of one who is in distress, as I now am. I have a grievous wound; my hand is aching with pain, there is no staunching the blood, and my whole arm drags by reason of my hurt,

so that I cannot grasp my sword nor go among my foes and fight them, though our prince, Zeus' son Sarpedon, is slain. Zeus defended not his son, do you, therefore, O king, heal me of my wound, ease my pain and grant me strength both to cheer on the Lycians and to fight along with them round the body of him who has fallen." Thus did he pray, and Apollo heard his prayer. He eased his pain, staunched the black blood from the wound, and gave him new strength. Glaukos perceived this, and was thankful that the mighty god had answered his prayer; forthwith, therefore, he went among the Lycian leaders, and bade them come to fight about the body of Sarpedon. From these he strode on among the Trojans to Polydamas son of Panthoos and Agenor; he then went in search of Aeneas and Hektor, and when he had found them he said, "Hektor, you have utterly forgotten your allies, who languish here for your sake far from friends and home while you do nothing to support them. Sarpedon leader of the Lycian warriors has fallen - he who was at once the right and might of Lycia; Ares has laid him low by the spear of Patroklos. Stand by him, my friends, and suffer not the Myrmidons to strip him of his armor, nor to treat his body with contumely in revenge for all the Danaans whom we have speared at the ships."

16.451

ἤτοι μέν μιν ἔασον ἐνὶ κρατερῇ ὑσμίνῃ
χέρσ’ ὕπο Πατρόκλοιο Μενοιτιάδαο δαμῆναι·
αὐτὰρ ἐπὴν δὴ τόν γε λίπῃ ψυχή τε καὶ αἰών,
πέμπειν μιν θάνατόν τε φέρειν καὶ νήδυμον ὕπνον
εἰς ὅ κε δὴ Λυκίης εὐρείης δῆμον ἵκωνται,
ἔνθά ἑ ταρχύσουσι κασίγνητοί τε ἔται τε
τύμβῳ τε στήλῃ τε· τὸ γὰρ γέρας ἐστὶ θανόντων.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε·
αἱματοέσσας δὲ ψιάδας κατέχευεν ἔραζε
παῖδα φίλον τιμῶν, τόν οἱ Πάτροκλος ἔμελλε
φθίσειν ἐν Τροίῃ ἐριβώλακι τηλόθι πάτρης.
οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντες,
ἔνθ’ ἤτοι Πάτροκλος ἀγακλειτὸν Θρασύμηλον,
ὅς ῥ’ ἡὺς θεράπων Σαρπηδόνος ἦεν ἄνακτος,
τὸν βάλε νείαιραν κατὰ γαστέρα, λῦσε δὲ γυῖα.
Σαρπηδὼν δ’ αὐτοῦ μὲν ἀπήμβροτε δουρὶ φαεινῷ
δεύτερον ὁρμηθείς, ὃ δὲ Πήδασον οὔτασεν ἵππον
ἔγχεϊ δεξιὸν ὦμον· ὃ δ’ ἔβραχε θυμὸν ἀΐσθων,
κὰδ δ’ ἔπεσ’ ἐν κονίῃσι μακών, ἀπὸ δ’ ἔπτατο θυμός.
τὼ δὲ διαστήτην, κρίκε δὲ ζυγόν, ἡνία δέ σφι
σύγχυτ’, ἐπεὶ δὴ κεῖτο παρήορος ἐν κονίῃσι.
τοῖο μὲν Αὐτομέδων δουρικλυτὸς εὔρετο τέκμωρ·
σπασσάμενος τανύηκες ἄορ παχέος παρὰ μηροῦ
ἀΐξας ἀπέκοψε παρήορον οὐδ’ ἐμάτησε·
τὼ δ’ ἰθυνθήτην, ἐν δὲ ῥυτῆρσι τάνυσθεν·
τὼ δ’ αὖτις συνίτην ἔριδος πέρι θυμοβόροιο.
ἔνθ’ αὖ Σαρπηδὼν μὲν ἀπήμβροτε δουρὶ φαεινῷ,
Πατρόκλου δ’ ὑπὲρ ὦμον ἀριστερὸν ἦλυθ’ ἀκωκὴ
ἔγχεος, οὐδ’ ἔβαλ’ αὐτόν· ὃ δ’ ὕστερος ὄρνυτο χαλκῷ
Πάτροκλος· τοῦ δ’ οὐχ ἅλιον βέλος ἔκφυγε χειρός,

16.481

ἀλλ’ ἔβαλ’ ἔνθ’ ἄρα τε φρένες ἔρχαται ἀμφ’ ἀδινὸν κῆρ.

ἤριπε δ’ ὡς ὅτε τις δρῦς ἤριπεν ἢ ἀχερωΐς
ἠὲ πίτυς βλωθρή, τήν τ’ οὔρεσι τέκτονες ἄνδρες
ἐξέταμον πελέκεσσι νεήκεσι νήϊον εἶναι·
ὣς ὃ πρόσθ’ ἵππων καὶ δίφρου κεῖτο τανυσθεὶς
βεβρυχὼς κόνιος δεδραγμένος αἱματοέσσης.
ἠΰτε ταῦρον ἔπεφνε λέων ἀγέληφι μετελθὼν
αἴθωνα μεγάθυμον ἐν εἰλιπόδεσσι βόεσσι,
ὤλετό τε στενάχων ὑπὸ γαμφηλῇσι λέοντος,
ὣς ὑπὸ Πατρόκλῳ Λυκίων ἀγὸς ἀσπιστάων
κτεινόμενος μενέαινε, φίλον δ’ ὀνόμηνεν ἑταῖρον·
Γλαῦκε πέπον πολεμιστὰ μετ’ ἀνδράσι νῦν σε μάλα χρὴ
αἰχμητήν τ’ ἔμεναι καὶ θαρσαλέον πολεμιστήν·
νῦν τοι ἐελδέσθω πόλεμος κακός, εἰ θοός ἐσσι.
πρῶτα μὲν ὄτρυνον Λυκίων ἡγήτορας ἄνδρας
πάντῃ ἐποιχόμενος Σαρπηδόνος ἀμφιμάχεσθαι·
αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα καὶ αὐτὸς ἐμεῦ πέρι μάρναο χαλκῷ.
σοὶ γὰρ ἐγὼ καὶ ἔπειτα κατηφείη καὶ ὄνειδος
ἔσσομαι ἤματα πάντα διαμπερές, εἴ κέ μ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
τεύχεα συλήσωσι νεῶν ἐν ἀγῶνι πεσόντα.
ἀλλ’ ἔχεο κρατερῶς, ὄτρυνε δὲ λαὸν ἅπαντα.
ὣς ἄρα μιν εἰπόντα τέλος θανάτοιο κάλυψεν
ὀφθαλμοὺς ῥῖνάς θ’· ὃ δὲ λὰξ ἐν στήθεσι βαίνων
ἐκ χροὸς ἔλκε δόρυ, προτὶ δὲ φρένες αὐτῷ ἔποντο·
τοῖο δ’ ἅμα ψυχήν τε καὶ ἔγχεος ἐξέρυσ’ αἰχμήν.
Μυρμιδόνες δ’ αὐτοῦ σχέθον ἵππους φυσιόωντας
ἰεμένους φοβέεσθαι, ἐπεὶ λίπον ἄρματ’ ἀνάκτων.
Γλαύκῳ δ’ αἰνὸν ἄχος γένετο φθογγῆς ἀΐοντι·
ὠρίνθη δέ οἱ ἦτορ ὅ τ’ οὐ δύνατο προσαμῦναι.
χειρὶ δ’ ἑλὼν ἐπίεζε βραχίονα· τεῖρε γὰρ αὐτὸν

16.511

ἕλκος, ὃ δή μιν Τεῦκρος ἐπεσσύμενον βάλεν ἰῷ
τείχεος ὑψηλοῖο, ἀρὴν ἑτάροισιν ἀμύνων.
εὐχόμενος δ’ ἄρα εἶπεν ἑκηβόλῳ Ἀπόλλωνι·
κλῦθι ἄναξ ὅς που Λυκίης ἐν πίονι δήμῳ
εἷς ἠ ἐνὶ Τροίῃ· δύνασαι δὲ σὺ πάντοσ’ ἀκούειν
ἀνέρι κηδομένῳ, ὡς νῦν ἐμὲ κῆδος ἱκάνει.
ἕλκος μὲν γὰρ ἔχω τόδε καρτερόν, ἀμφὶ δέ μοι χεὶρ
ὀξείῃς ὀδύνῃσιν ἐλήλαται, οὐδέ μοι αἷμα
τερσῆναι δύναται, βαρύθει δέ μοι ὦμος ὑπ’ αὐτοῦ·
ἔγχος δ’ οὐ δύναμαι σχεῖν ἔμπεδον, οὐδὲ μάχεσθαι
ἐλθὼν δυσμενέεσσιν. ἀνὴρ δ’ ὥριστος ὄλωλε
Σαρπηδὼν Διὸς υἱός· ὃ δ’ οὐ οἷ παιδὸς ἀμύνει.
ἀλλὰ σύ πέρ μοι ἄναξ τόδε καρτερὸν ἕλκος ἄκεσσαι,
κοίμησον δ’ ὀδύνας, δὸς δὲ κράτος, ὄφρ’ ἑτάροισι
κεκλόμενος Λυκίοισιν ἐποτρύνω πολεμίζειν,
αὐτός τ’ ἀμφὶ νέκυι κατατεθνηῶτι μάχωμαι.
ὣς ἔφατ’ εὐχόμενος, τοῦ δ’ ἔκλυε Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων.
αὐτίκα παῦσ’ ὀδύνας ἀπὸ δ’ ἕλκεος ἀργαλέοιο
αἷμα μέλαν τέρσηνε, μένος δέ οἱ ἔμβαλε θυμῷ.
Γλαῦκος δ’ ἔγνω ᾗσιν ἐνὶ φρεσὶ γήθησέν τε

ὅττί οἱ ὦκ᾽ ἤκουσε μέγας θεὸς εὐξαμένοιο.
πρῶτα μὲν ὄτρυνεν Λυκίων ἡγήτορας ἄνδρας
πάντῃ ἐποιχόμενος Σαρπηδόνος ἀμφιμάχεσθαι·
αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα μετὰ Τρῶας κίε μακρὰ βιβάσθων
Πουλυδάμαντ᾽ ἔπι Πανθοΐδην καὶ Ἀγήνορα δῖον,
βῆ δὲ μετ᾽ Αἰνείαν τε καὶ Ἕκτορα χαλκοκορυστήν,
ἀγχοῦ δ᾽ ἱστάμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Ἕκτορ νῦν δὴ πάγχυ λελασμένος εἰς ἐπικούρων,
οἳ σέθεν εἵνεκα τῆλε φίλων καὶ πατρίδος αἴης
θυμὸν ἀποφθινύθουσι· σὺ δ᾽ οὐκ ἐθέλεις ἐπαμύνειν.

16.541

κεῖται Σαρπηδὼν Λυκίων ἀγὸς ἀσπιστάων,
ὃς Λυκίην εἴρυτο δίκῃσί τε καὶ σθένεϊ ᾧ·
τὸν δ᾽ ὑπὸ Πατρόκλῳ δάμασ᾽ ἔγχεϊ χάλκεος Ἄρης.
ἀλλὰ φίλοι πάρστητε, νεμεσσήθητε δὲ θυμῷ,
μὴ ἀπὸ τεύχε᾽ ἕλωνται, ἀεικίσσωσι δὲ νεκρὸν
Μυρμιδόνες, Δαναῶν κεχολωμένοι ὅσσοι ὄλοντο,
τοὺς ἐπὶ νηυσὶ θοῇσιν ἐπέφνομεν ἐγχείῃσιν.
ὣς ἔφατο, Τρῶας δὲ κατὰ κρῆθεν λάβε πένθος
ἄσχετον, οὐκ ἐπιεικτόν, ἐπεί σφισιν ἔρμα πόληος
ἔσκε καὶ ἀλλοδαπός περ ἐών· πολέες γὰρ ἅμ᾽ αὐτῷ
λαοὶ ἕποντ᾽, ἐν δ᾽ αὐτὸς ἀριστεύεσκε μάχεσθαι·
βὰν δ᾽ ἰθὺς Δαναῶν λελιημένοι· ἦρχε δ᾽ ἄρά σφιν
Ἕκτωρ χωόμενος Σαρπηδόνος. αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὺς
ὦρσε Μενοιτιάδεω Πατροκλῆος λάσιον κῆρ·
Αἴαντε πρώτω προσέφη μεμαῶτε καὶ αὐτώ·
Αἴαντε νῦν σφῶϊν ἀμύνεσθαι φίλον ἔστω,
οἷοί περ πάρος ἦτε μετ᾽ ἀνδράσιν ἠὲ καὶ ἀρείους.
κεῖται ἀνὴρ ὃς πρῶτος ἐσήλατο τεῖχος Ἀχαιῶν
Σαρπηδών· ἀλλ᾽ εἴ μιν ἀεικισσαίμεθ᾽ ἐλόντες,
τεύχεά τ᾽ ὤμοιιν ἀφελοίμεθα, καί τιν᾽ ἑταίρων
αὐτοῦ ἀμυνομένων δαμασαίμεθα νηλέϊ χαλκῷ.
ὣς ἔφαθ᾽, οἳ δὲ καὶ αὐτοὶ ἀλέξασθαι μενέαινον.
οἳ δ᾽ ἐπεὶ ἀμφοτέρωθεν ἐκαρτύναντο φάλαγγας
Τρῶες καὶ Λύκιοι καὶ Μυρμιδόνες καὶ Ἀχαιοί,
σύμβαλον ἀμφὶ νέκυι κατατεθνηῶτι μάχεσθαι
δεινὸν ἀΰσαντες· μέγα δ᾽ ἔβραχε τεύχεα φωτῶν.
Ζεὺς δ᾽ ἐπὶ νύκτ᾽ ὀλοὴν τάνυσε κρατερῇ ὑσμίνῃ,
ὄφρα φίλῳ περὶ παιδὶ μάχης ὀλοὸς πόνος εἴη.
ὦσαν δὲ πρότεροι Τρῶες ἑλίκωπας Ἀχαιούς·
βλῆτο γὰρ οὔ τι κάκιστος ἀνὴρ μετὰ Μυρμιδόνεσσιν

As he spoke the Trojans were plunged in extreme and ungovernable grief [penthos]; for Sarpedon, alien though he was, had been one of the main stays of their city, both as having many people with him, and himself the foremost among them all. Led by Hektor, who was infuriated by the fall of Sarpedon, they made instantly for the Danaans with all their might, while the undaunted spirit of Patroklos son of Menoitios cheered on the Achaeans. First he spoke to the two Ajaxes, men who needed no bidding. "Ajaxes," said he, "may it now please you to show yourselves the men you have always been, or even better- Sarpedon is fallen - he who was first to overleap the wall of the Achaeans; let us take the body and outrage it; let us strip the armor from his shoulders, and kill his comrades if they try to rescue his

body." He spoke to men who of themselves were full eager; both sides, therefore, the Trojans and Lycians on the one hand, and the Myrmidons and Achaeans on the other, strengthened their battalions, and fought desperately about the body of Sarpedon, shouting fiercely the while. Mighty was the din of their armor as they came together, and Zeus shed a thick darkness over the fight, to increase the ordeal [ponos] of the battle over the body of his son. At first the Trojans made some headway against the Achaeans, for one of the best men among the Myrmidons was killed, Epeigeus, son of noble Agakles who had erewhile been king in the good city of Boudeion; but presently, having killed a valiant kinsman of his own, he took refuge with Peleus and Thetis, who sent him to Ilion the land of noble steeds to fight the Trojans under Achilles. Hektor now struck him on the head with a stone just as he had caught hold of the body, and his brains inside his helmet were all battered in, so that he fell face foremost upon the body of Sarpedon, and there died. Patroklos was enraged with grief [akhos] over by the death of his comrade, and sped through the front ranks as swiftly as a hawk that swoops down on a flock of daws or starlings. Even so swiftly, O noble horseman Patroklos, did you make straight for the Lycians and Trojans to avenge your comrade. Forthwith he struck Sthenelaos the son of Ithaimenes on the neck with a stone, and broke the tendons that join it to the head and spine. On this Hektor and the front rank of his men gave ground. As far as a man can throw a javelin in competition [athlos] for some prize, or even in battle - so far did the Trojans now retreat before the Achaeans. Glaukos, leader of the Lycians, was the first to rally them, by killing Bathykles son of Khalkon who lived in Hellas and was supreme in wealth [olbos] among the Myrmidons. Glaukos turned round suddenly, just as Bathykles who was pursuing him was about to lay hold of him, and drove his spear right into the middle of his chest, whereon he fell heavily to the ground, and the fall of so good a man filled the Achaeans with dismay [akhos], while the Trojans were exultant, and came up in a body round the corpse. Nevertheless the Achaeans, mindful of their prowess, bore straight down upon them. Meriones then killed a helmed warrior of the Trojans, Laogonos son of Onetor, who was priest of Zeus of Mount Ida, and was honored in the district [dêmos] as though he were a god. Meriones struck him under the jaw and ear, so that life went out of him and the darkness of death laid hold upon him. Aeneas then aimed a spear at Meriones, hoping to hit him under the shield as he was advancing, but Meriones saw it coming and stooped forward to avoid it, whereon the spear flew past him and the point stuck in the ground, while the butt-end went on quivering till Ares robbed it of its force. The spear, therefore, sped from Aeneas' hand in vain and fell quivering to the ground. Aeneas was angry and said, "Meriones, you are a good dancer, but if I had hit you my spear would soon have made an end of you." And Meriones answered, "Aeneas, for all your bravery, you will not be able to make an end of every one who comes against you. You are only a mortal like myself, and if I were to hit you in the middle of your shield with my spear, however strong and self-confident you may be, I should soon vanquish you, and you would yield your life-breath [psukhê] to Hades of the noble steeds." On this the son of Menoitios rebuked him and said, "Meriones, hero though you be, you should not speak thus; taunting speeches, my good friend, will not make the Trojans draw away from the dead body; some of them must go under ground first; the outcome [telos] of battle is in the force of hands, while the outcome of deliberation is words; fight, therefore, and say nothing." He led the way as he spoke and the hero went forward with him. As the sound of woodcutters in some forest glade upon the mountains- and the thud of their axes is heard afar - even such a din now rose from earth-clash of bronze armor and of good ox-hide shields, as men smote each other with their swords and spears pointed at both ends. A man had need of good eyesight now to know Sarpedon, so covered was he from head to foot with spears and blood and dust. Men swarmed about the body, as flies that buzz round the full milk-pails in the season [hôra] of spring when they are brimming with milk - even so did they gather round Sarpedon; nor did Zeus turn his keen eyes away for one moment from

the fight, but kept looking at it all the time, for he was settling how best to kill Patroklos, and considering whether Hektor should be allowed to end him now in the fight round the body of Sarpedon, and strip him of his armor, or whether he should let him give yet further trouble [ponos] to the Trojans. In the end, he deemed it best that the brave squire [therapôn] of Achilles son of Peleus should drive Hektor and the Trojans back towards the city and take the lives of many. First, therefore, he made Hektor turn fainthearted, whereon he mounted his chariot and fled, bidding the other Trojans flee also,

16.571

571 υἱὸς Ἀγακλῆος μεγαθύμου δῖος Ἐπειγεύς,
572 ὅς ῥ’ ἐν Βουδείῳ εὖ ναιομένῳ ἤνασσε
573 τὸ πρίν· ἀτὰρ τότε γ’ ἐσθλὸν ἀνεψιὸν ἐξεναρίξας
574 ἐς Πηλῆ’ ἱκέτευσε καὶ ἐς Θέτιν ἀργυρόπεζαν·
575 οἳ δ’ ἄμ’ Ἀχιλλῆϊ ῥηξήνορι πέμπον ἕπεσθαι
576 Ἴλιον εἰς εὔπωλον, ἵνα Τρώεσσι μάχοιτο.
577 τόν ῥα τόθ’ ἁπτόμενον νέκυος βάλε φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
578 χερμαδίῳ κεφαλήν· ἠ δ’ ἄνδιχα πᾶσα κεάσθη
579 ἐν κόρυθι βριαρῇ· ὃ δ’ ἄρα πρηνὴς ἐπὶ νεκρῷ
580 κάππεσεν, ἀμφὶ δέ μιν θάνατος χύτο θυμοραϊστής.
581 Πατρόκλῳ δ’ ἄρ’ ἄχος γένετο φθιμένου ἑτάροιο,
582 ἴθυσεν δὲ διὰ προμάχων ἴρηκι ἐοικὼς
583 ὠκέϊ, ὅς τ’ ἐφόβησε κολοιούς τε ψῆράς τε·
584 ὣς ἰθὺς Λυκίων Πατρόκλεες ἱπποκέλευθε
585 ἔσσυο καὶ Τρώων, κεχόλωσο δὲ κῆρ ἑτάροιο.
586 καί ῥ’ ἔβαλε Σθενέλαον Ἰθαιμένεος φίλον υἱὸν
587 αὐχένα χερμαδίῳ, ῥῆξεν δ’ ἀπὸ τοῖο τένοντας.
588 χώρησαν δ’ ὑπό τε πρόμαχοι καὶ φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ.
589 ὅσση δ’ αἰγανέης ῥιπὴ ταναοῖο τέτυκται,
590 ἥν ῥά τ’ ἀνὴρ ἀφέῃ πειρώμενος ἢ ἐν ἀέθλῳ
591 ἠὲ καὶ ἐν πολέμῳ δηΐων ὕπο θυμοραϊστέων,
592 τόσσον ἐχώρησαν Τρῶες, ὤσαντο δ’ Ἀχαιοί.
593 Γλαῦκος δὲ πρῶτος Λυκίων ἀγὸς ἀσπιστάων
594 ἐτράπετ’, ἔκτεινεν δὲ Βαθυκλῆα μεγάθυμον
595 Χάλκωνος φίλον υἱόν, ὃς Ἑλλάδι οἰκία ναίων
596 ὄλβῳ τε πλούτῳ τε μετέπρεπε Μυρμιδόνεσσι.
597 τὸν μὲν ἄρα Γλαῦκος στῆθος μέσον οὔτασε δουρὶ
598 στρεφθεὶς ἐξαπίνης, ὅτε μιν κατέμαρπτε διώκων·
599 δούπησεν δὲ πεσών· πυκινὸν δ’ ἄχος ἔλλαβ’ Ἀχαιούς,
600 ὡς ἔπεσ’ ἐσθλὸς ἀνήρ· μέγα δὲ Τρῶες κεχάροντο,

16.601

601 στὰν δ’ ἀμφ’ αὐτὸν ἰόντες ἀολλέες· οὐδ’ ἄρ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
602 ἀλκῆς ἐξελάθοντο, μένος δ’ ἰθὺς φέρον αὐτῶν.
603 ἔνθ’ αὖ Μηριόνης Τρώων ἔλεν ἄνδρα κορυστὴν
604 Λαόγονον θρασὺν υἱὸν Ὀνήτορος, ὃς Διὸς ἱρεὺς
605 Ἰδαίου ἐτέτυκτο, θεὸς δ’ ὣς τίετο δήμῳ.
606 τὸν βάλ’ ὑπὸ γναθμοῖο καὶ οὔατος· ὦκα δὲ θυμὸς
607 ὤχετ’ ἀπὸ μελέων, στυγερὸς δ’ ἄρα μιν σκότος εἶλεν.
608 Αἰνείας δ’ ἐπὶ Μηριόνῃ δόρυ χάλκεον ἧκεν·
609 ἔλπετο γὰρ τεύξεσθαι ὑπασπίδια προβιβῶντος.

ἀλλ᾽ ὃ μὲν ἄντα ἰδὼν ἠλεύατο χάλκεον ἔγχος·
πρόσσω γὰρ κατέκυψε, τὸ δ᾽ ἐξόπιθεν δόρυ μακρὸν
οὔδει ἐνισκίμφθη, ἐπὶ δ᾽ οὐρίαχος πελεμίχθη
ἔγχεος· ἔνθα δ᾽ ἔπειτ᾽ ἀφίει μένος ὄβριμος Ἄρης.
αἰχμὴ δ᾽ Αἰνείαο κραδαινομένη κατὰ γαίης
ὤχετ᾽, ἐπεί ῥ᾽ ἄλιον στιβαρῆς ἀπὸ χειρὸς ὄρουσεν.
Αἰνείας δ᾽ ἄρα θυμὸν ἐχώσατο φώνησέν τε·
Μηριόνη τάχα κέν σε καὶ ὀρχηστήν περ ἐόντα
ἔγχος ἐμὸν κατέπαυσε διαμπερές, εἴ σ᾽ ἔβαλόν περ.
τὸν δ᾽ αὖ Μηριόνης δουρικλυτὸς ἀντίον ηὔδα·
Αἰνεία χαλεπόν σε καὶ ἴφθιμόν περ ἐόντα
πάντων ἀνθρώπων σβέσσαι μένος, ὅς κέ σευ ἄντα
ἔλθῃ ἀμυνόμενος· θνητὸς δέ νυ καὶ σὺ τέτυξαι.
εἰ καὶ ἐγώ σε βάλοιμι τυχὼν μέσον ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ,
αἶψά κε καὶ κρατερός περ ἐὼν καὶ χερσὶ πεποιθὼς
εὖχος ἐμοὶ δοίης, ψυχὴν δ᾽ Ἄϊδι κλυτοπώλῳ.
ὣς φάτο, τὸν δ᾽ ἐνένιπε Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμος υἱός·
Μηριόνη τί σὺ ταῦτα καὶ ἐσθλὸς ἐὼν ἀγορεύεις;
ὦ πέπον οὔ τοι Τρῶες ὀνειδείοις ἐπέεσσι
νεκροῦ χωρήσουσι· πάρος τινὰ γαῖα καθέξει.
ἐν γὰρ χερσὶ τέλος πολέμου, ἐπέων δ᾽ ἐνὶ βουλῇ·

16.631

τὼ οὔ τι χρὴ μῦθον ὀφέλλειν, ἀλλὰ μάχεσθαι.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὃ μὲν ἦρχ᾽, ὃ δ᾽ ἅμ᾽ ἕσπετο ἰσόθεος φώς.
τῶν δ᾽ ὥς τε δρυτόμων ἀνδρῶν ὀρυμαγδὸς ὀρώρει
οὔρεος ἐν βήσσῃς, ἔκαθεν δέ τε γίγνετ᾽ ἀκουή,
ὣς τῶν ὄρνυτο δοῦπος ἀπὸ χθονὸς εὐρυοδείης
χαλκοῦ τε ῥινοῦ τε βοῶν τ᾽ εὐποιητάων,
νυσσομένων ξίφεσίν τε καὶ ἔγχεσιν ἀμφιγύοισιν.
οὐδ᾽ ἂν ἔτι φράδμων περ ἀνὴρ Σαρπηδόνα δῖον
ἔγνω, ἐπεὶ βελέεσσι καὶ αἵματι καὶ κονίῃσιν
ἐκ κεφαλῆς εἴλυτο διαμπερὲς ἐς πόδας ἄκρους.
οἳ δ᾽ αἰεὶ περὶ νεκρὸν ὁμίλεον, ὡς ὅτε μυῖαι
σταθμῷ ἔνι βρομέωσι περιγλαγέας κατὰ πέλλας
ὥρῃ ἐν εἰαρινῇ, ὅτε τε γλάγος ἄγγεα δεύει·
ὣς ἄρα τοὶ περὶ νεκρὸν ὁμίλεον, οὐδέ ποτε Ζεὺς
τρέψεν ἀπὸ κρατερῆς ὑσμίνης ὄσσε φαεινώ,
ἀλλὰ κατ᾽ αὐτοὺς αἰὲν ὅρα καὶ φράζετο θυμῷ,
πολλὰ μάλ᾽ ἀμφὶ φόνῳ Πατρόκλου μερμηρίζων,
ἢ ἤδη καὶ κεῖνον ἐνὶ κρατερῇ ὑσμίνῃ
αὐτοῦ ἐπ᾽ ἀντιθέῳ Σαρπηδόνι φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
χαλκῷ δηώσῃ, ἀπό τ᾽ ὤμων τεύχε᾽ ἕληται,
ἦ ἔτι καὶ πλεόνεσσιν ὀφέλλειεν πόνον αἰπύν.
ὧδε δέ οἱ φρονέοντι δοάσσατο κέρδιον εἶναι
ὅφρ᾽ ἠὺς θεράπων Πηληϊάδεω Ἀχιλῆος
ἐξαῦτις Τρῶάς τε καὶ Ἕκτορα χαλκοκορυστὴν
ὤσαιτο προτὶ ἄστυ, πολέων δ᾽ ἀπὸ θυμὸν ἔλοιτο.
Ἕκτορι δὲ πρωτίστῳ ἀνάλκιδα θυμὸν ἐνῆκεν·
ἐς δίφρον δ᾽ ἀναβὰς φύγαδ᾽ ἔτραπε, κέκλετο δ᾽ ἄλλους
Τρῶας φευγέμεναι· γνῶ γὰρ Διὸς ἱρὰ τάλαντα.

659 ἔνθ’ οὐδ’ ἴφθιμοι Λύκιοι μένον, ἀλλὰ φόβηθεν
660 πάντες, ἐπεὶ βασιλῆα ἴδον βεβλαμμένον ἦτορ
for he saw that the scales of Zeus had turned against him. Neither would the brave Lycians stand firm; they were dismayed when they saw their king lying struck to the heart amid a heap of corpses - for when the son of Kronos made the fight wax hot many had fallen above him. The Achaeans, therefore stripped the gleaming armor from his shoulders and the brave son of Menoitios gave it to his men to take to the ships. Then Zeus lord of the storm-cloud said to Apollo, "Dear Phoebus, go, I pray you, and take Sarpedon out of range of the weapons; cleanse the black blood from off him, and then bear him a long way off where you may wash him in the river, anoint him with ambrosia, and clothe him in immortal raiment; this done, commit him to the arms of the two fleet messengers, Death, and Sleep, who will carry him straightway to the fertile district [dêmos] of Lycia, where his brothers and kinsmen will give him a funeral, and will raise both mound and pillar to his memory, in due honor to the dead." Thus he spoke. Apollo obeyed his father's saying, and came down from the heights of Ida into the thick of the fight; forthwith he took Sarpedon out of range of the weapons, and then bore him a long way off, where he washed him in the river, anointed him with ambrosia and clothed him in immortal raiment; this done, he committed him to the arms of the two fleet messengers, Death and Sleep, who presently set him down in the fertile district [dêmos] of Lycia. Meanwhile Patroklos, with many a shout to his horses and to Automedon, pursued the Trojans and Lycians in the pride and foolishness of his heart. Had he but obeyed the bidding of the son of Peleus, he would have, escaped death and have been scatheless; but the counsels [noos] of Zeus pass man's understanding; he will put even a brave man to flight and snatch victory from his grasp, or again he will set him on to fight, as he now did when he put a high spirit into the heart of Patroklos. Who then first, and who last, was slain by you, O Patroklos, when the gods had now called you to meet your doom? First Adrastos, Autonoos, Echeklos, Perimos the son of Megas, Epistor and Melanippos; after these he killed Elasus, Moulios, and Pylartes. These he slew, but the rest saved themselves by flight. The sons of the Achaeans would now have taken Troy by the hands of Patroklos, for his spear flew in all directions, had not Phoebus Apollo taken his stand upon the wall to defeat his purpose and to aid the Trojans. Thrice did Patroklos charge at an angle of the high wall, and thrice did Apollo beat him back, striking his shield with his own immortal hands. When Patroklos was coming on like a daimôn for yet a fourth time, Apollo shouted to him with an awful voice and said, "Draw back, noble Patroklos, it is not your lot to sack the city of the Trojan chieftains, nor yet will it be that of Achilles who is a far better man than you are." On hearing this, Patroklos withdrew to some distance and avoided the anger [mênis] of Apollo. Meanwhile Hektor was waiting with his horses inside the Scaean gates, in doubt whether to drive out again and go on fighting, or to call the army inside the gates. As he was thus doubting Phoebus Apollo drew near him in the likeness of a young and lusty warrior Asios, who was Hektor's uncle, being own brother to Hecuba, and son of Dymas who lived in Phrygia by the waters of the river Sangarios; in his likeness Zeus' son Apollo now spoke to Hektor saying, "Hektor, why have you left off fighting? It is ill done of you. If I were as much better a man than you, as I am worse, you should soon rue your slackness. Drive straight towards Patroklos, if so be that Apollo may grant you a triumph over him, and you may kill him." With this the god went back into the struggle [ponos], and Hektor bade Kebriones drive again into the fight. Apollo passed in among them, and struck panic into the Argives, while he gave triumph to Hektor and the Trojans. Hektor let the other Danaans alone and killed no man, but drove straight at Patroklos. Patroklos then sprang from his chariot to the ground, with a spear in his left hand, and in his right a jagged stone as large as his hand could hold. He stood still and threw it, nor did it go far without hitting some one; the cast was not in vain, for the stone struck Kebriones, Hektor's charioteer, a bastard son of Priam, as he held the reins in his hands. The stone hit him on

the forehead and drove his brows into his head for the bone was smashed, and his eyes fell to the ground at his feet. He dropped dead from his chariot as though he were diving, and there was no more life left in him. Over him did you then vaunt, O horseman Patroklos, saying, "Bless my heart, how active he is, and how well he dives. If we had been at sea [pontos] this man would have dived from the ship's side and brought up as many oysters as the whole crew could stomach, even in rough water, for he has dived beautifully off his chariot on to the ground. It seems, then, that there are divers also among the Trojans."

16.661

κείμενον ἐν νεκύων ἀγύρει· πολέες γὰρ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ
κάππεσον, εὖτ’ ἔριδα κρατερὴν ἐτάνυσσε Κρονίων.
οἳ δ’ ἄρ’ ἀπ’ ὤμοιιν Σαρπηδόνος ἔντε’ ἔλοντο
χάλκεα μαρμαίροντα, τὰ μὲν κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας
δῶκε φέρειν ἑτάροισι Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμος υἱός.
καὶ τότ’ Ἀπόλλωνα προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
εἰ δ’ ἄγε νῦν φίλε Φοῖβε, κελαινεφὲς αἷμα κάθηρον
ἐλθὼν ἐκ βελέων Σαρπηδόνα, καί μιν ἔπειτα
πολλὸν ἀπὸ πρὸ φέρων λοῦσον ποταμοῖο ῥοῇσι
χρῖσόν τ’ ἀμβροσίῃ, περὶ δ’ ἄμβροτα εἵματα ἕσσον·
πέμπε δέ μιν ὀμπνοῖσιν ἅμα κραιπνοῖσι φέρεσθαι
ὕπνῳ καὶ θανάτῳ διδυμάοσιν, οἵ ῥά μιν ὦκα
θήσουσ’ ἐν Λυκίης εὐρείης πίονι δήμῳ,
ἔνθά ἑ ταρχύσουσι κασίγνητοί τε ἕταί τε
τύμβῳ τε στήλῃ τε· τὸ γὰρ γέρας ἐστὶ θανόντων.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἄρα πατρὸς ἀνηκούστησεν Ἀπόλλων.
βῆ δὲ κατ’ Ἰδαίων ὀρέων ἐς φύλοπιν αἰνήν,
αὐτίκα δ’ ἐκ βελέων Σαρπηδόνα δῖον ἀείρας
πολλὸν ἀπὸ πρὸ φέρων λοῦσεν ποταμοῖο ῥοῇσι
χρῖσέν τ’ ἀμβροσίῃ, περὶ δ’ ἄμβροτα εἵματα ἕσσε·
πέμπε δέ μιν ὀμπνοῖσιν ἅμα κραιπνοῖσι φέρεσθαι,
ὕπνῳ καὶ θανάτῳ διδυμάοσιν, οἵ ῥά μιν ὦκα
κάτθεσαν ἐν Λυκίης εὐρείης πίονι δήμῳ.
Πάτροκλος δ’ ἵπποισι καὶ Αὐτομέδοντι κελεύσας
Τρῶας καὶ Λυκίους μετεκίαθε, καὶ μέγ’ ἀάσθη
νήπιος· εἰ δὲ ἔπος Πηληϊάδαο φύλαξεν
ἦ τ’ ἂν ὑπέκφυγε κῆρα κακὴν μέλανος θανάτοιο.
ἀλλ’ αἰεί τε Διὸς κρείσσων νόος ἠέ περ ἀνδρῶν·
ὅς τε καὶ ἄλκιμον ἄνδρα φοβεῖ καὶ ἀφείλετο νίκην
ῥηϊδίως, ὅτε δ’ αὐτὸς ἐποτρύνῃσι μάχεσθαι·

16.691

ὅς οἱ καὶ τότε θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἀνῆκεν.
ἔνθα τίνα πρῶτον τίνα δ’ ὕστατον ἐξενάριξας
Πατρόκλεις, ὅτε δή σε θεοὶ θάνατον δὲ κάλεσσαν;
Ἄδρηστον μὲν πρῶτα καὶ Αὐτόνοον καὶ Ἔχεκλον
καὶ Πέριμον Μεγάδην καὶ Ἐπίστορα καὶ Μελάνιππον,
αὐτὰρ ἔπειτ’ Ἔλασον καὶ Μούλιον ἠδὲ Πυλάρτην·
τοὺς ἔλεν· οἳ δ’ ἄλλοι φύγαδε μνώοντο ἕκαστος.
ἔνθά κεν ὑψίπυλον Τροίην ἕλον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
Πατρόκλου ὑπὸ χερσί, περὶ πρὸ γὰρ ἔγχεϊ θῦεν,

εἰ μὴ Ἀπόλλων Φοῖβος ἐϋδμήτου ἐπὶ πύργου
ἔστη τῷ ὀλοὰ φρονέων, Τρώεσσι δ’ ἀρήγων.
τρὶς μὲν ἐπ’ ἀγκῶνος βῆ τείχεος ὑψηλοῖο
Πάτροκλος, τρὶς δ’ αὐτὸν ἀπεστυφέλιξεν Ἀπόλλων
χείρεσσ’ ἀθανάτῃσι φαεινὴν ἀσπίδα νύσσων.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ τὸ τέταρτον ἐπέσσυτο δαίμονι ἶσος,
δεινὰ δ’ ὁμοκλήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
χάζεο διογενὲς Πατρόκλεες· οὔ νύ τοι αἶσα
σῷ ὑπὸ δουρὶ πόλιν πέρθαι Τρώων ἀγερώχων,
οὐδ’ ὑπ’ Ἀχιλλῆος, ὅς περ σέο πολλὸν ἀμείνων.
ὣς φάτο, Πάτροκλος δ’ ἀνεχάζετο πολλὸν ὀπίσσω
μῆνιν ἀλευάμενος ἑκατηβόλου Ἀπόλλωνος.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ἐν Σκαιῇσι πύλῃς ἔχε μώνυχας ἵππους·
δίζε γὰρ ἠὲ μάχοιτο κατὰ κλόνον αὖτις ἐλάσσας,
ἦ λαοὺς ἐς τεῖχος ὁμοκλήσειεν ἀλῆναι.
ταῦτ’ ἄρα οἱ φρονέοντι παρίστατο Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων
ἀνέρι εἰσάμενος αἰζηῷ τε κρατερῷ τε
Ἀσίῳ, ὃς μήτρως ἦν Ἕκτορος ἱπποδάμοιο
αὐτοκασίγνητος Ἑκάβης, υἱὸς δὲ Δύμαντος,
ὃς Φρυγίῃ ναίεσκε ῥοῇς ἔπι Σαγγαρίοιο·
τῷ μιν ἐεισάμενος προσέφη Διὸς υἱὸς Ἀπόλλων·

16.721

Ἕκτορ τίπτε μάχης ἀποπαύεαι; οὐδέ τί σε χρή.
αἴθ’ ὅσον ἥσσων εἰμί, τόσον σέο φέρτερος εἴην·
τώ κε τάχα στυγερῶς πολέμου ἀπερωήσειας.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε Πατρόκλῳ ἔφεπε κρατερώνυχας ἵππους,
αἴ κέν πώς μιν ἕλῃς, δώῃ δέ τοι εὖχος Ἀπόλλων.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὃ μὲν αὖτις ἔβη θεὸς ἂμ πόνον ἀνδρῶν,
Κεβριόνῃ δ’ ἐκέλευσε δαΐφρονι φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
ἵππους ἐς πόλεμον πεπληγέμεν. αὐτὰρ Ἀπόλλων
δύσεθ’ ὅμιλον ἰών, ἐν δὲ κλόνον Ἀργείοισιν
ἧκε κακόν, Τρωσὶν δὲ καὶ Ἕκτορι κῦδος ὄπαζεν.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ἄλλους μὲν Δαναοὺς ἔα οὐδ’ ἐνάριζεν·
αὐτὰρ ὃ Πατρόκλῳ ἔφεπε κρατερώνυχας ἵππους.
Πάτροκλος δ’ ἐτέρωθεν ἀφ’ ἵππων ἅλτο χαμᾶζε
σκαιῇ ἔγχος ἔχων· ἑτέρηφι δὲ λάζετο πέτρον
μάρμαρον ὀκριόεντα τόν οἱ περὶ χεὶρ ἐκάλυψεν,
ἧκε δ’ ἐρεισάμενος, οὐδὲ δὴν χάζετο φωτός,
οὐδ’ ἀλίωσε βέλος, βάλε δ’ Ἕκτορος ἡνιοχῆα
Κεβριόνην νόθον υἱὸν ἀγακλῆος Πριάμοιο
ἵππων ἡνί’ ἔχοντα μετώπιον ὀξέϊ λᾶϊ.
ἀμφοτέρας δ’ ὀφρῦς σύνελεν λίθος, οὐδέ οἱ ἔσχεν
ὀστέον, ὀφθαλμοὶ δὲ χαμαὶ πέσον ἐν κονίῃσιν
αὐτοῦ πρόσθε ποδῶν· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ἀρνευτῆρι ἐοικὼς
κάππεσ’ ἀπ’ εὐεργέος δίφρου, λίπε δ’ ὀστέα θυμός.
τὸν δ’ ἐπικερτομέων προσέφης Πατρόκλεες ἱππεῦ·
ὢ πόποι ἦ μάλ’ ἐλαφρὸς ἀνήρ, ὡς ῥεῖα κυβιστᾷ.
εἰ δή που καὶ πόντῳ ἐν ἰχθυόεντι γένοιτο,
πολλοὺς ἂν κορέσειεν ἀνὴρ ὅδε τήθεα διφῶν
νηὸς ἀποθρῴσκων, εἰ καὶ δυσπέμφελος εἴη,

749 ὡς νῦν ἐν πεδίῳ ἐξ ἵππων ῥεῖα κυβιστᾷ.
750 ἦ ῥα καὶ ἐν Τρώεσσι κυβιστητῆρες ἔασιν.

16.751

751 ὣς εἰπὼν ἐπὶ Κεβριόνῃ ἥρωϊ βεβήκει
752 οἶμα λέοντος ἔχων, ὅς τε σταθμοὺς κεραΐζων
753 ἔβλητο πρὸς στῆθος, ἑή τέ μιν ὤλεσεν ἀλκή·
754 ὣς ἐπὶ Κεβριόνῃ Πατρόκλεες ἅλσο μεμαώς.
755 Ἕκτωρ δ’ αὖθ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἀφ’ ἵππων ἅλτο χαμᾶζε.
756 τὼ περὶ Κεβριόναο λέονθ’ ὡς δηρινθήτην,
757 ὥ τ’ ὄρεος κορυφῇσι περὶ κταμένης ἐλάφοιο
758 ἄμφω πεινάοντε μέγα φρονέοντε μάχεσθον·
759 ὣς περὶ Κεβριόναο δύω μήστωρες ἀϋτῆς
760 Πάτροκλός τε Μενοιτιάδης καὶ φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
761 ἴεντ’ ἀλλήλων ταμέειν χρόα νηλέϊ χαλκῷ.
762 Ἕκτωρ μὲν κεφαλῆφιν ἐπεὶ λάβεν οὐχὶ μεθίει·
763 Πάτροκλος δ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἔχεν ποδός· οἳ δὲ δὴ ἄλλοι
764 Τρῶες καὶ Δαναοὶ σύναγον κρατερὴν ὑσμίνην.
765 ὡς δ’ Εὖρός τε Νότος τ’ ἐριδαίνετον ἀλλήλοιιν
766 οὔρεος ἐν βήσσῃς βαθέην πελεμιζέμεν ὕλην
767 φηγόν τε μελίην τε τανύφλοιόν τε κράνειαν,
768 αἵ τε πρὸς ἀλλήλας ἔβαλον τανυήκεας ὄζους
769 ἠχῇ θεσπεσίῃ, πάταγος δέ τε ἀγνυμενάων,
770 ὣς Τρῶες καὶ Ἀχαιοὶ ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισι θορόντες
771 δῄουν, οὐδ’ ἔτεροι μνώοντ’ ὀλοοῖο φόβοιο.
772 πολλὰ δὲ Κεβριόνην ἀμφ’ ὀξέα δοῦρα πεπήγει
773 ἰοί τε πτερόεντες ἀπὸ νευρῆφι θορόντες,
774 πολλὰ δὲ χερμάδια μεγάλ’ ἀσπίδας ἐστυφέλιξαν
775 μαρναμένων ἀμφ’ αὐτόν· ὃ δ’ ἐν στροφάλιγγι κονίης
776 κεῖτο μέγας μεγαλωστί, λελασμένος ἱπποσυνάων.
777 ὄφρα μὲν Ἠέλιος μέσον οὐρανὸν ἀμφιβεβήκει,
778 τόφρα μάλ’ ἀμφοτέρων βέλε’ ἵπτετο, πῖπτε δὲ λαός·
779 ἦμος δ’ Ἠέλιος μετενίσετο βουλυτὸν δέ,
780 καὶ τότε δή ῥ’ ὑπὲρ αἶσαν Ἀχαιοὶ φέρτεροι ἦσαν.
As he spoke he flung himself on Kebriones with the spring, as it were, of a lion that while attacking a stockyard is himself struck in the chest, and his courage is his own bane - even so furiously, O Patroklos, did you then spring upon Kebriones. Hektor sprang also from his chariot to the ground. The pair then fought over the body of Kebriones. As two lions fight fiercely on some high mountain over the body of a stag that they have killed, even so did these two mighty warriors, Patroklos son of Menoitios and brave Hektor, hack and hew at one another over the corpse of Kebriones. Hektor would not let him go when he had once got him by the head, while Patroklos kept fast hold of his feet, and a fierce fight raged between the other Danaans and Trojans. As the east and south wind buffet one another when they beat upon some dense forest on the mountains - there is beech and ash and spreading cornel; the to of the trees roar as they beat on one another, and one can hear the boughs cracking and breaking - even so did the Trojans and Achaeans spring upon one another and lay about each other, and neither side would give way. Many a pointed spear fell to ground and many a winged arrow sped from its bow-string about the body of Kebriones; many a great stone, moreover, beat on many a shield as they fought around his body, but there he lay in the whirling clouds of dust, all huge and hugely, heedless of his driving now. So long as the sun was still high in mid-heaven the weapons of either side

were alike deadly, and the people fell; but when he went down towards the time when men loose their oxen, the Achaeans proved to be beyond all forecast stronger, so that they drew Kebriones out of range of the darts and tumult of the Trojans, and stripped the armor from his shoulders. Then Patroklos sprang like Ares with fierce intent and a terrific shout upon the Trojans, and thrice did he kill nine men; but as he was coming on like a daimôn for a time, at that moment, O Patroklos, was your doom approaching, for Phoebus fought you in fell earnest. Patroklos did not see him as he moved about in the crush, for he was enshrouded in thick darkness, and the god struck him from behind on his back and his broad shoulders with the flat of his hand, so that his eyes turned dizzy. Phoebus Apollo beat the helmet from off his head, and it rolled rattling off under the horses' feet, where its horse-hair plumes were all begrimed with dust and blood. Before this, it would not have been right [themis] for this to happen. For before, this helmet had served to protect the head and comely forehead of the godlike hero Achilles. Now, however, Zeus delivered it over to be worn by Hektor. Nevertheless the end of Hektor also was near. The bronze-shod spear, so great and so strong, was broken in the hand of Patroklos, while his shield that covered him from head to foot fell to the ground as did also the band that held it, and Apollo undid the fastenings of his corselet. At this his mind became clouded in derangement [atê]; his limbs failed him, and he stood as one dazed; whereon Euphorbos son of Panthoos, a Dardanian, the best spearman of his time, as also the finest horseman and fleetest runner, came behind him and struck him in the back with a spear, midway between the shoulders. This man as soon as ever he had come up with his chariot had dismounted twenty men, so proficient was he in all the arts of war - he it was, O horseman Patroklos, that first drove a weapon into you, but he did not quite overpower you. Euphorbos then ran back into the crowd, after drawing his ashen spear out of the wound; he would not stand firm and wait for Patroklos, unarmed though he now was, to attack him; but Patroklos unnerved, alike by the blow the god had given him and by the spear-wound, drew back under cover of his men in fear for his life. Hektor on this, seeing him to be wounded and giving ground, forced his way through the ranks, and when close up with him struck him in the lower part of the belly with a spear, driving the bronze point right through it, so that he fell heavily to the ground to the great of the Achaeans. As when a lion has fought some fierce wild-boar and worsted him - the two fight furiously upon the mountains over some little fountain at which they would both drink, and the lion has beaten the boar till he can hardly breathe - even so did Hektor son of Priam take the life of the brave son of Menoitios who had killed so many, striking him from close at hand, and vaunting over him the while. "Patroklos," said he, "you deemed that you should sack our city, rob our Trojan women of their freedom, and carry them off in your ships to your own country. Fool; Hektor and his fleet horses were ever straining their utmost to defend them. I am foremost of all the Trojan warriors to stave the day of bondage from off them; as for you, vultures shall devour you here. Poor wretch, Achilles with all his bravery availed you nothing; and yet I ween when you left him he charged you straitly saying, ‘Come not back to the ships, horseman Patroklos, till you have rent the bloodstained shirt of murderous Hektor about his body. Thus I ween did he charge you, and your fool's heart answered him ‘yea’ within you." Then, as the life ebbed out of you, you answered, O horseman Patroklos: "Hektor, vaunt as you will, for Zeus the son of Kronos and Apollo have granted you victory; it is they who have vanquished me so easily, and they who have stripped the armor from my shoulders; had twenty such men as you attacked me, all of them would have fallen before my spear. Fate and the son of Leto have overpowered me, and among mortal men Euphorbos; you are yourself third only in the killing of me. I say further, and lay my saying to your heart, you too shall live but for a little season; death and the day of your doom are close upon you, and they will lay you low by the hand of Achilles son of Aiakos." When he had thus spoken his eyes were closed in the doom [telos] of death, his life-breath [psukhê] left his body and flitted down to the house of

Hades, mourning its sad fate and bidding farewell to the youth and vigor of its manhood. Dead though he was, Hektor still spoke to him saying, "Patroklos, why should you thus foretell my doom? Who knows but Achilles, son of lovely Thetis, may be smitten by my spear and die before me?" As he spoke he drew the bronze spear from the wound, planting his foot upon the body, which he thrust off and let lie on its back. He then went spear in hand after Automedon, squire [therapôn] of the fleet descendant of Aiakos, for he longed to lay him low, but the immortal steeds which the gods had given as a rich gift to Peleus bore him swiftly from the field.

16.781

ἐκ μὲν Κεβριόνην βελέων ἥρωα ἔρυσσαν
Τρώων ἐξ ἐνοπῆς, καὶ ἀπ’ ὤμων τεύχε’ ἔλοντο,
Πάτροκλος δὲ Τρωσὶ κακὰ φρονέων ἐνόρουσε.
τρὶς μὲν ἔπειτ’ ἐπόρουσε θοῷ ἀτάλαντος Ἄρηϊ
σμερδαλέα ἰάχων, τρὶς δ’ ἐννέα φῶτας ἔπεφνεν.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ τὸ τέταρτον ἐπέσσυτο δαίμονι ἶσος,
ἔνθ’ ἄρα τοι Πάτροκλε φάνη βιότοιο τελευτή·
ἤντετο γάρ τοι Φοῖβος ἐνὶ κρατερῇ ὑσμίνῃ
δεινός· ὃ μὲν τὸν ἰόντα κατὰ κλόνον οὐκ ἐνόησεν,
ἠέρι γὰρ πολλῇ κεκαλυμμένος ἀντεβόλησε·
στῆ δ’ ὄπιθεν, πλῆξεν δὲ μετάφρενον εὐρέε τ’ ὦμω
χειρὶ καταπρηνεῖ, στρεφεδίνηθεν δέ οἱ ὄσσε.
τοῦ δ’ ἀπὸ μὲν κρατὸς κυνέην βάλε Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων·
ἣ δὲ κυλινδομένη καναχὴν ἔχε ποσσὶν ὑφ’ ἵππων
αὐλῶπις τρυφάλεια, μιάνθησαν δὲ ἔθειραι
αἵματι καὶ κονίῃσι· πάρος γε μὲν οὐ θέμις ἦεν
ἱππόκομον πήληκα μιαίνεσθαι κονίῃσιν,
ἀλλ’ ἀνδρὸς θείοιο κάρη χαρίεν τε μέτωπον
ῥύετ’ Ἀχιλλῆος· τότε δὲ Ζεὺς Ἕκτορι δῶκεν
ᾗ κεφαλῇ φορέειν, σχεδόθεν δέ οἱ ἦεν ὄλεθρος.
πᾶν δέ οἱ ἐν χείρεσσιν ἄγη δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος
βριθὺ μέγα στιβαρὸν κεκορυθμένον· αὐτὰρ ἀπ’ ὤμων
ἀσπὶς σὺν τελαμῶνι χαμαὶ πέσε τερμιόεσσα.
λῦσε δέ οἱ θώρηκα ἄναξ Διὸς υἱὸς Ἀπόλλων.
τὸν δ’ ἄτη φρένας εἶλε, λύθεν δ’ ὑπὸ φαίδιμα γυῖα,
στῆ δὲ ταφών· ὄπιθεν δὲ μετάφρενον ὀξέϊ δουρὶ
ὤμων μεσσηγὺς σχεδόθεν βάλε Δάρδανος ἀνὴρ
Πανθοΐδης Εὔφορβος, ὃς ἡλικίην ἐκέκαστο
ἔγχεΐ θ’ ἱπποσύνῃ τε πόδεσσί τε καρπαλίμοισι·
καὶ γὰρ δὴ τότε φῶτας ἐείκοσι βῆσεν ἀφ’ ἵππων

16.811

πρῶτ’ ἐλθὼν σὺν ὄχεσφι διδασκόμενος πολέμοιο·
ὅς τοι πρῶτος ἐφῆκε βέλος Πατρόκλεες ἱππεῦ
οὐδὲ δάμασσ’· ὃ μὲν αὖτις ἀνέδραμε, μίκτο δ’ ὁμίλῳ,
ἐκ χροὸς ἁρπάξας δόρυ μείλινον, οὐδ’ ὑπέμεινε
Πάτροκλον γυμνόν περ ἐόντ’ ἐν δηϊοτῆτι.
Πάτροκλος δὲ θεοῦ πληγῇ καὶ δουρὶ δαμασθεὶς
ἂψ ἐτάρων εἰς ἔθνος ἐχάζετο κῆρ’ ἀλεείνων.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ὡς εἶδεν Πατροκλῆα μεγάθυμον

ἂψ ἀναχαζόμενον βεβλημένον ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ,
ἀγχίμολόν ῥά οἱ ἦλθε κατὰ στίχας, οὗτα δὲ δουρὶ
νείατον ἐς κενεῶνα, διὰ πρὸ δὲ χαλκὸν ἔλασσε·
δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, μέγα δ’ ἤκαχε λαὸν Ἀχαιῶν·
ὡς δ’ ὅτε σῦν ἀκάμαντα λέων ἐβιήσατο χάρμῃ,
ὥ τ’ ὄρεος κορυφῇσι μέγα φρονέοντε μάχεσθον
πίδακος ἀμφ’ ὀλίγης· ἐθέλουσι δὲ πιέμεν ἄμφω·
πολλὰ δέ τ’ ἀσθμαίνοντα λέων ἐδάμασσε βίηφιν·
ὣς πολέας πεφνόντα Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμον υἱὸν
Ἕκτωρ Πριαμίδης σχεδὸν ἔγχεϊ θυμὸν ἀπηύρα,
καί οἱ ἐπευχόμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Πάτροκλ’ ἦ που ἔφησθα πόλιν κεραϊξέμεν ἀμήν,
Τρωϊάδας δὲ γυναῖκας ἐλεύθερον ἦμαρ ἀπούρας
ἄξειν ἐν νήεσσι φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν
νήπιε· τάων δὲ πρόσθ’ Ἕκτορος ὠκέες ἵπποι
ποσσὶν ὀρωρέχαται πολεμίζειν· ἔγχεϊ δ’ αὐτὸς
Τρωσὶ φιλοπτολέμοισι μεταπρέπω, ὅ σφιν ἀμύνω
ἦμαρ ἀναγκαῖον· σὲ δέ τ’ ἐνθάδε γῦπες ἔδονται.
ἆ δείλ’, οὐδέ τοι ἐσθλὸς ἐὼν χραίσμησεν Ἀχιλλεύς,
ὅς πού τοι μάλα πολλὰ μένων ἐπετέλλετ’ ἰόντι·
μή μοι πρὶν ἰέναι Πατρόκλεες ἱπποκέλευθε
νῆας ἔπι γλαφυρὰς πρὶν Ἕκτορος ἀνδροφόνοιο

16.841

αἱματόεντα χιτῶνα περὶ στήθεσσι δαΐξαι.
ὣς πού σε προσέφη, σοὶ δὲ φρένας ἄφρονι πεῖθε.
τὸν δ’ ὀλιγοδρανέων προσέφης Πατρόκλεες ἱππεῦ·
ἤδη νῦν Ἕκτορ μεγάλ’ εὔχεο· σοὶ γὰρ ἔδωκε
νίκην Ζεὺς Κρονίδης καὶ Ἀπόλλων, οἵ με δάμασσαν
ῥηιδίως· αὐτοὶ γὰρ ἀπ’ ὤμων τεύχε’ ἕλοντο.
τοιοῦτοι δ’ εἴ πέρ μοι ἐείκοσιν ἀντεβόλησαν,
πάντές κ’ αὐτόθ’ ὄλοντο ἐμῷ ὑπὸ δουρὶ δαμέντες.
ἀλλά με μοῖρ’ ὀλοὴ καὶ Λητοῦς ἔκτανεν υἱός,
ἀνδρῶν δ’ Εὔφορβος· σὺ δέ με τρίτος ἐξεναρίζεις.
ἄλλο δέ τοι ἐρέω, σὺ δ’ ἐνὶ φρεσὶ βάλλεο σῇσιν·
οὔ θην οὐδ’ αὐτὸς δηρὸν βέῃ, ἀλλά τοι ἤδη
ἄγχι παρέστηκεν θάνατος καὶ μοῖρα κραταιὴ
χερσὶ δαμέντ’ Ἀχιλῆος ἀμύμονος Αἰακίδαο.
ὣς ἄρα μιν εἰπόντα τέλος θανάτοιο κάλυψε·
ψυχὴ δ’ ἐκ ῥεθέων πταμένη Ἄϊδος δὲ βεβήκει
ὃν πότμον γοόωσα λιποῦσ’ ἀνδροτῆτα καὶ ἥβην.
τὸν καὶ τεθνηῶτα προσηύδα φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ·
Πατρόκλεις τί νύ μοι μαντεύεαι αἰπὺν ὄλεθρον;
τίς δ’ οἶδ’ εἴ κ’ Ἀχιλεὺς Θέτιδος πάϊς ἠϋκόμοιο
φθήῃ ἐμῷ ὑπὸ δουρὶ τυπεὶς ἀπὸ θυμὸν ὀλέσσαι;
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας δόρυ χάλκεον ἐξ ὠτειλῆς
εἵρυσε λὰξ προσβάς, τὸν δ’ ὕπτιον ὦσ’ ἀπὸ δουρός.
αὐτίκα δὲ ξὺν δουρὶ μετ’ Αὐτομέδοντα βεβήκει
ἀντίθεον θεράποντα ποδώκεος Αἰακίδαο·
ἵετο γὰρ βαλέειν· τὸν δ’ ἔκφερον ὠκέες ἵπποι
ἄμβροτοι, οὓς Πηλῆϊ θεοὶ δόσαν ἀγλαὰ δῶρα.

17.1

οὐδ’ ἔλαθ’ Ἀτρέος υἱὸν ἀρηΐφιλον Μενέλαον
Πάτροκλος Τρώεσσι δαμεὶς ἐν δηϊοτῆτι.
βῆ δὲ διὰ προμάχων κεκορυθμένος αἴθοπι χαλκῷ,
ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ αὐτῷ βαῖν’ ὥς τις περὶ πόρτακι μήτηρ
πρωτοτόκος κινυρὴ οὐ πρὶν εἰδυῖα τόκοιο·
ὣς περὶ Πατρόκλῳ βαῖνε ξανθὸς Μενέλαος.
πρόσθε δέ οἱ δόρυ τ’ ἔσχε καὶ ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην,
τὸν κτάμεναι μεμαὼς ὅς τις τοῦ γ’ ἀντίος ἔλθοι.
οὐδ’ ἄρα Πάνθου υἱὸς ἐϋμμελίης ἀμέλησε
Πατρόκλοιο πεσόντος ἀμύμονος· ἄγχι δ’ ἄρ’ αὐτοῦ
ἔστη, καὶ προσέειπεν ἀρηΐφιλον Μενέλαον·
Ἀτρεΐδη Μενέλαε διοτρεφὲς ὄρχαμε λαῶν
χάζεο, λεῖπε δὲ νεκρόν, ἔα δ’ ἔναρα βροτόεντα·
οὐ γάρ τις πρότερος Τρώων κλειτῶν τ’ ἐπικούρων
Πάτροκλον βάλε δουρὶ κατὰ κρατερὴν ὑσμίνην·
τώ με ἔα κλέος ἐσθλὸν ἐνὶ Τρώεσσιν ἀρέσθαι,
μή σε βάλω, ἀπὸ δὲ μελιηδέα θυμὸν ἕλωμαι.
τὸν δὲ μέγ’ ὀχθήσας προσέφη ξανθὸς Μενέλαος·
Ζεῦ πάτερ οὐ μὲν καλὸν ὑπέρβιον εὐχετάασθαι.
οὔτ’ οὖν παρδάλιος τόσσον μένος οὔτε λέοντος
οὔτε συὸς κάπρου ὀλοόφρονος, οὗ τε μέγιστος
θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσι περὶ σθένεϊ βλεμεαίνει,
ὅσσον Πάνθου υἷες ἐϋμμελίαι φρονέουσιν.
οὐδὲ μὲν οὐδὲ βίη Ὑπερήνορος ἱπποδάμοιο
ἦς ἤβης ἀπόνηθ’, ὅτε μ’ ὤνατο καί μ’ ὑπέμεινε
καί μ’ ἔφατ’ ἐν Δαναοῖσιν ἐλέγχιστον πολεμιστὴν
ἔμμεναι· οὐδέ ἑ φημι πόδεσσί γε οἷσι κιόντα
εὐφρῆναι ἄλοχόν τε φίλην κεδνούς τε τοκῆας.
ὥς θην καὶ σὸν ἐγὼ λύσω μένος εἴ κέ μευ ἄντα
στήῃς· ἀλλά σ’ ἔγωγ’ ἀναχωρήσαντα κελεύω

Brave Menelaos son of Atreus now came to know that Patroklos had fallen, and made his way through the front ranks clad in full armor to bestride him. As a cow stands lowing over her first calf, even so did yellow-haired Menelaos bestride Patroklos. He held his round shield and his spear in front of him, resolute to kill any who should dare face him. But the son of Panthoos had also noted the body, and came up to Menelaos saying, "Menelaos, son of Atreus, draw back, leave the body, and let the bloodstained spoils be. I was first of the Trojans and their brave allies to drive my spear into Patroklos, let me, therefore, have my full glory [kleos] among the Trojans, or I will take aim and kill you." To this Menelaos answered in great anger "By father Zeus, boasting is an ill thing. The pard is not more bold, nor the lion nor savage wild-boar, which is fiercest and most dauntless of all creatures, than are the proud sons of Panthoos. Yet Hyperenor did not see out the days of his youth when he made light of me and withstood me, deeming me the meanest warrior among the Danaans. His own feet never bore him back to gladden his wife and parents. Even so shall I make an end of you too, if you withstand me; get you back into the crowd and do not face me, or it shall be worse for you. Even a fool may be wise after the event." Euphorbos would not listen, and said, "Now indeed, Menelaos, shall you pay for the death of my brother over whom you vaunted, and whose wife you widowed in her bridal chamber, while you brought grief [penthos] unspeakable on his parents. I shall comfort these poor people if I bring your head and armor and place them in the hands of Panthoos and noble Phrontis. The time is come when this matter shall be fought out in a struggle [ponos] and settled, for me or

against me." As he spoke he struck Menelaos full on the shield, but the spear did not go through, for the shield turned its point. Menelaos then took aim, praying to father Zeus as he did so; Euphorbos was drawing back, and Menelaos struck him about the roots of his throat, leaning his whole weight on the spear, so as to drive it home. The point went clean through his neck, and his armor rang rattling round him as he fell heavily to the ground. His locks of hair, so deftly bound in bands of silver and gold, were all bedrabbled with flecks of blood, which looked like myrtle-blossoms [kharites]. As one who has grown a fine young olive tree in a clear space where there is abundance of water - the plant is full of promise, and though the winds beat upon it from every quarter it puts forth its white blossoms till the blasts of some fierce wind sweep down upon it and level it with the ground - even so did Menelaos strip the fair youth Euphorbos of his armor after he had slain him. Or as some fierce lion upon the mountains in the pride of his strength fastens on the finest heifer in a herd as it is feeding - first he breaks her neck with his strong jaws, and then gorges on her blood and entrails; dogs and shepherds raise a hue and cry against him, but they stand aloof and will not come close to him, for they are pale with fear - even so no one had the courage to face valiant Menelaos. The son of Atreus would have then carried off the armor of the son of Panthoos with ease, had not Phoebus Apollo been angry, and in the guise of Mentes chief of the Kikones incited Hektor to attack him. "Hektor," said he, "you are now going after the horses of the noble son of Aiakos, but you will not take them; they cannot be kept in hand and driven by mortal man, save only by Achilles, who is son to an immortal mother. Meanwhile Menelaos son of Atreus has bestridden the body of Patroklos and killed the noblest of the Trojans, Euphorbos son of Panthoos, so that he can fight no more." The god then went back into the toil [ponos] and turmoil, but the soul of Hektor was darkened with a cloud of grief [akhos]; he looked along the ranks and saw Euphorbos lying on the ground with the blood still flowing from his wound, and Menelaos stripping him of his armor. On this he made his way to the front like a flame of fire, clad in his gleaming armor, and crying with a loud voice. When the son of Atreus heard him, he said to himself in his dismay, "Alas! what shall I do? I may not let the Trojans take the armor of Patroklos who has fallen fighting on my behalf, lest some Danaan who sees me should cry shame upon me. Still if for the sake of my honor [timê] I fight Hektor and the Trojans single-handed, they will prove too many for me, for Hektor is bringing them up in force. Why, however, should I thus hesitate? When a man, opposing the will of a daimôn, fights with one whom a god befriends, he will soon rue it. Let no Danaan think ill of me if I give place to Hektor, for the hand of heaven gives him honor [timê]. Yet, if I could find Ajax, the two of us would fight Hektor and any daimôn too, if we might only save the body of Patroklos for Achilles son of Peleus. This, of many evils, would be the least." While he was thus in two minds, the Trojans came up to him with Hektor at their head; he therefore drew back and left the body, turning about like some bearded lion who is being chased by dogs and men from a stockyard with spears and hue and cry, whereon he is daunted and slinks sulkily off - even so did Menelaos son of Atreus turn and leave the body of Patroklos. When among the body of his men, he looked around for mighty Ajax son of Telamon, and presently saw him on the extreme left of the fight, cheering on his men and exhorting them to keep on fighting, for Phoebus Apollo had spread a great panic among them. He ran up to him and said, "Ajax, my good friend, come with me at once to dead Patroklos, if so be that we may take the body to Achilles - as for his armor, Hektor already has it." These words stirred the heart of Ajax, and he made his way among the front ranks, Menelaos going with him. Hektor had stripped Patroklos of his armor, and was dragging him away to cut off his head and take the body to fling before the dogs of Troy. But Ajax came up with his shield like wall before him, on which Hektor withdrew under shelter of his men, and sprang on to his chariot, giving the armor over to the Trojans to take to the city, as a great glory [kleos] for himself; Ajax, therefore, covered the body of Patroklos with his broad shield and bestrode

him; as a lion stands over his whelps if hunters have come upon him in a forest when he is with his little ones - in the pride and fierceness of his strength he draws his knit brows down till they cover his eyes - even so did Ajax bestride the body of Patroklos, and by his side stood Menelaos son of Atreus, nursing great sorrow [penthos] in his heart.

17.31

ἐς πληθὺν ἰέναι, μηδ’ ἀντίος ἵστασ’ ἐμεῖο
πρίν τι κακὸν παθέειν· ῥεχθὲν δέ τε νήπιος ἔγνω.
ὣς φάτο, τὸν δ’ οὐ πεῖθεν· ἀμειβόμενος δὲ προσηύδα·
νῦν μὲν δὴ Μενέλαε διοτρεφὲς ἦ μάλα τείσεις
γνωτὸν ἐμὸν τὸν ἔπεφνες, ἐπευχόμενος δ’ ἀγορεύεις,
χήρωσας δὲ γυναῖκα μυχῷ θαλάμοιο νέοιο,
ἀρητὸν δὲ τοκεῦσι γόον καὶ πένθος ἔθηκας.
ἦ κέ σφιν δειλοῖσι γόου κατάπαυμα γενοίμην
εἴ κεν ἐγὼ κεφαλήν τε τεὴν καὶ τεύχε’ ἐνείκας
Πάνθῳ ἐν χείρεσσι βάλω καὶ Φρόντιδι δίῃ.
ἀλλ’ οὐ μὰν ἔτι δηρὸν ἀπείρητος πόνος ἔσται
οὐδ’ ἔτ’ ἀδήριτος ἦτ’ ἀλκῆς ἤτε φόβοιο.
ὣς εἰπὼν οὔτησε κατ’ ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην·
οὐδ’ ἔρρηξεν χαλκός, ἀνεγνάμφθη δέ οἱ αἰχμὴ
ἀσπίδ’ ἐνὶ κρατερῇ· ὃ δὲ δεύτερος ὄρνυτο χαλκῷ
Ἀτρεΐδης Μενέλαος ἐπευξάμενος Διὶ πατρί·
ἂψ δ’ ἀναχαζομένοιο κατὰ στομάχοιο θέμεθλα
νύξ’, ἐπὶ δ’ αὐτὸς ἔρεισε βαρείῃ χειρὶ πιθήσας·
ἀντικρὺ δ’ ἀπαλοῖο δι’ αὐχένος ἦλυθ’ ἀκωκή,
δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, ἀράβησε δὲ τεύχε’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ.
αἵματί οἱ δεύοντο κόμαι Χαρίτεσσιν ὁμοῖαι
πλοχμοί θ’, οἳ χρυσῷ τε καὶ ἀργύρῳ ἐσφήκωντο.
οἷον δὲ τρέφει ἔρνος ἀνὴρ ἐριθηλὲς ἐλαίης
χώρῳ ἐν οἰοπόλῳ, ὅθ’ ἅλις ἀναβέβροχεν ὕδωρ,
καλὸν τηλεθάον· τὸ δέ τε πνοιαὶ δονέουσι
παντοίων ἀνέμων, καί τε βρύει ἄνθεϊ λευκῷ·
ἐλθὼν δ’ ἐξαπίνης ἄνεμος σὺν λαίλαπι πολλῇ
βόθρου τ’ ἐξέστρεψε καὶ ἐξετάνυσσ’ ἐπὶ γαίῃ·
τοῖον Πάνθου υἱὸν ἐϋμμελίην Εὔφορβον
Ἀτρεΐδης Μενέλαος ἐπεὶ κτάνε τεύχε’ ἐσύλα.

17.61

ὡς δ’ ὅτε τίς τε λέων ὀρεσίτροφος ἀλκὶ πεποιθὼς
βοσκομένης ἀγέλης βοῦν ἁρπάσῃ ἥ τις ἀρίστη·
τῆς δ’ ἐξ αὐχέν’ ἔαξε λαβὼν κρατεροῖσιν ὀδοῦσι
πρῶτον, ἔπειτα δέ θ’ αἷμα καὶ ἔγκατα πάντα λαφύσσει
δῃῶν· ἀμφὶ δὲ τόν γε κύνες τ’ ἄνδρές τε νομῆες
πολλὰ μάλ’ ἰύζουσιν ἀπόπροθεν οὐδ’ ἐθέλουσιν
ἀντίον ἐλθέμεναι· μάλα γὰρ χλωρὸν δέος αἱρεῖ·
ὣς τῶν οὔ τινι θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἐτόλμα
ἀντίον ἐλθέμεναι Μενελάου κυδαλίμοιο.
ἔνθά κε ῥεῖα φέροι κλυτὰ τεύχεα Πανθοΐδαο
Ἀτρεΐδης, εἰ μή οἱ ἀγάσσατο Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων,
ὅς ῥά οἱ Ἕκτορ’ ἐπῶρσε θοῷ ἀτάλαντον Ἄρηϊ

73 ἀνέρι εἰσάμενος Κικόνων ἠγήτορι Μέντῃ·
74 καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
75 Ἕκτορ νῦν σὺ μὲν ὧδε θέεις ἀκίχητα διώκων
76 ἵππους Αἰακίδαο δαΐφρονος· οἳ δ’ ἀλεγεινοὶ
77 ἀνδράσι γε θνητοῖσι δαμήμεναι ἠδ’ ὀχέεσθαι
78 ἄλλῳ γ’ ἢ Ἀχιλῆϊ, τὸν ἀθανάτη τέκε μήτηρ.
79 τόφρα δέ τοι Μενέλαος ἀρήϊος Ἀτρέος υἱὸς
80 Πατρόκλῳ περιβὰς Τρώων τὸν ἄριστον ἔπεφνε
81 Πανθοΐδην Εὔφορβον, ἔπαυσε δὲ θούριδος ἀλκῆς.
82 ὣς εἰπὼν ὃ μὲν αὖτις ἔβη θεὸς ἂμ πόνον ἀνδρῶν,
83 Ἕκτορα δ’ αἰνὸν ἄχος πύκασε φρένας ἀμφὶ μελαίνας·
84 πάπτηνεν δ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα κατὰ στίχας, αὐτίκα δ’ ἔγνω
85 τὸν μὲν ἀπαινύμενον κλυτὰ τεύχεα, τὸν δ’ ἐπὶ γαίῃ
86 κείμενον· ἔρρει δ’ αἷμα κατ’ οὐταμένην ὠτειλήν.
87 βῆ δὲ διὰ προμάχων κεκορυθμένος αἴθοπι χαλκῷ
88 ὀξέα κεκλήγων φλογὶ εἴκελος Ἡφαίστοιο
89 ἀσβέστῳ· οὐδ’ υἱὸν λάθεν Ἀτρέος ὀξὺ βοήσας·
90 ὀχθήσας δ’ ἄρα εἶπε πρὸς ὃν μεγαλήτορα θυμόν·

17.91

91 ὤ μοι ἐγὼν εἰ μέν κε λίπω κάτα τεύχεα καλὰ
92 Πάτροκλόν θ’, ὃς κεῖται ἐμῆς ἕνεκ’ ἐνθάδε τιμῆς,
93 μή τίς μοι Δαναῶν νεμεσήσεται ὅς κεν ἴδηται.
94 εἰ δέ κεν Ἕκτορι μοῦνος ἐὼν καὶ Τρωσὶ μάχωμαι
95 αἰδεσθείς, μή πώς με περιστήωσ’ ἕνα πολλοί·
96 Τρῶας δ’ ἐνθάδε πάντας ἄγει κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ.
97 ἀλλὰ τί ἦ μοι ταῦτα φίλος διελέξατο θυμός;
98 ὁππότ’ ἀνὴρ ἐθέλῃ πρὸς δαίμονα φωτὶ μάχεσθαι
99 ὅν κε θεὸς τιμᾷ, τάχα οἱ μέγα πῆμα κυλίσθη.
100 τώ μ’ οὔ τις Δαναῶν νεμεσήσεται ὅς κεν ἴδηται
101 Ἕκτορι χωρήσαντ’, ἐπεὶ ἐκ θεόφιν πολεμίζει.
102 εἰ δέ που Αἴαντός γε βοὴν ἀγαθοῖο πυθοίμην,
103 ἄμφω κ’ αὖτις ἰόντες ἐπιμνησαίμεθα χάρμης
104 καὶ πρὸς δαίμονά περ, εἴ πως ἐρυσαίμεθα νεκρὸν
105 Πηλεΐδῃ Ἀχιλῆϊ· κακῶν δέ κε φέρτατον εἴη.
106 εἶος ὁ ταῦθ’ ὅρμαινε κατὰ φρένα καὶ κατὰ θυμὸν
107 τόφρα δ’ ἐπὶ Τρώων στίχες ἤλυθον· ἦρχε δ’ ἄρ’ Ἕκτωρ.
108 αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἐξοπίσω ἀνεχάζετο, λεῖπε δὲ νεκρὸν
109 ἐντροπαλιζόμενος ὥς τε λὶς ἠϋγένειος,
110 ὅν ῥα κύνες τε καὶ ἄνδρες ἀπὸ σταθμοῖο δίωνται
111 ἔγχεσι καὶ φωνῇ· τοῦ δ’ ἐν φρεσὶν ἄλκιμον ἦτορ
112 παχνοῦται, ἀέκων δέ τ’ ἔβη ἀπὸ μεσσαύλοιο·
113 ὣς ἀπὸ Πατρόκλοιο κίε ξανθὸς Μενέλαος.
114 στῆ δὲ μεταστρεφθεὶς ἐπεὶ ἵκετο ἔθνος ἑταίρων
115 παπταίνων Αἴαντα μέγαν Τελαμώνιον υἱόν.
116 τὸν δὲ μάλ’ αἶψ’ ἐνόησε μάχης ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ πάσης
117 θαρσύνονθ’ ἑτάρους καὶ ἐποτρύνοντα μάχεσθαι·
118 θεσπέσιον γάρ σφιν φόβον ἔμβαλε Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων·
119 βῆ δὲ θέειν, εἶθαρ δὲ παριστάμενος ἔπος ηὔδα.
120 Αἶαν δεῦρο πέπον, περὶ Πατρόκλοιο θανόντος

17.121

121 σπεύσομεν, αἴ κε νέκυν περ Ἀχιλλῆϊ προφέρωμεν
122 γυμνόν· ἀτὰρ τά γε τεύχε’ ἔχει κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ.
123 ὣς ἔφατ’, Αἴαντι δὲ δαΐφρονι θυμὸν ὄρινε·
124 βῆ δὲ διὰ προμάχων, ἅμα δὲ ξανθὸς Μενέλαος.
125 Ἕκτωρ μὲν Πάτροκλον ἐπεὶ κλυτὰ τεύχε’ ἀπηύρα,
126 ἕλχ’ ἵν’ ἀπ’ ὤμοιιν κεφαλὴν τάμοι ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ,
127 τὸν δὲ νέκυν Τρωῇσιν ἐρυσσάμενος κυσὶ δοίη.
128 Αἴας δ’ ἐγγύθεν ἦλθε φέρων σάκος ἠΰτε πύργον·
129 Ἕκτωρ δ’ ἂψ ἐς ὅμιλον ἰὼν ἀνεχάζεθ’ ἑταίρων,
130 ἐς δίφρον δ’ ἀνόρουσε· δίδου δ’ ὅ γε τεύχεα καλὰ
131 Τρωσὶ φέρειν προτὶ ἄστυ, μέγα κλέος ἔμμεναι αὐτῷ.
132 Αἴας δ’ ἀμφὶ Μενοιτιάδῃ σάκος εὐρὺ καλύψας
133 ἑστήκει ὥς τίς τε λέων περὶ οἷσι τέκεσσιν,
134 ᾧ ῥά τε νήπι’ ἄγοντι συναντήσωνται ἐν ὕλῃ
135 ἄνδρες ἐπακτῆρες· ὃ δέ τε σθένεϊ βλεμεαίνει,
136 πᾶν δέ τ’ ἐπισκύνιον κάτω ἕλκεται ὄσσε καλύπτων·
137 ὣς Αἴας περὶ Πατρόκλῳ ἥρωϊ βεβήκει.
138 Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἀρηΐφιλος Μενέλαος
139 ἑστήκει, μέγα πένθος ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἀέξων.
140 Γλαῦκος δ’ Ἱππολόχοιο πάϊς Λυκίων ἀγὸς ἀνδρῶν
141 Ἕκτορ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν χαλεπῷ ἠνίπαπε μύθῳ·
142 Ἕκτορ εἶδος ἄριστε μάχης ἄρα πολλὸν ἐδεύεο.
143 ἦ σ’ αὔτως κλέος ἐσθλὸν ἔχει φύξηλιν ἐόντα.
144 φράζεο νῦν ὅππως κε πόλιν καὶ ἄστυ σαώσῃς
145 οἷος σὺν λαοῖς τοὶ Ἰλίῳ ἐγγεγάασιν·
146 οὐ γάρ τις Λυκίων γε μαχησόμενος Δαναοῖσιν
147 εἶσι περὶ πτόλιος, ἐπεὶ οὐκ ἄρα τις χάρις ἦεν
148 μάρνασθαι δηΐοισιν ἐπ’ ἀνδράσι νωλεμὲς αἰεί.
149 πῶς κε σὺ χείρονα φῶτα σαώσειας μεθ’ ὅμιλον
150 σχέτλι’, ἐπεὶ Σαρπηδόν’ ἅμα ξεῖνον καὶ ἑταῖρον

Then Glaukos son of Hippolokhos looked fiercely at Hektor and rebuked him sternly. "Hektor," said he, "you make a brave show, but in fight you are sadly wanting. A runaway like yourself has no claim to so great a glory [kleos]. Think how you may now save your town and citadel by the hands of your own people born in Ilion; for you will get no Lycians to fight for you, seeing what thanks they have had for their incessant hardships. Are you likely, sir, to do anything to help a man of less note, after leaving Sarpedon, who was at once your guest and comrade in arms, to be the spoil and prey of the Danaans? So long as he lived he did good service [kharis] both to your city and yourself; yet you had no stomach to save his body from the dogs. If the Lycians will listen to me, they will go home and leave Troy to its fate. If the Trojans had any of that daring fearless spirit which lays hold of men who are engaging in the struggle [ponos] for their land and harassing those who would attack it, we should soon bear off Patroklos into Ilion. Could we get this dead man away and bring him into the city of Priam, the Argives would readily give up the armor of Sarpedon, and we should get his body to boot. For he whose squire [therapôn] has been now killed is the foremost man at the ships of the Achaeans - he and his close-fighting followers [therapontes]. Nevertheless you dared not make a stand against Ajax, nor face him, eye to eye, with battle all round you, for he is a braver man than you are." Hektor scowled at him and answered, "Glaukos, you should know better. I have held you so far as a man of more understanding than any in all Lycia, but now I despise you for saying that I am afraid of Ajax. I fear neither battle nor the din of chariots, but Zeus' will [noos] is stronger than ours;

Zeus at one time makes even a strong man draw back and snatches victory from his grasp, while at another he will set him on to fight. Come hither then, my friend, stand by me and see indeed whether I shall play the coward the whole day through as you say, or whether I shall not stay some even of the boldest Danaans from fighting round the body of Patroklos." As he spoke he called loudly on the Trojans saying, "Trojans, Lycians, and Dardanians, fighters in close combat, be men, my friends, and fight might and main, while I put on the goodly armor of Achilles, which I took when I killed Patroklos." With this Hektor left the fight, and ran full speed after his men who were taking the armor of Achilles to Troy, but had not yet got far. Standing for a while apart from the woeful fight, he changed his armor. His own he sent to the strong city of Ilion and to the Trojans, while he put on the immortal armor of the son of Peleus, which the gods had given to Peleus, who in his age gave it to his son; but the son did not grow old in his father's armor. When Zeus, lord of the storm-cloud, saw Hektor standing aloof and arming himself in the armor of the son of Peleus, he wagged his head and muttered to himself saying, "A! poor wretch, you arm in the armor of a hero, before whom many another trembles, and you reck nothing of the doom that is already close upon you. You have killed his comrade so brave and strong, but it was not according to the order [kosmos] of things that you should strip the armor from his head and shoulders. I do indeed endow you with great might now, but as against this you shall not return from battle to lay the armor of the son of Peleus before Andromache." The son of Kronos bowed his portentous brows, and Hektor fitted the armor to his body, while terrible Ares entered into him, and filled his whole body with might and valor. With a shout he strode in among the allies, and his armor flashed about him so that he seemed to all of them like the great son of Peleus himself. He went about among them and cheered them on - Mesthles, Glaukos, Medon, Thersilokhos, Asteropaios, Deisenor and Hippothoos, Phorkys, Chromios, and Ennomos the augur. All these did he exhort saying, "Hear me, allies from other cities who are here in your thousands, it was not in order to have a crowd about me that I called you hither each from his several city, but that with heart and soul you might defend the wives and little ones of the Trojans from the fierce Achaeans. For this do I oppress my people with your food and the presents that make you rich. Therefore turn, and charge at the foe, to stand or fall as is the game of war; whoever shall bring Patroklos, dead though he be, into the hands of the Trojans, and shall make Ajax give way before him, I will give him one half of the spoils while I keep the other. He will thus share like honor [kleos] with myself." When he had thus spoken they charged full weight upon the Danaans with their spears held out before them, and the hopes of each ran high that he should force Ajax son of Telamon to yield up the body - fools that they were, for he was about to take the lives of many. Then Ajax said to Menelaos, "My good friend Menelaos, you and I shall hardly come out of this fight alive. I am less concerned for the body of Patroklos,

17.151

151 κάλλιπες Ἀργείοισιν ἔλωρ καὶ κύρμα γενέσθαι,
152 ὅς τοι πόλλ’ ὄφελος γένετο πτόλεΐ τε καὶ αὐτῷ
153 ζωὸς ἐών· νῦν δ’ οὔ οἱ ἀλαλκέμεναι κύνας ἔτλης.
154 τὼ νῦν εἴ τις ἐμοὶ Λυκίων ἐπιπείσεται ἀνδρῶν
155 οἴκαδ’ ἴμεν, Τροίῃ δὲ πεφήσεται αἰπὺς ὄλεθρος.
156 εἰ γὰρ νῦν Τρώεσσι μένος πολυθαρσὲς ἐνείη
157 ἄτρομον, οἷόν τ’ ἄνδρας ἐσέρχεται οἳ περὶ πάτρης
158 ἀνδράσι δυσμενέεσσι πόνον καὶ δῆριν ἔθεντο,
159 αἶψά κε Πάτροκλον ἐρυσαίμεθα Ἴλιον εἴσω.
160 εἰ δ’ οὗτος προτὶ ἄστυ μέγα Πριάμοιο ἄνακτος
161 ἔλθοι τεθνηὼς καί μιν ἐρυσαίμεθα χάρμης,
162 αἶψά κεν Ἀργεῖοι Σαρπηδόνος ἔντεα καλὰ

λύσειαν, καί κ’ αὐτὸν ἀγοίμεθα Ἴλιον εἴσω·
τοίου γὰρ θεράπων πέφατ’ ἀνέρος, ὃς μέγ’ ἄριστος
Ἀργείων παρὰ νηυσὶ καὶ ἀγχέμαχοι θεράποντες.
ἀλλὰ σύ γ’ Αἴαντος μεγαλήτορος οὐκ ἐτάλασσας
στήμεναι ἄντα κατ’ ὄσσε ἰδὼν δηΐων ἐν ἀϋτῇ,
οὐδ’ ἰθὺς μαχέσασθαι, ἐπεὶ σέο φέρτερός ἐστι.
τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
Γλαῦκε τί ἢ δὲ σὺ τοῖος ἐὼν ὑπέροπλον ἔειπες;
ὦ πόποι ἦ τ’ ἐφάμην σὲ περὶ φρένας ἔμμεναι ἄλλων
τῶν ὅσσοι Λυκίην ἐριβώλακα ναιετάουσι·
νῦν δέ σευ ὠνοσάμην πάγχυ φρένας οἷον ἔειπες,
ὅς τέ με φὴς Αἴαντα πελώριον οὐχ ὑπομεῖναι.
οὔ τοι ἐγὼν ἔρριγα μάχην οὐδὲ κτύπον ἵππων·
ἀλλ’ αἰεί τε Διὸς κρείσσων νόος αἰγιόχοιο,
ὅς τε καὶ ἄλκιμον ἄνδρα φοβεῖ καὶ ἀφείλετο νίκην
ῥηϊδίως, ὁτὲ δ’ αὐτὸς ἐποτρύνει μαχέσασθαι.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δεῦρο πέπον, παρ’ ἔμ’ ἵστασο καὶ ἴδε ἔργον,
ἠὲ πανημέριος κακὸς ἔσσομαι, ὡς ἀγορεύεις,

17.181

ἦ τινα καὶ Δαναῶν ἀλκῆς μάλα περ μεμαῶτα
σχήσω ἀμυνέμεναι περὶ Πατρόκλοιο θανόντος.
ὣς εἰπὼν Τρώεσσιν ἐκέκλετο μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
Τρῶες καὶ Λύκιοι καὶ Δάρδανοι ἀγχιμαχηταί,
ἀνέρες ἔστε φίλοι, μνήσασθε δὲ θούριδος ἀλκῆς,
ὄφρ’ ἂν ἐγὼν Ἀχιλῆος ἀμύμονος ἔντεα δύω
καλά, τὰ Πατρόκλοιο βίην ἐνάριξα κατακτάς.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἀπέβη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ
δηΐου ἐκ πολέμοιο· θέων δ’ ἐκίχανεν ἑταίρους
ὦκα μάλ’ οὔ πω τῆλε ποσὶ κραιπνοῖσι μετασπών,
οἳ προτὶ ἄστυ φέρον κλυτὰ τεύχεα Πηλεΐωνος.
στὰς δ’ ἀπάνευθε μάχης πολυδακρύου ἔντε’ ἄμειβεν·
ἤτοι ὃ μὲν τὰ ἃ δῶκε φέρειν προτὶ Ἴλιον ἱρὴν
Τρωσὶ φιλοπτολέμοισιν, ὃ δ’ ἄμβροτα τεύχεα δῦνε
Πηλεΐδεω Ἀχιλῆος ἅ οἱ θεοὶ Οὐρανίωνες
πατρὶ φίλῳ ἔπορον· ὃ δ’ ἄρα ᾧ παιδὶ ὄπασσε
γηράς· ἀλλ’ οὐχ υἱὸς ἐν ἔντεσι πατρὸς ἐγήρα.
τὸν δ’ ὡς οὖν ἀπάνευθεν ἴδεν νεφεληγερέτα Ζεὺς
τεύχεσι Πηλεΐδαο κορυσσόμενον θείοιο,
κινήσας ῥα κάρη προτὶ ὃν μυθήσατο θυμόν·
ἆ δείλ’ οὐδέ τί τοι θάνατος καταθύμιός ἐστιν
ὃς δή τοι σχεδὸν εἶσι· σὺ δ’ ἄμβροτα τεύχεα δύνεις
ἀνδρὸς ἀριστῆος, τόν τε τρομέουσι καὶ ἄλλοι·
τοῦ δὴ ἑταῖρον ἔπεφνες ἐνηέα τε κρατερόν τε,
τεύχεα δ’ οὐ κατὰ κόσμον ἀπὸ κρατός τε καὶ ὤμων
εἵλευ· ἀτάρ τοι νῦν γε μέγα κράτος ἐγγυαλίξω,
τῶν ποινὴν ὅ τοι οὔ τι μάχης ἐκνοστήσαντι
δέξεται Ἀνδρομάχη κλυτὰ τεύχεα Πηλεΐωνος.
ἦ καὶ κυανέῃσιν ἐπ’ ὀφρύσι νεῦσε Κρονίων.
Ἕκτορι δ’ ἤρμοσε τεύχε’ ἐπὶ χροΐ, δῦ δέ μιν Ἄρης

17.211

211 δεινὸς ἐνυάλιος, πλῆσθεν δ’ ἄρα οἱ μέλε’ ἐντὸς
212 ἀλκῆς καὶ σθένεος· μετὰ δὲ κλειτοὺς ἐπικούρους
213 βῆ ῥα μέγα ἰάχων· ἰνδάλλετο δέ σφισι πᾶσι
214 τεύχεσι λαμπόμενος μεγαθύμου Πηλεΐωνος.
215 ὄτρυνεν δὲ ἕκαστον ἐποιχόμενος ἐπέεσσι
216 Μέσθλην τε Γλαῦκόν τε Μέδοντά τε Θερσίλοχόν τε
217 Ἀστεροπαῖόν τε Δεισήνορά θ’ Ἱππόθοόν τε
218 Φόρκυν τε Χρομίον τε καὶ Ἔννομον οἰωνιστήν·
219 τοὺς ὅ γ’ ἐποτρύνων ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
220 κέκλυτε μυρία φῦλα περικτιόνων ἐπικούρων·
221 οὐ γὰρ ἐγὼ πληθὺν διζήμενος οὐδὲ χατίζων
222 ἐνθάδ’ ἀφ’ ὑμετέρων πολίων ἦγειρα ἕκαστον,
223 ἀλλ’ ἵνα μοι Τρώων ἀλόχους καὶ νήπια τέκνα
224 προφρονέως ῥύοισθε φιλοπτολέμων ὑπ’ Ἀχαιῶν.
225 τὰ φρονέων δώροισι κατατρύχω καὶ ἐδωδῇ
226 λαούς, ὑμέτερον δὲ ἑκάστου θυμὸν ἀέξω.
227 τώ τις νῦν ἰθὺς τετραμμένος ἢ ἀπολέσθω
228 ἠὲ σαωθήτω· ἢ γὰρ πολέμου ὀαριστύς.
229 ὃς δέ κε Πάτροκλον καὶ τεθνηῶτά περ ἔμπης
230 Τρῶας ἐς ἱπποδάμους ἐρύσῃ, εἴξῃ δέ οἱ Αἴας,
231 ἥμισυ τῷ ἐνάρων ἀποδάσσομαι, ἥμισυ δ’ αὐτὸς
232 ἕξω ἐγώ· τὸ δέ οἱ κλέος ἔσσεται ὅσσον ἐμοί περ.
233 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἰθὺς Δαναῶν βρίσαντες ἔβησαν
234 δούρατ’ ἀνασχόμενοι· μάλα δέ σφισιν ἔλπετο θυμὸς
235 νεκρὸν ὑπ’ Αἴαντος ἐρύειν Τελαμωνιάδαο
236 νήπιοι· ἦ τε πολέσσιν ἐπ’ αὐτῷ θυμὸν ἀπηύρα.
237 καὶ τότ’ ἄρ’ Αἴας εἶπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸν Μενέλαον·
238 ὦ πέπον ὦ Μενέλαε διοτρεφὲς οὐκέτι νῶϊ
239 ἔλπομαι αὐτώ περ νοστησέμεν ἐκ πολέμοιο.
240 οὔ τι τόσον νέκυος περιδείδια Πατρόκλοιο,

who will shortly become meat for the dogs and vultures of Troy, than for the safety of my own head and yours. Hektor has wrapped us round in a storm of battle from every quarter, and our destruction seems now certain. Call then upon the princes of the Danaans if there is any who can hear us." Menelaos did as he said, and shouted to the Danaans for help at the top of his voice. "My friends," he cried, "princes and counselors of the Argives, all you who with Agamemnon and Menelaos drink at the public cost, and give orders each to his own people as Zeus grants him power and honor [timê], the fight is so thick about me that I cannot distinguish you severally; come on, therefore, every man unbidden, and think it shame that Patroklos should become meat and morsel for Trojan hounds." Fleet Ajax son of Oileus heard him and was first to force his way through the fight and run to help him. Next came Idomeneus and Meriones his esquire, peer of murderous Ares. As for the others that came into the fight after these, who of his own self could name them? The Trojans with Hektor at their head charged in a body. As a great wave that comes thundering in at the mouth of some heaven-born river, and the rocks that jut into the sea ring with the roar of the breakers that beat and buffet them - even with such a roar did the Trojans come on; but the Achaeans in singleness of heart stood firm about the son of Menoitios, and fenced him with their bronze shields. Zeus, moreover, hid the brightness of their helmets in a thick cloud, for he had borne no grudge against the son of Menoitios while he was still alive and squire [therapôn] to the descendant of Aiakos; therefore he was loath to let him fall a prey to the dogs of his foes the Trojans, and urged his comrades on to defend him. At first the

Trojans drove the Achaeans back, and they withdrew from the dead man daunted. The Trojans did not succeed in killing any one, nevertheless they drew the body away. But the Achaeans did not lose it long, for Ajax, foremost of all the Danaans after the son of Peleus alike in stature and prowess, quickly rallied them and made towards the front like a wild boar upon the mountains when he stands at bay in the forest glades and routs the hounds and lusty youths that have attacked him - even so did Ajax son of Telamon passing easily in among the phalanxes of the Trojans, disperse those who had bestridden Patroklos and were most bent on winning glory by dragging him off to their city. At this moment Hippothoos brave son of the Pelasgian Lethus, in his zeal for Hektor and the Trojans, was dragging the body off by the foot through the press of the fight, having bound a strap round the sinews near the ankle; but a mischief soon befell him from which none of those could save him who would have gladly done so, for the son of Telamon sprang forward and smote him on his bronze-cheeked helmet. The plumed headpiece broke about the point of the weapon, struck at once by the spear and by the strong hand of Ajax, so that the bloody brain came oozing out through the crest-socket. His strength then failed him and he let Patroklos' foot drop from his hand, as he fell full length dead upon the body; thus he died far from the fertile land of Larissa, and never repaid his parents the cost of bringing him up, for his life was cut short early by the spear of mighty Ajax. Hektor then took aim at Ajax with a spear, but he saw it coming and just managed to avoid it; the spear passed on and struck Schedios son of noble Iphitos, leader of the Phoceans, who dwelt in famed Panopeus and reigned over many people; it struck him under the middle of the collar-bone the bronze point went right through him, coming out at the bottom of his shoulder-blade, and his armor rang rattling round him as he fell heavily to the ground. Ajax in his turn struck noble Phorkys son of Phainops in the middle of the belly as he was bestriding Hippothoos, and broke the plate of his cuirass; whereon the spear tore out his entrails and he clutched the ground in his palm as he fell to earth. Hektor and those who were in the front rank then gave ground, while the Argives raised a loud cry of triumph, and drew off the bodies of Phorkys and Hippothoos which they stripped presently of their armor. The Trojans would now have been worsted by the brave Achaeans and driven back to Ilion through their own cowardice, while the Argives, so great was their courage and endurance, would have achieved a triumph even against the will of Zeus, if Apollo had not roused Aeneas, in the likeness of Periphas son of Epytos, an attendant who had grown old in the service of Aeneas' aged father, and was at all times devoted to him. In his likeness, then, Apollo said, "Aeneas, can you not manage, even though heaven be against us, to save high Ilion? I have known men, whose numbers, courage, and self-reliance have saved their population [dêmos] in spite of Zeus, whereas in this case he would much rather give victory to us than to the Danaans, if you would only fight instead of being so terribly afraid." Aeneas knew Apollo when he looked straight at him, and shouted to Hektor saying, "Hektor and all other Trojans and allies, shame [aidôs] on us if we are beaten by the Achaeans and driven back to Ilion through our own cowardice. A god has just come up to me and told me that Zeus the supreme disposer will be with us. Therefore let us make for the Danaans, that it may go hard with them ere they bear away dead Patroklos to the ships."

17.241

ὅς κε τάχα Τρώων κορέει κύνας ἠδ’ οἰωνούς,
ὅσσον ἐμῇ κεφαλῇ περιδείδια μή τι πάθῃσι,
καὶ σῇ, ἐπεὶ πολέμοιο νέφος περὶ πάντα καλύπτει
Ἕκτωρ, ἡμῖν δ’ αὖτ’ ἀναφαίνεται αἰπὺς ὄλεθρος.
ἀλλ’ ἄγ’ ἀριστῆας Δαναῶν κάλει, ἤν τις ἀκούσῃ.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος,
ἤϋσεν δὲ διαπρύσιον Δαναοῖσι γεγωνώς·

ὦ φίλοι Ἀργείων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες
οἵ τε παρ’ Ἀτρεΐδῃς Ἀγαμέμνονι καὶ Μενελάῳ
δήμια πίνουσιν καὶ σημαίνουσιν ἕκαστος
λαοῖς· ἐκ δὲ Διὸς τιμὴ καὶ κῦδος ὀπηδεῖ.
ἀργαλέον δέ μοί ἐστι διασκοπιᾶσθαι ἕκαστον
ἡγεμόνων· τόσση γὰρ ἔρις πολέμοιο δέδηεν·
ἀλλά τις αὐτὸς ἴτω, νεμεσιζέσθω δ’ ἐνὶ θυμῷ
Πάτροκλον Τρῳῇσι κυσὶν μέλπηθρα γενέσθαι.
ὣς ἔφατ’, ὀξὺ δ’ ἄκουσεν Ὀϊλῆος ταχὺς Αἴας·
πρῶτος δ’ ἀντίος ἦλθε θέων ἀνὰ δηϊοτῆτα,
τὸν δὲ μετ’ Ἰδομενεὺς καὶ ὀπάων Ἰδομενῆος
Μηριόνης ἀτάλαντος Ἐνυαλίῳ ἀνδρειφόντῃ.
τῶν δ’ ἄλλων τίς κεν ᾗσι φρεσὶν οὐνόματ’ εἴποι,
ὅσσοι δὴ μετόπισθε μάχην ἤγειραν Ἀχαιῶν;
Τρῶες δὲ προὔτυψαν ἀολλέες· ἦρχε δ’ ἄρ’ Ἕκτωρ.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἐπὶ προχοῇσι διιπετέος ποταμοῖο
βέβρυχεν μέγα κῦμα ποτὶ ῥόον, ἀμφὶ δέ τ’ ἄκραι
ἠϊόνες βοόωσιν ἐρευγομένης ἁλὸς ἔξω,
τόσσῃ ἄρα Τρῶες ἰαχῇ ἴσαν. αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
ἔστασαν ἀμφὶ Μενοιτιάδῃ ἕνα θυμὸν ἔχοντες
φραχθέντες σάκεσιν χαλκήρεσιν· ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρά σφι
λαμπρῇσιν κορύθεσσι Κρονίων ἠέρα πολλὴν
χεῦ’, ἐπεὶ οὐδὲ Μενοιτιάδην ἔχθαιρε πάρος γε,

17.271

ὄφρα ζωὸς ἐὼν θεράπων ἦν Αἰακίδαο·
μίσησεν δ’ ἄρα μιν δηΐων κυσὶ κύρμα γενέσθαι
Τρῳῇσιν· τὼ καί οἱ ἀμυνέμεν ὦρσεν ἑταίρους.
ὦσαν δὲ πρότεροι Τρῶες ἑλίκωπας Ἀχαιούς·
νεκρὸν δὲ προλιπόντες ὑπέτρεσαν, οὐδέ τιν’ αὐτῶν
Τρῶες ὑπέρθυμοι ἔλον ἔγχεσιν ἱέμενοί περ,
ἀλλὰ νέκυν ἐρύοντο· μίνυνθα δὲ καὶ τοῦ Ἀχαιοὶ
μέλλον ἀπέσσεσθαι· μάλα γάρ σφεας ὦκ’ ἐλέλιξεν
Αἴας, ὃς περὶ μὲν εἶδος, περὶ δ’ ἔργα τέτυκτο
τῶν ἄλλων Δαναῶν μετ’ ἀμύμονα Πηλεΐωνα.
ἴθυσεν δὲ διὰ προμάχων συὶ εἴκελος ἀλκὴν
καπρίῳ, ὅς τ’ ἐν ὄρεσσι κύνας θαλερούς τ’ αἰζηοὺς
ῥηϊδίως ἐκέδασσεν, ἐλιξάμενος διὰ βήσσας·
ὣς υἱὸς Τελαμῶνος ἀγαυοῦ φαίδιμος Αἴας
ῥεῖα μετεισάμενος Τρώων ἐκέδασσε φάλαγγας
οἳ περὶ Πατρόκλῳ βέβασαν, φρόνεον δὲ μάλιστα
ἄστυ πότι σφέτερον ἐρύειν καὶ κῦδος ἀρέσθαι.
ἤτοι τὸν Λήθοιο Πελασγοῦ φαίδιμος υἱὸς
Ἱππόθοος ποδὸς ἕλκε κατὰ κρατερὴν ὑσμίνην
δησάμενος τελαμῶνι παρὰ σφυρὸν ἀμφὶ τένοντας
Ἕκτορι καὶ Τρώεσσι χαριζόμενος· τάχα δ’ αὐτῷ
ἦλθε κακόν, τό οἱ οὔ τις ἐρύκακεν ἰεμένων περ.
τὸν δ’ υἱὸς Τελαμῶνος ἐπαΐξας δι’ ὁμίλου
πλῆξ’ αὐτοσχεδίην κυνέης διὰ χαλκοπαρῄου·
ἤρικε δ’ ἱπποδάσεια κόρυς περὶ δουρὸς ἀκωκῇ
πληγεῖσ’ ἔγχεΐ τε μεγάλῳ καὶ χειρὶ παχείῃ,

297 ἐγκέφαλος δὲ παρ’ αὐλὸν ἀνέδραμεν ἐξ ὠτειλῆς
298 αἱματόεις· τοῦ δ’ αὖθι λύθη μένος, ἐκ δ’ ἄρα χειρῶν
299 Πατρόκλοιο πόδα μεγαλήτορος ἦκε χαμᾶζε
300 κεῖσθαι· ὃ δ’ ἄγχ’ αὐτοῖο πέσε πρηνὴς ἐπὶ νεκρῷ

17.301

301 τῆλ’ ἀπὸ Λαρίσης ἐριβώλακος, οὐδὲ τοκεῦσι
302 θρέπτρα φίλοις ἀπέδωκε, μινυνθάδιος δέ οἱ αἰὼν
303 ἔπλεθ’ ὑπ’ Αἴαντος μεγαθύμου δουρὶ δαμέντι.
304 Ἕκτωρ δ’ αὖτ’ Αἴαντος ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ·
305 ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν ἄντα ἰδὼν ἠλεύατο χάλκεον ἔγχος
306 τυτθόν· ὃ δὲ Σχεδίον μεγαθύμου Ἰφίτου υἱὸν
307 Φωκήων ὄχ’ ἄριστον, ὃς ἐν κλειτῷ Πανοπῆϊ
308 οἰκία ναιετάασκε πολέσσ’ ἄνδρεσσιν ἀνάσσων,
309 τὸν βάλ’ ὑπὸ κληῖδα μέσην· διὰ δ’ ἀμπερὲς ἄκρη
310 αἰχμὴ χαλκείη παρὰ νείατον ὦμον ἀνέσχε·
311 δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, ἀράβησε δὲ τεύχε’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ.
312 Αἴας δ’ αὖ Φόρκυνα δαΐφρονα Φαίνοπος υἱὸν
313 Ἱπποθόῳ περιβάντα μέσην κατὰ γαστέρα τύψε·
314 ῥῆξε δὲ θώρηκος γύαλον, διὰ δ’ ἔντερα χαλκὸς
315 ἤφυσ’· ὃ δ’ ἐν κονίῃσι πεσὼν ἔλε γαῖαν ἀγοστῷ.
316 χώρησαν δ’ ὑπό τε πρόμαχοι καὶ φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ·
317 Ἀργεῖοι δὲ μέγα ἴαχον, ἐρύσαντο δὲ νεκροὺς
318 Φόρκυν θ’ Ἱππόθοόν τε, λύοντο δὲ τεύχε’ ἀπ’ ὤμων.
319 ἔνθά κεν αὖτε Τρῶες ἀρηϊφίλων ὑπ’ Ἀχαιῶν
320 Ἴλιον εἰσανέβησαν ἀναλκείῃσι δαμέντες,
321 Ἀργεῖοι δέ κε κῦδος ἔλον καὶ ὑπὲρ Διὸς αἶσαν
322 κάρτεϊ καὶ σθένεϊ σφετέρῳ· ἀλλ’ αὐτὸς Ἀπόλλων
323 Αἰνείαν ὄτρυνε δέμας Περίφαντι ἐοικὼς
324 κήρυκι Ἠπυτίδῃ, ὅς οἱ παρὰ πατρὶ γέροντι
325 κηρύσσων γήρασκε φίλα φρεσὶ μήδεα εἰδώς·
326 τῷ μιν ἐεισάμενος προσέφη Διὸς υἱὸς Ἀπόλλων·
327 Αἰνεία πῶς ἂν καὶ ὑπὲρ θεὸν εἰρύσσαισθε
328 Ἴλιον αἰπεινήν; ὡς δὴ ἴδον ἀνέρας ἄλλους
329 κάρτεΐ τε σθένεΐ τε πεποιθότας ἠνορέῃ τε
330 πλήθεΐ τε σφετέρῳ καὶ ὑπερδέα δῆμον ἔχοντας·

17.331

331 ἡμῖν δὲ Ζεὺς μὲν πολὺ βούλεται ἢ Δαναοῖσι
332 νίκην· ἀλλ’ αὐτοὶ τρεῖτ’ ἄσπετον οὐδὲ μάχεσθε.
333 ὣς ἔφατ’, Αἰνείας δ’ ἑκατηβόλον Ἀπόλλωνα
334 ἔγνω ἐς ἄντα ἰδών, μέγα δ’ Ἕκτορα εἶπε βοήσας·
335 Ἕκτόρ τ’ ἠδ’ ἄλλοι Τρώων ἀγοὶ ἠδ’ ἐπικούρων
336 αἰδὼς μὲν νῦν ἦδε γ’ ἀρηϊφίλων ὑπ’ Ἀχαιῶν
337 Ἴλιον εἰσαναβῆναι ἀναλκείῃσι δαμέντας.
338 ἀλλ’ ἔτι γάρ τίς φησι θεῶν ἐμοὶ ἄγχι παραστὰς
339 Ζῆν’ ὕπατον μήστωρα μάχης ἐπιτάρροθον εἶναι·
340 τώ ῥ’ ἰθὺς Δαναῶν ἴομεν, μηδ’ οἵ γε ἕκηλοι
341 Πάτροκλον νηυσὶν πελασαίατο τεθνηῶτα.
342 ὣς φάτο, καί ῥα πολὺ προμάχων ἐξάλμενος ἔστη·

343 οἳ δ’ ἐλελίχθησαν καὶ ἐναντίοι ἔσταν Ἀχαιῶν.
344 ἔνθ’ αὖτ’ Αἰνείας Λειώκριτον οὔτασε δουρὶ
345 υἱὸν Ἀρίσβαντος Λυκομήδεος ἐσθλὸν ἑταῖρον.
346 τὸν δὲ πεσόντ’ ἐλέησεν ἀρηΐφιλος Λυκομήδης,
347 στῆ δὲ μάλ’ ἐγγὺς ἰών, καὶ ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ,
348 καὶ βάλεν Ἱππασίδην Ἀπισάονα ποιμένα λαῶν
349 ἦπαρ ὑπὸ πραπίδων, εἶθαρ δ’ ὑπὸ γούνατ’ ἔλυσεν,
350 ὅς ῥ’ ἐκ Παιονίης ἐριβώλακος εἰληλούθει,
351 καὶ δὲ μετ’ Ἀστεροπαῖον ἀριστεύεσκε μάχεσθαι.
352 τὸν δὲ πεσόντ’ ἐλέησεν ἀρήϊος Ἀστεροπαῖος,
353 ἴθυσεν δὲ καὶ ὃ πρόφρων Δαναοῖσι μάχεσθαι·
354 ἀλλ’ οὔ πως ἔτι εἶχε· σάκεσσι γὰρ ἔρχατο πάντῃ
355 ἑσταότες περὶ Πατρόκλῳ, πρὸ δὲ δούρατ’ ἔχοντο.
356 Αἴας γὰρ μάλα πάντας ἐπώχετο πολλὰ κελεύων·
357 οὔτέ τιν’ ἐξοπίσω νεκροῦ χάζεσθαι ἀνώγει
358 οὔτέ τινα προμάχεσθαι Ἀχαιῶν ἔξοχον ἄλλων,
359 ἀλλὰ μάλ’ ἀμφ’ αὐτῷ βεβάμεν, σχεδόθεν δὲ μάχεσθαι.
360 ὣς Αἴας ἐπέτελλε πελώριος, αἵματι δὲ χθὼν
As he spoke he sprang out far in front of the others, who then rallied and again faced the Achaeans. Aeneas speared Leiokritos son of Arisbas, a valiant follower of Lykomedes, and Lykomedes was moved with pity as he saw him fall; he therefore went close up, and speared Apisaon son of Hippasus shepherd of his people in the liver under the midriff, so that he died; he had come from fertile Paeonia and was the best man of them all after Asteropaios. Asteropaios flew forward to avenge him and attack the Danaans, but this might no longer be, inasmuch as those about Patroklos were well covered by their shields, and held their spears in front of them, for Ajax had given them strict orders that no man was either to give ground, or to stand out before the others, but all were to hold well together about the body and fight hand to hand. Thus did huge Ajax bid them, and the earth ran red with blood as the corpses fell thick on one another alike on the side of the Trojans and allies, and on that of the Danaans; for these last, too, fought no bloodless fight though many fewer of them perished, through the care they took to defend and stand by one another. Thus did they fight as it were a flaming fire; it seemed as though it had gone hard even with the sun and moon, for they were hidden over all that part where the bravest heroes were fighting about the dead son of Menoitios, whereas the other Danaans and Achaeans fought at their ease in full daylight with brilliant sunshine all round them, and there was not a cloud to be seen neither on plain nor mountain. These last moreover would rest for a while and leave off fighting, for they were some distance apart and beyond the range of one another's weapons, whereas those who were in the thick of the fray suffered both from battle and darkness. All the best of them were being worn out by the great weight of their armor, but the two valiant heroes, Thrasymedes and Antilokhos, had not yet heard of the death of Patroklos, and believed him to be still alive and leading the van against the Trojans; they were keeping themselves in reserve against the death or rout of their own comrades, for so Nestor had ordered when he sent them from the ships into battle. Thus through the livelong day did they wage fierce war, and the sweat of their toil rained ever on their legs under them, and on their hands and eyes, as they fought over the squire [therapôn] of the fleet son of Peleus. It was as when a man gives a great ox-hide all drenched in fat to his men, and bids them stretch it; whereon they stand round it in a ring and tug till the moisture leaves it, and the fat soaks in for the many that pull at it, and it is well stretched - even so did the two sides tug the dead body hither and thither within the compass of but a little space - the Trojans steadfastly set on dragging it into Ilion, while the Achaeans were no less so on taking it to their ships; and fierce was the fight between them.

Not Ares himself the lord of hosts, nor yet Athena, even in their fullest fury could make light of such a battle. Such fearful turmoil [ponos] of men and horses did Zeus on that day ordain round the body of Patroklos. Meanwhile Achilles did not know that he had fallen, for the fight was under the wall of Troy a long way off the ships. He had no idea, therefore, that Patroklos was dead, and deemed that he would return alive as soon as he had gone close up to the gates. He knew that he was not to sack the city neither with nor without himself, for his mother had often told him this when he had sat alone with her, and she had informed him of the counsels of great Zeus. Now, however, she had not told him how great a disaster had befallen him in the death of the one who was far dearest to him of all his comrades. The others still kept on charging one another round the body with their pointed spears and killing each other. Then would one say, "My friends, we can never again show our faces at the ships - better, and greatly better, that earth should open and swallow us here in this place, than that we should let the Trojans have the triumph of bearing off Patroklos to their city." The Trojans also on their part spoke to one another saying, "Friends, though we fall to a man beside this body, let none shrink from fighting." With such words did they exhort each other. They fought and fought, and an iron clank rose through the void air to the brazen vault of heaven. The horses of the descendant of Aiakos stood out of the fight and wept when they heard that their driver had been laid low by the hand of murderous Hektor.

17.361

361 δεύετο πορφυρέῳ, τοὶ δ’ ἀγχιστῖνοι ἔπιπτον
362 νεκροὶ ὁμοῦ Τρώων καὶ ὑπερμενέων ἐπικούρων
363 καὶ Δαναῶν· οὐδ’ οἳ γὰρ ἀναιμωτί γε μάχοντο,
364 παυρότεροι δὲ πολὺ φθίνυθον· μέμνηντο γὰρ αἰεὶ
365 ἀλλήλοις ἀν’ ὅμιλον ἀλεξέμεναι φόνον αἰπύν.
366 ὣς οἳ μὲν μάρναντο δέμας πυρός, οὐδέ κε φαίης
367 οὔτέ ποτ’ ἠέλιον σῶν ἔμμεναι οὔτε σελήνην·
368 ἠέρι γὰρ κατέχοντο μάχης ἐπί θ’ ὅσσον ἄριστοι
369 ἔστασαν ἀμφὶ Μενοιτιάδῃ κατατεθνηῶτι.
370 οἳ δ’ ἄλλοι Τρῶες καὶ ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
371 εὔκηλοι πολέμιζον ὑπ’ αἰθέρι, πέπτατο δ’ αὐγὴ
372 ἠελίου ὀξεῖα, νέφος δ’ οὐ φαίνετο πάσης
373 γαίης οὐδ’ ὀρέων· μεταπαυόμενοι δὲ μάχοντο
374 ἀλλήλων ἀλεείνοντες βέλεα στονόεντα
375 πολλὸν ἀφεσταότες. τοὶ δ’ ἐν μέσῳ ἄλγε’ ἔπασχον
376 ἠέρι καὶ πολέμῳ, τείροντο δὲ νηλέϊ χαλκῷ
377 ὅσσοι ἄριστοι ἔσαν· δύο δ’ οὔ πω φῶτε πεπύσθην
378 ἀνέρε κυδαλίμω Θρασυμήδης Ἀντίλοχός τε
379 Πατρόκλοιο θανόντος ἀμύμονος, ἀλλ’ ἔτ’ ἔφαντο
380 ζωὸν ἐνὶ πρώτῳ ὁμάδῳ Τρώεσσι μάχεσθαι.
381 τὼ δ’ ἐπιοσσομένω θάνατον καὶ φύζαν ἑταίρων
382 νόσφιν ἐμαρνάσθην, ἐπεὶ ὣς ἐπετέλλετο Νέστωρ
383 ὀτρύνων πόλεμον δὲ μελαινάων ἀπὸ νηῶν.
384 τοῖς δὲ πανημερίοις ἔριδος μέγα νεῖκος ὀρώρει
385 ἀργαλέης· καμάτῳ δὲ καὶ ἱδρῷ νωλεμὲς αἰεὶ
386 γούνατά τε κνῆμαί τε πόδες θ’ ὑπένερθεν ἑκάστου
387 χεῖρές τ’ ὀφθαλμοί τε παλάσσετο μαρναμένοιιν
388 ἀμφ’ ἀγαθὸν θεράποντα ποδώκεος Αἰακίδαο.
389 ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἀνὴρ ταύροιο βοὸς μεγάλοιο βοείην
390 λαοῖσιν δώῃ τανύειν μεθύουσαν ἀλοιφῇ·

17.391

391 δεξάμενοι δ’ ἄρα τοί γε διαστάντες τανύουσι
392 κυκλόσ’, ἄφαρ δέ τε ἰκμὰς ἔβη, δύνει δέ τ’ ἀλοιφὴ
393 πολλῶν ἐλκόντων, τάνυται δέ τε πᾶσα διὰ πρό·
394 ὣς οἵ γ’ ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα νέκυν ὀλίγῃ ἐνὶ χώρῃ
395 εἵλκεον ἀμφότεροι· μάλα δέ σφισιν ἔλπετο θυμὸς
396 Τρωσὶν μὲν ἐρύειν προτὶ Ἴλιον, αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοῖς
397 νῆας ἔπι γλαφυράς· περὶ δ’ αὐτοῦ μῶλος ὀρώρει
398 ἄγριος· οὐδέ κ’ Ἄρης λαοσσόος οὐδέ κ’ Ἀθήνη
399 τόν γε ἰδοῦσ’ ὀνόσαιτ’, οὐδ’ εἰ μάλα μιν χόλος ἴκοι·
400 τοῖον Ζεὺς ἐπὶ Πατρόκλῳ ἀνδρῶν τε καὶ ἵππων
401 ἤματι τῷ ἐτάνυσσε κακὸν πόνον· οὐδ’ ἄρα πώ τι
402 ᾔδεε Πάτροκλον τεθνηότα δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
403 πολλὸν γὰρ ῥ’ ἀπάνευθε νεῶν μάρναντο θοάων
404 τείχει ὕπο Τρώων· τό μιν οὔ ποτε ἔλπετο θυμῷ
405 τεθνάμεν, ἀλλὰ ζωὸν ἐνιχριμφθέντα πύλῃσιν
406 ἂψ ἀπονοστήσειν, ἐπεὶ οὐδὲ τὸ ἔλπετο πάμπαν
407 ἐκπέρσειν πτολίεθρον ἄνευ ἔθεν, οὐδὲ σὺν αὐτῷ·
408 πολλάκι γὰρ τό γε μητρὸς ἐπεύθετο νόσφιν ἀκούων,
409 ἥ οἱ ἀπαγγέλλεσκε Διὸς μεγάλοιο νόημα.
410 δὴ τότε γ’ οὔ οἱ ἔειπε κακὸν τόσον ὅσσον ἐτύχθη
411 μήτηρ, ὅττί ῥά οἱ πολὺ φίλτατος ὤλεθ’ ἑταῖρος.
412 οἳ δ’ αἰεὶ περὶ νεκρὸν ἀκαχμένα δούρατ’ ἔχοντες
413 νωλεμὲς ἐγχρίμπτοντο καὶ ἀλλήλους ἐνάριζον·
414 ὧδε δέ τις εἶπεσκεν Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων·
415 ὦ φίλοι οὐ μὰν ἦμιν ἐϋκλεὲς ἀπονέεσθαι
416 νῆας ἔπι γλαφυράς, ἀλλ’ αὐτοῦ γαῖα μέλαινα
417 πᾶσι χάνοι· τό κεν ἦμιν ἄφαρ πολὺ κέρδιον εἴη
418 εἰ τοῦτον Τρώεσσι μεθήσομεν ἱπποδάμοισιν
419 ἄστυ πότι σφέτερον ἐρύσαι καὶ κῦδος ἀρέσθαι.
420 ὣς δέ τις αὖ Τρώων μεγαθύμων αὐδήσασκεν·

17.421

421 ὦ φίλοι, εἰ καὶ μοῖρα παρ’ ἀνέρι τῷδε δαμῆναι
422 πάντας ὁμῶς, μή πώ τις ἐρωείτω πολέμοιο.
423 ὣς ἄρα τις εἶπεσκε, μένος δ’ ὄρσασκεν ἑκάστου.
424 ὣς οἳ μὲν μάρναντο, σιδήρειος δ’ ὀρυμαγδὸς
425 χάλκεον οὐρανὸν ἷκε δι’ αἰθέρος ἀτρυγέτοιο·
426 ἵπποι δ’ Αἰακίδαο μάχης ἀπάνευθεν ἐόντες
427 κλαῖον, ἐπεὶ δὴ πρῶτα πυθέσθην ἡνιόχοιο
428 ἐν κονίῃσι πεσόντος ὑφ’ Ἕκτορος ἀνδροφόνοιο.
429 ἦ μὰν Αὐτομέδων Διώρεος ἄλκιμος υἱὸς
430 πολλὰ μὲν ἀρ μάστιγι θοῇ ἐπεμαίετο θείνων,
431 πολλὰ δὲ μειλιχίοισι προσηύδα, πολλὰ δ’ ἀρειῇ·
432 τὼ δ’ οὔτ’ ἂψ ἐπὶ νῆας ἐπὶ πλατὺν Ἑλλήσποντον
433 ἠθελέτην ἰέναι οὔτ’ ἐς πόλεμον μετ’ Ἀχαιούς,
434 ἀλλ’ ὥς τε στήλη μένει ἔμπεδον, ἥ τ’ ἐπὶ τύμβῳ
435 ἀνέρος ἐστήκῃ τεθνηότος ἠὲ γυναικός,
436 ὣς μένον ἀσφαλέως περικαλλέα δίφρον ἔχοντες
437 οὔδει ἐνισκίμψαντε καρήατα· δάκρυα δέ σφι
438 θερμὰ κατὰ βλεφάρων χαμάδις ῥέε μυρομένοισιν

439 ἠνιόχοιο πόθῳ· θαλερὴ δ’ ἐμιαίνετο χαίτη
440 ζεύγλης ἐξεριποῦσα παρὰ ζυγὸν ἀμφοτέρωθεν.
441 μυρομένω δ’ ἄρα τώ γε ἰδὼν ἐλέησε Κρονίων,
442 κινήσας δὲ κάρη προτὶ ὃν μυθήσατο θυμόν·
443 ἆ δειλώ, τί σφῶϊ δόμεν Πηλῆϊ ἄνακτι
444 θνητῷ, ὑμεῖς δ’ ἐστὸν ἀγήρω τ’ ἀθανάτω τε;
445 ἦ ἵνα δυστήνοισι μετ’ ἀνδράσιν ἄλγε’ ἔχητον;
446 οὐ μὲν γάρ τί πού ἐστιν ὀϊζυρώτερον ἀνδρὸς
447 πάντων, ὅσσά τε γαῖαν ἔπι πνείει τε καὶ ἕρπει.
448 ἀλλ’ οὐ μὰν ὑμῖν γε καὶ ἅρμασι δαιδαλέοισιν
449 Ἕκτωρ Πριαμίδης ἐποχήσεται· οὐ γὰρ ἐάσω.
450 ἦ οὐχ ἅλις ὡς καὶ τεύχε’ ἔχει καὶ ἐπεύχεται αὖτως;
Automedon, valiant son of Diores, lashed them again and again; many a time did he speak kindly to them, and many a time did he upbraid them, but they would neither go back to the ships by the waters of the broad Hellespont, nor yet into battle among the Achaeans; they stood with their chariot stock still, as a pillar set over the tomb of some dead man or woman, and bowed their heads to the ground. Hot tears fell from their eyes as they mourned the loss of their charioteer, and their noble manes drooped all wet from under the yokestraps on either side the yoke. The son of Kronos saw them and took pity upon their sorrow. He wagged his head, and muttered to himself, saying, "Poor things, why did we give you to King Peleus who is a mortal, while you are yourselves ageless and immortal? Was it that you might share the sorrows that befall humankind? for of all creatures that live and move upon the earth there is none so pitiable as he is - still, Hektor son of Priam shall drive neither you nor your chariot. I will not have it. It is enough that he should have the armor over which he vaunts so vainly. Furthermore I will give you strength of heart and limb to bear Automedon safely to the ships from battle, for I shall let the Trojans triumph still further, and go on killing till they reach the ships; whereon night shall fall and darkness overshadow the land." As he spoke he breathed heart and strength into the horses so that they shook the dust from out of their manes, and bore their chariot swiftly into the fight that raged between Trojans and Achaeans. Behind them fought Automedon full of sorrow for his comrade, as a vulture amid a flock of geese. In and out, and here and there, full speed he dashed amid the throng of the Trojans, but for all the fury of his pursuit he killed no man, for he could not wield his spear and keep his horses in hand when alone in the chariot; at last, however, a comrade, Alkimedon, son of Laerkes son of Haimon caught sight of him and came up behind his chariot. "Automedon," said he, "what god has put this folly into your heart and robbed you of your right mind, that you fight the Trojans in the front rank single-handed? He who was your comrade is slain, and Hektor plumes himself on being armed in the armor of the descendant of Aiakos." Automedon son of Diores answered, "Alkimedon, there is no one else who can control and guide the immortal steeds so well as you can, save only Patroklos - while he was alive - peer of gods in counsel. Take then the whip and reins, while I go down from the car and fight. Alkimedon sprang on to the chariot, and caught up the whip and reins, while Automedon leaped from off the car. When Hektor saw him he said to Aeneas who was near him, "Aeneas, counselor of the mail-clad Trojans, I see the steeds of the fleet son of Aiakos come into battle with weak hands to drive them. I am sure, if you think well, that we might take them; they will not dare face us if we both attack them." The valiant son of Anchises was of the same mind, and the pair went right on, with their shoulders covered under shields of tough dry ox-hide, overlaid with much bronze. Chromios and Aretos went also with them, and their hearts beat high with hope that they might kill the men and capture the horses - fools that they were, for they were not to return scatheless from their meeting with Automedon, who prayed to father Zeus and was forthwith filled with courage and strength abounding. He turned to his trusty comrade

Alkimedon and said, "Alkimedon, keep your horses so close up that I may feel their breath upon my back; I doubt that we shall not stay Hektor son of Priam till he has killed us and mounted behind the horses; he will then either spread panic among the ranks of the Achaeans, or himself be killed among the foremost." On this he cried out to the two Ajaxes and Menelaos, "Ajaxes leaders of the Argives, and Menelaos, give the dead body over to them that are best able to defend it, and come to the rescue of us living; for Hektor and Aeneas who are the two best men among the Trojans, are pressing us hard in the full tide of war. Nevertheless the issue lies on the lap of heaven, I will therefore hurl my spear and leave the rest to Zeus." He poised and hurled as he spoke, whereon the spear struck the round shield of Aretos, and went right through it for the shield stayed it not, so that it was driven through his belt into the lower part of his belly. As when some sturdy youth, axe in hand, deals his blow behind the horns of an ox and severs the tendons at the back of its neck so that it springs forward and then drops, even so did Aretos give one bound and then fall on his back the spear quivering in his body till it made an end of him. Hektor then aimed a spear at Automedon but he saw it coming and stooped forward to avoid it, so that it flew past him and the point stuck in the ground, while the butt-end went on quivering till Ares robbed it of its force. They would then have fought hand to hand with swords had not the two Ajaxes forced their way through the crowd when they heard their comrade calling, and parted them for all their fury - for Hektor, Aeneas, and Chromios were afraid and drew back, leaving Aretos to lie there struck to the heart. Automedon, peer of fleet Ares, then stripped him of his armor and vaunted over him saying, "I have done little to assuage my sorrow [akhos] for the son of Menoitios, for the man I have killed is not so good as he was." As he spoke he took the blood-stained spoils and laid them upon his chariot; then he mounted the car with his hands and feet all steeped in gore as a lion that has been gorging upon a bull.

17.451

σφῶϊν δ’ ἐν γούνεσσι βαλῶ μένος ἠδ’ ἐνὶ θυμῷ,
ὄφρα καὶ Αὐτομέδοντα σαώσετον ἐκ πολέμοιο
νῆας ἔπι γλαφυράς· ἔτι γάρ σφισι κῦδος ὀρέξω
κτείνειν, εἰς ὅ κε νῆας ἐϋσσέλμους ἀφίκωνται
δύῃ τ’ ἠέλιος καὶ ἐπὶ κνέφας ἱερὸν ἔλθῃ·
ὣς εἰπὼν ἵπποισιν ἐνέπνευσεν μένος ἠΰ.
τὼ δ’ ἀπὸ χαιτάων κονίην οὖδας δὲ βαλόντε
ῥίμφα φέρον θοὸν ἅρμα μετὰ Τρῶας καὶ Ἀχαιούς.
τοῖσι δ’ ἐπ’ Αὐτομέδων μάχετ’ ἀχνύμενός περ ἑταίρου
ἵπποις ἀΐσσων ὥς τ’ αἰγυπιὸς μετὰ χῆνας·
ῥέα μὲν γὰρ φεύγεσκεν ὑπ’ ἐκ Τρώων ὀρυμαγδοῦ,
ῥεῖα δ’ ἐπαΐξασκε πολὺν καθ’ ὅμιλον ὀπάζων.
ἀλλ’ οὐχ ἥρει φῶτας ὅτε σεύαιτο διώκειν·
οὐ γάρ πως ἦν οἷον ἐόνθ’ ἱερῷ ἐνὶ δίφρῳ
ἔγχει ἐφορμᾶσθαι καὶ ἐπίσχειν ὠκέας ἵππους.
ὀψὲ δὲ δή μιν ἑταῖρος ἀνὴρ ἴδεν ὀφθαλμοῖσιν
Ἀλκιμέδων υἱὸς Λαέρκεος Αἱμονίδαο·
στῆ δ’ ὄπιθεν δίφροιο καὶ Αὐτομέδοντα προσηύδα·
Αὐτόμεδον, τίς τοί νυ θεῶν νηκερδέα βουλὴν
ἐν στήθεσσιν ἔθηκε, καὶ ἐξέλετο φρένας ἐσθλάς;
οἷον πρὸς Τρῶας μάχεαι πρώτῳ ἐν ὁμίλῳ
μοῦνος· ἀτάρ τοι ἑταῖρος ἀπέκτατο, τεύχεα δ’ Ἕκτωρ
αὐτὸς ἔχων ὤμοισιν ἀγάλλεται Αἰακίδαο.
τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ Αὐτομέδων προσέφη Διώρεος υἱός·

Ἀλκίμεδον τίς γάρ τοι Ἀχαιῶν ἄλλος ὁμοῖος
ἵππων ἀθανάτων ἐχέμεν δμῆσίν τε μένος τε,
εἰ μὴ Πάτροκλος θεόφιν μήστωρ ἀτάλαντος
ζωὸς ἐών; νῦν αὖ θάνατος καὶ μοῖρα κιχάνει.
ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν μάστιγα καὶ ἡνία σιγαλόεντα
δέξαι, ἐγὼ δ’ ἵππων ἀποβήσομαι, ὄφρα μάχωμαι.

17.481

ὣς ἔφατ’, Ἀλκιμέδων δὲ βοηθόον ἄρμ’ ἐπορούσας
καρπαλίμως μάστιγα καὶ ἡνία λάζετο χερσίν,
Αὐτομέδων δ’ ἀπόρουσε· νόησε δὲ φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ,
αὐτίκα δ’ Αἰνείαν προσεφώνεεν ἐγγὺς ἐόντα·
Αἰνεία Τρώων βουληφόρε χαλκοχιτώνων
ἵππω τώδ’ ἐνόησα ποδώκεος Αἰακίδαο
ἐς πόλεμον προφανέντε σὺν ἡνιόχοισι κακοῖσι·
τώ κεν ἐελποίμην αἱρησέμεν, εἰ σύ γε θυμῷ
σῷ ἐθέλεις, ἐπεὶ οὐκ ἂν ἐφορμηθέντε γε νῶϊ
τλαῖεν ἐναντίβιον στάντες μαχέσασθαι Ἀρηϊ.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησεν ἐὺς πάϊς Ἀγχίσαο.
τὼ δ’ ἰθὺς βήτην βοέῃς εἰλυμένω ὤμους
αὔῃσι στερεῇσι· πολὺς δ’ ἐπελήλατο χαλκός.
τοῖσι δ’ ἅμα Χρομίος τε καὶ Ἄρητος θεοειδὴς
ἤϊσαν ἀμφότεροι· μάλα δέ σφισιν ἔλπετο θυμὸς
αὐτώ τε κτενέειν ἐλάαν τ’ ἐριαύχενας ἵππους
νήπιοι, οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔμελλον ἀναιμωτί γε νέεσθαι
αὖτις ἀπ’ Αὐτομέδοντος. ὃ δ’ εὐξάμενος Διὶ πατρὶ
ἀλκῆς καὶ σθένεος πλῆτο φρένας ἀμφὶ μελαίνας·
αὐτίκα δ’ Ἀλκιμέδοντα προσηύδα πιστὸν ἑταῖρον·
Ἀλκίμεδον μὴ δή μοι ἀπόπροθεν ἰσχέμεν ἵππους,
ἀλλὰ μάλ’ ἐμπνείοντε μεταφρένῳ· οὐ γὰρ ἔγωγε
Ἕκτορα Πριαμίδην μένεος σχήσεσθαι ὀΐω,
πρίν γ’ ἐπ’ Ἀχιλλῆος καλλίτριχε βήμεναι ἵππω
νῶϊ κατακτείναντα, φοβῆσαί τε στίχας ἀνδρῶν
Ἀργείων, ἤ κ’ αὐτὸς ἐνὶ πρώτοισιν ἁλοίη.
ὣς εἰπὼν Αἴαντε καλέσσατο καὶ Μενέλαον·
Αἴαντ’ Ἀργείων ἡγήτορε καὶ Μενέλαε
ἤτοι μὲν τὸν νεκρὸν ἐπιτράπεθ’ οἵ περ ἄριστοι
ἀμφ’ αὐτῷ βεβάμεν καὶ ἀμύνεσθαι στίχας ἀνδρῶν,

17.511

νῶϊν δὲ ζωοῖσιν ἀμύνετε νηλεὲς ἦμαρ·
τῇδε γὰρ ἔβρισαν πόλεμον κάτα δακρυόεντα
Ἕκτωρ Αἰνείας θ’, οἳ Τρώων εἰσὶν ἄριστοι.
ἀλλ’ ἤτοι μὲν ταῦτα θεῶν ἐν γούνασι κεῖται·
ἥσω γὰρ καὶ ἐγώ, τὰ δέ κεν Διὶ πάντα μελήσει.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἀμπεπαλὼν προΐει δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος,
καὶ βάλεν Ἀρήτοιο κατ’ ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην·
ἣ δ’ οὐκ ἔγχος ἔρυτο, διὰ πρὸ δὲ εἴσατο χαλκός,
νειαίρῃ δ’ ἐν γαστρὶ διὰ ζωστῆρος ἔλασσεν.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἂν ὀξὺν ἔχων πέλεκυν αἰζήϊος ἀνὴρ

κόψας ἐξόπιθεν κεράων βοὸς ἀγραύλοιο
ἶνα τάμῃ διὰ πᾶσαν, ὃ δὲ προθορὼν ἐρίπῃσιν,
ὣς ἄρ’ ὅ γε προθορὼν πέσεν ὕπτιος· ἐν δέ οἱ ἔγχος
νηδυίοισι μάλ’ ὀξὺ κραδαινόμενον λύε γυῖα.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ Αὐτομέδοντος ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ·
ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν ἄντα ἰδὼν ἠλεύατο χάλκεον ἔγχος·
πρόσσω γὰρ κατέκυψε, τὸ δ’ ἐξόπιθεν δόρυ μακρὸν
οὔδει ἐνισκίμφθη, ἐπὶ δ’ οὐρίαχος πελεμίχθη
ἔγχεος· ἔνθα δ’ ἔπειτ’ ἀφίει μένος ὄβριμος Ἄρης.
καί νύ κε δὴ ξιφέεσσ’ αὐτοσχεδὸν ὁρμηθήτην
εἰ μή σφω’ Αἴαντε διέκριναν μεμαῶτε,
οἵ ῥ’ ἦλθον καθ’ ὅμιλον ἑταίρου κικλήσκοντος·
τοὺς ὑποταρβήσαντες ἐχώρησαν πάλιν αὖτις
Ἕκτωρ Αἰνείας τ’ ἠδὲ Χρομίος θεοειδής,
Ἄρητον δὲ κατ’ αὖθι λίπον δεδαϊγμένον ἦτορ
κείμενον· Αὐτομέδων δὲ θοῷ ἀτάλαντος Ἄρηϊ
τεύχεά τ’ ἐξενάριξε καὶ εὐχόμενος ἔπος ηὔδα·
ἦ δὴ μὰν ὀλίγον γε Μενοιτιάδαο θανόντος
κῆρ ἄχεος μεθέηκα χερείονά περ καταπέφνων.
ὣς εἰπὼν ἐς δίφρον ἐλὼν ἔναρα βροτόεντα

17.541

θῆκ’, ἂν δ’ αὐτὸς ἔβαινε πόδας καὶ χεῖρας ὕπερθεν
αἱματόεις ὥς τίς τε λέων κατὰ ταῦρον ἐδηδώς.
ἂψ δ’ ἐπὶ Πατρόκλῳ τέτατο κρατερὴ ὑσμίνη
ἀργαλέη πολύδακρυς, ἔγειρε δὲ νεῖκος Ἀθήνη
οὐρανόθεν καταβᾶσα· προῆκε γὰρ εὐρύοπα Ζεὺς
ὀρνύμεναι Δαναούς· δὴ γὰρ νόος ἐτράπετ’ αὐτοῦ.
ἠΰτε πορφυρέην ἶριν θνητοῖσι τανύσσῃ
Ζεὺς ἐξ οὐρανόθεν τέρας ἔμμεναι ἢ πολέμοιο
ἢ καὶ χειμῶνος δυσθαλπέος, ὅς ῥά τε ἔργων
ἀνθρώπους ἀνέπαυσεν ἐπὶ χθονί, μῆλα δὲ κήδει,
ὣς ἢ πορφυρέῃ νεφέλῃ πυκάσασα ἓ αὐτὴν
δύσετ’ Ἀχαιῶν ἔθνος, ἔγειρε δὲ φῶτα ἕκαστον.
πρῶτον δ’ Ἀτρέος υἱὸν ἐποτρύνουσα προσηύδα
ἴφθιμον Μενέλαον· ὃ γάρ ῥά οἱ ἐγγύθεν ἦεν·
εἰσαμένη Φοίνικι δέμας καὶ ἀτειρέα φωνήν·
σοὶ μὲν δὴ Μενέλαε κατηφείη καὶ ὄνειδος
ἔσσεται εἴ κ’ Ἀχιλῆος ἀγαυοῦ πιστὸν ἑταῖρον
τείχει ὕπο Τρώων ταχέες κύνες ἐλκήσουσιν.
ἀλλ’ ἔχεο κρατερῶς, ὄτρυνε δὲ λαὸν ἅπαντα.
τὴν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος·
Φοῖνιξ ἄττα γεραιὲ παλαιγενές, εἰ γὰρ Ἀθήνη
δοίη κάρτος ἐμοί, βελέων δ’ ἀπερύκοι ἐρωήν·
τώ κεν ἔγωγ’ ἐθέλοιμι παρεστάμεναι καὶ ἀμύνειν
Πατρόκλῳ· μάλα γάρ με θανὼν ἐσεμάσσατο θυμόν.
ἀλλ’ Ἕκτωρ πυρὸς αἰνὸν ἔχει μένος, οὐδ’ ἀπολήγει
χαλκῷ δηϊόων· τῷ γὰρ Ζεὺς κῦδος ὀπάζει.
ὣς φάτο, γήθησεν δὲ θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη,
ὅττί ῥά οἱ πάμπρωτα θεῶν ἠρήσατο πάντων.
ἐν δὲ βίην ὤμοισι καὶ ἐν γούνεσσιν ἔθηκε,

570 καί οἱ μυίης θάρσος ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἐνῆκεν,
And now the fierce groanful fight again raged about Patroklos, for Athena came down from heaven and roused its fury by the command of far-seeing Zeus, who had changed his mind [noos] and sent her to encourage the Danaans. As when Zeus bends his bright bow in heaven in token to humankind either of war or of the chill storms that stay men from their labor and plague the flocks - even so, wrapped in such radiant raiment, did Athena go in among the host and speak man by man to each. First she took the form and voice of Phoenix and spoke to Menelaos son of Atreus, who was standing near her. "Menelaos," said she, "it will be shame and dishonor to you, if dogs tear the noble comrade of Achilles under the walls of Troy. Therefore be staunch, and urge your men to be so also." Menelaos answered, "Phoenix, my good old friend, may Athena grant me strength and keep the darts from off me, for so shall I stand by Patroklos and defend him; his death has gone to my heart, but Hektor is as a raging fire and deals his blows without ceasing, for Zeus is now granting him a time of triumph." Athena was pleased at his having named herself before any of the other gods. Therefore she put strength into his knees and shoulders, and made him as bold as a fly, which, though driven off will yet come again and bite if it can, so dearly does it love man's blood- even so bold as this did she make him as he stood over Patroklos and threw his spear. Now there was among the Trojans a man named Podes, son of Eetion, who was both rich and valiant. Hektor held him in the highest honor in the district [dêmos], for he was his comrade and boon companion; the spear of Menelaos struck this man in the belt just as he had turned in flight, and went right through him. Whereon he fell heavily forward, and Menelaos son of Atreus drew off his body from the Trojans into the ranks of his own people. Apollo then went up to Hektor and spurred him on to fight, in the likeness of Phainops son of Asios who lived in Abydos and was the most favored of all Hektor's guests. In his likeness Apollo said, "Hektor, who of the Achaeans will fear you henceforward now that you have quailed before Menelaos who has ever been rated poorly as a warrior? Yet he has now got a corpse away from the Trojans single-handed, and has slain your own true comrade, a man brave among the foremost, Podes son of Eetion. A dark cloud of grief [akhos] fell upon Hektor as he heard, and he made his way to the front clad in full armor. Thereon the son of Kronos seized his bright tasseled aegis, and veiled Ida in cloud: he sent forth his lightnings and his thunders, and as he shook his aegis he gave victory to the Trojans and routed the Achaeans. The panic was begun by Peneleos the Boeotian, for while keeping his face turned ever towards the foe he had been hit with a spear on the upper part of the shoulder; a spear thrown by Polydamas had grazed the top of the bone, for Polydamas had come up to him and struck him from close at hand. Then Hektor in close combat struck Leitos son of noble Alektryon in the hand by the wrist, and disabled him from fighting further. He looked about him in dismay, knowing that never again should he wield spear in battle with the Trojans. While Hektor was in pursuit of Leitos, Idomeneus struck him on the breastplate over his chest near the nipple; but the spear broke in the shaft, and the Trojans cheered aloud. Hektor then aimed at Idomeneus son of Deukalion as he was standing on his chariot, and very narrowly missed him, but the spear hit Koiranos, a follower and charioteer of Meriones who had come with him from Lyktos. Idomeneus had left the ships on foot and would have afforded a great triumph to the Trojans if Koiranos had not driven quickly up to him, he therefore brought life and rescue to Idomeneus, but himself fell by the hand of murderous Hektor. For Hektor hit him on the jaw under the ear; the end of the spear drove out his teeth and cut his tongue in two pieces, so that he fell from his chariot and let the reins fall to the ground. Meriones gathered them up from the ground and took them into his own hands, then he said to Idomeneus, "Lay on, till you get back to the ships, for you must see that the day is no longer ours." On this Idomeneus lashed the horses to the ships, for fear had taken hold upon him.

17.571

ἥ τε καὶ ἐργομένη μάλα περ χροὸς ἀνδρομέοιο
ἰσχανάᾳ δακέειν, λαρόν τέ οἱ αἷμ’ ἀνθρώπου·
τοίου μιν θάρσευς πλῆσε φρένας ἀμφὶ μελαίνας,
βῆ δ’ ἐπὶ Πατρόκλῳ, καὶ ἀκόντισε δουρὶ φαεινῷ.
ἔσκε δ’ ἐνὶ Τρώεσσι Ποδῆς υἱὸς Ἠετίωνος
ἀφνειός τ’ ἀγαθός τε· μάλιστα δέ μιν τίεν Ἕκτωρ
δήμου, ἐπεί οἱ ἑταῖρος ἔην φίλος εἰλαπιναστής·
τόν ῥα κατὰ ζωστῆρα βάλε ξανθὸς Μενέλαος
ἀΐξαντα φόβον δέ, διὰ πρὸ δὲ χαλκὸν ἔλασσε·
δούπησεν δὲ πεσών· ἀτὰρ Ἀτρεΐδης Μενέλαος
νεκρὸν ὑπ’ ἐκ Τρώων ἔρυσεν μετὰ ἔθνος ἑταίρων.
Ἕκτορα δ’ ἐγγύθεν ἱστάμενος ὄτρυνεν Ἀπόλλων
Φαίνοπι Ἀσιάδῃ ἐναλίγκιος, ὅς οἱ ἀπάντων
ξείνων φίλτατος ἔσκεν Ἀβυδόθι οἰκία ναίων·
τῷ μιν ἐεισάμενος προσέφη ἑκάεργος Ἀπόλλων·
Ἕκτορ τίς κέ σ’ ἔτ’ ἄλλος Ἀχαιῶν ταρβήσειεν;
οἷον δὴ Μενέλαον ὑπέτρεσας, ὃς τὸ πάρος γε
μαλθακὸς αἰχμητής· νῦν δ’ οἴχεται οἷος ἀείρας
νεκρὸν ὑπ’ ἐκ Τρώων, σὸν δ’ ἔκτανε πιστὸν ἑταῖρον
ἐσθλὸν ἐνὶ προμάχοισι Ποδῆν υἱὸν Ἠετίωνος.
ὣς φάτο, τὸν δ’ ἄχεος νεφέλη ἐκάλυψε μέλαινα,
βῆ δὲ διὰ προμάχων κεκορυθμένος αἴθοπι χαλκῷ.
καὶ τότ’ ἄρα Κρονίδης ἔλετ’ αἰγίδα θυσσανόεσσαν
μαρμαρέην, Ἴδην δὲ κατὰ νεφέεσσι κάλυψεν,
ἀστράψας δὲ μάλα μεγάλ’ ἔκτυπε, τὴν δὲ τίναξε,
νίκην δὲ Τρώεσσι δίδου, ἐφόβησε δ’ Ἀχαιούς.
πρῶτος Πηνέλεως Βοιώτιος ἦρχε φόβοιο.
βλῆτο γὰρ ὦμον δουρὶ πρόσω τετραμμένος αἰεὶ
ἄκρον ἐπιλίγδην· γράψεν δέ οἱ ὀστέον ἄχρις
αἰχμὴ Πουλυδάμαντος· ὃ γάρ ῥ’ ἔβαλε σχεδὸν ἐλθών.

17.601

Λήϊτον αὖθ’ Ἕκτωρ σχεδὸν οὔτασε χεῖρ’ ἐπὶ καρπῷ
υἱὸν Ἀλεκτρυόνος μεγαθύμου, παῦσε δὲ χάρμης·
τρέσσε δὲ παπτήνας, ἐπεὶ οὐκέτι ἔλπετο θυμῷ
ἔγχος ἔχων ἐν χειρὶ μαχήσεσθαι Τρώεσσιν.
Ἕκτορα δ’ Ἰδομενεὺς μετὰ Λήϊτον ὁρμηθέντα
βεβλήκει θώρηκα κατὰ στῆθος παρὰ μαζόν·
ἐν καυλῷ δ’ ἐάγη δολιχὸν δόρυ, τοὶ δὲ βόησαν
Τρῶες· ὃ δ’ Ἰδομενῆος ἀκόντισε Δευκαλίδαο
δίφρῳ ἐφεσταότος· τοῦ μέν ῥ’ ἀπὸ τυτθὸν ἅμαρτεν·
αὐτὰρ ὃ Μηριόναο ὀπάονά θ’ ἡνίοχόν τε
Κοίρανον, ὅς ῥ’ ἐκ Λύκτου ἐϋκτιμένης ἔπετ’ αὐτῷ·
πεζὸς γὰρ τὰ πρῶτα λιπὼν νέας ἀμφιελίσσας
ἦλυθε, καί κε Τρωσὶ μέγα κράτος ἐγγυάλιξεν,
εἰ μὴ Κοίρανος ὦκα ποδώκεας ἤλασεν ἵππους·
καὶ τῷ μὲν φάος ἦλθεν, ἄμυνε δὲ νηλεὲς ἦμαρ,
αὐτὸς δ’ ὤλεσε θυμὸν ὑφ’ Ἕκτορος ἀνδροφόνοιο·
τὸν βάλ’ ὑπὸ γναθμοῖο καὶ οὔατος, ἐκ δ’ ἄρ’ ὀδόντας
ὦσε δόρυ πρυμνόν, διὰ δὲ γλῶσσαν τάμε μέσσην.

619 ἤριπε δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων, κατὰ δ’ ἠνία χεῦεν ἔραζε.
620 καὶ τά γε Μηριόνης ἔλαβεν χείρεσσι φίλῃσι
621 κύψας ἐκ πεδίοιο, καὶ Ἰδομενῆα προσηύδα·
622 μάστιε νῦν εἶός κε θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας ἵκηαι·
623 γιγνώσκεις δὲ καὶ αὐτὸς ὅ τ’ οὐκέτι κάρτος Ἀχαιῶν.
624 ὣς ἔφατ’, Ἰδομενεὺς δ’ ἵμασεν καλλίτριχας ἵππους
625 νῆας ἔπι γλαφυράς· δὴ γὰρ δέος ἔμπεσε θυμῷ.
626 οὐδ’ ἔλαθ’ Αἴαντα μεγαλήτορα καὶ Μενέλαον
627 Ζεύς, ὅτε δὴ Τρώεσσι δίδου ἑτεραλκέα νίκην.
628 τοῖσι δὲ μύθων ἦρχε μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας·
629 ὢ πόποι ἤδη μέν κε καὶ ὃς μάλα νήπιός ἐστι
630 γνοίη ὅτι Τρώεσσι πατὴρ Ζεὺς αὐτὸς ἀρήγει.
Ajax and Menelaos noted how Zeus had turned the scale in favor of the Trojans, and Ajax was first to speak. "Alas," said he, "even a fool may see that father Zeus is helping the Trojans. All their weapons strike home; no matter whether it be a brave man or a coward that hurls them, Zeus speeds all alike, whereas ours fall each one of them without effect. What, then, will be best both as regards rescuing the body, and our return to the joy of our friends who will be grieving as they look hitherwards; for they will make sure that nothing can now check the terrible hands of Hektor, and that he will fling himself upon our ships. I wish that some one would go and tell the son of Peleus at once, for I do not think he can have yet heard the sad news that the dearest of his friends has fallen. But I can see not a man among the Achaeans to send, for they and their chariots are alike hidden in darkness. O father Zeus, lift this cloud from over the sons of the Achaeans; make heaven serene, and let us see; if you will that we perish, let us fall at any rate by daylight." Father Zeus heard him and had compassion upon his tears. Forthwith he chased away the cloud of darkness, so that the sun shone out and all the fighting was revealed. Ajax then said to Menelaos, "Look, Menelaos, and if Antilokhos son of Nestor be still living, send him at once to tell Achilles that by far the dearest to him of all his comrades has fallen." Menelaos heeded his words and went his way as a lion from a stockyard - the lion is tired of attacking the men and hounds, who keep watch the whole night through and will not let him feast on the fat of their herd. In his lust of meat he makes straight at them but in vain, for darts from strong hands assail him, and burning brands which daunt him for all his hunger, so in the morning he slinks sulkily away - even so did Menelaos sorely against his will leave Patroklos, in great fear lest the Achaeans should be driven back in rout and let him fall into the hands of the foe. He charged Meriones and the two Ajaxes straitly saying, "Ajaxes and Meriones, leaders of the Argives, now indeed remember how good Patroklos was; he was ever courteous while alive, bear it in mind now that he is dead." With this Menelaos left them, looking round him as keenly as an eagle, whose sight they say is keener than that of any other bird - however high he may be in the heavens, not a hare that runs can escape him by crouching under bush or thicket, for he will swoop down upon it and make an end of it - even so, O Menelaos, did your keen eyes range round the mighty host of your followers to see if you could find the son of Nestor still alive. Presently Menelaos saw him on the extreme left of the battle cheering on his men and exhorting them to fight boldly. Menelaos went up to him and said, "Antilokhos, come here and listen to sad news, which I would indeed were untrue. You must see with your own eyes that heaven is heaping calamity upon the Danaans, and giving victory to the Trojans. Patroklos has fallen, who was the bravest of the Achaeans, and sorely will the Danaans miss him. Run instantly to the ships and tell Achilles, that he may come to rescue the body and bear it to the ships. As for the armor, Hektor already has it." Antilokhos was struck with horror. For a long time he was speechless; his eyes filled with tears and he could find no utterance, but he did as Menelaos had said, and set off running as soon as he had given his armor to a comrade, Laodokos,

who was wheeling his horses round, close beside him. Thus, then, did he run weeping from the field, to carry the bad news to Achilles son of Peleus. Nor were you, O Menelaos, minded to succor his harassed comrades, when Antilokhos had left the Pylians - and greatly did they miss him - but he sent them noble Thrasymedes, and himself went back to Patroklos. He came running up to the two Ajaxes and said, "I have sent Antilokhos to the ships to tell Achilles, but rage against Hektor as he may, he cannot come, for he cannot fight without armor. What then will be our best plan both as regards rescuing the dead, and our own escape from death amid the battle-cries of the Trojans?" Ajax answered, "Menelaos, you have said well: do you, then, and Meriones stoop down, raise the body, and bear it out of the fray [ponos], while we two behind you keep off Hektor and the Trojans, one in heart as in name, and long used to fighting side by side with one another." On this Menelaos and Meriones took the dead man in their arms and lifted him high aloft with a great effort. The Trojan host raised a hue and cry behind them when they saw the Achaeans bearing the body away, and flew after them like hounds attacking a wounded boar at the loo of a band of young huntsmen. For a while the hounds fly at him as though they would tear him in pieces, but now and again he turns on them in a fury, scaring and scattering them in all directions - even so did the Trojans for a while charge in a body, striking with sword and with spears pointed at both the ends, but when the two Ajaxes faced them and stood at bay, they would turn pale and no man dared press on to fight further about the dead.

17.631

631 τῶν μὲν γὰρ πάντων βέλε’ ἅπτεται ὅς τις ἀφήῃ
632 ἢ κακὸς ἢ ἀγαθός· Ζεὺς δ’ ἔμπης πάντ’ ἰθύνει·
633 ἡμῖν δ’ αὖτως πᾶσιν ἐτώσια πίπτει ἔραζε.
634 ἀλλ’ ἄγετ’ αὐτοί περ φραζώμεθα μῆτιν ἀρίστην,
635 ἡμὲν ὅπως τὸν νεκρὸν ἐρύσσομεν, ἠδὲ καὶ αὐτοὶ
636 χάρμα φίλοις ἑτάροισι γενώμεθα νοστήσαντες,
637 οἵ που δεῦρ’ ὁρόωντες ἀκηχέδατ’, οὐδ’ ἔτι φασὶν
638 Ἕκτορος ἀνδροφόνοιο μένος καὶ χεῖρας ἀάπτους
639 σχήσεσθ’, ἀλλ’ ἐν νηυσὶ μελαίνῃσιν πεσέεσθαι.
640 εἴη δ’ ὅς τις ἑταῖρος ἀπαγγείλειε τάχιστα
641 Πηλεΐδῃ, ἐπεὶ οὔ μιν ὀΐομαι οὐδὲ πεπύσθαι
642 λυγρῆς ἀγγελίης, ὅτι οἱ φίλος ὤλεθ’ ἑταῖρος.
643 ἀλλ’ οὔ πῃ δύναμαι ἰδέειν τοιοῦτον Ἀχαιῶν·
644 ἠέρι γὰρ κατέχονται ὁμῶς αὐτοί τε καὶ ἵπποι.
645 Ζεῦ πάτερ ἀλλὰ σὺ ῥῦσαι ὑπ’ ἠέρος υἷας Ἀχαιῶν,
646 ποίησον δ’ αἴθρην, δὸς δ’ ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ἰδέσθαι·
647 ἐν δὲ φάει καὶ ὄλεσσον, ἐπεί νύ τοι εὔαδεν οὕτως.
648 ὣς φάτο, τὸν δὲ πατὴρ ὀλοφύρατο δάκρυ χέοντα·
649 αὐτίκα δ’ ἠέρα μὲν σκέδασεν καὶ ἀπῶσεν ὀμίχλην,
650 ἠέλιος δ’ ἐπέλαμψε, μάχη δ’ ἐπὶ πᾶσα φαάνθη·
651 καὶ τότ’ ἄρ’ Αἴας εἶπε βοὴν ἀγαθὸν Μενέλαον·
652 σκέπτεο νῦν Μενέλαε διοτρεφὲς αἴ κεν ἴδηαι
653 ζωὸν ἔτ’ Ἀντίλοχον μεγαθύμου Νέστορος υἱόν,
654 ὄτρυνον δ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ δαΐφρονι θᾶσσον ἰόντα
655 εἰπεῖν ὅττι ῥά οἱ πολὺ φίλτατος ὤλεθ’ ἑταῖρος.
656 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος,
657 βῆ δ’ ἰέναι ὥς τίς τε λέων ἀπὸ μεσσαύλοιο,
658 ὅς τ’ ἐπεὶ ἄρ κε κάμῃσι κύνας τ’ ἄνδρας τ’ ἐρεθίζων,
659 οἵ τέ μιν οὐκ εἰῶσι βοῶν ἐκ πῖαρ ἑλέσθαι

πάννυχοι ἐγρήσσοντες· ὃ δὲ κρειῶν ἐρατίζων

17.661

ἰθύει, ἀλλ’ οὔ τι πρήσσει· θαμέες γὰρ ἄκοντες
ἀντίον ἀΐσσουσι θρασειάων ἀπὸ χειρῶν,
καιόμεναί τε δεταί, τάς τε τρεῖ ἐσσύμενός περ·
ἠῶθεν δ’ ἀπονόσφιν ἔβη τετιηότι θυμῷ·
ὣς ἀπὸ Πατρόκλοιο βοὴν ἀγαθὸς Μενέλαος
ἤϊε πόλλ’ ἀέκων· περὶ γὰρ δίε μή μιν Ἀχαιοὶ
ἀργαλέου πρὸ φόβοιο ἔλωρ δηΐοισι λίποιεν.
πολλὰ δὲ Μηριόνῃ τε καὶ Αἰάντεσσ’ ἐπέτελλεν·
Αἴαντ’ Ἀργείων ἡγήτορε Μηριόνη τε
νῦν τις ἐνηείης Πατροκλῆος δειλοῖο
μνησάσθω· πᾶσιν γὰρ ἐπίστατο μείλιχος εἶναι
ζωὸς ἐών· νῦν αὖ θάνατος καὶ μοῖρα κιχάνει.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἀπέβη ξανθὸς Μενέλαος,
πάντοσε παπταίνων ὥς τ’ αἰετός, ὅν ῥά τέ φασιν
ὀξύτατον δέρκεσθαι ὑπουρανίων πετεηνῶν,
ὅν τε καὶ ὑψόθ’ ἐόντα πόδας ταχὺς οὐκ ἔλαθε πτὼξ
θάμνῳ ὑπ’ ἀμφικόμῳ κατακείμενος, ἀλλά τ’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ
ἔσσυτο, καί τέ μιν ὦκα λαβὼν ἐξείλετο θυμόν.
ὣς τότε σοὶ Μενέλαε διοτρεφὲς ὄσσε φαεινὼ
πάντοσε δινείσθην πολέων κατὰ ἔθνος ἑταίρων,
εἴ που Νέστορος υἱὸν ἔτι ζώοντα ἴδοιτο.
τὸν δὲ μάλ’ αἶψ’ ἐνόησε μάχης ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ πάσης
θαρσύνονθ’ ἑτάρους καὶ ἐποτρύνοντα μάχεσθαι,
ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱστάμενος προσέφη ξανθὸς Μενέλαος·
Ἀντίλοχ’ εἰ δ’ ἄγε δεῦρο διοτρεφὲς ὄφρα πύθηαι
λυγρῆς ἀγγελίης, ἣ μὴ ὤφελλε γενέσθαι.
ἤδη μὲν σὲ καὶ αὐτὸν ὀΐομαι εἰσορόωντα
γιγνώσκειν ὅτι πῆμα θεὸς Δαναοῖσι κυλίνδει,
νίκη δὲ Τρώων· πέφαται δ’ ὥριστος Ἀχαιῶν
Πάτροκλος, μεγάλη δὲ ποθὴ Δαναοῖσι τέτυκται.

17.691

ἀλλὰ σύ γ’ αἶψ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ θέων ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
εἰπεῖν, αἴ κε τάχιστα νέκυν ἐπὶ νῆα σαώσῃ
γυμνόν· ἀτὰρ τά γε τεύχε’ ἔχει κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ.
ὣς ἔφατ’, Ἀντίλοχος δὲ κατέστυγε μῦθον ἀκούσας·
δὴν δέ μιν ἀμφασίη ἐπέων λάβε, τὼ δέ οἱ ὄσσε
δακρυόφι πλῆσθεν, θαλερὴ δέ οἱ ἔσχετο φωνή.
ἀλλ’ οὐδ’ ὣς Μενελάου ἐφημοσύνης ἀμέλησε,
βῆ δὲ θέειν, τὰ δὲ τεύχε’ ἀμύμονι δῶκεν ἑταίρῳ
Λαοδόκῳ, ὅς οἱ σχεδὸν ἔστρεφε μώνυχας ἵππους.
τὸν μὲν δάκρυ χέοντα πόδες φέρον ἐκ πολέμοιο
Πηλεΐδῃ Ἀχιλῆϊ κακὸν ἔπος ἀγγελέοντα.
οὐδ’ ἄρα σοὶ Μενέλαε διοτρεφὲς ἤθελε θυμὸς
τειρομένοις ἑτάροισιν ἀμυνέμεν, ἔνθεν ἀπῆλθεν
Ἀντίλοχος, μεγάλη δὲ ποθὴ Πυλίοισιν ἐτύχθη·
ἀλλ’ ὅ γε τοῖσιν μὲν Θρασυμήδεα δῖον ἀνῆκεν,

706 αὐτὸς δ’ αὖτ’ ἐπὶ Πατρόκλῳ ἤρωϊ βεβήκει,
707 στῆ δὲ παρ’ Αἰάντεσσι θέων, εἶθαρ δὲ προσηύδα·
708 κεῖνον μὲν δὴ νηυσὶν ἐπιπροέηκα θοῇσιν
709 ἐλθεῖν εἰς Ἀχιλῆα πόδας ταχύν· οὐδέ μιν οἴω
710 νῦν ἰέναι μάλα περ κεχολωμένον Ἕκτορι δίῳ·
711 οὐ γάρ πως ἂν γυμνὸς ἐὼν Τρώεσσι μάχοιτο.
712 ἡμεῖς δ’ αὐτοί περ φραζώμεθα μῆτιν ἀρίστην,
713 ἠμὲν ὅπως τὸν νεκρὸν ἐρύσσομεν, ἠδὲ καὶ αὐτοὶ
714 Τρώων ἐξ ἐνοπῆς θάνατον καὶ κῆρα φύγωμεν.
715 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας·
716 πάντα κατ’ αἶσαν ἔειπες ἀγακλεὲς ὦ Μενέλαε·
717 ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν καὶ Μηριόνης ὑποδύντε μάλ’ ὦκα
718 νεκρὸν ἀείραντες φέρετ’ ἐκ πόνου· αὐτὰρ ὄπισθε
719 νῶϊ μαχησόμεθα Τρωσίν τε καὶ Ἕκτορι δίῳ
720 ἶσον θυμὸν ἔχοντες ὁμώνυμοι, οἳ τὸ πάρος περ

17.721

721 μίμνομεν ὀξὺν Ἄρηα παρ’ ἀλλήλοισι μένοντες.
722 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα νεκρὸν ἀπὸ χθονὸς ἀγκάζοντο
723 ὕψι μάλα μεγάλως· ἐπὶ δ’ ἴαχε λαὸς ὄπισθε
724 Τρωϊκός, ὡς εἴδοντο νέκυν αἴροντας Ἀχαιούς.
725 ἴθυσαν δὲ κύνεσσιν ἐοικότες, οἵ τ’ ἐπὶ κάπρῳ
726 βλημένῳ ἀΐξωσι πρὸ κούρων θηρητήρων·
727 ἕως μὲν γάρ τε θέουσι διαρραῖσαι μεμαῶτες,
728 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἐν τοῖσιν ἐλίξεται ἀλκὶ πεποιθώς,
729 ἄψ τ’ ἀνεχώρησαν διά τ’ ἔτρεσαν ἄλλυδις ἄλλος.
730 ὣς Τρῶες εἶος μὲν ὁμιλαδὸν αἰὲν ἔποντο
731 νύσσοντες ξίφεσίν τε καὶ ἔγχεσιν ἀμφιγύοισιν·
732 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ Αἴαντε μεταστρεφθέντε κατ’ αὐτοὺς
733 σταίησαν, τῶν δὲ τράπετο χρώς, οὐδέ τις ἔτλη
734 πρόσσω ἀΐξας περὶ νεκροῦ δηριάασθαι.
735 ὣς οἵ γ’ ἐμμεμαῶτε νέκυν φέρον ἐκ πολέμοιο
736 νῆας ἔπι γλαφυράς· ἐπὶ δὲ πτόλεμος τέτατό σφιν
737 ἄγριος ἠΰτε πῦρ, τό τ’ ἐπεσσύμενον πόλιν ἀνδρῶν
738 ὄρμενον ἐξαίφνης φλεγέθει, μινύθουσι δὲ οἶκοι
739 ἐν σέλαϊ μεγάλῳ· τὸ δ’ ἐπιβρέμει ἴς ἀνέμοιο.
740 ὣς μὲν τοῖς ἵππων τε καὶ ἀνδρῶν αἰχμητάων
741 ἀζηχὴς ὀρυμαγδὸς ἐπήϊεν ἐρχομένοισιν·
742 οἳ δ’ ὥς θ’ ἡμίονοι κρατερὸν μένος ἀμφιβαλόντες
743 ἕλκωσ’ ἐξ ὄρεος κατὰ παιπαλόεσσαν ἀταρπὸν
744 ἢ δοκὸν ἠὲ δόρυ μέγα νήϊον· ἐν δέ τε θυμὸς
745 τείρεθ’ ὁμοῦ καμάτῳ τε καὶ ἱδρῷ σπευδόντεσσιν·
746 ὣς οἵ γ’ ἐμμεμαῶτε νέκυν φέρον. αὐτὰρ ὄπισθεν
747 Αἴαντ’ ἰσχανέτην, ὥς τε πρὼν ἰσχάνει ὕδωρ
748 ὑλήεις πεδίοιο διαπρύσιον τετυχηκώς,
749 ὅς τε καὶ ἰφθίμων ποταμῶν ἀλεγεινὰ ῥέεθρα
750 ἴσχει, ἄφαρ δέ τε πᾶσι ῥόον πεδίον δὲ τίθησι

In this wise did the two heroes strain every nerve to bear the body to the ships out of the fight. The battle raged round them like fierce flames that when once kindled spread like wildfire over a city, and the houses fall in the glare of its burning - even such was the roar and tramp of men and horses that pursued them as they bore Patroklos from the field. Or as

mules that put forth all their strength to draw some beam or great piece of ship's timber down a rough mountain-track, and they pant and sweat as they, go even so did Menelaos and pant and sweat as they bore the body of Patroklos. Behind them the two Ajaxes held stoutly out. As some wooded mountain-spur that stretches across a plain will turn water and check the flow even of a great river, nor is there any stream strong enough to break through it - even so did the two Ajaxes face the Trojans and stern the tide of their fighting though they kept pouring on towards them and foremost among them all was Aeneas son of Anchises with valiant Hektor. As a flock of daws or starlings fall to screaming and chattering when they see a falcon, foe to small birds, come soaring near them, even so did the Achaean youth raise a babel of cries as they fled before Aeneas and Hektor, unmindful of their former prowess. In the rout of the Danaans much goodly armor fell round about the trench, and of fighting there was no end.

17.751

πλάζων· οὐδέ τί μιν σθένεϊ ῥηγνῦσι ῥέοντες·
ὣς αἰεὶ Αἴαντε μάχην ἀνέεργον ὀπίσσω
Τρώων· οἳ δ’ ἄμ’ ἕποντο, δύω δ’ ἐν τοῖσι μάλιστα
Αἰνείας τ’ Ἀγχισιάδης καὶ φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ.
τῶν δ’ ὥς τε ψαρῶν νέφος ἔρχεται ἠὲ κολοιῶν
οὖλον κεκλήγοντες, ὅτε προΐδωσιν ἰόντα
κίρκον, ὅ τε σμικρῇσι φόνον φέρει ὀρνίθεσσιν,
ὣς ἄρ’ ὑπ’ Αἰνείᾳ τε καὶ Ἕκτορι κοῦροι Ἀχαιῶν
οὖλον κεκλήγοντες ἴσαν, λήθοντο δὲ χάρμης.
πολλὰ δὲ τεύχεα καλὰ πέσον περί τ’ ἀμφί τε τάφρον
φευγόντων Δαναῶν· πολέμου δ’ οὐ γίγνετ’ ἐρωή.

18.1

ὣς οἳ μὲν μάρναντο δέμας πυρὸς αἰθομένοιο,
Ἀντίλοχος δ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ πόδας ταχὺς ἄγγελος ἦλθε.
τὸν δ’ εὗρε προπάροιθε νεῶν ὀρθοκραιράων
τὰ φρονέοντ’ ἀνὰ θυμὸν ἃ δὴ τετελεσμένα ἦεν·
ὀχθήσας δ’ ἄρα εἶπε πρὸς ὃν μεγαλήτορα θυμόν·
ὤ μοι ἐγώ, τί τ’ ἄρ’ αὖτε κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοὶ
νηυσὶν ἔπι κλονέονται ἀτυζόμενοι πεδίοιο;
μὴ δή μοι τελέσωσι θεοὶ κακὰ κήδεα θυμῷ,
ὥς ποτέ μοι μήτηρ διεπέφραδε καί μοι ἔειπε
Μυρμιδόνων τὸν ἄριστον ἔτι ζώοντος ἐμεῖο
χερσὶν ὕπο Τρώων λείψειν φάος ἠελίοιο.
ἦ μάλα δὴ τέθνηκε Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμος υἱὸς
σχέτλιος· ἦ τ’ ἐκέλευον ἀπωσάμενον δήϊον πῦρ
ἂψ ἐπὶ νῆας ἴμεν, μηδ’ Ἕκτορι ἶφι μάχεσθαι.
εἶος ὃ ταῦθ’ ὥρμαινε κατὰ φρένα καὶ κατὰ θυμόν,
τόφρά οἱ ἐγγύθεν ἦλθεν ἀγαυοῦ Νέστορος υἱὸς
δάκρυα θερμὰ χέων, φάτο δ’ ἀγγελίην ἀλεγεινήν·
ὤ μοι Πηλέος υἱὲ δαΐφρονος ἦ μάλα λυγρῆς
πεύσεαι ἀγγελίης, ἣ μὴ ὄφελλε γενέσθαι.
κεῖται Πάτροκλος, νέκυος δὲ δὴ ἀμφιμάχονται
γυμνοῦ· ἀτὰρ τά γε τεύχε’ ἔχει κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ.
ὣς φάτο, τὸν δ’ ἄχεος νεφέλη ἐκάλυψε μέλαινα·
ἀμφοτέρῃσι δὲ χερσὶν ἑλὼν κόνιν αἰθαλόεσσαν

24 χεύατο κὰκ κεφαλῆς, χαρίεν δ’ ᾗσχυνε πρόσωπον·
25 νεκταρέῳ δὲ χιτῶνι μέλαιν’ ἀμφίζανε τέφρη.
26 αὐτὸς δ’ ἐν κονίῃσι μέγας μεγαλωστὶ τανυσθεὶς
27 κεῖτο, φίλῃσι δὲ χερσὶ κόμην ᾗσχυνε δαΐζων.
28 δμῳαὶ δ’ ἃς Ἀχιλεὺς ληΐσσατο Πάτροκλός τε
29 θυμὸν ἀκηχέμεναι μεγάλ’ ἴαχον, ἐκ δὲ θύραζε
30 ἔδραμον ἀμφ’ Ἀχιλῆα δαΐφρονα, χερσὶ δὲ πᾶσαι
Thus then did they fight as it were a flaming fire. Meanwhile the fleet runner Antilokhos, who had been sent as messenger, reached Achilles, and found him sitting by his tall ships and boding that which was indeed too surely true. "Alas," said he to himself in the heaviness of his heart, "why are the Achaeans again scouring the plain and flocking towards the ships? Heaven grant the gods be not now bringing that sorrow upon me of which my mother Thetis spoke, saying that while I was yet alive the bravest of the Myrmidons should fall before the Trojans, and see the light of the sun no longer. I fear the brave son of Menoitios has fallen through his own daring and yet I bade him return to the ships as soon as he had driven back those that were bringing fire against them, and not join battle with Hektor." As he was thus pondering, the son of Nestor came up to him and told his sad tale, weeping bitterly the while. "Alas," he cried, "son of noble Peleus, I bring you bad tidings, would indeed that they were untrue. Patroklos has fallen, and a fight is raging about his naked body - for Hektor holds his armor." A dark cloud of grief [akhos] fell upon Achilles as he listened. He filled both hands with dust from off the ground, and poured it over his head, disfiguring his comely face, and letting the refuse settle over his shirt so fair and new. He flung himself down all huge and hugely at full length, and tore his hair with his hands. The bondswomen whom Achilles and Patroklos had taken captive screamed aloud for grief, beating their breasts, and with their limbs failing them for sorrow. Antilokhos bent over him the while, weeping and holding both his hands as he lay groaning for he feared that he might plunge a knife into his own throat. Then Achilles gave a loud cry and his mother heard him as she was sitting in the depths of the sea by the old man her father, whereon she screamed, and all the goddesses daughters of Nereus that dwelt at the bottom of the sea, came gathering round her. There were Glauke, Thalia and Kymodoke, Nesaia, Speo, Thoe, and dark-eyed Halie, Kymothoe, Aktaia and Limnorea, Melite, Iaira, Amphithoe and Agaue, Doto and Proto, Pherousa and Dynamene, Dexamene, Amphinome and Kallianeira, Doris, Panope, and the famous sea-nymph Galatea, Nemertes, Apseudes and Kallianassa. There were also Klymene, Ianeira and Ianassa, Maira, Oreithuia and Amatheia of the lovely locks, with other Nereids who dwell in the depths of the sea. The crystal cave was filled with their multitude and they all beat their breasts while Thetis led them in their lament. "Listen," she cried, "sisters, daughters of Nereus, that you may hear the burden of my sorrows. Alas, woe is me, woe in that I have borne the most glorious of offspring. I bore him fair and strong, hero among heroes, and he shot up as a sapling; I tended him as a plant in a goodly garden, and sent him with his ships to Ilion to fight the Trojans, but never shall I welcome him back to the house of Peleus. So long as he lives to look upon the light of the sun he is in heaviness, and though I go to him I cannot help him. Nevertheless I will go, that I may see my dear son and learn what sorrow [penthos] has befallen him though he is still holding aloof from battle." She left the cave as she spoke, while the others followed weeping after, and the waves opened a path before them. When they reached the fertile plain of Troy, they came up out of the sea in a long line on to the sands, at the place where the ships of the Myrmidons were drawn up in close order round the tents of Achilles. His mother went up to him as he lay groaning; she laid her hand upon his head and spoke piteously, saying, "My son, why are you thus weeping? What sorrow [penthos] has now befallen you? Tell me; hide it not from me. Surely Zeus has granted you the prayer you made him, when you lifted up your hands and besought him that the Achaeans might all of

them be pent up at their ships, and rue it bitterly in that you were no longer with them." Achilles groaned and answered, "Mother, Olympian Zeus has indeed granted me the fulfillment of my prayer, but what boots it to me, seeing that my dear comrade Patroklos has fallen - he whom I valued more than all others, and loved as dearly as my own life? I have lost him; aye, and Hektor when he had killed him stripped the wondrous armor, so glorious to behold, which the gods gave to Peleus when they laid you in the couch of a mortal man. Would that you were still dwelling among the immortal sea-nymphs, and that Peleus had taken to himself some mortal bride. For now you shall have grief [penthos] infinite by reason of the death of that son whom you can never welcome home- nay, I will not live nor go about among humankind unless Hektor fall by my spear, and thus pay me for having slain Patroklos son of Menoitios." Thetis wept and answered, "Then, my son, is your end near at hand- for your own death awaits you full soon after that of Hektor."

18.31

31 στήθεα πεπλήγοντο, λύθεν δ’ ὑπὸ γυῖα ἑκάστης.
32 Ἀντίλοχος δ’ ἑτέρωθεν ὀδύρετο δάκρυα λείβων
33 χεῖρας ἔχων Ἀχιλῆος· ὃ δ’ ἔστενε κυδάλιμον κῆρ·
34 δείδιε γὰρ μὴ λαιμὸν ἀπαμήσειε σιδήρῳ.
35 σμερδαλέον δ’ ὤμωξεν· ἄκουσε δὲ πότνια μήτηρ
36 ἡμένη ἐν βένθεσσιν ἁλὸς παρὰ πατρὶ γέροντι,
37 κώκυσέν τ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα· θεαὶ δέ μιν ἀμφαγέροντο
38 πᾶσαι ὅσαι κατὰ βένθος ἁλὸς Νηρηΐδες ἦσαν.
39 ἔνθ’ ἄρ’ ἔην Γλαύκη τε Θάλειά τε Κυμοδόκη τε
40 Νησαίη Σπειώ τε Θόη θ’ Ἁλίη τε βοῶπις
41 Κυμοθόη τε καὶ Ἀκταίη καὶ Λιμνώρεια
42 καὶ Μελίτη καὶ Ἴαιρα καὶ Ἀμφιθόη καὶ Ἀγαυὴ
43 Δωτώ τε Πρωτώ τε Φέρουσά τε Δυναμένη τε
44 Δεξαμένη τε καὶ Ἀμφινόμη καὶ Καλλιάνειρα
45 Δωρὶς καὶ Πανόπη καὶ ἀγακλειτὴ Γαλάτεια
46 Νημερτής τε καὶ Ἀψευδὴς καὶ Καλλιάνασσα·
47 ἔνθα δ’ ἔην Κλυμένη Ἰάνειρά τε καὶ Ἰάνασσα
48 Μαῖρα καὶ Ὠρείθυια ἐϋπλόκαμός τ’ Ἀμάθεια
49 ἄλλαι θ’ αἳ κατὰ βένθος ἁλὸς Νηρηΐδες ἦσαν.
50 τῶν δὲ καὶ ἀργύφεον πλῆτο σπέος· αἳ δ’ ἅμα πᾶσαι
51 στήθεα πεπλήγοντο, Θέτις δ’ ἐξῆρχε γόοιο·
52 κλῦτε κασίγνηται Νηρηΐδες, ὄφρ’ ἐὺ πᾶσαι
53 εἴδετ’ ἀκούουσαι ὅσ’ ἐμῷ ἔνι κήδεα θυμῷ.
54 ὤ μοι ἐγὼ δειλή, ὤ μοι δυσαριστοτόκεια,
55 ἥ τ’ ἐπεὶ ἂρ τέκον υἱὸν ἀμύμονά τε κρατερόν τε
56 ἔξοχον ἡρώων· ὃ δ’ ἀνέδραμεν ἔρνεϊ ἶσος·
57 τὸν μὲν ἐγὼ θρέψασα φυτὸν ὡς γουνῷ ἀλωῆς
58 νηυσὶν ἐπιπροέηκα κορωνίσιν Ἴλιον εἴσω
59 Τρωσὶ μαχησόμενον· τὸν δ’ οὐχ ὑποδέξομαι αὖτις
60 οἴκαδε νοστήσαντα δόμον Πηλήϊον εἴσω.

18.61

61 ὄφρα δέ μοι ζώει καὶ ὁρᾷ φάος ἠελίοιο
62 ἄχνυται, οὐδέ τί οἱ δύναμαι χραισμῆσαι ἰοῦσα.
63 ἀλλ’ εἶμ’, ὄφρα ἴδωμι φίλον τέκος, ἠδ’ ἐπακούσω
64 ὅττί μιν ἵκετο πένθος ἀπὸ πτολέμοιο μένοντα.

65 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσασα λίπε σπέος· αἳ δὲ σὺν αὐτῇ
66 δακρυόεσσαι ἵσαν, περὶ δέ σφισι κῦμα θαλάσσης
67 ῥήγνυτο· ταὶ δ’ ὅτε δὴ Τροίην ἐρίβωλον ἵκοντο
68 ἀκτὴν εἰσανέβαινον ἐπισχερώ, ἔνθα θαμειαὶ
69 Μυρμιδόνων εἴρυντο νέες ταχὺν ἀμφ’ Ἀχιλῆα.
70 τῷ δὲ βαρὺ στενάχοντι παρίστατο πότνια μήτηρ,
71 ὀξὺ δὲ κωκύσασα κάρη λάβε παιδὸς ἑοῖο,
72 καί ῥ’ ὀλοφυρομένη ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
73 τέκνον τί κλαίεις; τί δέ σε φρένας ἵκετο πένθος;
74 ἐξαύδα, μὴ κεῦθε· τὰ μὲν δή τοι τετέλεσται
75 ἐκ Διός, ὡς ἄρα δὴ πρίν γ’ εὔχεο χεῖρας ἀνασχὼν
76 πάντας ἐπὶ πρύμνῃσιν ἀλήμεναι υἷας Ἀχαιῶν
77 σεῦ ἐπιδευομένους, παθέειν τ’ ἀεκήλια ἔργα.
78 τὴν δὲ βαρὺ στενάχων προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
79 μῆτερ ἐμή, τὰ μὲν ἄρ μοι Ὀλύμπιος ἐξετέλεσσεν·
80 ἀλλὰ τί μοι τῶν ἦδος ἐπεὶ φίλος ὤλεθ’ ἑταῖρος
81 Πάτροκλος, τὸν ἐγὼ περὶ πάντων τῖον ἑταίρων
82 ἶσον ἐμῇ κεφαλῇ; τὸν ἀπώλεσα, τεύχεα δ’ Ἕκτωρ
83 δηώσας ἀπέδυσε πελώρια θαῦμα ἰδέσθαι
84 καλά· τὰ μὲν Πηλῆϊ θεοὶ δόσαν ἀγλαὰ δῶρα
85 ἤματι τῷ ὅτε σε βροτοῦ ἀνέρος ἔμβαλον εὐνῇ.
86 αἴθ’ ὄφελες σὺ μὲν αὖθι μετ’ ἀθανάτῃς ἁλίῃσι
87 ναίειν, Πηλεὺς δὲ θνητὴν ἀγαγέσθαι ἄκοιτιν.
88 νῦν δ’ ἵνα καὶ σοὶ πένθος ἐνὶ φρεσὶ μυρίον εἴη
89 παιδὸς ἀποφθιμένοιο, τὸν οὐχ ὑποδέξεαι αὖτις
90 οἴκαδε νοστήσαντ’, ἐπεὶ οὐδ’ ἐμὲ θυμὸς ἄνωγε

18.91

91 ζώειν οὐδ’ ἄνδρεσσι μετέμμεναι, αἴ κε μὴ Ἕκτωρ
92 πρῶτος ἐμῷ ὑπὸ δουρὶ τυπεὶς ἀπὸ θυμὸν ὀλέσσῃ,
93 Πατρόκλοιο δ’ ἕλωρα Μενοιτιάδεω ἀποτίσῃ.
94 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε Θέτις κατὰ δάκρυ χέουσα·
95 ὠκύμορος δή μοι τέκος ἔσσεαι, οἷ’ ἀγορεύεις·
96 αὐτίκα γάρ τοι ἔπειτα μεθ’ Ἕκτορα πότμος ἑτοῖμος.
97 τὴν δὲ μέγ’ ὀχθήσας προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
98 αὐτίκα τεθναίην, ἐπεὶ οὐκ ἄρ’ ἔμελλον ἑταίρῳ
99 κτεινομένῳ ἐπαμῦναι· ὃ μὲν μάλα τηλόθι πάτρης
100 ἔφθιτ’, ἐμεῖο δὲ δῆσεν ἀρῆς ἀλκτῆρα γενέσθαι.
101 νῦν δ’ ἐπεὶ οὐ νέομαί γε φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν,
102 οὐδέ τι Πατρόκλῳ γενόμην φάος οὐδ’ ἑτάροισι
103 τοῖς ἄλλοις, οἳ δὴ πολέες δάμεν Ἕκτορι δίῳ,
104 ἀλλ’ ἧμαι παρὰ νηυσὶν ἐτώσιον ἄχθος ἀρούρης,
105 τοῖος ἐὼν οἷος οὔ τις Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων
106 ἐν πολέμῳ· ἀγορῇ δέ τ’ ἀμείνονές εἰσι καὶ ἄλλοι.
107 ὡς ἔρις ἔκ τε θεῶν ἔκ τ’ ἀνθρώπων ἀπόλοιτο
108 καὶ χόλος, ὅς τ’ ἐφέηκε πολύφρονά περ χαλεπῆναι,
109 ὅς τε πολὺ γλυκίων μέλιτος καταλειβομένοιο
110 ἀνδρῶν ἐν στήθεσσιν ἀέξεται ἠΰτε καπνός·
111 ὡς ἐμὲ νῦν ἐχόλωσεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων.
112 ἀλλὰ τὰ μὲν προτετύχθαι ἐάσομεν ἀχνύμενοί περ,
113 θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσι φίλον δαμάσαντες ἀνάγκῃ·

114 νῦν δ’ εἶμ’ ὄφρα φίλης κεφαλῆς ὀλετῆρα κιχείω
115 Ἕκτορα· κῆρα δ’ ἐγὼ τότε δέξομαι ὁππότε κεν δὴ
116 Ζεὺς ἐθέλῃ τελέσαι ἠδ’ ἀθάνατοι θεοὶ ἄλλοι.
117 οὐδὲ γὰρ οὐδὲ βίη Ἡρακλῆος φύγε κῆρα,
118 ὅς περ φίλτατος ἔσκε Διὶ Κρονίωνι ἄνακτι·
119 ἀλλά ἑ μοῖρα δάμασσε καὶ ἀργαλέος χόλος Ἥρης.
120 ὣς καὶ ἐγών, εἰ δή μοι ὁμοίη μοῖρα τέτυκται,
Then said Achilles in his great grief, "I would die here and now, in that I could not save my comrade. He has fallen far from home, and in his hour of need my hand was not there to help him. What is there for me? Return to my own land I shall not, and I have brought no saving neither to Patroklos nor to my other comrades of whom so many have been slain by mighty Hektor; I stay here by my ships a bootless burden upon the earth, I, who in fight have no peer among the Achaeans, though in council there are better than I. Therefore, perish strife both from among gods and men, and anger, wherein even a righteous man will harden his heart - which rises up in the soul of a man like smoke, and the taste thereof is sweeter than drops of honey. Even so has Agamemnon angered me. And yet - so be it, for it is over; I will force my soul into subjection as I needs must; I will go; I will pursue Hektor who has slain him whom I loved so dearly, and will then abide my doom when it may please Zeus and the other gods to send it. Even Herakles, the best beloved of Zeus - even he could not escape the hand of death, but fate and Hera's fierce anger laid him low, as I too shall lie when I am dead if a like doom awaits me. Till then I will win fame [kleos], and will bid Trojan and Dardanian women wring tears from their tender cheeks with both their hands in the grievousness of their great sorrow; thus shall they know that he who has held aloof so long will hold aloof no longer. Hold me not back, therefore, in the love you bear me, for you shall not move me." Then silver-footed Thetis answered, "My son, what you have said is true. It is well to save your comrades from destruction, but your armor is in the hands of the Trojans; Hektor bears it in triumph upon his own shoulders. Full well I know that his vaunt shall not be lasting, for his end is close at hand; go not, however, into the press of battle till you see me return hither; tomorrow at break of day I shall be here, and will bring you goodly armor from King Hephaistos." On this she left her brave son, and as she turned away she said to the sea-nymphs her sisters, "Dive into the bosom of the sea and go to the house of the old sea-god my father. Tell him everything; as for me, I will go to the cunning workman Hephaistos on high Olympus, and ask him to provide my son with a suit of splendid armor." When she had so said, they dived forthwith beneath the waves, while silver-footed Thetis went her way that she might bring the armor for her son. Thus, then, did her feet bear the goddess to Olympus, and meanwhile the Achaeans were fleeing with loud cries before murderous Hektor till they reached the ships and the Hellespont, and they could not draw the body of Ares' squire [therapôn] Patroklos out of reach of the weapons that were showered upon him, for Hektor son of Priam with his host and horsemen had again caught up to him like the flame of a fiery furnace; thrice did brave Hektor seize him by the feet, striving with might and main to draw him away and calling loudly on the Trojans, and thrice did the two Ajaxes, clothed in valor as with a garment, beat him from off the body; but all undaunted he would now charge into the thick of the fight, and now again he would stand still and cry aloud, but he would give no ground. As upland shepherds that cannot chase some famished lion from a carcass, even so could not the two Ajaxes scare Hektor son of Priam from the body of Patroklos. And now he would even have dragged it off and have won imperishable glory, had not Iris fleet as the wind, winged her way as messenger from Olympus to the son of Peleus and bidden him arm. She came secretly without the knowledge of Zeus and of the other gods, for Hera sent her, and when she had got close to him she said, "Up, son of Peleus, mightiest of all humankind; rescue Patroklos about whom this fearful fight is now raging by the ships. Men are killing one another, the

Danaans in defense of the dead body, while the Trojans are trying to hale it away, and take it to windy Ilion: Hektor is the most furious of them all; he is for cutting the head from the body and fixing it on the stakes of the wall. Up, then, and bide here no longer; shrink from the thought that Patroklos may become meat for the dogs of Troy. Shame on you, should his body suffer any kind of outrage." And Achilles said, "Iris, which of the gods was it that sent you to me?"

18.121

κείσομ’ ἐπεί κε θάνω· νῦν δὲ κλέος ἐσθλὸν ἀροίμην,
καί τινα Τρωϊάδων καὶ Δαρδανίδων βαθυκόλπων
ἀμφοτέρῃσιν χερσὶ παρειάων ἀπαλάων
δάκρυ’ ὀμορξαμένην ἀδινὸν στοναχῆσαι ἐφείην,
γνοῖεν δ’ ὡς δὴ δηρὸν ἐγὼ πολέμοιο πέπαυμαι·
μὴ δέ μ’ ἔρυκε μάχης φιλέουσά περ· οὐδέ με πείσεις.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα θεὰ Θέτις ἀργυρόπεζα·
ναὶ δὴ ταῦτά γε τέκνον ἐτήτυμον οὐ κακόν ἐστι
τειρομένοις ἑτάροισιν ἀμυνέμεν αἰπὺν ὄλεθρον.
ἀλλά τοι ἔντεα καλὰ μετὰ Τρώεσσιν ἔχονται
χάλκεα μαρμαίροντα· τὰ μὲν κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ
αὐτὸς ἔχων ὤμοισιν ἀγάλλεται· οὐδέ ἔ φημι
δηρὸν ἐπαγλαϊεῖσθαι, ἐπεὶ φόνος ἐγγύθεν αὐτῷ.
ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν μή πω καταδύσεο μῶλον Ἄρηος
πρίν γ’ ἐμὲ δεῦρ’ ἐλθοῦσαν ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ἴδηαι·
ἠῶθεν γὰρ νεῦμαι ἅμ’ ἠελίῳ ἀνιόντι
τεύχεα καλὰ φέρουσα παρ’ Ἡφαίστοιο ἄνακτος.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσασα πάλιν τράπεθ’ υἷος ἑοῖο,
καὶ στρεφθεῖσ’ ἀλίῃσι κασιγνήτῃσι μετηύδα·
ὑμεῖς μὲν νῦν δῦτε θαλάσσης εὐρέα κόλπον
ὀψόμεναί τε γέρονθ’ ἅλιον καὶ δώματα πατρός,
καί οἱ πάντ’ ἀγορεύσατ’· ἐγὼ δ’ ἐς μακρὸν Ὄλυμπον
εἶμι παρ’ Ἥφαιστον κλυτοτέχνην, αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσιν
υἱεῖ ἐμῷ δόμεναι κλυτὰ τεύχεα παμφανόωντα.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, αἳ δ’ ὑπὸ κῦμα θαλάσσης αὐτίκ’ ἔδυσαν·
ἣ δ’ αὖτ’ Οὔλυμπον δὲ θεὰ Θέτις ἀργυρόπεζα
ἤϊεν ὄφρα φίλῳ παιδὶ κλυτὰ τεύχε’ ἐνείκαι.
τὴν μὲν ἄρ’ Οὔλυμπον δὲ πόδες φέρον· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
θεσπεσίῳ ἀλαλητῷ ὑφ’ Ἕκτορος ἀνδροφόνοιο
φεύγοντες νῆάς τε καὶ Ἑλλήσποντον ἵκοντο.

18.151

οὐδέ κε Πάτροκλόν περ ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
ἐκ βελέων ἐρύσαντο νέκυν θεράποντ’ Ἀχιλῆος·
αὖτις γὰρ δὴ τόν γε κίχον λαός τε καὶ ἵπποι
Ἕκτωρ τε Πριάμοιο πάϊς φλογὶ εἴκελος ἀλκήν.
τρὶς μέν μιν μετόπισθε ποδῶν λάβε φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
ἑλκέμεναι μεμαώς, μέγα δὲ Τρώεσσιν ὁμόκλα·
τρὶς δὲ δύ’ Αἴαντες θοῦριν ἐπιειμένοι ἀλκὴν
νεκροῦ ἀπεστυφέλιξαν· ὃ δ’ ἔμπεδον ἀλκὶ πεποιθὼς
ἄλλοτ’ ἐπαΐξασκε κατὰ μόθον, ἄλλοτε δ’ αὖτε
στάσκε μέγα ἰάχων· ὀπίσω δ’ οὐ χάζετο πάμπαν.

ὡς δ’ ἀπὸ σώματος οὔ τι λέοντ’ αἴθωνα δύνανται
ποιμένες ἄγραυλοι μέγα πεινάοντα δίεσθαι,
ὥς ῥα τὸν οὐκ ἐδύναντο δύω Αἴαντε κορυστὰ
Ἕκτορα Πριαμίδην ἀπὸ νεκροῦ δειδίξασθαι.
καί νύ κεν εἴρυσσέν τε καὶ ἄσπετον ἤρατο κῦδος,
εἰ μὴ Πηλεΐωνι ποδήνεμος ὠκέα Ἶρις
ἄγγελος ἦλθε θέουσ’ ἀπ’ Ὀλύμπου θωρήσσεσθαι
κρύβδα Διὸς ἄλλων τε θεῶν· πρὸ γὰρ ἦκέ μιν Ἥρη.
ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱσταμένη ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
ὄρσεο Πηλεΐδη, πάντων ἐκπαγλότατ’ ἀνδρῶν·
Πατρόκλῳ ἐπάμυνον, οὗ εἵνεκα φύλοπις αἰνὴ
ἕστηκε πρὸ νεῶν· οἱ δ’ ἀλλήλους ὀλέκουσιν
οἱ μὲν ἀμυνόμενοι νέκυος πέρι τεθνηῶτος,
οἱ δὲ ἐρύσσασθαι ποτὶ Ἴλιον ἠνεμόεσσαν
Τρῶες ἐπιθύουσι· μάλιστα δὲ φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
ἑλκέμεναι μέμονεν· κεφαλὴν δέ ἑ θυμὸς ἄνωγε
πῆξαι ἀνὰ σκολόπεσσι ταμόνθ’ ἁπαλῆς ἀπὸ δειρῆς.
ἀλλ’ ἄνα μηδ’ ἔτι κεῖσο· σέβας δέ σε θυμὸν ἰκέσθω
Πάτροκλον Τρῳῇσι κυσὶν μέλπηθρα γενέσθαι·
σοὶ λώβη, αἴ κέν τι νέκυς ᾑσχυμμένος ἔλθῃ.

18.181

τὴν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
Ἶρι θεὰ τίς γάρ σε θεῶν ἐμοὶ ἄγγελον ἦκε;
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε ποδήνεμος ὠκέα Ἶρις·
Ἥρη με προέηκε Διὸς κυδρὴ παράκοιτις·
οὐδ’ οἶδε Κρονίδης ὑψίζυγος οὐδέ τις ἄλλος
ἀθανάτων, οἳ Ὄλυμπον ἀγάννιφον ἀμφινέμονται.
τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
πῶς τὰρ ἴω μετὰ μῶλον; ἔχουσι δὲ τεύχε’ ἐκεῖνοι·
μήτηρ δ’ οὔ με φίλη πρίν γ’ εἶα θωρήσσεσθαι
πρίν γ’ αὐτὴν ἐλθοῦσαν ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ἴδωμαι·
στεῦτο γὰρ Ἡφαίστοιο πάρ’ οἰσέμεν ἔντεα καλά.
ἄλλου δ’ οὔ τευ οἶδα τεῦ ἂν κλυτὰ τεύχεα δύω,
εἰ μὴ Αἴαντός γε σάκος Τελαμωνιάδαο.
ἀλλὰ καὶ αὐτὸς ὅ γ’ ἔλπομ’ ἐνὶ πρώτοισιν ὁμιλεῖ
ἔγχεϊ δηϊόων περὶ Πατρόκλοιο θανόντος.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε ποδήνεμος ὠκέα Ἶρις·
εὖ νυ καὶ ἡμεῖς ἴδμεν ὅ τοι κλυτὰ τεύχε’ ἔχονται·
ἀλλ’ αὔτως ἐπὶ τάφρον ἰὼν Τρώεσσι φάνηθι,
αἴ κέ σ’ ὑποδείσαντες ἀπόσχωνται πολέμοιο
Τρῶες, ἀναπνεύσωσι δ’ ἀρήϊοι υἷες Ἀχαιῶν
τειρόμενοι· ὀλίγη δέ τ’ ἀνάπνευσις πολέμοιο.
ἣ μὲν ἄρ’ ὣς εἰποῦσ’ ἀπέβη πόδας ὠκέα Ἶρις,
αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς ὦρτο Διῒ φίλος· ἀμφὶ δ’ Ἀθήνη
ὤμοις ἰφθίμοισι βάλ’ αἰγίδα θυσσανόεσσαν,
ἀμφὶ δέ οἱ κεφαλῇ νέφος ἔστεφε δῖα θεάων
χρύσεον, ἐκ δ’ αὐτοῦ δαῖε φλόγα παμφανόωσαν.
ὡς δ’ ὅτε καπνὸς ἰὼν ἐξ ἄστεος αἰθέρ’ ἵκηται
τηλόθεν ἐκ νήσου, τὴν δήϊοι ἀμφιμάχωνται,
οἵ τε πανημέριοι στυγερῷ κρίνονται Ἀρῃϊ

210 ἄστεος ἐκ σφετέρου· ἅμα δ’ ἠελίῳ καταδύντι
Iris answered, "It was Hera the royal spouse of Zeus, but the son of Kronos does not know of my coming, nor yet does any other of the immortals who dwell on the snowy summits of Olympus." Then fleet Achilles answered her saying, "How can I go up into the battle? They have my armor. My mother forbade me to arm till I should see her come, for she promised to bring me goodly armor from Hephaistos; I know no man whose arms I can put on, save only the shield of Ajax son of Telamon, and he surely must be fighting in the front rank and wielding his spear about the body of dead Patroklos." Iris said, ‘We know that your armor has been taken, but go as you are; go to the deep trench and show yourself before the Trojans, that they may fear you and cease fighting. Thus will the fainting sons of the Achaeans gain some brief breathing-time, which in battle may hardly be." Iris left him when she had so spoken. But Achilles dear to Zeus arose, and Athena flung her tasseled aegis round his strong shoulders; she crowned his head with a halo of golden cloud from which she kindled a glow of gleaming fire. As the smoke that goes up into heaven from some city that is being beleaguered on an island far out at sea - all day long do men sally from the city and fight their hardest, and at the going down of the sun the line of beacon-fires blazes forth, flaring high for those that dwell near them to behold, if so be that they may come with their ships and succor them - even so did the light flare from the head of Achilles, as he stood by the trench, going beyond the wall - but he aid not join the Achaeans for he heeded the charge which his mother laid upon him. There did he stand and shout aloud. Athena also raised her voice from afar, and spread terror unspeakable among the Trojans. Ringing as the note of a trumpet that sounds alarm then the foe is at the gates of a city, even so brazen was the voice of the son of Aiakos, and when the Trojans heard its clarion tones they were dismayed; the horses turned back with their chariots for they boded mischief, and their drivers were awe-struck by the steady flame which the gray-eyed goddess had kindled above the head of the great son of Peleus. Thrice did Achilles raise his loud cry as he stood by the trench, and thrice were the Trojans and their brave allies thrown into confusion; whereon twelve of their noblest champions fell beneath the wheels of their chariots and perished by their own spears. The Achaeans to their great joy then drew Patroklos out of reach of the weapons, and laid him on a litter: his comrades stood mourning round him, and among them fleet Achilles who wept bitterly as he saw his true comrade lying dead upon his bier. He had sent him out with horses and chariots into battle, but his return he was not to welcome. Then Hera sent the busy sun, loath though he was, into the waters of Okeanos; so he set, and the Achaeans had rest from the tug and turmoil of war. Now the Trojans when they had come out of the fight, unyoked their horses and gathered in assembly before preparing their supper. They kept their feet, nor would any dare to sit down, for fear had fallen upon them all because Achilles had shown himself after having held aloof so long from battle. Polydamas son of Panthoos was first to speak, a man of judgment, who alone among them could look both before and after. He was comrade to Hektor, and they had been born upon the same night; with all sincerity and goodwill, therefore, he addressed them thus:-

18.211

211 πυρσοί τε φλεγέθουσιν ἐπήτριμοι, ὑψόσε δ’ αὐγὴ
212 γίγνεται ἀΐσσουσα περικτιόνεσσιν ἰδέσθαι,
213 αἴ κέν πως σὺν νηυσὶν ἄρεω ἀλκτῆρες ἵκωνται·
214 ὣς ἀπ’ Ἀχιλλῆος κεφαλῆς σέλας αἰθέρ’ ἵκανε·
215 στῆ δ’ ἐπὶ τάφρον ἰὼν ἀπὸ τείχεος, οὐδ’ ἐς Ἀχαιοὺς
216 μίσγετο· μητρὸς γὰρ πυκινὴν ὠπίζετ’ ἐφετμήν.
217 ἔνθα στὰς ἤϋσ’, ἀπάτερθε δὲ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη
218 φθέγξατ’· ἀτὰρ Τρώεσσιν ἐν ἄσπετον ὦρσε κυδοιμόν.

ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἀριζήλη φωνή, ὅτε τ’ ἴαχε σάλπιγξ
ἄστυ περιπλομένων δηΐων ὕπο θυμοραϊστέων,
ὣς τότ’ ἀριζήλη φωνὴ γένετ’ Αἰακίδαο.
οἳ δ’ ὡς οὖν ἄϊον ὄπα χάλκεον Αἰακίδαο,
πᾶσιν ὀρίνθη θυμός· ἀτὰρ καλλίτριχες ἵπποι
ἂψ ὄχεα τρόπεον· ὄσσοντο γὰρ ἄλγεα θυμῷ.
ἡνίοχοι δ’ ἔκπληγεν, ἐπεὶ ἴδον ἀκάματον πῦρ
δεινὸν ὑπὲρ κεφαλῆς μεγαθύμου Πηλεΐωνος
δαιόμενον· τὸ δὲ δαῖε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη.
τρὶς μὲν ὑπὲρ τάφρου μεγάλ’ ἴαχε δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
τρὶς δὲ κυκήθησαν Τρῶες κλειτοί τ’ ἐπίκουροι.
ἔνθα δὲ καὶ τότ’ ὄλοντο δυώδεκα φῶτες ἄριστοι
ἀμφὶ σφοῖς ὀχέεσσι καὶ ἔγχεσιν. αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
ἀσπασίως Πάτροκλον ὑπ’ ἐκ βελέων ἐρύσαντες
κάθεσαν ἐν λεχέεσσι· φίλοι δ’ ἀμφέσταν ἑταῖροι
μυρόμενοι· μετὰ δέ σφι ποδώκης εἵπετ’ Ἀχιλλεὺς
δάκρυα θερμὰ χέων, ἐπεὶ εἴσιδε πιστὸν ἑταῖρον
κείμενον ἐν φέρτρῳ δεδαϊγμένον ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ,
τόν ῥ’ ἤτοι μὲν ἔπεμπε σὺν ἵπποισιν καὶ ὄχεσφιν
ἐς πόλεμον, οὐδ’ αὖτις ἐδέξατο νοστήσαντα.
Ἠέλιον δ’ ἀκάμαντα βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη
πέμψεν ἐπ’ Ὠκεανοῖο ῥοὰς ἀέκοντα νέεσθαι·

18.241

ἠέλιος μὲν ἔδυ, παύσαντο δὲ δῖοι Ἀχαιοὶ
φυλόπιδος κρατερῆς καὶ ὁμοιΐου πολέμοιο.
Τρῶες δ’ αὖθ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἀπὸ κρατερῆς ὑσμίνης
χωρήσαντες ἔλυσαν ὑφ’ ἅρμασιν ὠκέας ἵππους,
ἐς δ’ ἀγορὴν ἀγέροντο πάρος δόρποιο μέδεσθαι.
ὀρθῶν δ’ ἑσταότων ἀγορὴ γένετ’, οὐδέ τις ἔτλη
ἕζεσθαι· πάντας γὰρ ἔχε τρόμος, οὕνεκ’ Ἀχιλλεὺς
ἐξεφάνη, δηρὸν δὲ μάχης ἐπέπαυτ’ ἀλεγεινῆς.
τοῖσι δὲ Πουλυδάμας πεπνυμένος ἦρχ’ ἀγορεύειν
Πανθοΐδης· ὃ γὰρ οἷος ὅρα πρόσσω καὶ ὀπίσσω·
Ἕκτορι δ’ ἦεν ἑταῖρος, ἰῇ δ’ ἐν νυκτὶ γένοντο,
ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν ἂρ μύθοισιν, ὃ δ’ ἔγχεϊ πολλὸν ἐνίκα·
ὅ σφιν ἐϋφρονέων ἀγορήσατο καὶ μετέειπεν·
ἀμφὶ μάλα φράζεσθε φίλοι· κέλομαι γὰρ ἔγωγε
ἄστυδε νῦν ἰέναι, μὴ μίμνειν ἠῶ δῖαν
ἐν πεδίῳ παρὰ νηυσίν· ἐκὰς δ’ ἀπὸ τείχεός εἰμεν.
ὄφρα μὲν οὗτος ἀνὴρ Ἀγαμέμνονι μήνιε δίῳ
τόφρα δὲ ῥηΐτεροι πολεμίζειν ἦσαν Ἀχαιοί·
χαίρεσκον γὰρ ἔγωγε θοῇς ἐπὶ νηυσὶν ἰαύων
ἐλπόμενος νῆας αἱρησέμεν ἀμφιελίσσας.
νῦν δ’ αἰνῶς δείδοικα ποδώκεα Πηλεΐωνα·
οἷος κείνου θυμὸς ὑπέρβιος, οὐκ ἐθελήσει
μίμνειν ἐν πεδίῳ, ὅθι περ Τρῶες καὶ Ἀχαιοὶ
ἐν μέσῳ ἀμφότεροι μένος Ἄρηος δατέονται,
ἀλλὰ περὶ πτόλιός τε μαχήσεται ἠδὲ γυναικῶν.
ἀλλ’ ἴομεν προτὶ ἄστυ, πίθεσθέ μοι· ὧδε γὰρ ἔσται·
νῦν μὲν νὺξ ἀπέπαυσε ποδώκεα Πηλεΐωνα

268 ἀμβροσίη· εἰ δ’ ἄμμε κιχήσεται ἐνθάδ’ ἐόντας
269 αὔριον ὁρμηθεὶς σὺν τεύχεσιν, εὖ νύ τις αὐτὸν
270 γνώσεται· ἀσπασίως γὰρ ἀφίξεται Ἴλιον ἱρὴν
"Look to it well, my friends; I would urge you to go back now to your city and not wait here by the ships till morning, for we are far from our walls. So long as this man has anger [mênis] against Agamemnon, the Achaeans were easier to deal with, and I would have gladly camped by the ships in the hope of taking them; but now I go in great fear of the fleet son of Peleus; he is so daring that he will never bide here on the plain whereon the Trojans and Achaeans fight with equal valor, but he will try to storm our city and carry off our women. Do then as I say, and let us retreat. For this is what will happen. The darkness of night will for a time stay the son of Peleus, but if he find us here in the morning when he sallies forth in full armor, we shall have knowledge of him in good earnest. Glad indeed will he be who can escape and get back to Ilion, and many a Trojan will become meat for dogs and vultures may I never live to hear it. If we do as I say, little though we may like it, we shall have strength in counsel during the night, and the great gates with the doors that close them will protect the city. At dawn we can arm and take our stand on the walls; he will then rue it if he sallies from the ships to fight us. He will go back when he has given his horses their fill of being driven in every which direction under our walls, and will be in no mind to try and force his way into the city. Neither will he ever sack it, dogs shall devour him ere he do so." Hektor looked fiercely at him and answered, "Polydamas, your words are not to my liking in that you bid us go back and be pent within the city. Have you not had enough of being cooped up behind walls? In the old-days the city of Priam was famous the whole world over for its wealth of gold and bronze, but our treasures are wasted out of our houses, and much goods have been sold away to Phrygia and fair Meonia, for the hand of Zeus has been laid heavily upon us. Now, therefore, that the son of scheming Kronos has granted me to win glory here and to hem the Achaeans in at their ships, prate no more in this fool's wise among the population [dêmos]. You will have no man with you; it shall not be; do all of you as I now say; - take your suppers in your companies throughout the host, and keep your watches and be wakeful every man of you. If any Trojan is uneasy about his possessions, let him gather them and give them out among the people. Better let these, rather than the Achaeans, have them. At daybreak we will arm and fight about the ships; granted that Achilles has again come forward to defend them, let it be as he will, but it shall go hard with him. I shall not shun him, but will fight him, to fall or conquer. The god of war deals out like measure to all, and the slayer may yet be slain." Thus spoke Hektor; and the Trojans, fools that they were, shouted in approval, for Pallas Athena had robbed them of their understanding. They gave ear to Hektor with his evil counsel, but the wise words of Polydamas no man would heed. They took their supper throughout the host, and meanwhile through the whole night the Achaeans mourned Patroklos, and the son of Peleus led them in their lament. He laid his murderous hands upon the breast of his comrade, groaning again and again as a bearded lion when a man who was chasing deer has robbed him of his young in some dense forest; when the lion comes back he is furious, and searches dingle and dell to track the hunter if he can find him, for he is mad with rage - even so with many a sigh did Achilles speak among the Myrmidons saying, "Alas! vain were the words with which I cheered the hero Menoitios in his own house; I said that I would bring his brave son back again to Opoeis after he had sacked Ilion and taken his share of the spoils - but Zeus does not give all men their heart's desire. The same soil shall be reddened here at Troy by the blood of us both, for I too shall never be welcomed home by the old horseman Peleus, nor by my mother Thetis, but even in this place shall the earth cover me. Nevertheless, O Patroklos, now that I am left behind you, I will not bury you, till I have brought hither the head and armor of mighty Hektor who has slain you. Twelve noble sons of Trojans will I behead before your bier to avenge you; till I have done so you shall lie as you are by the

ships, and fair women of Troy and Dardanos, whom we have taken with spear and strength of arm when we sacked men's goodly cities, shall weep over you both night and day." Then Achilles told his men to set a large tripod upon the fire that they might wash the clotted gore from off Patroklos. Thereon they set a tripod full of bath water on to a clear fire: they threw sticks on to it to make it blaze, and the water became hot as the flame played about the belly of the tripod. When the water in the cauldron was boiling they washed the body, anointed it with oil, and closed its wounds with ointment that had been kept nine years. Then they laid it on a bier and covered it with a linen cloth from head to foot, and over this they laid a fair white robe. Thus all night long did the Myrmidons gather round Achilles to mourn Patroklos. Then Zeus said to Hera his sister-wife, "So, Queen Hera, you have gained your end, and have roused fleet Achilles. One would think that the Achaeans were of your own flesh and blood." And Hera answered, "Dread son of Kronos, why should you say this thing? May not a man though he be only mortal and knows less than we do, do what he can for another person? And shall not I - foremost of all goddesses both by descent and as wife to you who reign in heaven - devise evil for the Trojans if I am angry with them?" Thus did they converse. Meanwhile Thetis came to the house of Hephaistos, imperishable [aphthitos], star-bespangled, fairest of the abodes in heaven, a house of bronze wrought by the lame god's own hands. She found him busy with his bellows, sweating and hard at work, for he was making twenty tripods that were to stand by the wall of his house, and he set wheels of gold under them all that they might go of their own selves to the assemblies [agôn] of the gods, and come back again - marvels indeed to see. They were finished all but the ears of cunning workmanship which yet remained to be fixed to them: these he was now fixing, and he was hammering at the rivets. While he was thus at work silver-footed Thetis came to the house. Kharis, of graceful head-dress, wife to the far-famed lame god, came towards her as soon as she saw her, and took her hand in her own, saying, "Why have you come to our house, Thetis, honored and ever welcome - for you do not visit us often? Come inside and let me set refreshment before you."

18.271

ὅς κε φύγῃ, πολλοὺς δὲ κύνες καὶ γῦπες ἔδονται
Τρώων· αἲ γὰρ δή μοι ἀπ’ οὔατος ὧδε γένοιτο.
εἰ δ’ ἂν ἐμοῖς ἐπέεσσι πιθώμεθα κηδόμενοί περ,
νύκτα μὲν εἰν ἀγορῇ σθένος ἔξομεν, ἄστυ δὲ πύργοι
ὑψηλαί τε πύλαι σανίδες τ’ ἐπὶ τῇς ἀραρυῖαι
μακραὶ ἐΰξεστοι ἐζευγμέναι εἰρύσσονται·
πρῶϊ δ’ ὑπηοῖοι σὺν τεύχεσι θωρηχθέντες
στησόμεθ’ ἂμ πύργους· τῷ δ’ ἄλγιον, αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσιν
ἐλθὼν ἐκ νηῶν περὶ τείχεος ἄμμι μάχεσθαι.
ἂψ πάλιν εἶσ’ ἐπὶ νῆας, ἐπεί κ’ ἐριαύχενας ἵππους
παντοίου δρόμου ἄσῃ ὑπὸ πτόλιν ἠλασκάζων·
εἴσω δ’ οὔ μιν θυμὸς ἐφορμηθῆναι ἐάσει,
οὐδέ ποτ’ ἐκπέρσει· πρίν μιν κύνες ἀργοὶ ἔδονται.
τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
Πουλυδάμα σὺ μὲν οὐκέτ’ ἐμοὶ φίλα ταῦτ’ ἀγορεύεις,
ὃς κέλεαι κατὰ ἄστυ ἀλήμεναι αὖτις ἰόντας.
ἦ οὔ πω κεκόρησθε ἐελμένοι ἔνδοθι πύργων;
πρὶν μὲν γὰρ Πριάμοιο πόλιν μέροπες ἄνθρωποι
πάντες μυθέσκοντο πολύχρυσον πολύχαλκον·
νῦν δὲ δὴ ἐξαπόλωλε δόμων κειμήλια καλά,
πολλὰ δὲ δὴ Φρυγίην καὶ Μῃονίην ἐρατεινὴν
κτήματα περνάμεν’ ἵκει, ἐπεὶ μέγας ὠδύσατο Ζεύς.

νῦν δ’ ὅτε πέρ μοι ἔδωκε Κρόνου πάϊς ἀγκυλομήτεω
κῦδος ἀρέσθ’ ἐπὶ νηυσί, θαλάσσῃ τ’ ἔλσαι Ἀχαιούς,
νήπιε μηκέτι ταῦτα νοήματα φαῖν’ ἐνὶ δήμῳ·
οὐ γάρ τις Τρώων ἐπιπείσεται· οὐ γὰρ ἐάσω.
ἀλλ’ ἄγεθ’ ὡς ἂν ἐγὼ εἴπω, πειθώμεθα πάντες.
νῦν μὲν δόρπον ἕλεσθε κατὰ στρατὸν ἐν τελέεσσι,
καὶ φυλακῆς μνήσασθε, καὶ ἐγρήγορθε ἕκαστος·
Τρώων δ’ ὃς κτεάτεσσιν ὑπερφιάλως ἀνιάζει,

18.301

συλλέξας λαοῖσι δότω καταδημοβορῆσαι·
τῶν τινὰ βέλτερόν ἐστιν ἐπαυρέμεν ἤ περ Ἀχαιούς.
πρῶϊ δ’ ὑπηοῖοι σὺν τεύχεσι θωρηχθέντες
νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσιν ἐγείρομεν ὀξὺν Ἄρηα.
εἰ δ’ ἐτεὸν παρὰ ναῦφιν ἀνέστη δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
ἄλγιον αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσι τῷ ἔσσεται· οὔ μιν ἔγωγε
φεύξομαι ἐκ πολέμοιο δυσηχέος, ἀλλὰ μάλ’ ἄντην
στήσομαι, ἤ κε φέρῃσι μέγα κράτος, ἦ κε φεροίμην.
ξυνὸς Ἐνυάλιος, καί τε κτανέοντα κατέκτα.
ὣς Ἕκτωρ ἀγόρευ’, ἐπὶ δὲ Τρῶες κελάδησαν
νήπιοι· ἐκ γάρ σφεων φρένας εἵλετο Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη.
Ἕκτορι μὲν γὰρ ἐπῄνησαν κακὰ μητιόωντι,
Πουλυδάμαντι δ’ ἄρ’ οὔ τις ὃς ἐσθλὴν φράζετο βουλήν.
δόρπον ἔπειθ’ εἵλοντο κατὰ στρατόν· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
παννύχιοι Πάτροκλον ἀνεστενάχοντο γοῶντες.
τοῖσι δὲ Πηλεΐδης ἀδινοῦ ἐξῆρχε γόοιο
χεῖρας ἐπ’ ἀνδροφόνους θέμενος στήθεσσιν ἑταίρου
πυκνὰ μάλα στενάχων ὥς τε λὶς ἠϋγένειος,
ᾧ ῥά θ’ ὑπὸ σκύμνους ἐλαφηβόλος ἁρπάσῃ ἀνὴρ
ὕλης ἐκ πυκινῆς· ὃ δέ τ’ ἄχνυται ὕστερος ἐλθών,
πολλὰ δέ τ’ ἄγκε’ ἐπῆλθε μετ’ ἀνέρος ἴχνι’ ἐρευνῶν
εἴ ποθεν ἐξεύροι· μάλα γὰρ δριμὺς χόλος αἱρεῖ·
ὣς ὃ βαρὺ στενάχων μετεφώνεε Μυρμιδόνεσσιν·
ὢ πόποι ἦ ῥ’ ἄλιον ἔπος ἔκβαλον ἤματι κείνῳ
θαρσύνων ἥρωα Μενοίτιον ἐν μεγάροισι·
φῆν δέ οἱ εἰς Ὀπόεντα περικλυτὸν υἱὸν ἀπάξειν
Ἴλιον ἐκπέρσαντα, λαχόντα τε λῃΐδος αἶσαν.
ἀλλ’ οὐ Ζεὺς ἄνδρεσσι νοήματα πάντα τελευτᾷ·
ἄμφω γὰρ πέπρωται ὁμοίην γαῖαν ἐρεῦσαι
αὐτοῦ ἐνὶ Τροίῃ, ἐπεὶ οὐδ’ ἐμὲ νοστήσαντα

18.331

δέξεται ἐν μεγάροισι γέρων ἱππηλάτα Πηλεὺς
οὐδὲ Θέτις μήτηρ, ἀλλ’ αὐτοῦ γαῖα καθέξει.
νῦν δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν Πάτροκλε σεῦ ὕστερος εἶμ’ ὑπὸ γαῖαν,
οὔ σε πρὶν κτεριῶ πρίν γ’ Ἕκτορος ἐνθάδ’ ἐνεῖκαι
τεύχεα καὶ κεφαλὴν μεγαθύμου σοῖο φονῆος·
δώδεκα δὲ προπάροιθε πυρῆς ἀποδειροτομήσω
Τρώων ἀγλαὰ τέκνα σέθεν κταμένοιο χολωθείς.
τόφρα δέ μοι παρὰ νηυσὶ κορωνίσι κείσεαι αὖτως,

ἀμφὶ δὲ σὲ Τρῳαὶ καὶ Δαρδανίδες βαθύκολποι
κλαύσονται νύκτάς τε καὶ ἤματα δάκρυ χέουσαι,
τὰς αὐτοὶ καμόμεσθα βίηφί τε δουρί τε μακρῷ
πιείρας πέρθοντε πόλεις μερόπων ἀνθρώπων.
ὣς εἰπὼν ἑτάροισιν ἐκέκλετο δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
ἀμφὶ πυρὶ στῆσαι τρίποδα μέγαν, ὄφρα τάχιστα
Πάτροκλον λούσειαν ἄπο βρότον αἱματόεντα.
οἳ δὲ λοετροχόον τρίποδ' ἵστασαν ἐν πυρὶ κηλέῳ,
ἐν δ' ἄρ' ὕδωρ ἔχεαν, ὑπὸ δὲ ξύλα δαῖον ἐλόντες.
γάστρην μὲν τρίποδος πῦρ ἄμφεπε, θέρμετο δ' ὕδωρ·
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ ζέσσεν ὕδωρ ἐνὶ ἤνοπι χαλκῷ,
καὶ τότε δὴ λοῦσάν τε καὶ ἤλειψαν λίπ' ἐλαίῳ,
ἐν δ' ὠτειλὰς πλῆσαν ἀλείφατος ἐννεώροιο·
ἐν λεχέεσσι δὲ θέντες ἑανῷ λιτὶ κάλυψαν
ἐς πόδας ἐκ κεφαλῆς, καθύπερθε δὲ φάρεϊ λευκῷ.
παννύχιοι μὲν ἔπειτα πόδας ταχὺν ἀμφ' Ἀχιλῆα
Μυρμιδόνες Πάτροκλον ἀνεστενάχοντο γοῶντες·
Ζεὺς δ' Ἥρην προσέειπε κασιγνήτην ἄλοχόν τε·
ἔπρηξας καὶ ἔπειτα βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη
ἀνστήσασ' Ἀχιλῆα πόδας ταχύν· ἦ ῥά νυ σεῖο
ἐξ αὐτῆς ἐγένοντο κάρη κομόωντες Ἀχαιοί.
τὸν δ' ἠμείβετ' ἔπειτα βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη·

18.361

αἰνότατε Κρονίδη ποῖον τὸν μῦθον ἔειπες.
καὶ μὲν δή πού τις μέλλει βροτὸς ἀνδρὶ τελέσσαι,
ὅς περ θνητός τ' ἐστὶ καὶ οὐ τόσα μήδεα οἶδε·
πῶς δὴ ἔγωγ', ἥ φημι θεάων ἔμμεν ἀρίστη,
ἀμφότερον γενεῇ τε καὶ οὕνεκα σὴ παράκοιτις
κέκλημαι, σὺ δὲ πᾶσι μετ' ἀθανάτοισιν ἀνάσσεις,
οὐκ ὄφελον Τρώεσσι κοτεσσαμένη κακὰ ῥάψαι;
ὣς οἳ μὲν τοιαῦτα πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἀγόρευον·
Ἠφαίστου δ' ἵκανε δόμον Θέτις ἀργυρόπεζα
ἄφθιτον ἀστερόεντα μεταπρεπέ' ἀθανάτοισι
χάλκεον, ὅν ῥ' αὐτὸς ποιήσατο κυλλοποδίων.
τὸν δ' εὗρ' ἱδρώοντα ἑλισσόμενον περὶ φύσας
σπεύδοντα· τρίποδας γὰρ ἐείκοσι πάντας ἔτευχεν
ἑστάμεναι περὶ τοῖχον ἐϋσταθέος μεγάροιο,
χρύσεα δέ σφ' ὑπὸ κύκλα ἑκάστῳ πυθμένι θῆκεν,
ὄφρά οἱ αὐτόματοι θεῖον δυσαίατ' ἀγῶνα
ἠδ' αὖτις πρὸς δῶμα νεοίατο θαῦμα ἰδέσθαι.
οἳ δ' ἤτοι τόσσον μὲν ἔχον τέλος, οὔατα δ' οὔ πω
δαιδάλεα προσέκειτο· τά ῥ' ἤρτυε, κόπτε δὲ δεσμούς.
ὄφρ' ὅ γε ταῦτ' ἐπονεῖτο ἰδυίῃσι πραπίδεσσι,
τόφρά οἱ ἐγγύθεν ἦλθε θεὰ Θέτις ἀργυρόπεζα.
τὴν δὲ ἴδε προμολοῦσα Χάρις λιπαροκρήδεμνος
καλή, τὴν ὤπυιε περικλυτὸς ἀμφιγυήεις·
ἔν τ' ἄρα οἱ φῦ χειρὶ ἔπος τ' ἔφατ' ἔκ τ' ὀνόμαζε·
τίπτε Θέτι τανύπεπλε ἱκάνεις ἡμέτερον δῶ
αἰδοίη τε φίλη τε; πάρος γε μὲν οὔ τι θαμίζεις.
ἀλλ' ἕπεο προτέρω, ἵνα τοι πὰρ ξείνια θείω.

388 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσασα πρόσω ἄγε δῖα θεάων.
389 τὴν μὲν ἔπειτα καθεῖσεν ἐπὶ θρόνου ἀργυροήλου
390 καλοῦ δαιδαλέου· ὑπὸ δὲ θρῆνυς ποσὶν ἦεν·
The goddess led the way as she spoke, and bade Thetis sit on a richly decorated seat inlaid with silver; there was a footstool also under her feet. Then she called Hephaistos and said, "Hephaistos, come here, Thetis wants you"; and the far-famed lame god answered, "Then it is indeed an august and honored goddess who has come here; she it was that took care of me when I was suffering from the heavy fall which I had through my cruel mother's anger - for she would have got rid of me because I was lame. It would have gone hardly with me had not Eurynome, daughter of the ever-encircling waters of Okeanos, and Thetis, taken me to their bosom. Nine years did I stay with them, and many beautiful works in bronze, brooches, spiral armlets, cups, and chains, did I make for them in their cave, with the roaring waters of Okeanos foaming as they rushed ever past it; and no one knew, neither of gods nor men, save only Thetis and Eurynome who took care of me. If, then, Thetis has come to my house I must make her due requital for having saved me; entertain her, therefore, with all hospitality, while I put by my bellows and all my tools." On this the mighty monster hobbled off from his anvil, his thin legs plying lustily under him. He set the bellows away from the fire, and gathered his tools into a silver chest. Then he took a sponge and washed his face and hands, his shaggy chest and brawny neck; he donned his shirt, grasped his strong staff, and limped towards the door. There were golden handmaids also who worked for him, and were like real young women, with sense and reason [noos], voice also and strength, and all the learning of the immortals; these busied themselves as the king bade them, while he drew near to Thetis, seated her upon a goodly seat, and took her hand in his own, saying, "Why have you come to our house, Thetis honored and ever welcome - for you do not visit us often? Say what you want, and I will do it for you at once if I can, and if it can be done at all." Thetis wept and answered, "Hephaistos, is there another goddess in Olympus whom the son of Kronos has been pleased to try with so much affliction as he has me? Me alone of the marine goddesses did he make subject to a mortal husband, Peleus son of Aiakos, and sorely against my will did I submit to the embraces of one who was but mortal, and who now stays at home worn out with age. Neither is this all. Heaven granted me a son, hero among heroes, and he shot up as a sapling. I tended him as a plant in a goodly garden and sent him with his ships to Ilion to fight the Trojans, but never shall I welcome him back to the house of Peleus. So long as he lives to look upon the light of the sun, he is in heaviness, and though I go to him I cannot help him; King Agamemnon has made him give up the maiden whom the sons of the Achaeans had awarded him, and he wastes with sorrow [akhos] for her sake. Then the Trojans hemmed the Achaeans in at their ships' sterns and would not let them come forth; the elders, therefore, of the Argives besought Achilles and offered him great treasure, whereon he refused to bring deliverance to them himself, but put his own armor on Patroklos and sent him into the fight with many people after him. All day long they fought by the Scaean gates and would have taken the city there and then, had not Apollo granted glory to Hektor and slain the valiant son of Menoitios after he had done the Trojans much evil. Therefore I am suppliant at your knees if haply you may be pleased to provide my son, whose end is near at hand, with helmet and shield, with goodly greaves fitted with ankle-clasps, and with a breastplate, for he lost his own when his true comrade fell at the hands of the Trojans, and he now lies stretched on earth in the bitterness of his soul." And Hephaistos answered, "Take heart, and be no more disquieted about this matter; would that I could hide him from death's sight when his hour is come, so surely as I can find him armor that shall amaze the eyes of all who behold it." When he had so said he left her and went to his bellows, turning them towards the fire and bidding them do their office. Twenty bellows blew upon the melting-pots, and they blew blasts of every kind, some fierce to help him when he had need of them, and others less

strong as Hephaistos willed it in the course of his work. He threw tough copper into the fire, and tin, with silver and gold; he set his great anvil on its block, and with one hand grasped his mighty hammer while he took the tongs in the other. First he shaped the shield so great and strong, adorning it all over and binding it round with a gleaming circuit in three layers; and the baldric was made of silver. He made the shield in five thicknesses, and with many a wonder did his cunning hand enrich it. He wrought the earth, the heavens, and the sea; the moon also at her full and the untiring sun, with all the signs that glorify the face of heaven - the Pleiads, the Hyads, huge Orion, and the Bear, which men also call the Wain and which turns round ever in one place, facing. Orion, and alone never dips into the stream of Okeanos. He wrought also two cities, fair to see and busy with the hum of men. In the one were weddings and wedding-feasts, and they were going about the city with brides whom they were escorting by torchlight from their chambers. Loud rose the cry of Hymen, and the youths danced to the music of flute and lyre, while the women stood each at her house door to see them.

18.391

391 κέκλετο δ’ Ἥφαιστον κλυτοτέχνην εἶπέ τε μῦθον·
392 Ἥφαιστε πρόμολ’ ὧδε· Θέτις νύ τι σεῖο χατίζει.
393 τὴν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα περικλυτὸς ἀμφιγυήεις·
394 ἦ ῥά νύ μοι δεινή τε καὶ αἰδοίη θεὸς ἔνδον,
395 ἥ μ’ ἐσάωσ’ ὅτε μ’ ἄλγος ἀφίκετο τῆλε πεσόντα
396 μητρὸς ἐμῆς ἰότητι κυνώπιδος, ἥ μ’ ἐθέλησε
397 κρύψαι χωλὸν ἐόντα· τότ’ ἂν πάθον ἄλγεα θυμῷ,
398 εἰ μή μ’ Εὐρυνόμη τε Θέτις θ’ ὑπεδέξατο κόλπῳ
399 Εὐρυνόμη θυγάτηρ ἀψορρόου Ὠκεανοῖο.
400 τῇσι παρ’ εἰνάετες χάλκευον δαίδαλα πολλά,
401 πόρπας τε γναμπτάς θ’ ἕλικας κάλυκάς τε καὶ ὅρμους
402 ἐν σπῆϊ γλαφυρῷ· περὶ δὲ ῥόος Ὠκεανοῖο
403 ἀφρῷ μορμύρων ῥέεν ἄσπετος· οὐδέ τις ἄλλος
404 ᾔδεεν οὔτε θεῶν οὔτε θνητῶν ἀνθρώπων,
405 ἀλλὰ Θέτις τε καὶ Εὐρυνόμη ἴσαν, αἵ μ’ ἐσάωσαν.
406 ἣ νῦν ἡμέτερον δόμον ἵκει· τώ με μάλα χρεὼ
407 πάντα Θέτι καλλιπλοκάμῳ ζῳάγρια τίνειν.
408 ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν νῦν οἱ παράθες ξεινήϊα καλά,
409 ὄφρ’ ἂν ἐγὼ φύσας ἀποθείομαι ὄπλά τε πάντα.
410 ἦ, καὶ ἀπ’ ἀκμοθέτοιο πέλωρ αἴητον ἀνέστη
411 χωλεύων· ὑπὸ δὲ κνῆμαι ῥώοντο ἀραιαί.
412 φύσας μέν ῥ’ ἀπάνευθε τίθει πυρός, ὅπλά τε πάντα
413 λάρνακ’ ἐς ἀργυρέην συλλέξατο, τοῖς ἐπονεῖτο·
414 σπόγγῳ δ’ ἀμφὶ πρόσωπα καὶ ἄμφω χεῖρ’ ἀπομόργνυ
415 αὐχένα τε στιβαρὸν καὶ στήθεα λαχνήεντα,
416 δῦ δὲ χιτῶν’, ἔλε δὲ σκῆπτρον παχύ, βῆ δὲ θύραζε
417 χωλεύων· ὑπὸ δ’ ἀμφίπολοι ῥώοντο ἄνακτι
418 χρύσειαι ζωῇσι νεήνισιν εἰοικυῖαι.
419 τῇς ἐν μὲν νόος ἐστὶ μετὰ φρεσίν, ἐν δὲ καὶ αὐδὴ
420 καὶ σθένος, ἀθανάτων δὲ θεῶν ἄπο ἔργα ἴσασιν.

18.421

421 αἳ μὲν ὕπαιθα ἄνακτος ἐποίπνυον· αὐτὰρ ὃ ἔρρων
422 πλησίον, ἔνθα Θέτις περ, ἐπὶ θρόνου ἷζε φαεινοῦ,

423 ἔν τ’ ἄρα οἱ φῦ χειρὶ ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζε·
424 τίπτε Θέτι τανύπεπλε ἱκάνεις ἡμέτερον δῶ
425 αἰδοίη τε φίλη τε; πάρος γε μὲν οὔ τι θαμίζεις.
426 αὖδα ὅ τι φρονέεις· τελέσαι δέ με θυμὸς ἄνωγεν,
427 εἰ δύναμαι τελέσαι γε καὶ εἰ τετελεσμένον ἐστίν.
428 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Θέτις κατὰ δάκρυ χέουσα·
429 Ἥφαιστ’, ἦ ἄρα δή τις, ὅσαι θεαί εἰσ’ ἐν Ὀλύμπῳ,
430 τοσσάδ’ ἐνὶ φρεσὶν ᾗσιν ἀνέσχετο κήδεα λυγρὰ
431 ὅσσ’ ἐμοὶ ἐκ πασέων Κρονίδης Ζεὺς ἄλγε’ ἔδωκεν;
432 ἐκ μέν μ’ ἀλλάων ἁλιάων ἀνδρὶ δάμασσεν
433 Αἰακίδῃ Πηλῆϊ, καὶ ἔτλην ἀνέρος εὐνὴν
434 πολλὰ μάλ’ οὐκ ἐθέλουσα. ὃ μὲν δὴ γήραϊ λυγρῷ
435 κεῖται ἐνὶ μεγάροις ἀρημένος, ἄλλα δέ μοι νῦν·
436 υἱὸν ἐπεί μοι δῶκε γενέσθαί τε τραφέμεν τε
437 ἔξοχον ἡρώων· ὃ δ’ ἀνέδραμεν ἔρνεϊ ἶσος·
438 τὸν μὲν ἐγὼ θρέψασα φυτὸν ὡς γουνῷ ἀλωῆς
439 νηυσὶν ἐπιπροέηκα κορωνίσιν Ἴλιον εἴσω
440 Τρωσὶ μαχησόμενον· τὸν δ’ οὐχ ὑποδέξομαι αὖτις
441 οἴκαδε νοστήσαντα δόμον Πηλήϊον εἴσω.
442 ὄφρα δέ μοι ζώει καὶ ὁρᾷ φάος ἠελίοιο
443 ἄχνυται, οὐδέ τί οἱ δύναμαι χραισμῆσαι ἰοῦσα.
444 κούρην ἣν ἄρα οἱ γέρας ἔξελον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν,
445 τὴν ἂψ ἐκ χειρῶν ἕλετο κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων.
446 ἤτοι ὃ τῆς ἀχέων φρένας ἔφθιεν· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὺς
447 Τρῶες ἐπὶ πρύμνῃσιν ἐείλεον, οὐδὲ θύραζε
448 εἴων ἐξιέναι· τὸν δὲ λίσσοντο γέροντες
449 Ἀργείων, καὶ πολλὰ περικλυτὰ δῶρ’ ὀνόμαζον.
450 ἔνθ’ αὐτὸς μὲν ἔπειτ’ ἠναίνετο λοιγὸν ἀμῦναι,

18.451

451 αὐτὰρ ὃ Πάτροκλον περὶ μὲν τὰ ἃ τεύχεα ἔσσε,
452 πέμπε δέ μιν πόλεμον δέ, πολὺν δ’ ἅμα λαὸν ὄπασσε.
453 πᾶν δ’ ἦμαρ μάρναντο περὶ Σκαιῇσι πύλῃσι·
454 καί νύ κεν αὐτῆμαρ πόλιν ἔπραθον, εἰ μὴ Ἀπόλλων
455 πολλὰ κακὰ ῥέξαντα Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμον υἱὸν
456 ἔκταν’ ἐνὶ προμάχοισι καὶ Ἕκτορι κῦδος ἔδωκε.
457 τοὔνεκα νῦν τὰ σὰ γούναθ’ ἱκάνομαι, αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσθα
458 υἱεῖ ἐμῷ ὠκυμόρῳ δόμεν ἀσπίδα καὶ τρυφάλειαν
459 καὶ καλὰς κνημῖδας ἐπισφυρίοις ἀραρυίας
460 καὶ θώρηχ’· ὃ γὰρ ἦν οἱ ἀπώλεσε πιστὸς ἑταῖρος
461 Τρωσὶ δαμείς· ὃ δὲ κεῖται ἐπὶ χθονὶ θυμὸν ἀχεύων.
462 τὴν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα περικλυτὸς ἀμφιγυήεις·
463 θάρσει· μή τοι ταῦτα μετὰ φρεσὶ σῇσι μελόντων.
464 αἲ γάρ μιν θανάτοιο δυσηχέος ὧδε δυναίμην
465 νόσφιν ἀποκρύψαι, ὅτε μιν μόρος αἰνὸς ἱκάνοι,
466 ὡς οἱ τεύχεα καλὰ παρέσσεται, οἷά τις αὖτε
467 ἀνθρώπων πολέων θαυμάσσεται, ὅς κεν ἴδηται.
468 ὣς εἰπὼν τὴν μὲν λίπεν αὐτοῦ, βῆ δ’ ἐπὶ φύσας·
469 τὰς δ’ ἐς πῦρ ἔτρεψε κέλευσέ τε ἐργάζεσθαι.
470 φῦσαι δ’ ἐν χοάνοισιν ἐείκοσι πᾶσαι ἐφύσων
471 παντοίην εὔπρηστον ἀϋτμὴν ἐξανιεῖσαι,

ἄλλοτε μὲν σπεύδοντι παρέμμεναι, ἄλλοτε δ’ αὖτε,
ὅππως Ἥφαιστός τ’ ἐθέλοι καὶ ἔργον ἄνοιτο.
χαλκὸν δ’ ἐν πυρὶ βάλλεν ἀτειρέα κασσίτερόν τε
καὶ χρυσὸν τιμῆντα καὶ ἄργυρον· αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
θῆκεν ἐν ἀκμοθέτῳ μέγαν ἄκμονα, γέντο δὲ χειρὶ
ῥαιστῆρα κρατερήν, ἑτέρηφι δὲ γέντο πυράγρην.
ποίει δὲ πρώτιστα σάκος μέγα τε στιβαρόν τε
πάντοσε δαιδάλλων, περὶ δ’ ἄντυγα βάλλε φαεινὴν
τρίπλακα μαρμαρέην, ἐκ δ’ ἀργύρεον τελαμῶνα.

18.481

πέντε δ’ ἄρ’ αὐτοῦ ἔσαν σάκεος πτύχες· αὐτὰρ ἐν αὐτῷ
ποίει δαίδαλα πολλὰ ἰδυίῃσι πραπίδεσσιν.
ἐν μὲν γαῖαν ἔτευξ’, ἐν δ’ οὐρανόν, ἐν δὲ θάλασσαν,
ἠέλιόν τ’ ἀκάμαντα σελήνην τε πλήθουσαν,
ἐν δὲ τὰ τείρεα πάντα, τά τ’ οὐρανὸς ἐστεφάνωται,
Πληϊάδας θ’ Ὑάδας τε τό τε σθένος Ὠρίωνος
Ἄρκτόν θ’, ἣν καὶ Ἅμαξαν ἐπίκλησιν καλέουσιν,
ἥ τ’ αὐτοῦ στρέφεται καί τ’ Ὠρίωνα δοκεύει,
οἴη δ’ ἄμμορός ἐστι λοετρῶν Ὠκεανοῖο.
ἐν δὲ δύω ποίησε πόλεις μερόπων ἀνθρώπων
καλάς. ἐν τῇ μέν ῥα γάμοι τ’ ἔσαν εἰλαπίναι τε,
νύμφας δ’ ἐκ θαλάμων δαΐδων ὕπο λαμπομενάων
ἠγίνεον ἀνὰ ἄστυ, πολὺς δ’ ὑμέναιος ὀρώρει·
κοῦροι δ’ ὀρχηστῆρες ἐδίνεον, ἐν δ’ ἄρα τοῖσιν
αὐλοὶ φόρμιγγές τε βοὴν ἔχον· αἳ δὲ γυναῖκες
ἱστάμεναι θαύμαζον ἐπὶ προθύροισιν ἑκάστη.
λαοὶ δ’ εἰν ἀγορῇ ἔσαν ἀθρόοι· ἔνθα δὲ νεῖκος
ὠρώρει, δύο δ’ ἄνδρες ἐνείκεον εἵνεκα ποινῆς
ἀνδρὸς ἀποφθιμένου· ὃ μὲν εὔχετο πάντ’ ἀποδοῦναι
δήμῳ πιφαύσκων, ὃ δ’ ἀναίνετο μηδὲν ἑλέσθαι·
ἄμφω δ’ ἰέσθην ἐπὶ ἴστορι πεῖραρ ἑλέσθαι.
λαοὶ δ’ ἀμφοτέροισιν ἐπήπυον ἀμφὶς ἀρωγοί·
κήρυκες δ’ ἄρα λαὸν ἐρήτυον· οἳ δὲ γέροντες
εἵατ’ ἐπὶ ξεστοῖσι λίθοις ἱερῷ ἐνὶ κύκλῳ,
σκῆπτρα δὲ κηρύκων ἐν χέρσ’ ἔχον ἠεροφώνων·
τοῖσιν ἔπειτ’ ἤϊσσον, ἀμοιβηδὶς δὲ δίκαζον.
κεῖτο δ’ ἄρ’ ἐν μέσσοισι δύω χρυσοῖο τάλαντα,
τῷ δόμεν ὃς μετὰ τοῖσι δίκην ἰθύντατα εἴποι.
τὴν δ’ ἑτέρην πόλιν ἀμφὶ δύω στρατοὶ ἧατο λαῶν
τεύχεσι λαμπόμενοι· δίχα δέ σφισιν ἤνδανε βουλή,

Meanwhile the people were gathered in assembly, for there was a quarrel [neikos], and two men were wrangling about the blood-price for a man who had died, the one claiming to the dêmos that he had the right to pay off the damages in full, and the other refusing to accept anything. Each was seeking a limit [peirar], in the presence of an arbitrator [histôr], and the people took sides, each man backing the side that he had taken; but the heralds kept them back, and the elders sat on their seats of stone in a solemn circle, holding the staves which the heralds had put into their hands. Then they rose and each in his turn gave judgment [dikê], and there were two measures of gold laid down, to be given to him whose judgment [dikê] should be deemed the fairest. About the other city there lay encamped two hosts in gleaming armor, and they were divided whether to sack it, or to spare it and accept

the half of what it contained. But the men of the city would not yet consent, and armed themselves for a surprise; their wives and little children kept guard upon the walls, and with them were the men who were past fighting through age; but the others sallied forth with Ares and Pallas Athena at their head - both of them wrought in gold and clad in golden raiment, great and fair with their armor as befitting gods, while they that followed were smaller. When they reached the place where they would lay their ambush, it was on a riverbed to which live stock of all kinds would come from far and near to water; here, then, they lay concealed, clad in full armor. Some way off them there were two scouts who were on the look-out for the coming of sheep or cattle, which presently came, followed by two shepherds who were playing on their pipes, and had not so much as a thought of danger. When those who were in ambush saw this, they cut off the flocks and herds and killed the shepherds. Meanwhile the besiegers, when they heard much noise among the cattle as they sat in council, sprang to their horses, and made with all speed towards them; when they reached them they set battle in array by the banks of the river, and the hosts aimed their bronze-shod spears at one another. With them were Strife and Riot, and fell Fate who was dragging three men after her, one with a fresh wound, and the other unwounded, while the third was dead, and she was dragging him along by his heel: and her robe was bedrabbled in men's blood. They went in and out with one another and fought as though they were living people haling away one another's dead. He wrought also a fair fallow field, large and thrice ploughed already. Many men were working at the plough within it, turning their oxen to and fro, furrow after furrow. Each time that they turned on reaching the headland a man would come up to them and give them a cup of wine, and they would go back to their furrows looking forward to the time when they should again reach the headland. The part that they had ploughed was dark behind them, so that the field, though it was of gold, still looked as if it were being ploughed - very curious to behold. He wrought also a field of harvest grain, and the reapers were reaping with sharp sickles in their hands. Swathe after swathe fell to the ground in a straight line behind them, and the binders bound them in bands of twisted straw. There were three binders, and behind them there were boys who gathered the cut grain in armfuls and kept on bringing them to be bound: among them all the owner of the land stood by in silence and was glad. The servants were getting a meal ready under an oak, for they had sacrificed a great ox, and were busy cutting him up, while the women were making a porridge of much white barley for the laborers' dinner. He wrought also a vineyard, golden and fair to see, and the vines were loaded with grapes. The bunches overhead were black, but the vines were trained on poles of silver. He ran a ditch of dark metal all round it, and fenced it with a fence of tin; there was only one path to it, and by this the vintagers went when they would gather the vintage. Youths and maidens all blithe and full of glee, carried the luscious fruit in plaited baskets; and with them there went a boy who made sweet music with his lyre, and sang the Linus-song with his clear boyish voice. He wrought also a herd of horned cattle. He made the cows of gold and tin, and they lowed as they came full speed out of the yards to go and feed among the waving reeds that grow by the banks of the river. Along with the cattle there went four shepherds, all of them in gold, and their nine fleet dogs went with them. Two terrible lions had fastened on a bellowing bull that was with the foremost cows, and bellow as he might they haled him, while the dogs and men gave chase: the lions tore through the bull's thick hide and were gorging on his blood and bowels, but the herdsmen were afraid to do anything, and only hounded on their dogs; the dogs dared not fasten on the lions but stood by barking and keeping out of harm's way. The god wrought also a pasture in a fair mountain dell, and large flock of sheep, with a homestead and huts, and sheltered sheepfolds.

18.511

511 ἠὲ διαπραθέειν ἢ ἄνδιχα πάντα δάσασθαι

κτῆσιν ὅσην πτολίεθρον ἐπήρατον ἐντὸς ἔεργεν·
οἳ δ’ οὔ πω πείθοντο, λόχῳ δ’ ὑπεθωρήσσοντο.
τεῖχος μέν ῥ’ ἄλοχοί τε φίλαι καὶ νήπια τέκνα
ῥύατ’ ἐφεσταότες, μετὰ δ’ ἀνέρες οὓς ἔχε γῆρας·
οἳ δ’ ἴσαν· ἦρχε δ’ ἄρά σφιν Ἄρης καὶ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη
ἄμφω χρυσείω, χρύσεια δὲ εἵματα ἕσθην,
καλὼ καὶ μεγάλω σὺν τεύχεσιν, ὥς τε θεώ περ
ἀμφὶς ἀριζήλω· λαοὶ δ’ ὑπολίζονες ἦσαν.
οἳ δ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἵκανον ὅθι σφίσιν εἶκε λοχῆσαι
ἐν ποταμῷ, ὅθι τ’ ἀρδμὸς ἔην πάντεσσι βοτοῖσιν,
ἔνθ’ ἄρα τοί γ’ ἵζοντ’ εἰλυμένοι αἴθοπι χαλκῷ.
τοῖσι δ’ ἔπειτ’ ἀπάνευθε δύω σκοποὶ εἵατο λαῶν
δέγμενοι ὁππότε μῆλα ἰδοίατο καὶ ἕλικας βοῦς.
οἳ δὲ τάχα προγένοντο, δύω δ’ ἅμ’ ἕποντο νομῆες
τερπόμενοι σύριγξι· δόλον δ’ οὔ τι προνόησαν.
οἳ μὲν τὰ προϊδόντες ἐπέδραμον, ὦκα δ’ ἔπειτα
τάμνοντ’ ἀμφὶ βοῶν ἀγέλας καὶ πώεα καλὰ
ἀργεννέων οἰῶν, κτεῖνον δ’ ἐπὶ μηλοβοτῆρας.
οἳ δ’ ὡς οὖν ἐπύθοντο πολὺν κέλαδον παρὰ βουσὶν
εἰράων προπάροιθε καθήμενοι, αὐτίκ’ ἐφ’ ἵππων
βάντες ἀερσιπόδων μετεκίαθον, αἶψα δ’ ἵκοντο.
στησάμενοι δ’ ἐμάχοντο μάχην ποταμοῖο παρ’ ὄχθας,
βάλλον δ’ ἀλλήλους χαλκήρεσιν ἐγχείῃσιν.
ἐν δ’ Ἔρις ἐν δὲ Κυδοιμὸς ὁμίλεον, ἐν δ’ ὀλοὴ Κήρ,
ἄλλον ζωὸν ἔχουσα νεούτατον, ἄλλον ἄουτον,
ἄλλον τεθνηῶτα κατὰ μόθον ἕλκε ποδοῖιν·
εἶμα δ’ ἔχ’ ἀμφ’ ὤμοισι δαφοινεὸν αἵματι φωτῶν.
ὡμίλευν δ’ ὥς τε ζωοὶ βροτοὶ ἠδ’ ἐμάχοντο,
νεκρούς τ’ ἀλλήλων ἕρυον κατατεθνηῶτας.

18.541

ἐν δ’ ἐτίθει νειὸν μαλακὴν πίειραν ἄρουραν
εὐρεῖαν τρίπολον· πολλοὶ δ’ ἀροτῆρες ἐν αὐτῇ
ζεύγεα δινεύοντες ἐλάστρεον ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα.
οἳ δ’ ὁπότε στρέψαντες ἱκοίατο τέλσον ἀρούρης,
τοῖσι δ’ ἔπειτ’ ἐν χερσὶ δέπας μελιηδέος οἴνου
δόσκεν ἀνὴρ ἐπιών· τοὶ δὲ στρέψασκον ἀν’ ὄγμους,
ἱέμενοι νειοῖο βαθείης τέλσον ἱκέσθαι.
ἣ δὲ μελαίνετ’ ὄπισθεν, ἀρηρομένῃ δὲ ἐῴκει,
χρυσείη περ ἐοῦσα· τὸ δὴ περὶ θαῦμα τέτυκτο.
ἐν δ’ ἐτίθει τέμενος βασιλήϊον· ἔνθα δ’ ἔριθοι
ἤμων ὀξείας δρεπάνας ἐν χερσὶν ἔχοντες.
δράγματα δ’ ἄλλα μετ’ ὄγμον ἐπήτριμα πῖπτον ἔραζε,
ἄλλα δ’ ἀμαλλοδετῆρες ἐν ἑλλεδανοῖσι δέοντο.
τρεῖς δ’ ἄρ’ ἀμαλλοδετῆρες ἐφέστασαν· αὐτὰρ ὄπισθε
παῖδες δραγμεύοντες ἐν ἀγκαλίδεσσι φέροντες
ἀσπερχὲς πάρεχον· βασιλεὺς δ’ ἐν τοῖσι σιωπῇ
σκῆπτρον ἔχων ἑστήκει ἐπ’ ὄγμου γηθόσυνος κῆρ.
κήρυκες δ’ ἀπάνευθεν ὑπὸ δρυῒ δαῖτα πένοντο,
βοῦν δ’ ἱερεύσαντες μέγαν ἄμφεπον· αἱ δὲ γυναῖκες
δεῖπνον ἐρίθοισιν λεύκ’ ἄλφιτα πολλὰ πάλυνον.

561 ἐν δ’ ἐτίθει σταφυλῇσι μέγα βρίθουσαν ἀλωὴν
562 καλὴν χρυσείην· μέλανες δ’ ἀνὰ βότρυες ἦσαν,
563 ἐστήκει δὲ κάμαξι διαμπερὲς ἀργυρέῃσιν.
564 ἀμφὶ δὲ κυανέην κάπετον, περὶ δ’ ἕρκος ἔλασσε
565 κασσιτέρου· μία δ’ οἴη ἀταρπιτὸς ἦεν ἐπ’ αὐτήν,
566 τῇ νίσοντο φορῆες ὅτε τρυγόῳεν ἀλωήν.
567 παρθενικαὶ δὲ καὶ ἠΐθεοι ἀταλὰ φρονέοντες
568 πλεκτοῖς ἐν ταλάροισι φέρον μελιηδέα καρπόν.
569 τοῖσιν δ’ ἐν μέσσοισι πάϊς φόρμιγγι λιγείῃ
570 ἱμερόεν κιθάριζε, λίνον δ’ ὑπὸ καλὸν ἄειδε

18.571

571 λεπταλέῃ φωνῇ· τοὶ δὲ ῥήσσοντες ἀμαρτῇ
572 μολπῇ τ’ ἰυγμῷ τε ποσὶ σκαίροντες ἕποντο.
573 ἐν δ’ ἀγέλην ποίησε βοῶν ὀρθοκραιράων·
574 αἳ δὲ βόες χρυσοῖο τετεύχατο κασσιτέρου τε,
575 μυκηθμῷ δ’ ἀπὸ κόπρου ἐπεσσεύοντο νομὸν δὲ
576 πὰρ ποταμὸν κελάδοντα, παρὰ ῥοδανὸν δονακῆα.
577 χρύσειοι δὲ νομῆες ἅμ’ ἐστιχόωντο βόεσσι
578 τέσσαρες, ἐννέα δέ σφι κύνες πόδας ἀργοὶ ἕποντο.
579 σμερδαλέω δὲ λέοντε δύ’ ἐν πρώτῃσι βόεσσι
580 ταῦρον ἐρύγμηλον ἐχέτην· ὃ δὲ μακρὰ μεμυκὼς
581 ἕλκετο· τὸν δὲ κύνες μετεκίαθον ἠδ’ αἰζηοί.
582 τὼ μὲν ἀναρρήξαντε βοὸς μεγάλοιο βοείην
583 ἔγκατα καὶ μέλαν αἷμα λαφύσσετον· οἳ δὲ νομῆες
584 αὔτως ἐνδίεσαν ταχέας κύνας ὀτρύνοντες.
585 οἳ δ’ ἤτοι δακέειν μὲν ἀπετρωπῶντο λεόντων,
586 ἱστάμενοι δὲ μάλ’ ἐγγὺς ὑλάκτεον ἔκ τ’ ἀλέοντο.
587 ἐν δὲ νομὸν ποίησε περικλυτὸς ἀμφιγυήεις
588 ἐν καλῇ βήσσῃ μέγαν οἰῶν ἀργεννάων,
589 σταθμούς τε κλισίας τε κατηρεφέας ἰδὲ σηκούς.
590 ἐν δὲ χορὸν ποίκιλλε περικλυτὸς ἀμφιγυήεις,
591 τῷ ἴκελον οἷόν ποτ’ ἐνὶ Κνωσῷ εὐρείῃ
592 Δαίδαλος ἤσκησεν καλλιπλοκάμῳ Ἀριάδνῃ.
593 ἔνθα μὲν ἠΐθεοι καὶ παρθένοι ἀλφεσίβοιαι
594 ὀρχεῦντ’ ἀλλήλων ἐπὶ καρπῷ χεῖρας ἔχοντες.
595 τῶν δ’ αἳ μὲν λεπτὰς ὀθόνας ἔχον, οἳ δὲ χιτῶνας
596 εἵατ’ ἐϋννήτους, ἦκα στίλβοντας ἐλαίῳ·
597 καί ῥ’ αἳ μὲν καλὰς στεφάνας ἔχον, οἳ δὲ μαχαίρας
598 εἶχον χρυσείας ἐξ ἀργυρέων τελαμώνων.
599 οἳ δ’ ὁτὲ μὲν θρέξασκον ἐπισταμένοισι πόδεσσι
600 ῥεῖα μάλ’, ὡς ὅτε τις τροχὸν ἅρμενον ἐν παλάμῃσιν

Furthermore he wrought a green, like that which Daedalus once made in Knossos for lovely Ariadne. Here was a dance [khoros] of youths and maidens, whom all would woo, all with their hands on one another's wrists. The maidens wore robes of light linen, and the youths well woven shirts that were slightly oiled. The girls were crowned with garlands, while the young men had daggers of gold that hung by silver baldrics; sometimes they would dance deftly in a ring with merry twinkling feet, as it were a potter sitting at his work and making trial of his wheel to see whether it will run, and sometimes they would go all in line with one another, and many people was gathered joyously about the place of dancing [khoros]. There was a bard also to sing to them and play his lyre, while two tumblers went about

performing in the midst of them when the man struck up with his tune. All round the outermost rim of the shield he set the mighty stream of the river Okeanos. Then when he had fashioned the shield so great and strong, he made a breastplate also that shone brighter than fire. He made helmet, close fitting to the brow, and richly worked, with a golden plume overhanging it; and he made greaves also of beaten tin. Lastly, when the famed lame god had made all the armor, he took it and set it before the mother of Achilles; whereon she darted like a falcon from the snowy summits of Olympus and bore away the gleaming armor from the house of Hephaistos.

18.601

601 ἐζόμενος κεραμεὺς πειρήσεται, αἴ κε θέῃσιν·
602 ἄλλοτε δ’ αὖ θρέξασκον ἐπὶ στίχας ἀλλήλοισι.
603 πολλὸς δ’ ἱμερόεντα χορὸν περιίσταθ’ ὅμιλος
604 τερπόμενοι· μετὰ δέ σφιν ἐμέλπετο θεῖος ἀοιδὸς
605 φορμίζων· δοιὼ δὲ κυβιστητῆρε κατ’ αὐτοὺς
606 μολπῆς ἐξάρχοντες ἐδίνευον κατὰ μέσσους.
607 ἐν δ’ ἐτίθει ποταμοῖο μέγα σθένος Ὠκεανοῖο
608 ἄντυγα πὰρ πυμάτην σάκεος πύκα ποιητοῖο.
609 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ τεῦξε σάκος μέγα τε στιβαρόν τε,
610 τεῦξ’ ἄρα οἱ θώρηκα φαεινότερον πυρὸς αὐγῆς,
611 τεῦξε δέ οἱ κόρυθα βριαρὴν κροτάφοις ἀραρυῖαν
612 καλὴν δαιδαλέην, ἐπὶ δὲ χρύσεον λόφον ἧκε,
613 τεῦξε δέ οἱ κνημῖδας ἑανοῦ κασσιτέροιο.
614 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ πάνθ’ ὅπλα κάμε κλυτὸς ἀμφιγυήεις,
615 μητρὸς Ἀχιλλῆος θῆκε προπάροιθεν ἀείρας.
616 ἣ δ’ ἴρηξ ὣς ἆλτο κατ’ Οὐλύμπου νιφόεντος
617 τεύχεα μαρμαίροντα παρ’ Ἡφαίστοιο φέρουσα.

19.1

1 Ἠὼς μὲν κροκόπεπλος ἀπ’ Ὠκεανοῖο ῥοάων
2 ὄρνυθ’, ἵν’ ἀθανάτοισι φόως φέροι ἠδὲ βροτοῖσιν·
3 ἣ δ’ ἐς νῆας ἵκανε θεοῦ πάρα δῶρα φέρουσα.
4 εὗρε δὲ Πατρόκλῳ περικείμενον ὃν φίλον υἱὸν
5 κλαίοντα λιγέως· πολέες δ’ ἀμφ’ αὐτὸν ἑταῖροι
6 μύρονθ’· ἣ δ’ ἐν τοῖσι παρίστατο δῖα θεάων,
7 ἔν τ’ ἄρα οἱ φῦ χειρὶ ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζε·
8 τέκνον ἐμὸν τοῦτον μὲν ἐάσομεν ἀχνύμενοί περ
9 κεῖσθαι, ἐπεὶ δὴ πρῶτα θεῶν ἰότητι δαμάσθη·
10 τύνη δ’ Ἡφαίστοιο πάρα κλυτὰ τεύχεα δέξο
11 καλὰ μάλ’, οἷ’ οὔ πώ τις ἀνὴρ ὤμοισι φόρησεν.
12 ὡς ἄρα φωνήσασα θεὰ κατὰ τεύχε’ ἔθηκε
13 πρόσθεν Ἀχιλλῆος· τὰ δ’ ἀνέβραχε δαίδαλα πάντα.
14 Μυρμιδόνας δ’ ἄρα πάντας ἔλε τρόμος, οὐδέ τις ἔτλη
15 ἄντην εἰσιδέειν, ἀλλ’ ἔτρεσαν. αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
16 ὡς εἶδ’, ὥς μιν μᾶλλον ἔδυ χόλος, ἐν δέ οἱ ὄσσε
17 δεινὸν ὑπὸ βλεφάρων ὡς εἰ σέλας ἐξεφάανθεν·
18 τέρπετο δ’ ἐν χείρεσσιν ἔχων θεοῦ ἀγλαὰ δῶρα.
19 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ φρεσὶν ᾗσι τετάρπετο δαίδαλα λεύσσων
20 αὐτίκα μητέρα ἣν ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
21 μῆτερ ἐμὴ τὰ μὲν ὄπλα θεὸς πόρεν οἷ’ ἐπιεικὲς

22 ἔργ’ ἔμεν ἀθανάτων, μὴ δὲ βροτὸν ἄνδρα τελέσσαι.
23 νῦν δ’ ἤτοι μὲν ἐγὼ θωρήξομαι· ἀλλὰ μάλ’ αἰνῶς
24 δείδω μή μοι τόφρα Μενοιτίου ἄλκιμον υἱὸν
25 μυῖαι καδδῦσαι κατὰ χαλκοτύπους ὠτειλὰς
26 εὐλὰς ἐγγείνωνται, ἀεικίσσωσι δὲ νεκρόν,
27 ἐκ δ’ αἰὼν πέφαται, κατὰ δὲ χρόα πάντα σαπήῃ.
28 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα θεὰ Θέτις ἀργυρόπεζα·
29 τέκνον μή τοι ταῦτα μετὰ φρεσὶ σῇσι μελόντων.
30 τῷ μὲν ἐγὼ πειρήσω ἀλαλκεῖν ἄγρια φῦλα
Now when Dawn in robe of saffron was hastening from the streams of Okeanos, to bring light to mortals and immortals, Thetis reached the ships with the armor that the god had given her. She found her son fallen about the body of Patroklos and weeping bitterly. Many also of his followers were weeping round him, but when the goddess came among them she clasped his hand in her own, saying, "My son, grieve as we may we must let this man lie, for it is by heaven's will that he has fallen; now, therefore, accept from Hephaistos this rich and goodly armor, which no man has ever yet borne upon his shoulders." As she spoke she set the armor before Achilles, and it rang out bravely as she did so. The Myrmidons were struck with awe, and none dared look full at it, for they were afraid; but Achilles was roused to still greater fury, and his eyes gleamed with a fierce light, for he was glad when he handled the splendid present which the god had made him. Then, as soon as he had satisfied himself with looking at it, he said to his mother, "Mother, the god has given me armor, meet handiwork for an immortal and such as no living could have fashioned; I will now arm, but I much fear that flies will settle upon the son of Menoitios and breed worms about his wounds, so that his body, now he is dead, will be disfigured and the flesh will rot." Silver-footed Thetis answered, "My son, be not disquieted about this matter. I will find means to protect him from the swarms of noisome flies that prey on the bodies of men who have been killed in battle. He may lie for a whole year, and his flesh shall still be as sound as ever, or even sounder. Call, therefore, the Achaean heroes in assembly; unsay your anger [mênis] against Agamemnon; arm at once, and fight with might and main." As she spoke she put strength and courage into his heart, and she then dropped ambrosia and red nectar into the wounds of Patroklos, that his body might suffer no change. Then Achilles went out upon the seashore, and with a loud cry called on the Achaean heroes. On this even those who as yet had stayed always at the assembly of [agôn] of ships, the pilots and helmsmen, and even the stewards who were about the ships and served out rations, all came to the place of assembly because Achilles had shown himself after having held aloof so long from fighting. Two squires [therapontes] of Ares, Odysseus and the son of Tydeus, came limping, for their wounds still pained them; nevertheless they came, and took their seats in the front row of the assembly. Last of all came Agamemnon, king of men, he too wounded, for Koön son of Antenor had struck him with a spear in battle. When the Achaeans were got together Achilles rose and said, "Son of Atreus, surely it would have been better alike for both you and me, when we two were in such high anger about Briseis, surely it would have been better, had Artemis' arrow slain her at the ships on the day when I took her after having sacked Lyrnessos. For so, many an Achaean the less would have bitten dust before the foe in the days of my anger. It has been well for Hektor and the Trojans, but the Achaeans will long indeed remember our quarrel. Now, however, let it be, for it is over. If we have been angry, necessity has schooled our anger. I put it from me: I dare not nurse it for ever; therefore, bid the Achaeans arm forthwith that I may go out against the Trojans, and learn whether they will be in a mind to sleep by the ships or no. Glad, I ween, will he be to rest his knees who may flee my spear when I wield it." Thus did he speak, and the Achaeans rejoiced in that he had put away his anger [mênis]. Then Agamemnon spoke, rising in his place, and not going into the middle of the assembly.

"Danaan heroes," said he, "squires [therapontes] of Ares, it is well to listen when a man stands up to speak, and it is not seemly to interrupt him, or it will go hard even with a practiced speaker. Who can either hear or speak in an uproar? Even the finest orator will be disconcerted by it. I will expound to the son of Peleus, and do you other Achaeans heed me and mark me well. Often have the Achaeans spoken to me of this matter and upbraided me, but it was not I who was responsible [aitios]: Zeus, and Fate [Moira], and Erinys that walks in darkness struck me with derangement [atê] when we were assembled on the day that I took from Achilles the prize that had been awarded to him. What could I do? All things are in the hand of heaven, and Atê, eldest of Zeus' daughters, shuts men's eyes to their destruction. She walks delicately, not on the solid earth, but hovers over the heads of men to make them stumble or to ensnare them. "Time was when she fooled Zeus himself, who they say is greatest whether of gods or men; for Hera, woman though she was, beguiled him on the day when Alkmene was to bring forth mighty Herakles in the fair city of Thebes. He told it out among the gods saying, ‘Hear me all gods and goddesses, that I may speak even as I am minded; this day shall an Eileithuia, helper of women who are in labor, bring a man child into the world who shall be lord over all that dwell about him who are of my blood and lineage.’ Then said Hera all crafty and full of guile, ‘You will play false, and will not hold to the finality [telos] of your word. Swear me, O Olympian, swear me a great oath, that he who shall this day fall between the feet of a woman, shall be lord over all that dwell about him who are of your blood and lineage.’ "Thus she spoke, and Zeus suspected her not, but swore the great oath, to his much ruing thereafter. For Hera darted down from the high summit of Olympus, and went in haste to Achaean Argos where she knew that the noble wife of Sthenelos son of Perseus then was. She being with child and in her seventh month, Hera brought the child to birth though there was a month still wanting, but she stayed the offspring of Alkmene, and kept back the Eileithuiai. Then she went to tell Zeus the son of Kronos, and said, ‘Father Zeus, lord of the lightning - I have a word for your ear. There is a fine child born this day, Eurystheus, son to Sthenelos the son of Perseus; he is of your lineage; it is well, therefore, that he should reign over the Argives.’

19.31

μυίας, αἵ ῥά τε φῶτας ἀρηϊφάτους κατέδουσιν·
ἤν περ γὰρ κεῖταί γε τελεσφόρον εἰς ἐνιαυτόν,
αἰεὶ τῷ γ’ ἔσται χρὼς ἔμπεδος, ἢ καὶ ἀρείων.
ἀλλὰ σύ γ’ εἰς ἀγορὴν καλέσας ἥρωας Ἀχαιοὺς
μῆνιν ἀποειπὼν Ἀγαμέμνονι ποιμένι λαῶν
αἶψα μάλ’ ἐς πόλεμον θωρήσσεο, δύσεο δ’ ἀλκήν.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσασα μένος πολυθαρσὲς ἐνῆκε,
Πατρόκλῳ δ’ αὖτ’ ἀμβροσίην καὶ νέκταρ ἐρυθρὸν
στάξε κατὰ ῥινῶν, ἵνα οἱ χρὼς ἔμπεδος εἴη.
αὐτὰρ ὃ βῆ παρὰ θῖνα θαλάσσης δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
σμερδαλέα ἰάχων, ὦρσεν δ’ ἥρωας Ἀχαιούς.
καί ῥ’ οἵ περ τὸ πάρος γε νεῶν ἐν ἀγῶνι μένεσκον
οἵ τε κυβερνῆται καὶ ἔχον οἰήϊα νηῶν
καὶ ταμίαι παρὰ νηυσὶν ἔσαν σίτοιο δοτῆρες,
καὶ μὴν οἳ τότε γ’ εἰς ἀγορὴν ἴσαν, οὔνεκ’ Ἀχιλλεὺς
ἐξεφάνη, δηρὸν δὲ μάχης ἐπέπαυτ’ ἀλεγεινῆς.
τὼ δὲ δύω σκάζοντε βάτην Ἄρεος θεράποντε
Τυδεΐδης τε μενεπτόλεμος καὶ δῖος Ὀδυσσεὺς
ἔγχει ἐρειδομένω· ἔτι γὰρ ἔχον ἕλκεα λυγρά·
κὰδ δὲ μετὰ πρώτῃ ἀγορῇ ἵζοντο κιόντες.
αὐτὰρ ὃ δεύτατος ἦλθεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων

52 ἕλκος ἔχων· καὶ γὰρ τὸν ἐνὶ κρατερῇ ὑσμίνῃ
53 οὗτα Κόων Ἀντηνορίδης χαλκήρεϊ δουρί.
54 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ δὴ πάντες ἀολλίσθησαν Ἀχαιοί,
55 τοῖσι δ’ ἀνιστάμενος μετέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
56 Ἀτρεΐδη ἦ ἄρ τι τόδ’ ἀμφοτέροισιν ἄρειον
57 ἔπλετο σοὶ καὶ ἐμοί, ὅ τε νῶϊ περ ἀχνυμένω κῆρ
58 θυμοβόρῳ ἔριδι μενεήναμεν εἵνεκα κούρης;
59 τὴν ὄφελ’ ἐν νήεσσι κατακτάμεν Ἄρτεμις ἰῷ
60 ἤματι τῷ ὅτ’ ἐγὼν ἑλόμην Λυρνησσὸν ὀλέσσας·

19.61

61 τώ κ’ οὐ τόσσοι Ἀχαιοὶ ὀδὰξ ἕλον ἄσπετον οὖδας
62 δυσμενέων ὑπὸ χερσὶν ἐμεῦ ἀπομηνίσαντος.
63 Ἕκτορι μὲν καὶ Τρωσὶ τὸ κέρδιον· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὺς
64 δηρὸν ἐμῆς καὶ σῆς ἔριδος μνήσεσθαι ὀΐω.
65 ἀλλὰ τὰ μὲν προτετύχθαι ἐάσομεν ἀχνύμενοί περ
66 θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσι φίλον δαμάσαντες ἀνάγκῃ·
67 νῦν δ’ ἤτοι μὲν ἐγὼ παύω χόλον, οὐδέ τί με χρὴ
68 ἀσκελέως αἰεὶ μενεαινέμεν· ἀλλ’ ἄγε θᾶσσον
69 ὄτρυνον πόλεμον δὲ κάρη κομόωντας Ἀχαιούς,
70 ὄφρ’ ἔτι καὶ Τρώων πειρήσομαι ἀντίον ἐλθὼν
71 αἴ κ’ ἐθέλωσ’ ἐπὶ νηυσὶν ἰαύειν· ἀλλά τιν’ οἴω
72 ἀσπασίως αὐτῶν γόνυ κάμψειν, ὅς κε φύγῃσι
73 δηΐου ἐκ πολέμοιο ὑπ’ ἔγχεος ἠμετέροιο.
74 Ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἐχάρησαν ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
75 μῆνιν ἀπειπόντος μεγαθύμου Πηλεΐωνος.
76 τοῖσι δὲ καὶ μετέειπεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων
77 αὐτόθεν ἐξ ἕδρης, οὐδ’ ἐν μέσσοισιν ἀναστάς·
78 ὦ φίλοι ἥρωες Δαναοὶ θεράποντες Ἄρηος
79 ἐσταότος μὲν καλὸν ἀκούειν, οὐδὲ ἔοικεν
80 ὑββάλλειν· χαλεπὸν γὰρ ἐπισταμένῳ περ ἐόντι.
81 ἀνδρῶν δ’ ἐν πολλῷ ὁμάδῳ πῶς κέν τις ἀκούσαι
82 ἢ εἴποι; βλάβεται δὲ λιγύς περ ἐὼν ἀγορητής.
83 Πηλεΐδῃ μὲν ἐγὼν ἐνδείξομαι· αὐτὰρ οἱ ἄλλοι
84 σύνθεσθ’ Ἀργεῖοι, μῦθόν τ’ εὖ γνῶτε ἕκαστος.
85 πολλάκι δή μοι τοῦτον Ἀχαιοὶ μῦθον ἔειπον
86 καί τέ με νεικείεσκον· ἐγὼ δ’ οὐκ αἴτιός εἰμι,
87 ἀλλὰ Ζεὺς καὶ Μοῖρα καὶ ἠεροφοῖτις Ἐρινύς,
88 οἵ τέ μοι εἰν ἀγορῇ φρεσὶν ἔμβαλον ἄγριον ἄτην,
89 ἤματι τῷ ὅτ’ Ἀχιλλῆος γέρας αὐτὸς ἀπηύρων.
90 ἀλλὰ τί κεν ῥέξαιμι; θεὸς διὰ πάντα τελευτᾷ.

19.91

91 πρέσβα Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἄτη, ἣ πάντας ἀᾶται,
92 οὐλομένη· τῇ μέν θ’ ἁπαλοὶ πόδες· οὐ γὰρ ἐπ’ οὔδει
93 πίλναται, ἀλλ’ ἄρα ἥ γε κατ’ ἀνδρῶν κράατα βαίνει
94 βλάπτουσ’ ἀνθρώπους· κατὰ δ’ οὖν ἕτερόν γε πέδησε.
95 καὶ γὰρ δή νύ ποτε Ζεὺς ἄσατο, τόν περ ἄριστον
96 ἀνδρῶν ἠδὲ θεῶν φασ’ ἔμμεναι· ἀλλ’ ἄρα καὶ τὸν
97 Ἥρη θῆλυς ἐοῦσα δολοφροσύνῃς ἀπάτησεν,

ἤματι τῷ ὅτ’ ἔμελλε βίην Ἡρακληείην
Ἀλκμήνη τέξεσθαι ἐϋστεφάνῳ ἐνὶ Θήβῃ.
ἦτοι ὅ γ’ εὐχόμενος μετέφη πάντεσσι θεοῖσι·
κέκλυτέ μευ πάντές τε θεοὶ πᾶσαί τε θέαιναι,
ὄφρ’ εἴπω τά με θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἀνώγει.
σήμερον ἄνδρα φόως δὲ μογοστόκος Εἰλείθυια
ἐκφανεῖ, ὃς πάντεσσι περικτιόνεσσιν ἀνάξει,
τῶν ἀνδρῶν γενεῆς οἵ θ’ αἵματος ἐξ ἐμεῦ εἰσί.
τὸν δὲ δολοφρονέουσα προσηύδα πότνια Ἥρη·
ψευστήσεις, οὐδ’ αὖτε τέλος μύθῳ ἐπιθήσεις.
εἰ δ’ ἄγε νῦν μοι ὄμοσσον Ὀλύμπιε καρτερὸν ὅρκον,
ἦ μὲν τὸν πάντεσσι περικτιόνεσσιν ἀνάξειν
ὅς κεν ἐπ’ ἤματι τῷδε πέσῃ μετὰ ποσσὶ γυναικὸς
τῶν ἀνδρῶν οἳ σῆς ἐξ αἵματός εἰσι γενέθλης.
ὣς ἔφατο· Ζεὺς δ’ οὔ τι δολοφροσύνην ἐνόησεν,
ἀλλ’ ὄμοσεν μέγαν ὅρκον, ἔπειτα δὲ πολλὸν ἀάσθη.
Ἥρη δ’ ἀΐξασα λίπεν ῥίον Οὐλύμποιο,
καρπαλίμως δ’ ἵκετ’ Ἄργος Ἀχαικόν, ἔνθ’ ἄρα ᾔδη
ἰφθίμην ἄλοχον Σθενέλου Περσηϊάδαο.
ἣ δ’ ἐκύει φίλον υἱόν, ὃ δ’ ἕβδομος ἐστήκει μείς·
ἐκ δ’ ἄγαγε πρὸ φόως δὲ καὶ ἡλιτόμηνον ἐόντα,
Ἀλκμήνης δ’ ἀπέπαυσε τόκον, σχέθε δ’ Εἰλειθυίας.
αὐτὴ δ’ ἀγγελέουσα Δία Κρονίωνα προσηύδα·

19.121

Ζεῦ πάτερ ἀργικέραυνε ἔπος τί τοι ἐν φρεσὶ θήσω·
ἤδη ἀνὴρ γέγον’ ἐσθλὸς ὃς Ἀργείοισιν ἀνάξει
Εὐρυσθεὺς Σθενέλοιο πάϊς Περσηϊάδαο
σὸν γένος· οὔ οἱ ἀεικὲς ἀνασσέμεν Ἀργείοισιν.
ὣς φάτο, τὸν δ’ ἄχος ὀξὺ κατὰ φρένα τύψε βαθεῖαν·
αὐτίκα δ’ εἶλ’ Ἄτην κεφαλῆς λιπαροπλοκάμοιο
χωόμενος φρεσὶν ᾗσι, καὶ ὤμοσε καρτερὸν ὅρκον
μή ποτ’ ἐς Οὔλυμπόν τε καὶ οὐρανὸν ἀστερόεντα
αὖτις ἐλεύσεσθαι Ἄτην, ἣ πάντας ἀᾶται.
ὣς εἰπὼν ἔρριψεν ἀπ’ οὐρανοῦ ἀστερόεντος
χειρὶ περιστρέψας· τάχα δ’ ἵκετο ἔργ’ ἀνθρώπων.
τὴν αἰεὶ στενάχεσχ’ ὅθ’ ἑὸν φίλον υἱὸν ὁρῷτο
ἔργον ἀεικὲς ἔχοντα ὑπ’ Εὐρυσθῆος ἀέθλων.
ὣς καὶ ἐγών, ὅτε δ’ αὖτε μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ
Ἀργείους ὀλέκεσκεν ἐπὶ πρυμνῇσι νέεσσιν,
οὐ δυνάμην λελαθέσθ’ Ἄτης ᾗ πρῶτον ἀάσθην.
ἀλλ’ ἐπεὶ ἀασάμην καί μευ φρένας ἐξέλετο Ζεύς,
ἄψ ἐθέλω ἀρέσαι, δόμεναί τ’ ἀπερείσι’ ἄποινα·
ἀλλ’ ὄρσευ πόλεμον δὲ καὶ ἄλλους ὄρνυθι λαούς.
δῶρα δ’ ἐγὼν ὅδε πάντα παρασχέμεν ὅσσά τοι ἐλθὼν
χθιζὸς ἐνὶ κλισίῃσιν ὑπέσχετο δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς.
εἰ δ’ ἐθέλεις, ἐπίμεινον ἐπειγόμενός περ Ἄρηος,
δῶρα δέ τοι θεράποντες ἐμῆς παρὰ νηὸς ἐλόντες
οἴσουσ’, ὄφρα ἴδηαι ὅ τοι μενοεικέα δώσω.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
Ἀτρεΐδη κύδιστε ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγάμεμνον

147 δῶρα μὲν αἴ κ’ ἐθέλῃσθα παρασχέμεν, ὡς ἐπιεικές,
148 ἥ τ’ ἐχέμεν παρὰ σοί· νῦν δὲ μνησώμεθα χάρμης
149 αἶψα μάλ’· οὐ γὰρ χρὴ κλοτοπεύειν ἐνθάδ’ ἐόντας
150 οὐδὲ διατρίβειν· ἔτι γὰρ μέγα ἔργον ἄρεκτον·
"On this Zeus was stung to the very quick with grief [akhos], and in his rage he caught Atê by the hair, and swore a great oath that never should she again invade starry heaven and Olympus, for she was the bane of all. Then he whirled her round with a twist of his hand, and flung her down from heaven so that she fell on to the fields of mortal men; and he was ever angry with her when he saw his son groaning under the cruel labors [athloi] that Eurystheus laid upon him. Even so did I grieve when mighty Hektor was killing the Argives at their ships, and all the time I kept thinking of Atê who had so baned me. I was blind, and Zeus robbed me of my reason; I will now make atonement, and will add much treasure by way of amends. Go, therefore, into battle, you and your people with you. I will give you all that Odysseus offered you yesterday in your tents: or if it so please you, wait, though you would fain fight at once, and my squires [therapontes] shall bring the gifts from my ship, that you may see whether what I give you is enough." And Achilles answered, "Son of Atreus, king of men Agamemnon, you can give such gifts as you think proper, or you can withhold them: it is in your own hands. Let us now set battle in array; it is not well to tarry talking about trifles, for there is a deed which is as yet to do. Achilles shall again be seen fighting among the foremost, and laying low the ranks of the Trojans: bear this in mind each one of you when he is fighting." Then Odysseus said, "Achilles, godlike and brave, send not the Achaeans thus against Ilion to fight the Trojans fasting, for the battle will be no brief one, when it is once begun, and heaven has filled both sides with fury; bid them first take food both bread and wine by the ships, for in this there is strength and stay. No man can do battle the livelong day to the going down of the sun if he is without food; however much he may want to fight his strength will fail him before he knows it; hunger and thirst will find him out, and his limbs will grow weary under him. But a man can fight all day if he is full fed with meat and wine; his heart beats high, and his strength will stay till he has routed all his foes; therefore, send the people away and bid them prepare their meal; King Agamemnon will bring out the gifts in presence of the assembly, that all may see them and you may be satisfied. Moreover let him swear an oath before the Argives that he has never gone up into the couch of Briseis, nor has lain down with her, even though it is right [themis] for humans, both men and women, to do this; and do you, too, show yourself of a gracious mind; let Agamemnon entertain you in his tents with a feast of reconciliation, that so you may have had your dues in full. As for you, son of Atreus, treat people more righteously in future; it is no disgrace even to a king that he should make amends if he was wrong in the first instance." And King Agamemnon answered, "Son of Laertes, your words please me well, for throughout you have spoken wisely. I will swear as you would have me do; I do so of my own free will, neither shall I take the name of a daimôn in vain. Let, then, Achilles wait, though he would fain fight at once, and do you others wait also, till the gifts come from my tent and we ratify the oath with sacrifice. Thus, then, do I charge you: choose [krinô] some noble young Achaeans to go with you, and bring from my tents the gifts that I promised yesterday to Achilles, and bring the women also; furthermore let Talthybios find me a boar from those that are with the host, and make it ready for sacrifice to Zeus and to the sun." Then said Achilles, "Son of Atreus, king of men Agamemnon, see to these matters at some other season, when there is breathing time and when I am calmer. Would you have men eat while the bodies of those whom Hektor son of Priam slew are still lying mangled upon the plain? Let the sons of the Achaeans, say I, fight fasting and without food, till we have avenged them; afterwards at the going down of the sun let them eat their fill. As for me, Patroklos is lying dead in my tent, all hacked and hewn, with his feet to the door, and his comrades are mourning round him. Therefore I can take thought of nothing

save only slaughter and blood and the rattle in the throat of the dying." Odysseus answered, "Achilles, son of Peleus, mightiest of all the Achaeans, in battle you are better than I, and that more than a little, but in counsel I am much before you, for I am older and of greater knowledge. Therefore be patient under my words. Fighting is a thing of which men soon surfeit, and when Zeus, who is wars steward, weighs the upshot, it may well prove that the straw which our sickles have reaped is far heavier than the grain. It may not be that the Achaeans should mourn the dead with their bellies; day by day men fall thick and threefold continually; when should we have respite from our sorrow [ponos]? Let us mourn our dead for a day and bury them out of sight and mind, but let those of us who are left eat and drink that we may arm and fight our foes more fiercely. In that hour let no man hold back, waiting for a second summons; such summons shall bode ill for him who is found lagging behind at our ships; let us rather sally as one man and loose the fury of war upon the Trojans." When he had thus spoken he took with him the sons of Nestor, with Meges son of Phyleus, Thoas, Meriones, Lykomedes son of Kreontes, and Melanippos, and went to the tent of Agamemnon son of Atreus. The word was not sooner said than the deed was done: they brought out the seven tripods which Agamemnon had promised, with the twenty metal cauldrons and the twelve horses; they also brought the women skilled in useful arts, seven in number, with Briseis, which made eight. Odysseus weighed out the ten talents of gold and then led the way back, while the young Achaeans brought the rest of the gifts, and laid them in the middle of the assembly.

19.151

ὥς κέ τις αὖτ’ Ἀχιλῆα μετὰ πρώτοισιν ἴδηται
ἔγχεϊ χαλκείῳ Τρώων ὀλέκοντα φάλαγγας.
ὧδέ τις ὑμείων μεμνημένος ἀνδρὶ μαχέσθω.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεύς·
μὴ δ’ οὕτως, ἀγαθός περ ἐών, θεοείκελ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ
νήστιας ὄτρυνε προτὶ Ἴλιον υἷας Ἀχαιῶν
Τρωσὶ μαχησομένους, ἐπεὶ οὐκ ὀλίγον χρόνον ἔσται
φύλοπις, εὖτ’ ἂν πρῶτον ὁμιλήσωσι φάλαγγες
ἀνδρῶν, ἐν δὲ θεὸς πνεύσῃ μένος ἀμφοτέροισιν.
ἀλλὰ πάσασθαι ἄνωχθι θοῇς ἐπὶ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιοὺς
σίτου καὶ οἴνοιο· τὸ γὰρ μένος ἐστὶ καὶ ἀλκή.
οὐ γὰρ ἀνὴρ πρόπαν ἦμαρ ἐς ἠέλιον καταδύντα
ἄκμηνος σίτοιο δυνήσεται ἄντα μάχεσθαι·
εἴ περ γὰρ θυμῷ γε μενοινάᾳ πολεμίζειν,
ἀλλά τε λάθρῃ γυῖα βαρύνεται, ἠδὲ κιχάνει
δίψά τε καὶ λιμός, βλάβεται δέ τε γούνατ’ ἰόντι.
ὃς δέ κ’ ἀνὴρ οἴνοιο κορεσσάμενος καὶ ἐδωδῆς
ἀνδράσι δυσμενέεσσι πανημέριος πολεμίζῃ,
θαρσαλέον νύ οἱ ἦτορ ἐνὶ φρεσίν, οὐδέ τι γυῖα
πρὶν κάμνει πρὶν πάντας ἐρωῆσαι πολέμοιο.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε λαὸν μὲν σκέδασον καὶ δεῖπνον ἄνωχθι
ὄπλεσθαι· τὰ δὲ δῶρα ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων
οἰσέτω ἐς μέσσην ἀγορήν, ἵνα πάντες Ἀχαιοὶ
ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ἴδωσι, σὺ δὲ φρεσὶ σῇσιν ἰανθῇς.
ὀμνυέτω δέ τοι ὅρκον ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἀναστὰς
μή ποτε τῆς εὐνῆς ἐπιβήμεναι ἠδὲ μιγῆναι·
ἣ θέμις ἐστὶν ἄναξ ἥ τ’ ἀνδρῶν ἥ τε γυναικῶν·
καὶ δὲ σοὶ αὐτῷ θυμὸς ἐνὶ φρεσὶν ἵλαος ἔστω.
αὐτὰρ ἔπειτά σε δαιτὶ ἐνὶ κλισίῃς ἀρεσάσθω

πιείρῃ, ἵνα μή τι δίκης ἐπιδευὲς ἔχῃσθα.

19.181

Ἀτρεΐδη σὺ δ’ ἔπειτα δικαιότερος καὶ ἐπ’ ἄλλῳ
ἔσσεαι. οὐ μὲν γάρ τι νεμεσσητὸν βασιλῆα
ἄνδρ’ ἀπαρέσσασθαι ὅτε τις πρότερος χαλεπήνῃ.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
χαίρω σεῦ Λαερτιάδη τὸν μῦθον ἀκούσας·
ἐν μοίρῃ γὰρ πάντα διίκεο καὶ κατέλεξας.
ταῦτα δ’ ἐγὼν ἐθέλω ὀμόσαι, κέλεται δέ με θυμός,
οὐδ’ ἐπιορκήσω πρὸς δαίμονος. αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
μιμνέτω αὐτόθι τεῖος ἐπειγόμενός περ Ἄρηος·
μίμνετε δ’ ἄλλοι πάντες ἀολλέες, ὄφρά κε δῶρα
ἐκ κλισίης ἔλθῃσι καὶ ὅρκια πιστὰ τάμωμεν.
σοὶ δ’ αὐτῷ τόδ’ ἐγὼν ἐπιτέλλομαι ἠδὲ κελεύω·
κρινάμενος κούρητας ἀριστῆας Παναχαιῶν
δῶρα ἐμῆς παρὰ νηὸς ἐνεικέμεν, ὅσσ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ
χθιζὸν ὑπέστημεν δώσειν, ἀγέμεν τε γυναῖκας.
Ταλθύβιος δέ μοι ὧκα κατὰ στρατὸν εὐρὺν Ἀχαιῶν
κάπρον ἑτοιμασάτω ταμέειν Διί τ’ Ἠελίῳ τε.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
Ἀτρεΐδη κύδιστε ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγάμεμνον
ἄλλοτέ περ καὶ μᾶλλον ὀφέλλετε ταῦτα πένεσθαι,
ὀππότε τις μεταπαυσωλὴ πολέμοιο γένηται
καὶ μένος οὐ τόσον ᾖσιν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἐμοῖσι.
νῦν δ’ οἳ μὲν κέαται δεδαϊγμένοι, οὓς ἐδάμασσεν
Ἕκτωρ Πριαμίδης, ὅτε οἱ Ζεὺς κῦδος ἔδωκεν,
ὑμεῖς δ’ ἐς βρωτὺν ὀτρύνετον· ἦ τ’ ἂν ἔγωγε
νῦν μὲν ἀνώγοιμι πτολεμίζειν υἷας Ἀχαιῶν
νήστιας ἀκμήνους, ἅμα δ’ ἠελίῳ καταδύντι
τεύξεσθαι μέγα δόρπον, ἐπὴν τεισαίμεθα λώβην.
πρὶν δ’ οὔ πως ἂν ἔμοιγε φίλον κατὰ λαιμὸν ἰείη
οὐ πόσις οὐδὲ βρῶσις ἑταίρου τεθνηῶτος

19.211

ὅς μοι ἐνὶ κλισίῃ δεδαϊγμένος ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ
κεῖται ἀνὰ πρόθυρον τετραμμένος, ἀμφὶ δ’ ἑταῖροι
μύρονται· τό μοι οὔ τι μετὰ φρεσὶ ταῦτα μέμηλεν,
ἀλλὰ φόνος τε καὶ αἷμα καὶ ἀργαλέος στόνος ἀνδρῶν.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πολύμητις Ὀδυσσεύς·
ὦ Ἀχιλεῦ Πηλῆος υἱὲ μέγα φέρτατ’ Ἀχαιῶν,
κρείσσων εἰς ἐμέθεν καὶ φέρτερος οὐκ ὀλίγον περ
ἔγχει, ἐγὼ δέ κε σεῖο νοήματί γε προβαλοίμην
πολλόν, ἐπεὶ πρότερος γενόμην καὶ πλείονα οἶδα.
τώ τοι ἐπιτλήτω κραδίη μύθοισιν ἐμοῖσιν.
αἶψά τε φυλόπιδος πέλεται κόρος ἀνθρώποισιν,
ἧς τε πλείστην μὲν καλάμην χθονὶ χαλκὸς ἔχευεν,
ἄμητος δ’ ὀλίγιστος, ἐπὴν κλίνῃσι τάλαντα
Ζεύς, ὅς τ’ ἀνθρώπων ταμίης πολέμοιο τέτυκται.
γαστέρι δ’ οὔ πως ἔστι νέκυν πενθῆσαι Ἀχαιούς·

λίην γὰρ πολλοὶ καὶ ἐπήτριμοι ἤματα πάντα
πίπτουσιν· πότε κέν τις ἀναπνεύσειε πόνοιο;
ἀλλὰ χρὴ τὸν μὲν καταθάπτειν ὅς κε θάνῃσι
νηλέα θυμὸν ἔχοντας ἐπ’ ἤματι δακρύσαντας·
ὅσσοι δ’ ἂν πολέμοιο περὶ στυγεροῖο λίπωνται
μεμνῆσθαι πόσιος καὶ ἐδητύος, ὄφρ’ ἔτι μᾶλλον
ἀνδράσι δυσμενέεσσι μαχώμεθα νωλεμὲς αἰεὶ
ἐσσάμενοι χροῒ χαλκὸν ἀτειρέα. μηδέ τις ἄλλην
λαῶν ὀτρυντὺν ποτιδέγμενος ἰσχαναάσθω·
ἥδε γὰρ ὀτρυντὺς κακὸν ἔσσεται ὅς κε λίπηται
νηυσὶν ἐπ’ Ἀργείων· ἀλλ’ ἀθρόοι ὁρμηθέντες
Τρωσὶν ἐφ’ ἱπποδάμοισιν ἐγείρομεν ὀξὺν Ἄρηα.
ἦ, καὶ Νέστορος υἱὰς ὀπάσσατο κυδαλίμοιο
Φυλεΐδην τε Μέγητα Θόαντά τε Μηριόνην τε
καὶ Κρειοντιάδην Λυκομήδεα καὶ Μελάνιππον·

19.241

βὰν δ’ ἴμεν ἐς κλισίην Ἀγαμέμνονος Ἀτρεΐδαο.
αὐτίκ’ ἔπειθ’ ἅμα μῦθος ἔην, τετέλεστο δὲ ἔργον·
ἑπτὰ μὲν ἐκ κλισίης τρίποδας φέρον, οὓς οἱ ὑπέστη,
αἴθωνας δὲ λέβητας ἐείκοσι, δώδεκα δ’ ἵππους·
ἐκ δ’ ἄγον αἶψα γυναῖκας ἀμύμονα ἔργα ἰδυίας
ἕπτ’, ἀτὰρ ὀγδοάτην Βρισηΐδα καλλιπάρῃον.
χρυσοῦ δὲ στήσας Ὀδυσεὺς δέκα πάντα τάλαντα
ἦρχ’, ἅμα δ’ ἄλλοι δῶρα φέρον κούρητες Ἀχαιῶν.
καὶ τὰ μὲν ἐν μέσσῃ ἀγορῇ θέσαν, ἂν δ’ Ἀγαμέμνων
ἵστατο· Ταλθύβιος δὲ θεῷ ἐναλίγκιος αὐδὴν
κάπρον ἔχων ἐν χερσὶ παρίστατο ποιμένι λαῶν.
Ἀτρεΐδης δὲ ἐρυσσάμενος χείρεσσι μάχαιραν,
ἥ οἱ πὰρ ξίφεος μέγα κουλεὸν αἰὲν ἄωρτο,
κάπρου ἀπὸ τρίχας ἀρξάμενος Διὶ χεῖρας ἀνασχὼν
εὔχετο· τοὶ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἐπ’ αὐτόφιν εἵατο σιγῇ
Ἀργεῖοι κατὰ μοῖραν ἀκούοντες βασιλῆος.
εὐξάμενος δ’ ἄρα εἶπεν ἰδὼν εἰς οὐρανὸν εὐρύν·
ἴστω νῦν Ζεὺς πρῶτα θεῶν ὕπατος καὶ ἄριστος
Γῆ τε καὶ Ἠέλιος καὶ Ἐρινύες, αἵ θ’ ὑπὸ γαῖαν
ἀνθρώπους τίνυνται, ὅτις κ’ ἐπίορκον ὀμόσσῃ,
μὴ μὲν ἐγὼ κούρῃ Βρισηΐδι χεῖρ’ ἐπένεικα,
οὔτ’ εὐνῆς πρόφασιν κεχρημένος οὔτέ τευ ἄλλου.
ἀλλ’ ἔμεν’ ἀπροτίμαστος ἐνὶ κλισίῃσιν ἐμῇσιν.
εἰ δέ τι τῶνδ’ ἐπίορκον ἐμοὶ θεοὶ ἄλγεα δοῖεν
πολλὰ μάλ’, ὅσσα διδοῦσιν ὅτίς σφ’ ἀλίτηται ὀμόσσας.
ἦ, καὶ ἀπὸ στόμαχον κάπρου τάμε νηλέϊ χαλκῷ.
τὸν μὲν Ταλθύβιος πολιῆς ἁλὸς ἐς μέγα λαῖτμα
ῥῖψ’ ἐπιδινήσας βόσιν ἰχθύσιν· αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
ἀνστὰς Ἀργείοισι φιλοπτολέμοισι μετηύδα·
Ζεῦ πάτερ ἦ μεγάλας ἄτας ἄνδρεσσι διδοῖσθα·

Agamemnon then rose, and Talthybios whose voice was like that of a god came to him with the boar. The son of Atreus drew the knife which he wore by the scabbard of his mighty sword, and began by cutting off some bristles from the boar, lifting up his hands in prayer as he did so. The other Achaeans sat where they were all silent and orderly to hear the

king, and Agamemnon looked into the vault of heaven and prayed saying, "I call Zeus the first and mightiest of all gods to witness, I call also Earth and Sun and the Erinyes who dwell below and take vengeance on him who shall swear falsely, that I have laid no hand upon the girl Briseis, neither to take her to my bed nor otherwise, but that she has remained in my tents inviolate. If I swear falsely may heaven visit me with all the penalties which it metes out to those who perjure themselves." He cut the boar's throat as he spoke, whereon Talthybios whirled it round his head, and flung it into the wide sea to feed the fishes. Then Achilles also rose and said to the Argives, "Father Zeus, truly you give atê to men and bane them. The son of Atreus had not else stirred me to so fierce an anger, nor so stubbornly taken Briseis from me against my will. Surely Zeus must have counseled the destruction of many an Argive. Go, now, and take your food that we may begin fighting." On this he broke up the assembly, and every man went back to his own ship. The Myrmidons attended to the presents and took them away to the ship of Achilles. They placed them in his tents, while the stable-men [therapontes] drove the horses in among the others. Briseis, fair as Aphrodite, when she saw the mangled body of Patroklos, flung herself upon it and cried aloud, tearing her breast, her neck, and her lovely face with both her hands. Beautiful as a goddess she wept and said, "Patroklos, dearest friend, when I went hence I left you living; I return, O prince, to find you dead; thus do fresh sorrows multiply upon me one after the other. I saw him to whom my father and mother married me, cut down before our city, and my three own dear brothers perished with him on the self-same day; but you, Patroklos, even when Achilles slew my husband and sacked the city of noble Mynes, told me that I was not to weep, for you said you would make Achilles marry me, and take me back with him to Phthia, we should have a wedding feast among the Myrmidons. You were always kind to me and I shall never cease to grieve for you." She wept as she spoke, and the women joined in her lament-making as though their tears were for Patroklos, but in truth each was weeping for her own sorrows. The elders of the Achaeans gathered round Achilles and prayed him to take food, but he groaned and would not do so. "I pray you," said he, "if any comrade will hear me, bid me neither eat nor drink, for I am in great heaviness, and will stay fasting even to the going down of the sun." On this he sent the other princes away, save only the two sons of Atreus and Odysseus, Nestor, Idomeneus, and the horseman Phoenix, who stayed behind and tried to comfort him in the bitterness of his sorrow [akhos]: but he would not be comforted till he should have flung himself into the jaws of battle, and he fetched sigh on sigh, thinking ever of Patroklos. Then he said- "Hapless and dearest comrade, you it was who would get a good dinner ready for me at once and without delay when the Achaeans were hastening to fight the Trojans; now, therefore, though I have meat and drink in my tents, yet will I fast for sorrow. Grief greater than this I could not know, not even though I were to hear of the death of my father, who is now in Phthia weeping for the loss of me his son, who am here fighting the Trojans in a strange land [dêmos] for the accursed sake of Helen, nor yet though I should hear that my son is no more - he who is being brought up in Skyros - if indeed Neoptolemos is still living. Till now I made sure that I alone was to fall here at Troy away from Argos, while you were to return to Phthia, bring back my son with you in your own ship, and show him all my property, my bondsmen, and the greatness of my house - for Peleus must surely be either dead, or what little life remains to him is oppressed alike with the infirmities of age and ever present fear lest he should hear the sad tidings of my death." He wept as he spoke, and the elders sighed in concert as each thought on what he had left at home behind him. The son of Kronos looked down with pity upon them, and said presently to Athena, "My child, you have quite deserted your hero; is he then gone so clean out of your recollection? There he sits by the ships all desolate for the loss of his dear comrade, and though the others are gone to their dinner he will neither eat nor drink. Go then and drop nectar and ambrosia into his breast, that he may know no hunger."

19.271

271 οὐκ ἂν δή ποτε θυμὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἐμοῖσιν
272 Ἀτρεΐδης ὤρινε διαμπερές, οὐδέ κε κούρην
273 ἦγεν ἐμεῦ ἀέκοντος ἀμήχανος· ἀλλά ποθι Ζεὺς
274 ἤθελ’ Ἀχαιοῖσιν θάνατον πολέεσσι γενέσθαι.
275 νῦν δ’ ἔρχεσθ’ ἐπὶ δεῖπνον, ἵνα ξυνάγωμεν Ἄρηα.
276 ὣς ἄρ’ ἐφώνησεν, λῦσεν δ’ ἀγορὴν αἰψηρήν.
277 οἳ μὲν ἄρ’ ἐσκίδναντο ἐὴν ἐπὶ νῆα ἕκαστος,
278 δῶρα δὲ Μυρμιδόνες μεγαλήτορες ἀμφεπένοντο,
279 βὰν δ’ ἐπὶ νῆα φέροντες Ἀχιλλῆος θείοιο.
280 καὶ τὰ μὲν ἐν κλισίῃσι θέσαν, κάθισαν δὲ γυναῖκας,
281 ἵππους δ’ εἰς ἀγέλην ἔλασαν θεράποντες ἀγαυοί.
282 Βρισηΐς δ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτ’ ἰκέλη χρυσέῃ Ἀφροδίτῃ
283 ὡς ἴδε Πάτροκλον δεδαϊγμένον ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ,
284 ἀμφ’ αὐτῷ χυμένη λίγ’ ἐκώκυε, χερσὶ δ’ ἄμυσσε
285 στήθεά τ’ ἠδ’ ἀπαλὴν δειρὴν ἰδὲ καλὰ πρόσωπα.
286 εἶπε δ’ ἄρα κλαίουσα γυνὴ ἐϊκυῖα θεῇσι·
287 Πάτροκλέ μοι δειλῇ πλεῖστον κεχαρισμένε θυμῷ
288 ζωὸν μέν σε ἔλειπον ἐγὼ κλισίηθεν ἰοῦσα,
289 νῦν δέ σε τεθνηῶτα κιχάνομαι ὄρχαμε λαῶν
290 ἂψ ἀνιοῦσ’· ὥς μοι δέχεται κακὸν ἐκ κακοῦ αἰεί.
291 ἄνδρα μὲν ᾧ ἔδοσάν με πατὴρ καὶ πότνια μήτηρ
292 εἶδον πρὸ πτόλιος δεδαϊγμένον ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ,
293 τρεῖς τε κασιγνήτους, τούς μοι μία γείνατο μήτηρ,
294 κηδείους, οἳ πάντες ὁλέθριον ἦμαρ ἐπέσπον.
295 οὐδὲ μὲν οὐδέ μ’ ἔασκες, ὅτ’ ἄνδρ’ ἐμὸν ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεὺς
296 ἔκτεινεν, πέρσεν δὲ πόλιν θείοιο Μύνητος,
297 κλαίειν, ἀλλά μ’ ἔφασκες Ἀχιλλῆος θείοιο
298 κουριδίην ἄλοχον θήσειν, ἄξειν τ’ ἐνὶ νηυσὶν
299 ἐς Φθίην, δαίσειν δὲ γάμον μετὰ Μυρμιδόνεσσι.
300 τώ σ’ ἄμοτον κλαίω τεθνηότα μείλιχον αἰεί.

19.301

301 ὣς ἔφατο κλαίουσ’, ἐπὶ δὲ στενάχοντο γυναῖκες
302 Πάτροκλον πρόφασιν, σφῶν δ’ αὐτῶν κήδε’ ἑκάστη.
303 αὐτὸν δ’ ἀμφὶ γέροντες Ἀχαιῶν ἠγερέθοντο
304 λισσόμενοι δειπνῆσαι· ὃ δ’ ἠρνεῖτο στεναχίζων·
305 λίσσομαι, εἴ τις ἔμοιγε φίλων ἐπιπείθεθ’ ἑταίρων,
306 μή με πρὶν σίτοιο κελεύετε μηδὲ ποτῆτος
307 ἄσασθαι φίλον ἦτορ, ἐπεί μ’ ἄχος αἰνὸν ἱκάνει·
308 δύντα δ’ ἐς ἠέλιον μενέω καὶ τλήσομαι ἔμπης.
309 ὣς εἰπὼν ἄλλους μὲν ἀπεσκέδασεν βασιλῆας,
310 δοιὼ δ’ Ἀτρεΐδα μενέτην καὶ δῖος Ὀδυσσεὺς
311 Νέστωρ Ἰδομενεύς τε γέρων θ’ ἱππηλάτα Φοῖνιξ
312 τέρποντες πυκινῶς ἀκαχήμενον· οὐδέ τι θυμῷ
313 τέρπετο, πρὶν πολέμου στόμα δύμεναι αἱματόεντος.
314 μνησάμενος δ’ ἀδινῶς ἀνενείκατο φώνησέν τε·
315 ἦ ῥά νύ μοί ποτε καὶ σὺ δυσάμμορε φίλταθ’ ἑταίρων
316 αὐτὸς ἐνὶ κλισίῃ λαρὸν παρὰ δεῖπνον ἔθηκας
317 αἶψα καὶ ὀτραλέως, ὁπότε σπερχοίατ’ Ἀχαιοὶ
318 Τρωσὶν ἐφ’ ἱπποδάμοισι φέρειν πολύδακρυν Ἄρηα.

νῦν δὲ σὺ μὲν κεῖσαι δεδαϊγμένος, αὐτὰρ ἐμὸν κῆρ
ἄκμηνον πόσιος καὶ ἐδητύος, ἔνδον ἐόντων,
σῇ ποθῇ· οὐ μὲν γάρ τι κακώτερον ἄλλο πάθοιμι,
οὐδ’ εἴ κεν τοῦ πατρὸς ἀποφθιμένοιο πυθοίμην,
ὅς που νῦν Φθίηφι τέρεν κατὰ δάκρυον εἴβει
χήτεϊ τοιοῦδ’ υἷος· ὃ δ’ ἀλλοδαπῷ ἐνὶ δήμῳ
εἵνεκα ῥιγεδανῆς Ἑλένης Τρωσὶν πολεμίζω·
ἠὲ τὸν ὃς Σκύρῳ μοι ἔνι τρέφεται φίλος υἱός,
εἴ που ἔτι ζώει γε Νεοπτόλεμος θεοειδής.
πρὶν μὲν γάρ μοι θυμὸς ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ἐώλπει
οἷον ἐμὲ φθίσεσθαι ἀπ’ Ἄργεος ἱπποβότοιο
αὐτοῦ ἐνὶ Τροίῃ, σὲ δέ τε Φθίην δὲ νέεσθαι,

19.331

ὡς ἄν μοι τὸν παῖδα θοῇ ἐνὶ νηῒ μελαίνῃ
Σκυρόθεν ἐξαγάγοις καί οἱ δείξειας ἕκαστα
κτῆσιν ἐμὴν δμῶάς τε καὶ ὑψερεφὲς μέγα δῶμα.
ἤδη γὰρ Πηλῆά γ’ ὀΐομαι ἢ κατὰ πάμπαν
τεθνάμεν, ἤ που τυτθὸν ἔτι ζώοντ’ ἀκάχησθαι
γήραΐ τε στυγερῷ καὶ ἐμὴν ποτιδέγμενον αἰεὶ
λυγρὴν ἀγγελίην, ὅτ’ ἀποφθιμένοιο πύθηται.
ὣς ἔφατο κλαίων, ἐπὶ δὲ στενάχοντο γέροντες,
μνησάμενοι τὰ ἕκαστος ἐνὶ μεγάροισιν ἔλειπον·
μυρομένους δ’ ἄρα τούς γε ἰδὼν ἐλέησε Κρονίων,
αἶψα δ’ Ἀθηναίην ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
τέκνον ἐμόν, δὴ πάμπαν ἀποίχεαι ἀνδρὸς ἐῆος.
ἦ νύ τοι οὐκέτι πάγχυ μετὰ φρεσὶ μέμβλετ’ Ἀχιλλεύς;
κεῖνος ὅ γε προπάροιθε νεῶν ὀρθοκραιράων
ἧσται ὀδυρόμενος ἕταρον φίλον· οἱ δὲ δὴ ἄλλοι
οἴχονται μετὰ δεῖπνον, ὃ δ’ ἄκμηνος καὶ ἄπαστος.
ἀλλ’ ἴθι οἱ νέκτάρ τε καὶ ἀμβροσίην ἐρατεινὴν
στάξον ἐνὶ στήθεσσ’, ἵνα μή μιν λιμὸς ἵκηται.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε πάρος μεμαυῖαν Ἀθήνην·
ἣ δ’ ἅρπῃ ἐϊκυῖα τανυπτέρυγι λιγυφώνῳ
οὐρανοῦ ἐκκατεπᾶλτο δι’ αἰθέρος. αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
αὐτίκα θωρήσσοντο κατὰ στρατόν· ἣ δ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ
νέκταρ ἐνὶ στήθεσσι καὶ ἀμβροσίην ἐρατεινὴν
στάξ’, ἵνα μή μιν λιμὸς ἀτερπὴς γούναθ’ ἵκοιτο·
αὐτὴ δὲ πρὸς πατρὸς ἐρισθενέος πυκινὸν δῶ
ᾤχετο, τοὶ δ’ ἀπάνευθε νεῶν ἐχέοντο θοάων.
ὡς δ’ ὅτε ταρφειαὶ νιφάδες Διὸς ἐκποτέονται
ψυχραὶ ὑπὸ ῥιπῆς αἰθρηγενέος Βορέαο,
ὣς τότε ταρφειαὶ κόρυθες λαμπρὸν γανόωσαι
νηῶν ἐκφορέοντο καὶ ἀσπίδες ὀμφαλόεσσαι

With these words he urged Athena, who was already of the same mind. She darted down from heaven into the air like some falcon sailing on his broad wings and screaming. Meanwhile the Achaeans were arming throughout the host, and when Athena had dropped nectar and ambrosia into Achilles so that no cruel hunger should cause his limbs to fail him, she went back to the house of her mighty father. Thick as the chill snow-flakes shed from the hand of Zeus and borne on the keen blasts of the north wind, even so thick did the gleaming helmets, the bossed shields, the strongly plated breastplates, and the ashen

spears stream from the ships. The sheen pierced the sky, the whole land was radiant with their flashing armor, and the sound of the tramp of their treading rose from under their feet. In the midst of them all Achilles put on his armor; he gnashed his teeth, his eyes gleamed like fire, for his grief [akhos] was greater than he could bear. Thus, then, full of fury against the Trojans, did he don the gift of the god, the armor that Hephaistos had made him. First he put on the goodly greaves fitted with ankle-clasps, and next he did on the breastplate about his chest. He slung the silver-studded sword of bronze about his shoulders, and then took up the shield so great and strong that shone afar with a splendor as of the moon. As the light seen by sailors from out at sea [pontos], when men have lit a fire in their homestead high up among the mountains, but the sailors are carried out to sea [pontos] by wind and storm far from the haven where they would be - even so did the gleam of Achilles' wondrous shield strike up into the heavens. He lifted the redoubtable helmet, and set it upon his head, from whence it shone like a star, and the golden plumes which Hephaistos had set thick about the ridge of the helmet, waved all around it. Then Achilles made trial of himself in his armor to see whether it fitted him, so that his limbs could play freely under it, and it seemed to buoy him up as though it had been wings. He also drew his father's spear out of the spear-stand, a spear so great and heavy and strong that none of the Achaeans save only Achilles had strength to wield it; this was the spear of Pelian ash from the topmost ridges of Mount Pelion, which Chiron had once given to Peleus, fraught with the death of heroes. Automedon and Alkimos busied themselves with the harnessing of his horses; they made the bands fast about them, and put the bit in their mouths, drawing the reins back towards the chariot. Automedon, whip in hand, sprang up behind the horses, and after him Achilles mounted in full armor, resplendent as the sun-god Hyperion. Then with a loud voice he chided with his father's horses saying, " Xanthos and Balios, famed offspring of Podarge - this time when we have done fighting be sure and bring your driver safely back to the host of the Achaeans, and do not leave him dead on the plain as you did Patroklos." Then fleet Xanthos answered under the yoke - for white-armed Hera had endowed him with human speech - and he bowed his head till his mane touched the ground as it hung down from under the yoke-band. "Dread Achilles," said he, "we will indeed save you now, but the day of your death is near, and we will not be responsible [aitioi], for it will be heaven and stern fate that will destroy you. Neither was it through any sloth or slackness on our part that the Trojans stripped Patroklos of his armor; it was the mighty god whom lovely Leto bore that slew him as he fought among the foremost, and granted a triumph to Hektor. We two can fly as swiftly as Zephyros who they say is fleetest of all winds; nevertheless it is your doom to fall by the hand of a man and of a god." When he had thus spoken, the Erinyes stayed his speech, and Achilles answered him in great sadness, saying, "Why, O Xanthos, do you thus foretell my death? You need not do so, for I well know that I am to fall here, far from my dear father and mother; none the more, however, shall I stay my hand till I have given the Trojans their fill of fighting." So saying, with a loud cry he drove his horses to the front.

19.361

361 θώρηκές τε κραταιγύαλοι καὶ μείλινα δοῦρα.
362 αἴγλη δ’ οὐρανὸν ἷκε, γέλασσε δὲ πᾶσα περὶ χθὼν
363 χαλκοῦ ὑπὸ στεροπῆς· ὑπὸ δὲ κτύπος ὄρνυτο ποσσὶν
364 ἀνδρῶν· ἐν δὲ μέσοισι κορύσσετο δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς.
365 τοῦ καὶ ὀδόντων μὲν καναχὴ πέλε, τὼ δέ οἱ ὄσσε
366 λαμπέσθην ὡς εἴ τε πυρὸς σέλας, ἐν δέ οἱ ἦτορ
367 δῦν’ ἄχος ἄτλητον· ὃ δ’ ἄρα Τρωσὶν μενεαίνων
368 δύσετο δῶρα θεοῦ, τά οἱ Ἥφαιστος κάμε τεύχων.
369 κνημῖδας μὲν πρῶτα περὶ κνήμῃσιν ἔθηκε

καλὰς ἀργυρέοισιν ἐπισφυρίοις ἀραρυίας·
δεύτερον αὖ θώρηκα περὶ στήθεσσιν ἔδυνεν.
ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ ὤμοισιν βάλετο ξίφος ἀργυρόηλον
χάλκεον· αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα σάκος μέγα τε στιβαρόν τε
εἵλετο, τοῦ δ’ ἀπάνευθε σέλας γένετ’ ἠΰτε μήνης.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἂν ἐκ πόντοιο σέλας ναύτῃσι φανήῃ
καιομένοιο πυρός, τό τε καίεται ὑψόθ’ ὄρεσφι
σταθμῷ ἐν οἰοπόλῳ· τοὺς δ’ οὐκ ἐθέλοντας ἄελλαι
πόντον ἐπ’ ἰχθυόεντα φίλων ἀπάνευθε φέρουσιν·
ὣς ἀπ’ Ἀχιλλῆος σάκεος σέλας αἰθέρ’ ἵκανε
καλοῦ δαιδαλέου· περὶ δὲ τρυφάλειαν ἀείρας
κρατὶ θέτο βριαρήν· ἣ δ’ ἀστὴρ ὣς ἀπέλαμπεν
ἵππουρις τρυφάλεια, περισσείοντο δ’ ἔθειραι
χρύσεαι, ἃς Ἥφαιστος ἵει λόφον ἀμφὶ θαμειάς.
πειρήθη δ’ ἔο αὐτοῦ ἐν ἔντεσι δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
εἰ οἱ ἐφαρμόσσειε καὶ ἐντρέχοι ἀγλαὰ γυῖα·
τῷ δ’ εὖτε πτερὰ γίγνετ’, ἄειρε δὲ ποιμένα λαῶν.
ἐκ δ’ ἄρα σύριγγος πατρώϊον ἐσπάσατ’ ἔγχος
βριθὺ μέγα στιβαρόν· τὸ μὲν οὐ δύνατ’ ἄλλος Ἀχαιῶν
πάλλειν, ἀλλά μιν οἷος ἐπίστατο πῆλαι Ἀχιλλεύς,
Πηλιάδα μελίην, τὴν πατρὶ φίλῳ πόρε Χείρων

19.391

Πηλίου ἐκ κορυφῆς φόνον ἔμμεναι ἡρώεσσιν·
ἵππους δ’ Αὐτομέδων τε καὶ Ἄλκιμος ἀμφιέποντες
ζεύγνυον· ἀμφὶ δὲ καλὰ λέπαδν’ ἔσαν, ἐν δὲ χαλινοὺς
γαμφηλῇς ἔβαλον, κατὰ δ’ ἡνία τεῖναν ὀπίσσω
κολλητὸν ποτὶ δίφρον. ὃ δὲ μάστιγα φαεινὴν
χειρὶ λαβὼν ἀραρυῖαν ἐφ’ ἵπποιιν ἀνόρουσεν
Αὐτομέδων· ὄπιθεν δὲ κορυσσάμενος βῆ Ἀχιλλεὺς
τεύχεσι παμφαίνων ὥς τ’ ἠλέκτωρ Ὑπερίων,
σμερδαλέον δ’ ἵπποισιν ἐκέκλετο πατρὸς ἑοῖο·
Ξάνθέ τε καὶ Βαλίε τηλεκλυτὰ τέκνα Ποδάργης
ἄλλως δὴ φράζεσθε σαωσέμεν ἡνιοχῆα
ἂψ Δαναῶν ἐς ὅμιλον ἐπεί χ’ ἔωμεν πολέμοιο,
μηδ’ ὡς Πάτροκλον λίπετ’ αὐτόθι τεθνηῶτα.
τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπὸ ζυγόφι προσέφη πόδας αἰόλος ἵππος
Ξάνθος, ἄφαρ δ’ ἤμυσε καρήατι· πᾶσα δὲ χαίτη
ζεύγλης ἐξεριποῦσα παρὰ ζυγὸν οὖδας ἵκανεν·
αὐδήεντα δ’ ἔθηκε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη·
καὶ λίην σ’ ἔτι νῦν γε σαώσομεν ὄβριμ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ·
ἀλλά τοι ἐγγύθεν ἦμαρ ὀλέθριον· οὐδέ τοι ἡμεῖς
αἴτιοι, ἀλλὰ θεός τε μέγας καὶ Μοῖρα κραταιή.
οὐδὲ γὰρ ἡμετέρῃ βραδυτῆτί τε νωχελίῃ τε
Τρῶες ἀπ’ ὤμοιιν Πατρόκλου τεύχε’ ἔλοντο·
ἀλλὰ θεῶν ὤριστος, ὃν ἠΰκομος τέκε Λητώ,
ἔκταν’ ἐνὶ προμάχοισι καὶ Ἕκτορι κῦδος ἔδωκε.
νῶϊ δὲ καί κεν ἅμα πνοιῇ Ζεφύροιο θέοιμεν,
ἤν περ ἐλαφροτάτην φάσ’ ἔμμεναι· ἀλλὰ σοὶ αὐτῷ
μόρσιμόν ἐστι θεῷ τε καὶ ἀνέρι ἶφι δαμῆναι.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσαντος Ἐρινύες ἔσχεθον αὐδήν.

419 τὸν δὲ μέγ’ ὀχθήσας προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
420 Ξάνθε τί μοι θάνατον μαντεύεαι; οὐδέ τί σε χρή.

19.421

421 εὖ νυ τὸ οἶδα καὶ αὐτὸς ὅ μοι μόρος ἐνθάδ’ ὀλέσθαι
422 νόσφι φίλου πατρὸς καὶ μητέρος· ἀλλὰ καὶ ἔμπης
423 οὐ λήξω πρὶν Τρῶας ἄδην ἐλάσαι πολέμοιο.
424 ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἐν πρώτοις ἰάχων ἔχε μώνυχας ἵππους.

20.1

1 ὣς οἳ μὲν παρὰ νηυσὶ κορωνίσι θωρήσσοντο
2 ἀμφὶ σὲ Πηλέος υἱὲ μάχης ἀκόρητον Ἀχαιοί,
3 Τρῶες δ’ αὖθ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐπὶ θρωσμῷ πεδίοιο·
4 Ζεὺς δὲ Θέμιστα κέλευσε θεοὺς ἀγορὴν δὲ καλέσσαι
5 κρατὸς ἀπ’ Οὐλύμποιο πολυπτύχου· ἣ δ’ ἄρα πάντῃ
6 φοιτήσασα κέλευσε Διὸς πρὸς δῶμα νέεσθαι.
7 οὔτέ τις οὖν ποταμῶν ἀπέην νόσφ’ Ὠκεανοῖο,
8 οὔτ’ ἄρα νυμφάων αἵ τ’ ἄλσεα καλὰ νέμονται
9 καὶ πηγὰς ποταμῶν καὶ πίσεα ποιήεντα.
10 ἐλθόντες δ’ ἐς δῶμα Διὸς νεφεληγερέταο
11 ξεστῇς αἰθούσῃσιν ἐνίζανον, ἃς Διὶ πατρὶ
12 Ἥφαιστος ποίησεν ἰδυίῃσι πραπίδεσσιν.
13 ὣς οἳ μὲν Διὸς ἔνδον ἀγηγέρατ’· οὐδ’ ἐνοσίχθων
14 νηκούστησε θεᾶς, ἀλλ’ ἐξ ἁλὸς ἦλθε μετ’ αὐτούς,
15 ἷζε δ’ ἄρ’ ἐν μέσσοισι, Διὸς δ’ ἐξείρετο βουλήν·
16 τίπτ’ αὖτ’ ἀργικέραυνε θεοὺς ἀγορὴν δὲ κάλεσσας;
17 ἦ τι περὶ Τρώων καὶ Ἀχαιῶν μερμηρίζεις;
18 τῶν γὰρ νῦν ἄγχιστα μάχη πόλεμός τε δέδηε.
19 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
20 ἔγνως ἐννοσίγαιε ἐμὴν ἐν στήθεσι βουλὴν
21 ὧν ἕνεκα ξυνάγειρα· μέλουσί μοι ὀλλύμενοί περ.
22 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι μὲν ἐγὼ μενέω πτυχὶ Οὐλύμποιο
23 ἥμενος, ἔνθ’ ὀρόων φρένα τέρψομαι· οἳ δὲ δὴ ἄλλοι
24 ἔρχεσθ’ ὄφρ’ ἂν ἵκησθε μετὰ Τρῶας καὶ Ἀχαιούς,
25 ἀμφοτέροισι δ’ ἀρήγεθ’ ὅπῃ νόος ἐστὶν ἑκάστου.
26 εἰ γὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς οἷος ἐπὶ Τρώεσσι μαχεῖται
27 οὐδὲ μίνυνθ’ ἕξουσι ποδώκεα Πηλεΐωνα.
28 καὶ δέ τί μιν καὶ πρόσθεν ὑποτρομέεσκον ὁρῶντες·
29 νῦν δ’ ὅτε δὴ καὶ θυμὸν ἑταίρου χώεται αἰνῶς
30 δείδω μὴ καὶ τεῖχος ὑπέρμορον ἐξαλαπάξῃ.

Thus, then, did the Achaeans arm by their ships round you, O son of Peleus, who were hungering for battle; while the Trojans over against them armed upon the rise of the plain. Meanwhile Zeus from the top of many-delled Olympus, bade Themis gather the gods in council, whereon she went about and called them to the house of Zeus. There was not a river absent except Okeanos, nor a single one of the nymphs that haunt fair groves, or springs of rivers and meadows of green grass. When they reached the house of cloud-compelling Zeus, they took their seats in the arcades of polished marble which Hephaistos with his consummate skill had made for father Zeus. In such wise, therefore, did they gather in the house of Zeus. Poseidon also, lord of the earthquake, obeyed the call of the goddess, and came up out of the sea to join them. There, sitting in the midst of them, he

asked what Zeus' purpose might be. "Why," said he, "wielder of the lightning, have you called the gods in council? Are you considering some matter that concerns the Trojans and Achaeans - for the blaze of battle is on the point of being kindled between them?" And Zeus answered, "You know my purpose, shaker of earth, and wherefore I have called you hither. I take thought for them even in their destruction. For my own part I shall stay here seated on Mount Olympus and look on in peace, but do you others go about among Trojans and Achaeans, and help either side as you may be severally disposed in your thinking [noos]. If Achilles fights the Trojans without hindrance they will make no stand against him; they have ever trembled at the sight of him, and now that he is roused to such fury about his comrade, he will override fate itself and storm their city." Thus spoke Zeus and gave the word for war, whereon the gods took their several sides and went into battle. Hera, Pallas Athena, earth-encircling Poseidon, Hermes bringer of good luck and excellent in all cunning - all these joined the host that came from the assembly [agôn] of ships; with them also came Hephaistos in all his glory, limping, but yet with his thin legs plying lustily under him. Ares of gleaming helmet joined the Trojans, and with him Apollo of locks unshorn, and the archer goddess Artemis, Leto, Xanthos, and laughter-loving Aphrodite. So long as the gods held themselves aloof from mortal warriors the Achaeans were triumphant, for Achilles who had long refused to fight was now with them. There was not a Trojan but his limbs failed him for fear as he beheld the fleet son of Peleus all glorious in his armor, and looking like Ares himself. When, however, the Olympians came to take their part among men, forthwith uprose strong Strife, rouser of hosts, and Athena raised her loud voice, now standing by the deep trench that ran outside the wall, and now shouting with all her might upon the shore of the sounding sea. Ares also bellowed out upon the other side, dark as some black thunder-cloud, and called on the Trojans at the top of his voice, now from the acropolis, and now speeding up the side of the river Simoeis till he came to the hill Kallikolone. Thus did the gods spur on both hosts to fight, and rouse fierce contention also among themselves. The sire of gods and men thundered from heaven above, while from beneath Poseidon shook the vast earth, and bade the high hills tremble. The spurs and crests of many-fountained Ida quaked, as also the city of the Trojans and the ships of the Achaeans. Hades, king of the realms below, was struck with fear; he sprang panic-stricken from his throne and cried aloud in terror lest Poseidon, lord of the earthquake, should crack the ground over his head, and lay bare his moldy mansions to the sight of mortals and immortals - mansions so ghastly grim that even the gods shudder to think of them. Such was the uproar as the gods came together in battle. Apollo with his arrows took his stand to face King Poseidon, while Athena took hers against the god of war; the archer-goddess Artemis with her golden arrows, sister of far-darting Apollo, stood to face Hera; Hermes the lusty bringer of good luck faced Leto, while the mighty eddying river whom men can Skamandros, but gods Xanthos, matched himself against Hephaistos. The gods, then, were thus ranged against one another. But the heart of Achilles was set on meeting Hektor son of Priam, for it was with his blood that he longed above all things else to glut the stubborn lord of battle. Meanwhile Apollo set Aeneas on to attack the son of Peleus, and put courage into his heart, speaking with the voice of Lykaon son of Priam. In his likeness therefore, he said to Aeneas, "Aeneas, counselor of the Trojans, where are now the brave words with which you vaunted over your wine before the Trojan princes, saying that you would fight Achilles son of Peleus in single combat?"

20.31

31 ὣς ἔφατο Κρονίδης, πόλεμον δ’ ἀλίαστον ἔγειρε.
32 βὰν δ’ ἴμεναι πόλεμον δὲ θεοὶ δίχα θυμὸν ἔχοντες·
33 Ἥρη μὲν μετ’ ἀγῶνα νεῶν καὶ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη
34 ἠδὲ Ποσειδάων γαιήοχος ἠδ’ ἐριούνης

Ἑρμείας, ὃς ἐπὶ φρεσὶ πευκαλίμῃσι κέκασται·
Ἥφαιστος δ’ ἅμα τοῖσι κίε σθένεϊ βλεμεαίνων
χωλεύων, ὑπὸ δὲ κνῆμαι ῥώοντο ἀραιαί.
ἐς δὲ Τρῶας Ἄρης κορυθαίολος, αὐτὰρ ἅμ’ αὐτῷ
Φοῖβος ἀκερσεκόμης ἠδ’ Ἄρτεμις ἰοχέαιρα
Λητώ τε Ξάνθός τε φιλομειδής τ’ Ἀφροδίτη.
εἶος μέν ῥ’ ἀπάνευθε θεοὶ θνητῶν ἔσαν ἀνδρῶν,
τεῖος Ἀχαιοὶ μὲν μέγα κύδανον, οὔνεκ’ Ἀχιλλεὺς
ἐξεφάνη, δηρὸν δὲ μάχης ἐπέπαυτ’ ἀλεγεινῆς·
Τρῶας δὲ τρόμος αἰνὸς ὑπήλυθε γυῖα ἕκαστον
δειδιότας, ὅθ’ ὁρῶντο ποδώκεα Πηλεΐωνα
τεύχεσι λαμπόμενον βροτολοιγῷ ἶσον Ἄρηϊ.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ μεθ’ ὅμιλον Ὀλύμπιοι ἤλυθον ἀνδρῶν,
ὦρτο δ’ Ἔρις κρατερὴ λαοσσόος, αὖε δ’ Ἀθήνη
στᾶσ’ ὁτὲ μὲν παρὰ τάφρον ὀρυκτὴν τείχεος ἐκτός,
ἄλλοτ’ ἐπ’ ἀκτάων ἐριδούπων μακρὸν ἀΰτει.
αὖε δ’ Ἄρης ἑτέρωθεν ἐρεμνῇ λαίλαπι ἶσος
ὀξὺ κατ’ ἀκροτάτης πόλιος Τρώεσσι κελεύων,
ἄλλοτε πὰρ Σιμόεντι θέων ἐπὶ Καλλικολώνῃ.
ὣς τοὺς ἀμφοτέρους μάκαρες θεοὶ ὀτρύνοντες
σύμβαλον, ἐν δ’ αὐτοῖς ἔριδα ῥήγνυντο βαρεῖαν·
δεινὸν δὲ βρόντησε πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε
ὑψόθεν· αὐτὰρ νέρθε Ποσειδάων ἐτίναξε
γαῖαν ἀπειρεσίην ὀρέων τ’ αἰπεινὰ κάρηνα.
πάντες δ’ ἐσσείοντο πόδες πολυπίδακος Ἴδης
καὶ κορυφαί, Τρώων τε πόλις καὶ νῆες Ἀχαιῶν.

20.61

ἔδεισεν δ’ ὑπένερθεν ἄναξ ἐνέρων Ἀϊδωνεύς,
δείσας δ’ ἐκ θρόνου ἅλτο καὶ ἴαχε, μή οἱ ὕπερθε
γαῖαν ἀναρρήξειε Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων,
οἰκία δὲ θνητοῖσι καὶ ἀθανάτοισι φανείη
σμερδαλέ’ εὐρώεντα, τά τε στυγέουσι θεοί περ·
τόσσος ἄρα κτύπος ὦρτο θεῶν ἔριδι ξυνιόντων.
ἤτοι μὲν γὰρ ἔναντα Ποσειδάωνος ἄνακτος
ἵστατ’ Ἀπόλλων Φοῖβος ἔχων ἰὰ πτερόεντα,
ἄντα δ’ Ἐνυαλίοιο θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·
Ἥρῃ δ’ ἀντέστη χρυσηλάκατος κελαδεινὴ
Ἄρτεμις ἰοχέαιρα κασιγνήτη ἑκάτοιο·
Λητοῖ δ’ ἀντέστη σῶκος ἐριούνιος Ἑρμῆς,
ἄντα δ’ ἄρ’ Ἡφαίστοιο μέγας ποταμὸς βαθυδίνης,
ὃν Ξάνθον καλέουσι θεοί, ἄνδρες δὲ Σκάμανδρον.
ὣς οἳ μὲν θεοὶ ἄντα θεῶν ἴσαν· αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
Ἕκτορος ἄντα μάλιστα λιλαίετο δῦναι ὅμιλον
Πριαμίδεω· τοῦ γάρ ῥα μάλιστά ἑ θυμὸς ἀνώγει
αἵματος ἆσαι Ἄρηα ταλαύρινον πολεμιστήν.
Αἰνείαν δ’ ἰθὺς λαοσσόος ὦρσεν Ἀπόλλων
ἀντία Πηλεΐωνος, ἐνῆκε δέ οἱ μένος ἠΰ·
υἱέϊ δὲ Πριάμοιο Λυκάονι εἴσατο φωνήν·
τῷ μιν ἐεισάμενος προσέφη Διὸς υἱὸς Ἀπόλλων·
Αἰνεία Τρώων βουληφόρε ποῦ τοι ἀπειλαὶ

84 ἂς Τρώων βασιλεῦσιν ὑπίσχεο οἰνοποτάζων
85 Πηλεΐδεω Ἀχιλῆος ἐναντίβιον πολεμίξειν;
86 τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ Αἰνείας ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέειπε·
87 Πριαμίδη τί με ταῦτα καὶ οὐκ ἐθέλοντα κελεύεις
88 ἀντία Πηλεΐωνος ὑπερθύμοιο μάχεσθαι;
89 οὐ μὲν γὰρ νῦν πρῶτα ποδώκεος ἄντ’ Ἀχιλῆος
90 στήσομαι, ἀλλ’ ἤδη με καὶ ἄλλοτε δουρὶ φόβησεν
And Aeneas answered, "Why do you thus bid me fight the proud son of Peleus, when I am in no mind to do so? Were I to face him now, it would not be for the first time. His spear has already put me to Right from Ida, when he attacked our cattle and sacked Lyrnessos and Pedasos; Zeus indeed saved me in that he granted me strength to flee, else had the fallen by the hands of Achilles and Athena, who went before him to protect him and urged him to fall upon the Leleges and Trojans. No man may fight Achilles, for one of the gods is always with him as his guardian, and even were it not so, his weapon flies ever straight, and fails not to pierce the flesh of him who is against him; if heaven would let me fight him to the finish [telos] on even terms, he should not soon overcome me, though he boasts that he is made of bronze." Then said King Apollo, son to Zeus, "Nay, hero, pray to the ever-living gods, for men say that you were born of Zeus' daughter Aphrodite, whereas Achilles is son to a goddess of inferior rank. Aphrodite is child to Zeus, while Thetis is but daughter to the old man of the sea. Bring, therefore, your spear to bear upon him, and let him not scare you with his taunts and menaces." As he spoke he put courage into the heart of the shepherd of his people, and he strode in full armor among the ranks of the foremost fighters. Nor did the son of Anchises escape the notice of white-armed Hera, as he went forth into the throng to meet Achilles. She called the gods about her, and said, "Look to it, you two, Poseidon and Athena, and consider how this shall be; Phoebus Apollo has been sending Aeneas clad in full armor to fight Achilles. Shall we turn him back at once, or shall one of us stand by Achilles and endow him with strength so that his heart fail not, and he may learn that the chiefs of the immortals are on his side, while the others who have all along been defending the Trojans are but vain helpers? Let us all come down from Olympus and join in the fight, that this day he may take no hurt at the hands of the Trojans. Hereafter let him suffer whatever fate may have spun out for him when he was begotten and his mother bore him. If Achilles be not thus assured by the voice of a god, he may come to fear presently when one of us meets him in battle, for the gods are terrible if they are seen face to face." Poseidon lord of the earthquake answered her saying, "Hera, restrain your fury, which has made you veer in your thinking [noos]; it is not well; I am not in favor of forcing the other gods to fight us, for the advantage is too greatly on our own side; let us take our places on some hill out of the beaten track, and let mortals fight it out among themselves. If Ares or Phoebus Apollo begin fighting, or keep Achilles in check so that he cannot fight, we too, will at once raise the cry of battle, and in that case they will soon leave the field and go back vanquished to Olympus among the other gods." With these words the dark-haired god led the way to the high earth-barrow of Herakles, built round solid masonry, and made by the Trojans and Pallas Athena for him flee to when the sea-monster was chasing him from the shore on to the plain. Here Poseidon and those that were with him took their seats, wrapped in a thick cloud of darkness; but the other gods seated themselves on the brow of Kallikolone round you, O Phoebus, and Ares the waster of cities. Thus did the gods sit apart and form their plans, but neither side was willing to begin battle with the other, and Zeus from his seat on high was in command over them all. Meanwhile the whole plain was alive with men and horses, and blazing with the gleam of armor. The earth rang again under the tramp of their feet as they rushed towards each other, and two champions, by far the foremost of them all, met between the hosts to fight - to wit, Aeneas son of Anchises, and noble Achilles. Aeneas was first to stride forward in attack, his doughty helmet tossing defiance as he came on. He held

his strong shield before his breast, and brandished his bronze spear. The son of Peleus from the other side sprang forth to meet him, like some fierce lion that the whole population [dêmos] has met to hunt and kill - at first he bodes no ill, but when some daring youth has struck him with a spear, he crouches openmouthed, his jaws foam, he roars with fury, he lashes his tail from side to side about his ribs and loins, and glares as he springs straight before him, to find out whether he is to slay, or be slain among the foremost of his foes - even with such fury did Achilles burn to spring upon Aeneas. When they were now close up with one another Achilles was first to speak. "Aeneas," said he, "why do you stand thus out before the host to fight me? Is it that you hope to reign over the Trojans, partaking of the honor [timê] of Priam? Nay, though you kill me Priam will not hand his kingdom over to you. He is a man of sound judgment, and he has sons of his own. Or have the Trojans been allotting you a demesne of passing richness, fair with orchard lawns and wheat lands, if you should slay me? This you shall hardly do. I have discomfited you once already. Have you forgotten how when you were alone I chased you from your herds helter-skelter down the slopes of Ida? You did not turn round to look behind you; you took refuge in Lyrnessos, but I attacked the city, and with the help of Athena and father Zeus I sacked it and carried its women into captivity, though Zeus and the other gods rescued you. You think they will protect you now, but they will not do so; therefore I say go back into the host, and do not face me, or you will rue it. Even a fool may be wise after the event."

20.91

91 ἐξ Ἴδης, ὅτε βουσὶν ἐπήλυθεν ἡμετέρῃσι,
92 πέρσε δὲ Λυρνησσὸν καὶ Πήδασον· αὐτὰρ ἐμὲ Ζεὺς
93 εἰρύσαθ’, ὅς μοι ἐπῶρσε μένος λαιψηρά τε γοῦνα.
94 ἦ κ’ ἐδάμην ὑπὸ χερσὶν Ἀχιλλῆος καὶ Ἀθήνης,
95 ἥ οἱ πρόσθεν ἰοῦσα τίθει φάος ἠδ’ ἐκέλευεν
96 ἔγχεϊ χαλκείῳ Λέλεγας καὶ Τρῶας ἐναίρειν.
97 τὼ οὐκ ἔστ’ Ἀχιλῆος ἐναντίον ἄνδρα μάχεσθαι·
98 αἰεὶ γὰρ πάρα εἷς γε θεῶν ὃς λοιγὸν ἀμύνει.
99 καὶ δ’ ἄλλως τοῦ γ’ ἰθὺ βέλος πέτετ’, οὐδ’ ἀπολήγει
100 πρὶν χροὸς ἀνδρομέοιο διελθέμεν. εἰ δὲ θεός περ
101 ἶσον τείνειεν πολέμου τέλος, οὔ κε μάλα ῥέα
102 νικήσει’, οὐδ’ εἰ παγχάλκεος εὔχεται εἶναι.
103 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν ἄναξ Διὸς υἱὸς Ἀπόλλων·
104 ἤρως ἀλλ’ ἄγε καὶ σὺ θεοῖς αἰειγενέτῃσιν
105 εὔχεο· καὶ δὲ σέ φασι Διὸς κούρης Ἀφροδίτης
106 ἐκγεγάμεν, κεῖνος δὲ χερείονος ἐκ θεοῦ ἐστίν·
107 ἣ μὲν γὰρ Διός ἐσθ’, ἣ δ’ ἐξ ἁλίοιο γέροντος.
108 ἀλλ’ ἰθὺς φέρε χαλκὸν ἀτειρέα, μηδέ σε πάμπαν
109 λευγαλέοις ἐπέεσσιν ἀποτρεπέτω καὶ ἀρειῆ.
110 ὣς εἰπὼν ἔμπνευσε μένος μέγα ποιμένι λαῶν,
111 βῆ δὲ διὰ προμάχων κεκορυθμένος αἴθοπι χαλκῷ.
112 οὐδ’ ἔλαθ’ Ἀγχίσαο πάϊς λευκώλενον Ἥρην
113 ἀντία Πηλεΐωνος ἰὼν ἀνὰ οὐλαμὸν ἀνδρῶν·
114 ἣ δ’ ἄμυδις στήσασα θεοὺς μετὰ μῦθον ἔειπε·
115 φράζεσθον δὴ σφῶϊ Ποσείδαον καὶ Ἀθήνη
116 ἐν φρεσὶν ὑμετέρῃσιν, ὅπως ἔσται τάδε ἔργα.
117 Αἰνείας ὅδ’ ἔβη κεκορυθμένος αἴθοπι χαλκῷ
118 ἀντία Πηλεΐωνος, ἀνῆκε δὲ Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων.
119 ἀλλ’ ἄγεθ’, ἡμεῖς πέρ μιν ἀποτρωπῶμεν ὀπίσσω
120 αὐτόθεν· ἤ τις ἔπειτα καὶ ἡμείων Ἀχιλῆϊ

20.121

παρσταίη, δοίη δὲ κράτος μέγα, μηδέ τι θυμῷ
δευέσθω, ἵνα εἰδῇ ὅ μιν φιλέουσιν ἄριστοι
ἀθανάτων, οἳ δ’ αὖτ’ ἀνεμώλιοι οἳ τὸ πάρος περ
Τρωσὶν ἀμύνουσιν πόλεμον καὶ δηϊοτῆτα.
πάντες δ’ Οὐλύμποιο κατήλθομεν ἀντιόωντες
τῆσδε μάχης, ἵνα μή τι μετὰ Τρώεσσι πάθῃσι
σήμερον· ὕστερον αὖτε τὰ πείσεται ἄσσά οἱ αἶσα
γιγνομένῳ ἐπένησε λίνῳ ὅτε μιν τέκε μήτηρ.
εἰ δ’ Ἀχιλεὺς οὐ ταῦτα θεῶν ἐκ πεύσεται ὀμφῆς
δείσετ’ ἔπειθ’, ὅτε κέν τις ἐναντίβιον θεὸς ἔλθῃ
ἐν πολέμῳ· χαλεποὶ δὲ θεοὶ φαίνεσθαι ἐναργεῖς.
τὴν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων·
Ἥρη μὴ χαλέπαινε παρ’ ἐκ νόον· οὐδέ τί σε χρή.
οὐκ ἂν ἔγωγ’ ἐθέλοιμι θεοὺς ἔριδι ξυνελάσσαι
ἡμέας τοὺς ἄλλους, ἐπεὶ ἦ πολὺ φέρτεροί εἰμεν·
ἀλλ’ ἡμεῖς μὲν ἔπειτα καθεζώμεσθα κιόντες
ἐκ πάτου ἐς σκοπιήν, πόλεμος δ’ ἄνδρεσσι μελήσει.
εἰ δέ κ’ Ἄρης ἄρχωσι μάχης ἢ Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων,
ἢ Ἀχιλῆ’ ἴσχωσι καὶ οὐκ εἰῶσι μάχεσθαι,
αὐτίκ’ ἔπειτα καὶ ἄμμι παρ’ αὐτόθι νεῖκος ὀρεῖται
φυλόπιδος· μάλα δ’ ὦκα διακρινθέντας ὀΐω
ἂψ ἴμεν Οὔλυμπον δὲ θεῶν μεθ’ ὁμήγυριν ἄλλων
ἡμετέρῃς ὑπὸ χερσὶν ἀναγκαίηφι δαμέντας.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἡγήσατο κυανοχαίτης
τεῖχος ἐς ἀμφίχυτον Ἡρακλῆος θείοιο
ὑψηλόν, τό ῥά οἱ Τρῶες καὶ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη
ποίεον, ὄφρα τὸ κῆτος ὑπεκπροφυγὼν ἀλέαιτο,
ὁππότε μιν σεύαιτο ἀπ’ ἠϊόνος πεδίον δέ.
ἔνθα Ποσειδάων κατ’ ἄρ’ ἕζετο καὶ θεοὶ ἄλλοι,
ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ ἄρρηκτον νεφέλην ὤμοισιν ἔσαντο·

20.151

οἳ δ’ ἑτέρωσε καθῖζον ἐπ’ ὀφρύσι Καλλικολώνης
ἀμφὶ σὲ ἥϊε Φοῖβε καὶ Ἄρηα πτολίπορθον.
ὣς οἳ μέν ῥ’ ἑκάτερθε καθήατο μητιόωντες
βουλάς· ἀρχέμεναι δὲ δυσηλεγέος πολέμοιο
ὄκνεον ἀμφότεροι, Ζεὺς δ’ ἤμενος ὕψι κέλευε.
τῶν δ’ ἅπαν ἐπλήσθη πεδίον καὶ λάμπετο χαλκῷ
ἀνδρῶν ἠδ’ ἵππων· κάρκαιρε δὲ γαῖα πόδεσσιν
ὀρνυμένων ἄμυδις. δύο δ’ ἀνέρες ἔξοχ’ ἄριστοι
ἐς μέσον ἀμφοτέρων συνίτην μεμαῶτε μάχεσθαι
Αἰνείας τ’ Ἀγχισιάδης καὶ δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς.
Αἰνείας δὲ πρῶτος ἀπειλήσας ἐβεβήκει
νευστάζων κόρυθι βριαρῇ· ἀτὰρ ἀσπίδα θοῦριν
πρόσθεν ἔχε στέρνοιο, τίνασσε δὲ χάλκεον ἔγχος.
Πηλεΐδης δ’ ἑτέρωθεν ἐναντίον ὦρτο λέων ὡς
σίντης, ὅν τε καὶ ἄνδρες ἀποκτάμεναι μεμάασιν
ἀγρόμενοι πᾶς δῆμος· ὃ δὲ πρῶτον μὲν ἀτίζων
ἔρχεται, ἀλλ’ ὅτε κέν τις ἀρηϊθόων αἰζηῶν
δουρὶ βάλῃ ἐάλη τε χανών, περί τ’ ἀφρὸς ὀδόντας

γίγνεται, ἐν δέ τέ οἱ κραδίῃ στένει ἄλκιμον ἦτορ,
οὐρῇ δὲ πλευράς τε καὶ ἰσχία ἀμφοτέρωθεν
μαστίεται, ἐὲ δ’ αὐτὸν ἐποτρύνει μαχέσασθαι,
γλαυκιόων δ’ ἰθὺς φέρεται μένει, ἤν τινα πέφνῃ
ἀνδρῶν, ἢ αὐτὸς φθίεται πρώτῳ ἐν ὁμίλῳ·
ὣς Ἀχιλῆ’ ὄτρυνε μένος καὶ θυμὸς ἀγήνωρ
ἀντίον ἐλθέμεναι μεγαλήτορος Αἰνείαο.
οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντες,
τὸν πρότερος προσέειπε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
Αἰνεία τί σὺ τόσσον ὁμίλου πολλὸν ἐπελθὼν
ἔστης; ἦ σέ γε θυμὸς ἐμοὶ μαχέσασθαι ἀνώγει
ἐλπόμενον Τρώεσσιν ἀνάξειν ἱπποδάμοισι

20.181

τιμῆς τῆς Πριάμου; ἀτὰρ εἴ κεν ἔμ’ ἐξεναρίξῃς,
οὔ τοι τοὔνεκά γε Πρίαμος γέρας ἐν χερὶ θήσει·
εἰσὶν γάρ οἱ παῖδες, ὃ δ’ ἔμπεδος οὐδ’ ἀεσίφρων.
ἦ νύ τί τοι Τρῶες τέμενος τάμον ἔξοχον ἄλλων
καλὸν φυταλιῆς καὶ ἀρούρης, ὄφρα νέμηαι
αἴ κεν ἐμὲ κτείνῃς; χαλεπῶς δέ σ’ ἔολπα τὸ ῥέξειν.
ἤδη μὲν σέ γέ φημι καὶ ἄλλοτε δουρὶ φοβῆσαι.
ἦ οὐ μέμνῃ ὅτε πέρ σε βοῶν ἄπο μοῦνον ἐόντα
σεῦα κατ’ Ἰδαίων ὀρέων ταχέεσσι πόδεσσι
καρπαλίμως; τότε δ’ οὔ τι μετατροπαλίζεο φεύγων.
ἔνθεν δ’ ἐς Λυρνησσὸν ὑπέκφυγες· αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ τὴν
πέρσα μεθορμηθεὶς σὺν Ἀθήνῃ καὶ Διὶ πατρί,
ληϊάδας δὲ γυναῖκας ἐλεύθερον ἦμαρ ἀπούρας
ἦγον· ἀτὰρ σὲ Ζεὺς ἐρρύσατο καὶ θεοὶ ἄλλοι.
ἀλλ’ οὐ νῦν ἐρύεσθαι ὀΐομαι, ὡς ἐνὶ θυμῷ
βάλλεαι· ἀλλά σ’ ἔγωγ’ ἀναχωρήσαντα κελεύω
ἐς πληθὺν ἰέναι, μηδ’ ἀντίος ἵστασ’ ἐμεῖο,
πρίν τι κακὸν παθέειν· ῥεχθὲν δέ τε νήπιος ἔγνω.
τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ Αἰνείας ἀπαμείβετο φώνησέν τε·
Πηλεΐδη μὴ δὴ ἐπέεσσί με νηπύτιον ὡς
ἔλπεο δειδίξεσθαι, ἐπεὶ σάφα οἶδα καὶ αὐτὸς
ἠμὲν κερτομίας ἠδ’ αἴσυλα μυθήσασθαι.
ἴδμεν δ’ ἀλλήλων γενεήν, ἴδμεν δὲ τοκῆας
πρόκλυτ’ ἀκούοντες ἔπεα θνητῶν ἀνθρώπων·
ὄψει δ’ οὔτ’ ἄρ πω σὺ ἐμοὺς ἴδες οὔτ’ ἄρ’ ἐγὼ σούς.
φασὶ σὲ μὲν Πηλῆος ἀμύμονος ἔκγονον εἶναι,
μητρὸς δ’ ἐκ Θέτιδος καλλιπλοκάμου ἁλοσύδνης·
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼν υἱὸς μεγαλήτορος Ἀγχίσαο
εὔχομαι ἐκγεγάμεν, μήτηρ δέ μοί ἐστ’ Ἀφροδίτη·
τῶν δὴ νῦν ἕτεροί γε φίλον παῖδα κλαύσονται

Then Aeneas answered, "Son of Peleus, think not that your words can scare me as though I were a child. I too, if I will, can brag and talk unseemly. We know one another's race and parentage as matters of common fame, though neither have you ever seen my parents nor I yours. Men say that you are son to noble Peleus, and that your mother is Thetis, fair-haired daughter of the sea. I have noble Anchises for my father, and Aphrodite for my mother; the parents of one or other of us shall this day mourn a son, for it will be more than silly talk that shall part us when the fight is over. Learn, then, my lineage if you will - and it is known

to many. "In the beginning Dardanos was the son of Zeus, and founded Dardania, for Ilion was not yet established on the plain for men to dwell in, and her people still abode on the spurs of many-fountained Ida. Dardanos had a son, king Erichthonios, who was wealthiest of all men living; he had three thousand mares that fed by the water-meadows, they and their foals with them. Boreas was enamored of them as they were feeding, and covered them in the semblance of a dark-maned stallion. Twelve filly foals did they conceive and bear him, and these, as they sped over the fertile plain, would go bounding on over the ripe ears of wheat and not break them; or again when they would disport themselves on the broad back of Ocean they could gallop on the crest of a breaker. Erichthonios begat Tros, king of the Trojans, and Tros had three noble sons, Ilos, Assarakos, and Ganymede who was comeliest of mortal men; wherefore the gods carried him off to be Zeus' cupbearer, for his beauty's sake, that he might dwell among the immortals. Ilos begat Laomedon, and Laomedon begat Tithonos, Priam, Lampos, Klytios, and Hiketaon of the stock of Ares. But Assarakos was father to Kapys, and Kapys to Anchises, who was my father, while Hektor is son to Priam. "Such do I declare my blood and lineage, but as for valor [aretê], Zeus gives it or takes it as he will, for he is lord of all. And now let there be no more of this prating in mid-battle as though we were children. We could fling taunts without end at one another; a hundred-oared galley would not hold them. The tongue can run in every which direction and talk all wise; it can go here and there, and as a man says, so shall he be gainsaid. What is the use of our bandying hard like women who when they fall foul of one another go out and wrangle in the streets, one half true and the other lies, as rage inspires them? No words of yours shall turn me now that I am fain to fight- therefore let us make trial of one another with our spears." As he spoke he drove his spear at the great and terrible shield of Achilles, which rang out as the point struck it. The son of Peleus held the shield before him with his strong hand, and he was afraid, for he deemed that Aeneas' spear would go through it quite easily, not reflecting that the god's glorious gifts were little likely to yield before the blows of mortal men; and indeed Aeneas' spear did not pierce the shield, for the layer of gold, gift of the god, stayed the point. It went through two layers, but the god had made the shield in five, two of bronze, the two innermost ones of tin, and one of gold; it was in this that the spear was stayed. Achilles in his turn threw, and struck the round shield of Aeneas at the very edge, where the bronze was thinnest; the spear of Pelian ash went clean through, and the shield rang under the blow; Aeneas was afraid, and crouched backwards, holding the shield away from him; the spear, however, flew over his back, and stuck quivering in the ground, after having gone through both circles of the sheltering shield. Aeneas though he had avoided the spear, stood still, blinded with fear and grief [akhos] because the weapon had gone so near him; then Achilles sprang furiously upon him, with a cry as of death and with his keen blade drawn, and Aeneas seized a great stone, so huge that two men, as men now are, would be unable to lift it, but Aeneas wielded it quite easily. Aeneas would then have struck Achilles as he was springing towards him, either on the helmet, or on the shield that covered him, and Achilles would have closed with him and dispatched him with his sword, had not Poseidon lord of the earthquake been quick to mark, and said forthwith to the immortals, "Alas, I feel grief [akhos] for great Aeneas, who will now go down to the house of Hades, vanquished by the son of Peleus. Fool that he was to give ear to the counsel of Apollo. Apollo will never save him from destruction. Why should this man suffer grief [akhos] when he is guiltless, to no purpose, and in another's quarrel? Has he not at all times offered acceptable sacrifice to the gods that dwell in heaven? Let us then snatch him from death's jaws, lest the son of Kronos be angry should Achilles slay him. It is fated, moreover, that he should escape, and that the race of Dardanos, whom Zeus loved above all the sons born to him of mortal women, shall not perish utterly without seed or sign. For now indeed has Zeus hated the blood of Priam, while Aeneas shall reign over the Trojans, he and his children's children that shall be born

hereafter." Then answered Hera, "Earth-shaker, look to this matter yourself, and consider concerning Aeneas, whether you will save him, or suffer him, brave though he be, to fall by the hand of Achilles son of Peleus. For of a truth we two, I and Pallas Athena, have sworn full many a time before all the immortals, that never would we shield Trojans from destruction, not even when all Troy is burning in the flames that the Achaeans shall kindle." When earth-encircling Poseidon heard this he went into the battle amid the clash of spears, and came to the place where Achilles and Aeneas were. Forthwith he shed a darkness before the eyes of the son of Peleus, drew the bronze-headed ashen spear from the shield of Aeneas, and laid it at the feet of Achilles. Then he lifted Aeneas on high from off the earth and hurried him away. Over the heads of many a band of warriors both horse and foot did he soar as the god's hand sped him, till he came to the very fringe of the battle where the Cauconians were arming themselves for fight. Poseidon, shaker of the earth, then came near to him and said, Aeneas, what god has egged you on to this folly in fighting the son of Peleus, who is both a mightier man of valor and more beloved of heaven than you are? Give way before him whensoever you meet him, lest you go down to the house of Hades even though fate would have it otherwise. When Achilles is dead you may then fight among the foremost undaunted, for none other of the Achaeans shall slay you."

20.211

211 σήμερον· οὐ γάρ φημ’ ἐπέεσσί γε νηπυτίοισιν
212 ὧδε διακρινθέντε μάχης ἐξαπονέεσθαι.
213 εἰ δ’ ἐθέλεις καὶ ταῦτα δαήμεναι, ὄφρ’ ἐὺ εἰδῇς
214 ἡμετέρην γενεήν, πολλοὶ δέ μιν ἄνδρες ἴσασι·
215 Δάρδανον αὖ πρῶτον τέκετο νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς,
216 κτίσσε δὲ Δαρδανίην, ἐπεὶ οὔ πω Ἴλιος ἰρὴ
217 ἐν πεδίῳ πεπόλιστο πόλις μερόπων ἀνθρώπων,
218 ἀλλ’ ἔθ’ ὑπωρείας ᾤκεον πολυπίδακος Ἴδης.
219 Δάρδανος αὖ τέκεθ’ υἱὸν Ἐριχθόνιον βασιλῆα,
220 ὃς δὴ ἀφνειότατος γένετο θνητῶν ἀνθρώπων·
221 τοῦ τρισχίλιαι ἵπποι ἔλος κάτα βουκολέοντο
222 θήλειαι, πώλοισιν ἀγαλλόμεναι ἀταλῇσι.
223 τάων καὶ Βορέης ἠράσσατο βοσκομενάων,
224 ἵππῳ δ’ εἰσάμενος παρελέξατο κυανοχαίτῃ·
225 αἳ δ’ ὑποκυσάμεναι ἔτεκον δυοκαίδεκα πώλους.
226 αἳ δ’ ὅτε μὲν σκιρτῷεν ἐπὶ ζείδωρον ἄρουραν,
227 ἄκρον ἐπ’ ἀνθερίκων καρπὸν θέον οὐδὲ κατέκλων·
228 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ σκιρτῷεν ἐπ’ εὐρέα νῶτα θαλάσσης,
229 ἄκρον ἐπὶ ῥηγμῖνος ἁλὸς πολιοῖο θέεσκον.
230 Τρῶα δ’ Ἐριχθόνιος τέκετο Τρώεσσιν ἄνακτα·
231 Τρωὸς δ’ αὖ τρεῖς παῖδες ἀμύμονες ἐξεγένοντο
232 Ἶλός τ’ Ἀσσάρακός τε καὶ ἀντίθεος Γανυμήδης,
233 ὃς δὴ κάλλιστος γένετο θνητῶν ἀνθρώπων·
234 τὸν καὶ ἀνηρείψαντο θεοὶ Διὶ οἰνοχοεύειν
235 κάλλεος εἵνεκα οἷο ἴν’ ἀθανάτοισι μετείη.
236 Ἶλος δ’ αὖ τέκεθ’ υἱὸν ἀμύμονα Λαομέδοντα·
237 Λαομέδων δ’ ἄρα Τιθωνὸν τέκετο Πρίαμόν τε
238 Λάμπόν τε Κλυτίον θ’ Ἱκετάονά τ’ ὄζον Ἄρηος·
239 Ἀσσάρακος δὲ Κάπυν, ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ Ἀγχίσην τέκε παῖδα·
240 αὐτὰρ ἔμ’ Ἀγχίσης, Πρίαμος δ’ ἔτεχ’ Ἕκτορα δῖον.

20.241

ταύτης τοι γενεῆς τε καὶ αἵματος εὔχομαι εἶναι.
Ζεὺς δ’ ἀρετὴν ἄνδρεσσιν ὀφέλλει τε μινύθει τε
ὅππως κεν ἐθέλῃσιν· ὃ γὰρ κάρτιστος ἁπάντων.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε μηκέτι ταῦτα λεγώμεθα νηπύτιοι ὣς
ἑσταότ’ ἐν μέσσῃ ὑσμίνῃ δῃϊοτῆτος.
ἔστι γὰρ ἀμφοτέροισιν ὀνείδεα μυθήσασθαι
πολλὰ μάλ’, οὐδ’ ἂν νηῦς ἑκατόζυγος ἄχθος ἄροιτο.
στρεπτὴ δὲ γλῶσσ’ ἐστὶ βροτῶν, πολέες δ’ ἔνι μῦθοι
παντοῖοι, ἐπέων δὲ πολὺς νομὸς ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα.
ὁπποῖόν κ’ εἴπῃσθα ἔπος, τοῖόν κ’ ἐπακούσαις.
ἀλλὰ τί ἢ ἔριδας καὶ νείκεα νῶϊν ἀνάγκη
νεικεῖν ἀλλήλοισιν ἐναντίον ὥς τε γυναῖκας,
αἵ τε χολωσάμεναι ἔριδος πέρι θυμοβόροιο
νεικεῦσ’ ἀλλήλῃσι μέσην ἐς ἄγυιαν ἰοῦσαι
πόλλ’ ἐτεά τε καὶ οὐκί· χόλος δέ τε καὶ τὰ κελεύει.
ἀλκῆς δ’ οὔ μ’ ἐπέεσσιν ἀποτρέψεις μεμαῶτα
πρὶν χαλκῷ μαχέσασθαι ἐναντίον· ἀλλ’ ἄγε θᾶσσον
γευσόμεθ’ ἀλλήλων χαλκήρεσιν ἐγχείῃσιν.
ἦ ῥα καὶ ἐν δεινῷ σάκει ἤλασεν ὄβριμον ἔγχος
σμερδαλέῳ· μέγα δ’ ἀμφὶ σάκος μύκε δουρὸς ἀκωκῇ.
Πηλεΐδης δὲ σάκος μὲν ἀπὸ ἕο χειρὶ παχείῃ
ἔσχετο ταρβήσας· φάτο γὰρ δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος
ῥέα διελεύσεσθαι μεγαλήτορος Αἰνείαο
νήπιος, οὐδ’ ἐνόησε κατὰ φρένα καὶ κατὰ θυμὸν
ὡς οὐ ῥηΐδι’ ἐστὶ θεῶν ἐρικυδέα δῶρα
ἀνδράσι γε θνητοῖσι δαμήμεναι οὐδ’ ὑποείκειν.
οὐδὲ τότ’ Αἰνείαο δαΐφρονος ὄβριμον ἔγχος
ῥῆξε σάκος· χρυσὸς γὰρ ἐρύκακε, δῶρα θεοῖο·
ἀλλὰ δύω μὲν ἔλασσε διὰ πτύχας, αἳ δ’ ἄρ’ ἔτι τρεῖς
ἦσαν, ἐπεὶ πέντε πτύχας ἤλασε κυλλοποδίων,

20.271

τὰς δύο χαλκείας, δύο δ’ ἔνδοθι κασσιτέροιο,
τὴν δὲ μίαν χρυσῆν, τῇ ῥ’ ἔσχετο μείλινον ἔγχος.
δεύτερος αὖτ’ Ἀχιλεὺς προΐει δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος,
καὶ βάλεν Αἰνείαο κατ’ ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην
ἄντυγ’ ὕπο πρώτην, ᾗ λεπτότατος θέε χαλκός,
λεπτοτάτη δ’ ἐπέην ῥινὸς βοός· ἣ δὲ διὰ πρὸ
Πηλιὰς ἤϊξεν μελίη, λάκε δ’ ἀσπὶς ὑπ’ αὐτῆς.
Αἰνείας δ’ ἐάλη καὶ ἀπὸ ἕθεν ἀσπίδ’ ἀνέσχε
δείσας· ἐγχείη δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπὲρ νώτου ἐνὶ γαίῃ
ἔστη ἰεμένη, διὰ δ’ ἀμφοτέρους ἔλε κύκλους
ἀσπίδος ἀμφιβρότης· ὃ δ’ ἀλευάμενος δόρυ μακρὸν
ἔστη, κὰδ δ’ ἄχος οἱ χύτο μυρίον ὀφθαλμοῖσι,
ταρβήσας ὅ οἱ ἄγχι πάγη βέλος. αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
ἐμμεμαὼς ἐπόρουσεν ἐρυσσάμενος ξίφος ὀξὺ
σμερδαλέα ἰάχων· ὃ δὲ χερμάδιον λάβε χειρὶ
Αἰνείας, μέγα ἔργον, ὃ οὐ δύο γ’ ἄνδρε φέροιεν,
οἷοι νῦν βροτοί εἰσ’· ὃ δέ μιν ῥέα πάλλε καὶ οἷος.
ἔνθά κεν Αἰνείας μὲν ἐπεσσύμενον βάλε πέτρῳ

ἢ κόρυθ’ ἠὲ σάκος, τό οἱ ἤρκεσε λυγρὸν ὄλεθρον,
τὸν δέ κε Πηλεΐδης σχεδὸν ἄορι θυμὸν ἀπηύρα,
εἰ μὴ ἄρ’ ὀξὺ νόησε Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων·
αὐτίκα δ’ ἀθανάτοισι θεοῖς μετὰ μῦθον ἔειπεν·
ὢ πόποι ἦ μοι ἄχος μεγαλήτορος Αἰνείαο,
ὃς τάχα Πηλεΐωνι δαμεὶς Ἄϊδος δὲ κάτεισι
πειθόμενος μύθοισιν Ἀπόλλωνος ἑκάτοιο
νήπιος, οὐδέ τί οἱ χραισμήσει λυγρὸν ὄλεθρον.
ἀλλὰ τί ἢ νῦν οὗτος ἀναίτιος ἄλγεα πάσχει
μὰψ ἕνεκ’ ἀλλοτρίων ἀχέων, κεχαρισμένα δ’ αἰεὶ
δῶρα θεοῖσι δίδωσι τοὶ οὐρανὸν εὐρὺν ἔχουσιν;
ἀλλ’ ἄγεθ’ ἡμεῖς πέρ μιν ὑπὲκ θανάτου ἀγάγωμεν,

20.301

μή πως καὶ Κρονίδης κεχολώσεται, αἴ κεν Ἀχιλλεὺς
τόνδε κατακτείνῃ· μόριμον δέ οἱ ἐστ’ ἀλέασθαι,
ὄφρα μὴ ἄσπερμος γενεὴ καὶ ἄφαντος ὄληται
Δαρδάνου, ὃν Κρονίδης περὶ πάντων φίλατο παίδων
οἳ ἔθεν ἐξεγένοντο γυναικῶν τε θνητάων.
ἤδη γὰρ Πριάμου γενεὴν ἔχθηρε Κρονίων·
νῦν δὲ δὴ Αἰνείαο βίη Τρώεσσιν ἀνάξει
καὶ παίδων παῖδες, τοί κεν μετόπισθε γένωνται.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα βοῶπις πότνια Ἥρη·
ἐννοσίγαι’, αὐτὸς σὺ μετὰ φρεσὶ σῇσι νόησον
Αἰνείαν ἤ κέν μιν ἐρύσσεαι ἦ κεν ἐάσῃς
Πηλεΐδῃ Ἀχιλῆϊ δαμήμεναι, ἐσθλὸν ἐόντα.
ἤτοι μὲν γὰρ νῶϊ πολέας ὠμόσσαμεν ὅρκους
πᾶσι μετ’ ἀθανάτοισιν ἐγὼ καὶ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη
μή ποτ’ ἐπὶ Τρώεσσιν ἀλεξήσειν κακὸν ἦμαρ,
μηδ’ ὁπότ’ ἂν Τροίη μαλερῷ πυρὶ πᾶσα δάηται
καιομένη, καίωσι δ’ ἀρήϊοι υἱες Ἀχαιῶν.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ τό γ’ ἄκουσε Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων,
βῆ ῥ’ ἴμεν ἄν τε μάχην καὶ ἀνὰ κλόνον ἐγχειάων,
ἷξε δ’ ὅθ’ Αἰνείας ἠδ’ ὃ κλυτὸς ἦεν Ἀχιλλεύς.
αὐτίκα τῷ μὲν ἔπειτα κατ’ ὀφθαλμῶν χέεν ἀχλὺν
Πηλεΐδῃ Ἀχιλῆϊ· ὃ δὲ μελίην εὔχαλκον
ἀσπίδος ἐξέρυσεν μεγαλήτορος Αἰνείαο·
καὶ τὴν μὲν προπάροιθε ποδῶν Ἀχιλῆος ἔθηκεν,
Αἰνείαν δ’ ἔσσευεν ἀπὸ χθονὸς ὑψόσ’ ἀείρας.
πολλὰς δὲ στίχας ἡρώων, πολλὰς δὲ καὶ ἵππων
Αἰνείας ὑπερᾶλτο θεοῦ ἀπὸ χειρὸς ὀρούσας,
ἷξε δ’ ἐπ’ ἐσχατιὴν πολυάϊκος πολέμοιο,
ἔνθά τε Καύκωνες πόλεμον μέτα θωρήσσοντο.
τῷ δὲ μάλ’ ἐγγύθεν ἦλθε Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων,

20.331

καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Αἰνεία, τίς σ’ ὧδε θεῶν ἀτέοντα κελεύει
ἀντία Πηλεΐωνος ὑπερθύμοιο μάχεσθαι,
ὃς σεῦ ἅμα κρείσσων καὶ φίλτερος ἀθανάτοισιν;

335 ἀλλ’ ἀναχωρῆσαι ὅτε κεν συμβλήσεαι αὐτῷ,
336 μὴ καὶ ὑπὲρ μοῖραν δόμον Ἄϊδος εἰσαφίκηαι.
337 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί κ’ Ἀχιλεὺς θάνατον καὶ πότμον ἐπίσπῃ,
338 θαρσήσας δὴ ἔπειτα μετὰ πρώτοισι μάχεσθαι·
339 οὐ μὲν γάρ τίς σ’ ἄλλος Ἀχαιῶν ἐξεναρίξει.
340 ὣς εἰπὼν λίπεν αὐτόθ’, ἐπεὶ διεπέφραδε πάντα.
341 αἶψα δ’ ἔπειτ’ Ἀχιλῆος ἀπ’ ὀφθαλμῶν σκέδασ’ ἀχλὺν
342 θεσπεσίην· ὃ δ’ ἔπειτα μέγ’ ἔξιδεν ὀφθαλμοῖσιν,
343 ὀχθήσας δ’ ἄρα εἶπε πρὸς ὃν μεγαλήτορα θυμόν·
344 ὢ πόποι ἦ μέγα θαῦμα τόδ’ ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ὁρῶμαι·
345 ἔγχος μὲν τόδε κεῖται ἐπὶ χθονός, οὐδέ τι φῶτα
346 λεύσσω, τῷ ἐφέηκα κατακτάμεναι μενεαίνων.
347 ἦ ῥα καὶ Αἰνείας φίλος ἀθανάτοισι θεοῖσιν
348 ἦεν· ἀτάρ μιν ἔφην μὰψ αὔτως εὐχετάασθαι.
349 ἐρρέτω· οὔ οἱ θυμὸς ἐμεῦ ἔτι πειρηθῆναι
350 ἔσσεται, ὃς καὶ νῦν φύγεν ἄσμενος ἐκ θανάτοιο.
351 ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ Δαναοῖσι φιλοπτολέμοισι κελεύσας
352 τῶν ἄλλων Τρώων πειρήσομαι ἀντίος ἐλθών.
353 ἦ, καὶ ἐπὶ στίχας ἆλτο, κέλευε δὲ φωτὶ ἑκάστῳ·
354 μηκέτι νῦν Τρώων ἑκὰς ἔστατε δῖοι Ἀχαιοί,
355 ἀλλ’ ἄγ’ ἀνὴρ ἄντ’ ἀνδρὸς ἴτω, μεμάτω δὲ μάχεσθαι.
356 ἀργαλέον δέ μοί ἐστι καὶ ἰφθίμῳ περ ἐόντι
357 τοσσούσδ’ ἀνθρώπους ἐφέπειν καὶ πᾶσι μάχεσθαι·
358 οὐδέ κ’ Ἄρης, ὅς περ θεὸς ἄμβροτος, οὐδέ κ’ Ἀθήνη
359 τοσσῆσδ’ ὑσμίνης ἐφέποι στόμα καὶ πονέοιτο·
360 ἀλλ’ ὅσσον μὲν ἐγὼ δύναμαι χερσίν τε ποσίν τε

The god left him when he had given him these instructions, and at once removed the darkness from before the eyes of Achilles, who opened them wide indeed and said in great anger, "Alas! what marvel am I now beholding? Here is my spear upon the ground, but I see not him whom I meant to kill when I hurled it. Of a truth Aeneas also must be under heaven's protection, although I had thought his boasting was idle. Let him go hang; he will be in no mood to fight me further, seeing how narrowly he has missed being killed. I will now give my orders to the Danaans and attack some other of the Trojans." He sprang forward along the line and cheered his men on as he did so. "Let not the Trojans," he cried, "keep you at arm's length, Achaeans, but go for them and fight them man for man. However valiant I may be, I cannot give chase to so many and fight all of them. Even Ares, who is an immortal, or Athena, would shrink from flinging himself into the jaws of such a fight and laying about him; nevertheless, so far as in me lies I will show no slackness of hand or foot nor want of endurance, not even for a moment; I will utterly break their ranks, and woe to the Trojan who shall venture within reach of my spear." Thus did he exhort them.
Meanwhile Hektor called upon the Trojans and declared that he would fight Achilles. "Be not afraid, proud Trojans," said he, "to face the son of Peleus; I could fight gods myself if the battle were one of words only, but they would be more than a match for me, if we had to use our spears. Even so the deed of Achilles will fall somewhat short of the outcome [telos] of his word; he will do in part, and the other part he will clip short. I will go up against him though his hands be as fire - though his hands be fire and his strength iron." Thus urged the Trojans lifted up their spears against the Achaeans, and raised the cry of battle as they flung themselves into the midst of their ranks. But Phoebus Apollo came up to Hektor and said, "Hektor, on no account must you challenge Achilles to single combat; keep a lookout for him while you are under cover of the others and away from the thick of the fight, otherwise he will either hit you with a spear or cut you down at close quarters." Thus he

spoke, and Hektor drew back within the crowd, for he was afraid when he heard what the god had said to him. Achilles then sprang upon the Trojans with a terrible cry, clothed in valor as with a garment. First he killed Iphition son of Otrynteus, a leader of many people whom a naiad nymph had borne to Otrynteus waster of cities, in the district [dêmos] of Hyde under the snowy heights of Mount Tmolos. Achilles struck him full on the head as he was coming on towards him, and split it clean in two; whereon he fell heavily to the ground and Achilles vaunted over him saying, "You be low, son of Otrynteus, mighty hero; your death is here, but your lineage is on the Gygaean lake where your father's estate lies, by Hyllos, rich in fish, and the eddying waters of Hermos." Thus did he vaunt, but darkness closed the eyes of the other. The chariots of the Achaeans cut him up as their wheels passed over him in the front of the battle, and after him Achilles killed Demoleon, a valiant man of war and son to Antenor. He struck him on the temple through his bronze-cheeked helmet. The helmet did not stay the spear, but it went right on, crushing the bone so that the brain inside was shed in all directions, and his lust of fighting was ended. Then he struck Hippodamas in the midriff as he was springing down from his chariot in front of him, and trying to escape. He breathed his last, bellowing like a bull bellows when young men are dragging him to offer him in sacrifice to the King of Helike, and the heart of the earth-shaker is glad; even so did he bellow as he lay dying. Achilles then went in pursuit of Polydoros son of Priam, whom his father had always forbidden to fight because he was the youngest of his sons, the one he loved best, and the fastest runner. He, in his folly and showing off the excellence [aretê] of his speed, was rushing about among front ranks until he lost his life, for Achilles struck him in the middle of the back as he was darting past him: he struck him just at the golden fastenings of his belt and where the two pieces of the double breastplate overlapped. The point of the spear pierced him through and came out by the navel, whereon he fell groaning on to his knees and a cloud of darkness overshadowed him as he sank holding his entrails in his hands. When Hektor saw his brother Polydoros with his entrails in his hands and sinking down upon the ground, a mist came over his eyes, and he could not bear to keep longer at a distance; he therefore poised his spear and darted towards Achilles like a flame of fire. When Achilles saw him he bounded forward and vaunted saying, "This is he that has wounded my heart most deeply and has slain my beloved comrade. Not for long shall we two quail before one another on the highways of war." He looked fiercely on Hektor and said, "Draw near, that you may meet your doom the sooner." Hektor feared him not and answered, "Son of Peleus, think not that your words can scare me as though I were a child; I too if I will can brag and talk unseemly; I know that you are a mighty warrior, mightier by far than I, nevertheless the issue lies in the lap of heaven whether I, worse man though I be, may not slay you with my spear, for this too has been found keen ere now."

20.361

361 καὶ σθένει, οὔ μ’ ἔτι φημὶ μεθησέμεν οὐδ’ ἠβαιόν,
362 ἀλλὰ μάλα στιχὸς εἶμι διαμπερές, οὐδέ τιν’ οἴω
363 Τρώων χαιρήσειν, ὅς τις σχεδὸν ἔγχεος ἔλθῃ.
364 ὣς φάτ’ ἐποτρύνων· Τρώεσσι δὲ φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ
365 κέκλεθ’ ὁμοκλήσας, φάτο δ’ ἴμεναι ἄντ’ Ἀχιλῆος·
366 Τρῶες ὑπέρθυμοι μὴ δείδιτε Πηλεΐωνα.
367 καί κεν ἐγὼ ἐπέεσσι καὶ ἀθανάτοισι μαχοίμην,
368 ἔγχεϊ δ’ ἀργαλέον, ἐπεὶ ἦ πολὺ φέρτεροί εἰσιν.
369 οὐδ’ Ἀχιλεὺς πάντεσσι τέλος μύθοις ἐπιθήσει,
370 ἀλλὰ τὸ μὲν τελέει, τὸ δὲ καὶ μεσσηγὺ κολούει.
371 τοῦ δ’ ἐγὼ ἀντίος εἶμι καὶ εἰ πυρὶ χεῖρας ἔοικεν,
372 εἰ πυρὶ χεῖρας ἔοικε, μένος δ’ αἴθωνι σιδήρῳ.

ὣς φάτ’ ἐποτρύνων, οἳ δ’ ἀντίοι ἔγχε’ ἄειραν
Τρῶες· τῶν δ’ ἄμυδις μίχθη μένος, ὦρτο δ’ ἀϋτή.
καὶ τότ’ ἄρ’ Ἕκτορα εἶπε παραστὰς Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων·
Ἕκτορ μηκέτι πάμπαν Ἀχιλλῆϊ προμάχιζε,
ἀλλὰ κατὰ πληθύν τε καὶ ἐκ φλοίσβοιο δέδεξο,
μή πώς σ’ ἠὲ βάλῃ ἠὲ σχεδὸν ἄορι τύψῃ.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, Ἕκτωρ δ’ αὖτις ἐδύσετο οὐλαμὸν ἀνδρῶν
ταρβήσας, ὅτ’ ἄκουσε θεοῦ ὄπα φωνήσαντος.
ἐν δ’ Ἀχιλεὺς Τρώεσσι θόρε φρεσὶν εἰμένος ἀλκὴν
σμερδαλέα ἰάχων, πρῶτον δ’ ἔλεν Ἰφιτίωνα
ἐσθλὸν Ὀτρυντεΐδην πολέων ἡγήτορα λαῶν,
ὃν νύμφη τέκε νηΐς Ὀτρυντῆϊ πτολιπόρθῳ
Τμώλῳ ὕπο νιφόεντι Ὕδης ἐν πίονι δήμῳ·
τὸν δ’ ἰθὺς μεμαῶτα βάλ’ ἔγχεϊ δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
μέσσην κὰκ κεφαλήν· ἣ δ’ ἄνδιχα πᾶσα κεάσθη,
δούπησεν δὲ πεσών, ὃ δ’ ἐπεύξατο δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
κεῖσαι Ὀτρυντεΐδη πάντων ἐκπαγλότατ’ ἀνδρῶν·
ἐνθάδε τοι θάνατος, γενεὴ δέ τοί ἐστ’ ἐπὶ λίμνῃ

20.391

Γυγαίῃ, ὅθι τοι τέμενος πατρώϊόν ἐστιν
Ὕλλῳ ἐπ’ ἰχθυόεντι καὶ Ἕρμῳ δινήεντι.
ὣς ἔφατ’ εὐχόμενος, τὸν δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψε.
τὸν μὲν Ἀχαιῶν ἵπποι ἐπισσώτροις δατέοντο
πρώτῃ ἐν ὑσμίνῃ· ὃ δ’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ Δημολέοντα
ἐσθλὸν ἀλεξητῆρα μάχης Ἀντήνορος υἱὸν
νύξε κατὰ κρόταφον, κυνέης διὰ χαλκοπαρῄου.
οὐδ’ ἄρα χαλκείη κόρυς ἔσχεθεν, ἀλλὰ δι’ αὐτῆς
αἰχμὴ ἰεμένη ῥῆξ’ ὀστέον, ἐγκέφαλος δὲ
ἔνδον ἅπας πεπάλακτο· δάμασσε δέ μιν μεμαῶτα.
Ἱπποδάμαντα δ’ ἔπειτα καθ’ ἵππων ἀΐξαντα
πρόσθεν ἔθεν φεύγοντα μετάφρενον οὔτασε δουρί.
αὐτὰρ ὃ θυμὸν ἄϊσθε καὶ ἤρυγεν, ὡς ὅτε ταῦρος
ἤρυγεν ἑλκόμενος Ἑλικώνιον ἀμφὶ ἄνακτα
κούρων ἑλκόντων· γάνυται δέ τε τοῖς ἐνοσίχθων·
ὣς ἄρα τόν γ’ ἐρυγόντα λίπ’ ὀστέα θυμὸς ἀγήνωρ·
αὐτὰρ ὃ βῆ σὺν δουρὶ μετ’ ἀντίθεον Πολύδωρον
Πριαμίδην. τὸν δ’ οὔ τι πατὴρ εἴασκε μάχεσθαι,
οὕνεκά οἱ μετὰ παισὶ νεώτατος ἔσκε γόνοιο,
καί οἱ φίλτατος ἔσκε, πόδεσσι δὲ πάντας ἐνίκα
δὴ τότε νηπιέῃσι ποδῶν ἀρετὴν ἀναφαίνων
θῦνε διὰ προμάχων, εἷος φίλον ὤλεσε θυμόν.
τὸν βάλε μέσσον ἄκοντι ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
νῶτα παραΐσσοντος, ὅθι ζωστῆρος ὀχῆες
χρύσειοι σύνεχον καὶ διπλόος ἤντετο θώρηξ·
ἀντικρὺ δὲ διέσχε παρ’ ὀμφαλὸν ἔγχεος αἰχμή,
γνὺξ δ’ ἔριπ’ οἰμώξας, νεφέλη δέ μιν ἀμφεκάλυψε
κυανέη, προτὶ οἷ δ’ ἔλαβ’ ἔντερα χερσὶ λιασθείς.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ὡς ἐνόησε κασίγνητον Πολύδωρον
ἔντερα χερσὶν ἔχοντα λιαζόμενον ποτὶ γαίη

20.421

κάρ ῥά οἱ ὀφθαλμῶν κέχυτ’ ἀχλύς· οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔτ’ ἔτλη
δηρὸν ἐκὰς στρωφᾶσθ’, ἀλλ’ ἀντίος ἦλθ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ
ὀξὺ δόρυ κραδάων φλογὶ εἴκελος· αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
ὡς εἶδ’, ὣς ἀνεπᾶλτο, καὶ εὐχόμενος ἔπος ηὔδα·
ἐγγὺς ἀνὴρ ὃς ἐμόν γε μάλιστ’ ἐσεμάσσατο θυμόν,
ὅς μοι ἑταῖρον ἔπεφνε τετιμένον· οὐδ’ ἂν ἔτι δὴν
ἀλλήλους πτώσσοιμεν ἀνὰ πτολέμοιο γεφύρας.
ἦ, καὶ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσεφώνεεν Ἕκτορα δῖον·
ἆσσον ἴθ’ ὥς κεν θᾶσσον ὀλέθρου πείραθ’ ἵκηαι.
τὸν δ’ οὐ ταρβήσας προσέφη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
Πηλεΐδη μὴ δὴ ἐπέεσσί με νηπύτιον ὡς
ἔλπεο δειδίξεσθαι, ἐπεὶ σάφα οἶδα καὶ αὐτὸς
ἠμὲν κερτομίας ἠδ’ αἴσυλα μυθήσασθαι.
οἶδα δ’ ὅτι σὺ μὲν ἐσθλός, ἐγὼ δὲ σέθεν πολὺ χείρων.
ἀλλ’ ἤτοι μὲν ταῦτα θεῶν ἐν γούνασι κεῖται,
αἴ κέ σε χειρότερός περ ἐὼν ἀπὸ θυμὸν ἕλωμαι
δουρὶ βαλών, ἐπεὶ ἦ καὶ ἐμὸν βέλος ὀξὺ πάροιθεν.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἀμπεπαλὼν προΐει δόρυ, καὶ τό γ’ Ἀθήνη
πνοιῇ Ἀχιλλῆος πάλιν ἔτραπε κυδαλίμοιο
ἧκα μάλα ψύξασα· τὸ δ’ ἂψ ἴκεθ’ Ἕκτορα δῖον,
αὐτοῦ δὲ προπάροιθε ποδῶν πέσεν. αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
ἐμμεμαὼς ἐπόρουσε κατακτάμεναι μενεαίνων,
σμερδαλέα ἰάχων· τὸν δ’ ἐξήρπαξεν Ἀπόλλων
ῥεῖα μάλ’ ὥς τε θεός, ἐκάλυψε δ’ ἄρ’ ἠέρι πολλῇ.
τρὶς μὲν ἔπειτ’ ἐπόρουσε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
ἔγχεϊ χαλκείῳ, τρὶς δ’ ἠέρα τύψε βαθεῖαν.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ τὸ τέταρτον ἐπέσσυτο δαίμονι ἶσος,
δεινὰ δ’ ὁμοκλήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
ἐξ αὖ νῦν ἔφυγες θάνατον κύον· ἦ τέ τοι ἄγχι
ἦλθε κακόν· νῦν αὖτέ σ’ ἐρύσατο Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων,

He hurled his spear as he spoke, but Athena breathed upon it, and though she breathed but very lightly she turned it back from going towards Achilles, so that it returned to Hektor and lay at his feet in front of him. Achilles then sprang furiously on him with a loud cry, bent on killing him, but Apollo caught him up easily as a god can, and hid him in a thick darkness. Thrice did Achilles spring towards him spear in hand, and thrice did he waste his blow upon the air. When he rushed forward for the fourth time as though he were a daimôn he shouted aloud saying, "Hound, this time too you have escaped death - but of a truth it came exceedingly near you. Phoebus Apollo, to whom it seems you pray before you go into battle, has again saved you; but if I too have any friend among the gods I will surely make an end of you when I come across you at some other time. Now, however, I will pursue and overtake other Trojans." On this he struck Dryops with his spear, about the middle of his neck, and he fell headlong at his feet. There he let him lie and stayed Demoukhos son of Philetor, a man both brave and of great stature, by hitting him on the knee with a spear; then he smote him with his sword and killed him. After this he sprang on Laogonos and Dardanos, sons of Bias, and threw them from their chariot, the one with a blow from a thrown spear, while the other he cut down in hand-to-hand fight. There was also Tros the son of Alastor - he came up to Achilles and clasped his knees in the hope that he would spare him and not kill him but let him go, because they were both of the same age. Fool, he might have known that he should not prevail with him, for the man was in no mood for pity or forbearance but was in grim earnest. Therefore when Tros laid hold of his knees and

sought a hearing for his prayers, Achilles drove his sword into his liver, and the liver came rolling out, while his bosom was all covered with the black blood that welled from the wound. Thus did death close his eyes as he lay lifeless. Achilles then went up to Moulios and struck him on the ear with a spear, and the bronze spear-head came right out at the other ear. He also struck Echeklos son of Agenor on the head with his sword, which became warm with the blood, while death and stern fate closed the eyes of Echeklos. Next in order the bronze point of his spear wounded Deukalion in the fore-arm where the sinews of the elbow are united, whereon he waited Achilles' onset with his arm hanging down and death staring him in the face. Achilles cut his head off with a blow from his sword and flung it helmet and all away from him, and the marrow came oozing out of his backbone as he lay. He then went in pursuit of Rhigmos, noble son of Peires, who had come from fertile Thrace, and struck him through the middle with a spear which fixed itself in his belly, so that he fell headlong from his chariot. He also speared Areithoos squire [therapôn] to Rhigmos in the back as he was turning his horses in flight, and thrust him from his chariot, while the horses were struck with panic. As a fire raging in some mountain glen after long drought - and the dense forest is in a blaze, while the wind carries great tongues of fire in every direction - even so furiously did Achilles rage, wielding his spear as though he were a daimôn, and giving chase to those whom he would slay, till the dark earth ran with blood. Or as one who yokes broad-browed oxen that they may tread barley in a threshing-floor - and it is soon bruised small under the feet of the lowing cattle - even so did the horses of Achilles trample on the shields and bodies of the slain. The axle underneath and the railing that ran round the car were bespattered with clots of blood thrown up by the horses' hoofs, and from the tires of the wheels; but the son of Peleus pressed on to win still further glory, and his hands were bedrabbled with gore.

20.451

ᾧ μέλλεις εὔχεσθαι ἰὼν ἐς δοῦπον ἀκόντων.
ἦ θήν σ’ ἐξανύω γε καὶ ὕστερον ἀντιβολήσας,
εἴ πού τις καὶ ἔμοιγε θεῶν ἐπιτάρροθός ἐστι.
νῦν αὖ τοὺς ἄλλους ἐπιείσομαι, ὄν κε κιχείω.
ὣς εἰπὼν Δρύοπ’ οὖτα κατ’ αὐχένα μέσσον ἄκοντι·
ἤριπε δὲ προπάροιθε ποδῶν· ὃ δὲ τὸν μὲν ἔασε,
Δημοῦχον δὲ Φιλητορίδην ἠΰν τε μέγαν τε
κὰγ γόνυ δουρὶ βαλὼν ἠρύκακε. τὸν μὲν ἔπειτα
οὐτάζων ξίφεϊ μεγάλῳ ἐξαίνυτο θυμόν·
αὐτὰρ ὃ Λαόγονον καὶ Δάρδανον υἷε Βίαντος
ἄμφω ἐφορμηθεὶς ἐξ ἵππων ὦσε χαμᾶζε,
τὸν μὲν δουρὶ βαλών, τὸν δὲ σχεδὸν ἄορι τύψας.
Τρῶα δ’ Ἀλαστορίδην, ὃ μὲν ἀντίος ἦλυθε γούνων,
εἴ πώς εὐ πεφίδοιτο λαβὼν καὶ ζωὸν ἀφείη
μηδὲ κατακτείνειεν ὁμηλικίην ἐλεήσας,
νήπιος, οὐδὲ τὸ ᾔδη ὃ οὐ πείσεσθαι ἔμελλεν·
οὐ γάρ τι γλυκύθυμος ἀνὴρ ἦν οὐδ’ ἀγανόφρων,
ἀλλὰ μάλ’ ἐμμεμαώς· ὃ μὲν ἥπτετο χείρεσι γούνων
ἱέμενος λίσσεσθ’, ὃ δὲ φασγάνῳ οὖτα καθ’ ἧπαρ·
ἐκ δέ οἱ ἧπαρ ὄλισθεν, ἀτὰρ μέλαν αἷμα κατ’ αὐτοῦ
κόλπον ἐνέπλησεν· τὸν δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψε
θυμοῦ δευόμενον· ὃ δὲ Μούλιον οὖτα παραστὰς
δουρὶ κατ’ οὖς· εἶθαρ δὲ δι’ οὔατος ἦλθ’ ἐτέροιο
αἰχμὴ χαλκείη· ὃ δ’ Ἀγήνορος υἱὸν Ἔχεκλον
μέσσην κὰκ κεφαλὴν ξίφει ἤλασε κωπήεντι,

476 πᾶν δ’ ὑπεθερμάνθη ξίφος αἵματι· τὸν δὲ κατ’ ὄσσε
477 ἔλλαβε πορφύρεος θάνατος καὶ μοῖρα κραταιή.
478 Δευκαλίωνα δ’ ἔπειθ’, ἵνα τε ξυνέχουσι τένοντες
479 ἀγκῶνος, τῇ τόν γε φίλης διὰ χειρὸς ἔπειρεν
480 αἰχμῇ χαλκείῃ· ὃ δέ μιν μένε χεῖρα βαρυνθεὶς

20.481

481 πρόσθ’ ὀρόων θάνατον· ὃ δὲ φασγάνῳ αὐχένα θείνας
482 τῆλ’ αὐτῇ πήληκι κάρη βάλε· μυελὸς αὖτε
483 σφονδυλίων ἔκπαλθ’, ὃ δ’ ἐπὶ χθονὶ κεῖτο τανυσθείς.
484 αὐτὰρ ὃ βῆ ῥ’ ἰέναι μετ’ ἀμύμονα Πείρεω υἱὸν
485 Ῥίγμον, ὃς ἐκ Θρῄκης ἐριβώλακος εἰληλούθει·
486 τὸν βάλε μέσσον ἄκοντι, πάγη δ’ ἐν νηδύϊ χαλκός,
487 ἤριπε δ’ ἐξ ὀχέων· ὃ δ’ Ἀρηΐθοον θεράποντα
488 ἂψ ἵππους στρέψαντα μετάφρενον ὀξέϊ δουρὶ
489 νύξ’, ἀπὸ δ’ ἄρματος ὦσε· κυκήθησαν δέ οἱ ἵπποι.
490 ὡς δ’ ἀναμαιμάει βαθέ’ ἄγκεα θεσπιδαὲς πῦρ
491 οὔρεος ἀζαλέοιο, βαθεῖα δὲ καίεται ὕλη,
492 πάντῃ τε κλονέων ἄνεμος φλόγα εἰλυφάζει,
493 ὣς ὅ γε πάντῃ θῦνε σὺν ἔγχεϊ δαίμονι ἶσος
494 κτεινομένους ἐφέπων· ῥέε δ’ αἵματι γαῖα μέλαινα.
495 ὡς δ’ ὅτε τις ζεύξῃ βόας ἄρσενας εὐρυμετώπους
496 τριβέμεναι κρῖ λευκὸν ἐϋκτιμένῃ ἐν ἀλωῇ,
497 ῥίμφά τε λέπτ’ ἐγένοντο βοῶν ὑπὸ πόσσ’ ἐριμύκων,
498 ὣς ὑπ’ Ἀχιλλῆος μεγαθύμου μώνυχες ἵπποι
499 στεῖβον ὁμοῦ νέκυάς τε καὶ ἀσπίδας· αἵματι δ’ ἄξων
500 νέρθεν ἄπας πεπάλακτο καὶ ἄντυγες αἳ περὶ δίφρον,
501 ἃς ἄρ’ ἀφ’ ἱππείων ὁπλέων ῥαθάμιγγες ἔβαλλον
502 αἵ τ’ ἀπ’ ἐπισσώτρων· ὃ δὲ ἵετο κῦδος ἀρέσθαι
503 Πηλεΐδης, λύθρῳ δὲ παλάσσετο χεῖρας ἀάπτους.

21.1

1 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ πόρον ἶξον ἐϋρρεῖος ποταμοῖο
2 Ξάνθου δινήεντος, ὃν ἀθάνατος τέκετο Ζεύς,
3 ἔνθα διατμήξας τοὺς μὲν πεδίον δὲ δίωκε
4 πρὸς πόλιν, ᾗ περ Ἀχαιοὶ ἀτυζόμενοι φοβέοντο
5 ἤματι τῷ προτέρῳ, ὅτε μαίνετο φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ·
6 τῇ ῥ’ οἵ γε προχέοντο πεφυζότες, ἠέρα δ’ Ἥρη
7 πίτνα πρόσθε βαθεῖαν ἐρυκέμεν· ἡμίσεες δὲ
8 ἐς ποταμὸν εἰλεῦντο βαθύρροον ἀργυροδίνην,
9 ἐν δ’ ἔπεσον μεγάλῳ πατάγῳ, βράχε δ’ αἰπὰ ῥέεθρα,
10 ὄχθαι δ’ ἀμφὶ περὶ μεγάλ’ ἴαχον· οἳ δ’ ἀλαλητῷ
11 ἔννεον ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα ἑλισσόμενοι περὶ δίνας.
12 ὡς δ’ ὅθ’ ὑπὸ ῥιπῆς πυρὸς ἀκρίδες ἠερέθονται
13 φευγέμεναι ποταμὸν δέ· τὸ δὲ φλέγει ἀκάματον πῦρ
14 ὄρμενον ἐξαίφνης, ταὶ δὲ πτώσσουσι καθ’ ὕδωρ·
15 ὣς ὑπ’ Ἀχιλλῆος Ξάνθου βαθυδινήεντος
16 πλῆτο ῥόος κελάδων ἐπιμὶξ ἵππων τε καὶ ἀνδρῶν.
17 αὐτὰρ ὃ διογενὴς δόρυ μὲν λίπεν αὐτοῦ ἐπ’ ὄχθῃ
18 κεκλιμένον μυρίκῃσιν, ὃ δ’ ἔσθορε δαίμονι ἶσος

19 φάσγανον οἷον ἔχων, κακὰ δὲ φρεσὶ μήδετο ἔργα,
20 τύπτε δ’ ἐπιστροφάδην· τῶν δὲ στόνος ὄρνυτ’ ἀεικὴς
21 ἄορι θεινομένων, ἐρυθαίνετο δ’ αἵματι ὕδωρ.
22 ὡς δ’ ὑπὸ δελφῖνος μεγακήτεος ἰχθύες ἄλλοι
23 φεύγοντες πιμπλᾶσι μυχοὺς λιμένος εὐόρμου
24 δειδιότες· μάλα γάρ τε κατεσθίει ὅν κε λάβῃσιν·
25 ὣς Τρῶες ποταμοῖο κατὰ δεινοῖο ῥέεθρα
26 πτῶσσον ὑπὸ κρημνούς. ὃ δ’ ἐπεὶ κάμε χεῖρας ἐναίρων,
27 ζωοὺς ἐκ ποταμοῖο δυώδεκα λέξατο κούρους
28 ποινὴν Πατρόκλοιο Μενοιτιάδαο θανόντος·
29 τοὺς ἐξῆγε θύραζε τεθηπότας ἠΰτε νεβρούς,
30 δῆσε δ’ ὀπίσσω χεῖρας ἐϋτμήτοισιν ἱμᾶσι,
Now when they came to the ford of the full-flowing river Xanthos, begotten of immortal Zeus, Achilles cut their forces in two: one half he chased over the plain towards the city by the same way that the Achaeans had taken when fleeing panic-stricken on the preceding day with Hektor in full triumph; this way did they flee pell-mell, and Hera sent down a thick mist in front of them to stay them. The other half were hemmed in by the deep silver-eddying stream, and fell into it with a great uproar. The waters resounded, and the banks rang again, as they swam hither and thither with loud cries amid the whirling eddies. As locusts flying to a river before the blast of a grass fire- the flame comes on and on till at last it overtakes them and they huddle into the water - even so was the eddying stream of Xanthos filled with the uproar of men and horses, all struggling in confusion before Achilles. Forthwith the hero left his spear upon the bank, leaning it against a tamarisk bush, and plunged into the river like a daimôn, armed with his sword only. Fell was his purpose as he hewed the Trojans down on every side. Their dying groans rose hideous as the sword smote them, and the river ran red with blood. As when fish flee scared before a huge dolphin, and fill every nook and corner of some fair haven - for he is sure to eat all he can catch - even so did the Trojans cower under the banks of the mighty river, and when Achilles' arms grew weary with killing them, he drew twelve youths alive out of the water, to sacrifice in revenge for Patroklos son of Menoitios. He drew them out like dazed fawns, bound their hands behind them with the belts of their own shirts, and gave them over to his men to take back to the ships. Then he sprang into the river, thirsting for still further blood. There he found Lykaon, son of Priam seed of Dardanos, as he was escaping out of the water; he it was whom he had once taken prisoner when he was in his father's vineyard, having set upon him by night, as he was cutting young shoots from a wild fig-tree to make the wicker sides of a chariot. Achilles then caught him to his sorrow unawares, and sent him by sea to Lemnos, where the son of Jason bought him. But a guest-friend, Eetion of Imbros, freed him with a great sum, and sent him to Arisbe, whence he had escaped and returned to his father's house. He had spent eleven days happily with his friends after he had come from Lemnos, but on the twelfth heaven again delivered him into the hands of Achilles, who was to send him to the house of Hades sorely against his will. He was unarmed when Achilles caught sight of him, and had neither helmet nor shield; nor yet had he any spear, for he had thrown all his armor from him on to the bank, and was sweating with his struggles to get out of the river, so that his strength was now failing him. Then Achilles said to himself in his surprise, "What marvel do I see here? If this man can come back alive after having been sold over into Lemnos, I shall have the Trojans also whom I have slain rising from the world below. Could not even the waters of the gray sea [pontos] imprison him, as they do many another whether he will or no? This time let him taste my spear, that I may know for certain whether mother earth who can keep even a strong man down, will be able to hold him, or whether thence too he will return." Thus did he pause and ponder. But Lykaon came up to him dazed and trying hard to embrace his knees, for he

would fain live, not die. Achilles thrust at him with his spear, meaning to kill him, but Lykaon ran crouching up to him and caught his knees, whereby the spear passed over his back, and stuck in the ground, hungering though it was for blood. With one hand he caught Achilles' knees as he besought him, and with the other he clutched the spear and would not let it go. Then he said, "Achilles, have mercy upon me and spare me, for I am your suppliant. It was in your tents that I first broke bread on the day when you took me prisoner in the vineyard; after which you sold away to Lemnos far from my father and my friends, and I brought you the price of a hundred oxen. I have paid three times as much to gain my freedom; it is but twelve days that I have come to Ilion after much suffering, and now cruel fate has again thrown me into your hands. Surely father Zeus must hate me, that he has given me over to you a second time. Short of life indeed did my mother Laothoe bear me, daughter of aged Altes - of Altes who reigns over the warlike Leleges and holds steep Pedasos on the river Satnioeis. Priam married his daughter along with many other women and two sons were born of her, both of whom you will have slain. Your spear slew noble Polydoros as he was fighting in the front ranks, and now evil will here befall me, for I fear that I shall not escape you since a daimôn has delivered me over to you. Furthermore I say, and lay my saying to your heart, spare me, for I am not of the same womb as Hektor who slew your brave and noble comrade." With such words did the princely son of Priam beseech Achilles; but Achilles answered him sternly. "Idiot," said he, "talk not to me of ransom. Until Patroklos fell I preferred to give the Trojans quarter, and sold beyond the sea many of those whom I had taken alive; but now not a man shall live of those whom heaven delivers into my hands before the city of Ilion - and of all Trojans it shall fare hardest with the sons of Priam. Therefore, my friend, you too shall die. Why should you whine in this way? Patroklos fell, and he was a better man than you are. I too - see you not how I am great and goodly? I am son to a noble father, and have a goddess for my mother, but the hands of doom and death overshadow me all as surely. The day will come, either at dawn or dark, or at the noontide, when one shall take my life also in battle, either with his spear, or with an arrow sped from his bow."

21.31

31 τοὺς αὐτοὶ φορέεσκον ἐπὶ στρεπτοῖσι χιτῶσι,
32 δῶκε δ’ ἑταίροισιν κατάγειν κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας.
33 αὐτὰρ ὃ ἂψ ἐπόρουσε δαϊζέμεναι μενεαίνων.
34 ἔνθ’ υἷι Πριάμοιο συνήντετο Δαρδανίδαο
35 ἐκ ποταμοῦ φεύγοντι Λυκάονι, τόν ῥά ποτ’ αὐτὸς
36 ἦγε λαβὼν ἐκ πατρὸς ἀλωῆς οὐκ ἐθέλοντα
37 ἐννύχιος προμολών· ὃ δ’ ἐρινεὸν ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ
38 τάμνε νέους ὄρπηκας, ἵν’ ἅρματος ἄντυγες εἶεν·
39 τῷ δ’ ἄρ’ ἀνώϊστον κακὸν ἦλυθε δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς.
40 καὶ τότε μέν μιν Λῆμνον ἐϋκτιμένην ἐπέρασσε
41 νηυσὶν ἄγων, ἀτὰρ υἱὸς Ἰήσονος ὦνον ἔδωκε·
42 κεῖθεν δὲ ξεῖνός μιν ἐλύσατο πολλὰ δ’ ἔδωκεν
43 Ἴμβριος Ἠετίων, πέμψεν δ’ ἐς δῖαν Ἀρίσβην·
44 ἔνθεν ὑπεκπροφυγὼν πατρώϊον ἵκετο δῶμα.
45 ἔνδεκα δ’ ἤματα θυμὸν ἐτέρπετο οἷσι φίλοισιν
46 ἐλθὼν ἐκ Λήμνοιο· δυωδεκάτῃ δέ μιν αὖτις
47 χερσὶν Ἀχιλλῆος θεὸς ἔμβαλεν, ὅς μιν ἔμελλε
48 πέμψειν εἰς Ἀΐδαο καὶ οὐκ ἐθέλοντα νέεσθαι.
49 τὸν δ’ ὡς οὖν ἐνόησε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
50 γυμνὸν ἄτερ κόρυθός τε καὶ ἀσπίδος, οὐδ’ ἔχεν ἔγχος,
51 ἀλλὰ τὰ μέν ῥ’ ἀπὸ πάντα χαμαὶ βάλε· τεῖρε γὰρ ἱδρὼς

φεύγοντ’ ἐκ ποταμοῦ, κάματος δ’ ὑπὸ γούνατ’ ἐδάμνα·
ὀχθήσας δ’ ἄρα εἶπε πρὸς ὃν μεγαλήτορα θυμόν·
ὢ πόποι ἦ μέγα θαῦμα τόδ’ ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ὁρῶμαι·
ἦ μάλα δὴ Τρῶες μεγαλήτορες οὕς περ ἔπεφνον
αὖτις ἀναστήσονται ὑπὸ ζόφου ἠερόεντος,
οἷον δὴ καὶ ὅδ’ ἦλθε φυγὼν ὕπο νηλεὲς ἦμαρ
Λῆμνον ἐς ἠγαθέην πεπερημένος· οὐδέ μιν ἔσχε
πόντος ἁλὸς πολιῆς, ὃ πολέας ἀέκοντας ἐρύκει.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ καὶ δουρὸς ἀκωκῆς ἡμετέροιο

21.61

γεύσεται, ὄφρα ἴδωμαι ἐνὶ φρεσὶν ἠδὲ δαείω
ἢ ἄρ’ ὁμῶς καὶ κεῖθεν ἐλεύσεται, ἦ μιν ἐρύξει
γῆ φυσίζοος, ἥ τε κατὰ κρατερόν περ ἐρύκει.
ὣς ὄρμαινε μένων· ὃ δέ οἱ σχεδὸν ἦλθε τεθηπὼς
γούνων ἄψασθαι μεμαώς, περὶ δ’ ἤθελε θυμῷ
ἐκφυγέειν θάνατόν τε κακὸν καὶ κῆρα μέλαιναν.
ἤτοι ὃ μὲν δόρυ μακρὸν ἀνέσχετο δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
οὐτάμεναι μεμαώς, ὃ δ’ ὑπέδραμε καὶ λάβε γούνων
κύψας· ἐγχείη δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπὲρ νώτου ἐνὶ γαίῃ
ἔστη ἰεμένη χροὸς ἄμεναι ἀνδρομέοιο.
αὐτὰρ ὃ τῇ ἑτέρῃ μὲν ἑλὼν ἐλλίσσετο γούνων,
τῇ δ’ ἑτέρῃ ἔχεν ἔγχος ἀκαχμένον οὐδὲ μεθίει·
καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
γουνοῦμαι σ’ Ἀχιλεῦ· σὺ δέ μ’ αἴδεο καί μ’ ἐλέησον·
ἀντί τοί εἰμ’ ἱκέταο διοτρεφὲς αἰδοίοιο·
πὰρ γὰρ σοὶ πρώτῳ πασάμην Δημήτερος ἀκτὴν
ἤματι τῷ ὅτε μ’ εἶλες ἐϋκτιμένῃ ἐν ἀλωῇ,
καί μ’ ἐπέρασσας ἄνευθεν ἄγων πατρός τε φίλων τε
Λῆμνον ἐς ἠγαθέην, ἑκατόμβοιον δέ τοι ἦλφον.
νῦν δὲ λύμην τρὶς τόσσα πορών· ἠὼς δέ μοί ἐστιν
ἥδε δυωδεκάτη, ὅτ’ ἐς Ἴλιον εἰλήλουθα
πολλὰ παθών· νῦν αὖ με τεῇς ἐν χερσὶν ἔθηκε
μοῖρ’ ὀλοή· μέλλω που ἀπεχθέσθαι Διὶ πατρί,
ὅς με σοὶ αὖτις δῶκε· μινυνθάδιον δέ με μήτηρ
γείνατο Λαοθόη θυγάτηρ Ἄλταο γέροντος
Ἄλτεω, ὃς Λελέγεσσι φιλοπτολέμοισιν ἀνάσσει
Πήδασον αἰπήεσσαν ἔχων ἐπὶ Σατνιόεντι.
τοῦ δ’ ἔχε θυγατέρα Πρίαμος, πολλὰς δὲ καὶ ἄλλας·
τῆς δὲ δύω γενόμεσθα, σὺ δ’ ἄμφω δειροτομήσεις,
ἤτοι τὸν πρώτοισι μετὰ πρυλέεσσι δάμασσας

21.91

ἀντίθεον Πολύδωρον, ἐπεὶ βάλες ὀξέϊ δουρί·
νῦν δὲ δὴ ἐνθάδ’ ἐμοὶ κακὸν ἔσσεται· οὐ γὰρ ὄΐω
σὰς χεῖρας φεύξεσθαι, ἐπεί ῥ’ ἐπέλασσέ γε δαίμων.
ἄλλο δέ τοι ἐρέω, σὺ δ’ ἐνὶ φρεσὶ βάλλεο σῇσι·
μή με κτεῖν’, ἐπεὶ οὐχ ὁμογάστριος Ἕκτορός εἰμι,
ὅς τοι ἑταῖρον ἔπεφνεν ἐνηέα τε κρατερόν τε.
ὣς ἄρα μιν Πριάμοιο προσηύδα φαίδιμος υἱὸς

98 λισσόμενος ἐπέεσσιν, ἀμείλικτον δ’ ὄπ’ ἄκουσε·
99 νήπιε μή μοι ἄποινα πιφαύσκεο μηδ’ ἀγόρευε·
100 πρὶν μὲν γὰρ Πάτροκλον ἐπισπεῖν αἴσιμον ἦμαρ
101 τόφρά τί μοι πεφιδέσθαι ἐνὶ φρεσὶ φίλτερον ἦεν
102 Τρώων, καὶ πολλοὺς ζωοὺς ἕλον ἠδ’ ἐπέρασσα·
103 νῦν δ’ οὐκ ἔσθ’ ὅς τις θάνατον φύγῃ ὅν κε θεός γε
104 Ἰλίου προπάροιθεν ἐμῇς ἐν χερσὶ βάλῃσι
105 καὶ πάντων Τρώων, περὶ δ’ αὖ Πριάμοιό γε παίδων.
106 ἀλλὰ φίλος θάνε καὶ σύ· τί ἦ ὀλοφύρεαι οὕτως;
107 κάτθανε καὶ Πάτροκλος, ὅ περ σέο πολλὸν ἀμείνων.
108 οὐχ ὁράᾳς οἷος καὶ ἐγὼ καλός τε μέγας τε;
109 πατρὸς δ’ εἶμ’ ἀγαθοῖο, θεὰ δέ με γείνατο μήτηρ·
110 ἀλλ’ ἔπι τοι καὶ ἐμοὶ θάνατος καὶ μοῖρα κραταιή·
111 ἔσσεται ἢ ἠὼς ἢ δείλη ἢ μέσον ἦμαρ
112 ὁππότε τις καὶ ἐμεῖο Ἄρῃ ἐκ θυμὸν ἕληται
113 ἢ ὅ γε δουρὶ βαλὼν ἢ ἀπὸ νευρῆφιν ὀϊστῷ.
114 ὣς φάτο, τοῦ δ’ αὐτοῦ λύτο γούνατα καὶ φίλον ἦτορ·
115 ἔγχος μέν ῥ’ ἀφέηκεν, ὃ δ’ ἕζετο χεῖρε πετάσσας
116 ἀμφοτέρας· Ἀχιλεὺς δὲ ἐρυσσάμενος ξίφος ὀξὺ
117 τύψε κατὰ κληῖδα παρ’ αὐχένα, πᾶν δέ οἱ εἴσω
118 δῦ ξίφος ἄμφηκες· ὃ δ’ ἄρα πρηνὴς ἐπὶ γαίῃ
119 κεῖτο ταθείς, ἐκ δ’ αἷμα μέλαν ῥέε, δεῦε δὲ γαῖαν.
120 τὸν δ’ Ἀχιλεὺς ποταμὸν δὲ λαβὼν ποδὸς ἧκε φέρεσθαι,

Thus did he speak, and Lykaon's heart sank within him. He loosed his hold of the spear, and held out both hands before him; but Achilles drew his keen blade, and struck him by the collar-bone on his neck; he plunged his two-edged sword into him to the very hilt, whereon he lay at full length on the ground, with the dark blood welling from him till the earth was soaked. Then Achilles caught him by the foot and flung him into the river to go down stream, vaunting over him the while, and saying, "Lie there among the fishes, who will lick the blood from your wound and gloat over it; your mother shall not lay you on any bier to mourn you, but the eddies of Skamandros shall bear you into the broad bosom of the sea. There shall the fishes feed on the fat of Lykaon as they dart under the dark ripple of the waters - so perish all of you till we reach the citadel of strong Ilion - you in flight, and I following after to destroy you. The river with its broad silver stream shall serve you in no stead, for all the bulls you offered him and all the horses that you flung living into his waters. None the less miserably shall you perish till there is not a man of you but has paid in full for the death of Patroklos and the havoc you wrought among the Achaeans whom you have slain while I held aloof from battle." So spoke Achilles, but the river grew more and more angry, and pondered within himself how he should keep Achilles out of the struggle [ponos] and save the Trojans from disaster. Meanwhile the son of Peleus, spear in hand, sprang upon Asteropaios son of Pelegon to kill him. He was son to the broad river Axios and Periboia eldest daughter of Akessamenos; for the river had lain with her. Asteropaios stood up out of the water to face him with a spear in either hand, and Xanthos filled him with courage, being angry for the death of the youths whom Achilles was slaying ruthlessly within his waters. When they were close up with one another Achilles was first to speak. "Who and whence are you," said he, "who dare to face me? Woe to the parents whose son stands up against me." And the son of Pelegon answered, "Great son of Peleus, why should you ask my lineage. I am from the fertile land of far Paeonia, leader of the Paeonians, and it is now eleven days that I am at Ilion. I am of the blood of the river Axios - of Axios that is the fairest of all rivers that run. He begot the famed warrior Pelegon, whose son men call me. Let us now fight, Achilles." Thus did he defy him, and Achilles raised his spear of Pelian

ash. Asteropaios failed with both his spears, for he could use both hands alike; with the one spear he struck Achilles' shield, but did not pierce it, for the layer of gold, gift of the god, stayed the point; with the other spear he grazed the elbow of Achilles! right arm drawing dark blood, but the spear itself went by him and fixed itself in the ground, foiled of its bloody banquet. Then Achilles, fain to kill him, hurled his spear at Asteropaios, but failed to hit him and struck the steep bank of the river, driving the spear half its length into the earth. The son of Peleus then drew his sword and sprang furiously upon him. Asteropaios vainly tried to draw Achilles' spear out of the bank by main force; thrice did he tug at it, trying with all his might to draw it out, and thrice he had to leave off trying; the fourth time he tried to bend and break it, but ere he could do so Achilles smote him with his sword and killed him. He struck him in the belly near the navel, so that all his bowels came gushing out on to the ground, and the darkness of death came over him as he lay gasping. Then Achilles set his foot on his chest and spoiled him of his armor, vaunting over him and saying, "Lie there - begotten of a river though you be, it is hard for you to strive with the offspring of Kronos' son. You declare yourself sprung from the blood of a broad river, but I am of the seed of mighty Zeus. My father is Peleus, son of Aiakos ruler over the many Myrmidons, and Aiakos was the son of Zeus. Therefore as Zeus is mightier than any river that flows into the sea, so are his children stronger than those of any river whatsoever. Moreover you have a great river hard by if he can be of any use to you, but there is no fighting against Zeus the son of Kronos, with whom not even King Akheloos can compare, nor the mighty stream of deep-flowing Okeanos, from whom all rivers and seas with all springs and deep wells proceed; even Okeanos fears the lightnings of great Zeus, and his thunder that comes crashing out of heaven." With this he drew his bronze spear out of the bank, and now that he had killed Asteropaios, he let him lie where he was on the sand, with the dark water flowing over him and the eels and fishes busy nibbling and gnawing the fat that was about his kidneys. Then he went in chase of the Paeonians, who were fleeing along the bank of the river in panic when they saw their leader slain by the hands of the son of Peleus. Therein he slew Thersilokhos, Mydon, Astypylos, Mnesos, Thrasios, Oeneus, and Ophelestes, and he would have slain yet others, had not the river in anger taken human form, and spoken to him from out the deep waters saying, "Achilles, if you excel all in strength, so do you also in wickedness, for the gods are ever with you to protect you: if, then, the son of Kronos has granted it to you to destroy all the Trojans, at any rate drive them out of my stream, and do your grim work on land. My fair waters are now filled with corpses, nor can I find any channel by which I may pour myself into the sea for I am choked with dead, and yet you go on mercilessly slaying. I am in despair, therefore, O leader of your host, trouble me no further." Achilles answered, "So be it, Skamandros, Zeus-descended; but I will never cease dealing out death among the Trojans, till I have pent them up in their city, and made trial of Hektor face to face, that I may learn whether he is to vanquish me, or I him." As he spoke he set upon the Trojans with a fury like that of a daimôn. But the river said to Apollo, "Surely, son of Zeus, lord of the silver bow, you are not obeying the commands of Zeus who charged you straitly that you should stand by the Trojans and defend them, till twilight fades, and darkness is over an the earth." Meanwhile Achilles sprang from the bank into mid-stream, whereon the river raised a high wave and attacked him. He swelled his stream into a torrent, and swept away the many dead whom Achilles had slain and left within his waters. These he cast out on to the land, bellowing like a bull the while, but the living he saved alive, hiding them in his mighty eddies. The great and terrible wave gathered about Achilles, falling upon him and beating on his shield, so that he could not keep his feet; he caught hold of a great elm-tree, but it came up by the roots, and tore away the bank, damming the stream with its thick branches and bridging it all across; whereby Achilles struggled out of the stream, and fled full speed over the plain, for he was afraid.

21.121

καί οἱ ἐπευχόμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντ’ ἀγόρευεν·
ἐνταυθοῖ νῦν κεῖσο μετ’ ἰχθύσιν, οἵ σ’ ὠτειλὴν
αἷμ’ ἀπολιχμήσονται ἀκηδέες· οὐδέ σε μήτηρ
ἐνθεμένη λεχέεσσι γοήσεται, ἀλλὰ Σκάμανδρος
οἴσει δινήεις εἴσω ἁλὸς εὐρέα κόλπον·
θρῴσκων τις κατὰ κῦμα μέλαιναν φρῖχ’ ὑπαΐξει
ἰχθύς, ὅς κε φάγῃσι Λυκάονος ἀργέτα δημόν.
φθείρεσθ’ εἰς ὅ κεν ἄστυ κιχείομεν Ἰλίου ἱρῆς
ὑμεῖς μὲν φεύγοντες, ἐγὼ δ’ ὄπιθεν κεραΐζων.
οὐδ’ ὑμῖν ποταμός περ ἐΰρροος ἀργυροδίνης
ἀρκέσει, ᾧ δὴ δηθὰ πολέας ἱερεύετε ταύρους,
ζωοὺς δ’ ἐν δίνῃσι καθίετε μώνυχας ἵππους.
ἀλλὰ καὶ ὣς ὀλέεσθε κακὸν μόρον, εἰς ὅ κε πάντες
τίσετε Πατρόκλοιο φόνον καὶ λοιγὸν Ἀχαιῶν,
οὓς ἐπὶ νηυσὶ θοῇσιν ἐπέφνετε νόσφιν ἐμεῖο.
ὣς ἄρ’ ἔφη, ποταμὸς δὲ χολώσατο κηρόθι μᾶλλον,
ὅρμηνεν δ’ ἀνὰ θυμὸν ὅπως παύσειε πόνοιο
δῖον Ἀχιλλῆα, Τρώεσσι δὲ λοιγὸν ἀλάλκοι.
τόφρα δὲ Πηλέος υἱὸς ἔχων δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος
Ἀστεροπαίῳ ἐπᾶλτο κατακτάμεναι μενεαίνων
υἱέϊ Πηλεγόνος· τὸν δ’ Ἀξιὸς εὐρυρέεθρος
γείνατο καὶ Περίβοια Ἀκεσσαμενοῖο θυγατρῶν
πρεσβυτάτη· τῇ γάρ ῥα μίγη ποταμὸς βαθυδίνης.
τῷ ῥ’ Ἀχιλεὺς ἐπόρουσεν, ὃ δ’ ἀντίος ἐκ ποταμοῖο
ἔστη ἔχων δύο δοῦρε· μένος δέ οἱ ἐν φρεσὶ θῆκε
Ξάνθος, ἐπεὶ κεχόλωτο δαϊκταμένων αἰζηῶν,
τοὺς Ἀχιλεὺς ἐδάϊζε κατὰ ῥόον οὐδ’ ἐλέαιρεν.
οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντες,
τὸν πρότερος προσέειπε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
τίς πόθεν εἰς ἀνδρῶν ὅ μευ ἔτλης ἀντίος ἐλθεῖν;

21.151

δυστήνων δέ τε παῖδες ἐμῷ μένει ἀντιόωσι.
τὸν δ’ αὖ Πηλεγόνος προσεφώνεε φαίδιμος υἱός·
Πηλεΐδη μεγάθυμε τί ἦ γενεὴν ἐρεείνεις;
εἶμ’ ἐκ Παιονίης ἐριβώλου τηλόθ’ ἐούσης
Παίονας ἄνδρας ἄγων δολιχεγχέας· ἤδε δέ μοι νῦν
ἠὼς ἐνδεκάτη ὅτε Ἴλιον εἰλήλουθα.
αὐτὰρ ἐμοὶ γενεὴ ἐξ Ἀξιοῦ εὐρὺ ῥέοντος
Ἀξιοῦ, ὃς κάλλιστον ὕδωρ ἐπὶ γαῖαν ἵησιν,
ὃς τέκε Πηλεγόνα κλυτὸν ἔγχεϊ· τὸν δ’ ἐμέ φασι
γείνασθαι· νῦν αὖτε μαχώμεθα φαίδιμ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ.
ὣς φάτ’ ἀπειλήσας, ὃ δ’ ἀνέσχετο δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
Πηλιάδα μελίην· ὃ δ’ ἁμαρτῇ δούρασιν ἀμφὶς
ἥρως Ἀστεροπαῖος, ἐπεὶ περιδέξιος ἦεν.
καί ῥ’ ἑτέρῳ μὲν δουρὶ σάκος βάλεν, οὐδὲ διὰ πρὸ
ῥῆξε σάκος· χρυσὸς γὰρ ἐρύκακε δῶρα θεοῖο·
τῷ δ’ ἑτέρῳ μιν πῆχυν ἐπιγράβδην βάλε χειρὸς
δεξιτερῆς, σύτο δ’ αἷμα κελαινεφές· ἣ δ’ ὑπὲρ αὐτοῦ
γαίῃ ἐνεστήρικτο λιλαιομένη χροὸς ἆσαι.

δεύτερος αὖτ’ Ἀχιλεὺς μελίην ἰθυπτίωνα
Ἀστεροπαίῳ ἐφῆκε κατακτάμεναι μενεαίνων.
καὶ τοῦ μέν ῥ’ ἀφάμαρτεν, ὃ δ’ ὑψηλὴν βάλεν ὄχθην,
μεσσοπαγὲς δ’ ἄρ’ ἔθηκε κατ’ ὄχθης μείλινον ἔγχος.
Πηλεΐδης δ’ ἄορ ὀξὺ ἐρυσσάμενος παρὰ μηροῦ
ἅλτ’ ἐπί οἱ μεμαώς· ὃ δ’ ἄρα μελίην Ἀχιλῆος
οὐ δύνατ’ ἐκ κρημνοῖο ἐρύσσαι χειρὶ παχείῃ.
τρὶς μέν μιν πελέμιξεν ἐρύσσασθαι μενεαίνων,
τρὶς δὲ μεθῆκε βίης· τὸ δὲ τέτρατον ἤθελε θυμῷ
ἆξαι ἐπιγνάμψας δόρυ μείλινον Αἰακίδαο,
ἀλλὰ πρὶν Ἀχιλεὺς σχεδὸν ἄορι θυμὸν ἀπηύρα.
γαστέρα γάρ μιν τύψε παρ’ ὀμφαλόν, ἐκ δ’ ἄρα πᾶσαι

21.181

χύντο χαμαὶ χολάδες· τὸν δὲ σκότος ὄσσε κάλυψεν
ἀσθμαίνοντ’· Ἀχιλεὺς δ’ ἄρ’ ἐνὶ στήθεσσιν ὀρούσας
τεύχεά τ’ ἐξενάριξε καὶ εὐχόμενος ἔπος ηὔδα·
κεῖσ’ οὕτως· χαλεπόν τοι ἐρισθενέος Κρονίωνος
παισὶν ἐριζέμεναι ποταμοῖό περ ἐκγεγαῶτι.
φῆσθα σὺ μὲν ποταμοῦ γένος ἔμμεναι εὐρὺ ῥέοντος,
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ γενεὴν μεγάλου Διὸς εὔχομαι εἶναι.
τίκτέ μ’ ἀνὴρ πολλοῖσιν ἀνάσσων Μυρμιδόνεσσι
Πηλεὺς Αἰακίδης· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ Αἰακὸς ἐκ Διὸς ἦεν.
τὼ κρείσσων μὲν Ζεὺς ποταμῶν ἁλιμυρηέντων,
κρείσσων αὖτε Διὸς γενεὴ ποταμοῖο τέτυκται.
καὶ γὰρ σοὶ ποταμός γε πάρα μέγας, εἰ δύναταί τι
χραισμεῖν· ἀλλ’ οὐκ ἔστι Διὶ Κρονίωνι μάχεσθαι,
τῷ οὐδὲ κρείων Ἀχελώϊος ἰσοφαρίζει,
οὐδὲ βαθυρρείταο μέγα σθένος Ὠκεανοῖο,
ἐξ οὗ περ πάντες ποταμοὶ καὶ πᾶσα θάλασσα
καὶ πᾶσαι κρῆναι καὶ φρείατα μακρὰ νάουσιν·
ἀλλὰ καὶ ὃς δείδοικε Διὸς μεγάλοιο κεραυνὸν
δεινήν τε βροντήν, ὅτ’ ἀπ’ οὐρανόθεν σμαραγήσῃ.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἐκ κρημνοῖο ἐρύσσατο χάλκεον ἔγχος,
τὸν δὲ κατ’ αὐτόθι λεῖπεν, ἐπεὶ φίλον ἦτορ ἀπηύρα,
κείμενον ἐν ψαμάθοισι, δίαινε δέ μιν μέλαν ὕδωρ.
τὸν μὲν ἄρ’ ἐγχέλυές τε καὶ ἰχθύες ἀμφεπένοντο
δημὸν ἐρεπτόμενοι ἐπινεφρίδιον κείροντες·
αὐτὰρ ὃ βῆ ῥ’ ἰέναι μετὰ Παίονας ἱπποκορυστάς,
οἵ ῥ’ ἔτι πὰρ ποταμὸν πεφοβήατο δινήεντα,
ὡς εἶδον τὸν ἄριστον ἐνὶ κρατερῇ ὑσμίνῃ
χέρσ’ ὕπο Πηλεΐδαο καὶ ἄορι ἶφι δαμέντα.
ἔνθ’ ἔλε Θερσίλοχόν τε Μύδωνά τε Ἀστύπυλόν τε
Μνῆσόν τε Θρασίον τε καὶ Αἴνιον ἠδ’ Ὀφελέστην·

21.211

καί νύ κ’ ἔτι πλέονας κτάνε Παίονας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς,
εἰ μὴ χωσάμενος προσέφη ποταμὸς βαθυδίνης
ἀνέρι εἰσάμενος, βαθέης δ’ ἐκ φθέγξατο δίνης·
ὦ Ἀχιλεῦ, περὶ μὲν κρατέεις, περὶ δ’ αἴσυλα ῥέζεις

ἀνδρῶν· αἰεὶ γάρ τοι ἀμύνουσιν θεοὶ αὐτοί.
εἴ τοι Τρῶας ἔδωκε Κρόνου παῖς πάντας ὀλέσσαι,
ἐξ ἐμέθεν γ’ ἐλάσας πεδίον κάτα μέρμερα ῥέζε·
πλήθει γὰρ δή μοι νεκύων ἐρατεινὰ ῥέεθρα,
οὐδέ τί πῃ δύναμαι προχέειν ῥόον εἰς ἅλα δῖαν
στεινόμενος νεκύεσσι, σὺ δὲ κτείνεις ἀϊδήλως.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ καὶ ἔασον· ἄγη μ’ ἔχει ὄρχαμε λαῶν.
τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
ἔσται ταῦτα Σκάμανδρε διοτρεφές, ὡς σὺ κελεύεις.
Τρῶας δ’ οὐ πρὶν λήξω ὑπερφιάλους ἐναρίζων,
πρὶν ἔλσαι κατὰ ἄστυ καὶ Ἕκτορι πειρηθῆναι
ἀντιβίην, ἤ κέν με δαμάσσεται, ἦ κεν ἐγὼ τόν.
ὣς εἰπὼν Τρώεσσιν ἐπέσσυτο δαίμονι ἶσος·
καὶ τότ’ Ἀπόλλωνα προσέφη ποταμὸς βαθυδίνης·
ὢ πόποι ἀργυρότοξε Διὸς τέκος οὐ σύ γε βουλὰς
εἰρύσαο Κρονίωνος, ὅ τοι μάλα πόλλ’ ἐπέτελλε
Τρωσὶ παρεστάμεναι καὶ ἀμύνειν, εἰς ὅ κεν ἔλθῃ
δείελος ὀψὲ δύων, σκιάσῃ δ’ ἐρίβωλον ἄρουραν.
ἦ, καὶ Ἀχιλλεὺς μὲν δουρικλυτὸς ἔνθορε μέσσῳ
κρημνοῦ ἀπαΐξας· ὃ δ’ ἐπέσσυτο οἴδματι θύων,
πάντα δ’ ὄρινε ῥέεθρα κυκώμενος, ὦσε δὲ νεκροὺς
πολλούς, οἵ ῥα κατ’ αὐτὸν ἅλις ἔσαν, οὓς κτάν’ Ἀχιλλεύς
τοὺς ἔκβαλλε θύραζε μεμυκὼς ἠΰτε ταῦρος
χέρσον δέ· ζωοὺς δὲ σάω κατὰ καλὰ ῥέεθρα,
κρύπτων ἐν δίνῃσι βαθείῃσιν μεγάλῃσι.
δεινὸν δ’ ἀμφ’ Ἀχιλῆα κυκώμενον ἵστατο κῦμα,

21.241

ὤθει δ’ ἐν σάκεϊ πίπτων ῥόος· οὐδὲ πόδεσσιν
εἶχε στηρίξασθαι· ὃ δὲ πτελέην ἔλε χερσὶν
εὐφυέα μεγάλην· ἣ δ’ ἐκ ῥιζῶν ἐριποῦσα
κρημνὸν ἅπαντα διῶσεν, ἐπέσχε δὲ καλὰ ῥέεθρα
ὄζοισιν πυκινοῖσι, γεφύρωσεν δέ μιν αὐτὸν
εἴσω πᾶσ’ ἐριποῦσ’· ὃ δ’ ἄρ’ ἐκ δίνης ἀνορούσας
ἤϊξεν πεδίοιο ποσὶ κραιπνοῖσι πέτεσθαι
δείσας· οὐδέ τ’ ἔληγε θεὸς μέγας, ὦρτο δ’ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ
ἀκροκελαινιόων, ἵνα μιν παύσειε πόνοιο
δῖον Ἀχιλλῆα, Τρώεσσι δὲ λοιγὸν ἀλάλκοι.
Πηλεΐδης δ’ ἀπόρουσεν ὅσον τ’ ἐπὶ δουρὸς ἐρωή,
αἰετοῦ οἴματ’ ἔχων μέλανος τοῦ θηρητῆρος,
ὅς θ’ ἅμα κάρτιστός τε καὶ ὤκιστος πετεηνῶν·
τῷ ἐϊκὼς ἤϊξεν, ἐπὶ στήθεσσι δὲ χαλκὸς
σμερδαλέον κονάβιζεν· ὕπαιθα δὲ τοῖο λιασθεὶς
φεῦγ’, ὃ δ’ ὄπισθε ῥέων ἕπετο μεγάλῳ ὀρυμαγδῷ.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἀνὴρ ὀχετηγὸς ἀπὸ κρήνης μελανύδρου
ἂμ φυτὰ καὶ κήπους ὕδατι ῥόον ἡγεμονεύῃ
χερσὶ μάκελλαν ἔχων, ἀμάρης ἐξ ἔχματα βάλλων·
τοῦ μέν τε προρέοντος ὑπὸ ψηφῖδες ἅπασαι
ὀχλεῦνται· τὸ δέ τ’ ὦκα κατειβόμενον κελαρύζει
χώρῳ ἔνι προαλεῖ, φθάνει δέ τε καὶ τὸν ἄγοντα·
ὣς αἰεὶ Ἀχιλῆα κιχήσατο κῦμα ῥόοιο

264 καὶ λαιψηρὸν ἐόντα· θεοὶ δέ τε φέρτεροι ἀνδρῶν.
265 ὁσσάκι δ’ ὁρμήσειε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
266 στῆναι ἐναντίβιον καὶ γνώμεναι εἴ μιν ἅπαντες
267 ἀθάνατοι φοβέουσι, τοὶ οὐρανὸν εὐρὺν ἔχουσι,
268 τοσσάκι μιν μέγα κῦμα διιπετέος ποταμοῖο
269 πλάζ’ ὤμους καθύπερθεν· ὃ δ’ ὑψόσε ποσσὶν ἐπήδα
270 θυμῷ ἀνιάζων· ποταμὸς δ’ ὑπὸ γούνατ’ ἐδάμνα
But the mighty god ceased not in his pursuit, and sprang upon him with a dark-crested wave, to keep him out of the struggle [ponos] and save the Trojans from destruction. The son of Peleus darted away a spear's throw from him; swift as the swoop of a black hunter-eagle which is the strongest and fleetest of all birds, even so did he spring forward, and the armor rang loudly about his breast. He fled on in front, but the river with a loud roar came tearing after. As one who would water his garden leads a stream from some fountain over his plants, and all his ground - spade in hand he clears away the dams to free the channels, and the little stones run rolling round and round with the water as it goes merrily down the bank faster than the man can follow- even so did the river keep catching up with Achilles albeit he was a fleet runner, for the gods are stronger than men. As often as he would strive to stand his ground, and see whether or no all the gods in heaven were in league against him, so often would the mighty wave come beating down upon his shoulders, and he would have to keep fleeing on and on in great dismay; for the angry flood was tiring him out as it flowed past him and ate the ground from under his feet. Then the son of Peleus lifted up his voice to heaven saying, "Father Zeus, is there none of the gods who will take pity upon me, and save me from the river? I do not care what may happen to me afterwards. I blame [aitios] none of the other dwellers on Olympus so severely as I do my dear mother, who has beguiled and tricked me. She told me I was to fall under the walls of Troy by the flying arrows of Apollo; would that Hektor, the best man among the Trojans, might there slay me; then should I fall a hero by the hand of a hero; whereas now it seems that I shall come to a most pitiable end, trapped in this river as though I were some swineherd's boy, who gets carried down a torrent while trying to cross it during a storm." As soon as he had spoken thus, Poseidon and Athena came up to him in the likeness of two men, and took him by the hand to reassure him. Poseidon spoke first. "Son of Peleus," said he, "be not so exceeding fearful; we are two gods, come with Zeus' sanction to assist you, I, and Pallas Athena. It is not your fate to perish in this river; he will abate presently as you will see; moreover we strongly advise you, if you will be guided by us, not to stay your hand from fighting till you have pent the Trojan host within the famed walls of Ilion - as many of them as may escape. Then kill Hektor and go back to the ships, for we will grant you a triumph over him." When they had so said they went back to the other immortals, but Achilles strove onward over the plain, encouraged by the charge the gods had laid upon him. All was now covered with the flood of waters, and much goodly armor of the youths that had been slain was rifting about, as also many corpses, but he forced his way against the stream, speeding right onwards, nor could the broad waters stay him, for Athena had endowed him with great strength. Nevertheless Skamandros did not slacken in his pursuit, but was still more furious with the son of Peleus. He lifted his waters into a high crest and cried aloud to Simoeis saying, "Dear brother, let the two of us unite to save this man, or he will sack the mighty city of King Priam, and the Trojans will not hold out against him. Help me at once; fill your streams with water from their sources, rouse all your torrents to a fury; raise your wave on high, and let snags and stones come thundering down you that we may make an end of this savage creature who is now lording it as though he were a god. Nothing shall serve him longer, not strength nor comeliness, nor his fine armor, which indeed shall soon be lying low in the deep waters covered over with mud. I will wrap him in sand, and pour tons of shingle round him, so that the Achaeans shall not know how to gather his bones for the silt in which I

shall have hidden him, and when they celebrate his funeral they need build no tomb [sêma]." On this he upraised his tumultuous flood high against Achilles, seething as it was with foam and blood and the bodies of the dead. The dark waters of the river stood upright and would have overwhelmed the son of Peleus, but Hera, trembling lest Achilles should be swept away in the mighty torrent, lifted her voice on high and called out to Hephaistos her son. "Crook-foot," she cried, "my child, be up and doing, for I deem it is with you that Xanthos is fain to fight; help us at once, kindle a fierce fire; I will then bring up the west and the white south wind in a mighty gale from the sea, that shall bear the flames against the heads and armor of the Trojans and consume them, while you go along the banks of Xanthos burning his trees and wrapping him round with fire. Let him not turn you back neither by fair words nor foul, and slacken not till I shout and tell you. Then you may stay your flames." On this Hephaistos kindled a fierce fire, which broke out first upon the plain and burned the many dead whom Achilles had killed and whose bodies were lying about in great numbers; by this means the plain was dried and the flood stayed. As the north wind, blowing on an orchard that has been sodden with autumn rain, soon dries it, and the heart of the owner is glad - even so the whole plan was dried and the dead bodies were consumed. Then he turned tongues of fire on to the river. He burned the elms the willows and the tamarisks, the lotus also, with the rushes and marshy herbage that grew abundantly by the banks of the river. The eels and fishes that go darting about everywhere in the water, these, too, were sorely harassed by the flames that cunning Hephaistos had kindled, and the river himself was scalded, so that he spoke saying, "Hephaistos, there is no god can hold his own against you. I cannot fight you when you flare out your flames in this way; strive with me no longer. Let Achilles drive the Trojans out of city immediately. What have I to do with quarreling and helping people?"

21.271

λάβρος ὕπαιθα ῥέων, κονίην δ’ ὑπέρεπτε ποδοῖιν.
Πηλεΐδης δ’ ὤμωξεν ἰδὼν εἰς οὐρανὸν εὐρύν·
Ζεῦ πάτερ ὡς οὔ τίς με θεῶν ἐλεεινὸν ὑπέστη
ἐκ ποταμοῖο σαῶσαι· ἔπειτα δὲ καί τι πάθοιμι.
ἄλλος δ’ οὔ τις μοι τόσον αἴτιος Οὐρανιώνων,
ἀλλὰ φίλη μήτηρ, ἥ με ψεύδεσσιν ἔθελγεν·
ἦ μ’ ἔφατο Τρώων ὑπὸ τείχεϊ θωρηκτάων
λαιψηροῖς ὀλέεσθαι Ἀπόλλωνος βελέεσσιν.
ὥς μ’ ὄφελ’ Ἕκτωρ κτεῖναι ὃς ἐνθάδε γ’ ἔτραφ’ ἄριστος·
τώ κ’ ἀγαθὸς μὲν ἔπεφν’, ἀγαθὸν δέ κεν ἐξενάριξε·
νῦν δέ με λευγαλέῳ θανάτῳ εἵμαρτο ἁλῶναι
ἐρχθέντ’ ἐν μεγάλῳ ποταμῷ ὡς παῖδα συφορβόν,
ὅν ῥά τ’ ἔναυλος ἀποέρσῃ χειμῶνι περῶντα.
ὣς φάτο, τῷ δὲ μάλ’ ὦκα Ποσειδάων καὶ Ἀθήνη
στήτην ἐγγὺς ἰόντε, δέμας δ’ ἄνδρεσσιν ἐΐκτην,
χειρὶ δὲ χεῖρα λαβόντες ἐπιστώσαντ’ ἐπέεσσι.
τοῖσι δὲ μύθων ἦρχε Ποσειδάων ἐνοσίχθων·
Πηλεΐδη μήτ’ ἄρ τι λίην τρέε μήτέ τι τάρβει·
τοίω γάρ τοι νῶϊ θεῶν ἐπιταρρόθω εἰμὲν
Ζηνὸς ἐπαινήσαντος ἐγὼ καὶ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη·
ὡς οὔ τοι ποταμῷ γε δαμήμεναι αἴσιμόν ἐστιν,
ἀλλ’ ὅδε μὲν τάχα λωφήσει, σὺ δὲ εἴσεαι αὐτός·
αὐτάρ τοι πυκινῶς ὑποθησόμεθ’ αἴ κε πίθηαι·
μὴ πρὶν παύειν χεῖρας ὁμοιΐου πολέμοιο
πρὶν κατὰ Ἰλιόφι κλυτὰ τείχεα λαὸν ἐέλσαι

296 Τρωϊκόν, ὅς κε φύγῃσι· σὺ δ’ Ἕκτορι θυμὸν ἀπούρας
297 ἂψ ἐπὶ νῆας ἴμεν· δίδομεν δέ τοι εὖχος ἀρέσθαι.
298 τὼ μὲν ἄρ’ ὣς εἰπόντε μετ’ ἀθανάτους ἀπεβήτην·
299 αὐτὰρ ὃ βῆ, μέγα γάρ ῥα θεῶν ὄτρυνεν ἐφετμή,
300 ἐς πεδίον· τὸ δὲ πᾶν πλῆθ’ ὕδατος ἐκχυμένοιο,

21.301

301 πολλὰ δὲ τεύχεα καλὰ δαὶ κταμένων αἰζηῶν
302 πλῶον καὶ νέκυες· τοῦ δ’ ὑψόσε γούνατ’ ἐπήδα
303 πρὸς ῥόον ἀΐσσοντος ἀν’ ἰθύν, οὐδέ μιν ἴσχεν
304 εὐρὺ ῥέων ποταμός· μέγα γὰρ σθένος ἔμβαλ’ Ἀθήνη.
305 οὐδὲ Σκάμανδρος ἔληγε τὸ ὂν μένος, ἀλλ’ ἔτι μᾶλλον
306 χώετο Πηλεΐωνι, κόρυσσε δὲ κῦμα ῥόοιο
307 ὑψόσ’ ἀειρόμενος, Σιμόεντι δὲ κέκλετ’ ἀΰσας·
308 φίλε κασίγνητε σθένος ἀνέρος ἀμφότεροί περ
309 σχῶμεν, ἐπεὶ τάχα ἄστυ μέγα Πριάμοιο ἄνακτος
310 ἐκπέρσει, Τρῶες δὲ κατὰ μόθον οὐ μενέουσιν.
311 ἀλλ’ ἐπάμυνε τάχιστα, καὶ ἐμπίπληθι ῥέεθρα
312 ὕδατος ἐκ πηγέων, πάντας δ’ ὀρόθυνον ἐναύλους,
313 ἵστη δὲ μέγα κῦμα, πολὺν δ’ ὀρυμαγδὸν ὄρινε
314 φιτρῶν καὶ λάων, ἵνα παύσομεν ἄγριον ἄνδρα
315 ὃς δὴ νῦν κρατέει, μέμονεν δ’ ὅ γε ἶσα θεοῖσι.
316 φημὶ γὰρ οὔτε βίην χραισμησέμεν οὔτέ τι εἶδος
317 οὔτε τὰ τεύχεα καλά, τά που μάλα νειόθι λίμνης
318 κείσεθ’ ὑπ’ ἰλύος κεκαλυμμένα· κὰδ δέ μιν αὐτὸν
319 εἰλύσω ψαμάθοισιν ἄλις χέραδος περιχεύας
320 μυρίον, οὐδέ οἱ ὀστέ’ ἐπιστήσονται Ἀχαιοὶ
321 ἀλλέξαι· τόσσην οἱ ἄσιν καθύπερθε καλύψω.
322 αὐτοῦ οἱ καὶ σῆμα τετεύξεται, οὐδέ τί μιν χρεὼ
323 ἔσται τυμβοχόης, ὅτε μιν θάπτωσιν Ἀχαιοί.
324 ἦ, καὶ ἐπῶρτ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ κυκώμενος ὑψόσε θύων
325 μορμύρων ἀφρῷ τε καὶ αἵματι καὶ νεκύεσσι.
326 πορφύρεον δ’ ἄρα κῦμα διιπετέος ποταμοῖο
327 ἵστατ’ ἀειρόμενον, κατὰ δ’ ᾖρεε Πηλεΐωνα·
328 Ἥρη δὲ μέγ’ ἄϋσε περιδείσασ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ
329 μή μιν ἀποέρσειε μέγας ποταμὸς βαθυδίνης,
330 αὐτίκα δ’ Ἥφαιστον προσεφώνεεν ὃν φίλον υἱόν·

21.331

331 ὄρσεο κυλλοπόδιον ἐμὸν τέκος· ἄντα σέθεν γὰρ
332 Ξάνθον δινήεντα μάχῃ ἠΐσκομεν εἶναι·
333 ἀλλ’ ἐπάμυνε τάχιστα, πιφαύσκεο δὲ φλόγα πολλήν.
334 αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ Ζεφύροιο καὶ ἀργεστᾶο Νότοιο
335 εἴσομαι ἐξ ἀλόθεν χαλεπὴν ὄρσουσα θύελλαν,
336 ἥ κεν ἀπὸ Τρώων κεφαλὰς καὶ τεύχεα κήαι
337 φλέγμα κακὸν φορέουσα· σὺ δὲ Ξάνθοιο παρ’ ὄχθας
338 δένδρεα καῖ’, ἐν δ’ αὐτὸν ἴει πυρί· μὴ δέ σε πάμπαν
339 μειλιχίοις ἐπέεσσιν ἀποτρεπέτω καὶ ἀρειῇ·
340 μὴ δὲ πρὶν ἀπόπαυε τεὸν μένος, ἀλλ’ ὁπότ’ ἂν δὴ
341 φθέγξομ’ ἐγὼν ἰάχουσα, τότε σχεῖν ἀκάματον πῦρ.

ὣς ἔφαθ’, Ἥφαιστος δὲ τιτύσκετο θεσπιδαὲς πῦρ.
πρῶτα μὲν ἐν πεδίῳ πῦρ δαίετο, καῖε δὲ νεκροὺς
πολλούς, οἵ ῥα κατ’ αὐτὸν ἅλις ἔσαν, οὓς κτάν’ Ἀχιλλεύς·
πᾶν δ’ ἐξηράνθη πεδίον, σχέτο δ’ ἀγλαὸν ὕδωρ.
ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ὀπωρινὸς Βορέης νεοαρδέ’ ἀλωὴν
αἶψ’ ἀγξηράνῃ· χαίρει δέ μιν ὅς τις ἐθείρῃ·
ὣς ἐξηράνθη πεδίον πᾶν, κὰδ δ’ ἄρα νεκροὺς
κῆεν· ὃ δ’ ἐς ποταμὸν τρέψε φλόγα παμφανόωσαν.
καίοντο πτελέαι τε καὶ ἰτέαι ἠδὲ μυρῖκαι,
καίετο δὲ λωτός τε ἰδὲ θρύον ἠδὲ κύπειρον,
τὰ περὶ καλὰ ῥέεθρα ἅλις ποταμοῖο πεφύκει·
τείροντ’ ἐγχέλυές τε καὶ ἰχθύες οἳ κατὰ δίνας,
οἳ κατὰ καλὰ ῥέεθρα κυβίστων ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα
πνοιῇ τειρόμενοι πολυμήτιος Ἡφαίστοιο.
καίετο δ’ ἳς ποταμοῖο ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζεν·
Ἥφαιστ’, οὔ τις σοί γε θεῶν δύνατ’ ἀντιφερίζειν,
οὐδ’ ἂν ἐγὼ σοί γ’ ὧδε πυρὶ φλεγέθοντι μαχοίμην.
λῆγ’ ἔριδος, Τρῶας δὲ καὶ αὐτίκα δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
ἄστεος ἐξελάσειε· τί μοι ἔριδος καὶ ἀρωγῆς;

21.361

φῆ πυρὶ καιόμενος, ἀνὰ δ’ ἔφλυε καλὰ ῥέεθρα.
ὡς δὲ λέβης ζεῖ ἔνδον ἐπειγόμενος πυρὶ πολλῷ
κνίσην μελδόμενος ἀπαλοτρεφέος σιάλοιο
πάντοθεν ἀμβολάδην, ὑπὸ δὲ ξύλα κάγκανα κεῖται,
ὣς τοῦ καλὰ ῥέεθρα πυρὶ φλέγετο, ζέε δ’ ὕδωρ·
οὐδ’ ἔθελε προρέειν, ἀλλ’ ἴσχετο· τεῖρε δ’ ἀϋτμὴ
Ἡφαίστοιο βίηφι πολύφρονος. αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ Ἥρην
πολλὰ λισσόμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Ἥρη τίπτε σὸς υἱὸς ἐμὸν ῥόον ἔχραε κήδειν
ἐξ ἄλλων; οὐ μέν τοι ἐγὼ τόσον αἴτιός εἰμι
ὅσσον οἱ ἄλλοι πάντες, ὅσοι Τρώεσσιν ἀρωγοί.
ἀλλ’ ἤτοι μὲν ἐγὼν ἀποπαύσομαι εἰ σὺ κελεύεις,
παυέσθω δὲ καὶ οὗτος· ἐγὼ δ’ ἐπὶ καὶ τόδ’ ὀμοῦμαι,
μή ποτ’ ἐπὶ Τρώεσσιν ἀλεξήσειν κακὸν ἦμαρ,
μὴ δ’ ὁπότ’ ἂν Τροίη μαλερῷ πυρὶ πᾶσα δάηται
καιομένη, καίωσι δ’ ἀρήϊοι υἷες Ἀχαιῶν.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ τό γ’ ἄκουσε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη,
αὐτίκ’ ἄρ’ Ἥφαιστον προσεφώνεεν ὃν φίλον υἱόν·
Ἥφαιστε σχέο τέκνον ἀγακλεές· οὐ γὰρ ἔοικεν
ἀθάνατον θεὸν ὧδε βροτῶν ἕνεκα στυφελίζειν.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, Ἥφαιστος δὲ κατέσβεσε θεσπιδαὲς πῦρ,
ἄψορρον δ’ ἄρα κῦμα κατέσσυτο καλὰ ῥέεθρα.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ Ξάνθοιο δάμη μένος, οἳ μὲν ἔπειτα
παυσάσθην, Ἥρη γὰρ ἐρύκακε χωομένη περ·
ἐν δ’ ἄλλοισι θεοῖσιν ἔρις πέσε βεβριθυῖα
ἀργαλέη, δίχα δέ σφιν ἐνὶ φρεσὶ θυμὸς ἄητο·
σὺν δ’ ἔπεσον μεγάλῳ πατάγῳ, βράχε δ’ εὐρεῖα χθών,
ἀμφὶ δὲ σάλπιγξεν μέγας οὐρανός. ἄϊε δὲ Ζεὺς
ἥμενος Οὐλύμπῳ· ἐγέλασσε δέ οἱ φίλον ἦτορ
γηθοσύνῃ, ὅθ’ ὁρᾶτο θεοὺς ἔριδι ξυνιόντας.

He was boiling as he spoke, and all his waters were seething. As a cauldron upon ‘a large fire boils when it is melting the lard of some fatted hog, and the lard keeps bubbling up all over when the dry faggots blaze under it - even so were the goodly waters of Xanthos heated with the fire till they were boiling. He could flow no longer but stayed his stream, so afflicted was he by the blasts of fire which cunning Hephaistos had raised. Then he prayed to Hera and besought her saying, "Hera, why should your son vex my stream with such especial fury? I am not so much responsible [aitios] as all the others are who have been helping the Trojans. I will leave off, since you so desire it, and let son leave off also. Furthermore I swear never again will I do anything to save the Trojans from destruction, not even when all Troy is burning in the flames which the Achaeans will kindle." As soon as Hera heard this she said to her son Hephaistos, "Son Hephaistos, hold now your flames; we ought not to use such violence against a god for the sake of mortals." When she had thus spoken Hephaistos quenched his flames, and the river went back once more into his own fair bed. Xanthos was now beaten, so these two left off fighting, for Hera stayed them though she was still angry; but a furious quarrel broke out among the other gods, for they were of divided counsels. They fell on one another with a mighty uproar - earth groaned, and the spacious firmament rang out as with a blare of trumpets. Zeus heard as he was sitting on Olympus, and laughed for joy when he saw the gods coming to blows among themselves. They were not long about beginning, and Ares piercer of shields opened the battle. Sword in hand he sprang at once upon Athena and reviled her. "Why, vixen," said he, "have you again set the gods by the ears in the pride and haughtiness of your heart? Have you forgotten how you set Diomedes son of Tydeus on to wound me, and yourself took visible spear and drove it into me to the hurt of my fair body? You shall now suffer for what you then did to me." As he spoke he struck her on the terrible tasseled aegis - so terrible that not even can Zeus' lightning pierce it. Here did murderous Ares strike her with his great spear. She drew back and with her strong hand seized a stone that was lying on the plain - great and rugged and black - which men of old had set for the boundary of a field. With this she struck Ares on the neck, and brought him down. Nine roods did he cover in his fall, and his hair was all soiled in the dust, while his armor rang rattling round him. But Athena laughed and vaunted over him saying, "Idiot, have you not learned how far stronger I am than you, but you must still match yourself against me? Thus do your mother's curses now roost upon you, for she is angry and would do you mischief because you have deserted the Achaeans and are helping the Trojans." She then turned her two piercing eyes elsewhere, whereon Zeus' daughter Aphrodite took Ares by the hand and led him away groaning all the time, for it was only with great difficulty that he had come to himself again. When Queen Hera saw her, she said to Athena, "Look, daughter of aegis-bearing Zeus, unweariable, that vixen Aphrodite is again taking Ares through the crowd out of the battle; go after her at once."

21.391

391 ἔνθ’ οἵ γ’ οὐκέτι δηρὸν ἀφέστασαν· ἦρχε γὰρ Ἄρης
392 ῥινοτόρος, καὶ πρῶτος Ἀθηναίῃ ἐπόρουσε
393 χάλκεον ἔγχος ἔχων, καὶ ὀνείδειον φάτο μῦθον·
394 τίπτ’ αὖτ’ ὦ κυνάμυια θεοὺς ἔριδι ξυνελαύνεις
395 θάρσος ἄητον ἔχουσα, μέγας δέ σε θυμὸς ἀνῆκεν;
396 ἦ οὐ μέμνῃ ὅτε Τυδεΐδην Διομήδε’ ἀνῆκας
397 οὐτάμεναι, αὐτὴ δὲ πανόψιον ἔγχος ἐλοῦσα
398 ἰθὺς ἐμεῦ ὦσας, διὰ δὲ χρόα καλὸν ἔδαψας;
399 τώ σ’ αὖ νῦν ὀΐω ἀποτισέμεν ὅσσα ἔοργας.
400 ὣς εἰπὼν οὔτησε κατ’ αἰγίδα θυσσανόεσσαν
401 σμερδαλέην, ἣν οὐδὲ Διὸς δάμνησι κεραυνός·

τῇ μιν Ἄρης οὔτησε μιαιφόνος ἔγχεϊ μακρῷ.
ἣ δ’ ἀναχασσαμένη λίθον εἵλετο χειρὶ παχείῃ
κείμενον ἐν πεδίῳ μέλανα τρηχύν τε μέγαν τε,
τόν ῥ’ ἄνδρες πρότεροι θέσαν ἔμμεναι οὖρον ἀρούρης·
τῷ βάλε θοῦρον Ἄρηα κατ’ αὐχένα, λῦσε δὲ γυῖα.
ἑπτὰ δ’ ἐπέσχε πέλεθρα πεσών, ἐκόνισε δὲ χαίτας,
τεύχεά τ’ ἀμφαράβησε· γέλασσε δὲ Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη,
καί οἱ ἐπευχομένη ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
νηπύτι’ οὐδέ νύ πώ περ ἐπεφράσω ὅσσον ἀρείων
εὔχομ’ ἐγὼν ἔμεναι, ὅτι μοι μένος ἰσοφαρίζεις.
οὕτω κεν τῆς μητρὸς ἐρινύας ἐξαποτίνοις,
ἥ τοι χωομένη κακὰ μήδεται οὕνεκ’ Ἀχαιοὺς
κάλλιπες, αὐτὰρ Τρωσὶν ὑπερφιάλοισιν ἀμύνεις.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσασα πάλιν τρέπεν ὄσσε φαεινώ·
τὸν δ’ ἄγε χειρὸς ἑλοῦσα Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἀφροδίτη
πυκνὰ μάλα στενάχοντα· μόγις δ’ ἐσαγείρετο θυμόν.
τὴν δ’ ὡς οὖν ἐνόησε θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη,
αὐτίκ’ Ἀθηναίην ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
ὢ πόποι αἰγιόχοιο Διὸς τέκος Ἀτρυτώνη

21.421

καὶ δ’ αὖθ’ ἡ κυνάμυια ἄγει βροτολοιγὸν Ἄρηα
δηΐου ἐκ πολέμοιο κατὰ κλόνον· ἀλλὰ μέτελθε.
ὣς φάτ’, Ἀθηναίη δὲ μετέσσυτο, χαῖρε δὲ θυμῷ,
καί ῥ’ ἐπιεισαμένη πρὸς στήθεα χειρὶ παχείῃ
ἤλασε· τῆς δ’ αὐτοῦ λύτο γούνατα καὶ φίλον ἦτορ.
τὼ μὲν ἄρ’ ἄμφω κεῖντο ἐπὶ χθονὶ πουλυβοτείρῃ,
ἣ δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπευχομένη ἔπεα πτερόεντ’ ἀγόρευε·
τοιοῦτοι νῦν πάντες ὅσοι Τρώεσσιν ἀρωγοὶ
εἶεν, ὅτ’ Ἀργείοισι μαχοίατο θωρηκτῇσιν,
ὦδέ τε θαρσαλέοι καὶ τλήμονες, ὡς Ἀφροδίτη
ἦλθεν Ἄρῃ ἐπίκουρος ἐμῷ μένει ἀντιόωσα·
τώ κεν δὴ πάλαι ἄμμες ἐπαυσάμεθα πτολέμοιο
Ἰλίου ἐκπέρσαντες ἐϋκτίμενον πτολίεθρον.
ὣς φάτο, μείδησεν δὲ θεὰ λευκώλενος Ἥρη.
αὐτὰρ Ἀπόλλωνα προσέφη κρείων ἐνοσίχθων·
Φοῖβε τί ἢ δὴ νῶϊ διέσταμεν; οὐδὲ ἔοικεν
ἀρξάντων ἑτέρων· τὸ μὲν αἴσχιον αἴ κ’ ἀμαχητὶ
ἴομεν Οὐλυμπον δὲ Διὸς ποτὶ χαλκοβατὲς δῶ.
ἄρχε· σὺ γὰρ γενεῇφι νεώτερος· οὐ γὰρ ἔμοιγε
καλόν, ἐπεὶ πρότερος γενόμην καὶ πλείονα οἶδα.
νηπύτι’ ὡς ἄνοον κραδίην ἔχες· οὐδέ νυ τῶν περ
μέμνηαι ὅσα δὴ πάθομεν κακὰ Ἴλιον ἀμφὶ
μοῦνοι νῶϊ θεῶν, ὅτ’ ἀγήνορι Λαομέδοντι
πὰρ Διὸς ἐλθόντες θητεύσαμεν εἰς ἐνιαυτὸν
μισθῷ ἔπι ῥητῷ· ὃ δὲ σημαίνων ἐπέτελλεν.
ἤτοι ἐγὼ Τρώεσσι πόλιν πέρι τεῖχος ἔδειμα
εὐρύ τε καὶ μάλα καλόν, ἵν’ ἄρρηκτος πόλις εἴη·
Φοῖβε σὺ δ’ εἰλίποδας ἕλικας βοῦς βουκολέεσκες
Ἴδης ἐν κνημοῖσι πολυπτύχου ὑληέσσης.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ μισθοῖο τέλος πολυγηθέες ὧραι

Thus she spoke. Athena sped after Aphrodite with a will, and made at her, striking her on the bosom with her strong hand so that she fell fainting to the ground, and there they both lay stretched at full length. Then Athena vaunted over her saying, "May all who help the Trojans against the Argives prove just as redoubtable and stalwart as Aphrodite did when she came across me while she was helping Ares. Had this been so, we should long since have ended the war by sacking the strong city of Ilion." Hera smiled as she listened. Meanwhile King Poseidon turned to Apollo saying, "Phoebus, why should we keep each other at arm's length? it is not well, now that the others have begun fighting; it will be disgraceful to us if we return to Zeus' bronze-floored mansion on Olympus without having fought each other; therefore come on, you are the younger of the two, and I ought not to attack you, for I am older and have had more experience. Idiot, you have no sense, and forget how we two alone of all the gods fared hardly round about Ilion when we came from Zeus' house and worked for Laomedon a whole year at a stated wage and he gave us his orders. I built the Trojans the wall about their city, so wide and fair that it might be impregnable, while you, Phoebus, herded cattle for him in the dales of many valleyed Ida. When, however, the glad hours [hôrai] brought round the time-limit [telos] for payment, mighty Laomedon robbed us of all our hire and sent us off with nothing but abuse. He threatened to bind us hand and foot and sell us over into some distant island. He tried, moreover, to cut off the ears of both of us, so we went away in a rage, furious about the payment he had promised us, and yet withheld; in spite of all this, you are now showing favor [kharis] to his people, and will not join us in compassing the utter ruin of the proud Trojans with their wives and children." And King Apollo answered, "Lord of the earthquake, you would not think me moderate [sôphrôn] if I were to fight you about a pack of miserable mortals, who come out like leaves in summer and eat the fruit of the field, and presently fall lifeless to the ground. Let us stay this fighting at once and let them settle it among themselves." He turned away as he spoke, for he would lay no hand on the brother of his own father. But his sister the huntress Artemis, patroness of wild beasts, was very angry with him and said, "So you would flee, Far-Darter, and hand victory over to Poseidon with a cheap vaunt to boot. Baby, why keep your bow thus idle? Never let me again hear you bragging in my father's house, as you have often done in the presence of the immortals, that you would stand up and fight with Poseidon." Apollo made her no answer, but Zeus' august queen was angry and upbraided her bitterly. "Bold vixen," she cried, "how dare you cross me thus? For all your bow you will find it hard to hold your own against me. Zeus made you as a lion among women, and lets you kill them whenever you choose. You will And it better to chase wild beasts and deer upon the mountains than to fight those who are stronger than you are. If you would try war, do so, and find out by pitting yourself against me, how far stronger I am than you are." She caught both Artemis' wrists with her left hand as she spoke, and with her right she took the bow from her shoulders, and laughed as she beat her with it about the ears while Artemis wriggled and writhed under her blows. Her swift arrows were shed upon the ground, and she fled weeping from under Hera's hand as a dove that flies before a falcon to the cleft of some hollow rock, when it is her good fortune to escape. Even so did she flee weeping away, leaving her bow and arrows behind her. Then the slayer of Argos, guide and guardian, said to Leto, "Leto, I shall not fight you; it is ill to come to blows with any of Zeus' wives. Therefore boast as you will among the immortals that you worsted me in fair fight."

21.451

451 ἐξέφερον, τότε νῶϊ βιήσατο μισθὸν ἅπαντα
452 Λαομέδων ἔκπαγλος, ἀπειλήσας δ’ ἀπέπεμπε.
453 σὺν μὲν ὅ γ’ ἠπείλησε πόδας καὶ χεῖρας ὕπερθε
454 δήσειν, καὶ περάαν νήσων ἔπι τηλεδαπάων·

στεῦτο δ’ ὅ γ’ ἀμφοτέρων ἀπολεψέμεν οὔατα χαλκῷ.
νῶϊ δὲ ἄψορροι κίομεν κεκοτηότι θυμῷ
μισθοῦ χωόμενοι, τὸν ὑποστὰς οὐκ ἐτέλεσσε.
τοῦ δὴ νῦν λαοῖσι φέρεις χάριν, οὐδὲ μεθ’ ἡμέων
πειρᾷ ὥς κε Τρῶες ὑπερφίαλοι ἀπόλωνται
πρόχνυ κακῶς σὺν παισὶ καὶ αἰδοίῃς ἀλόχοισι
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν ἄναξ ἑκάεργος Ἀπόλλων·
ἐννοσίγαι’ οὐκ ἄν με σαόφρονα μυθήσαιο
ἔμμεναι, εἰ δὴ σοί γε βροτῶν ἕνεκα πτολεμίξω
δειλῶν, οἳ φύλλοισιν ἐοικότες ἄλλοτε μέν τε
ζαφλεγέες τελέθουσιν ἀρούρης καρπὸν ἔδοντες,
ἄλλοτε δὲ φθινύθουσιν ἀκήριοι. ἀλλὰ τάχιστα
παυώμεσθα μάχης· οἳ δ’ αὐτοὶ δηριαάσθων.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας πάλιν ἐτράπετ’· αἴδετο γάρ ῥα
πατροκασιγνήτοιο μιγήμεναι ἐν παλάμῃσι.
τὸν δὲ κασιγνήτη μάλα νείκεσε πότνια θηρῶν
Ἄρτεμις ἀγροτέρη, καὶ ὀνείδειον φάτο μῦθον·
φεύγεις δὴ ἑκάεργε, Ποσειδάωνι δὲ νίκην
πᾶσαν ἐπέτρεψας, μέλεον δέ οἱ εὖχος ἔδωκας·
νηπύτιε τί νυ τόξον ἔχεις ἀνεμώλιον αὔτως;
μή σευ νῦν ἔτι πατρὸς ἐνὶ μεγάροισιν ἀκούσω
εὐχομένου, ὡς τὸ πρὶν ἐν ἀθανάτοισι θεοῖσιν,
ἄντα Ποσειδάωνος ἐναντίβιον πολεμίζειν.
ὣς φάτο, τὴν δ’ οὔ τι προσέφη ἑκάεργος Ἀπόλλων,
ἀλλὰ χολωσαμένη Διὸς αἰδοίη παράκοιτις
νείκεσεν ἰοχέαιραν ὀνειδείοις ἐπέεσσι·

21.481

πῶς δὲ σὺ νῦν μέμονας κύον ἀδεὲς ἀντί’ ἐμεῖο
στήσεσθαι; χαλεπή τοι ἐγὼ μένος ἀντιφέρεσθαι
τοξοφόρῳ περ ἐούσῃ, ἐπεὶ σὲ λέοντα γυναιξὶ
Ζεὺς θῆκεν, καὶ ἔδωκε κατακτάμεν ἥν κ’ ἐθέλῃσθα.
ἦτοι βέλτερόν ἐστι κατ’ οὔρεα θῆρας ἐναίρειν
ἀγροτέρας τ’ ἐλάφους ἢ κρείσσοσιν ἶφι μάχεσθαι.
εἰ δ’ ἐθέλεις πολέμοιο δαήμεναι, ὄφρ’ ἐῢ εἰδῇς
ὅσσον φερτέρη εἶμ’, ὅτι μοι μένος ἀντιφερίζεις.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἀμφοτέρας ἐπὶ καρπῷ χεῖρας ἔμαρπτε
σκαιῇ, δεξιτερῇ δ’ ἄρ’ ἀπ’ ὤμων αἶνυτο τόξα,
αὐτοῖσιν δ’ ἄρ’ ἔθεινε παρ’ οὔατα μειδιόωσα
ἐντροπαλιζομένην· ταχέες δ’ ἔκπιπτον ὀϊστοί.
δακρυόεσσα δ’ ὕπαιθα θεὰ φύγεν ὥς τε πέλεια,
ἥ ῥά θ’ ὑπ’ ἴρηκος κοίλην εἰσέπτατο πέτρην
χηραμόν· οὐδ’ ἄρα τῇ γε ἀλώμεναι αἴσιμον ἦεν·
ὣς ἣ δακρυόεσσα φύγεν, λίπε δ’ αὐτόθι τόξα.
Λητὼ δὲ προσέειπε διάκτορος ἀργεϊφόντης·
Λητοῖ ἐγὼ δέ τοι οὔ τι μαχήσομαι· ἀργαλέον δὲ
πληκτίζεσθ’ ἀλόχοισι Διὸς νεφεληγερέταο·
ἀλλὰ μάλα πρόφρασσα μετ’ ἀθανάτοισι θεοῖσιν
εὔχεσθαι ἐμὲ νικῆσαι κρατερῇφι βίηφιν.
ὣς ἄρ’ ἔφη, Λητὼ δὲ συναίνυτο καμπύλα τόξα
πεπτεῶτ’ ἄλλυδις ἄλλα μετὰ στροφάλιγγι κονίης.

504 ἣ μὲν τόξα λαβοῦσα πάλιν κίε θυγατέρος ἧς·
505 ἣ δ’ ἄρ’ Ὄλυμπον ἵκανε Διὸς ποτὶ χαλκοβατὲς δῶ,
506 δακρυόεσσα δὲ πατρὸς ἐφέζετο γούνασι κούρη,
507 ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ ἀμβρόσιος ἑανὸς τρέμε· τὴν δὲ προτὶ οἷ
508 εἷλε πατὴρ Κρονίδης, καὶ ἀνείρετο ἡδὺ γελάσσας·
509 τίς νύ σε τοιάδ’ ἔρεξε φίλον τέκος Οὐρανιώνων
510 μαψιδίως, ὡς εἴ τι κακὸν ῥέζουσαν ἐνωπῇ;
Leto then gathered up Artemis' bow and arrows that had fallen about amid the whirling dust, and when she had got them she made all haste after her daughter. Artemis had now reached Zeus' bronze-floored mansion on Olympus, and sat herself down with many tears on the knees of her father, while her ambrosial raiment was quivering all about her. The son of Kronos drew her towards him, and laughing pleasantly the while began to question her saying, "Which of the heavenly beings, my dear child, has been treating you in this cruel manner, as though you had been misconducting yourself in the face of everybody?" and the fair-crowned goddess of the chase answered, "It was your wife Hera, father, who has been beating me; it is always her doing when there is any quarreling among the immortals." Thus did they converse, and meanwhile Phoebus Apollo entered the strong city of Ilion, for he was uneasy lest the wall should not hold out and the Danaans should take the city then and there, before its hour had come; but the rest of the ever-living gods went back, some angry and some triumphant to Olympus, where they took their seats beside Zeus lord of the storm cloud, while Achilles still kept on dealing out death alike on the Trojans and on their As when the smoke from some burning city ascends to heaven when the anger [mênis] of the gods has kindled it - there is then toil [ponos] for all, and sorrow for not a few - even so did Achilles bring toil [ponos] and sorrow on the Trojans. Old King Priam stood on a high tower of the wall looking down on huge Achilles as the Trojans fled panic-stricken before him, and there was none to help them. Presently he came down from off the tower and with many a groan went along the wall to give orders to the brave warders of the gate. "Keep the gates," said he, "wide open till the people come fleeing into the city, for Achilles is hard by and is driving them in rout before him. I see we are in great peril. As soon as our people are inside and in safety, close the strong gates for I fear lest that terrible man should come bounding inside along with the others." As he spoke they drew back the bolts and opened the gates, and when these were opened there was a haven of refuge for the Trojans. Apollo then came full speed out of the city to meet them and protect them. Right for the city and the high wall, parched with thirst and grimy with dust, still they hurried on, with Achilles wielding his spear furiously behind them. For he was as one possessed, and was thirsting after glory. Then had the sons of the Achaeans taken the lofty gates of Troy if Apollo had not spurred on Agenor, valiant and noble son to Antenor. He put courage into his heart, and stood by his side to guard him, leaning against a beech tree and shrouded in thick darkness. When Agenor saw Achilles he stood still and his heart was clouded with care. "Alas," said he to himself in his dismay, "if I flee before mighty Achilles, and go where all the others are being driven in rout, he will none the less catch me and kill me for a coward. How would it be were I to let Achilles drive the others before him, and then flee from the wall to the plain that is behind Ilion till I reach the spurs of Ida and can hide in the underwood that is thereon? I could then wash the sweat from off me in the river and in the evening return to Ilion. But why commune with myself in this way? Like enough he would see me as I am hurrying from the city over the plain, and would speed after me till he had caught me - I should stand no chance against him, for he is mightiest of all humankind. What, then, if I go out and meet him in front of the city? His flesh too, I take it, can be pierced by pointed bronze. Life [psukhê] is the same in one and all, and men say that he is but mortal despite the triumph that Zeus son of Kronos grants him." So saying he stood on his guard and awaited Achilles, for he was now fain to fight him. As a leopardess

that bounds from out a thick covert to attack a hunter - she knows no fear and is not dismayed by the baying of the hounds; even though the man be too quick for her and wound her either with thrust or spear, still, though the spear has pierced her she will not give in till she has either caught him in her grip or been killed outright - even so did noble Agenor son of Antenor refuse to flee till he had made trial of Achilles, and took aim at him with his spear, holding his round shield before him and crying with a loud voice. "Of a truth," said he, "noble Achilles, you deem that you shall this day sack the city of the proud Trojans. Fool, there will be trouble enough yet before it, for there is many a brave man of us still inside who will stand in front of our dear parents with our wives and children, to defend Ilion. Here therefore, huge and mighty warrior though you be, here shall you cue. As he spoke his strong hand hurled his javelin from him, and the spear struck Achilles on the leg beneath the knee; the greave of newly wrought tin rang loudly, but the spear recoiled from the body of him whom it had struck, and did not pierce it, for the gods gift stayed it. Achilles in his turn attacked noble Agenor, but Apollo would not grant him glory,

21.511

511 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπεν ἐϋστέφανος κελαδεινή·
512 σή μ’ ἄλοχος στυφέλιξε πάτερ λευκώλενος Ἥρη,
513 ἐξ ἧς ἀθανάτοισιν ἔρις καὶ νεῖκος ἐφῆπται.
514 ὣς οἳ μὲν τοιαῦτα πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἀγόρευον·
515 αὐτὰρ Ἀπόλλων Φοῖβος ἐδύσετο Ἴλιον ἱρήν·
516 μέμβλετο γάρ οἱ τεῖχος ἐϋδμήτοιο πόληος
517 μὴ Δαναοὶ πέρσειαν ὑπὲρ μόρον ἤματι κείνῳ.
518 οἳ δ’ ἄλλοι πρὸς Ὄλυμπον ἴσαν θεοὶ αἰὲν ἐόντες,
519 οἳ μὲν χωόμενοι, οἳ δὲ μέγα κυδιόωντες·
520 κὰδ δ’ ἵζον παρὰ πατρὶ κελαινεφεῖ· αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
521 Τρῶας ὁμῶς αὐτούς τ’ ὄλεκεν καὶ μώνυχας ἵππους.
522 ὡς δ’ ὅτε καπνὸς ἰὼν εἰς οὐρανὸν εὐρὺν ἵκηται
523 ἄστεος αἰθομένοιο, θεῶν δέ ἑ μῆνις ἀνῆκε,
524 πᾶσι δ’ ἔθηκε πόνον, πολλοῖσι δὲ κήδε’ ἐφῆκεν,
525 ὣς Ἀχιλεὺς Τρώεσσι πόνον καὶ κήδε’ ἔθηκεν.
526 ἑστήκει δ’ ὃ γέρων Πρίαμος θείου ἐπὶ πύργου,
527 ἐς δ’ ἐνόησ’ Ἀχιλῆα πελώριον· αὐτὰρ ὑπ’ αὐτοῦ
528 Τρῶες ἄφαρ κλονέοντο πεφυζότες, οὐδέ τις ἀλκὴ
529 γίγνεθ’· ὃ δ’ οἰμώξας ἀπὸ πύργου βαῖνε χαμᾶζε
530 ὀτρύνων παρὰ τεῖχος ἀγακλειτοὺς πυλαωρούς·
531 πεπταμένας ἐν χερσὶ πύλας ἔχετ’ εἰς ὅ κε λαοὶ
532 ἔλθωσι προτὶ ἄστυ πεφυζότες· ἦ γὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
533 ἐγγὺς ὅδε κλονέων· νῦν οἷω λοίγι’ ἔσεσθαι.
534 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί κ’ ἐς τεῖχος ἀναπνεύσωσιν ἀλέντες,
535 αὖτις ἐπανθέμεναι σανίδας πυκινῶς ἀραρυίας·
536 δείδια γὰρ μὴ οὖλος ἀνὴρ ἐς τεῖχος ἅληται.
537 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄνεσάν τε πύλας καὶ ἀπῶσαν ὀχῆας·
538 αἳ δὲ πετασθεῖσαι τεῦξαν φάος· αὐτὰρ Ἀπόλλων
539 ἀντίος ἐξέθορε Τρώων ἵνα λοιγὸν ἀλάλκοι.
540 οἳ δ’ ἰθὺς πόλιος καὶ τείχεος ὑψηλοῖο

21.541

541 δίψῃ καρχαλέοι κεκονιμένοι ἐκ πεδίοιο
542 φεῦγον· ὃ δὲ σφεδανὸν ἔφεπ’ ἔγχεϊ, λύσσα δέ οἱ κῆρ

αἰὲν ἔχε κρατερή, μενέαινε δὲ κῦδος ἀρέσθαι.
ἔνθά κεν ὑψίπυλον Τροίην ἕλον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν,
εἰ μὴ Ἀπόλλων Φοῖβος Ἀγήνορα δῖον ἀνῆκε
φῶτ᾽ Ἀντήνορος υἱὸν ἀμύμονά τε κρατερόν τε.
ἐν μέν οἱ κραδίῃ θάρσος βάλε, πὰρ δέ οἱ αὐτὸς
ἔστη, ὅπως θανάτοιο βαρείας χεῖρας ἀλάλκοι
φηγῷ κεκλιμένος· κεκάλυπτο δ᾽ ἄρ᾽ ἠέρι πολλῇ.
αὐτὰρ ὅ γ᾽ ὡς ἐνόησεν Ἀχιλλῆα πτολίπορθον
ἔστη, πολλὰ δέ οἱ κραδίη πόρφυρε μένοντι·
ὀχθήσας δ᾽ ἄρα εἶπε πρὸς ὃν μεγαλήτορα θυμόν·
ὤ μοι ἐγών· εἰ μέν κεν ὑπὸ κρατεροῦ Ἀχιλῆος
φεύγω, τῇ περ οἱ ἄλλοι ἀτυζόμενοι κλονέονται,
αἰρήσει με καὶ ὦς, καὶ ἀνάλκιδα δειροτομήσει.
εἰ δ᾽ ἂν ἐγὼ τούτους μὲν ὑποκλονέεσθαι ἐάσω
Πηλεΐδῃ Ἀχιλῆϊ, ποσὶν δ᾽ ἀπὸ τείχεος ἄλλῃ
φεύγω πρὸς πεδίον Ἰλήϊον, ὄφρ᾽ ἂν ἵκωμαι
Ἴδης τε κνημοὺς κατά τε ῥωπήϊα δύω·
ἐσπέριος δ᾽ ἂν ἔπειτα λοεσσάμενος ποταμοῖο
ἱδρῶ ἀποψυχθεὶς προτὶ Ἴλιον ἀπονεοίμην·
ἀλλὰ τί ἤ μοι ταῦτα φίλος διελέξατο θυμός;
μή μ᾽ ἀπαειρόμενον πόλιος πεδίον δὲ νοήσῃ
καί με μεταΐξας μάρψῃ ταχέεσσι πόδεσσιν.
οὐκέτ᾽ ἔπειτ᾽ ἔσται θάνατον καὶ κῆρας ἀλύξαι·
λίην γὰρ κρατερὸς περὶ πάντων ἔστ᾽ ἀνθρώπων.
εἰ δέ κέ οἱ προπάροιθε πόλεος κατεναντίον ἔλθω·
καὶ γάρ θην τούτῳ τρωτὸς χρὼς ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ,
ἐν δὲ ἴα ψυχή, θνητὸν δέ ἕ φασ᾽ ἄνθρωποι
ἔμμεναι· αὐτάρ οἱ Κρονίδης Ζεὺς κῦδος ὀπάζει.

21.571

ὣς εἰπὼν Ἀχιλῆα ἀλεὶς μένεν, ἐν δέ οἱ ἦτορ
ἄλκιμον ὁρμᾶτο πτολεμίζειν ἠδὲ μάχεσθαι.
ἠΰτε πάρδαλις εἶσι βαθείης ἐκ ξυλόχοιο
ἀνδρὸς θηρητῆρος ἐναντίον, οὐδέ τι θυμῷ
ταρβεῖ οὐδὲ φοβεῖται, ἐπεί κεν ὑλαγμὸν ἀκούσῃ·
εἴ περ γὰρ φθάμενός μιν ἢ οὐτάσῃ ἠὲ βάλῃσιν,
ἀλλά τε καὶ περὶ δουρὶ πεπαρμένη οὐκ ἀπολήγει
ἀλκῆς, πρίν γ᾽ ἠὲ ξυμβλήμεναι ἠὲ δαμῆναι·
ὣς Ἀντήνορος υἱὸς ἀγαυοῦ δῖος Ἀγήνωρ
οὐκ ἔθελεν φεύγειν, πρὶν πειρήσαιτ᾽ Ἀχιλῆος.
ἀλλ᾽ ὅ γ᾽ ἄρ᾽ ἀσπίδα μὲν πρόσθ᾽ ἔσχετο πάντοσ᾽ ἐΐσην,
ἐγχείῃ δ᾽ αὐτοῖο τιτύσκετο, καὶ μέγ᾽ ἀΰτει·
ἦ δή που μάλ᾽ ἔολπας ἐνὶ φρεσὶ φαίδιμ᾽ Ἀχιλλεῦ
ἤματι τῷδε πόλιν πέρσειν Τρώων ἀγερώχων
νηπύτι᾽· ἦ τ᾽ ἔτι πολλὰ τετεύξεται ἄλγε᾽ ἐπ᾽ αὐτῇ.
ἐν γάρ οἱ πολέες τε καὶ ἄλκιμοι ἀνέρες εἰμέν,
οἳ καὶ πρόσθε φίλων τοκέων ἀλόχων τε καὶ υἱῶν
Ἴλιον εἰρυόμεσθα· σὺ δ᾽ ἐνθάδε πότμον ἐφέψεις
ὦδ᾽ ἔκπαγλος ἐὼν καὶ θαρσαλέος πολεμιστής.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ὀξὺν ἄκοντα βαρείης χειρὸς ἀφῆκε,
καί ῥ᾽ ἔβαλε κνήμην ὑπὸ γούνατος οὐδ᾽ ἀφάμαρτεν.

592 ἀμφὶ δέ οἱ κνημὶς νεοτεύκτου κασσιτέροιο
593 σμερδαλέον κονάβησε· πάλιν δ’ ἀπὸ χαλκὸς ὄρουσε
594 βλημένου, οὐδ’ ἐπέρησε, θεοῦ δ’ ἠρύκακε δῶρα.
595 Πηλεΐδης δ’ ὁρμήσατ’ Ἀγήνορος ἀντιθέοιο
596 δεύτερος· οὐδ’ ἔτ’ ἔασεν Ἀπόλλων κῦδος ἀρέσθαι,
597 ἀλλά μιν ἐξήρπαξε, κάλυψε δ’ ἄρ’ ἠέρι πολλῇ,
598 ἡσύχιον δ’ ἄρα μιν πολέμου ἔκπεμπε νέεσθαι.
599 αὐτὰρ ὃ Πηλεΐωνα δόλῳ ἀποέργαθε λαοῦ·
600 αὐτῷ γὰρ ἐκάεργος Ἀγήνορι πάντα ἐοικὼς
for he snatched Agenor away and hid him in a thick mist, sending him out of the battle unmolested Then he craftily drew the son of Peleus away from going after the host, for he put on the semblance of Agenor and stood in front of Achilles, who ran towards him to give him chase and pursued him over the wheat lands of the plain, turning him towards the deep waters of the river Skamandros. Apollo ran but a little way before him and beguiled Achilles by making him think all the time that he was on the point of overtaking him. Meanwhile the rabble of routed Trojans was thankful to crowd within the city till their numbers thronged it; no longer did they dare wait for one another outside the city walls, to learn who had escaped and who were fallen in fight, but all whose feet and knees could still carry them poured pell-mell into the town.

21.601

601 ἔστη πρόσθε ποδῶν, ὃ δ’ ἐπέσσυτο ποσσὶ διώκειν·
602 εἶος ὃ τὸν πεδίοιο διώκετο πυροφόροιο
603 τρέψας πὰρ ποταμὸν βαθυδινήεντα Σκάμανδρον
604 τυτθὸν ὑπεκπροθέοντα· δόλῳ δ’ ἄρ’ ἔθελγεν Ἀπόλλων
605 ὡς αἰεὶ ἔλποιτο κιχήσεσθαι ποσὶν οἷσι·
606 τόφρ’ ἄλλοι Τρῶες πεφοβημένοι ἦλθον ὁμίλῳ
607 ἀσπάσιοι προτὶ ἄστυ, πόλις δ’ ἔμπλητο ἀλέντων.
608 οὐδ’ ἄρα τοί γ’ ἔτλαν πόλιος καὶ τείχεος ἐκτὸς
609 μεῖναι ἔτ’ ἀλλήλους, καὶ γνώμεναι ὅς τε πεφεύγοι
610 ὅς τ’ ἔθαν’ ἐν πολέμῳ· ἀλλ’ ἐσσυμένως ἐσέχυντο
611 ἐς πόλιν, ὅν τινα τῶν γε πόδες καὶ γοῦνα σαώσαι.

22.1

1 ὣς οἳ μὲν κατὰ ἄστυ πεφυζότες ἠΰτε νεβροὶ
2 ἱδρῷ ἀπεψύχοντο πίον τ’ ἀκέοντό τε δίψαν
3 κεκλιμένοι καλῇσιν ἐπάλξεσιν· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
4 τείχεος ἆσσον ἴσαν σάκε’ ὤμοισι κλίναντες.
5 Ἕκτορα δ’ αὐτοῦ μεῖναι ὁλοιὴ μοῖρα πέδησεν
6 Ἰλίου προπάροιθε πυλάων τε Σκαιάων.
7 αὐτὰρ Πηλείωνα προσηύδα Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων·
8 τίπτέ με Πηλέος υἱὲ ποσὶν ταχέεσσι διώκεις
9 αὐτὸς θνητὸς ἐὼν θεὸν ἄμβροτον; οὐδέ νύ πώ με
10 ἔγνως ὡς θεός εἰμι, σὺ δ’ ἀσπερχὲς μενεαίνεις.
11 ἦ νύ τοι οὔ τι μέλει Τρώων πόνος, οὓς ἐφόβησας,
12 οἳ δή τοι εἰς ἄστυ ἄλεν, σὺ δὲ δεῦρο λιάσθης.
13 οὐ μέν με κτενέεις, ἐπεὶ οὔ τοι μόρσιμός εἰμι.
14 τὸν δὲ μέγ’ ὀχθήσας προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
15 ἔβλαψάς μ’ ἑκάεργε θεῶν ὀλοώτατε πάντων
16 ἐνθάδε νῦν τρέψας ἀπὸ τείχεος· ἦ κ’ ἔτι πολλοὶ

17 γαῖαν ὀδὰξ εἷλον πρὶν Ἴλιον εἰσαφικέσθαι.
18 νῦν δ’ ἐμὲ μὲν μέγα κῦδος ἀφείλεο, τοὺς δὲ σάωσας
19 ῥηϊδίως, ἐπεὶ οὔ τι τίσιν γ’ ἔδεισας ὀπίσσω.
20 ἦ σ’ ἂν τισαίμην, εἴ μοι δύναμίς γε παρείη.
21 ὣς εἰπὼν προτὶ ἄστυ μέγα φρονέων ἐβεβήκει,
22 σευάμενος ὥς θ’ ἵππος ἀεθλοφόρος σὺν ὄχεσφιν,
23 ὅς ῥά τε ῥεῖα θέῃσι τιταινόμενος πεδίοιο·
24 ὣς Ἀχιλεὺς λαιψηρὰ πόδας καὶ γούνατ’ ἐνώμα.
25 τὸν δ’ ὃ γέρων Πρίαμος πρῶτος ἴδεν ὀφθαλμοῖσι
26 παμφαίνονθ’ ὥς τ’ ἀστέρ’ ἐπεσσύμενον πεδίοιο,
27 ὅς ῥά τ’ ὀπώρης εἶσιν, ἀρίζηλοι δέ οἱ αὐγαὶ
28 φαίνονται πολλοῖσι μετ’ ἀστράσι νυκτὸς ἀμολγῷ,
29 ὅν τε κύν’ Ὠρίωνος ἐπίκλησιν καλέουσι.
30 λαμπρότατος μὲν ὅ γ’ ἐστί, κακὸν δέ τε σῆμα τέτυκται,
Thus the Trojans in the city, scared like fawns, wiped the sweat from off them and drank to quench their thirst, leaning against the goodly battlements, while the Achaeans with their shields laid upon their shoulders drew close up to the walls. But stern fate bade Hektor stay where he was before Ilion and the Scaean gates. Then Phoebus Apollo spoke to the son of Peleus saying, "Why, son of Peleus, do you, who are but man, give chase to me who am immortal? Have you not yet found out that it is a god whom you pursue so furiously? You did not inflict struggles [ponos] on the Trojans whom you had routed, and now they are within their walls, while you have been decoyed hither away from them. Me you cannot kill, for death can take no hold upon me." Achilles was greatly angered and said, "You have baulked me, Far-Darter, most malicious of all gods, and have drawn me away from the wall, where many another man would have bitten the dust ere he got within Ilion; you have robbed me of great glory and have saved the Trojans at no risk to yourself, for you have nothing to fear, but I would indeed have my revenge if it were in my power to do so." On this, with fell intent he made towards the city, and as the winning horse in a chariot race strains every nerve when he is flying over the plain, even so fast and furiously did the limbs of Achilles bear him onwards. King Priam was first to note him as he scoured the plain, all radiant as the star which men call Orion's Hound, and whose beams blaze forth in time of harvest more brilliantly than those of any other that shines by night; brightest of them all though he be, he yet sends an ill sign [sêma] for mortals, for he brings fire and fever in his train - even so did Achilles' armor gleam on his breast as he sped onwards. Priam raised a cry and beat his head with his hands as he lifted them up and shouted out to his dear son, imploring him to return; but Hektor still stayed before the gates, for his heart was set upon doing battle with Achilles. The old man reached out his arms towards him and bade him for pity's sake come within the walls. "Hektor," he cried, "my son, stay not to face this man alone and unsupported, or you will meet death at the hands of the son of Peleus, for he is mightier than you. Monster that he is; would indeed that the gods loved him no better than I do, for so, dogs and vultures would soon devour him as he lay stretched on earth, and a load of grief [akhos] would be lifted from my heart, for many a brave son has he reft from me, either by killing them or selling them away in the islands that are beyond the sea: even now I miss two sons from among the Trojans who have thronged within the city, Lykaon and Polydoros, whom Laothoe peeress among women bore me. Should they be still alive and in the hands of the Achaeans, we will ransom them with gold and bronze, of which we have store, for the old man Altes endowed his daughter richly; but if they are already dead and in the house of Hades, sorrow will it be to us two who were their parents; albeit the grief of others will be more short-lived unless you too perish at the hands of Achilles. Come, then, my son, within the city, to be the guardian of Trojan men and Trojan women, or you will both lose your own life and afford a mighty triumph to the son of Peleus. Have pity also on

your unhappy father while life yet remains to him - on me, whom the son of Kronos will destroy by a terrible doom on the threshold of old age, after I have seen my sons slain and my daughters haled away as captives, my bridal chambers pillaged, little children dashed to earth amid the rage of battle, and my sons' wives dragged away by the cruel hands of the Achaeans; in the end fierce hounds will tear me in pieces at my own gates after some one has beaten the life out of my body with sword or spear-hounds that I myself reared and fed at my own table to guard my gates, but who will yet lap my blood and then lie all distraught at my doors. When a young man falls by the sword in battle, he may lie where he is and there is nothing unseemly; let what will be seen, all is honorable in death, but when an old man is slain there is nothing in this world more pitiable than that dogs should defile his gray hair and beard and all that men hide for shame [aidôs]." The old man tore his gray hair as he spoke, but he moved not the heart of Hektor. His mother hard by wept and moaned aloud as she bared her bosom and pointed to the breast which had suckled him. "Hektor," she cried, weeping bitterly the while, "Hektor, my son, spurn not this breast, but have pity upon me too: if I have ever given you comfort from my own bosom, think on it now, dear son, and come within the wall to protect us from this man; stand not without to meet him. Should the wretch kill you, neither I nor your richly dowered wife shall ever weep, dear offshoot of myself, over the bed on which you lie, for dogs will devour you at the ships of the Achaeans." Thus did the two with many tears implore their son, but they moved not the heart of Hektor, and he stood his ground awaiting huge Achilles as he drew nearer towards him. As serpent in its den upon the mountains, full fed with deadly poisons, waits for the approach of man - he is filled with fury and his eyes glare terribly as he goes writhing round his den - even so Hektor leaned his shield against a tower that jutted out from the wall and stood where he was, undaunted. "Alas," said he to himself in the heaviness of his heart, "if I go within the gates, Polydamas will be the first to heap reproach upon me, for it was he that urged me to lead the Trojans back to the city on that awful night when Achilles again came forth against us. I would not listen, but it would have been indeed better if I had done so. Now that my folly has destroyed the host, I dare not look Trojan men and Trojan women in the face, lest a worse man should say, ‘Hektor has ruined us by his self-confidence.’ Surely it would be better for me to return after having fought Achilles and slain him, or to die gloriously here before the city. What, again, if were to lay down my shield and helmet, lean my spear against the wall and go straight up to noble Achilles? What if I were to promise to give up Helen, who was the fountainhead of all this war, and all the treasure that Alexander brought with him in his ships to Troy, aye, and to let the Achaeans divide the half of everything that the city contains among themselves? I might make the Trojans, by the mouths of their princes, take a solemn oath that they would hide nothing, but would divide into two shares all that is within the city - but why argue with myself in this way? Were I to go up to him he would show me no kind of mercy; he would kill me then and there as easily as though I were a woman, when I had off my armor. There is no parleying with him from some rock or oak tree as young men and maidens prattle with one another. Better fight him at once, and learn to which of us Zeus will grant victory." Thus did he stand and ponder, but Achilles came up to him as it were Ares himself, plumed lord of battle. From his right shoulder he brandished his terrible spear of Pelian ash, and the bronze gleamed around him like flashing fire or the rays of the rising sun. Fear fell upon Hektor as he beheld him, and he dared not stay longer where he was but fled in dismay from before the gates, while Achilles darted after him at his utmost speed. As a mountain falcon, swiftest of all birds, swoops down upon some cowering dove - the dove flies before him but the

22.31

31 καί τε φέρει πολλὸν πυρετὸν δειλοῖσι βροτοῖσιν·
32 ὣς τοῦ χαλκὸς ἔλαμπε περὶ στήθεσσι θέοντος.

ὤμωξεν δ’ ὃ γέρων, κεφαλὴν δ’ ὅ γε κόψατο χερσὶν
ὑψόσ’ ἀνασχόμενος, μέγα δ’ οἰμώξας ἐγεγώνει
λισσόμενος φίλον υἱόν· ὃ δὲ προπάροιθε πυλάων
ἑστήκει ἄμοτον μεμαὼς Ἀχιλῆϊ μάχεσθαι·
τὸν δ’ ὃ γέρων ἐλεεινὰ προσηύδα χεῖρας ὀρεγνύς·
Ἕκτορ μή μοι μίμνε φίλον τέκος ἀνέρα τοῦτον
οἷος ἄνευθ’ ἄλλων, ἵνα μὴ τάχα πότμον ἐπίσπῃς
Πηλεΐωνι δαμείς, ἐπεὶ ἦ πολὺ φέρτερός ἐστι
σχέτλιος· αἴθε θεοῖσι φίλος τοσσόνδε γένοιτο
ὅσσον ἐμοί· τάχα κέν ἑ κύνες καὶ γῦπες ἔδοιεν
κείμενον· ἦ κέ μοι αἰνὸν ἀπὸ πραπίδων ἄχος ἔλθοι·
ὅς μ’ υἱῶν πολλῶν τε καὶ ἐσθλῶν εὖνιν ἔθηκε
κτείνων καὶ περνὰς νήσων ἔπι τηλεδαπάων.
καὶ γὰρ νῦν δύο παῖδε Λυκάονα καὶ Πολύδωρον
οὐ δύναμαι ἰδέειν Τρώων εἰς ἄστυ ἀλέντων,
τούς μοι Λαοθόη τέκετο κρείουσα γυναικῶν.
ἀλλ’ εἰ μὲν ζώουσι μετὰ στρατῷ, ἦ τ’ ἂν ἔπειτα
χαλκοῦ τε χρυσοῦ τ’ ἀπολυσόμεθ’, ἔστι γὰρ ἔνδον·
πολλὰ γὰρ ὤπασε παιδὶ γέρων ὀνομάκλυτος Ἄλτης.
εἰ δ’ ἤδη τεθνᾶσι καὶ εἰν Ἀΐδαο δόμοισιν,
ἄλγος ἐμῷ θυμῷ καὶ μητέρι τοὶ τεκόμεσθα·
λαοῖσιν δ’ ἄλλοισι μινυνθαδιώτερον ἄλγος
ἔσσεται, ἢν μὴ καὶ σὺ θάνῃς Ἀχιλῆϊ δαμασθείς.
ἀλλ’ εἰσέρχεο τεῖχος ἐμὸν τέκος, ὄφρα σαώσῃς
Τρῶας καὶ Τρῳάς, μὴ δὲ μέγα κῦδος ὀρέξῃς
Πηλεΐδῃ, αὐτὸς δὲ φίλης αἰῶνος ἀμερθῇς.
πρὸς δ’ ἐμὲ τὸν δύστηνον ἔτι φρονέοντ’ ἐλέησον
δύσμορον, ὅν ῥα πατὴρ Κρονίδης ἐπὶ γήραος οὐδῷ

22.61

αἴσῃ ἐν ἀργαλέῃ φθίσει κακὰ πόλλ’ ἐπιδόντα
υἷάς τ’ ὀλλυμένους ἑλκηθείσας τε θύγατρας,
καὶ θαλάμους κεραϊζομένους, καὶ νήπια τέκνα
βαλλόμενα προτὶ γαίῃ ἐν αἰνῇ δῃϊοτῆτι,
ἑλκομένας τε νυοὺς ὀλοῇς ὑπὸ χερσὶν Ἀχαιῶν.
αὐτὸν δ’ ἂν πύματόν με κύνες πρώτῃσι θύρῃσιν
ὠμησταὶ ἐρύουσιν, ἐπεί κέ τις ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ
τύψας ἠὲ βαλὼν ῥεθέων ἐκ θυμὸν ἕληται,
οὓς τρέφον ἐν μεγάροισι τραπεζῆας θυραωρούς,
οἵ κ’ ἐμὸν αἷμα πιόντες ἀλύσσοντες περὶ θυμῷ
κείσοντ’ ἐν προθύροισι. νέῳ δέ τε πάντ’ ἐπέοικεν
ἄρηϊ κταμένῳ δεδαϊγμένῳ ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ
κεῖσθαι· πάντα δὲ καλὰ θανόντι περ ὅττι φανήῃ·
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ πολιόν τε κάρη πολιόν τε γένειον
αἰδῶ τ’ αἰσχύνωσι κύνες κταμένοιο γέροντος,
τοῦτο δὴ οἴκτιστον πέλεται δειλοῖσι βροτοῖσιν.
ἦ ῥ’ ὃ γέρων, πολιὰς δ’ ἄρ’ ἀνὰ τρίχας ἕλκετο χερσὶ
τίλλων ἐκ κεφαλῆς· οὐδ’ Ἕκτορι θυμὸν ἔπειθε.
μήτηρ δ’ αὖθ’ ἑτέρωθεν ὀδύρετο δάκρυ χέουσα
κόλπον ἀνιεμένη, ἑτέρηφι δὲ μαζὸν ἀνέσχε·
καί μιν δάκρυ χέουσ’ ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·

Ἕκτορ τέκνον ἐμὸν τάδε τ’ αἴδεο καί μ’ ἐλέησον
αὐτήν, εἴ ποτέ τοι λαθικηδέα μαζὸν ἐπέσχον·
τῶν μνῆσαι φίλε τέκνον ἄμυνε δὲ δήϊον ἄνδρα
τείχεος ἐντὸς ἐών, μὴ δὲ πρόμος ἵστασο τούτῳ
σχέτλιος· εἴ περ γάρ σε κατακτάνῃ, οὔ σ’ ἔτ’ ἔγωγε
κλαύσομαι ἐν λεχέεσσι φίλον θάλος, ὃν τέκον αὐτή,
οὐδ’ ἄλοχος πολύδωρος· ἄνευθε δέ σε μέγα νῶϊν
Ἀργείων παρὰ νηυσὶ κύνες ταχέες κατέδονται.
ὣς τώ γε κλαίοντε προσαυδήτην φίλον υἱὸν

22.91

πολλὰ λισσομένω· οὐδ’ Ἕκτορι θυμὸν ἔπειθον,
ἀλλ’ ὅ γε μίμν’ Ἀχιλῆα πελώριον ἆσσον ἰόντα.
ὡς δὲ δράκων ἐπὶ χειῇ ὀρέστερος ἄνδρα μένῃσι
βεβρωκὼς κακὰ φάρμακ’, ἔδυ δέ τέ μιν χόλος αἰνός,
σμερδαλέον δὲ δέδορκεν ἑλισσόμενος περὶ χειῇ·
ὣς Ἕκτωρ ἄσβεστον ἔχων μένος οὐχ ὑπεχώρει
πύργῳ ἔπι προὔχοντι φαεινὴν ἀσπίδ’ ἐρείσας·
ὀχθήσας δ’ ἄρα εἶπε πρὸς ὃν μεγαλήτορα θυμόν·
ὤ μοι ἐγών, εἰ μέν κε πύλας καὶ τείχεα δύω,
Πουλυδάμας μοι πρῶτος ἐλεγχείην ἀναθήσει,
ὅς μ’ ἐκέλευε Τρωσὶ ποτὶ πτόλιν ἠγήσασθαι
νύχθ’ ὕπο τήνδ’ ὀλοὴν ὅτε τ’ ὤρετο δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς.
ἀλλ’ ἐγὼ οὐ πιθόμην· ἦ τ’ ἂν πολὺ κέρδιον ἦεν.
νῦν δ’ ἐπεὶ ὤλεσα λαὸν ἀτασθαλίῃσιν ἐμῇσιν,
αἰδέομαι Τρῶας καὶ Τρῳάδας ἑλκεσιπέπλους,
μή ποτέ τις εἴπῃσι κακώτερος ἄλλος ἐμεῖο·
Ἕκτωρ ἦφι βίηφι πιθήσας ὤλεσε λαόν.
ὣς ἐρέουσιν· ἐμοὶ δὲ τότ’ ἂν πολὺ κέρδιον εἴη
ἄντην ἢ Ἀχιλῆα κατακτείναντα νέεσθαι,
ἠέ κεν αὐτῷ ὀλέσθαι ἐϋκλειῶς πρὸ πόληος.
εἰ δέ κεν ἀσπίδα μὲν καταθείομαι ὀμφαλόεσσαν
καὶ κόρυθα βριαρήν, δόρυ δὲ πρὸς τεῖχος ἐρείσας
αὐτὸς ἰὼν Ἀχιλῆος ἀμύμονος ἀντίος ἔλθω
καί οἱ ὑπόσχωμαι Ἑλένην καὶ κτήματ’ ἄμ’ αὐτῇ,
πάντα μάλ’ ὅσσά τ’ Ἀλέξανδρος κοίλῃς ἐνὶ νηυσὶν
ἠγάγετο Τροίηνδ’, ἥ τ’ ἔπλετο νείκεος ἀρχή,
δωσέμεν Ἀτρεΐδῃσιν ἄγειν, ἅμα δ’ ἀμφὶς Ἀχαιοῖς
ἄλλ’ ἀποδάσσεσθαι ὅσα τε πτόλις ἥδε κέκευθε·
Τρωσὶν δ’ αὖ μετόπισθε γερούσιον ὅρκον ἔλωμαι
μή τι κατακρύψειν, ἀλλ’ ἄνδιχα πάντα δάσασθαι

22.121

κτῆσιν ὅσην πτολίεθρον ἐπήρατον ἐντὸς ἐέργει·
ἀλλὰ τί ἦ μοι ταῦτα φίλος διελέξατο θυμός;
μή μιν ἐγὼ μὲν ἴκωμαι ἰών, ὃ δέ μ’ οὐκ ἐλεήσει
οὐδέ τί μ’ αἰδέσεται, κτενέει δέ με γυμνὸν ἐόντα
αὕτως ὥς τε γυναῖκα, ἐπεί κ’ ἀπὸ τεύχεα δύω.
οὐ μέν πως νῦν ἔστιν ἀπὸ δρυὸς οὐδ’ ἀπὸ πέτρης
τῷ ὀαριζέμεναι, ἅ τε παρθένος ἠΐθεός τε

128 παρθένος ἠΐθεός τ’ ὀαρίζετον ἀλλήλοιιν.
129 βέλτερον αὖτ’ ἔριδι ξυνελαυνέμεν ὅττι τάχιστα·
130 εἴδομεν ὁπποτέρῳ κεν Ὀλύμπιος εὖχος ὀρέξῃ.
131 ὣς ὅρμαινε μένων, ὃ δέ οἱ σχεδὸν ἦλθεν Ἀχιλλεὺς
132 ἶσος Ἐνυαλίῳ κορυθάϊκι πτολεμιστῇ
133 σείων Πηλιάδα μελίην κατὰ δεξιὸν ὦμον
134 δεινήν· ἀμφὶ δὲ χαλκὸς ἐλάμπετο εἴκελος αὐγῇ
135 ἢ πυρὸς αἰθομένου ἢ ἠελίου ἀνιόντος.
136 Ἕκτορα δ’, ὡς ἐνόησεν, ἔλε τρόμος· οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔτ’ ἔτλη
137 αὖθι μένειν, ὀπίσω δὲ πύλας λίπε, βῆ δὲ φοβηθείς·
138 Πηλεΐδης δ’ ἐπόρουσε ποσὶ κραιπνοῖσι πεποιθώς.
139 ἠΰτε κίρκος ὄρεσφιν ἐλαφρότατος πετεηνῶν
140 ῥηϊδίως οἴμησε μετὰ τρήρωνα πέλειαν,
141 ἣ δέ θ’ ὕπαιθα φοβεῖται, ὃ δ’ ἐγγύθεν ὀξὺ λεληκὼς
142 ταρφέ’ ἐπαΐσσει, ἐλέειν τέ ἑ θυμὸς ἀνώγει·
143 ὣς ἄρ’ ὅ γ’ ἐμμεμαὼς ἰθὺς πέτετο, τρέσε δ’ Ἕκτωρ
144 τεῖχος ὕπο Τρώων, λαιψηρὰ δὲ γούνατ’ ἐνώμα.
145 οἳ δὲ παρὰ σκοπιὴν καὶ ἐρινεὸν ἠνεμόεντα
146 τείχεος αἰὲν ὑπ’ ἐκ κατ’ ἀμαξιτὸν ἐσσεύοντο,
147 κρουνὼ δ’ ἵκανον καλλιρρόω· ἔνθα δὲ πηγαὶ
148 δοιαὶ ἀναΐσσουσι Σκαμάνδρου δινήεντος.
149 ἣ μὲν γάρ θ’ ὕδατι λιαρῷ ῥέει, ἀμφὶ δὲ καπνὸς
150 γίγνεται ἐξ αὐτῆς ὡς εἰ πυρὸς αἰθομένοιο·
falcon with a shrill scream follows close after, resolved to have her - even so did Achilles make straight for Hektor with all his might, while Hektor fled under the Trojan wall as fast as his limbs could take him. On they flew along the wagon-road that ran hard by under the wall, past the lookout station, and past the weather-beaten wild fig-tree, till they came to two fair springs which feed the river Skamandros. One of these two springs is warm, and steam rises from it as smoke from a burning fire, but the other even in summer is as cold as hail or snow, or the ice that forms on water. Here, hard by the springs, are the goodly washing-troughs of stone, where in the time of peace before the coming of the Achaeans the wives and fair daughters of the Trojans used to wash their clothes. Past these did they flee, the one in front and the other giving chase behind him: good was the man that fled, but better far was he that followed after, and swiftly indeed did they run, for the prize was no mere beast for sacrifice or bullock's hide, as it might be for a common foot-race, but they ran for the life [psukhê] of Hektor. As horses in a chariot race speed round the turning-posts when they are running for some great prize [athlon] - a tripod or woman - at the games in honor of some dead hero, so did these two run full speed three times round the city of Priam. All the gods watched them, and the sire of gods and men was the first to speak. "Alas," said he, "my eyes behold a man who is dear to me being pursued round the walls of Troy; my heart is full of pity for Hektor, who has burned the thigh-bones of many a heifer in my honor, at one while on the of many-valleyed Ida, and again on the citadel of Troy; and now I see noble Achilles in full pursuit of him round the city of Priam. What say you? Consider among yourselves and decide whether we shall now save him or let him fall, valiant though he be, before Achilles, son of Peleus." Then Athena said, "Father, wielder of the lightning, lord of cloud and storm, what mean you? Would you pluck this mortal whose doom has long been decreed out of the jaws of death? Do as you will, but we others shall not be of a mind with you." And Zeus answered, "My child, Trito-born, take heart. I did not speak in full earnest, and I will let you have your way. Do as your thinking [noos] tells you, without letting up, without hindrance." Thus did he urge Athena who was already eager, and down she darted from the topmost summits of Olympus. Achilles was still in full pursuit

of Hektor, as a hound chasing a fawn which he has started from its covert on the mountains, and hunts through glade and thicket. The fawn may try to elude him by crouching under cover of a bush, but he will scent her out and follow her up until he gets her - even so there was no escape for Hektor from the fleet son of Peleus. Whenever he made a set to get near the Dardanian gates and under the walls, that his people might help him by showering down weapons from above, Achilles would gain on him and head him back towards the plain, keeping himself always on the city side. As a man in a dream who fails to lay hands upon another whom he is pursuing - the one cannot escape nor the other overtake - even so neither could Achilles come up with Hektor, nor Hektor break away from Achilles; nevertheless he might even yet have escaped death had not the time come when Apollo, who thus far had sustained his strength and nerved his running, was now no longer to stay by him. Achilles made signs to the Achaean host, and shook his head to show that no man was to aim a dart at Hektor, lest another might win the glory of having hit him and he might himself come in second. Then, at last, as they were nearing the fountains for the fourth time, the father of all balanced his golden scales and placed a doom in each of them, one for Achilles and the other for Hektor. As he held the scales by the middle, the doom of Hektor fell down deep into the house of Hades - and then Phoebus Apollo left him. Thereon Athena went close up to the son of Peleus and said, "Noble Achilles, favored of heaven, I think in my mind [noos] we two shall surely take back to the ships a triumph for the Achaeans by slaying Hektor, for all his lust of battle. Do what Apollo may as he lies groveling before his father, aegis-bearing Zeus, Hektor cannot escape us longer. Stay here and take breath, while I go up to him and persuade him to make a stand and fight you." Thus spoke Athena. Achilles obeyed her gladly, and stood still, leaning on his bronze-pointed ashen spear, while Athena left him and went after Hektor in the form and with the voice of Deiphobos. She came close up to him and said, "Dear brother, I see you are hard pressed by Achilles who is chasing you at full speed round the city of Priam, let us await his onset and stand on our defense."

22.151

151 ἢ δ’ ἑτέρη θέρεϊ προρέει ἐϊκυῖα χαλάζῃ,
152 ἢ χιόνι ψυχρῇ ἢ ἐξ ὕδατος κρυστάλλῳ.
153 ἔνθα δ’ ἐπ’ αὐτάων πλυνοὶ εὐρέες ἐγγὺς ἔασι
154 καλοὶ λαΐνεοι, ὅθι εἵματα σιγαλόεντα
155 πλύνεσκον Τρώων ἄλοχοι καλαί τε θύγατρες
156 τὸ πρὶν ἐπ’ εἰρήνης πρὶν ἐλθεῖν υἷας Ἀχαιῶν.
157 τῇ ῥα παραδραμέτην φεύγων ὃ δ’ ὄπισθε διώκων·
158 πρόσθε μὲν ἐσθλὸς ἔφευγε, δίωκε δέ μιν μέγ’ ἀμείνων
159 καρπαλίμως, ἐπεὶ οὐχ ἱερήϊον οὐδὲ βοείην
160 ἀρνύσθην, ἅ τε ποσσὶν ἀέθλια γίγνεται ἀνδρῶν,
161 ἀλλὰ περὶ ψυχῆς θέον Ἕκτορος ἱπποδάμοιο.
162 ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἀεθλοφόροι περὶ τέρματα μώνυχες ἵπποι
163 ῥίμφα μάλα τρωχῶσι· τὸ δὲ μέγα κεῖται ἄεθλον
164 ἢ τρίπος ἠὲ γυνὴ ἀνδρὸς κατατεθνηῶτος·
165 ὣς τὼ τρὶς Πριάμοιο πόλιν πέρι δινηθήτην
166 καρπαλίμοισι πόδεσσι· θεοὶ δ’ ἐς πάντες ὁρῶντο·
167 τοῖσι δὲ μύθων ἦρχε πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε·
168 ὢ πόποι ἦ φίλον ἄνδρα διωκόμενον περὶ τεῖχος
169 ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ὁρῶμαι· ἐμὸν δ’ ὀλοφύρεται ἦτορ
170 Ἕκτορος, ὅς μοι πολλὰ βοῶν ἐπὶ μηρί’ ἔκηεν
171 Ἴδης ἐν κορυφῇσι πολυπτύχου, ἄλλοτε δ’ αὖτε
172 ἐν πόλει ἀκροτάτῃ· νῦν αὖτέ ἑ δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς

ἄστυ πέρι Πριάμοιο ποσὶν ταχέεσσι διώκει.
ἀλλ’ ἄγετε φράζεσθε θεοὶ καὶ μητιάασθε
ἠέ μιν ἐκ θανάτοιο σαώσομεν, ἦέ μιν ἤδη
Πηλεΐδῃ Ἀχιλῆϊ δαμάσσομεν ἐσθλὸν ἐόντα.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·
ὦ πάτερ ἀργικέραυνε κελαινεφὲς οἷον ἔειπες·
ἄνδρα θνητὸν ἐόντα πάλαι πεπρωμένον αἴσῃ
ἂψ ἐθέλεις θανάτοιο δυσηχέος ἐξαναλῦσαι;

22.181

ἔρδ’· ἀτὰρ οὔ τοι πάντες ἐπαινέομεν θεοὶ ἄλλοι.
τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
θάρσει Τριτογένεια φίλον τέκος· οὔ νύ τι θυμῷ
πρόφρονι μυθέομαι, ἐθέλω δέ τοι ἤπιος εἶναι·
ἔρξον ὅπῃ δή τοι νόος ἔπλετο, μὴ δ’ ἔτ’ ἐρώει.
ὣς εἰπὼν ὄτρυνε πάρος μεμαυῖαν Ἀθήνην·
βῆ δὲ κατ’ Οὐλύμποιο καρήνων ἀΐξασα.
Ἕκτορα δ’ ἀσπερχὲς κλονέων ἔφεπ’ ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς.
ὡς δ’ ὅτε νεβρὸν ὄρεσφι κύων ἐλάφοιο δίηται
ὄρσας ἐξ εὐνῆς διά τ’ ἄγκεα καὶ διὰ βήσσας·
τὸν δ’ εἴ πέρ τε λάθῃσι καταπτήξας ὑπὸ θάμνῳ,
ἀλλά τ’ ἀνιχνεύων θέει ἔμπεδον ὄφρά κεν εὕρῃ·
ὣς Ἕκτωρ οὐ λῆθε ποδώκεα Πηλεΐωνα.
ὁσσάκι δ’ ὁρμήσειε πυλάων Δαρδανιάων
ἀντίον ἀΐξασθαι ἐϋδμήτους ὑπὸ πύργους,
εἴ πως οἱ καθύπερθεν ἀλάλκοιεν βελέεσσι,
τοσσάκι μιν προπάροιθεν ἀποστρέψασκε παραφθὰς
πρὸς πεδίον· αὐτὸς δὲ ποτὶ πτόλιος πέτετ’ αἰεί.
ὡς δ’ ἐν ὀνείρῳ οὐ δύναται φεύγοντα διώκειν·
οὔτ’ ἄρ’ ὃ τὸν δύναται ὑποφεύγειν οὔθ’ ὃ διώκειν·
ὣς ὃ τὸν οὐ δύνατο μάρψαι ποσίν, οὐδ’ ὃς ἀλύξαι.
πῶς δέ κεν Ἕκτωρ κῆρας ὑπεξέφυγεν θανάτοιο,
εἰ μή οἱ πύματόν τε καὶ ὕστατον ἤντετ’ Ἀπόλλων
ἐγγύθεν, ὅς οἱ ἐπῶρσε μένος λαιψηρά τε γοῦνα;
λαοῖσιν δ’ ἀνένευε καρήατι δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
οὐδ’ ἔα ἰέμεναι ἐπὶ Ἕκτορι πικρὰ βέλεμνα,
μή τις κῦδος ἄροιτο βαλών, ὃ δὲ δεύτερος ἔλθοι.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ τὸ τέταρτον ἐπὶ κρουνοὺς ἀφίκοντο,
καὶ τότε δὴ χρύσεια πατὴρ ἐτίταινε τάλαντα,
ἐν δ’ ἐτίθει δύο κῆρε τανηλεγέος θανάτοιο,

22.211

τὴν μὲν Ἀχιλλῆος, τὴν δ’ Ἕκτορος ἱπποδάμοιο,
ἕλκε δὲ μέσσα λαβών· ῥέπε δ’ Ἕκτορος αἴσιμον ἦμαρ,
ᾤχετο δ’ εἰς Ἀΐδαο, λίπεν δέ ἑ Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων.
Πηλεΐωνα δ’ ἴκανε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη,
ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱσταμένη ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
νῦν δὴ νῶι ἔολπα Διὶ φίλε φαίδιμ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ
οἴσεσθαι μέγα κῦδος Ἀχαιοῖσι προτὶ νῆας
Ἕκτορα δῃώσαντε μάχης ἄατόν περ ἐόντα.

219 οὔ οἱ νῦν ἔτι γ’ ἔστι πεφυγμένον ἄμμε γενέσθαι,
220 οὐδ’ εἴ κεν μάλα πολλὰ πάθοι ἐκάεργος Ἀπόλλων
221 προπροκυλινδόμενος πατρὸς Διὸς αἰγιόχοιο.
222 ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν νῦν στῆθι καὶ ἄμπνυε, τόνδε δ’ ἐγώ τοι
223 οἰχομένη πεπιθήσω ἐναντίβιον μαχέσασθαι.
224 ὣς φάτ’ Ἀθηναίη, ὃ δ’ ἐπείθετο, χαῖρε δὲ θυμῷ,
225 στῆ δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπὶ μελίης χαλκογλώχινος ἐρεισθείς.
226 ἦ δ’ ἄρα τὸν μὲν ἔλειπε, κιχήσατο δ’ Ἕκτορα δῖον
227 Δηϊφόβῳ ἐϊκυῖα δέμας καὶ ἀτειρέα φωνήν·
228 ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱσταμένη ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
229 ἠθεῖ’ ἦ μάλα δή σε βιάζεται ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεὺς
230 ἄστυ πέρι Πριάμοιο ποσὶν ταχέεσσι διώκων·
231 ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ στέωμεν καὶ ἀλεξώμεσθα μένοντες.
232 τὴν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
233 Δηΐφοβ’ ἦ μέν μοι τὸ πάρος πολὺ φίλτατος ἦσθα
234 γνωτῶν οὓς Ἑκάβη ἠδὲ Πρίαμος τέκε παῖδας·
235 νῦν δ’ ἔτι καὶ μᾶλλον νοέω φρεσὶ τιμήσασθαι,
236 ὃς ἔτλης ἐμεῦ εἵνεκ’, ἐπεὶ ἴδες ὀφθαλμοῖσι,
237 τείχεος ἐξελθεῖν, ἄλλοι δ’ ἔντοσθε μένουσι.
238 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε θεὰ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη·
239 ἠθεῖ’ ἦ μὲν πολλὰ πατὴρ καὶ πότνια μήτηρ
240 λίσσονθ’ ἑξείης γουνούμενοι, ἀμφὶ δ’ ἑταῖροι,
And Hektor answered, "Deiphobos, you have always been dearest to me of all my brothers, children of Hecuba and Priam, but henceforth I shall rate you yet more highly, inasmuch as you have ventured outside the wall for my sake when all the others remain inside." Then Athena said, "Dear brother, my father and mother went down on their knees and implored me, as did all my comrades, to remain inside, so great a fear has fallen upon them all; but I was in an agony of grief when I beheld you; now, therefore, let us two make a stand and fight, and let there be no keeping our spears in reserve, that we may learn whether Achilles shall kill us and bear off our spoils to the ships, or whether he shall fall before you." Thus did Athena inveigle him by her cunning, and when the two were now close to one another great Hektor was first to speak. "I will no longer flee you, son of Peleus," said he, "as I have been doing hitherto. Three times have I fled round the mighty city of Priam, without daring to withstand you, but now, let me either slay or be slain, for I am in the mind to face you. Let us, then, give pledges to one another by our gods, who are the fittest witnesses and guardians of all covenants; let it be agreed between us that if Zeus grants me the longer stay and I take your life [psukhê], I am not to treat your dead body in any unseemly fashion, but when I have stripped you of your armor, I am to give up your body to the Achaeans. And do you likewise." Achilles glared at him and answered, "Fool, prate not to me about covenants. There can be no covenants between men and lions, wolves and lambs can never be of one mind, but hate each other out and out an through. Therefore there can be no understanding between you and me, nor may there be any covenants between us, till one or other shall fall and glut grim Ares with his life's blood. Be mindful of all your excellence [aretê]; you have need now to prove yourself indeed a bold warrior and fighter. You have no more chance, and Pallas Athena will forthwith vanquish you by my spear: you shall now pay me in full for the grief you have caused me on account of my comrades whom you have killed in battle." He poised his spear as he spoke and hurled it. Hektor saw it coming and avoided it; he watched it and crouched down so that it flew over his head and stuck in the ground beyond; Athena then snatched it up and gave it back to Achilles without Hektor's seeing her; Hektor thereon said to the son of Peleus, "You have missed your aim, Achilles, peer of the gods, and Zeus has not yet revealed to you the hour of my doom, though you

made sure that he had done so. You were a false-tongued liar when you deemed that I should forget my valor and quail before you. You shall not drive spear into the back of a runaway - drive it, should heaven so grant you power, drive it into me as I make straight towards you; and now for your own part avoid my spear if you can - would that you might receive the whole of it into your body; if you were once dead the Trojans would find the war an easier matter, for it is you who have harmed them most." He poised his spear as he spoke and hurled it. His aim was true for he hit the middle of Achilles' shield, but the spear rebounded from it, and did not pierce it. Hektor was angry when he saw that the weapon had sped from his hand in vain, and stood there in dismay for he had no second spear. With a loud cry he called Deiphobos and asked him for one, but there was no man; then he saw the truth and said to himself, "Alas! the gods have lured me on to my destruction. I deemed that the hero Deiphobos was by my side, but he is within the wall, and Athena has inveigled me; death is now indeed exceedingly near at hand and there is no way out of it - for so Zeus and his son Apollo the far-darter have willed it, though heretofore they have been ever ready to protect me. My doom has come upon me; let me not then die ingloriously and without a struggle, but let me first do some great thing that shall be told among men hereafter." As he spoke he drew the keen blade that hung so great and strong by his side, and gathering himself together be sprang on Achilles like a soaring eagle which swoops down from the clouds on to some lamb or timid hare - even so did Hektor brandish his sword and spring upon Achilles. Achilles mad with rage darted towards him, with his wondrous shield before his breast, and his gleaming helmet, made with four layers of metal, nodding fiercely forward. The thick tresses of gold with which Hephaistos had crested the helmet floated round it, and as the evening star that shines brighter than all others through the stillness of night, even such was the gleam of the spear which Achilles poised in his right hand, fraught with the death of noble Hektor. He eyed his fair flesh over and over to see where he could best wound it, but all was protected by the goodly armor of which Hektor had spoiled Patroklos after he had slain him, save only the throat where the collar-bones divide the neck from the shoulders, and this is the quickest place for the life-breath [psukhê] to escape: here then did Achilles strike him as he was coming on towards him, and the point of his spear went right through the fleshy part of the neck, but it did not sever his windpipe so that he could still speak. Hektor fell headlong, and Achilles vaunted over him saying, "Hektor, you deemed that you should come off scatheless when you were spoiling Patroklos, and recked not of myself who was not with him. Fool that you were: for I, his comrade, mightier far than he, was still left behind him at the ships, and now I have laid you low. The Achaeans shall give him all due funeral rites, while dogs and vultures shall work their will upon yourself." Then Hektor said, as the life-breath [psukhê] ebbed out of him, "I pray you by your life and knees, and by your parents, let not dogs devour me at the ships of the Achaeans, but accept the rich treasure of gold and bronze which my father and mother will offer you, and send my body home, that the Trojans and their wives may give me my dues of fire when I am dead."

22.241

241 αὖθι μένειν· τοῖον γὰρ ὑποτρομέουσιν ἅπαντες·
242 ἀλλ’ ἐμὸς ἔνδοθι θυμὸς ἐτείρετο πένθεϊ λυγρῷ.
243 νῦν δ’ ἰθὺς μεμαῶτε μαχώμεθα, μὴ δέ τι δούρων
244 ἔστω φειδωλή, ἵνα εἴδομεν εἴ κεν Ἀχιλλεὺς
245 νῶϊ κατακτείνας ἔναρα βροτόεντα φέρηται
246 νῆας ἔπι γλαφυράς, ἦ κεν σῷ δουρὶ δαμήῃ.
247 ὣς φαμένη καὶ κερδοσύνῃ ἠγήσατ’ Ἀθήνη·
248 οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντες,
249 τὸν πρότερος προσέειπε μέγας κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·

οὔ σ’ ἔτι Πηλέος υἱὲ φοβήσομαι, ὡς τὸ πάρος περ
τρὶς περὶ ἄστυ μέγα Πριάμου δίον, οὐδέ ποτ’ ἔτλην
μεῖναι ἐπερχόμενον· νῦν αὖτέ με θυμὸς ἀνῆκε
στήμεναι ἀντία σεῖο· ἕλοιμί κεν ἤ κεν ἁλοίην.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δεῦρο θεοὺς ἐπιδώμεθα· τοὶ γὰρ ἄριστοι
μάρτυροι ἔσσονται καὶ ἐπίσκοποι ἁρμονιάων·
οὐ γὰρ ἐγώ σ’ ἔκπαγλον ἀεικιῶ, αἶ κεν ἐμοὶ Ζεὺς
δώῃ καμμονίην, σὴν δὲ ψυχὴν ἀφέλωμαι·
ἀλλ’ ἐπεὶ ἄρ κέ σε συλήσω κλυτὰ τεύχε’ Ἀχιλλεῦ
νεκρὸν Ἀχαιοῖσιν δώσω πάλιν· ὣς δὲ σὺ ῥέζειν.
τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
Ἕκτορ μή μοι ἄλαστε συνημοσύνας ἀγόρευε·
ὡς οὐκ ἔστι λέουσι καὶ ἀνδράσιν ὅρκια πιστά,
οὐδὲ λύκοι τε καὶ ἄρνες ὁμόφρονα θυμὸν ἔχουσιν,
ἀλλὰ κακὰ φρονέουσι διαμπερὲς ἀλλήλοισιν,
ὣς οὐκ ἔστ’ ἐμὲ καὶ σὲ φιλήμεναι, οὐδέ τι νῶϊν
ὅρκια ἔσσονται, πρίν γ’ ἢ ἕτερόν γε πεσόντα
αἵματος ἆσαι Ἄρηα ταλαύρινον πολεμιστήν.
παντοίης ἀρετῆς μιμνήσκεο· νῦν σε μάλα χρὴ
αἰχμητήν τ’ ἔμεναι καὶ θαρσαλέον πολεμιστήν.
οὔ τοι ἔτ’ ἔσθ’ ὑπάλυξις, ἄφαρ δέ σε Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη

22.271

ἔγχει ἐμῷ δαμάᾳ· νῦν δ’ ἀθρόα πάντ’ ἀποτίσεις
κήδε’ ἐμῶν ἑτάρων οὓς ἔκτανες ἔγχεϊ θύων.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἀμπεπαλὼν προΐει δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος·
καὶ τὸ μὲν ἄντα ἰδὼν ἠλεύατο φαίδιμος Ἕκτωρ·
ἔζετο γὰρ προϊδών, τὸ δ’ ὑπέρπτατο χάλκεον ἔγχος,
ἐν γαίῃ δ’ ἐπάγη· ἀνὰ δ’ ἥρπασε Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη,
ἂψ δ’ Ἀχιλῆϊ δίδου, λάθε δ’ Ἕκτορα ποιμένα λαῶν.
Ἕκτωρ δὲ προσέειπεν ἀμύμονα Πηλεΐωνα·
ἤμβροτες, οὐδ’ ἄρα πώ τι θεοῖς ἐπιείκελ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ
ἐκ Διὸς ἠείδης τὸν ἐμὸν μόρον, ἦ τοι ἔφης γε·
ἀλλά τις ἀρτιεπὴς καὶ ἐπίκλοπος ἔπλεο μύθων,
ὄφρά σ’ ὑποδείσας μένεος ἀλκῆς τε λάθωμαι.
οὐ μέν μοι φεύγοντι μεταφρένῳ ἐν δόρυ πήξεις,
ἀλλ’ ἰθὺς μεμαῶτι διὰ στήθεσφιν ἔλασσον
εἴ τοι ἔδωκε θεός· νῦν αὖτ’ ἐμὸν ἔγχος ἄλευαι
χάλκεον· ὡς δή μιν σῷ ἐν χροῒ πᾶν κομίσαιο.
καί κεν ἐλαφρότερος πόλεμος Τρώεσσι γένοιτο
σεῖο καταφθιμένοιο· σὺ γάρ σφισι πῆμα μέγιστον.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἀμπεπαλὼν προΐει δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος,
καὶ βάλε Πηλεΐδαο μέσον σάκος οὐδ’ ἀφάμαρτε·
τῆλε δ’ ἀπεπλάγχθη σάκεος δόρυ· χώσατο δ’ Ἕκτωρ
ὅττί ῥά οἱ βέλος ὠκὺ ἐτώσιον ἔκφυγε χειρός,
στῆ δὲ κατηφήσας, οὐδ’ ἄλλ’ ἔχε μείλινον ἔγχος.
Δηΐφοβον δ’ ἐκάλει λευκάσπιδα μακρὸν ἀΰσας·
ᾔτεέ μιν δόρυ μακρόν· ὃ δ’ οὔ τί οἱ ἐγγύθεν ἦεν.
Ἕκτωρ δ’ ἔγνω ᾗσιν ἐνὶ φρεσὶ φώνησέν τε·
ὢ πόποι ἦ μάλα δή με θεοὶ θάνατόνδε κάλεσσαν·
Δηΐφοβον γὰρ ἔγωγ’ ἐφάμην ἥρωα παρεῖναι·

299 ἀλλ’ ὃ μὲν ἐν τείχει, ἐμὲ δ’ ἐξαπάτησεν Ἀθήνη.
300 νῦν δὲ δὴ ἐγγύθι μοι θάνατος κακός, οὐδ’ ἔτ’ ἄνευθεν,

22.301

301 οὐδ’ ἀλέη· ἦ γάρ ῥα πάλαι τό γε φίλτερον ἦεν
302 Ζηνί τε καὶ Διὸς υἱῖ ἐκηβόλῳ, οἵ με πάρος γε
303 πρόφρονες εἰρύατο· νῦν αὖτέ με μοῖρα κιχάνει.
304 μὴ μὰν ἀσπουδί γε καὶ ἀκλειῶς ἀπολοίμην,
305 ἀλλὰ μέγα ῥέξας τι καὶ ἐσσομένοισι πυθέσθαι.
306 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας εἰρύσσατο φάσγανον ὀξύ,
307 τό οἱ ὑπὸ λαπάρην τέτατο μέγα τε στιβαρόν τε,
308 οἴμησεν δὲ ἀλεὶς ὥς τ’ αἰετὸς ὑψιπετήεις,
309 ὅς τ’ εἶσιν πεδίον δὲ διὰ νεφέων ἐρεβεννῶν
310 ἁρπάξων ἢ ἄρν’ ἀμαλὴν ἢ πτῶκα λαγωόν·
311 ὣς Ἕκτωρ οἴμησε τινάσσων φάσγανον ὀξύ.
312 ὁρμήθη δ’ Ἀχιλεύς, μένεος δ’ ἐμπλήσατο θυμὸν
313 ἀγρίου, πρόσθεν δὲ σάκος στέρνοιο κάλυψε
314 καλὸν δαιδάλεον, κόρυθι δ’ ἐπένευε φαεινῇ
315 τετραφάλῳ· καλαὶ δὲ περισσείοντο ἔθειραι
316 χρύσεαι, ἃς Ἥφαιστος ἴει λόφον ἀμφὶ θαμειάς.
317 οἷος δ’ ἀστὴρ εἶσι μετ’ ἀστράσι νυκτὸς ἀμολγῷ
318 ἕσπερος, ὃς κάλλιστος ἐν οὐρανῷ ἵσταται ἀστήρ,
319 ὣς αἰχμῆς ἀπέλαμπ’ εὐήκεος, ἣν ἄρ’ Ἀχιλλεὺς
320 πάλλεν δεξιτερῇ φρονέων κακὸν Ἕκτορι δίῳ,
321 εἰσορόων χρόα καλόν, ὅπῃ εἴξειε μάλιστα.
322 τοῦ δὲ καὶ ἄλλο τόσον μὲν ἔχε χρόα χάλκεα τεύχεα,
323 καλά, τὰ Πατρόκλοιο βίην ἐνάριξε κατακτάς·
324 φαίνετο δ’ ᾗ κληῖδες ἀπ’ ὤμων αὐχέν’ ἔχουσι,
325 λαυκανίην, ἵνα τε ψυχῆς ὤκιστος ὄλεθρος·
326 τῇ ῥ’ ἐπὶ οἱ μεμαῶτ’ ἔλασ’ ἔγχεϊ δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
327 ἀντικρὺ δ’ ἀπαλοῖο δι’ αὐχένος ἤλυθ’ ἀκωκή·
328 οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἀπ’ ἀσφάραγον μελίη τάμε χαλκοβάρεια,
329 ὄφρά τί μιν προτιείποι ἀμειβόμενος ἐπέεσσιν.
330 ἤριπε δ’ ἐν κονίῃς· ὃ δ’ ἐπεύξατο δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·

22.331

331 Ἕκτορ ἀτάρ που ἔφης Πατροκλῆ’ ἐξεναρίζων
332 σῶς ἔσσεσθ’, ἐμὲ δ’ οὐδὲν ὀπίζεο νόσφιν ἐόντα,
333 νήπιε· τοῖο δ’ ἄνευθεν ἀοσσητὴρ μέγ’ ἀμείνων
334 νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσιν ἐγὼ μετόπισθε λελείμμην,
335 ὅς τοι γούνατ’ ἔλυσα· σὲ μὲν κύνες ἠδ’ οἰωνοὶ
336 ἑλκήσουσ’ ἀϊκῶς, τὸν δὲ κτεριοῦσιν Ἀχαιοί.
337 τὸν δ’ ὀλιγοδρανέων προσέφη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
338 λίσσομ’ ὑπὲρ ψυχῆς καὶ γούνων σῶν τε τοκήων,
339 μή με ἔα παρὰ νηυσὶ κύνας καταδάψαι Ἀχαιῶν,
340 ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν χαλκόν τε ἅλις χρυσόν τε δέδεξο,
341 δῶρα τά τοι δώσουσι πατὴρ καὶ πότνια μήτηρ,
342 σῶμα δὲ οἶκαδ’ ἐμὸν δόμεναι πάλιν, ὄφρα πυρός με
343 Τρῶες καὶ Τρώων ἄλοχοι λελάχωσι θανόντα.
344 τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·

345 μή με κύον γούνων γουνάζεο μὴ δὲ τοκήων·
346 αἴ γάρ πως αὐτόν με μένος καὶ θυμὸς ἀνήη
347 ὤμ’ ἀποταμνόμενον κρέα ἔδμεναι, οἷα ἔοργας,
348 ὡς οὐκ ἔσθ’ ὃς σῆς γε κύνας κεφαλῆς ἀπαλάλκοι,
349 οὐδ’ εἴ κεν δεκάκις τε καὶ εἰκοσινήριτ’ ἄποινα
350 στήσωσ’ ἐνθάδ’ ἄγοντες, ὑπόσχωνται δὲ καὶ ἄλλα,
351 οὐδ’ εἴ κέν σ’ αὐτὸν χρυσῷ ἐρύσασθαι ἀνώγοι
352 Δαρδανίδης Πρίαμος· οὐδ’ ὥς σέ γε πότνια μήτηρ
353 ἐνθεμένη λεχέεσσι γοήσεται ὃν τέκεν αὐτή,
354 ἀλλὰ κύνες τε καὶ οἰωνοὶ κατὰ πάντα δάσονται.
355 τὸν δὲ καταθνήσκων προσέφη κορυθαίολος Ἕκτωρ·
356 ἦ σ’ εὖ γιγνώσκων προτιόσσομαι, οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔμελλον
357 πείσειν· ἦ γὰρ σοί γε σιδήρεος ἐν φρεσὶ θυμός.
358 φράζεο νῦν, μή τοί τι θεῶν μήνιμα γένωμαι
359 ἤματι τῷ ὅτε κέν σε Πάρις καὶ Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων
360 ἐσθλὸν ἐόντ’ ὀλέσωσιν ἐνὶ Σκαιῇσι πύλῃσιν.
Achilles glared at him and answered, "Dog, talk not to me neither of knees nor parents; would that I could be as sure of being able to cut your flesh into pieces and eat it raw, for the ill have done me, as I am that nothing shall save you from the dogs - it shall not be, though they bring ten or twenty-fold ransom and weigh it out for me on the spot, with promise of yet more hereafter. Though Priam son of Dardanos should bid them offer me your weight in gold, even so your mother shall never lay you out and make lament over the son she bore, but dogs and vultures shall eat you utterly up." Hektor with his dying breath then said, "I know you what you are, and was sure that I should not move you, for your heart is hard as iron; look to it that I bring not heaven's anger upon you on the day when Paris and Phoebus Apollo, valiant though you be, shall slay you at the Scaean gates." When he had thus said the shrouds of death's final outcome [telos] enfolded him, whereon his life-breath [psukhê] went out of him and flew down to the house of Hades, lamenting its sad fate that it should enjoy youth and strength no longer. But Achilles said, speaking to the dead body, "Die; for my part I will accept my fate whensoever Zeus and the other gods see fit to send it." As he spoke he drew his spear from the body and set it on one side; then he stripped the blood-stained armor from Hektor's shoulders while the other Achaeans came running up to view his wondrous strength and beauty; and no one came near him without giving him a fresh wound. Then would one turn to his neighbor and say, "It is easier to handle Hektor now than when he was flinging fire on to our ships" and as he spoke he would thrust his spear into him anew. When Achilles had done spoiling Hektor of his armor, he stood among the Argives and said, "My friends, princes and counselors of the Argives, now that heaven has granted us to overcome this man, who has done us more hurt than all the others together, consider whether we should not attack the city in force, and discover in what mind [noos] the Trojans may be. We should thus learn whether they will desert their city now that Hektor has fallen, or will still hold out even though he is no longer living. But why argue with myself in this way, while Patroklos is still lying at the ships unburied, and unmourned - he Whom I can never forget so long as I am alive and my strength fails not? Though men forget their dead when once they are within the house of Hades, yet not even there will I forget the comrade whom I have lost. Now, therefore, Achaean youths, let us raise the song of victory and go back to the ships taking this man along with us; for we have achieved a mighty triumph and have slain noble Hektor to whom the Trojans prayed throughout their city as though he were a god." On this he treated the body of Hektor with contumely: he pierced the sinews at the back of both his feet from heel to ankle and passed thongs of ox-hide through the slits he had made: thus he made the body fast to his chariot, letting the head trail upon the ground. Then when he had put the goodly armor on the

chariot and had himself mounted, he lashed his horses on and they flew forward nothing loath. The dust rose from Hektor as he was being dragged along, his dark hair flew all abroad, and his head once so comely was laid low on earth, for Zeus had now delivered him into the hands of his foes to do him outrage in his own land. Thus was the head of Hektor being dishonored in the dust. His mother tore her hair, and flung her veil from her with a loud cry as she looked upon her son. His father made piteous moan, and throughout the city the people fell to weeping and wailing. It was as though the whole of frowning Ilion was being smirched with fire. Hardly could the people hold Priam back in his hot haste to rush without the gates of the city. He groveled in the mire and besought them, calling each one of them by his name.

22.361

ὣς ἄρα μιν εἰπόντα τέλος θανάτοιο κάλυψε,
ψυχὴ δ’ ἐκ ῥεθέων πταμένη Ἄϊδος δὲ βεβήκει
ὃν πότμον γοόωσα λιποῦσ’ ἀνδροτῆτα καὶ ἥβην.
τὸν καὶ τεθνηῶτα προσηύδα δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
τέθναθι· κῆρα δ’ ἐγὼ τότε δέξομαι ὁππότε κεν δὴ
Ζεὺς ἐθέλῃ τελέσαι ἠδ’ ἀθάνατοι θεοὶ ἄλλοι.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἐκ νεκροῖο ἐρύσσατο χάλκεον ἔγχος,
καὶ τό γ’ ἄνευθεν ἔθηχ’, ὃ δ’ ἀπ’ ὤμων τεύχε’ ἐσύλα
αἱματόεντ’· ἄλλοι δὲ περίδραμον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν,
οἳ καὶ θηήσαντο φυὴν καὶ εἶδος ἀγητὸν
Ἕκτορος· οὐδ’ ἄρα οἵ τις ἀνουτητί γε παρέστη.
ὧδε δέ τις εἴπεσκεν ἰδὼν ἐς πλησίον ἄλλον·
ὢ πόποι, ἦ μάλα δὴ μαλακώτερος ἀμφαφάασθαι
Ἕκτωρ ἢ ὅτε νῆας ἐνέπρησεν πυρὶ κηλέῳ.
ὣς ἄρα τις εἶπεσκε καὶ οὐτήσασκε παραστάς.
τὸν δ’ ἐπεὶ ἐξενάριξε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
στὰς ἐν Ἀχαιοῖσιν ἔπεα πτερόεντ’ ἀγόρευεν·
ὦ φίλοι Ἀργείων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες
ἐπεὶ δὴ τόνδ’ ἄνδρα θεοὶ δαμάσασθαι ἔδωκαν,
ὃς κακὰ πόλλ’ ἔρρεξεν ὅσ’ οὐ σύμπαντες οἱ ἄλλοι,
εἰ δ’ ἄγετ’ ἀμφὶ πόλιν σὺν τεύχεσι πειρηθῶμεν,
ὄφρά κ’ ἔτι γνῶμεν Τρώων νόον ὅν τιν’ ἔχουσιν,
ἢ καταλείψουσιν πόλιν ἄκρην τοῦδε πεσόντος,
ἦε μένειν μεμάασι καὶ Ἕκτορος οὐκέτ’ ἐόντος.
ἀλλὰ τί ἦ μοι ταῦτα φίλος διελέξατο θυμός;
κεῖται πὰρ νήεσσι νέκυς ἄκλαυτος ἄθαπτος
Πάτροκλος· τοῦ δ’ οὐκ ἐπιλήσομαι, ὄφρ’ ἂν ἔγωγε
ζωοῖσιν μετέω καί μοι φίλα γούνατ’ ὀρώρῃ·
εἰ δὲ θανόντων περ καταλήθοντ’ εἰν Ἄϊδαο
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ καὶ κεῖθι φίλου μεμνήσομ’ ἑταίρου.

22.391

νῦν δ’ ἄγ’ ἀείδοντες παιήονα κοῦροι Ἀχαιῶν
νηυσὶν ἔπι γλαφυρῇσι νεώμεθα, τόνδε δ’ ἄγωμεν.
ἠράμεθα μέγα κῦδος· ἐπέφνομεν Ἕκτορα δῖον,
ᾧ Τρῶες κατὰ ἄστυ θεῷ ὡς εὐχετόωντο.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ Ἕκτορα δῖον ἀεικέα μήδετο ἔργα.
ἀμφοτέρων μετόπισθε ποδῶν τέτρηνε τένοντε

397 ἐς σφυρὸν ἐκ πτέρνης, βοέους δ’ ἐξῆπτεν ἱμάντας,
398 ἐκ δίφροιο δ’ ἔδησε, κάρη δ’ ἔλκεσθαι ἔασεν·
399 ἐς δίφρον δ’ ἀναβὰς ἀνά τε κλυτὰ τεύχε’ ἀείρας
400 μάστιξέν ῥ’ ἐλάαν, τὼ δ’ οὐκ ἀέκοντε πετέσθην.
401 τοῦ δ’ ἦν ἑλκομένοιο κονίσαλος, ἀμφὶ δὲ χαῖται
402 κυάνεαι πίτναντο, κάρη δ’ ἄπαν ἐν κονίῃσι
403 κεῖτο πάρος χαρίεν· τότε δὲ Ζεὺς δυσμενέεσσι
404 δῶκεν ἀεικίσσασθαι ἐῇ ἐν πατρίδι γαίῃ.
405 ὣς τοῦ μὲν κεκόνιτο κάρη ἅπαν· ἣ δέ νυ μήτηρ
406 τίλλε κόμην, ἀπὸ δὲ λιπαρὴν ἔρριψε καλύπτρην
407 τηλόσε, κώκυσεν δὲ μάλα μέγα παῖδ’ ἐσιδοῦσα·
408 ὤμωξεν δ’ ἐλεεινὰ πατὴρ φίλος, ἀμφὶ δὲ λαοὶ
409 κωκυτῷ τ’ εἴχοντο καὶ οἰμωγῇ κατὰ ἄστυ.
410 τῷ δὲ μάλιστ’ ἄρ’ ἔην ἐναλίγκιον ὡς εἰ ἅπασα
411 Ἴλιος ὀφρυόεσσα πυρὶ σμύχοιτο κατ’ ἄκρης.
412 λαοὶ μέν ῥα γέροντα μόγις ἔχον ἀσχαλόωντα
413 ἐξελθεῖν μεμαῶτα πυλάων Δαρδανιάων.
414 πάντας δ’ ἐλλιτάνευε κυλινδόμενος κατὰ κόπρον,
415 ἐξονομακλήδην ὀνομάζων ἄνδρα ἕκαστον·
416 σχέσθε φίλοι, καί μ’ οἶον ἐάσατε κηδόμενοί περ
417 ἐξελθόντα πόληος ἰκέσθ’ ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν.
418 λίσσωμ’ ἀνέρα τοῦτον ἀτάσθαλον ὀβριμοεργόν,
419 ἤν πως ἡλικίην αἰδέσσεται ἠδ’ ἐλεήσῃ
420 γῆρας· καὶ δέ νυ τῷ γε πατὴρ τοιόσδε τέτυκται
"Let be, my friends," he cried, "and for all your sorrow, suffer me to go single-handed to the ships of the Achaeans. Let me beseech this cruel and terrible man, if maybe he will respect the feeling of his fellow-men, and have compassion on my old age. His own father is even such another as myself - Peleus, who bred him and reared him to - be the bane of us Trojans, and of myself more than of all others. Many a son of mine has he slain in the flower of his youth, and yet, grieve for these as I may, I do so for one - Hektor - more than for them all, and the bitterness of my sorrow [akhos] will bring me down to the house of Hades. Would that he had died in my arms, for so both his ill-starred mother who bore him, and myself, should have had the comfort of weeping and mourning over him." Thus did he speak with many tears, and all the people of the city joined in his lament. Hecuba then raised the cry of wailing among the Trojans. "Alas, my son," she cried, "what have I left to live for now that you are no more? Night and day did I glory in. you throughout the city, for you were a tower of strength to all in Troy, and both men and women alike hailed you as a god. So long as you lived you were their pride, but now death and destruction have fallen upon you." Hektor's wife had as yet heard nothing, for no one had come to tell her that her husband had remained without the gates. She was at her loom in an inner part of the house, weaving a double purple web, and embroidering it with many flowers. She told her maids to set a large tripod on the fire, so as to have a warm bath ready for Hektor when he came out of battle; poor woman, she knew not that he was now beyond the reach of baths, and that Athena had laid him low by the hands of Achilles. She heard the cry coming as from the wall, and trembled in every limb; the shuttle fell from her hands, and again she spoke to her waiting-women. "Two of you," she said, "come with me that I may learn what it is that has befallen; I heard the voice of my husband's honored mother; my own heart beats as though it would come into my mouth and my limbs refuse to carry me; some great misfortune for Priam's children must be at hand. May I never live to hear it, but I greatly fear that Achilles has cut off the retreat of brave Hektor and has chased him on to the plain where he was singlehanded; I fear he may have put an end to the reckless daring which possessed my

husband, who would never remain with the body of his men, but would dash on far in front, foremost of them all in valor." Her heart beat fast, and as she spoke she flew from the house like a maniac, with her waiting-women following after. When she reached the battlements and the crowd of people, she stood looking out upon the wall, and saw Hektor being borne away in front of the city - the horses dragging him without heed or care over the ground towards the ships of the Achaeans. Her eyes were then shrouded as with the darkness of night and she fell fainting backwards, losing her life-breath [psukhê]. She tore the tiring from her head and flung it from her, the frontlet and net with its plaited band, and the veil which golden Aphrodite had given her on the day when Hektor took her with him from the house of Eetion, after having given countless gifts of wooing for her sake. Her husband's sisters and the wives of his brothers crowded round her and supported her, for she was fain to die in her distraction; when she again presently breathed and came to herself, she sobbed and made lament among the Trojans saying, ‘Woe is me, O Hektor; woe, indeed, that to share a common lot we were born, you at Troy in the house of Priam, and I at Thebes under the wooded mountain of Plakos in the house of Eetion who brought me up when I was a child - ill-starred sire of an ill-starred daughter - would that he had never begotten me. You are now going into the house of Hades under the secret places of the earth, and you leave me a sorrowing widow in your house. The child, of whom you and I are the unhappy parents, is as yet a mere infant. Now that you are gone, O Hektor, you can do nothing for him nor he for you. Even though he escape the horrors of this woeful war with the Achaeans, yet shall his life henceforth be one of labor [ponos] and sorrow, for others will seize his lands. The day that robs a child of his parents severs him from his own kind; his head is bowed, his cheeks are wet with tears, and he will go about destitute among the friends of his father, plucking one by the cloak and another by the shirt. Some one or other of these may so far pity him as to hold the cup for a moment towards him and let him moisten his lips, but he must not drink enough to wet the roof of his mouth; then one whose parents are alive will drive him from the table with blows and angry words. ‘Out with you,’ he will say, ‘you have no father here,’ and the child will go crying back to his widowed mother - he, Astyanax, who erewhile would sit upon his father's knees, and have none but the daintiest and choicest morsels set before him. When he had played till he was tired and went to sleep, he would lie in a bed, in the arms of his nurse, on a soft couch, knowing neither want nor care, whereas now that he has lost his father his lot will be full of hardship - he, whom the Trojans name Astyanax, because you, O Hektor, were the only defense of their gates and battlements. The wriggling writhing worms will now eat you at the ships, far from your parents, when the dogs have glutted themselves upon you. You will lie naked, although in your house you have fine and goodly raiment made by hands of women. This will I now burn; it is of no use to you, for you can never again wear it, and thus you will have glory [kleos] among the Trojans both men and women." In such wise did she cry aloud amid her tears, and the women joined in her lament.

22.421

421 Πηλεύς, ὅς μιν ἔτικτε καὶ ἔτρεφε πῆμα γενέσθαι
422 Τρωσί· μάλιστα δ’ ἐμοὶ περὶ πάντων ἄλγε’ ἔθηκε.
423 τόσσους γάρ μοι παῖδας ἀπέκτανε τηλεθάοντας·
424 τῶν πάντων οὐ τόσσον ὀδύρομαι ἀχνύμενός περ
425 ὡς ἑνός, οὗ μ’ ἄχος ὀξὺ κατοίσεται Ἄϊδος εἴσω,
426 Ἕκτορος· ὡς ὄφελεν θανέειν ἐν χερσὶν ἐμῇσι·
427 τώ κε κορεσσάμεθα κλαίοντέ τε μυρομένω τε
428 μήτηρ θ’, ἥ μιν ἔτικτε δυσάμμορος, ἠδ’ ἐγὼ αὐτός.
429 ὣς ἔφατο κλαίων, ἐπὶ δὲ στενάχοντο πολῖται·
430 Τρῳῇσιν δ’ Ἑκάβη ἀδινοῦ ἐξῆρχε γόοιο·

τέκνον ἐγὼ δειλή· τί νυ βείομαι αἰνὰ παθοῦσα
σεῦ ἀποτεθνηῶτος; ὅ μοι νύκτάς τε καὶ ἦμαρ
εὐχωλὴ κατὰ ἄστυ πελέσκεο, πᾶσί τ’ ὄνειαρ
Τρωσί τε καὶ Τρῳῇσι κατὰ πτόλιν, οἵ σε θεὸν ὣς
δειδέχατ’· ἦ γὰρ καί σφι μάλα μέγα κῦδος ἔησθα
ζωὸς ἐών· νῦν αὖ θάνατος καὶ μοῖρα κιχάνει.
ὣς ἔφατο κλαίουσ’, ἄλοχος δ’ οὔ πώ τι πέπυστο
Ἕκτορος· οὐ γάρ οἵ τις ἐτήτυμος ἄγγελος ἐλθὼν
ἤγγειλ’ ὅττί ῥά οἱ πόσις ἔκτοθι μίμνε πυλάων,
ἀλλ’ ἥ γ’ ἱστὸν ὕφαινε μυχῷ δόμου ὑψηλοῖο
δίπλακα πορφυρέην, ἐν δὲ θρόνα ποικίλ’ ἔπασσε.
κέκλετο δ’ ἀμφιπόλοισιν ἐϋπλοκάμοις κατὰ δῶμα
ἀμφὶ πυρὶ στῆσαι τρίποδα μέγαν, ὄφρα πέλοιτο
Ἕκτορι θερμὰ λοετρὰ μάχης ἐκ νοστήσαντι
νηπίη, οὐδ’ ἐνόησεν ὅ μιν μάλα τῆλε λοετρῶν
χερσὶν Ἀχιλλῆος δάμασε γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνη.
κωκυτοῦ δ’ ἤκουσε καὶ οἰμωγῆς ἀπὸ πύργου·
τῆς δ’ ἐλελίχθη γυῖα, χαμαὶ δέ οἱ ἔκπεσε κερκίς·
ἢ δ’ αὖτις δμῳῇσιν ἐϋπλοκάμοισι μετηύδα·
δεῦτε δύω μοι ἕπεσθον, ἴδωμ’ ὅτιν’ ἔργα τέτυκται.

22.451

αἰδοίης ἐκυρῆς ὀπὸς ἔκλυον, ἐν δ’ ἐμοὶ αὐτῇ
στήθεσι πάλλεται ἦτορ ἀνὰ στόμα, νέρθε δὲ γοῦνα
πήγνυται· ἐγγὺς δή τι κακὸν Πριάμοιο τέκεσσιν.
αἲ γὰρ ἀπ’ οὔατος εἴη ἐμεῦ ἔπος· ἀλλὰ μάλ’ αἰνῶς
δείδω μὴ δή μοι θρασὺν Ἕκτορα δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
μοῦνον ἀποτμήξας πόλιος πεδίον δὲ δίηται,
καὶ δή μιν καταπαύσῃ ἀγηνορίης ἀλεγεινῆς
ἥ μιν ἔχεσκ’, ἐπεὶ οὔ ποτ’ ἐνὶ πληθυῖ μένεν ἀνδρῶν,
ἀλλὰ πολὺ προθέεσκε, τὸ ὃν μένος οὐδενὶ εἴκων.
ὣς φαμένη μεγάροιο διέσσυτο μαινάδι ἴση
παλλομένη κραδίην· ἅμα δ’ ἀμφίπολοι κίον αὐτῇ
αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ πύργόν τε καὶ ἀνδρῶν ἵξεν ὅμιλον
ἔστη παπτήνασ’ ἐπὶ τείχεϊ, τὸν δὲ νόησεν
ἑλκόμενον πρόσθεν πόλιος· ταχέες δέ μιν ἵπποι
ἕλκον ἀκηδέστως κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν.
τὴν δὲ κατ’ ὀφθαλμῶν ἐρεβεννὴ νὺξ ἐκάλυψεν,
ἤριπε δ’ ἐξοπίσω, ἀπὸ δὲ ψυχὴν ἐκάπυσσε.
τῆλε δ’ ἀπὸ κρατὸς βάλε δέσματα σιγαλόεντα,
ἄμπυκα κεκρύφαλόν τε ἰδὲ πλεκτὴν ἀναδέσμην
κρήδεμνόν θ’, ὅ ῥά οἱ δῶκε χρυσῆ Ἀφροδίτη
ἤματι τῷ ὅτε μιν κορυθαίολος ἠγάγεθ’ Ἕκτωρ
ἐκ δόμου Ἠετίωνος, ἐπεὶ πόρε μυρία ἕδνα.
ἀμφὶ δέ μιν γαλόῳ τε καὶ εἰνατέρες ἅλις ἔσταν,
αἵ ἑ μετὰ σφίσιν εἶχον ἀτυζομένην ἀπολέσθαι.
ἢ δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν ἔμπνυτο καὶ ἐς φρένα θυμὸς ἀγέρθη
ἀμβλήδην γοόωσα μετὰ Τρῳῇσιν ἔειπεν·
Ἕκτορ ἐγὼ δύστηνος· ἰῇ ἄρα γεινόμεθ’ αἴσῃ
ἀμφότεροι, σὺ μὲν ἐν Τροίῃ Πριάμου κατὰ δῶμα,
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ Θήβῃσιν ὑπὸ Πλάκῳ ὑληέσσῃ

480 ἐν δόμῳ Ἠετίωνος, ὅ μ’ ἔτρεφε τυτθὸν ἐοῦσαν

22.481

481 δύσμορος αἰνόμορον· ὡς μὴ ὤφελλε τεκέσθαι.
482 νῦν δὲ σὺ μὲν Ἄϊδαο δόμους ὑπὸ κεύθεσι γαίης
483 ἔρχεαι, αὐτὰρ ἐμὲ στυγερῷ ἐνὶ πένθεϊ λείπεις
484 χήρην ἐν μεγάροισι· πάϊς δ’ ἔτι νήπιος αὖτως,
485 ὃν τέκομεν σύ τ’ ἐγώ τε δυσάμμοροι· οὔτε σὺ τούτῳ
486 ἔσσεαι Ἕκτορ ὄνειαρ ἐπεὶ θάνες, οὔτε σοὶ οὗτος.
487 ἦν περ γὰρ πόλεμόν γε φύγῃ πολύδακρυν Ἀχαιῶν,
488 αἰεί τοι τούτῳ γε πόνος καὶ κήδε’ ὀπίσσω
489 ἔσσοντ’· ἄλλοι γάρ οἱ ἀπουρίσσουσιν ἀρούρας.
490 ἦμαρ δ’ ὀρφανικὸν παναφήλικα παῖδα τίθησι·
491 πάντα δ’ ὑπεμνήμυκε, δεδάκρυνται δὲ παρειαί,
492 δευόμενος δέ τ’ ἄνεισι πάϊς ἐς πατρὸς ἑταίρους,
493 ἄλλον μὲν χλαίνης ἐρύων, ἄλλον δὲ χιτῶνος·
494 τῶν δ’ ἐλεησάντων κοτύλην τις τυτθὸν ἐπέσχε·
495 χείλεα μέν τ’ ἐδίην’, ὑπερῴην δ’ οὐκ ἐδίηνε.
496 τὸν δὲ καὶ ἀμφιθαλὴς ἐκ δαιτύος ἐστυφέλιξε
497 χερσὶν πεπλήγων καὶ ὀνειδείοισιν ἐνίσσων·
498 ἔρρ’ οὕτως· οὐ σός γε πατὴρ μεταδαίνυται ἡμῖν.
499 δακρυόεις δέ τ’ ἄνεισι πάϊς ἐς μητέρα χήρην
500 Ἀστυάναξ, ὃς πρὶν μὲν ἑοῦ ἐπὶ γούνασι πατρὸς
501 μυελὸν οἶον ἔδεσκε καὶ οἰῶν πίονα δημόν·
502 αὐτὰρ ὅθ’ ὕπνος ἔλοι, παύσαιτό τε νηπιαχεύων,
503 εὕδεσκ’ ἐν λέκτροισιν ἐν ἀγκαλίδεσσι τιθήνης
504 εὐνῇ ἔνι μαλακῇ θαλέων ἐμπλησάμενος κῆρ·
505 νῦν δ’ ἂν πολλὰ πάθῃσι φίλου ἀπὸ πατρὸς ἀμαρτὼν
506 Ἀστυάναξ, ὃν Τρῶες ἐπίκλησιν καλέουσιν·
507 οἶος γάρ σφιν ἔρυσο πύλας καὶ τείχεα μακρά.
508 νῦν δὲ σὲ μὲν παρὰ νηυσὶ κορωνίσι νόσφι τοκήων
509 αἰόλαι εὐλαὶ ἔδονται, ἐπεί κε κύνες κορέσωνται
510 γυμνόν· ἀτάρ τοι εἵματ’ ἐνὶ μεγάροισι κέονται

22.511

511 λεπτά τε καὶ χαρίεντα τετυγμένα χερσὶ γυναικῶν.
512 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι τάδε πάντα καταφλέξω πυρὶ κηλέῳ
513 οὐδὲν σοί γ’ ὄφελος, ἐπεὶ οὐκ ἐγκείσεαι αὐτοῖς,
514 ἀλλὰ πρὸς Τρώων καὶ Τρωϊάδων κλέος εἶναι.
515 ὣς ἔφατο κλαίουσ’, ἐπὶ δὲ στενάχοντο γυναῖκες.

23.1

1 ὣς οἳ μὲν στενάχοντο κατὰ πτόλιν· αὐτὰρ Ἀχαιοὶ
2 ἐπεὶ δὴ νῆάς τε καὶ Ἑλλήσποντον ἵκοντο,
3 οἳ μὲν ἄρ’ ἐσκίδναντο ἐὴν ἐπὶ νῆα ἕκαστος,
4 Μυρμιδόνας δ’ οὐκ εἴα ἀποσκίδνασθαι Ἀχιλλεύς,
5 ἀλλ’ ὅ γε οἷς ἑτάροισι φιλοπτολέμοισι μετηύδα·
6 Μυρμιδόνες ταχύπωλοι ἐμοὶ ἐρίηρες ἑταῖροι
7 μὴ δή πω ὑπ’ ὄχεσφι λυώμεθα μώνυχας ἵππους,
8 ἀλλ’ αὐτοῖς ἵπποισι καὶ ἅρμασιν ἆσσον ἰόντες

9 Πάτροκλον κλαίωμεν· ὃ γὰρ γέρας ἐστὶ θανόντων.
10 αὐτὰρ ἐπεί κ’ ὀλοοῖο τεταρπώμεσθα γόοιο,
11 ἵππους λυσάμενοι δορπήσομεν ἐνθάδε πάντες.
12 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ὤμωξαν ἀολλέες, ἦρχε δ’ Ἀχιλλεύς.
13 οἳ δὲ τρὶς περὶ νεκρὸν ἐΰτριχας ἤλασαν ἵππους
14 μυρόμενοι· μετὰ δέ σφι Θέτις γόου ἵμερον ὦρσε.
15 δεύοντο ψάμαθοι, δεύοντο δὲ τεύχεα φωτῶν
16 δάκρυσι· τοῖον γὰρ πόθεον μήστωρα φόβοιο.
17 τοῖσι δὲ Πηλεΐδης ἀδινοῦ ἐξῆρχε γόοιο
18 χεῖρας ἐπ’ ἀνδροφόνους θέμενος στήθεσσιν ἑταίρου·
19 χαῖρέ μοι ὦ Πάτροκλε καὶ εἰν Ἀΐδαο δόμοισι·
20 πάντα γὰρ ἤδη τοι τελέω τὰ πάροιθεν ὑπέστην
21 Ἕκτορα δεῦρ’ ἐρύσας δώσειν κυσὶν ὠμὰ δάσασθαι,
22 δώδεκα δὲ προπάροιθε πυρῆς ἀποδειροτομήσειν
23 Τρώων ἀγλαὰ τέκνα σέθεν κταμένοιο χολωθείς.
24 ἦ ῥα καὶ Ἕκτορα δῖον ἀεικέα μήδετο ἔργα
25 πρηνέα πὰρ λεχέεσσι Μενοιτιάδαο τανύσσας
26 ἐν κονίῃς· οἳ δ’ ἔντε’ ἀφωπλίζοντο ἕκαστος
27 χάλκεα μαρμαίροντα, λύον δ’ ὑψηχέας ἵππους,
28 κὰδ δ’ ἵζον παρὰ νηῒ ποδώκεος Αἰακίδαο
29 μυρίοι· αὐτὰρ ὃ τοῖσι τάφον μενοεικέα δαίνυ.
30 πολλοὶ μὲν βόες ἀργοὶ ὀρέχθεον ἀμφὶ σιδήρῳ
Thus did they make their moan throughout the city, while the Achaeans when they reached the Hellespont went back every man to his own ship. But Achilles would not let the Myrmidons go, and spoke to his brave comrades saying, "Myrmidons, famed horsemen and my own trusted friends, not yet, I say, let us unyoke, but with horse and chariot draw near to the body and mourn Patroklos, in due honor to the dead. When we have had full comfort of lamentation we will unyoke our horses and take supper all of us here." On this they all joined in a cry of wailing and Achilles led them in their lament. Thrice did they drive their chariots all sorrowing round the body, and Thetis stirred within them a still deeper yearning. The sands of the seashore and the men's armor were wet with their weeping, so great a minister of fear was he whom they had lost. Chief in all their mourning was the son of Peleus: he laid his bloodstained hand on the breast of his friend. "Fare well," he cried, "Patroklos, even in the house of Hades. I will now do all that I erewhile promised you; I will drag Hektor hither and let dogs devour him raw; twelve noble sons of Trojans will I also slay before your pyre to avenge you." As he spoke he treated the body of noble Hektor with contumely, laying it at full length in the dust beside the bier of Patroklos. The others then put off every man his armor, took the horses from their chariots, and seated themselves in great multitude by the ship of the fleet descendant of Aiakos, who thereon feasted them with an abundant funeral banquet. Many a goodly ox, with many a sheep and bleating goat did they butcher and cut up; many a tusked boar moreover, fat and well-fed, did they singe and set to roast in the flames of Hephaistos; and rivulets of blood flowed all round the place where the body was lying. Then the princes of the Achaeans took the son of Peleus to Agamemnon, but hardly could they persuade him to come with them, so wroth was he for the death of his comrade. As soon as they reached Agamemnon's tent they told the serving-men to set a large tripod over the fire in case they might persuade the son of Peleus ‘to wash the clotted gore from this body, but he denied them sternly, and swore it with a solemn oath, saying, "Nay, by King Zeus, first and mightiest of all gods, it is not right [themis] that water should touch my body, till I have laid Patroklos on the flames, have built him a tomb [sêma], and shaved my head - for so long as I live no such second sorrow [akhos] shall ever draw nigh me. Now, therefore, let us do all that this sad festival

demands, but at break of day, King Agamemnon, bid your men bring wood, and provide all else that the dead may duly take into the realm of darkness; the fire shall thus burn him out of our sight the sooner, and the people shall turn again to their own labors." Thus did he speak, and they did even as he had said. They made haste to prepare the meal, they ate, and every man had his full share so that all were satisfied. As soon as they had had enough to eat and drink, the others went to their rest each in his own tent, but the son of Peleus lay grieving among his Myrmidons by the shore of the sounding sea, in an open place where the waves came surging in one after another. Here a very deep slumber took hold upon him and eased the burden of his sorrows, for his limbs were weary with chasing Hektor round windy Ilion. Presently the sad spirit [psukhê] of Patroklos drew near him, like what he had been in stature, voice, and the light of his beaming eyes, clad, too, as he had been clad in life. The spirit hovered over his head and said- "You sleep, Achilles, and have forgotten me; you loved me living, but now that I am dead you think for me no further. Bury me with all speed that I may pass the gates of Hades; the ghosts [psukhai], vain shadows of men that can labor no more, drive me away from them; they will not yet suffer me to join those that are beyond the river, and I wander all desolate by the wide gates of the house of Hades. Give me now your hand I pray you, for when you have once given me my dues of fire, never shall I again come forth out of the house of Hades. Nevermore shall we sit apart and take sweet counsel among the living; the cruel fate which was my birth-right has yawned its wide jaws around me - nay, you too Achilles, peer of gods, are doomed to die beneath the wall of the noble Trojans. "One prayer more will I make you, if you will grant it; let not my bones be laid apart from yours, Achilles, but with them; even as we were brought up together in your own home, what time Menoitios brought me to you as a child from Opoeis because by a sad spite I had killed the son of Amphidamas - not of set purpose, but in childish quarrel over the dice. The horseman Peleus took me into his house, entreated me kindly, and named me to be your squire [therapôn]; therefore let our bones lie in but a single urn, the two-handled golden vase given to you by your mother."

23.31

31 σφαζόμενοι, πολλοὶ δ’ ὄϊες καὶ μηκάδες αἶγες·
32 πολλοὶ δ’ ἀργιόδοντες ὗες θαλέθοντες ἀλοιφῇ
33 εὐόμενοι τανύοντο διὰ φλογὸς Ἡφαίστοιο·
34 πάντῃ δ’ ἀμφὶ νέκυν κοτυλήρυτον ἔρρεεν αἷμα.
35 αὐτὰρ τόν γε ἄνακτα ποδώκεα Πηλεΐωνα
36 εἰς Ἀγαμέμνονα δῖον ἄγον βασιλῆες Ἀχαιῶν
37 σπουδῇ παρπεπιθόντες ἑταίρου χωόμενον κῆρ.
38 οἳ δ’ ὅτε δὴ κλισίην Ἀγαμέμνονος ἷξον ἰόντες,
39 αὐτίκα κηρύκεσσι λιγυφθόγγοισι κέλευσαν
40 ἀμφὶ πυρὶ στῆσαι τρίποδα μέγαν, εἰ πεπίθοιεν
41 Πηλεΐδην λούσασθαι ἄπο βρότον αἱματόεντα.
42 αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἠρνεῖτο στερεῶς, ἐπὶ δ’ ὅρκον ὄμοσσεν·
43 οὐ μὰ Ζῆν’, ὅς τίς τε θεῶν ὕπατος καὶ ἄριστος,
44 οὐ θέμις ἐστὶ λοετρὰ καρήατος ἆσσον ἰκέσθαι
45 πρίν γ’ ἐνὶ Πάτροκλον θέμεναι πυρὶ σῆμά τε χεῦαι
46 κείρασθαί τε κόμην, ἐπεὶ οὔ μ’ ἔτι δεύτερον ὧδε
47 ἵξετ’ ἄχος κραδίην ὄφρα ζωοῖσι μετείω.
48 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι νῦν μὲν στυγερῇ πειθώμεθα δαιτί·
49 ἠῶθεν δ’ ὄτρυνον ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγάμεμνον
50 ὕλην τ’ ἀξέμεναι παρά τε σχεῖν ὅσσ’ ἐπιεικὲς
51 νεκρὸν ἔχοντα νέεσθαι ὑπὸ ζόφον ἠερόεντα,
52 ὄφρ’ ἤτοι τοῦτον μὲν ἐπιφλέγῃ ἀκάματον πῦρ

53 θᾶσσον ἀπ’ ὀφθαλμῶν, λαοὶ δ’ ἐπὶ ἔργα τράπωνται.
54 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα τοῦ μάλα μὲν κλύον ἠδὲ πίθοντο.
55 ἐσσυμένως δ’ ἄρα δόρπον ἐφοπλίσσαντες ἕκαστοι
56 δαίνυντ’, οὐδέ τι θυμὸς ἐδεύετο δαιτὸς ἐΐσης.
57 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ πόσιος καὶ ἐδητύος ἐξ ἔρον ἔντο,
58 οἳ μὲν κακκείοντες ἔβαν κλισίην δὲ ἕκαστος,
59 Πηλεΐδης δ’ ἐπὶ θινὶ πολυφλοίσβοιο θαλάσσης
60 κεῖτο βαρὺ στενάχων πολέσιν μετὰ Μυρμιδόνεσσιν

23.61

61 ἐν καθαρῷ, ὅθι κύματ’ ἐπ’ ἠϊόνος κλύζεσκον·
62 εὖτε τὸν ὕπνος ἔμαρπτε λύων μελεδήματα θυμοῦ
63 νήδυμος ἀμφιχυθείς· μάλα γὰρ κάμε φαίδιμα γυῖα
64 Ἕκτορ’ ἐπαΐσσων προτὶ Ἴλιον ἠνεμόεσσαν·
65 ἦλθε δ’ ἐπὶ ψυχὴ Πατροκλῆος δειλοῖο
66 πάντ’ αὐτῷ μέγεθός τε καὶ ὄμματα κάλ’ ἐϊκυῖα
67 καὶ φωνήν, καὶ τοῖα περὶ χροῒ εἵματα ἕστο·
68 στῆ δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπὲρ κεφαλῆς καί μιν πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν·
69 εὕδεις, αὐτὰρ ἐμεῖο λελασμένος ἔπλευ Ἀχιλλεῦ.
70 οὐ μέν μευ ζώοντος ἀκήδεις, ἀλλὰ θανόντος·
71 θάπτέ με ὅττι τάχιστα πύλας Ἀΐδαο περήσω.
72 τῆλέ με εἴργουσι ψυχαὶ εἴδωλα καμόντων,
73 οὐδέ μέ πω μίσγεσθαι ὑπὲρ ποταμοῖο ἐῶσιν,
74 ἀλλ’ αὖτως ἀλάλημαι ἀν’ εὐρυπυλὲς Ἄϊδος δῶ.
75 καί μοι δὸς τὴν χεῖρ’· ὀλοφύρομαι, οὐ γὰρ ἔτ’ αὖτις
76 νίσομαι ἐξ Ἀΐδαο, ἐπήν με πυρὸς λελάχητε.
77 οὐ μὲν γὰρ ζωοί γε φίλων ἀπάνευθεν ἑταίρων
78 βουλὰς ἑζόμενοι βουλεύσομεν, ἀλλ’ ἐμὲ μὲν κὴρ
79 ἀμφέχανε στυγερή, ἥ περ λάχε γιγνόμενόν περ·
80 καὶ δὲ σοὶ αὐτῷ μοῖρα, θεοῖς ἐπιείκελ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ,
81 τείχει ὕπο Τρώων εὐηφενέων ἀπολέσθαι.
82 ἄλλο δέ τοι ἐρέω καὶ ἐφήσομαι αἴ κε πίθηαι·
83 μὴ ἐμὰ σῶν ἀπάνευθε τιθήμεναι ὀστέ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ,
84 ἀλλ’ ὁμοῦ ὡς ἐτράφημεν ἐν ὑμετέροισι δόμοισιν,
85 εὖτέ με τυτθὸν ἐόντα Μενοίτιος ἐξ Ὀπόεντος
86 ἤγαγεν ὑμέτερόνδ’ ἀνδροκτασίης ὕπο λυγρῆς,
87 ἤματι τῷ ὅτε παῖδα κατέκτανον Ἀμφιδάμαντος
88 νήπιος οὐκ ἐθέλων ἀμφ’ ἀστραγάλοισι χολωθείς·
89 ἔνθά με δεξάμενος ἐν δώμασιν ἱππότα Πηλεὺς
90 ἔτραφέ τ’ ἐνδυκέως καὶ σὸν θεράποντ’ ὀνόμηνεν·

23.91

91 ὣς δὲ καὶ ὀστέα νῶϊν ὁμὴ σορὸς ἀμφικαλύπτοι
92 χρύσεος ἀμφιφορεύς, τόν τοι πόρε πότνια μήτηρ.
93 τὸν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
94 τίπτέ μοι ἠθείη κεφαλὴ δεῦρ’ εἰλήλουθας
95 καί μοι ταῦτα ἕκαστ’ ἐπιτέλλεαι; αὐτὰρ ἐγώ τοι
96 πάντα μάλ’ ἐκτελέω καὶ πείσομαι ὡς σὺ κελεύεις.
97 ἀλλά μοι ἆσσον στῆθι· μίνυνθά περ ἀμφιβαλόντε
98 ἀλλήλους ὀλοοῖο τεταρπώμεσθα γόοιο.

99 ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ὠρέξατο χερσὶ φίλῃσιν
100 οὐδ’ ἔλαβε· ψυχὴ δὲ κατὰ χθονὸς ἠΰτε καπνὸς
101 ᾤχετο τετριγυῖα· ταφὼν δ’ ἀνόρουσεν Ἀχιλλεὺς
102 χερσί τε συμπλατάγησεν, ἔπος δ’ ὀλοφυδνὸν ἔειπεν·
103 ὢ πόποι ἦ ῥά τίς ἐστι καὶ εἰν Ἀΐδαο δόμοισι
104 ψυχὴ καὶ εἴδωλον, ἀτὰρ φρένες οὐκ ἔνι πάμπαν·
105 παννυχίη γάρ μοι Πατροκλῆος δειλοῖο
106 ψυχὴ ἐφεστήκει γοόωσά τε μυρομένη τε,
107 καί μοι ἕκαστ’ ἐπέτελλεν, ἔϊκτο δὲ θέσκελον αὐτῷ.
108 ὣς φάτο, τοῖσι δὲ πᾶσιν ὑφ’ ἵμερον ὦρσε γόοιο·
109 μυρομένοισι δὲ τοῖσι φάνη ῥοδοδάκτυλος Ἠὼς
110 ἀμφὶ νέκυν ἐλεεινόν. ἀτὰρ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων
111 οὐρῆάς τ’ ὄτρυνε καὶ ἀνέρας ἀξέμεν ὕλην
112 πάντοθεν ἐκ κλισιῶν· ἐπὶ δ’ ἀνὴρ ἐσθλὸς ὀρώρει
113 Μηριόνης θεράπων ἀγαπήνορος Ἰδομενῆος.
114 οἳ δ’ ἴσαν ὑλοτόμους πελέκεας ἐν χερσὶν ἔχοντες
115 σειράς τ’ εὐπλέκτους· πρὸ δ’ ἄρ’ οὐρῆες κίον αὐτῶν.
116 πολλὰ δ’ ἄναντα κάταντα πάραντά τε δόχμιά τ’ ἦλθον·
117 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ κνημοὺς προσέβαν πολυπίδακος Ἴδης,
118 αὐτίκ’ ἄρα δρῦς ὑψικόμους ταναήκεϊ χαλκῷ
119 τάμνον ἐπειγόμενοι· ταὶ δὲ μεγάλα κτυπέουσαι
120 πῖπτον· τὰς μὲν ἔπειτα διαπλήσσοντες Ἀχαιοὶ

And Achilles answered, "Why, true heart, are you come hither to lay these charges upon me? will of my own self do all as you have bidden me. Draw closer to me, let us once more throw our arms around one another, and find sad comfort in the sharing of our sorrows." He opened his arms towards him as he spoke and would have clasped him in them, but there was nothing, and the spirit [psukhê] vanished as a vapor, gibbering and whining into the earth. Achilles sprang to his feet, smote his two hands, and made lamentation saying, "Of a truth even in the house of Hades there are ghosts [psukhai] and phantoms that have no life in them; all night long the sad spirit [psukhê] of Patroklos has hovered over head making piteous moan, telling me what I am to do for him, and looking wondrously like himself." Thus did he speak and his words set them all weeping and mourning about the poor dumb dead, till rosy-fingered morn appeared. Then King Agamemnon sent men and mules from all parts of the camp, to bring wood, and Meriones, squire [therapôn] to Idomeneus, was in charge over them. They went out with woodmen's axes and strong ropes in their hands, and before them went the mules. Up hill and down dale did they go, by straight ways and crooked, and when they reached the heights of many-fountained Ida, they laid their axes to the roots of many a tall branching oak that came thundering down as they felled it. They split the trees and bound them behind the mules, which then wended their way as they best could through the thick brushwood on to the plain. All who had been cutting wood bore logs, for so Meriones squire [therapôn] to Idomeneus had bidden them, and they threw them down in a line upon the seashore at the place where Achilles would make a mighty monument for Patroklos and for himself. When they had thrown down their great logs of wood over the whole ground, they stayed all of them where they were, but Achilles ordered his brave Myrmidons to gird on their armor, and to yoke each man his horses; they therefore rose, girded on their armor and mounted each his chariot - they and their charioteers with them. The chariots went before, and they that were on foot followed as a cloud in their tens of thousands after. In the midst of them his comrades bore Patroklos and covered him with the locks of their hair which they cut off and threw upon his body. Last came Achilles with his head bowed for sorrow, so noble a comrade was he taking to the house of Hades. When they came to the place of which Achilles had told them they laid

the body down and built up the wood. Achilles then bethought him of another matter. He went a space away from the pyre, and cut off the yellow lock which he had let grow for the river Spercheios. He looked all sorrowfully out upon the dark sea [pontos], and said, "Spercheios, in vain did my father Peleus vow to you that when I returned home to my loved native land I should cut off this lock and offer you a holy hecatomb; fifty she-goats was I to sacrifice to you there at your springs, where is your grove and your altar fragrant with burnt-offerings. Thus did my father vow, but you have not fulfilled the thinking [noos] of his prayer; now, therefore, that I shall see my home no more, I give this lock as a keepsake to the hero Patroklos." As he spoke he placed the lock in the hands of his dear comrade, and all who stood by were filled with yearning and lamentation. The sun would have gone down upon their mourning had not Achilles presently said to Agamemnon, "Son of Atreus, for it is to you that the people will give ear, there is a time to mourn and a time to cease from mourning; bid the people now leave the pyre and set about getting their dinners: we, to whom the dead is dearest, will see to what is wanted here, and let the other princes also stay by me." When King Agamemnon heard this he dismissed the people to their ships, but those who were about the dead heaped up wood and built a pyre a hundred feet this way and that; then they laid the dead all sorrowfully upon the top of it. They flayed and dressed many fat sheep and oxen before the pyre, and Achilles took fat from all of them and wrapped the body therein from head to foot, heaping the flayed carcasses all round it. Against the bier he leaned two-handled jars of honey and unguents; four proud horses did he then cast upon the pyre, groaning the while he did so. The dead hero had had house-dogs; two of them did Achilles slay and threw upon the pyre; he also put twelve brave sons of noble Trojans to the sword and laid them with the rest, for he was full of bitterness and fury.

23.121

121 ἔκδεον ἡμιόνων· ταὶ δὲ χθόνα ποσσὶ δατεῦντο
122 ἐλδόμεναι πεδίοιο διὰ ῥωπήϊα πυκνά.
123 πάντες δ’ ὑλοτόμοι φιτροὺς φέρον· ὡς γὰρ ἀνώγει
124 Μηριόνης θεράπων ἀγαπήνορος Ἰδομενῆος.
125 κὰδ δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπ’ ἀκτῆς βάλλον ἐπισχερώ, ἔνθ’ ἄρ’ Ἀχιλλεὺς
126 φράσσατο Πατρόκλῳ μέγα ἠρίον ἠδὲ οἷ αὐτῷ.
127 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ πάντῃ παρακάββαλον ἄσπετον ὕλην
128 ἧατ’ ἄρ’ αὖθι μένοντες ἀολλέες. αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
129 αὐτίκα Μυρμιδόνεσσι φιλοπτολέμοισι κέλευσε
130 χαλκὸν ζώννυσθαι, ζεῦξαι δ’ ὑπ’ ὄχεσφιν ἕκαστον
131 ἵππους· οἳ δ’ ὄρνυντο καὶ ἐν τεύχεσσιν ἔδυνον,
132 ἂν δ’ ἔβαν ἐν δίφροισι παραιβάται ἡνίοχοί τε,
133 πρόσθε μὲν ἱππῆες, μετὰ δὲ νέφος εἵπετο πεζῶν
134 μυρίοι· ἐν δὲ μέσοισι φέρον Πάτροκλον ἑταῖροι.
135 θριξὶ δὲ πάντα νέκυν καταείνυσαν, ἃς ἐπέβαλλον
136 κειρόμενοι· ὄπιθεν δὲ κάρη ἔχε δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
137 ἀχνύμενος· ἔταρον γὰρ ἀμύμονα πέμπ’ Ἄϊδος δέ.
138 οἳ δ’ ὅτε χῶρον ἵκανον ὅθί σφισι πέφραδ’ Ἀχιλλεὺς
139 κάτθεσαν, αἶψα δέ οἱ μενοεικέα νήεον ὕλην.
140 ἔνθ’ αὖτ’ ἄλλ’ ἐνόησε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
141 στὰς ἀπάνευθε πυρῆς ξανθὴν ἀπεκείρατο χαίτην,
142 τήν ῥα Σπερχειῷ ποταμῷ τρέφε τηλεθόωσαν·
143 ὀχθήσας δ’ ἄρα εἶπεν ἰδὼν ἐπὶ οἴνοπα πόντον·
144 Σπερχεί’ ἄλλως σοί γε πατὴρ ἠρήσατο Πηλεὺς
145 κεῖσέ με νοστήσαντα φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν

146 σοί τε κόμην κερέειν ῥέξειν θ’ ἱερὴν ἑκατόμβην,
147 πεντήκοντα δ’ ἔνορχα παρ’ αὐτόθι μῆλ’ ἱερεύσειν
148 ἐς πηγάς, ὅθι τοι τέμενος βωμός τε θυήεις.
149 ὣς ἠρᾶθ’ ὁ γέρων, σὺ δέ οἱ νόον οὐκ ἐτέλεσσας.
150 νῦν δ’ ἐπεὶ οὐ νέομαί γε φίλην ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν

23.151

151 Πατρόκλῳ ἥρωϊ κόμην ὀπάσαιμι φέρεσθαι.
152 ὣς εἰπὼν ἐν χερσὶ κόμην ἑτάροιο φίλοιο
153 θῆκεν, τοῖσι δὲ πᾶσιν ὑφ’ ἵμερον ὦρσε γόοιο.
154 καί νύ κ’ ὀδυρομένοισιν ἔδυ φάος ἠελίοιο
155 εἰ μὴ Ἀχιλλεὺς αἶψ’ Ἀγαμέμνονι εἶπε παραστάς·
156 Ἀτρεΐδη, σοὶ γάρ τε μάλιστά γε λαὸς Ἀχαιῶν
157 πείσονται μύθοισι, γόοιο μὲν ἔστι καὶ ἆσαι,
158 νῦν δ’ ἀπὸ πυρκαϊῆς σκέδασον καὶ δεῖπνον ἄνωχθι
159 ὄπλεσθαι· τάδε δ’ ἀμφὶ πονησόμεθ’ οἷσι μάλιστα
160 κήδεός ἐστι νέκυς· παρὰ δ’ οἵ τ’ ἀγοὶ ἄμμι μενόντων.
161 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ τό γ’ ἄκουσεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων,
162 αὐτίκα λαὸν μὲν σκέδασεν κατὰ νῆας ἐΐσας,
163 κηδεμόνες δὲ παρ’ αὖθι μένον καὶ νήεον ὕλην,
164 ποίησαν δὲ πυρὴν ἑκατόμπεδον ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα,
165 ἐν δὲ πυρῇ ὑπάτῃ νεκρὸν θέσαν ἀχνύμενοι κῆρ.
166 πολλὰ δὲ ἴφια μῆλα καὶ εἰλίποδας ἕλικας βοῦς
167 πρόσθε πυρῆς ἔδερόν τε καὶ ἄμφεπον· ἐκ δ’ ἄρα πάντων
168 δημὸν ἑλὼν ἐκάλυψε νέκυν μεγάθυμος Ἀχιλλεὺς
169 ἐς πόδας ἐκ κεφαλῆς, περὶ δὲ δρατὰ σώματα νήει.
170 ἐν δ’ ἐτίθει μέλιτος καὶ ἀλείφατος ἀμφιφορῆας
171 πρὸς λέχεα κλίνων· πίσυρας δ’ ἐριαύχενας ἵππους
172 ἐσσυμένως ἐνέβαλλε πυρῇ μεγάλα στεναχίζων.
173 ἐννέα τῷ γε ἄνακτι τραπεζῆες κύνες ἦσαν,
174 καὶ μὲν τῶν ἐνέβαλλε πυρῇ δύο δειροτομήσας,
175 δώδεκα δὲ Τρώων μεγαθύμων υἱέας ἐσθλοὺς
176 χαλκῷ δηϊόων· κακὰ δὲ φρεσὶ μήδετο ἔργα·
177 ἐν δὲ πυρὸς μένος ἧκε σιδήρεον ὄφρα νέμοιτο.
178 ᾤμωξέν τ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα, φίλον δ’ ὀνόμηνεν ἑταῖρον·
179 χαῖρέ μοι ὦ Πάτροκλε καὶ εἰν Ἀΐδαο δόμοισι·
180 πάντα γὰρ ἤδη τοι τελέω τὰ πάροιθεν ὑπέστην,
Then he committed all to the resistless and devouring might of the fire; he groaned aloud and called on his dead comrade by name. "Fare well," he cried, "Patroklos, even in the house of Hades; I am now doing all that I have promised you. Twelve brave sons of noble Trojans shall the flames consume along with yourself, but dogs, not fire, shall devour the flesh of Hektor son of Priam." Thus did he vaunt, but the dogs came not about the body of Hektor, for Zeus' daughter Aphrodite kept them off him night and day, and anointed him with ambrosial oil of roses that his flesh might not be torn when Achilles was dragging him about. Phoebus Apollo moreover sent a dark cloud from heaven to earth, which gave shade to the whole place where Hektor lay, that the heat of the sun might not parch his body. Now the pyre about dead Patroklos would not kindle. Achilles therefore bethought him of another matter; he went apart and prayed to the two winds Boreas and Zephyros vowing them goodly offerings. He made them many drink-offerings from the golden cup and besought them to come and help him that the wood might make haste to kindle and the dead bodies be consumed. Fleet Iris heard him praying and started off to fetch the winds.

They were holding high feast in the house of boisterous Zephyros when Iris came running up to the stone threshold of the house and stood there, but as soon as they set eyes on her they all came towards her and each of them called her to him, but Iris would not sit down. "I cannot stay," she said, "I must go back to the streams of Okeanos and the land of the Ethiopians who are offering hecatombs to the immortals, and I would have my share; but Achilles prays that Boreas and shrill Zephyros will come to him, and he vows them goodly offerings; he would have you blow upon the pyre of Patroklos for whom all the Achaeans are lamenting." With this she left them, and the two winds rose with a cry that rent the air and swept the clouds before them. They blew on and on until they came to the sea [pontos], and the waves rose high beneath them, but when they reached Troy they fell upon the pyre till the mighty flames roared under the blast that they blew. All night long did they blow hard and beat upon the fire, and all night long did Achilles grasp his double cup, drawing wine from a mixing-bowl of gold, and calling upon the spirit [psukhê] of dead Patroklos as he poured it upon the ground until the earth was drenched. As a father mourns when he is burning the bones of his bridegroom son whose death has wrung the hearts of his parents, even so did Achilles mourn while burning the body of his comrade, pacing round the bier with piteous groaning and lamentation. At length as the Morning Star was beginning to herald the light which saffron-mantled Dawn was soon to suffuse over the sea, the flames fell and the fire began to die. The winds then went home beyond the Thracian sea [pontos], which roared and boiled as they swept over it. The son of Peleus now turned away from the pyre and lay down, overcome with toil, till he fell into a sweet slumber. Presently they who were about the son of Atreus drew near in a body, and roused him with the noise and tramp of their coming. He sat upright and said, "Son of Atreus, and all other princes of the Achaeans, first pour red wine everywhere upon the fire and quench it; let us then gather the bones of Patroklos son of Menoitios, singling them out with care; they are easily found, for they lie in the middle of the pyre, while all else, both men and horses, has been thrown in a heap and burned at the outer edge. We will lay the bones in a golden urn, in two layers of fat, against the time when I shall myself go down into the house of Hades. As for the barrow, labor not to raise a great one now, but such as is reasonable. Afterwards, let those Achaeans who may be left at the ships when I am gone, build it both broad and high." Thus he spoke and they obeyed the word of the son of Peleus. First they poured red wine upon the thick layer of ashes and quenched the fire. With many tears they singled out the whitened bones of their loved comrade and laid them within a golden urn in two layers of fat: they then covered the urn with a linen cloth and took it inside the tent. They marked off the circle where the tomb [sêma] should be, made a foundation for it about the pyre, and forthwith heaped up the earth. When they had thus raised a mound [sêma] they were going away, but Achilles stayed the people and made them sit in assembly [agôn]. He brought prizes from the ships - cauldrons, tripods, horses and mules, noble oxen, women with fair girdles, and swart iron. The first prize he offered was for the chariot races - a woman skilled in all useful arts, and a three-legged cauldron that had ears for handles, and would hold twenty-two measures. This was for the man who came in first. For the second there was a six-year old mare, unbroken, and in foal to a he-ass; the third was to have a goodly cauldron that had never yet been on the fire; it was still bright as when it left the maker, and would hold four measures. The fourth prize was two talents of gold, and the fifth a two-handled urn as yet unsoiled by smoke. Then he stood up and spoke among the Argives saying- "Son of Atreus, and all other Achaeans, these are the prizes that lie waiting the winners in the contest [agôn] of the chariot races. At any other time I should carry off the first prize and take it to my own tent; you know how much my steeds are better in excellence [aretê] than all others - for they are immortal; Poseidon gave them to my father Peleus, who in his turn gave them to myself; but I shall hold aloof, I and my steeds that have lost the glory [kleos] of their brave and kind driver, who many a time has washed them in clear water and

anointed their manes with oil. See how they stand weeping here, with their manes trailing on the ground in the extremity of their sorrow. But do you others set yourselves in order throughout the host, whosoever has confidence in his horses and in the strength of his chariot."

23.181

δώδεκα μὲν Τρώων μεγαθύμων υἱέας ἐσθλοὺς
τοὺς ἅμα σοὶ πάντας πῦρ ἐσθίει· Ἕκτορα δ’ οὔ τι
δώσω Πριαμίδην πυρὶ δαπτέμεν, ἀλλὰ κύνεσσιν.
ὣς φάτ’ ἀπειλήσας· τὸν δ’ οὐ κύνες ἀμφεπένοντο,
ἀλλὰ κύνας μὲν ἄλαλκε Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἀφροδίτη
ἤματα καὶ νύκτας, ῥοδόεντι δὲ χρῖεν ἐλαίῳ
ἀμβροσίῳ, ἵνα μή μιν ἀποδρύφοι ἑλκυστάζων.
τῷ δ’ ἐπὶ κυάνεον νέφος ἦγαγε Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων
οὐρανόθεν πεδίον δέ, κάλυψε δὲ χῶρον ἅπαντα
ὅσσον ἐπεῖχε νέκυς, μὴ πρὶν μένος ἠελίοιο
σκήλει’ ἀμφὶ περὶ χρόα ἵνεσιν ἠδὲ μέλεσσιν.
οὐδὲ πυρὴ Πατρόκλου ἐκαίετο τεθνηῶτος·
ἔνθ’ αὖτ’ ἀλλ’ ἐνόησε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
στὰς ἀπάνευθε πυρῆς δοιοῖς ἠρᾶτ’ ἀνέμοισι
Βορέῃ καὶ Ζεφύρῳ, καὶ ὑπίσχετο ἱερὰ καλά·
πολλὰ δὲ καὶ σπένδων χρυσέῳ δέπαϊ λιτάνευεν
ἐλθέμεν, ὄφρα τάχιστα πυρὶ φλεγεθοίατο νεκροί,
ὕλη τε σεύαιτο καήμεναι. ὦκα δὲ Ἶρις
ἀράων ἀΐουσα μετάγγελος ἦλθ’ ἀνέμοισιν.
οἳ μὲν ἄρα Ζεφύροιο δυσαέος ἀθρόοι ἔνδον
εἰλαπίνην δαίνυντο· θέουσα δὲ Ἶρις ἐπέστη
βηλῷ ἔπι λιθέῳ· τοὶ δ’ ὡς ἴδον ὀφθαλμοῖσι
πάντες ἀνήϊξαν, κάλεόν τέ μιν εἰς ἕ ἕκαστος·
ἣ δ’ αὖθ’ ἕζεσθαι μὲν ἀνήνατο, εἶπε δὲ μῦθον·
οὐχ ἕδος· εἶμι γὰρ αὖτις ἐπ’ Ὠκεανοῖο ῥέεθρα
Αἰθιόπων ἐς γαῖαν, ὅθι ῥέζουσ’ ἑκατόμβας
ἀθανάτοις, ἵνα δὴ καὶ ἐγὼ μεταδαίσομαι ἱρῶν.
ἀλλ’ Ἀχιλεὺς Βορέην ἠδὲ Ζέφυρον κελαδεινὸν
ἐλθεῖν ἀρᾶται, καὶ ὑπίσχεται ἱερὰ καλά,
ὄφρα πυρὴν ὄρσητε καήμεναι, ᾗ ἔνι κεῖται

23.211

Πάτροκλος, τὸν πάντες ἀναστενάχουσιν Ἀχαιοί.
ἣ μὲν ἄρ’ ὣς εἰποῦσ’ ἀπεβήσετο, τοὶ δ’ ὀρέοντο
ἠχῇ θεσπεσίῃ νέφεα κλονέοντε πάροιθεν.
αἶψα δὲ πόντον ἵκανον ἀήμεναι, ὦρτο δὲ κῦμα
πνοιῇ ὕπο λιγυρῇ· Τροίην δ’ ἐρίβωλον ἱκέσθην,
ἐν δὲ πυρῇ πεσέτην, μέγα δ’ ἴαχε θεσπιδαὲς πῦρ.
παννύχιοι δ’ ἄρα τοί γε πυρῆς ἄμυδις φλόγ’ ἔβαλλον
φυσῶντες λιγέως· ὃ δὲ πάννυχος ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεὺς
χρυσέου ἐκ κρητῆρος ἐλὼν δέπας ἀμφικύπελλον
οἶνον ἀφυσσόμενος χαμάδις χέε, δεῦε δὲ γαῖαν
ψυχὴν κικλήσκων Πατροκλῆος δειλοῖο.
ὡς δὲ πατὴρ οὗ παιδὸς ὀδύρεται ὀστέα καίων

νυμφίου, ὅς τε θανὼν δειλοὺς ἀκάχησε τοκῆας,
ὣς Ἀχιλεὺς ἑτάροιο ὀδύρετο ὀστέα καίων,
ἑρπύζων παρὰ πυρκαϊὴν ἀδινὰ στεναχίζων.
ἦμος δ’ ἐωσφόρος εἶσι φόως ἐρέων ἐπὶ γαῖαν,
ὅν τε μέτα κροκόπεπλος ὑπεὶρ ἅλα κίδναται ἠώς,
τῆμος πυρκαϊὴ ἐμαραίνετο, παύσατο δὲ φλόξ.
οἳ δ’ ἄνεμοι πάλιν αὖτις ἔβαν οἶκον δὲ νέεσθαι
Θρηΐκιον κατὰ πόντον· ὃ δ’ ἔστενεν οἴδματι θύων.
Πηλεΐδης δ’ ἀπὸ πυρκαϊῆς ἑτέρωσε λιασθεὶς
κλίνθη κεκμηώς, ἐπὶ δὲ γλυκὺς ὕπνος ὄρουσεν·
οἳ δ’ ἀμφ’ Ἀτρεΐωνα ἀολλέες ἠγερέθοντο·
τῶν μιν ἐπερχομένων ὅμαδος καὶ δοῦπος ἔγειρεν,
ἕζετο δ’ ὀρθωθεὶς καί σφεας πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν·
Ἀτρεΐδη τε καὶ ἄλλοι ἀριστῆες Παναχαιῶν,
πρῶτον μὲν κατὰ πυρκαϊὴν σβέσατ’ αἴθοπι οἴνῳ
πᾶσαν, ὁπόσσον ἐπέσχε πυρὸς μένος· αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
ὀστέα Πατρόκλοιο Μενοιτιάδαο λέγωμεν
εὖ διαγιγνώσκοντες· ἀριφραδέα δὲ τέτυκται·

23.241

ἐν μέσσῃ γὰρ ἔκειτο πυρῇ, τοὶ δ’ ἄλλοι ἄνευθεν
ἐσχατιῇ καίοντ’ ἐπιμὶξ ἵπποι τε καὶ ἄνδρες.
καὶ τὰ μὲν ἐν χρυσέῃ φιάλῃ καὶ δίπλακι δημῷ
θείομεν, εἰς ὅ κεν αὐτὸς ἐγὼν Ἄϊδι κεύθωμαι.
τύμβον δ’ οὐ μάλα πολλὸν ἐγὼ πονέεσθαι ἄνωγα,
ἀλλ’ ἐπιεικέα τοῖον· ἔπειτα δὲ καὶ τὸν Ἀχαιοὶ
εὐρύν θ’ ὑψηλόν τε τιθήμεναι, οἵ κεν ἐμεῖο
δεύτεροι ἐν νήεσσι πολυκλήϊσι λίπησθε.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἐπίθοντο ποδώκεϊ Πηλεΐωνι.
πρῶτον μὲν κατὰ πυρκαϊὴν σβέσαν αἴθοπι οἴνῳ
ὅσσον ἐπὶ φλὸξ ἦλθε, βαθεῖα δὲ κάππεσε τέφρη·
κλαίοντες δ’ ἑτάροιο ἐνηέος ὀστέα λευκὰ
ἄλλεγον ἐς χρυσέην φιάλην καὶ δίπλακα δημόν,
ἐν κλισίῃσι δὲ θέντες ἐανῷ λιτὶ κάλυψαν·
τορνώσαντο δὲ σῆμα θεμείλιά τε προβάλοντο
ἀμφὶ πυρήν· εἶθαρ δὲ χυτὴν ἐπὶ γαῖαν ἔχευαν,
χεύαντες δὲ τὸ σῆμα πάλιν κίον. αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
αὐτοῦ λαὸν ἔρυκε καὶ ἵζανεν εὐρὺν ἀγῶνα,
νηῶν δ’ ἔκφερ’ ἄεθλα λέβητάς τε τρίποδάς τε
ἵππους θ’ ἡμιόνους τε βοῶν τ’ ἴφθιμα κάρηνα,
ἠδὲ γυναῖκας ἐϋζώνους πολιόν τε σίδηρον.
ἱππεῦσιν μὲν πρῶτα ποδώκεσιν ἀγλά’ ἄεθλα
θῆκε γυναῖκα ἄγεσθαι ἀμύμονα ἔργα ἰδυῖαν
καὶ τρίποδ’ ὠτώεντα δυωκαιεικοσίμετρον
τῷ πρώτῳ· ἀτὰρ αὖ τῷ δευτέρῳ ἵππον ἔθηκεν
ἐξέτε’ ἀδμήτην βρέφος ἡμίονον κυέουσαν·
αὐτὰρ τῷ τριτάτῳ ἄπυρον κατέθηκε λέβητα
καλὸν τέσσαρα μέτρα κεχανδότα λευκὸν ἔτ’ αὔτως·
τῷ δὲ τετάρτῳ θῆκε δύω χρυσοῖο τάλαντα,
πέμπτῳ δ’ ἀμφίθετον φιάλην ἀπύρωτον ἔθηκε.

23.271

271 στῆ δ’ ὀρθὸς καὶ μῦθον ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἔειπεν·
272 Ἀτρεΐδη τε καὶ ἄλλοι ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
273 ἱππῆας τάδ’ ἄεθλα δεδεγμένα κεῖτ’ ἐν ἀγῶνι.
274 εἰ μὲν νῦν ἐπὶ ἄλλῳ ἀεθλεύοιμεν Ἀχαιοὶ
275 ἦ τ’ ἂν ἐγὼ τὰ πρῶτα λαβὼν κλισίην δὲ φεροίμην.
276 ἴστε γὰρ ὅσσον ἐμοὶ ἀρετῇ περιβάλλετον ἵπποι·
277 ἀθάνατοί τε γάρ εἰσι, Ποσειδάων δὲ πόρ’ αὐτοὺς
278 πατρὶ ἐμῷ Πηλῆϊ, ὃ δ’ αὖτ’ ἐμοὶ ἐγγυάλιξεν.
279 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι μὲν ἐγὼ μενέω καὶ μώνυχες ἵπποι·
280 τοίου γὰρ κλέος ἐσθλὸν ἀπώλεσαν ἡνιόχοιο
281 ἠπίου, ὅς σφωϊν μάλα πολλάκις ὑγρὸν ἔλαιον
282 χαιτάων κατέχευε λοέσσας ὕδατι λευκῷ.
283 τὸν τώ γ’ ἑσταότες πενθείετον, οὔδεϊ δέ σφι
284 χαῖται ἐρηρέδαται, τὼ δ’ ἕστατον ἀχνυμένω κῆρ.
285 ἄλλοι δὲ στέλλεσθε κατὰ στρατόν, ὅς τις Ἀχαιῶν
286 ἵπποισίν τε πέποιθε καὶ ἅρμασι κολλητοῖσιν.
287 ὣς φάτο Πηλεΐδης, ταχέες δ’ ἱππῆες ἄγερθεν.
288 ὦρτο πολὺ πρῶτος μὲν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Εὔμηλος
289 Ἀδμήτου φίλος υἱός, ὃς ἱπποσύνῃ ἐκέκαστο·
290 τῷ δ’ ἐπὶ Τυδεΐδης ὦρτο κρατερὸς Διομήδης,
291 ἵππους δὲ Τρῳοὺς ὕπαγε ζυγόν, οὕς ποτ’ ἀπηύρα
292 Αἰνείαν, ἀτὰρ αὐτὸν ὑπεξεσάωσεν Ἀπόλλων.
293 τῷ δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπ’ Ἀτρεΐδης ὦρτο ξανθὸς Μενέλαος
294 διογενής, ὑπὸ δὲ ζυγὸν ἤγαγεν ὠκέας ἵππους
295 Αἴθην τὴν Ἀγαμεμνονέην τὸν ἑόν τε Πόδαργον·
296 τὴν Ἀγαμέμνονι δῶκ’ Ἀγχισιάδης Ἐχέπωλος
297 δῶρ’, ἵνα μή οἱ ἕποιθ’ ὑπὸ Ἴλιον ἠνεμόεσσαν,
298 ἀλλ’ αὐτοῦ τέρποιτο μένων· μέγα γάρ οἱ ἔδωκε
299 Ζεὺς ἄφενος, ναῖεν δ’ ὅ γ’ ἐν εὐρυχόρῳ Σικυῶνι·
300 τὴν ὅ γ’ ὑπὸ ζυγὸν ἦγε μέγα δρόμου ἰσχανόωσαν.

Thus spoke the son of Peleus and the drivers of chariots bestirred themselves. First among them all uprose Eumelos, king of men, son of Admetos, a man excellent in horsemanship. Next to him rose mighty Diomedes son of Tydeus; he yoked the Trojan horses which he had taken from Aeneas, when Apollo bore him out of the fight. Next to him, yellow-haired Menelaos son of Atreus rose and yoked his fleet horses, Agamemnon's mare Aithe, and his own horse Podagros. The mare had been given to Agamemnon by Echepolos son of Anchises, that he might not have to follow him to Ilion, but might stay at home and take his ease; for Zeus had endowed him with great wealth and he lived in spacious Sicyon. This mare, all eager for the race, did Menelaos put under the yoke. Fourth in order Antilokhos, son to noble Nestor son of Neleus, made ready his horses. These were bred in Pylos, and his father came up to him to give him good advice of which, however, he stood in but little need. "Antilokhos," said Nestor, "you are young, but Zeus and Poseidon have loved you well, and have made you an excellent horseman. I need not therefore say much by way of instruction. You are skillful at wheeling your horses round the post, but the horses themselves are very slow, and it is this that will, I fear, mar your chances. The other drivers know less than you do, but their horses are fleeter; therefore, my dear son, see if you cannot hit upon some artifice [mêtis] whereby you may insure that the prize shall not slip through your fingers. The woodsman does more by skill [mêtis] than by brute force [biê]; by skill [mêtis] the pilot guides his storm-tossed ship over the sea [pontos], and so by skill [mêtis] one driver can beat another. If a man go wide in rounding this way and that,

whereas a man of craft [kerdos] may have worse horses, but he will keep them well in hand when he sees the turning-post [terma]; he knows the precise moment at which to pull the rein, and keeps his eye well on the man in front of him. I will give you this certain sign [sêma] which cannot escape your notice. There is a stump of a dead tree-oak or pine as it may be - some six feet above the ground, and not yet rotted away by rain; it stands at the fork of the road; it has two white stones set one on each side, and there is a clear course all round it. It may have been a tomb [sêma] of someone who died long ago, or it may have been used as a turning-post in days gone by; now, however, it has been fixed on by Achilles as the mark [terma] round which the chariots shall turn; hug it as close as you can, but as you stand in your chariot lean over a little to the left; urge on your right-hand horse with voice and lash, and give him a loose rein, but let the left-hand horse keep so close in, that the nave of your wheel shall almost graze the post; but mind the stone, or you will wound your horses and break your chariot in pieces, which would be sport for others but confusion for yourself. Therefore, my dear son, mind well what you are about, for if you can be first to round the post there is no chance of any one giving you the go-by later, not even though you had Adrastos' horse Arion behind you horse which is of divine race - or those of Laomedon, which are the noblest in this country." When Nestor had made an end of counseling his son he sat down in his place, and fifth in order Meriones got ready his horses. They then all mounted their chariots and cast lots. - Achilles shook the helmet, and the lot of Antilokhos son of Nestor fell out first; next came that of King Eumelos, and after his, those of Menelaos son of Atreus and of Meriones. The last place fell to the lot of Diomedes son of Tydeus, who was the best man of them all. They took their places in line; Achilles showed them the turning-post round which they were to turn, some way off upon the plain; here he stationed his father's follower Phoenix as umpire, to note the running, and report truly. At the same instant they all of them lashed their horses, struck them with the reins, and shouted at them with all their might. They flew full speed over the plain away from the ships, the dust rose from under them as it were a cloud or whirlwind, and their manes were all flying in the wind. At one moment the chariots seemed to touch the ground, and then again they bounded into the air; the drivers stood erect, and their hearts beat fast and furious in their lust of victory. Each kept calling on his horses, and the horses scoured the plain amid the clouds of dust that they raised. It was when they were doing the last part of the course on their way back towards the sea that their pace was strained to the utmost and it was seen what each could do in striving [aretê] toward the prize. The horses of the descendant of Pheres now took the lead, and close behind them came the Trojan stallions of Diomedes. They seemed as if about to mount Eumelos' chariot, and he could feel their warm breath on his back and on his broad shoulders, for their heads were close to him as they flew over the course. Diomedes would have now passed him, or there would have been a dead heat, but Phoebus Apollo to spite him made him drop his whip. Tears of anger fell from his eyes as he saw the mares going on faster than ever, while his own horses lost ground through his having no whip. Athena saw the trick which Apollo had played the son of Tydeus, so she brought him his whip and put spirit into his horses; moreover she went after the son of Admetos in a rage and broke his yoke for him; the mares went one to one side the course, and the other to the other, and the pole was broken against the ground. Eumelos was thrown from his chariot close to the wheel; his elbows, mouth, and nostrils were all torn, and his forehead was bruised above his eyebrows; his eyes filled with tears and he could find no utterance. But the son of Tydeus turned his horses aside and shot far ahead, for Athena put fresh strength into them and covered Diomedes himself with glory. Menelaos son of Atreus came next behind him, but Antilokhos called to his father's horses. "On with you both," he cried, "and do your very utmost. I do not bid you try to beat the steeds of the son of Tydeus, for Athena has put running into them, and has covered Diomedes with glory; but you must overtake the horses of the son of Atreus and not be left

behind, or Aethe who is so fleet will taunt you. Why, my good men, are you lagging? I tell you, and it shall surely be - Nestor will keep neither of you, but will put both of you to the sword, if we win any the worse a prize [athlon] through your carelessness, fly after them at your utmost speed; I will hit on a plan for passing them in a narrow part of the way, and it shall not fail me." They feared the rebuke of their master, and for a short space went quicker. Presently Antilokhos saw a narrow place where the road had sunk. The ground was broken, for the winter's rain had gathered and had worn the road so that the whole place was deepened. Menelaos was making towards it so as to get there first, for fear of a foul, but Antilokhos turned his horses out of the way, and followed him a little on one side. The son of Atreus was afraid and shouted out, "Antilokhos, you are driving recklessly; rein in your horses; the road is too narrow here, it will be wider soon, and you can pass me then; if you foul my chariot you may bring both of us to a mischief."

23.301

301 Ἀντίλοχος δὲ τέταρτος ἐΰτριχας ὁπλίσαθ’ ἵππους,
302 Νέστορος ἀγλαὸς υἱὸς ὑπερθύμοιο ἄνακτος
303 τοῦ Νηληϊάδαο· Πυλοιγενέες δέ οἱ ἵπποι
304 ὠκύποδες φέρον ἅρμα· πατὴρ δέ οἱ ἄγχι παραστὰς
305 μυθεῖτ’ εἰς ἀγαθὰ φρονέων νοέοντι καὶ αὐτῷ·
306 Ἀντίλοχ’ ἤτοι μέν σε νέον περ ἐόντ’ ἐφίλησαν
307 Ζεύς τε Ποσειδάων τε, καὶ ἱπποσύνας ἐδίδαξαν
308 παντοίας· τὼ καί σε διδασκέμεν οὔ τι μάλα χρεώ·
309 οἶσθα γὰρ εὖ περὶ τέρμαθ’ ἑλισσέμεν· ἀλλά τοι ἵπποι
310 βάρδιστοι θείειν· τώ τ’ οἴω λοίγι’ ἔσεσθαι.
311 τῶν δ’ ἵπποι μὲν ἔασιν ἀφάρτεροι, οὐδὲ μὲν αὐτοὶ
312 πλείονα ἴσασιν σέθεν αὐτοῦ μητίσασθαι.
313 ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ σὺ φίλος μῆτιν ἐμβάλλεο θυμῷ
314 παντοίην, ἵνα μή σε παρεκπροφύγῃσιν ἄεθλα.
315 μήτι τοι δρυτόμος μέγ’ ἀμείνων ἠὲ βίηφι·
316 μήτι δ’ αὖτε κυβερνήτης ἐνὶ οἴνοπι πόντῳ
317 νῆα θοὴν ἰθύνει ἐρεχθομένην ἀνέμοισι·
318 μήτι δ’ ἡνίοχος περιγίγνεται ἡνιόχοιο.
319 ἀλλ’ ὃς μέν θ’ ἵπποισι καὶ ἅρμασιν οἷσι πεποιθὼς
320 ἀφραδέως ἐπὶ πολλὸν ἐλίσσεται ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα,
321 ἵπποι δὲ πλανόωνται ἀνὰ δρόμον, οὐδὲ κατίσχει·
322 ὃς δέ κε κέρδεα εἰδῇ ἐλαύνων ἥσσονας ἵππους,
323 αἰεὶ τέρμ’ ὁρόων στρέφει ἐγγύθεν, οὐδέ ἑ λήθει
324 ὅππως τὸ πρῶτον τανύσῃ βοέοισιν ἱμᾶσιν,
325 ἀλλ’ ἔχει ἀσφαλέως καὶ τὸν προὔχοντα δοκεύει.
326 σῆμα δέ τοι ἐρέω μάλ’ ἀριφραδές, οὐδέ σε λήσει.
327 ἕστηκε ξύλον αὖον ὅσον τ’ ὄργυι’ ὑπὲρ αἴης
328 ἢ δρυὸς ἢ πεύκης· τὸ μὲν οὐ καταπύθεται ὄμβρῳ,
329 λᾶε δὲ τοῦ ἑκάτερθεν ἐρηρέδαται δύο λευκὼ
330 ἐν ξυνοχῇσιν ὁδοῦ, λεῖος δ’ ἱππόδρομος ἀμφὶς

23.331

331 ἤ τευ σῆμα βροτοῖο πάλαι κατατεθνηῶτος,
332 ἢ τό γε νύσσα τέτυκτο ἐπὶ προτέρων ἀνθρώπων,
333 καὶ νῦν τέρματ’ ἔθηκε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς.
334 τῷ σὺ μάλ’ ἐγχρίμψας ἐλάαν σχεδὸν ἅρμα καὶ ἵππους,

335 αὐτὸς δὲ κλινθῆναι ἐϋπλέκτῳ ἐνὶ δίφρῳ
336 ἦκ’ ἐπ’ ἀριστερὰ τοῖιν· ἀτὰρ τὸν δεξιὸν ἵππον
337 κένσαι ὁμοκλήσας, εἶξαί τέ οἱ ἡνία χερσίν.
338 ἐν νύσσῃ δέ τοι ἵππος ἀριστερὸς ἐγχριμφθήτω,
339 ὡς ἄν τοι πλήμνη γε δοάσσεται ἄκρον ἱκέσθαι
340 κύκλου ποιητοῖο· λίθου δ’ ἀλέασθαι ἐπαυρεῖν,
341 μή πως ἵππους τε τρώσῃς κατά θ’ ἅρματα ἄξῃς·
342 χάρμα δὲ τοῖς ἄλλοισιν, ἐλεγχείη δὲ σοὶ αὐτῷ
343 ἔσσεται· ἀλλὰ φίλος φρονέων πεφυλαγμένος εἶναι.
344 εἰ γάρ κ’ ἐν νύσσῃ γε παρεξελάσῃσθα διώκων,
345 οὐκ ἔσθ’ ὅς κέ σ’ ἕλῃσι μετάλμενος οὐδὲ παρέλθῃ,
346 οὐδ’ εἴ κεν μετόπισθεν Ἀρίονα δῖον ἐλαύνοι
347 Ἀδρήστου ταχὺν ἵππον, ὃς ἐκ θεόφιν γένος ἦεν,
348 ἢ τοὺς Λαομέδοντος, οἳ ἐνθάδε γ’ ἔτραφεν ἐσθλοί.
349 ὣς εἰπὼν Νέστωρ Νηλήϊος ἂψ ἐνὶ χώρῃ
350 ἕζετ’, ἐπεὶ ᾧ παιδὶ ἑκάστου πείρατ’ ἔειπε.
351 Μηριόνης δ’ ἄρα πέμπτος ἑΰτριχας ὀπλίσαθ’ ἵππους.
352 ἂν δ’ ἔβαν ἐς δίφρους, ἐν δὲ κλήρους ἐβάλοντο·
353 πάλλ’ Ἀχιλεύς, ἐκ δὲ κλῆρος θόρε Νεστορίδαο
354 Ἀντιλόχου· μετὰ τὸν δ’ ἔλαχε κρείων Εὔμηλος·
355 τῷ δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπ’ Ἀτρεΐδης δουρὶ κλειτὸς Μενέλαος,
356 τῷ δ’ ἐπὶ Μηριόνης λάχ’ ἐλαυνέμεν· ὕστατος αὖτε
357 Τυδεΐδης ὄχ’ ἄριστος ἐὼν λάχ’ ἐλαυνέμεν ἵππους.
358 στὰν δὲ μεταστοιχί, σήμηνε δὲ τέρματ’ Ἀχιλλεὺς
359 τηλόθεν ἐν λείῳ πεδίῳ· παρὰ δὲ σκοπὸν εἶσεν
360 ἀντίθεον Φοίνικα ὀπάονα πατρὸς ἑοῖο,

23.361

361 ὡς μεμνέῳτο δρόμους καὶ ἀληθείην ἀποείποι.
362 οἳ δ’ ἅμα πάντες ἐφ’ ἵπποιιν μάστιγας ἄειραν,
363 πέπληγόν θ’ ἱμᾶσιν, ὀμόκλησάν τ’ ἐπέεσσιν
364 ἐσσυμένως· οἳ δ’ ὦκα διέπρησσον πεδίοιο
365 νόσφι νεῶν ταχέως· ὑπὸ δὲ στέρνοισι κονίη
366 ἵστατ’ ἀειρομένη ὥς τε νέφος ἠὲ θύελλα,
367 χαῖται δ’ ἐρρώοντο μετὰ πνοιῇς ἀνέμοιο.
368 ἅρματα δ’ ἄλλοτε μὲν χθονὶ πίλνατο πουλυβοτείρῃ,
369 ἄλλοτε δ’ ἀΐξασκε μετήορα· τοὶ δ’ ἐλατῆρες
370 ἔστασαν ἐν δίφροισι, πάτασσε δὲ θυμὸς ἑκάστου
371 νίκης ἱεμένων· κέκλοντο δὲ οἷσιν ἕκαστος
372 ἵπποις, οἳ δ’ ἐπέτοντο κονίοντες πεδίοιο.
373 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ πύματον τέλεον δρόμον ὠκέες ἵπποι
374 ἂψ ἐφ’ ἁλὸς πολιῆς, τότε δὴ ἀρετή γε ἑκάστου
375 φαίνετ’, ἄφαρ δ’ ἵπποισι τάθη δρόμος· ὦκα δ’ ἔπειτα
376 αἳ Φηρητιάδαο ποδώκεες ἔκφερον ἵπποι.
377 τὰς δὲ μετ’ ἐξέφερον Διομήδεος ἄρσενες ἵπποι
378 Τρῴοι, οὐδέ τι πολλὸν ἄνευθ’ ἔσαν, ἀλλὰ μάλ’ ἐγγύς·
379 αἰεὶ γὰρ δίφρου ἐπιβησομένοισιν ἐΐκτην,
380 πνοιῇ δ’ Εὐμήλοιο μετάφρενον εὐρέε τ’ ὤμω
381 θέρμετ’· ἐπ’ αὐτῷ γὰρ κεφαλὰς καταθέντε πετέσθην.
382 καί νύ κεν ἢ παρέλασσ’ ἢ ἀμφήριστον ἔθηκεν,
383 εἰ μὴ Τυδέος υἷϊ κοτέσσατο Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων,

ὅς ῥά οἱ ἐκ χειρῶν ἔβαλεν μάστιγα φαεινήν.
τοῖο δ’ ἀπ’ ὀφθαλμῶν χύτο δάκρυα χωομένοιο,
οὕνεκα τὰς μὲν ὅρα ἔτι καὶ πολὺ μᾶλλον ἰούσας,
οἳ δέ οἱ ἐβλάφθησαν ἄνευ κέντροιο θέοντες.
οὐδ’ ἄρ’ Ἀθηναίην ἐλεφηράμενος λάθ’ Ἀπόλλων
Τυδεΐδην, μάλα δ’ ὦκα μετέσσυτο ποιμένα λαῶν,
δῶκε δέ οἱ μάστιγα, μένος δ’ ἵπποισιν ἐνῆκεν·

23.391

ἣ δὲ μετ’ Ἀδμήτου υἱὸν κοτέουσ’ ἐβεβήκει,
ἵππειον δέ οἱ ἦξε θεὰ ζυγόν· αἳ δέ οἱ ἵπποι
ἀμφὶς ὁδοῦ δραμέτην, ῥυμὸς δ’ ἐπὶ γαῖαν ἐλύσθη.
αὐτὸς δ’ ἐκ δίφροιο παρὰ τροχὸν ἐξεκυλίσθη,
ἀγκῶνάς τε περιδρύφθη στόμα τε ῥῖνάς τε,
θρυλίχθη δὲ μέτωπον ἐπ’ ὀφρύσι· τὼ δέ οἱ ὄσσε
δακρυόφι πλῆσθεν, θαλερὴ δέ οἱ ἔσχετο φωνή.
Τυδεΐδης δὲ παρατρέψας ἔχε μώνυχας ἵππους,
πολλὸν τῶν ἄλλων ἐξάλμενος· ἐν γὰρ Ἀθήνη
ἵπποις ἦκε μένος καὶ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ κῦδος ἔθηκε.
τῷ δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπ’ Ἀτρεΐδης εἶχε ξανθὸς Μενέλαος.
Ἀντίλοχος δ’ ἵπποισιν ἐκέκλετο πατρὸς ἑοῖο·
ἔμβητον καὶ σφῶϊ· τιταίνετον ὄττι τάχιστα.
ἤτοι μὲν κείνοισιν ἐριζέμεν οὔ τι κελεύω
Τυδεΐδεω ἵπποισι δαΐφρονος, οἷσιν Ἀθήνη
νῦν ὤρεξε τάχος καὶ ἐπ’ αὐτῷ κῦδος ἔθηκεν·
ἵππους δ’ Ἀτρεΐδαο κιχάνετε, μὴ δὲ λίπησθον,
καρπαλίμως, μὴ σφῶϊν ἐλεγχείην καταχεύῃ
Αἴθη θῆλυς ἐοῦσα· τί ἢ λείπεσθε φέριστοι;
ὧδε γὰρ ἐξερέω, καὶ μὴν τετελεσμένον ἔσται·
οὐ σφῶϊν κομιδὴ παρὰ Νέστορι ποιμένι λαῶν
ἔσσεται, αὐτίκα δ’ ὔμμε κατακτενεῖ ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ,
αἴ κ’ ἀποκηδήσαντε φερώμεθα χεῖρον ἄεθλον.
ἀλλ’ ἐφομαρτεῖτον καὶ σπεύδετον ὄττι τάχιστα·
ταῦτα δ’ ἐγὼν αὐτὸς τεχνήσομαι ἠδὲ νοήσω
στεινωπῷ ἐν ὁδῷ παραδύμεναι, οὐδέ με λήσει.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δὲ ἄνακτος ὑποδείσαντες ὁμοκλὴν
μᾶλλον ἐπιδραμέτην ὀλίγον χρόνον· αἶψα δ’ ἔπειτα
στεῖνος ὁδοῦ κοίλης ἴδεν Ἀντίλοχος μενεχάρμης.
ῥωχμὸς ἔην γαίης, ᾗ χειμέριον ἀλὲν ὕδωρ

23.421

ἐξέρρηξεν ὁδοῖο, βάθυνε δὲ χῶρον ἅπαντα·
τῇ ῥ’ εἶχεν Μενέλαος ἀματροχιὰς ἀλεείνων.
Ἀντίλοχος δὲ παρατρέψας ἔχε μώνυχας ἵππους
ἐκτὸς ὁδοῦ, ὀλίγον δὲ παρακλίνας ἐδίωκεν.
Ἀτρεΐδης δ’ ἔδεισε καὶ Ἀντιλόχῳ ἐγεγώνει·
Ἀντίλοχ’ ἀφραδέως ἱππάζεαι, ἀλλ’ ἄνεχ’ ἵππους·
στεινωπὸς γὰρ ὁδός, τάχα δ’ εὐρυτέρη παρελάσσαι·
μή πως ἀμφοτέρους δηλήσεαι ἅρματι κύρσας.
ὣς ἔφατ’, Ἀντίλοχος δ’ ἔτι καὶ πολὺ μᾶλλον ἔλαυνε

430 κέντρῳ ἐπισπέρχων ὡς οὐκ ἀΐοντι ἐοικώς.
431 ὅσσα δὲ δίσκου οὖρα κατωμαδίοιο πέλονται,
432 ὅν τ’ αἰζηὸς ἀφῆκεν ἀνὴρ πειρώμενος ἤβης,
433 τόσσον ἐπιδραμέτην· αἳ δ’ ἠρώησαν ὀπίσσω
434 Ἀτρεΐδεω· αὐτὸς γὰρ ἑκὼν μεθέηκεν ἐλαύνειν
435 μή πως συγκύρσειαν ὁδῷ ἔνι μώνυχες ἵπποι,
436 δίφρους τ’ ἀνστρέψειαν ἐϋπλεκέας, κατὰ δ’ αὐτοὶ
437 ἐν κονίῃσι πέσοιεν ἐπειγόμενοι περὶ νίκης.
438 τὸν καὶ νεικείων προσέφη ξανθὸς Μενέλαος·
439 Ἀντίλοχ’ οὔ τις σεῖο βροτῶν ὀλοώτερος ἄλλος·
440 ἔρρ’, ἐπεὶ οὔ σ’ ἔτυμόν γε φάμεν πεπνῦσθαι Ἀχαιοί.
441 ἀλλ’ οὐ μὰν οὐδ’ ὧς ἄτερ ὅρκου οἵσῃ ἄεθλον.
442 ὣς εἰπὼν ἵπποισιν ἐκέκλετο φώνησέν τε·
443 μή μοι ἐρύκεσθον μὴ δ’ ἔστατον ἀχνυμένω κῆρ.
444 φθήσονται τούτοισι πόδες καὶ γοῦνα καμόντα
445 ἢ ὑμῖν· ἄμφω γὰρ ἀτέμβονται νεότητος.
446 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δὲ ἄνακτος ὑποδείσαντες ὁμοκλὴν
447 μᾶλλον ἐπιδραμέτην, τάχα δέ σφισιν ἄγχι γένοντο.
448 Ἀργεῖοι δ’ ἐν ἀγῶνι καθήμενοι εἰσορόωντο
449 ἵππους· τοὶ δὲ πέτοντο κονίοντες πεδίοιο.
450 πρῶτος δ’ Ἰδομενεὺς Κρητῶν ἀγὸς ἐφράσαθ’ ἵππους·
But Antilokhos plied his whip, and drove faster, as though he had not heard him. They went side by side for about as far as a young man can hurl a disc from his shoulder when he is trying his strength, and then Menelaos' mares drew behind, for he left off driving for fear the horses should foul one another and upset the chariots; thus, while pressing on in quest of victory, they might both come headlong to the ground. Menelaos then upbraided Antilokhos and said, "There is no greater trickster living than you are; go, and bad luck go with you; the Achaeans say not well that you have understanding, and come what may you shall not bear away the prize [athlon] without sworn protest on my part." Then he called on his horses and said to them, "Keep your pace, and slacken not; the limbs of the other horses will weary sooner than yours, for they are neither of them young." The horses feared the rebuke of their master, and went faster, so that they were soon nearly up with the others. Meanwhile the Achaeans from their seats were watching how the horses went, as they scoured the plain amid clouds of their own dust. Idomeneus leader of the Cretans was first to make out the running, for he was not in the thick of the crowd, but stood on the most commanding part of the ground. The driver was a long way off from the assembly [agôn], but Idomeneus could hear him shouting, and could see the foremost horse quite plainly - a chestnut with a round white mark [sêma], like the moon, on its forehead. He stood up and said among the Argives, "My friends, princes and counselors of the Argives, can you see the running as well as I can? There seems to be another pair in front now, and another driver; those that led off at the start must have been disabled out on the plain. I saw them at first making their way round the turning-post, but now, though I search the plain of Troy, I cannot find them. Perhaps the reins fell from the driver's hand so that he lost command of his horses at the turning-post, and could not turn it. I suppose he must have been thrown out there, and broken his chariot, while his mares have left the course and gone off wildly in a panic. Come up and see for yourselves, I cannot make out for certain, but the driver seems an Aetolian by descent, ruler over the Argives, brave Diomedes the son of Tydeus." Ajax the son of Oileus took him up rudely and said, "Idomeneus, why should you be in such a hurry to tell us all about it, when the mares are still so far out upon the plain? You are none of the youngest, nor your eyes none of the sharpest, but you are always laying down the law. You have no right to do so, for there are better men here than you are. Eumelos'

horses are in front now, as they always have been, and he is on the chariot holding the reins." The leader of the Cretans was angry, and answered, "Ajax, you are an excellent railer, but you have no judgment [noos], and are wanting in much else as well, for you have a vile temper. I will wager you a tripod or cauldron, and Agamemnon son of Atreus shall decide whose horses are first. You will then know to your cost." Ajax son of Oileus was for making him an angry answer, and there would have been yet further brawling between them, had not Achilles risen in his place and said, "Cease your railing Ajax and Idomeneus; it is not you would be scandalized if you saw any one else do the like: sit down in the assembly [agôn] and keep your eyes on the horses; they are speeding towards the winning-post and will be here directly. You will then both of you know whose horses are first, and whose come after."

23.451

ἦστο γὰρ ἐκτὸς ἀγῶνος ὑπέρτατος ἐν περιωπῇ·
τοῖο δ’ ἄνευθεν ἐόντος ὁμοκλητῆρος ἀκούσας
ἔγνω, φράσσατο δ’ ἵππον ἀριπρεπέα προὔχοντα,
ὃς τὸ μὲν ἄλλο τόσον φοῖνιξ ἦν, ἐν δὲ μετώπῳ
λευκὸν σῆμα τέτυκτο περίτροχον ἠΰτε μήνη.
στῆ δ’ ὀρθὸς καὶ μῦθον ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἔειπεν·
ὦ φίλοι Ἀργείων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες
οἷος ἐγὼν ἵππους αὐγάζομαι ἦε καὶ ὑμεῖς;
ἄλλοι μοι δοκέουσι παροίτεροι ἔμμεναι ἵπποι,
ἄλλος δ’ ἡνίοχος ἰνδάλλεται· αἶ δέ που αὐτοῦ
ἔβλαβεν ἐν πεδίῳ, αἳ κεῖσέ γε φέρτεραι ἦσαν·
ἤτοι γὰρ τὰς πρῶτα ἴδον περὶ τέρμα βαλούσας,
νῦν δ’ οὔ πῃ δύναμαι ἰδέειν· πάντῃ δέ μοι ὄσσε
Τρωϊκὸν ἂμ πεδίον παπταίνετον εἰσορόωντι·
ἦε τὸν ἡνίοχον φύγον ἡνία, οὐδὲ δυνάσθη
εὖ σχεθέειν περὶ τέρμα καὶ οὐκ ἐτύχησεν ἐλίξας·
ἔνθά μιν ἐκπεσέειν ὀΐω σύν θ’ ἅρματα ἆξαι,
αἳ δ’ ἐξηρώησαν, ἐπεὶ μένος ἔλλαβε θυμόν.
ἀλλὰ ἴδεσθε καὶ ὔμμες ἀνασταδόν· οὐ γὰρ ἔγωγε
εὖ διαγιγνώσκω· δοκέει δέ μοι ἔμμεναι ἀνὴρ
Αἰτωλὸς γενεήν, μετὰ δ’ Ἀργείοισιν ἀνάσσει
Τυδέος ἱπποδάμου υἱὸς κρατερὸς Διομήδης.
τὸν δ’ αἰσχρῶς ἐνένιπεν Ὀϊλῆος ταχὺς Αἴας·
Ἰδομενεῦ τί πάρος λαβρεύεαι; αἳ δέ τ’ ἄνευθεν
ἵπποι ἀερσίποδες πολέος πεδίοιο δίενται.
οὔτε νεώτατός ἐσσι μετ’ Ἀργείοισι τοσοῦτον,
οὔτέ τοι ὀξύτατον κεφαλῆς ἐκδέρκεται ὄσσε·
ἀλλ’ αἰεὶ μύθοις λαβρεύεαι· οὐδέ τί σε χρὴ
λαβραγόρην ἔμεναι· πάρα γὰρ καὶ ἀμείνονες ἄλλοι.
ἵπποι δ’ αὐταὶ ἔασι παροίτεραι, αἳ τὸ πάρος περ,

23.481

Εὐμήλου, ἐν δ’ αὐτὸς ἔχων εὔληρα βέβηκε.
τὸν δὲ χολωσάμενος Κρητῶν ἀγὸς ἀντίον ηὔδα·
Αἶαν νεῖκος ἄριστε κακοφραδὲς ἄλλά τε πάντα
δεύεαι Ἀργείων, ὅτι τοι νόος ἐστὶν ἀπηνής.
δεῦρό νυν ἢ τρίποδος περιδώμεθον ἠὲ λέβητος,

ἴστορα δ’ Ἀτρεΐδην Ἀγαμέμνονα θείομεν ἄμφω,
ὀππότεραι πρόσθ’ ἵπποι, ἵνα γνώῃς ἀποτίνων.
ὣς ἔφατ’, ὄρνυτο δ’ αὐτίκ’ Ὀϊλῆος ταχὺς Αἴας
χωόμενος χαλεποῖσιν ἀμείψασθαι ἐπέεσσι·
καί νύ κε δὴ προτέρω ἔτ’ ἔρις γένετ’ ἀμφοτέροισιν,
εἰ μὴ Ἀχιλλεὺς αὐτὸς ἀνίστατο καὶ φάτο μῦθον·
μηκέτι νῦν χαλεποῖσιν ἀμείβεσθον ἐπέεσσιν
Αἶαν Ἰδομενεῦ τε κακοῖς, ἐπεὶ οὐδὲ ἔοικε.
καὶ δ’ ἄλλῳ νεμεσᾶτον ὅτις τοιαῦτά γε ῥέζοι.
ἀλλ’ ὑμεῖς ἐν ἀγῶνι καθήμενοι εἰσοράασθε
ἵππους· οἳ δὲ τάχ’ αὐτοὶ ἐπειγόμενοι περὶ νίκης
ἐνθάδ’ ἐλεύσονται· τότε δὲ γνώσεσθε ἕκαστος
ἵππους Ἀργείων, οἳ δεύτεροι οἵ τε πάροιθεν.
ὣς φάτο, Τυδεΐδης δὲ μάλα σχεδὸν ἦλθε διώκων,
μάστι δ’ αἰὲν ἔλαυνε κατωμαδόν· οἳ δέ οἱ ἵπποι
ὑψόσ’ ἀειρέσθην ῥίμφα πρήσσοντε κέλευθον.
αἰεὶ δ’ ἡνίοχον κονίης ῥαθάμιγγες ἔβαλλον,
ἅρματα δὲ χρυσῷ πεπυκασμένα κασσιτέρῳ τε
ἵπποις ὠκυπόδεσσιν ἐπέτρεχον· οὐδέ τι πολλὴ
γίγνετ’ ἐπισσώτρων ἁρματροχιὴ κατόπισθεν
ἐν λεπτῇ κονίῃ· τὼ δὲ σπεύδοντε πετέσθην.
στῆ δὲ μέσῳ ἐν ἀγῶνι, πολὺς δ’ ἀνεκήκιεν ἰδρὼς
ἵππων ἔκ τε λόφων καὶ ἀπὸ στέρνοιο χαμᾶζε.
αὐτὸς δ’ ἐκ δίφροιο χαμαὶ θόρε παμφανόωντος,
κλῖνε δ’ ἄρα μάστιγα ποτὶ ζυγόν· οὐδὲ μάτησεν

As he was speaking, the son of Tydeus came driving in, plying his whip lustily from his shoulder, and his horses stepping high as they flew over the course. The sand and grit rained thick on the driver, and the chariot inlaid with gold and tin ran close behind his fleet horses. There was little trace of wheel-marks in the fine dust, and the horses came flying in at their utmost speed. Diomedes stayed them in the middle of the assembly [agôn], and the sweat from their manes and chests fell in streams on to the ground. Forthwith he sprang from his goodly chariot, and leaned his whip against his horses' yoke; brave Sthenelos now lost no time, but at once brought on the prize [athlon], and gave the woman and the ear-handled cauldron to his comrades to take away. Then he unyoked the horses. Next after him came in Antilokhos of the race of Neleus, who had passed Menelaos by craft [kerdos] and not by the fleetness of his horses; but even so Menelaos came in as close behind him as the wheel is to the horse that draws both the chariot and its master. The end hairs of a horse's tail touch the tire of the wheel, and there is never much space between wheel and horse when the chariot is going; Menelaos was no further than this behind Antilokhos, though at first he had been a full disc's throw behind him. He had soon caught him up again, for Agamemnon's mare Aethe kept pulling stronger and stronger, so that if the course had been longer he would have passed him, and there would not even have been a dead heat. Idomeneus' brave squire [therapôn] Meriones was about a spear's cast behind Menelaos. His horses were slowest of all in the contest [agôn], and he was the worst driver. Last of them all came the son of Admetos, dragging his chariot and driving his horses on in front. When Achilles saw him he was sorry, and stood up among the Argives saying, "The best man is coming in last. Let us give him a prize for it is reasonable. He shall have the second, but the first must go to the son of Tydeus." Thus did he speak and the others all of them applauded his saying, and were for doing as he had said, but Nestor's son Antilokhos stood up and claimed his rights from the son of Peleus. "Achilles," said he, "I shall take it much amiss if you do this thing; you would rob me of my prize [athlon], because you think

Eumelos' chariot and horses were thrown out, and himself too, good man that he is. He should have prayed duly to the immortals; he would not have come in fast if he had done so. If you are sorry for him and so choose, you have much gold in your tents, with bronze, sheep, cattle, and horses. Take something from this store if you would have the Achaeans speak well of you, and give him a better prize [athlon] even than that which you have now offered; but I will not give up the mare, and he that will fight me for her, let him come on." Achilles smiled as he heard this, and was pleased with Antilokhos, who was one of his dearest comrades. So he said - "Antilokhos, if you would have me find Eumelos another prize, I will give him the bronze breastplate with a rim of tin running all round it which I took from Asteropaios. It will be worth much money to him." He bade his comrade Automedon bring the breastplate from his tent, and he did so. Achilles then gave it over to Eumelos, who received it gladly. But Menelaos got up in a rage, furiously angry with Antilokhos. An attendant placed his staff in his hands and bade the Argives keep silence: the hero then addressed them. "Antilokhos," said he, "what is this from you who have been so far blameless? You have shamed my excellence [aretê] and baulked my horses by flinging your own in front of them, though yours are much worse than mine are; therefore, O princes and counselors of the Argives, judge between us and show no favor, lest one of the Achaeans say, ‘Menelaos has got the mare through lying and corruption; his horses were far inferior to Antilokhos', but he is superior in excellence [aretê] and force [biê].’ Nay, I will determine the matter myself, and no man will blame me, for I shall do what is just. Come here, Antilokhos, and stand, as our custom [themis] is, whip in hand before your chariot and horses; lay your hand on your steeds, and swear by earth-encircling Poseidon that you did not purposely and guilefully get in the way of my horses." And Antilokhos answered, "Forgive me; I am much younger, King Menelaos, than you are; you stand higher than I do and are the better man of the two; you know how easily young men are betrayed into indiscretion; their tempers are more hasty and they have less judgment [noos]; make due allowances therefore, and bear with me; I will of my own accord give up the mare that I have won, and if you claim any further chattel from my own possessions, I would rather yield it to you, at once, than fall from your good graces henceforth, and do wrong in the eyes of daimones."

23.511

511 ἴφθιμος Σθένελος, ἀλλ’ ἐσσυμένως λάβ’ ἄεθλον,
512 δῶκε δ’ ἄγειν ἑτάροισιν ὑπερθύμοισι γυναῖκα
513 καὶ τρίποδ’ ὠτώεντα φέρειν· ὃ δ’ ἔλυεν ὑφ’ ἵππους.
514 τῷ δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπ’ Ἀντίλοχος Νηλήϊος ἤλασεν ἵππους
515 κέρδεσιν, οὔ τι τάχει γε, παραφθάμενος Μενέλαον·
516 ἀλλὰ καὶ ὣς Μενέλαος ἔχ’ ἐγγύθεν ὠκέας ἵππους.
517 ὅσσον δὲ τροχοῦ ἵππος ἀφίσταται, ὅς ῥα ἄνακτα
518 ἕλκῃσιν πεδίοιο τιταινόμενος σὺν ὄχεσφι·
519 τοῦ μέν τε ψαύουσιν ἐπισσώτρου τρίχες ἄκραι
520 οὐραῖαι· ὃ δέ τ’ ἄγχι μάλα τρέχει, οὐδέ τι πολλὴ
521 χώρη μεσσηγὺς πολέος πεδίοιο θέοντος·
522 τόσσον δὴ Μενέλαος ἀμύμονος Ἀντιλόχοιο
523 λείπετ’· ἀτὰρ τὰ πρῶτα καὶ ἐς δίσκουρα λέλειπτο,
524 ἀλλά μιν αἶψα κίχανεν· ὀφέλλετο γὰρ μένος ἠὺ
525 ἵππου τῆς Ἀγαμεμνονέης καλλίτριχος Αἴθης·
526 εἰ δέ κ’ ἔτι προτέρω γένετο δρόμος ἀμφοτέροισι,
527 τώ κέν μιν παρέλασσ’ οὐδ’ ἀμφήριστον ἔθηκεν.
528 αὐτὰρ Μηριόνης θεράπων ἐΰς Ἰδομενῆος
529 λείπετ’ ἀγακλῆος Μενελάου δουρὸς ἐρωήν·

βάρδιστοι μὲν γάρ οἱ ἔσαν καλλίτριχες ἵπποι,
ἤκιστος δ’ ἦν αὐτὸς ἐλαυνέμεν ἅρμ’ ἐν ἀγῶνι.
υἱὸς δ’ Ἀδμήτοιο πανύστατος ἤλυθεν ἄλλων
ἔλκων ἅρματα καλὰ ἐλαύνων πρόσσοθεν ἵππους.
τὸν δὲ ἰδὼν ὤκτειρε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
στὰς δ’ ἄρ’ ἐν Ἀργείοις ἔπεα πτερόεντ’ ἀγόρευε·
λοῖσθος ἀνὴρ ὥριστος ἐλαύνει μώνυχας ἵππους·
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δή οἱ δῶμεν ἀέθλιον ὡς ἐπιεικὲς
δεύτερ’· ἀτὰρ τὰ πρῶτα φερέσθω Τυδέος υἱός.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἐπήνεον ὡς ἐκέλευε.
καί νύ κέ οἱ πόρεν ἵππον, ἐπήνησαν γὰρ Ἀχαιοί,

23.541

εἰ μὴ ἄρ’ Ἀντίλοχος μεγαθύμου Νέστορος υἱὸς
Πηλεΐδην Ἀχιλῆα δίκῃ ἠμείψατ’ ἀναστάς·
ὦ Ἀχιλεῦ μάλα τοι κεχολώσομαι αἴ κε τελέσσῃς
τοῦτο ἔπος· μέλλεις γὰρ ἀφαιρήσεσθαι ἄεθλον
τὰ φρονέων ὅτι οἱ βλάβεν ἅρματα καὶ ταχέ’ ἵππω
αὐτός τ’ ἐσθλὸς ἐών· ἀλλ’ ὤφελεν ἀθανάτοισιν
εὔχεσθαι· τό κεν οὔ τι πανύστατος ἦλθε διώκων.
εἰ δέ μιν οἰκτίρεις καί τοι φίλος ἔπλετο θυμῷ
ἔστί τοι ἐν κλισίῃ χρυσὸς πολύς, ἔστι δὲ χαλκὸς
καὶ πρόβατ’, εἰσὶ δέ τοι δμῳαὶ καὶ μώνυχες ἵπποι·
τῶν οἱ ἔπειτ’ ἀνελὼν δόμεναι καὶ μεῖζον ἄεθλον
ἠὲ καὶ αὐτίκα νῦν, ἵνα σ’ αἰνήσωσιν Ἀχαιοί.
τὴν δ’ ἐγὼ οὐ δώσω· περὶ δ’ αὐτῆς πειρηθήτω
ἀνδρῶν ὅς κ’ ἐθέλῃσιν ἐμοὶ χείρεσσι μάχεσθαι.
ὣς φάτο, μείδησεν δὲ ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεὺς
χαίρων Ἀντιλόχῳ, ὅτι οἱ φίλος ἦεν ἑταῖρος·
καί μιν ἀμειβόμενος ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
Ἀντίλοχ’, εἰ μὲν δή με κελεύεις οἷκοθεν ἄλλο
Εὐμήλῳ ἐπιδοῦναι, ἐγὼ δέ κε καὶ τὸ τελέσσω.
δώσω οἱ θώρηκα, τὸν Ἀστεροπαῖον ἀπηύρων
χάλκεον, ᾧ πέρι χεῦμα φαεινοῦ κασσιτέροιο
ἀμφιδεδίνηται· πολέος δέ οἱ ἄξιος ἔσται.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ Αὐτομέδοντι φίλῳ ἐκέλευσεν ἑταίρῳ
οἰσέμεναι κλισίηθεν· ὃ δ’ ᾤχετο καί οἱ ἔνεικεν,
Εὐμήλῳ δ’ ἐν χερσὶ τίθει· ὃ δὲ δέξατο χαίρων.
τοῖσι δὲ καὶ Μενέλαος ἀνίστατο θυμὸν ἀχεύων
Ἀντιλόχῳ ἄμοτον κεχολωμένος· ἐν δ’ ἄρα κῆρυξ
χειρὶ σκῆπτρον ἔθηκε, σιωπῆσαί τε κέλευσεν
Ἀργείους· ὃ δ’ ἔπειτα μετηύδα ἰσόθεος φώς·
Ἀντίλοχε πρόσθεν πεπνυμένε ποῖον ἔρεξας.

23.571

ᾗσχυνας μὲν ἐμὴν ἀρετήν, βλάψας δέ μοι ἵππους
τοὺς σοὺς πρόσθε βαλών, οἵ τοι πολὺ χείρονες ἦσαν.
ἀλλ’ ἄγετ’ Ἀργείων ἡγήτορες ἠδὲ μέδοντες
ἐς μέσον ἀμφοτέροισι δικάσσατε, μὴ δ’ ἐπ’ ἀρωγῇ,
μή ποτέ τις εἴπῃσιν Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων·

576 Ἀντίλοχον ψεύδεσσι βιησάμενος Μενέλαος
577 οἴχεται ἵππον ἄγων, ὅτι οἱ πολὺ χείρονες ἦσαν
578 ἵπποι, αὐτὸς δὲ κρείσσων ἀρετῇ τε βίῃ τε.
579 εἰ δ’ ἄγ’ ἐγὼν αὐτὸς δικάσω, καί μ’ οὔ τινά φημι
580 ἄλλον ἐπιπλήξειν Δαναῶν· ἰθεῖα γὰρ ἔσται.
581 Ἀντίλοχ’ εἰ δ’ ἄγε δεῦρο διοτρεφές, ἢ θέμις ἐστί,
582 στὰς ἵππων προπάροιθε καὶ ἅρματος, αὐτὰρ ἱμάσθλην
583 χερσὶν ἔχε ῥαδινήν, ᾗ περ τὸ πρόσθεν ἔλαυνες,
584 ἵππων ἁψάμενος γαιήοχον ἐννοσίγαιον
585 ὄμνυθι μὴ μὲν ἑκὼν τὸ ἐμὸν δόλῳ ἅρμα πεδῆσαι.
586 τὸν δ’ αὖτ’ Ἀντίλοχος πεπνυμένος ἀντίον ηὔδα·
587 ἄνσχεο νῦν· πολλὸν γὰρ ἔγωγε νεώτερός εἰμι
588 σεῖο ἄναξ Μενέλαε, σὺ δὲ πρότερος καὶ ἀρείων.
589 οἶσθ’ οἷαι νέου ἀνδρὸς ὑπερβασίαι τελέθουσι·
590 κραιπνότερος μὲν γάρ τε νόος, λεπτὴ δέ τε μῆτις.
591 τώ τοι ἐπιτλήτω κραδίη· ἵππον δέ τοι αὐτὸς
592 δώσω, τὴν ἀρόμην. εἰ καί νύ κεν οἴκοθεν ἄλλο
593 μεῖζον ἐπαιτήσειας, ἄφαρ κέ τοι αὐτίκα δοῦναι
594 βουλοίμην ἢ σοί γε διοτρεφὲς ἤματα πάντα
595 ἐκ θυμοῦ πεσέειν καὶ δαίμοσιν εἶναι ἀλιτρός.
596 ἦ ῥα καὶ ἵππον ἄγων μεγαθύμου Νέστορος υἱὸς
597 ἐν χείρεσσι τίθει Μενελάου· τοῖο δὲ θυμὸς
598 ἰάνθη ὡς εἴ τε περὶ σταχύεσσιν ἐέρση
599 ληΐου ἀλδήσκοντος, ὅτε φρίσσουσιν ἄρουραι·
600 ὣς ἄρα σοὶ Μενέλαε μετὰ φρεσὶ θυμὸς ἰάνθη.
The son of Nestor then took the mare and gave her over to Menelaos, whose anger was thus appeased; as when dew falls upon a field of ripening wheat, and the lands are bristling with the harvest - even so, O Menelaos, was your heart made glad within you. He turned to Antilokhos and said, "Now, Antilokhos, angry though I have been, I can give way to you of my own free will; you have never been headstrong nor ill-disposed hitherto, but this time your youth has got the better of your judgment [noos]; be careful how you outwit your betters in future; no one else could have brought me round so easily, but your good father, your brother, and yourself have all of you had infinite trouble on my behalf; I therefore yield to your entreaty, and will give up the mare to you, mine though it indeed be; the people will thus see that I am neither harsh nor vindictive." With this he gave the mare over to Antilokhos' comrade Noemon, and then took the cauldron. Meriones, who had come in fourth, carried off the two talents of gold, and the fifth prize [athlon], the two-handled urn, being unawarded, Achilles gave it to Nestor, going up to him in the assembly [agôn] of Argives and saying, "Take this, my good old friend, as an heirloom and memorial of the funeral of Patroklos - for you shall see him no more among the Argives. I give you this prize [athlon] though you cannot win one; you can now neither wrestle nor fight, and cannot enter for the javelin-match nor foot-races, for the hand of age has been laid heavily upon you." So saying he gave the urn over to Nestor, who received it gladly and answered, "My son, all that you have said is true; there is no strength now in my legs and feet, nor can I hit out with my hands from either shoulder. Would that I were still young and strong as when the Epeans were burying King Amarynkeus in Bouprasion, and his sons offered prizes in his honor. There was then none that could vie with me neither of the Epeans nor the Pylians themselves nor the Aetolians. In boxing I overcame Klytomedes son of Enops, and in wrestling, Ankaios of Pleuron who had come forward against me. Iphiklos was a good runner, but I beat him, and threw farther with my spear than either Phyleus or Polydoros. In chariot-racing alone did the two sons of Aktor surpass me by crowding their horses in

front of me, for they were angry at the way victory had gone, and at the greater part of the prizes remaining in the place in which they had been offered. They were twins, and the one kept on holding the reins, and holding the reins, while the other plied the whip. Such was I then, but now I must leave these matters to younger men; I must bow before the weight of years, but in those days I was eminent among heroes. And now, sir, go on with the funeral contests [athloi] in honor of your comrade: gladly do I accept this urn, and my heart rejoices that you do not forget me but are ever mindful of my goodwill towards you, and of the respect [timê] due to me from the Achaeans. For all which may the grace [kharis] of heaven be granted you in great abundance." Thereon the son of Peleus, when he had listened to all the praise [ainos] of Nestor, went about among the concourse of the Achaeans, and presently offered prizes for skill in the painful art of boxing. He brought out a strong mule, and made it fast in the middle of the crowd [agôn] - a she-mule never yet broken, but six years old - when it is hardest of all to break them: this was for the victor, and for the vanquished he offered a double cup. Then he stood up and said among the Argives, "Son of Atreus, and all other Achaeans, I invite our two champion boxers to lay about them lustily and compete for these prizes. He to whom Apollo grants the greater endurance, and whom the Achaeans acknowledge as victor, shall take the mule back with him to his own tent, while he that is vanquished shall have the double cup." As he spoke there stood up a champion both brave and great stature, a skillful boxer, Epeios, son of Panopeus. He laid his hand on the mule and said, "Let the man who is to have the cup come hither, for none but myself will take the mule. I am the best boxer of all here present, and none can beat me. Is it not enough that I should fall short of you in actual fighting? Still, no man can be good at everything. I tell you plainly, and it shall come true; if any man will box with me I will bruise his body and break his bones; therefore let his friends stay here in a body and be at hand to take him away when I have done with him." They all held their peace, and no man rose save Euryalos son of Mekisteus, who was son of Talaos. Mekisteus went once to Thebes after the fall of Oedipus, to attend his funeral, and he beat all the people of Cadmus. The son of Tydeus was Euryalos' second, cheering him on and hoping heartily that he would win. First he put a waistband round him and then he gave him some well-cut thongs of ox-hide; the two men being now girt went into the middle of the ring [agôn], and immediately fell to; heavily indeed did they punish one another and lay about them with their brawny fists. One could hear the horrid crashing of their jaws, and they sweated from every pore of their skin. Presently Epeios came on and gave Euryalos a blow on the jaw as he was looking round; Euryalos could not keep his legs; they gave way under him in a moment and he sprang up with a bound, as a fish leaps into the air near some shore that is all bestrewn with sea-wrack, when Boreas furs the top of the waves, and then falls back into deep water. But noble Epeios caught hold of him and raised him up; his comrades also came round him and led him from the ring [agôn], unsteady in his gait, his head hanging on one side, and spitting great clots of gore. They set him down in a swoon and then went to fetch the double cup. The son of Peleus now brought out the prizes for the third contest and showed them to the Argives. These were for the painful art of wrestling. For the winner there was a great tripod ready for setting upon the fire,

23.601

601 καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
602 Ἀντίλοχε νῦν μέν τοι ἐγὼν ὑποείξομαι αὐτὸς
603 χωόμενος, ἐπεὶ οὔ τι παρήορος οὐδ’ ἀεσίφρων
604 ἦσθα πάρος· νῦν αὖτε νόον νίκησε νεοίη.
605 δεύτερον αὖτ’ ἀλέασθαι ἀμείνονας ἠπεροπεύειν.
606 οὐ γάρ κέν με τάχ’ ἄλλος ἀνὴρ παρέπεισεν Ἀχαιῶν.
607 ἀλλὰ σὺ γὰρ δὴ πολλὰ πάθες καὶ πολλὰ μόγησας

σός τε πατὴρ ἀγαθὸς καὶ ἀδελφεὸς εἵνεκ’ ἐμεῖο·
τώ τοι λισσομένῳ ἐπιπείσομαι, ἠδὲ καὶ ἵππον
δώσω ἐμήν περ ἐοῦσαν, ἵνα γνώωσι καὶ οἵδε
ὡς ἐμὸς οὔ ποτε θυμὸς ὑπερφίαλος καὶ ἀπηνής.
ἦ ῥα, καὶ Ἀντιλόχοιο Νοήμονι δῶκεν ἑταίρῳ
ἵππον ἄγειν· ὃ δ’ ἔπειτα λέβηθ’ ἕλε παμφανόωντα.
Μηριόνης δ’ ἀνάειρε δύω χρυσοῖο τάλαντα
τέτρατος, ὡς ἔλασεν. πέμπτον δ’ ὑπελείπετ’ ἄεθλον,
ἀμφίθετος φιάλη· τὴν Νέστορι δῶκεν Ἀχιλλεὺς
Ἀργείων ἀν’ ἀγῶνα φέρων, καὶ ἔειπε παραστάς·
τῆ νῦν, καὶ σοὶ τοῦτο γέρον κειμήλιον ἔστω
Πατρόκλοιο τάφου μνῆμ’ ἔμμεναι· οὐ γὰρ ἔτ’ αὐτὸν
ὄψῃ ἐν Ἀργείοισι· δίδωμι δέ τοι τόδ’ ἄεθλον
αὔτως· οὐ γὰρ πύξ γε μαχήσεαι, οὐδὲ παλαίσεις,
οὐδ’ ἔτ’ ἀκοντιστὺν ἐσδύσεαι, οὐδὲ πόδεσσι
θεύσεαι· ἤδη γὰρ χαλεπὸν κατὰ γῆρας ἐπείγει.
ὣς εἰπὼν ἐν χερσὶ τίθει· ὃ δ’ ἐδέξατο χαίρων,
καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
ναὶ δὴ ταῦτά γε πάντα τέκος κατὰ μοῖραν ἔειπες·
οὐ γὰρ ἔτ’ ἔμπεδα γυῖα φίλος πόδες, οὐδέ τι χεῖρες
ὤμων ἀμφοτέρωθεν ἐπαΐσσονται ἐλαφραί.
εἴθ’ ὡς ἠβώοιμι βίη τέ μοι ἔμπεδος εἴη
ὡς ὁπότε κρείοντ’ Ἀμαρυγκέα θάπτον Ἐπειοὶ

23.631

Βουπρασίῳ, παῖδες δ’ ἔθεσαν βασιλῆος ἄεθλα·
ἔνθ’ οὔ τίς μοι ὁμοῖος ἀνὴρ γένετ’, οὔτ’ ἄρ’ Ἐπειῶν
οὔτ’ αὐτῶν Πυλίων οὔτ’ Αἰτωλῶν μεγαθύμων.
πὺξ μὲν ἐνίκησα Κλυτομήδεα Ἤνοπος υἱόν,
Ἀγκαῖον δὲ πάλῃ Πλευρώνιον, ὅς μοι ἀνέστη·
Ἴφικλον δὲ πόδεσσι παρέδραμον ἐσθλὸν ἐόντα,
δουρὶ δ’ ὑπειρέβαλον Φυλῆά τε καὶ Πολύδωρον.
οἵοισίν μ’ ἵπποισι παρήλασαν Ἀκτορίωνε
πλήθει πρόσθε βαλόντες ἀγασσάμενοι περὶ νίκης,
οὕνεκα δὴ τὰ μέγιστα παρ’ αὐτόθι λείπετ’ ἄεθλα.
οἳ δ’ ἄρ’ ἔσαν δίδυμοι· ὃ μὲν ἔμπεδον ἡνιόχευεν,
ἔμπεδον ἡνιόχευ’, ὃ δ’ ἄρα μάστιγι κέλευεν.
ὥς ποτ’ ἔον· νῦν αὖτε νεώτεροι ἀντιόωντων
ἔργων τοιούτων· ἐμὲ δὲ χρὴ γήραϊ λυγρῷ
πείθεσθαι, τότε δ’ αὖτε μετέπρεπον ἠρώεσσιν.
ἀλλ’ ἴθι καὶ σὸν ἑταῖρον ἀέθλοισι κτερέϊζε.
τοῦτο δ’ ἐγὼ πρόφρων δέχομαι, χαίρει δέ μοι ἦτορ,
ὥς μευ ἀεὶ μέμνησαι ἐνηέος, οὐδέ σε λήθω,
τιμῆς ἥς τέ μ’ ἔοικε τετιμῆσθαι μετ’ Ἀχαιοῖς.
σοὶ δὲ θεοὶ τῶνδ’ ἀντὶ χάριν μενοεικέα δοῖεν.
ὣς φάτο, Πηλεΐδης δὲ πολὺν καθ’ ὅμιλον Ἀχαιῶν
ᾤχετ’, ἐπεὶ πάντ’ αἶνον ἐπέκλυε Νηλεΐδαο.
αὐτὰρ ὃ πυγμαχίης ἀλεγεινῆς θῆκεν ἄεθλα·
ἡμίονον ταλαεργὸν ἄγων κατέδησ’ ἐν ἀγῶνι
ἐξέτε’ ἀδμήτην, ἥ τ’ ἀλγίστη δαμάσασθαι·
τῷ δ’ ἄρα νικηθέντι τίθει δέπας ἀμφικύπελλον.

στῆ δ’ ὀρθὸς καὶ μῦθον ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἔειπεν·
Ἀτρεΐδη τε καὶ ἄλλοι ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοὶ
ἄνδρε δύω περὶ τῶνδε κελεύομεν, ὥ περ ἀρίστω,
πὺξ μάλ’ ἀνασχομένω πεπληγέμεν· ᾧ δέ κ’ Ἀπόλλων

23.661

δώῃ καμμονίην, γνώωσι δὲ πάντες Ἀχαιοί,
ἡμίονον ταλαεργὸν ἄγων κλισίηνδὲ νεέσθω·
αὐτὰρ ὃ νικηθεὶς δέπας οἴσεται ἀμφικύπελλον.
ὣς ἔφατ’, ὄρνυτο δ’ αὐτίκ’ ἀνὴρ ἠΰς τε μέγας τε
εἰδὼς πυγμαχίης υἱὸς Πανοπῆος Ἐπειός,
ἅψατο δ’ ἡμιόνου ταλαεργοῦ φώνησέν τε·
ἆσσον ἴτω ὅς τις δέπας οἴσεται ἀμφικύπελλον·
ἡμίονον δ’ οὔ φημί τιν’ ἀξέμεν ἄλλον Ἀχαιῶν
πυγμῇ νικήσαντ’, ἐπεὶ εὔχομαι εἶναι ἄριστος.
ἦ οὐχ ἅλις ὅττι μάχης ἐπιδεύομαι; οὐδ’ ἄρα πως ἦν
ἐν πάντεσσ’ ἔργοισι δαήμονα φῶτα γενέσθαι.
ὧδε γὰρ ἐξερέω, τὸ δὲ καὶ τετελεσμένον ἔσται·
ἀντικρὺ χρόα τε ῥήξω σύν τ’ ὀστέ’ ἀράξω.
κηδεμόνες δέ οἱ ἐνθάδ’ ἀολλέες αὖθι μενόντων,
οἵ κέ μιν ἐξοίσουσιν ἐμῆς ὑπὸ χερσὶ δαμέντα.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἀκὴν ἐγένοντο σιωπῇ.
Εὐρύαλος δέ οἱ οἷος ἀνίστατο ἰσόθεος φὼς
Μηκιστῆος υἱὸς Ταλαϊονίδαο ἄνακτος,
ὅς ποτε Θήβας δ’ ἦλθε δεδουπότος Οἰδιπόδαο
ἐς τάφον· ἔνθα δὲ πάντας ἐνίκα Καδμείωνας.
τὸν μὲν Τυδεΐδης δουρὶ κλυτὸς ἀμφεπονεῖτο
θαρσύνων ἔπεσιν, μέγα δ’ αὐτῷ βούλετο νίκην.
ζῶμα δέ οἱ πρῶτον παρακάββαλεν, αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
δῶκεν ἰμάντας ἐϋτμήτους βοὸς ἀγραύλοιο.
τὼ δὲ ζωσαμένω βήτην ἐς μέσσον ἀγῶνα,
ἄντα δ’ ἀνασχομένω χερσὶ στιβαρῇσιν ἄμ’ ἄμφω
σύν ῥ’ ἔπεσον, σὺν δέ σφι βαρεῖαι χεῖρες ἔμιχθεν.
δεινὸς δὲ χρόμαδος γενύων γένετ’, ἔρρεε δ’ ἱδρὼς
πάντοθεν ἐκ μελέων· ἐπὶ δ’ ὄρνυτο δῖος Ἐπειός,
κόψε δὲ παπτήναντα παρήϊον· οὐδ’ ἄρ’ ἔτι δὴν

23.691

ἐστήκειν· αὐτοῦ γὰρ ὑπήριπε φαίδιμα γυῖα.
ὡς δ’ ὅθ’ ὑπὸ φρικὸς Βορέω ἀναπάλλεται ἰχθὺς
θίν’ ἐν φυκιόεντι, μέλαν δέ ἑ κῦμα κάλυψεν,
ὣς πληγεὶς ἀνέπαλτ’· αὐτὰρ μεγάθυμος Ἐπειὸς
χερσὶ λαβὼν ὤρθωσε· φίλοι δ’ ἀμφέσταν ἑταῖροι,
οἵ μιν ἄγον δι’ ἀγῶνος ἐφελκομένοισι πόδεσσιν
αἷμα παχὺ πτύοντα κάρη βάλλονθ’ ἑτέρωσε·
κὰδ δ’ ἀλλοφρονέοντα μετὰ σφίσιν εἷσαν ἄγοντες,
αὐτοὶ δ’ οἰχόμενοι κόμισαν δέπας ἀμφικύπελλον.
Πηλεΐδης δ’ αἶψ’ ἄλλα κατὰ τρίτα θῆκεν ἄεθλα
δεικνύμενος Δαναοῖσι παλαισμοσύνης ἀλεγεινῆς,
τῷ μὲν νικήσαντι μέγαν τρίποδ’ ἐμπυριβήτην,

703 τὸν δὲ δυωδεκάβοιον ἐνὶ σφίσι τῖον Ἀχαιοί·
704 ἀνδρὶ δὲ νικηθέντι γυναῖκ’ ἐς μέσσον ἔθηκε,
705 πολλὰ δ’ ἐπίστατο ἔργα, τίον δέ ἑ τεσσαράβοιον.
706 στῆ δ’ ὀρθὸς καὶ μῦθον ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἔειπεν·
707 ὄρνυσθ’ οἳ καὶ τούτου ἀέθλου πειρήσεσθον.
708 ὣς ἔφατ’, ὦρτο δ’ ἔπειτα μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας,
709 ἂν δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς πολύμητις ἀνίστατο κέρδεα εἰδώς.
710 ζωσαμένω δ’ ἄρα τώ γε βάτην ἐς μέσσον ἀγῶνα,
711 ἀγκὰς δ’ ἀλλήλων λαβέτην χερσὶ στιβαρῇσιν
712 ὡς ὅτ’ ἀμείβοντες, τούς τε κλυτὸς ἤραρε τέκτων
713 δώματος ὑψηλοῖο βίας ἀνέμων ἀλεείνων.
714 τετρίγει δ’ ἄρα νῶτα θρασειάων ἀπὸ χειρῶν
715 ἑλκόμενα στερεῶς· κατὰ δὲ νότιος ῥέεν ἱδρώς,
716 πυκναὶ δὲ σμώδιγγες ἀνὰ πλευράς τε καὶ ὤμους
717 αἵματι φοινικόεσσαι ἀνέδραμον· οἳ δὲ μάλ’ αἰεὶ
718 νίκης ἱέσθην τρίποδος πέρι ποιητοῖο·
719 οὔτ’ Ὀδυσεὺς δύνατο σφῆλαι οὔδει τε πελάσσαι,
720 οὔτ’ Αἴας δύνατο, κρατερὴ δ’ ἔχεν ἶς Ὀδυσῆος.
and the Achaeans valued it among themselves at twelve oxen. For the loser he brought out a woman skilled in all manner of arts, and they valued her at four oxen. He rose and said among the Argives, "Stand forward, you who will essay this contest [athlon]." Forthwith uprose great Ajax the son of Telamon, and crafty Odysseus, full of craft [kerdos] rose also. The two girded themselves and went into the middle of the ring [agôn]. They gripped each other in their strong hands like the rafters which some master-builder frames for the roof of a high house to keep the wind out. Their backbones cracked as they tugged at one another with their mighty arms - and sweat rained from them in torrents. Many a bloody weal sprang up on their sides and shoulders, but they kept on striving with might and main for victory and to win the tripod. Odysseus could not throw Ajax, nor Ajax him; Odysseus was too strong for him; but when the Achaeans began to tire of watching them, Ajax said to Odysseus, "Odysseus, noble son of Laertes, you shall either lift me, or I you, and let Zeus settle it between us." He lifted him from the ground as he spoke, but Odysseus did not forget his cunning. He hit Ajax in the hollow at back of his knee, so that he could not keep his feet, but fell on his back with Odysseus lying upon his chest, and all who saw it marveled. Then Odysseus in turn lifted Ajax and stirred him a little from the ground but could not lift him right off it, his knee sank under him, and the two fell side by side on the ground and were all begrimed with dust. They now sprang towards one another and were for wrestling yet a third time, but Achilles rose and stayed them. "Put not each other further," said he, "to such cruel suffering; the victory is with both alike, take each of you an equal prize, and let the other Achaeans now compete." Thus did he speak and they did even as he had said, and put on their shirts again after wiping the dust from off their bodies. The son of Peleus then offered prizes for speed in running - a mixing-bowl beautifully wrought, of pure silver. It would hold six measures, and far exceeded all others in the whole world for beauty; it was the work of cunning artificers in Sidon, and had been brought into port by Phoenicians from beyond the sea [pontos], who had made a present of it to Thoas. Eueneus son of Jason had given it to Patroklos in ransom of Priam's son Lykaon, and Achilles now offered it as a prize [athlon] in honor of his comrade to him who should be the swiftest runner. For the second prize he offered a large ox, well fattened, while for the last there was to be half a talent of gold. He then rose and said among the Argives, "Stand forward, you who will essay this contest [athlon]." Forthwith uprose fleet Ajax son of Oileus, with cunning Odysseus, and Nestor's son Antilokhos, the fastest runner among all the youth of his time. They stood side by side and Achilles showed them the goal. The course was set out

for them from the starting-post, and the son of Oileus took the lead at once, with Odysseus as close behind him as the shuttle is to a woman's bosom when she throws the woof across the warp and holds it close up to her; even so close behind him was Odysseus - treading in his footprints before the dust could settle there, and Ajax could feel his breath on the back of his head as he ran swiftly on. The Achaeans all shouted approval as they saw him straining his utmost, and cheered him as he shot past them; but when they were now nearing the end of the course Odysseus prayed inwardly to Athena. "Hear me," he cried, "and help my feet, O goddess." Thus did he pray, and Pallas Athena heard his prayer; she made his hands and his feet feel light, and when the runners were at the point of pouncing upon the prize [athlon], Ajax, through Athena's spite slipped upon some offal that was lying there from the cattle which Achilles had slaughtered in honor of Patroklos, and his mouth and nostrils were all filled with cow dung. Odysseus therefore carried off the mixing-bowl, for he got before Ajax and came in first. But Ajax took the ox and stood with his hand on one of its horns, spitting the dung out of his mouth. Then he said to the Argives, "Alas, the goddess has spoiled my running; she watches over Odysseus and stands by him as though she were his own mother." Thus did he speak and they all of them laughed heartily. Antilokhos carried off the last prize [athlon] and smiled as he said to the bystanders, "You all see, my friends, that now too the gods have shown their respect for seniority. Ajax is somewhat older than I am, and as for Odysseus, he belongs to an earlier generation, but he is hale in spite of his years, and no man of the Achaeans can run against him save only Achilles."

23.721

ἀλλ’ ὅτε δή ῥ’ ἀνίαζον ἐϋκνήμιδας Ἀχαιούς,
δὴ τότε μιν προσέειπε μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας·
διογενὲς Λαερτιάδη πολυμήχαν’ Ὀδυσσεῦ
ἤ μ’ ἀνάειρ’, ἢ ἐγὼ σέ· τὰ δ’ αὖ Διὶ πάντα μελήσει.
ὣς εἰπὼν ἀνάειρε· δόλου δ’ οὐ λήθετ’ Ὀδυσσεύς·
κόψ’ ὄπιθεν κώληπα τυχών, ὑπέλυσε δὲ γυῖα,
κὰδ δ’ ἔβαλ’ ἐξοπίσω· ἐπὶ δὲ στήθεσσιν Ὀδυσσεὺς
κάππεσε· λαοὶ δ’ αὖ θηεῦντό τε θάμβησάν τε.
δεύτερος αὖτ’ ἀνάειρε πολύτλας δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς,
κίνησεν δ’ ἄρα τυτθὸν ἀπὸ χθονός, οὐδ’ ἔτ’ ἄειρεν,
ἐν δὲ γόνυ γνάμψεν· ἐπὶ δὲ χθονὶ κάππεσον ἄμφω
πλησίοι ἀλλήλοισι, μιάνθησαν δὲ κονίῃ.
καί νύ κε τὸ τρίτον αὖτις ἀναΐξαντ’ ἐπάλαιον,
εἰ μὴ Ἀχιλλεὺς αὐτὸς ἀνίστατο καὶ κατέρυκε·
μηκέτ’ ἐρείδεσθον, μὴ δὲ τρίβεσθε κακοῖσι·
νίκη δ’ ἀμφοτέροισιν· ἀέθλια δ’ ἶσ’ ἀνελόντες
ἔρχεσθ’, ὄφρα καὶ ἄλλοι ἀεθλεύωσιν Ἀχαιοί.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα τοῦ μάλα μὲν κλύον ἠδὲ πίθοντο,
καί ῥ’ ἀπομορξαμένω κονίην δύσαντο χιτῶνας.
Πηλεΐδης δ’ αἶψ’ ἄλλα τίθει ταχυτῆτος ἄεθλα
ἀργύρεον κρητῆρα τετυγμένον· ἓξ δ’ ἄρα μέτρα
χάνδανεν, αὐτὰρ κάλλει ἐνίκα πᾶσαν ἐπ’ αἶαν
πολλόν, ἐπεὶ Σιδόνες πολυδαίδαλοι εὖ ἤσκησαν,
Φοίνικες δ’ ἄγον ἄνδρες ἐπ’ ἠεροειδέα πόντον,
στῆσαν δ’ ἐν λιμένεσσι, Θόαντι δὲ δῶρον ἔδωκαν·
υἱὸς δὲ Πριάμοιο Λυκάονος ὦνον ἔδωκε
Πατρόκλῳ ἥρωϊ Ἰησονίδης Εὔνηος.
καὶ τὸν Ἀχιλλεὺς θῆκεν ἄεθλον οὖ ἑτάροιο,

ὅς τις ἐλαφρότατος ποσσὶ κραιπνοῖσι πέλοιτο·
δευτέρῳ αὖ βοῦν θῆκε μέγαν καὶ πίονα δημῷ,

23.751

ἡμιτάλαντον δὲ χρυσοῦ λοισθήϊ’ ἔθηκε.
στῆ δ’ ὀρθὸς καὶ μῦθον ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἔειπεν·
ὄρνυσθ’ οἳ καὶ τούτου ἀέθλου πειρήσεσθε.
ὣς ἔφατ’, ὄρνυτο δ’ αὐτίκ’ Ὀϊλῆος ταχὺς Αἴας,
ἂν δ’ Ὀδυσεὺς πολύμητις, ἔπειτα δὲ Νέστορος υἱὸς
Ἀντίλοχος· ὃ γὰρ αὖτε νέους ποσὶ πάντας ἐνίκα.
στὰν δὲ μεταστοιχί· σήμηνε δὲ τέρματ’ Ἀχιλλεύς.
τοῖσι δ’ ἀπὸ νύσσης τέτατο δρόμος· ὦκα δ’ ἔπειτα
ἔκφερ’ Ὀϊλιάδης· ἐπὶ δ’ ὄρνυτο δῖος Ὀδυσσεὺς
ἄγχι μάλ’, ὡς ὅτε τίς τε γυναικὸς ἐϋζώνοιο
στήθεός ἐστι κανών, ὅν τ’ εὖ μάλα χερσὶ τανύσσῃ
πηνίον ἐξέλκουσα παρὲκ μίτον, ἀγχόθι δ’ ἴσχει
στήθεος· ὣς Ὀδυσεὺς θέεν ἐγγύθεν, αὐτὰρ ὄπισθεν
ἴχνια τύπτε πόδεσσι πάρος κόνιν ἀμφιχυθῆναι·
κὰδ δ’ ἄρα οἱ κεφαλῆς χέ’ ἀϋτμένα δῖος Ὀδυσσεὺς
αἰεὶ ῥίμφα θέων· ἴαχον δ’ ἐπὶ πάντες Ἀχαιοὶ
νίκης ἰεμένῳ, μάλα δὲ σπεύδοντι κέλευον.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ πύματον τέλεον δρόμον, αὐτίκ’ Ὀδυσσεὺς
εὔχετ’ Ἀθηναίῃ γλαυκώπιδι ὃν κατὰ θυμόν·
κλῦθι θεά, ἀγαθή μοι ἐπίρροθος ἐλθὲ ποδοῖιν.
ὣς ἔφατ’ εὐχόμενος· τοῦ δ’ ἔκλυε Παλλὰς Ἀθήνη,
γυῖα δ’ ἔθηκεν ἐλαφρά, πόδας καὶ χεῖρας ὕπερθεν.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ τάχ’ ἔμελλον ἐπαΐξασθαι ἄεθλον,
ἔνθ’ Αἴας μὲν ὄλισθε θέων, βλάψεν γὰρ Ἀθήνη,
τῇ ῥα βοῶν κέχυτ’ ὄνθος ἀποκταμένων ἐριμύκων,
οὓς ἐπὶ Πατρόκλῳ πέφνεν πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
ἐν δ’ ὄνθου βοέου πλῆτο στόμα τε ῥῖνάς τε·
κρητῆρ’ αὖτ’ ἀνάειρε πολύτλας δῖος Ὀδυσσεύς,
ὡς ἦλθε φθάμενος· ὃ δὲ βοῦν ἕλε φαίδιμος Αἴας.
στῆ δὲ κέρας μετὰ χερσὶν ἔχων βοὸς ἀγραύλοιο

23.781

ὄνθον ἀποπτύων, μετὰ δ’ Ἀργείοισιν ἔειπεν·
ὢ πόποι ἦ μ’ ἔβλαψε θεὰ πόδας, ἠ τὸ πάρος περ
μήτηρ ὡς Ὀδυσῆϊ παρίσταται ἠδ’ ἐπαρήγει.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πάντες ἐπ’ αὐτῷ ἡδὺ γέλασσαν.
Ἀντίλοχος δ’ ἄρα δὴ λοισθήϊον ἔκφερ’ ἄεθλον
μειδιόων, καὶ μῦθον ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἔειπεν·
εἰδόσιν ὔμμ’ ἐρέω πᾶσιν φίλοι, ὡς ἔτι καὶ νῦν
ἀθάνατοι τιμῶσι παλαιοτέρους ἀνθρώπους.
Αἴας μὲν γὰρ ἐμεῖ’ ὀλίγον προγενέστερός ἐστιν,
οὗτος δὲ προτέρης γενεῆς προτέρων τ’ ἀνθρώπων·
ὠμογέροντα δέ μίν φασ’ ἔμμεναι· ἀργαλέον δὲ
ποσσὶν ἐριδήσασθαι Ἀχαιοῖς, εἰ μὴ Ἀχιλλεῖ.
ὣς φάτο, κύδηνεν δὲ ποδώκεα Πηλεΐωνα.
τὸν δ’ Ἀχιλεὺς μύθοισιν ἀμειβόμενος προσέειπεν·

795 Ἀντίλοχ’ οὐ μέν τοι μέλεος εἰρήσεται αἶνος,
796 ἀλλά τοι ἡμιτάλαντον ἐγὼ χρυσοῦ ἐπιθήσω.
797 ὣς εἰπὼν ἐν χερσὶ τίθει, ὃ δ’ ἐδέξατο χαίρων.
798 αὐτὰρ Πηλεΐδης κατὰ μὲν δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος
799 θῆκ’ ἐς ἀγῶνα φέρων, κατὰ δ’ ἀσπίδα καὶ τρυφάλειαν
800 τεύχεα Σαρπήδοντος, ἅ μιν Πάτροκλος ἀπηύρα.
801 στῆ δ’ ὀρθὸς καὶ μῦθον ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἔειπεν·
802 ἄνδρε δύω περὶ τῶνδε κελεύομεν, ὥ περ ἀρίστω,
803 τεύχεα ἐσσαμένω ταμεσίχροα χαλκὸν ἐλόντε
804 ἀλλήλων προπάροιθεν ὁμίλου πειρηθῆναι.
805 ὁππότερός κε φθῇσιν ὀρεξάμενος χρόα καλόν,
806 ψαύσῃ δ’ ἐνδίνων διά τ’ ἔντεα καὶ μέλαν αἷμα,
807 τῷ μὲν ἐγὼ δώσω τόδε φάσγανον ἀργυρόηλον
808 καλὸν Θρηΐκιον, τὸ μὲν Ἀστεροπαῖον ἀπηύρων·
809 τεύχεα δ’ ἀμφότεροι ξυνήϊα ταῦτα φερέσθων·
810 καί σφιν δαῖτ’ ἀγαθὴν παραθήσομεν ἐν κλισίῃσιν.
He said this to pay a compliment to the son of Peleus, and Achilles answered, "Antilokhos, you shall not have given me praise [ainos] to no purpose; I shall give you an additional half talent of gold." He then gave the half talent to Antilokhos, who received it gladly. Then the son of Peleus brought out to the assembly [agôn] the spear, helmet, and shield that had been borne by Sarpedon, and were taken from him by Patroklos. He stood up and said among the Argives, "We bid two champions put on their armor, take their keen blades, and make trial of one another in the presence of the multitude; whichever of them can first wound the flesh of the other, cut through his armor, and draw blood, to him will I give this goodly Thracian sword inlaid with silver, which I took from Asteropaios, but the armor let both hold in partnership, and I will give each of them a hearty meal in my own tent." Forthwith uprose great Ajax the son of Telamon, as also mighty Diomedes son of Tydeus. When they had put on their armor each on his own side of the ring, they both went into the middle eager to engage, and with fire flashing from their eyes. The Achaeans marveled as they beheld them, and when the two were now close up with one another, thrice did they spring forward and thrice try to strike each other in close combat. Ajax pierced Diomedes' round shield, but did not draw blood, for the cuirass beneath the shield protected him; thereon the son of Tydeus from over his huge shield kept aiming continually at Ajax's neck with the point of his spear, and the Achaeans alarmed for his safety bade them leave off fighting and divide the prize between them. Achilles then gave the great sword to the son of Tydeus, with its scabbard, and the leathern belt with which to hang it. Achilles next offered the massive iron quoit which mighty Eetion had erewhile been used to hurl, until Achilles had slain him and carried it off in his ships along with other spoils. He stood up and said among the Argives, "Stand forward, you who would essay this contest [athlon]. He who wins it will have a store of iron that will last him five years as they go rolling round, and if his fair fields lie far from a town his shepherd or ploughman will not have to make a journey to buy iron, for he will have a stock of it on his own premises." Then uprose the two mighty men Polypoites and Leonteus, with Ajax son of Telamon and noble Epeios. They stood up one after the other and Epeios took the quoit, whirled it, and flung it from him, which set all the Achaeans laughing. After him threw Leonteus of the race of Ares. Ajax son of Telamon threw third, and sent the quoit beyond any mark [sêma] that had been made yet, but when mighty Polypoites took the quoit he hurled it as though it had been a stockman's stick which he sends flying about among his cattle when he is driving them, so far did his throw out-distance those of the others in the contest [agôn]. All who saw it roared approval, and his comrades carried the prize [athlon] for him and set it on board his ship. Achilles next offered a prize of iron for archery - ten double-edged axes and ten with single eddies: he set

up a ship's mast, some way off upon the sands, and with a fine string tied a pigeon to it by the foot; this was what they were to aim at. "Whoever," he said, "can hit the pigeon shall have all the axes and take them away with him; he who hits the string without hitting the bird will have taken a worse aim and shall have the single-edged axes." Then uprose King Teucer, and Meriones the stalwart squire [therapôn] of Idomeneus rose also, They cast lots in a bronze helmet and the lot of Teucer fell first. He let fly with his arrow forthwith, but he did not promise hecatombs of firstling lambs to King Apollo, and missed his bird, for Apollo foiled his aim; but he hit the string with which the bird was tied, near its foot; the arrow cut the string clean through so that it hung down towards the ground, while the bird flew up into the sky, and the Achaeans shouted approval. Meriones, who had his arrow ready while Teucer was aiming, snatched the bow out of his hand, and at once promised that he would sacrifice a hecatomb of firstling lambs to Apollo lord of the bow; then espying the pigeon high up under the clouds, he hit her in the middle of the wing as she was circling upwards; the arrow went clean through the wing and fixed itself in the ground at Meriones' feet, but the bird perched on the ship's mast hanging her head and with all her feathers drooping; the life went out of her, and she fell heavily from the mast. Meriones, therefore, took all ten double-edged axes, while Teucer bore off the single-edged ones to his ships.

23.811

811 ὣς ἔφατ’, ὦρτο δ’ ἔπειτα μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας,
812 ἂν δ’ ἄρα Τυδεΐδης ὦρτο, κρατερὸς Διομήδης.
813 οἳ δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν ἑκάτερθεν ὁμίλου θωρήχθησαν,
814 ἐς μέσον ἀμφοτέρω συνίτην μεμαῶτε μάχεσθαι
815 δεινὸν δερκομένω· θάμβος δ’ ἔχε πάντας Ἀχαιούς.
816 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ σχεδὸν ἦσαν ἐπ’ ἀλλήλοισιν ἰόντες,
817 τρὶς μὲν ἐπήϊξαν, τρὶς δὲ σχεδὸν ὁρμήθησαν.
818 ἔνθ’ Αἴας μὲν ἔπειτα κατ’ ἀσπίδα πάντοσ’ ἐΐσην
819 νύξ’, οὐδὲ χρό’ ἴκανεν· ἔρυτο γὰρ ἔνδοθι θώρηξ·
820 Τυδεΐδης δ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα ὑπὲρ σάκεος μεγάλοιο
821 αἰὲν ἐπ’ αὐχένι κῦρε φαεινοῦ δουρὸς ἀκωκῇ.
822 καὶ τότε δή ῥ’ Αἴαντι περιδείσαντες Ἀχαιοὶ
823 παυσαμένους ἐκέλευσαν ἀέθλια ἶσ’ ἀνελέσθαι.
824 αὐτὰρ Τυδεΐδῃ δῶκεν μέγα φάσγανον ἥρως
825 σὺν κολεῷ τε φέρων καὶ ἐϋτμήτῳ τελαμῶνι.
826 αὐτὰρ Πηλεΐδης θῆκεν σόλον αὐτοχόωνον
827 ὃν πρὶν μὲν ῥίπτασκε μέγα σθένος Ἠετίωνος·
828 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι τὸν ἔπεφνε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
829 τὸν δ’ ἄγετ’ ἐν νήεσσι σὺν ἄλλοισι κτεάτεσσι.
830 στῆ δ’ ὀρθὸς καὶ μῦθον ἐν Ἀργείοισιν ἔειπεν·
831 ὄρνυσθ’ οἳ καὶ τούτου ἀέθλου πειρήσεσθε.
832 εἴ οἱ καὶ μάλα πολλὸν ἀπόπροθι πίονες ἀγροί,
833 ἕξει μιν καὶ πέντε περιπλομένους ἐνιαυτοὺς
834 χρεώμενος· οὐ μὲν γάρ οἱ ἀτεμβόμενός γε σιδήρου
835 ποιμὴν οὐδ’ ἀροτὴρ εἶσ’ ἐς πόλιν, ἀλλὰ παρέξει.
836 ὣς ἔφατ’, ὦρτο δ’ ἔπειτα μενεπτόλεμος Πολυποίτης,
837 ἂν δὲ Λεοντῆος κρατερὸν μένος ἀντιθέοιο,
838 ἂν δ’ Αἴας Τελαμωνιάδης καὶ δῖος Ἐπειός.
839 ἐξείης δ’ ἵσταντο, σόλον δ’ ἔλε δῖος Ἐπειός,
840 ἦκε δὲ δινήσας· γέλασαν δ’ ἐπὶ πάντες Ἀχαιοί.

23.841

δεύτερος αὖτ’ ἀφέηκε Λεοντεὺς ὄζος Ἄρηος·
τὸ τρίτον αὖτ’ ἔρριψε μέγας Τελαμώνιος Αἴας
χειρὸς ἄπο στιβαρῆς, καὶ ὑπέρβαλε σήματα πάντων.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ σόλον εἶλε μενεπτόλεμος Πολυποίτης,
ὅσσόν τίς τ’ ἔρριψε καλαύροπα βουκόλος ἀνήρ,
ἢ δέ θ’ ἑλισσομένη πέτεται διὰ βοῦς ἀγελαίας,
τόσσον παντὸς ἀγῶνος ὑπέρβαλε· τοὶ δὲ βόησαν.
ἀνστάντες δ’ ἔταροι Πολυποίταο κρατεροῖο
νῆας ἔπι γλαφυρὰς ἔφερον βασιλῆος ἄεθλον.
αὐτὰρ ὃ τοξευτῇσι τίθει ἰόεντα σίδηρον,
κὰδ δ’ ἐτίθει δέκα μὲν πελέκεας, δέκα δ’ ἡμιπέλεκκα,
ἱστὸν δ’ ἔστησεν νηὸς κυανοπρῴροιο
τηλοῦ ἐπὶ ψαμάθοις, ἐκ δὲ τρήρωνα πέλειαν
λεπτῇ μηρίνθῳ δῆσεν ποδός, ἧς ἄρ’ ἀνώγει
τοξεύειν· ὃς μέν κε βάλῃ τρήρωνα πέλειαν,
πάντας ἀειράμενος πελέκεας οἶκον δὲ φερέσθω·
ὃς δέ κε μηρίνθοιο τύχῃ ὄρνιθος ἁμαρτών,
ἥσσων γὰρ δὴ κεῖνος, ὃ δ’ οἴσεται ἡμιπέλεκκα.
ὣς ἔφατ’, ὦρτο δ’ ἔπειτα βίη Τεύκροιο ἄνακτος,
ἂν δ’ ἄρα Μηριόνης θεράπων ἐὺς Ἰδομενῆος.
κλήρους δ’ ἐν κυνέῃ χαλκήρεϊ πάλλον ἐλόντες,
Τεῦκρος δὲ πρῶτος κλήρῳ λάχεν· αὐτίκα δ’ ἰὸν
ἧκεν ἐπικρατέως, οὐδ’ ἠπείλησεν ἄνακτι
ἀρνῶν πρωτογόνων ῥέξειν κλειτὴν ἑκατόμβην.
ὄρνιθος μὲν ἅμαρτε· μέγηρε γάρ οἱ τό γ’ Ἀπόλλων·
αὐτὰρ ὃ μήρινθον βάλε πὰρ πόδα, τῇ δέδετ’ ὄρνις·
ἀντικρὺ δ’ ἀπὸ μήρινθον τάμε πικρὸς ὀϊστός.
ἣ μὲν ἔπειτ’ ἴξε πρὸς οὐρανόν, ἣ δὲ παρείθη
μήρινθος ποτὶ γαῖαν· ἀτὰρ κελάδησαν Ἀχαιοί.
σπερχόμενος δ’ ἄρα Μηριόνης ἐξείρυσε χειρὸς

23.871

τόξον· ἀτὰρ δὴ ὀϊστὸν ἔχεν πάλαι, ὡς ἴθυνεν.
αὐτίκα δ’ ἠπείλησεν ἑκηβόλῳ Ἀπόλλωνι
ἀρνῶν πρωτογόνων ῥέξειν κλειτὴν ἑκατόμβην.
ὕψι δ’ ὑπὸ νεφέων εἶδε τρήρωνα πέλειαν·
τῇ ῥ’ ὅ γε δινεύουσαν ὑπὸ πτέρυγος βάλε μέσσην,
ἀντικρὺ δὲ διῆλθε βέλος· τὸ μὲν ἂψ ἐπὶ γαίῃ
πρόσθεν Μηριόναο πάγη ποδός· αὐτὰρ ἡ ὄρνις
ἱστῷ ἐφεζομένη νηὸς κυανοπρῴροιο
αὐχέν’ ἀπεκρέμασεν, σὺν δὲ πτερὰ πυκνὰ λίασθεν.
ὠκὺς δ’ ἐκ μελέων θυμὸς πτάτο, τῆλε δ’ ἀπ’ αὐτοῦ
κάππεσε· λαοὶ δ’ αὖ θηεῦντό τε θάμβησάν τε.
ἂν δ’ ἄρα Μηριόνης πελέκεας δέκα πάντας ἄειρε,
Τεῦκρος δ’ ἡμιπέλεκκα φέρεν κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας.
αὐτὰρ Πηλεΐδης κατὰ μὲν δολιχόσκιον ἔγχος,
κὰδ δὲ λέβητ’ ἄπυρον βοὸς ἄξιον ἀνθεμόεντα
θῆκ’ ἐς ἀγῶνα φέρων· καί ῥ’ ἥμονες ἄνδρες ἀνέσταν·
ἂν μὲν ἄρ’ Ἀτρεΐδης εὐρὺ κρείων Ἀγαμέμνων,
ἂν δ’ ἄρα Μηριόνης, θεράπων ἐὺς Ἰδομενῆος.

889 τοῖσι δὲ καὶ μετέειπε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
890 Ἀτρεΐδη· ἴδμεν γὰρ ὅσον προβέβηκας ἁπάντων
891 ἠδ’ ὅσσον δυνάμει τε καὶ ἥμασιν ἔπλευ ἄριστος·
892 ἀλλὰ σὺ μὲν τόδ’ ἄεθλον ἔχων κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας
893 ἔρχευ, ἀτὰρ δόρυ Μηριόνῃ ἥρωϊ πόρωμεν,
894 εἰ σύ γε σῷ θυμῷ ἐθέλοις· κέλομαι γὰρ ἔγωγε.
895 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησεν ἄναξ ἀνδρῶν Ἀγαμέμνων·
896 δῶκε δὲ Μηριόνῃ δόρυ χάλκεον· αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ ἥρως
897 Ταλθυβίῳ κήρυκι δίδου περικαλλὲς ἄεθλον.
Then the son of Peleus brought in to the contest [agôn] a spear and a cauldron that had never been on the fire; it was worth an ox, and was chased with a pattern of flowers; and those that throw the javelin stood up - to wit the son of Atreus, king of men Agamemnon, and Meriones, stalwart squire of Idomeneus. But Achilles spoke saying, "Son of Atreus, we know how far you excel all others both in power and in throwing the javelin; take the cauldron as prize [athlon] back with you to your ships, but if it so please you, let us give the spear to Meriones; this at least is what I should myself wish." King Agamemnon assented. So he gave the bronze spear to Meriones, and handed the goodly cauldron as prize [athlon] to Talthybios his esquire.

24.1

1 λῦτο δ’ ἀγών, λαοὶ δὲ θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας ἕκαστοι
2 ἐσκίδναντ’ ἰέναι. τοὶ μὲν δόρποιο μέδοντο
3 ὕπνου τε γλυκεροῦ ταρπήμεναι· αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
4 κλαῖε φίλου ἑτάρου μεμνημένος, οὐδέ μιν ὕπνος
5 ᾕρει πανδαμάτωρ, ἀλλ’ ἐστρέφετ’ ἔνθα καὶ ἔνθα
6 Πατρόκλου ποθέων ἀνδροτῆτά τε καὶ μένος ἠΰ,
7 ἠδ’ ὁπόσα τολύπευσε σὺν αὐτῷ καὶ πάθεν ἄλγεα
8 ἀνδρῶν τε πτολέμους ἀλεγεινά τε κύματα πείρων·
9 τῶν μιμνησκόμενος θαλερὸν κατὰ δάκρυον εἶβεν,
10 ἄλλοτ’ ἐπὶ πλευρὰς κατακείμενος, ἄλλοτε δ’ αὖτε
11 ὕπτιος, ἄλλοτε δὲ πρηνής· τοτὲ δ’ ὀρθὸς ἀναστὰς
12 δινεύεσκ’ ἀλύων παρὰ θῖν’ ἁλός· οὐδέ μιν ἠὼς
13 φαινομένη λήθεσκεν ὑπεὶρ ἅλα τ’ ἠϊόνας τε.
14 ἀλλ’ ὅ γ’ ἐπεὶ ζεύξειεν ὑφ’ ἅρμασιν ὠκέας ἵππους,
15 Ἕκτορα δ’ ἕλκεσθαι δησάσκετο δίφρου ὄπισθεν,
16 τρὶς δ’ ἐρύσας περὶ σῆμα Μενοιτιάδαο θανόντος
17 αὖτις ἐνὶ κλισίῃ παυέσκετο, τὸν δέ τ’ ἔασκεν
18 ἐν κόνι ἐκτανύσας προπρηνέα· τοῖο δ’ Ἀπόλλων
19 πᾶσαν ἀεικείην ἄπεχε χροῒ φῶτ’ ἐλεαίρων
20 καὶ τεθνηότα περ· περὶ δ’ αἰγίδι πάντα κάλυπτε
21 χρυσείῃ, ἵνα μή μιν ἀποδρύφοι ἑλκυστάζων.
22 ὣς ὃ μὲν Ἕκτορα δῖον ἀείκιζεν μενεαίνων·
23 τὸν δ’ ἐλεαίρεσκον μάκαρες θεοὶ εἰσορόωντες,
24 κλέψαι δ’ ὀτρύνεσκον ἐΰσκοπον ἀργεϊφόντην.
25 ἔνθ’ ἄλλοις μὲν πᾶσιν ἐήνδανεν, οὐδέ ποθ’ Ἥρῃ
26 οὐδὲ Ποσειδάων’ οὐδὲ γλαυκώπιδι κούρῃ,
27 ἀλλ’ ἔχον ὥς σφιν πρῶτον ἀπήχθετο Ἴλιος ἱρὴ
28 καὶ Πρίαμος καὶ λαὸς Ἀλεξάνδρου ἕνεκ’ ἄτης,
29 ὃς νείκεσσε θεὰς ὅτε οἱ μέσσαυλον ἵκοντο,
30 τὴν δ’ ἤνησ’ ἥ οἱ πόρε μαχλοσύνην ἀλεγεινήν.
The assembly [agôn] now broke up and the people went their ways each to his own ship.

There they made ready their supper, and then bethought them of the blessed boon of sleep; but Achilles still wept for thinking of his dear comrade, and sleep, before whom all things bow, could take no hold upon him. This way and that did he turn as he yearned after the might and manfulness of Patroklos; he thought of all they had done together, and all they had gone through both on the field of battle and on the waves of the weary sea. As he dwelt on these things he wept bitterly and lay now on his side, now on his back, and now face downwards, till at last he rose and went out as one distraught to wander upon the seashore. Then, when he saw dawn breaking over beach and sea, he yoked his horses to his chariot, and bound the body of Hektor behind it that he might drag it about. Thrice did he drag it round the tomb [sêma] of the son of Menoitios, and then went back into his tent, leaving the body on the ground full length and with its face downwards. But Apollo would not suffer it to be disfigured, for he pitied the man, dead though he now was; therefore he shielded him with his golden aegis continually, that he might take no hurt while Achilles was dragging him. Thus shamefully did Achilles in his fury dishonor Hektor; but the blessed gods looked down in pity from heaven, and urged Hermes, slayer of Argos, to steal the body. All were of this mind save only Hera, Poseidon, and Zeus' gray-eyed daughter, who persisted in the hate which they had ever borne towards Ilion with Priam and his people; for they forgave not the wrong [atê] done them by Alexander in disdaining the goddesses who came to him when he was in his sheepyards, and preferring her who had offered him a wanton to his ruin. When, therefore, the morning of the twelfth day had now come, Phoebus Apollo spoke among the immortals saying, "You gods ought to be ashamed of yourselves; you are cruel and hard-hearted. Did not Hektor burn you thigh-bones of heifers and of unblemished goats? And now dare you not rescue even his dead body, for his wife to look upon, with his mother and child, his father Priam, and his people, who would forthwith commit him to the flames, and give him his due funeral rites? So, then, you would all be on the side of mad Achilles, who knows neither right nor ruth? He is like some savage lion that in the pride of his great strength [biê] and spirit [thumos] springs upon men's flocks and gorges on them. Even so has Achilles flung aside all pity, and all that decency [aidôs] which at once so greatly banes yet greatly boons him that will heed it. man may lose one far dearer than Achilles has lost- a son, it may be, or a brother born from his own mother's womb; yet when he has mourned him and wept over him he will let him bide, for it takes much sorrow to kill a man; whereas Achilles, now that he has slain noble Hektor, drags him behind his chariot round the tomb [sêma] of his comrade. It were better of him, and for him, that he should not do so, for brave though he be we gods may take it ill that he should vent his fury upon dead clay." Hera spoke up in a rage. "This were well," she cried, "O lord of the silver bow, if you would give like honor [timê] to Hektor and to Achilles; but Hektor was mortal and suckled at a woman's breast, whereas Achilles is the offspring of a goddess whom I myself reared and brought up. I married her to Peleus, who is above measure dear to the immortals; you gods came all of you to her wedding; you feasted along with them yourself and brought your lyre - false, and fond of low company, that you have ever been." Then said Zeus, "Hera, be not so bitter. Their honor [timê] shall not be equal, but of all that dwell in Ilion, Hektor was dearest to the gods, as also to myself, for his offerings never failed me. Never was my altar stinted of its dues, nor of the drink-offerings and savor of sacrifice which we claim of right. I shall therefore permit the body of mighty Hektor to be stolen; and yet this may hardly be without Achilles coming to know it, for his mother keeps night and day beside him. Let some one of you, therefore, send Thetis to me, and I will impart my counsel to her, namely that Achilles is to accept a ransom from Priam, and give up the body." On this Iris fleet as the wind went forth to carry his message. Down she plunged into the dark sea [pontos] midway between Samos and rocky Imbros; the waters hissed as they closed over her, and she sank into the bottom as the lead at the end of an ox-horn, that is sped to carry death to fishes. She found Thetis sitting in a great cave with the other sea-

goddesses gathered round her; there she sat in the midst of them weeping for her noble son who was to fall far from his own land, on the fertile plains of Troy. Iris went up to her and said, "Rise Thetis; Zeus, whose counsels fail not, bids you come to him." And Thetis answered, "Why does the mighty god so bid me? I am in great grief [akhos], and shrink from going in and out among the immortals. Still, I will go, and the word that he may speak shall not be spoken in vain." The goddess took her dark veil, than which there can be no robe more somber, and went forth with fleet Iris leading the way before her. The waves of the sea opened them a path, and when they reached the shore they flew up into the heavens, where they found the all-seeing son of Kronos with the blessed gods that live for ever assembled near him. Athena gave up her seat to her, and she sat down by the side of father Zeus. Hera then placed a fair golden cup in her hand, and spoke to her in words of comfort, whereon Thetis drank and gave her back the cup; and the sire of gods and men was the first to speak.

24.31

ἀλλ᾽ ὅτε δή ῥ᾽ ἐκ τοῖο δυωδεκάτη γένετ᾽ ἠώς,
καὶ τότ᾽ ἄρ᾽ ἀθανάτοισι μετηύδα Φοῖβος Ἀπόλλων·
σχέτλιοί ἐστε θεοί, δηλήμονες· οὔ νύ ποθ᾽ ὑμῖν
Ἕκτωρ μηρί᾽ ἔκηε βοῶν αἰγῶν τε τελείων;
τὸν νῦν οὐκ ἔτλητε νέκυν περ ἐόντα σαῶσαι
ᾗ τ᾽ ἀλόχῳ ἰδέειν καὶ μητέρι καὶ τέκεϊ ᾧ
καὶ πατέρι Πριάμῳ λαοῖσί τε, τοί κέ μιν ὦκα
ἐν πυρὶ κήαιεν καὶ ἐπὶ κτέρεα κτερίσαιεν.
ἀλλ᾽ ὀλοῷ Ἀχιλῆϊ θεοὶ βούλεσθ᾽ ἐπαρήγειν,
ᾧ οὔτ᾽ ἂρ φρένες εἰσὶν ἐναίσιμοι οὔτε νόημα
γναμπτὸν ἐνὶ στήθεσσι, λέων δ᾽ ὣς ἄγρια οἶδεν,
ὅς τ᾽ ἐπεὶ ἂρ μεγάλῃ τε βίῃ καὶ ἀγήνορι θυμῷ
εἴξας εἶσ᾽ ἐπὶ μῆλα βροτῶν ἵνα δαῖτα λάβῃσιν·
ὣς Ἀχιλεὺς ἔλεον μὲν ἀπώλεσεν, οὐδέ οἱ αἰδὼς
γίγνεται, ἥ τ᾽ ἄνδρας μέγα σίνεται ἠδ᾽ ὀνίνησι.
μέλλει μέν πού τις καὶ φίλτερον ἄλλον ὀλέσσαι
ἠὲ κασίγνητον ὁμογάστριον ἠὲ καὶ υἱόν·
ἀλλ᾽ ἤτοι κλαύσας καὶ ὀδυράμενος μεθέηκε·
τλητὸν γὰρ Μοῖραι θυμὸν θέσαν ἀνθρώποισιν.
αὐτὰρ ὅ γ᾽ Ἕκτορα δῖον, ἐπεὶ φίλον ἦτορ ἀπηύρα,
ἵππων ἐξάπτων περὶ σῆμ᾽ ἑτάροιο φίλοιο
ἕλκει· οὐ μήν οἱ τό γε κάλλιον οὐδέ τ᾽ ἄμεινον.
μὴ ἀγαθῷ περ ἐόντι νεμεσσηθέωμέν οἱ ἡμεῖς·
κωφὴν γὰρ δὴ γαῖαν ἀεικίζει μενεαίνων.
τὸν δὲ χολωσαμένη προσέφη λευκώλενος Ἥρη·
εἴη κεν καὶ τοῦτο τεὸν ἔπος ἀργυρότοξε
εἰ δὴ ὁμὴν Ἀχιλῆϊ καὶ Ἕκτορι θήσετε τιμήν.
Ἕκτωρ μὲν θνητός τε γυναῖκά τε θήσατο μαζόν·
αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεύς ἐστι θεᾶς γόνος, ἣν ἐγὼ αὐτὴ
θρέψά τε καὶ ἀτίτηλα καὶ ἀνδρὶ πόρον παράκοιτιν

24.61

Πηλέϊ, ὃς περὶ κῆρι φίλος γένετ᾽ ἀθανάτοισι.
πάντες δ᾽ ἀντιάασθε θεοὶ γάμου· ἐν δὲ σὺ τοῖσι
δαίνυ᾽ ἔχων φόρμιγγα κακῶν ἔταρ᾽, αἰὲν ἄπιστε.

τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη νεφεληγερέτα Ζεύς·
Ἥρη μὴ δὴ πάμπαν ἀποσκύδμαινε θεοῖσιν·
οὐ μὲν γὰρ τιμή γε μί’ ἔσσεται· ἀλλὰ καὶ Ἕκτωρ
φίλτατος ἔσκε θεοῖσι βροτῶν οἳ ἐν Ἰλίῳ εἰσίν·
ὣς γὰρ ἔμοιγ’, ἐπεὶ οὔ τι φίλων ἡμάρτανε δώρων.
οὐ γάρ μοί ποτε βωμὸς ἐδεύετο δαιτὸς ἐΐσης
λοιβῆς τε κνίσης τε· τὸ γὰρ λάχομεν γέρας ἡμεῖς.
ἀλλ’ ἤτοι κλέψαι μὲν ἐάσομεν, οὐδέ πῃ ἔστι,
λάθρῃ Ἀχιλλῆος θρασὺν Ἕκτορα· ἦ γάρ οἱ αἰεὶ
μήτηρ παρμέμβλωκεν ὁμῶς νύκτάς τε καὶ ἦμαρ.
ἀλλ’ εἴ τις καλέσειε θεῶν Θέτιν ἆσσον ἐμεῖο,
ὄφρά τί οἱ εἴπω πυκινὸν ἔπος, ὥς κεν Ἀχιλλεὺς
δώρων ἐκ Πριάμοιο λάχῃ ἀπό θ’ Ἕκτορα λύσῃ.
ὣς ἔφατ’, ὦρτο δὲ Ἶρις ἀελλόπος ἀγγελέουσα,
μεσσηγὺς δὲ Σάμου τε καὶ Ἴμβρου παιπαλοέσσης
ἔνθορε μείλανι πόντῳ· ἐπεστονάχησε δὲ λίμνη.
ἣ δὲ μολυβδαίνῃ ἰκέλη ἐς βυσσὸν ὄρουσεν,
ἥ τε κατ’ ἀγραύλοιο βοὸς κέρας ἐμβεβαυῖα
ἔρχεται ὠμηστῇσιν ἐπ’ ἰχθύσι κῆρα φέρουσα.
εὗρε δ’ ἐνὶ σπῆϊ γλαφυρῷ Θέτιν, ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρ’ ἄλλαι
εἴαθ’ ὁμηγερέες ἅλιαι θεαί· ἣ δ’ ἐνὶ μέσσῃς
κλαῖε μόρον οὗ παιδὸς ἀμύμονος, ὅς οἱ ἔμελλε
φθίσεσθ’ ἐν Τροίῃ ἐριβώλακι τηλόθι πάτρης.
ἀγχοῦ δ’ ἱσταμένη προσέφη πόδας ὠκέα Ἶρις·
ὄρσο Θέτι· καλέει Ζεὺς ἄφθιτα μήδεα εἰδώς.
τὴν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα θεὰ Θέτις ἀργυρόπεζα·
τίπτέ με κεῖνος ἄνωγε μέγας θεός; αἰδέομαι δὲ

24.91

μίσγεσθ’ ἀθανάτοισιν, ἔχω δ’ ἄχε’ ἄκριτα θυμῷ.
εἶμι μέν, οὐδ’ ἅλιον ἔπος ἔσσεται ὅττί κεν εἴπῃ.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσασα κάλυμμ’ ἕλε δῖα θεάων
κυάνεον, τοῦ δ’ οὔ τι μελάντερον ἔπλετο ἔσθος.
βῆ δ’ ἰέναι, πρόσθεν δὲ ποδήνεμος ὠκέα Ἶρις
ἡγεῖτ’· ἀμφὶ δ’ ἄρα σφι λιάζετο κῦμα θαλάσσης.
ἀκτὴν δ’ ἐξαναβᾶσαι ἐς οὐρανὸν ἀϊχθήτην,
εὗρον δ’ εὐρύοπα Κρονίδην, περὶ δ’ ἄλλοι ἅπαντες
εἴαθ’ ὁμηγερέες μάκαρες θεοὶ αἰὲν ἐόντες.
ἣ δ’ ἄρα πὰρ Διὶ πατρὶ καθέζετο, εἶξε δ’ Ἀθήνη.
Ἥρη δὲ χρύσεον καλὸν δέπας ἐν χερὶ θῆκε
καί ῥ’ εὔφρην’ ἐπέεσσι· Θέτις δ’ ὥρεξε πιοῦσα.
τοῖσι δὲ μύθων ἦρχε πατὴρ ἀνδρῶν τε θεῶν τε·
ἤλυθες Οὔλυμπον δὲ θεὰ Θέτι κηδομένη περ,
πένθος ἄλαστον ἔχουσα μετὰ φρεσίν· οἶδα καὶ αὐτός·
ἀλλὰ καὶ ὣς ἐρέω τοῦ σ’ εἵνεκα δεῦρο κάλεσσα.
ἐννῆμαρ δὴ νεῖκος ἐν ἀθανάτοισιν ὄρωρεν
Ἕκτορος ἀμφὶ νέκυι καὶ Ἀχιλλῆϊ πτολιπόρθῳ·
κλέψαι δ’ ὀτρύνουσιν ἐΰσκοπον ἀργεϊφόντην·
αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ τόδε κῦδος Ἀχιλλῆϊ προτιάπτω
αἰδῶ καὶ φιλότητα τεὴν μετόπισθε φυλάσσων.
αἶψα μάλ’ ἐς στρατὸν ἐλθὲ καὶ υἱέϊ σῷ ἐπίτειλον·

113 σκύζεσθαί οἱ εἰπὲ θεούς, ἐμὲ δ’ ἔξοχα πάντων
114 ἀθανάτων κεχολῶσθαι, ὅτι φρεσὶ μαινομένῃσιν
115 Ἕκτορ’ ἔχει παρὰ νηυσὶ κορωνίσιν οὐδ’ ἀπέλυσεν,
116 αἴ κέν πως ἐμέ τε δείσῃ ἀπό θ’ Ἕκτορα λύσῃ.
117 αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ Πριάμῳ μεγαλήτορι Ἶριν ἐφήσω
118 λύσασθαι φίλον υἱὸν ἰόντ’ ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν,
119 δῶρα δ’ Ἀχιλλῆϊ φερέμεν, τά κε θυμὸν ἰήνῃ.
120 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε θεὰ Θέτις ἀργυρόπεζα,
"So, goddess Thetis," said he, "for all your sorrow, and the grief [penthos] that I well know reigns ever in your heart, you have come hither to Olympus, and I will tell you why I have sent for you. This nine days past the immortals have been quarreling about Achilles waster of cities and the body of Hektor. The gods would have Hermes slayer of Argos steal the body, but in furtherance of our decency [aidôs] and sense of being near-and-dear [philotês] henceforward, I will concede such honor to your son as I will now tell you. Go, then, to the host and lay these commands upon him; say that the gods are angry with him, and that I am myself more angry than them all, in that he keeps Hektor at the ships and will not give him up. He may thus fear me and let the body go. At the same time I will send Iris to great Priam to bid him go to the ships of the Achaeans, and ransom his son, taking with him such gifts for Achilles as may give him satisfaction. Silver-footed Thetis did as the god had told her, and forthwith down she darted from the topmost summits of Olympus. She went to her son's tents where she found him grieving bitterly, while his trusty comrades round him were busy preparing their morning meal, for which they had killed a great woolly sheep. His mother sat down beside him and caressed him with her hand saying, "My son, how long will you keep on thus grieving and making moan? You are gnawing at your own heart, and think neither of food nor of woman's embraces; and yet these too were well, for you have no long time to live, and death with the strong hand of fate are already close beside you. Now, therefore, heed what I say, for I come as a messenger from Zeus; he says that the gods are angry with you, and himself more angry than them all, in that you keep Hektor at the ships and will not give him up. Therefore let him go, and accept a ransom for his body." And Achilles answered, "So be it. If Olympian Zeus of his own motion thus commands me, let him that brings the ransom bear the body away." Thus did mother and son talk together at the ships in long discourse with one another. Meanwhile the son of Kronos sent Iris to the strong city of Ilion. "Go," said he, "fleet Iris, from the mansions of Olympus, and tell King Priam in Ilion, that he is to go to the ships of the Achaeans and free the body of his dear son. He is to take such gifts with him as shall give satisfaction to Achilles, and he is to go alone, with no other Trojan, save only some honored servant who may drive his mules and wagon, and bring back the body of him whom noble Achilles has slain. Let him have no thought nor fear of death in his heart, for we will send the slayer of Argos to escort him, and bring him within the tent of Achilles. Achilles will not kill him nor let another do so, for he will take heed to his ways and err not, and he will entreat a suppliant with all honorable courtesy." On this Iris, fleet as the wind, sped forth to deliver her message. She went to Priam's house, and found weeping and lamentation therein. His sons were seated round their father in the outer courtyard, and their raiment was wet with tears: the old man sat in the midst of them with his mantle wrapped close about his body, and his head and neck all covered with the filth which he had clutched as he lay groveling in the mire. His daughters and his sons' wives went wailing about the house, as they thought of the many and brave men who lost their life-breath [psukhê], slain by the Argives. The messenger of Zeus stood by Priam and spoke softly to him, but fear fell upon him as she did so. "Take heart," she said, "Priam offspring of Dardanos, take heart and fear not. I bring no evil tidings, but am minded well towards you. I come as a messenger from Zeus, who though he be not near, takes thought for you and pities you. The lord of Olympus bids you go and ransom noble

Hektor, and take with you such gifts as shall give satisfaction to Achilles. You are to go alone, with no Trojan, save only some honored servant who may drive your mules and wagon, and bring back to the city the body of him whom noble Achilles has slain. You are to have no thought, nor fear of death, for Zeus will send the slayer of Argos to escort you. When he has brought you within Achilles' tent, Achilles will not kill you nor let another do so, for he will take heed to his ways and err not, and he will entreat a suppliant with all honorable courtesy." Iris went her way when she had thus spoken, and Priam told his sons to get a mule-wagon ready, and to make the body of the wagon fast upon the top of its bed. Then he went down into his fragrant store-room, high-vaulted, and made of cedar-wood, where his many treasures were kept, and he called Hecuba his wife. "Wife," said he, "a messenger has come to me from Olympus, and has told me to go to the ships of the Achaeans to ransom my dear son, taking with me such gifts as shall give satisfaction to Achilles. What think you of this matter? for my own part I am greatly moved to pass through the of the Achaeans and go to their ships." His wife cried aloud as she heard him, and said, "Alas, what has become of that judgment for which you have been ever famous both among strangers and your own people? How can you venture alone to the ships of the Achaeans, and look into the face of him who has slain so many of your brave sons? You must have iron courage, for if the cruel savage sees you and lays hold on you, he will know neither respect nor pity. Let us then weep Hektor from afar here in our own house, for when I gave him birth the threads of overruling fate were spun for him that dogs should eat his flesh far from his parents, in the house of that terrible man on whose liver I would fain fasten and devour it. Thus would I avenge my son, who showed no cowardice when Achilles slew him, and thought neither of Right nor of avoiding battle as he stood in defense of Trojan men and Trojan women."

24.121

121 βῆ δὲ κατ’ Οὐλύμποιο καρήνων ἀΐξασα,
122 ἶξεν δ’ ἐς κλισίην οὗ υἱέος· ἔνθ’ ἄρα τόν γε
123 εὗρ’ ἀδινὰ στενάχοντα· φίλοι δ’ ἀμφ’ αὐτὸν ἑταῖροι
124 ἐσσυμένως ἐπένοντο καὶ ἐντύνοντο ἄριστον·
125 τοῖσι δ’ ὄϊς λάσιος μέγας ἐν κλισίῃ ἱέρευτο.
126 ἡ δὲ μάλ’ ἄγχ’ αὐτοῖο καθέζετο πότνια μήτηρ,
127 χειρί τέ μιν κατέρεξεν ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζε·
128 τέκνον ἐμὸν τέο μέχρις ὀδυρόμενος καὶ ἀχεύων
129 σὴν ἔδεαι κραδίην μεμνημένος οὔτέ τι σίτου
130 οὔτ’ εὐνῆς; ἀγαθὸν δὲ γυναικί περ ἐν φιλότητι
131 μίσγεσθ’· οὐ γάρ μοι δηρὸν βέῃ, ἀλλά τοι ἤδη
132 ἄγχι παρέστηκεν θάνατος καὶ μοῖρα κραταιή.
133 ἀλλ’ ἐμέθεν ξύνες ὦκα, Διὸς δέ τοι ἄγγελός εἰμι·
134 σκύζεσθαι σοί φησι θεούς, ἐὲ δ’ ἔξοχα πάντων
135 ἀθανάτων κεχολῶσθαι, ὅτι φρεσὶ μαινομένῃσιν
136 Ἕκτορ’ ἔχεις παρὰ νηυσὶ κορωνίσιν οὐδ’ ἀπέλυσας.
137 ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ λῦσον, νεκροῖο δὲ δέξαι ἄποινα.
138 τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
139 τῇδ’ εἴη· ὃς ἄποινα φέροι καὶ νεκρὸν ἄγοιτο,
140 εἰ δὴ πρόφρονι θυμῷ Ὀλύμπιος αὐτὸς ἀνώγει.
141 ὣς οἵ γ’ ἐν νηῶν ἀγύρει μήτηρ τε καὶ υἱὸς
142 πολλὰ πρὸς ἀλλήλους ἔπεα πτερόεντ’ ἀγόρευον.
143 Ἶριν δ’ ὄτρυνε Κρονίδης εἰς Ἴλιον ἱρήν·
144 βάσκ’ ἴθι Ἶρι ταχεῖα λιποῦσ’ ἕδος Οὐλύμποιο
145 ἄγγειλον Πριάμῳ μεγαλήτορι Ἴλιον εἴσω

λύσασθαι φίλον υἱὸν ἰόντ’ ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν,
δῶρα δ’ Ἀχιλλῆϊ φερέμεν τά κε θυμὸν ἰήνῃ
οἷον, μὴ δέ τις ἄλλος ἅμα Τρώων ἴτω ἀνήρ.
κῆρύξ τίς οἱ ἕποιτο γεραίτερος, ὅς κ’ ἰθύνοι
ἡμιόνους καὶ ἄμαξαν ἐΰτροχον, ἠδὲ καὶ αὖτις

24.151

νεκρὸν ἄγοι προτὶ ἄστυ, τὸν ἔκτανε δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς.
μὴ δέ τί οἱ θάνατος μελέτω φρεσὶ μὴ δέ τι τάρβος·
τοῖον γάρ οἱ πομπὸν ὀπάσσομεν ἀργεϊφόντην,
ὃς ἄξει εἶός κεν ἄγων Ἀχιλῆϊ πελάσσῃ.
αὐτὰρ ἐπὴν ἀγάγῃσιν ἔσω κλισίην Ἀχιλῆος,
οὔτ’ αὐτὸς κτενέει ἀπό τ’ ἄλλους πάντας ἐρύξει·
οὔτε γάρ ἐστ’ ἄφρων οὔτ’ ἄσκοπος οὔτ’ ἀλιτήμων,
ἀλλὰ μάλ’ ἐνδυκέως ἱκέτεω πεφιδήσεται ἀνδρός.
ὣς ἔφατ’, ὦρτο δὲ Ἶρις ἀελλόπος ἀγγελέουσα.
ἶξεν δ’ ἐς Πριάμοιο, κίχεν δ’ ἐνοπήν τε γόον τε.
παῖδες μὲν πατέρ’ ἀμφὶ καθήμενοι ἔνδοθεν αὐλῆς
δάκρυσιν εἵματ’ ἔφυρον, ὃ δ’ ἐν μέσσοισι γεραιὸς
ἐντυπὰς ἐν χλαίνῃ κεκαλυμμένος· ἀμφὶ δὲ πολλὴ
κόπρος ἔην κεφαλῇ τε καὶ αὐχένι τοῖο γέροντος
τήν ῥα κυλινδόμενος καταμήσατο χερσὶν ἑῇσι.
θυγατέρες δ’ ἀνὰ δώματ’ ἰδὲ νυοὶ ὠδύροντο
τῶν μιμνησκόμεναι οἳ δὴ πολέες τε καὶ ἐσθλοὶ
χερσὶν ὑπ’ Ἀργείων κέατο ψυχὰς ὀλέσαντες.
στῆ δὲ παρὰ Πρίαμον Διὸς ἄγγελος, ἠδὲ προσηύδα
τυτθὸν φθεγξαμένη· τὸν δὲ τρόμος ἔλλαβε γυῖα·
θάρσει Δαρδανίδη Πρίαμε φρεσί, μὴ δέ τι τάρβει·
οὐ μὲν γάρ τοι ἐγὼ κακὸν ὀσσομένη τόδ’ ἱκάνω
ἀλλ’ ἀγαθὰ φρονέουσα· Διὸς δέ τοι ἄγγελός εἰμι,
ὅς σευ ἄνευθεν ἐὼν μέγα κήδεται ἠδ’ ἐλεαίρει.
λύσασθαί σ’ ἐκέλευσεν Ὀλύμπιος Ἕκτορα δῖον,
δῶρα δ’ Ἀχιλλῆϊ φερέμεν τά κε θυμὸν ἰήνῃ
οἷον, μὴ δέ τις ἄλλος ἅμα Τρώων ἴτω ἀνήρ.
κῆρύξ τίς τοι ἕποιτο γεραίτερος, ὅς κ’ ἰθύνοι
ἡμιόνους καὶ ἄμαξαν ἐΰτροχον, ἠδὲ καὶ αὖτις
νεκρὸν ἄγοι προτὶ ἄστυ, τὸν ἔκτανε δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς.

24.181

μὴ δέ τί τοι θάνατος μελέτω φρεσὶ μηδέ τι τάρβος·
τοῖος γάρ τοι πομπὸς ἅμ’ ἕψεται ἀργεϊφόντης,
ὅς σ’ ἄξει εἶός κεν ἄγων Ἀχιλῆϊ πελάσσῃ.
αὐτὰρ ἐπὴν ἀγάγῃσιν ἔσω κλισίην Ἀχιλῆος,
οὔτ’ αὐτὸς κτενέει ἀπό τ’ ἄλλους πάντας ἐρύξει·
οὔτε γάρ ἔστ’ ἄφρων οὔτ’ ἄσκοπος οὔτ’ ἀλιτήμων,
ἀλλὰ μάλ’ ἐνδυκέως ἱκέτεω πεφιδήσεται ἀνδρός.
ἦ μὲν ἄρ’ ὣς εἰποῦσ’ ἀπέβη πόδας ὠκέα Ἶρις,
αὐτὰρ ὅ γ’ υἷας ἄμαξαν ἐΰτροχον ἡμιονείην
ὁπλίσαι ἠνώγει, πείρινθα δὲ δῆσαι ἐπ’ αὐτῆς.
αὐτὸς δ’ ἐς θάλαμον κατεβήσετο κηώεντα

κέδρινον ὑψόροφον, ὃς γλήνεα πολλὰ κεχάνδει·
ἐς δ’ ἄλοχον Ἑκάβην ἐκαλέσσατο φώνησέν τε·
δαιμονίη Διόθεν μοι Ὀλύμπιος ἄγγελος ἦλθε
λύσασθαι φίλον υἱὸν ἰόντ’ ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν,
δῶρα δ’ Ἀχιλλῆϊ φερέμεν τά κε θυμὸν ἰήνῃ.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε μοι τόδε εἰπὲ τί τοι φρεσὶν εἴδεται εἶναι;
αἰνῶς γάρ μ’ αὐτόν γε μένος καὶ θυμὸς ἄνωγε
κεῖσ’ ἰέναι ἐπὶ νῆας ἔσω στρατὸν εὐρὺν Ἀχαιῶν.
ὣς φάτο, κώκυσεν δὲ γυνὴ καὶ ἀμείβετο μύθῳ·
ὤ μοι πῇ δή τοι φρένες οἴχονθ’, ᾗς τὸ πάρος περ
ἔκλε’ ἐπ’ ἀνθρώπους ξείνους ἠδ’ οἷσιν ἀνάσσεις;
πῶς ἐθέλεις ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν ἐλθέμεν οἷος
ἀνδρὸς ἐς ὀφθαλμοὺς ὅς τοι πολέας τε καὶ ἐσθλοὺς
υἱέας ἐξενάριξε· σιδήρειόν νύ τοι ἦτορ.
εἰ γάρ σ’ αἱρήσει καὶ ἐσόψεται ὀφθαλμοῖσιν
ὠμηστὴς καὶ ἄπιστος ἀνὴρ ὅ γε οὔ σ’ ἐλεήσει,
οὐδέ τί σ’ αἰδέσεται. νῦν δὲ κλαίωμεν ἄνευθεν
ἥμενοι ἐν μεγάρῳ· τῷ δ’ ὥς ποθι Μοῖρα κραταιὴ
γιγνομένῳ ἐπένησε λίνῳ, ὅτε μιν τέκον αὐτή,

24.211

ἀργίποδας κύνας ἦσαι ἐῶν ἀπάνευθε τοκήων
ἀνδρὶ πάρα κρατερῷ, τοῦ ἐγὼ μέσον ἦπαρ ἔχοιμι
ἐσθέμεναι προσφῦσα· τότ’ ἄντιτα ἔργα γένοιτο
παιδὸς ἐμοῦ, ἐπεὶ οὔ ἑ κακιζόμενόν γε κατέκτα,
ἀλλὰ πρὸ Τρώων καὶ Τρωϊάδων βαθυκόλπων
ἐσταότ’ οὔτε φόβου μεμνημένον οὔτ’ ἀλεωρῆς.
τὴν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε γέρων Πρίαμος θεοειδής·
μή μ’ ἐθέλοντ’ ἰέναι κατερύκανε, μὴ δέ μοι αὐτὴ
ὄρνις ἐνὶ μεγάροισι κακὸς πέλευ· οὐδέ με πείσεις.
εἰ μὲν γάρ τίς μ’ ἄλλος ἐπιχθονίων ἐκέλευεν,
ἢ οἳ μάντιές εἰσι θυοσκόοι ἢ ἱερῆες,
ψεῦδός κεν φαῖμεν καὶ νοσφιζοίμεθα μᾶλλον·
νῦν δ’, αὐτὸς γὰρ ἄκουσα θεοῦ καὶ ἐσέδρακον ἄντην,
εἶμι καὶ οὐχ ἅλιον ἔπος ἔσσεται. εἰ δέ μοι αἶσα
τεθνάμεναι παρὰ νηυσὶν Ἀχαιῶν χαλκοχιτώνων
βούλομαι· αὐτίκα γάρ με κατακτείνειεν Ἀχιλλεὺς
ἀγκὰς ἑλόντ’ ἐμὸν υἱόν, ἐπὴν γόου ἐξ ἔρον εἴην.
ἦ καὶ φωριαμῶν ἐπιθήματα κάλ’ ἀνέῳγεν·
ἔνθεν δώδεκα μὲν περικαλλέας ἔξελε πέπλους,
δώδεκα δ’ ἁπλοΐδας χλαίνας, τόσσους δὲ τάπητας,
τόσσα δὲ φάρεα λευκά, τόσους δ’ ἐπὶ τοῖσι χιτῶνας.
χρυσοῦ δὲ στήσας ἔφερεν δέκα πάντα τάλαντα,
ἐκ δὲ δύ’ αἴθωνας τρίποδας, πίσυρας δὲ λέβητας,
ἐκ δὲ δέπας περικαλλές, ὅ οἱ Θρῆκες πόρον ἄνδρες
ἐξεσίην ἐλθόντι μέγα κτέρας· οὐδέ νυ τοῦ περ
φείσατ’ ἐνὶ μεγάροις ὃ γέρων, περὶ δ’ ἤθελε θυμῷ
λύσασθαι φίλον υἱόν. ὃ δὲ Τρῶας μὲν ἅπαντας
αἰθούσης ἀπέεργεν ἔπεσσ’ αἰσχροῖσιν ἐνίσσων·
ἔρρετε λωβητῆρες ἐλεγχέες· οὔ νυ καὶ ὑμῖν
οἴκοι ἔνεστι γόος, ὅτι μ’ ἦλθετε κηδήσοντες;

Then Priam said, "I would go, do not therefore stay me nor be as a bird of ill omen in my house, for you will not move me. Had it been some mortal man who had sent me some seer [mantis] or priest who divines from sacrifice - I should have deemed him false and have given him no heed; but now I have heard the goddess and seen her face to face, therefore I will go and her saying shall not be in vain. If it be my fate to die at the ships of the Achaeans even so would I have it; let Achilles slay me, if I may but first have taken my son in my arms and mourned him to my heart's comforting." So saying he lifted the lids of his chests, and took out twelve goodly vestments. He took also twelve cloaks of single fold, twelve rugs, twelve fair mantles, and an equal number of shirts. He weighed out ten talents of gold, and brought moreover two burnished tripods, four cauldrons, and a very beautiful cup which the Thracians had given him when he had gone to them on an embassy; it was very precious, but he grudged not even this, so eager was he to ransom the body of his son. Then he chased all the Trojans from the court and rebuked them with words of anger. "Out," he cried, "shame and disgrace to me that you are. Have you no grief in your own homes that you are come to plague me here? Is it a small thing, think you, that the son of Kronos has sent this sorrow upon me, to lose the bravest of my sons? Nay, you shall prove it in person, for now he is gone the Achaeans will have easier work in killing you. As for me, let me go down within the house of Hades, ere mine eyes behold the sacking and wasting of the city." He drove the men away with his staff, and they went forth as the old man sped them. Then he called to his sons, upbraiding Helenos, Paris, noble Agathon, Pammon, Antiphonos, Polites of the loud battle-cry, Deiphobos, Hippothoos, and Dios. These nine did the old man call near him. "Come to me at once," he cried, "worthless sons who do me shame; would that you had all been killed at the ships rather than Hektor. Miserable man that I am, I have had the bravest sons in all Troy - noble Nestor, Troilus the dauntless charioteer, and Hektor who was a god among men, so that one would have thought he was son to an immortal - yet there is not one of them left. Ares has slain them and those of whom I am ashamed are alone left me. Liars, and light of foot, heroes of the dance, robbers of lambs and kids from your own people, why do you not get a wagon ready for me at once, and put all these things upon it that I may set out on my way?" Thus did he speak, and they feared the rebuke of their father. They brought out a strong mule-wagon, newly made, and set the body of the wagon fast on its bed. They took the mule-yoke from the peg on which it hung, a yoke of boxwood with a knob on the top of it and rings for the reins to go through. Then they brought a yoke-band eleven cubits long, to bind the yoke to the pole; they bound it on at the far end of the pole, and put the ring over the upright pin making it fast with three turns of the band on either side the knob, and bending the thong of the yoke beneath it. This done, they brought from the store-chamber the rich ransom that was to purchase the body of Hektor, and they set it all orderly on the wagon; then they yoked the strong harness-mules which the Mysians had on a time given as a goodly present to Priam; but for Priam himself they yoked horses which the old king had bred, and kept for own use. Thus heedfully did Priam and his servant see to the yoking of their cars at the palace. Then Hecuba came to them all sorrowful, with a golden goblet of wine in her right hand, that they might make a drink-offering before they set out. She stood in front of the horses and said, "Take this, make a drink-offering to father Zeus, and since you are minded to go to the ships in spite of me, pray that you may come safely back from the hands of your enemies. Pray to the son of Kronos lord of the whirlwind, who sits on Ida and looks down over all Troy, pray him to send his swift messenger on your right hand, the bird of omen which is strongest and most dear to him of all birds, that you may see it with your own eyes and trust it as you go forth to the ships of the Danaans. If all-seeing Zeus will not send you this messenger, however set upon it you may be, I would not have you go to the ships of the Argives." And Priam answered, "Wife, I will do as you desire me; it is well to lift hands in prayer to Zeus, if so be he may have mercy upon me." With this the old man bade the

serving-woman pour pure water over his hands, and the woman came, bearing the water in a bowl. He washed his hands and took the cup from his wife; then he made the drink-offering and prayed, standing in the middle of the courtyard and turning his eyes to heaven. "Father Zeus," he said, "you who rule from Ida, most glorious and most great, grant that I may be received kindly and compassionately in the tents of Achilles; and send your swift messenger upon my right hand, the bird of omen which is strongest and most dear to you of all birds, that I may see it with my own eyes and trust it as I go forth to the ships of the Danaans."

24.241

241 ἦ ὀνόσασθ’ ὅτι μοι Κρονίδης Ζεὺς ἄλγε’ ἔδωκε
242 παῖδ’ ὀλέσαι τὸν ἄριστον; ἀτὰρ γνώσεσθε καὶ ὔμμες·
243 ῥηΐτεροι γὰρ μᾶλλον Ἀχαιοῖσιν δὴ ἔσεσθε
244 κείνου τεθνηῶτος ἐναιρέμεν. αὐτὰρ ἔγωγε
245 πρὶν ἀλαπαζομένην τε πόλιν κεραϊζομένην τε
246 ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ἰδεῖν βαίην δόμον Ἄϊδος εἴσω.
247 ἦ καὶ σκηπανίῳ δίεπ’ ἀνέρας· οἳ δ’ ἴσαν ἔξω
248 σπερχομένοιο γέροντος· ὃ δ’ υἱάσιν οἷσιν ὀμόκλα
249 νεικείων Ἕλενόν τε Πάριν τ’ Ἀγάθωνά τε δῖον
250 Πάμμονά τ’ Ἀντίφονόν τε βοὴν ἀγαθόν τε Πολίτην
251 Δηΐφοβόν τε καὶ Ἱππόθοον καὶ δῖον Ἀγαυόν·
252 ἐννέα τοῖς ὃ γεραιὸς ὁμοκλήσας ἐκέλευε·
253 σπεύσατέ μοι κακὰ τέκνα κατηφόνες· αἴθ’ ἅμα πάντες
254 Ἕκτορος ὠφέλετ’ ἀντὶ θοῇς ἐπὶ νηυσὶ πεφάσθαι.
255 ὤ μοι ἐγὼ πανάποτμος, ἐπεὶ τέκον υἷας ἀρίστους
256 Τροίῃ ἐν εὐρείῃ, τῶν δ’ οὔ τινά φημι λελεῖφθαι,
257 Μήστορά τ’ ἀντίθεον καὶ Τρωΐλον ἱππιοχάρμην
258 Ἕκτορά θ’, ὃς θεὸς ἔσκε μετ’ ἀνδράσιν, οὐδὲ ἐῴκει
259 ἀνδρός γε θνητοῦ πάϊς ἔμμεναι ἀλλὰ θεοῖο.
260 τοὺς μὲν ἀπώλεσ’ Ἄρης, τὰ δ’ ἐλέγχεα πάντα λέλειπται
261 ψεῦσταί τ’ ὀρχησταί τε χοροιτυπίῃσιν ἄριστοι
262 ἀρνῶν ἠδ’ ἐρίφων ἐπιδήμιοι ἁρπακτῆρες.
263 οὐκ ἂν δή μοι ἅμαξαν ἐφοπλίσσαιτε τάχιστα,
264 ταῦτά τε πάντ’ ἐπιθεῖτε, ἵνα πρήσσωμεν ὁδοῖο;
265 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ἄρα πατρὸς ὑποδείσαντες ὁμοκλὴν
266 ἐκ μὲν ἅμαξαν ἄειραν ἐΰτροχον ἡμιονείην
267 καλὴν πρωτοπαγέα, πείρινθα δὲ δῆσαν ἐπ’ αὐτῆς,
268 κὰδ δ’ ἀπὸ πασσαλόφι ζυγὸν ᾖρεον ἡμιόνειον
269 πύξινον ὀμφαλόεν εὖ οἰήκεσσιν ἀρηρός·
270 ἐκ δ’ ἔφερον ζυγόδεσμον ἅμα ζυγῷ ἐννεάπηχυ.

24.271

271 καὶ τὸ μὲν εὖ κατέθηκαν ἐϋξέστῳ ἐπὶ ῥυμῷ
272 πέζῃ ἔπι πρώτῃ, ἐπὶ δὲ κρίκον ἔστορι βάλλον,
273 τρὶς δ’ ἑκάτερθεν ἔδησαν ἐπ’ ὀμφαλόν, αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
274 ἐξείης κατέδησαν, ὑπὸ γλωχῖνα δ’ ἔκαμψαν.
275 ἐκ θαλάμου δὲ φέροντες ἐϋξέστης ἐπ’ ἀπήνης
276 νήεον Ἕκτορέης κεφαλῆς ἀπερείσι’ ἄποινα,
277 ζεῦξαν δ’ ἡμιόνους κρατερώνυχας ἐντεσιεργούς,
278 τούς ῥά ποτε Πριάμῳ Μυσοὶ δόσαν ἀγλαὰ δῶρα.

279 ἵππους δὲ Πριάμῳ ὕπαγον ζυγόν, οὓς ὃ γεραιὸς
280 αὐτὸς ἔχων ἀτίταλλεν ἐϋξέστῃ ἐπὶ φάτνῃ.
281 τὼ μὲν ζευγνύσθην ἐν δώμασιν ὑψηλοῖσι
282 κῆρυξ καὶ Πρίαμος πυκινὰ φρεσὶ μήδε’ ἔχοντες·
283 ἀγχίμολον δέ σφ’ ἦλθ’ Ἑκάβη τετιηότι θυμῷ
284 οἶνον ἔχουσ’ ἐν χειρὶ μελίφρονα δεξιτερῇφι
285 χρυσέῳ ἐν δέπαϊ, ὄφρα λείψαντε κιοίτην·
286 στῆ δ’ ἵππων προπάροιθεν ἔπος τ’ ἔφατ’ ἔκ τ’ ὀνόμαζε·
287 τῇ σπεῖσον Διὶ πατρί, καὶ εὔχεο οἴκαδ’ ἱκέσθαι
288 ἂψ ἐκ δυσμενέων ἀνδρῶν, ἐπεὶ ἂρ σέ γε θυμὸς
289 ὀτρύνει ἐπὶ νῆας ἐμεῖο μὲν οὐκ ἐθελούσης.
290 ἀλλ’ εὔχεο σύ γ’ ἔπειτα κελαινεφέϊ Κρονίωνι
291 Ἰδαίῳ, ὅς τε Τροίην κατὰ πᾶσαν ὁρᾶται,
292 αἴτει δ’ οἰωνὸν ταχὺν ἄγγελον, ὅς τέ οἱ αὐτῷ
293 φίλτατος οἰωνῶν, καί εὐ κράτος ἐστὶ μέγιστον,
294 δεξιόν, ὄφρά μιν αὐτὸς ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖσι νοήσας
295 τῷ πίσυνος ἐπὶ νῆας ἴῃς Δαναῶν ταχυπώλων.
296 εἰ δέ τοι οὐ δώσει ἐὸν ἄγγελον εὐρύοπα Ζεύς,
297 οὐκ ἂν ἔγωγέ σ’ ἔπειτα ἐποτρύνουσα κελοίμην
298 νῆας ἐπ’ Ἀργείων ἰέναι μάλα περ μεμαῶτα.
299 τὴν δ’ ἀπαμειβόμενος προσέφη Πρίαμος θεοειδής·
300 ὦ γύναι οὐ μέν τοι τόδ’ ἐφιεμένῃ ἀπιθήσω.

24.301

301 ἐσθλὸν γὰρ Διὶ χεῖρας ἀνασχέμεν αἴ κ’ ἐλεήσῃ.
302 ἦ ῥα καὶ ἀμφίπολον ταμίην ὄτρυν’ ὃ γεραιὸς
303 χερσὶν ὕδωρ ἐπιχεῦαι ἀκήρατον· ἣ δὲ παρέστη
304 χέρνιβον ἀμφίπολος πρόχοόν θ’ ἅμα χερσὶν ἔχουσα.
305 νιψάμενος δὲ κύπελλον ἐδέξατο ἧς ἀλόχοιο·
306 εὔχετ’ ἔπειτα στὰς μέσῳ ἕρκεϊ, λεῖβε δὲ οἶνον
307 οὐρανὸν εἰσανιδών, καὶ φωνήσας ἔπος ηὔδα·
308 Ζεῦ πάτερ Ἴδηθεν μεδέων κύδιστε μέγιστε
309 δός μ’ ἐς Ἀχιλλῆος φίλον ἐλθεῖν ἠδ’ ἐλεεινόν,
310 πέμψον δ’ οἰωνὸν ταχὺν ἄγγελον, ὅς τε σοὶ αὐτῷ
311 φίλτατος οἰωνῶν, καί εὐ κράτος ἐστὶ μέγιστον,
312 δεξιόν, ὄφρά μιν αὐτὸς ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖσι νοήσας
313 τῷ πίσυνος ἐπὶ νῆας ἴω Δαναῶν ταχυπώλων.
314 ὣς ἔφατ’ εὐχόμενος, τοῦ δ’ ἔκλυε μητίετα Ζεὺς
315 αὐτίκα δ’ αἰετὸν ἧκε τελειότατον πετεηνῶν
316 μόρφνον θηρητῆρ’ ὃν καὶ περκνὸν καλέουσιν.
317 ὅσση δ’ ὑψορόφοιο θύρη θαλάμοιο τέτυκται
318 ἀνέρος ἀφνειοῖο ἐὺ κληῗσ’ ἀραρυῖα,
319 τόσσ’ ἄρα τοῦ ἑκάτερθεν ἔσαν πτερά· εἵσατο δέ σφι
320 δεξιὸς ἀΐξας διὰ ἄστεος· οἳ δὲ ἰδόντες
321 γήθησαν, καὶ πᾶσιν ἐνὶ φρεσὶ θυμὸς ἰάνθη.
322 σπερχόμενος δ’ ὃ γεραιὸς ἑοῦ ἐπεβήσετο δίφρου,
323 ἐκ δ’ ἔλασε προθύροιο καὶ αἰθούσης ἐριδούπου.
324 πρόσθε μὲν ἡμίονοι ἕλκον τετράκυκλον ἀπήνην,
325 τὰς Ἰδαῖος ἔλαυνε δαΐφρων· αὐτὰρ ὄπισθεν
326 ἵπποι, τοὺς ὃ γέρων ἐφέπων μάστιγι κέλευε
327 καρπαλίμως κατὰ ἄστυ· φίλοι δ’ ἅμα πάντες ἕποντο

πόλλ’ ὀλοφυρόμενοι ὡς εἰ θάνατον δὲ κιόντα.
οἳ δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν πόλιος κατέβαν, πεδίον δ’ ἀφίκοντο,
οἳ μὲν ἄρ’ ἄψορροι προτὶ Ἴλιον ἀπονέοντο
So did he pray, and Zeus the lord of counsel heard his prayer. Forthwith he sent an eagle, the most unerring portent of all birds that fly, the dusky hunter that men also call the Black Eagle. His wings were spread abroad on either side as wide as the well-made and well-bolted door of a rich man's chamber. He came to them flying over the city upon their right hands, and when they saw him they were glad and their hearts took comfort within them. The old man made haste to mount his chariot, and drove out through the inner gateway and under the echoing gatehouse of the outer court. Before him went the mules drawing the four-wheeled wagon, and driven by wise Idaios; behind these were the horses, which the old man lashed with his whip and drove swiftly through the city, while his friends followed after, wailing and lamenting for him as though he were on his road to death. As soon as they had come down from the city and had reached the plain, his sons and sons-in-law who had followed him went back to Ilion. But Priam and Idaios as they showed out upon the plain did not escape the ken of all-seeing Zeus, who looked down upon the old man and pitied him; then he spoke to his son Hermes and said, "Hermes, for it is you who are the most disposed to escort men on their way, and to hear those whom you will hear, go, and so conduct Priam to the ships of the Achaeans that no other of the Danaans shall see him nor take note of him until he reach the son of Peleus." Thus he spoke and Hermes, guide and guardian, slayer of Argos, did as he was told. Forthwith he bound on his glittering golden sandals with which he could fly like the wind over land and sea; he took the wand with which he seals men's eyes in sleep, or wakes them just as he pleases, and flew holding it in his hand till he came to Troy and to the Hellespont. To look at, he was like a young man of noble birth in the hey-day of his youth and beauty with the down just coming upon his face. Now when Priam and Idaios had driven past the great tomb [sêma] of Ilion, they stayed their mules and horses that they might drink in the river, for the shades of night were falling, when, therefore, Idaios saw Hermes standing near them he said to Priam, "Take heed, descendant of Dardanos; here is matter which demands consideration [noos]. I see a man who I think will presently fall upon us; let us flee with our horses, or at least embrace his knees and implore him to take compassion upon us? When he heard this the old man's heart [noos] failed him, and he was in great fear; he stayed where he was as one dazed, and the hair stood on end over his whole body; but the bringer of good luck came up to him and took him by the hand, saying, "Whither, father, are you thus driving your mules and horses in the dead of night when other men are asleep? Are you not afraid of the fierce Achaeans who are hard by you, so cruel and relentless? Should some one of them see you bearing so much treasure through the darkness of the fleeing night, what would not your state of mind [noos] then be? You are no longer young, and he who is with you is too old to protect you from those who would attack you. For myself, I will do you no harm, and I will defend you from any one else, for you remind me of my own father." And Priam answered, "It is indeed as you say, my dear son; nevertheless some god has held his hand over me, in that he has sent such a wayfarer as yourself to meet me so Opportunely; you are so comely in mien and figure, and your judgment [noos] is so excellent that you must come of blessed parents."

24.331

παῖδες καὶ γαμβροί, τὼ δ’ οὐ λάθον εὐρύοπα Ζῆν
ἐς πεδίον προφανέντε· ἰδὼν δ’ ἐλέησε γέροντα,
αἶψα δ’ ἄρ’ Ἑρμείαν υἱὸν φίλον ἀντίον ηὔδα·
Ἑρμεία, σοὶ γάρ τε μάλιστά γε φίλτατόν ἐστιν
ἀνδρὶ ἑταιρίσσαι, καί τ’ ἔκλυες ᾧ κ’ ἐθέλῃσθα,
βάσκ’ ἴθι καὶ Πρίαμον κοίλας ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν

ὣς ἄγαγ’, ὡς μήτ’ ἄρ τις ἴδῃ μήτ’ ἄρ τε νοήσῃ
τῶν ἄλλων Δαναῶν, πρὶν Πηλεΐωνα δ’ ἱκέσθαι.
ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδ’ ἀπίθησε διάκτορος ἀργεϊφόντης.
αὐτίκ’ ἔπειθ’ ὑπὸ ποσσὶν ἐδήσατο καλὰ πέδιλα
ἀμβρόσια χρύσεια, τά μιν φέρον ἠμὲν ἐφ’ ὑγρὴν
ἠδ’ ἐπ’ ἀπείρονα γαῖαν ἅμα πνοιῇς ἀνέμοιο·
εἵλετο δὲ ῥάβδον, τῇ τ’ ἀνδρῶν ὄμματα θέλγει
ὧν ἐθέλει, τοὺς δ’ αὖτε καὶ ὑπνώοντας ἐγείρει·
τὴν μετὰ χερσὶν ἔχων πέτετο κρατὺς ἀργεϊφόντης.
αἶψα δ’ ἄρα Τροίην τε καὶ Ἑλλήσποντον ἵκανε,
βῆ δ’ ἰέναι κούρῳ αἰσυμνητῆρι ἐοικὼς
πρῶτον ὑπηνήτῃ, τοῦ περ χαριεστάτη ἥβη.
οἳ δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν μέγα σῆμα παρὲξ Ἴλοιο ἔλασσαν,
στῆσαν ἄρ’ ἡμιόνους τε καὶ ἵππους ὄφρα πίοιεν
ἐν ποταμῷ· δὴ γὰρ καὶ ἐπὶ κνέφας ἦλυθε γαῖαν.
τὸν δ’ ἐξ ἀγχιμόλοιο ἰδὼν ἐφράσσατο κῆρυξ
Ἑρμείαν, ποτὶ δὲ Πρίαμον φάτο φώνησέν τε·
φράζεο Δαρδανίδη· φραδέος νόου ἔργα τέτυκται.
ἄνδρ’ ὁρόω, τάχα δ’ ἄμμε διαρραίσεσθαι ὀΐω.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ φεύγωμεν ἐφ’ ἵππων, ἤ μιν ἔπειτα
γούνων ἀψάμενοι λιτανεύσομεν αἴ κ’ ἐλεήσῃ.
ὣς φάτο, σὺν δὲ γέροντι νόος χύτο, δείδιε δ’ αἰνῶς,
ὀρθαὶ δὲ τρίχες ἔσταν ἐνὶ γναμπτοῖσι μέλεσσι,
στῆ δὲ ταφών· αὐτὸς δ’ ἐριούνιος ἐγγύθεν ἐλθὼν

24.361

χεῖρα γέροντος ἑλὼν ἐξείρετο καὶ προσέειπε·
πῇ πάτερ ὦδ’ ἵππους τε καὶ ἡμιόνους ἰθύνεις
νύκτα δι’ ἀμβροσίην, ὅτε θ’ εὕδουσι βροτοὶ ἄλλοι;
οὐδὲ σύ γ’ ἔδεισας μένεα πνείοντας Ἀχαιούς,
οἵ τοι δυσμενέες καὶ ἀνάρσιοι ἐγγὺς ἔασι;
τῶν εἴ τίς σε ἴδοιτο θοὴν διὰ νύκτα μέλαιναν
τοσσάδ’ ὀνείατ’ ἄγοντα, τίς ἂν δή τοι νόος εἴη;
οὔτ’ αὐτὸς νέος ἐσσί, γέρων δέ τοι οὗτος ὀπηδεῖ,
ἄνδρ’ ἀπαμύνασθαι, ὅτε τις πρότερος χαλεπήνῃ.
ἀλλ’ ἐγὼ οὐδέν σε ῥέξω κακά, καὶ δέ κεν ἄλλον
σεῦ ἀπαλεξήσαιμι· φίλῳ δέ σε πατρὶ ἐΐσκω.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα γέρων Πρίαμος θεοειδής·
οὕτω πῃ τάδε γ’ ἐστὶ φίλον τέκος ὡς ἀγορεύεις.
ἀλλ’ ἔτι τις καὶ ἐμεῖο θεῶν ὑπερέσχεθε χεῖρα,
ὅς μοι τοιόνδ’ ἧκεν ὁδοιπόρον ἀντιβολῆσαι
αἴσιον, οἷος δὴ σὺ δέμας καὶ εἶδος ἀγητός,
πέπνυσαί τε νόῳ, μακάρων δ’ ἔξεσσι τοκήων.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε διάκτορος ἀργεϊφόντης·
ναὶ δὴ ταῦτά γε πάντα γέρον κατὰ μοῖραν ἔειπες.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε μοι τόδε εἰπὲ καὶ ἀτρεκέως κατάλεξον,
ἠέ πῃ ἐκπέμπεις κειμήλια πολλὰ καὶ ἐσθλὰ
ἄνδρας ἐς ἀλλοδαποὺς ἵνα περ τάδε τοι σόα μίμνῃ,
ἦ ἤδη πάντες καταλείπετε Ἴλιον ἱρὴν
δειδιότες· τοῖος γὰρ ἀνὴρ ὤριστος ὄλωλε
σὸς πάϊς· οὐ μὲν γάρ τι μάχης ἐπιδεύετ’ Ἀχαιῶν.

386 τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα γέρων Πρίαμος θεοειδής·
387 τίς δὲ σύ ἐσσι φέριστε τέων δ’ ἔξεσσι τοκήων;
388 ὥς μοι καλὰ τὸν οἶτον ἀπότμου παιδὸς ἔνισπες.
389 τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε διάκτορος ἀργεϊφόντης·
390 πειρᾷ ἐμεῖο γεραιὲ καὶ εἴρεαι Ἕκτορα δῖον.
Then said the slayer of Argos, guide and guardian, "Sir, all that you have said is right; but tell me and tell me true, are you taking this rich treasure to send it to a foreign people where it may be safe, or are you all leaving strong Ilion in dismay now that your son has fallen who was the bravest man among you and was never lacking in battle with the Achaeans?" And Priam said, "Who are you, my friend, and who are your parents, that you speak so truly about the fate of my unhappy son?" The slayer of Argos, guide and guardian, answered him, "Sir, you would prove me, that you question me about noble Hektor. Many a time have I set eyes upon him in battle when he was driving the Argives to their ships and putting them to the sword. We stood still and marveled, for Achilles in his anger with the son of Atreus suffered us not to fight. I am his squire [therapôn], and came with him in the same ship. I am a Myrmidon, and my father's name is Polyktor: he is a rich man and about as old as you are; he has six sons besides myself, and I am the seventh. We cast lots, and it fell upon me to sail hither with Achilles. I am now come from the ships on to the plain, for with daybreak the Achaeans will set battle in array about the city. They chafe at doing nothing, and are so eager that their princes cannot hold them back." Then answered Priam, "If you are indeed the squire [therapôn] of Achilles son of Peleus, tell me now the Whole truth. Is my son still at the ships, or has Achilles hewn him limb from limb, and given him to his hounds?" "Sir," replied the slayer of Argos, guide and guardian, "neither hounds nor vultures have yet devoured him; he is still just lying at the tents by the ship of Achilles, and though it is now twelve days that he has lain there, his flesh is not wasted nor have the worms eaten him although they feed on warriors. At daybreak Achilles drags him cruelly round the sepulcher [sêma] of his dear comrade, but it does him no hurt. You should come yourself and see how he lies fresh as dew, with the blood all washed away, and his wounds every one of them closed though many pierced him with their spears. Such care have the blessed gods taken of your brave son, for he was dear to them beyond all measure." The old man was comforted as he heard him and said, "My son, see what a good thing it is to have made due offerings to the immortals; for as sure as that he was born my son never forgot the gods that hold Olympus, and now they requite it to him even in death. Accept therefore at my hands this goodly chalice; guard me and with heaven's help guide me till I come to the tent of the son of Peleus." Then answered the slayer of Argos, guide and guardian, "Sir, you are tempting me and playing upon my youth, but you shall not move me, for you are offering me presents without the knowledge of Achilles whom I fear and hold it great guiltless to defraud, lest some evil presently befall me; but as your guide I would go with you even to Argos itself, and would guard you so carefully whether by sea or land, that no one should attack you through making light of him who was with you." The bringer of good luck then sprang on to the chariot, and seizing the whip and reins he breathed fresh spirit into the mules and horses. When they reached the trench and the wall that was before the ships, those who were on guard had just been getting their suppers, and the slayer of Argos threw them all into a deep sleep. Then he drew back the bolts to open the gates, and took Priam inside with the treasure he had upon his wagon. Ere long they came to the lofty dwelling of the son of Peleus for which the Myrmidons had cut pine and which they had built for their king; when they had built it they thatched it with coarse tussock-grass which they had mown out on the plain, and all round it they made a large courtyard, which was fenced with stakes set close together. The gate was barred with a single bolt of pine which it took three men to force into its place, and three to draw back so as to open the gate, but Achilles could draw it by himself. Hermes opened the gate for the old man, and brought in

the treasure that he was taking with him for the son of Peleus. Then he sprang from the chariot on to the ground and said, "Sir, it is I, immortal Hermes, that am come with you, for my father sent me to escort you. I will now leave you, and will not enter into the presence of Achilles, for it might anger him that a god should befriend mortal men thus openly. Go you within, and embrace the knees of the son of Peleus: beseech him by his father, his lovely mother, and his son; thus you may move him."

24.391

τὸν μὲν ἐγὼ μάλα πολλὰ μάχῃ ἔνι κυδιανείρῃ
ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ὄπωπα, καὶ εὖτ’ ἐπὶ νηυσὶν ἐλάσσας
Ἀργείους κτείνεσκε δαΐζων ὀξέϊ χαλκῷ·
ἡμεῖς δ’ ἐσταότες θαυμάζομεν· οὐ γὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
εἴα μάρνασθαι κεχολωμένος Ἀτρεΐωνι.
τοῦ γὰρ ἐγὼ θεράπων, μία δ’ ἅγαγε νηῦς εὐεργής·
Μυρμιδόνων δ’ ἔξειμι, πατὴρ δέ μοί ἐστι Πολύκτωρ.
ἀφνειὸς μὲν ὅ γ’ ἐστί, γέρων δὲ δὴ ὡς σύ περ ὧδε,
ἓξ δέ οἱ υἷες ἔασιν, ἐγὼ δέ οἱ ἕβδομός εἰμι·
τῶν μέτα παλλόμενος κλήρῳ λάχον ἐνθάδ’ ἕπεσθαι.
νῦν δ’ ἦλθον πεδίον δ’ ἀπὸ νηῶν· ἠῶθεν γὰρ
θήσονται περὶ ἄστυ μάχην ἐλίκωπες Ἀχαιοί.
ἀσχαλόωσι γὰρ οἵδε καθήμενοι, οὐδὲ δύνανται
ἴσχειν ἐσσυμένους πολέμου βασιλῆες Ἀχαιῶν.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα γέρων Πρίαμος θεοειδής·
εἰ μὲν δὴ θεράπων Πηληϊάδεω Ἀχιλῆος
εἷς, ἄγε δή μοι πᾶσαν ἀληθείην κατάλεξον,
ἦ ἔτι πὰρ νήεσσιν ἐμὸς πάϊς, ἦέ μιν ἤδη
ᾔσι κυσὶν μελεϊστὶ ταμὼν προύθηκεν Ἀχιλλεύς.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε διάκτορος ἀργεϊφόντης·
ὦ γέρον οὔ πω τόν γε κύνες φάγον οὐδ’ οἰωνοί,
ἀλλ’ ἔτι κεῖνος κεῖται Ἀχιλλῆος παρὰ νηῒ
αὔτως ἐν κλισίῃσι· δυωδεκάτη δέ οἱ ἠὼς
κειμένῳ, οὐδέ τί οἱ χρὼς σήπεται, οὐδέ μιν εὐλαὶ
ἔσθουσ’, αἵ ῥά τε φῶτας ἀρηϊφάτους κατέδουσιν.
ἦ μέν μιν περὶ σῆμα ἑοῦ ἑτάροιο φίλοιο
ἕλκει ἀκηδέστως ἠὼς ὅτε δῖα φανήῃ,
οὐδέ μιν αἰσχύνει· θηοῖό κεν αὐτὸς ἐπελθὼν
οἷον ἐερσήεις κεῖται, περὶ δ’ αἷμα νένιπται,
οὐδέ ποθι μιαρός· σὺν δ’ ἕλκεα πάντα μέμυκεν

24.421

ὅσσ’ ἐτύπη· πολέες γὰρ ἐν αὐτῷ χαλκὸν ἔλασσαν.
ὥς τοι κήδονται μάκαρες θεοὶ υἷος ἑῆος
καὶ νέκυός περ ἐόντος, ἐπεί σφι φίλος περὶ κῆρι.
ὣς φάτο, γήθησεν δ’ ὁ γέρων, καὶ ἀμείβετο μύθῳ·
ὦ τέκος, ἦ ῥ’ ἀγαθὸν καὶ ἐναίσιμα δῶρα διδοῦναι
ἀθανάτοις, ἐπεὶ οὔ ποτ’ ἐμὸς πάϊς, εἴ ποτ’ ἔην γε,
λήθετ’ ἐνὶ μεγάροισι θεῶν οἳ Ὄλυμπον ἔχουσι·
τώ οἱ ἀπεμνήσαντο καὶ ἐν θανάτοιό περ αἴσῃ.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ τόδε δέξαι ἐμεῦ πάρα καλὸν ἄλεισον,
αὐτόν τε ῥῦσαι, πέμψον δέ με σύν γε θεοῖσιν,

ὄφρά κεν ἐς κλισίην Πηληϊάδεω ἀφίκωμαι.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε διάκτορος ἀργεϊφόντης·
πειρᾷ ἐμεῖο γεραιὲ νεωτέρου, οὐδέ με πείσεις,
ὅς με κέλῃ σέο δῶρα παρὲξ Ἀχιλῆα δέχεσθαι.
τὸν μὲν ἐγὼ δείδοικα καὶ αἰδέομαι περὶ κῆρι
συλεύειν, μή μοί τι κακὸν μετόπισθε γένηται.
σοὶ δ’ ἂν ἐγὼ πομπὸς καί κε κλυτὸν Ἄργος ἱκοίμην,
ἐνδυκέως ἐν νηῒ θοῇ ἢ πεζὸς ὁμαρτέων·
οὐκ ἄν τίς τοι πομπὸν ὀνοσσάμενος μαχέσαιτο.
ἦ καὶ ἀναΐξας ἐριούνιος ἅρμα καὶ ἵππους
καρπαλίμως μάστιγα καὶ ἡνία λάζετο χερσίν,
ἐν δ’ ἔπνευσ’ ἵπποισι καὶ ἡμιόνοις μένος ἠΰ.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ πύργους τε νεῶν καὶ τάφρον ἵκοντο,
οἳ δὲ νέον περὶ δόρπα φυλακτῆρες πονέοντο,
τοῖσι δ’ ἐφ’ ὕπνον ἔχευε διάκτορος ἀργεϊφόντης
πᾶσιν, ἄφαρ δ’ ὤϊξε πύλας καὶ ἀπῶσεν ὀχῆας,
ἐς δ’ ἄγαγε Πρίαμόν τε καὶ ἁγλαὰ δῶρ’ ἐπ’ ἀπήνης.
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ κλισίην Πηληϊάδεω ἀφίκοντο
ὑψηλήν, τὴν Μυρμιδόνες ποίησαν ἄνακτι
δοῦρ’ ἐλάτης κέρσαντες· ἀτὰρ καθύπερθεν ἔρεψαν

24.451

λαχνήεντ’ ὄροφον λειμωνόθεν ἀμήσαντες·
ἀμφὶ δέ οἱ μεγάλην αὐλὴν ποίησαν ἄνακτι
σταυροῖσιν πυκινοῖσι· θύρην δ’ ἔχε μοῦνος ἐπιβλὴς
εἰλάτινος, τὸν τρεῖς μὲν ἐπιρρήσσεσκον Ἀχαιοί,
τρεῖς δ’ ἀναοίγεσκον μεγάλην κληῖδα θυράων
τῶν ἄλλων· Ἀχιλεὺς δ’ ἄρ’ ἐπιρρήσσεσκε καὶ οἷος·
δή ῥα τόθ’ Ἑρμείας ἐριούνιος ᾤξε γέροντι,
ἐς δ’ ἄγαγε κλυτὰ δῶρα ποδώκεϊ Πηλεΐωνι,
ἐξ ἵππων δ’ ἀπέβαινεν ἐπὶ χθόνα φώνησέν τε·
ὦ γέρον ἤτοι ἐγὼ θεὸς ἄμβροτος εἰλήλουθα
Ἑρμείας· σοὶ γάρ με πατὴρ ἅμα πομπὸν ὄπασσεν.
ἀλλ’ ἤτοι μὲν ἐγὼ πάλιν εἶσομαι, οὐδ’ Ἀχιλῆος
ὀφθαλμοὺς εἴσειμι· νεμεσσητὸν δέ κεν εἴη
ἀθάνατον θεὸν ὧδε βροτοὺς ἀγαπαζέμεν ἄντην·
τύνη δ’ εἰσελθὼν λαβὲ γούνατα Πηλεΐωνος,
καί μιν ὑπὲρ πατρὸς καὶ μητέρος ἠϋκόμοιο
λίσσεο καὶ τέκεος, ἵνα οἱ σὺν θυμὸν ὀρίνῃς.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἀπέβη πρὸς μακρὸν Ὄλυμπον
Ἑρμείας· Πρίαμος δ’ ἐξ ἵππων ἅλτο χαμᾶζε,
Ἰδαῖον δὲ κατ’ αὖθι λίπεν· ὃ δὲ μίμνεν ἐρύκων
ἵππους ἡμιόνους τε· γέρων δ’ ἰθὺς κίεν οἴκου,
τῇ ῥ’ Ἀχιλεὺς ἵζεσκε Διῒ φίλος· ἐν δέ μιν αὐτὸν
εὗρ’, ἕταροι δ’ ἀπάνευθε καθήατο· τὼ δὲ δύ’ οἴω
ἥρως Αὐτομέδων τε καὶ Ἄλκιμος ὄζος Ἄρηος
ποίπνυον παρεόντε· νέον δ’ ἀπέληγεν ἐδωδῆς
ἔσθων καὶ πίνων· ἔτι καὶ παρέκειτο τράπεζα.
τοὺς δ’ ἔλαθ’ εἰσελθὼν Πρίαμος μέγας, ἄγχι δ’ ἄρα στὰς
χερσὶν Ἀχιλλῆος λάβε γούνατα καὶ κύσε χεῖρας
δεινὰς ἀνδροφόνους, αἳ οἱ πολέας κτάνον υἷας.

480 ὡς δ’ ὅτ’ ἂν ἄνδρ’ ἄτη πυκινὴ λάβῃ, ὅς τ’ ἐνὶ πάτρῃ
With these words Hermes went back to high Olympus. Priam sprang from his chariot to the ground, leaving Idaios where he was, in charge of the mules and horses. The old man went straight into the house where Achilles, loved of the gods, was sitting. There he found him with his men seated at a distance from him: only two, the hero Automedon, and Alkimos of the race of Ares, were busy in attendance about his person, for he had but just done eating and drinking, and the table was still there. King Priam entered without their seeing him, and going right up to Achilles he clasped his knees and kissed the dread murderous hands that had slain so many of his sons. As when some cruel spite [atê] has befallen a man that he should have killed some one in his own country, and must flee to a great man's protection in a land [dêmos] of strangers, and all marvel who see him, even so did Achilles marvel as he beheld Priam. The others looked one to another and marveled also, but Priam besought Achilles saying, "Think of your father, O Achilles like unto the gods, who is such even as I am, on the sad threshold of old age. It may be that those who dwell near him harass him, and there is none to keep war and ruin from him. Yet when he hears of you being still alive, he is glad, and his days are full of hope that he shall see his dear son come home to him from Troy; but I, wretched man that I am, had the bravest in all Troy for my sons, and there is not one of them left. I had fifty sons when the Achaeans came here; nineteen of them were from a single womb, and the others were borne to me by the women of my household. The greater part of them has fierce Ares laid low, and Hektor, him who was alone left, him who was the guardian of the city and ourselves, him have you lately slain; therefore I am now come to the ships of the Achaeans to ransom his body from you with a great ransom. Fear, O Achilles, the wrath of heaven; think on your own father and have compassion upon me, who am the more pitiable, for I have steeled myself as no man yet has ever steeled himself before me, and have raised to my lips the hand of him who slew my son." Thus spoke Priam, and the heart of Achilles yearned as he bethought him of his father. He took the old man's hand and moved him gently away. The two wept bitterly - Priam, as he lay at Achilles' feet, weeping for Hektor, and Achilles now for his father and now for Patroklos, till the house was filled with their lamentation. But when Achilles was now sated with grief and had unburdened the bitterness of his sorrow, he left his seat and raised the old man by the hand, in pity for his white hair and beard; then he said, "Unhappy man, you have indeed been greatly daring; how could you venture to come alone to the ships of the Achaeans, and enter the presence of him who has slain so many of your brave sons? You must have iron courage: sit now upon this seat, and for all our grief we will hide our sorrows in our hearts, for weeping will not avail us. The immortals know no care, yet the lot they spin for man is full of sorrow; on the floor of Zeus' palace there stand two urns, the one filled with evil gifts, and the other with good ones. He for whom Zeus the lord of thunder mixes the gifts he sends, will meet now with good and now with evil fortune; but he to whom Zeus sends none but evil gifts will be pointed at by the finger of scorn, the hand of famine will pursue him to the ends of the world, and he will go up and down the face of the earth, respected neither by gods nor men. Even so did it befall Peleus; the gods endowed him with all good things from his birth upwards, for he reigned over the Myrmidons excelling all men in prosperity [olbos] and wealth, and mortal though he was they gave him a goddess for his bride. But even on him too did heaven send misfortune, for there is no race of royal children born to him in his house, save one son who is doomed to die all untimely; nor may I take care of him now that he is growing old, for I must stay here at Troy to be the bane of you and your children. And you too, O Priam, I have heard that you were aforetime happy [olbios]. They say that in wealth and plenitude of offspring you surpassed all that is in Lesbos, the realm of Makar to the northward, Phrygia that is more inland, and those that dwell upon the great Hellespont; but from the day when the dwellers in heaven sent this evil upon you, war and slaughter have been about your city continually.

Bear up against it, and let there be some intervals in your sorrow. Mourn as you may for your brave son, you will take nothing by it. You cannot raise him from the dead, ere you do so yet another sorrow shall befall you." And Priam answered, "O king, bid me not be seated, while Hektor is still lying uncared for in your tents, but accept the great ransom which I have brought you, and give him to me at once that I may look upon him. May you prosper with the ransom and reach your own land in safety, seeing that you have suffered me to live and to look upon the light of the sun." Achilles looked at him sternly and said, "Vex me, sir, no longer; I am of myself minded to give up the body of Hektor. My mother, daughter of the old man of the sea, came to me from Zeus to bid me deliver it to you. Moreover I know well, O Priam, and you cannot hide it, that some god has brought you to the ships of the Achaeans, for else, no man however strong and in his prime would dare to come to our host; he could neither pass our guard unseen, nor draw the bolt of my gates thus easily; therefore, provoke me no further, lest I err against the word of Zeus, and suffer you not, suppliant though you are, within my tents."

24.481

481 φῶτα κατακτείνας ἄλλων ἐξίκετο δῆμον
482 ἀνδρὸς ἐς ἀφνειοῦ, θάμβος δ’ ἔχει εἰσορόωντας,
483 ὣς Ἀχιλεὺς θάμβησεν ἰδὼν Πρίαμον θεοειδέα·
484 θάμβησαν δὲ καὶ ἄλλοι, ἐς ἀλλήλους δὲ ἴδοντο.
485 τὸν καὶ λισσόμενος Πρίαμος πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπε·
486 μνῆσαι πατρὸς σοῖο θεοῖς ἐπιείκελ’ Ἀχιλλεῦ,
487 τηλίκου ὥς περ ἐγών, ὀλοῷ ἐπὶ γήραος οὐδῷ·
488 καὶ μέν που κεῖνον περιναιέται ἀμφὶς ἐόντες
489 τείρουσ’, οὐδέ τίς ἐστιν ἀρὴν καὶ λοιγὸν ἀμῦναι.
490 ἀλλ’ ἤτοι κεῖνός γε σέθεν ζώοντος ἀκούων
491 χαίρει τ’ ἐν θυμῷ, ἐπί τ’ ἔλπεται ἤματα πάντα
492 ὄψεσθαι φίλον υἱὸν ἀπὸ Τροίηθεν ἰόντα·
493 αὐτὰρ ἐγὼ πανάποτμος, ἐπεὶ τέκον υἷας ἀρίστους
494 Τροίῃ ἐν εὐρείῃ, τῶν δ’ οὔ τινά φημι λελεῖφθαι.
495 πεντήκοντά μοι ἦσαν ὅτ’ ἦλυθον υἷες Ἀχαιῶν·
496 ἐννεακαίδεκα μέν μοι ἰῆς ἐκ νηδύος ἦσαν,
497 τοὺς δ’ ἄλλους μοι ἔτικτον ἐνὶ μεγάροισι γυναῖκες.
498 τῶν μὲν πολλῶν θοῦρος Ἄρης ὑπὸ γούνατ’ ἔλυσεν·
499 ὃς δέ μοι οἶος ἦεν, εἴρυτο δὲ ἄστυ καὶ αὐτούς,
500 τὸν σὺ πρῴην κτείνας ἀμυνόμενον περὶ πάτρης
501 Ἕκτορα· τοῦ νῦν εἵνεχ’ ἱκάνω νῆας Ἀχαιῶν
502 λυσόμενος παρὰ σεῖο, φέρω δ’ ἀπερείσι’ ἄποινα.
503 ἀλλ’ αἰδεῖο θεοὺς Ἀχιλεῦ, αὐτόν τ’ ἐλέησον
504 μνησάμενος σοῦ πατρός· ἐγὼ δ’ ἐλεεινότερός περ,
505 ἔτλην δ’ οἷ’ οὔ πώ τις ἐπιχθόνιος βροτὸς ἄλλος,
506 ἀνδρὸς παιδοφόνοιο ποτὶ στόμα χεῖρ’ ὀρέγεσθαι.
507 ὣς φάτο, τῷ δ’ ἄρα πατρὸς ὑφ’ ἵμερον ὦρσε γόοιο·
508 ἁψάμενος δ’ ἄρα χειρὸς ἀπώσατο ἦκα γέροντα.
509 τὼ δὲ μνησαμένω ὃ μὲν Ἕκτορος ἀνδροφόνοιο
510 κλαῖ’ ἀδινὰ προπάροιθε ποδῶν Ἀχιλῆος ἐλυσθείς,

24.511

511 αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς κλαῖεν ἑὸν πατέρ’, ἄλλοτε δ’ αὖτε
512 Πάτροκλον· τῶν δὲ στοναχὴ κατὰ δώματ’ ὀρώρει.

αὐτὰρ ἐπεί ῥα γόοιο τετάρπετο δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
καί οἱ ἀπὸ πραπίδων ἦλθ’ ἵμερος ἠδ’ ἀπὸ γυίων,
αὐτίκ’ ἀπὸ θρόνου ὦρτο, γέροντα δὲ χειρὸς ἀνίστη
οἰκτίρων πολιόν τε κάρη πολιόν τε γένειον,
καί μιν φωνήσας ἔπεα πτερόεντα προσηύδα·
ἆ δείλ’, ἦ δὴ πολλὰ κάκ’ ἄνσχεο σὸν κατὰ θυμόν.
πῶς ἔτλης ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν ἐλθέμεν οἷος
ἀνδρὸς ἐς ὀφθαλμοὺς ὅς τοι πολέας τε καὶ ἐσθλοὺς
υἱέας ἐξενάριξα; σιδήρειόν νύ τοι ἦτορ.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ κατ’ ἄρ’ ἕζευ ἐπὶ θρόνου, ἄλγεα δ’ ἔμπης
ἐν θυμῷ κατακεῖσθαι ἐάσομεν ἀχνύμενοί περ·
οὐ γάρ τις πρῆξις πέλεται κρυεροῖο γόοιο·
ὡς γὰρ ἐπεκλώσαντο θεοὶ δειλοῖσι βροτοῖσι
ζώειν ἀχνυμένοις· αὐτοὶ δέ τ’ ἀκηδέες εἰσί.
δοιοὶ γάρ τε πίθοι κατακείαται ἐν Διὸς οὔδει
δώρων οἷα δίδωσι κακῶν, ἕτερος δὲ ἐάων·
ᾧ μέν κ’ ἀμμίξας δώῃ Ζεὺς τερπικέραυνος,
ἄλλοτε μέν τε κακῷ ὅ γε κύρεται, ἄλλοτε δ’ ἐσθλῷ·
ᾧ δέ κε τῶν λυγρῶν δώῃ, λωβητὸν ἔθηκε,
καί ἑ κακὴ βούβρωστις ἐπὶ χθόνα δῖαν ἐλαύνει,
φοιτᾷ δ’ οὔτε θεοῖσι τετιμένος οὔτε βροτοῖσιν.
ὣς μὲν καὶ Πηλῆϊ θεοὶ δόσαν ἀγλαὰ δῶρα
ἐκ γενετῆς· πάντας γὰρ ἐπ’ ἀνθρώπους ἐκέκαστο
ὄλβῳ τε πλούτῳ τε, ἄνασσε δὲ Μυρμιδόνεσσι,
καί οἱ θνητῷ ἐόντι θεὰν ποίησαν ἄκοιτιν.
ἀλλ’ ἐπὶ καὶ τῷ θῆκε θεὸς κακόν, ὅττί οἱ οὔ τι
παίδων ἐν μεγάροισι γονὴ γένετο κρειόντων,
ἀλλ’ ἕνα παῖδα τέκεν παναώριον· οὐδέ νυ τόν γε

24.541

γηράσκοντα κομίζω, ἐπεὶ μάλα τηλόθι πάτρης
ἧμαι ἐνὶ Τροίῃ, σέ τε κήδων ἠδὲ σὰ τέκνα.
καὶ σὲ γέρον τὸ πρὶν μὲν ἀκούομεν ὄλβιον εἶναι·
ὅσσον Λέσβος ἄνω Μάκαρος ἕδος ἐντὸς ἐέργει
καὶ Φρυγίη καθύπερθε καὶ Ἑλλήσποντος ἀπείρων,
τῶν σε γέρον πλούτῳ τε καὶ υἱάσι φασὶ κεκάσθαι.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεί τοι πῆμα τόδ’ ἤγαγον Οὐρανίωνες
αἰεί τοι περὶ ἄστυ μάχαι τ’ ἀνδροκτασίαι τε.
ἄνσχεο, μὴ δ’ ἀλίαστον ὀδύρεο σὸν κατὰ θυμόν·
οὐ γάρ τι πρήξεις ἀκαχήμενος υἷος ἑῆος,
οὐδέ μιν ἀνστήσεις, πρὶν καὶ κακὸν ἄλλο πάθῃσθα.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα γέρων Πρίαμος θεοειδής·
μή πω μ’ ἐς θρόνον ἵζε διοτρεφὲς ὄφρά κεν Ἕκτωρ
κεῖται ἐνὶ κλισίῃσιν ἀκηδής, ἀλλὰ τάχιστα
λῦσον ἵν’ ὀφθαλμοῖσιν ἴδω· σὺ δὲ δέξαι ἄποινα
πολλά, τά τοι φέρομεν· σὺ δὲ τῶνδ’ ἀπόναιο, καὶ ἔλθοις
σὴν ἐς πατρίδα γαῖαν, ἐπεί με πρῶτον ἔασας
αὐτόν τε ζώειν καὶ ὁρᾶν φάος ἠελίοιο.
τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπόδρα ἰδὼν προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
μηκέτι νῦν μ’ ἐρέθιζε γέρον· νοέω δὲ καὶ αὐτὸς
Ἕκτορά τοι λῦσαι, Διόθεν δέ μοι ἄγγελος ἦλθε

562 μήτηρ, ἥ μ’ ἔτεκεν, θυγάτηρ ἁλίοιο γέροντος.
563 καὶ δέ σε γιγνώσκω Πρίαμε φρεσίν, οὐδέ με λήθεις,
564 ὅττι θεῶν τίς σ’ ἦγε θοὰς ἐπὶ νῆας Ἀχαιῶν.
565 οὐ γάρ κε τλαίη βροτὸς ἐλθέμεν, οὐδὲ μάλ’ ἡβῶν,
566 ἐς στρατόν· οὐδὲ γὰρ ἂν φυλάκους λάθοι, οὐδέ κ’ ὀχῆα
567 ῥεῖα μετοχλίσσειε θυράων ἡμετεράων.
568 τὼ νῦν μή μοι μᾶλλον ἐν ἄλγεσι θυμὸν ὀρίνῃς,
569 μή σε γέρον οὐδ’ αὐτὸν ἐνὶ κλισίῃσιν ἐάσω
570 καὶ ἱκέτην περ ἐόντα, Διὸς δ’ ἀλίτωμαι ἐφετμάς.

24.571

571 ὣς ἔφατ’, ἔδεισεν δ’ ὃ γέρων καὶ ἐπείθετο μύθῳ.
572 Πηλεΐδης δ’ οἴκοιο λέων ὡς ἆλτο θύραζε
573 οὐκ οἶος, ἅμα τῷ γε δύω θεράποντες ἕποντο
574 ἥρως Αὐτομέδων ἠδ’ Ἄλκιμος, οὕς ῥα μάλιστα
575 τῖ’ Ἀχιλεὺς ἑτάρων μετὰ Πάτροκλόν γε θανόντα,
576 οἳ τόθ’ ὑπὸ ζυγόφιν λύον ἵππους ἠμιόνους τε,
577 ἐς δ’ ἄγαγον κήρυκα καλήτορα τοῖο γέροντος,
578 κὰδ δ’ ἐπὶ δίφρου εἷσαν· ἐϋξέστου δ’ ἀπ’ ἀπήνης
579 ᾑρεον Ἕκτορέης κεφαλῆς ἀπερείσι’ ἄποινα.
580 κὰδ δ’ ἔλιπον δύο φάρε’ ἐΰννητόν τε χιτῶνα,
581 ὄφρα νέκυν πυκάσας δοίη οἶκον δὲ φέρεσθαι.
582 δμῳὰς δ’ ἐκκαλέσας λοῦσαι κέλετ’ ἀμφί τ’ ἀλεῖψαι
583 νόσφιν ἀειράσας, ὡς μὴ Πρίαμος ἴδοι υἱόν,
584 μὴ ὃ μὲν ἀχνυμένῃ κραδίῃ χόλον οὐκ ἐρύσαιτο
585 παῖδα ἰδών, Ἀχιλῆϊ δ’ ὀρινθείη φίλον ἦτορ,
586 καί ἑ κατακτείνειε, Διὸς δ’ ἁλίτηται ἐφετμάς.
587 τὸν δ’ ἐπεὶ οὖν δμῳαὶ λοῦσαν καὶ χρῖσαν ἐλαίῳ,
588 ἀμφὶ δέ μιν φᾶρος καλὸν βάλον ἠδὲ χιτῶνα,
589 αὐτὸς τόν γ’ Ἀχιλεὺς λεχέων ἐπέθηκεν ἀείρας,
590 σὺν δ’ ἕταροι ἤειραν ἐϋξέστην ἐπ’ ἀπήνην.
591 ᾤμωξέν τ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα, φίλον δ’ ὀνόμηνεν ἑταῖρον·
592 μή μοι Πάτροκλε σκυδμαινέμεν, αἴ κε πύθηαι
593 εἰν Ἄϊδός περ ἐὼν ὅτι Ἕκτορα δῖον ἔλυσα
594 πατρὶ φίλῳ, ἐπεὶ οὔ μοι ἀεικέα δῶκεν ἄποινα.
595 σοὶ δ’ αὖ ἐγὼ καὶ τῶνδ’ ἀποδάσσομαι ὅσσ’ ἐπέοικεν.
596 ἦ ῥα, καὶ ἐς κλισίην πάλιν ἤϊε δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς,
597 ἕζετο δ’ ἐν κλισμῷ πολυδαιδάλῳ ἔνθεν ἀνέστη
598 τοίχου τοῦ ἑτέρου, ποτὶ δὲ Πρίαμον φάτο μῦθον·
599 υἱὸς μὲν δή τοι λέλυται γέρον ὡς ἐκέλευες,
600 κεῖται δ’ ἐν λεχέεσσ’· ἅμα δ’ ἠοῖ φαινομένηφιν

The old man feared him and obeyed. Then the son of Peleus sprang like a lion through the door of his house, not alone, but with him went his two squires [therapontes] Automedon and Alkimos who were closer to him than any others of his comrades now that Patroklos was no more. These unyoked the horses and mules, and bade Priam's herald and attendant be seated within the house. They lifted the ransom for Hektor's body from the wagon. but they left two mantles and a goodly shirt, that Achilles might wrap the body in them when he gave it to be taken home. Then he called to his servants and ordered them to wash the body and anoint it, but he first took it to a place where Priam should not see it, lest if he did so, he should break out in the bitterness of his grief, and enrage Achilles, who might then kill him and err against the word of Zeus. When the servants had washed the body and

anointed it, and had wrapped it in a fair shirt and mantle, Achilles himself lifted it on to a bier, and he and his men then laid it on the wagon. He cried aloud as he did so and called on the name of his dear comrade, "Be not angry with me, Patroklos," he said, "if you hear even in the house of Hades that I have given Hektor to his father for a ransom. It has been no unworthy one, and I will share it equitably with you." Achilles then went back into the tent and took his place on the richly inlaid seat from which he had risen, by the wall that was at right angles to the one against which Priam was sitting. "Sir," he said, "your son is now laid upon his bier and is ransomed according to desire; you shall look upon him when you him away at daybreak; for the present let us prepare our supper. Even lovely Niobe had to think about eating, though her twelve children - six daughters and six lusty sons - had been all slain in her house. Apollo killed the sons with arrows from his silver bow, to punish Niobe, and Artemis slew the daughters, because Niobe had vaunted herself against Leto; she said Leto had borne two children only, whereas she had herself borne many - whereon the two killed the many. Nine days did they lie weltering, and there was none to bury them, for the son of Kronos turned the people into stone; but on the tenth day the gods in heaven themselves buried them, and Niobe then took food, being worn out with weeping. They say that somewhere among the rocks on the mountain pastures of Sipylos, where the nymphs live that haunt the river Akheloos, there, they say, she lives in stone and still nurses the sorrows sent upon her by the hand of heaven. Therefore, noble sir, let us two now take food; you can weep for your dear son hereafter as you are bearing him back to Ilion - and many a tear will he cost you." With this Achilles sprang from his seat and killed a sheep of silvery whiteness, which his followers skinned and made ready all in due order [kosmos]. They cut the meat carefully up into smaller pieces, spitted them, and drew them off again when they were well roasted. Automedon brought bread in fair baskets and served it round the table, while Achilles dealt out the meat, and they laid their hands on the good things that were before them. As soon as they had had enough to eat and drink, Priam, descendant of Dardanos, marveled at the strength and beauty of Achilles for he was as a god to see, and Achilles marveled at Priam as he listened to him and looked upon his noble presence. When they had gazed their fill Priam spoke first. "And now, O king," he said, "take me to my couch that we may lie down and enjoy the blessed boon of sleep. Never once have my eyes been closed from the day your hands took the life of my son; I have groveled without ceasing in the mire of my stable-yard, making moan and brooding over my countless sorrows. Now, moreover, I have eaten bread and drunk wine; hitherto I have tasted nothing." As he spoke Achilles told his men and the women-servants to set beds in the room that was in the gatehouse, and make them with good red rugs, and spread coverlets on the top of them with woolen cloaks for Priam and Idaios to wear. So the maids went out carrying a torch and got the two beds ready in all haste. Then Achilles said laughingly to Priam, "Dear sir, you shall lie outside, lest some counselor of those who, as is right [themis], keep coming to advise with me should see you here in the darkness of the fleeing night, and tell it to Agamemnon. This might cause delay in the delivery of the body. And now tell me and tell me true, for how many days would you celebrate the funeral rites of noble Hektor? Tell me, that I may hold aloof from war and restrain the host." And Priam answered, "Since, then, you suffer me to bury my noble son with all due rites, do thus, Achilles, and I shall be grateful. You know how we are pent up within our city; it is far for us to fetch wood from the mountain, and the people live in fear. Nine days, therefore, will we mourn Hektor in my house; on the tenth day we will bury him and there shall be a public feast in his honor; on the eleventh we will build a mound over his ashes, and on the twelfth, if there be need, we will fight." And Achilles answered, "All, King Priam, shall be as you have said. I will stay our fighting for as long a time as you have named." As he spoke he laid his hand on the old man's right wrist, in token that he should have no fear; thus then did Priam and his attendant sleep there in the forecourt, full of thought, while Achilles lay in an inner room of

the house, with fair Briseis by his side. And now both gods and mortals were fast asleep through the livelong night, but upon Hermes alone, the bringer of good luck, sleep could take no hold for he was thinking all the time how to get King Priam away from the ships without his being seen by the strong force of sentinels. He hovered therefore over Priam's head and said, "Sir, now that Achilles has spared your life, you seem to have no fear about sleeping in the thick of your foes. You have paid a great ransom, and have received the body of your son; were you still alive and a prisoner the sons whom you have left at home would have to give three times as much to free you; and so it would be if Agamemnon and the other Achaeans were to know of your being here."

24.601

601 ὄψεαι αὐτὸς ἄγων· νῦν δὲ μνησώμεθα δόρπου.
602 καὶ γάρ τ’ ἠΰκομος Νιόβη ἐμνήσατο σίτου,
603 τῇ περ δώδεκα παῖδες ἐνὶ μεγάροισιν ὄλοντο
604 ἓξ μὲν θυγατέρες, ἓξ δ’ υἱέες ἡβώοντες.
605 τοὺς μὲν Ἀπόλλων πέφνεν ἀπ’ ἀργυρέοιο βιοῖο
606 χωόμενος Νιόβῃ, τὰς δ’ Ἄρτεμις ἰοχέαιρα,
607 οὕνεκ’ ἄρα Λητοῖ ἰσάσκετο καλλιπαρῄῳ·
608 φῆ δοιὼ τεκέειν, ἣ δ’ αὐτὴ γείνατο πολλούς·
609 τὼ δ’ ἄρα καὶ δοιώ περ ἐόντ’ ἀπὸ πάντας ὄλεσσαν.
610 οἳ μὲν ἄρ’ ἐννῆμαρ κέατ’ ἐν φόνῳ, οὐδέ τις ἦεν
611 κατθάψαι, λαοὺς δὲ λίθους ποίησε Κρονίων·
612 τοὺς δ’ ἄρα τῇ δεκάτῃ θάψαν θεοὶ Οὐρανίωνες.
613 ἣ δ’ ἄρα σίτου μνήσατ’, ἐπεὶ κάμε δάκρυ χέουσα.
614 νῦν δέ που ἐν πέτρῃσιν ἐν οὔρεσιν οἰοπόλοισιν
615 ἐν Σιπύλῳ, ὅθι φασὶ θεάων ἔμμεναι εὐνὰς
616 νυμφάων, αἵ τ’ ἀμφ’ Ἀχελώϊον ἐρρώσαντο,
617 ἔνθα λίθος περ ἐοῦσα θεῶν ἐκ κήδεα πέσσει.
618 ἀλλ’ ἄγε δὴ καὶ νῶϊ μεδώμεθα δῖε γεραιὲ
619 σίτου· ἔπειτά κεν αὖτε φίλον παῖδα κλαίοισθα
620 Ἴλιον εἰσαγαγών· πολυδάκρυτος δέ τοι ἔσται.
621 ἦ καὶ ἀναΐξας ὄϊν ἄργυφον ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεὺς
622 σφάξ’· ἕταροι δ’ ἔδερόν τε καὶ ἄμφεπον εὖ κατὰ κόσμον,
623 μίστυλλόν τ’ ἄρ’ ἐπισταμένως πεῖράν τ’ ὀβελοῖσιν,
624 ὄπτησάν τε περιφραδέως, ἐρύσαντό τε πάντα.
625 Αὐτομέδων δ’ ἄρα σῖτον ἐλὼν ἐπένειμε τραπέζῃ
626 καλοῖς ἐν κανέοισιν· ἀτὰρ κρέα νεῖμεν Ἀχιλλεύς.
627 οἳ δ’ ἐπ’ ὀνείαθ’ ἑτοῖμα προκείμενα χεῖρας ἴαλλον.
628 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ πόσιος καὶ ἐδητύος ἐξ ἔρον ἔντο,
629 ἤτοι Δαρδανίδης Πρίαμος θαύμαζ’ Ἀχιλῆα
630 ὅσσος ἔην οἷός τε· θεοῖσι γὰρ ἄντα ἐῴκει·

24.631

631 αὐτὰρ ὃ Δαρδανίδην Πρίαμον θαύμαζεν Ἀχιλλεὺς
632 εἰσορόων ὄψίν τ’ ἀγαθὴν καὶ μῦθον ἀκούων.
633 αὐτὰρ ἐπεὶ τάρπησαν ἐς ἀλλήλους ὁρόωντες,
634 τὸν πρότερος προσέειπε γέρων Πρίαμος θεοειδής·
635 λέξον νῦν με τάχιστα διοτρεφές, ὄφρα καὶ ἤδη
636 ὕπνῳ ὕπο γλυκερῷ ταρπώμεθα κοιμηθέντες·
637 οὐ γάρ πω μύσαν ὄσσε ὑπὸ βλεφάροισιν ἐμοῖσιν

ἐξ οὗ σῆς ὑπὸ χερσὶν ἐμὸς πάϊς ὤλεσε θυμόν,
ἀλλ’ αἰεὶ στενάχω καὶ κήδεα μυρία πέσσω
αὐλῆς ἐν χόρτοισι κυλινδόμενος κατὰ κόπρον.
νῦν δὴ καὶ σίτου πασάμην καὶ αἴθοπα οἶνον
λαυκανίης καθέηκα· πάρος γε μὲν οὔ τι πεπάσμην.
ἦ ῥ’, Ἀχιλεὺς δ’ ἑτάροισιν ἰδὲ δμῳῇσι κέλευσε
δέμνι’ ὑπ’ αἰθούσῃ θέμεναι καὶ ῥήγεα καλὰ
πορφύρε’ ἐμβαλέειν, στορέσαι τ’ ἐφύπερθε τάπητας,
χλαίνας τ’ ἐνθέμεναι οὔλας καθύπερθεν ἔσασθαι.
αἳ δ’ ἴσαν ἐκ μεγάροιο δάος μετὰ χερσὶν ἔχουσαι,
αἶψα δ’ ἄρα στόρεσαν δοιὼ λέχε’ ἐγκονέουσαι.
τὸν δ’ ἐπικερτομέων προσέφη πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεύς·
ἐκτὸς μὲν δὴ λέξο γέρον φίλε, μή τις Ἀχαιῶν
ἐνθάδ’ ἐπέλθῃσιν βουληφόρος, οἵ τέ μοι αἰεὶ
βουλὰς βουλεύουσι παρήμενοι, ἢ θέμις ἐστί·
τῶν εἴ τίς σε ἴδοιτο θοὴν διὰ νύκτα μέλαιναν,
αὐτίκ’ ἂν ἐξείποι Ἀγαμέμνονι ποιμένι λαῶν,
καί κεν ἀνάβλησις λύσιος νεκροῖο γένηται.
ἀλλ’ ἄγε μοι τόδε εἰπὲ καὶ ἀτρεκέως κατάλεξον,
ποσσῆμαρ μέμονας κτερεϊζέμεν Ἕκτορα δῖον,
ὄφρα τέως αὐτός τε μένω καὶ λαὸν ἐρύκω.
τὸν δ’ ἠμείβετ’ ἔπειτα γέρων Πρίαμος θεοειδής·
εἰ μὲν δή μ’ ἐθέλεις τελέσαι τάφον Ἕκτορι δίῳ,

24.661

ὧδέ κέ μοι ῥέζων Ἀχιλεῦ κεχαρισμένα θείης.
οἶσθα γὰρ ὡς κατὰ ἄστυ ἐέλμεθα, τηλόθι δ’ ὕλη
ἀξέμεν ἐξ ὄρεος, μάλα δὲ Τρῶες δεδίασιν.
ἐννῆμαρ μέν κ’ αὐτὸν ἐνὶ μεγάροις γοάοιμεν,
τῇ δεκάτῃ δέ κε θάπτοιμεν δαινῦτό τε λαός,
ἐνδεκάτῃ δέ κε τύμβον ἐπ’ αὐτῷ ποιήσαιμεν,
τῇ δὲ δυωδεκάτῃ πολεμίξομεν εἴ περ ἀνάγκη.
τὸν δ’ αὖτε προσέειπε ποδάρκης δῖος Ἀχιλλεύς·
ἔσται τοι καὶ ταῦτα γέρον Πρίαμ’ ὡς σὺ κελεύεις·
σχήσω γὰρ πόλεμον τόσσον χρόνον ὅσσον ἄνωγας.
ὣς ἄρα φωνήσας ἐπὶ καρπῷ χεῖρα γέροντος
ἔλλαβε δεξιτερήν, μή πως δείσει’ ἐνὶ θυμῷ.
οἳ μὲν ἄρ’ ἐν προδόμῳ δόμου αὐτόθι κοιμήσαντο
κῆρυξ καὶ Πρίαμος πυκινὰ φρεσὶ μήδε’ ἔχοντες,
αὐτὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς εὖδε μυχῷ κλισίης ἐϋπήκτου·
τῷ δὲ Βρισηὶς παρελέξατο καλλιπάρῃος.
ἄλλοι μέν ῥα θεοί τε καὶ ἀνέρες ἱπποκορυσταὶ
εὗδον παννύχιοι μαλακῷ δεδμημένοι ὕπνῳ·
ἀλλ’ οὐχ Ἑρμείαν ἐριούνιον ὕπνος ἔμαρπτεν
ὀρμαίνοντ’ ἀνὰ θυμὸν ὅπως Πρίαμον βασιλῆα
νηῶν ἐκπέμψειε λαθὼν ἱεροὺς πυλαωρούς.
στῆ δ’ ἄρ’ ὑπὲρ κεφαλῆς καί μιν πρὸς μῦθον ἔειπεν·
ὦ γέρον οὔ νύ τι σοί γε μέλει κακόν, οἷον ἔθ’ εὕδεις
ἀνδράσιν ἐν δηΐοισιν, ἐπεί σ’ εἴασεν Ἀχιλλεύς.
καὶ νῦν μὲν φίλον υἱὸν ἐλύσαο, πολλὰ δ’ ἔδωκας·
σεῖο δέ κε ζωοῦ καὶ τρὶς τόσα δοῖεν ἄποινα

687 παῖδες τοὶ μετόπισθε λελειμμένοι, αἴ κ’ Ἀγαμέμνων
688 γνώῃ σ’ Ἀτρεΐδης, γνώωσι δὲ πάντες Ἀχαιοί.
689 ὣς ἔφατ’, ἔδεισεν δ’ ὃ γέρων, κήρυκα δ’ ἀνίστη.
690 τοῖσιν δ’ Ἑρμείας ζεῦξ’ ἵππους ἠμιόνους τε,
When he heard this the old man was afraid and roused his servant. Hermes then yoked their horses and mules, and drove them quickly through the host so that no man perceived them. When they came to the ford of eddying Xanthos, begotten of immortal Zeus, Hermes went back to high Olympus, and dawn in robe of saffron began to break over all the land. Priam and Idaios then drove on toward the city lamenting and making moan, and the mules drew the body of Hektor. No one neither man nor woman saw them, till Cassandra, fair as golden Aphrodite standing on Pergamos, caught sight of her dear father in his chariot, and his servant that was the city's herald with him. Then she saw him that was lying upon the bier, drawn by the mules, and with a loud cry she went about the city saying, "Come hither Trojans, men and women, and look on Hektor; if ever you rejoiced to see him coming from battle when he was alive, look now on him that was the glory of our city and all our ." At this there was not man nor woman left in the city, so great a sorrow [penthos] had possessed them. Hard by the gates they met Priam as he was bringing in the body. Hektor's wife and his mother were the first to mourn him: they flew towards the wagon and laid their hands upon his head, while the crowd stood weeping round them. They would have stayed before the gates, weeping and lamenting the livelong day to the going down of the sun, had not Priam spoken to them from the chariot and said, "Make way for the mules to pass you. Afterwards when I have taken the body home you shall have your fill of weeping." On this the people stood asunder, and made a way for the wagon. When they had borne the body within the house they laid it upon a bed and seated minstrels round it to lead the dirge, whereon the women joined in the sad music of their lament. Foremost among them all Andromache led their wailing as she clasped the head of mighty Hektor in her embrace. "Husband," she cried, "you have died young, and leave me in your house a widow; he of whom we are the ill-starred parents is still a mere child, and I fear he may not reach manhood. Ere he can do so our city will be razed and overthrown, for you who watched over it are no more - you who were its savior, the guardian of our wives and children. Our women will be carried away captives to the ships, and I among them; while you, my child, who will be with me will be put to some unseemly tasks, working for a cruel master. Or, may be, some Achaean will hurl you (O miserable death) from our walls, to avenge some brother, son, or father whom Hektor slew; many of them have indeed bitten the dust at his hands, for your father's hand in battle was no light one. Therefore do the people mourn him. You have left, O Hektor, sorrow unutterable to your parents, and my own grief [penthos] is greatest of all, for you did not stretch forth your arms and embrace me as you lay dying, nor say to me any words that might have lived with me in my tears night and day for evermore." Bitterly did she weep the while, and the women joined in her lament. Hecuba in her turn took up the strains of woe. "Hektor," she cried, "dearest to me of all my children. So long as you were alive the gods loved you well, and even in death they have not been utterly unmindful of you; for when Achilles took any other of my sons, he would sell him beyond the seas, to Samos Imbros or rugged Lemnos; and when he had taken away with his sword your life-breath [psukhê] as well, many a time did he drag you round the sepulcher [sêma] of his comrade - though this could not give him life - yet here you lie all fresh as dew, and comely as one whom Apollo has slain with his painless shafts." Thus did she too speak through her tears with bitter moan, and then Helen for a third time took up the strain of lamentation. "Hektor," said she, "dearest of all my brothers-in-law-for I am wife to Alexander who brought me hither to Troy - would that I had died ere he did so - twenty years are come and gone since I left my home and came from over the sea, but I have never heard one word of insult or unkindness from you. When another would chide with me, as it

might be one of your brothers or sisters or of your brothers' wives, or my mother-in-law - for Priam was as kind to me as though he were my own father - you would rebuke and check them with words of gentleness and goodwill. Therefore my tears flow both for you and for my unhappy self, for there is no one else in Troy who is kind to me, but all shrink and shudder as they go by me." She wept as she spoke and the vast population [dêmos] that was gathered round her joined in her lament. Then King Priam spoke to them saying, "Bring wood, O Trojans, to the city, and fear no cunning ambush of the Argives, for Achilles when he dismissed me from the ships gave me his word that they should not attack us until the morning of the twelfth day."

24.691

691 ῥίμφα δ’ ἄρ’ αὐτὸς ἔλαυνε κατὰ στρατόν, οὐδέ τις ἔγνω.
692 ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ πόρον ἶξον ἐϋρρεῖος ποταμοῖο
693 Ξάνθου δινήεντος, ὃν ἀθάνατος τέκετο Ζεύς,
694 Ἑρμείας μὲν ἔπειτ’ ἀπέβη πρὸς μακρὸν Ὄλυμπον,
695 Ἠὼς δὲ κροκόπεπλος ἐκίδνατο πᾶσαν ἐπ’ αἶαν,
696 οἳ δ’ εἰς ἄστυ ἔλων οἰμωγῇ τε στοναχῇ τε
697 ἵππους, ἡμίονοι δὲ νέκυν φέρον. οὐδέ τις ἄλλος
698 ἔγνω πρόσθ’ ἀνδρῶν καλλιζώνων τε γυναικῶν,
699 ἀλλ’ ἄρα Κασσάνδρη ἰκέλη χρυσῇ Ἀφροδίτῃ
700 Πέργαμον εἰσαναβᾶσα φίλον πατέρ’ εἰσενόησεν
701 ἑσταότ’ ἐν δίφρῳ, κήρυκά τε ἀστυβοώτην·
702 τὸν δ’ ἄρ’ ἐφ’ ἡμιόνων ἴδε κείμενον ἐν λεχέεσσι·
703 κώκυσέν τ’ ἄρ’ ἔπειτα γέγωνέ τε πᾶν κατὰ ἄστυ·
704 ὄψεσθε Τρῶες καὶ Τρῳάδες Ἕκτορ’ ἰόντες,
705 εἴ ποτε καὶ ζώοντι μάχης ἐκνοστήσαντι
706 χαίρετ’, ἐπεὶ μέγα χάρμα πόλει τ’ ἦν παντί τε δήμῳ.
707 ὣς ἔφατ’, οὐδέ τις αὐτόθ’ ἐνὶ πτόλεϊ λίπετ’ ἀνὴρ
708 οὐδὲ γυνή· πάντας γὰρ ἀάσχετον ἵκετο πένθος·
709 ἀγχοῦ δὲ ξύμβληντο πυλάων νεκρὸν ἄγοντι.
710 πρῶται τόν γ’ ἄλοχός τε φίλη καὶ πότνια μήτηρ
711 τιλλέσθην ἐπ’ ἄμαξαν ἐΰτροχον ἀΐξασαι
712 ἁπτόμεναι κεφαλῆς· κλαίων δ’ ἀμφίσταθ’ ὅμιλος.
713 καί νύ κε δὴ πρόπαν ἦμαρ ἐς ἠέλιον καταδύντα
714 Ἕκτορα δάκρυ χέοντες ὀδύροντο πρὸ πυλάων,
715 εἰ μὴ ἄρ’ ἐκ δίφροιο γέρων λαοῖσι μετηύδα·
716 εἴξατέ μοι οὐρεῦσι διελθέμεν· αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
717 ἄσεσθε κλαυθμοῖο, ἐπὴν ἀγάγωμι δόμον δέ.
718 ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δὲ διέστησαν καὶ εἶξαν ἀπήνῃ.
719 οἳ δ’ ἐπεὶ εἰσάγαγον κλυτὰ δώματα, τὸν μὲν ἔπειτα
720 τρητοῖς ἐν λεχέεσσι θέσαν, παρὰ δ’ εἷσαν ἀοιδοὺς

24.721

721 θρήνων ἐξάρχους, οἵ τε στονόεσσαν ἀοιδὴν
722 οἳ μὲν ἄρ’ ἐθρήνεον, ἐπὶ δὲ στενάχοντο γυναῖκες.
723 τῇσιν δ’ Ἀνδρομάχη λευκώλενος ἦρχε γόοιο
724 Ἕκτορος ἀνδροφόνοιο κάρη μετὰ χερσὶν ἔχουσα·
725 ἄνερ ἀπ’ αἰῶνος νέος ὤλεο, κὰδ δέ με χήρην
726 λείπεις ἐν μεγάροισι· πάϊς δ’ ἔτι νήπιος αὖτως
727 ὃν τέκομεν σύ τ’ ἐγώ τε δυσάμμοροι, οὐδέ μιν οἴω

ἤβην ἴξεσθαι· πρὶν γὰρ πόλις ἥδε κατ’ ἄκρης
πέρσεται· ἦ γὰρ ὅλωλας ἐπίσκοπος, ὅς τέ μιν αὐτὴν
ῥύσκευ, ἔχες δ’ ἀλόχους κεδνὰς καὶ νήπια τέκνα,
αἳ δή τοι τάχα νηυσὶν ὀχήσονται γλαφυρῇσι,
καὶ μὲν ἐγὼ μετὰ τῇσι· σὺ δ’ αὖ τέκος ἦ ἐμοὶ αὐτῇ
ἕψεαι, ἔνθά κεν ἔργα ἀεικέα ἐργάζοιο
ἀθλεύων πρὸ ἄνακτος ἀμειλίχου, ἤ τις Ἀχαιῶν
ῥίψει χειρὸς ἑλὼν ἀπὸ πύργου λυγρὸν ὄλεθρον
χωόμενος, ᾧ δή που ἀδελφεὸν ἔκτανεν Ἕκτωρ
ἢ πατέρ’ ἠὲ καὶ υἱόν, ἐπεὶ μάλα πολλοὶ Ἀχαιῶν
Ἕκτορος ἐν παλάμῃσιν ὀδὰξ ἕλον ἄσπετον οὖδας.
οὐ γὰρ μείλιχος ἔσκε πατὴρ τεὸς ἐν δαὶ λυγρῇ·
τὼ καί μιν λαοὶ μὲν ὀδύρονται κατὰ ἄστυ,
ἀρητὸν δὲ τοκεῦσι γόον καὶ πένθος ἔθηκας
Ἕκτορ· ἐμοὶ δὲ μάλιστα λελείψεται ἄλγεα λυγρά.
οὐ γάρ μοι θνῄσκων λεχέων ἐκ χεῖρας ὄρεξας,
οὐδέ τί μοι εἶπες πυκινὸν ἔπος, οὗ τέ κεν αἰεὶ
μεμνῄμην νύκτάς τε καὶ ἤματα δάκρυ χέουσα.
ὣς ἔφατο κλαίουσ’, ἐπὶ δὲ στενάχοντο γυναῖκες.
τῇσιν δ’ αὖθ’ Ἑκάβη ἀδινοῦ ἐξῆρχε γόοιο·
Ἕκτορ ἐμῷ θυμῷ πάντων πολὺ φίλτατε παίδων,
ἦ μέν μοι ζωός περ ἐὼν φίλος ἦσθα θεοῖσιν·
οἳ δ’ ἄρα σεῦ κήδοντο καὶ ἐν θανάτοιό περ αἴσῃ.

24.751

ἄλλους μὲν γὰρ παῖδας ἐμοὺς πόδας ὠκὺς Ἀχιλλεὺς
πέρνασχ’ ὅν τιν’ ἔλεσκε πέρην ἁλὸς ἀτρυγέτοιο,
ἐς Σάμον ἔς τ’ Ἴμβρον καὶ Λῆμνον ἀμιχθαλόεσσαν·
σεῦ δ’ ἐπεὶ ἐξέλετο ψυχὴν ταναήκεϊ χαλκῷ,
πολλὰ ῥυστάζεσκεν ἑοῦ περὶ σῆμ’ ἑτάροιο
Πατρόκλου, τὸν ἔπεφνες· ἀνέστησεν δέ μιν οὐδ’ ὧς.
νῦν δέ μοι ἐρσήεις καὶ πρόσφατος ἐν μεγάροισι
κεῖσαι, τῷ ἴκελος ὅν τ’ ἀργυρότοξος Ἀπόλλων
οἷς ἀγανοῖσι βέλεσσιν ἐποιχόμενος κατέπεφνεν.
ὣς ἔφατο κλαίουσα, γόον δ’ ἀλίαστον ὄρινε.
τῇσι δ’ ἔπειθ’ Ἑλένη τριτάτη ἐξῆρχε γόοιο·
Ἕκτορ ἐμῷ θυμῷ δαέρων πολὺ φίλτατε πάντων,
ἦ μέν μοι πόσις ἐστὶν Ἀλέξανδρος θεοειδής,
ὅς μ’ ἄγαγε Τροίηνδ’· ὡς πρὶν ὤφελλον ὀλέσθαι.
ἤδη γὰρ νῦν μοι τόδε εἰκοστὸν ἔτος ἐστὶν
ἐξ οὗ κεῖθεν ἔβην καὶ ἐμῆς ἀπελήλυθα πάτρης·
ἀλλ’ οὔ πω σεῦ ἄκουσα κακὸν ἔπος οὐδ’ ἀσύφηλον·
ἀλλ’ εἴ τίς με καὶ ἄλλος ἐνὶ μεγάροισιν ἐνίπτοι
δαέρων ἢ γαλόων ἢ εἰνατέρων εὐπέπλων,
ἢ ἐκυρή, ἐκυρὸς δὲ πατὴρ ὡς ἤπιος αἰεί,
ἀλλὰ σὺ τὸν ἐπέεσσι παραιφάμενος κατέρυκες
σῇ τ’ ἀγανοφροσύνῃ καὶ σοῖς ἀγανοῖς ἐπέεσσι.
τὼ σέ θ’ ἅμα κλαίω καὶ ἔμ’ ἄμμορον ἀχνυμένη κῆρ·
οὐ γάρ τίς μοι ἔτ’ ἄλλος ἐνὶ Τροίῃ εὐρείῃ
ἤπιος οὐδὲ φίλος, πάντες δέ με πεφρίκασιν.
ὣς ἔφατο κλαίουσ’, ἐπὶ δ’ ἔστενε δῆμος ἀπείρων.

λαοῖσιν δ’ ὃ γέρων Πρίαμος μετὰ μῦθον ἔειπεν·
ἄξετε νῦν Τρῶες ξύλα ἄστυ δέ, μὴ δέ τι θυμῷ
δείσητ’ Ἀργείων πυκινὸν λόχον· ἦ γὰρ Ἀχιλλεὺς
πέμπων μ’ ὧδ’ ἐπέτελλε μελαινάων ἀπὸ νηῶν

24.781

μὴ πρὶν πημανέειν πρὶν δωδεκάτη μόλῃ ἠώς.
ὣς ἔφαθ’, οἳ δ’ ὑπ’ ἀμάξῃσιν βόας ἠμιόνους τε
ζεύγνυσαν, αἶψα δ’ ἔπειτα πρὸ ἄστεος ἠγερέθοντο.
ἐννῆμαρ μὲν τοί γε ἀγίνεον ἄσπετον ὕλην·
ἀλλ’ ὅτε δὴ δεκάτη ἐφάνη φαεσίμβροτος ἠώς,
καὶ τότ’ ἄρ’ ἐξέφερον θρασὺν Ἕκτορα δάκρυ χέοντες,
ἐν δὲ πυρῇ ὑπάτῃ νεκρὸν θέσαν, ἐν δ’ ἔβαλον πῦρ.
ἦμος δ’ ἠριγένεια φάνη ῥοδοδάκτυλος Ἠώς,
τῆμος ἄρ’ ἀμφὶ πυρὴν κλυτοῦ Ἕκτορος ἔγρετο λαός.
αὐτὰρ ἐπεί ῥ’ ἤγερθεν ὁμηγερέες τ’ ἐγένοντο
πρῶτον μὲν κατὰ πυρκαϊὴν σβέσαν αἴθοπι οἴνῳ
πᾶσαν, ὁπόσσον ἐπέσχε πυρὸς μένος· αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
ὀστέα λευκὰ λέγοντο κασίγνητοί θ’ ἕταροί τε
μυρόμενοι, θαλερὸν δὲ κατείβετο δάκρυ παρειῶν.
καὶ τά γε χρυσείην ἐς λάρνακα θῆκαν ἐλόντες
πορφυρέοις πέπλοισι καλύψαντες μαλακοῖσιν.
αἶψα δ’ ἄρ’ ἐς κοίλην κάπετον θέσαν, αὐτὰρ ὕπερθε
πυκνοῖσιν λάεσσι κατεστόρεσαν μεγάλοισι·
ῥίμφα δὲ σῆμ’ ἔχεαν, περὶ δὲ σκοποὶ ἧατο πάντῃ,
μὴ πρὶν ἐφορμηθεῖεν ἐϋκνήμιδες Ἀχαιοί.
χεύαντες δὲ τὸ σῆμα πάλιν κίον· αὐτὰρ ἔπειτα
εὖ συναγειρόμενοι δαίνυντ’ ἐρικυδέα δαῖτα
δώμασιν ἐν Πριάμοιο διοτρεφέος βασιλῆος.
ὣς οἵ γ’ ἀμφίεπον τάφον Ἕκτορος ἱπποδάμοιο.

Forthwith they yoked their oxen and mules and gathered together before the city. Nine days long did they bring in great heaps wood, and on the morning of the tenth day with many tears they took brave Hektor forth, laid his dead body upon the summit of the pile, and set the fire thereto. Then when the child of morning rosy-fingered dawn appeared on the eleventh day, the people again assembled, round the pyre of mighty Hektor. When they were got together, they first quenched the fire with wine wherever it was burning, and then his brothers and comrades with many a bitter tear gathered his white bones, wrapped them in soft robes of purple, and laid them in a golden urn, which they placed in a grave [sêma] and covered over with large stones set close together. Then they built a tomb [sêma] hurriedly over it keeping guard on every side lest the Achaeans should attack them before they had finished. When they had heaped up the barrow they went back again into the city, and being well assembled they held high feast in the house of Priam their king. Thus, then, did they celebrate the funeral of Hektor tamer of horses.